# ArcadeDB Manual

Version 26.10.1

# Table of Contents


Documentation . . . 1
1. Welcome . . . 2
1.1. ArcadeDB Documentation . . . 2
1.1.1. Tutorials . . . 2
1.1.2. ArcadeDB Academy . . . 2
1.1.3. Use Cases . . . 2
1.1.4. Community & Resources . . . 2
2. Get Started . . . 3
2.1. Get Started with ArcadeDB . . . 3
2.1.1. Choose your starting point . . . 3
2.1.2. Connect from your application . . . 3
2.1.3. Pick a query language . . . 3
2.1.4. Next steps . . . 3
2.2. What is ArcadeDB? . . . 4
2.2.1. TL;DR . . . 4
2.2.2. The problem with running many databases . . . 4
2.2.3. One engine, every model . . . 5
2.2.4. The graph model is our core — and it's native . . . 6
2.2.5. The other models you get . . . 6
2.2.6. Pick the query language your team already knows . . . 7
2.2.7. Embedded or server, your choice . . . 8
2.2.8. Why it's so fast . . . 8
2.2.9. Apache 2.0, free for commercial use . . . 8
2.2.10. Where to next . . . 8
2.3. Run ArcadeDB . . . 9
2.3.1. Embedded . . . 9
2.3.2. Client-Server . . . 9
2.3.3. High Availability (HA) . . . 9
2.3.4. Getting Started . . . 9
2.4. Docker . . . 10
2.4.1. Quick start with the OpenBeer database . . . 11
2.4.2. Persistence . . . 13
2.4.3. Tuning . . . 15
3. Examples . . . 16
3.1. Vector Search Tutorial . . . 16
3.1.1. What You Will Build . . . 16
3.1.2. Prerequisites . . . 16
3.1.3. Step 1: Create the Schema . . . 16

3.1.4. Step 2: Create a Vector Index . . . 16
3.1.5. Step 3: Insert Data with Embeddings . . . 16
3.1.6. Step 4: Query by Similarity . . . 17
3.1.7. Step 5: Add Graph Relationships . . . 17
3.1.8. Step 6: Combine Vector Search with Graph Traversal . . . 18
3.1.9. Step 7: Use Different Similarity Metrics . . . 18
3.1.10. Step 8: Control Search Quality with efSearch . . . 19
3.1.11. Step 9: Enable Quantization for Large Datasets . . . 19
3.1.12. Next Steps . . . 19
3.2. Time Series Tutorial . . . 19
3.2.1. Prerequisites . . . 20
3.2.2. Step 1: Create a TimeSeries Type . . . 20
3.2.3. Step 2: Ingest Data via InfluxDB Line Protocol . . . 20
3.2.4. Step 3: Ingest Data via SQL . . . 21
3.2.5. Step 4: Query with Time Range Filters . . . 21
3.2.6. Step 5: Aggregate with Time Bucketing . . . 21
3.2.7. Step 6: Calculate Rates and Percentiles . . . 21
3.2.8. Step 7: Fill Gaps with Interpolation . . . 22
3.2.9. Step 8: Query with PromQL . . . 22
3.2.10. Step 9: Create a Continuous Aggregate . . . 23
3.2.11. Step 10: Set Up Retention and Downsampling . . . 23
3.2.12. Next Steps . . . 23
3.3. Recommendation Engine . . . 23
3.3.1. Architecture Overview . . . 24
3.3.2. Key Queries . . . 24
3.3.3. Try It Yourself . . . 25
3.3.4. Related Documentation . . . 25
3.4. Knowledge Graphs . . . 25
3.4.1. Architecture Overview . . . 25
3.4.2. Key Queries . . . 25
3.4.3. Try It Yourself . . . 26
3.4.4. Related Documentation . . . 26
3.5. Graph RAG . . . 27
3.5.1. Architecture Overview . . . 27
3.5.2. Key Queries . . . 27
3.5.3. Try It Yourself . . . 28
3.5.4. Related Documentation . . . 28
3.6. Fraud Detection . . . 28
3.6.1. Architecture Overview . . . 28
3.6.2. Key Queries . . . 29
3.6.3. Try It Yourself . . . 29

3.6.4. Related Documentation . . . 29
3.7. Realtime Analytics . . . 30
3.7.1. Architecture Overview . . . 30
3.7.2. Key Queries . . . 30
3.7.3. Try It Yourself . . . 30
3.7.4. Related Documentation . . . 31
3.8. Social Network Analytics . . . 31
3.8.1. Architecture Overview . . . 31
3.8.2. Key Queries . . . 31
3.8.3. Try It Yourself . . . 32
3.8.4. Related Documentation . . . 32
3.9. Supply Chain . . . 32
3.9.1. Architecture Overview . . . 32
3.9.2. Key Queries . . . 33
3.9.3. Try It Yourself . . . 33
3.9.4. Related Documentation . . . 33
3.10. Identity & Access Management . . . 34
3.10.1. Architecture Overview . . . 34
3.10.2. Key Queries . . . 34
3.10.3. Try It Yourself . . . 35
3.10.4. Related Documentation . . . 35
3.11. Customer 360 . . . 35
3.11.1. Architecture Overview . . . 35
3.11.2. Key Queries . . . 35
3.11.3. Try It Yourself . . . 36
3.11.4. Related Documentation . . . 37
3.12. Semantic Search (Planned) . . . 37
3.12.1. Planned Features . . . 37
3.12.2. Reference Hybrid Query . . . 37
3.12.3. Target Scenarios . . . 38
3.13. Geospatial Analytics (Planned) . . . 38
3.13.1. Planned Features . . . 38
3.13.2. Target Scenarios . . . 38
3.14. Content Management (Planned) . . . 38
3.14.1. Planned Features . . . 38
3.14.2. Target Scenarios . . . 39
3.15. Network Monitoring (Planned) . . . 39
3.15.1. Planned Features . . . 39
3.15.2. Target Scenarios . . . 39
3.16. Data Lineage (Planned) . . . 39
3.16.1. Planned Features . . . 40

3.16.2. Target Scenarios . . . 40
4. Languages & Drivers . . . 41
4.1. Languages & Drivers . . . 41
4.2. Java . . . 41
4.2.1. Embedded . . . 41
4.2.2. Remote . . . 51
4.3. Database API . . . 52
4.3.1. `DatabaseFactory` Class . . . 52
4.3.2. close() . . . 52
4.3.3. exists() . . . 52
4.3.4. Database create() . . . 52
4.3.5. Database open() . . . 53
4.3.6. Database open(MODE mode) . . . 53
4.3.7. `Database` Interface . . . 53
4.3.8. Methods . . . 53
4.4. `DatabaseAsyncExecutor` Interface . . . 70
4.5. Schema . . . 79
4.5.1. Creating many types at once . . . 80
4.5.2. Working with buckets . . . 80
4.5.3. Working with indexes . . . 81
4.5.4. Indexing Edges . . . 82
4.5.5. Database Configuration . . . 83
4.6. Native Select API . . . 83
4.6.1. Quick Start . . . 83
4.6.2. Building Queries . . . 83
4.6.3. Terminal Operations . . . 86
4.6.4. Pagination and Ordering . . . 88
4.6.5. Compiled Queries . . . 88
4.6.6. Parallel Execution . . . 90
4.6.7. Timeout . . . 90
4.6.8. Index Detection . . . 91
4.6.9. Graph Traversal . . . 91
4.6.10. Vector k-NN Search . . . 93
4.6.11. Complete Example . . . 94
4.7. Embedded Documents . . . 95
4.8. Events . . . 97
4.9. Graph Batch . . . 98
4.9.1. Quick Start . . . 99
4.9.2. How It Works . . . 99
4.9.3. Edges with Properties . . . 99
4.9.4. Builder Options . . . 100

4.9.5. Auto-Tuning Batch Size . . . 101
4.9.6. Key Methods . . . 101
4.9.7. Transactions . . . 102
4.9.8. Performance . . . 102
4.9.9. Importing into an Existing Graph . . . 102
4.9.10. HTTP Batch Endpoint . . . 103
4.9.11. Relationship with GraphImporter . . . 103
4.10. Working with Vector Embeddings . . . 103
4.10.1. Key Features . . . 103
4.10.2. Creating Vector Indexes with SQL . . . 103
4.10.3. Memory and Performance Tuning . . . 110
4.10.4. Vector Quantization . . . 117
4.10.5. Querying Vector Indexes with SQL . . . 123
4.10.6. Using the Java API . . . 126
4.10.7. Migration from HnswVectorIndexRAM . . . 129
4.10.8. Best Practices . . . 130
4.10.9. Common Use Cases . . . 130
4.11. Java API (Remote) . . . 131
4.11.1. RemoteServer Class . . . 132
4.11.2. RemoteDatabase Class . . . 132
4.11.3. 10-Minute Tutorial . . . 132
4.11.4. RemoteImmutableVertex and RemoteMutableVertex . . . 133
4.12. Java API (gRPC) . . . 136
4.12.1. Why Use gRPC for ArcadeDB? . . . 136
4.12.2. RemoteGrpcServer Class . . . 137
4.12.3. RemoteGrpcDatabase Class . . . 137
4.12.4. Maven Dependencies . . . 137
4.12.5. 10-Minute Tutorial . . . 138
4.12.6. Transaction Management . . . 146
4.12.7. Error Handling . . . 146
4.12.8. Performance Tips . . . 147
4.12.9. Complete Example . . . 147
4.12.10. See Also . . . 148
4.13. JDBC Driver . . . 149
4.14. Neo4j BOLT Protocol . . . 149
4.14.1. Choosing a protocol for low latency . . . 150
4.14.2. Setup . . . 150
4.14.3. Configuration . . . 151
4.14.4. Access Control . . . 152
4.14.5. TLS/SSL . . . 152
4.14.6. Server Identity and Feature Envelope . . . 153

4.14.7. Compatible Drivers . . . 153
4.14.8. Connection URI Schemes . . . 154
4.14.9. Java Example . . . 154
4.14.10. Python Example . . . 155
4.14.11. JavaScript Example . . . 156
4.14.12. Go Example . . . 156
4.14.13. Cypher Query Examples . . . 157
4.14.14. Transactions . . . 158
4.14.15. Listing and terminating running statements . . . 159
4.14.16. Causal Consistency (Bookmarks) . . . 159
4.14.17. Data Type Mapping . . . 160
4.14.18. Error Codes . . . 160
4.14.19. Routing and High Availability . . . 161
4.14.20. Current Limitations . . . 162
4.14.21. Troubleshooting . . . 162
4.14.22. See Also . . . 162
4.14.23. Numeric ids . . . 163
4.15. Native Drivers . . . 163
4.15.1. HTTP or gRPC? . . . 163
4.15.2. The result envelope, and why `truncated` matters . . . 164
4.15.3. Versions and server compatibility . . . 164
4.16. Python — HTTP Driver . . . 164
4.16.1. Install . . . 164
4.16.2. Connect and query . . . 165
4.16.3. Sync and async . . . 165
4.16.4. Close your client . . . 166
4.16.5. Transactions . . . 166
4.16.6. Two error models . . . 167
4.16.7. Choosing a protocol from Python . . . 168
4.16.8. Next steps . . . 169
4.17. Python — gRPC Driver . . . 169
4.17.1. Install . . . 169
4.17.2. Connect and query . . . 170
4.17.3. `raw` and the three wrappers . . . 171
4.17.4. Authentication is attached to the channel . . . 172
4.17.5. Streaming queries . . . 173
4.17.6. Streaming inserts . . . 174
4.17.7. Transactions . . . 174
4.17.8. Errors . . . 175
4.17.9. Async . . . 176
4.17.10. Next steps . . . 177

4.18. Python . . . 177
4.18.1. Prerequisites . . . 177
4.18.2. Connect to ArcadeDB . . . 177
4.18.3. Create a Schema . . . 178
4.18.4. Query with SQL . . . 178
4.18.5. Query with Cypher . . . 178
4.18.6. Vector Search . . . 179
4.18.7. Full Example . . . 179
4.18.8. HTTP / JSON API . . . 180
4.18.9. Embedded Python Bindings . . . 181
4.18.10. Next Steps . . . 181
4.19. JavaScript / TypeScript — HTTP Driver . . . 181
4.19.1. Install . . . 181
4.19.2. Connect and query . . . 181
4.19.3. The result envelope . . . 183
4.19.4. Transactions . . . 183
4.19.5. Two error models . . . 184
4.19.6. Next steps . . . 185
4.20. JavaScript / TypeScript — gRPC Driver . . . 185
4.20.1. Install . . . 185
4.20.2. Runtime targets: Node, Bun, Deno — not browsers . . . 185
4.20.3. Connect and query . . . 185
4.20.4. `record.properties` and the `GrpcValue` wrapper . . . 187
4.20.5. Authentication and the insecure guard . . . 188
4.20.6. Streaming queries and `retrievalMode` . . . 188
4.20.7. Streaming inserts . . . 190
4.20.8. Transactions . . . 190
4.20.9. Errors . . . 191
4.20.10. Next steps . . . 192
4.21. JavaScript / TypeScript . . . 192
4.21.1. Prerequisites . . . 193
4.21.2. Connect to ArcadeDB . . . 193
4.21.3. Create a Schema . . . 193
4.21.4. Query with SQL . . . 194
4.21.5. Query with Cypher . . . 194
4.21.6. Vector Search . . . 194
4.21.7. Full Example . . . 195
4.21.8. Next Steps . . . 196
4.22. HTTP / JSON from JavaScript . . . 196
4.22.1. Using fetch . . . 197
4.22.2. Using axios . . . 198

4.22.3. TypeScript . . . 198
4.22.4. Further Reading . . . 198
4.23. Go — HTTP Driver . . . 199
4.23.1. Install . . . 199
4.23.2. Connect and query . . . 199
4.23.3. Streaming queries . . . 201
4.23.4. Transactions . . . 202
4.23.5. Two error models . . . 203
4.23.6. Beyond queries . . . 203
4.23.7. Next steps . . . 204
4.24. Go — gRPC Driver . . . 204
4.24.1. Install . . . 204
4.24.2. Connect and query . . . 204
4.24.3. `Raw()` and the facade . . . 205
4.24.4. Authentication is attached to the connection . . . 207
4.24.5. Streaming queries . . . 207
4.24.6. Streaming inserts . . . 208
4.24.7. Transactions . . . 209
4.24.8. Errors . . . 210
4.24.9. Administration: `RawAdmin` . . . 211
4.24.10. Next steps . . . 211
4.25. Go . . . 211
4.25.1. Prerequisites . . . 212
4.25.2. Connect to ArcadeDB . . . 212
4.25.3. Create a Schema . . . 213
4.25.4. Query with SQL . . . 214
4.25.5. Query with Cypher . . . 214
4.25.6. Vector Search . . . 215
4.25.7. Full Example . . . 216
4.25.8. Next Steps . . . 217
4.26. C# . . . 217
4.26.1. Sample Code . . . 217
4.27. C . . . 218
4.27.1. PostgreSQL Wire Protocol — `libpq` . . . 218
4.27.2. HTTP/JSON API — `libcurl` . . . 219
4.28. C++ . . . 220
4.28.1. PostgreSQL Wire Protocol — `libpqxx` . . . 220
4.28.2. HTTP/JSON API — `cpp-httplib` . . . 221
4.29. Rust . . . 221
4.29.1. Neo4j BOLT — `neo4rs` . . . 221
4.29.2. PostgreSQL Wire Protocol — `postgres` . . . 222

4.29.3. HTTP/JSON API — `reqwest` 222
4.30. Ruby 223
4.30.1. Neo4j BOLT — `neo4j-ruby-driver` 223
4.30.2. PostgreSQL Wire Protocol — `pg` 224
4.30.3. HTTP/JSON API — `Net::HTTP` 224
4.31. R 224
4.31.1. PostgreSQL Wire Protocol — `RPostgres` 225
4.31.2. HTTP/JSON API — `httr2` 225
4.32. Elixir 226
4.32.1. Configuration 226
4.32.2. Sample Code 226
5. API & Integration 228
5.1. API & Integration 228
5.2. HTTP/JSON API 228
5.2.1. Introduction 229
5.2.2. Token-Based Authentication 229
5.2.3. Server-Side Transactions 231
5.2.4. Transaction Scripts 232
5.2.5. Streaming Change Events 232
5.2.6. Streaming Inserts over WebSocket 233
5.2.7. Responses 235
5.2.8. Retrying Requests Safely (`X-Request-Id`) 235
5.2.9. Tutorial 236
5.2.10. Reference 237
5.2.11. Numbers and arrays in `params` 260
5.3. gRPC API 273
5.3.1. Enabling the gRPC server 273
5.3.2. Services 274
5.3.3. Cancellation and running statements 281
5.3.4. Message Types 282
5.4. Bolt Driver Compatibility Matrix 285
5.4.1. Certified Feature Areas 285
5.4.2. Error Codes 286
5.4.3. Documented Limitations 287
5.4.4. Certified Drivers and Versions 287
5.4.5. See Also 288
5.5. Postgres Protocol Plugin 288
5.5.1. Other query languages 289
5.5.2. TLS/SSL 290
5.5.3. Current limitations 290
5.5.4. System catalog and schema introspection 291

5.5.5. COPY … TO STDOUT . . . 292
5.5.6. Column type mapping . . . 293
5.5.7. Transactions . . . 294
5.5.8. Session settings (SET, SHOW, RESET) . . . 295
5.5.9. Cancelling a statement . . . 296
5.5.10. Postgres Tools Known to Work . . . 297
5.6. MCP Server . . . 298
5.6.1. Endpoint . . . 298
5.6.2. Configuration . . . 299
5.6.3. Tool Profiles . . . 300
5.6.4. Per-Database Scoping . . . 301
5.6.5. Configuration Endpoint . . . 302
5.6.6. MCP Protocol Methods . . . 303
5.6.7. Available Tools . . . 304
5.6.8. Resources . . . 321
5.6.9. Prompts . . . 322
5.6.10. Transport . . . 325
5.6.11. Security . . . 326
5.6.12. Using with AI Clients . . . 327
6. Data Modeling . . . 328
6.1. Multi-Model Architecture . . . 328
6.1.1. Why Multi-Model Matters . . . 328
6.1.2. The Latency Problem with Multiple Databases . . . 329
6.1.3. Supported Data Models . . . 329
6.1.4. Unified Query Layer . . . 332
6.1.5. Type Inheritance Across Models . . . 332
6.1.6. Schema Flexibility . . . 333
6.1.7. Cross-Model Queries . . . 333
6.2. Graph Database . . . 333
6.2.1. Graph Components . . . 333
6.2.2. Graph Database Types . . . 334
6.2.3. Why (Property) Graph Databases? . . . 334
6.2.4. See Also . . . 334
6.3. Time Series . . . 334
6.3.1. Creating a TimeSeries Type . . . 335
6.3.2. Altering a TimeSeries Type . . . 337
6.3.3. Compacting a TimeSeries Type . . . 338
6.3.4. Dropping a TimeSeries Type . . . 338
6.3.5. Ingesting Data . . . 339
6.3.6. Querying Time Series Data . . . 343
6.3.7. Moving the bucket grid . . . 346

6.3.8. PromQL Query Language . . . 352
6.3.9. Continuous Aggregates . . . 354
6.3.10. Retention Policies . . . 355
6.3.11. Downsampling Policies . . . 356
6.3.12. Grafana Integration . . . 357
6.3.13. Studio TimeSeries Explorer . . . 357
6.3.14. HTTP API Reference . . . 358
6.3.15. High Availability . . . 359
6.3.16. Integrity Checking . . . 359
6.3.17. Comparison with Other TimeSeries Databases . . . 361
6.3.18. Choosing the layout: `COMPACTION_INTERVAL` and `SHARDS` . . . 362
6.3.19. Architecture . . . 363
6.4. Vector . . . 363
6.4.1. How Vector Search Works . . . 364
6.4.2. LSMVectorIndex Architecture . . . 364
6.4.3. Flat vs Hierarchical Structure . . . 364
6.4.4. Similarity Functions . . . 364
6.4.5. Quantization . . . 365
6.4.6. Vector Encoding (Pre-Quantized Ingest) . . . 367
6.4.7. Store Embeddings in an `EXTERNAL` Property . . . 368
6.4.8. Key Parameters . . . 369
6.4.9. efSearch and Adaptive Search . . . 374
6.4.10. Filtered Search . . . 375
6.4.11. Multi-Modal Search . . . 376
6.4.12. Integration with Other Models . . . 377
6.4.13. SQL Example . . . 377
6.4.14. Java Example . . . 377
6.4.15. Configuration Parameters . . . 378
6.4.16. Supported Similarity Functions . . . 378
6.4.17. Sparse Vector Search . . . 378
6.4.18. Hybrid Search with `vector.fuse` . . . 381
6.4.19. Group-By Retrieval . . . 383
6.4.20. Further Reading . . . 384
6.5. Geospatial Index . . . 384
6.5.1. Creating a Geospatial Index . . . 384
6.5.2. Inserting Geometries . . . 385
6.5.3. Querying with Spatial Predicates . . . 386
6.5.4. How Index-Accelerated Queries Work . . . 386
6.5.5. geo.* Functions Reference . . . 386
6.5.6. Practical Examples . . . 392
6.5.7. Notes and Limitations . . . 393

6.6. Full-Text Index and BM25 Ranking . . . 394
6.6.1. Creating a Full-Text Index . . . 394
6.6.2. Configuring the Analyzer . . . 395
6.6.3. Searching . . . 396
6.6.4. Lucene Query Syntax . . . 397
6.6.5. Relevance Scoring . . . 400
6.6.6. More Like This . . . 401
6.6.7. Practical Examples . . . 404
6.6.8. Maintenance: BM25 Corpus Statistics . . . 406
6.6.9. Behavior Changes When Upgrading . . . 406
6.6.10. Getting BM25 on Existing Indexes . . . 407
6.6.11. Notes . . . 407
6.7. Key/Value . . . 407
6.7.1. How Keys Work in ArcadeDB . . . 407
6.7.2. Key/Value with the Redis Wire Protocol . . . 408
6.7.3. Key/Value with the Java API . . . 409
6.7.4. Key/Value over HTTP . . . 409
6.7.5. Comparison with Other Models . . . 410
6.7.6. Why ArcadeDB for Key/Value . . . 410
6.7.7. Further Reading . . . 410
6.8. Record . . . 410
6.8.1. Document . . . 411
6.8.2. Vertex . . . 411
6.8.3. Edge . . . 411
6.8.4. Record ID . . . 411
6.8.5. Types . . . 412
6.8.6. Buckets . . . 413
6.8.7. Types vs. Buckets in Queries . . . 413
6.8.8. One bucket per period . . . 413
6.8.9. One bucket per location . . . 414
6.8.10. Bucket Selection Strategy . . . 415
6.8.11. Relationships . . . 418
6.8.12. Graph Connections . . . 418
6.8.13. Referenced Relationships . . . 418
6.8.14. Embedded Relationships . . . 419
6.8.15. 1:1 and n:1 Embedded Relationships . . . 419
6.8.16. 1:n and n:n Embedded Relationships . . . 419
6.8.17. Inverse Relationships . . . 419
6.8.18. Edge Constraints . . . 420
6.8.19. Relationship Traversal Complexity . . . 420
6.9. Database . . . 420

6.9.1. Database URL . . . 421
6.9.2. Database lifecycle . . . 421
6.9.3. Creating Databases . . . 421
6.10. Schema . . . 423
6.10.1. Types . . . 423
6.10.2. Properties . . . 423
6.10.3. Buckets . . . 425
6.10.4. Indexes . . . 426
6.10.5. Triggers . . . 426
6.10.6. Materialized Views . . . 427
6.11. Inheritance . . . 427
6.12. Indexes . . . 428
6.12.1. Why (and when) to add an index . . . 428
6.12.2. Index Types at a Glance . . . 429
6.12.3. LSM Tree (default) . . . 429
6.12.4. Hash Index . . . 431
6.12.5. Dense Vector Index (LSM_VECTOR) . . . 433
6.12.6. Sparse Vector Index (LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR) . . . 433
6.12.7. Full-Text Index . . . 434
6.12.8. Geospatial Index . . . 434
6.12.9. Case-Insensitive Indexes (COLLATE CI) . . . 434
6.12.10. Building a large index over existing data (sorted bulk build) . . . 436
6.12.11. What can be indexed . . . 437
6.12.12. See also . . . 438
6.13. Transactions . . . 438
6.13.1. ACID Properties . . . 439
6.13.2. Atomicity . . . 439
6.13.3. Consistency . . . 439
6.13.4. Isolation . . . 439
6.13.5. Durability . . . 442
6.13.6. Optimistic Transaction . . . 445
6.13.7. Nested transactions and propagation . . . 445
6.14. Data Types . . . 445
6.15. Binary Types (BLOB) . . . 449
6.16. Managing Dates . . . 450
6.17. Materialized Views . . . 458
6.17.1. Refresh Modes . . . 458
6.17.2. View Status . . . 459
6.17.3. Querying a Materialized View . . . 459
6.17.4. Java API . . . 460
6.17.5. Behavior and Constraints . . . 461

6.17.6. Error Handling . . . 461
6.17.7. Limitations . . . 462
6.17.8. Example: Sales Dashboard . . . 462
6.18. Vector Embeddings . . . 463
6.18.1. Choosing an Embedding Model . . . 463
6.18.2. Creating a Vector Index . . . 463
6.18.3. Choosing a Similarity Function . . . 464
6.18.4. Quantization Trade-offs . . . 464
6.18.5. INT8 Pre-Quantized Ingest . . . 465
6.18.6. Tuning for Recall vs Speed . . . 466
6.18.7. Tuning efSearch . . . 466
6.18.8. Multi-Modal Embeddings . . . 467
6.18.9. Searching a Type Hierarchy . . . 467
6.18.10. Hybrid Search: Dense + Sparse + Full-Text . . . 468
6.18.11. Batch Ingestion . . . 469
6.18.12. Searching Vectors Not Yet in the Graph . . . 470
6.18.13. Rebuild Memory and Deferred Rebuilds . . . 471
6.18.14. Global Configuration . . . 473
6.18.15. Further Reading . . . 474
7. Import & Migration . . . 475
7.1. Importer . . . 475
7.1.1. Additional Settings . . . 478
7.1.2. Transactions . . . 478
7.1.3. CSV rows and the header . . . 478
7.1.4. Import report . . . 479
7.2. Graph Importer . . . 484
7.2.1. How It Works . . . 484
7.2.2. Memory and Progress . . . 485
7.2.3. Command-Line Usage . . . 485
7.2.4. Java API . . . 486
7.2.5. JSON Configuration . . . 486
7.2.6. Complete Example . . . 491
7.2.7. Identities and Missing Edges . . . 492
7.2.8. Supported File Formats . . . 493
7.2.9. Data Sources (Java API) . . . 493
7.3. JSON Importer . . . 494
7.4. OrientDB Importer . . . 498
7.4.1. What the import preserves . . . 498
7.4.2. Differences with OrientDB . . . 498
7.4.3. Architecture . . . 498
7.4.4. Data Model . . . 499

7.4.5. Geospatial Data (OPoint and other spatial types) . . . 499
7.4.6. SQL . . . 500
7.4.7. API . . . 500
7.4.8. Connectivity . . . 501
7.4.9. Migration . . . 501
7.5. Neo4j Importer . . . 501
7.5.1. Performance . . . 502
7.5.2. Multi-label handling . . . 502
7.5.3. Importing via SQL . . . 502
7.5.4. Importing via command line . . . 503
7.5.5. Memory considerations . . . 503
7.5.6. Differences with Neo4j . . . 504
7.5.7. What's compatible . . . 504
7.5.8. Where ArcadeDB goes further . . . 504
7.5.9. Performance comparison . . . 505
7.5.10. Connecting an existing Neo4j application . . . 505
7.5.11. Importing a Neo4j database . . . 506
7.5.12. Multi-label nodes . . . 506
7.5.13. Schema and constraints . . . 506
7.5.14. Embedding ArcadeDB . . . 507
7.5.15. Further reading . . . 508
8. Self-Managed Deployment . . . 509
8.1. Installations from Binaries . . . 509
8.1.1. Binaries . . . 509
8.1.2. macOS via Homebrew . . . 509
8.1.3. Manual installation on macOS . . . 510
8.1.4. Windows via Scoop . . . 510
8.1.5. Custom Package Builder . . . 510
8.1.6. Prerequisites . . . 511
8.1.7. Quick Start . . . 511
8.1.8. Available Modules . . . 511
8.1.9. Usage Examples . . . 512
8.1.10. Command-Line Options . . . 513
8.1.11. Output Files . . . 513
8.2. Installation with Docker . . . 513
8.3. Kubernetes . . . 514
8.3.1. Prerequisites . . . 514
8.3.2. Quickstart with kind . . . 514
8.3.3. Installing the chart . . . 515
8.3.4. Configuration reference . . . 516
8.3.5. Operating the cluster . . . 532

8.3.6. High Availability on Kubernetes . . . 534
8.3.7. Troubleshooting . . . 535
8.3.8. Reference deployment . . . 536
8.4. Embedded Server . . . 536
8.4.1. Java 17 notes . . . 538
8.4.2. Start the server in the JVM . . . 538
8.4.3. Create custom HTTP commands . . . 539
8.4.4. HTTPS connection . . . 541
8.4.5. Replication between boxes . . . 541
8.5. Server . . . 542
8.5.1. Start server hint . . . 544
8.5.2. Server modes . . . 544
8.5.3. Create default database(s) . . . 546
8.5.4. Logging . . . 548
8.5.5. Server Plugins (Extend The Server) . . . 549
8.5.6. Metrics . . . 550
8.6. Changing Settings . . . 551
8.6.1. Environment Variables . . . 551
8.6.2. RAM Configuration . . . 552
8.7. High Availability . . . 553
8.7.1. Leader-Replica Replication Model . . . 553
8.7.2. Server Roles and Election . . . 553
8.7.3. Replication and the Raft Log . . . 554
8.7.4. Write Quorum . . . 554
8.7.5. Read Consistency . . . 555
8.7.6. Automatic Failover . . . 555
8.7.7. Split-Brain Protection . . . 556
8.7.8. Snapshots and Catch-Up . . . 556
8.7.9. Cluster Bootstrap from Pre-Staged Data . . . 556
8.7.10. Dynamic Membership . . . 556
8.7.11. Cluster Discovery and Configuration . . . 556
8.7.12. Continuous Correctness Testing with Jepsen . . . 557
8.8. High Availability . . . 559
8.8.1. Quick Start . . . 559
8.8.2. Server List Entry Format . . . 560
8.8.3. Client Routing Ports (`bolt`, `grpc`) . . . 561
8.8.4. Peer-to-Peer Endpoints (`http`, `https`) . . . 561
8.8.5. Named Peers . . . 563
8.8.6. Architecture . . . 564
8.8.7. Schema Replication . . . 565
8.8.8. Schema Delta Replication (from v26.10.1) . . . 565

8.8.9. Write Quorum . . . 566
8.8.10. Read Consistency . . . 566
8.8.11. Load Shedding and Backpressure . . . 567
8.8.12. Witness / Read-Scale Nodes . . . 568
8.8.13. Automatic Failover . . . 568
8.8.14. Replication-Channel Self-Healing . . . 568
8.8.15. Durable Raft Storage . . . 570
8.8.16. Committed-remotely response contract . . . 570
8.8.17. Running statements on a cluster . . . 571
8.8.18. Offline Cluster Bootstrap . . . 571
8.8.19. When a node has stopped for good . . . 572
8.8.20. Cluster Management REST API . . . 573
8.8.21. Verify Outcomes . . . 577
8.8.22. Studio Cluster Dashboard . . . 578
8.8.23. Security . . . 578
8.8.24. TLS/SSL for peer-to-peer transfers . . . 579
8.8.25. mTLS for the Raft gRPC transport (from v26.9.1) . . . 581
8.8.26. Kubernetes . . . 586
8.8.27. Troubleshooting . . . 586
8.8.28. HA Settings . . . 589
8.9. Backup of a Database . . . 594
8.9.1. Consistency of TimeSeries data . . . 594
8.9.2. Configuration . . . 595
8.9.3. Cloud Backups . . . 595
8.10. Automatic Backup Scheduler . . . 595
8.10.1. Features . . . 595
8.10.2. Configuration File . . . 596
8.10.3. Configuration Options . . . 597
8.10.4. CRON Expressions . . . 599
8.10.5. HA Cluster Support . . . 599
8.10.6. Backup Directory Structure . . . 600
8.10.7. Monitoring . . . 600
8.10.8. Studio Integration . . . 601
8.10.9. Triggering Manual Backups . . . 601
8.10.10. Database Lifecycle . . . 603
8.10.11. Troubleshooting . . . 603
8.11. Restore a Database . . . 603
8.11.1. Restore via HTTP API (recommended) . . . 604
8.11.2. Restore via command line . . . 604
8.11.3. Configuration . . . 605
8.12. Monitoring . . . 605

8.12.1. Enabling Metrics . . . 605
8.12.2. Prometheus Integration . . . 605
8.12.3. Available Metrics . . . 606
8.12.4. Periodic Metric Dumps . . . 608
8.12.5. Grafana Dashboard Setup . . . 608
8.12.6. Health Checks . . . 608
8.12.7. Server health warnings . . . 608
8.12.8. Further Reading . . . 609
8.13. Cloud Observability . . . 609
8.13.1. Metrics depth . . . 609
8.13.2. Distributed tracing . . . 611
8.13.3. Structured logging and correlation IDs . . . 612
8.13.4. Health probes . . . 613
8.13.5. Further reading . . . 614
8.14. Logging . . . 615
8.14.1. The default logger (java.util.logging) . . . 615
8.14.2. Per-package verbosity . . . 616
8.14.3. Log directory . . . 616
8.14.4. Console format . . . 617
8.14.5. Routing through SLF4J when embedding . . . 617
8.14.6. Custom logger implementations . . . 618
8.14.7. Further Reading . . . 619
8.15. Upgrade ArcadeDB . . . 619
8.15.1. Breaking changes . . . 619
8.15.2. Single-server upgrade . . . 627
8.15.3. What to copy . . . 627
8.15.4. HA cluster upgrade . . . 629
8.15.5. Docker / Kubernetes . . . 630
8.15.6. Downgrade ArcadeDB . . . 630
8.15.7. Downgrading a node of an HA cluster . . . 630
9. Security . . . 632
9.1. Users . . . 632
9.1.1. Via Console . . . 634
9.1.2. Via Cypher . . . 634
9.1.3. Password hash format . . . 634
9.2. Groups . . . 635
9.3. Security Policy . . . 638
9.4. Handling Secrets . . . 639
9.5. Gremlin Security . . . 640
9.5.1. Execution Engines . . . 640
9.5.2. Who Can Evaluate Groovy . . . 641

9.5.3. Configuration . . . 641
9.5.4. Security Best Practices . . . 642
9.5.5. Security Limitations (Groovy Engine) . . . 642
9.5.6. Migration from Groovy to Java Engine . . . 642
9.5.7. Security Considerations . . . 643
10. Tools . . . 644
10.1. Studio . . . 644
10.1.1. Main menu . . . 644
10.1.2. Login and themes . . . 645
10.2. Query Panel . . . 645
10.2.1. Left icon sidebar . . . 646
10.2.2. Editor and toolbar . . . 647
10.2.3. Index search (Vector, Hybrid, Full-text) . . . 647
10.2.4. Result views . . . 648
10.3. Database Panel . . . 652
10.3.1. Schema . . . 653
10.3.2. Buckets . . . 653
10.3.3. Indexes . . . 654
10.3.4. Dictionary . . . 654
10.3.5. Time Series . . . 655
10.3.6. Metrics . . . 655
10.3.7. Database Settings . . . 656
10.3.8. Backup . . . 656
10.4. Time Series Sub-tab . . . 657
10.4.1. Query . . . 658
10.4.2. Schema . . . 658
10.4.3. Quick Tour . . . 659
10.5. Server Panel . . . 659
10.5.1. Summary . . . 660
10.5.2. Metrics . . . 661
10.5.3. Sessions . . . 662
10.5.4. Running Queries . . . 662
10.5.5. Events . . . 663
10.5.6. Server Settings . . . 663
10.5.7. Backup . . . 663
10.5.8. MCP . . . 664
10.6. Profiler Panel . . . 665
10.6.1. Toolbar . . . 665
10.6.2. Summary . . . 666
10.6.3. Query list . . . 666
10.6.4. Query detail . . . 666

10.6.5. AI analysis . . . 667
10.7. Security Panel . . . 668
10.7.1. Users . . . 668
10.7.2. User Groups . . . 669
10.7.3. API Tokens . . . 669
10.7.4. Group and Token Changes During a Rolling Upgrade . . . 670
10.8. Cluster Panel . . . 671
10.8.1. Overview . . . 671
10.8.2. Metrics . . . 672
10.8.3. Management . . . 672
10.9. API Panel . . . 672
10.9.1. Endpoint sidebar . . . 673
10.9.2. Detail pane . . . 673
10.9.3. Try It playground . . . 674
10.10. Info Panel . . . 675
10.10.1. Documentation sidebar . . . 676
10.10.2. Feature overview . . . 676
10.11. AI Assistant Panel . . . 676
10.11.1. Subscription . . . 677
10.11.2. Activation . . . 677
10.11.3. Using the assistant . . . 679
10.11.4. Modes . . . 679
10.11.5. Executing suggested commands . . . 679
10.11.6. Privacy and security notes . . . 680
10.12. Settings Panel . . . 680
10.12.1. Appearance . . . 680
10.13. Console . . . 681
10.13.1. Tutorial . . . 683
10.13.2. Settings . . . 686
10.13.3. Scripting . . . 686
10.13.4. Console-Server Interaction . . . 687
10.14. Swagger-UI . . . 687
10.15. Compatible Tools . . . 689
10.15.1. gdotv . . . 689
10.15.2. JetBrains DataGrip/Database Plugin . . . 691
10.15.3. DBeaver . . . 693
10.15.4. DbVisualizer . . . 698
10.15.5. DbGate . . . 703
10.15.6. LibreOffice Base . . . 705
11. BI & Analytics . . . 711
11.1. BI and Analytics Integration . . . 711

11.1.1. Connection paths . . . 711
11.1.2. Supported tools . . . 711
11.1.3. Setting up the Postgres endpoint . . . 712
11.1.4. Sending non-SQL queries from a Postgres-only tool . . . 712
11.1.5. Suggesting a missing tool . . . 712
11.2. Apache Superset . . . 713
11.2.1. Setup . . . 713
11.2.2. Usage . . . 713
11.2.3. Known Limitations . . . 714
11.3. Grafana . . . 714
11.3.1. ArcadeDB Grafana Plugin (Recommended) . . . 714
11.3.2. PostgreSQL Data Source (Fallback) . . . 716
11.3.3. Grafana Time Series Endpoints . . . 716
11.4. Metabase . . . 716
11.4.1. Setup . . . 716
11.4.2. Usage . . . 717
11.4.3. Known Limitations . . . 717
11.5. Power BI . . . 717
11.5.1. Setup . . . 718
11.5.2. Usage . . . 718
11.5.3. Known Limitations . . . 718
11.6. Tableau . . . 719
11.6.1. Setup . . . 719
11.6.2. Usage . . . 719
11.6.3. Known Limitations . . . 720
12. Advanced . . . 721
12.1. Performance Tuning . . . 721
12.1.1. Memory Configuration . . . 721
12.1.2. Index Selection . . . 722
12.1.3. Query Optimization . . . 722
12.1.4. Bucket Configuration . . . 723
12.1.5. Page Size Tuning . . . 724
12.1.6. Connection Pool Settings . . . 724
12.1.7. Concurrent Requests (Query Admission Gate) . . . 724
12.1.8. Write Optimization . . . 726
12.1.9. Read Optimization . . . 726
12.1.10. High Availability Resync . . . 726
12.1.11. Further Reading . . . 727
12.2. Settings . . . 727
12.2.1. JVM startup (server/embedded only) . . . 727
12.2.2. SQL (Database Level) . . . 729

12.2.3. Programmatically (Server/Embedded and Database levels) . . . 729
12.2.4. Available settings by scope (in alphabetic order): . . . 729
12.3. SQL Syntax . . . 786
12.4. Graph OLAP Engine . . . 801
12.4.1. Why Graph OLAP? . . . 801
12.4.2. Graph Analytical View (GAV) . . . 801
12.4.3. SQL . . . 802
12.4.4. Builder Options . . . 803
12.4.5. Async Build for Large Graphs . . . 804
12.4.6. Update Modes . . . 804
12.4.7. CSR Persistence . . . 805
12.4.8. How CSR Works . . . 807
12.4.9. Columnar Property Storage . . . 807
12.4.10. Memory Usage . . . 808
12.4.11. Graph Algorithms . . . 808
12.4.12. Shortest Paths with Contraction Hierarchies (CCH) . . . 809
12.4.13. Query Planner Integration . . . 811
12.4.14. Lifecycle . . . 814
12.4.15. Benchmark Results . . . 814
12.4.16. Limitations . . . 814
12.5. Storage Internals . . . 815
12.5.1. Pages and Record IDs . . . 815
12.5.2. Zero Copy Objects . . . 815
12.5.3. How Buckets Work . . . 816
12.5.4. Bucket Partitioning . . . 818
12.5.5. Add and Remove Buckets from Types . . . 819
12.5.6. Page Version . . . 820
12.5.7. Schema File Persistence . . . 820
12.5.8. Cost of a Schema Change, and Batching Many . . . 821
12.6. LSM-Tree Algorithm . . . 822
12.6.1. Quick Overview . . . 822
13. Help . . . 825
13.1. Community . . . 825
13.1.1. Professional Support . . . 825
13.1.2. Frequently Asked Questions . . . 825
13.2. Get the Latest Build . . . 826
13.2.1. Option 1: Build it Yourself . . . 826
13.2.2. Option 2: Wait ~15 Minutes for the Maven Central SNAPSHOT . . . 827
13.2.3. Verifying You Have the Build You Expect . . . 828
13.2.4. When to Use Which Option . . . 828
13.3. Report an Issue . . . 829

13.4. Requirements . . . 829
13.4.1. Memory . . . 829
13.4.2. Java . . . 829
Query Languages . . . 831
14. SQL . . . 832
14.1. SQL . . . 832
14.1.1. Introduction to SQL . . . 832
14.1.2. Automatic usage of indexes . . . 832
14.1.3. Extra resources . . . 833
14.1.4. ArcadeDB SQL dialect . . . 833
14.1.5. Learning SQL . . . 834
14.1.6. No JOINs . . . 835
14.1.7. Projection . . . 835
14.1.8. System Types . . . 836
14.1.9. DISTINCT . . . 837
14.1.10. HAVING . . . 837
14.1.11. Multiple targets . . . 838
14.1.12. SQL Differences . . . 838
14.1.13. Commands . . . 839
14.1.14. Comments . . . 839
14.2. SQL - SELECT . . . 839
14.2.1. LET Block . . . 844
14.2.2. Sub-query . . . 844
14.2.3. Unwinding . . . 845
14.3. SQL - INSERT . . . 845
14.4. SQL - UPDATE . . . 850
14.5. SQL - DELETE . . . 854
14.6. SQL - MATCH . . . 855
14.6.1. Simplified Syntax . . . 859
14.6.2. Arrow notation . . . 861
14.7. SQL - TRAVERSE . . . 872
14.7.1. Traversal Strategies . . . 876
14.8. SQL - MOVE VERTEX . . . 876
14.9. SQL - CREATE VERTEX . . . 877
14.10. SQL - CREATE EDGE . . . 879
14.11. Types . . . 881
14.11.1. SQL - CREATE TYPE . . . 881
14.11.2. SQL - ALTER TYPE . . . 884
14.11.3. SQL - DROP TYPE . . . 887
14.11.4. SQL - TRUNCATE TYPE . . . 888
14.12. Properties . . . 889

14.12.1. SQL - CREATE PROPERTY . . . 889
14.12.2. SQL - ALTER PROPERTY . . . 894
14.12.3. SQL - DROP PROPERTY . . . 896
14.13. Indexes . . . 897
14.13.1. SQL - CREATE INDEX . . . 897
14.13.2. SQL - REBUILD INDEX . . . 908
14.13.3. SQL - COMPACT INDEX . . . 909
14.13.4. SQL - DROP INDEX . . . 910
14.14. Buckets . . . 911
14.14.1. SQL - CREATE BUCKET . . . 911
14.14.2. SQL - DROP BUCKET . . . 911
14.14.3. SQL - TRUNCATE BUCKET . . . 912
14.15. Triggers (DDL) . . . 913
14.15.1. SQL - CREATE TRIGGER . . . 913
14.15.2. Listing triggers . . . 915
14.15.3. SQL - DROP TRIGGER . . . 916
14.16. Materialized Views . . . 916
14.16.1. SQL - CREATE MATERIALIZED VIEW . . . 916
14.16.2. SQL - ALTER MATERIALIZED VIEW . . . 918
14.16.3. SQL - DROP MATERIALIZED VIEW . . . 918
14.16.4. SQL - REFRESH MATERIALIZED VIEW . . . 919
14.17. Database Admin . . . 920
14.17.1. SQL - ALIGN DATABASE . . . 920
14.17.2. SQL - ALTER DATABASE . . . 920
14.17.3. SQL - BACKUP DATABASE . . . 921
14.17.4. SQL - CHECK DATABASE . . . 923
14.17.5. SQL - EXPORT DATABASE . . . 931
14.17.6. SQL - IMPORT DATABASE . . . 933
14.18. Inspection . . . 935
14.18.1. SQL - EXPLAIN . . . 935
14.18.2. SQL - PROFILE . . . 936
14.18.3. SQL - CONSOLE . . . 936
14.19. Projections . . . 937
14.19.1. Query result . . . 938
14.19.2. Nested projections . . . 940
14.20. Pagination . . . 947
14.21. Filtering . . . 947
14.21.1. Operators . . . 948
14.22. SQL Script . . . 956
14.22.1. Why use SQL Script . . . 956
14.22.2. Schema-only scripts run as one schema change . . . 957

14.22.3. Differences between `sql` and `sqlscript` . . . 957
14.22.4. Syntax reference . . . 958
14.22.5. BEGIN — start an explicit transaction . . . 959
14.22.6. COMMIT — commit, retry, fallback . . . 959
14.22.7. LOCK — explicit type or bucket lock . . . 960
14.22.8. LET — script variables . . . 961
14.22.9. SET GLOBAL — database-scoped variables . . . 962
14.22.10. RETURN — end the script with a value . . . 962
14.22.11. IF — conditional execution . . . 963
14.22.12. FOREACH — iterate a collection . . . 963
14.22.13. WHILE — loop on a condition . . . 964
14.22.14. BREAK — exit the current loop . . . 964
14.22.15. SLEEP — pause execution . . . 964
14.22.16. CONSOLE — log from a script . . . 965
14.22.17. End-to-end example: a graph upsert with retry . . . 965
14.22.18. Running scripts . . . 966
14.23. Functions . . . 967
14.23.1. Aggregated mode . . . 967
14.23.2. Inline mode . . . 967
14.23.3. Function Reference . . . 968
14.24. Methods . . . 1006
14.24.1. Method Reference . . . 1006
14.25. Triggers . . . 1032
14.25.1. Overview . . . 1032
14.25.2. Trigger Events . . . 1032
14.25.3. SQL Triggers . . . 1033
14.25.4. JavaScript Triggers . . . 1035
14.25.5. Java Triggers . . . 1036
14.25.6. Use Cases . . . 1039
14.25.7. Performance Considerations . . . 1040
14.25.8. Best Practices . . . 1042
14.25.9. Managing Triggers . . . 1043
14.25.10. Limitations . . . 1044
14.25.11. See Also . . . 1044
14.26. User Functions . . . 1044
14.26.1. Overview . . . 1045
14.26.2. Database's Functions . . . 1045
14.26.3. Defining User Functions . . . 1045
14.26.4. User Functions in Java . . . 1049
14.26.5. Best Practices . . . 1053
14.26.6. Advantages Over Neo4j . . . 1053

14.27. SQL SELECT Statements Execution . . . 1053
15. Cypher (openCypher) . . . 1057
15.1. Introduction . . . 1057
15.1.1. Key Features . . . 1057
15.1.2. Using OpenCypher . . . 1058
15.1.3. Using Record IDs (RIDs) . . . 1058
15.1.4. Parameters . . . 1059
15.1.5. Automatic Transaction Handling . . . 1059
15.1.6. Performance Considerations . . . 1059
15.1.7. Comparison with Legacy Cypher . . . 1060
15.1.8. Resources . . . 1061
15.2. Cypher Tutorial . . . 1061
15.2.1. What is Cypher? . . . 1061
15.2.2. Setting Up . . . 1061
15.2.3. Part 1: Creating Data . . . 1061
15.2.4. Part 2: Reading Data . . . 1063
15.2.5. Part 3: Aggregations . . . 1066
15.2.6. Part 4: Data Modification . . . 1067
15.2.7. Part 5: Advanced Queries . . . 1068
15.2.8. Part 6: Using Functions . . . 1069
15.2.9. Part 7: Best Practices . . . 1070
15.3. MATCH . . . 1071
15.3.1. Path Mode (WALK, TRAIL, ACYCLIC) . . . 1072
15.3.2. Matching a Bound Relationship List . . . 1074
15.3.3. Named Paths . . . 1074
15.3.4. OPTIONAL MATCH . . . 1075
15.3.5. WHERE . . . 1076
15.3.6. RETURN . . . 1078
15.3.7. CREATE . . . 1079
15.3.8. MERGE . . . 1079
15.3.9. SET . . . 1081
15.3.10. DELETE . . . 1082
15.3.11. Reads and Writes in the Same Query . . . 1083
15.3.12. WITH . . . 1084
15.3.13. UNWIND . . . 1085
15.3.14. ORDER BY . . . 1086
15.3.15. SKIP and LIMIT . . . 1086
15.3.16. EXPLAIN . . . 1088
15.3.17. PROFILE . . . 1089
15.3.18. UNION and UNION ALL . . . 1090
15.3.19. CALL . . . 1091

15.3.20. FOREACH . . . 1096
15.3.21. LOAD CSV . . . 1097
15.3.22. CREATE CONSTRAINT . . . 1100
15.3.23. DROP CONSTRAINT . . . 1104
15.3.24. SHOW CONSTRAINTS . . . 1105
15.3.25. CREATE INDEX / DROP INDEX . . . 1107
15.3.26. SHOW INDEXES . . . 1107
15.3.27. SHOW USERS . . . 1108
15.3.28. SHOW CURRENT USER . . . 1109
15.3.29. CREATE USER . . . 1110
15.3.30. DROP USER . . . 1111
15.3.31. ALTER USER . . . 1111
15.3.32. SHOW TRANSACTIONS and TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS . . . 1111
15.3.33. Transaction Control (START TRANSACTION, COMMIT, ROLLBACK) . . . 1114
15.3.34. Session Management (SESSION SET, SESSION RESET, SESSION CLOSE) . . . 1115
15.4. Expressions and Functions . . . 1116
15.4.1. Literals . . . 1116
15.4.2. Property Access . . . 1116
15.4.3. CASE Expression . . . 1117
15.4.4. Arithmetic Expressions . . . 1118
15.4.5. Map Literals . . . 1118
15.4.6. List Comprehensions . . . 1119
15.4.7. Map Projections . . . 1119
15.4.8. Aggregation Functions . . . 1120
15.4.9. String Functions . . . 1121
15.4.10. Math Functions . . . 1123
15.4.11. List Functions . . . 1124
15.4.12. Node and Relationship Functions . . . 1125
15.4.13. Path Functions . . . 1128
15.4.14. Type Conversion Functions . . . 1128
15.4.15. SQL Function Bridge . . . 1129
15.4.16. Extended Functions (APOC Compatible) . . . 1130
15.4.17. Operators . . . 1132
15.4.18. Parameters . . . 1133
15.5. Cypher Compatibility Matrix . . . 1134
15.5.1. OpenCypher TCK Compliance . . . 1134
15.5.2. Known Limitations . . . 1134
15.5.3. 1. Temporal Range Limitation (Java Platform Constraint) . . . 1135
15.5.4. 2. Case-Insensitive Identifiers (By Design) . . . 1135
15.5.5. 3. Cross-Type Comparison Strictness (Semantic Edge Case) . . . 1135
15.5.6. 4. User Functions Support . . . 1136

15.5.7. 6. Map-Valued Properties (Multi-Model Boundary) 1136
15.5.8. Not Implemented Features 1137
15.5.9. Cypher 25 / GQL Strictness 1137
15.5.10. Three-Valued Logic (UNKNOWN) 1137
15.5.11. Zoned DateTime Equality and Ordering 1138
15.5.12. Stored TIME, LOCAL TIME and DURATION Values 1138
15.5.13. Strict Numeric Types 1139
15.5.14. Temporal and Spatial Value Types 1139
15.5.15. Relationship Types and Sub-types 1139
15.5.16. shortestPath() and Hop Bounds 1139
15.5.17. Self-Loops in Undirected Patterns 1140
15.5.18. Indexes Inherited from a Parent Type 1140
15.5.19. Architectural Differences from Neo4j 1141
16. Gremlin 1142
16.1. Gremlin 1142
16.1.1. Gremlin from Java API 1142
16.1.2. Transactions and closing a graph 1143
16.1.3. Vertex property identifiers 1144
16.1.4. Gremlin through Postgres Driver 1144
16.1.5. Gremlin through HTTP/JSON 1144
16.1.6. Use the Gremlin Server 1144
16.1.7. Listing and terminating running traversals 1148
16.1.8. Known Limitations with the Gremlin Implementation 1148
16.1.9. Recommended Tools with Gremlin 1149
17. GraphQL 1150
17.1. GraphQL 1150
17.1.1. Type definition 1150
17.1.2. Query arguments 1151
17.1.3. Query variables 1153
17.1.4. Field aliases 1154
17.1.5. Fragments 1154
17.1.6. Supported directives 1154
18. MongoDB QL 1158
18.1. Mongo 1158
18.1.1. MongoDB Query Language 1158
18.1.2. MongoDB Protocol Plugin 1159
19. Redis 1165
19.1. Redis 1165
19.1.1. Installation 1165
19.1.2. How it works 1166
19.1.3. Transient (RAM Only) Commands 1166

19.1.4. Persistent Commands . . . 1167
19.1.5. Redis via HTTP API . . . 1170
20. Graph Algorithms . . . 1175
20.1. Graph Algorithms . . . 1175
20.1.1. Algorithm Index . . . 1175
20.1.2. Categories . . . 1177
20.2. Path Finding . . . 1178
20.2.1. algo.dijkstra . . . 1178
20.2.2. algo.cch.shortestPath . . . 1179
20.2.3. algo.astar . . . 1181
20.2.4. algo.bellmanford . . . 1183
20.2.5. algo.allsimplepaths . . . 1184
20.2.6. algo.kShortestPaths . . . 1185
20.2.7. algo.apsp . . . 1186
20.2.8. algo.bfs . . . 1188
20.2.9. algo.dfs . . . 1189
20.2.10. algo.dijkstra.singleSource . . . 1190
20.2.11. algo.longestPath . . . 1192
20.2.12. algo.msa . . . 1193
20.2.13. algo.steinerTree . . . 1195
20.3. Centrality . . . 1196
20.3.1. algo.pagerank . . . 1196
20.3.2. algo.betweenness . . . 1198
20.3.3. algo.closeness . . . 1199
20.3.4. algo.degree . . . 1201
20.3.5. algo.harmonic . . . 1202
20.3.6. algo.eigenvector . . . 1203
20.3.7. algo.hits . . . 1204
20.3.8. algo.katz . . . 1206
20.3.9. algo.voteRank . . . 1207
20.3.10. algo.eccentricity . . . 1208
20.3.11. algo.personalizedPageRank . . . 1210
20.3.12. algo.articlerank . . . 1211
20.4. Community Detection . . . 1213
20.4.1. algo.wcc . . . 1213
20.4.2. algo.scc . . . 1214
20.4.3. algo.louvain . . . 1215
20.4.4. algo.leiden . . . 1216
20.4.5. algo.labelpropagation . . . 1217
20.4.6. algo.hierarchicalClustering . . . 1219
20.4.7. algo.slpa . . . 1220

20.4.8. algo.maxKCut . . . 1222
20.5. Structural Analysis . . . 1223
20.5.1. algo.kcore . . . 1223
20.5.2. algo.triangleCount . . . 1224
20.5.3. algo.articulationPoints . . . 1226
20.5.4. algo.bridges . . . 1227
20.5.5. algo.mst . . . 1228
20.5.6. algo.topologicalSort . . . 1229
20.5.7. algo.bipartite . . . 1230
20.5.8. algo.graphColoring . . . 1232
20.5.9. algo.cycleDetection . . . 1233
20.5.10. algo.densestSubgraph . . . 1234
20.5.11. algo.clique . . . 1235
20.5.12. algo.kTruss . . . 1236
20.5.13. algo.biconnectedComponents . . . 1238
20.5.14. algo.localClusteringCoefficient . . . 1239
20.5.15. algo.bipartiteMatching . . . 1240
20.6. Similarity and Link Prediction . . . 1241
20.6.1. algo.jaccard . . . 1241
20.6.2. algo.adamicAdar . . . 1243
20.6.3. algo.commonNeighbors . . . 1244
20.6.4. algo.preferentialAttachment . . . 1245
20.6.5. algo.resourceAllocation . . . 1247
20.6.6. algo.simRank . . . 1248
20.6.7. algo.knn . . . 1249
20.6.8. algo.sameCommunity . . . 1251
20.6.9. algo.totalNeighbors . . . 1252
20.7. Network Flow . . . 1253
20.7.1. algo.maxFlow . . . 1253
20.8. Traversal and Sampling . . . 1255
20.8.1. algo.randomWalk . . . 1255
20.9. Network Science Metrics . . . 1256
20.9.1. algo.assortativity . . . 1256
20.9.2. algo.richClub . . . 1257
20.9.3. algo.influenceMaximization . . . 1259
20.10. Community Quality Metrics . . . 1260
20.10.1. algo.modularityScore . . . 1260
20.10.2. algo.conductance . . . 1261
20.11. Graph Statistics . . . 1262
20.11.1. algo.graphSummary . . . 1263
20.12. Node Embedding . . . 1264

20.12.1. algo.fastrp . . . 1264
20.12.2. algo.node2vec . . . 1266
20.12.3. algo.graphsage . . . 1267
20.12.4. algo.hashgnn . . . 1269
20.13. SQL Path Functions . . . 1271
20.13.1. dijkstra() SQL Function . . . 1271
20.13.2. cchShortestPath() SQL Function . . . 1272
20.13.3. duanSSSP() SQL Function . . . 1273
20.13.4. bellmanFord() SQL Function . . . 1274
20.13.5. shortestPath() SQL Function . . . 1275
20.14. Notes . . . 1277
20.14.1. relTypes Parameter . . . 1277
20.14.2. direction Parameter . . . 1277
20.14.3. Unidirectional Edge Types . . . 1278
20.14.4. Config Map Parameters . . . 1278
20.14.5. Memory Considerations . . . 1278
21. Extended Functions . . . 1279
21.1. Extended Functions Reference . . . 1279
21.1.1. Overview . . . 1279
21.1.2. APOC Prefix Compatibility . . . 1279
21.1.3. Function Namespaces . . . 1280
21.1.4. Function Categories . . . 1280
21.1.5. Migration Guide . . . 1281
21.2. Aggregation Functions . . . 1282
21.2.1. agg.first() . . . 1282
21.2.2. agg.last() . . . 1282
21.2.3. agg.maxItems() . . . 1282
21.2.4. agg.median() . . . 1283
21.2.5. agg.minItems() . . . 1283
21.2.6. agg.nth() . . . 1283
21.2.7. agg.percentiles() . . . 1283
21.2.8. agg.product() . . . 1284
21.2.9. agg.slice() . . . 1284
21.2.10. agg.statistics() . . . 1284
21.2.11. Collection Functions . . . 1285
21.2.12. coll.avg() . . . 1285
21.2.13. coll.distinct() . . . 1285
21.2.14. coll.flatten() . . . 1286
21.2.15. coll.indexOf() . . . 1286
21.2.16. coll.insert() . . . 1287
21.2.17. coll.max() . . . 1287

21.2.18. coll.min() . . . 1288
21.2.19. coll.pairsMin() . . . 1288
21.2.20. coll.remove() . . . 1289
21.2.21. coll.sort() . . . 1289
21.2.22. coll.sum() . . . 1290
21.2.23. coll.toSet() . . . 1290
21.2.24. coll.union() . . . 1291
21.2.25. coll.unionAll() . . . 1292
21.2.26. Map Functions . . . 1292
21.2.27. map.clean() . . . 1292
21.2.28. map.flatten() . . . 1292
21.2.29. map.fromLists() . . . 1293
21.2.30. map.fromPairs() . . . 1293
21.2.31. map.groupBy() . . . 1293
21.2.32. map.merge() . . . 1293
21.2.33. map.mergeList() . . . 1294
21.2.34. map.removeKey() . . . 1294
21.2.35. map.removeKeys() . . . 1294
21.2.36. map.setKey() . . . 1294
21.2.37. map.sortedProperties() . . . 1295
21.2.38. map.submap() . . . 1295
21.2.39. map.unflatten() . . . 1295
21.2.40. map.values() . . . 1295
21.2.41. Convert Functions . . . 1296
21.2.42. convert.fromJsonList() . . . 1296
21.2.43. convert.fromJsonMap() . . . 1296
21.2.44. convert.toBoolean() . . . 1296
21.2.45. convert.toFloat() . . . 1297
21.2.46. convert.toInteger() . . . 1297
21.2.47. convert.toJson() . . . 1297
21.2.48. convert.toList() . . . 1297
21.2.49. convert.toMap() . . . 1298
21.2.50. convert.toSet() . . . 1298
21.2.51. convert.toString() . . . 1298
21.2.52. Create Functions . . . 1298
21.2.53. create.uuid() . . . 1299
21.2.54. create.uuidBase64() . . . 1299
21.2.55. create.vNode() . . . 1299
21.2.56. create.vRelationship() . . . 1299
21.3. Date & Math Functions . . . 1299
21.3.1. Date Functions (Extended) . . . 1299

21.3.2. date.add() . . . 1300
21.3.3. date.convert() . . . 1300
21.3.4. date.currentTimestamp() . . . 1300
21.3.5. date.field() . . . 1301
21.3.6. date.fields() . . . 1301
21.3.7. date.format() . . . 1301
21.3.8. date.fromISO8601() . . . 1302
21.3.9. date.parse() . . . 1302
21.3.10. date.systemTimezone() . . . 1302
21.3.11. date.toISO8601() . . . 1302
21.3.12. Math Functions (Extended) . . . 1303
21.3.13. math.cosh() . . . 1303
21.3.14. math.maxDouble() . . . 1303
21.3.15. math.maxLong() . . . 1303
21.3.16. math.minLong() . . . 1303
21.3.17. math.round() . . . 1304
21.3.18. math.sigmoid() . . . 1304
21.3.19. math.sigmoidPrime() . . . 1305
21.3.20. math.sinh() . . . 1305
21.3.21. math.tanh() . . . 1305
21.3.22. Number Functions . . . 1305
21.3.23. number.format() . . . 1305
21.3.24. Node Functions . . . 1306
21.3.25. node.degree() . . . 1306
21.3.26. node.degree.in() . . . 1306
21.3.27. node.degree.out() . . . 1307
21.3.28. node.id() . . . 1307
21.3.29. node.labels() . . . 1307
21.3.30. node.relationship.exists() . . . 1307
21.3.31. node.relationship.types() . . . 1307
21.3.32. Relationship Functions . . . 1308
21.3.33. rel.endNode() . . . 1308
21.3.34. rel.id() . . . 1308
21.3.35. rel.startNode() . . . 1308
21.3.36. rel.type() . . . 1308
21.3.37. Algorithm Procedures . . . 1309
21.3.38. algo.allsimplepaths() . . . 1309
21.3.39. algo.astar() . . . 1309
21.3.40. algo.dijkstra() . . . 1310
21.3.41. Path Functions (Extended) . . . 1311
21.3.42. path.combine() . . . 1311

21.3.43. path.create() . . . 1311
21.3.44. path.elements() . . . 1311
21.3.45. path.slice() . . . 1312
21.3.46. Path Expansion Procedures . . . 1312
21.3.47. path.expand() . . . 1312
21.3.48. path.expandconfig() . . . 1312
21.3.49. path.spanningtree() . . . 1313
21.3.50. path.subgraphall() . . . 1313
21.3.51. path.subgraphnodes() . . . 1314
21.3.52. Control Flow Procedures . . . 1315
21.3.53. do.when() . . . 1315
21.3.54. Refactor Procedures . . . 1316
21.3.55. refactor.cloneNodesWithRelationships() . . . 1316
21.3.56. refactor.mergeNodes() . . . 1317
21.4. Schema & Meta Procedures . . . 1318
21.4.1. Meta/Schema Procedures . . . 1318
21.4.2. meta.graph() . . . 1318
21.4.3. meta.nodetypeproperties() . . . 1319
21.4.4. meta.reltypeproperties() . . . 1319
21.4.5. meta.schema() . . . 1320
21.4.6. meta.stats() . . . 1320
21.4.7. Merge Procedures . . . 1321
21.4.8. merge.node() . . . 1321
21.4.9. merge.relationship() . . . 1321
21.4.10. text.byteCount() . . . 1322
21.4.11. text.camelCase() . . . 1323
21.4.12. text.capitalize() . . . 1323
21.4.13. text.capitalizeAll() . . . 1323
21.4.14. text.charAt() . . . 1324
21.4.15. text.code() . . . 1324
21.4.16. text.decapitalize() . . . 1324
21.4.17. text.decapitalizeAll() . . . 1324
21.4.18. text.format() . . . 1324
21.4.19. text.hammingDistance() . . . 1325
21.4.20. text.hexValue() . . . 1325
21.4.21. text.indexOf() . . . 1325
21.4.22. text.jaroWinklerDistance() . . . 1326
21.4.23. text.join() . . . 1327
21.4.24. text.levenshteinDistance() . . . 1327
21.4.25. text.levenshteinSimilarity() . . . 1328
21.4.26. text.lpad() . . . 1328

21.4.27. text.random() . . . 1328
21.4.28. text.regexReplace() . . . 1329
21.4.29. text.replace() . . . 1329
21.4.30. text.rpad() . . . 1329
21.4.31. text.slug() . . . 1330
21.4.32. text.snakeCase() . . . 1330
21.4.33. text.sorensenDiceSimilarity() . . . 1330
21.4.34. text.split() . . . 1331
21.4.35. text.upperCamelCase() . . . 1331
21.5. Utility Functions . . . 1331
21.5.1. util.compress() . . . 1331
21.5.2. util.decompress() . . . 1332
21.5.3. util.md5() . . . 1332
21.5.4. util.sha1() . . . 1333
21.5.5. util.sha256() . . . 1333
21.5.6. util.sha512() . . . 1333
21.5.7. util.sleep() . . . 1333
21.5.8. util.validate() . . . 1334
21.6. Vector Functions . . . 1334
21.6.1. Aggregation Functions . . . 1334
21.6.2. Basic Operations . . . 1336
21.6.3. Nearest Neighbor Search . . . 1337
21.6.4. Normalization and Norms . . . 1340
21.6.5. Quantization . . . 1342
21.6.6. Scoring and Fusion . . . 1343
21.6.7. Similarity and Distance . . . 1345
21.6.8. Sparse Vectors . . . 1347
21.6.9. Statistics . . . 1348
21.6.10. Utility Functions . . . 1350

# Documentation

# Chapter 1. Welcome

## 1.1. ArcadeDB Documentation

### 1.1.1. Tutorials

Step-by-step guides to learn ArcadeDB's data models, query languages, and drivers.

### 1.1.2. ArcadeDB Academy

Free, self-paced courses with certification on completion. Hosted at arcadedb.com/academy.

### 1.1.3. Use Cases

Production-ready example projects you can clone and run with `docker compose up`.

### 1.1.4. Community & Resources

# Chapter 2. Get Started

## 2.1. Get Started with ArcadeDB

### 2.1.1. Choose your starting point

### 2.1.2. Connect from your application

ArcadeDB exposes several wire protocols and drivers, so you can keep your existing client libraries:

- <a href="reference/http-api/http.pdf">HTTP / JSON REST API</a> — language-agnostic, no driver required
- <a href="how-to/connectivity/postgres.pdf">PostgreSQL wire protocol</a> — existing Postgres clients connect unchanged
- <a href="how-to/connectivity/bolt.pdf">Neo4j Bolt protocol</a> — reuse Neo4j’s official drivers
- <a href="reference/mongodb-ql/mongo.pdf">MongoDB QL</a> — MongoDB drivers
- <a href="reference/redis-ql/redis.pdf">Redis commands</a> — Redis clients
- <a href="reference/mcp/mcp.pdf">MCP server</a> — for AI agents and LLM tooling
- <a href="reference/java-api/java-ref-database.pdf">Native Java API</a> — embedded mode
- <a href="how-to/connectivity/jdbc.pdf">JDBC driver</a> — for BI and traditional SQL tools

### 2.1.3. Pick a query language

ArcadeDB supports six query languages over the same data — use whichever your team already knows:

- <a href="reference/sql/sql-introduction.pdf">SQL</a> — extended with graph, full-text, and vector functions
- <a href="reference/cypher/cypher-introduction.pdf">Cypher (openCypher)</a> — drop-in replacement for Neo4j Cypher
- Apache TinkerPop Gremlin
- GraphQL
- MongoDB QL
- Redis commands

### 2.1.4. Next steps

- <a href="concepts/basics.pdf">Records, Documents, Vertices & Edges</a> — how ArcadeDB models data

- <a href="concepts/schema.pdf">Schema</a> — types, properties, constraints
- <a href="concepts/transactions.pdf">Transactions</a> — ACID guarantees
- <a href="how-to/operations/binaries.pdf">Self-managed deployment</a> — production install
- <a href="https://arcadedb.com/academy.html">ArcadeDB Academy</a> — free, self-paced courses with certification

# 2.2. What is ArcadeDB?

ArcadeDB is a **multi-model database management system**: graph, document, key/value, time-series, vector, and geospatial data live on the **same storage** and inside the **same transaction**. One process, one schema, one query language of your choice — instead of a separate database for each shape of data.

If you've ever stitched together PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Neo4j, Elasticsearch, and a vector database to back a single application, this page explains why ArcadeDB collapses that stack into one engine, and why we believe the **graph model** (more on that below) is a better default than people realise.

## 2.2.1. TL;DR

- Six data models — graph, document, key/value, full-text, vector, time-series — share the same storage and transaction.
- Six query languages — SQL, Cypher, Gremlin, GraphQL, MongoDB QL, Redis — read and write the same records.
- Native graph: edges are physical pointers between records, every traversal hop is O(1).
- Embeddable in any JVM (16 MB heap minimum) or run as a server with Docker / Kubernetes.
- Apache 2.0 — free for commercial use, no copyleft, no Enterprise edition gate.

## 2.2.2. The problem with running many databases

Most teams that need to combine relationships, JSON, full-text search and vector similarity end up with **polyglot persistence**: PostgreSQL for transactional data, Neo4j for the graph, Elasticsearch for search, MongoDB for flexible documents, Pinecone or Qdrant for embeddings. Each system brings:

- a separate deployment, backup strategy, security model, and failure mode;
- an ETL pipeline (or change-data-capture queue) to keep data in sync — every sync introduces lag, complexity, and bugs;
- a learning curve per database for every developer on the team;
- a multiplier on infrastructure cost and operational headcount.

A single user request often turns into a chain of sequential calls across these systems: query Postgres, then Neo4j, then Elasticsearch, then stitch the results together in the application layer. The total response time is the **sum** of every hop, plus the cost of serializing data three times.

The animation runs faster than reality, but the proportions hold: by the time the polyglot scenario

finishes one round of three sequential calls, ArcadeDB has completed several full transactions. The numbers below match the animation:

| **Polyglot persistence (sequential)** | **Database** | **Latency** |
|---|---|---|
| Your app → PostgreSQL | Relational | ~15 ms |
| then … → MongoDB | Document | ~20 ms |
| then … → Neo4j | Graph | ~12 ms |
| **Total: ~47 ms+** (sum of calls + serialization overhead) | | |

| **ArcadeDB (single call)** | **Engine** | **Latency** |
|---|---|---|
| Your app → ArcadeDB (graph + document + search in one query) | Multi-model | ~5 ms |
| **Total: ~5 ms** (one call, zero chaining, no serialization) | | |

### 2.2.3. One engine, every model

ArcadeDB collapses the polyglot stack into a single engine. A single ACID transaction can:

- create a JSON document,
- connect it as a vertex in a graph,
- index its embedding for vector similarity,
- and append a time-series sample for it,

— atomically. There is no replication lag **between models**, because there is no replication: the data exists once, on one storage layer.

The consequences run deeper than just lower latency:

- **Lower latency** — one network round-trip, no waiting on the slowest database in the chain.
- **One operational model** — one backup, one HA topology, one monitoring dashboard, one upgrade path.
- **One learning curve** — your team learns ArcadeDB once, not five products.
- **Real cross-model queries** — a SQL statement can traverse a graph, filter on document fields, and rank by vector similarity in a single pass:

```
SELECT FROM (
  MATCH {type: User, as: u} -Follows-> {type: User, as: f}
  RETURN f
) WHERE vector.cosineSimilarity(f.embedding, ?) > 0.8
```

The graph traversal and the vector comparison run against the same records in the same transaction. No cross-database join, no eventual consistency, no glue code.

### 2.2.4. The graph model is our core — and it's native

ArcadeDB is a **native graph database**. That phrase carries weight, so let's unpack it.

In a relational database, a relationship between two rows is a foreign key — a value in one table that **matches** a value in another. To follow it, the database engine must look the other side up, typically via an index. The cost grows with the size of the joined tables: a `JOIN` on millions of rows forces the planner to choose between hash join, merge join, or nested loop, and none of those are free. As your data grows, your queries slow down.

In a native graph, **edges are physical links between records.** Following an edge dereferences a pointer; the database does not scan, does not probe an index, does not build a hash table. Every traversal hop is **O(1) regardless of database size.** This is called **index-free adjacency**, and it changes the kind of question you can ask:

- "Friends of friends of friends of Alice" — three pointer hops, milliseconds, no matter how many users you have.
- "Every person within 4 degrees of someone who bought product X in the last hour" — a traversal, not a query plan with three nested joins.
- "Shortest path between two arbitrary entities in a 100-million-vertex graph" — feasible.

In ArcadeDB, edges are first-class records: a `Follows` edge can carry properties like `since`, `weight`, `label`. Lightweight edges exist for relationships with no properties (zero per-edge storage). Both are stored as physical links — there are no join tables, no adjacency lists bolted onto a relational schema, no LINKBAG-style indirection.

This is also why we recommend the graph model as the **default** even for "non-graph" applications. Anything you can model as parent/child, owner/owned, follower/followee, before/after, or "belongs to" is naturally a graph. Modelling it as a graph means a `JOIN` becomes a single-pointer dereference, and your query keeps the same speed when the table grows from a thousand rows to a billion.

- Graph database concepts
- SQL `MATCH`
- Cypher (openCypher)
- Apache TinkerPop Gremlin

### 2.2.5. The other models you get

#### Documents

Documents are JSON-like records with nested properties, lists, and maps. Document types can be **schema-full** (every property declared with a type and constraints), **schema-less** (no validation, free-form), or **schema-hybrid** (some properties enforced, others free-form). Types support inheritance — a `Customer` type can extend `Person` and inherit its properties, indexes, and constraints.

- Records, documents, vertices, edges
- Schema modes

**Key-value**

Every record has a Record ID (RID); fetching by RID is O(1). Buckets can also act as dedicated key/value namespaces — useful for caching, session storage, and configuration without a type schema.

**Full-text search**

Built-in Lucene engine with fuzzy matching, integrated into the query languages. No external Elasticsearch deployment required for typical search workloads.

- Full-text index

**Time-series**

Columnar storage with Gorilla XOR compression for floats and Delta-of-Delta for timestamps — 0.4 to 1.4 bytes per sample. Ingestion via the InfluxDB Line Protocol (works with Telegraf, Grafana Agent, etc.); query with PromQL or SQL analytical functions like `ts.timeBucket`, `ts.rate`, `ts.percentile`.

- Time-series concepts

**Vector**

JVector indexes (HNSW or Vamana / DiskANN) with COSINE, DOT_PRODUCT, and EUCLIDEAN similarity, and INT8 / BINARY quantisation for memory savings. Vector indexes participate in ACID transactions and integrate directly into SQL through `vector.neighbors()` and `vector.cosineSimilarity()`.

- Vector search

**Geospatial**

Built-in geometric and geographic functions over points, polygons, and bounding boxes — distance queries, containment, intersections — all in the same SQL planner as the rest of the data.

- Geospatial

### 2.2.6. Pick the query language your team already knows

ArcadeDB speaks the languages your team is comfortable with. They all read and write the **same** records on the **same** storage:

- **SQL** — extended with graph traversal, full-text, vector, and time-series functions
- **Cypher (openCypher)** — drop-in replacement for Neo4j Cypher, 97.8% TCK compliant
- **Gremlin** — Apache TinkerPop graph traversal
- **GraphQL** — schema-driven queries over HTTP
- **MongoDB QL** — document-oriented queries via the MongoDB protocol
- **Redis commands** — key/value access via the Redis wire protocol

A record created through SQL is immediately visible to a Gremlin traversal, and an edge created through Cypher can be queried through GraphQL.

### 2.2.7. Embedded or server, your choice

ArcadeDB runs in two modes:

- **Embedded** — link the JAR into a JVM application and run the database in-process. No separate server, no network hop, no IPC overhead. Footprint starts at ~16 MB of heap. Apache 2.0; no Enterprise edition required.
- **Server** — run as a process and connect from any language over HTTP/REST, the PostgreSQL wire protocol, the Neo4j Bolt protocol, MongoDB drivers, Redis clients, the gRPC API, or MCP for AI agents.

Many ArcadeDB deployments mix both: an embedded engine inside a hot-path service plus a server cluster for analytics and external clients, all sharing the same database files.

### 2.2.8. Why it's so fast

ArcadeDB is written in **Low-Level Java** — Java 21+, but without high-level abstractions on the hot path. Few objects are allocated at run time, so the garbage collector rarely needs to act. The kernel uses cache-line-aware data layouts, lock-free reads where possible, and other mechanical-sympathy techniques to make the JVM behave more like a hand-tuned native binary.

The storage engine is an LSM-tree with bucket partitioning, page caching, and a write-ahead log. On the LDBC Graphalytics benchmark, ArcadeDB outperforms popular graph databases by 5×–80× on PageRank, BFS, and weakly-connected-components workloads.

- Storage internals
- LSM-tree algorithm
- Performance comparison vs. Neo4j

### 2.2.9. Apache 2.0, free for commercial use

ArcadeDB Community Edition is released under the Apache 2.0 license — free for any purpose, commercial use included, no copyleft. You can embed it in proprietary products without publishing your source.

When code is public, anyone can scrutinize, test, report, and resolve issues. Open source moves faster than the proprietary world, and the trust comes from being able to read the code rather than a marketing page.

For mission-critical production deployments, professional support is available with guaranteed response times and SLA coverage. See the SLA page for service-level details.

### 2.2.10. Where to next

- Run ArcadeDB — install with Docker, native binaries, or Kubernetes

- Multi-model architecture — see how all six models share one engine
- 10-minute Java tutorial — embedded mode quickstart
- Python quickstart — connect via PostgreSQL or HTTP
- ArcadeDB Academy — free, self-paced courses with certification

## 2.3. Run ArcadeDB

You can run ArcadeDB in the following ways:

- In the cloud, by running an ArcadeDB instance on Amazon AWS, Microsoft Azure, or Google Cloud Engine.
- On-premise, on your servers, any OS is good. You can run with Docker, Podman, Kubernetes or bare metal.
- On x86(-64), arm(64), or any other hardware supporting a JRE (Java* Runtime Environment)
- Embedded, if you develop with a language that runs on the JVM (Java* Virtual Machine)*

To reach the best performance, use ArcadeDB in embedded mode to reach two million insertions per second on common hardware. If you need to scale up with the queries, run a HA (high availability) configuration with at least three servers, and a load balancer in front. Run ArcadeDB with Kubernetes to have an automatic setup of servers in HA and a load balancer upfront.

### 2.3.1. Embedded

This mode is possible only if your application is running in a JVM* (Java* Virtual Machine). In this configuration ArcadeDB runs in the same JVM as your application. In this way you completely avoid the client/server communication cost (TCP/IP, marshalling/unmarshalling, etc.) If the JVM that hosts your application crashes, then also ArcadeDB would crash, but don't worry, ArcadeDB uses a WAL to recover partially committed transactions. Your data is safe! Check the Embedded Server section.

### 2.3.2. Client-Server

This is the classic way people use a DBMS, like with relational databases. The ArcadeDB server exposes HTTP/JSON API, so you can connect to ArcadeDB from any language without even using drivers. Take a look at the API and Driver Reference chapter for more information.

### 2.3.3. High Availability (HA)

You can spin up as many ArcadeDB servers as you want to have a HA setup and scale up with queries that can be executed on any servers. ArcadeDB uses a Raft based election system to guarantee the consistency of the database. For more information look at High Availability.

### 2.3.4. Getting Started

See Installation for guides to install under Linux, MacOS, Windows. Alternatively, you can run ArcadeDB using Docker:

```
docker run --rm -p 2480:2480 -p 5432:5432 \
    --name arcadedb arcadedata/arcadedb:26.10.1
```

## 2.4. Docker

To run the ArcadeDB server with Docker, type this (replace <password> with the root password you want to use):

```
$ docker run --rm -p 2480:2480 --name my_arcadedb \
             --env ARCADEDB_SETTINGS="-Darcadedb.server.rootPassword=playwithdata" \
             --hostname my_arcadedb arcadedata/arcadedb:26.10.1
```

If there are no errors, Docker prints immediately the container id. You can use that id to stop the container, or execute some commands from it.

Pass ArcadeDB settings in `ARCADEDB_SETTINGS` and extra JVM flags in `JAVA_OPTS`. Docker **replaces** an environment variable rather than adding to it, so putting `-Darcadedb.*` settings in `JAVA_OPTS` would discard the garbage collector the image selects for you. Keeping the two apart means your container runs the same JVM as one started with no environment at all (*since v26.9.1*).

With `arcadedb.server.apiTokenRequireSecureTransport=true` the server refuses to mint an API token over a plain-HTTP connection that does not come from the loopback address. The setting is `false` in 26.10.1 (an unprotected mint is only logged at WARNING) and is scheduled to default to `true` from 27.1.1. Once it is on, a container reached through a published port (`-p 2480:2480`) usually sees the Docker network gateway as the peer, not loopback, so **Create Token** in Studio on `http://localhost:2480` is answered with a `412`, and opening Studio "from the server host itself" does not help. For a local development container, either enable HTTPS or leave the check off with `-Darcadedb.server.apiTokenRequireSecureTransport=false` in `ARCADEDB_SETTINGS`. Do not turn it off for a server reachable from other machines. Behind a TLS-terminating reverse proxy, list the proxy in `arcadedb.server.apiTokenTrustedProxies` instead; see Create an API token.

To run the console from the container started above, use:

```
$ docker exec -it my_arcadedb bin/console.sh
ArcadeDB Console v26.10.1 - Copyrights (c) 2021 Arcade Data (https://arcadedb.com)

>
```

The ArcadeDB image can also be used with Podman, just replace `docker` with `podman` in the examples.

### 2.4.1. Quick start with the OpenBeer database

You can run ArcadeDB server with a demo database in less than 1 minute. Run ArcadeDB server with docker specifying the database to import as a parameter in the docker command.

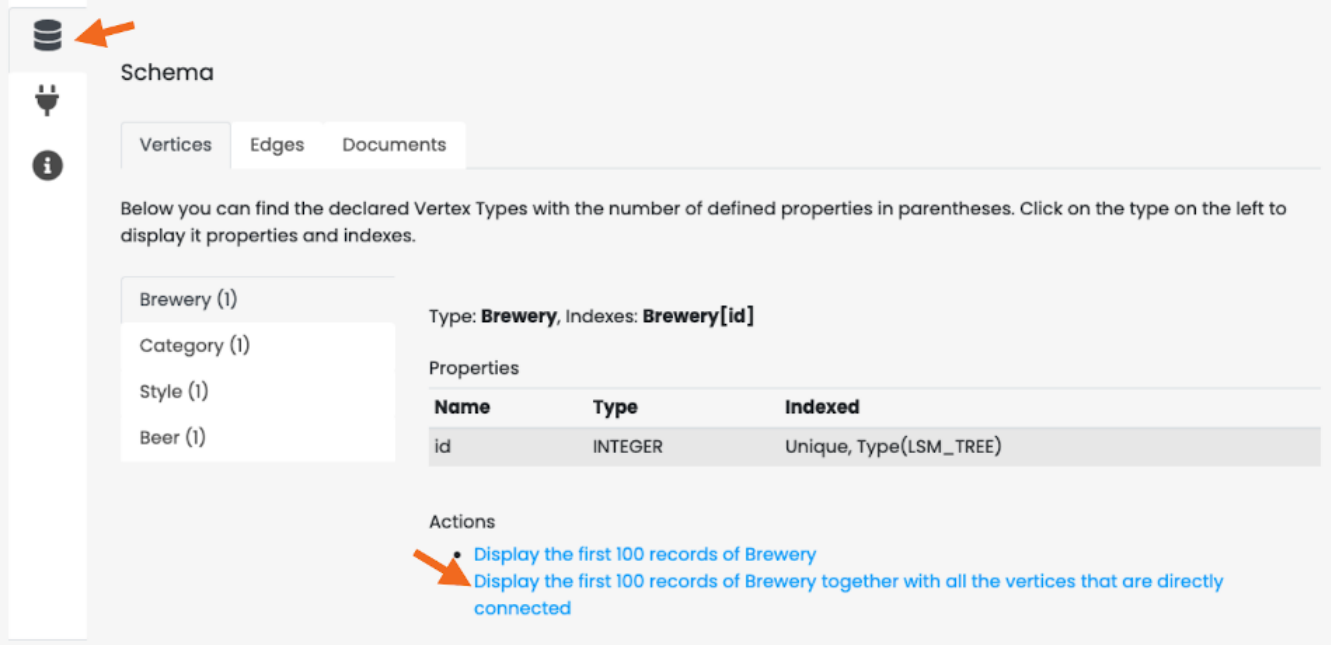
Example of running ArcadeDB Server with all the plugins enabled (Redis, Postgres, Mongo, Gremlin) that download and install OrientDB's `OpenBeer` dataset:

```
$ docker run --rm  -p 2480:2480 -p 6379:6379 -p 5432:5432 -p 8182:8182 --env
ARCADEDB_SETTINGS="\
   -Darcadedb.server.rootPassword=playwithdata \

-Darcadedb.server.defaultDatabases=Imported[root]{import:https://github.com/ArcadeData
/arcadedb-datasets/raw/main/orientdb/OpenBeer.gz} \
   -Darcadedb.server.plugins=Redis:com.arcadedb.redis.RedisProtocolPlugin, \
                             MongoDB:com.arcadedb.mongo.MongoDBProtocolPlugin, \
                             Postgres:com.arcadedb.postgres.PostgresProtocolPlugin, \

GremlinServer:com.arcadedb.server.gremlin.GremlinServerPlugin" \
         arcadedata/arcadedb:latest
```

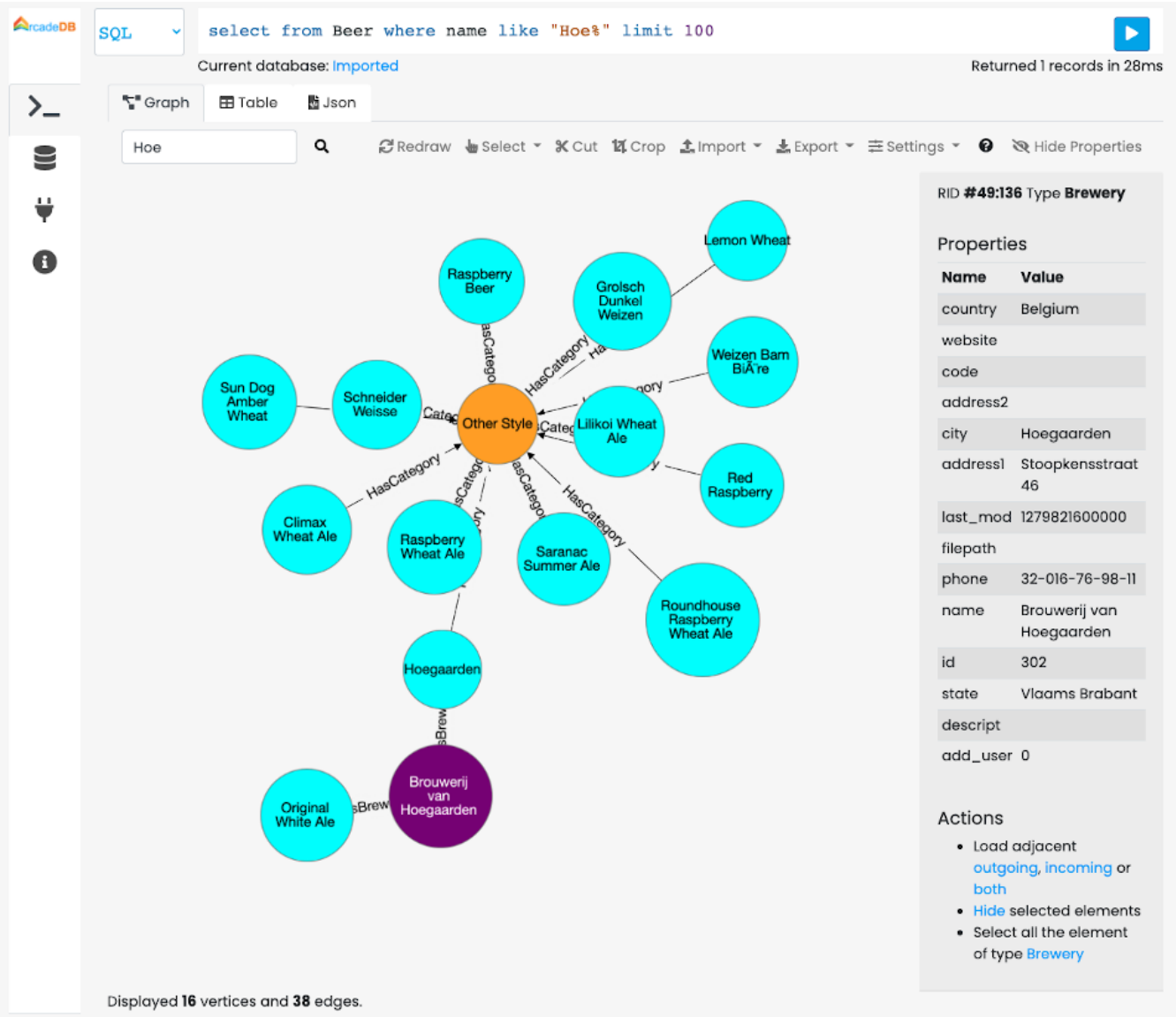
Now point your browser on **http://localhost:2480** and you'll see ArcadeDB Studio. Now enter "root" as a user and "playwithdata" as a password.

User and password are specified in the docker command above.

Now click on the "Database" icon on the toolbar on the left. This is the database schema. Click on "OpenBeer" vertex type and then on the action "Display the first 100 records of Beer together with all the vertices that are directly connected".




You should see the first 100 beers in the database and all their connections.




Copyright 2021 Arcade Data Ltd

### 2.4.2. Persistence

By default, data created in a Docker container is lost when the container stops. To preserve your ArcadeDB databases beyond the container's lifecycle, you need to configure persistent storage by mounting volumes.

#### Understanding ArcadeDB's Database Directory

ArcadeDB stores its databases in the `/home/arcadedb/databases` directory by default. This is the path you need to mount to persist your data. You can customize this location using the `-Darcadedb.server.databaseDirectory` setting if needed.

#### Docker Volumes vs. Bind Mounts

Docker offers two approaches for persistent storage:

1. **Docker volumes** - Docker-managed storage sections on the host filesystem. Docker handles the storage location, permissions, and lifecycle. This is the recommended approach for most use cases as it's more portable and easier to manage.
2. **Bind mounts** - Direct mapping to a specific path on your host machine. This gives you full control over the exact location of your data files and allows direct access to them from the host. Useful when you need to inspect, backup, or manipulate the database files directly.

See the Docker storage documentation for detailed setup instructions.

#### Persisting the Database Directory

The default path `/home/arcadedb/databases` contains all your database files. Mount this directory to make your data persistent. Here's an example using a bind mount:

```
$ docker run --rm -p 2480:2480 --name my_arcadedb \
    -v /path/on/host/databases:/home/arcadedb/databases \
    --env ARCADEDB_SETTINGS="-Darcadedb.server.rootPassword=playwithdata" \
    --hostname my_arcadedb arcadedata/arcadedb:26.10.1
```

Replace `/path/on/host/databases` with your desired directory path. All database read and write operations will occur on this mounted volume.

If you prefer using Docker volumes instead of bind mounts, replace `-v /path/on/host/databases:/home/arcadedb/databases` with `-v arcadedb-data:/home/arcadedb/databases` where `arcadedb-data` is your chosen volume name.

#### Alternative: Custom Database Directory

If you need to change where ArcadeDB stores databases, use the `-Darcadedb.server.databaseDirectory` setting and mount your volume to match the new path:

```
$ docker run --rm -p 2480:2480 --name my_arcadedb \
```

```
    -v /path/on/host/databases:/mydatabases \
    --env ARCADEDB_SETTINGS="-Darcadedb.server.databaseDirectory=/mydatabases \
                    -Darcadedb.server.rootPassword=playwithdata" \
    --hostname my_arcadedb arcadedata/arcadedb:26.10.1
```

This example changes the database directory to `/mydatabases` and mounts the volume to that location.

#### Alternative: Backup-Only Persistence

For better performance, you can keep databases in container storage and only persist backups. All database operations occur in fast container storage, but you must perform regular backups:

```
$ docker run --rm -p 2480:2480 --name my_arcadedb \
    -v /path/on/host/backups:/home/arcadedb/backups \
    --env ARCADEDB_SETTINGS="-Darcadedb.server.rootPassword=playwithdata" \
    --hostname my_arcadedb arcadedata/arcadedb:26.10.1
```

The default backup directory is `/home/arcadedb/backups`. You can customize it with `-Darcadedb.server.backupDirectory=/mybackup`. Remember to execute regular `BACKUP DATABASE` operations.

The optimal strategy depends on your infrastructure. "Local storage" performance characteristics vary between bare metal, virtual machines, and container orchestration platforms.

#### Comprehensive Persistence Example

Mount multiple directories for complete data, backup, log, and configuration persistence:

```
$ docker run --rm -p 2480:2480 --name my_arcadedb \
    -v /path/on/host/databases:/home/arcadedb/databases \
    -v /path/on/host/backups:/home/arcadedb/backups \
    -v /path/on/host/log:/home/arcadedb/log \
    -v /path/on/host/config:/home/arcadedb/config \
    --env ARCADEDB_SETTINGS="-Darcadedb.server.rootPassword=playwithdata" \
    --hostname my_arcadedb arcadedata/arcadedb:26.10.1
```

#### Relocating the configuration directory

The server keeps its configuration files in `/home/arcadedb/config`: `server-configuration.json`, the users, groups and API tokens (`server-users.jsonl`, `server-groups.json`, `server-api-tokens.json`), `backup.json`, `ai.json`, `mcp-config.json` and `gremlin-server.yaml`. Since v26.10.1 you can move them with `arcadedb.server.configDirectory`, for example onto the volume that already holds the databases, so a single mount persists both:

```
$ docker run --rm -p 2480:2480 --name my_arcadedb \
    -v /path/on/host/arcadedb:/data \
    --env ARCADEDB_SETTINGS="-Darcadedb.server.databaseDirectory=/data/databases \
                    -Darcadedb.server.configDirectory=/data/config \
                    -Darcadedb.server.rootPassword=playwithdata" \
    --hostname my_arcadedb arcadedata/arcadedb:26.10.1
```

Keep in mind:

- Pass the setting as a `-D` property (here through `ARCADEDB_SETTINGS`). Setting it in `server-configuration.json` has no effect, because that file is itself read from the configuration directory.
- The server creates the directory if it does not exist, but it does not copy the files shipped in the image's `config/` directory into it. If you rely on one of them, such as `gremlin-server.yaml` for the Gremlin plugin, copy it over yourself.
- Logging is not affected: `arcadedb-log.properties` is still loaded through `-Djava.util.logging.config.file`.

### 2.4.3. Tuning

The image sizes the JVM heap as a share of the container's memory limit (`-XX:MaxRAMPercentage=75`), so in most cases there is nothing to tune: give the container the memory you want ArcadeDB to have and the heap follows. The image also selects generational ZGC through `ARCADEDB_OPTS_GC`. See JVM settings inside a fixed memory budget for how the heap share and the collector are chosen, and why a heap pinned with `-Xms` equal to `-Xmx` inflates the memory the container reports.

```
$ docker run -m 4g ... arcadedata/arcadedb:latest
```

*Since v26.9.1* the heap is sized from the container limit. Earlier images pinned it to 2 GB (`-Xms2G -Xmx2G`), which meant a container limited to less than about 2.3 GB was killed at startup before the server came up.

To set the heap explicitly instead, override `ARCADEDB_OPTS_MEMORY`:

```
$ docker ... -e ARCADEDB_OPTS_MEMORY="-Xms800M -Xmx800M" ...
```

To run ArcadeDB with RAM <800M, it's suggested to tune some settings. You can use the `low-ram` profile to use the least memory possible.

```
$ docker ... -e ARCADEDB_OPTS_MEMORY="-Xms800M -Xmx800M" -e ARCADEDB_SETTINGS="-
Darcadedb.profile=low-ram" ...
```

# Chapter 3. Examples

## 3.1. Vector Search Tutorial

This tutorial walks you through building a semantic search system with ArcadeDB. You will create vector embeddings, index them, query by similarity, and combine vector search with graph traversal.

### 3.1.1. What You Will Build

A product catalog with semantic search: given a query like "portable computing device", find the most relevant products by embedding similarity rather than keyword matching.

### 3.1.2. Prerequisites

- ArcadeDB running (Docker or binary install)
- A way to send queries (Console, HTTP API, or a Python/JavaScript client)

### 3.1.3. Step 1: Create the Schema

Create a vertex type with a vector property:

```
CREATE VERTEX TYPE Product
CREATE PROPERTY Product.name STRING
CREATE PROPERTY Product.category STRING
CREATE PROPERTY Product.embedding LIST OF FLOAT
```

### 3.1.4. Step 2: Create a Vector Index

Create an LSM_VECTOR index on the embedding property. Specify the number of dimensions and the similarity metric:

```
CREATE INDEX ON Product (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  dimensions: 4,
  similarity: 'COSINE'
}
```

In production, embeddings are typically 384-1536 dimensions. This tutorial uses 4 dimensions for simplicity. For production workloads, add `quantization: 'INT8'` for significantly better search performance — see concepts/vector-search.pdf below.

### 3.1.5. Step 3: Insert Data with Embeddings

Insert products with pre-computed embedding vectors:

```
CREATE VERTEX Product SET name = 'Laptop',       category = 'Electronics', embedding =
[0.9, 0.1, 0.8, 0.2]
CREATE VERTEX Product SET name = 'Tablet',        category = 'Electronics', embedding
= [0.85, 0.15, 0.75, 0.25]
CREATE VERTEX Product SET name = 'Smartphone',    category = 'Electronics', embedding
= [0.8, 0.2, 0.7, 0.3]
CREATE VERTEX Product SET name = 'Headphones',    category = 'Electronics', embedding
= [0.6, 0.4, 0.5, 0.5]
CREATE VERTEX Product SET name = 'Novel',         category = 'Books',       embedding
= [0.1, 0.9, 0.2, 0.8]
CREATE VERTEX Product SET name = 'Textbook',      category = 'Books',       embedding
= [0.2, 0.8, 0.3, 0.7]
CREATE VERTEX Product SET name = 'Running Shoes', category = 'Sports',      embedding
= [0.3, 0.5, 0.9, 0.1]
CREATE VERTEX Product SET name = 'Yoga Mat',      category = 'Sports',      embedding
= [0.25, 0.55, 0.85, 0.15]
```

In a real application, you would generate embeddings using an external model such as OpenAI's `text-embedding-3-small` (1536 dimensions) or Sentence Transformers' `all-MiniLM-L6-v2` (384 dimensions).

### 3.1.6. Step 4: Query by Similarity

Find the 3 products most similar to a query vector:

```
SELECT name, category, distance FROM (
  SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Product[embedding]', [0.88, 0.12, 0.78, 0.22], 3))
)
```

The `vector.neighbors()` function returns a list of results — `expand()` flattens it into individual rows so you can access properties like `name`, `category`, and `distance` directly. The query vector `[0.88, 0.12, 0.78, 0.22]` is close to the electronics cluster. The results should return Laptop, Tablet, and Smartphone — the three most similar items by cosine similarity.

### 3.1.7. Step 5: Add Graph Relationships

Make the example more interesting by adding edges between products:

```
CREATE EDGE TYPE FREQUENTLY_BOUGHT_WITH
CREATE EDGE TYPE SIMILAR_TO

CREATE EDGE FREQUENTLY_BOUGHT_WITH
  FROM (SELECT FROM Product WHERE name = 'Laptop')
  TO (SELECT FROM Product WHERE name = 'Headphones')

CREATE EDGE SIMILAR_TO
  FROM (SELECT FROM Product WHERE name = 'Laptop')
```

```
  TO (SELECT FROM Product WHERE name = 'Tablet')

CREATE EDGE FREQUENTLY_BOUGHT_WITH
  FROM (SELECT FROM Product WHERE name = 'Novel')
  TO (SELECT FROM Product WHERE name = 'Textbook')
```

### 3.1.8. Step 6: Combine Vector Search with Graph Traversal

Find similar products, then expand recommendations through graph relationships:

```
-- Step 1: Find top 3 by vector similarity
SELECT name, category, distance FROM (
  SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Product[embedding]', [0.88, 0.12, 0.78, 0.22], 3))
)
```

Then traverse from those results to find related products:

```
-- Step 2: Get products frequently bought with the top match
SELECT friend.name, friend.category
FROM MATCH {type: Product, as: product, where: (name = 'Laptop')}
     -FREQUENTLY_BOUGHT_WITH-> {type: Product, as: friend}
```

This two-step pattern — vector search to find semantically similar items, then graph traversal to expand through relationships — is the foundation of the Graph RAG and Recommendation Engine patterns.

### 3.1.9. Step 7: Use Different Similarity Metrics

Create additional indexes with different metrics for comparison:

```
-- Euclidean distance (absolute distance in vector space)
CREATE PROPERTY Product.embedding_l2 LIST OF FLOAT
CREATE INDEX ON Product (embedding_l2) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  dimensions: 4,
  similarity: 'EUCLIDEAN'
}

-- Dot product (fastest for normalized vectors)
CREATE PROPERTY Product.embedding_dot LIST OF FLOAT
CREATE INDEX ON Product (embedding_dot) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  dimensions: 4,
  similarity: 'DOT_PRODUCT'
}
```

### 3.1.10. Step 8: Control Search Quality with efSearch

By default, ArcadeDB uses an adaptive search strategy that works well for most queries. You can override it per-query by passing efSearch as the 4th argument:

```
-- Higher efSearch for better recall (useful for critical queries)
SELECT name, category, distance FROM (
  SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Product[embedding]', [0.88, 0.12, 0.78, 0.22], 3,
200))
)
```

See Adaptive efSearch for details on how the default strategy works.

### 3.1.11. Step 9: Enable Quantization for Large Datasets

For production datasets with many vectors, enable INT8 quantization to reduce memory by 75%:

```
CREATE VERTEX TYPE LargeProduct
CREATE PROPERTY LargeProduct.embedding ARRAY_OF_FLOATS

CREATE INDEX ON LargeProduct (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  dimensions: 384,
  similarity: 'COSINE',
  quantization: 'INT8'
}
```

Queries work exactly the same — quantization is transparent:

```
SELECT name, distance FROM (
  SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('LargeProduct[embedding]', $queryVector, 10))
)
```

### 3.1.12. Next Steps

- Vector Search Concepts — Architecture, algorithms, and parameter tuning
- Vector Embeddings How-To — Production best practices
- Recommendation Engine — Full use case with vector + graph + time-series
- Graph RAG — Vector + graph for LLM retrieval augmentation

## 3.2. Time Series Tutorial

This tutorial walks you through ingesting and querying time series data with ArcadeDB. You will create a sensor monitoring system that ingests temperature readings and queries them with SQL aggregations, PromQL, and continuous aggregates.

### 3.2.1. Prerequisites

- ArcadeDB running (Docker or binary install)
- `curl` for HTTP requests

### 3.2.2. Step 1: Create a TimeSeries Type

Create a type to store sensor readings with temperature, humidity, and pressure fields:

```
CREATE TIMESERIES TYPE SensorReading
  TIMESTAMP ts PRECISION MILLISECOND
  TAGS (sensor_id STRING, location STRING)
  FIELDS (
    temperature DOUBLE,
    humidity DOUBLE,
    pressure DOUBLE
  )
  SHARDS 4
```

- **TIMESTAMP** — Every time series type needs a timestamp column
- **TAGS** — Low-cardinality dimensions used for filtering (indexed automatically)
- **FIELDS** — The measurement values
- **SHARDS** — Parallel write/read partitions (default: CPU count)

### 3.2.3. Step 2: Ingest Data via InfluxDB Line Protocol

The fastest remote ingestion method. Send sensor readings using `curl`:

```
curl -X POST "http://localhost:2480/api/v1/ts/mydb/write?precision=ms" \
  -u root:arcadedb \
  -H "Content-Type: text/plain" \
  --data-binary '
SensorReading,sensor_id=sensor-A,location=floor-1
temperature=22.5,humidity=65.0,pressure=1013.2 1708430400000
SensorReading,sensor_id=sensor-A,location=floor-1
temperature=22.7,humidity=64.5,pressure=1013.1 1708430460000
SensorReading,sensor_id=sensor-A,location=floor-1
temperature=23.1,humidity=63.0,pressure=1013.0 1708430520000
SensorReading,sensor_id=sensor-B,location=floor-2
temperature=19.8,humidity=70.0,pressure=1012.5 1708430400000
SensorReading,sensor_id=sensor-B,location=floor-2
temperature=19.5,humidity=71.0,pressure=1012.6 1708430460000
SensorReading,sensor_id=sensor-B,location=floor-2
temperature=19.2,humidity=72.0,pressure=1012.7 1708430520000
'
```

The format is: `<type>,<tag>=<value> <field>=<value> <timestamp>`

### 3.2.4. Step 3: Ingest Data via SQL

You can also insert using standard SQL. The timestamp is built with the `date()` function (an ISO-8601 string is not accepted by `INSERT`, while it is in `WHERE` conditions); an epoch value in milliseconds works too:

```
INSERT INTO SensorReading
  (ts, sensor_id, location, temperature, humidity, pressure)
  VALUES
    (date('2026-02-20 10:10:00', 'yyyy-MM-dd HH:mm:ss'), 'sensor-A', 'floor-1', 23.5,
62.0, 1012.9),
    (date('2026-02-20 10:10:00', 'yyyy-MM-dd HH:mm:ss'), 'sensor-B', 'floor-2', 19.0,
73.0, 1012.8)
```

### 3.2.5. Step 4: Query with Time Range Filters

Time range conditions on the timestamp column are pushed down to the storage engine for efficient scans:

```
SELECT ts, sensor_id, temperature, humidity
FROM SensorReading
WHERE ts BETWEEN '2026-02-20T10:00:00Z' AND '2026-02-20T11:00:00Z'
  AND sensor_id = 'sensor-A'
ORDER BY ts
```

### 3.2.6. Step 5: Aggregate with Time Bucketing

Use `ts.timeBucket()` to group data into time intervals:

```
SELECT ts.timeBucket('1h', ts) AS hour,
       sensor_id,
       avg(temperature) AS avg_temp,
       max(temperature) AS max_temp,
       min(temperature) AS min_temp,
       count(*) AS samples
FROM SensorReading
WHERE ts BETWEEN '2026-02-20' AND '2026-02-21'
GROUP BY hour, sensor_id
ORDER BY hour
```

### 3.2.7. Step 6: Calculate Rates and Percentiles

```
-- Rate of change per minute
SELECT ts.timeBucket('5m', ts) AS window,
```

```
       sensor_id,
       ts.rate(temperature, ts) AS temp_change_per_sec
FROM SensorReading
GROUP BY window, sensor_id

-- 99th percentile temperature per hour
SELECT ts.timeBucket('1h', ts) AS hour,
       ts.percentile(temperature, 0.99) AS p99_temp
FROM SensorReading
GROUP BY hour
```

### 3.2.8. Step 7: Fill Gaps with Interpolation

Sensor data often has gaps. Use `ts.interpolate()` to fill them:

```
SELECT ts.timeBucket('1m', ts) AS minute,
       ts.interpolate(temperature, 'linear', ts) AS temp
FROM SensorReading
WHERE sensor_id = 'sensor-A'
  AND ts BETWEEN '2026-02-20T10:00:00Z' AND '2026-02-20T11:00:00Z'
GROUP BY minute
```

Methods: `'zero'` (fill with 0), `'prev'` (forward fill), `'linear'` (interpolate), `'none'` (keep null).

### 3.2.9. Step 8: Query with PromQL

ArcadeDB includes a native PromQL evaluator. Query via HTTP:

```
# Instant query
curl
"http://localhost:2480/ts/mydb/prom/api/v1/query?query=avg(SensorReading{sensor_id='se
nsor-A'})" \
  -u root:arcadedb

# Range query with rate calculation
curl "http://localhost:2480/ts/mydb/prom/api/v1/query_range?\
query=rate(SensorReading{sensor_id='sensor-A'}[5m])&\
start=1708430400&end=1708434000&step=60" \
  -u root:arcadedb
```

Or use PromQL from within SQL:

```
RETURN promql('avg(SensorReading{sensor_id="sensor-A"})')
```

### 3.2.10. Step 9: Create a Continuous Aggregate

Pre-compute hourly summaries that update automatically:

```
CREATE CONTINUOUS AGGREGATE hourly_temps AS
  SELECT ts.timeBucket('1h', ts) AS hour,
         sensor_id,
         avg(temperature) AS avg_temp,
         max(temperature) AS max_temp,
         count(*) AS cnt
  FROM SensorReading
  GROUP BY hour, sensor_id
```

Query the aggregate like any table:

```
SELECT * FROM hourly_temps ORDER BY hour DESC LIMIT 10
```

New inserts into `SensorReading` automatically trigger incremental updates to the aggregate.

### 3.2.11. Step 10: Set Up Retention and Downsampling

Keep raw data for 90 days, then downsample:

```
ALTER TIMESERIES TYPE SensorReading
  ADD DOWNSAMPLING POLICY
    AFTER 7 DAYS GRANULARITY 1 MINUTES
    AFTER 30 DAYS GRANULARITY 1 HOURS
```

Raw data is automatically downsampled by a background scheduler.

### 3.2.12. Next Steps

- Time Series Concepts — Architecture, compression, HA, and full reference
- Realtime Analytics Use Case — Complete IoT monitoring with Grafana
- Time Series Quick Reference — Syntax cheat sheet

## 3.3. Recommendation Engine

Build intelligent product and content recommendations in a single multi-model database — no external recommendation service required. Graph traversal powers collaborative filtering through relationship patterns like User-PURCHASED→Product and User-WATCHED→Show, vector similarity drives content-based recommendations using `vector.neighbors()` with LSM_VECTOR indexes on product and show embeddings, and time-series analysis detects trending items by aggregating interaction counts over time windows.

### 3.3.1. Architecture Overview

| | |
|---|---|
| Vertices | `User`, `Product`, `Show` (each with embedding vectors) |
| Edges | `PURCHASED`, `WATCHED`, `INTERACTED` |
| Documents | `ProductInteraction` (productId, purchaseCount, timestamp) |

Users connect to products and shows through purchase, watch, and interaction edges. Each item carries a 4-dimensional embedding vector for content-based similarity. A `ProductInteraction` document type tracks interaction counts over time for trending analysis.

### 3.3.2. Key Queries

**Collaborative Filtering** — Find products purchased by users who bought the same items:

```
MATCH (u:User)-[:PURCHASED]->(p:Product)<-[:PURCHASED]-(other:User)-[:PURCHASED]->
(rec:Product)
WHERE u.name = 'Alice' AND NOT (u)-[:PURCHASED]->(rec)
RETURN rec.name, count(other) AS score ORDER BY score DESC
```

**Vector Similarity Search** — Find products similar to a given product by embedding:

```
SELECT name, category, distance FROM (
  SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Product[embedding]', [0.9, 0.1, 0.8, 0.2], 5))
) ORDER BY distance
```

**Diversified Recommendations Across Categories** — Avoid result-page collapse to a single category by asking for the best matching product per category in one call:

```
SELECT expand(`vector.neighbors`(
    'Product[embedding]',
    [0.9, 0.1, 0.8, 0.2],
    10,
    { groupBy: 'category', groupSize: 1 }
))
```

`groupBy` is integrated with the index lookup, so a 10-category-wide carousel does not require over-fetching 50 or 100 candidates at the application layer just to dedupe afterwards. `groupSize: 2` would return up to two products per category for a "browse more like this" surface.

**Trending Detection** — Identify trending products by recent interaction volume:

```
SELECT productId, SUM(purchaseCount) AS total
FROM ProductInteraction
WHERE timestamp > date('2024-01-14', 'yyyy-MM-dd')
```

```
GROUP BY productId ORDER BY total DESC
```

### 3.3.3. Try It Yourself

```
git clone https://github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb-usecases.git
cd arcadedb-usecases/recommendation-engine
docker compose up -d
./setup.sh
./queries/queries.sh
```

Full source: recommendation-engine on GitHub

### 3.3.4. Related Documentation

- Vector Search Concepts
- Graph Model
- Time Series

## 3.4. Knowledge Graphs

Build a unified academic research system that integrates researchers, papers, institutions, and topics in a single database. Graph traversal drives multi-hop queries across co-authorship and citation networks, vector similarity enables semantic paper search via `vector.neighbors()` on paper embeddings, full-text search supports keyword queries on abstracts using `SEARCH_INDEX()`, and time-series tracking monitors citation activity over time.

### 3.4.1. Architecture Overview

| | |
|---|---|
| Vertices | `Researcher`, `Paper`, `Topic`, `Institution` |
| Edges | `CO_AUTHORED`, `CITES`, `COVERS`, `AFFILIATED_WITH` |
| Documents | `PaperActivity` (paperId, citationCount, timestamp) |

Papers carry 4-dimensional embedding vectors for semantic search and full-text indexed abstracts for keyword search. Citation activity is tracked as time-series documents.

### 3.4.2. Key Queries

**Co-authorship Network** — Discover collaborations between researchers:

```
MATCH (r:Researcher)-[:CO_AUTHORED]->(p:Paper)<-[:CO_AUTHORED]-(coauthor:Researcher)
WHERE r.name = 'Dr. Smith'
RETURN coauthor.name, collect(p.title) AS papers
```

**Semantic Paper Search** — Find papers similar to a research topic by embedding:

```
SELECT title, year, distance FROM (
  SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Paper[embedding]', [0.8, 0.3, 0.7, 0.1], 5))
) ORDER BY distance
```

**Full-Text Abstract Search** — Keyword search across paper abstracts:

```
SELECT title, abstract FROM Paper
WHERE SEARCH_INDEX('Paper[abstract]', 'machine learning graph')
```

**Hybrid Semantic + Keyword Search, one query** — Fuse the semantic-similarity ranking with the abstract keyword match into a single ranked list, then collapse to one paper per topic so the literature review surface does not over-represent a single research thread:

```
SELECT expand(`vector.fuse`(
    `vector.neighbors`('Paper[embedding]', [0.8, 0.3, 0.7, 0.1], 50),
    (SELECT @rid, $score FROM Paper
     WHERE SEARCH_INDEX('Paper[abstract]', 'machine learning graph') = true),
    { fusion: 'RRF', groupBy: 'topic', groupSize: 1 }
)) LIMIT 10
```

The semantic side surfaces conceptually similar papers even when the abstract phrasing diverges; the full-text side anchors the result on papers that explicitly use the query terms; RRF balances the two without requiring score calibration. Replace `groupBy: 'topic'` with `'institution'`, `'venue'`, or `'year'` to diversify along a different axis. To dedupe across multiple authors of the same paper, the upstream sparse vector index can be added as a third source for term-level disambiguation.

### 3.4.3. Try It Yourself

```
git clone https://github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb-usecases.git
cd arcadedb-usecases/knowledge-graphs
docker compose up -d
./setup.sh
./queries/queries.sh
```

Full source: knowledge-graphs on GitHub

### 3.4.4. Related Documentation

- Vector Search Concepts
- Full-Text Search
- Graph Model

# 3.5. Graph RAG

Implement retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) that retrieves richer, more connected context for LLM queries — all within a single database. Graph traversal enables multi-hop entity bridging across knowledge graph relationships, vector similarity powers semantic chunk retrieval using `vector.neighbors()` with LSM_VECTOR indexes, sparse vectors add SPLADE / BM25-style learned sparse retrieval for exact-term and OOV matches that dense embeddings miss, server-side hybrid fusion combines all of the above in one query, full-text search provides keyword-based chunk lookup, and Neo4j Bolt protocol compatibility on port 7687 supports LangChain4j integration.

## 3.5.1. Architecture Overview

| | |
|---|---|
| Vertices | `Chunk` (content, source, chunkIndex, embedding, tokens, weights), `Entity`, `Person`, `Concept`, `Organization` |
| Edges | `MENTIONS`, `RELATES_TO`, `WORKS_AT`, `AUTHORED` |

Document chunks carry both a dense embedding (`embedding`) and a sparse vector (`tokens` + `weights`) so the same record participates in both retrieval modalities. Chunks link to extracted entities through `MENTIONS` edges, and entities connect via `RELATES_TO`, enabling multi-hop discovery that bridges chunks from different documents through shared entity mentions.

## 3.5.2. Key Queries

**Vector Search** — Find semantically similar chunks by dense embedding:

```
SELECT content, source, distance FROM (
  SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Chunk[embedding]', [0.9, 0.1, 0.8, 0.2], 5))
)
```

**Hybrid Retrieval (Dense + Sparse), one query** — The canonical modern-RAG retrieval shape. Dense + sparse hybrid with Reciprocal Rank Fusion, deduped to one chunk per source document via `groupBy`:

```
SELECT expand(`vector.fuse`(
    `vector.neighbors`('Chunk[embedding]', :denseQuery, 50),
    `vector.sparseNeighbors`('Chunk[tokens,weights]', :qIdx, :qVal, 50),
    { fusion: 'RRF', groupBy: 'source', groupSize: 1 }
)) LIMIT 10
```

Sparse retrieval fixes the case where dense embeddings collapse semantically distinct queries onto the same point: "freeze card after theft" and "unfreeze card after travel" share the same dense vector but separate cleanly under sparse term matching. `groupBy: 'source', groupSize: 1` ensures each source document contributes its single best matching chunk to the LLM context window rather than overwhelming the prompt with near-duplicate chunks from one document.

**Multi-Hop Entity Bridge** — Discover related entities across documents:

```
MATCH (c:Chunk)-[:MENTIONS]->(e:Entity)-[:RELATES_TO*1..2]-(related:Entity)<-
[:MENTIONS]-(other:Chunk)
WHERE c.source = 'quantum_computing.txt'
RETURN related.name, other.content, other.source
```

**Composite Scoring** — Combine vector distance with graph connectivity for ranked retrieval:

```
SELECT content, source,
  (1.0 / (1.0 + distance)) * 0.7 + (entityCount / 5.0) * 0.3 AS compositeScore
FROM ChunkScores ORDER BY compositeScore DESC
```

### 3.5.3. Try It Yourself

```
git clone https://github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb-usecases.git
cd arcadedb-usecases/graph-rag
docker compose up -d
./setup.sh
./queries/queries.sh
```

Full source: graph-rag on GitHub

### 3.5.4. Related Documentation

- Vector Search Concepts
- Graph Model
- Full-Text Search and BM25 Ranking

## 3.6. Fraud Detection

Detect financial fraud by unifying four detection signals in a single multi-model database: graph traversal exposes organized fraud rings through shared identifier patterns such as devices, phones, and addresses; vector similarity flags behavioral anomalies using `vector.cosineSimilarity()` on transaction embeddings; time-series analysis catches velocity attacks through temporal transaction patterns; and document queries resolve synthetic identities by detecting duplicate SSNs.

### 3.6.1. Architecture Overview

| | |
|---|---|
| Vertices | `Account`, `Customer`, `Device`, `Phone`, `Address`, `Email`, `Beneficiary`, `Transaction` |
| Edges | `USES_DEVICE`, `HAS_PHONE`, `HAS_ADDRESS`, `HAS_EMAIL`, `TRANSFERRED_TO`, `BENEFICIARY_OF` |

Accounts and customers connect through shared devices, phones, and addresses. Overlapping identifiers reveal fraud rings. Customers carry `profile_embedding` vectors and transactions carry `behavior_embedding` vectors for anomaly detection.

### 3.6.2. Key Queries

**Fraud Ring Detection** — Identify accounts sharing devices or phones:

```
MATCH (a1:Account)-[:USES_DEVICE]->(d:Device)<-[:USES_DEVICE]-(a2:Account)
WHERE a1 <> a2
RETURN a1.name, a2.name, d.deviceId AS sharedDevice
```

**Synthetic Identity Detection** — Find accounts sharing SSNs:

```
SELECT a1.name, a2.name, a1.ssn
FROM Account a1, Account a2
WHERE a1.ssn = a2.ssn AND a1 != a2
```

**Behavioral Anomaly Detection** — Compare transaction embeddings against baselines:

```
SELECT name, vector.cosineSimilarity(behavior_embedding, [0.1, 0.9, 0.1, 0.8]) AS
similarity
FROM Transaction
WHERE vector.cosineSimilarity(behavior_embedding, [0.1, 0.9, 0.1, 0.8]) < 0.7
```

### 3.6.3. Try It Yourself

```
git clone https://github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb-usecases.git
cd arcadedb-usecases/fraud-detection
docker compose up -d
./setup.sh
./queries/queries.sh
```

Full source: fraud-detection on GitHub

### 3.6.4. Related Documentation

- Graph Model
- Vector Search Concepts
- Time Series
- Cypher Query Language
- Louvain Community Detection — Identify fraud rings as communities
- Cycle Detection — Detect circular money flows
- Dijkstra Shortest Path — Trace shortest paths between suspicious accounts

# 3.7. Realtime Analytics

Replace a fragmented stack of specialized monitoring tools with a single database that integrates time-series sensor data, service metrics, and infrastructure topology. Time-series native functions — `ts.timeBucket()`, `ts.rate()`, `ts.percentile()`, and `ts.interpolate()` — power sensor and service metric analysis, while graph traversal maps building topology and service dependencies, enabling multi-model correlation that combines graph-based entity identification with time-series aggregation in unified queries.

## 3.7.1. Architecture Overview

| | |
|---|---|
| Time Series | `SensorReading` (sensor_id, location, temperature, humidity, pressure), `ServiceMetrics` (service_id, server_id, request_count, error_count, latency_ms) |
| Vertices | `Building`, `Floor`, `Sensor`, `Server`, `Service` |
| Edges | `HAS_FLOOR`, `INSTALLED_IN`, `RUNS_ON`, `DEPENDS_ON` |

Sensors are installed on floors within buildings; services run on servers and depend on other services. Time-series data links to graph topology, enabling queries like "show the temperature trend for all sensors on the 2nd floor of Building A."

## 3.7.2. Key Queries

**Hourly Temperature Bucketing** — Aggregate sensor readings by hour:

```
SELECT sensor_id, ts.timeBucket(timestamp, 'PT1H') AS hour,
  AVG(temperature) AS avg_temp, MAX(temperature) AS max_temp
FROM SensorReading
GROUP BY sensor_id, hour ORDER BY hour
```

**Service Request Rate** — Calculate request rate per service:

```
SELECT service_id, ts.rate(timestamp, request_count, 'PT5M') AS req_per_5min
FROM ServiceMetrics
WHERE service_id = 'api-gateway'
```

**Service Impact Analysis** — Trace service dependencies for outage impact:

```
MATCH (s:Service {name: 'database'})<-[:DEPENDS_ON*1..3]-(dependent:Service)
RETURN dependent.name AS affected_service, length(path) AS hops
```

## 3.7.3. Try It Yourself

```
git clone https://github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb-usecases.git
```

```
cd arcadedb-usecases/realtime-analytics
docker compose up -d
./setup.sh
./queries/queries.sh
```

Full source: realtime-analytics on GitHub

### 3.7.4. Related Documentation

- Time Series
- Graph Model

## 3.8. Social Network Analytics

Analyze social network dynamics — trending content, user influence, viral propagation, and engagement metrics — in a unified platform. Materialized views with three refresh modes (PERIODIC for trending dashboards, INCREMENTAL for post counts on commit, and MANUAL for on-demand influence scores) pre-compute key analytics, graph traversal powers viral spread chain analysis and community overlap detection, time-series tracking captures engagement metrics as historical snapshots, and polyglot query support lets you use SQL for views and aggregations alongside OpenCypher for graph traversals.

### 3.8.1. Architecture Overview

| | |
|---|---|
| Vertices | `User`, `Post`, `Topic`, `Group` |
| Edges | `FOLLOWS`, `CREATED`, `LIKED`, `SHARED`, `TAGGED`, `MEMBER_OF` |
| Documents | `EngagementMetric` (postId, likes, shares, comments, timestamp) |

Users create and interact with posts, follow each other, and belong to groups. Engagement metrics are captured as time-series snapshots. Materialized views pre-compute trending scores, post counts, and influence rankings.

### 3.8.2. Key Queries

**Trending Content Dashboard** — Aggregate engagement into trending scores (via PERIODIC materialized view):

```
SELECT postId, SUM(likes + shares * 2 + comments * 3) AS trendingScore
FROM EngagementMetric
WHERE timestamp > date('2024-01-15', 'yyyy-MM-dd')
GROUP BY postId ORDER BY trendingScore DESC
```

**Viral Spread Chain** — Trace how content propagates through the network:

```
MATCH path = (origin:User)-[:CREATED]->(p:Post)<-[:SHARED]-(sharer:User)-[:FOLLOWS]->
```

```
(reached:User)
WHERE origin.name = 'Alice'
RETURN origin.name, sharer.name, reached.name, p.title
```

**Community Overlap** — Find users active in multiple groups:

```
MATCH (u:User)-[:MEMBER_OF]->(g1:Group), (u)-[:MEMBER_OF]->(g2:Group)
WHERE g1 <> g2
RETURN u.name, g1.name, g2.name
```

### 3.8.3. Try It Yourself

```
git clone https://github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb-usecases.git
cd arcadedb-usecases/social-network-analytics
docker compose up -d
./setup.sh
./queries/queries.sh
```

Full source: social-network-analytics on GitHub

### 3.8.4. Related Documentation

- Graph Model
- Time Series
- PageRank — Rank user influence in the network
- Louvain Community Detection — Discover user communities
- Betweenness Centrality — Identify bridge users connecting communities
- Label Propagation — Fast community assignment

## 3.9. Supply Chain

Achieve multi-tier supply chain visibility in a single database by combining graph traversal for multi-tier supplier discovery, blast radius analysis, and end-to-end batch traceability via variable-length path queries, vector similarity for alternative supplier sourcing using capability embeddings with `vector.neighbors()`, time-series analysis for delivery disruption detection via metric aggregation, and the PostgreSQL wire protocol for JavaScript connectivity.

### 3.9.1. Architecture Overview

| | |
|---|---|
| Vertices | `Supplier`, `Component`, `Product`, `Warehouse`, `Customer`, `ShippingRoute`, `RawMaterial` |
| Edges | `SUPPLIES`, `CONTAINS`, `STORED_AT`, `SHIPS_VIA`, `SHIPPED_TO`, `ALTERNATIVE_FOR`, `ASSEMBLED_FROM` |

| Documents | `DeliveryMetric` (supplierId, deliveryTime, qualityScore, timestamp) |
|---|---|

Suppliers carry 4-dimensional capability vectors. Components flow through a multi-tier graph from raw materials through assembly to distribution. Delivery metrics track supplier performance over time.

### 3.9.2. Key Queries

**Multi-Tier Supplier Discovery** — Find all suppliers up to 3 tiers deep:

```
MATCH path = (p:Product)-[:CONTAINS*1..3]->(c:Component)<-[:SUPPLIES]-(s:Supplier)
WHERE p.name = 'SmartWatch Pro'
RETURN s.name, c.name, length(path) AS tier
```

**Blast Radius Analysis** — Assess impact of a supplier going offline:

```
MATCH (s:Supplier {name: 'ChipCorp'})-[:SUPPLIES]->(c:Component)<-[:CONTAINS]-(
p:Product)
OPTIONAL MATCH (alt:Supplier)-[:SUPPLIES]->(c)
WHERE alt <> s
RETURN p.name, c.name, collect(alt.name) AS alternatives
```

**Alternative Supplier Sourcing** — Find suppliers with similar capabilities by embedding:

```
SELECT name, region, distance FROM (
  SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Supplier[capability_vec]', [0.9, 0.8, 0.7, 0.6], 5))
)
```

### 3.9.3. Try It Yourself

```
git clone https://github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb-usecases.git
cd arcadedb-usecases/supply-chain
docker compose up -d
./setup.sh
./queries/queries.sh
```

Full source: supply-chain on GitHub

### 3.9.4. Related Documentation

- Graph Model
- Vector Search Concepts
- Time Series
- PostgreSQL Protocol

# 3.10. Identity & Access Management

Manage identity access across complex permission hierarchies while detecting security anomalies and maintaining compliance. Graph traversal resolves permissions through nested group/role hierarchies via SQL MATCH queries, vector similarity detects behavioral anomalies using access pattern embeddings with `vector.neighbors()`, time-series tracking captures access audit logs for SOX/GDPR compliance reporting, and the PostgreSQL wire protocol provides Python connectivity for integration.

## 3.10.1. Architecture Overview

| | |
|---|---|
| Vertices | `Identity`, `Group`, `Role`, `Permission`, `Resource`, `Policy` |
| Edges | `MEMBER_OF`, `HAS_ROLE`, `GRANTS`, `APPLIES_TO`, `GOVERNED_BY` |
| Documents | `AccessLog` (identityEmail, resourceName, action, source_ip, recordedAt) |

Identities belong to nested groups that hold roles. Roles grant permissions on resources. Policies govern resources for compliance. Access logs track all actions for audit trails. Identities carry 8-dimensional access pattern vectors for behavioral analysis.

## 3.10.2. Key Queries

**Permission Resolution** — Resolve all permissions for a user through group/role hierarchy:

```
SELECT identity.email, role.name AS role, permission.action, resource.name AS resource
FROM MATCH {type: Identity, as: identity, where: (email = 'alice@corp.com')}
  -MEMBER_OF->  {type: Group, as: grp}
  -HAS_ROLE->   {type: Role, as: role}
  -GRANTS->     {type: Permission, as: permission}
  -APPLIES_TO-> {type: Resource, as: resource}
```

**Shadow Admin Detection** — Find users with admin-equivalent access through indirect paths:

```
SELECT identity.email, role.name
FROM MATCH {type: Identity, as: identity}
  -MEMBER_OF-> {type: Group, as: grp, while: (true)}
  -HAS_ROLE->  {type: Role, as: role, where: (name LIKE '%admin%')}
```

**Behavioral Anomaly Detection** — Identify users with unusual access patterns:

```
SELECT email, distance FROM (
  SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Identity[access_pattern_vec]', [0.1,0.9,0.1,0.8,0.2
,0.7,0.3,0.6], 3))
) WHERE distance > 0.5
```

### 3.10.3. Try It Yourself

```
git clone https://github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb-usecases.git
cd arcadedb-usecases/iam
docker compose up -d
./setup.sh
./queries/queries.sh
```

Full source: iam on GitHub

### 3.10.4. Related Documentation

- Graph Model
- Vector Search Concepts
- PostgreSQL Protocol
- BFS — Traverse permission hierarchies level by level
- All Simple Paths — Enumerate all permission paths to a resource
- Strongly Connected Components — Detect circular permission dependencies

## 3.11. Customer 360

Build a unified customer view in a single database by leveraging graph traversal for identity resolution, churn risk scoring, and cross-sell recommendations, the document model for fuzzy deduplication via cross-matching on customer attributes, vector similarity with LSM_VECTOR embeddings for customer preference and product matching, full-text search for support ticket content indexing, and time-series analysis for customer journey event chains and conversion path tracking.

### 3.11.1. Architecture Overview

| | |
|---|---|
| Vertices | `Customer`, `Household`, `Product`, `Device`, `Address`, `Ticket`, `Campaign`, `Session`, `Event`, `Identifier` |
| Edges | `BELONGS_TO`, `PURCHASED`, `USES`, `LIVES_AT`, `OPENED`, `TARGETED_BY`, `STARTED`, `TRIGGERED`, `HAS_IDENTIFIER` |

Customers connect to households, devices, addresses, and support tickets. Sessions contain events that trace customer journeys. Customers carry `prefVector` embeddings for personalization. Support tickets are full-text indexed.

### 3.11.2. Key Queries

**Identity Resolution** — Discover linked identities through shared sessions (3-hop transitive):

```
SELECT c1.name, c2.name, session.id AS sharedSession
```

```
FROM MATCH {type: Customer, as: c1}
  -STARTED->      {type: Session, as: session}
  <-STARTED-      {type: Customer, as: c2}
WHERE c1 <> c2
```

**Churn Risk Scoring** — Calculate churn risk based on churned neighbors in the social network:

```
SELECT customer.name,
  COUNT(CASE WHEN neighbor.status = 'churned' THEN 1 END) * 1.0 / COUNT(neighbor) AS
churnRatio
FROM MATCH {type: Customer, as: customer}
  -BELONGS_TO-> {type: Household}
  <-BELONGS_TO- {type: Customer, as: neighbor}
GROUP BY customer.name ORDER BY churnRatio DESC
```

**Hybrid Preference + Ticket Search** — Match a customer's preference vector against products while keeping support-ticket keyword evidence in the same ranked list. Useful for "next best action" surfaces that fold both behavioural similarity and recent issue context into one ranking, deduped to one product per category:

```
SELECT expand(`vector.fuse`(
    `vector.neighbors`('Product[embedding]', :customerPrefVector, 50),
    (SELECT @rid, $score FROM Ticket WHERE SEARCH_INDEX('Ticket[content]',
:recentIssueTerms) = true),
    { fusion: 'RRF', groupBy: 'category', groupSize: 1 }
)) LIMIT 10
```

**Customer Journey Analysis** — Trace conversion paths from ad click to purchase:

```
MATCH (c:Customer)-[:STARTED]->(s:Session)-[:TRIGGERED]->(e1:Event)-[:TRIGGERED]->(
e2:Event)-[:TRIGGERED]->(e3:Event)
WHERE e1.type = 'ad_click' AND e3.type = 'purchase'
RETURN c.name, e1.type, e2.type, e3.type, s.channel
```

### 3.11.3. Try It Yourself

```
git clone https://github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb-usecases.git
cd arcadedb-usecases/customer-360
docker compose up -d
./setup.sh
./queries/queries.sh
```

Full source: customer-360 on GitHub

### 3.11.4. Related Documentation

- Graph Model
- Document Model
- Vector Search Concepts
- Full-Text Search

## 3.12. Semantic Search (Planned)

This use case is in development. Want to contribute? See the arcadedb-usecases repository.

Standalone vector search for e-commerce product discovery and document retrieval. Demonstrates ArcadeDB's vector capabilities without requiring graph traversal — pure semantic search with filtering, faceting, and hybrid dense + sparse + keyword ranking.

### 3.12.1. Planned Features

- **Vector Similarity** — Product and document embeddings with LSM_VECTOR, HNSW, and DiskANN indexes
- **Sparse Vector Retrieval** — SPLADE / BGE-M3 learned-sparse embeddings via `LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR`
- **Server-side Hybrid Fusion** — `vector.fuse` combining dense + sparse + full-text in one query with RRF / DBSF / LINEAR strategies
- **BM25 Full-Text Search** — Lucene-backed keyword index with native BM25 ranking, plugged in as a `SEARCH_INDEX(⋯)` source of `vector.fuse` (see Hybrid Retrieval)
- **Document Model** — Faceted filtering on product attributes
- **Python** — Primary implementation language targeting data science and AI workflows

### 3.12.2. Reference Hybrid Query

```
SELECT expand(`vector.fuse`(
    `vector.neighbors`('Product[dense]', :queryVec, 50),
    `vector.sparseNeighbors`('Product[tokens,weights]', :qIdx, :qVal, 50),
    (SELECT @rid, $score FROM Product WHERE SEARCH_INDEX('Product[name]', :keywords) =
true),
    { fusion: 'RRF', groupBy: 'category', groupSize: 1 }
)) LIMIT 20
```

This is the typical e-commerce shape: semantic similarity (dense embeddings) + exact-term matching (sparse) + keyword search (full-text), fused server-side, then diversified across product categories so the result page does not collapse to one category.

### 3.12.3. Target Scenarios

- E-commerce product search with natural language queries
- Document retrieval with semantic understanding
- Hybrid search combining keyword matching and dense+sparse vector similarity
- Multi-vector search (title embeddings + description embeddings + sparse term embeddings)

## 3.13. Geospatial Analytics (Planned)

This use case is in development. Want to contribute? See the arcadedb-usecases repository.

Fleet tracking and location-based services combining geospatial indexes with graph topology and time-series movement data. Demonstrates spatial queries, route optimization, and real-time vehicle tracking.

### 3.13.1. Planned Features

- **Geospatial** — Spatial indexes for point-in-polygon, nearest-neighbor, and distance queries
- **Graph Traversal** — Road network and delivery route graph modeling
- **Time Series** — Vehicle position tracking and movement analytics
- **Python and JavaScript** — Dual implementation for backend analytics and frontend visualization

### 3.13.2. Target Scenarios

- Fleet tracking with real-time position updates
- Nearest point-of-interest discovery
- Geofence-based alerting
- Route optimization through road network graphs

## 3.14. Content Management (Planned)

This use case is in development. Want to contribute? See the arcadedb-usecases repository.

A content management system combining document storage, full-text search, and graph-based taxonomies. Demonstrates how ArcadeDB replaces separate CMS databases with a single multi-model store for content, metadata, and navigation hierarchies.

### 3.14.1. Planned Features

- **Document Model** — Content storage with flexible schemas for articles, pages, and media

- **Full-Text Search** — Content indexing and search across all document types
- **Graph Traversal** — Category trees, tag taxonomies, and content relationship graphs
- **JavaScript/TypeScript** — Primary implementation for web application integration

### 3.14.2. Target Scenarios

- Hierarchical content organization with category graphs
- Full-text search across articles and documents
- Related content discovery via graph relationships
- Content versioning and publishing workflows

## 3.15. Network Monitoring (Planned)

This use case is in development. Want to contribute? See the arcadedb-usecases repository.

Network topology modeling with time-series metrics and Grafana dashboards. Demonstrates how ArcadeDB unifies network graph analysis with performance monitoring, replacing separate topology databases and time-series stores.

### 3.15.1. Planned Features

- **Graph Traversal** — Network topology modeling (routers, switches, links, VLANs) with path analysis
- **Time Series** — Interface metrics (bandwidth, latency, packet loss) with PromQL queries
- **Vector Similarity** — Anomaly detection on traffic pattern embeddings
- **Python** — Primary implementation for network operations tooling

### 3.15.2. Target Scenarios

- Network topology visualization and path analysis
- Interface utilization monitoring with Grafana
- Anomaly detection on traffic patterns
- Impact analysis for planned maintenance windows

## 3.16. Data Lineage (Planned)

This use case is in development. Want to contribute? See the arcadedb-usecases repository.

Data pipeline lineage tracking with graph traversal for impact analysis, compliance reporting, and debugging data quality issues. Demonstrates modeling ETL/ELT pipelines as directed graphs with transformation metadata.

### 3.16.1. Planned Features

- **Graph Traversal** — Pipeline DAG modeling (sources, transformations, destinations) with upstream/downstream analysis
- **Document Model** — Schema snapshots and transformation metadata storage
- **Time Series** — Pipeline execution history and data quality metrics
- **Python** — Primary implementation for data engineering workflows

### 3.16.2. Target Scenarios

- Upstream/downstream impact analysis for schema changes
- Data quality issue root cause tracing
- Compliance reporting (which data flows where)
- Pipeline execution monitoring and alerting

# Chapter 4. Languages & Drivers

## 4.1. Languages & Drivers

## 4.2. Java

The Java API is the primary interface to ArcadeDB. Use it in **embedded** mode to run the database inside your JVM (no separate server process), or in **remote** mode to talk to a running ArcadeDB Server over HTTP.

**Connection options for Java**

From Java you can also reach an ArcadeDB Server over the wire protocol of your choice:

- **Neo4j BOLT** using the official `neo4j-java-driver` — run Cypher queries.
- **PostgreSQL wire protocol** using any JDBC PostgreSQL driver — run SQL.
- **HTTP/JSON API** using `java.net.http.HttpClient` — no driver required.

The tutorial below covers the embedded / native Java API. Per-protocol Java examples are coming soon.

### 4.2.1. Embedded

Add the following dependency to your Maven `pom.xml` (or the equivalent in Gradle / SBT):

```
<dependency>
    <groupId>com.arcadedb</groupId>
    <artifactId>arcadedb-engine</artifactId>
    <version>26.10.1</version>
</dependency>
```

Most of the API works in both synchronous and asynchronous modes. Synchronous calls execute on the current thread and return when finished — the easiest model for procedural code. Asynchronous calls schedule jobs onto a pool of worker threads (sized to the available cores by default), so a single-threaded application can still saturate every core. The asynchronous API is reached via `db.async()` — see the Async Database API page.

You can create a new database from scratch or open an existent one.

To start from scratch, let's create a new database. The entry point it's the `DatabaseFactory` class that allows to create and open a database.

```
DatabaseFactory databaseFactory = new DatabaseFactory("/databases/mydb");
```

Pass the path in the file system where you want the database to be stored. In this case a new directory 'mydb' will be created under the path `/databases/` of your file system. You can also use a relative path like `databases/mydb`.

A `DatabaseFactory` object doesn't hold the `Database` instances. It's up to you to close them once you have finished.

#### Create a new database

To create a new database from scratch, use the `.create()` method in `DatabaseFactory` class. If the database already exists, an exception is thrown.

Syntax:

```
DatabaseFactory databaseFactory = new DatabaseFactory("/databases/mydb");
try( Database db = databaseFactory.create(); ){
  // YOUR CODE
}
```

The database instance `db` is ready to be used inside the try block. The `Database` instance extends Java7 `AutoClosable` interface, that means the database is closed automatically when the Database variable reaches out of the scope.

#### Open an existent database

If you want to open an existent database, use the `open()` method instead:

```
DatabaseFactory databaseFactory = new DatabaseFactory("/databases/mydb");
try( Database db = databaseFactory.open(); ){
  // YOUR CODE
}
```

By default a database is open in `READ_WRITE` mode, but you can open it in `READ_ONLY` in this way:

```
databaseFactory.open(PaginatedFile.MODE.READ_ONLY);
```

Using `READ_ONLY` denys any changes to the database. This is the suggested method if you're going to execute reads and queries only. Or if you are opening a database from a read-only file system like a DVD or a shared read-only directory. By letting know to ArcadeDB that you're not changing the database, a lot of optimizations will be used, like in a distributed high-available configuration a REPLICA server could be used instead of the busy MASTER.

If you open a database in READ_ONLY mode, no lock file is created, so the same database could be

opened in READ_ONLY mode by another process at the same time.

### Write your first transaction

Either if you create or open a database, in order to use it, you have to execute your code inside a transaction, in this way:

```
try( Database db = databaseFactory.open(); ){
  db.transaction( (tx) -> {
    // YOUR CODE HERE
  });
}
```

Using the database's auto-close and the `transaction()` method allows to forget to manage begin/commit/rollback/close operations like you would do with a normal DBMS. Anyway, you can control the transaction with explicit methods if you prefer. This code block is equivalent to the previous one:

```
Database db = databaseFactory.open();
try {
  db.begin();

  // YOUR CHANGES HERE

  db.commit();

} catch (Exception e) {
  db.rollback();
} finally {
  db.close();
}
```

Remember that every change in the database must be executed inside a transaction. ArcadeDB is a fully transactional DBMS, ACID compliant. The usage of transactions is like with a Relational DBMS: `.begin()` starts a new transaction and `.commit()` commits all the changes in the database unless there is an error (like a conflict on updating the same record), then the entire transaction will be automatically rollbacked and none of your changes will be in the database. In case you want to manually rollback the transaction at a certain point (like when you have an error in your application code), you can call `.rollback()`.

Once you have your database instance (in this tutorial the variable `db` is used), you can create/update/delete records and execute queries.

### Write your first document object

Let's start now populating the database by creating our first document of type "Customer". What is a document? A Document is like a map of entries. They can be nested and entries can have different types of values, such as Strings, Integers, Floats, etc. You can think to a document like a JSON

Document but it's stored in a binary form in the database. By the way, if you use JSON in your application, ArcadeDB provides easy API to convert a document to and from JSON.

In ArcadeDB it's mandatory to specify a type when you want tot create a document, a vertex or an edge.

Let's create the new document type "Customer" without any properties:

```
try( Database db = databaseFactory.open(); ){
  db.transaction( () -> {
    // CREATE THE CUSTOMER TYPE
    db.getSchema().createDocumentType("Customer");
  });
}
```

Once the "Customer" type has been created, we can create our first document:

```
try( Database db = databaseFactory.open(); ){
  db.transaction( () -> {
    // CREATE A CUSTOMER INSTANCE
    MutableDocument customer = db.newDocument("Customer");
    customer.set("name", "Jay");
    customer.set("surname", "Miner");
    customer.save(); // THE DOCUMENT IS SAVED IN THE DATABASE ONLY WHEN `.save()` IS
CALLED
  });
}
```

You can create types and records in the same transaction.

#### Execute a Query

Once we have our database populated, how to extract data from it? Simple, with a query. Example of executing a prepared query:

```
try( Database db = databaseFactory.open(); ){
  db.transaction( () -> {
    ResultSet result = db.query("SQL", "select from V where age > ? and city = ?", 18,
"Melbourne");
    while (result.hasNext()) {
      Result record = result.next();
      System.out.println( "Found record, name = " + record.getProperty("name"));
    }
  });
}
```

The first parameter of the query method is the language to be used. In this case the common "SQL"

is used. You can also use Gremlin or other language that will be supported in the future.

The prepared statement is cached in the database, so further executions will be faster than the first one. With prepared statements, the parameters can be passed in positional way, like in this case, or with a `Map<String,Object>` where the keys are the parameter names and the values the parameter values. A `Map` passed as the only positional argument is bound to the first `?` placeholder (since 26.10.1). To pass named parameters use the `query(language, text, Map)` overload. Example:

```
try( Database db = databaseFactory.open(); ){
  db.transaction( () -> {
    Map<String,Object> parameters = new HashMap<>();
    parameters.put( "age", 18 );
    parameters.put( "city", "Melbourne" );

    ResultSet result = db.query("SQL", "select from V where age > :age and city =
:city", parameters);
    while (result.hasNext()) {
      Result record = result.next();
      System.out.println( "Found record, name = " + record.getProperty("name"));
    }
  });
}
```

By using a map, parameters are referenced by name (`:age` and `:city` in this example).

#### Create a Graph

Now that we're familiar with the most basic operations, let's see how to work with graphs. Before creating our vertices and edges, we have to create both vertex and edge types beforehand. In our example, we're going to create a minimal social network with "User" type for vertices and "IsFriendOf" to map the friendship relationship:

```
try( Database db = databaseFactory.open(); ){
  db.transaction( () -> {
    // CREATE THE ACCOUNT TYPE
    db.getSchema().createVertexType("User");
    db.getSchema().createEdgeType("IsFriendOf");
  });
}
```

Now let's create two "Profile" vertices and let's connect them with the friendship relationship "IsFriendOf", like in the chart below:

```
try( Database db = databaseFactory.open(); ){
  db.transaction( () -> {
    MutableVertex albert = db.newVertex("User").set("name", "Albert").set("lastName",
"Einstein").save();
    MutableVertex michelle = db.newVertex("User").set("name", "Michelle").set
```

```
("lastName", "Besso").save();
    albert.newEdge("IsFriendOf", michelle, true, "since", 2010);
  });
}
```

In the code snipped above, we have just created our first graph, made of 2 vertices and one edge that connects them. Vertices and documents are not persistent until you call the `save()` method. Note the 3rd parameter in the `newEdge()` method. It's telling to the Graph engine that we want a bidirectional edge. In this way, even if the direction is still from the "Albert" vertex to the "Michelle" vertex, we can traverse the edge from both sides. Use always bidirectional unless you want to avoid creating super-nodes when it's necessary to traverse only from one side. Note also that we stored a property "since = 2010" in the edge. That's right, edges can have properties like vertices.

### Traverse the Graph

What do you do with a brand new graph? Traversing, of course!

You have basically three ways to do that (Java API, SQL, Apache Gremlin and Open Cypher) each one with its pros/cons:

| | JVM Embedded API | SQL | Apache Gremlin | Cypher |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Speed | * * * | * * | * * | * * |
| Flexibility | * * * | * | * * | * * |
| Embedded mode | Yes | Yes | Yes | Yes |
| Remote mode | Yes (via `RemoteImmutableVertex`) | Yes | Yes (through the Gremlin Server plugin) | Yes (through the Gremlin Server plugin) |

When using the API, when the SQL and Apache Gremlin? The API is the very code based. You have total control on the query/traversal. With the SQL, you can combine the `SELECT` with the `MATCH` statement to create powerful traversals in a just few lines. You could use Apache Gremlin if you're coming from another GraphDB that supports this language.

#### Traverse via API

In order to start traversing a graph, you need your root vertex (in some cases you want to start from multiple root vertices). You can load your root vertex by its RID (Record ID), via the indexes properties or via a SQL query.

Loading a record by its RID it's the fastest way and the execution time remains constants with the growing of the database (algorithm complexity: `O(1)`). Example of lookup by RID:

```
try( Database db = databaseFactory.open(); ){
  db.transaction( () -> {
    // #10:232 in our example is Albert Einstein's RID
    Vertex albert = db.lookupByRID( new RID(db, "#10:232"), true );
```

```
  });
}
```

In order to have a quick lookup, it's always suggested to create an index against one or multiple properties. In our case, we could index the properties "name" and "lastName" with 2 separate indexes, or indeed, creating a composite index with both properties. In this case the algorithm complexity is `O(LogN)`). Example:

```
try( Database db = databaseFactory.open(); ){
  db.transaction( () -> {
    db.getSchema().createTypeIndex(SchemaImpl.INDEX_TYPE.LSM_TREE, false, "Profile",
new String[] { "name", "lastName" });
  });
}
```

Now we're able to load Michelle's vertex in a flash by using this:

```
try( Database db = databaseFactory.open(); ){
  db.transaction( () -> {
    Vertex michelle = db.lookupByKey( "Profile", new String[]{"name", "lastName"}, new
String[]{"Michelle", "Besso"} );
  });
}
```

Remember that loading a record by its RID is always faster than looking up from an index. What about the query approach? ArcadeDB supports SQL, so try this:

```
try( Database db = databaseFactory.open(); ){
  db.transaction( () -> {
    ResultSet result = db.query( "SQL", "select from Profile where name = ? and
lastName = ?", "Michelle", "Besso" );
    Vertex michelle = result.next();
  });
}
```

With the query approach, if an existent index is available, then it's automatically used, otherwise a scan is executed.

Now that we have loaded the root vertex in memory, we're ready to do some traversal. Before looking at the API, it's important to understand every edge has a direction: from vertex A to vertex B. In the example above, the direction of the friendship is from "Albert" to "Michelle". While in most of the cases the direction is important, sometimes, like with the friendship, it doesn't really matter the direction because if A is friend with B, it's true also the opposite.

In our example, the relationship is `Albert ---Friend--> Michelle`. This means that if I want to retrieve all Albert's friends, I could start from the vertex "Albert" and traverse all the **outgoing**

edges of type "IsFriendOf".

Instead, if I want to retrieve all Michelle's friends, I could start from Michelle as root vertex and traverse all the **incoming** edges.

In case the direction doesn't really matters (like with friendship), I could consider **both** outgoing and incoming.

So the basic traversal operations from one or more vertices, are:

- outgoing, expressed as `OUT`
- incoming, expressed as `IN`
- both, expressed as `BOTH`

In order to load Michelle's friends, this is the example by using API:

```
try( Database db = databaseFactory.open(); ){
  db.transaction( () -> {
    Vertex michelle; // ALREADY LOADED VIA RID, KEYS OR SQL
    Iterable<Vertex> friends = michelle.getVertices(DIRECTION.IN, "IsFriendOf" );
  });
}
```

Instead, if I start from Albert's vertex, it would be:

```
try( Database db = databaseFactory.open(); ){
  db.transaction( () -> {
    Vertex albert; // ALREADY LOADED VIA RID, KEYS OR SQL
    Iterable<Vertex> friends = albert.getVertices(DIRECTION.OUT, "IsFriendOf");
  });
}
```

The iterators returned by `getEdges()` and `getVertices()` support `Iterator.remove()`: it deletes the edge of the element the last `next()` returned, exactly like `edge.delete()` (the edge is disconnected from both vertices, and a record-backed edge's record is deleted with it). For `getVertices()` that is the edge leading to the vertex just returned; the vertex itself is not deleted.

Since 26.11.1, `remove()` behaves the same on every edge-list iterator, with or without an edge type filter, and reports a failure to the caller:

- a delete the current user is not allowed to perform throws `SecurityException` and leaves the edge in place. Earlier versions logged a WARNING and unlinked the edge from the vertex being iterated anyway;
- on a filtered iterator, such as `getEdges(DIRECTION.OUT, "IsFriendOf")`, earlier versions only unlinked the entry from the iterated vertex, leaving the edge record and the other vertex's link behind;

- calling `remove()` twice without a `next()` in between throws `IllegalStateException`, as the `Iterator` contract requires.

The iterators over a super-node's striped edge list do not support `remove()` and throw `UnsupportedOperationException`: delete the edge with `edge.delete()` instead.

#### Traverse via API (Remote)

When working with a `RemoteDatabase`, graph traversal uses the same `getVertices()` and `getEdges()` methods on the vertex object returned from a lookup. Each call translates to a SQL query executed over HTTP — there is no per-vertex round trip.

```
RemoteDatabase db = new RemoteDatabase("localhost", 2480, "school", "root",
"playwithdata");

// lookupByRID returns a RemoteImmutableVertex when connected remotely
Vertex albert = db.lookupByRID(new RID(db, "#1:0"), true);

// iterate all outgoing "IsFriendOf" neighbors -- automatically paginates
for (Vertex friend : albert.getVertices(Vertex.DIRECTION.OUT, "IsFriendOf")) {
    System.out.println(friend.getString("name"));
}
```

`getVertices()` and `getEdges()` on a remote vertex automatically paginate results in batches of 2,000 records per HTTP call (`RemoteImmutableVertex.DEFAULT_PAGE_SIZE`), so they work correctly even when the vertex has tens of thousands of neighbors without hitting the server result limit.

For a vertex with an extremely large number of edges (a *supernode*), you can tune the page size by casting to `RemoteImmutableVertex` and calling `getVerticesPaged()`:

```
RemoteImmutableVertex albert = (RemoteImmutableVertex) db.lookupByRID(new RID(db,
"#1:0"), true);

// fetch 5,000 neighbors per HTTP call instead of the default 2,000
for (Vertex friend : albert.getVerticesPaged(Vertex.DIRECTION.OUT, 5_000,
"IsFriendOf")) {
    System.out.println(friend.getString("name"));
}

// manual offset-based page (e.g. records 1001-2000)
for (Vertex friend : albert.getVertices(Vertex.DIRECTION.OUT, 1_000, 1_000,
"IsFriendOf")) {
    System.out.println(friend.getString("name"));
}
```

Each page uses a `SKIP/LIMIT` SQL clause on the server. For supernodes with

> millions of edges the edge list is re-scanned from the beginning on every page ($O(n^2)$ total). In that case, prefer a targeted SQL query with a server-side `WHERE` filter to narrow the result set before returning it.

#### Traverse via SQL

By using SQL, you can do the traversal by using SELECT:

```
try( Database db = databaseFactory.open(); ){
  db.transaction( () -> {
    ResultSet friends = db.query( "SQL", "SELECT expand( out('IsFriendOf') ) FROM
Profile WHERE name = ? AND lastName = ?", "Michelle", "Besso" );
  });
}
```

Or with the more powerful MATCH statement:

```
try( Database db = databaseFactory.open(); ){
  db.transaction( () -> {
    ResultSet friends = db.query( "SQL", "MATCH {type: Profile, as: Profile, where:
(name = ? and lastName = ?)}.out('IsFriendOf') {as: Friend} RETURN Friend",
"Michelle", "Besso" );
  });
}
```

#### Traverse via Apache Gremlin

Since ArcadeDB is 100% compliant with Gremlin 3.7.x, you can run this query against the Apache Gremlin Server configured with ArcadeDB:

```
g.V().has('name','Michelle').has('lastName','Besso').out('IsFriendOf');
```

For more information about Apache Gremlin see: Gremlin API support

#### Traverse via Open Cypher

ArcadeDB supports also Open Cypher. The same query would be the following:

```
MATCH (me)-[:IsFriendOf]-(friend)
WHERE me.name = 'Michelle' and me.lastName = 'Besso'
RETURN friend.name, friend.lastName
```

For more information about Cypher see: Cypher support

### 4.2.2. Remote

When ArcadeDB runs as a separate server process, your Java application can connect over HTTP/JSON via the `RemoteDatabase` driver, which wraps the same `Database` API you use in embedded mode.

Add the network module alongside the engine:

```
<dependency>
    <groupId>com.arcadedb</groupId>
    <artifactId>arcadedb-engine</artifactId>
    <version>26.10.1</version>
</dependency>
<dependency>
    <groupId>com.arcadedb</groupId>
    <artifactId>arcadedb-network</artifactId>
    <version>26.10.1</version>
</dependency>
```

Create the database on the server, then open a `RemoteDatabase` and run a query:

```
RemoteServer server = new RemoteServer("localhost", 2480, "root", "playwithdata");
if (!server.exists("school"))
    server.create("school");

RemoteDatabase db = new RemoteDatabase("localhost", 2480, "school", "root",
"playwithdata");

db.command("sqlscript", """
    create document type Class if not exists;
    create property Class.name if not exists string;
    """);

db.command("sql",
    "insert into Class set name = :name, location = :location",
    Map.of("name", "English", "location", "3rd floor"));

ResultSet rs = db.query("sql", "select from Class");
rs.forEachRemaining(r -> System.out.println(r.toJSON()));
```

`RemoteDatabase` is **not** thread-safe — it carries a backend session, and a thread closing a transaction also closes the session. Don't share an instance across threads; instead create one inside the method scope where you use it.

For the full reference covering connection pooling, async calls, gRPC, and every server endpoint, see the Remote API and HTTP/JSON API pages.

## 4.3. Database API

The two core classes of the embedded Java API are:

- `DatabaseFactory` — entry point that creates and opens databases.
- `Database` — main handle for transactions, queries, schema, and CRUD operations.

### 4.3.1. `DatabaseFactory` Class

It's the entry point class that allows to create and open a database. A `DatabaseFactory` object doesn't keep any state and its only goal is creating a `Database` instance.

Never open the same database directory from two processes at once (for example, an embedded tool and a running ArcadeDB Server). Doing so can corrupt the database. If a server already has a database open, connect to it remotely instead of opening it with `DatabaseFactory`.

Example:

```
DatabaseFactory factory = new DatabaseFactory("/databases/mydb");
```

### 4.3.2. close()

Close a database factory. This method frees some resources, but it's not necessary to call it to unlock the databases.

Syntax:

```
void close()
```

---

### 4.3.3. exists()

Returns `true` if the database already exists, otherwise `false`.

Syntax:

```
boolean exists()
```

---

### 4.3.4. Database create()

Creates a new database. If the database already exists, an exception is thrown.

Example:

```
DatabaseFactory arcade = new DatabaseFactory("/databases/mydb");
Database db = arcade.create();
```

### 4.3.5. Database open()

Opens an existent database in READ_WRITE mode. If the database does not exist, an exception is thrown.

Example:

```
DatabaseFactory arcade = new DatabaseFactory("/databases/mydb");
try( Database db = arcade.open(); ) {
  // YOUR CODE
}
```

### 4.3.6. Database open(MODE mode)

Opens an existent database by specifying a mode between READ_WRITE and READ_ONLY mode. If the database does not exist, an exception is thrown. In READ_ONLY mode, any attempt to modify the database throws an exception.

Example:

```
DatabaseFactory arcade = new DatabaseFactory("/databases/mydb");
Database db = arcade.open(MODE.READ_ONLY);
try {
  // YOUR CODE
} finally {
  db.close();
}
```

### 4.3.7. `Database` Interface

It's the main class to operate with ArcadeDB. To obtain an instance of Database, use the class `DatabaseFactory`.

### 4.3.8. Methods

| Transaction | Lifecycle | Query | Records | Misc |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| transaction() default | close() | query() positional parameters | newDocument() | async() |
| transaction() with retries | drop() | query() (parameter map) | newVertex() | command() positional parameters |
| begin() | isOpen() | lookupByKey() | newEdgeByKeys() | command() (parameter map) |
| commit() | | lookupByRID() | deleteRecord() | getSchema() |
| rollback() | | iterateType() | | getSize() |
| | | iterateBucket() | | |
| | | scanBucket() | | |
| | | scanType() | | |
| | | select() | | |

#### async()

It returns an instance of `DatabaseAsyncExecutor` to execute asynchronous calls.

Syntax:

```
DatabaseAsyncExecutor async()
```

Example:

Execute an asynchronous query:

```
db.async().query("sql", "select from User", new AsyncResultsetCallback() {
  @Override
  public void onComplete(ResultSet resultSet) {
    while (resultSet.hasNext())
      System.out.println( "Name = " + resultSet.next().getProperty("name"));
  }

  @Override
  public void onError(Exception exception) {
    System.err.println("Error on executing the query: " + exception );
  }
});
```

#### begin()

Starts a transaction on the current thread. Each thread can have only one active transaction. All the modification to the database become persistent only at pending changes in the transaction are made persistent only when the `commit()` method is called. ArcadeDB supports ACID transactions. Before the commit, no other thread/client can see any of the changes contained in the current transaction.

Syntax:

```
begin()
```

Example:

```
db.begin();  // <--- AT THIS POINT THE TRANSACTION IS STARTED AND ALL THE CHANGES ARE
COLLECTED TILL THE COMMIT (SEE BELOW)
try{
  // YOUR CODE HERE
  db.commit();
} catch( Exception e ){
  db.rollback();
}
```

---

#### close()

Closes a database. This method should be called at the end of the application. By using Java7+ AutoClosed statement, the `close()` method is executed automatically at the end of the scope of the database variable.

Syntax:

```
void close()
```

Example:

```
Database db = new DatabaseFactory("/temp/mydb").open();
try{
  // YOUR CODE HERE
} finally {
  db.close();
}
```

The suggested method is using Java7+ AutoClosed statement, to avoid the explicit `close()` calling:

```
try( Database db = new DatabaseFactory("/temp/mydb").open(); ) {
  // YOUR CODE
}
```

#### drop()

Drops a database. The database will be completely removed from the filesystem.

Syntax:

```
void drop()
```

Example:

```
new DatabaseFactory("/temp/mydb").open().drop();
```

#### getSchema()

Returns the Schema instance for the database.

Syntax:

```
Schema getSchema()
```

Example:

```
db.getSchema().createVertexType("Song");
```

#### getSize()

Returns the size of the database in bytes.

Syntax:

```
Schema getSize()
```

Example:

```
db.getSize();
```

### isOpen()

Returns `true` if the database is open, otherwise `false`.

Syntax:

```
boolean isOpen()
```

Example:

```
if( db.isOpen() ){
  // YOUR CODE HERE
}
```

### query( language, command, positionalParameters )

Executes a query, with optional positional parameters. This method only executes idempotent statements, namely `SELECT` and `MATCH`, that cannot change the database. The execution of any other commands will throw a `QueryNotIdempotentException` exception.

Syntax:

```
Resultset query( String language, String command, Object... positionalParameters )
```

Where:

- `language` is the language to use. Only "SQL" language is supported for now, but in the future multiple languages could be used
- `command` is the command to execute. If the language supports prepared statements (SQL does), you can specify parameters by using `?` for positional replacement
- `positionalParameters` optional variable array of parameters to execute with the query

It returns a `Resultset` object where the result can be iterated.

Examples:

Simple query:

```
ResultSet resultset = db.query("sql", "select from V");
while (resultset.hasNext()) {
```

```
  Result record = resultset.next();
  System.out.println( "Found record, name = " + record.getProperty("name"));
}
```

Query passing positional parameters:

```
ResultSet resultset = db.query("sql", "select from V where age > ? and city = ?", 18,
"Melbourne");
while (resultset.hasNext()) {
  Result record = resultset.next();
  System.out.println( "Found record, name = " + record.getProperty("name"));
}
```

To tell a property that is missing from one stored as `null`, use `Result.getPropertyIfPresent(name, absentValue)` (or `Document.getIfPresent(name, absentValue)` on a record). It returns the value, `null` included, when the property exists, and `absentValue` otherwise. It does in one lookup what `hasProperty()` followed by `getProperty()` does in two *(since v26.10.1)*.

---

#### query( language, command, parameterMap )

Executes a query taking a map for parameters. This method only executes idempotent statements, namely `SELECT` and `MATCH`, that cannot change the database. The execution of any other commands will throw a `QueryNotIdempotentException` exception.

Syntax:

```
Resultset query( String language, String command, Map<String,Object> parameterMap )
```

Where:

- `language` is the language to use. Only "SQL" language is supported for now, but in the future multiple languages could be used
- `command` is the command to execute. If the language supports prepared statements (SQL does), you can specify parameters by name by using `:<arg-name>`
- `parameterMap` this map is used to extract the named parameters

It returns a `Resultset` object where the result can be iterated.

Examples:

```
Map<String,Object> parameters = new HashMap<>();
parameters.put("age", 18);
parameters.put("city", "Melbourne");
```

```
ResultSet resultset = db.query("sql", "select from V where age > :age and city =
:city", parameters);
while (resultset.hasNext()) {
  Result record = resultset.next();
  System.out.println( "Found record, name = " + record.getProperty("name"));
}
```

---

#### command( language, command, positionalParameters )

Executes a command that could change the database. This is the equivalent to `query()`, but allows the command to modify the database. Only "SQL" language is supported, but in the future multiple languages could be used.

Syntax:

```
Resultset command( String language, String command, Object... positionalParameters )
```

Where:

- `language` is the language to use. Only "SQL" is supported
- `command` is the command to execute. If the language supports prepared statements (SQL does), you can specify parameters by using `?` for positional replacement or by name by using `:<arg-name>`
- `positionalParameters` optional variable array of parameters to execute with the query

It returns a `Resultset` object where the result can be iterated.

Examples:

Create a new record:

```
db.command("sql", "insert into V set name = 'Jay', surname = 'Miner'");
```

Create a new record by passing position parameters:

```
db.command("sql", "insert into V set name = ?, surname = ?", "Jay", "Miner");
```

---

#### command( language, command, parameterMap )

Executes a command that could change the database. This is the equivalent to `query()`, but allows the command to modify the database. Only "SQL" language is supported, but in the future multiple languages could be used.

---

Syntax:

```
Resultset command( String language, String command, Map<String,Object> parameterMap )
```

Where:

- `language` is the language to use. Only "SQL" is supported
- `command` is the command to execute. If the language supports prepared statements (SQL does), you can specify parameters by using `?` for positional replacement or by name by using `:<arg-name>`
- `parameterMap` this map is used to extract the named parameters

It returns a `Resultset` object where the result can be iterated.

Examples:

Create a new record by passing a map of parameters:

```
Map<String,Object> parameters = new HashMap<>();
parameters.put("name", "Jay");
parameters.put("surname", "Miner");

db.command("sql", "insert into V set name = :name, surname = :surname", parameters);
```

---

**commit()**

Commits the thread's active transaction. All the pending changes in the transaction are made persistent. A transaction must be begun by calling the `begin()` method. Rolled back transactions cannot be committed. ArcadeDB supports ACID transactions. Before the commit, no other thread/client can see any of the changes contained in the current transaction. ArcadeDB uses a WAL (Write Ahead Log) as journal in case a crash happens at commit time. In this way, at the next restart, the database can be rollbacked at the previous state. If the commit operation succeed, the changes are immediately visible to the other threads/clients and further transactions of the current thread.

Syntax:

```
commit()
```

Example:

```
db.begin();
try{
  // YOUR CODE HERE
```

```
  db.commit();  // <--- COMMIT ALL THE CHANGES "ALL OR NOTHING" IN PERSISTENT WAY
} catch( Exception e ){
  db.rollback();
}
```

---

#### deleteRecord( record )

Deleted a record. The record will be persistently deleted only at commit time.

Syntax:

```
void deleteRecord( Record record )
```

Examples:

```
db.deleteRecord( customer );
```

---

#### iterateBucket( bucketName )

Iterates all the records contained in a bucket. To scan a type (with all its buckets), use the method iterateType() instead. The result are not accumulated in RAM, but rather this method returns an `Iterator<Record>` that fetches the records only when `.next()` is called.

Syntax:

```
Iterator<Record> iterateBucket( String bucketName )
```

Example:

Aggregate the records by age. This is equivalent to a SQL query with a "group by age":

```
Map<String, AtomicInteger> aggregate = new HashMap<>();

Iterator<Record> result = db.iterateType("V", true );
while( result.hasNext() ){
  Record record = result.next();

  String age = (String) record.get("age");
  AtomicInteger counter = aggregate.get(age);
  if (counter == null) {
    counter = new AtomicInteger(1);
    aggregate.put(age, counter);
  } else
```

```
    counter.incrementAndGet();
}
```

Example:

Prints all the records in the bucket "Customer" with age major or equals to 21.

```
Iterator<Record> result = db.iterateBucket("Customer");
while( result.hasNext() ){
  Record record = result.next();

  final Document customer = record.asDocument();
  final Integer age = customer.getInteger("age");
  if (age != null && age >= 21 )
    System.out.println("Found customer: " + customer.getString("name") );
}
```

---

#### iterateType( className, polymorphic )

Iterates all the records contained in the buckets relative to a type. If `polymorphic` is `true`, then also the sub-types buckets are considered. To iterate one bucket only check out the iterateBucket() method. The result are not accumulated in RAM, but rather this method returns an `Iterator<Record>` that fetches the records only when `.next()` is called.

Syntax:

```
Iterator<Record> iterateType( String typeName, boolean polymorphic )
```

Example:

Aggregate the records by age. This is equivalent to a SQL query with a "group by age":

```
Map<String, AtomicInteger> aggregate = new HashMap<>();

Iterator<Record> result = db.iterateType("V", true );
while( result.hasNext() ){
  Record record = result.next();

  String age = (String) record.get("age");
  AtomicInteger counter = aggregate.get(age);
  if (counter == null) {
    counter = new AtomicInteger(1);
    aggregate.put(age, counter);
  } else
    counter.incrementAndGet();
```

```
}
```

---

#### lookupByKey( type, properties, keys )

Look ups for one or more records (document, vertex or edge) that match one or more indexed keys.

Syntax:

```
Cursor<RID> lookupByKey( String type, String[] properties, Object[] keys )
```

Where:

- `type` type name
- `properties` array of property names to match
- `keys` array of keys

It returns a `Cursor<RID>` (like an iterator).

The properties must be covered by a key index (`LSM_TREE` or `HASH`). A full-text index matches words rather than whole values, so it cannot answer an exact lookup: `lookupByKey()` and `newEdgeByKeys()` throw an `IllegalArgumentException` when the only index on the properties is `FULL_TEXT`, as they do when there is no index at all. *(Since v26.10.1: before, a full-text index returned every record sharing a word with the key.)*

Examples:

Look up for an author with name "Jay" and surname "Miner". This requires an index on the type "Author", properties "name" and "surname".

```
Cursor<RID> jayMiner = database.lookupByKey("Author", new String[] { "name", "surname"
}, new Object[] { "Jay", "Miner" });
while( jayMiner.hasNext() ){
  System.out.println( "Found Jay! " + jayMiner.next().getProperty("name"));
}
```

---

#### lookupByRID( rid, loadContent )

Look ups for a record (document, vertex or edge) by its RID (Record Identifier).

Syntax:

```
Record lookupByRID( RID rid, boolean loadContent )
```

Where:

- `rid` is the record identifier
- `loadContent` forces the load of the content too. If the content is not loaded will be lazy loaded at the first access. Use `true` if you are going to access to the record content for sure, otherwise, use `false`

It returns a `Record` implementation (document, vertex or edge).

Examples:

Load the vertex by RID and its content:

```
Vertex v = (Vertex) db.lookupByRID(new RID("#3:47"));
```

---

#### newDocument( typeName )

Creates a new document of a certain type. The type must be of type "document" and must be created beforehand. In order to be saved, the method `MutableDocument.save()` must be called.

Syntax:

```
MutableDocument newDocument( typeName )
```

Where:

- `typeName` type name

It returns a `MutableDocument` instance.

Examples:

Create a new document of type "Customer":

```
MutableDocument doc = db.newDocument("Customer");
doc.set("name", "Jay");
doc.set("surname", "Miner");
doc.save();  // THE DOCUMENT IS SAVED IN THE DATABASE ONLY WHEN `.save()` IS CALLED
```

The metadata names `@rid`, `@type`, `@cat`, `@in`, `@out`, `@props` and `@this` are not properties. Since v26.11.1 the positional setters (`set(name, value)`, `set(n1, v1, n2, v2)`, `set(Object…)`) refuse them with an `IllegalArgumentException`, before assigning anything; earlier versions stored them as properties no reader could return. Another name starting with `@` (for example `@special`) is an ordinary property. The map-based setters (`set(Map)`, `fromMap()`, `fromJSON()`, `merge()`) skip every key starting

> with `@` as metadata, so the output of `toMap(true)` can be fed back. On an edge, `@in` and `@out` re-point the edge through every one of these setters (earlier versions did it only through `set(name, value)` and `merge()`).

---

#### newVertex( typeName )

Creates a new vertex of a certain type. The type must be of type "vertex" and must be created beforehand. In order to be saved, the method `MutableVertex.save()` must be called.

Syntax:

```
MutableVertex newVertex( typeName )
```

Where:

- `typeName` type name

It returns a `MutableVertex` instance.

Examples:

Create a new document of type "Customer":

```
MutableVertex v = db.newVertex("Customer");
v.set("name", "Jay");
v.set("surname", "Miner");
v.save();
```

---

#### newEdgeByKeys( sourceVertexType, sourceVertexKey, sourceVertexValue, destinationVertexType, destinationVertexKey, destinationVertexValue, createVertexIfNotExist, edgeType, bidirectional, properties )

Creates a new edge between two vertices found by their keys.

Syntax:

```
Edge newEdgeByKeys( String sourceVertexType, String[] sourceVertexKey,
                    Object[] sourceVertexValue,
                    String destinationVertexType, String[] destinationVertexKey,
                    Object[] destinationVertexValue,
                    boolean createVertexIfNotExist, String edgeType, boolean
bidirectional,
                    Object... properties )
```

Where:

- `sourceVertexType` source vertex type name
- `sourceVertexKey` source vertex key properties
- `sourceVertexValue` source vertex key values
- `destinationVertexType` destination vertex type name
- `destinationVertexKey` destination vertex key properties
- `destinationVertexValue` destination vertex key values
- `createVertexIfNotExist` creates source and/or destination vertices if not exist
- `edgeType` edge type name
- `bidirectional` `true` if the edge must be bidirectional, otherwise `false`
- `properties` optional property array with pairs of name (as string) and value

It returns a `MutableEdge` instance.

Examples:

Create a new document of type "Customer":

```
Edge likes = db.newEdgeByKeys( "Account",
                                new String[] {"id"}, new Object[] {322323},
                               "Song",
                                new String[] {"title"},
                                new Object[] {"Chasing Cars"},
                               false, "Likes", true);
likes.save();
```

---

**rollback()**

Aborts the thread's active transaction by rolling back all the pending changes. Usually the transaction rollback is executed in case of errors. If an exception happens during the call `commit()`, the transaction is roll backed automatically. Once rolled backed, the transaction cannot be committed anymore but it has to be re-started by calling the `begin()` method.

Syntax:

```
rollback()
```

Example:

```
db.begin();
try{
```

```
  // YOUR CODE HERE
  db.commit();
} catch( Exception e ){
  db.rollback(); // <--- ROLLBACK IN CASE OF EXCEPTION
}
```

---

#### scanBucket( bucketName, callback )

Scans all the records contained in a buckets. For each record found, the callback is called passing the current record. To scan a type (with all its buckets), use the method scanType() instead. The callback method must return `true` to continue the scan, otherwise `false`. Look also at the iterateBucket() method if you want to use an iterator approach instead of callback.

Syntax:

```
void scanBucket(String bucketName, RecordCallback callback);
```

Example:

Prints all the records in the bucket "Customer" with age major or equals to 21.

```
db.scanBucket("Customer", (record) -> {
  final Document customer = record.asDocument();
  final Integer age = customer.getInteger("age");
  if (age != null && age >= 21 )
    System.out.println("Found customer: " + customer.getString("name") );
  return true;
});
```

---

#### scanType( className, polymorphic, callback )

Scans all the records contained in all the buckets relative to a type. If `polymorphic` is `true`, then also the sub-types buckets are considered. For each record found, the callback is called passing the current record. To scan one bucket only check out the scanBucket() method. The callback method must return `true` to continue the scan, otherwise `false`. Look also at the iterateType() method if you want to use an iterator approach instead of callback.

Syntax:

```
scanType( String className, boolean polymorphic, DocumentCallback callback )
```

Example:

Aggregate the records by age. This is equivalent to a SQL query with a "group by age":

```
Map<String, AtomicInteger> aggregate = new HashMap<>();

db.scanType("V", true, (record) -> {
  String age = (String) record.get("age");
  AtomicInteger counter = aggregate.get(age);
  if (counter == null) {
    counter = new AtomicInteger(1);
    aggregate.put(age, counter);
  } else
    counter.incrementAndGet();

  return true;
});
```

---

#### select()

Returns a `Select` builder to construct and execute queries using the Native Select API. This provides a zero-parsing, JIT-friendly fluent query builder as an alternative to SQL or Cypher.

Syntax:

```
Select select()
```

It returns a `Select` instance that supports fluent chaining for building queries.

Examples:

Simple query:

```
Vertex v = db.select().fromType("Person")
    .where().property("name").eq().value("John")
    .vertices().nextOrNull();
```

With count:

```
long count = db.select().fromType("Person")
    .where().property("active").eq().value(true)
    .count();
```

With stream:

```
List<String> names = db.select().fromType("Person")
```

```
    .where().property("age").gt().value(18)
    .stream()
    .map(d -> d.getString("name"))
    .collect(Collectors.toList());
```

See the Native Select API documentation for the full reference including operators, graph traversal, and vector search.

---

#### transaction( txBlock )

This methods wraps a call to the method transaction with retries by using the default retries specified in the database setting `arcadedb.mvccRetries`.

---

#### transaction( txBlock, retries )

Executes a transaction block as a callback or a clojure. Before calling the callback in `TransactionScope`, the transaction is begun and after the end of the callback, the transaction is committed. In case of any exceptions, the transaction is rolled back. In case a `NeedRetryException` exceptions is thrown, the transaction is repeated up to `retries` times

The retry is skipped if the block already committed part of its work before failing. This happens when the block runs a statement with an explicit batch boundary, such as `UPDATE ⋯ BATCH n`, `DELETE ⋯ BATCH n` or `MOVE VERTEX ⋯ BATCH n`: those commit every `n` records by design, so the rollback can no longer undo the records already committed and repeating the block would apply them a second time. In that case the exception is propagated to the caller, who is the only one who knows how to compensate for the part that already went through. `TRUNCATE TYPE` and `REBUILD TYPE` are not affected, because they skip their internal batching when they run inside a transaction opened by the caller.

Syntax:

```
void transaction( TransactionScope txBlock )
```

Examples:

Example by using Java21+ syntax:

```
db.transaction( () -> {
  final MutableVertex v = database.newVertex("Author");
  v.set("name", "Jay");
  v.set("surname", "Miner");
  v.save();
});
```

Example by using Java7 syntax:

```
db.transaction( new Database.TransactionScope() {
  @Override
  public void execute() {
    final MutableVertex v = db.newVertex("Author");
    v.set("name", "Jay");
    v.set("surname", "Miner");
    v.save();
  }
});
```

## 4.4. `DatabaseAsyncExecutor` Interface

This is the class to manage asynchronous operations. To obtain an instance of DatabaseAsyncExecutor, use the method `.async()` in `Database`.

The Asynchronous API schedule the operation to be executed as soon as possible, but by a different thread. ArcadeDB optimizes the usage of asynchronous threads to be equals to the number of cores found in the machine (but it is still configurable). Use Asynchronous API if the response of the operation can be managed in asynchronous way and if you want to avoid developing Multi-Threads application by yourself.

**query( language, command, callback, positionalParameters )**

Executes a query in asynchronous way, with optional positional parameters. This method returns immediately. This method only executes idempotent statements, namely `SELECT` and `MATCH`, that cannot change the database. The execution of any other commands will throw a `IllegalArgumentException` exception.

Syntax:

```
void query( String language, String command, AsyncResultsetCallback callback,
            Object... positionalParameters )
```

Where:

- `language` is the language to use
- `command` is the command to execute If the language supports prepared statements (SQL does), you can specify parameters by using `?` for positional replacement If the language supports prepared statements (SQL does), you can specify parameters by name by using `:<arg-name>`
- `callback` optional, is the callback that will be used for the whole lifecycle of the result set:
  - `onStart()` executed when the query is parsed and the first result ready
  - `onNext()` executed foreach result in the result set Return `true` to continue browsing the result set, otherwise `false` to interrupt fetching the result set

    - `onComplete()` executed when the entire result set is browsed, or the `onNext()` returned false to interrupt the browsing
    - `onError()` in case of any exception while executing the query
- `positionalParameters` optional variable array of parameters to execute with the query

To iterate the result, use the callback.

Examples:

Simple query:

```
db.async().query("sql", "select from V", new AsyncResultsetCallback() {
  @Override
  public boolean onNext(Result result) {
    System.out.println( "Found record, name = " + result.getProperty("name"));
    return true;
  }

  @Override
  public void onError(Exception exception) {
    System.err.println("Error on executing query: " + exception );
  }
});
```

Query passing positional parameters:

```
db.async().query("sql", "select from V where age > ? and city = ?", new
AsyncResultsetCallback(){
  @Override
  public boolean onNext(Result result) {
    System.out.println( "Found record, name = " + result.getProperty("name"));
    return true;
  }
}, 18, "Melbourne");
```

When you have multiple independent queries that could be executed in parallel, you could use the asynchronous interface and a `CountDownLatch`. The following example executes 3 queries in parallel and wait for all of them to have finished.

```
CountDownLatch counter = new CountDownLatch(3);

final ResultSet[] resultSets = new ResultSet[3];
database.async().query("sql", "select from X", resultset -> { resultSets[0] =
resultset; counter.countDown(); });
database.async().query("sql", "select from Y", resultset -> { resultSets[1] =
resultset; counter.countDown(); });
database.async().query("sql", "select from Z", resultset -> { resultSets[2] =
```

```
resultset; counter.countDown(); });

// WAIT INDEFINITELY
counter.await();

// OR YOU CAN SPECIFY A TIMEOUT, LIKE 10 SECONDS TOP
// counter.await(10, TimeUnit.SECONDS);
```

---

#### query( language, command, callback, parameterMap )

Executes a query in asynchronous way, with optional named parameter. This method returns immediately. This method only executes idempotent statements, namely `SELECT` and `MATCH`, that cannot change the database. The execution of any other commands will throw a `IllegalArgumentException` exception.

Syntax:

```
void query( String language, String command, AsyncResultsetCallback callback,
            Map<String, Object> parameterMap )
```

Where:

- `language` is the language to use
- `command` is the command to execute If the language supports prepared statements (SQL does), you can specify parameters by name by using `:<arg-name>`
- `callback` optional, is the callback that will be used for the whole lifecycle of the result set:
  - `onStart()` executed when the query is parsed and the first result ready
  - `onNext()` executed foreach result in the result set Return `true` to continue browsing the result set, otherwise `false` to interrupt fetching the result set
  - `onComplete()` executed when the entire result set is browsed, or the `onNext()` returned false to interrupt the browsing
  - `onError()` in case of any exception while executing the query
- `parameterMap` this map is used to extract the named parameters

To iterate the result, use the callback.

Examples:

```
Map<String,Object> parameters = Map.of("age", 18, "city", "Melbourne");

db.async().query("sql", "select from V where age > :age and city = :city", new
AsyncResultsetCallback(){
  @Override
  public boolean onNext(Result result) {
```

```
    System.out.println( "Found record, name = " + result.getProperty("name"));
    return true;
  }
}, parameters);
```

---

#### command( language, command, callback, positionalParameters )

Executes any command in asynchronous way, with optional positional parameters and callback. This method returns immediately.

Syntax:

```
void command( String language, String command,
              AsyncResultsetCallback callback,
              Object... positionalParameters )
```

Where:

- `language` is the language to use
- `command` is the command to execute If the language supports prepared statements (SQL does), you can specify parameters by using `?` for positional replacement or by name by using `:<arg-name>` If the language supports prepared statements (SQL does), you can specify parameters by name by using `:<arg-name>`
- `callback` optional, is the callback that will be used for the whole lifecycle of the result set:
  - `onStart()` executed when the query is parsed and the first result ready
  - `onNext()` executed foreach result in the result set Return `true` to continue browsing the result set, otherwise `false` to interrupt fetching the result set
  - `onComplete()` executed when the entire result set is browsed, or the `onNext()` returned false to interrupt the browsing
  - `onError()` in case of any exception while executing the query
- `positionalParameters` optional variable array of parameters to execute with the query

To iterate the result, use the callback.

Examples:

Create a new record:

```
db.async().command("sql", "insert into V set name = 'Jay', surname = 'Miner'", new
AsyncResultsetCallback() {
  @Override
  public boolean onNext(Result result) {
    System.out.println("Created new record: " + result.toJSON() );
    return true;
```

```
  }

  @Override
  public void onError(Exception exception) {
    System.err.println("Error on creating new record: " + exception );
  }
});
```

Create a new record by passing position parameters:

```
db.async().command("sql", "insert into V set name = ? surname = ?", new
AsyncResultsetCallback() {
  @Override
  public boolean onNext(Result result) {
    System.out.println("Created new record: " + result.toJSON() );
    return true;
  }
}, "Jay", "Miner");
```

---

#### command( language, command, callback, parameterMap )

Executes any command in asynchronous way, with optional parameters passed in map format. This method returns immediately. It takes named parameters. Each parameter name (in the SQL query) is prefixed by a semicolon (`:`).

Syntax:

```
void command( String language, String command,
            AsyncResultsetCallback callback,
            Map<String, Object> parameterMap )
```

Where:

- `language` is the language to use
- `command` is the command to execute If the language supports prepared statements (SQL does), you can specify parameters by using `?` for positional replacement or by name by using `:<arg-name>` If the language supports prepared statements (SQL does), you can specify parameters by name by using `:<arg-name>`
- `callback` optional, is the callback that will be used for the whole lifecycle of the result set:
  - `onStart()` executed when the query is parsed and the first result ready
  - `onNext()` executed foreach result in the result set Return `true` to continue browsing the result set, otherwise `false` to interrupt fetching the result set
  - `onComplete()` executed when the entire result set is browsed, or the `onNext()` returned false to interrupt the browsing

    - `onError()` in case of any exception while executing the query
- `parameterMap` this map is used to extract the named parameters

To iterate the result, use the callback.

Examples:

Create a new record by passing a map of parameters:

```
Map<String,Object> parameters = Map.of("name", "Jay", "surname", "Miner");

db.async().command("sql", "insert into V set name = :name, surname = :surname", new
AsyncResultsetCallback() {
  @Override
  public boolean onNext(Result result) {
    System.out.println("Created new record: " + result.toJSON() );
    return true;
  }

  @Override
  public void onError(Exception exception) {
    System.err.println("Error on creating new record: " + exception );
  }
}, parameters);
```

#### transaction()

Executes a transaction in async mode. The transaction is executed in a separated thread. Example of use:

```
database.async().transaction( database -> {
  // EXECUTE OPERATIONS WITHIN TRANSACTION ASYNCHRONOUSLY
  // I.E.: database.command("sql", "update client set bonus = true where type = 'gold'
and bonus is null");
  // I.E.: database.command("sql", "insert into notification set type = 'bonus',
status = 'waiting', date = sysdate() ");
});
```

---

#### setParallelLevel( parallelLevel )

Changes the number of worker threads used for asynchronous operations. It is recommended to keep this number equal to or lower than the cores available on the machine. The initial value comes from the `arcadedb.asyncWorkerThreads` setting (see Settings).

Syntax:

```
void setParallelLevel( int parallelLevel )
```

Example:

```
database.async().setParallelLevel( 8 );
```

This call is **safe to use while other threads have asynchronous work in flight** on the same database. Growing the pool only adds workers and leaves the existing ones untouched. Shrinking it stops routing new work to the workers it retires and lets them finish the tasks already queued on them, so nothing already submitted is dropped and no unrelated caller is told the executor has shut down.

Because a shrink waits for the retired workers to finish, `setParallelLevel()` **blocks** until they have drained, up to an internal bound of ten seconds. If a worker is still busy inside user code when that bound expires, the call returns anyway, logs a warning, and leaves that worker finishing in the background - where it is still counted by `waitCompletion()` and `isProcessing()`. Treat this as an administrative call rather than something to invoke on a hot path.

`async().command()` hands commands to the workers in turn, so with a type that has a single bucket every worker writes the same bucket and their batch commits often conflict. A conflicting batch is replayed (up to `arcadedb.txRetries` times, waiting the `arcadedb.txRetryDelay` backoff between attempts), and a batch that still cannot commit is reported through `onError`. For heavy parallel inserts, create the type with as many buckets as the parallel level, for example `CREATE DOCUMENT TYPE Item BUCKETS 4`.

---

#### setTransactionUseWAL( useWAL ) and setTransactionSync( flushType )

Set the durability policy the asynchronous executor applies to the transactions it opens. Turning the write-ahead log off makes bulk loading substantially faster at the cost of losing crash recovery for those transactions, which is why bulk-loading APIs such as `GraphBatch` use it.

Syntax:

```
void setTransactionUseWAL( boolean transactionUseWAL )
void setTransactionSync( WALFile.FlushType transactionSync )
```

Example:

```
database.async().setTransactionUseWAL( false );
database.async().setTransactionSync( WALFile.FlushType.NO );
```

Both take effect on the **next task** the executor runs, and apply to every task it runs, including DDL dispatched through `command()` with no wait for the response. A change made while a batch transaction is already open closes that transaction first, so records accumulated under the previous policy are always committed under the policy they were written with, never under the new one.

---

#### Batch commit conflicts

Each async worker thread batches its writes and commits them together every `arcadedb.asyncTxBatchSize` operations (see Settings). If that periodic commit conflicts with another worker writing the same data, it is now retried automatically (up to `arcadedb.txRetries` attempts) instead of being silently dropped. If every retry fails, the `onError()` callback of every command in that batch is invoked, so a genuine failure is always reported rather than lost.

A statement that commits part-way through on its own - `UPDATE`/`DELETE`/`MOVE VERTEX … BATCH n`, `TRUNCATE TYPE`, `REBUILD INDEX` - makes everything batched before it durable at that moment. Since 26.10.1 the executor recognises this, so a later conflict on the same worker never re-applies those writes and never reports them as lost.

---

#### createRecord(record, newRecordCallback [,errorCallback])

Create a record in async way. Once the record is created in the database, the callback will be executed. This method returns immediately. The result can be managed in the NewRecordCallback callback and errors in ErrorCallback callback.

Syntax:

```
void createRecord(final MutableDocument record, final NewRecordCallback
newRecordCallback,
                  final ErrorCallback errorCallback)
```

Where:

- `record` is the mutable record to insert
- `newRecordCallback` is the callback to handle the result after the record has been inserted
- `errorCallback` (optional) is the callback to handle any error raised during insertion

Example on inserting a vertex asynchronously.

```
final MutableVertex vertex = database.newVertex("Customer").set("name", "Albert");
database.async().createRecord(vertex,
                              v -> { System.out.println("Record " + v.toJSON() + "
created") });
```

---

#### updateRecord(record, updateRecordCallback [,errorCallback])

Updates a record in async way. Once the record is updated in the database, the callback will be executed. This method returns immediately. The result can be managed in the UpdatedRecordCallback callback and errors in ErrorCallback callback.

Syntax:

```
void updateRecord(final MutableDocument record, final UpdatedRecordCallback
updateRecordCallback,
                  final ErrorCallback errorCallback)
```

Where:

- `record` is the mutable record to update
- `updateRecordCallback` is the callback to handle the result after the record has been updated
- `errorCallback` (optional) is the callback to handle any error raised during update]

Example on inserting a vertex asynchronously.

```
database.async().updateRecord(vertex,
                              v -> { System.out.println("Record " + v.toJSON() + "
updated") });
```

---

#### deleteRecord(record, deleteRecordCallback [,errorCallback])

Deletes a record in async way. Once the record is deleted from the database, the callback will be executed. This method returns immediately. The result can be managed in the DeletedRecordCallback callback and errors in ErrorCallback callback.

Syntax:

```
void deleteRecord(final Record record, final DeletedRecordCallback
deleteRecordCallback,
                  final ErrorCallback errorCallback)
```

Where:

- `record` is the record to delete
- `updateRecordCallback` is the callback to handle the result after the record has been deleted
- `errorCallback` (optional) is the callback to handle any error raised during deletion

Example on inserting a vertex asynchronously.

```
database.async().deleteRecord(vertex,
                              v -> { System.out.println("Record " + v.toJSON() + "
updated") });
```

## 4.5. Schema

ArcadeDB can work in schema-less mode (like most of NoSQL DBMS), schema-full (like with RDBMS) or hybrid. The main API to manage the schema is the Schema interface you can obtain by calling the API `db.getSchema()`:

```
Schema schema = db.getSchema();
```

Before creating any record it's mandatory to define a type. If you're going to create a new Document, then you need a Document Type. The same applies for Vertex → Vertex Type and Edge → Edge Type.

The specific API to manage document types in the Schema interface are:

```
DocumentType createDocumentType(String typeName);
DocumentType createDocumentType(String typeName, int buckets);
DocumentType createDocumentType(String typeName, int buckets, int pageSize);
```

Where:

- `typeName` is the name of the type
- `buckets` is the number of buckets to create. A bucket is like a file. If not specified, the default is taken from the `arcadedb.typeDefaultBuckets` global setting, which is `1` by default
- `pageSize` is the page size for the file. If not specified is 65K. Pay attention to this value. In case of large objects to store, you need to increase the page size or the record won't be stored, throwing an exception.

To manage vertex types, the API are similar as for the document types:

```
VertexType createVertexType(String typeName);
VertexType createVertexType(String typeName, int buckets);
VertexType createVertexType(String typeName, int buckets, int pageSize);
```

And the same for edge types:

```
EdgeType createEdgeType(String typeName);
EdgeType createEdgeType(String typeName, int buckets);
EdgeType createEdgeType(String typeName, int buckets, int pageSize);
```

In order to retrieve and removing a type, API common to any record type are provided:

```
Collection<DocumentType> getTypes();
DocumentType             getType(String typeName);
void                     dropType(String typeName);
String                   getTypeNameByBucketId(int bucketId);
DocumentType             getTypeByBucketId(int bucketId);
boolean                  existsType(String typeName);
```

### 4.5.1. Creating many types at once

Every schema change is written to disk before the call returns, which costs a durable file write per statement. To create many types, properties and indexes at once, wrap them in `bulkChange()`: the schema is written once, at the end, and under HA the whole batch is replicated as one entry.

```
db.getSchema().bulkChange(() -> {
  for (String name : List.of("Customer", "Order", "Product")) {
    db.getSchema().createDocumentType(name).createProperty("id", Type.LONG);
    db.getSchema().createTypeIndex(Schema.INDEX_TYPE.LSM_TREE, true, name, "id");
  }
});
```

There is no rollback. If a call fails, the changes made before it are kept and published (under HA, as one replicated entry, so every node holds the same partial schema), and the exception is rethrown. This is the same rule a schema-only SQL script follows; see reference/sql/sql-script.pdf.

The database write lock is held for the whole callback, so use it for schema definition, not for loading data. On a remote database (`RemoteDatabase`) `bulkChange()` simply runs the callback: each call is already its own HTTP request, so it is safe to call but batches nothing. See reference/storage.pdf for the other ways to batch schema changes.

### 4.5.2. Working with buckets

A bucket is like a file. A type can rely on one or multiple buckets. Why using multiple buckets? Because ArcadeDB could lock a bucket for certain operations. Having multiple buckets allows to go in parallel with a multi-cpus and multi-cores architecture.

The specific API to manage buckets are:

```
Bucket             createBucket(String bucketName);
boolean            existsBucket(String bucketName);
Bucket             getBucketById(int id);
Bucket             getBucketByName(String name);
Collection<Bucket> getBuckets();
```

### 4.5.3. Working with indexes

Like any other DBMS, ArcadeDB has indexes. Even if indexes are not used to manage relationships (because ArcadeDB has a native GraphDB engine based on links), indexes are fundamental for a quick lookup of records by one or multiple properties.

By default null values are not indexed, so any query that is looking for null values will not use the index but instead result in a full scan.

ArcadeDB provides automatic and manual indexes:

- `automatic` that are updated automatically when you work with records
- `manual` are detached from a type and the user is totally responsible to insert and remove entries into and from the index

The `Schema` API to manage indexes are:

```
TypeIndex createTypeIndex(SchemaImpl.INDEX_TYPE indexType, boolean unique, String
typeName, String[] propertyNames);

TypeIndex createTypeIndex(SchemaImpl.INDEX_TYPE indexType, boolean unique, String
typeName, String[] propertyNames, int pageSize);

TypeIndex createTypeIndex(EmbeddedSchema.INDEX_TYPE indexType, boolean unique, String
typeName, String[] propertyNames, int pageSize, Index.BuildIndexCallback callback);

TypeIndex createTypeIndex(EmbeddedSchema.INDEX_TYPE indexType, boolean unique, String
typeName, String[] propertyNames, int pageSize, LSMTreeIndexAbstract.NULL_STRATEGY
nullStrategy, Index.BuildIndexCallback callback);

boolean existsIndex(String indexName);

Index[] getIndexes();

Index   getIndexByName(String indexName);
```

Where:

- `indexName` is the name of the index
- `indexType` can be:
  - `LSM_TREE`, implemented as a Log Structured Merge tree. Best for range scans and ordered iteration.
  - `HASH`, implemented using extendable hashing. Provides O(1) equality lookups — best for primary keys, JOINs, and edge traversal where ordering is not needed. Does not support range queries.
  - `FULL_TEXT`, that uses Lucene's Analyzers for tokenizing, stemming and categorize words inside a text. Internally it's managed as a LSM_TREE

- `unique` tells if the entries in the index must be unique or they can be repeated
- `typeName` is the name of the type (document, vertex or edge) where the index must be applied
- `propertyNames` is the array of property names to index. In case of more than one property is used, the index is composed. Property names may also reference a document type's polymorphic properties
- `pageSize` is the page size. If not specified, the default of 2MB is used
- `nullStrategy` can be:
  - `SKIP` ignores all null values when creating and reading an index, this is the default.
  - `ERROR` throws an exception when creating or reading a null value indexed property.
- `callback` is a 2 argument Functional interface called when each `Document` is added to this index. *This is most likely only useful for internal use cases*. The callback receives the `Document` just indexed, and a running count of the total number of documents indexed in the bucket.

The API above sometimes returns `TypeIndex` vs `Index`. The more general `getIndexes` and `getIndexByName` methods return `Index` because the index might be a bucket index or a type index. The `TypeIndex` should be useful in most cases, but sometimes it may be useful to work at the bucket level.

In addition to the `createTypeIndex` methods above, for each overload there is a matching `getOrCreateTypeIndex` method which returns an existing index rather than throwing an exception if a matching index is found. There are also matching index API creation methods available via the `DocumentType` for creating an index directly from a document type, rather than against the general `Schema` object. When using the `DocumentType` convenience variants `typeName` is provided automatically.

An index is unique to a set of property names per document type. Any attempt to create a second index on a non-unique set of [`typeName`, `propertyNames`] will throw an exception using the `createTypeIndex` method variants.

A special mention goes for the method `createManualIndex()` that creates indexes not attached to any type (manual):

```
Index createManualIndex(SchemaImpl.INDEX_TYPE indexType, boolean unique, String
indexName, com.arcadedb.schema.Type[] keyTypes, int pageSize);
```

While by default indexes are updated automatically when you work with records, in this case, the user is totally responsible to insert and remove entries into and from the index.

### 4.5.4. Indexing Edges

Like any other document type, indexes may be defined for `Edge` types as well. If the property name for the index is either `@out` or `@in`, the index property will be a `LINK` type on the adjacently referenced `Vertex`.

The `LINK` type represents @RIDs (like #13:222). Usually creating `LINK` indexes is meant for indexing

incoming/outgoing edges in order to prevent multigraphs (i.e. duplicates edges between the same vertex pairs).

### 4.5.5. Database Configuration

ArcadeDB stores the database configuration into the schema and allows to change things like the timezone, the format of dates and the encoding:

```
TimeZone getTimeZone();
void     setTimeZone(TimeZone timeZone);
String   getDateFormat();
void     setDateFormat(String dateFormat);
String   getDateTimeFormat();
void     setDateTimeFormat(String dateTimeFormat);
String   getEncoding();
```

## 4.6. Native Select API

The Native Select API is a zero-parsing, JIT-friendly fluent query builder for embedded Java applications. It provides a type-safe alternative to SQL or Cypher for common query patterns, with automatic index detection and significantly lower overhead.

### 4.6.1. Quick Start

```
// Simple query
List<Vertex> results = database.select().fromType("Person")
    .where().property("age").gt().value(18)
    .vertices().toList();

// Compiled query with parameters (reusable)
SelectCompiled query = database.select().fromType("Person")
    .where().property("name").eq().parameter("name")
    .compile();

Vertex john = query.parameter("name", "John").vertices().nextOrNull();
Vertex jane = query.parameter("name", "Jane").vertices().nextOrNull();
```

### 4.6.2. Building Queries

#### From Type or Buckets

Every query starts with `database.select()` followed by the source:

```
// Query from a type (polymorphic by default)
database.select().fromType("Person")...
```

```
// Disable polymorphic query (only the exact type, not subtypes)
database.select().fromType("Person").polymorphic(false)...

// Query from specific buckets
database.select().fromBuckets("person_bucket_0", "person_bucket_1")...
```

### WHERE Conditions

The `where()` method starts the fluent condition builder. Each condition follows the pattern: `property(name)` → `operator()` → `value(val)`.

```
database.select().fromType("Person")
    .where().property("age").gt().value(18)
    .and().property("active").eq().value(true)
    .vertices().toList();
```

### Comparison Operators

| Method | Description | Example |
|---|---|---|
| `eq()` | Equals | `.property("name").eq().value("John")` |
| `neq()` | Not equals | `.property("status").neq().value("inactive")` |
| `lt()` | Less than | `.property("age").lt().value(30)` |
| `le()` | Less than or equal | `.property("age").le().value(30)` |
| `gt()` | Greater than | `.property("age").gt().value(18)` |
| `ge()` | Greater than or equal | `.property("age").ge().value(18)` |
| `like()` | Pattern match (case-sensitive) | `.property("name").like().value("J%")` |
| `ilike()` | Pattern match (case-insensitive) | `.property("name").ilike().value("j%")` |
| `in()` | Value in collection | `.property("status").in().value(List.of("A", "B"))` |
| `between()` | Value in range (inclusive) | `.property("age").between().values(18, 65)` |
| `isNull()` | Property is null (unary) | `.property("email").isNull()` |
| `isNotNull()` | Property is not null (unary) | `.property("email").isNotNull()` |

`like()` and `ilike()` follow exactly the same rules as SQL `LIKE`/`ILIKE`: a record without the property, or a `null` pattern, does not match; a non-string value is matched by its text form; a list property matches when any of its items does. Before v26.10.1 `ilike()` threw a `NullPointerException` on a record without the property, and both failed on non-string values.

A comparison against a missing or `null` value is never true. `lt()`, `le()`, `gt()`, `ge()` and `between()` all skip a record that does not carry the property, or carries it as `null`, exactly as SQL does - so `age < 30` never matches a record without an `age`. Use `isNull()` / `isNotNull()` to ask about absent values. Before v26.10.1 `lt()` and `le()` treated a missing value as smaller than any value and matched such records, and they did so only while no index existed on the property - so the same query over the same data could return a different number of rows depending on whether an index was present.

#### IN Operator

The `in()` operator checks if a property value is contained in a collection. When the property is indexed, ArcadeDB performs multiple point lookups on the index.

```
// Find persons with specific statuses
List<Vertex> results = database.select().fromType("Person")
    .where().property("status").in().value(List.of("active", "pending"))
    .vertices().toList();

// IN with parameterized values
SelectCompiled query = database.select().fromType("Order")
    .where().property("status").in().parameter("statuses")
    .compile();

List<Document> orders = query.parameter("statuses", List.of("shipped", "delivered"))
    .documents().toList();
```

#### BETWEEN Operator

The `between()` operator checks if a value falls within an inclusive range. When the property is indexed, ArcadeDB uses a range scan on the index.

```
// Find orders with amount between 100 and 500
List<Document> results = database.select().fromType("Order")
    .where().property("amount").between().values(100, 500)
    .documents().toList();
```

#### IS NULL / IS NOT NULL

These are unary operators — they don't require a right-hand value.

```
// Find records where email is not set
List<Document> results = database.select().fromType("Person")
    .where().property("email").isNull()
    .documents().toList();

// Combine with other conditions
```

```
List<Vertex> active = database.select().fromType("Person")
    .where().property("email").isNotNull()
    .and().property("age").gt().value(18)
    .vertices().toList();
```

#### AND / OR Logic

Conditions can be combined with `and()` and `or()`. AND has higher precedence than OR (same as SQL).

```
// AND: both conditions must match
database.select().fromType("Person")
    .where().property("age").gt().value(18)
    .and().property("active").eq().value(true)
    .vertices();

// OR: either condition matches
database.select().fromType("Person")
    .where().property("role").eq().value("admin")
    .or().property("role").eq().value("manager")
    .vertices();

// Mixed: AND binds tighter than OR
// Equivalent to: (age > 18 AND active = true) OR role = 'admin'
database.select().fromType("Person")
    .where().property("age").gt().value(18)
    .and().property("active").eq().value(true)
    .or().property("role").eq().value("admin")
    .vertices();
```

### 4.6.3. Terminal Operations

Terminal methods execute the query and return results.

#### Iterator-Based Results

```
// Returns SelectIterator<Vertex>
SelectIterator<Vertex> iter = database.select().fromType("Person")
    .where().property("active").eq().value(true)
    .vertices();

// Returns SelectIterator<Edge>
SelectIterator<Edge> iter = database.select().fromType("Follows")
    .where().property("since").gt().value(2020)
    .edges();

// Returns SelectIterator<Document>
SelectIterator<Document> iter = database.select().fromType("Log")
```

```
    .where().property("level").eq().value("ERROR")
    .documents();
```

`SelectIterator` extends `Iterator` and adds:

- `toList()` — collects all results into a `List`
- `nextOrNull()` — returns the next element or `null` if empty
- `stream()` — returns a Java `Stream` for functional-style processing
- `getMetrics()` — returns execution metrics (evaluated records, used indexes)
- `outVertices()` / `inVertices()` / `bothVertices()` — traverse to adjacent vertices (see Graph Traversal)
- `outEdges()` / `inEdges()` / `bothEdges()` — traverse to adjacent edges (see Graph Traversal)

#### count()

Returns the number of matching records without materializing them. Respects `skip()` and `limit()`.

```
long total = database.select().fromType("Person")
    .where().property("active").eq().value(true)
    .count();

// With limit
long capped = database.select().fromType("Person")
    .where().property("active").eq().value(true)
    .limit(100).count();

// From compiled query
SelectCompiled query = database.select().fromType("Order")
    .where().property("status").eq().parameter("status")
    .compile();

long pending = query.parameter("status", "pending").count();
```

#### exists()

Returns `true` if at least one matching record exists. Short-circuits immediately on the first match (does not scan further).

```
boolean hasAdmins = database.select().fromType("Person")
    .where().property("role").eq().value("admin")
    .exists();
```

#### stream()

Returns a standard Java `Stream<Document>` for functional-style processing.

```
List<String> names = database.select().fromType("Person")
    .where().property("age").gt().value(18)
    .stream()
    .map(d -> d.getString("name"))
    .collect(Collectors.toList());

// From iterator (preserves the generic type)
Optional<Vertex> first = database.select().fromType("Person")
    .where().property("name").eq().value("Alice")
    .vertices().stream()
    .findFirst();
```

### 4.6.4. Pagination and Ordering

#### Skip and Limit

```
// Skip the first 20, return the next 10
List<Vertex> page = database.select().fromType("Person")
    .where().property("active").eq().value(true)
    .skip(20).limit(10)
    .vertices().toList();
```

#### Order By

```
// Sort ascending by name
List<Vertex> sorted = database.select().fromType("Person")
    .where().property("active").eq().value(true)
    .orderBy("name", true)  // true = ascending
    .vertices().toList();

// Sort descending by age
List<Vertex> sorted = database.select().fromType("Person")
    .orderBy("age", false)  // false = descending
    .vertices().toList();
```

When the ORDER BY property matches an indexed property used in the WHERE condition, ArcadeDB reads results directly from the index in sorted order, avoiding an in-memory sort. This also applies when ORDER BY targets the property immediately following a matched composite-index prefix (see Index Detection): the index is scanned as a directional range in that case, so it already returns rows in the requested order.

### 4.6.5. Compiled Queries

Compiled queries separate query definition from execution. The query structure is built once, then reused with different parameter values.

```
// Compile once
SelectCompiled query = database.select().fromType("Person")
    .where().property("name").eq().parameter("name")
    .and().property("city").eq().parameter("city")
    .compile();

// Execute many times with different parameters
Vertex v1 = query.parameter("name", "John").parameter("city", "NYC").vertices
().nextOrNull();
Vertex v2 = query.parameter("name", "Jane").parameter("city", "LA").vertices
().nextOrNull();

// All terminal methods are available on compiled queries
long count = query.parameter("name", "John").parameter("city", "NYC").count();
boolean exists = query.parameter("name", "John").parameter("city", "NYC").exists();
Stream<Document> stream = query.parameter("name", "John").parameter("city", "NYC"
).stream();
```

#### JSON Serialization

Compiled queries can be serialized to/from JSON for persistence or network transfer:

```
SelectCompiled original = database.select().fromType("Person")
    .where().property("name").eq().parameter("name")
    .compile();

// Serialize to JSON
JSONObject json = original.json();

// Deserialize from JSON
SelectCompiled restored = database.select().json(json).compile();

Vertex v = restored.parameter("name", "John").vertices().nextOrNull();
```

`json()` and `json(JSONObject)` are inverse: reading a serialized query back and serializing it again produces the same document.

The `where` entry is a condition, and a condition is one of:

| Shape | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `[left, "<operator>", right]` | A binary condition, e.g. `[":name", "=", "John"]`. |
| `[left, "<operator>"]` | A unary condition: `not`, `is null` and `is not null` are the only operators that take no right operand. |
| `[condition]` | A single condition, the shape a query with one `where` leaf serializes to. |

An operand is `":property"` for a property, `"#parameter"` for a named parameter, a nested condition

array, or a literal value. A nested array **is a parenthesis**: it is evaluated as one unit, so `[[":a", "=", 2], "and", [[":b", "=", 1], "or", [":b", "=", 3]]]` means `a = 2 AND (b = 1 OR b = 3)` and never the re-associated `(a = 2 AND b = 1) OR b = 3`. This is the only way to hand the native API an explicitly grouped condition: the fluent builder appends conditions left to right and applies operator precedence.

A literal value that itself starts with `:` or ` is escaped by doubling that leading character (e.g. the literal ":alice" is written as "::alice"), so it is never confused with a property or parameter reference. This happens automatically on serialization; a hand-written literal starting with : or` must be doubled the same way.

The right operand of `between` and `in` is a plain array of values — `[":age", "between", [18, 65]]` — which is told apart from a nested condition by its shape: a condition's second element names an operator.

### 4.6.6. Parallel Execution

For large datasets, enable parallel execution to distribute bucket scanning across multiple threads:

```
SelectCompiled query = database.select().fromType("LargeTable")
    .where().property("status").eq().value("active")
    .compile()
    .parallel();

List<Document> results = query.documents().toList();
```

Parallel queries cannot use the current transaction context because they execute in separate threads. Use them for read-only queries outside transactions.

### 4.6.7. Timeout

Set a maximum execution time for queries:

```
// Timeout after 5 seconds, throw TimeoutException
database.select().fromType("Person")
    .where().property("name").like().value("%pattern%")
    .timeout(5, TimeUnit.SECONDS, true)
    .documents().toList();

// Timeout after 5 seconds, silently return partial results
database.select().fromType("Person")
    .where().property("name").like().value("%pattern%")
    .timeout(5, TimeUnit.SECONDS, false)
    .documents().toList();
```

### 4.6.8. Index Detection

The Select API automatically detects and leverages available indexes:

- **Equality (`eq`)** — single-key index lookup
- **Range (`gt`, `ge`, `lt`, `le`)** — range scan on the index
- **IN (`in`)** — multiple point lookups on the index; with an ascending `orderBy()` on the same property the rows come back in key order
- **BETWEEN (`between`)** — range scan with inclusive bounds
- **AND logic** — uses the best available index (prefers unique indexes)
- **OR logic** — uses both indexes when both sides are indexed, even when they are on properties of different types; falls back to full scan when either side is not indexed
- **Composite indexes** — an AND chain of equality conditions covering a leading prefix of a composite (multi-property) index's properties uses that index too, even when not every property is bound; if the query's `orderBy()` matches the trailing indexed property, the scan also satisfies the ordering without a separate in-memory sort

Operators that cannot use indexes (`neq`, `like`, `ilike`, `isNull`, `isNotNull`) always require a full scan (but can still benefit from indexes on other conditions in an AND chain).

Use `getMetrics()` on the iterator to verify index usage:

```
SelectIterator<Vertex> iter = database.select().fromType("Person")
    .where().property("id").eq().value(42)
    .vertices();

Vertex result = iter.nextOrNull();

Map<String, Object> metrics = iter.getMetrics();
long evaluatedRecords = (long) metrics.get("evaluatedRecords");
int usedIndexes = (int) metrics.get("usedIndexes");
```

### 4.6.9. Graph Traversal

The Select API supports graph traversal directly from query results. ArcadeDB is optimized to skip edges when you only need vertices — use `outVertices()` / `inVertices()` / `bothVertices()` for vertex-to-vertex traversal, and `outEdges()` / `inEdges()` / `bothEdges()` when you need the edge records themselves.

#### Vertex Traversal

```
// Single hop: find all friends of Alice
List<Vertex> friends = database.select().fromType("User")
    .where().property("name").eq().value("Alice")
    .vertices()
    .outVertices("FRIENDS")
```

```
    .toList();

// Multi-hop: friends of friends
Set<String> friendsOfFriends = database.select().fromType("User")
    .where().property("name").eq().value("Alice")
    .vertices()
    .outVertices("FRIENDS")
    .thenOutVertices("FRIENDS")
    .stream()
    .map(v -> v.getString("name"))
    .collect(Collectors.toSet());

// Incoming direction
List<Vertex> followers = database.select().fromType("User")
    .where().property("name").eq().value("Alice")
    .vertices()
    .inVertices("FOLLOWS")
    .toList();

// Both directions
List<Vertex> connections = database.select().fromType("User")
    .where().property("name").eq().value("Alice")
    .vertices()
    .bothVertices("KNOWS")
    .toList();

// No edge type filter (all edge types)
List<Vertex> allNeighbors = database.select().fromType("User")
    .where().property("name").eq().value("Alice")
    .vertices()
    .outVertices()
    .toList();
```

`SelectVertexTraversal` implements `Iterator<Vertex>` and provides:

- `thenOutVertices(edgeTypes…)` — chain another outgoing vertex traversal
- `thenInVertices(edgeTypes…)` — chain another incoming vertex traversal
- `thenBothVertices(edgeTypes…)` — chain another bidirectional vertex traversal
- `thenOutEdges(edgeTypes…)` — switch to edge traversal (outgoing)
- `thenInEdges(edgeTypes…)` — switch to edge traversal (incoming)
- `thenBothEdges(edgeTypes…)` — switch to edge traversal (both directions)
- `toList()` — collect results into a `List<Vertex>`
- `stream()` — return a Java `Stream<Vertex>`

#### Edge Traversal

Use edge traversal when you need the edge records (e.g., to read edge properties):

```
// Get outgoing FRIENDS edges
List<Edge> edges = database.select().fromType("User")
    .where().property("name").eq().value("Alice")
    .vertices()
    .outEdges("FRIENDS")
    .toList();

// Access edge properties
for (Edge edge : edges) {
    System.out.println(edge.getString("since"));
}

// Vertex-to-edge chaining: find friends, then get their WORKS_AT edges
List<Edge> worksAt = database.select().fromType("User")
    .where().property("name").eq().value("Alice")
    .vertices()
    .outVertices("FRIENDS")
    .thenOutEdges("WORKS_AT")
    .toList();
```

`SelectEdgeTraversal` implements `Iterator<Edge>` and provides:

- `toList()` — collect results into a `List<Edge>`
- `stream()` — return a Java `Stream<Edge>`

### 4.6.10. Vector k-NN Search

The Select API provides a fluent interface for vector similarity search. It requires a vector index on the target property.

```
float[] queryVector = getEmbedding("search query");

// Basic k-NN search: find 10 nearest neighbors
List<SelectVectorResult<Vertex>> results = database.select()
    .fromType("Product")
    .nearestTo("embedding", queryVector, 10)
    .vertices();

// Access results
for (SelectVectorResult<Vertex> result : results) {
    Vertex doc = result.getDocument();     // the matched vertex
    float distance = result.getDistance();  // distance from query vector
}
```

Results are returned as a `List` (not an iterator) sorted by ascending distance, because vector search is inherently bounded by `k` and requires cross-bucket merging.

The search covers the records of the type passed to `fromType()` and of its sub-types, even when the

vector index is defined on a parent type. With `polymorphic(false)` it covers that type only. A record deleted by a concurrent transaction while the search runs is skipped, and the search widens to still return `k` results when enough records exist.

#### Approximate Search

For large datasets, enable approximate nearest neighbor search using product quantization:

```
List<SelectVectorResult<Vertex>> results = database.select()
    .fromType("Product")
    .nearestTo("embedding", queryVector, 10)
    .approximate(true)
    .vertices();
```

#### Post-Filtering

Apply WHERE conditions to filter vector search results:

```
// Find 50 nearest, then filter to only "electronics" category
List<SelectVectorResult<Vertex>> results = database.select()
    .fromType("Product")
    .nearestTo("embedding", queryVector, 50)
    .where().property("category").eq().value("electronics")
    .vectorVertices();
```

Post-filtering is applied after the k-NN search. To ensure enough results after filtering, request more candidates than you need (e.g., request 50 to get ~10 after filtering).

### 4.6.11. Complete Example

```
try (DatabaseFactory factory = new DatabaseFactory("./mydb")) {
  Database database;
  if (factory.exists())
    database = factory.open();
  else
    database = factory.create();

  // Create schema
  VertexType person = database.getSchema().createVertexType("Person");
  person.createProperty("name", Type.STRING)
      .createIndex(Schema.INDEX_TYPE.LSM_TREE, true);
  person.createProperty("age", Type.INTEGER);
  database.getSchema().createEdgeType("FRIENDS");

  // Insert data
  database.transaction(() -> {
```

```
    Vertex alice = database.newVertex("Person").set("name", "Alice", "age", 30).
save();
    Vertex bob = database.newVertex("Person").set("name", "Bob", "age", 25).save();
    alice.newEdge("FRIENDS", bob).save();
  });

  // Query with the Select API
  // Count
  long adults = database.select().fromType("Person")
      .where().property("age").ge().value(18).count();

  // Check existence
  boolean hasAlice = database.select().fromType("Person")
      .where().property("name").eq().value("Alice").exists();

  // Stream processing
  List<String> names = database.select().fromType("Person")
      .where().property("age").gt().value(20)
      .stream()
      .map(d -> d.getString("name"))
      .sorted()
      .collect(Collectors.toList());

  // Graph traversal
  List<Vertex> aliceFriends = database.select().fromType("Person")
      .where().property("name").eq().value("Alice")
      .vertices()
      .outVertices("FRIENDS")
      .toList();

  database.close();
}
```

## 4.7. Embedded Documents

ArcadeDB is a Multi-Model database with a full support for documents. The nice thing about documents (and Document Databases) is that they can have embedded documents. This feature is very powerful. In some cases is preferable to embed documents instead of connect them by using a graph.

```
{
  "firstName": "Jay",
  "lastName": "Miner",
  "worksAt": {
    "companyName": "Commodore",
    "since": "1982"
  }
}
```

Below you can find the code to create such document by using the Java API. Note the creation of the types at the beginning:

```
db.transaction( () -> {
  // CREATE THE SCHEMA (NEED ONLY ONCE BEFORE CREATING RECORDS)
  DocumentType employee = db.getSchema().createDocumentType("Employee");
  DocumentType company = db.getSchema().createDocumentType("Company");

  // CREATE DOCUMENTS
  MutableDocument jay = db.newDocument("Employee").set("firstName", "Jay", "lastName",
"Miner");

  jay.newEmbeddedDocument("Company", "worksAt").set("companyName", "Commodore",
"since", 2010);

  // MAKE THE MAIN DOCUMENT PERSISTENT
  jay.save();
});
```

Modeling with a graph it would be something like this:

And this would be the code to create the types and the graph.

```
db.transaction( () -> {
  // CREATE THE SCHEMA (NEED ONLY ONCE BEFORE CREATING RECORDS)
  VertexType employee = db.getSchema().createVertexType("Employee");
  VertexType company = db.getSchema().createVertexType("Company");
  EdgeType worksAt = db.getSchema().createEdgeType("WorksAt");

  // CREATE THE GRAPH
  MutableVertex jay = db.newVertex("Employee").set("firstName", "Jay", "lastName",
"Miner").save();
  MutableVertex commodore = db.newVertex("Company").set("name", "Commodore").save();
  jay.newEdge("WorksAt", commodore, "since", 2010);
});
```

With ArcadeDB Multi-Model DBMS you can have vertices with embedded documents linked to other vertices through edges. Check out this example that uses a graph to connect Employee with Company, but keeps the addresses as embedded documents.

```
db.transaction( () -> {
  // CREATE THE SCHEMA (NEED ONLY ONCE BEFORE CREATING RECORDS)
  VertexType employee = db.getSchema().createVertexType("Employee");
  VertexType company = db.getSchema().createVertexType("Company");
  EdgeType worksAt = db.getSchema().createEdgeType("WorksAt");
  DocumentType address = db.getSchema().createDocumentType("Address");

  // CREATE THE GRAPH + EMBEDDED DOCUMENTS
```

```
  MutableVertex jay = db.newVertex("Employee").set("firstName", "Jay", "lastName",
"Miner").save();
  jay.newEmbeddedDocument("Address", "residenceAddress").set("city", "San Francisco",
"state", "CA", "country", "USA");

  MutableVertex commodore = db.newVertex("Company").set("name", "Commodore").save();
  commodore.newEmbeddedDocument("Address", "hqAddress").set("city", "Palo Alto",
"state", "CA", "country", "USA");
  commodore.newEmbeddedDocument("Address", "ukAddress").set("city", "London", "state",
"London", "country", "UK");

  jay.newEdge("WorksAt", commodore, "since", 2010);
});
```

To retrieve embedded documents, you can retrieve as any other properties. Example:

```
db.transaction( () -> {
  ResultSet result = db.query( "SQL", "select from Employee where firstName = ? and
lastName = ?", "Jay", "Miner" );
  Vertex jay = result.next().getVertex().get();

  EmbeddedDocument residenceAddress = (EmbeddedDocument) jay.get("residenceAddress");
  System.out.println( "Jay's lives in " + residenceAddress.getString("city") );
});
```

## 4.8. Events

ArcadeDB allows hooking listener to the following events on records (vertices, edges, documents):

- **before** is **created**, by registering the interface `BeforeRecordCreateListener`
- **after** is **created**, by registering the interface `AfterRecordCreateListener`
- **before** is **read**, by registering the interface `BeforeRecordReadListener`
- **after** is **read**, by registering the interface `AfterRecordReadListener`
- **before** is **updates**, by registering the interface `BeforeRecordUpdateListener`
- **after** is **updated**, by registering the interface `AfterRecordUpdateListener`
- **before** is **deleted**, by registering the interface `BeforeRecordDeleteListener`
- **after** is **deleted**, by registering the interface `AfterRecordDeleteListener`

The listeners above can be installed and removed at database by using:

```
database.getEvents().registerListener()
```

And at specific type level by using:

```
database.getSchema().getType(<type-name>).registerListener()
```

All the interface listeners that work **before** a record is created, read, updated or deleted, require to return a boolean value. If the callback returns `true`, the listener chain continues and all the following listeners are invoked. If `false`, the chain of calls is interrupted and the operation is skipped with no errors. In case an error is requested, the callback can throw an exception instead of returning false.

A full scan of a type or bucket (`iterateType()`, `iterateBucket()`, or a query that scans a type) fires the read listeners when it reads each record, once per record, even for records your code then never reads. A record a before-read or after-read listener filters out is not returned by the scan *(since v26.10.1)*.

The typical use cases for the listeners are:

- listen before a create or update to enhance the record with additional properties
- listen before a create or update to validate properties and in case the record is not valid, returning false or an exception to avoid the operation is executed
- execute cascade operations. This is the typical use case for `AfterRecordDeleteListener` where a cascade deletion of multiple connected records can be executed
- listen to after create, read, update and delete operations to propagate changes to the external or the webapp via web-socket. This allows to have a reactive application that doesn't poll the database for changes, but rather listens and receives updates as soon as they occur
- implement custom profiling on changes to the database (by implementing "before" listeners)

Example of `before-record-create` listener where vertices with "validated" field equal to false cannot be saved (callback returns false):

```
database.getEvents().registerListener((BeforeRecordCreateListener)
  record -> record instanceof Vertex && record.asVertex().getBoolean("validated"));
```

The same by only for vertex type "Client":

```
database.getSchema().getType("Client").getEvents().registerListener((BeforeRecordCreat
eListener)
  record -> record.asVertex().getBoolean("validated"));
```

# 4.9. Graph Batch

The `GraphBatch` is a high-performance bulk graph loader designed for importing large volumes of edges into an ArcadeDB graph. It achieves **8-12x speedup** over the standard edge creation API by buffering edges in memory, sorting them by vertex for sequential I/O, parallel edge connection, and deferring incoming edge connection to a single optimized pass.

### 4.9.1. Quick Start

```
Database db = new DatabaseFactory("mydb").create();
db.transaction(() -> {
  db.getSchema().createVertexType("Person");
  db.getSchema().createEdgeType("KNOWS");
});

try (GraphBatch batch = db.batch()
    .withExpectedEdgeCount(1_000_000)
    .build()) {

  // Phase 1: Create vertices in bulk
  RID[] vertices = batch.createVertices("Person", 100_000);

  // Phase 2: Buffer edges (auto-flushes when batch is full)
  for (int i = 0; i < edgeCount; i++)
    batch.newEdge(vertices[src[i]], "KNOWS", vertices[dst[i]]);

} // close() flushes remaining edges + connects all incoming edges
```

All edges (both outgoing and incoming) are fully connected when `close()` returns.

### 4.9.2. How It Works

The importer operates in phases for maximum throughput:

1. **Buffer**: Edges are stored in flat primitive arrays (minimal GC pressure)
2. **Sort**: On flush, outgoing edges are sorted by source vertex, converting random I/O into sequential page access
3. **Connect OUT**: Outgoing edges are connected to source vertices in sorted order, using vectorized segment writes
4. **Accumulate IN**: Incoming edges are deferred to an in-memory buffer across flushes
5. **Connect IN at close()**: All deferred incoming edges are sorted by destination vertex and connected in a single pass
6. **Batch vertex update**: All vertex head-chunk pointers are updated in one final sorted pass

### 4.9.3. Edges with Properties

The importer supports edges with properties. Pass them as key-value pairs:

```
try (GraphBatch batch = db.batch()
    .withExpectedEdgeCount(500_000)
    .withLightEdges(false)  // edges have properties
    .build()) {
```

```
  RID[] vertices = batch.createVertices("Person", 50_000);

  for (int i = 0; i < edgeCount; i++)
    batch.newEdge(vertices[src[i]], "KNOWS", vertices[dst[i]],
        "weight", weights[i], "timestamp", timestamps[i]);
}
```

Property edges use a bulk record creation path that bypasses per-record overhead, achieving nearly the same throughput as light edges. Edges of a type with declared properties still get what `Vertex.newEdge()` gives them: values converted to the declared type, defaults applied and constraints (mandatory, min/max, regexp...) validated. A violation is raised when the buffered edges are flushed, not at the `newEdge()` call. Properties can be passed as name/value pairs or as a single `Map`. With `withLightEdges(true)`, an edge without properties is still stored as a regular edge if its type declares a property with a default or a mandatory property.

*(Since v26.11.1)* An edge type with an `EXTERNAL` property, declared on the type or inherited from a super type, does not use the bulk record creation path: its values are stored in the paired external bucket, so those edges are saved one at a time and the import is slower than for other edge types. Before 26.11.1 the bulk path kept those values inside the edge record instead of the external bucket.

### 4.9.4. Builder Options

| Method | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `withExpectedEdgeCount(int)` | — | Auto-tunes the batch size to `edgeCount` (clamped to 100K-5M). A single flush is optimal for most workloads. |
| `withBatchSize(int)` | 100,000 | Maximum edges buffered before auto-flush. Overrides auto-tuning if both are set. |
| `withLightEdges(boolean)` | `false` | If true, edges without properties are created as light edges (no record stored, only connectivity pointers). Deprecated: the edge type must declare `LIGHTWEIGHT`, otherwise an `IllegalArgumentException` is raised. |
| `withBidirectional(boolean)` | `true` | If true, incoming edges are connected for the edge types declared bidirectional; an edge type declared `UNIDIRECTIONAL` never gets them, whatever this flag says. Set to false to load only unidirectional edge types: `newEdge()` then refuses an edge of a bidirectional type with an `IllegalArgumentException` (since 26.10.1; before, the batch silently skipped the incoming side, and a query walking those edges from their target found nothing). |
| `withWAL(boolean)` | `false` | Write-Ahead Logging during import. Disable for maximum speed; enable if crash recovery is needed. |

| Method | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `withCommitEvery(int)` | 0 (WAL off) / 50,000 (WAL on) | Edges per transaction commit within a flush. Set to 0 to commit once per flush. Auto-set to 0 when WAL is disabled. |
| `withEdgeListInitialSize(int)` | 2048 | Initial size in bytes for edge segments. Larger values reduce segment splits for high-degree vertices. |
| `withPreAllocateEdgeChunks(boolean)` | `true` | Pre-allocate empty edge segments at vertex creation time, eliminating lazy allocation cost. Each segment takes `withEdgeListInitialSize` bytes on disk even if the vertex never gets an edge, so turn it off when loading many vertices whose edges come later: the edges then get segments of exactly the size they need. |
| `withMaxVertices(long)` | 0 (no bound) | Upper bound on the distinct vertices the batch's edges can touch. The batch keeps a small entry per touched vertex until `close()`; the bound stops that table from growing past what it needs. Nothing is allocated up front *(since 26.11.1)*. |
| `withParallelFlush(boolean)` | `true` | Parallel edge connection partitioned by bucket. Uses the database async executor to connect edges across buckets concurrently. |

### 4.9.5. Auto-Tuning Batch Size

The `withExpectedEdgeCount()` method automatically selects the optimal batch size based on benchmarks. A single flush (batch size = edge count) delivers the best throughput, so the batch size is set to `edgeCount`, clamped between 100K and 5M:

| Expected Edges | Auto-tuned Batch | Approx. RAM |
|---|---|---|
| < 100K | 100K (minimum) | ~200MB |
| 100K - 5M | = edge count (single flush) | ~300MB-1GB |
| > 5M | 5M (maximum) | ~1GB |

You can always override with `withBatchSize()` if you know your workload characteristics.

### 4.9.6. Key Methods

| Method | Description |
|---|---|
| `createVertices(typeName, count)` | Creates vertices in bulk within a single transaction. Returns an array of RIDs for use with `newEdge()`. |
| `newEdge(srcRID, edgeType, dstRID, properties…)` | Buffers an edge for batch processing. Automatically triggers a flush when the batch size is reached. |

| Method | Description |
|---|---|
| `flush()` | Manually flushes all buffered edges. Outgoing edges are sorted and connected; incoming edges are deferred. |
| `close()` | Flushes remaining edges, connects all deferred incoming edges in a single sorted pass, and batch-updates vertex head-chunk pointers. |

### 4.9.7. Transactions

The batch manages its own transactions: every flush is several durable steps, committed by the batch itself. For this reason `createVertices()`, `flush()`, `close()` and any `newEdge()` call that fills the buffer refuse to run inside a transaction you opened with `begin()` or `transaction()`. They throw an `IllegalStateException` and leave your transaction untouched.

Commit or roll back your own transaction first. If `close()` is refused, the batch stays open with its pending work, and calling `close()` again outside the transaction writes it.

The batch's relaxed WAL settings apply only to the batch's own transactions, never to the ones you run between batch calls.

### 4.9.8. Performance

Benchmark results on a single machine (500K edges, 50K vertices):

| Method | Time (ms) | Edges/sec | Speedup |
|---|---|---|---|
| Standard API (tx batches of 1000) | 11,933 | 42K | 1.0x |
| **GraphBatch (light edges)** | **1,028** | **486K** | **11.6x** |
| Standard API + properties (int + long) | 13,385 | 37K | 1.0x |
| **GraphBatch + properties** | **1,584** | **316K** | **8.5x** |

### 4.9.9. Importing into an Existing Graph

The importer can also connect edges to vertices that already exist in the database (not just vertices created by `createVertices()`). Simply pass existing vertex RIDs to `newEdge()`:

```
try (GraphBatch batch = db.batch()
    .withExpectedEdgeCount(100_000)
    .build()) {

  // Use existing vertex RIDs from queries or lookups
  for (int i = 0; i < edgeCount; i++)
    batch.newEdge(existingVertexRIDs[src[i]], "FOLLOWS", existingVertexRIDs[dst[i]]);
}
```

### 4.9.10. HTTP Batch Endpoint

GraphBatch is also available over HTTP for non-Java clients. The POST /api/v1/batch endpoint accepts JSONL or CSV input and uses GraphBatch under the hood, with all builder options exposed as query parameters. See HTTP Batch Import for full details and examples in curl, Python, and JavaScript.

### 4.9.11. Relationship with GraphImporter

The GraphImporter is a declarative, JSON-driven graph importer built on top of `GraphBatch`. It adds file parsing (XML, CSV, JSONL), schema auto-creation, foreign key resolution, and post-import commands.

Use `GraphBatch` directly when you need full programmatic control over vertex and edge creation. Use `GraphImporter` when you want to import graph data from files using a JSON configuration.

## 4.10. Working with Vector Embeddings

ArcadeDB provides robust support for vector embeddings through the LSMVectorIndex, a persistent vector index built on ArcadeDB's LSM Tree architecture and powered by the JVector 4.0.0 library. LSMVectorIndex offers efficient storage, retrieval, and similarity search for vector embeddings with full transaction support and automatic persistence.

### 4.10.1. Key Features

The LSMVectorIndex implementation provides:

- **Persistent Storage**: Vector indexes are stored on disk with automatic page management and compaction
- **Transaction Support**: Full ACID compliance with automatic persistence on transaction commit
- **Multiple Similarity Functions**: Supports COSINE (default), DOT_PRODUCT, and EUCLIDEAN distance metrics
- **SQL Integration**: Create and query vector indexes using SQL commands
- **Automatic Compaction**: Efficiently reclaims disk space through automatic compaction of immutable pages
- **High Performance**: Leverages LSM Tree benefits for write efficiency and space optimization at scale
- **Configurable Parameters**: Tune maxConnections and beamWidth for optimal ANN search performance
- **JVector Library**: Built on JVector 4.0.0 for state-of-the-art vector search capabilities

### 4.10.2. Creating Vector Indexes with SQL

The simplest way to create a vector index is through SQL. This approach is recommended for most use cases as it provides a declarative syntax and automatic schema management.

### Basic Vector Index Creation

Create a basic LSMVectorIndex for similarity search:

```
-- Create vertex type and property
CREATE VERTEX TYPE Document;
CREATE PROPERTY Document.embedding LIST OF FLOAT;

-- Create vector index with 384 dimensions using COSINE similarity and INT8
quantization
CREATE INDEX ON Document (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 384,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "quantization": "INT8"
};
```

INT8 quantization is recommended for production use. It stores vectors in compact index pages instead of full documents, providing 2.5x faster search and 4x lower memory usage with negligible accuracy loss. See concepts/vector-search.pdf for benchmarks.

### Configuring Similarity Functions

Choose the appropriate similarity function for your use case:

**COSINE Similarity** (default) - Best for normalized vectors, commonly used with text embeddings:

```
CREATE INDEX ON Document (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 768,
  "similarity": "COSINE"
};
```

**DOT_PRODUCT** - Efficient for normalized vectors, faster than cosine:

```
CREATE INDEX ON Image (featureVector) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 512,
  "similarity": "DOT_PRODUCT"
};
```

**EUCLIDEAN** - Measures absolute distance, useful for spatial data:

```
CREATE INDEX ON Product (attributes) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 256,
  "similarity": "EUCLIDEAN"
};
```

**Performance Tuning Parameters**

For large-scale deployments, tune performance parameters:

```
CREATE INDEX ON VectorVertex (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 1024,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "quantization": "INT8",           -- 2.5x faster search, 4x less memory
(recommended)
  "maxConnections": 32,             -- Higher values improve recall but increase
memory
  "beamWidth": 200,                 -- Higher values improve accuracy but reduce
speed
  "neighborOverflowFactor": 1.2,    -- Candidate neighbor pool multiplier (default:
1.2)
  "alphaDiversityRelaxation": 1.2,  -- Diversity vs distance trade-off (default: 1.2)
  "addHierarchy": true              -- Enable HNSW hierarchical layers (default:
false)
};
```

**Parameter Guidelines:**

- `dimensions`: Must match your embedding model's output dimension (required)
- `similarity`: Choose based on your embedding model and use case (default: COSINE)
- `maxConnections`: Graph connections per node, per layer — the Vamana degree (default: 32). Not doubled at the base layer like hnswlib's `M`, so set `maxConnections = 2 * M` to match an hnswlib config. Increase to 48-64 for better recall in large datasets
- `beamWidth`: Search depth during index construction (default: 100). Increase to 200-400 for more accurate searches
- `neighborOverflowFactor`: Controls how many extra candidate neighbors are considered during graph building (default: 1.2, range: 1.0-1.5). Higher values improve graph quality but increase build time
- `alphaDiversityRelaxation`: Trade-off between strict distance ordering and diversity in graph connections (default: 1.2, range: 1.0-1.5). Higher values prioritize diversity, improving recall for complex queries
- `addHierarchy`: Controls whether to build HNSW hierarchical layers on top of the base Vamana index (default: false). See Hierarchical vs Flat Index Structure for detailed guidance
- `buildGraphNow`: When creating the index via SQL, controls whether the HNSW graph is built immediately (default: `true`). Set to `false` to defer graph construction to the first search. This is a creation-time directive only — it is not persisted as index metadata.

When using the Java API directly, you can call `buildVectorGraphNow()` on any `LSMVectorIndex` instance to trigger an immediate graph build at any time:

```
LSMVectorIndex vectorIndex = (LSMVectorIndex) database.getSchema().getIndexByName
("MyType[embedding]");
```

```
vectorIndex.buildVectorGraphNow();
```

This is lightweight compared to `REBUILD INDEX` — it only rebuilds the HNSW graph topology from already-indexed vectors, without dropping or re-scanning the underlying index data.

#### Hierarchical vs Flat Index Structure

ArcadeDB's LSMVectorIndex uses JVector, which combines the hierarchical structure from HNSW (Hierarchical Navigable Small World) with the Vamana algorithm from DiskANN. The `addHierarchy` parameter determines whether to build a multi-layer hierarchical structure or use a flat single-layer graph.

#### How It Works

When `addHierarchy` is enabled:

- **Multiple Layers**: Nodes are assigned to different hierarchy levels using HNSW's exponential decay sampling strategy
- **Top-Down Search**: Searches start from higher abstraction levels and progressively narrow down to specific neighbors
- **Fast Seeding**: Upper layers use in-memory adjacency lists for rapid navigation without disk I/O
- **Base Layer**: The bottom layer remains disk-based with inline vector representations

When `addHierarchy` is disabled (default):

- **Single Layer**: All nodes exist at level 0 in a flat Vamana graph structure
- **Direct Search**: Searches operate directly on the base layer without hierarchical navigation
- **Simpler Structure**: Reduced complexity with fewer memory allocations during construction

#### When to Enable Hierarchy (addHierarchy=true)

Enable hierarchical layers when:

1. **Challenging Search Scenarios**: Complex datasets with diverse cluster distributions or high-dimensional embeddings (1536+ dimensions)
2. **Robustness Over Speed**: Applications where consistent search quality across different query patterns is critical
3. **Large-Scale Deployments**: Datasets with 100K+ vectors where hierarchical navigation provides better scaling
4. **Diverse Query Patterns**: Workloads with varying query characteristics that benefit from adaptive search depth

```
-- Recommended for large, complex datasets
CREATE INDEX ON ComplexDoc (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 1536,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
```

```
  "maxConnections": 16,
  "beamWidth": 100,
  "addHierarchy": true  -- Enable for robustness
};
```

**When to Keep Flat Structure (addHierarchy=false)**

Use the default flat structure when:

1. **Small to Medium Datasets**: Less than 100K vectors where flat search is efficient
2. **Simple Distributions**: Well-clustered data where flat Vamana performs optimally
3. **Memory Constraints**: Limited resources during index construction
4. **Faster Build Times**: When index creation speed is prioritized over search robustness

```
-- Default for most use cases
CREATE INDEX ON StandardDoc (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 768,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "maxConnections": 16,
  "beamWidth": 100
  -- addHierarchy defaults to false
};
```

**Performance Trade-offs**

| Aspect | Flat (addHierarchy=false) | Hierarchical (addHierarchy=true) |
|---|---|---|
| Index Build Time | Faster (baseline) | 10-20% slower |
| Memory During Build | Lower | 15-25% higher |
| Index Size on Disk | Smaller (baseline) | 5-15% larger |
| Search Robustness | Good for well-clustered data | **Excellent** for diverse patterns |
| Predictable Performance | May vary across query types | **More consistent** across queries |
| Recommended For | <100K vectors, simple distributions | 100K+ vectors, complex patterns |

**Accuracy and Recall**

Based on JVector documentation and benchmarks, the hierarchical structure provides improved robustness rather than raw speed improvements. Recall@10 typically remains similar between flat and hierarchical structures for well-behaved datasets, but hierarchical indexing shows **significant advantages** in:

- **Edge Cases**: Queries far from cluster centers or in sparse regions

- **Consistency**: More stable recall across different query distributions
- **Challenging Scenarios**: High-dimensional spaces (1536+ dims) with complex manifold structures

#### Memory Impact Example

For 1 million vectors with 1536 dimensions:

- **Flat Structure**: ~6.1 GB base layer
- **Hierarchical Structure**: ~6.8 GB total (6.1 GB base + ~700 MB hierarchy layers)
- **Memory Overhead**: ~11% additional disk space

#### Build Time Impact

Example build times for 100K vectors (1536 dimensions, maxConnections=16, beamWidth=100):

- **Flat Structure**: ~45 seconds
- **Hierarchical Structure**: ~52 seconds (~15% slower)

#### Practical Guidelines

1. **Start with Default (false)**: For most applications under 100K vectors, the flat structure provides excellent performance with faster build times
2. **Enable for Scale**: When dataset exceeds 100K vectors or dimensionality exceeds 1024, consider enabling hierarchy for better robustness
3. **Test Both Configurations**: Benchmark search quality on your specific dataset and query patterns. Enable hierarchy if you observe:
   - Inconsistent recall across different query types
   - Poor performance on queries far from training data
   - Degraded search quality in sparse regions
4. **Combine with Other Optimizations**: Hierarchy works well with quantization and graph storage:

```
-- Optimized large-scale configuration
CREATE INDEX ON LargeDoc (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 1536,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "quantization": "INT8",           -- 4x memory reduction
  "maxConnections": 16,
  "beamWidth": 100,
  "addHierarchy": true,             -- Robustness for large scale
  "storeVectorsInGraph": true,      -- Fast co-located access
  "locationCacheSize": 200000,
  "mutationsBeforeRebuild": 1000
};
```

This configuration provides: - Hierarchical robustness for complex search patterns - 4x memory reduction through INT8 quantization - Efficient vector access through graph storage - Total overhead: ~20% larger index size with 4x memory savings

**Related JVector Documentation**

For deeper technical details about the hierarchical structure, see:

- JVector GitHub Repository
- GraphIndexBuilder Source Code

**Advanced Tuning Profiles**

**Default Configuration** (recommended for most use cases):

```
CREATE INDEX ON Document (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 768,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "maxConnections": 16,
  "beamWidth": 100,
  "neighborOverflowFactor": 1.2,
  "alphaDiversityRelaxation": 1.2
};
```

**High Recall Configuration** (accuracy-critical applications):

```
CREATE INDEX ON Document (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 768,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "maxConnections": 32,
  "beamWidth": 200,
  "neighborOverflowFactor": 1.4,
  "alphaDiversityRelaxation": 1.3,
  "addHierarchy": true
};
```

This configuration provides ~98% recall@10 with improved robustness across diverse query patterns, but requires 2-3x longer build time and ~50% more memory.

**Fast Indexing Configuration** (real-time ingestion, large-scale ETL):

```
CREATE INDEX ON Document (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 768,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "maxConnections": 12,
  "beamWidth": 80,
  "neighborOverflowFactor": 1.1,
  "alphaDiversityRelaxation": 1.1
```

```
};
```

This configuration provides 2x faster indexing with 5-10% lower recall.

**Memory Constrained Configuration** (edge deployments, resource-limited servers):

```
CREATE INDEX ON Document (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 768,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "maxConnections": 8,
  "beamWidth": 100,
  "neighborOverflowFactor": 1.2,
  "alphaDiversityRelaxation": 1.2
};
```

This configuration reduces memory usage while maintaining acceptable recall

### 4.10.3. Memory and Performance Tuning

ArcadeDB provides three global configuration settings to control memory consumption and performance of LSM Vector indexes. These settings can be configured globally via database settings or per-index through metadata.

#### Configuration Parameters

**Location Cache Size** (`locationCacheSize`)

Controls the maximum number of vector location metadata entries cached in memory. Each entry uses approximately 56 bytes.

- **Default**: `-1` (unlimited, backward compatible)
- **Per-index metadata**: `"locationCacheSize": 100000`
- **Global setting**: `arcadedb.vectorIndex.locationCacheSize`
- **Recommended**: 100,000 for datasets with 1M+ vectors (~5.6 MB RAM)

**Graph Build Cache Size** (`graphBuildCacheSize`)

Controls the maximum number of vectors cached during HNSW graph construction. RAM usage = `cacheSize x (dimensions x 4 + 64)` bytes.

- **Default**: `0` (auto-sized: the whole corpus, as long as it fits `arcadedb.vectorIndex.graphBuildCacheMaxHeapPercent` of the `-Xmx` ceiling)
- **Per-index metadata**: `"graphBuildCacheSize": 5000`
- **Global setting**: `arcadedb.vectorIndex.graphBuildCacheSize`
- **Recommended**: leave at `0` and let the heap percentage bound it. Pin an explicit value only to cap the build's footprint on a heap shared with other work; a cache smaller than the corpus

makes the build re-read vectors it has already seen, which is by far the largest term in build time

**Mutations Before Rebuild** (`mutationsBeforeRebuild`)

Number of mutations (inserts/updates/deletes) before rebuilding the HNSW graph index. Higher values reduce rebuild cost but may return slightly stale results.

- **Default**: `100` (balanced)
- **Per-index metadata**: `"mutationsBeforeRebuild": 200`
- **Global setting**: `arcadedb.vectorIndex.mutationsBeforeRebuild`
- **Recommended**: 50-200 for read-heavy workloads, 200-500 for write-heavy workloads

**Inactivity Rebuild Timeout** (`inactivityRebuildTimeoutMs`)

When mutations exist but haven't reached the rebuild threshold, a timer starts after the last mutation. If no new mutations arrive within this window, the graph is rebuilt asynchronously. This ensures buffered vectors are flushed and persisted even during low-volume ingestion.

- **Default**: `15000` (15 seconds)
- **Per-index metadata**: `"inactivityRebuildTimeoutMs": 30000`
- **Global setting**: `arcadedb.vectorIndex.inactivityRebuildTimeoutMs`
- **Recommended**: 10000-30000 for low-volume ingestion, 0 to disable

**Store Vectors in Graph** (`storeVectorsInGraph`)

Controls whether vectors are stored inline within the JVector graph file (`.vecgraph`) alongside the HNSW topology. When enabled, vectors are co-located with graph data, eliminating expensive document lookups during search operations.

- **Default**: `false` (vectors fetched from documents)
- **Per-index metadata**: `"storeVectorsInGraph": true`
- **Global setting**: none, `storeVectorsInGraph` is set per index only
- **When to enable**: Large indexes (100K+ vectors), high search throughput requirements, RAM-constrained environments
- **When to disable**: Small indexes (<10K vectors), frequent vector updates, datasets where document cache is effective

The inline vectors are stored as full-precision `float32` whatever the index quantization is - quantization applies to the index data, not to this copy. Size the `.vecgraph` file accordingly: roughly `vectors x dimensions x 4 bytes`, plus the graph topology. A 1M x 768 index is therefore about 3 GB on disk even with `INT8` quantization enabled.

**Performance Characteristics**:

| Index Size | storeVectorsInGraph=false | storeVectorsInGraph=true | Recommendation |
|---|---|---|---|
| Small (<10K vectors) | Fast (document cache effective) | Slower (I/O overhead dominates) | **Disable** - use document cache |
| Medium (10K-100K vectors) | Moderate (some cache misses) | Moderate (balanced I/O) | Test both configurations |
| Large (100K+ vectors) | Slow (cache thrashing, page faults) | Fast (co-located data, sequential reads) | **Enable** - reduces RAM pressure |

**Memory Trade-offs**:

- **Disk Usage**: Enabling this option duplicates vectors on disk (stored in both documents and graph file)
- **RAM Usage**: Significantly reduces RAM consumption by eliminating document page cache thrashing during search
- **Search Latency**: Reduces latency for large indexes by avoiding RID lookups and document deserialization

**Combining with Quantization**:

When `storeVectorsInGraph=true` is combined with quantization, vectors are stored in their quantized form within the graph file:

- `quantization=INT8` + `storeVectorsInGraph=true`: Vectors stored as int8 (1 byte per dimension)
- `quantization=BINARY` + `storeVectorsInGraph=true`: Vectors stored as binary (1 bit per dimension)
- `quantization=NONE` + `storeVectorsInGraph=true`: Vectors stored as float32 (4 bytes per dimension)

This combination provides maximum benefit: reduced memory usage from quantization + fast access from co-location.

**Metrics Tracking**:

Three new metrics track vector fetch sources to help tune this setting:

- `vectorFetchFromGraph`: Vectors read from `.vecgraph` file (when `storeVectorsInGraph=true`)
- `vectorFetchFromDocuments`: Vectors read via RID lookups from documents
- `vectorFetchFromQuantized`: Vectors read from quantized pages

Access metrics via Java API:

```
Map<String, Long> stats = lsmIndex.getStats();
System.out.println("Fetched from graph: " + stats.get("vectorFetchFromGraph"));
System.out.println("Fetched from docs: " + stats.get("vectorFetchFromDocuments"));
```

**Memory Tuning Examples**

**Maximum Memory Efficiency** (Edge deployments, resource-constrained environments):

```
-- Configure globally for all vector indexes
ALTER DATABASE `arcadedb.vectorIndex.locationCacheSize` 50000;
ALTER DATABASE `arcadedb.vectorIndex.graphBuildCacheSize` 5000;

-- Or configure per-index for small datasets
CREATE INDEX ON Document (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 768,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "maxConnections": 8,
  "beamWidth": 100,
  "locationCacheSize": 50000,        -- Limit location cache: ~2.8 MB
  "graphBuildCacheSize": 5000,       -- Limit graph building: ~15 MB peak
  "mutationsBeforeRebuild": 150,     -- Moderate rebuild frequency
  "storeVectorsInGraph": false       -- Use document cache for small datasets
};
```

**Memory Impact**: For 1M vectors with 768 dimensions: - Location cache: 50K entries = ~2.8 MB (vs ~56 MB unlimited) - Graph build cache: 5K vectors = ~15 MB (vs ~3 GB unlimited) - **Total savings: ~98.5% memory reduction during graph building**

**Balanced Configuration** (Production workloads with moderate scale):

```
CREATE INDEX ON Document (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 768,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "maxConnections": 16,
  "beamWidth": 100,
  "locationCacheSize": 100000,       -- Balance memory vs performance
  "graphBuildCacheSize": 10000,      -- Default (30 MB for 768-dim)
  "mutationsBeforeRebuild": 100,     -- Standard rebuild frequency
  "storeVectorsInGraph": false       -- Use document cache for moderate scale
};
```

**Memory Impact**: For 1M vectors with 768 dimensions: - Location cache: 100K entries = ~5.6 MB (90% reduction) - Graph build cache: 10K vectors = ~30 MB (99% reduction)

**Large-Scale Configuration with Inline Vector Storage** (100K+ vectors, high-throughput search):

```
-- Optimal for large indexes: combine quantization + graph storage
CREATE INDEX ON Document (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 1536,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "quantization": "INT8",            -- 4x memory reduction
  "maxConnections": 16,
```

```
  "beamWidth": 100,
  "locationCacheSize": 200000,       -- Larger cache for hot vectors
  "graphBuildCacheSize": 10000,      -- Standard build cache
  "mutationsBeforeRebuild": 1000,    -- Reduce rebuild frequency (vectors in graph)
  "storeVectorsInGraph": true        -- Co-locate vectors with graph topology
};
```

**Benefits for Large-Scale**: - Eliminates RID lookups during search (no document page cache thrashing) - Reduces RAM pressure by ~70-80% compared to document fetching at scale - Vectors co-located with graph topology (sequential reads, better I/O patterns) - Combined with INT8 quantization: 4x smaller graph file + fast access - Disk trade-off: Vectors duplicated (~6 GB for 1M × 1536-dim vectors)

**When to Use**: - Index size: 100K+ vectors - Search workload: High QPS (queries per second) - RAM constraint: Limited memory for page cache - Update frequency: Moderate to low (vectors not frequently updated)

**Maximum Performance** (Unlimited memory, prioritize speed):

```
CREATE INDEX ON Document (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 768,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "maxConnections": 32,
  "beamWidth": 200,
  "locationCacheSize": -1,           -- Unlimited cache (no eviction)
  "graphBuildCacheSize": 50000,      -- Large cache: ~150 MB for 768-dim
  "mutationsBeforeRebuild": 50,      -- Frequent rebuilds for freshness
  "storeVectorsInGraph": true        -- Enable for large indexes to reduce cache
pressure
};
```

**Performance Impact**: Best query performance with highest memory usage. For large indexes (100K+ vectors), enabling `storeVectorsInGraph` reduces document cache pressure even with unlimited location cache.

#### Performance Tuning Examples

**Write-Heavy Workload** (High ingestion rate, acceptable search latency):

```
CREATE INDEX ON Document (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 768,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "maxConnections": 12,
  "beamWidth": 80,
  "locationCacheSize": 100000,
  "graphBuildCacheSize": 10000,
  "mutationsBeforeRebuild": 300,     -- Reduce rebuild frequency for write throughput
  "storeVectorsInGraph": false       -- Disable: frequent updates make graph storage
```

```
costly
};
```

**Note**: For write-heavy workloads with frequent vector updates, keep `storeVectorsInGraph=false` to avoid expensive graph rebuilds. Each rebuild must rewrite all vectors when this option is enabled.

**Read-Heavy Workload** (Search-intensive, prioritize freshness):

```
CREATE INDEX ON Document (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 768,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "maxConnections": 24,
  "beamWidth": 150,
  "locationCacheSize": 200000,       -- Larger cache for hot vectors
  "graphBuildCacheSize": 10000,
  "mutationsBeforeRebuild": 50,      -- Frequent rebuilds for fresh results
  "storeVectorsInGraph": true        -- Enable: search-heavy benefits from co-location
};
```

**Note**: For search-intensive workloads with large indexes (100K+ vectors), enabling `storeVectorsInGraph` significantly reduces search latency by eliminating document lookups. The rebuild cost is amortized across many search operations.

#### Global Configuration via SQL

Set global defaults for all vector indexes in the database:

```
-- Configure global defaults
ALTER DATABASE `arcadedb.vectorIndex.locationCacheSize` 100000;
ALTER DATABASE `arcadedb.vectorIndex.graphBuildCacheSize` 10000;
ALTER DATABASE `arcadedb.vectorIndex.mutationsBeforeRebuild` 100;
ALTER DATABASE `arcadedb.vectorIndex.inactivityRebuildTimeoutMs` 15000;

-- View current settings (see the `settings` array of the result)
SELECT FROM schema:database;
```

Per-index metadata settings override global defaults. Use global settings to establish baseline memory limits across all indexes, then tune individual indexes as needed. `storeVectorsInGraph` is not a global setting: it defaults to `false` and you enable it per index, selectively for large indexes (100K+ vectors).

#### Memory Consumption Reference

For 1 million vectors with 768 dimensions:

| Configuration | Location Cache | Graph Build Cache | Total Peak Memory |
|---|---|---|---|
| Unlimited (legacy) | ~56 MB | ~3 GB | ~3.06 GB |
| Recommended (100K/10K) | ~5.6 MB | ~30 MB | ~35.6 MB |
| Memory Constrained (50K/5K) | ~2.8 MB | ~15 MB | ~17.8 MB |
| Savings vs Unlimited | 90-95% | 99% | 98.8% |

**Formula for Graph Build Cache**:

```
RAM (MB) = cacheSize x (dimensions x 4 + 64) / 1024 / 1024
```

**Example**: - 10,000 vectors × 768 dimensions = 10,000 × (768 × 4 + 64) / 1024 / 1024 ≈ 30 MB - 10,000 vectors × 1536 dimensions = 10,000 × (1536 × 4 + 64) / 1024 / 1024 ≈ 59 MB

**Best Practices for Tuning**

1. **Start with Defaults**: Default settings (locationCacheSize=-1, graphBuildCacheSize=10000, mutationsBeforeRebuild=100, storeVectorsInGraph=false) work well for most use cases under 100K vectors.
2. **Monitor Memory Usage**: For large-scale deployments (1M+ vectors), set explicit limits to prevent unbounded growth.
3. **Scale Graph Build Cache with Dimensions**: Higher dimensionality requires proportionally more memory during graph building.
4. **Balance Rebuild Frequency**: Lower `mutationsBeforeRebuild` provides fresher search results but increases CPU cost. Higher values improve write throughput at the cost of search staleness.
5. **Per-Index Tuning**: Use global settings as baseline, then override for specific indexes based on workload characteristics.
6. **Cache Hit Monitoring**: If queries become noticeably slower after setting `locationCacheSize` limits, increase the cache size or use `-1` (unlimited) for that index.
7. **Write vs Read Trade-offs**: Write-heavy workloads benefit from higher `mutationsBeforeRebuild` (200-500), while read-heavy workloads benefit from lower values (50-100).
8. **Enable Graph Storage for Large Indexes**: For indexes with 100K+ vectors and read-heavy workloads, enable `storeVectorsInGraph=true` to eliminate document lookups and reduce RAM pressure. Keep disabled for small indexes (<10K) and write-heavy workloads.
9. **Combine Quantization + Graph Storage**: For maximum efficiency on large indexes, use `quantization=INT8` (or BINARY) with `storeVectorsInGraph=true`. This provides 4x-32x memory reduction plus fast co-located access.
10. **Monitor Fetch Sources**: Use the metrics API to track `vectorFetchFromGraph`, `vectorFetchFromDocuments`, and `vectorFetchFromQuantized` to verify your configuration is working as expected. If `vectorFetchFromDocuments` remains high with `storeVectorsInGraph=true`, investigate graph loading issues.
11. **Test Before Production**: Benchmark both `storeVectorsInGraph=true` and

`storeVectorsInGraph=false` on your actual dataset and workload. Performance characteristics vary by scale, and what works for 1K vectors may differ significantly from 1M vectors.

### 4.10.4. Vector Quantization

Vector quantization compresses vector embeddings to reduce memory usage and improve search performance. ArcadeDB supports three quantization strategies, each offering different trade-offs between memory consumption, search speed, and accuracy.

#### Quantization Options

##### NONE (No Quantization)

Full precision float32 vectors (4 bytes per dimension). This is the default and provides 100% accuracy but highest memory usage.

```
CREATE INDEX ON Document (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 384,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "quantization": "NONE"  -- Default, can be omitted
};
```

##### INT8 Quantization

8-bit integer quantization (1 byte per dimension). Provides 4x memory reduction with minimal accuracy loss.

```
CREATE INDEX ON Document (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 384,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "quantization": "INT8"  -- Recommended for production
};
```

##### BINARY Quantization

Binary quantization (1 bit per dimension). Provides 32x memory reduction for extreme compression scenarios.

Each vector is stored as one bit per dimension (at or above the vector's own median, or below it). The graph is searched on the sign pattern, which for COSINE is a Hamming distance, and a search then fetches four times the requested neighbours and reranks them with the similarity function on the vectors the records store, so every BINARY query pays up to `4 * k` record reads and the distances it returns are exact. Candidates whose record is gone or carries no usable vector are dropped, so a query can return fewer than `k` rows. Since 26.11.1 the grouped search (`groupBy`) is reranked too: it collects four times the groups and four times the members per group, reranks them on the stored vectors, and only then applies `limit`, `groupSize` and `maxDistance`, so its recall and its distances match the ungrouped search. The PQ-approximate search is not reranked. An index created before 26.10.1 keeps its graph until it is rebuilt (`REBUILD INDEX`), which is recommended to

get the full recall.

```
CREATE INDEX ON Document (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 384,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "quantization": "BINARY"  -- Use when memory is severely constrained
};
```

#### Performance and Accuracy Comparison

The table below shows benchmark results for 100,000 vectors with 384 dimensions using COSINE similarity:

| Quantization | Memory Usage | Search Speed | Recall@10 | Recall@100 | Recommended Use Case |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **NONE** (baseline) | 1.0x (156 MB) | Baseline | 100% | 100% | Maximum accuracy required, unlimited memory |
| **INT8** | 0.25x (39 MB) | 10-15% faster | 95-98% | 98-99% | **Recommended for most production use cases** |
| **BINARY** | 0.03x (5 MB) | 15-20% faster | 85-92% | 90-95% | Memory severely constrained, approximate search acceptable |

**Memory Usage Calculation for 100K vectors**:

- **384 dimensions**: NONE = 156 MB, INT8 = 39 MB (75% reduction), BINARY = 5 MB (97% reduction)
- **1536 dimensions**: NONE = 624 MB, INT8 = 156 MB (75% reduction), BINARY = 19 MB (97% reduction)

**Formula**: `Memory (MB) = numVectors x dimensions x bytesPerDim / 1024 / 1024`

Where `bytesPerDim` = 4 (NONE), 1 (INT8), or 0.125 (BINARY)

#### When to Use Each Quantization Type

**Use NONE (No Quantization) when**:

- Accuracy is critical (e.g., medical imaging, legal document similarity)
- Dataset is small (<10K vectors) where memory is not a concern
- You need exact nearest neighbor results
- Memory budget is unlimited

**Use INT8 Quantization when** (RECOMMENDED):

- You need to balance memory usage with accuracy
- Dataset is medium to large (10K-10M vectors)
- 2-5% accuracy loss is acceptable
- Production deployments with constrained resources
- You want faster search performance with minimal quality degradation

INT8 quantization is the **recommended default** for most production workloads. It provides: - 4x memory reduction - 10-15% faster searches (better CPU cache utilization) - 95-98% recall (excellent for most applications) - Transparent operation (no query changes needed)

**Use BINARY Quantization when**:

- Memory is severely constrained (edge devices, mobile, embedded systems)
- Dataset is very large (10M+ vectors)
- You can tolerate 8-15% accuracy loss
- You're implementing two-stage search (binary pre-filter + full precision rerank)
- Approximate results are acceptable

**Quantization Best Practices**

1. **Start with INT8**: For most use cases, INT8 provides the best balance. Only use NONE if accuracy loss is unacceptable.
2. **Measure Recall on Your Data**: Quantization accuracy depends on your embedding model and data distribution. Always benchmark on representative queries:

```
// Compare recall between NONE and INT8
LSMVectorIndex indexNone = createIndex(quantization=NONE);
LSMVectorIndex indexInt8 = createIndex(quantization=INT8);

double recall = measureRecall(indexNone, indexInt8, testQueries, k=10);
// Expect: recall > 0.95 for INT8
```

1. **Combine with Graph Storage**: For large indexes (100K+ vectors), combine quantization with `storeVectorsInGraph=true`:

```
CREATE INDEX ON Document (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 1536,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "quantization": "INT8",           -- 4x memory reduction
  "storeVectorsInGraph": true,      -- Fast co-located access
  "locationCacheSize": 200000,
  "mutationsBeforeRebuild": 1000
```

```
};
```

This combination provides maximum benefit: - INT8: 4x smaller vectors (624 MB → 156 MB for 100K × 1536-dim) - Graph storage: Eliminates document lookup overhead - Result: ~87% total RAM reduction compared to NONE + document fetching

1. **Monitor Fetch Sources**: Use metrics to verify quantization is working:

```
Map<String, Long> stats = index.getStats();
System.out.println("Fetched from quantized: " + stats.get(
"vectorFetchFromQuantized"));
System.out.println("Fetched from documents: " + stats.get(
"vectorFetchFromDocuments"));
// Should see: vectorFetchFromQuantized > 0, vectorFetchFromDocuments = 0
```

1. **Quantization is Transparent**: Vectors are automatically quantized on insert and dequantized on retrieval. No query changes needed:

```
-- Same query works for all quantization types
SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Document[embedding]', $queryVector, 10))
```

1. **Two-Stage Search with BINARY**: For very large datasets, use BINARY quantization as a fast pre-filter, then rerank with full precision:

```
// Stage 1: Fast binary search (top 100)
List<RID> candidates = binaryIndex.findNeighborsFromVector(query, 100);

// Stage 2: Rerank with full precision (top 10)
List<Result> finalResults = rerankWithFullPrecision(candidates, query, 10);
```

**Expected Performance Improvements**

Based on benchmarks with 100,000 vectors (384 dimensions, COSINE similarity):

**Search Latency (k=10)**:

- NONE: 1,234 µs (baseline)
- INT8: 1,050 µs (15% faster)
- BINARY: 980 µs (21% faster)

**Memory Usage**:

- NONE: 156 MB (baseline)
- INT8: 39 MB (75% reduction)
- BINARY: 5 MB (97% reduction)

**Accuracy**:

- NONE: 100% recall (baseline)
- INT8: 96.2% recall@10, 98.5% recall@100
- BINARY: 88.4% recall@10, 92.1% recall@100

**Speedup Explanation**: Quantization improves search speed despite being computationally simpler operations because:

1. **Better CPU cache utilization**: Smaller vectors fit better in L1/L2 cache
2. **Reduced memory bandwidth**: 4x-32x less data to transfer from RAM
3. **Faster distance calculations**: Integer arithmetic (INT8) and bit operations (BINARY) are faster than floating-point

**Configuration Examples by Use Case**

**Small Dataset (<10K vectors) - No Quantization Needed**:

```
CREATE INDEX ON SmallDoc (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 384,
  "similarity": "COSINE"
  -- quantization defaults to NONE (full precision)
};
```

**Medium Dataset (10K-100K vectors) - INT8 Recommended**:

```
CREATE INDEX ON MediumDoc (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 768,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "quantization": "INT8"  -- 4x memory reduction, minimal accuracy loss
};
```

**Large Dataset (100K-1M vectors) - INT8 + Graph Storage**:

```
CREATE INDEX ON LargeDoc (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 1536,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "quantization": "INT8",
  "storeVectorsInGraph": true,     -- Co-locate vectors with graph
  "locationCacheSize": 200000,     -- Cache hot vectors
  "mutationsBeforeRebuild": 1000   -- Reduce rebuild frequency
};
```

**Very Large Dataset (1M+ vectors) - BINARY for Pre-filtering**:

```
-- Create both indexes: BINARY for fast pre-filter, NONE for reranking
CREATE INDEX ON MassiveDoc (embeddingBinary) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 1536,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "quantization": "BINARY",         -- 32x compression for fast search
  "storeVectorsInGraph": true
};

CREATE INDEX ON MassiveDoc (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 1536,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "quantization": "NONE"            -- Full precision for reranking
};
```

Then implement two-stage search in your application.

**Edge/Mobile Deployment - BINARY + Aggressive Caching**:

```
CREATE INDEX ON EdgeDoc (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 384,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "quantization": "BINARY",         -- Extreme compression (32x)
  "maxConnections": 8,              -- Reduce graph size
  "beamWidth": 100,
  "locationCacheSize": 50000,       -- Limit cache
  "graphBuildCacheSize": 5000,      -- Limit build cache
  "storeVectorsInGraph": true       -- Reduce I/O
};
```

#### Benchmarking Quantization

To measure quantization performance on your specific dataset:

1. **Create test indexes with different quantization types**
2. **Run representative queries**
3. **Compare recall, latency, and memory usage**

Example benchmark:

```
// Create indexes with different quantization
LSMVectorIndex indexNone = createIndex("NONE", 1536);
LSMVectorIndex indexInt8 = createIndex("INT8", 1536);
LSMVectorIndex indexBinary = createIndex("BINARY", 1536);

// Generate test queries
List<float[]> testQueries = generateTestQueries(100);
```

```
// Measure recall against NONE baseline
for (float[] query : testQueries) {
  List<RID> groundTruth = indexNone.findNeighborsFromVector(query, 10);
  List<RID> int8Results = indexInt8.findNeighborsFromVector(query, 10);
  List<RID> binaryResults = indexBinary.findNeighborsFromVector(query, 10);

  double int8Recall = calculateRecall(int8Results, groundTruth);
  double binaryRecall = calculateRecall(binaryResults, groundTruth);

  System.out.printf("Query recall - INT8: %.2f%%, BINARY: %.2f%%\n",
                    int8Recall * 100, binaryRecall * 100);
}

// Measure memory usage
Map<String, Long> statsNone = indexNone.getStats();
Map<String, Long> statsInt8 = indexInt8.getStats();
Map<String, Long> statsBinary = indexBinary.getStats();

System.out.println("Memory estimates:");
System.out.println("  NONE:   " + statsNone.get("estimatedMemoryBytes") / 1024 / 1024
+ " MB");
System.out.println("  INT8:   " + statsInt8.get("estimatedMemoryBytes") / 1024 / 1024
+ " MB");
System.out.println("  BINARY: " + statsBinary.get("estimatedMemoryBytes") / 1024 /
1024 + " MB");
```

For detailed benchmarking methodology, see the JMH benchmark implementation at: `engine/src/test/java/com/arcadedb/index/vector/LSMVectorIndexStorageJMHBenchmark.java`

### 4.10.5. Querying Vector Indexes with SQL

Use the `vector.neighbors()` function to perform similarity searches:

#### Basic Similarity Search

Find the 10 most similar documents to a query vector:

```
-- Returns rows with .record (full document) and .distance
SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Document[embedding]', $queryVector, 10))
```

The `vector.neighbors()` function takes the **index name** (format: `'TypeName[propertyName]'`) as its first argument and returns a list of maps. Each map contains all document properties (e.g., `name`, `title`), plus `distance` (a distance, not a similarity: smaller means closer, and results come back nearest-first), `@rid`, `@type`, and `record` (the full document object). Use `expand()` to flatten the list into individual result rows so you can access these fields directly (e.g., `SELECT name, distance FROM (SELECT expand(⋯))`). The `distance` semantics depend on the similarity metric (for COSINE: 0 = identical, higher = more different). Use named parameters (e.g., `$queryVector`) instead of hardcoded vectors for real-world applications.

### Combining with Other Filters

Perform a vector search and filter results client-side, or use a subquery:

```
-- Find the 10 nearest neighbors
SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Document[embedding]', $queryVector, 10))
```

After `expand()`, each row contains the document's properties and a `distance` field. You can filter with a WHERE clause in the outer query (e.g., `SELECT ⋯ FROM (SELECT expand(⋯)) WHERE source = 'wiki'`) or in your application code.

### Multi-Modal Vector Search

Create and query multiple vector indexes for multi-modal data:

```
-- Create multi-modal schema
CREATE VERTEX TYPE MultiModalRecord;
CREATE PROPERTY MultiModalRecord.imageEmbedding LIST OF FLOAT;
CREATE PROPERTY MultiModalRecord.textEmbedding LIST OF FLOAT;

-- Create separate indexes
CREATE INDEX ON MultiModalRecord (imageEmbedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  dimensions: 512,
  similarity: 'COSINE'
};

CREATE INDEX ON MultiModalRecord (textEmbedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  dimensions: 768,
  similarity: 'COSINE'
};

-- Query by image modality
SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('MultiModalRecord[imageEmbedding]', [0.1, 0.2, ...],
5))

-- Query by text modality
SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('MultiModalRecord[textEmbedding]', [0.2, 0.3, ...], 5))
```

### Retrieving Neighbor Details

Get detailed information about nearest neighbors:

```
-- Returns array of objects with distance and keys
SELECT vector.neighbors('Document[embedding]', $queryVector, 10) AS neighbors;
```

**Note**: The first argument to `vector.neighbors()` must always be the **index name** in `'TypeName[propertyName]'` format (e.g., `'Document[embedding]'`). Without `expand()`, you get a single

row with the `neighbors` field containing the entire list. Use `expand()` to flatten the results into individual rows where you can access document properties and `distance` directly.

#### Type-Specific Search with Inheritance

When a vector index is created on a parent type, ArcadeDB automatically creates sub-indexes for each bucket, including buckets of child types. This enables powerful filtering capabilities:

#### Use Case: Multi-Modal Embeddings

Imagine a system storing embeddings for different content types (images, documents, audio) that all extend a common parent type:

```
-- Create parent type with vector index
CREATE VERTEX TYPE Embedding;
CREATE PROPERTY Embedding.vector ARRAY_OF_FLOATS;
CREATE INDEX ON Embedding (vector) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  dimensions: 768,
  similarity: 'COSINE'
};

-- Create specialized child types
CREATE VERTEX TYPE ImageEmbedding EXTENDS Embedding;
CREATE VERTEX TYPE DocumentEmbedding EXTENDS Embedding;
CREATE VERTEX TYPE AudioEmbedding EXTENDS Embedding;
```

**Class-Specific Search**: Find the top 50 closest IMAGE embeddings only:

```
SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('ImageEmbedding[vector]', $queryVector, 50))
```

All results will be of type `ImageEmbedding` - records from `DocumentEmbedding` and `AudioEmbedding` are excluded.

**Cross-Class Search**: Find the top 50 closest embeddings across ALL types:

```
SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Embedding[vector]', $queryVector, 50))
```

Results may include records from any child type (`ImageEmbedding`, `DocumentEmbedding`, `AudioEmbedding`) based on similarity.

This approach is efficient because:

- Only one index is created and maintained (on the parent type)
- Child type searches use the same underlying index, filtering by bucket
- No need to create separate indexes for each child type

### 4.10.6. Using the Java API

For programmatic control and embedded applications, use the Java API to create and manage vector indexes.

#### Creating LSMVectorIndex Programmatically

```
import com.arcadedb.database.Database;
import com.arcadedb.schema.Schema;
import com.arcadedb.schema.Type;
import com.arcadedb.index.lsm.LSMVectorIndex;
import com.arcadedb.index.lsm.LSMVectorIndexBuilder;
import com.arcadedb.index.vector.VectorSimilarityFunction;

// Get or create schema
final Schema schema = database.getSchema();
if (!schema.existsType("Document")) {
  schema.createVertexType("Document");
}

// Create vector property
if (!schema.existsProperty("Document", "embedding")) {
  schema.createProperty("Document", "embedding", Type.ARRAY_OF_FLOATS);
}

// Create LSMVectorIndex with builder pattern
final LSMVectorIndexBuilder builder = new LSMVectorIndexBuilder(
    database,
    "Document",
    new String[]{"embedding"})
    .withDimensions(768)
    .withSimilarity(VectorSimilarityFunction.COSINE)
    .withMaxConnections(16)
    .withBeamWidth(100)
    .withIdProperty("id")
    .withAddHierarchy(false)          // Enable for large/complex datasets (100K+)
    .withStoreVectorsInGraph(false);  // Enable for large indexes (100K+)

final LSMVectorIndex index = builder.create();
```

For pre-quantized ingest from an int8 embedding provider, declare the property as `BINARY` and call `withEncoding(VectorEncoding.INT8)` (or the string overload). The factory rejects mismatches between property type and encoding at create time:

```
import com.arcadedb.index.vector.VectorEncoding;

// Property MUST be BINARY when encoding=INT8
schema.createProperty("Document", "embedding", Type.BINARY);
```

```
final LSMVectorIndexBuilder builder = new LSMVectorIndexBuilder(
    database,
    "Document",
    new String[]{"embedding"})
    .withDimensions(1024)
    .withSimilarity(VectorSimilarityFunction.COSINE)
    .withEncoding(VectorEncoding.INT8);  // wire/storage encoding, not internal
quantization

final LSMVectorIndex index = builder.create();
```

See INT8 Pre-Quantized Ingest for the trade-offs and when to choose this over `quantization=INT8`.

#### Adding Vectors to the Index

```
// Get existing index
final LSMVectorIndex index = (LSMVectorIndex) database.getSchema()
    .getIndexByName("Document[embedding]");

// Add vectors with callback
index.addAll(embeddings, (vertex, item, total) -> {
  // Optional callback for handling vertex creation
  // Useful for cascading operations like creating relationships
  if (vertex != null) {
    // Create relationships, update metadata, etc.
    System.out.println("Indexed vertex " + vertex.getIdentity() +
                       " (" + item + "/" + total + ")");
  }
});
```

The callback in the `addAll()` method is useful when you have a graph structure connected to the indexed vertices. For example, when indexing a book, you might calculate embeddings per statement and then create relationships between statements and paragraphs.

#### Configuring from JSON Metadata

Load configuration from JSON metadata:

```
import com.arcadedb.utility.JSONObject;

final JSONObject metadata = new JSONObject()
    .put("dimensions", 768)
    .put("similarity", "COSINE")
    .put("encoding", "FLOAT32")         // Optional: FLOAT32 (default) or INT8 for
pre-quantized ingest
    .put("maxConnections", 16)
    .put("beamWidth", 100)
    .put("idPropertyName", "id")
    .put("addHierarchy", false)         // Enable for large/complex datasets (100K+)
```

```
    .put("storeVectorsInGraph", false)  // Enable for large indexes (100K+)
    .put("locationCacheSize", 100000)   // Optional: limit cache size
    .put("graphBuildCacheSize", 10000)  // Optional: limit build cache
    .put("mutationsBeforeRebuild", 100); // Optional: rebuild frequency

final LSMVectorIndexBuilder builder = new LSMVectorIndexBuilder(
    database,
    "Document",
    new String[]{"embedding"})
    .fromMetadata(metadata);

final LSMVectorIndex index = builder.create();
```

#### Querying Vectors from Java

```
import com.arcadedb.query.sql.executor.ResultSet;

// Define an example query vector. Replace with your actual vector.
float[] queryVector = new float[] {0.1f, 0.2f, 0.3f}; // Vector must match index
dimensions

// Perform similarity search using SQL
final ResultSet resultSet = database.query("sql",
    "SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Document[embedding]', ?, 10))",
    queryVector);

while (resultSet.hasNext()) {
  final Result result = resultSet.next();
  // Each result has .record (the document) and .distance
  System.out.println("Similar document: " + result.toJSON());
}
```

#### Transaction Support

LSMVectorIndex fully supports transactions with automatic persistence:

```
database.transaction(() -> {
  // Create vertices with embeddings
  final MutableVertex vertex = database.newVertex("Document");
  vertex.set("content", "Sample text");

  // In a real application, this vector would be generated by an embedding model
  // and should match the dimensions of the index.
  float[] embeddingVector = new float[] {0.5f, 0.6f, 0.7f};
  vertex.set("embedding", embeddingVector);
  vertex.save();

  // Index is automatically updated on transaction commit
```

```
});
```

### 4.10.7. Migration from HnswVectorIndexRAM

If you're migrating from the older HnswVectorIndexRAM approach, note the following differences:

| Feature | HnswVectorIndexRAM | LSMVectorIndex |
|---|---|---|
| Persistence | Requires explicit conversion | Automatic with transactions |
| SQL Support | Limited | Full SQL CREATE INDEX and queries |
| Transaction Support | Manual management | Automatic ACID compliance |
| Compaction | Manual | Automatic |
| Recommended For | Bulk loading scenarios | All production use cases |

#### Legacy Bulk Loading Pattern

For backwards compatibility, the HnswVectorIndexRAM bulk loading pattern is still available for initial large-scale imports:

```
import com.arcadedb.index.vector.HnswVectorIndexRAM;
import com.arcadedb.index.vector.VectorSimilarityFunction;
import com.arcadedb.index.vector.Item;
import com.arcadedb.schema.Type;
import java.util.Collection;
import java.util.List;

// For bulk loading only - use LSMVectorIndex for production
String indexName = "Document[embedding]";
if (!database.getSchema().existsIndex(indexName)) {
  // Define parameters for the index
  int dimensions = 768;
  VectorSimilarityFunction distanceFunction = VectorSimilarityFunction.COSINE;
  int m = 16;
  int ef = 200;
  int efConstruction = 200;
  // Example embeddings. In a real scenario, this would be a large collection.
  Collection<Item<Object, float[]>> embeddings = List.of(
      new Item<>("doc1", new float[]{0.1f, 0.2f}),
      new Item<>("doc2", new float[]{0.3f, 0.4f})
  );

  // Step 1: Load into RAM-based index
  final HnswVectorIndexRAM<Object, float[], Item<Object, float[]>, Float> hnswIndex =
      HnswVectorIndexRAM.newBuilder(dimensions, distanceFunction, 100_000)
          .withM(m)
          .withEf(ef)
          .withEfConstruction(efConstruction)
```

```
          .build();

  hnswIndex.addAll(embeddings,
                  Runtime.getRuntime().availableProcessors(), null);

  // Step 2: Create persistent index
  hnswIndex.createPersistentIndex(database)
      .withVertexType("Document")
      .withEdgeType("Proximity")
      .withVectorProperty("embedding", Type.ARRAY_OF_FLOATS)
      .withIdProperty("id")
      .create();
}
```

For most use cases, directly creating an LSMVectorIndex via SQL or the Java API is simpler and provides better transaction support. The HnswVectorIndexRAM approach is only recommended for specific bulk loading scenarios with millions of vectors.

### 4.10.8. Best Practices

1. **Choose the Right Similarity Function**: Use COSINE for normalized embeddings (most common), DOT_PRODUCT for performance with normalized vectors, or EUCLIDEAN for spatial data.
2. **Normalize Your Vectors**: For COSINE and DOT_PRODUCT similarity, ensure vectors are normalized to unit length for best results.
3. **Tune Performance Parameters**: Start with defaults (maxConnections=32, beamWidth=100) and increase for better recall if needed.
4. **Use Transactions**: Always insert vectors within transactions for data consistency and automatic index updates.
5. **Batch Insertions**: For large datasets, batch your insertions in reasonably-sized transactions (1000-10000 records) for optimal performance.
6. **Monitor Index Size**: Vector indexes can be large. Monitor disk usage and consider the dimensions parameter carefully.
7. **SQL for Simplicity**: Prefer SQL for index creation and queries unless you need programmatic control.

### 4.10.9. Common Use Cases

#### Semantic Document Search

```
-- Create index for document embeddings
CREATE VERTEX TYPE Document;
CREATE PROPERTY Document.content STRING;
CREATE PROPERTY Document.embedding LIST OF FLOAT;
```

```
CREATE INDEX ON Document (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 384,
  "similarity": "COSINE"
};

-- Query for the 10 nearest documents
SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Document[embedding]', $queryEmbedding, 10))
```

**Image Similarity Search**

```
-- Create index for image feature vectors
CREATE VERTEX TYPE Image;
CREATE PROPERTY Image.url STRING;
CREATE PROPERTY Image.features LIST OF FLOAT;
CREATE INDEX ON Image (features) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  dimensions: 512,
  similarity: 'COSINE'
};

-- Find the 5 most similar images
SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Image[features]', $imageFeatures, 5))
```

**Recommendation System**

```
-- Create index for user/item embeddings
CREATE VERTEX TYPE Product;
CREATE PROPERTY Product.embedding LIST OF FLOAT;
CREATE INDEX ON Product (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 128,
  "similarity": "COSINE"
};

-- Find the 20 most similar products for recommendations
SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Product[embedding]', $userPreferenceVector, 20))
```

For more information, see:

- Indexes
- CREATE INDEX
- vector.neighbors()

# 4.11. Java API (Remote)

ArcadeDB comes with a convenient Java library to work with a remote database.

### 4.11.1. RemoteServer Class

The RemoteServer class is used to manage remote server connections and databases.

The server administration calls (databases, users, groups and API tokens) prefer the cluster leader and wait out an election in progress. If the server becomes unreachable, they switch to another server of the cluster only when `arcadedb.network.sameServerErrorRetries` is greater than 0 (the default is 0). A write whose answer was lost is never sent again, because the server may already have applied it. `createApiToken` refuses to send the token over plain HTTP to a non-loopback host, whichever server the request is sent to, unless `setAllowInsecureApiTokenTransport(true)` is set.

### 4.11.2. RemoteDatabase Class

The RemoteDatabase class is used to work with a remote database instance.

Add the following dependencies in your Maven pom.xml file under the tag `<dependencies>`:

```
<dependency>
    <groupId>com.arcadedb</groupId>
    <artifactId>arcadedb-engine</artifactId>
    <version>26.10.1</version>
</dependency>
<dependency>
    <groupId>com.arcadedb</groupId>
    <artifactId>arcadedb-network</artifactId>
    <version>26.10.1</version>
</dependency>
```

### 4.11.3. 10-Minute Tutorial

#### Connect to a remote database

There are 2 main classes that handle the connection to the remote database by translating the Java API into http-calls:

- `RemoteServer`, to create new database on a remote server
- `RemoteDatabase`, to work with a remote database instance

We start by creating a RemoteServer:

```
RemoteServer server = new RemoteServer("localhost", 2480, "root", "playwithdata");
```

Next, let's create a RemoteDatabase instance pointing to the database "mydb" on ArcadeDB Server located on "localhost", port 2480 — the HTTP port, which is what `RemoteDatabase` speaks. User and passwords are respectively "root" and "playwithdata":

```
RemoteDatabase database = new RemoteDatabase("localhost", 2480, "mydb", "root",
```

```
"playwithdata");
```

The `RemoteDatabase` is not thread-safe. It holds a backend session. If a thread closes a transaction, it also closes the session, so that any request performed by a concurrent thread using the same RemoteDatabase instance leads to unexpected behavior. To avoid concurrency problems you should not hold RemoteDatabase instances as fields on the heap, but rather create a new instance in method scope as a variable on the stack.

### 4.11.4. RemoteImmutableVertex and RemoteMutableVertex

Vertices retrieved through `RemoteDatabase` are instances of `RemoteImmutableVertex` (or `RemoteMutableVertex` after calling `modify()`). These classes expose graph-traversal methods that translate directly into SQL queries over HTTP — there is no per-vertex round trip.

#### Traversal methods

| Method | Description |
|---|---|
| `getVertices(direction, edgeTypes…)` | Returns all neighbor vertices, transparently paginating in batches of `DEFAULT_PAGE_SIZE` (2,000) records per HTTP call. |
| `getVerticesPaged(direction, pageSize, edgeTypes…)` | Same as above but with an explicit page size. Use to tune round-trip vs. payload trade-off for supernodes. |
| `getVertices(direction, limit, skip, edgeTypes…)` | Returns a single page of up to `limit` neighbor vertices starting at offset `skip`. Useful for implementing your own pagination. |
| `getEdges(direction, edgeTypes…)` | Returns all connected edges, transparently paginating with `DEFAULT_PAGE_SIZE` per HTTP call. |
| `getEdgesPaged(direction, pageSize, edgeTypes…)` | Same as above but with an explicit page size. |
| `getEdges(direction, limit, skip, edgeTypes…)` | Returns a single page of up to `limit` edges starting at offset `skip`. |
| `countEdges(direction, edgeTypes…)` | Returns the number of connected edges (single HTTP call, no result materialization). |

`DEFAULT_PAGE_SIZE = 2_000` is the batch size used by `getVertices()` / `getEdges()`. Values up to 20,000 are safe against the server's default result limit.

#### Example

```
RemoteDatabase db = new RemoteDatabase("localhost", 2480, "mydb", "root",
"playwithdata");

// standard traversal -- paginates automatically, no cast needed
Vertex hub = db.lookupByRID(new RID(db, "#1:0"), true);
```

```
for (Vertex neighbor : hub.getVertices(Vertex.DIRECTION.OUT, "Knows")) {
    System.out.println(neighbor.getString("name"));
}

// supernode -- explicit page size requires cast to the concrete remote type
RemoteImmutableVertex hubRemote = (RemoteImmutableVertex) hub;
for (Vertex neighbor : hubRemote.getVerticesPaged(Vertex.DIRECTION.OUT, 5_000,
"Knows")) {
    System.out.println(neighbor.getString("name"));
}
```

Each page uses a `SKIP/LIMIT` SQL clause, so the edge list is re-scanned from the beginning on every page. For supernodes with millions of edges prefer a SQL query with a server-side `WHERE` filter to narrow results before fetching them.

The database, which name you have given as the third parameter in the constructor is not automatically created nor is it checked whether it exists. Before you use the `RemoteDatabase` make sure that the database exists, or, if it doesn't, create it:

```
if (!server.exists("mydb"))
    server.create();
```

For a list of all databases hosted by the server use:

```
List<String> databases = server.databases();
assert(databases.contains("mydb"));
```

Now that we have the database created we may create the schema (but we may also work without):

```
String schema =
"""
    create vertex type Customer if not exists;
    create property Customer.name if not exists string;
    create property Customer.surname if not exists string;
    create index if not exists on Customer (name, surname) unique;
""";
database.command("sqlscript", schema);
```

As language we have used `sqlscript`, which has the advantage that all the statements in the script are executed within one single transaction. Of course you can also send these requests line by line with `sql` as language. If you go line by line it is important to enclose the requests in a common transaction:

```
database.begin();
database.command("sql", "create vertex type Customer if not exists");
```

```
database.command("sql", "create property Customer.name if not exists string");
database.command("sql", "create property Customer.surname if not exists string");
database.command("sql", "create index if not exists on Customer (name, surname)
unique");
database.commit();
```

Or:

```
database.transaction(() -> {
    ...
});
```

The `transaction` method encloses the lambda function with a `begin` - `commit`, or a `rollback` in case of any exception.

If the transaction fails because another client modified the same records, it is rolled back and the lambda is executed again, up to `arcadedb.txRetries` times (3 by default). There is one exception: when `transaction(lambda, true)` is called from inside a transaction you opened yourself, the error is thrown to you instead of being retried, because re-executing the lambda inside your still open transaction would leave the effects of the failed attempt behind. In that case catch the exception and retry the whole unit of work.

The same happens when the server refuses the transaction before running it: the `503` a node answers while it installs a snapshot, a leader change, or a `begin` whose connection could not be established. Each retry waits first, with the exponential backoff the embedded `transaction()` uses (`arcadedb.txRetryDelayBase` doubling up to `arcadedb.txRetryDelay`), and when the refusal carries a `Retry-After` header the retry waits at least that long, up to `arcadedb.network.retryAfterMaxWait` (30 seconds by default). A duplicated key is retried only once, since failing twice means the duplicate is genuine. A commit the server answered with an error also releases the server-side session right away instead of leaving it to the session timeout. *(Since v26.10.1: before, the retries ran back to back, so a node installing a snapshot used up the whole budget within milliseconds.)*

A commit whose connection drops after the request was sent is different: the server may already have applied it. Over gRPC such a commit (status `UNAVAILABLE` with no error from the server) raises a `TransactionException` and is **not** retried, so the work is never applied twice. Read the data back to find out whether the commit landed. *(Since v26.10.1: before, it was reported as a retryable conflict.)*

A statement stopped on the server (by the `terminate query` server command, Cypher `TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS` or Studio) raises `com.arcadedb.exception.QueryTerminatedException`, over HTTP and over gRPC alike. It is not retried by `transaction()`: somebody asked for the work to stop. *(Since v26.11.1.)*

Now that the schema is in place, we will insert some data:

```
database.command("sql", "insert into Customer(name, surname) values(?, ?)", "Jay",
"Miner");
database.command("sql",
        "update Customer set lastcall = :lastcall where name = :name and surname =
```

```
:surname",
        Map.of("lastcall", Date.from(Instant.now()), "name", "Jay", "surname",
"Miner"));
```

The first command creates a new vertex of type 'Customer'. The second command updates this vertex by adding a new value for the property 'lastcall'. The first command uses unnamed parameters where the values are mapped by their order in the parameter list. Whereas the second command uses named parameters, which are mapped by the parameter names.

We can now query some customer data from our database:

```
ResultSet resultSet = database.query("sql", "select from Customer where name = :name",
        Map.of("name", "Jay"));
Map<String, Object> customer = resultSet.stream().findFirst().map(Result::toMap
).orElse(Map.of());
```

The query returns a `ResultSet`, which holds an array of objects of type `Result`, which can be read as Map:

```
{name=Jay, @cat=d, @rid=#1:0, lastcall=1675961747290, surname=Miner, @type=Customer}
```

# 4.12. Java API (gRPC)

ArcadeDB provides a high-performance gRPC-based Java library for remote database communication. gRPC (gRPC Remote Procedure Call) is a modern, open-source, high-performance RPC framework that can efficiently connect services in and across data centers.

## 4.12.1. Why Use gRPC for ArcadeDB?

gRPC offers several advantages over traditional HTTP-based communication:

- **High Performance**: gRPC uses HTTP/2 for transport, providing lower latency and higher throughput compared to traditional HTTP/1.1
- **Efficient Binary Protocol**: Uses Protocol Buffers for serialization, resulting in smaller message sizes and faster parsing
- **Streaming Support**: Built-in support for bidirectional streaming, ideal for real-time applications
- **Language Agnostic**: While this guide focuses on Java, gRPC supports multiple programming languages with consistent APIs
- **Low Latency**: Optimized for scenarios requiring minimal latency and maximum throughput
- **Connection Multiplexing**: Multiple requests can be sent over a single TCP connection

gRPC is particularly well-suited for:

- Real-time applications requiring fast data access
- Microservices architectures
- High-throughput data processing
- Mobile applications with limited bandwidth
- Services requiring bidirectional streaming

### 4.12.2. RemoteGrpcServer Class

The `RemoteGrpcServer` class manages connections to the gRPC server and provides server-level operations such as creating databases, listing available databases, and managing server resources.

Key features:

- Establishes and maintains the connection to the ArcadeDB gRPC server
- Handles authentication and security
- Provides methods for database lifecycle management
- Supports connection pooling and resource management

### 4.12.3. RemoteGrpcDatabase Class

The `RemoteGrpcDatabase` class is used to work with a specific remote database instance via gRPC. It provides methods for executing queries, commands, and transactions with optimal performance characteristics.

Key features:

- Execute SQL queries and commands
- Support for parameterized queries (both named and positional)
- Transaction management (begin, commit, rollback)
- Schema manipulation
- Data manipulation (insert, update, delete)
- High-performance data retrieval

### 4.12.4. Maven Dependencies

Add the following dependency in your Maven pom.xml file under the tag `<dependencies>`:

```
<dependency>
    <groupId>com.arcadedb</groupId>
    <artifactId>arcadedb-grpc-client</artifactId>
    <version>26.10.1</version>
</dependency>
```

The gRPC client dependency includes all necessary Protocol Buffer definitions and

> gRPC runtime libraries. No additional dependencies are required.

### 4.12.5. 10-Minute Tutorial

This tutorial will guide you through the essential operations using ArcadeDB's gRPC API, from establishing a connection to executing various types of database operations.

#### Connect to a gRPC Server

To begin working with ArcadeDB via gRPC, you need to establish a connection to the server. The gRPC API provides two main classes:

- `RemoteGrpcServer`, to manage server connections and create databases
- `RemoteGrpcDatabase`, to work with a specific remote database instance

The gRPC server listens on port 50051 by default (different from the HTTP port 2480).

#### Create a RemoteGrpcServer Instance

First, create a `RemoteGrpcServer` instance to connect to your ArcadeDB server:

```
RemoteGrpcServer server = new RemoteGrpcServer(
    "localhost",           // Server hostname
    50051,                 // gRPC port (default: 50051)
    "root",                // Username
    "password",            // Password
    false,                 // Use TLS/SSL (false for development)
    List.of()              // Additional channel credentials (if needed)
);
```

The constructor parameters are:

- `hostname`: The server hostname or IP address
- `port`: The gRPC port (typically 50051)
- `username`: Database user credentials
- `password`: User password
- `useTls`: Whether to use TLS/SSL encryption
- `channelCredentials`: Optional additional credentials for advanced security configurations

Before creating or accessing a database, you can check if it exists:

```
if (!server.exists("mydb")) {
    server.create("mydb");
    System.out.println("Database 'mydb' created successfully");
}
```

You can also list all available databases on the server:

```
List<String> databases = server.databases();
System.out.println("Available databases: " + databases);
```

#### Create a RemoteGrpcDatabase Instance

Once the server connection is established and the database exists, create a `RemoteGrpcDatabase` instance to interact with a specific database:

```
RemoteGrpcDatabase database = new RemoteGrpcDatabase(
    server,                 // RemoteGrpcServer instance
    "localhost",            // Server hostname
    50051,                  // gRPC port
    2480,                   // HTTP port (for fallback operations)
    "mydb",                 // Database name
    "root",                 // Username
    "password"              // Password
);
```

Like `RemoteDatabase`, the `RemoteGrpcDatabase` class is not thread-safe. Each thread should create its own instance. Avoid sharing `RemoteGrpcDatabase` instances across threads to prevent unexpected behavior.

Best practice for thread safety:

```
// Create database instance in method scope, not as a field
public void performDatabaseOperation() {
    try (RemoteGrpcDatabase database = new RemoteGrpcDatabase(
        server, "localhost", 50051, 2480, "mydb", "root", "password"
    )) {
        // Perform operations
        ResultSet results = database.query("sql", "SELECT * FROM MyType");
        // Process results...
    }
}
```

#### Create Schema with SQL Commands

With the database connection established, you can create your schema. The gRPC API supports both single SQL statements and SQL scripts:

```
// Using sqlscript for multiple statements in one transaction
String schema = """
    CREATE VERTEX TYPE Article IF NOT EXISTS;
    CREATE PROPERTY Article.id IF NOT EXISTS INTEGER;
```

```
    CREATE PROPERTY Article.title IF NOT EXISTS STRING;
    CREATE PROPERTY Article.content IF NOT EXISTS STRING;
    CREATE PROPERTY Article.published IF NOT EXISTS DATETIME;
    CREATE PROPERTY Article.author IF NOT EXISTS STRING;
    CREATE INDEX IF NOT EXISTS ON Article(id) UNIQUE;
    """;

database.command("sqlscript", schema);
System.out.println("Schema created successfully");
```

The `sqlscript` language is recommended for schema creation because:

- All statements execute within a single transaction
- Improved performance due to reduced network round-trips
- Atomic operations - either all succeed or all fail

Alternatively, you can execute statements individually:

```
database.begin();
try {
    database.command("sql", "CREATE VERTEX TYPE Article IF NOT EXISTS");
    database.command("sql", "CREATE PROPERTY Article.id IF NOT EXISTS INTEGER");
    database.command("sql", "CREATE PROPERTY Article.title IF NOT EXISTS STRING");
    database.command("sql", "CREATE INDEX IF NOT EXISTS ON Article(id) UNIQUE");
    database.commit();
    System.out.println("Schema created successfully");
} catch (Exception e) {
    database.rollback();
    System.err.println("Schema creation failed: " + e.getMessage());
}
```

#### Execute Queries

The gRPC API provides optimized query execution with support for both simple and parameterized queries:

```
// Simple query
ResultSet resultSet = database.query("sql", "SELECT * FROM Article");

// Process results
while (resultSet.hasNext()) {
    Result result = resultSet.next();
    System.out.println("Article: " + result.toMap());
}
```

Using parameterized queries (recommended for security and performance):

```
// Named parameters
ResultSet resultSet = database.query(
    "sql",
    "SELECT * FROM Article WHERE author = :author AND published > :date",
    Map.of(
        "author", "John Doe",
        "date", LocalDateTime.now().minusDays(30)
    )
);

// Positional parameters
ResultSet resultSet2 = database.query(
    "sql",
    "SELECT * FROM Article WHERE id = ? AND published = ?",
    1,
    LocalDateTime.now()
);
```

Working with query results:

```
// Convert results to a list of maps
List<Map<String, Object>> articles = database.query("sql", "SELECT * FROM Article")
    .stream()
    .map(Result::toMap)
    .collect(Collectors.toList());

// Find first result
Optional<Map<String, Object>> firstArticle = database.query(
        "sql",
        "SELECT * FROM Article WHERE id = :id",
        Map.of("id", 1)
    )
    .stream()
    .findFirst()
    .map(Result::toMap);

if (firstArticle.isPresent()) {
    System.out.println("Found article: " + firstArticle.get());
}
```

#### Update Data

Updating existing records is straightforward with the gRPC API:

```
// Simple update with positional parameters
database.command(
    "sql",
    "UPDATE Article SET title = ? WHERE id = ?",
```

```
    "Updated Article Title",
    3
);

// Update with named parameters
database.command(
    "sql",
    "UPDATE Article SET title = :title, content = :content WHERE id = :id",
    Map.of(
        "title", "Understanding gRPC in ArcadeDB",
        "content", "gRPC provides high-performance communication...",
        "id", 3
    )
);

// Update with complex expressions
database.command(
    "sql",
    "UPDATE Article SET published = :now, views = views + 1 WHERE id = :id",
    Map.of(
        "now", LocalDateTime.now(),
        "id", 3
    )
);
```

Batch updates using transactions:

```
database.transaction(() -> {
    List<Integer> articleIds = List.of(1, 2, 3, 4, 5);

    for (Integer id : articleIds) {
        database.command(
            "sql",
            "UPDATE Article SET views = views + 1 WHERE id = ?",
            id
        );
    }

    System.out.println("Updated " + articleIds.size() + " articles");
});
```

#### Insert Data

The gRPC API supports multiple approaches for inserting data:

```
// Traditional INSERT with values
database.command(
    "sql",
    "INSERT INTO Article (id, title, author, published) VALUES (?, ?, ?, ?)",
```

```
    1,
    "Getting Started with ArcadeDB",
    "Jane Smith",
    LocalDateTime.now()
);

// INSERT with named parameters
database.command(
    "sql",
    "INSERT INTO Article (id, title, author, published) VALUES (:id, :title, :author,
:published)",
    Map.of(
        "id", 2,
        "title", "Advanced Query Techniques",
        "author", "John Doe",
        "published", LocalDateTime.now()
    )
);
```

Using JSON content for complex documents:

```
// INSERT with JSON CONTENT
String jsonContent = """
    {
        "id": 3,
        "title": "gRPC Performance Guide",
        "content": "Learn how to optimize your gRPC implementations...",
        "author": "Alice Johnson",
        "published": "2024-03-15T10:30:00",
        "tags": ["performance", "gRPC", "optimization"],
        "metadata": {
            "category": "Tutorial",
            "difficulty": "Intermediate"
        }
    }
    """;

database.command("sql", "INSERT INTO Article CONTENT " + jsonContent);
```

Bulk insert operations:

```
database.transaction(() -> {
    List<Map<String, Object>> articles = List.of(
        Map.of("id", 10, "title", "Article 10", "author", "Author A"),
        Map.of("id", 11, "title", "Article 11", "author", "Author B"),
        Map.of("id", 12, "title", "Article 12", "author", "Author C")
    );

    for (Map<String, Object> article : articles) {
```

```
        database.command(
            "sql",
            "INSERT INTO Article (id, title, author) VALUES (:id, :title, :author)",
            article
        );
    }

    System.out.println("Inserted " + articles.size() + " articles");
});
```

#### Create Vertices with RETURN Clause

When creating vertices, you often need to retrieve the created record's RID (Record ID) or other properties. The RETURN clause makes this efficient:

```
// Create vertex and return the new record
ResultSet result = database.command(
    "sql",
    "CREATE VERTEX Article SET id = ?, title = ?, author = ? RETURN @this",
    100,
    "Real-time Data Processing",
    "Bob Wilson"
);

// Get the created vertex
if (result.hasNext()) {
    Result vertex = result.next();
    String rid = vertex.getIdentity().toString();
    System.out.println("Created vertex with RID: " + rid);
    System.out.println("Vertex data: " + vertex.toMap());
}
```

Return specific properties:

```
// Return only the RID
ResultSet result = database.command(
    "sql",
    "CREATE VERTEX Article SET id = :id, title = :title RETURN @rid",
    Map.of(
        "id", 101,
        "title", "Graph Traversal Patterns"
    )
);

if (result.hasNext()) {
    Result vertex = result.next();
    System.out.println("New vertex RID: " + vertex.getProperty("@rid"));
}
```

```
// Return multiple properties
ResultSet result2 = database.command(
    "sql",
    "CREATE VERTEX Article SET id = :id, title = :title, published = :now " +
    "RETURN @rid, id, title",
    Map.of(
        "id", 102,
        "title", "Distributed Database Architecture",
        "now", LocalDateTime.now()
    )
);
```

Creating edges between vertices:

```
// Create vertices
ResultSet author = database.command(
    "sql",
    "CREATE VERTEX Author SET name = ? RETURN @rid",
    "Emily Davis"
);

if (author.hasNext()) {
    String authorRid = author.next().getProperty("@rid").toString();

    ResultSet article = database.command(
        "sql",
        "CREATE VERTEX Article SET title = ? RETURN @rid",
        "Mastering Graph Databases"
    );

    if (article.hasNext()) {
        String articleRid = article.next().getProperty("@rid").toString();

        // Create edge connecting them
        database.command(
            "sql",
            "CREATE EDGE Authored FROM ? TO ?",
            authorRid,
            articleRid
        );

        System.out.println("Created relationship between author and article");
    } else {
        System.err.println("Failed to create article, no RID returned.");
    }
} else {
    System.err.println("Failed to create author, no RID returned.");
}
```

### 4.12.6. Transaction Management

The gRPC API provides comprehensive transaction support for ensuring data consistency:

```
// Explicit transaction control
database.begin();
try {
    database.command("sql", "CREATE VERTEX Article SET id = 200");
    database.command("sql", "CREATE VERTEX Article SET id = 201");
    database.commit();
    System.out.println("Transaction committed successfully");
} catch (Exception e) {
    database.rollback();
    System.err.println("Transaction rolled back due to error: " + e.getMessage());
}

// Using transaction lambda (recommended)
database.transaction(() -> {
    database.command("sql", "CREATE VERTEX Article SET id = 300");
    database.command("sql", "CREATE VERTEX Article SET id = 301");
    // Automatically commits if no exception, rolls back on exception
});
```

### 4.12.7. Error Handling

Proper error handling is essential for robust applications:

```
try {
    RemoteGrpcDatabase database = new RemoteGrpcDatabase(
        server, "localhost", 50051, 2480, "mydb", "root", "password"
    );

    ResultSet results = database.query("sql", "SELECT * FROM Article");
    // Process results...

} catch (SecurityException e) {
    System.err.println("Authentication failed: " + e.getMessage());
} catch (DatabaseOperationException e) {
    System.err.println("Database operation failed: " + e.getMessage());
} catch (Exception e) {
    System.err.println("Unexpected error: " + e.getMessage());
    e.printStackTrace();
}
```

Since 26.11.1 a statement stopped on the server (by `terminate query`, Cypher `TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS` or Studio) raises `com.arcadedb.exception.QueryTerminatedException`. It is not a transient error and is never retried. Cancelling a call, or letting its deadline expire, also stops the server-side work. See Cancellation and running statements.

### 4.12.8. Performance Tips

To get the best performance from the gRPC API:

1. **Use Connection Pooling**: Create a single `RemoteGrpcServer` instance and reuse it across your application
2. **Batch Operations**: Group multiple operations in transactions to reduce network round-trips
3. **Parameterized Queries**: Always use parameterized queries for better performance and security
4. **Use sqlscript**: For multiple statements, use `sqlscript` to execute them in a single transaction
5. **Close Resources**: Ensure proper cleanup of database instances, especially in multi-threaded environments
6. **Stream Results**: For large result sets, process results as you iterate rather than loading everything into memory
7. **Enable TLS in Production**: Use TLS/SSL in production for security without significant performance impact

### 4.12.9. Complete Example

Here's a complete example demonstrating the gRPC API usage:

```
import com.arcadedb.remote.grpc.RemoteGrpcServer;
import com.arcadedb.remote.grpc.RemoteGrpcDatabase;
import com.arcadedb.query.sql.executor.Result;
import com.arcadedb.query.sql.executor.ResultSet;

import java.time.LocalDateTime;
import java.util.List;
import java.util.Map;

public class ArcadeDBGrpcExample {
    public static void main(String[] args) {
        // Connect to gRPC server
        try (RemoteGrpcServer server = new RemoteGrpcServer(
            "localhost", 50051, "root", "password", false, List.of()
        )) {
            // Create database if it doesn't exist
            if (!server.exists("mydb")) {
                server.create("mydb");
            }

            // Create database instance
            try (RemoteGrpcDatabase database = new RemoteGrpcDatabase(
                server, "localhost", 50051, 2480, "mydb", "root", "password"
            )) {
                // Create schema
                String schema = """
```

```
                    CREATE VERTEX TYPE Article IF NOT EXISTS;
                    CREATE PROPERTY Article.id IF NOT EXISTS INTEGER;
                    CREATE PROPERTY Article.title IF NOT EXISTS STRING;
                    CREATE PROPERTY Article.author IF NOT EXISTS STRING;
                    CREATE INDEX IF NOT EXISTS ON Article(id) UNIQUE;
                    """;
                database.command("sqlscript", schema);

                // Insert data
                database.transaction(() -> {
                    database.command(
                        "sql",
                        "INSERT INTO Article (id, title, author, published) VALUES
(:id, :title, :author, :published)",
                        Map.of(
                            "id", 1,
                            "title", "Introduction to gRPC",
                            "author", "Jane Doe",
                            "published", LocalDateTime.now()
                        )
                    );
                });

                // Query data
                ResultSet results = database.query(
                    "sql",
                    "SELECT * FROM Article WHERE author = :author",
                    Map.of("author", "Jane Doe")
                );

                // Process results
                results.stream()
                    .map(Result::toMap)
                    .forEach(article ->
                        System.out.println("Article: " + article.get("title"))
                    );

                System.out.println("gRPC API example completed successfully");
            }
        }
    }
}
```

### 4.12.10. See Also

- Java API (Remote) - HTTP-based remote API
- Java API (Local) - Embedded database API
- Java API Reference - Complete API documentation

## 4.13. JDBC Driver

If you're using Java you can use the Postgres JDBC driver. This means the Postgres Plugin needs to be loaded by the server.

```
Class.forName("org.postgresql.Driver");

Properties props = new Properties();
props.setProperty("user", "user");
props.setProperty("password", "password");
props.setProperty("ssl", "false");

try (Connection conn = DriverManager.getConnection("jdbc:postgresql://localhost/mydb",
props) ) {
  try (Statement st = conn.createStatement()) {
    st.executeQuery("create vertex type Hero");
    st.executeQuery("create vertex Hero set name = 'Jay', lastName = 'Miner'");

    PreparedStatement pst = conn.prepareStatement("create vertex Hero set name = ?,
lastName = ?");
    pst.setString(1, "Rocky");
    pst.setString(2, "Balboa");
    pst.execute();
    pst.close();

    try( ResultSet rs = st.executeQuery("SELECT * FROM Hero") ) { // Type and property
names are case sensitive!
      while (rs.next()) {
        System.out.println("First Name: " + rs.getString(1) + " - Last Name: " + rs
.getString(2));
      }
    }
  }
}
```

## 4.14. Neo4j BOLT Protocol

ArcadeDB Server supports the Neo4j BOLT protocol, enabling connectivity from any BOLT-compatible client or driver. This allows you to use the official Neo4j drivers with ArcadeDB, leveraging the native OpenCypher query engine for graph operations.

The BOLT implementation is certified against all five official Neo4j drivers (Java, JavaScript, Python, .NET, and Go) through a shared conformance spec. See the Driver Compatibility Matrix for the exact, per-driver certification status.

The BOLT protocol implementation supports:

- **BOLT v3.0, v4.0, v4.4, and v5.0–v5.4** protocol versions, negotiated automatically with the client

- **Full Cypher query support** via ArcadeDB's native OpenCypher implementation
- **Parameterized queries** for security and performance
- **TLS/SSL** encrypted connections (`bolt+s://`, `neo4j+s://`)
- **Explicit and managed transactions**, including automatic retry on transient errors
- **Bookmarks** for causal consistency across sessions
- **Multi-database support** with database selection per session
- **HA-aware routing** so `neo4j://` discovery reflects the actual cluster topology
- **Native BOLT structures** for graph (Node, Relationship, Path), temporal, `Duration`, and spatial `Point` values
- **Multi-label vertices** following Neo4j's node labeling conventions

### 4.14.1. Choosing a protocol for low latency

For single-row reads and writes from Python on the same host, a community measurement (ArcadeDB 26.10.1, loopback, one connection) ranked the options as follows, relative to HTTP with a persistent connection (lower is faster):

| Route | One-row Cypher read |
|---|---|
| PostgreSQL wire with the `{cypher}` prefix (psycopg 3) | ~0.5x |
| HTTP with a persistent connection (`http.client`) | 1x |
| gRPC | ~1.1x |
| BOLT (`neo4j` Python driver) | ~1.6x |
| HTTP through `requests.Session` | ~4x |

Most of the difference is client-side cost in the Python drivers, so treat the numbers as a guide and measure your own workload. The PostgreSQL wire uses positional parameters (`$1`, `$2`) for Cypher. Reuse connections and sessions on every route: opening one per request dominates the latency.

BOLT sends the records of a `PULL` batched in a few large network writes, so a slow, long-running query shows its first rows when a batch fills or the `PULL` ends. Drivers fetch in batches (1000 records by default), which makes this invisible in normal use.

### 4.14.2. Setup

If you're using ArcadeDB as embedded, add the dependency to the `arcadedb-bolt` library. If you're using Maven, include this dependency in your `pom.xml` file:

```
<dependency>
    <groupId>com.arcadedb</groupId>
    <artifactId>arcadedb-bolt</artifactId>
    <version>26.10.1</version>
</dependency>
```

To start the BOLT plugin, enlist it in the `server.plugins` settings. To specify multiple plugins, use the comma `,` as separator. Example:

```
~/arcadedb $ bin/server.sh -Darcadedb.server.plugins
="Bolt:com.arcadedb.bolt.BoltProtocolPlugin"
```

If you're using MS Windows OS, replace `server.sh` with `server.bat`.

In case you're running ArcadeDB with Docker, use `-e` to pass settings and open the BOLT default port `7687`:

```
docker run --rm -p 2480:2480 -p 7687:7687 \
       --env ARCADEDB_SETTINGS="-Darcadedb.server.rootPassword=playwithdata \
          -Darcadedb.server.plugins=Bolt:com.arcadedb.bolt.BoltProtocolPlugin " \
          arcadedata/arcadedb:latest
```

The Server output will contain this line:

```
INFO  [ArcadeDBServer] - Bolt Protocol plugin started (host=0.0.0.0 port=7687)
```

### 4.14.3. Configuration

The BOLT plugin supports the following configuration options:

| Setting | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `arcadedb.bolt.port` | 7687 | TCP/IP port for BOLT connections |
| `arcadedb.bolt.host` | 0.0.0.0 | Host/IP address to bind to. A name that resolves to several local addresses, such as `localhost` (`127.0.0.1` and `::1`), is bound on every one of them; a port held on any of them is skipped |
| `arcadedb.bolt.defaultDatabase` | (none) | Default database when not specified by the client; if unset, the first database the user has access to is used |
| `arcadedb.bolt.maxConnections` | 0 | Maximum concurrent connections (0 = unlimited) |
| `arcadedb.bolt.ssl` | DISABLED | TLS mode for BOLT connections: `DISABLED`, `OPTIONAL`, or `REQUIRED` (see TLS/SSL) |
| `arcadedb.bolt.routing.ttl` | 300 | Time-to-live in seconds for routing table entries returned to `neo4j://` clients |
| `arcadedb.bolt.maxOpenStreams` | 1024 | Maximum number of result streams one connection may keep open at the same time (see Transactions) |

| Setting | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `arcadedb.bolt.debug` | false | Enable BOLT protocol debug logging |

Example configuration:

```
bin/server.sh -Darcadedb.server.plugins="Bolt:com.arcadedb.bolt.BoltProtocolPlugin" \
              -Darcadedb.bolt.port=7687 \
              -Darcadedb.bolt.defaultDatabase=mydatabase
```

### 4.14.4. Access Control

A BOLT connection can only use the databases its user has access to, as with every other ArcadeDB protocol:

- Selecting a database the user has no access to (in the session, `RUN` or `BEGIN`) fails with `Neo.ClientError.Security.Forbidden`. The same error is returned for a database that does not exist, so a user cannot discover which databases the server hosts. The default database is checked the same way.
- `SHOW DATABASES` lists only the databases the user has access to (plus the virtual `system` entry).
- `SHOW INDEXES`, `SHOW CONSTRAINTS`, `CALL db.labels()`, `db.relationshipTypes()`, `db.propertyKeys()` and `db.schema.visualization()` hide the types the user is not allowed to read.

*(Since v26.10.1; before, these commands were not filtered by the user's permissions.)*

### 4.14.5. TLS/SSL

The BOLT plugin supports encrypted connections. Set `arcadedb.bolt.ssl` to one of:

| Mode | Behavior |
|---|---|
| `DISABLED` | (default) plaintext only. Clients connect with `bolt://` / `neo4j://` and encryption off. |
| `OPTIONAL` | the server auto-detects the connection: a TLS handshake is served encrypted, a plaintext connection is served in the clear. Useful during migration. |
| `REQUIRED` | only encrypted connections are accepted. Clients must use `bolt+s://` / `neo4j+s://`. |

When TLS is enabled (`OPTIONAL` or `REQUIRED`), the plugin reuses the server's shared HTTPS keystore and truststore. Configure them with the standard network settings:

```
bin/server.sh -Darcadedb.server.plugins="Bolt:com.arcadedb.bolt.BoltProtocolPlugin" \
              -Darcadedb.bolt.ssl=REQUIRED \
              -Darcadedb.network.ssl.keyStore=/path/to/keystore.p12 \
              -Darcadedb.network.ssl.keyStorePassword=secret \
              -Darcadedb.network.ssl.trustStore=/path/to/truststore.jks \
```

```
-Darcadedb.network.ssl.trustStorePassword=secret
```

The keystore defaults to PKCS12 and the truststore to JKS. Connect from a driver using the `bolt+s://` (or `neo4j+s://` for routing) scheme.

### 4.14.6. Server Identity and Feature Envelope

Neo4j drivers gate feature negotiation off the server identity they receive during the initial handshake. ArcadeDB deliberately advertises a Neo4j-compatible identity so that the official drivers enable the correct feature set:

- In the `HELLO`/`SUCCESS` response the server reports itself as `Neo4j/5.26.0 compatible (ArcadeDB <version>)`.
- `CALL dbms.components()` returns `Neo4j Kernel`, version `5.26.0`, edition `community`.

This advertised identity is the contract against which every certification result is measured: it declares the Neo4j 5.26-era feature envelope the drivers may assume. The following capabilities are **certified as working** against the official drivers:

- Protocol negotiation for BOLT 3.0/4.0/4.4 and 5.0–5.4.
- Basic authentication.
- Autocommit, explicit (`BEGIN`/`COMMIT`/`ROLLBACK`), and managed transactions with retry-on-transient.
- Bookmarks (causal consistency) and per-session database selection.
- Streaming (`PULL`/`DISCARD`) with accurate result-summary counters.
- Native BOLT structures for Node, Relationship, Path, temporal types, `Duration`, spatial `Point`, byte arrays, and nested lists/maps.
- Structured `Neo.ClientError.` and `Neo.TransientError.` error codes.
- HA-aware `neo4j://` routing.

Explicit, documented differences from a real Neo4j server (never silent omissions):

- The `none` authentication scheme is **intentionally rejected** — ArcadeDB always requires credentials.
- `RID` and `UUID` values are serialized as strings (there is no native BOLT type for them).
- `BigDecimal` and out-of-range `BigInteger` values are down-converted to `double`, which may lose precision.
- Aura and enterprise-clustering-specific driver behaviors are out of scope.
- The advertised `server_agent` version (`5.26.0`) is a fixed, deliberate choice; changing it is a compatibility-affecting decision.

### 4.14.7. Compatible Drivers

The Neo4j official drivers are open source and licensed under Apache 2.0. You can use them with ArcadeDB's BOLT protocol implementation:

| Language | Driver | Installation |
|---|---|---|
| Java | neo4j-java-driver | Maven: `org.neo4j.driver:neo4j-java-driver` |
| Python | neo4j | `pip install neo4j` |
| JavaScript | neo4j-driver | `npm install neo4j-driver` |
| .NET | Neo4j.Driver | NuGet: `Neo4j.Driver` |
| Go | neo4j-go-driver | `go get github.com/neo4j/neo4j-go-driver/v5` |

Each driver is certified across a pinned version range that is re-tested nightly against driver-side releases. The exact versions are tracked in the driver-version matrix; see the Driver Compatibility Matrix for per-scenario results.

For the complete list of community drivers, check the Neo4j Driver documentation.

### 4.14.8. Connection URI Schemes

| Scheme | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `bolt://` | Direct connection to a single server, plaintext. |
| `bolt+s://` | Direct connection to a single server, TLS-encrypted. |
| `neo4j://` | Routing/discovery connection — the driver asks the server for the cluster routing table (HA-aware). |
| `neo4j+s://` | Routing/discovery connection, TLS-encrypted. |

### 4.14.9. Java Example

```
import org.neo4j.driver.*;

// Create driver (without encryption for local development)
Driver driver = GraphDatabase.driver(
    "bolt://localhost:7687",
    AuthTokens.basic("root", "playwithdata"),
    Config.builder().withoutEncryption().build()
);

// Open session for specific database
try (Session session = driver.session(SessionConfig.forDatabase("mydatabase"))) {

    // Execute a simple query
    Result result = session.run("MATCH (n:Person) RETURN n.name AS name LIMIT 10");
    while (result.hasNext()) {
        Record record = result.next();
        System.out.println(record.get("name").asString());
    }
```

```
    // Execute parameterized query
    Result paramResult = session.run(
        "MATCH (p:Person) WHERE p.age >= $minAge RETURN p.name, p.age",
        Values.parameters("minAge", 25)
    );

    // Execute in explicit transaction
    try (Transaction tx = session.beginTransaction()) {
        tx.run("CREATE (n:Person {name: $name, age: $age})",
               Values.parameters("name", "Alice", "age", 30));
        tx.run("CREATE (n:Person {name: $name, age: $age})",
               Values.parameters("name", "Bob", "age", 25));
        tx.commit();
    }
}

driver.close();
```

### 4.14.10. Python Example

```
from neo4j import GraphDatabase

# Create driver
driver = GraphDatabase.driver(
    "bolt://localhost:7687",
    auth=("root", "playwithdata")
)

# Query example
with driver.session(database="mydatabase") as session:
    # Simple query
    result = session.run("MATCH (n:Person) RETURN n.name AS name LIMIT 10")
    for record in result:
        print(record["name"])

    # Parameterized query
    result = session.run(
        "MATCH (p:Person) WHERE p.age >= $minAge RETURN p.name, p.age",
        minAge=25
    )

    # Explicit transaction
    with session.begin_transaction() as tx:
        tx.run("CREATE (n:Person {name: $name, age: $age})", name="Alice", age=30)
        tx.run("CREATE (n:Person {name: $name, age: $age})", name="Bob", age=25)
        tx.commit()

driver.close()
```

### 4.14.11. JavaScript Example

```
const neo4j = require('neo4j-driver');

// Create driver
const driver = neo4j.driver(
    'bolt://localhost:7687',
    neo4j.auth.basic('root', 'playwithdata')
);

// Query example
const session = driver.session({ database: 'mydatabase' });

try {
    // Simple query
    const result = await session.run('MATCH (n:Person) RETURN n.name AS name LIMIT 10
');
    result.records.forEach(record => {
        console.log(record.get('name'));
    });

    // Parameterized query
    const paramResult = await session.run(
        'MATCH (p:Person) WHERE p.age >= $minAge RETURN p.name, p.age',
        { minAge: 25 }
    );

    // Explicit transaction
    const tx = session.beginTransaction();
    await tx.run('CREATE (n:Person {name: $name, age: $age})', { name: 'Alice', age:
30 });
    await tx.run('CREATE (n:Person {name: $name, age: $age})', { name: 'Bob', age: 25
});
    await tx.commit();

} finally {
    await session.close();
    await driver.close();
}
```

### 4.14.12. Go Example

```
package main

import (
    "context"
    "fmt"

    "github.com/neo4j/neo4j-go-driver/v5/neo4j"
```

```
)

func main() {
    ctx := context.Background()

    // Create driver (empty realm string for basic auth)
    driver, err := neo4j.NewDriverWithContext(
        "bolt://localhost:7687",
        neo4j.BasicAuth("root", "playwithdata", ""),
    )
    if err != nil {
        panic(err)
    }
    defer driver.Close(ctx)

    session := driver.NewSession(ctx, neo4j.SessionConfig{DatabaseName: "mydatabase"})
    defer session.Close(ctx)

    // Simple query
    result, err := session.Run(ctx,
        "MATCH (n:Person) RETURN n.name AS name LIMIT 10", nil)
    if err != nil {
        panic(err)
    }
    for result.Next(ctx) {
        fmt.Println(result.Record().AsMap()["name"])
    }

    // Managed write transaction with automatic retry on transient errors
    _, err = session.ExecuteWrite(ctx, func(tx neo4j.ManagedTransaction) (any, error)
{
        return tx.Run(ctx,
            "CREATE (n:Person {name: $name, age: $age})",
            map[string]any{"name": "Alice", "age": 30})
    })
    if err != nil {
        panic(err)
    }
}
```

### 4.14.13. Cypher Query Examples

Since BOLT protocol uses Cypher as its query language, you can execute any query supported by ArcadeDB's OpenCypher implementation:

```
// Create vertices
CREATE (alice:Person {name: 'Alice', age: 30})
CREATE (bob:Person {name: 'Bob', age: 25})
```

```
// Create relationship
MATCH (a:Person {name: 'Alice'}), (b:Person {name: 'Bob'})
CREATE (a)-[:KNOWS {since: 2020}]->(b)

// Query with pattern matching
MATCH (p:Person)-[:KNOWS]->(friend)
WHERE p.age > 20
RETURN p.name, friend.name

// Variable-length paths
MATCH path = (start:Person)-[:KNOWS*1..3]->(end:Person)
RETURN path

// Aggregations
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN avg(p.age) AS averageAge, count(p) AS totalPeople
```

### 4.14.14. Transactions

The BOLT protocol supports three transaction styles:

- **Auto-commit mode**: single queries run outside a transaction are automatically committed.
- **Explicit transactions**: use `BEGIN`/`COMMIT`/`ROLLBACK` for multi-statement transactions. Transactions are automatically rolled back if an error occurs.
- **Managed transactions**: the driver's `executeRead`/`executeWrite` transaction functions run your work in a retried transaction. If the server returns a `Neo.TransientError.*` (for example, a write-write conflict), the driver **automatically retries** the transaction function. Prefer this style for write paths that may contend.

```
// Auto-commit (implicit transaction)
session.run("CREATE (n:Person {name: 'Charlie'})");

// Explicit transaction with multiple operations
try (Transaction tx = session.beginTransaction()) {
    tx.run("CREATE (a:Person {name: 'David'})");
    tx.run("CREATE (b:Person {name: 'Eve'})");
    tx.run("MATCH (a:Person {name: 'David'}), (b:Person {name: 'Eve'}) CREATE (a)-
[:FRIENDS]->(b)");
    tx.commit();
}

// Managed transaction — retried automatically on a transient error
session.executeWrite(tx -> {
    tx.run("CREATE (n:Person {name: $name})", Values.parameters("name", "Grace"));
    return null;
});
```

Inside an explicit transaction you can run a second query before you have finished reading the

results of the first one. This happens on its own whenever the driver's fetch size is smaller than the number of rows the first query returns, because the driver then keeps that result open while your code moves on:

```
// Driver configured with Config.builder().withFetchSize(1)
try (Transaction tx = session.beginTransaction()) {
    Result people = tx.run("MATCH (p:Person) RETURN p");
    people.next();                              // the first result is still open

    tx.run("MATCH (c:Company) RETURN c").consume();  // a second query in the same
transaction

    while (people.hasNext()) people.next();       // finish reading the first one
    tx.commit();
}
```

Each open result holds server-side resources until you read it to the end or discard it, so a single connection may keep at most `arcadedb.bolt.maxOpenStreams` of them open at once (1024 by default, far more than any driver uses).

### 4.14.15. Listing and terminating running statements

Since v26.11.1 the statements a Bolt client runs are listed and can be stopped like the ones of every other protocol: by Neo4j's own `SHOW TRANSACTIONS` and `TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS`, sent over Bolt as any other Cypher statement, or by the HTTP `list queries` and `terminate query` server commands. A statement appears with `protocol bolt` and `connectionId bolt-<n>` from its `RUN` until its result has been read to the end or discarded, so a result the client leaves open keeps it listed.

```
try (Session admin = driver.session(SessionConfig.forDatabase("mydatabase"))) {
    for (Record row : admin.run("SHOW TRANSACTIONS YIELD transactionId, username,
currentQuery, elapsedTime").list())
        System.out.println(row);

    admin.run("TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS $ids", Values.parameters("ids", List.of("q118-
5e1f0a9c"))).consume();
}
```

The terminated statement fails with `Neo.ClientError.Transaction.Terminated`, which drivers do not retry, not even in a managed transaction. A statement terminated inside an explicit transaction fails the transaction: it is rolled back, as after any other failure in it.

### 4.14.16. Causal Consistency (Bookmarks)

Bookmarks let a client guarantee it reads its own (or another session's) writes. Capture the bookmarks from one session and pass them to the next; the server will not serve the follow-up read until it has caught up to that bookmark. This works across sessions and is exercised by the certification suite.

```
Bookmark bookmark;
try (Session write = driver.session(SessionConfig.forDatabase("mydatabase"))) {
    write.run("CREATE (n:Person {name: 'Heidi'})").consume();
    bookmark = write.lastBookmark();
}

// A later session reads with the bookmark to observe the write
try (Session read = driver.session(SessionConfig.builder()
        .withDatabase("mydatabase")
        .withBookmarks(bookmark)
        .build())) {
    read.run("MATCH (n:Person {name: 'Heidi'}) RETURN n").list();
}
```

### 4.14.17. Data Type Mapping

ArcadeDB emits native BOLT/PackStream structures for the following, so drivers receive typed objects (not strings):

| Category | Types |
|---|---|
| Graph | Node, Relationship, Path |
| Temporal | `Date`, `Time`, `LocalTime`, `DateTime`, `LocalDateTime` (DateTime uses the UTC encoding on BOLT 5.0+, legacy encoding on 4.x) |
| Other structured | `Duration`, spatial `Point` (2D/3D), byte arrays, nested lists and maps, null |

Values without a native BOLT type — `RID` and `UUID` — are serialized as strings. `BigDecimal` and out-of-range `BigInteger` values are converted to `double` and may lose precision.

Temporal values (`Date`, `Time`, `LocalTime`, `DateTime`, `LocalDateTime`) are carried as native PackStream temporal structures in **both** directions. Read them with the driver's native temporal accessors — e.g. `Value.asZonedDateTime()` or `Value.asLocalDate()` — exactly as you would against Neo4j.

### 4.14.18. Error Codes

Server errors are mapped to Neo4j-style structured status codes so driver-side error handling and retry logic behave as expected:

| Code | Raised when |
|---|---|
| `Neo.ClientError.Security.Unauthorized` | authentication failed or credentials were missing |
| `Neo.ClientError.Security.Forbidden` | an operation is not permitted for the user, including selecting a database the user has no access to (see Access Control) |
| `Neo.ClientError.Statement.SyntaxError` | the Cypher statement failed to parse |

| Code | Raised when |
| --- | --- |
| `Neo.ClientError.Statement.SemanticError` | the statement parsed but is semantically invalid |
| `Neo.ClientError.Statement.TypeError` | a value cannot be stored in a property — a map, or a list containing one. See Map-Valued Properties |
| `Neo.ClientError.Transaction.TransactionNotFound` | a transaction reference is unknown |
| `Neo.ClientError.Schema.ConstraintValidationFailed` | a unique-index (constraint) violation — this is permanent, so drivers should not retry |
| `Neo.ClientError.Transaction.TransactionTimedOut` | a query or transaction ran out of time |
| `Neo.ClientError.Transaction.Terminated` | the statement was stopped by `TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS`, `terminate query` or a terminate from Studio; drivers do not retry it (see Listing and terminating running statements). Since v26.11.1 |
| `Neo.ClientError.Request.Invalid` | a malformed or out-of-sequence protocol message |
| `Neo.TransientError.Transaction.DeadlockDetected` | a concurrent-modification / lock-timeout conflict — drivers retry managed transactions on this code |
| `Neo.DatabaseError.General.UnknownError` | an unexpected server-side failure |

In `production` server mode the message of a `FAILURE` raised by the engine (a duplicated key, a syntax error, a failed commit) is replaced by "The request failed. Check the server log for the details", and the detail is written to the server log. The status code is kept, so driver-side error handling and retries are unchanged. Text Bolt writes itself about the request, such as the database name of a failed database selection, stays visible. Before v26.11.1 the message was sent as is in every mode. See Error details in production mode.

### 4.14.19. Routing and High Availability

`neo4j://` clients ask the server for a routing table. The response is HA-aware:

- **Single-node deployment**: the node advertises itself for all roles (WRITE, READ, ROUTE).
- **HA cluster with a known leader**: the leader is returned as WRITE + ROUTE and the followers as READ + ROUTE, so driver-side load balancing works.
- **HA cluster mid-election** (leader unknown): the node is advertised as READ + ROUTE only, never WRITE, until a leader is elected.

The routing table's time-to-live is controlled by `arcadedb.bolt.routing.ttl` (default 300 s).

For clusters where nodes expose the BOLT port on **different** ports, each node's client-reachable BOLT address must be declared using the object form of `arcadedb.ha.serverList` (`host:{raft:..,http:..,bolt:..}`). When omitted, each peer's BOLT address is derived from its Raft host plus this node's BOLT port, which

> is correct only for homogeneous deployments (for example, a Kubernetes StatefulSet).
>
> When the derived addresses cannot tell two peers apart - nodes that share a host and differ only by port - no routing table is advertised at all, and the node answers ROUTE with itself as READ and ROUTE only, exactly as it does mid-election. Declaring `bolt` is what restores a WRITE entry. See the HA guide, *Client Routing Ports*. *(Since v26.9.1)*

### 4.14.20. Current Limitations

- **Authentication**: the `none` scheme is not accepted — ArcadeDB always requires credentials. This is intentional, not a bug.
- **Type fidelity**: `RID` and `UUID` are returned as strings; `BigDecimal` / oversized `BigInteger` are down-converted to `double`.
- **Heterogeneous cluster ports**: see the note under Routing and High Availability.

### 4.14.21. Troubleshooting

If you encounter connection issues:

1. **Enable debug logging**: Start the server with `-Darcadedb.bolt.debug=true` to see detailed protocol messages. Passwords are never written to the log.
2. **Check port availability**: Ensure port 7687 (or your configured port) is not in use by another service.
3. **Verify authentication**: ArcadeDB always requires authentication. Ensure you're providing valid credentials — the `none` scheme is rejected.
4. **Match the encryption mode**: If the server runs with `arcadedb.bolt.ssl=REQUIRED`, connect with `bolt+s://` / `neo4j+s://`. If TLS is `DISABLED` (the default), connect with `bolt://` / `neo4j://` and encryption turned off in the driver.

To connect without encryption against a plaintext server:

```
// Java
Config.builder().withoutEncryption().build()
```

```
# Python
driver = GraphDatabase.driver(uri, auth=auth, encrypted=False)
```

### 4.14.22. See Also

- Bolt Driver Compatibility Matrix
- OpenCypher Query Language
- PostgreSQL Protocol Plugin

- Neo4j BOLT Protocol Specification
- Neo4j Driver Documentation

### 4.14.23. Numeric ids

The numeric id of a node or relationship sent over Bolt (`Node.id()` in the 4.x drivers) is the same value the Cypher `id()` function returns, so `MATCH (n) WHERE id(n) = $id` finds the node it came from. It follows the `arcadedb.opencypher.idBucketBits` setting. Ids kept by a client from an earlier version are different and must be read again *(since v26.10.1)*. Prefer `elementId()`, which is the record id (for example `#3:0`).

## 4.15. Native Drivers

**Which page do I want?**

- Building a new application in Python, JavaScript/TypeScript or Go — start here.
- Prefer the clients you already have in Python — Python quickstart, which teaches `psycopg`, the Neo4j driver and `httpx` against ArcadeDB.
- Prefer the clients you already have in JavaScript/TypeScript — JavaScript / TypeScript quickstart, which teaches `pg`, `neo4j-driver` and `fetch` against ArcadeDB.
- Prefer the clients you already have in Go — Go quickstart, which teaches `pgx` against ArcadeDB.
- Already running a PostgreSQL stack — PostgreSQL wire protocol.
- Already running a Neo4j stack — Neo4j BOLT.
- Any other language — HTTP/JSON API, no driver required.

ArcadeDB publishes six native drivers, an HTTP one and a gRPC one for each of Python, JavaScript/TypeScript and Go, from the arcadedb-drivers repository. Every one of them is generated from a shared contract — an OpenAPI specification for the HTTP drivers, a Protobuf `.proto` for the gRPC drivers — and each driver's build regenerates from that contract and fails if the checked-in code and a fresh regeneration disagree.

That matters to you, not just to the people who build the drivers: a generated client cannot silently disagree with the server about the wire format. When ArcadeDB adds a field, the driver gets it from the contract rather than from someone remembering to hand-write it.

### 4.15.1. HTTP or gRPC?

| Choose | When |
|---|---|
| HTTP | General application traffic, browsers, serverless functions, and anywhere you want the smallest dependency footprint. This is the right default. |
| gRPC | Throughput-sensitive server-to-server work: large result sets you want to stream rather than page, and bulk inserts. |

There is no browser gRPC driver, and there cannot be one until the server changes. ArcadeDB's `GrpcServerPlugin` is plain grpc-java over HTTP/2, with no gRPC-Web handler and no Connect protocol in front of it. A browser cannot speak raw HTTP/2 gRPC framing at all, so no client library in any language can reach this server from a browser. Use an HTTP driver there.

### 4.15.2. The result envelope, and why `truncated` matters

The HTTP drivers' `query` and `command` do not return bare rows. They return the whole response envelope: `result`, `limit`, `returned`, and `truncated`.

`truncated` is true when the server's serializer hit its row cap while the query still had rows left to write. `result` is then a partial answer, not a short-but-complete one — and the two are indistinguishable by shape. A caller that reads `result` and ignores `truncated` will silently work off half an answer.

Always check `truncated` before treating `result` as the whole result set. When it is true, re-query with a narrower filter or a higher `limit`. Raising `limit` is not always the fix: a result whose true size exceeds the server's hard ceiling (`arcadedb.server.httpQueryMaxResultRows`) is refused outright with HTTP 413 rather than truncated, so past that ceiling a narrower filter is the only way forward.

### 4.15.3. Versions and server compatibility

| Package | Version | ArcadeDB server |
|---|---|---|
| `arcadedb-driver`, `arcadedb-driver-grpc` (PyPI) | 0.1.0 | 26.9.1 |
| `@arcadedb/driver`, `@arcadedb/driver-grpc` (npm) | 0.1.0 | 26.9.1 |
| `github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb-drivers/go/arcadedb`, `…/go/arcadedbgrpc` (Go modules) | 0.2.0 | 26.10.1 |

Each driver is generated against one server release's contract, shown above. Install commands in these pages are deliberately unpinned; the registries carry the current version. The Go modules had no 0.1.0 release: their first published version is 0.2.0.

## 4.16. Python — HTTP Driver

`arcadedb-driver` is ArcadeDB's Python HTTP client, generated from the server's OpenAPI contract. It wraps queries, commands and transactions in a small facade over `httpx`, plus a matching `asyncio` facade for async applications.

### 4.16.1. Install

```
pip install arcadedb-driver
```

Or with uv:

```
uv add arcadedb-driver
```

Requires Python 3.10 or later.

### 4.16.2. Connect and query

```
import httpx
from arcadedb_driver import ArcadeDBServer, basic_auth

with ArcadeDBServer(
    base_url="http://localhost:2480",
    auth=basic_auth("root", "playwithdata"),
    timeout=httpx.Timeout(5.0),
) as srv:
    db = srv.db("mydb")

    envelope = db.query(language="sql", command="SELECT FROM Person WHERE age > ?",
params={"0": 21})
    print(envelope.result, envelope.returned, envelope.truncated)
```

```
[{'@rid': '#1:0', '@type': 'Person', '@cat': 'v', 'name': 'Alice', 'age': 30},
{'@rid': '#1:1', '@type': 'Person', '@cat': 'v', 'name': 'Bob', 'age': 25}] 2 False
```

**Positional parameters are zero-indexed — `{"1": 21}` silently returns nothing.**

Positional parameters are keyed by their zero-based index as a string. For the single placeholder above, the key is `"0"`, not `"1"`. Passing `params={"1": 21}` does not raise and does not match the wrong rows — it runs the query with no bound value for `?` at all and comes back empty:

```
[] 0 False
```

The driver's own README shows `{"1": 21}`; it looks plausible and returns quietly, which is exactly what makes it easy to ship. Always start positional parameter keys at `"0"`.

`basic_auth("root", "playwithdata")` builds the `Authorization` header for HTTP basic auth; `bearer_auth("AU-…")` substitutes directly for it wherever you already hold a session token from `/api/v1/login`, or any other bearer credential.

### 4.16.3. Sync and async

Every facade method has an async twin. `AsyncArcadeDBServer` mirrors `ArcadeDBServer` method for method, just `await`-ed:

```
import asyncio
from arcadedb_driver import AsyncArcadeDBServer, basic_auth

async def main() -> None:
    async with AsyncArcadeDBServer(
        base_url="http://localhost:2480", auth=basic_auth("root", "playwithdata")
    ) as srv:
        envelope = await srv.db("mydb").query(language="sql", command="SELECT FROM
Person")
        print(envelope.result)

asyncio.run(main())
```

```
[{'@rid': '#1:0', '@type': 'Person', '@cat': 'v', 'name': 'Alice', 'age': 30},
{'@rid': '#1:1', '@type': 'Person', '@cat': 'v', 'name': 'Bob', 'age': 25}]
```

Beyond `query`, `command` and `transaction`, a database handle also exposes `db.ts`, `db.grafana` and `db.promql` for time-series ingestion and querying — see the package README linked below for those.

### 4.16.4. Close your client

Both `ArcadeDBServer` and `AsyncArcadeDBServer` are context managers, because each owns an `httpx` client with its own connection pool that must be released. Prefer `with` / `async with`. When you cannot use one — a long-lived client held across requests, say — call `close()` on the sync class or `await aclose()` on the async one yourself.

**Timeouts are off by default.**

Omitting `timeout` does not mean "use httpx's five-second default" — it means no timeout at all. `ArcadeDBServer` and `AsyncArcadeDBServer` default `timeout` to `None`, and in httpx an explicit `timeout=None` means exactly that: requests are free to hang forever on a stalled connection. Pass an explicit `httpx.Timeout` to bound requests, as in the example above: `timeout=httpx.Timeout(5.0)`.

### 4.16.5. Transactions

```
with db.transaction() as tx:
    tx.command(language="sql", command="INSERT INTO Account SET balance = 100")
    total = tx.query(language="sql", command="SELECT sum(balance) AS total FROM
Account").result[0]["total"]
print("total:", total)
```

```
total: 100
```

`db.transaction()` returns a context manager whose `enter` gives you a second database handle — here, `tx` — that carries the transaction's session id. The contract:

- If the block exits cleanly, the transaction commits.
- If the block raises, the transaction rolls back and the block's own exception propagates. If the rollback itself also fails, that failure is attached as the exception's `cause` rather than replacing it — the block's error is what you asked about.
- If the commit itself fails, a best-effort rollback is issued first, so the server-side session is not left open for `arcadedb.server.httpSessionExpireTimeout` to reap it.

The trap: calls made through the outer `db` handle while a transaction is open do not join that transaction — they auto-commit individually, outside it. Only calls made through the handle `transaction()` gives you (`tx` above) take part.

### 4.16.6. Two error models

Facade methods raise `ArcadeDBError` on any non-2xx response, carrying `status`, `error`, `detail` and `request_id`. This holds for `query`, `command` and `transaction`, and equally for the `ts`, `grafana` and `promql` namespaces — every one of them raises the same `ArcadeDBError` rather than letting an `httpx` exception or anything else through:

```
from arcadedb_driver import ArcadeDBError

try:
    db.query(language="sql", command="SELECT FROM NoSuchType")
except ArcadeDBError as err:
    print(err.status, err.error, err.detail, err.request_id)
```

```
500 Internal error Type with name 'NoSuchType' was not found 7f43ebd2c31c5c12-24
```

`request_id` is the server's `X-Request-Id` for that call and is different on every request; use it to correlate a failure with the server log.

`srv.raw` takes the opposite approach: it never raises. It is not a second facade with its own `query` and `command` methods — it is the generated `openapi-python-client` `Client` object, the value you hand to the generated endpoint functions as their `client=` argument. Each of those functions returns a response whose `status_code` and `parsed` body you inspect yourself, the same shape you get for a successful call. Use `raw` when you would rather branch on a status code than catch an exception:

```
from arcadedb_driver import ArcadeDBServer, basic_auth
from arcadedb_driver._generated.api.database import list_databases

with ArcadeDBServer(base_url="http://localhost:2480", auth=basic_auth("root",
"playwithdata")) as srv:
    response = list_databases.sync_detailed(client=srv.raw)
```

```
print(response.status_code, response.parsed.result)
```

```
200 ['mydb']
```

### 4.16.7. Choosing a protocol from Python

ArcadeDB can be queried from Python over three protocols. For small results (a few rows per call) they perform the same; for **large results** the choice matters.

| | **HTTP API** | **Bolt (`neo4j` driver)** | **gRPC (`grpcio`)** |
|---|---|---|---|
| Install | `pip install requests` | `pip install neo4j` | `pip install grpcio protobuf`, plus stubs generated from `arcadedb-server.proto` |
| Server setup | enabled by default (port 2480) | add the `Bolt` plugin (port 7687) | add the `GRPC` plugin (port 50051) |
| Authentication | HTTP Basic | user and password | call metadata `x-arcade-user` / `x-arcade-password` |
| Transactions | yes (`/begin`, `/commit`) | yes | yes |
| Streams a large result | no, one JSON body | yes, in `fetch_size` batches | yes, in `batch_size` batches |
| 633K vertex ids | 0.54 s | 2.59 s | **0.30 s** |
| 633K PageRank scores | 0.98 s | 2.81 s | **0.79 s** |
| 2M edge rows | 1.61 s | 8.55 s | **1.34 s** |
| Few rows per call (a count) | fast | fast | not measured |

Times are for the whole result consumed in Python (warm median of 3). Bolt is shown with the whole result in one PULL (`fetch_size=-1`); with the driver's default of 1,000 rows per PULL the 2M-row call took about 15 s. gRPC is shown with 100,000 rows per batch; 10,000 is nearly as fast, while 1,000 is slower than HTTP on wider rows (1.8 s and 2.9 s for the last two calls).

#### Recommendation

- Large results from Python: use **gRPC streaming** with a batch size of 10,000 or more, or the HTTP API when you want the simplest setup.
- Use **Bolt** when you need Neo4j tooling and driver compatibility. From Python, set a large `fetch_size` for big results. The Python driver is the limit here, not the server: the official Java driver reads the same 2M rows over Bolt in 1.5 s.
- Small results, or many small calls: any of the three.

#### Measurement notes

- Server: ArcadeDB 26.11.1-SNAPSHOT image, with the Bolt buffering fix (#9165).
- Machine: Docker Desktop on macOS, on battery power, so only the ratios are meaningful. The benchmark script is `scripts/grpc_transfer_bench.py`, and the details are in `ArcadeDB-release-progress.md`.
- Rows are narrow (one or two numeric columns). Wide rows, strings and whole vertices or edges were not measured.
- Docker Desktop adds about 1.3 ms to each client-server round trip, which penalizes small batches. A native Linux server will show less of that penalty.

### 4.16.8. Next steps

- Native Drivers — the result envelope and why `truncated` matters, and how this driver compares to the others.
- Python — gRPC Driver — the gRPC counterpart for throughput-sensitive server-to-server work.
- The package README for the full method list, including `db.ts`, `db.grafana` and `db.promql`.

## 4.17. Python — gRPC Driver

`arcadedb-driver-grpc` is ArcadeDB's Python gRPC client, generated from the server's Protobuf contract. It wraps the generated stub in a small facade for streaming queries, streaming inserts and transactions, plus a matching `asyncio` facade for async applications.

### 4.17.1. Install

```
pip install arcadedb-driver-grpc
```

Or with uv:

```
uv add arcadedb-driver-grpc
```

Requires Python 3.10 or later.

**The gRPC server is a plugin, and it is not started by default.**

Register it in the server's plugin list before connecting:

```
-Darcadedb.server.plugins
=GRPC:com.arcadedb.server.grpc.GrpcServerPlugin
```

Once registered, it listens on port `50051`. See the gRPC API reference for the full option list, including TLS and message-size settings.

### 4.17.2. Connect and query

```
from arcadedb_driver_grpc import create_client, messages, password_auth

with create_client(
    "localhost:50051",
    insecure=True,
    auth=password_auth("root", "playwithdata", "mydb"),
) as client:
    response = client.raw.ExecuteQuery(
        messages.ExecuteQueryRequest(database="mydb", query="SELECT FROM Person WHERE
age > 21", language="sql")
    )
    for result in response.results:
        for record in result.records:
            print(record.rid, dict(record.properties))
```

```
#1:0 {'age': int32_value: 30
, '@type': string_value: "Person"
, '@rid': link_value {
  rid: "#1:0"
}
logical_type: "rid"
, '@cat': string_value: "v"
, 'name': string_value: "Alice"
}
#1:1 {'age': int32_value: 25
, '@type': string_value: "Person"
, '@rid': link_value {
  rid: "#1:1"
}
logical_type: "rid"
, '@cat': string_value: "v"
, 'name': string_value: "Bob"
}
```

The target is gRPC's native `host:port` form, not a URL — there is no scheme to parse and nothing to default. That is why TLS and plaintext are both explicit: pass `credentials=grpc.ssl_channel_credentials()` for TLS, or `insecure=True` to opt into plaintext.

The output above is not a copy-paste mistake — it is exactly what `dict(record.properties)` prints. See below for why, and how to get plain Python values instead.

**The unary `ExecuteQuery` has a row ceiling, and it fails rather than truncates.**

`ExecuteQuery` builds its whole answer into one gRPC message, so the server caps it: `server.grpcQueryMaxResultRows` (100000 by default) is a hard ceiling, and a result that would exceed it fails the call with `RESOURCE_EXHAUSTED` instead of coming back

> short. Unlike the HTTP drivers there is no `truncated` flag to check — a capped query does not return at all.
>
> Streaming is the answer for result sets that large: `stream_query` emits incrementally and is bounded instead by `server.grpcStreamMaxMaterializedRows` (and only in `MATERIALIZE_ALL` mode) and by `server.grpcStreamWriteTimeoutMs`. See Settings for all three, and the gRPC API reference for the service itself.

### 4.17.3. `raw` and the three wrappers

`client.raw` is the generated stub for `ArcadeDbService`, the contract's data plane, and it is that service only: all 14 of its RPCs are reachable through it exactly as shown above with `ExecuteQuery`. `create_client` adds three methods on top of `raw` — `stream_query`, `insert_stream` and `transaction` — which between them cover five of those 14: `StreamQuery`, `InsertStream`, and `BeginTransaction`/`CommitTransaction`/`RollbackTransaction`. These are the RPCs the generated stub alone handles badly — consuming a server-side stream one message at a time, feeding a client-side stream from an iterable, and pairing begin, commit and rollback into a context manager. The remaining nine — `ExecuteQuery`, `ExecuteCommand`, `CreateRecord`, `UpdateRecord`, `DeleteRecord`, `LookupByRid`, `BulkInsert`, `InsertBidirectional` and `GraphBatchLoad` — are used directly through `raw`.

Administration is a second service, and `raw` does not reach it. `ArcadeDbAdminService` carries its own nine RPCs (`Ping`, `GetServerInfo`, `ListDatabases`, `ExistsDatabase`, `CreateDatabase`, `DropDatabase`, `GetDatabaseInfo`, `CreateUser`, `DeleteUser`), and `client.raw.GetServerInfo` raises `AttributeError` because the attribute is not there. Build that stub yourself when you need it. Its RPCs also take their credentials in the request message rather than from the channel, so this call needs no auth interceptor at all:

```
import grpc

from arcadedb_driver_grpc import messages
from arcadedb_driver_grpc._generated import arcadedb_server_pb2_grpc as pb2_grpc

with grpc.insecure_channel("localhost:50051") as channel:
    admin = pb2_grpc.ArcadeDbAdminServiceStub(channel)
    response = admin.ListDatabases(
        messages.ListDatabasesRequest(
            credentials=messages.DatabaseCredentials(username="root", password
="playwithdata")
        )
    )
    print(list(response.databases))
```

```
['mydb']
```

`raw` also means every value that comes back is exactly what the wire sent: a generated protobuf message, not a Python scalar. The `rid` and `type` fields of a `GrpcRecord` are already plain strings, but each entry in its `properties` map is a `GrpcValue` — a protobuf message with a `oneof` field named `kind`

holding the actual value under one of `int32_value`, `string_value`, `link_value`, and so on. `dict(record.properties)` therefore gives you a dict of `GrpcValue` objects, not a dict of names, ages and RIDs. Unwrap each one by checking which field of the `oneof` is set:

```
def unwrap(value):
    field = value.WhichOneof("kind")
    if field == "link_value":
        return value.link_value.rid
    return getattr(value, field) if field else None

props = {k: unwrap(v) for k, v in record.properties.items()}
print(record.rid, props)
```

```
#1:0 {'age': 30, 'name': 'Alice', '@type': 'Person', '@rid': '#1:0', '@cat': 'v'}
#1:1 {'age': 25, 'name': 'Bob', '@type': 'Person', '@rid': '#1:1', '@cat': 'v'}
```

`link_value` is the one case that does not unwrap to a scalar directly — it is itself a message (`GrpcLink`), so reach into `.rid` for the record ID string. There is no library function that does this unwrapping for you; it is a plain `oneof` read, shown above for reference.

### 4.17.4. Authentication is attached to the channel

`bearer_auth(token)` and `password_auth(user, password, database=None)` do not attach credentials to individual calls. `create_client` turns whichever one you pass into a gRPC channel interceptor, so it runs on every call made through that channel — `client.raw.ExecuteCommand(…)` carries the same authentication headers that `client.stream_query(…)` does, with no extra work at the call site.

This matters because the facade's three methods cover only five of the data plane's 14 RPCs. If authentication were attached per-call instead — say, only on the methods `create_client` itself wraps — every one of the other nine RPCs reached through `raw` would go out silently anonymous. Attaching auth to the channel instead of the call means there is no RPC you can reach through this client without it.

**The insecure-channel guard, and its limit.**

`password_auth` sends the password as plaintext call metadata. To keep that from happening by accident over an unencrypted channel, `create_client` raises `InsecureChannelError` unless you either pass channel credentials or explicitly opt in with `insecure=True`:

```
from arcadedb_driver_grpc import InsecureChannelError, create_client,
password_auth

try:
    create_client("localhost:50051", auth=password_auth("root",
"playwithdata", "mydb"))
except InsecureChannelError as err:
```

```
    print("guard fired:", err)
```

```
guard fired: create_client: refusing to send a plaintext password over
an insecure channel to "localhost:50051". Pass
credentials=grpc.ssl_channel_credentials(), switch to bearer_auth, or
pass insecure=True to opt in explicitly.
```

The check is honest about what it can and cannot see: it keys on whether channel credentials were supplied, not on whether the channel is actually encrypted end-to-end. A `bearer_auth` token never trips it, at any security level, because a bearer token is not a password — the guard is specifically about `password_auth` sending a plaintext secret.

### 4.17.5. Streaming queries

```
for record in client.stream_query(
    messages.StreamQueryRequest(
        database="mydb",
        query="SELECT FROM Person",
        language="sql",
        retrieval_mode=messages.StreamQueryRequest.RetrievalMode.CURSOR,
        batch_size=500,
    )
):
    print(record.rid, dict(record.properties))
```

```
#1:0 {'age': int32_value: 30
, '@cat': string_value: "v"
, 'name': string_value: "Alice"
}
#1:1 {'age': int32_value: 25
, '@cat': string_value: "v"
, 'name': string_value: "Bob"
}
```

`stream_query` flattens the server's stream of `QueryResult` batches into one `GrpcRecord` at a time and does nothing else — it picks no default for `retrieval_mode` or `batch_size`. There are three retrieval modes:

- `CURSOR` — the proto default (value `0`). The server runs the query once and streams rows as you iterate.
- `MATERIALIZE_ALL` — the server runs the query to completion first, then batches the already-materialized result set back to you.
- `PAGED` — the client re-issues the query with `LIMIT`/`SKIP` per batch.

Leaving both `retrieval_mode` and `batch_size` unset does not pick `CURSOR` and a sensible batch size as a considered choice — it sends whatever protobuf's zero values happen to be for those fields (`0`, which is `CURSOR`, and `0` rows per batch). Set both explicitly.

### 4.17.6. Streaming inserts

`insert_stream` owns the envelope bookkeeping the client-streaming `InsertStream` RPC needs — one session id for the stream, an incrementing chunk sequence, `database` on the first chunk, `last` on the final one — and leaves how rows are batched to you.

**`InsertStreamRequest.transaction` is forwarded but not honored.**

The field exists because the `.proto` declares it, and the driver sets it on every chunk exactly as you give it. On server 26.9.1 and earlier it buys nothing: the server ignores the `TransactionContext` on `InsertStream` entirely (ArcadeData/arcadedb#6607), builds its own insert context, and commits on its own. A batch you believe is atomic is not, and nothing errors to tell you so. That is also why `insert_stream` is absent from the transaction handle below. Do not rely on it until #6607 lands.

### 4.17.7. Transactions

```
from arcadedb_driver_grpc import create_client, messages, password_auth

with create_client(
    "localhost:50051",
    insecure=True,
    auth=password_auth("root", "playwithdata", "mydb"),
) as client:
    with client.transaction("mydb") as tx:
        tx.execute_command(
            messages.ExecuteCommandRequest(
                command="INSERT INTO Account SET balance = 100, owner = 'grpc-demo'",
                language="sql",
            )
        )
        response = tx.execute_query(
            messages.ExecuteQueryRequest(
                query="SELECT sum(balance) AS total FROM Account WHERE owner = 'grpc-
demo'",
                language="sql",
            )
        )
    print("total:", response.results[0].records[0].properties["total"].int32_value)
```

```
total: 100
```

`client.transaction(database)` is a context manager. `enter` issues `BeginTransaction` and hands back a `TransactionHandle`; the block commits on a clean exit and rolls back on an exception, which then propagates. A rollback that fails on that path is attached as the original exception's `cause` rather than replacing it, and a commit that fails triggers a best-effort rollback first so the server-side session is not left for the reaper.

The handle is how you run work inside the transaction. It exposes `execute_query`, `execute_command`, `create_record`, `update_record`, `delete_record`, `lookup_by_rid` and `stream_query`, each of them binding the transaction's id and database onto a copy of the request you pass — so you never set `transaction` or `database` yourself, and a request object you reuse elsewhere is left untouched. Note the omissions: `insert_stream` and `BulkInsert` are not on the handle, because the server does not run them inside your transaction at all.

The trap is the same one the HTTP driver has: calls made through the outer `client` while a transaction is open do not join it. Only calls through the handle take part.

### 4.17.8. Errors

Every RPC raises `grpc.RpcError` on failure — the driver adds no exception type of its own. `err.code()` is a `grpc.StatusCode` and `err.details()` is the server's message:

```
import grpc

from arcadedb_driver_grpc import create_client, messages, password_auth

with create_client(
    "localhost:50051",
    insecure=True,
    auth=password_auth("root", "playwithdata", "mydb"),
) as client:
    try:
        client.raw.ExecuteQuery(
            messages.ExecuteQueryRequest(database="mydb", query="SELECT FROM
NoSuchType", language="sql")
        )
    except grpc.RpcError as err:
        print(err.code(), err.details())
```

```
StatusCode.NOT_FOUND Type with name 'NoSuchType' was not found
```

The status you are most likely to meet first is `UNAUTHENTICATED`. A stock ArcadeDB gRPC server refuses anonymous calls, so a client built without `auth=` connects happily and then fails on the first RPC:

```
import grpc

from arcadedb_driver_grpc import create_client, messages
```

```
with create_client("localhost:50051", insecure=True) as anonymous:
    try:
        anonymous.raw.ExecuteQuery(
            messages.ExecuteQueryRequest(database="mydb", query="SELECT FROM Person",
language="sql")
        )
    except grpc.RpcError as err:
        print(err.code() is grpc.StatusCode.UNAUTHENTICATED, err.details())
```

```
True Authentication required
```

`RESOURCE_EXHAUSTED` is the other status worth branching on: it is what a result set larger than the server's row cap returns, as described above.

### 4.17.9. Async

Importing `create_client` from `arcadedb_driver_grpc.aio` instead of `arcadedb_driver_grpc` is the whole signal for which client you get: the async client mirrors the sync one method for method, `await`-ed, with the same `insecure` and `auth` arguments.

```
import asyncio

from arcadedb_driver_grpc import messages, password_auth
from arcadedb_driver_grpc.aio import create_client

async def main() -> None:
    async with create_client(
        "localhost:50051",
        insecure=True,
        auth=password_auth("root", "playwithdata", "mydb"),
    ) as client:
        response = await client.raw.ExecuteQuery(
            messages.ExecuteQueryRequest(database="mydb", query="SELECT FROM Person",
language="sql")
        )
        for result in response.results:
            for record in result.records:
                print(record.rid)

asyncio.run(main())
```

```
#1:0
#1:1
```

### 4.17.10. Next steps

- Choosing a protocol from Python — measured HTTP, Bolt and gRPC timings for large results.
- Native Drivers — how this driver compares to the others, and when to reach for gRPC instead of HTTP.
- Python — HTTP Driver — the HTTP counterpart for general application traffic.
- The package README for the internals, including why the async facade needs four interceptor classes — one per gRPC call shape (unary-unary, unary-stream, stream-unary, stream-stream) — where the sync facade needs only one.

## 4.18. Python

**Connection options for Python**

ArcadeDB exposes multiple wire protocols, so you can pick the one your stack already speaks:

- **Native HTTP driver** — `pip install arcadedb-driver`, generated from ArcadeDB's OpenAPI contract. Start here for most applications.
- **Native gRPC driver** — `pip install arcadedb-driver-grpc`, for streaming and bulk inserts.
- **Neo4j BOLT** — `pip install neo4j`, run Cypher queries.
- **HTTP/JSON API** — use `requests` or `httpx`, no driver required.

This tutorial uses the PostgreSQL wire protocol, which is the right choice when you already run a PostgreSQL stack.

This tutorial shows how to connect to ArcadeDB from Python using the PostgreSQL wire protocol. You will create a graph, run queries, and use vector search — all from a Python script.

### 4.18.1. Prerequisites

- ArcadeDB running with PostgreSQL protocol enabled (default port 5432)
- Python 3.10+
- `psycopg` library

```
pip install "psycopg[binary]>=3.1,<4"
```

### 4.18.2. Connect to ArcadeDB

ArcadeDB speaks the PostgreSQL wire protocol, so you can use standard PostgreSQL drivers. No special SDK is needed.

```
import psycopg
```

```
conn = psycopg.connect(
    host='localhost',
    port=5432,
    dbname='mydb',
    user='root',
    password='arcadedb',
    autocommit=True,
)
print('Connected to ArcadeDB')
```

### 4.18.3. Create a Schema

Use SQL to create vertex and edge types:

```
with conn.cursor() as cur:
    # Create vertex types
    cur.execute("CREATE VERTEX TYPE Person IF NOT EXISTS")
    cur.execute("CREATE VERTEX TYPE Movie IF NOT EXISTS")

    # Create edge type
    cur.execute("CREATE EDGE TYPE Acted IF NOT EXISTS")

    # Insert data
    cur.execute("CREATE VERTEX Person SET name = 'Alice', age = 30")
    cur.execute("CREATE VERTEX Person SET name = 'Bob', age = 25")
    cur.execute("CREATE VERTEX Movie SET title = 'The Matrix', year = 1999")
    cur.execute("""
        CREATE EDGE Acted FROM (SELECT FROM Person WHERE name = 'Alice')
                          TO (SELECT FROM Movie WHERE title = 'The Matrix')
                          SET role = 'Trinity'
    """)
```

### 4.18.4. Query with SQL

```
with conn.cursor() as cur:
    cur.execute("""
        MATCH {type: Person, as: person}.outE('Acted'){as: acted}.inV(){type: Movie,
as: movie}
        RETURN person.name AS name, movie.title AS title, acted.role AS role
    """)
    for row in cur.fetchall():
        print(f'{row[0]} acted in {row[1]} as {row[2]}')
```

### 4.18.5. Query with Cypher

ArcadeDB supports Cypher queries through the same connection:

```
with conn.cursor() as cur:
    cur.execute("{cypher} MATCH (p:Person)-[a:Acted]->(m:Movie) RETURN p.name,
m.title, a.role")
    for row in cur.fetchall():
        print(f'{row[0]} acted in {row[1]} as {row[2]}')
```

Prefix Cypher queries with `{cypher}` when using the PostgreSQL protocol.

### 4.18.6. Vector Search

ArcadeDB supports vector similarity search. Add embeddings to your data and query by similarity:

```
with conn.cursor() as cur:
    # Create a type with a vector property
    cur.execute("CREATE VERTEX TYPE Product IF NOT EXISTS")
    cur.execute("CREATE PROPERTY Product.embedding IF NOT EXISTS LIST OF FLOAT")
    cur.execute("CREATE INDEX IF NOT EXISTS ON Product (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA
{dimensions: 4, similarity: 'COSINE'}")

    # Insert products with embeddings
    cur.execute("CREATE VERTEX Product SET name = 'Laptop', embedding = [0.9, 0.1,
0.8, 0.2]")
    cur.execute("CREATE VERTEX Product SET name = 'Tablet', embedding = [0.8, 0.2,
0.7, 0.3]")
    cur.execute("CREATE VERTEX Product SET name = 'Phone',  embedding = [0.7, 0.3,
0.6, 0.4]")
    cur.execute("CREATE VERTEX Product SET name = 'Book',   embedding = [0.1, 0.9,
0.2, 0.8]")

    # Find the 3 most similar products to a query vector
    cur.execute("""
        SELECT name, distance FROM (
            SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Product[embedding]', [0.85, 0.15, 0.75,
0.25], 3))
        )
    """)
    print('Similar products:')
    for row in cur.fetchall():
        print(f'  {row[0]}')
```

### 4.18.7. Full Example

Here is a complete script that connects, creates data, and queries:

```
#!/usr/bin/env python3
"""ArcadeDB Python quickstart -- graph + vector search."""
```

```
import psycopg

def main():
    conn = psycopg.connect(
        host='localhost', port=5432, dbname='mydb',
        user='root', password='arcadedb', autocommit=True,
    )

    with conn.cursor() as cur:
        # Create schema
        cur.execute("CREATE VERTEX TYPE Person IF NOT EXISTS")
        cur.execute("CREATE VERTEX TYPE Movie IF NOT EXISTS")
        cur.execute("CREATE EDGE TYPE Acted IF NOT EXISTS")

        # Insert data
        cur.execute("CREATE VERTEX Person SET name = 'Alice', age = 30")
        cur.execute("CREATE VERTEX Movie SET title = 'The Matrix', year = 1999")
        cur.execute("""
            CREATE EDGE Acted FROM (SELECT FROM Person WHERE name = 'Alice')
                              TO (SELECT FROM Movie WHERE title = 'The Matrix')
                              SET role = 'Trinity'
        """)

        # Query with SQL MATCH
        cur.execute("""
            MATCH {type: Person, as: person}.outE('Acted'){as: acted}.inV(){type:
Movie, as: movie}
            RETURN person.name AS name, movie.title AS title, acted.role AS role
        """)
        for row in cur.fetchall():
            print(f'{row[0]} acted in {row[1]} as {row[2]}')

    conn.close()

if __name__ == '__main__':
    main()
```

### 4.18.8. HTTP / JSON API

For lightweight scripts or serverless environments where you want minimal dependencies, talk to ArcadeDB's HTTP/JSON API directly with `requests` or `httpx` — no driver needed.

```
import requests

base_url = 'http://localhost:2480/api/v1'
auth = ('root', 'arcadedb')

# Run a SQL query
response = requests.post(
```

```
    f'{base_url}/command/mydb',
    json={'language': 'sql', 'command': 'SELECT FROM V LIMIT 10'},
    auth=auth,
)
print(response.json())

# Run a Cypher query
response = requests.post(
    f'{base_url}/command/mydb',
    json={'language': 'cypher', 'command': 'MATCH (n) RETURN n LIMIT 10'},
    auth=auth,
)
print(response.json())
```

See the HTTP/JSON API reference for every endpoint and parameter.

### 4.18.9. Embedded Python Bindings

For high-performance use cases that need in-process access (no network overhead), see the arcadedb-embedded-python project, which provides direct JVM bindings via JPype.

### 4.18.10. Next Steps

- IAM Use Case — Full Python implementation with 7 query patterns
- PostgreSQL Protocol Reference
- SQL Reference
- Cypher Reference

## 4.19. JavaScript / TypeScript — HTTP Driver

`@arcadedb/driver` is ArcadeDB's TypeScript/JavaScript HTTP client, generated from the server's OpenAPI contract.

**Node.js 20+, ESM only.**

The package requires Node.js 20 or later, and it ships **ESM only** — there is no CommonJS build and no `require()` entry point. Import it with `import`, not `require`.

### 4.19.1. Install

```
npm install @arcadedb/driver
```

### 4.19.2. Connect and query

```
import { ArcadeDBError, basicAuth, createClient } from "@arcadedb/driver";
```

```
const server = createClient({
  baseUrl: "http://localhost:2480",
  auth: basicAuth("root", "playwithdata"),
});

const db = server.db("mydb");

const envelope = await db.query({
  language: "sql",
  command: "SELECT FROM Person WHERE age > ?",
  params: { 0: 21 },
});
console.log(envelope.result, envelope.returned, envelope.truncated);
```

```
[
  {
    '@rid': '#1:0',
    '@type': 'Person',
    '@cat': 'v',
    name: 'Alice',
    age: 30
  },
  {
    '@rid': '#1:1',
    '@type': 'Person',
    '@cat': 'v',
    name: 'Bob',
    age: 25
  }
] 2 false
```

**Positional parameters are zero-indexed — `{ 1: 21 }` silently returns nothing.**

Positional parameters are keyed by their zero-based index. For the single placeholder above, the key is `0`, not `1`. Passing `params: { 1: 21 }` does not raise an error and does not match the wrong rows — it runs the query with no bound value for `?` at all and comes back with an empty `result` (`returned: 0`, `truncated: false`). The driver's own README shows `{ 1: 21 }`; it looks plausible and returns quietly, which is exactly what makes it easy to ship. Always start positional parameter keys at `0`.

**There is no timeout option, and `fetch` has no default timeout.**

`createClient` accepts exactly three options — `baseUrl`, `auth` and `fetch`. There is no `timeout`, and the client calls the runtime's global `fetch`, which waits forever by default. A request against a stalled connection therefore hangs indefinitely unless you bound it yourself. The `fetch` option is where to do that: pass a wrapper that

attaches an `AbortSignal`.

```
import { basicAuth, createClient } from "@arcadedb/driver";

const server = createClient({
  baseUrl: "http://localhost:2480",
  auth: basicAuth("root", "playwithdata"),
  fetch: (input, init) => fetch(input, { ...init, signal: AbortSignal
.timeout(5000) }),
});

const envelope = await server.db("mydb").query({ language: "sql",
command: "SELECT FROM Person" });
console.log(envelope.returned);
```

```
2
```

The Python driver takes an explicit `timeout` argument instead; see the Python HTTP driver page, where the same "no timeout unless you ask" default applies.

`basicAuth("root", "playwithdata")` builds the `Authorization` header for HTTP basic auth; `bearerAuth("AU-…")` substitutes directly for it wherever you already hold a session token or other bearer credential.

### 4.19.3. The result envelope

`query` and `command` do not return bare rows. They return the whole response envelope:

```
interface QueryEnvelope<T> {
  result: T[];
  limit: number;
  returned: number;
  truncated: boolean;
}
```

See Native Drivers for why `truncated` matters and what to do when it is `true`.

### 4.19.4. Transactions

```
const total = await db.transaction(async (tx) => {
  await tx.command({ language: "sql", command: "INSERT INTO Account SET balance = 100"
});
  const { result } = await tx.query({ language: "sql", command: "SELECT sum(balance)
AS total FROM Account" });
  return result[0].total;
});
```

```
console.log("total:", total);
```

```
total: 200
```

(The total above reflects balances already present in this database from earlier examples on this page's server; a fresh `Account` type would show `100`.)

Every call inside the callback must go through the `tx` handle it receives, not the outer `db` — calls made through `db` while a transaction is open auto-commit individually, outside it. The contract:

- `transaction` commits when the callback resolves, and returns the callback's own return value.
- It rolls back and re-throws when the callback throws or rejects.
- The caller always sees the callback's own error. If the rollback itself also fails, that failure is attached to the error as `err.cause` rather than replacing it.
- If the commit itself fails, `transaction` issues a best-effort rollback first, to release the server-side session, before re-throwing the commit's error.

### 4.19.5. Two error models

Facade methods — `query`, `command`, `transaction`, and others — throw `ArcadeDBError` on any non-2xx response:

```
try {
  await db.query({ language: "sql", command: "SELECT FROM NoSuchType" });
} catch (err) {
  if (err instanceof ArcadeDBError) console.error(err.status, err.error, err.detail,
err.requestId);
}
```

```
500 Internal error Type with name 'NoSuchType' was not found 1a9b928039f2a6cd-30
```

`requestId` is the server's request identifier for that call and differs on every request; use it to correlate a failure with the server log.

`server.raw` — the underlying openapi-fetch client beneath the facade — takes the opposite approach: it never throws. It returns `{ data, error }` and leaves handling the error to the caller. Use the facade for the ergonomics of try/catch; use `raw` when you would rather branch on `{ data, error }` without exceptions.

Beyond `query`, `command` and `transaction`, a database handle also exposes `db.ts`, `db.grafana` and `db.promql` for time-series ingestion, Grafana panel queries and a PromQL-compatible query surface — see the package README linked below for those.

### 4.19.6. Next steps

- Native Drivers — the result envelope and why `truncated` matters, and how this driver compares to the others.
- JavaScript / TypeScript — gRPC Driver — the gRPC counterpart for throughput-sensitive server-to-server work.
- The package README for the full method list, including `db.ts`, `db.grafana` and `db.promql`.

## 4.20. JavaScript / TypeScript — gRPC Driver

`@arcadedb/driver-grpc` is ArcadeDB's TypeScript/JavaScript gRPC client, generated from the server's Protobuf contract. It wraps the generated Connect client in a small facade for streaming queries, streaming inserts and transactions.

### 4.20.1. Install

```
npm install @arcadedb/driver-grpc
```

**The gRPC server is a plugin, and it is not started by default.**

Register it in the server's plugin list before connecting:

```
-Darcadedb.server.plugins
=GRPC:com.arcadedb.server.grpc.GrpcServerPlugin
```

Once registered, it listens on port `50051`. See the gRPC API reference for the full option list, including TLS and message-size settings.

### 4.20.2. Runtime targets: Node, Bun, Deno — not browsers

The package requires Node.js 20 or later, and it ships **ESM only** — there is no CommonJS build and no `require()` entry point. Import it with `import`, not `require`.

Bun and Deno are intended targets for this driver, but only Node is what the arcadedb-drivers repository's continuous integration actually exercises against a live server. Treat Bun and Deno as likely to work rather than as verified.

There is no browser build, and there cannot be one until the server changes. ArcadeDB's `GrpcServerPlugin` is plain grpc-java over HTTP/2, with no gRPC-Web handler and no Connect protocol in front of it, so a browser cannot speak this driver's wire format at all. Use the HTTP driver there.

### 4.20.3. Connect and query

```
import { createClient, passwordAuth } from "@arcadedb/driver-grpc";
```

```
const grpc = createClient({
  baseUrl: "http://localhost:50051",
  auth: passwordAuth("root", "playwithdata", "mydb"),
  insecure: true,
});

const response = await grpc.raw.executeQuery({
  database: "mydb",
  query: "SELECT FROM Person WHERE age > 21",
  language: "sql",
});
console.log(response.results.flatMap((r) => r.records.map((rec) => [rec.rid, rec
.properties])));
```

```
[
  [ '#1:0', { name: [Object], age: [Object], '@rid': [Object], '@type': [Object],
'@cat': [Object] } ],
  [ '#1:1', { name: [Object], age: [Object], '@rid': [Object], '@type': [Object],
'@cat': [Object] } ]
]
```

Node's default `console.log` collapses nested objects two levels deep, and each property value here is itself a nested message — that is the summarizing behavior of `util.inspect`, not evidence of anything wrong. See below for what those objects actually contain and how to unwrap them.

**The unary `executeQuery` has a row ceiling, and it fails rather than truncates.**

`ExecuteQuery` builds its whole answer into one gRPC message, so the server caps it: `server.grpcQueryMaxResultRows` (100000 by default) is a hard ceiling, and a result that would exceed it fails the call with `RESOURCE_EXHAUSTED` instead of coming back short. Unlike the HTTP drivers there is no `truncated` flag to check — a capped query does not return at all.

Streaming is the answer for result sets that large: `streamQuery` emits incrementally and is bounded instead by `server.grpcStreamMaxMaterializedRows` (and only in `MATERIALIZE_ALL` mode) and by `server.grpcStreamWriteTimeoutMs`. See Settings for all three, and the gRPC API reference for the service itself.

`raw` is the generated Connect client for `ArcadeDbService`, the same one you get from `createClient(ArcadeDbService, transport)` if you built the transport yourself — every RPC in the data-plane contract is callable through it exactly as shown above with `executeQuery`. `createClient` from this package adds `streamQuery`, `insertStream` and `transaction` on top, covering the RPCs the generated client alone handles awkwardly: consuming a server-side stream, feeding a client-side stream, and pairing begin/commit/rollback into one call.

### 4.20.4. `record.properties` and the `GrpcValue` wrapper

Every value in a record's `properties` map comes back as a `GrpcValue` object, not a plain JavaScript scalar. Printed at full depth, the `name` and `age` fields above look like this:

```
name: {
  '$typeName': 'com.arcadedb.grpc.GrpcValue',
  kind: { case: 'stringValue', value: 'Alice' },
  logicalType: ''
}
age: {
  '$typeName': 'com.arcadedb.grpc.GrpcValue',
  kind: { case: 'int32Value', value: 30 },
  logicalType: ''
}
'@rid': {
  '$typeName': 'com.arcadedb.grpc.GrpcValue',
  kind: {
    case: 'linkValue',
    value: { '$typeName': 'com.arcadedb.grpc.GrpcLink', rid: '#1:0', type: '' }
  },
  logicalType: 'rid'
}
```

`GrpcValue.kind` is this package's Connect-ES rendering of the contract's `oneof` field: a discriminated union with `case` naming which alternative is set and `value` holding it directly — there is no per-type field name to guess, unlike the generated Python client's `int32_value`/`string_value`/`link_value` fields for the same `oneof`. Unwrap it by branching on `kind.case`:

```
function unwrap(value) {
  if (value.kind.case === "linkValue") return value.kind.value.rid;
  return value.kind.value;
}

for (const result of response.results) {
  for (const rec of result.records) {
    const props = Object.fromEntries(Object.entries(rec.properties).map(([k, v]) => [
k, unwrap(v)]));
    console.log(rec.rid, props);
  }
}
```

```
#1:0 { name: 'Alice', age: 30, '@rid': '#1:0', '@type': 'Person', '@cat': 'v' }
#1:1 { name: 'Bob', age: 25, '@rid': '#1:1', '@type': 'Person', '@cat': 'v' }
```

`linkValue` is the one case that does not unwrap to a scalar directly — its `value` is itself a `GrpcLink` message, so reach into `.rid` for the record ID string, as `unwrap` does above. There is no library

function that performs this unwrapping; it is a plain discriminated-union read, shown here for reference.

### 4.20.5. Authentication and the insecure guard

`bearerAuth(token)` sets `authorization: Bearer <token>` on every outgoing call's metadata. `passwordAuth(user, password, database?)` sets `x-arcade-user`, `x-arcade-password` and (when given) `x-arcade-database` instead. Both are passed once, as the `auth` option to `createClient` — there is no per-call credential to attach separately.

**The insecure-channel guard, and its limit.**

`passwordAuth` sends the password as plaintext call metadata. `createClient` refuses to pair it with a non-TLS `http://` `baseUrl` unless you pass `insecure: true` explicitly:

```
import { createClient, passwordAuth } from "@arcadedb/driver-grpc";

try {
  createClient({ baseUrl: "http://localhost:50051", auth: passwordAuth
("root", "playwithdata") });
} catch (err) {
  console.log("guard fired:", err.message);
}
```

```
guard fired: createClient: refusing to send a plaintext password over
insecure baseUrl "http://localhost:50051". Use an https:// baseUrl,
switch to bearerAuth, or pass insecure: true to opt in explicitly.
```

This is why the connect example above needs `insecure: true` at all: pairing `passwordAuth` with an `http://` `baseUrl` is exactly what this guard exists to catch.

The check has a real limit, stated plainly: it recognizes only the exact interceptor value `passwordAuth` returns, marked internally with a symbol property. Wrap that interceptor in your own logging or retry interceptor and the value `createClient` sees is a new function without the marker — the refusal is silently skipped, and the plaintext password still goes out over `http://`. The guard protects the direct, undecorated case; it is not a general plaintext-secret scanner.

### 4.20.6. Streaming queries and `retrievalMode`

```
import { createClient, passwordAuth, StreamQueryRequest_RetrievalMode } from
"@arcadedb/driver-grpc";

const grpc = createClient({
  baseUrl: "http://localhost:50051",
  auth: passwordAuth("root", "playwithdata", "mydb"),
```

```
  insecure: true,
});

for await (const row of grpc.streamQuery({
  database: "mydb",
  query: "SELECT FROM Person",
  language: "sql",
  retrievalMode: StreamQueryRequest_RetrievalMode.CURSOR,
  batchSize: 500,
})) {
  console.log(row.rid, row.properties);
}
```

```
#1:0 {
  name: {
    '$typeName': 'com.arcadedb.grpc.GrpcValue',
    kind: { case: 'stringValue', value: 'Alice' },
    logicalType: ''
  },
  age: {
    '$typeName': 'com.arcadedb.grpc.GrpcValue',
    kind: { case: 'int32Value', value: 30 },
    logicalType: ''
  },
  '@cat': {
    '$typeName': 'com.arcadedb.grpc.GrpcValue',
    kind: { case: 'stringValue', value: 'v' },
    logicalType: ''
  }
}
#1:1 {
  name: {
    '$typeName': 'com.arcadedb.grpc.GrpcValue',
    kind: { case: 'stringValue', value: 'Bob' },
    logicalType: ''
  },
  age: {
    '$typeName': 'com.arcadedb.grpc.GrpcValue',
    kind: { case: 'int32Value', value: 25 },
    logicalType: ''
  },
  '@cat': {
    '$typeName': 'com.arcadedb.grpc.GrpcValue',
    kind: { case: 'stringValue', value: 'v' },
    logicalType: ''
  }
}
```

`streamQuery` flattens the server's stream of row batches into one record at a time and does nothing

else — each `properties` entry is still a `GrpcValue` needing the same `unwrap` shown above. Both `retrievalMode` and `batchSize` are deliberately the caller's own choice; the wrapper picks no default for either. There are three retrieval modes:

- `CURSOR` — the proto default (value `0`). The server runs the query once and streams rows as you iterate.
- `MATERIALIZE_ALL` — the server runs the query to completion first, then batches the already-materialized result set back to you.
- `PAGED` — the client re-issues the query with `LIMIT`/`SKIP` per batch.

Leaving both fields out does not pick `CURSOR` and a sensible batch size as a considered choice — it sends whatever protobuf's zero values happen to be for those fields (`0`, which is `CURSOR`, and `0` rows per batch). Set both explicitly, as above.

### 4.20.7. Streaming inserts

`insertStream` owns the envelope bookkeeping the client-streaming `InsertStream` RPC needs — one session id for the stream, an incrementing chunk sequence, `database` on the first chunk, `last` on the final one — and leaves how rows are batched to you.

**`InsertStreamRequest.transaction` is forwarded but not honored.**

The field exists because the `.proto` declares it, and the driver sets it on every chunk exactly as you give it. On server 26.9.1 and earlier it buys nothing: the server ignores the `TransactionContext` on `InsertStream` entirely (ArcadeData/arcadedb#6607), builds its own insert context, and commits on its own. A batch you believe is atomic is not, and nothing errors to tell you so. That is also why `insertStream` is absent from the transaction handle below. Do not rely on it until #6607 lands.

### 4.20.8. Transactions

```
import { createClient, passwordAuth } from "@arcadedb/driver-grpc";

const grpc = createClient({
  baseUrl: "http://localhost:50051",
  auth: passwordAuth("root", "playwithdata", "mydb"),
  insecure: true,
});

const total = await grpc.transaction("mydb", async (tx) => {
  await tx.executeCommand({
    command: "INSERT INTO Account SET balance = 100, owner = 'grpc-demo-js'",
    language: "sql",
  });
  const response = await tx.executeQuery({
    query: "SELECT sum(balance) AS total FROM Account WHERE owner = 'grpc-demo-js'",
    language: "sql",
```

```
  });
  return response.results[0].records[0].properties.total.kind.value;
});
console.log("total:", total);
```

```
total: 100
```

`transaction(database, fn)` begins a server-side transaction, hands `fn` a `TransactionHandle`, and ends the transaction on both paths: it commits when `fn` resolves and returns the value `fn` returned, and rolls back and re-throws the original error when `fn` throws or rejects. A rollback that fails on that path is attached as `cause` on the original error rather than replacing it, and a failing commit issues a best-effort rollback first so the server-side session is released. A `commitTransaction` that resolves with `committed: false` — what the server answers for a transaction it already reaped — throws rather than reporting a success whose writes were lost.

The handle exposes `executeQuery`, `executeCommand`, `createRecord`, `updateRecord`, `deleteRecord`, `lookupByRid` and `streamQuery`, each with the transaction's `database` and `transaction` context bound in automatically, so you never set either yourself. Note the omissions: `insertStream` and `bulkInsert` are not on the handle, because the server does not run them inside your transaction at all — binding them there would silently lie.

The trap is the same one the HTTP driver has: calls made through the outer client while a transaction is open do not join it. Only calls through the handle take part.

### 4.20.9. Errors

Every RPC rejects with a Connect `ConnectError` on failure — this driver adds no error type of its own. `err.code` is a Connect `Code` and `err.rawMessage` is the server's message. Both come from `@connectrpc/connect`, which the driver depends on; add it to your own dependencies to import it directly.

```
import { Code, ConnectError } from "@connectrpc/connect";
import { createClient, passwordAuth } from "@arcadedb/driver-grpc";

const grpc = createClient({
  baseUrl: "http://localhost:50051",
  auth: passwordAuth("root", "playwithdata", "mydb"),
  insecure: true,
});

try {
  await grpc.raw.executeQuery({ database: "mydb", query: "SELECT FROM NoSuchType",
language: "sql" });
} catch (err) {
  if (err instanceof ConnectError) console.log(Code[err.code], err.rawMessage);
}
```

```
NotFound Type with name 'NoSuchType' was not found
```

The code you are most likely to meet first is `Unauthenticated`. A stock ArcadeDB gRPC server refuses anonymous calls, so a client built without `auth` is created happily and then fails on the first RPC:

```
import { Code, ConnectError } from "@connectrpc/connect";
import { createClient } from "@arcadedb/driver-grpc";

const anonymous = createClient({ baseUrl: "http://localhost:50051" });

try {
  await anonymous.raw.executeQuery({ database: "mydb", query: "SELECT FROM Person",
language: "sql" });
} catch (err) {
  if (err instanceof ConnectError) console.log(err.code === Code.Unauthenticated, err
.rawMessage);
}
```

```
true Authentication required
```

`ResourceExhausted` is the other code worth branching on: it is what a result set larger than the server's row cap returns, as described above.

### 4.20.10. Next steps

- Native Drivers — how this driver compares to the others, and when to reach for gRPC instead of HTTP.
- JavaScript / TypeScript — HTTP Driver — the HTTP counterpart, and the only option for browsers.
- The package README for the full method list, including `insertStream` and `transaction`.

## 4.21. JavaScript / TypeScript

**Connection options for JavaScript / TypeScript**

ArcadeDB exposes multiple wire protocols, so you can pick the one your stack already speaks:

- **Native HTTP driver** — `npm install @arcadedb/driver`, generated from ArcadeDB's OpenAPI contract. Start here for most applications.
- **Native gRPC driver** — `npm install @arcadedb/driver-grpc`, for streaming and bulk inserts.
- **Neo4j BOLT** — `npm install neo4j-driver`, run Cypher queries.

- **HTTP/JSON API** — use `fetch` or `axios`, no driver required.

This tutorial uses the PostgreSQL wire protocol, which is the right choice when you already run a PostgreSQL stack.

This tutorial shows how to connect to ArcadeDB from Node.js using the PostgreSQL wire protocol. You will create a graph, run queries, and use vector search — all from JavaScript.

### 4.21.1. Prerequisites

- ArcadeDB running with PostgreSQL protocol enabled (default port 5432)
- Node.js 18+
- `pg` library

```
npm install pg
```

### 4.21.2. Connect to ArcadeDB

ArcadeDB speaks the PostgreSQL wire protocol, so you can use the standard `pg` client. No special SDK is needed.

```
const { Client } = require('pg');

const client = new Client({
  host: 'localhost',
  port: 5432,
  database: 'mydb',
  user: 'root',
  password: 'arcadedb',
});

await client.connect();
console.log('Connected to ArcadeDB');
```

### 4.21.3. Create a Schema

Use SQL to create vertex and edge types:

```
// Create vertex types
await client.query('CREATE VERTEX TYPE Person IF NOT EXISTS');
await client.query('CREATE VERTEX TYPE Movie IF NOT EXISTS');

// Create edge type
await client.query('CREATE EDGE TYPE Acted IF NOT EXISTS');

// Insert data
```

```
await client.query("CREATE VERTEX Person SET name = 'Alice', age = 30");
await client.query("CREATE VERTEX Person SET name = 'Bob', age = 25");
await client.query("CREATE VERTEX Movie SET title = 'The Matrix', year = 1999");
await client.query(`
  CREATE EDGE Acted FROM (SELECT FROM Person WHERE name = 'Alice')
                    TO (SELECT FROM Movie WHERE title = 'The Matrix')
                    SET role = 'Trinity'
`);
```

### 4.21.4. Query with SQL

```
const result = await client.query(`
  MATCH {type: Person, as: person}.outE('Acted'){as: acted}.inV(){type: Movie, as:
movie}
  RETURN person.name AS name, movie.title AS title, acted.role AS role
`);

for (const row of result.rows) {
  console.log(`${row.name} acted in ${row.title} as ${row.role}`);
}
```

### 4.21.5. Query with Cypher

ArcadeDB supports Cypher queries through the same connection:

```
const result = await client.query(
  '{cypher} MATCH (p:Person)-[a:Acted]->(m:Movie) RETURN p.name, m.title, a.role'
);

for (const row of result.rows) {
  console.log(`${row['p.name']} acted in ${row['m.title']} as ${row['a.role']}`);
}
```

Prefix Cypher queries with `{cypher}` when using the PostgreSQL protocol.

### 4.21.6. Vector Search

Add embeddings to your data and query by similarity:

```
// Create a type with a vector property
await client.query('CREATE VERTEX TYPE Product IF NOT EXISTS');
await client.query('CREATE PROPERTY Product.embedding IF NOT EXISTS LIST OF FLOAT');
await client.query("CREATE INDEX IF NOT EXISTS ON Product (embedding) LSM_VECTOR
METADATA {dimensions: 4, similarity: 'COSINE'}");

// Insert products with embeddings
```

```
await client.query("CREATE VERTEX Product SET name = 'Laptop', embedding = [0.9, 0.1,
0.8, 0.2]");
await client.query("CREATE VERTEX Product SET name = 'Tablet', embedding = [0.8, 0.2,
0.7, 0.3]");
await client.query("CREATE VERTEX Product SET name = 'Phone',  embedding = [0.7, 0.3,
0.6, 0.4]");
await client.query("CREATE VERTEX Product SET name = 'Book',   embedding = [0.1, 0.9,
0.2, 0.8]");

// Find the 3 most similar products to a query vector
const similar = await client.query(`
  SELECT name, distance FROM (
    SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Product[embedding]', [0.85, 0.15, 0.75, 0.25], 3))
  )
`);
console.log('Similar products:');
for (const row of similar.rows) {
  console.log(`  ${row.name}`);
}
```

### 4.21.7. Full Example

```
#!/usr/bin/env node
/**
 * ArcadeDB JavaScript quickstart -- graph + vector search.
 */

const { Client } = require('pg');

async function main() {
  const client = new Client({
    host: 'localhost', port: 5432, database: 'mydb',
    user: 'root', password: 'arcadedb',
  });
  await client.connect();

  // Create schema
  await client.query('CREATE VERTEX TYPE Person IF NOT EXISTS');
  await client.query('CREATE VERTEX TYPE Movie IF NOT EXISTS');
  await client.query('CREATE EDGE TYPE Acted IF NOT EXISTS');

  // Insert data
  await client.query("CREATE VERTEX Person SET name = 'Alice', age = 30");
  await client.query("CREATE VERTEX Movie SET title = 'The Matrix', year = 1999");
  await client.query(`
    CREATE EDGE Acted FROM (SELECT FROM Person WHERE name = 'Alice')
                      TO (SELECT FROM Movie WHERE title = 'The Matrix')
                      SET role = 'Trinity'
  `);
```

```
  // Query with SQL MATCH
  const result = await client.query(`
    MATCH {type: Person, as: person}.outE('Acted'){as: acted}.inV(){type: Movie, as:
movie}
    RETURN person.name AS name, movie.title AS title, acted.role AS role
  `);
  for (const row of result.rows) {
    console.log(`${row.name} acted in ${row.title} as ${row.role}`);
  }

  await client.end();
}

main().catch(console.error);
```

### 4.21.8. Next Steps

- Supply Chain Use Case — Full JavaScript implementation with 7 query patterns
- PostgreSQL Protocol Reference
- SQL Reference
- HTTP/JSON API — Alternative: use `fetch()` with ArcadeDB's REST API

## 4.22. HTTP / JSON from JavaScript

**Connecting to ArcadeDB from JavaScript / TypeScript**

- **Native HTTP driver** — `npm install @arcadedb/driver`, generated from ArcadeDB's OpenAPI contract. Start here for most applications.
- **Native gRPC driver** — `npm install @arcadedb/driver-grpc`, for streaming and bulk inserts.
- **PostgreSQL wire protocol** — `npm install pg`, run SQL through a driver you may already have.
- **Neo4j BOLT** — `npm install neo4j-driver`, run Cypher queries.

This page covers the remaining option: calling the HTTP/JSON API directly, with no driver at all.

ArcadeDB's HTTP/JSON API is reachable from any HTTP client, so JavaScript can talk to it with nothing installed. Prefer `@arcadedb/driver` when you can — it gives you typed results, transactions, and error handling for one dependency. Reach for raw HTTP when you cannot add a dependency at all: a serverless function you want to keep cold-start-free, a build script, or a quick probe.

See the HTTP/JSON API reference for every endpoint and parameter.

### 4.22.1. Using fetch

`fetch` is built into Node.js 18 and later, and into every current browser — so this needs no packages.

```
const base = 'http://localhost:2480/api/v1';
const auth = 'Basic ' + Buffer.from('root:playwithdata').toString('base64');

const response = await fetch(`${base}/command/mydb`, {
  method: 'POST',
  headers: {
    Authorization: auth,
    'Content-Type': 'application/json',
  },
  body: JSON.stringify({
    language: 'sql',
    command: 'SELECT FROM Person LIMIT 10',
  }),
});

if (!response.ok) {
  throw new Error(`${response.status} ${await response.text()}`);
}

const data = await response.json();
console.log(data.result);
```

```
[
  {
    '@rid': '#1:0',
    '@type': 'Person',
    '@cat': 'v',
    name: 'Alice',
    age: 30
  }
]
```

`Buffer` is Node-only; in a browser, build the same header with `btoa('root:playwithdata')`.

Two things worth knowing. `fetch` does not throw on an HTTP error status — a 401 or a 500 resolves normally, and only a network failure rejects — so check `response.ok` yourself, as above. And `fetch` has no timeout at all: wrap the call with `signal: AbortSignal.timeout(5000)` if a hung connection would be worse than a failed one.

The response is the full envelope, not a bare array: `result` holds the rows, alongside `limit`, `returned`, and `truncated`. A `truncated` of `true` means the server stopped serializing before the result set ended, so `result` is a partial answer that looks exactly like a complete one — see Native Drivers for what to do about it.

### 4.22.2. Using axios

`axios` handles the base64 encoding and throws on non-2xx responses, which is the main reason to prefer it over `fetch` here.

```
npm install axios
```

```
import axios from 'axios';

const res = await axios.post(
  'http://localhost:2480/api/v1/command/mydb',
  { language: 'sql', command: 'SELECT FROM Person LIMIT 10' },
  { auth: { username: 'root', password: 'playwithdata' } },
);

console.log(res.data.result);
```

```
[
  {
    '@rid': '#1:0',
    '@type': 'Person',
    '@cat': 'v',
    name: 'Alice',
    age: 30
  }
]
```

### 4.22.3. TypeScript

Both examples are valid TypeScript as written, and need no type packages beyond the `@types/node` a Node project already has: `fetch` and `Buffer` come from it, and `axios` ships its own types. Annotate the response shape yourself if you want the rows typed:

```
interface QueryResponse<T> {
  result: T[];
  limit: number;
  returned: number;
  truncated: boolean;
}

const data = (await response.json()) as QueryResponse<{ name: string; age: number }>;
```

### 4.22.4. Further Reading

- Native HTTP driver — typed results, transactions, and error handling

- HTTP/JSON API reference — every endpoint and parameter
- Supply Chain Use Case — a full JavaScript implementation with 7 query patterns

## 4.23. Go — HTTP Driver

`github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb-drivers/go/arcadedb` is ArcadeDB's Go HTTP client, generated from the server's OpenAPI contract. A hand-written facade on top covers queries, commands, transactions, streaming, batch loading, vector search and time series.

### 4.23.1. Install

```
go get github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb-drivers/go/arcadedb@latest
```

Requires Go 1.26 or later. Go has no package registry: the module is fetched through the Go module proxy like any other, and each release is the git tag `go/arcadedb/v<version>` in the arcadedb-drivers repository.

### 4.23.2. Connect and query

```
package main

import (
    "context"
    "fmt"
    "log"

    "github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb-drivers/go/arcadedb"
)

func main() {
    ctx := context.Background()

    srv, err := arcadedb.NewServer("http://localhost:2480",
        arcadedb.WithBasicAuth("root", "playwithdata"))
    if err != nil {
        log.Fatal(err)
    }
    defer srv.Close()

    db := srv.DB("mydb")

    env, err := db.Query(ctx, arcadedb.SQL, "SELECT FROM Person WHERE age > ?", map
[string]any{"0": 21})
    if err != nil {
        log.Fatal(err)
    }
    fmt.Println(env.Result, env.Returned, env.Truncated)
```

```
}
```

```
[map[@cat:v @rid:#1:0 @type:Person age:30 name:Alice] map[@cat:v @rid:#1:1
@type:Person age:25 name:Bob]] 2 false
```

`Query` returns a `QueryEnvelope`. The rows are in `Result`, a `[]map[string]any`, and the envelope also carries `Limit`, `Returned` and `Truncated`. Check `Truncated` before you treat `Result` as the whole answer; Native Drivers explains why. Pass `arcadedb.WithLimit(n)` to `Query` to set the row cap for one call (`-1` for none). `Command` takes no limit.

Rows are decoded with `encoding/json`, so numbers arrive as `float64`. An integer larger than $2^{53}$ loses precision.

**Positional parameters are zero-indexed, and `"1"` silently returns nothing.**

Positional parameters are keyed by their zero-based index as a string. For the single placeholder above, the key is `"0"`, not `"1"`. Passing `map[string]any{"1": 21}` returns no error. The query runs with no value bound to `?` and comes back empty:

```
[] 0 false
```

Named parameters sidestep the problem: `"SELECT FROM Person WHERE age > :min"` with `map[string]any{"min": 21}`.

`NewServer` takes functional options:

- `WithBasicAuth(user, password)` or `WithBearerToken(token)`, for example a session token from `/api/v1/login`.
- `WithHeader(name, value)` adds a header to every request.
- `WithHTTPClient(client)` replaces the default `http.Client`.

A `*Server` is safe for concurrent use, and `srv.DB(name)` makes no request; it only returns a handle. Every call takes a `context.Context` as its first argument. There is no async variant of anything: run calls in goroutines when you want them concurrent.

**There is no timeout by default.**

Without `WithHTTPClient`, the server handle uses a bare `http.Client`, and Go's default client has no timeout. A call against a stalled connection can block forever. Bound each call with a context deadline:

```
ctx, cancel := context.WithTimeout(ctx, 5*time.Second)
defer cancel()
env, err := db.Query(ctx, arcadedb.SQL, "SELECT FROM Person", nil)
```

> You can also pass `arcadedb.WithHTTPClient(&http.Client{Timeout: 30 * time.Second})`. A client-level `Timeout` also cuts off a long streaming response halfway through, though, so for the streaming methods below prefer a per-call context.

`Close` releases idle connections, including those of a client you passed in with `WithHTTPClient`. Call it when you are done with the server handle, usually with `defer`.

### 4.23.3. Streaming queries

`QueryStream` and `CommandStream` read the result as newline-delimited JSON and return an `iter.Seq2[StreamEvent, error]`, so you range over them instead of holding the whole result in memory:

```
for ev, err := range db.QueryStream(ctx, arcadedb.SQL, "SELECT name FROM Person ORDER
BY name", nil) {
    if err != nil {
        log.Fatal(err)
    }
    if ev.Stats != nil {
        fmt.Println("returned", ev.Stats.Returned, "truncated", ev.Stats.Truncated)
        continue
    }
    fmt.Println(ev.Record["name"])
}
```

```
Alice
Bob
returned 2 truncated false
```

The iterator yields events. Each `StreamEvent` has either `Record` or `Stats` set, never both. The `Stats` event always comes last in a complete stream and carries the same `Limit`, `Returned` and `Truncated` values as the buffered envelope. If a stream ends without a `Stats` event, it was cut short (a server write timeout or a dropped connection, for example), and the rows you saw may be a partial answer.

Some behavior to know about:

- The request is sent on the first iteration and again on every later range over the same iterator. Treat the iterator as single-use.
- An error that happens after the server has sent its `200` status arrives in-band. The driver yields it once as an `*ArcadeDBError` with `Status` 200, and the loop ends. Rows yielded before it stay delivered.
- Leaving the loop early with `break` or `return` closes the response body.
- `CommandStream` only works for read-only statements. The server refuses a mutating statement with `400`, because the streamed rows would reach you before the commit, and that commit

could still roll back. Use `Command` for writes.

### 4.23.4. Transactions

```
var total any
err := db.Transaction(ctx, func(tx *arcadedb.Database) error {
    if _, err := tx.Command(ctx, arcadedb.SQL, "INSERT INTO Account SET balance =
100", nil); err != nil {
        return err
    }
    env, err := tx.Query(ctx, arcadedb.SQL, "SELECT sum(balance) AS total FROM
Account", nil)
    if err != nil {
        return err
    }
    total = env.Result[0]["total"]
    return nil
})
if err != nil {
    log.Fatal(err)
}
fmt.Println("total:", total)
```

```
total: 100
```

`Transaction` begins a server-side transaction and calls your function with a second `*Database`, `tx` above, that carries the transaction's session id. It takes a callback instead of returning a handle because Go has no `with` statement: a handle would rely on every caller remembering `defer tx.Rollback()`, while a callback cannot leak a session. The contract:

- If the function returns `nil`, the transaction commits.
- If the function returns an error or panics, the transaction rolls back and the error is returned (or the panic re-raised). If the rollback also fails, you get a `*arcadedb.TxError` whose `Unwrap` returns only your error, so `errors.Is` and `errors.As` match what your code produced. The rollback's error stays on the `RollbackErr` field.
- If the commit itself fails, a best-effort rollback is issued first, so the server-side session is not left open for `arcadedb.server.httpSessionExpireTimeout` to reap it.

Rollbacks run on `context.WithoutCancel(ctx)`, so a callback that failed because `ctx` was cancelled still gets its transaction rolled back.

Watch which handle you call. Calls made through the outer `db` while a transaction is open do not join it; each one auto-commits on its own. Only calls made through `tx` take part. Batch loads cannot join a transaction at all, so `tx.BatchLoad` returns `arcadedb.ErrBatchInTransaction` before sending anything.

### 4.23.5. Two error models

Facade methods return an `*arcadedb.ArcadeDBError` for any non-2xx response. `Ready` is the one exception: it answers a `503` with `false` and no error. Match the error with `errors.As`:

```
_, err := db.Query(ctx, arcadedb.SQL, "SELECT FROM NoSuchType", nil)
var aerr *arcadedb.ArcadeDBError
if errors.As(err, &aerr) {
    fmt.Println(aerr.Status, aerr.ErrorMessage, aerr.Detail, aerr.RequestID)
}
```

```
500 Internal error Type with name 'NoSuchType' was not found 44613703d0741a4c-11
```

`RequestID` is the server's `X-Request-Id` for that call and differs on every request; use it to find the failure in the server log. The body's `error` string is in `ErrorMessage` rather than `Error`, because Go does not allow a field and a method with the same name.

`srv.Raw()` takes the opposite approach. It returns the generated `*generated.ClientWithResponses`, which never turns a status code into an error: `err` reports transport failures only, and you check the status yourself.

```
resp, err := srv.Raw().ListDatabasesWithResponse(ctx)
if err != nil {
    log.Fatal(err) // transport failure only
}
fmt.Println(resp.StatusCode(), resp.JSON200.Result)
```

```
200 [mydb]
```

Use `Raw()` for the endpoints the facade does not wrap: security, cluster, authentication, MCP and metrics, and `POST /api/v1/server` for server commands. Mixing up which of the two surfaces you are calling is the most common way to end up with an unhandled failure.

`srv.Exists(ctx, name)` returns `false` both when a database does not exist and when it exists but the caller is not allowed to see it. The server answers both cases identically, so `false` is not proof that a database is absent.

### 4.23.6. Beyond queries

The database handle also has:

- `db.BatchLoad` and `db.BatchLoadStream` for bulk loading vertices and edges through `/api/v1/batch`. A load commits every `commitEvery` records, so it is not atomic: a load that fails partway leaves earlier chunks committed, and retrying the whole payload duplicates them.

- `db.Vector()` for vector, hybrid and full-text search.
- `db.TS()`, `db.Grafana()` and `db.PromQL()` for time-series ingestion and querying.

The package README linked below covers each of them.

### 4.23.7. Next steps

- Native Drivers — the result envelope and why `truncated` matters, and how this driver compares to the others.
- Go — gRPC Driver — the gRPC counterpart for throughput-sensitive server-to-server work.
- The package README for the full API, including batch loading, vector search and time series.
- The API reference on pkg.go.dev.

## 4.24. Go — gRPC Driver

`github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb-drivers/go/arcadedbgrpc` is ArcadeDB's Go gRPC client, generated from the server's Protobuf contract. A small facade on top handles authentication, the streaming RPCs and transactions. It shares no code and no dependency with the Go HTTP driver, so using one never downloads the other.

### 4.24.1. Install

```
go get github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb-drivers/go/arcadedbgrpc@latest
```

Requires Go 1.26 or later. The module depends only on `google.golang.org/grpc` and `google.golang.org/protobuf`.

**The gRPC server is a plugin, and it is not started by default.**

Register it in the server's plugin list before connecting:

```
-Darcadedb.server.plugins
=GRPC:com.arcadedb.server.grpc.GrpcServerPlugin
```

Once registered, it listens on port `50051`. See the gRPC API reference for the full option list, including TLS and message-size settings.

### 4.24.2. Connect and query

```
package main

import (
    "context"
    "fmt"
```

```
    "log"

    "github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb-drivers/go/arcadedbgrpc"
    "github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb-drivers/go/arcadedbgrpc/generated"
)

func main() {
    ctx := context.Background()

    c, err := arcadedbgrpc.NewClient("localhost:50051",
        arcadedbgrpc.WithPasswordAuth("root", "playwithdata", "mydb"),
        arcadedbgrpc.WithInsecure()) // plaintext, opted into explicitly
    if err != nil {
        log.Fatal(err)
    }
    defer c.Close()

    resp, err := c.Raw().ExecuteQuery(ctx, &generated.ExecuteQueryRequest{
        Database: "mydb",
        Query:    "SELECT FROM Person WHERE age > 21",
        Language: "sql",
    })
    if err != nil {
        log.Fatal(err)
    }
    for _, result := range resp.GetResults() {
        for _, rec := range result.GetRecords() {
            fmt.Println(rec.GetRid(), rec.GetProperties()["name"].GetStringValue())
        }
    }
}
```

```
#1:0 Alice
#1:1 Bob
```

The target is grpc-go's native form (`localhost:50051`, `[::1]:50051`, or a resolver name such as `dns:///db.example.com:50051`), not a URL. `NewClient` refuses a target that starts with `http://` or `https://`. Like `grpc.NewClient`, it performs no I/O: the connection opens on the first call.

A `*Client` is safe for concurrent use. Every call takes a `context.Context` first, and there is no default timeout, so bound calls with a context deadline. Every facade method also accepts trailing `…grpc.CallOption` values and passes them to grpc-go unchanged.

### 4.24.3. `Raw()` and the facade

`c.Raw()` is the generated client for `ArcadeDbService`, the data plane, and every one of its 21 RPCs is reachable through it, as `ExecuteQuery` is above. The facade adds wrappers for the RPCs that the generated client alone handles badly:

- `StreamQuery` and `TimeSeriesQuery` turn server streams into Go iterators.
- `InsertStream` and `TimeSeriesWriteStream` feed client streams from an iterator you supply.
- `Transaction` pairs begin, commit and rollback around a callback.

Everything else goes through `Raw()` directly: the CRUD calls, `VectorSearch`, `HybridSearch`, `FullTextSearch`, `TimeSeriesWrite`, `TimeSeriesLatest`, `BulkInsert`, `InsertBidirectional` and `GraphBatchLoad`.

Values come back as the generated protobuf types. In a `GrpcRecord`, the record id from `GetRid()` is a plain string, but each entry in `GetProperties()` is a `*generated.GrpcValue`, a protobuf message whose `Kind` oneof holds the real value. Unwrap it with a type switch:

```
func unwrap(v *generated.GrpcValue) any {
    switch k := v.GetKind().(type) {
    case *generated.GrpcValue_LinkValue:
        return k.LinkValue.GetRid()
    case *generated.GrpcValue_Int32Value:
        return k.Int32Value
    case *generated.GrpcValue_Int64Value:
        return k.Int64Value
    case *generated.GrpcValue_DoubleValue:
        return k.DoubleValue
    case *generated.GrpcValue_StringValue:
        return k.StringValue
    case *generated.GrpcValue_BoolValue:
        return k.BoolValue
    case nil:
        return nil
    default:
        return k // lists, maps, embedded documents, decimals, timestamps, bytes
    }
}

props := make(map[string]any, len(rec.GetProperties()))
for k, v := range rec.GetProperties() {
    props[k] = unwrap(v)
}
fmt.Println(rec.GetRid(), props)
```

```
#1:0 map[@cat:v @rid:#1:0 @type:Person age:30 name:Alice]
#1:1 map[@cat:v @rid:#1:1 @type:Person age:25 name:Bob]
```

`LinkValue` is the one scalar-looking case that is itself a message (`GrpcLink`), so read its `GetRid()`. The driver has no helper that does this unwrapping for you.

**A capped `ExecuteQuery` fails instead of truncating.**

`ExecuteQuery` builds its whole answer into one gRPC message, so the server caps it: `server.grpcQueryMaxResultRows` (100000 by default) is a hard ceiling, and a larger result fails the call with `ResourceExhausted`. Unlike the HTTP drivers, there is no `truncated` flag to check. Use `StreamQuery` for result sets that large. See Settings for the streaming limits.

### 4.24.4. Authentication is attached to the connection

`WithPasswordAuth(user, password, database)` and `WithBearerToken(token)` do not attach credentials to individual calls. `NewClient` installs them as connection interceptors that cover all four gRPC call shapes, so `c.Raw().ExecuteCommand(…)` carries the same metadata as `c.StreamQuery(…)`. Most RPCs are reachable only through `Raw()`; per-call credentials on the facade methods would leave all of those calls anonymous. The metadata is appended to whatever you already set on the outgoing context, so your own metadata (a request id, for example) still reaches the server.

**The insecure-channel guard.**

`WithPasswordAuth` sends the password as plaintext call metadata. To keep that from happening by accident, `NewClient` refuses to pair it with a plaintext connection unless you pass TLS through `WithTransportCredentials` or opt in with `WithInsecure()`:

```
_, err := arcadedbgrpc.NewClient("localhost:50051",
    arcadedbgrpc.WithPasswordAuth("root", "playwithdata", "mydb"))
fmt.Println(errors.Is(err, arcadedbgrpc.ErrInsecureChannel), err)
```

```
true arcadedbgrpc: refusing to send credentials over a connection
without transport credentials: NewClient would send a plaintext
password to "localhost:50051"; pass WithTransportCredentials(creds),
switch to WithBearerToken, or pass WithInsecure() to opt in explicitly
(ArcadeData/arcadedb#5048)
```

For TLS, pass `arcadedbgrpc.WithTransportCredentials(credentials.NewTLS(&tls.Config{}))`. Do not pass TLS through `WithDialOptions`: it works, but the guard cannot see it there and still demands `WithTransportCredentials` or `WithInsecure`. A bearer token is not a password and never trips the guard.

### 4.24.5. Streaming queries

```
for rec, err := range c.StreamQuery(ctx, &generated.StreamQueryRequest{
    Database:      "mydb",
    Query:         "SELECT FROM Person",
    Language:      "sql",
    RetrievalMode: generated.StreamQueryRequest_CURSOR,
    BatchSize:     500,
```

```
}) {
    if err != nil {
        log.Fatal(err) // a grpc-go status error; records already yielded stay yielded
    }
    fmt.Println(rec.GetRid(), rec.GetProperties()["name"].GetStringValue())
}
```

```
#1:0 Alice
#1:1 Bob
```

`StreamQuery` returns an `iter.Seq2[*generated.GrpcRecord, error]` that flattens the server's batches into one record at a time. It sends your request as given and picks no default for `RetrievalMode` or `BatchSize`, so set both. There are three retrieval modes:

- `CURSOR`, the proto zero value: the server runs the query once and streams rows as you iterate.
- `MATERIALIZE_ALL`: the server runs the query to completion first, then sends the result in batches.
- `PAGED`: the query is re-issued with `LIMIT`/`SKIP` for each batch.

The iterator is lazy and each range issues a new RPC, so treat it as single-use. Leaving the loop early cancels the server stream. A failure, including one in the middle of the stream, arrives once as a final `(nil, err)` pair.

### 4.24.6. Streaming inserts

`InsertStream` takes your rows as an `iter.Seq[[]*generated.GrpcRecord]`. Each batch becomes one wire chunk, so you decide how rows are batched. The driver handles the envelope: one session id for the stream, an incrementing chunk sequence, `Database` on the first chunk and `last` on the final one.

```
person := func(name string) *generated.GrpcRecord {
    return &generated.GrpcRecord{Type: "Person", Properties: map[string]*generated
.GrpcValue{
        "name": {Kind: &generated.GrpcValue_StringValue{StringValue: name}},
    }}
}
batches := func(yield func([]*generated.GrpcRecord) bool) {
    if !yield([]*generated.GrpcRecord{person("Carol")}) {
        return
    }
    yield([]*generated.GrpcRecord{person("Dave")})
}

sum, err := c.InsertStream(ctx, arcadedbgrpc.InsertStreamRequest{
    Database: "mydb",
    Options:  &generated.InsertOptions{TargetClass: "Person"},
    Chunks:   batches,
})
```

```
if err != nil {
    log.Fatal(err)
}
fmt.Println(sum.GetInserted(), sum.GetFailed())
```

```
2 0
```

Check the summary even when the error is `nil`. A server that ends the stream early with a summary makes the call return that summary and no error. Your sequence runs on the calling goroutine, so cancelling `ctx` does not interrupt a sequence that is blocked producing its next batch. If your sequence waits on a channel, a file or the network, have it watch `ctx` itself.

`TimeSeriesWriteStream` works the same way for time-series points. Its `Precision` field is a required pointer, because the enum's zero value is milliseconds, while the HTTP line-protocol endpoint treats a missing precision as nanoseconds.

### 4.24.7. Transactions

```
var total int32
err := c.Transaction(ctx, "mydb", func(tx *arcadedbgrpc.TxHandle) error {
    if _, err := tx.ExecuteCommand(ctx, &generated.ExecuteCommandRequest{
        Command:  "INSERT INTO Account SET balance = 100, owner = 'grpc-demo'",
        Language: "sql",
    }); err != nil {
        return err // rolls back
    }
    resp, err := tx.ExecuteQuery(ctx, &generated.ExecuteQueryRequest{
        Query:    "SELECT sum(balance) AS total FROM Account WHERE owner = 'grpc-
demo'",
        Language: "sql",
    })
    if err != nil {
        return err
    }
    total = resp.GetResults()[0].GetRecords()[0].GetProperties()["total"]
.GetInt32Value()
    return nil // commits
})
if err != nil {
    log.Fatal(err)
}
fmt.Println("total:", total)
```

```
total: 100
```

`Transaction` calls `BeginTransaction`, hands your function a `*TxHandle` bound to the new transaction,

and then commits or rolls back with the same contract as the HTTP driver:

- If the function returns `nil`, the transaction commits.
- If it returns an error or panics, the transaction rolls back and the error is returned (or the panic re-raised). If the rollback also fails, you get a `*arcadedbgrpc.TxError` whose `Unwrap` returns only your error.
- If the commit fails, a best-effort rollback runs first, and the commit's error is returned.
- A commit that the server answers with `committed=false` (a transaction it has already reaped, for example) returns `arcadedbgrpc.ErrNotCommitted` instead of reporting success.

The handle has `ExecuteQuery`, `ExecuteCommand`, `CreateRecord`, `UpdateRecord`, `DeleteRecord`, `LookupByRid`, `VectorSearch`, `HybridSearch`, `FullTextSearch`, `TimeSeriesLatest`, `StreamQuery` and `TimeSeriesQuery`. Each sends a copy of your request with `Database` and the `Transaction` field set to this transaction, so you never set either yourself, and the request you passed in is left untouched for reuse. `InsertStream` and `TimeSeriesWriteStream` are not on the handle, and `BulkInsert`, `InsertBidirectional` and `GraphBatchLoad` are raw-only.

As with the HTTP driver, calls made through `c` or `c.Raw()` while the function runs do not join the transaction. Do not keep the handle after `Transaction` returns: the server refuses its calls with `FailedPrecondition`.

### 4.24.8. Errors

A failed RPC returns grpc-go's status error unchanged, from `Raw()` and from every facade method. The driver adds no error type of its own for server failures. Match it with `status.Code(err)` or `status.FromError(err)`:

```
_, err := c.Raw().ExecuteQuery(ctx, &generated.ExecuteQueryRequest{
    Database: "mydb", Query: "SELECT FROM NoSuchType", Language: "sql",
})
if st, ok := status.FromError(err); ok && st.Code() != codes.OK {
    fmt.Println(st.Code(), st.Message())
}
```

```
NotFound Query execution failed: Type with name 'NoSuchType' was not found
```

The status you are most likely to meet first is `Unauthenticated`. A stock ArcadeDB gRPC server refuses anonymous calls, so a client built without an auth option connects fine and then fails on the first RPC with `Authentication required`.

The facade's own refusals are sentinel errors, matched with `errors.Is`: `ErrInsecureChannel`, `ErrNoTransactionID` (the server returned a blank transaction id, so your function never ran) and `ErrNotCommitted`. Match `*TxError` with `errors.As`.

### 4.24.9. Administration: `RawAdmin`

Server administration lives on a second service, `ArcadeDbAdminService`: 44 RPCs covering databases, users, groups, API tokens, settings, backups, the profiler and cluster operations. `Raw()` does not reach it. `c.RawAdmin()` returns its generated client on the same connection:

```
admin, err := c.RawAdmin()
if err != nil {
    log.Fatal(err) // ErrInsecureChannel: the client has neither TLS nor WithInsecure
}
resp, err := admin.ListDatabases(ctx, &generated.ListDatabasesRequest{
    Credentials: &generated.DatabaseCredentials{Username: "root", Password:
"playwithdata"},
})
if err != nil {
    log.Fatal(err)
}
fmt.Println(resp.GetDatabases())
```

```
[mydb]
```

Admin RPCs take their credentials inside the request message, not from the connection, so `WithPasswordAuth` and `WithBearerToken` do not authenticate them. Because those credentials travel in the request body, `RawAdmin` has its own guard: it returns `ErrInsecureChannel` unless the client was built with `WithTransportCredentials` or `WithInsecure`, whatever auth option you chose. A plaintext client without `WithInsecure` still works for the data plane; only `RawAdmin` fails.

### 4.24.10. Next steps

- Native Drivers — how this driver compares to the others, and when to reach for gRPC instead of HTTP.
- Go — HTTP Driver — the HTTP counterpart for general application traffic.
- The package README for the time-series streams, vector search and the full transaction contract.
- The API reference on pkg.go.dev.

## 4.25. Go

**Connection options for Go**

ArcadeDB exposes multiple wire protocols, so you can pick the one your stack already speaks:

- **Native HTTP driver** — `go get github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb-drivers/go/arcadedb`, generated from ArcadeDB's OpenAPI contract. Start here

for most applications.

- **Native gRPC driver** — `go get github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb-drivers/go/arcadedbgrpc`, for streaming and bulk inserts.
- **Neo4j BOLT** — `go get github.com/neo4j/neo4j-go-driver/v5`, run Cypher queries.

This tutorial uses the PostgreSQL wire protocol, which is the right choice when you already run a PostgreSQL stack.

This tutorial shows how to connect to ArcadeDB from Go using the PostgreSQL wire protocol and pgx. You will create a graph, query it with SQL and Cypher, and run a vector search.

### 4.25.1. Prerequisites

- ArcadeDB running with the PostgreSQL protocol enabled (default port 5432)
- Go 1.25+ (required by pgx v5)
- The `pgx` driver

```
go get github.com/jackc/pgx/v5
```

### 4.25.2. Connect to ArcadeDB

No ArcadeDB-specific SDK is needed. `pgx` connects with an ordinary PostgreSQL connection string:

```
package main

import (
    "context"
    "fmt"
    "log"

    "github.com/jackc/pgx/v5"
)

func main() {
    ctx := context.Background()

    conn, err := pgx.Connect(ctx,

"postgres://root:arcadedb@localhost:5432/mydb?sslmode=disable&default_query_exec_mode=
exec")
    if err != nil {
        log.Fatal(err)
    }
    defer conn.Close(ctx)

    fmt.Println("Connected to ArcadeDB")
```

```
}
```

**Why `default_query_exec_mode=exec`?**

By default, pgx prepares each statement and asks the server for its parameter types. ArcadeDB reports every parameter as text, so pgx then refuses to send a Go `int` or `float64` for it:

```
failed to encode args[0]: unable to encode 26 into text format for
varchar (OID 1043): cannot find encode plan
```

In `exec` mode, pgx sends parameters as text without asking the server first, and ArcadeDB converts them. `simple_protocol` works too. You can also choose the mode for a single call by passing `pgx.QueryExecModeExec` as the first argument after the SQL.

### 4.25.3. Create a Schema

Use SQL to create vertex and edge types, then insert some data:

```
for _, stmt := range []string{
    "CREATE VERTEX TYPE Person IF NOT EXISTS",
    "CREATE VERTEX TYPE Movie IF NOT EXISTS",
    "CREATE EDGE TYPE Acted IF NOT EXISTS",
    "CREATE VERTEX Person SET name = 'Alice', age = 30",
    "CREATE VERTEX Person SET name = 'Bob', age = 25",
    "CREATE VERTEX Movie SET title = 'The Matrix', year = 1999",
    `CREATE EDGE Acted FROM (SELECT FROM Person WHERE name = 'Alice')
                       TO (SELECT FROM Movie WHERE title = 'The Matrix')
                       SET role = 'Trinity'`,
} {
    if _, err := conn.Exec(ctx, stmt); err != nil {
        log.Fatalf("%s: %v", stmt, err)
    }
}
```

Parameters use PostgreSQL's `$1`, `$2` placeholders:

```
tag, err := conn.Exec(ctx, "CREATE VERTEX Person SET name = $1, age = $2", "Carol",
41)
if err != nil {
    log.Fatal(err)
}
fmt.Println(tag)
```

```
INSERT 0 1
```

### 4.25.4. Query with SQL

```
rows, err := conn.Query(ctx, `
    MATCH {type: Person, as: person}.outE('Acted'){as: acted}.inV(){type: Movie, as:
movie}
    RETURN person.name AS name, movie.title AS title, acted.role AS role`)
if err != nil {
    log.Fatal(err)
}
defer rows.Close()

for rows.Next() {
    var name, title, role string
    if err := rows.Scan(&name, &title, &role); err != nil {
        log.Fatal(err)
    }
    fmt.Printf("%s acted in %s as %s\n", name, title, role)
}
if err := rows.Err(); err != nil {
    log.Fatal(err)
}
```

```
Alice acted in The Matrix as Trinity
```

Always check `rows.Err()` after the loop: `rows.Next()` returns `false` both at the end of the result and on an error, and only `rows.Err()` tells the two apart.

### 4.25.5. Query with Cypher

ArcadeDB supports Cypher queries through the same connection:

```
rows, err := conn.Query(ctx,
    "{cypher} MATCH (p:Person)-[a:Acted]->(m:Movie) RETURN p.name AS name, m.title AS
title, a.role AS role")
if err != nil {
    log.Fatal(err)
}
defer rows.Close()

for rows.Next() {
    var name, title, role string
    if err := rows.Scan(&name, &title, &role); err != nil {
        log.Fatal(err)
    }
```

```
    fmt.Printf("%s acted in %s as %s\n", name, title, role)
}
```

Prefix Cypher queries with `{cypher}` when using the PostgreSQL protocol.

### 4.25.6. Vector Search

Add embeddings to your data and query by similarity:

```
for _, stmt := range []string{
    // A type with a vector property and an index on it
    "CREATE VERTEX TYPE Product IF NOT EXISTS",
    "CREATE PROPERTY Product.embedding IF NOT EXISTS LIST OF FLOAT",
    "CREATE INDEX IF NOT EXISTS ON Product (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA
{dimensions: 4, similarity: 'COSINE'}",

    // Products with embeddings
    "CREATE VERTEX Product SET name = 'Laptop', embedding = [0.9, 0.1, 0.8, 0.2]",
    "CREATE VERTEX Product SET name = 'Tablet', embedding = [0.8, 0.2, 0.7, 0.3]",
    "CREATE VERTEX Product SET name = 'Phone',  embedding = [0.7, 0.3, 0.6, 0.4]",
    "CREATE VERTEX Product SET name = 'Book',   embedding = [0.1, 0.9, 0.2, 0.8]",
} {
    if _, err := conn.Exec(ctx, stmt); err != nil {
        log.Fatalf("%s: %v", stmt, err)
    }
}

// Find the 3 products most similar to a query vector
rows, err := conn.Query(ctx, `
    SELECT name, distance FROM (
      SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Product[embedding]', [0.85, 0.15, 0.75, 0.25],
3))
    )`)
if err != nil {
    log.Fatal(err)
}
defer rows.Close()

fmt.Println("Similar products:")
for rows.Next() {
    var name string
    var distance float64
    if err := rows.Scan(&name, &distance); err != nil {
        log.Fatal(err)
    }
    fmt.Printf("  %s (%.4f)\n", name, distance)
}
```

```
Similar products:
  Laptop (0.0025)
  Tablet (0.0029)
  Phone (0.0306)
```

See the vector search tutorial for the index options and similarity functions.

### 4.25.7. Full Example

```go
// ArcadeDB Go quickstart: a small graph queried over the PostgreSQL protocol.
package main

import (
    "context"
    "fmt"
    "log"

    "github.com/jackc/pgx/v5"
)

func main() {
    ctx := context.Background()

    conn, err := pgx.Connect(ctx,

"postgres://root:arcadedb@localhost:5432/mydb?sslmode=disable&default_query_exec_mode=
exec")
    if err != nil {
        log.Fatal(err)
    }
    defer conn.Close(ctx)

    // Create schema and data
    for _, stmt := range []string{
        "CREATE VERTEX TYPE Person IF NOT EXISTS",
        "CREATE VERTEX TYPE Movie IF NOT EXISTS",
        "CREATE EDGE TYPE Acted IF NOT EXISTS",
        "CREATE VERTEX Person SET name = 'Alice', age = 30",
        "CREATE VERTEX Movie SET title = 'The Matrix', year = 1999",
        `CREATE EDGE Acted FROM (SELECT FROM Person WHERE name = 'Alice')
                           TO (SELECT FROM Movie WHERE title = 'The Matrix')
                           SET role = 'Trinity'`,
    } {
        if _, err := conn.Exec(ctx, stmt); err != nil {
            log.Fatalf("%s: %v", stmt, err)
        }
    }

    // Query with SQL MATCH
```

```
    rows, err := conn.Query(ctx, `
        MATCH {type: Person, as: person}.outE('Acted'){as: acted}.inV(){type: Movie,
as: movie}
        RETURN person.name AS name, movie.title AS title, acted.role AS role`)
    if err != nil {
        log.Fatal(err)
    }
    defer rows.Close()

    for rows.Next() {
        var name, title, role string
        if err := rows.Scan(&name, &title, &role); err != nil {
            log.Fatal(err)
        }
        fmt.Printf("%s acted in %s as %s\n", name, title, role)
    }
    if err := rows.Err(); err != nil {
        log.Fatal(err)
    }
}
```

### 4.25.8. Next Steps

- PostgreSQL Protocol Reference
- SQL Reference
- Go HTTP driver — the native driver, which adds ArcadeDB's batch loading and vector search APIs

## 4.26. C#

**Connection options for C# / .NET**

ArcadeDB exposes multiple wire protocols, so you can pick the one your stack already speaks:

- **Neo4j BOLT** — `Install-Package Neo4j.Driver`, run Cypher queries.
- **PostgreSQL wire protocol** — `Install-Package Npgsql`, run SQL.
- **HTTP/JSON API** — use `HttpClient`, no driver required.

This page covers the HTTP/JSON approach. Per-protocol C# examples for BOLT and PostgreSQL are coming soon.

### 4.26.1. Sample Code

In C#/.NET 7.0/8.0, HTTP/JSON requests can be made using the `HTTPClient` class inside an async function.

In real situations, the `HTTPClient` object should not be created or discarded on each request. `HTTPClient` should be typically created once in the lifespan of an application, stored in a Singleton Instance or static reference/class, and reused for each request. Here it is created in the function just for simplicity.

The following example demonstrates a simple function which will add a record of the type `Profile` to a database named `mydb` with the name `Alexander`.

```
public async void addProfileName(){
    HttpClient httpClient = new(); //typically instantiate this only once over course
of application, then reuse
    HttpRequestMessage msg = new();
    msg.Method = HttpMethod.Post;
    string authString = "root:arcadedb-password"; //add your password here
    string base64AuthString = Convert.ToBase64String
(System.Text.ASCIIEncoding.ASCII.GetBytes(authString));
    msg.Headers.Authorization = new("Basic", base64AuthString);
    msg.RequestUri = new Uri("http://serveraddress:2480/api/v1/command/mydb"); //add
your server address (or localhost) and db name
    HttpContent httpContent = new StringContent("{ \"language\": \"sql\", \"command\":
\"INSERT into Profile set name = \'Alexander\'\" }", Encoding.UTF8,
"application/json"); //customize command here
    msg.Content = httpContent;
    HttpResponseMessage response = await httpClient.SendAsync(msg);
    string responseString = await response.Content.ReadAsStringAsync();
    Debug.WriteLine("SENT REQUEST, RESPONSE: " + responseString);
}
```

## 4.27. C

**Connection options for C**

ArcadeDB exposes multiple wire protocols, so you can pick the one your stack already speaks:

- **PostgreSQL wire protocol** — use `libpq`, run SQL.
- **HTTP/JSON API** — use `libcurl`, no driver required.

There is no actively maintained Neo4j BOLT driver for plain C. If you need Cypher from C, the easiest path is to call out to one of the BOLT-capable languages (Python, Go) over an FFI, or use the HTTP/JSON API and target the OpenCypher endpoint.

### 4.27.1. PostgreSQL Wire Protocol — `libpq`

```
#include <stdio.h>
#include <libpq-fe.h>
```

```c
int main(void) {
    PGconn *conn = PQconnectdb(
        "host=localhost port=5432 dbname=mydatabase user=root password=playwithdata");
    if (PQstatus(conn) != CONNECTION_OK) {
        fprintf(stderr, "connection failed: %s", PQerrorMessage(conn));
        PQfinish(conn);
        return 1;
    }

    PGresult *res = PQexec(conn, "SELECT FROM schema:types LIMIT 5");
    for (int i = 0; i < PQntuples(res); i++)
        printf("%s\n", PQgetvalue(res, i, 0));

    PQclear(res);
    PQfinish(conn);
    return 0;
}
```

Build:

```
gcc example.c -lpq -o example
```

### 4.27.2. HTTP/JSON API — `libcurl`

```c
#include <curl/curl.h>

int main(void) {
    CURL *curl = curl_easy_init();
    curl_easy_setopt(curl, CURLOPT_URL,
        "http://localhost:2480/api/v1/query/mydatabase");
    curl_easy_setopt(curl, CURLOPT_USERPWD, "root:playwithdata");

    struct curl_slist *headers = NULL;
    headers = curl_slist_append(headers, "Content-Type: application/json");
    curl_easy_setopt(curl, CURLOPT_HTTPHEADER, headers);

    const char *body =
        "{\"language\":\"sql\","
        " \"command\":\"SELECT FROM schema:types LIMIT 5\"}";
    curl_easy_setopt(curl, CURLOPT_POSTFIELDS, body);

    curl_easy_perform(curl);

    curl_slist_free_all(headers);
    curl_easy_cleanup(curl);
    return 0;
}
```

Build:

```
gcc example.c -lcurl -o example
```

## 4.28. C++

**Connection options for C++**

ArcadeDB exposes multiple wire protocols, so you can pick the one your stack already speaks:

- **PostgreSQL wire protocol** — use `libpqxx`, run SQL.
- **HTTP/JSON API** — use `cpp-httplib`, `cpp-restclient`, or `libcurl`, no driver required.

There is no actively maintained Neo4j BOLT driver for C. If you need Cypher from C, the easiest path is to use the HTTP/JSON API or to embed a BOLT-capable runtime (e.g. Python via pybind11).

### 4.28.1. PostgreSQL Wire Protocol — `libpqxx`

```
#include <pqxx/pqxx>
#include <iostream>

int main() {
    pqxx::connection conn(
        "host=localhost port=5432 dbname=mydatabase "
        "user=root password=playwithdata");

    pqxx::work tx{conn};
    auto result = tx.exec("SELECT FROM schema:types LIMIT 5");

    for (auto const &row : result)
        std::cout << row[0].c_str() << "\n";

    tx.commit();
    return 0;
}
```

Build:

```
g++ -std=c++17 example.cpp -lpqxx -lpq -o example
```

### 4.28.2. HTTP/JSON API — cpp-httplib

```
#include <httplib.h>
#include <iostream>

int main() {
    httplib::Client cli("http://localhost:2480");
    cli.set_basic_auth("root", "playwithdata");

    auto res = cli.Post(
        "/api/v1/query/mydatabase",
        R"({"language":"sql","command":"SELECT FROM schema:types LIMIT 5"})",
        "application/json");

    if (res) std::cout << res->body << "\n";
    return 0;
}
```

Build (header-only library):

```
g++ -std=c++17 example.cpp -o example
```

## 4.29. Rust

**Connection options for Rust**

ArcadeDB exposes multiple wire protocols, so you can pick the one your stack already speaks:

- **Neo4j BOLT** — the community `neo4rs` crate, run Cypher queries.
- **PostgreSQL wire protocol** — the `postgres` crate (or the async `tokio-postgres`), run SQL.
- **HTTP/JSON API** — `reqwest` or any HTTP client, no driver required.

### 4.29.1. Neo4j BOLT — neo4rs

`Cargo.toml`:

```
[dependencies]
neo4rs = "0.7"
tokio = { version = "1", features = ["full"] }
```

```
use neo4rs::*;
```

```
#[tokio::main]
async fn main() -> Result<()> {
    let graph = Graph::new("bolt://localhost:7687", "root", "playwithdata").await?;
    let mut result = graph.execute(query("MATCH (n) RETURN n LIMIT 5")).await?;
    while let Ok(Some(row)) = result.next().await {
        println!("{:?}", row);
    }
    Ok(())
}
```

### 4.29.2. PostgreSQL Wire Protocol — postgres

Cargo.toml:

```
[dependencies]
postgres = "0.19"
```

```
use postgres::{Client, NoTls};

fn main() -> Result<(), postgres::Error> {
    let mut client = Client::connect(
        "host=localhost port=5432 dbname=mydatabase \
         user=root password=playwithdata",
        NoTls,
    )?;

    for row in client.query("SELECT FROM schema:types LIMIT 5", &[])? {
        let value: &str = row.get(0);
        println!("{}", value);
    }
    Ok(())
}
```

### 4.29.3. HTTP/JSON API — reqwest

Cargo.toml:

```
[dependencies]
reqwest = { version = "0.12", features = ["json", "blocking"] }
serde_json = "1"
```

```
use serde_json::json;

fn main() -> Result<(), reqwest::Error> {
    let body = json!({
```

```
        "language": "sql",
        "command":  "SELECT FROM schema:types LIMIT 5"
    });

    let res = reqwest::blocking::Client::new()
        .post("http://localhost:2480/api/v1/query/mydatabase")
        .basic_auth("root", Some("playwithdata"))
        .json(&body)
        .send()?
        .text()?;

    println!("{}", res);
    Ok(())
}
```

# 4.30. Ruby

**Connection options for Ruby**

ArcadeDB exposes multiple wire protocols, so you can pick the one your stack already speaks:

- **Neo4j BOLT** — the community `neo4j-ruby-driver` gem, run Cypher queries.
- **PostgreSQL wire protocol** — the `pg` gem, run SQL.
- **HTTP/JSON API** — standard library `Net::HTTP` or the `faraday` gem, no driver required.

## 4.30.1. Neo4j BOLT — `neo4j-ruby-driver`

```
gem install neo4j-ruby-driver
```

```
require "neo4j/driver"

driver = Neo4j::Driver::GraphDatabase.driver(
  "bolt://localhost:7687",
  Neo4j::Driver::AuthTokens.basic("root", "playwithdata"),
  encryption: false
)

driver.session(database: "mydatabase") do |session|
  session.run("MATCH (n) RETURN n LIMIT 5").each do |record|
    puts record.values
  end
end
```

```
driver.close
```

### 4.30.2. PostgreSQL Wire Protocol — pg

```
gem install pg
```

```
require "pg"

conn = PG.connect(
  host:     "localhost",
  port:     5432,
  dbname:   "mydatabase",
  user:     "root",
  password: "playwithdata"
)

conn.exec("SELECT FROM schema:types LIMIT 5") do |result|
  result.each { |row| puts row.values.first }
end

conn.close
```

### 4.30.3. HTTP/JSON API — Net::HTTP

```
require "net/http"
require "json"
require "uri"

uri = URI("http://localhost:2480/api/v1/query/mydatabase")

req = Net::HTTP::Post.new(uri, "Content-Type" => "application/json")
req.basic_auth("root", "playwithdata")
req.body = JSON.dump(
  language: "sql",
  command:  "SELECT FROM schema:types LIMIT 5"
)

res = Net::HTTP.start(uri.host, uri.port) { |http| http.request(req) }
puts JSON.parse(res.body)
```

## 4.31. R

**Connection options for R**

ArcadeDB exposes multiple wire protocols, so you can pick the one your stack

already speaks:

- **PostgreSQL wire protocol** — the `RPostgreSQL` package (or the modern `RPostgres`), run SQL.
- **HTTP/JSON API** — the `httr2` or `httr` package, no driver required.

There is no Neo4j BOLT driver for R. The closest option is the community `neo4r` package, which talks to Neo4j over HTTP/Cypher rather than BOLT, so it does not work directly against ArcadeDB. Use the HTTP/JSON API for OpenCypher queries from R.

### 4.31.1. PostgreSQL Wire Protocol — `RPostgres`

```
install.packages("RPostgres")
library(DBI)

con <- dbConnect(
  RPostgres::Postgres(),
  host     = "localhost",
  port     = 5432,
  dbname   = "mydatabase",
  user     = "root",
  password = "playwithdata"
)

result <- dbGetQuery(con, "SELECT FROM schema:types LIMIT 5")
print(result)

dbDisconnect(con)
```

### 4.31.2. HTTP/JSON API — `httr2`

```
install.packages("httr2")
library(httr2)

response <- request("http://localhost:2480/api/v1/query/mydatabase") |>
  req_auth_basic("root", "playwithdata") |>
  req_body_json(list(
    language = "sql",
    command  = "SELECT FROM schema:types LIMIT 5"
  )) |>
  req_perform()

print(resp_body_json(response))
```

# 4.32. Elixir

**Connection options for Elixir**

The community has not yet released a Neo4j BOLT driver for Elixir, and the PostgreSQL Elixir libraries (`postgrex` / Ecto adapter) introspect Postgres-specific catalogs that ArcadeDB does not implement. The recommended way to talk to ArcadeDB from Elixir is therefore the **HTTP/JSON API** using a library like HTTPoison or `Req`.

If your team has tried BOLT or PostgreSQL from Elixir successfully, we'd love to add an example — please open a discussion.

## 4.32.1. Configuration

Ensure the Phoenix Elixir framework is installed as per official instructions.

A test project named `testproject` can then be created in a given folder by running `mix phx.new testproject`. Various options during project creation are available.

A package such as HTTPoison must next be added to perform HTTP Requests.

Open the newly created `mix.exs` file and add the line `{:httpoison, "~> 2.2"}` (check current version of the package as indicated on the HTTPoison Package site):

```
defp deps do
    [
      {:phoenix, "~> 1.7.10"},
      # ... other packages
      {:httpoison, "~> 2.2"}
    ]
  end
```

Save and close `mix.exs`. Run `mix deps.get` to update the project and download `HTTPoison` into this project.

To start an interactive prompt enter `cd testserver` and then `iex -S mix phx.server`. This will begin an Interactive Elixir command prompt as indicated by `iex()>`.

## 4.32.2. Sample Code

A simple HTTP request can then be performed by running the following commands sequentially:

```
userPass = "root:arcadedb-password"
base64UserPass = Base.encode64(userPass)
authString = "Basic " <> base64UserPass
url = "http://serveraddress:2480/api/v1/command/mydb"
body = Jason.encode!(%{language: "sql", command: "SELECT from Profile"})
```

```
headers = [{"Authorization", authString}, {"Content-Type", "application/json"}]
HTTPoison.post(url, body, headers)
```

To process returned data, one can use the following approach:

```
case HTTPoison.post(url, body, headers) do
  {:ok, %{status_code: 200, body: body}} ->
    # do something with the body
    Jason.decode!(body)

  {:ok, %{status_code: 404}} ->
    # do something with a 404
    IO.puts("error404")

  {:error, %{reason: reason}} ->
    # do something with an error
    IO.puts(reason)

end
```

# Chapter 5. API & Integration

## 5.1. API & Integration

## 5.2. HTTP/JSON API

**Overview Endpoints**

| Action | Method | Endpoint |
|---|---|---|
| Get OpenAPI definition | GET | `/api/v1/openapi.json` |
| Get server status | GET, HEAD | `/api/v1/ready` |
| Check server liveness | GET, HEAD | `/api/v1/health` |
| Get server information | GET | `/api/v1/server` |
| Send server command | POST | `/api/v1/server` |
| List databases | GET | `/api/v1/databases` |
| Does database exist | GET | `/api/v1/exists/{database}` |
| Login (get auth token) | POST | `/api/v1/login` |
| Logout (invalidate token) | POST | `/api/v1/logout` |
| List active sessions | GET | `/api/v1/sessions` |
| Execute a query | GET | `/api/v1/query/{database}/{language}/{query}` |
| Execute a query | POST | `/api/v1/query/{database}` |
| Execute database command | POST | `/api/v1/command/{database}` |
| Begin a new transaction | POST | `/api/v1/begin/{database}` |
| Commit a transaction | POST | `/api/v1/commit/{database}` |
| Rollback a transaction | POST | `/api/v1/rollback/{database}` |
| Batch import vertices and edges | POST | `/api/v1/batch/{database}` |

**Overview Query & Command Parameters**

| Parameter | Type | Values |
|---|---|---|
| language | Required | `sql`, `sqlscript`, `graphql`, `cypher`, `gremlin`, `mongo`, and others |
| command | Required | encoded command string |
| awaitResponse | Optional | set synchronous (`true`, default) or asynchronous (`false`) command |
| limit | Optional | maximum number of results |

| Parameter | Type | Values |
|---|---|---|
| params | Optional | map of parameters |
| serializer | Optional | `graph`, `record`, `studio` |
| autoCommit | Optional | Boolean. `true` to force atomic transaction, `false` to disable, omit for automatic behavior |

### 5.2.1. Introduction

The ArcadeDB Server is accessible from the remote through the HTTP/JSON protocol. The protocol is very simple. For this reason, you don't need a driver, because every modern programming language provides an easy way to execute HTTP requests and parse JSON.

For the examples in this chapter we're going to use `curl`. Every request must be authenticated by passing user and password as HTTP basic authentication (in HTTP Headers). In the examples below we're going to always use "root" user with password "arcadedb-password".

Under Windows (Powershell) single and double quotes inside a single or double quoted string need to be replaced with their Unicode entity representations `\u0022` (double quote) and `\u0027` (single quote). This is for example the case in the data argument (`-d`) of POST requests.

### 5.2.2. Token-Based Authentication

In addition to HTTP Basic Authentication, ArcadeDB supports token-based authentication. This allows you to login once with credentials and receive a token that can be used for subsequent requests, avoiding the need to send username and password with every request.

This is particularly useful when:

- Building applications that make multiple API calls
- You want to avoid storing credentials in your application
- You need to manage user sessions with explicit logout capability

**Authentication Flow:**

1. Call `POST /api/v1/login` with Basic Auth credentials to obtain a token
2. Use the token in subsequent requests via `Authorization: Bearer <token>` header
3. Call `POST /api/v1/logout` to invalidate the token when done

Example workflow:

```
# 1. Login and get a token
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/login \
       --user root:arcadedb-password

# Response: {"token":"AU-ArcadeDB_0-2af64e60-8455-423a-bc64-
```

```
ed0e19729f04","user":"root"}

# 2. Use the token for subsequent requests
$ curl http://localhost:2480/api/v1/query/mydb/sql/select%201 \
       -H "Authorization: Bearer AU-ArcadeDB_0-2af64e60-8455-423a-bc64-ed0e19729f04"

# 3. Logout when done
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/logout \
       -H "Authorization: Bearer AU-ArcadeDB_0-2af64e60-8455-423a-bc64-ed0e19729f04"
```

Authentication tokens expire after a configurable period of inactivity (default is 30 minutes). See `server.httpAuthSessionExpireTimeout` to configure this timeout.

**Token revocation:**

Since version 26.9.1, deleting a user or changing its password immediately invalidates every token already issued to that user, on every server of a cluster. Previously such a token kept working until it expired on its own. This applies however the change is made: the `/api/v1/server/users` endpoints, the `create user` / `drop user` server commands, the Cypher `CREATE USER` / `ALTER USER … SET PASSWORD` / `DROP USER` statements, or an edit to `server-users.jsonl`.

**Tokens in a cluster:**

Since version 26.10.1 a token issued by one server of a cluster is honoured by every other server, so a load balancer in front of the cluster needs no sticky sessions. The token names the server that issued it, `AU-<server name>-<uuid>`, where the server name is the value of `arcadedb.server.name` (any character outside letters, digits, `.`, `_` and `-` is replaced with `_`). A server that receives a token it has never seen asks the issuer once, through the cluster-internal channel protected by the cluster token, and keeps a local copy for the following requests. The copy is confirmed with the issuer periodically (a third of `server.httpAuthSessionExpireTimeout`, at most every 60 seconds), which also counts as activity on the issuer, so a token in use anywhere in the cluster does not expire at its source. A logout served by any server drops the copies on every other server. If the issuer no longer holds the session (it expired there, or the server restarted) the copies are dropped at their next confirmation; if the issuer cannot be reached, a copy is served for at most one idle timeout and then dropped.

Every server must be able to map the name in the token to a member of the cluster. This is the same rule a server uses to find itself in `arcadedb.ha.serverList`: a `name@host:port` entry, a host equal to the server name, or a `-N` / `_N` suffix giving the position in the list (the Kubernetes Helm chart satisfies it as-is). A token whose name matches no member is refused without asking anyone. Tokens in the previous `AU-<uuid>` form are still accepted, but only by the server that issued them.

API tokens (`at-` prefix) work the same way on every server: since 26.10.1 they are replicated to the whole cluster, like users and groups (see Cluster security

documents).

**Number of concurrent tokens:**

Since version 26.9.1 the server bounds how many authentication tokens it keeps. A single user may hold up to `server.httpAuthSessionMaxPerUser` tokens (default `100`); past that, its own oldest token is invalidated to make room for the new one, and no other user is ever affected. Across all users the server keeps up to `server.httpAuthSessionMax` tokens (default `10000`); expired tokens are reclaimed first, and a login that still finds no room is answered `503`. Set either setting to `0` for the previous unlimited behaviour (not recommended: an unbounded number of sessions is a memory-exhaustion risk).

The client metadata stored with a session (`User-Agent`, `CF-Connecting-IP`, `X-Forwarded-For`, `CF-IPCountry`, `CF-IPCity`) is truncated to 256 characters.

### 5.2.3. Server-Side Transactions

ArcadeDB implements server-side transaction over HTTP stateless protocol by using sessions. A session is created with the /begin request and returns a session id in the response header (example `arcadedb-session-id: AS-ee056170-dc9b-4956-8d71-d7cfa01900d4`). Use the session id in the request header of further commands you want to execute in the same transaction and request /commit to commit the server side transaction or /rollback to rollback the changes. After a period of inactivity (default is 5 seconds, see `server.httpSessionExpireTimeout`), the server automatically rolls back and purges expired transactions.

If a request names a session id the server can no longer resolve - because it expired, or was already committed or rolled back - a **write** is refused with `404`, while a **read** still answers, running outside any transaction. A read that degraded this way says so: the response carries an `arcadedb-session-expired` header holding the id that could not be resolved, so a client can tell it apart from a read that ran inside its transaction. This applies to `GET /query`, `/begin`, `/commit`, `/rollback` and the time-series and Prometheus read endpoints.

The time-series and observability endpoints accept a session id so they run under that session's user and keep it from expiring while you use it, but they do **not** take part in its transaction: samples are durable as soon as they are written, and the reads only read. Since 26.10.1 an error on one of them therefore leaves your open transaction exactly as it was. Before, it rolled the transaction back while leaving the session alive, so a later `/commit` reported success and the work was silently gone. The endpoints this covers:

- the three time-series endpoints, `/api/v1/ts/{database}/write`, `/query` and `/latest`;
- the PromQL endpoints under `/api/v1/ts/{database}/prom`, and the Prometheus `remote_read` and `remote_write` endpoints;
- the Grafana query, metadata and health endpoints.

The two errors easiest to hit on the observability routes are a malformed `start`/`end` timestamp and a read whose answer exceeds `arcadedb.server.maxResultRows`; neither touches your transaction any more.

Since v26.11.1 the same holds for `GET /api/v1/query` and `POST /api/v1/query`. They still run inside the session's transaction, so they see what you wrote in it, but they only read, so an error on them leaves your open transaction as it was: a `413` for an answer over `arcadedb.server.maxResultRows`, or a `400` for a request refused before the query ran (for example `Accept: application/x-ndjson` on a statement that cannot be streamed). `POST /api/v1/command` also leaves the transaction alone for a `400` of this kind, which includes a malformed request body: a missing `command`, a field of the wrong type (such as a numeric `language`), a `limit` that is not an integer, or a `$bytes`/`$int8` parameter marker that cannot be decoded. An error raised by the statement itself on `/api/v1/command` still rolls the transaction back, as described under Commit a transaction.

### 5.2.4. Transaction Scripts

In case SQL (`sql`) is supposed to be used as language for a transactions, the language variant SQL Script (`sqlscript`) is also available. A `sqlscript` can consist of one or multiple SQL statements, which is collectively treated as a transaction. Hence, for such a batch of SQL statements, no `begin` and `commit` commands are necessary, since `begin` and `commit` implicitly enclose any `sqlscript` command.

### 5.2.5. Streaming Change Events

This feature only works on the server where changes are executed. In a replicated environment, the changes executed on other servers would not fire events on all the servers in the cluster, but only on the local server. The cluster support is coming soon.

The Java API supports real-time change notifications, which the HTTP API implements via a websocket. You can opt into notifications for all changes that occur on a database, or filter by the operation (i.e. create, update, delete) or underlying entity type.

To connect, point your favorite WebSocket client to the `ws://SERVER:PORT/ws` endpoint. You will need to authenticate with HTTP Basic, which for some clients (like most browsers) is only possible via the URI, like this: `ws://USERNAME:PASSWORD@SERVER:PORT/ws`. Others will require that you set the Authorization header directly. Check the documentation for your client of choice for details.

To subscribe/unsubscribe to change events, send JSON messages using the following structure:

| Property | Required | Description |
|---|---|---|
| **action** | **Required** | `subscribe` or `unsubscribe`. |
| **database** | **Required** | The database name. |
| **type** | **Optional** | The entity type to filter by. |
| **changeTypes** | **Optional** | Array of change types you'd like to receive. Must be `create`, `update`, or `delete`. |

Example: to subscribe to all changes (create, update, delete) for the type `Movie` in the database

`movies`, use:

```
{"action": "subscribe", "database": "movies", "type": "Movie"}
```

If instead, you only want updates, send:

```
{"action": "subscribe", "database": "movies", "type": "Movie", "changeTypes":
["update"]}
```

If you want every change on the database (use with caution!):

```
{"action": "subscribe", "database": "movies"}
```

Once subscribed, you will get JSON messages for any matching changes with the following properties:

| Property | Description |
|---|---|
| **database** | The source database. |
| **changeType** | create, update or delete. |
| **record** | The full record that generated the change event. |

A subscription is not permanent. Starting from v26.9.1, the server re-checks on every event that the connected user is still allowed to read the database: if that access is revoked, or the user is deleted, the subscription is dropped and the connection closed instead of continuing to stream.

A subscriber is also expected to keep reading. Events are sent asynchronously, so a client that stops consuming them accumulates unsent frames in the server's memory. Once more than `server.eventBusMaxPendingBytes` (16 MB by default) is outstanding towards one connection, that subscription is dropped and the connection closed. Set it to `0` to disable the limit.

In `production` server mode an `error` frame answering a failed action carries "The request failed. Check the server log for the details" instead of the engine's message, which is written to the server log (since v26.11.1). See Error details in production mode.

### 5.2.6. Streaming Inserts over WebSocket

Starting from v26.10.1, the same `ws://SERVER:PORT/ws` connection can run a duplex insert session: the client sends records in chunks and gets one acknowledgement per chunk while it is still sending the next, and it decides when the session commits. This is the WebSocket counterpart of the gRPC `InsertBidirectional` RPC. Each frame is a JSON object whose `action` is one of:

| Action | Description |
|---|---|
| **start** | Opens a session on `database`. Optional `sessionId` (the server generates one when absent) and `options`, see below. Answered with `started`, which echoes the modes the session runs under. |
| **chunk** | `sessionId`, `chunkSeq` (contiguous from 1; re-sending an applied chunk is acknowledged as a replay and not applied again) and `records`, an array of JSON objects. A record takes its type from `@class` or from the session's `targetType`; an edge names its endpoints with `@from` and `@to` (`out` / `in` are accepted too). Answered with `batchAck`. |
| **commit, rollback** | Ends the session. Answered with `committed`, whose `outcome` says which of the two it was and whose `summary` carries the totals of the whole session. |

The `options` object of `start` accepts:

| Option | Description |
|---|---|
| **targetType** | Default type of the records, overridable per record with `@class`. |
| **transactionMode** | `per_stream` (default, also spelled `per_request`): one transaction for the whole session, committed or rolled back by the client. `per_batch`: one transaction per chunk, committed before its acknowledgement. `per_row`: one transaction per record. Under the last two, `committed` reports `partialCommit: true` because a `rollback` cannot take back what was already committed. |
| **conflictMode** | What to do with a record whose key is already taken: `error` (default) reports it as a failed row with the error code `CONFLICT`; `update` rewrites the existing record with the incoming values; `ignore` drops it; `abort` is accepted for parity with gRPC and behaves as `error`. The gRPC spellings (`CONFLICT_UPDATE`, ...) are accepted as well. |
| **keyColumns** | The properties an existing record is matched on. Required for `update`. When absent, a duplicate is found by the engine where the transaction commits: per row under `per_row`, per chunk under `per_batch`, and on the `commit` frame under `per_stream`, which is then answered with an error and closes the session. |
| **updateColumnsOnConflict** | With `update`, the only properties overwritten. When absent, every non-key property sent is merged; a null value never overwrites, and an edge's endpoints are never changed. |
| **validateOnly** | `true` to parse and count every record without writing anything. |

The `batchAck` frame carries `chunkSeq`, the counters `received`, `inserted`, `updated`, `ignored`, `failed`, and an `errors` array with `rowIndex`, `code` and `message` for each record that could not be applied; the rest of the chunk still goes in. A session the client walks away from - the connection drops, or no frame arrives for `server.wsInsertSessionExpireTimeout` milliseconds - is rolled back, and the idle case is reported with an unsolicited `error` frame.

In `production` server mode the engine's text in an `error` frame and in the `message` of an `errors` entry (for a conflict, the key values the row carried) is replaced by "The

> request failed. Check the server log for the details", and the detail is written to the server log. The `code` and the exception class are kept. Text the protocol writes about the request itself, such as a missing `keyColumns`, an invalid option or an expired session, stays visible. Before v26.11.1 the message was sent as is in every mode. See Error details in production mode.

A `/ws` connection is allowed `server.wsMaxControlFrameSize` (64 KB by default) per text frame until it has an insert session, and `server.wsMaxInsertFrameSize` (16 MB) while it has one, so a `chunk` can carry a whole batch while a connection that never inserts stays on the small budget. A frame over the budget in force closes the connection with a `1009` close code. A separate cap, `server.wsMaxInsertChunkRows` (100,000), bounds the number of records in one `chunk` after parsing; a chunk over it is refused with an `error` frame and leaves the session open, so the client can split the batch and resend it under the same `chunkSeq`.

Example, upserting people by `email`:

```
{"action": "start", "database": "crm", "options": {"targetType": "Person",
"conflictMode": "update", "keyColumns": ["email"]}}
{"action": "chunk", "sessionId": "...", "chunkSeq": 1, "records": [{"email": "a@x.io",
"name": "Ann"}, {"email": "b@x.io", "name": "Bob"}]}
{"action": "commit", "sessionId": "..."}
```

### 5.2.7. Responses

The server answers a HTTP request with a response. This response can have a body, which will always be in the JSON format. Generally, a successful response (HTTP status codes 2xx) contains a `result` field, while an erroneous request (HTTP status code 4xx) has an `error` field, and a server error (HTTP status code 5xx), in addition to the `error` field, provides a `detail` and an `exception` field.

### 5.2.8. Retrying Requests Safely (`X-Request-Id`)

Every request can carry an `X-Request-Id` header. The server echoes it on the response and logs it with the request (it generates one when the request has none), which is what correlates a failure with the server log.

On a `POST` it also makes a retry safe to send verbatim. A successful (`2xx`) response is kept for `arcadedb.ha.idempotencyCacheTtlMs` milliseconds, keyed by the id together with the method, path, database and body, and bound to the authenticated user. An identical retry is answered from it instead of executing the request a second time, so a client that lost the answer to a write, a restore or an import can simply send it again with the same id.

- A failed request is not kept: its retry executes afresh.
- While the first request is still executing, an identical retry waits briefly for it and then answers `409 Conflict` with a `Retry-After` header, naming `RequestStillInFlightException`. The request was not executed again: retry it later with the same id to receive the result of the execution in progress.
- A `restore database`, `restore backup` or `import database` asked for as an SSE progress stream

(`Accept: text/event-stream`) is replayed as a one-event stream carrying its `completed` event, since a finished stream cannot be sent again. A retry without that header receives the JSON answer instead, whichever way the first request asked.

- Not replayed: a request inside a client-managed transaction (it carries `arcadedb-session-id`), a request asking for an NDJSON stream, a response larger than `arcadedb.ha.idempotencyCacheMaxBodyBytes` bytes, and the bulk-load route `POST /api/v1/batch/{database}`, whose body is streamed rather than buffered and so cannot be part of the key.

Every response carries the header `X-ArcadeDB-Replay-Protection: true`, which tells a client that this server answers a repeated id from that cache. The remote Java driver (`RemoteDatabase`, `RemoteServer`) sends one `X-Request-Id` per `command` call, outside a transaction, and once it has seen that header it sends the same call again, with the same id, to the same server when the response was lost, instead of failing with "the server may already have applied it". The retry names the server process in `X-ArcadeDB-Replay-Instance`: a server that restarted, or that no longer holds the answer (too large to keep, expired or evicted), answers `412` and does not run the request again. *(Since v26.10.1.)*

Use a new id for every distinct request. The OpenAPI document declares the header and the `409` on every `POST` operation that honours them.

### 5.2.9. Tutorial

Let's first create an empty database "school" on the server:

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server \
       -d '{"command": "create database school"}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Now let's create the type "Class":

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/command/school \
       -d '{"language": "sql", "command": "create document type Class"}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

We could insert our first Class by using SQL:

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/command/school \
       -d '{"language": "sql", "command": "insert into Class set name = '\''English'
\'', location =  '\''3rd floor'\''"}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Or better, using parameters with SQL:

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/command/school \
       -d '{"language": "sql", "command": "insert into Class set name = :name,
location = :location", "params": {"name": "English", "location": "3rd floor"}}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

### 5.2.10. Reference

#### Get OpenAPI Definition (GET)

Returns a JSON document containing the HTTP API's OpenAPI definition.

URL Syntax: `/api/v1/openapi.json`

Response:

- `200` OK

Example:

```
$ curl -X GET "http://localhost:2480/api/v1/openapi.json"
```

Return:

```
{"openapi":"3.0.3", ... }
```

#### Check if server is ready (GET, HEAD)

Returns a header-only (no content) status about if the ArcadeDB server is ready.

URL Syntax: `/api/v1/ready`

This endpoint accepts GET or HEAD requests without authentication, and is useful for remote monitoring of server readiness. Use it as a Kubernetes **readiness** probe. HEAD is supported so tools that check health with a HEAD request (e.g. `wget --spider`) work out of the box.

Responses:

- `204` OK — server is `ONLINE`
- `503` server not started yet

When `arcadedb.server.readinessRequiresHA=true` and HA is active, readiness additionally requires the node to have joined the Raft group: it returns `503` (`Node has not yet joined the Raft group`) until a leader has been elected. Once a leader is known, a second gate requires the node to be a member of the current Raft configuration and, for a follower, to have replayed the committed log to within `arcadedb.server.readinessHAMaxLag` entries of the commit index; until then it returns `503` (`Node is not yet in the Raft configuration or has not caught up`). This keeps a (re)joined follower with a

wiped or lagging log out of traffic during a rolling restart, so the write quorum is not dropped. The default (`false` for `readinessRequiresHA`) preserves the behavior above. See Health probes.

Example:

```
$ curl -I -X GET "http://localhost:2480/api/v1/ready"
```

Return:

```
HTTP/1.1 204 OK
```

#### Check server liveness (GET, HEAD)

Returns a header-only (no content) liveness status. Use it as a Kubernetes **liveness** probe.

URL Syntax: `/api/v1/health`

This endpoint accepts GET or HEAD requests without authentication and performs no database I/O. It returns `204` whenever the server process and HTTP layer are up; unlike readiness it never reports a busy state, so a warming-up node is not restarted. The one exception: on a High Availability cluster, a node that has given up recovering from a crash loop returns `503`, so the orchestrator restarts it. See Health probes.

Response:

- `204` OK — server process and HTTP layer are up
- `503` Service Unavailable — (HA only) the node is stuck in an unrecoverable crash loop and needs a restart

Example:

```
$ curl -I -X GET "http://localhost:2480/api/v1/health"
```

Return:

```
HTTP/1.1 204 OK
```

#### Get server information (GET)

Returns the current configuration.

URL Syntax: `/api/v1/server`

The following `mode` query parameter values are available:

- `basic` returns minimal server information.

- `default` returns full server configuration (default value when no parameter is given).
- `cluster` returns cluster layout.

In `default` mode the `settings` array reports, for each server-level setting, the value this server is actually running on in `value` and the built-in default in `default`, with `overridden` telling you whether the two differ because the setting was given an explicit value - in the server configuration file, by an embedding application, or at runtime with `set server setting`. Secrets are masked: settings that are secrets in their entirety (the HA cluster token, any key containing `password`) report `, and arcadedb.server.defaultDatabases, whose value merely *embeds` credentials, keeps its database names, user names and groups while each password is replaced *(since v26.10.1)*.

Responses:

- `200` OK
- `403` invalid credentials

Example:

```
$ curl -X GET "http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server?mode=basic" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Return:

```
{"version": "26.10.1", "serverName": "ArcadeDB_0"}
```

**Send server command (POST)**

Sends control commands to server.

URL Syntax: `/api/v1/server`

The following commands are available:

- `list databases` returns the list of databases installed in the server
- `create database <dbname>` creates database with name `dbname`
- `drop database <dbname>` deletes database with name `dbname`
- `open database <dbname>` opens database with name `dbname`
- `close database <dbname>` closes database with name `dbname`. Refused while a backup, restore, import, export or another close of the same database is running, so it cannot pull the database out from under one; retry once that operation finishes
- `create user { "name": "<username>", "password": "<password>", "databases": { "<dbname>": "admin", "<dbname>": "admin" } }` creates user credentials `username` and `password` and admin access to databases `dbname`.
- `drop user <username>` deletes user `username`

- `get server events [<filename>]` returns a list of server events, optionally a filename of the form `server-event-log-yyyymmdd-HHMMSS.INDEX.jsonl` (where `INDEX` is a integer, i.e. `0`) can be given to retrieve older event logs
- `shutdown [<serverName>]` kills a server gracefully: this one when no name is given, otherwise the named peer of the HA cluster. See Shutdown server.
- `set server setting <key> <value>` sets the server setting with `key` to `value`, see the list of server-level settings
- `set database setting <dbname> <key> <value>` sets the database's <dbname> with `key` to `value`, see the list of database-level settings
- `connect cluster <address>` connects this server to a cluster with `address`
- `disconnect cluster` disconnects this server from a cluster
- `align database <dbname>` aligns database `<dbname>`, see the associated SQL command
- `restore database <dbname> <url>` restores a database from a backup file. The URL can be a local path (`file://`), HTTP/HTTPS URL, or classpath resource. The database must not already exist. See how-to/operations/restore.pdf.
- `import database <dbname> <url>` creates a new database and imports data from the given URL (OrientDB export, GraphML, GraphSON, CSV, JSON). Combines `create database` and `IMPORT DATABASE` in a single command. See how-to/migration/importer.pdf.
- `list queries [database <dbname>] [tag <label>]` lists the statements the server is running. See List and terminate running queries.
- `terminate query <id>` and `terminate queries tag <label>` stop running statements and say whether they stopped. See List and terminate running queries.
- `list transactions` lists the open transaction sessions, and `terminate transaction <sessionId>` rolls one back and ends it. See List and terminate running queries.

Both `restore database` and `import database` support **SSE progress streaming**: send `Accept: text/event-stream` in the request headers to receive real-time progress events instead of waiting for the response. With an `X-Request-Id`, a retry of a restore or import that completed is replayed rather than run again, in either encoding (see Retrying Requests Safely (`X-Request-Id`)).

Only **root** users can run these command, except the `list databases` command, which every user can run, and this user's accessible databases are listed, and the commands on running work (`list queries`, `terminate query`, `terminate queries`, `list transactions`, `terminate transaction`), which every user can run on their own work.

Responses:

- `200` OK
- `400` invalid command
- `403` invalid credentials
- `404` the command names a database this server does not have

- `500` invalid JSON request body

Since 26.10.1, a command naming a database that does not exist - `open database nosuchdb`, for example - answers `404` instead of `500`. Naming a database the server has not got is a mistake in the request, not a server fault, and it is the same status the server already gave for a database that is closed or dropped. Adjust any monitoring that alerts on `5xx` from this endpoint.

Examples:

**List databases**

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server \
       -d '{"command": "list databases"}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Return:

```
{"result": ["school", "mydatabase"]}
```

**Create database**

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server \
       -d '{"command": "create database mydatabase"}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Return:

```
{"result": "ok"}
```

**Drop database**

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server \
       -d '{"command": "drop database mydatabase"}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Return:

```
{"result": "ok"}
```

#### Open database

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server \
       -d '{"command": "open database mydatabase"}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Return:

```
{"result": "ok"}
```

#### Close database

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server \
       -d '{"command": "close database mydatabase"}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Return:

```
{"result": "ok"}
```

#### Restore database

Restores a database from a backup file (local or remote). This is the fastest way to provision a database from a backup archive.

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server \
       -d '{"command": "restore database mydatabase
https://example.com/backups/mydatabase.zip"}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Restoring from a local file:

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server \
       -d '{"command": "restore database mydatabase file:///path/to/mydatabase-
backup.zip"}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Return:

```
{"result": "ok"}
```

#### Create user

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server \
       -d '{"command": "create user {\"name\": \"myuser\", \"password\":
\"mypassword\", \"databases\": {\"mydatabase\": \"admin\"}}"}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Return:

```
{"result": "ok"}
```

#### Drop user

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server \
       -d '{"command": "drop user myuser"}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Return:

```
{"result": "ok"}
```

#### Shutdown server

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server \
       -d '{"command": "shutdown"}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Return:

```
{"result": "ok"}
```

### Shutting down another node of an HA cluster

Naming a server after the command stops that peer instead of the one receiving the request. The command is relayed over the cluster's own transport — encrypted when the cluster has TLS configured for its side channels, see TLS/SSL for peer-to-peer transfers:

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server \
       -d '{"command": "shutdown arcadedb-1"}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

The name is matched as a substring against each peer's identifier and its HTTP address, so a partial name is enough:

- **No peer matches** it — the request fails with `Cannot find server '<name>' in the cluster`.
- **More than one peer matches** it — the request is refused rather than resolved to an arbitrary one. `arcadedb-1` matches `arcadedb-10` as well, so on a cluster holding both, name the one you mean exactly.
- **The name is this server** — this server shuts down, exactly as the plain `shutdown` command does.

In a Kubernetes StatefulSet each pod's hostname is the name to use (`arcadedb-0`, `arcadedb-1`, ...). Prefer `POST /api/v1/cluster/leave` when the intent is to take a node out of the cluster rather than to stop its process.

#### Get server events

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server \
       -d '{"command": "get server events"}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Return:

```
{"result": [{"time": "2023-06-18 15:37:40.378", "type": "INFO", "component": "Server",
"message": "ArcadeDB Server started in \u0027development\u0027 mode (CPUs\u003d8
MAXRAM\u003d4,00GB)"}]}
```

#### Set server setting

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server \
       -d '{"command": "set server setting arcadedb.server.name player0"}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Return:

```
{"result": "ok"}
```

#### Set database setting

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server \
       -d '{"command": "set database setting mydb arcadedb.typeDefaultBuckets 4"}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Return:

```
{"result": "ok"}
```

#### Connect cluster

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server \
       -d '{"command": "connect cluster 192.168.0.1"}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Return:

```
{"result": "ok"}
```

This adds the given server to **this** server's cluster; it does not make this server join another cluster. *(Since v26.10.1)* An address that resolves to this server itself is refused with `400` instead of being silently accepted as a no-op.

#### Disconnect cluster

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server \
       -d '{"command": "disconnect cluster"}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Return:

```
{"result": "ok"}
```

#### Align database

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server \
       -d '{"command": "align database mydb"}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
```

```
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Return:

```
{"result": "ok"}
```

#### List and terminate running queries

Since 26.11.1 a client can see what the server is running, stop one statement, and verify afterwards that the server really stopped working on it. A benchmark harness or a coordinator that gives up on a query (its own deadline, a killed client process) uses this to free the server before it runs the next one.

The list covers every protocol, not only HTTP: statements received over PostgreSQL, Bolt, gRPC, MongoDB, Redis and the Gremlin Server are listed and stopped the same way, and the same registry answers the Cypher `SHOW TRANSACTIONS` and `TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS` commands and the Studio Running Queries tab.

**Label your work.** Send the `X-ArcadeDB-Query-Tag` header with a query, a command, a GET query or a batch load. The value is an opaque label of at most 256 printable characters; the statement is listed under it. Sent to `/api/v1/begin`, it labels every statement of that transaction session that carries no label of its own. A value that breaks these rules is refused with `400 Bad Request` on every endpoint, before anything runs or a transaction session is created. *(Since v26.11.1: a refused tag on `/api/v1/begin` still opened a transaction session that no client could end.)*

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/command/mydb \
       -H "X-ArcadeDB-Query-Tag: bench-run-42" \
       -d '{"language": "opencypher", "command": "UNWIND range(1, 10000) AS i UNWIND
range(1, 10000) AS j RETURN sum(sin(toFloat(i * j))) AS total"}' \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

**List.** `list queries` returns the statements this server is running. `database <dbname>` and `tag <label>` narrow the list (the label runs to the end of the command):

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server \
       -d '{"command": "list queries tag bench-run-42"}' \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

```
{"result": [{"id": "q118-5e1f0a9c", "server": "ArcadeDB_0", "database": "mydb",
"user": "root", "protocol": "http",
  "language": "opencypher", "text": "UNWIND range(1, 10000) AS i UNWIND ...", "tag":
"bench-run-42",
  "startedAt": 1791620000000, "elapsedMs": 2311, "terminating": false}]}
```

An id is `q<n>-<instance>`: the instance part belongs to the server that issued it, so a `terminate query`

that a load balancer sends to another server answers `not found` there rather than stopping a different statement. The text is truncated to 1024 characters, and the parameters are never listed. `protocol` names how the statement reached the server: `http`, `postgres`, `bolt`, `grpc`, `mongodb`, `redis` or `gremlin` (the Gremlin Server). Some entries carry more fields:

| Field | Present when |
|---|---|
| `sessionId` | The statement runs in an HTTP transaction session. |
| `connectionId` | The protocol keeps connections of its own: the backend process id of a PostgreSQL connection (what `pg_backend_pid()` answers, see Cancelling a statement), `bolt-<n>` for a Bolt connection, the channel id of a MongoDB connection, the connection name of a Redis connection. |
| `clientAddress` | The address of the client the statement came from, for the protocols that keep a connection. |
| `forwardedFrom` | On an HA leader, for a statement a replica forwarded to it: the id the statement has on that replica. |
| `forwardedTo` | On an HA replica, for a statement it forwarded to the leader: the name of the leader running it. |

**Terminate.** `terminate query <id>` stops a statement, and `terminate queries tag <label>` stops every statement carrying the label that you may see - for **root**, every user's statement carrying it. The command waits for the work to end before it answers, up to `wait` milliseconds in the request (5000 when absent, 10000 at most; poll `list queries` for longer), and says what happened:

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server \
       -d '{"command": "terminate query q118-5e1f0a9c", "wait": 2000}' \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

```
{"result": {"id": "q118-5e1f0a9c", "status": "terminated"}}
```

| Status | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `terminated` | The statement stopped, and what it wrote was rolled back. |
| `completed` | The statement ended on its own before it noticed the request: what it did stands, a write it committed included. |
| `terminating` | The statement was asked to stop and has not reached a check yet. Poll `list queries` until it is gone. |
| `not found` | No such statement is running: it already ended, or it is not one you may see. |

The terminated request fails with HTTP `409` and `"error": "Query terminated"`. It is not a transient error: do not retry it. The Java `RemoteDatabase` raises it as `com.arcadedb.exception.QueryTerminatedException`, which its `transaction()` does not retry. Once a statement is gone from `list queries`, its rollback and its cleanup are over: its absence is the

evidence that the server no longer works on it.

Each protocol reports the termination to its client in its own terms, never as a transient error:

| Protocol | The terminated statement fails with |
|---|---|
| HTTP | Status `409`, `"error": "Query terminated"`. |
| PostgreSQL | SQLSTATE `57014` (`query_canceled`). The connection stays open. |
| Bolt | `Neo.ClientError.Transaction.Terminated`, which drivers do not retry. |
| gRPC | Status `CANCELLED` with the trailer `arcadedb-exception-class` set to `com.arcadedb.exception.QueryTerminatedException`. The gRPC Java client raises that exception. |
| MongoDB | Error code `11601` (`Interrupted`), what MongoDB answers for an operation `killOp` interrupted. |
| Redis | An `ERR` error whose message says the statement was terminated. |

Termination is cooperative: the statement stops at its next check, made by the SQL and openCypher operators that loop over data (scans, expansions, UNWIND, aggregations, sorts, FOREACH, script lines), and its commit is refused if it reaches one. A Gremlin traversal checks inside its adjacency steps (`out()`, `bothE()`, ...) and while its results are iterated. A JavaScript script (`command("js", …)`), a JavaScript function called from SQL (`DEFINE FUNCTION … LANGUAGE js`) and a JavaScript trigger are interrupted through GraalVM, so even an endless loop in user code stops; the SQL such a script runs is stopped as any other.

**Clients that go away.** A client that disconnects while its statement runs (a closed socket, a killed process, `curl --max-time`) terminates the statement, instead of leaving the server busy with it until it completes or reaches `arcadedb.command.timeout`. This applies to plain HTTP/1.x connections once the request body has been read, not to TLS connections, to HTTP/2, or to a request whose client has already pipelined the next one. A statement that runs in a transaction session and is terminated this way follows the transaction session rule below. Keep-alive and pipelined requests are not affected. A client that half-closes its side of the connection after sending the request and still waits for the response cannot be told from one that left: for such clients, set `arcadedb.server.httpTerminateOnClientDisconnect` to `false`.

**Transaction sessions.** Terminating a command that writes in a transaction session (`/api/v1/command`, `/api/v1/batch`) also ends the session and rolls back everything the session wrote, exactly as a failure of that command does. Terminating a read (`GET` or `POST /api/v1/query`) or a time-series, vector, PromQL or Grafana request stops only that request and leaves the session and its transaction as they were, so a client whose read timed out can retry it and still commit its writes *(since v26.11.1)*. `list transactions` lists the open sessions (id, user, database, tag, idle time, whether a request is running in it, and the ids of its running statements), and `terminate transaction <sessionId>` terminates what runs in it, rolls it back and ends it. That includes a `/ws` insert session writing into it, whose current chunk is listed under the session. The command never waits longer than its time limit (at most 10 seconds): when the session is still busy at that point it answers `terminating`, and the transaction is rolled back as soon as the running work ends. A later `/api/v1/commit` on that session publishes nothing and answers `204` with the `arcadedb-session-expired` header, as for any session that no longer exists.

**Who can do what.** Every authenticated user can run these commands. **root** sees and stops every statement and session; any other user only their own, and someone else's is answered `not found`, so its existence is not given away. The commands are never held back by the query admission gate (`arcadedb.queryMaxConcurrent`), so a saturated server can still be relieved, and they are never forwarded to the leader: each server lists and stops its own work.

On an HA cluster a write that a replica forwards to the leader runs on the leader. It is listed on both: on the replica with `forwardedTo` (the leader's name), on the leader with `forwardedFrom` (the id it has on the replica) and the client's tag. `terminate query <replica id>` sent to the replica stops the work on the leader too, and the same command sent to the leader finds the statement by the replica's id. See Running statements on a cluster.

**Credentials.** The listed text masks the value after `IDENTIFIED BY`, `PASSWORD` (`PASSWD`, `PWD`), `TOKEN`, `SECRET`, `API_KEY` and `AUTHORIZATION` (also after a `Bearer` or `Basic` scheme) with `*` (best effort).

#### Cluster authentication session lookup (POST, internal)

*(Since v26.10.1)* `POST /api/v1/cluster/auth-session` is a cluster-internal route that lets servers share authentication tokens (see *Tokens in a cluster* under Token-Based Authentication). It is not meant for clients and is listed here only so it is not mistaken for a public API. The request must arrive through the cluster-token channel (`X-ArcadeDB-Cluster-Token` header) on behalf of the root user: a request without that header is refused with `403`, even with root credentials, and an invalid cluster token gets `401`.

The body is `{"token": "<AU-⋯ token>", "action": "validate" | "revoke"}` (`action` defaults to `validate`). `validate` answers `200` with `{"user": ⋯, "createdAt": ⋯}` when this server issued the session, and `404` otherwise (including for a copy held on behalf of another server); `revoke` drops the session and answers `204`. A missing token or an unknown action answers `400`.

#### List Databases (GET)

Returns a list of available databases for the requesting user.

URL Syntax: `/api/v1/databases`

Responses:

- `200` OK
- `403` invalid credentials

Example:

```
$ curl -X GET http://localhost:2480/api/v1/databases \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Return:

```
{"result": ["school", "mydatabase"]}
```

#### Does database exist (GET)

Returns boolean answering if database exists.

URL Syntax: `/api/v1/exists/{database}`

Responses:

- `200` OK
- `400` no database passed

Example:

```
$ curl -X GET http://localhost:2480/api/v1/exists/school \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Return:

```
{"result": true}
```

#### Get operation progress (GET)

Returns the long-running maintenance operations currently in progress on this server for one database, with their step-by-step progress. `CHECK DATABASE`, `REBUILD INDEX`, `COMPACT INDEX`, `BACKUP DATABASE` and `IMPORT DATABASE` publish their progress here while they run. The endpoint answers from an in-memory snapshot without touching the database, so it is safe to poll at any frequency (the console and Studio poll it to render a live progress bar). In a cluster each server reports its own operations.

URL Syntax: `/api/v1/progress/{database}`

Responses:

- `200` OK
- `400` no database passed
- `403` the user is not authorized on the database

Example:

```
$ curl -X GET http://localhost:2480/api/v1/progress/school \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Return (one entry per running operation, empty array when nothing is running):

```
{"result": [{
  "id": 3,
  "database": "school",
  "operation": "check database fix",
  "stepName": "Checking vertices 'Account'",
  "stepIndex": 3,
  "totalSteps": 9,
  "done": 421000,
  "total": 1000000,
  "percentage": 42,
  "startedOn": 1786370000000,
  "elapsedMs": 154000
}]}
```

`percentage` is `-1` when the current step's total is unknown (for example the backup or the import, whose sizes cannot be computed upfront).

**Login - Get Authentication Token (POST)**

Authenticates a user and returns an authentication token that can be used for subsequent requests instead of sending credentials each time. See Token-Based Authentication for more details.

URL Syntax: `/api/v1/login`

This endpoint requires HTTP Basic Authentication with valid credentials. On successful authentication, it returns a JSON response containing the authentication token.

Responses:

- `200` OK - returns token and username
- `403` invalid credentials
- `503` the server holds the maximum number of concurrent authentication sessions and none could be reclaimed - see `server.httpAuthSessionMax` *(since v26.9.1)*

Example:

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/login \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Return:

```
{"token": "AU-ArcadeDB_0-2af64e60-8455-423a-bc64-ed0e19729f04", "user": "root"}
```

The returned token can be used in subsequent requests via the `Authorization: Bearer` header:

```
$ curl http://localhost:2480/api/v1/databases \
```

```
       -H "Authorization: Bearer AU-ArcadeDB_0-2af64e60-8455-423a-bc64-ed0e19729f04"
```

#### Logout - Invalidate Authentication Token (POST)

Invalidates an authentication token so it can no longer be used for requests. The token must be provided via the `Authorization: Bearer` header.

URL Syntax: `/api/v1/logout`

Responses:

- `204` OK - token invalidated (or was already invalid)

Example:

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/logout \
       -H "Authorization: Bearer AU-ArcadeDB_0-2af64e60-8455-423a-bc64-ed0e19729f04"
```

After logout, any attempt to use the invalidated token will result in a `401 Unauthorized` response.

#### List Active Authentication Sessions (GET)

Returns a list of all active authentication sessions. This endpoint is restricted to **root** users only for security reasons.

URL Syntax: `/api/v1/sessions`

Responses:

- `200` OK - returns list of active sessions
- `403` forbidden (non-root user)

Example:

```
$ curl http://localhost:2480/api/v1/sessions \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Return:

```
{
  "result": [
    {
      "token": "AU-ArcadeDB_0-2af64e60-8455-423a-bc64-ed0e19729f04",
      "user": "root",
      "elapsedMs": 12345
    },
    {
      "token": "AU-6fa459ea-ee8a-3ca4-894e-db77e160355e",
```

```
      "user": "admin",
      "elapsedMs": 5678
    }
  ],
  "count": 2
}
```

The `elapsedMs` field indicates how many milliseconds have passed since the last request using that token.

#### Create an API token (POST)

Mints a long-lived API token (`at-` prefix) for a script or service. Root only. The plaintext token is returned once, in `result.token`, and is never shown again: the server keeps only its hash. On a cluster the request is forwarded to the leader and the token is replicated to every node. `GET /api/v1/server/api-tokens` lists the tokens and `DELETE /api/v1/server/api-tokens?token=<hash>` revokes one. Studio's API Tokens panel uses the same routes.

URL Syntax: `/api/v1/server/api-tokens`

Body: `name` (required), `database` (default `*`, every database), `expiresAt` (epoch milliseconds, `0` for no expiry) and `permissions` (the same structure as a group).

Responses:

- `201` created - the token is in `result.token`
- `400` missing name or malformed permissions
- `403` forbidden (non-root user)
- `409` a token with that name already exists
- `412` the request did not arrive over a protected transport and `arcadedb.server.apiTokenRequireSecureTransport` is on *(since v26.10.1)*

```
$ curl -X POST https://localhost:2490/api/v1/server/api-tokens \
       --user root:arcadedb-password \
       -d '{"name":"etl-job","database":"mydb"}'
```

**Transport check (since v26.10.1).** The token authenticates whoever holds it, so the server checks how the mint reached it. The transport counts as protected when the request came over HTTPS, from a loopback address, or from a reverse proxy listed in `arcadedb.server.apiTokenTrustedProxies` that reports `https` for every hop through `X-Forwarded-Proto` or the RFC 7239 `Forwarded` header. What happens otherwise depends on `arcadedb.server.apiTokenRequireSecureTransport`:

- `false` (the default in 26.10.1): the token is minted and the server logs `Minting an API token over an unprotected transport (scheme=…, peer=…)` at WARNING.
- `true`: the mint is refused with `412` and a body explaining the three ways out: connect over TLS, list the proxy, or turn the check off.

On a cluster the check also covers the hop between nodes: a mint forwarded to the leader over cleartext inter-node HTTP is refused with `412` too, even when the client itself used HTTPS.

The default of `arcadedb.server.apiTokenRequireSecureTransport` is scheduled to change to `true` in 27.1.1. From that release an unprotected mint is refused unless you set the value back to `false`. It is `false` today only because Studio's own **Create Token** button uses this route, and enforcing it would break Studio served over plain HTTP from a remote host. If you mint tokens over plain HTTP, plan for HTTPS (or a trusted proxy) before upgrading.

**Behind a TLS-terminating reverse proxy.** When nginx, Envoy or a Kubernetes ingress terminates TLS and forwards to ArcadeDB over HTTP, the server sees a cleartext request from the proxy's address. List that address (or its subnet) in `arcadedb.server.apiTokenTrustedProxies`, for example `-Darcadedb.server.apiTokenTrustedProxies=10.0.0.5,10.1.0.0/16`, and make sure the proxy sets `X-Forwarded-Proto` (nginx: `proxy_set_header X-Forwarded-Proto $scheme;`). The rules are strict on purpose:

- A peer that is not on the list gains nothing by sending the same headers. They are ignored, because the client asking for a token is the one that would forge them.
- Entries must be literal addresses or CIDR ranges. A hostname is rejected rather than resolved.
- A list that does not parse is treated as empty, so a typo denies instead of opening the gate. The server logs the discarded list at SEVERE (`Ignoring the whole of arcadedb.server.apiTokenTrustedProxies (…)`).
- List only an L7 proxy that writes the header itself. An L4 balancer (nginx `stream`, HAProxy `mode tcp`) passes the client's own headers through, so listing one lets any client vouch for itself.
- If the request carries a `Forwarded` header, every element must include `proto=https`; an element without `proto=` refuses the mint. A proxy that does not use `Forwarded` should strip any it receives.

The gRPC `CreateApiToken` RPC applies the same list, reading the `x-forwarded-proto` and `forwarded` metadata keys. Unlike HTTP it always refuses an unprotected mint, whatever `apiTokenRequireSecureTransport` says.

#### Execute a query (GET|POST)

This command allows executing idempotent commands, like `SELECT` and `MATCH`:

URL Syntax GET: `/api/v1/query/{database}/{language}/{command}`

URL Syntax POST: `/api/v1/query/{database}`

Where:

- `database` is the database name
- `language` is the query language used. is the query language used, between "sql", "sqlscript", "graphql", "cypher", "gremlin", "mongo" and any other language supported by ArcadeDB and available at runtime.
- `command` the command to execute in encoded format

- `params` (optional), is the map of parameters to pass to the query engine via the POST body, where parameters are introduced with a colon `:`. Parameter values may include the typed-marker objects described in Typed parameter markers to send `byte[]` — e.g. INT8-encoded vectors — without a float32 round trip.

When using the `GET` variant the query needs to be URL encoded.

Due to security reasons (encoded) slashes `/` (`%2F`) which are used for divisions or block comments, cannot be used in queries via the GET method with the `query/` endpoint.

Question marks (`?`) cause the server to stop reading the query string when sent via GET. To use question marks (inside strings) one can use `format('%c',63)`; in this case make sure to replace all percent symbols (`%`) in the format string with `%%`.

These restrictions do not apply to the `POST` variant, where the `language` and `command` are send in the body.

Even though a `POST` method is used, the query in `command` has to be idempotent.

*(since v26.10.1)* `POST /api/v1/query` runs without an implicit transaction, like `GET /api/v1/query`, so a full scan of a large type can use several threads and is as fast as with `GET`. Inside a session (`/begin`) a scan stays sequential to keep it consistent with the transaction. `POST /api/v1/command` still runs in a transaction.

`EXPLAIN` is answered the same way by the `GET` and the `POST` variants and by `/api/v1/command`: the plan arrives in the `explain` (indented text) and `explainPlan` (structured) members of the response envelope, and `result` is empty — the plan is the answer, not a row. Requesting it with `Accept: application/x-ndjson` is refused with `400` ("EXPLAIN produces a plan, not a row stream"), because a stream of rows plus a stats trailer has nowhere to carry one. Before 26.10.1 the `GET` variant reached neither rule: it serialized the plan as an ordinary result row, and streamed it as an ndjson `record` line that no consumer of that encoding can read.

With `Accept: application/x-ndjson` the rows are streamed one per line (`record`), followed by a `stats` trailer. While the server is still producing the next row it writes an empty line every `arcadedb.server.httpStreamingKeepAliveInterval` milliseconds (default 5000, `0` disables), so a client that bounds silence does not mistake a slow query for a dead server. Consumers must ignore blank lines, which the Java driver does. The Java driver fails a stream after `arcadedb.network.socketTimeout` of silence, with a minimum of 30 seconds, as for any other call.

Responses:

- `200` OK
- `400` invalid language, invalid query
- `403` invalid credentials
- `500` database does not exist, cannot execute query

- `503` the server is busy and the query can be retried as it is: the running queries hold the heap budget (`QueryHeapBudgetExceededException`, see `queryMaxHeapRAM`), or the query admission gate did not start it, because it waited longer than `queryQueueTimeout` or found the queue full (`QueryAdmissionException`, see `queryMaxConcurrent`)

Example:

```
$ curl -X GET http://localhost:2480/api/v1/query/school/sql/select%20from%20Class \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

The `query` endpoint may also be used via the POST method, which has no character restrictions such as `/` or `?`:

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/query/school \
       -d '{"language": "sql", "command": "select from Class"}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

The POST variant accepts additional parameters in the JSON body:

- `autoCommit` (optional) controls transaction behavior (same as in Execute database command):
  - `true`: Forces the query to execute within an atomic transaction
  - `false`: Disables transaction wrapping (query executes directly)
  - not specified: Uses automatic behavior (no transaction for read-only queries)

Example of forcing a transaction for a query to ensure consistent reads:

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/query/mydb \
       -d '{"language": "sql", "command": "SELECT FROM Account WHERE balance > 1000",
"autoCommit": true}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

**Execute database command (POST)**

Executes a non-idempotent command (as an implicit transaction).

URL Syntax: `/api/v1/command/{database}`

Where:

- `database` is the database name

Example to create the new document type "Class":

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/command/school \
```

```
      -d '{"language": "sql", "command": "create document type Class"}' \
      -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
      --user root:arcadedb-password
```

The payload, as a JSON, accepts the following parameters:

- `language` is the query language used, between "sql", "sqlscript", "graphql", "cypher", "gremlin", "mongo" and any other language supported by ArcadeDB and available at runtime.
- `command` the command to execute in encoded format
- `awaitResponse` (optional) a boolean which is by default "true", if set to "false" the command will be executed asynchronously and only acknowledgement of receiving the command is responded. The completion of the command is noted in the log, yet no results of the command can be returned.
- `limit` (optional) is the maximum number of results to return
- `params` (optional), is the map of parameters to pass to the query engine, where parameters are prefixed with a colon `:`. Parameter values may include the typed-marker objects described in Typed parameter markers to send `byte[]` — e.g. INT8-encoded vectors — without a float32 round trip.
- `retries` (optional), is the number of times the command (transaction) is retried. When omitted it follows the `arcadedb.txRetries` database setting (3 by default), the same attempt count the embedded and the remote Java APIs take it from; up to v26.9.0 it was hard-coded to 1, so nothing was ever retried. Only a concurrent-modification conflict is retried (`NeedRetryException` and `DuplicatedKeyException`, the latter capped at a single retry), and always after a full rollback, so a retried attempt starts from committed state with nothing of the failed one surviving. Note the consequence for side effects **outside** the database: a SQL or JavaScript function that calls another system can now run more than once per request. Send `"retries": 1` to keep the previous single-attempt behavior for such a command.
- `autoCommit` (optional) controls transaction behavior:
  - `true`: Forces the command to execute within an atomic transaction that auto-commits on success
  - `false`: Disables automatic transaction wrapping (command executes directly without transaction)
  - not specified (default): Uses automatic behavior (commands are wrapped in atomic transactions unless a session is active)
  - NOTE: This parameter is ignored when using session-based transactions (see Begin a transaction). If you provide `autoCommit: true` with an active session, a warning will be logged and the session transaction will be used instead.
- `serializer` (optional) specify the serializer used for the result:
  - `graph`: returns a graph separating vertices from edges
  - `record`: returns everything as records
  - `studio`: by default it's like record but with additional metadata for vertex records, such as the number of outgoing edges in `@out` property and total incoming edges in `@in` property.

This serializer is used by Studio.

Asynchronous commands (using `"awaitResponse": false`) are queued, and their processing is configurable via `async*` database settings.

Responses:

- `200` OK
- `202` Accepted
- `400` invalid language, invalid command
- `403` invalid credentials
- `503` the server is busy and the command can be retried as it is: the running queries hold the heap budget (`QueryHeapBudgetExceededException`, see `queryMaxHeapRAM`), or the query admission gate did not start it, because it waited longer than `queryQueueTimeout` or found the queue full (`QueryAdmissionException`, see `queryMaxConcurrent`)

Example of insertion of a new Client by using parameters:

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/command/company \
       -d '{"language": "sql", "command": "create vertex Client set firstName =
:firstName, lastName =  :lastName", params: {"firstName": "Jay", "lastName":
"Miner"}}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Example of forcing an atomic transaction with `autoCommit`:

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/command/mydb \
       -d '{"language": "sql", "command": "INSERT INTO Account SET balance = 1000",
"autoCommit": true}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Example of disabling automatic transaction wrapping:

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/command/mydb \
       -d '{"language": "sql", "command": "SELECT FROM Account LIMIT 1", "autoCommit":
false}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

**Write statistics (`stats`)**

When a command **modifies** data, the `POST /api/v1/command/{database}` response includes a `stats` object alongside `result`, reporting how many entities the command created, deleted or changed.

The object is **omitted for read-only queries** (a command that changes nothing has no `stats` field). It is populated for OpenCypher writes — including counts aggregated across `UNION` branches and `CALL { … }` subqueries — and mirrors the counters the Bolt driver exposes through its result summary.

The shape is an ArcadeDB-native camelCase object with a stable set of keys (each counter is always present, `0` when unused):

| Key | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `nodesCreated` / `nodesDeleted` | Vertices created / deleted |
| `relationshipsCreated` / `relationshipsDeleted` | Edges created / deleted |
| `propertiesSet` | Properties assigned a value |
| `labelsAdded` / `labelsRemoved` | Type/label memberships added / removed |
| `indexesAdded` / `indexesRemoved` | Indexes created / dropped |
| `constraintsAdded` / `constraintsRemoved` | Constraints (`UNIQUE`, `NOT_NULL`, `KEY`, `TYPED`) added / removed |
| `containsUpdates` | `true` when any counter above is non-zero |

Example — a Cypher write returns the counters it produced:

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/command/school \
       -d '{"language": "cypher", "command": "CREATE (a:Person {name:$n})-[:KNOWS]-
>(b:Person)", "params": {"n": "Ada"}}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

```
{
  "user": "root",
  "result": [],
  "stats": {
    "nodesCreated": 2,
    "nodesDeleted": 0,
    "relationshipsCreated": 1,
    "relationshipsDeleted": 0,
    "propertiesSet": 1,
    "labelsAdded": 2,
    "labelsRemoved": 0,
    "indexesAdded": 0,
    "indexesRemoved": 0,
    "constraintsAdded": 0,
    "constraintsRemoved": 0,
    "containsUpdates": true
```

```
  }
}
```

The gRPC service carries the same counters in the write-result summary of `ExecuteCommand`; see gRPC API.

### 5.2.11. Numbers and arrays in `params`

Parameters keep the numbers as written: an integer beyond the `long` range, or a decimal with more than 17 significant digits, is read as a `DECIMAL` (`BigDecimal`) instead of being wrapped or rounded to a double. A number token with more than 1000 characters or an exponent beyond 1000 is refused with `400`. A JSON array given as a parameter is a list, as when the statement runs embedded: written to a `LIST` property it is stored as that list, and `[0.1, 3.141592653589793]` keeps both doubles. *(Since v26.10.1: before, such integers wrapped around and arrays with a fraction were narrowed to float32.)*

#### Typed parameter markers (`$bytes`, `$int8`)

JSON has no native `byte[]` type, so HTTP/JSON clients cannot send binary parameters with the standard scalar/array shapes. The `query` and `command` endpoints recognise two reserved single-key marker objects in any parameter value (named or positional) and decode them to a Java `byte[]` before the parameter binder sees them. The primary use case is sending an INT8-encoded vector to a `LSM_VECTOR` index without the float32 round trip — see Vector Encoding.

| Marker | Decodes to |
|---|---|
| `{"$bytes": "<base64>"}` | `byte[]` from a base64 string. Both standard (RFC 4648 section 4) and URL-safe (section 5, with `-` and `_` in place of `+` and `/`) alphabets are accepted. |
| `{"$int8": [v0, v1, …]}` | `byte[]` from an array of integers. Each element must round to an integer in `[-128, 127]`; fractional or out-of-range values are rejected with HTTP 400. |

A single-key map whose key is one of these is decoded; multi-key maps that happen to contain a `$bytes` or `$int8` key are passed through unchanged so user data with leading-`$` keys is not silently transformed. The decoder also recurses into nested arrays and maps, so a list of typed markers (e.g. a batch of int8 vectors as a single parameter) works.

Examples:

```
# Base64-encoded byte array
curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/query/mydb \
     -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
     --user root:arcadedb-password \
     -d '{
       "language": "sql",
       "command": "SELECT expand(`vector.neighbors`(\"Doc[embedding]\", :q, 5))",
       "params": {
         "q": {"$bytes": "AwIB/38="}
       }
```

```
    }'

# Integer array form (handy for debugging)
curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/query/mydb \
    -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
    --user root:arcadedb-password \
    -d '{
      "language": "sql",
      "command": "SELECT expand(`vector.neighbors`(\"Doc[embedding]\", :q, 5))",
      "params": {
        "q": {"$int8": [1, 2, 3, -1, 127, -128]}
      }
    }'
```

Malformed markers (invalid base64, non-numeric `$int8` element, value out of `[-128, 127]`, `null` payload) return `400 Bad Request` with a message naming the marker and the offending value.

#### Vector search (POST)

*(Since v26.10.1)* Returns the nearest neighbors of a query vector in a dense `LSM_VECTOR` or sparse `LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR` index, without writing the `vector.neighbors` SQL by hand. ArcadeDB does not compute embeddings: the caller supplies the vector. The same request body and limits apply to the MCP `vector_search` tool and the gRPC `VectorSearch` RPC.

URL Syntax: `/api/v1/vector/{database}/search`

The JSON body accepts:

- `indexName` (required) name of the vector index, for example `Doc[embedding]`
- `queryVector` (required) array of numbers, not empty, finite values only. On a dense index its length must match the index dimensions and at least one value must be non-zero. With `sparse: true` it holds the weights matching `queryIndices`, or the full vector when `queryIndices` is omitted (zero entries are dropped)
- `k` (optional, default `10`) maximum number of results, between `1` and `1000`
- `sparse` (optional, default `false`) search an `LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR` index instead of a dense one. The index type must match the flag
- `queryIndices` (optional, sparse only) dimension ids matching the `queryVector` weights: non-negative integers, no duplicates, same length as `queryVector`. Refused without `sparse: true`
- `efSearch` (optional, dense only) HNSW search beam width, between `1` and `10000`. Refused with `sparse: true`
- `filter` (optional) read-only SQL `WHERE` predicate, at most 4096 characters, applied to each neighbor row (record properties are flattened, and `@rid`, `@type`, `record` plus `distance` or `score` are available). With a filter the search inspects a candidate window of `k * 8` rows, at most 8000, reported as `candidateLimit`

The response carries:

- `indexName`, `sparse`
- `scoring`: the ranking direction, for example `distance_lower_is_better:COSINE` for a dense index, or `score_higher_is_better:dot_product` (`score_higher_is_better:idf_weighted_dot_product` with the IDF modifier) for a sparse one
- `candidateLimit`: the candidate window inspected
- `truncated`: `true` when `k` results were returned, so more matches may exist
- `count`, `results`: each hit has `rid`, `properties` and either `distance` (dense, lower is better) or `score` (sparse, higher is better). Records deleted between the index scan and the load are skipped, so a search can return fewer than `k` hits

Responses:

- `200` OK
- `400` missing body, missing or out-of-range argument, unknown index or wrong index type (the message lists the available indexes), invalid filter expression
- `401` missing or invalid credentials
- `403` the user has no access to the database

The route runs without a transaction. A `400` caused by a bad argument does not roll back a transaction the client opened with `/begin`.

Example:

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/vector/mydb/search \
       -d '{"indexName": "Doc[embedding]", "queryVector": [0.12, 0.85, 0.33], "k": 2,
"filter": "lang = '\''en'\''"}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Return:

```
{
  "indexName": "Doc[embedding]",
  "sparse": false,
  "scoring": "distance_lower_is_better:COSINE",
  "candidateLimit": 16,
  "truncated": true,
  "count": 2,
  "results": [
    { "rid": "#12:4", "distance": 0.018, "properties": { "@rid": "#12:4", "@type":
"Doc", "title": "Graphs 101", "lang": "en" } },
    { "rid": "#12:9", "distance": 0.041, "properties": { "@rid": "#12:9", "@type":
"Doc", "title": "Vector search", "lang": "en" } }
  ]
}
```

#### Hybrid search (POST)

*(Since v26.10.1)* Fuses a vector leg, an optional full-text leg and an optional graph expansion leg into one ranked list, using the engine's `vector.fuse` function. The same request body and limits apply to the MCP `hybrid_search` tool and the gRPC `HybridSearch` RPC.

URL Syntax: `/api/v1/vector/{database}/hybrid`

The JSON body accepts:

- `vectorIndexName` (required) name of the vector index
- `queryVector`, `queryIndices`, `sparse`, `efSearch`, `filter` (vector leg): same meaning and limits as in Vector search. The `filter` applies to the vector leg only
- `k` (optional, default `10`) maximum number of fused results, between `1` and `1000`. Each retrieval leg fetches `k * 4` rows, at most 1000, before fusion
- `fulltextIndexName` and `fulltextQuery` (optional) add the full-text leg: a `FULL_TEXT` index and a Lucene-syntax query. They must be given together, otherwise the request is refused. Note the field is `fulltextQuery`, not `queryText` as in Full-text search
- `fusionStrategy` (optional, default `RRF`) one of `RRF`, `DBSF`, `LINEAR`, case-insensitive
- `weights` (optional) object with per-leg weights: `vector` (default `1.0`), `fulltext` (default `1.0`), `expand` (default `0.5`). Each must be a finite number, not negative. Any other key, or a weight for a leg the request does not run, is refused
- `expand` (optional) object that adds the graph expansion leg, seeded from the results of the retrieval legs (at most 256 seeds) and ranked by breadth-first discovery order:
  - `edgeTypes` (optional) edge type names to walk; each must exist. Empty or omitted walks every edge type
  - `direction` (optional, default `out`) one of `out`, `in`, `both`
  - `maxDepth` (optional, default `1`) between `1` and `3`

  The expansion returns at most 2000 records. Both the vector index and the full-text index must be declared on vertex types. Since the expansion leg has no score, it can only be used with `RRF`.

The response carries `vectorIndexName`, `sparse`, `scoring`, `fused`, `truncated`, `count`, `results`, plus:

- `fulltextIndexName` when the full-text leg ran
- `fusionStrategy` (upper-cased) when `fused` is `true`
- `legs`: per-leg accounting. `vector.count` always; `fulltext` with `indexName`, `similarity` (`BM25` or `CLASSIC`) and `count` when that leg ran; `expand` with `direction`, `edgeTypes`, `maxDepth`, `truncated` (fan-out cap reached), `seedCount`, `seedsTruncated` and `count` when `expand` was given

Fusion needs at least two legs that returned rows. When only the vector leg did, `fused` is `false` and each hit carries the native `distance` (dense) or `score` (sparse) instead of a fused score. Otherwise each hit has `rid`, `fusedScore` (higher is better), `sources` (the legs that produced it: `vector`, `fulltext`, `expand`) and `properties`, plus `depth` and `path` (RIDs from the seed, seed included) for a hit found by

the expansion.

Responses:

- `200` OK
- `400` missing body, missing or out-of-range argument, unknown index, edge type or strategy, half a full-text leg, `expand` with a strategy other than `RRF` or on a non-vertex type, invalid filter or full-text query
- `401` missing or invalid credentials
- `403` the user has no access to the database

Example:

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/vector/mydb/hybrid \
       -d '{
             "vectorIndexName": "Doc[embedding]",
             "queryVector": [0.12, 0.85, 0.33],
             "fulltextIndexName": "Doc[content]",
             "fulltextQuery": "+graph database",
             "k": 5,
             "expand": { "edgeTypes": ["Cites"], "direction": "out", "maxDepth": 1 }
           }' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Return (abridged):

```
{
  "vectorIndexName": "Doc[embedding]",
  "sparse": false,
  "scoring": "distance_lower_is_better:COSINE",
  "legs": {
    "vector": { "count": 20 },
    "fulltext": { "indexName": "Doc[content]", "similarity": "BM25", "count": 7 },
    "expand": { "direction": "out", "edgeTypes": ["Cites"], "maxDepth": 1,
"truncated": false,
                "seedCount": 24, "seedsTruncated": false, "count": 11 }
  },
  "fused": true,
  "fusionStrategy": "RRF",
  "fulltextIndexName": "Doc[content]",
  "truncated": true,
  "count": 5,
  "results": [
    { "rid": "#12:4", "fusedScore": 0.0325, "sources": ["vector", "fulltext"],
"properties": { "@rid": "#12:4", "@type": "Doc", "title": "Graphs 101" } },
    { "rid": "#12:17", "fusedScore": 0.0081, "sources": ["expand"], "depth": 1,
"path": ["#12:4", "#12:17"], "properties": { "@rid": "#12:17", "@type": "Doc",
```

```
"title": "Property graphs" } }
  ]
}
```

**Full-text search (POST)**

*(Since v26.10.1)* Runs a Lucene-syntax query against a `FULL_TEXT` index and returns the matching documents, highest score first (ties ordered by RID). The same request body and limits apply to the MCP `full_text_search` tool and the gRPC `FullTextSearch` RPC.

URL Syntax: `/api/v1/vector/{database}/fulltext`

The JSON body accepts:

- `queryText` (required) Lucene-syntax query, for example `java` or `+java -python`. Must not be blank
- `indexName` (optional) the full-text index to search. Wins over `typeName` when both are given
- `typeName` (optional) the type whose full-text index to search. Alone, it works only when the type has exactly one full-text index. An index declared on a supertype is named after the supertype
- `properties` (optional) array of indexed property names, to pick one of several full-text indexes on `typeName`
- `limit` (optional, default `10`) maximum number of results, between `1` and `1000`

One of `indexName` or `typeName` is required. The response carries `indexName`, `similarity` (`BM25` or `CLASSIC`), `count` and `results`, where each hit has `rid`, `score` and `properties`. The limit is applied per bucket, so a record deleted between the index scan and the load is skipped rather than replaced, and a search can return fewer than `limit` hits.

Responses:

- `200` OK
- `400` missing body, blank `queryText`, `limit` out of range, no index addressed, unknown or ambiguous index (the message lists the available full-text indexes), invalid Lucene syntax
- `401` missing or invalid credentials
- `403` the user has no access to the database

Example:

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/vector/mydb/fulltext \
       -d '{"typeName": "Doc", "queryText": "+graph -relational", "limit": 3}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Return:

```
{
```

```
  "indexName": "Doc[content]",
  "similarity": "BM25",
  "count": 1,
  "results": [
    { "rid": "#12:4", "score": 2.71, "properties": { "@rid": "#12:4", "@type": "Doc",
"title": "Graphs 101" } }
  ]
}
```


**Begin a transaction (POST)**

Begins a transaction on the server managed as a session. The response header contains the session id. Set this id in the following requests to execute them in the same transaction scope. See also /commit and /rollback.

URL Syntax: `/api/v1/begin/{database}`

Where:

- `database` is the database name

The payload, optional as a JSON, accepts the following parameters:

- `isolationLevel` is the isolation level for the current transaction, either `READ_COMMITTED` (default) or `REPEATABLE_READ`.

Responses:

- `204` OK
- `400` invalid value
- `401` transaction already started
- `403` invalid credentials
- `500` invalid database, invalid JSON, invalid body

Example:

```
$ curl -I -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/begin/school \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Returns the Session Id in the response header, example:

```
arcadedb-session-id: AS-ee056170-dc9b-4956-8d71-d7cfa01900d4
```

Use the session id in the request header of further commands you want to execute in the same transaction and execute /commit to commit the server side transaction or /rollback to rollback the changes. After a period of inactivity (default is 30 seconds), the server automatically rollback and purge expired transactions.

#### Commit a transaction (POST)

Commits a transaction on the server. Set the session id obtained with the /begin command as a header of the request. See also /begin and /rollback.

URL Syntax: `/api/v1/commit/{database}`

Where:

- `database` is the database name

Set the session id returned from the /begin command in the request header. If the session (and therefore the server side transaction) is expired, then an internal server error is returned.

The commit ends the session, whether it succeeds or fails: a commit that fails rolls the transaction back, and the answer carries the header `arcadedb-session-closed: true`, so there is no need to send a /rollback afterwards. *(Since v26.10.1: before, the session of a failed commit stayed registered until it timed out.)*

A command that fails inside a session rolls the session's transaction back. When the transaction held changes, they are lost, so the session is marked as rolled back: the next command naming it is refused with `404`, and `/commit` answers `404` with a message saying that the transaction was rolled back, instead of `204`. Send a /rollback (or the `/commit`) to end it. When nothing was lost (a failed read, an error before the first write) the session goes on in a fresh transaction. *(Since v26.10.1: before, the commands after the failure ran in autocommit and `/commit` answered `204`.)*

Response:

- `204` OK
- `403` invalid credentials
- `404` the session's transaction was rolled back by a failed command
- `500` transaction expired, not found, not begun

Example:

```
$ curl -I -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/commit/school \
       -H "arcadedb-session-id: AS-ee056170-dc9b-4956-8d71-d7cfa01900d4" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

#### Rollback a transaction (POST)

Rollbacks a transaction on the server. Set the session id obtained with the /begin command as a header of the request. See also /begin and /commit.

URL Syntax: `/api/v1/rollback/{database}`

Where:

- `database` is the database name

Set the session id returned from the /begin command in the request header. If the session (and therefore the server side transaction) is expired, then an internal server error is returned.

The commit ends the session, whether it succeeds or fails: a commit that fails rolls the transaction back, and the answer carries the header `arcadedb-session-closed: true`, so there is no need to send a /rollback afterwards. *(Since v26.10.1: before, the session of a failed commit stayed registered until it timed out.)*

Response:

- `204` OK
- `403` invalid credentials
- `500` transaction expired, not found, not begun

Example:

```
$ curl -I -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/rollback/school \
       -H "arcadedb-session-id: AS-ee056170-dc9b-4956-8d71-d7cfa01900d4" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

**Batch import vertices and edges (POST)**

High-performance bulk import of vertices and edges using the GraphBatch engine under the hood. Supports JSONL and CSV input formats with streaming parsing — the server never loads the entire request body into memory, so you can push millions of records in a single request.

URL Syntax: `/api/v1/batch/{database}`

Where:

- `database` is the database name

The `Content-Type` header determines the input format:

- `application/x-ndjson` or `application/jsonl` — JSONL (newline-delimited JSON)
- `text/csv` — CSV

All vertices must appear before edges in the request body. Edges reference vertices either by temporary ID or by existing database RID.

**JSONL Format**

Each line is a JSON object with the following meta fields:

| Field | Required | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `@type` | Yes | `"vertex"` (or `"v"`) for vertices, `"edge"` (or `"e"`) for edges |
| `@class` | Yes | The vertex or edge type name (must exist in schema) |

| Field | Required | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `@id` | No | Client-assigned temporary ID for vertices. Used by edges to reference newly created vertices. |
| `@from` | Edges only | Source vertex reference: a temporary ID (e.g., `"t1"`) or an existing RID (e.g., `"#12:0"`) |
| `@to` | Edges only | Destination vertex reference: a temporary ID or an existing RID |

All other fields are treated as properties.

A control key sent on the kind of line that cannot use it is refused with `400`, naming the line: `@id` on an edge, `@from` or `@to` on a vertex. Before 26.10.1 such a key was silently dropped — neither stored nor reported — so a client that models both line shapes with one struct got a load that looked clean while the value was gone. A key carrying **nothing** is still accepted, so JSON `null` and the empty string are ignored.

Example:

```
{"@type":"vertex","@class":"Person","@id":"t1","name":"Alice","age":30}
{"@type":"vertex","@class":"Person","@id":"t2","name":"Bob","age":25}
{"@type":"edge","@class":"KNOWS","@from":"t1","@to":"t2","since":2020}
{"@type":"edge","@class":"KNOWS","@from":"#12:0","@to":"t2","weight":0.8}
```

#### CSV Format

The first line is the column header. A `---` sentinel row separates the vertex section from the edge section, followed by a new header row for edges.

Example:

```
@type,@class,@id,name,age
vertex,Person,t1,Alice,30
vertex,Person,t2,Bob,25
---
@type,@class,@from,@to,since
edge,KNOWS,t1,t2,2020
```

CSV parsing supports RFC 4180 quoting (double-quote escaping). Numeric values are auto-detected as integers or floats. Boolean values (`true`/`false`) are also auto-detected.

The same rule as JSONL applies to a control **value**, not to the column: a row carrying a value in a control column its kind cannot use — `@id` on an edge row, `@from`/`@to` on a vertex row — is refused with `400`, while an empty one is ignored. That keeps a single header naming all five control columns across both sections working, as long as the inapplicable columns are left empty on each row.

#### Query Parameters

All parameters are optional and map directly to GraphBatch builder options:

| Parameter | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `batchSize` | 100000 | Maximum edges buffered before auto-flush |
| `lightEdges` | false | If true, property-less edges are stored as connectivity only (saves ~33% I/O) |
| `wal` | false | Enable Write-Ahead Logging for crash safety |
| `parallelFlush` | true | Parallelize edge connection across async threads |
| `preAllocateEdgeChunks` | true | Pre-allocate edge segments on vertex creation |
| `edgeListInitialSize` | 2048 | Initial segment size in bytes (64-8192) |
| `bidirectional` | true | Connect the incoming side of the edges whose type is declared bidirectional; a `UNIDIRECTIONAL` type never gets it. Set to `false` only to load unidirectional edge types: an edge of a bidirectional type is then refused with HTTP 400 (since 26.10.1) |
| `commitEvery` | 50000 | Edges per sub-transaction within a flush |
| `expectedEdgeCount` | 0 | Hint for auto-tuning batch size |

#### Response

The response is a JSON object with import statistics:

```
{
  "verticesCreated": 2,
  "edgesCreated": 1,
  "elapsedMs": 42,
  "idMapping": {
    "t1": "#9:0",
    "t2": "#9:1"
  }
}
```

The `idMapping` field is included only when temporary IDs (`@id`) were used. It maps each temporary ID to the actual RID assigned by the database.

Because this response is built in full before anything is sent, the mapping of a very large load is dropped rather than risk exhausting memory: past 10,000 entries the server replies with `idMappingOmitted: true` and `idMappingSize` instead. Send `idMapping=true` to demand it anyway, or use the streaming response below, which has no such limit.

#### Streaming response

Send `Accept: application/x-ndjson` to be answered as the load runs instead of once at the end. The

response is one JSON object per line:

```
{"progress":{"phase":"vertices","verticesCreated":10000,"edgesCreated":0,"idMapping":{
"t1":"#9:0","...":"..."}}}
{"progress":{"phase":"vertices","verticesCreated":20000,"edgesCreated":0,"idMapping":{
"...":"..."}}}
{"summary":{"verticesCreated":20000,"edgesCreated":0,"elapsedMs":1234,"idMappingStream
ed":true,"idMappingSize":20000}}
```

Each `progress` line acknowledges a committed chunk and carries the temporary-ID mapping **for that chunk only**. Concatenate them to obtain the whole mapping, and check the total against `idMappingSize` on the last line. Because neither side ever holds more than one chunk, the 10,000-entry limit above does not apply here: a load of any size gets its complete mapping.

The stream always ends with either a `summary` line (success) or an `error` line (failure); a stream that ends with neither did not arrive complete. On failure the `error` line carries the same counters the buffered response would have, plus the status code it would have been sent under, since the status line can no longer be changed once the stream has started.

Sending no `Accept` header, or any other value, returns the single buffered object described above, unchanged.

The Java driver's `RemoteGraphBatch` uses this encoding automatically, so a bulk load through it is not limited by the mapping size either. Call `withProgressListener(…)` on the builder to be notified of each chunk.

Responses:

- `200` OK
- `400` invalid input format, missing required fields, unknown temporary ID, vertices after edges
- `403` invalid credentials
- `413` the body exceeds `server.httpBodyContentMaxSize`; the load is cut short and the records loaded before the cut **stay loaded**
- `503` / `504` the request could not be forwarded (for example from a follower to the leader); the records loaded before the failure **stay loaded**

A `413`, `503` or `504` does NOT mean that nothing was applied. A batch that is cut short may be partially applied: the server log carries the counts, but the HTTP answer does not. A client that reads such an error as "rejected, nothing applied" and resends the whole payload after raising the limit or splitting it creates duplicates, unless the payload is idempotent (for example `@id`-keyed upserts). Deduplicate on the client side, or reload into a clean target database.

This endpoint is NOT atomic by design. The underlying GraphBatch commits internally in chunks for maximum throughput. The response tells you exactly how many records were committed. Treat it as a bulk-loading operation, not a

transactional one.

For maximum throughput, group vertices by type in the input. The endpoint batches consecutive same-type vertices into a single `createVertices()` call. Interleaving types forces smaller, less efficient batches.

**Examples**

JSONL import with light edges:

```
$ curl -X POST "http://localhost:2480/api/v1/batch/mydb?lightEdges=true" \
       -H "Content-Type: application/x-ndjson" \
       --data-binary @graph-data.jsonl \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

CSV import:

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/batch/mydb \
       -H "Content-Type: text/csv" \
       --data-binary @graph-data.csv \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Inline JSONL with WAL enabled:

```
$ curl -X POST "http://localhost:2480/api/v1/batch/mydb?wal=true" \
       -H "Content-Type: application/x-ndjson" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password \
       -d '{"@type":"vertex","@class":"Person","@id":"p1","name":"Alice"}
{"@type":"vertex","@class":"Person","@id":"p2","name":"Bob"}
{"@type":"edge","@class":"KNOWS","@from":"p1","@to":"p2"}'
```

Python example:

```
import requests

data = (
    '{"@type":"vertex","@class":"Person","@id":"p1","name":"Alice"}\n'
    '{"@type":"vertex","@class":"Person","@id":"p2","name":"Bob"}\n'
    '{"@type":"edge","@class":"KNOWS","@from":"p1","@to":"p2"}\n'
)

resp = requests.post(
    "http://localhost:2480/api/v1/batch/mydb?lightEdges=true",
    auth=("root", "arcadedb-password"),
    headers={"Content-Type": "application/x-ndjson"},
    data=data,
```

```
)
print(resp.json())
# {'verticesCreated': 2, 'edgesCreated': 1, 'elapsedMs': 15, 'idMapping': {'p1':
'#9:0', 'p2': '#9:1'}}
```

JavaScript (Node.js) example:

```
const resp = await fetch("http://localhost:2480/api/v1/batch/mydb", {
  method: "POST",
  headers: {
    "Content-Type": "application/x-ndjson",
    "Authorization": "Basic " + btoa("root:arcadedb-password"),
  },
  body: [
    '{"@type":"vertex","@class":"Person","@id":"p1","name":"Alice"}',
    '{"@type":"vertex","@class":"Person","@id":"p2","name":"Bob"}',
    '{"@type":"edge","@class":"KNOWS","@from":"p1","@to":"p2"}',
  ].join("\n"),
});
console.log(await resp.json());
```

# 5.3. gRPC API

ArcadeDB exposes a gRPC interface for high-performance, strongly-typed access from any language with gRPC support (Java, Python, Go, C++, Node.js, Rust, C#, and more). The gRPC API provides two services with 65 RPCs covering queries, record operations, transactions, graph bulk loading, vector and full-text search, time series, and server administration.

Proto definition: arcadedb-server.proto

## 5.3.1. Enabling the gRPC server

The gRPC module is bundled in the `full` distribution, but the server is implemented as a plugin (`com.arcadedb.server.grpc.GrpcServerPlugin`) that is **not started by default**. If the server is not listening on any gRPC port, it is because the plugin has not been registered yet.

Enable it by adding the plugin to the `arcadedb.server.plugins` setting, then start the server:

```
-Darcadedb.server.plugins=gRPC:com.arcadedb.server.grpc.GrpcServerPlugin
```

The format is `<pluginName>:<pluginFullClass>` (comma-separated when registering several plugins). Once enabled, the server listens on port `50051` by default. Confirm it started by looking for a `gRPC server started` line in the server log, or with `grpcurl -plaintext localhost:50051 list`.

Host, port, TLS, message size and the other gRPC options are configured through `arcadedb.grpc.` system properties - see gRPC settings for the full list. These plugin-level options are read as JVM system properties (`-Darcadedb.grpc.`) and, unlike `arcadedb.server.plugins`, are not resolved

from environment variables.

### 5.3.2. Services

#### ArcadeDbService

The main service for database operations: querying, record CRUD, bulk inserts, transactions, graph bulk loading, search, and time series.

| RPC | Request | Response | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `StreamQuery` | `StreamQueryRequest` | stream `QueryResult` | Execute a query and stream results back row by row |
| `ExecuteCommand` | `ExecuteCommandRequest` | `ExecuteCommandResponse` | Execute a DDL/DML command (CREATE, INSERT, UPDATE, DELETE) |
| `ExecuteQuery` | `ExecuteQueryRequest` | `ExecuteQueryResponse` | Execute a query and return all results at once |
| `CreateRecord` | `CreateRecordRequest` | `CreateRecordResponse` | Create a new record (vertex, edge, or document) |
| `UpdateRecord` | `UpdateRecordRequest` | `UpdateRecordResponse` | Update an existing record by RID |
| `LookupByRid` | `LookupByRidRequest` | `LookupByRidResponse` | Look up a record by its Record ID |
| `DeleteRecord` | `DeleteRecordRequest` | `DeleteRecordResponse` | Delete a record by RID |
| `BulkInsert` | `BulkInsertRequest` | `InsertSummary` | Insert multiple records in a single request |
| `InsertStream` | stream `InsertChunk` | `InsertSummary` | Client-streaming insert for large datasets |
| `InsertBidirectional` | stream `InsertRequest` | stream `InsertResponse` | Bidirectional streaming for insert with per-record feedback |
| `BeginTransaction` | `BeginTransactionRequest` | `BeginTransactionResponse` | Begin an explicit transaction |
| `CommitTransaction` | `CommitTransactionRequest` | `CommitTransactionResponse` | Commit the current transaction |
| `RollbackTransaction` | `RollbackTransactionRequest` | `RollbackTransactionResponse` | Roll back the current transaction |
| `GraphBatchLoad` | stream `GraphBatchChunk` | `GraphBatchResult` | Client-streaming bulk load of vertices and edges (see below) |
| `VectorSearch` | `VectorSearchRequest` | `VectorSearchResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* k-nearest-neighbor search over a dense or sparse vector index |

| RPC | Request | Response | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `HybridSearch` | `HybridSearchRequest` | `HybridSearchResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Fused vector, full-text, and graph-expansion search |
| `FullTextSearch` | `FullTextSearchRequest` | `FullTextSearchResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Lucene-syntax search over a `FULL_TEXT` index |
| `TimeSeriesWrite` | `TimeSeriesWriteRequest` | `TimeSeriesWriteSummary` | *Since 26.10.1.* Write a batch of time-series points |
| `TimeSeriesWriteStream` | stream `TimeSeriesWriteChunk` | `TimeSeriesWriteSummary` | *Since 26.10.1.* Client-streaming time-series ingest |
| `TimeSeriesQuery` | `TimeSeriesQueryRequest` | stream `TimeSeriesQueryResult` | *Since 26.10.1.* Range query, raw or aggregated into buckets, streamed back |
| `TimeSeriesLatest` | `TimeSeriesLatestRequest` | `TimeSeriesLatestResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Latest sample of a time-series type, optionally filtered by tags |

#### Graph batch load

`GraphBatchLoad` streams `GraphBatchChunk` messages, each carrying `GraphBatchRecord` entries of kind `VERTEX` or `EDGE`. The first chunk must name the `database` and carry the `GraphBatchOptions` (batch size, light edges, WAL, commit frequency, `vertex_batch_size`, commit retries, and `return_id_mapping`); options on later chunks are ignored. Vertices declare a `temp_id`, and edges reference their endpoints by `temp_id` or by an existing RID (`#bucket:pos`) in `from_ref` / `to_ref`. All `VERTEX` records must precede every `EDGE` record across the whole stream: interleaving is an error. On a replicated cluster the load must run on the leader; a follower refuses it.

`GraphBatchResult` reports `vertices_created`, `edges_created`, `elapsed_ms` and, depending on `return_id_mapping`, the `temp_id` to RID map in `id_mapping` (when the map is not returned, `id_mapping_omitted` is set and `id_mapping_size` still reports its size). The load commits incrementally, so a failure is not a rollback: the counts already durable at the point of failure travel in the `arcadedb-graph-batch-result-bin` trailer of the failed call, with `partial_commit` set.

#### Vector, hybrid, and full-text search

*Since 26.10.1.* These three unary RPCs run the same server-side implementation as the HTTP `/api/v1/vector/*` routes and the MCP search tools, so a request that is legal on one protocol is legal on all of them and is rejected with the same message. Every hit is a `SearchHit` with `rid`, `record`, and either `distance` (dense index, lower is better) or `score` (sparse, full-text, or fused, higher is better); the response's `scoring` field says which.

| RPC | Key request fields |
| --- | --- |
| `VectorSearch` | `index_name` (an `LSM_VECTOR` index, or an `LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR` index when `sparse` is set), `query_vector`, `query_indices` (sparse dimension ids), `k` (1 to 1000, default 10), `ef_search` (dense only), `filter` (read-only SQL `WHERE` predicate applied to a bounded candidate window). ArcadeDB does not generate embeddings. |
| `HybridSearch` | The vector fields above (`vector_index_name` instead of `index_name`), plus an optional full-text leg (`fulltext_query` and `fulltext_index_name`, which must be given together), `fusion_strategy` (`RRF` by default, `DBSF`, or `LINEAR`), per-leg `weights` (keys `vector`, `fulltext`, `expand`), and an optional `expand` graph leg (`edge_types`, `direction` `out`/`in`/`both`, `max_depth` 1 to 3). The `expand` leg requires `RRF`. |
| `FullTextSearch` | `query_text` (Lucene syntax, not blank), the index addressed by `index_name` or by `type_name` plus optional `properties` (`index_name` wins when both are set), and `limit` (1 to 1000, default 10). |

All three accept an optional `transaction`: when it names a live transaction the search reads exactly what that transaction reads, including its uncommitted changes. A transaction id the server no longer knows is refused with `FAILED_PRECONDITION`. See also Full-text index.

#### Time series

*Since 26.10.1.* The time-series RPCs read and write `TIMESERIES` types (see Time series).

- **`TimeSeriesWrite` / `TimeSeriesWriteStream`**: each `TimeSeriesPoint` carries `type` (the measurement, defaulting to the request or chunk `type`), `timestamp`, and `tags` / `fields` maps of `GrpcValue`. `precision` defaults to `TS_PRECISION_MILLISECONDS` (unlike the HTTP line-protocol endpoint, which defaults to nanoseconds). The streaming variant needs `database` on the first chunk only and applies back-pressure, pulling one chunk at a time. A write is not atomic: each measurement's batch commits as it is appended. `TimeSeriesWriteSummary` reports `received`, `written`, and `dropped` (`written + dropped == received`), and lists dropped points' types under `unknown_types`, `non_time_series_types`, or `unavailable_types`.
- **`TimeSeriesQuery`**: `type`, inclusive `from_timestamp` / `to_timestamp` (unset means unbounded), `fields` projection (an unknown name is refused with `INVALID_ARGUMENT`), `tags` (`TimeSeriesTagFilter`, a conjunction of equality predicates on TAG columns; a non-TAG name is refused with `INVALID_ARGUMENT`), `limit`, `batch_size` (rows per streamed message, default 1000), and optional `aggregation` (`bucket_interval_ms` > 0, at least one `TimeSeriesAggregationRequest` of `TS_AGG_SUM`, `AVG`, `MIN`, `MAX` or `COUNT`, and an optional `bucket_origin_ms`). The answer streams as `TimeSeriesQueryResult` messages carrying `rows` (raw) or `buckets` (aggregated); the last message has `last` set, and `truncated` when the limit cut the answer short. The server-side ceiling `arcadedb.server.grpcTimeSeriesMaxResultRows` (default 1000000) cannot be raised by the client: a `limit` above it is refused with `RESOURCE_EXHAUSTED` before the first message.
- **`TimeSeriesLatest`**: `type` and optional `tags`. `TimeSeriesLatestResponse` returns `columns`, `found`, and the `latest` row (unset when `found` is `false`).

`TimeSeriesQuery` and `TimeSeriesLatest` accept an optional `transaction`; when set, the read sees that transaction's uncommitted points. An unresolvable transaction id is refused with `FAILED_PRECONDITION` (the HTTP time-series read routes instead fall back to reading outside the transaction).

#### ArcadeDbAdminService

Administration service for server and database management. Every admin RPC runs the same implementation as the HTTP control plane, so the two protocols behave the same way.

**Authentication and authorization.** Every request is authenticated from its `credentials` field, except `Health` and `Ready`, which are unauthenticated like `GET /api/v1/health` and `GET /api/v1/ready`. `Ping`, `GetServerInfo`, `ListDatabases`, `ExistsDatabase`, and `GetDatabaseInfo` need any valid account; `GetProgress` needs an account granted the named database; every other RPC requires the `root` user and otherwise fails with `PERMISSION_DENIED`.

**Leader routing.** On a replicated cluster, `CreateDatabase`, `DropDatabase`, `CreateUser`, `UpdateUser`, `DeleteUser`, `SaveGroup`, `DeleteGroup`, `CreateApiToken`, `DeleteApiToken`, `RestoreBackup`, `RestoreDatabase`, and `ImportDatabase` are refused on a follower with `FAILED_PRECONDITION` and the leader's address in the `arcadedb-leader-*` trailers. gRPC has no request proxy, so the client redirects itself.

##### Server info and databases

| RPC | Request | Response | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `Ping` | `PingRequest` | `PingResponse` | Health check |
| `GetServerInfo` | `GetServerInfoRequest` | `GetServerInfoResponse` | Server version, uptime, and configuration |
| `ListDatabases` | `ListDatabasesRequest` | `ListDatabasesResponse` | List all databases |
| `ExistsDatabase` | `ExistsDatabaseRequest` | `ExistsDatabaseResponse` | Check if a database exists |
| `CreateDatabase` | `CreateDatabaseRequest` | `CreateDatabaseResponse` | Create a new database (see below) |
| `DropDatabase` | `DropDatabaseRequest` | `DropDatabaseResponse` | Drop an existing database (see below) |
| `OpenDatabase` | `OpenDatabaseRequest` | `OpenDatabaseResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Open the named database |
| `CloseDatabase` | `CloseDatabaseRequest` | `CloseDatabaseResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Close the named database's open instance; the files stay, and a later request reopens it |
| `AlignDatabase` | `AlignDatabaseRequest` | `AlignDatabaseResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Run `ALIGN DATABASE` on the named database |
| `GetDatabaseInfo` | `GetDatabaseInfoRequest` | `GetDatabaseInfoResponse` | Schema, types, and database statistics |

| RPC | Request | Response | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `GetProgress` | `GetProgressRequest` | `GetProgressResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Long-running operations (CHECK DATABASE, REBUILD INDEX, backup, import, ...) running on the database, as `GET /api/v1/progress/{database}`. Empty when nothing runs |

`CreateDatabase` and `DropDatabase` answer the no-op case the way the HTTP `create database` and `drop database` commands do: a name already taken is refused with `ALREADY_EXISTS`, a name that does not exist with `NOT_FOUND`. Set `if_not_exists` on `CreateDatabaseRequest`, or `if_exists` on `DropDatabaseRequest`, to make the call idempotent instead. Either way the response says what happened: `CreateDatabaseResponse.created` is `true` only when this call created the database, and `DropDatabaseResponse.dropped` only when it dropped one, so a provisioning tool can tell "created for me" from "already there" rather than reading an empty OK as ownership. Database names are exact and never case-folded. The Java client exposes the two forms as `createDatabase` / `createDatabaseIfMissing` and `dropDatabase` / `dropDatabaseIfExists`; the `IfMissing` / `IfExists` variants return the boolean.

**Users, groups, and API tokens**

| RPC | Request | Response | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `CreateUser` | `CreateUserRequest` | `CreateUserResponse` | Create a new user |
| `UpdateUser` | `UpdateUserRequest` | `UpdateUserResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Update a user's `password` and/or `databases` grants. Each field is optional and an absent one is left untouched; a present but empty `databases` clears the grants |
| `DeleteUser` | `DeleteUserRequest` | `DeleteUserResponse` | Delete a user |
| `ListUsers` | `ListUsersRequest` | `ListUsersResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* List users with their per-database groups. Password hashes are never included |
| `ListGroups` | `ListGroupsRequest` | `ListGroupsResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* The whole group document, as JSON in `groups_json` |
| `SaveGroup` | `SaveGroupRequest` | `SaveGroupResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Create or replace one group of a database (`*` for all) from `group_json` |
| `DeleteGroup` | `DeleteGroupRequest` | `DeleteGroupResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Delete one group of a database |

| RPC | Request | Response | Description |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `ListApiTokens` | `ListApiTokensRequest` | `ListApiTokensResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* List API tokens as `ApiTokenInfo` (hash, last four characters, expiry, `expired` flag), never the token itself |
| `CreateApiToken` | `CreateApiTokenRequest` | `CreateApiTokenResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Mint an API token. The plaintext `token` is returned once only. Refused with `FAILED_PRECONDITION` unless the channel uses TLS or the client is on loopback; a duplicate name is `ALREADY_EXISTS` |
| `DeleteApiToken` | `DeleteApiTokenRequest` | `DeleteApiTokenResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Revoke a token by its `token_hash` (the plaintext token is not accepted) |

### Settings

| RPC | Request | Response | Description |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `SetServerSetting` | `SetServerSettingRequest` | `SetServerSettingResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Set a server setting. `key` and `value` are separate fields, so a value with spaces needs no quoting |
| `SetDatabaseSetting` | `SetDatabaseSettingRequest` | `SetDatabaseSettingResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Set a setting of one database |

### Backup, restore, and import

| RPC | Request | Response | Description |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `GetBackupConfig` | `GetBackupConfigRequest` | `GetBackupConfigResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Auto-backup configuration as JSON, and whether the auto-backup plugin is running |
| `SetBackupConfig` | `SetBackupConfigRequest` | `SetBackupConfigResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Save the auto-backup configuration from `config_json` |
| `ListBackups` | `ListBackupsRequest` | `ListBackupsResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Backup archives of a database, with retention totals |
| `TriggerBackup` | `TriggerBackupRequest` | `TriggerBackupResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Back up a database now; returns the archive path |

| RPC | Request | Response | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `DeleteBackup` | `DeleteBackupRequest` | `DeleteBackupResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Delete one archive by plain file name (path separators and traversal are refused) |
| `RestoreBackup` | `RestoreBackupRequest` | stream `RestoreProgress` | *Since 26.10.1.* Restore a database's backup archive into `target_database`; `overwrite` replaces an existing target only after the restore succeeded |
| `RestoreDatabase` | `RestoreDatabaseRequest` | stream `RestoreProgress` | *Since 26.10.1.* Create a new database from an archive at a `url` |
| `ImportDatabase` | `ImportDatabaseRequest` | stream `ImportProgress` | *Since 26.10.1.* Create a new database and import the source at a `url` into it; progress carries importer lines and `parsed` / `vertices` / `edges` counters |

The three restore and import RPCs are server-streaming: they send progress messages while the operation runs, then one final message with `completed = true` (`ImportProgress.result_json` carries the importer's final report). A failure ends the stream with an error status instead. Cancelling the call stops the progress messages, not the operation. Unless `arcadedb.server.restoreImportAllowLocalUrls` is enabled, only `http`/`https` URLs to non-private hosts are accepted. See also Backup.

### Query profiler

| RPC | Request | Response | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `ProfilerStart` | `ProfilerStartRequest` | `ProfilerStateResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Start recording. `timeout_seconds` of 0 or less applies the server default; the effective timeout is returned |
| `ProfilerStop` | `ProfilerStopRequest` | `ProfilerDocumentResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Stop recording and return the run as JSON |
| `ProfilerReset` | `ProfilerResetRequest` | `ProfilerStateResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Reset the profiler |
| `ProfilerResults` | `ProfilerResultsRequest` | `ProfilerDocumentResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Current profiler results as JSON, without stopping |
| `ProfilerList` | `ProfilerListRequest` | `ProfilerListResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Saved profiler runs on disk, newest first |
| `ProfilerLoad` | `ProfilerLoadRequest` | `ProfilerDocumentResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Load a saved run by file name |

**Server lifecycle and cluster**

| RPC | Request | Response | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `GetServerEvents` | `GetServerEventsRequest` | `GetServerEventsResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Server events as a JSON array, from the current event file or a named one, plus the list of event files |
| `Shutdown` | `ShutdownRequest` | `ShutdownResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Shut down this server (empty `server_name`) or the named HA peer. The local shutdown is scheduled asynchronously, so the response arrives first |
| `DisconnectCluster` | `DisconnectClusterRequest` | `DisconnectClusterResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Disconnect this server from the cluster |
| `ConnectCluster` | `ConnectClusterRequest` | `ConnectClusterResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Join the server at `server_address` (an `arcadedb.ha.serverList` entry) to the cluster. `FAILED_PRECONDITION` when HA is not running or cannot change membership at runtime; empty address is `INVALID_ARGUMENT` |
| `ListSessions` | `ListSessionsRequest` | `ListSessionsResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Open HTTP authentication sessions, including their bearer tokens. Enable TLS before calling it across an untrusted network |

**Health probes**

| RPC | Request | Response | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `Health` | `HealthRequest` | `HealthResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Unauthenticated liveness probe; `ok` is `false` only when the HA layer escalated a crash loop |
| `Ready` | `ReadyRequest` | `ReadyResponse` | *Since 26.10.1.* Unauthenticated readiness probe; a not-ready node answers `ready = false` with a `reason` rather than an error status |

### 5.3.3. Cancellation and running statements

*Since 26.11.1.* The `ArcadeDbService` RPCs whose client sends a single request (such as `ExecuteQuery`,

`ExecuteCommand`, `StreamQuery`, the search RPCs and `TimeSeriesQuery`; not the client-streaming inserts and loads, nor `BeginTransaction` and `RollbackTransaction`) are listed, while they run, by the HTTP `list queries` server command and by Cypher `SHOW TRANSACTIONS`, with `protocol grpc`, and can be stopped by `terminate query`, `TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS` or Studio.

A client that cancels a call, or whose deadline expires, or whose connection drops, terminates the server-side work too: the server stops it at its next check instead of running it to the end for an answer nobody reads.

A terminated call ends with status `CANCELLED` and the trailer `arcadedb-exception-class` set to `com.arcadedb.exception.QueryTerminatedException`; the gRPC Java client raises that exception, which it does not retry. A statement terminated inside a client-managed transaction (`BeginTransaction`) ends that transaction: it is rolled back, and a later `CommitTransaction` answers `committed = false`.

### 5.3.4. Message Types

#### Connection & Authentication

| | |
|---|---|
| `DatabaseCredentials` | Database name, username, and password for per-request authentication |

#### Value Types

The `GrpcValue` message uses a `oneof` to represent any ArcadeDB value:

| Field | ArcadeDB Type |
|---|---|
| `bool_value` | Boolean |
| `int32_value` | Integer |
| `int64_value` | Long |
| `float_value` | Float |
| `double_value` | Double |
| `string_value` | String |
| `bytes_value` | Binary / byte array |
| `timestamp_value` | Datetime (google.protobuf.Timestamp) |
| `list_value` | List / array |
| `map_value` | Map / embedded document |
| `link_value` | RID reference (bucket:position) |
| `decimal_value` | Decimal (string-encoded) |
| `null_value` | Null |

`GrpcRecord` wraps a record with its RID, type name, and a map of property name to `GrpcValue`.

### Enums

| Enum | Values |
|---|---|
| `RetrievalMode` | `CURSOR` (streaming), `MATERIALIZE_ALL` (all at once), `PAGED` (paginated) |
| `ProjectionEncoding` | `PROJECTION_AS_LINK`, `PROJECTION_AS_MAP`, `PROJECTION_AS_JSON` |
| `TransactionIsolation` | `READ_UNCOMMITTED`, `READ_COMMITTED`, `REPEATABLE_READ`, `SERIALIZABLE` |
| `ConflictMode` | `CONFLICT_ERROR`, `CONFLICT_UPDATE`, `CONFLICT_IGNORE`, `CONFLICT_ABORT` |
| `TransactionMode` | `PER_REQUEST`, `PER_BATCH`, `PER_STREAM`, `PER_ROW`, `NONE` |

`PAGED` retrieval keeps the `ORDER BY` your query specifies. When the query specifies none, rows are ordered by `@rid`, because cutting pages needs a stable order or a row could be skipped or repeated across pages. `PAGED` also reserves the parameter names `_skip` and `_limit`, and applies to SQL only: a query in another language falls back to `CURSOR`. If you order by a column with duplicate values, rows that tie can still move between pages, since every page re-runs the query; add a unique tie-break such as `ORDER BY createdAt DESC, @rid` when pages must be reproducible.

### Insert Operations

| | |
|---|---|
| `BulkInsertRequest` | Batch of records with type name, properties, and insert options |
| `InsertChunk` | A chunk of records for client-streaming inserts |
| `InsertRequest` / `InsertResponse` | Per-record request/response for bidirectional streaming |
| `InsertSummary` | Result summary: total inserted, errors, duration |
| `InsertOptions` | Transaction mode, conflict handling, and batch size configuration |

### Command Results & Write Statistics

`ExecuteCommand` returns an `ExecuteCommandResponse`:

| Field | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `success` / `message` | Whether the command succeeded, and an optional message |
| `affected_records` | Server-computed count of affected elements and numeric scalars |
| `execution_time_ms` | Server-side execution time |
| `records` | Optional row payload, returned when `return_rows` is set on the request |

| Field | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `stats` | A `QueryUpdateStats` message, **present only for write commands that mutated data** |

`QueryUpdateStats` carries the same write counters the HTTP `stats` object and the Bolt result summary expose, including counts aggregated across OpenCypher `UNION` branches and `CALL { … }` subqueries:

| Field | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `nodes_created` / `nodes_deleted` | Vertices created / deleted |
| `relationships_created` / `relationships_deleted` | Edges created / deleted |
| `properties_set` | Properties assigned a value |
| `labels_added` / `labels_removed` | Type/label memberships added / removed |
| `indexes_added` / `indexes_removed` | Indexes created / dropped |
| `constraints_added` / `constraints_removed` | Constraints added / removed |
| `contains_updates` | `true` when any counter above is non-zero |

The equivalent HTTP response object is documented at Write statistics.

### Connecting from Python

```
import grpc
import arcadedb_server_pb2 as pb
import arcadedb_server_pb2_grpc as rpc

channel = grpc.insecure_channel('localhost:50051')
stub = rpc.ArcadeDbServiceStub(channel)

# Execute a query
request = pb.ExecuteQueryRequest(
    credentials=pb.DatabaseCredentials(
        database='mydb', username='root', password='arcadedb'
    ),
    language='sql',
    command='SELECT FROM V LIMIT 10',
)
response = stub.ExecuteQuery(request)
for record in response.records:
    print(record)
```

### Connecting from Node.js

```
const grpc = require('@grpc/grpc-js');
```

```
const protoLoader = require('@grpc/proto-loader');

const packageDef = protoLoader.loadSync('arcadedb-server.proto');
const proto = grpc.loadPackageDefinition(packageDef).arcadedb;

const client = new proto.ArcadeDbService(
  'localhost:50051', grpc.credentials.createInsecure()
);

client.ExecuteQuery({
  credentials: { database: 'mydb', username: 'root', password: 'arcadedb' },
  language: 'sql',
  command: 'SELECT FROM V LIMIT 10',
}, (err, response) => {
  console.log(response.records);
});
```

**Further Reading**

- Proto definition on GitHub
- HTTP/JSON API — Alternative REST-based access
- PostgreSQL Protocol — Alternative wire protocol

# 5.4. Bolt Driver Compatibility Matrix

ArcadeDB's Neo4j BOLT protocol implementation is certified against every official Neo4j driver — Java, JavaScript, Python, .NET, and Go — driven by a single, language-neutral conformance spec. Every driver is proven against the full feature matrix, and every unsupported cell is an explicitly documented limitation, never a silent omission.

The full driver × feature × version matrix is **generated from CI** and is the authoritative source. It is published and kept current in the ArcadeDB repository:

- Compatibility matrix (COMPATIBILITY.md) — one cell per scenario × driver × pinned version, with a "last verified" timestamp and a link to the CI run that produced it.
- Conformance spec (spec.yaml) — the shared, language-neutral scenario definitions.
- Driver-version matrix (driver-versions.md) — the pinned driver versions, re-tested nightly against new driver releases.

The matrix on this page summarizes the certified feature areas. Consult the generated matrix above for exact per-version results.

## 5.4.1. Certified Feature Areas

| Area | Scenarios | Status |
|---|---|---|
| Connection | `bolt://`, `bolt+s://` (TLS required), `neo4j://` routing (single-node and HA), TLS `OPTIONAL` fallback | Certified |
| Authentication | Basic auth (valid / invalid credentials); scheme `none` rejected (intentional) | Certified |
| Transactions | Autocommit; explicit `BEGIN`/`COMMIT`/`ROLLBACK`; managed `executeRead`/`executeWrite` with retry-on-transient | Certified |
| Causal consistency | Bookmarks (read-after-write across sessions) | Certified |
| Multi-database | Per-session named-database selection; isolation across databases | Certified |
| Result handling | Streaming `PULL n`, `DISCARD`, accurate `ResultSummary` counters | Certified |
| Type round-trip | Node, Relationship, Path; temporal (`Date`, `Time`, `LocalTime`, `DateTime`, `LocalDateTime`); `Duration`; spatial `Point`; byte array; lists, sets and typed array properties (`ARRAY_OF_FLOATS` and the other `ARRAY_OF_*` types, as used for vector embeddings) all returned as lists; nested lists/maps; null | Certified |
| Errors | `Neo.ClientError.` (syntax, semantic, security, missing entity, invalid argument, constraint, type) and `Neo.TransientError.` (drives driver retry). Since 26.10.1 a missing record, an unknown type or property, and an invalid value report their own client error codes instead of the generic `Neo.DatabaseError.General.UnknownError`. See Error codes | Certified |
| Protocol | BOLT 3.0 / 4.0 / 4.4 and 5.0–5.4 negotiation; `RESET` mid-stream | Certified |

### 5.4.2. Error Codes

Every failure carries the Neo4j status code that describes it, so a driver can tell a mistake in your request from a problem with the server, and retry only what is worth retrying.

**Selecting a database.** These are the first errors a driver can meet, because the database is resolved before anything else runs:

| Code | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `Neo.ClientError.Database.DatabaseNotFound` | The name in the `database` connection parameter does not exist on this server. Permanent: retrying cannot help, fix the name. |
| `Neo.TransientError.Database.DatabaseUnavailable` | The database exists but cannot serve the request right now - it is closed, or the server has not finished opening its databases. The same request succeeds once it is available, so a retry is worthwhile. |

| Code | Meaning |
| --- | --- |
| `Neo.ClientError.Security.Forbidden` | The user is not allowed to reach that database. A permissions problem, not a database one. |
| `Neo.DatabaseError.General.UnknownError` | The database is genuinely broken - corruption, an I/O failure. This is the only case that is the server's fault. |

**Transactions.** `BEGIN`, `COMMIT` and `ROLLBACK` all report the same code for the same underlying failure:

| Code | Meaning |
| --- | --- |
| `Neo.TransientError.Transaction.DeadlockDetected` | A concurrent modification or lock contention. Drivers retry a managed transaction on this code automatically. |
| `Neo.ClientError.Transaction.TransactionTimedOut` | A query or transaction deadline ran out. Retrying with a longer timeout is a decision for the caller, so drivers do not retry it on their own. |
| `Neo.ClientError.Security.Forbidden` | The operation was refused for permission reasons. |
| `Neo.ClientError.Transaction.TransactionNotFound` | The fallback when the failure matches none of the above. |

Before 26.10.1, `BEGIN` and `ROLLBACK` reported `Neo.ClientError.Transaction.TransactionNotFound` for every failure, and all database-selection failures reported `Neo.DatabaseError.General.UnknownError`. If your application branches on the status code, a conflict on `BEGIN` is now retried by the driver instead of failing, and a wrong database name is no longer indistinguishable from a broken server.

### 5.4.3. Documented Limitations

These cells are deliberate, documented differences rather than defects:

- **Auth** `none` — always rejected; ArcadeDB requires credentials.
- **Unauthenticated** `RUN` — the "reject a query before authentication" scenario cannot be exercised through any official driver, because every driver completes the handshake before exposing query methods. It is therefore marked not-applicable rather than tested.
- **Heterogeneous HA BOLT ports** — clusters whose nodes expose BOLT on different ports must declare each node's client-reachable address in `arcadedb.ha.serverList` (see Routing and High Availability).
- `RID` / `UUID` — serialized as strings (no native BOLT type).
- `BigDecimal` / **oversized** `BigInteger` — down-converted to `double` (possible precision loss).

### 5.4.4. Certified Drivers and Versions

Each driver is pinned for PR-gating CI and re-tested nightly across a wider version band, so a driver-side release that breaks compatibility is caught quickly. The pinned versions live in the driver-version matrix.

| Language | Driver | Certified version bands |
|---|---|---|
| Java | `neo4j-java-driver` | 4.4.x (legacy), 5.x, 6.x |
| JavaScript | `neo4j-driver` | 5.x, 6.x |
| Python | `neo4j` | 5.x (LTS), 6.x |
| .NET | `Neo4j.Driver` | 5.x, 6.x |
| Go | `neo4j-go-driver/v5` | 5.x |

For the advertised server identity these results are measured against, see Server Identity and Feature Envelope.

### 5.4.5. See Also

- Neo4j BOLT Protocol
- OpenCypher Query Language
- Generated compatibility matrix

## 5.5. Postgres Protocol Plugin

ArcadeDB Server supports a subset of the Postgres wire protocol, such as connection and queries.

If you're using ArcadeDB as embedded, please add the dependency to the `arcadedb-postgresw` library. If you're using Maven include this dependency in your `pom.xml` file.

```
<dependency>
    <groupId>com.arcadedb</groupId>
    <artifactId>arcadedb-postgresw</artifactId>
    <version>26.10.1</version>
</dependency>
```

To start the Postgres plugin, enlist it in the `server.plugins` settings. To specify multiple plugins, use the comma `,` as separator. Example:

```
~/arcadedb $ bin/server.sh -Darcadedb.server.plugins
="Postgres:com.arcadedb.postgres.PostgresProtocolPlugin"
```

If you're using MS Windows OS, replace `server.sh` with `server.bat`.

In case of an incompatibility, restart the server with the additional option `-Darcadedb.postgres.debug=true`, repeat the connection attempt, and add the debug output to the issue report.

In case you're running ArcadeDB with Docker, use `-e` to pass settings and open the Postgres default port `5432`:

```
docker run --rm -p 2480:2480 -p 5432:5432 \
       --env ARCADEDB_SETTINGS="-Darcadedb.server.rootPassword=playwithdata \

-Darcadedb.server.plugins=Postgres:com.arcadedb.postgres.PostgresProtocolPlugin " \
          arcadedata/arcadedb:latest
```

The Server output will contain this line:

```
2021-07-08 19:05:06.081 INFO  [ArcadeDBServer] <ArcadeDB_0> - Postgres Protocol plugin
started
```

Once you have enabled the Postgres Protocol, you can interact with ArcadeDB server by using any Postgres drivers. The driver sends the queries to the ArcadeDB server without parsing or checking the syntax. For this reason, even if ArcadeDB SQL is different from Postgres SQL, you're still able to execute any ArcadeDB SQL command through the Postgres driver. Check out the following list with the official drivers for the most popular programming languages:

- C
- C#
- C++
- Go
- Javascript - Node.js
- PHP
- Python
- R
- Ruby
- Rust

For the complete list, please check Postgres website.

### 5.5.1. Other query languages

By default the Postgres driver interprets all the commands as SQL. To use another supported language, like Cypher, Gremlin, GraphQL or MongoDB, prefix the command with the language to use between curly brackets.

Example to execute a query by using GraphQL:

```
{graphql}{ bookById(id: "book-1"){ id name authors { firstName, lastName } }
```

Example to use Cypher:

```
{cypher}MATCH (m:Movie)<-[a:ACTED_IN]-(p:Person) WHERE id(m) = '#1:0' RETURN *
```

Example of using Gremlin:

```
{gremlin}g.V()
```

### 5.5.2. TLS/SSL

The plugin supports TLS through the Postgres protocol's own handshake, so `psql`, JDBC and BI tools can connect with `sslmode=require`. Set `arcadedb.postgres.ssl` to one of:

- `DISABLED` (default): no TLS. A client asking for TLS is told to continue in plain text.
- `OPTIONAL`: the client chooses TLS or plain text.
- `REQUIRED`: plain text connections are refused before any password is requested.

TLS uses the same key store and trust store settings as the HTTP server (`arcadedb.ssl.keyStore`, `arcadedb.ssl.keyStorePassword`, `arcadedb.ssl.trustStore`, `arcadedb.ssl.trustStorePassword`), and all four must be set. The server does not ask clients for a certificate.

```
bin/server.sh -Darcadedb.server.plugins
="Postgres:com.arcadedb.postgres.PostgresProtocolPlugin" \
  -Darcadedb.postgres.ssl=REQUIRED \
  -Darcadedb.ssl.keyStore=/path/keystore.pkcs12 -Darcadedb.ssl.keyStorePassword=secret
\
  -Darcadedb.ssl.trustStore=/path/truststore.jks -Darcadedb.ssl.trustStorePassword
=secret
psql "host=localhost port=5432 dbname=mydb user=root sslmode=require"
```

PostgreSQL 17 "direct" TLS (`sslnegotiation=direct`) is not supported.

### 5.5.3. Current limitations

The documentation about Postgres wire protocol is not exhaustive to build a bullet proof protocol. In particular the state machine. For this reason this plugin was created by reading the available documentation online (official and not official) and looking into Postgres drivers or implementations.

Both the "simple" query protocol and the extended query protocol (`Parse`/`Bind`/`Describe`/`Execute`/ `Sync`, what `PreparedStatement` uses) are supported.

*Since v26.10.1*, `BEGIN`, `COMMIT` and `ROLLBACK` sent through the extended query protocol are acknowledged the way PostgreSQL acknowledges them. Previously a libpq-based client - psycopg3, asyncpg, the Apache Arrow ADBC PostgreSQL driver - could fail to open a transaction with `Failed to begin transaction`. In the same release, a statement the server rejects no longer leaves the

previously prepared statement usable under the same name, so a client can no longer receive the earlier statement's rows in answer to one that was refused.

*Since v26.10.1*, a portal (the bound statement `Execute` runs) lives only as long as the transaction it was created in, as in PostgreSQL: in autocommit it ends at `Sync`, inside `BEGIN` it ends at `COMMIT`/`ROLLBACK`. Fetching a large result in chunks (JDBC `setFetchSize()`) therefore needs a transaction, which is what the PostgreSQL JDBC driver already requires. Binding from a prepared statement that does not exist is refused with SQLSTATE `26000`, and executing or describing a portal that does not exist with `34000`, instead of answering with a success message.

*Since v26.10.1*, running a prepared statement without asking for its row description again (what the PostgreSQL JDBC driver does once a statement has run `prepareThreshold` times, 5 by default) no longer sends an unrequested row description. Before, the JDBC connection failed with `NoSuchElementException` from the 6th execution on.

*Since v26.10.1*, when a prepared statement is described (`Describe` on the statement, what asyncpg, npgsql and pgx do) and the server answers that it returns no rows, running it keeps that promise. An `INSERT`, `UPDATE`, `DELETE`, `CREATE VERTEX` or `CREATE EDGE` without `RETURN` answers only its command tag with the number of affected records (e.g. `INSERT 0 1`), like PostgreSQL. A statement whose columns cannot be known before it runs (e.g. a `{cypher}` query) and that then returns rows is refused with SQLSTATE `0A000`: describe the portal instead (what the PostgreSQL JDBC driver, libpq and psycopg do), which runs the statement first and reports its real columns.

### 5.5.4. System catalog and schema introspection

*Since v26.9.1*, queries against `pg_catalog` and `information_schema` - the ones a client's driver sends to discover schemas, tables, columns and types, typically via `DatabaseMetaData.getSchemas()`/`getTables()`/`getColumns()`/`getTypeInfo()` - are answered by recognizing the **shape** of the query (which relations it names, which columns it projects, including a client's own `CASE` expressions) rather than by matching one tool's exact spelling. This means the same question is answered the same way whichever Postgres client sends it, rather than only for a short list of tools this plugin happened to be tested against. A catalog query in a shape the server does not recognize returns an empty result set rather than an error, matching how PostgreSQL itself answers a `pg_catalog` object it does not have.

The emulated schema list always contains exactly one schema, named after the connected database - matching `SELECT current_schema()` - because a PostgreSQL connection is bound to one database and sees the schemas inside it, and in ArcadeDB a connection is likewise bound to one database whose types are its tables.

*Since v26.10.1*, `pg_type` can also be queried on its own, and not only as part of a column list. Some clients build a map of every type the server has before they run a single query, and refuse to connect if that map comes back empty - the Apache Arrow ADBC PostgreSQL driver is one of them. Such a query is answered with the types this protocol can actually produce (see Column type mapping below), each described the way PostgreSQL describes it. A filter the server cannot interpret returns no rows rather than every type, so a client asking whether an extension type such as `hstore` exists is correctly told it does not.

*Since v26.10.1*, the `regclass` and `regtype` casts resolve, in both directions: `'mytable'::regclass` is that

type's OID and `attrelid::regclass` is its name, and likewise `'int4'::regtype` and `atttypid::regtype` for types. The function spellings `to_regclass()` and `to_regtype()` do the same. Some drivers ask for a table's columns by writing the name as a `regclass` cast and comparing it against `pg_class.oid` - the Apache Arrow ADBC PostgreSQL driver does this in `GetTableSchema` - and before this the cast was ignored, so the comparison silently matched nothing and the client saw a table with no columns. A name no type carries resolves to `NULL`, as `to_regclass()` does in PostgreSQL, so asking about a table that does not exist returns nothing rather than describing every table.

Type names are matched case-sensitively first, as ArcadeDB stores them, and only then ignoring case - so `'MyType'::regclass` finds the type spelled that way even though PostgreSQL would have folded the unquoted name to lower case. If two types differ only in case, an unquoted name that matches neither of them exactly resolves to nothing rather than picking one; quote the name to say which you mean.

*Since v26.10.1*, a query that joins a catalog relation to `pg_roles` or `pg_user` to name an owner - what a GUI browser sends to list tables with their owner - answers with the connected user rather than `NULL`:

```
SELECT c.relname, r.rolname AS owner FROM pg_class c JOIN pg_roles r ON r.oid = c
.relowner
```

Only the connected user is described as a role; an emulated catalog does not hand out the server's account list. A query about roles, databases, privileges, character sets or collations that also mentions `pg_namespace` is now answered as the question it asks, instead of being answered as a schema query.

### 5.5.5. COPY … TO STDOUT

`COPY` in its export direction is supported (since 26.10.1), in every form PostgreSQL accepts for it:

```
COPY (SELECT name, age FROM Person WHERE age > 18) TO STDOUT
COPY Person TO STDOUT (FORMAT csv, HEADER)
COPY Person (name, age) TO STDOUT WITH (FORMAT binary)
COPY (SELECT FROM Person) TO STDOUT CSV HEADER DELIMITER ';' NULL 'nil'
```

The query in parentheses runs as it stands, in the session's query language (so a `{cypher}` prefix applies to it), and a type name with an optional column list stands for the equivalent `SELECT`. Quote the name if it is not a plain identifier - `COPY "My Type" TO STDOUT` - and any character is allowed in it, backslashes and backticks included (fixed in 26.10.1: such a name used to be misread or refused). The rows travel in PostgreSQL's own `text`, `csv` or `binary` COPY encoding, so anything that reads a PostgreSQL COPY stream reads them: `psql␣s `\copy` (`\copy (SELECT FROM Person) TO 'people.csv' CSV HEADER`), pgjdbc's `CopyManager`, pandas, and the Apache Arrow ADBC PostgreSQL driver, which reads every result set through `COPY … TO STDOUT (FORMAT binary)` by default and no longer needs `adbc.postgresql.use_copy=false`.

The option list (`FORMAT`, `DELIMITER`, `NULL`, `HEADER`, `QUOTE`, `ESCAPE`, `FORCE_QUOTE`, `ENCODING`) and the older keyword spelling (`BINARY`, `CSV HEADER`, `DELIMITER AS`, `NULL AS`, `QUOTE AS`, `ESCAPE AS`, `FORCE QUOTE`) are

both accepted, with the same restrictions PostgreSQL applies to their combinations. The output is always UTF-8.

The exported columns are fixed before the first row goes out, the way `RowDescription` fixes them for a query. For a whole type they are every property the type declares, inherited ones included, plus whatever a sample row adds on top - a declared property is exported even when the first row does not have one. Because ArcadeDB types can hold rows of different shapes, that set is a good answer but not a provable one: if a row turns out to carry a property the export never announced, the `COPY` fails with SQLSTATE `0A000` naming that column, rather than writing the row without it. List the columns yourself to make the set exact and the export complete:

```
COPY Person (name, age, email) TO STDOUT
COPY (SELECT name, age, email FROM Person) TO STDOUT
```

A `COPY` whose columns the schema can name is streamed row by row and is not subject to `arcadedb.postgres.queryMaxRows`, which is what makes it the way to export a large type over this protocol; a query whose columns only its rows can name (a schemaless type with no sample row, another query language) is materialized first, within that limit, exactly as a plain query is. The streamed form holds the query's cursor open for as long as the client reads, which is what a bulk export needs; where that is not wanted for every user of the wire, bound the query itself with a `WHERE` or a `LIMIT`, as `psql \copy` users do.

Not supported, and refused with SQLSTATE `0A000` (`feature_not_supported`): the ingest direction `COPY ⋯ FROM STDIN` (use `INSERT`, or the HTTP import API), and the server-side targets `COPY ⋯ TO 'file'` and `COPY ⋯ TO PROGRAM`, which would let a wire client write files or run commands on the server host. In binary format a column without a binary encoding on this server (an array) is refused the same way; export it in text or CSV format, or project it as a string.

### 5.5.6. Column type mapping

A column's advertised PostgreSQL type must not depend on whether the query happens to return any rows - a client that prepares a statement against an empty result (or a schema-discovery `DESCRIBE`) and later re-executes it against a populated one would otherwise see the column's type change under it. As of *v26.9.1* this holds for every type ArcadeDB maps onto a native PostgreSQL OID:

- `BINARY` is announced as `bytea` (with the standard `\x<hex>` text encoding), so `ResultSet.getBytes()` /`PreparedStatement.setBytes()` round-trip it as raw bytes, rather than the lossy `varchar`/`"char"[]` answers used before *v26.9.1*.
- `DECIMAL` is announced as `numeric` (OID 1700), with a real binary encoder/decoder, rather than the lossy `double precision` or the text-only `varchar` used before *v26.9.1* - `ResultSet.getBigDecimal()` round-trips the full precision. A `NUMERIC` value is capped at 16,000 total decimal digits (well under PostgreSQL's own limit of 131,072 integer / 16,383 fractional digits), because ArcadeDB's `DECIMAL` type has no configured precision or scale limit of its own; a value beyond this cap is declined with an error rather than accepted and silently truncated.
- `SHORT` and `BYTE` are announced as `int2` (`smallint`), matching the declared schema type, rather than widening to `int4` (`integer`) as they did before *v26.9.1*.

- `DATE` is announced as `date`. Before *v26.9.1*, a `DATE` property's value on a database left at its default configuration (`arcadedb.dateImplementation=java.time.LocalDate`) was announced as `varchar` for a populated result.
- `DATETIME` is announced as `timestamp`. The one case where a `DATETIME` column's announced type can still depend on whether a row was sampled is a database explicitly configured with `arcadedb.dateTimeImplementation=java.util.Date` (the default is `java.time.LocalDateTime`): `java.util.Date` is also `DATE`'s default representation, so a bare sampled value cannot always tell the two apart on its own. The server resolves this from the schema whenever the query names a single source type, which covers ordinary column selection; a column reached through a table alias, a computed expression, or a multi-table `JOIN` can still fall back to the value-only answer in that one configuration.

*Since v26.10.1*, a column is typed from all the rows of a result, not from the first one, and a list from all its elements: `[1, 2.5]` is announced as `float8[]`, `[1, 3000000000]` as `int8[]`, and a list that also holds a `DECIMAL` as `numeric[]`. A list or column that mixes values no common number type can hold is announced as text.

*Since v26.10.1*, a prepared statement keeps ONE layout for all its rows, because a client may describe it once and reuse that description. A property the type does not declare (ArcadeDB is schemaless) can hold an integer in one record and a long, a double or a string in the next, so such a property is announced as `varchar` (a list as `text[]`) when the statement is described (`Describe` on the statement, or on a portal of a named statement, which is what the PostgreSQL JDBC driver does from its `prepareThreshold`-th execution). Declared properties keep their exact native type. To get a native type back for a property in a prepared statement, declare it, for example `CREATE PROPERTY Event.score INTEGER`.

### 5.5.7. Transactions

In autocommit mode (the JDBC default) every statement is one transaction: a write statement that touches many records - `UPDATE`, `DELETE`, `INSERT`, `CREATE VERTEX`, `CREATE EDGE` - either lands whole or is rolled back whole, for vertex, edge and document types alike. The one exception is a statement that asks for chunked commits with `BATCH <n>`, which commits every `<n>` records: use it on a statement touching millions of records, since one transaction otherwise holds every modified page until the statement ends. To span several statements with one transaction, send an explicit `BEGIN` … `COMMIT` (or `ROLLBACK`).

A client that PIPELINES several statements before waiting for their answers - a JDBC `executeBatch()`, psycopg3 pipeline mode, asyncpg - groups them differently (since 26.10.1): everything between two `Sync` messages is one transaction, so a batch either lands whole or leaves nothing behind, and the statements after the one that failed are not run at all. This is what PostgreSQL does and what `BatchUpdateException` handling assumes. Before 26.10.1 each statement in such a batch committed on its own, so a failure halfway left the earlier ones persisted; if you relied on that, split the batch into separate round trips.

Since v26.10.1 a transaction-control statement is recognized in every spelling ArcadeDB SQL accepts, not only the bare keyword: with a leading or trailing comment (as added by sqlcommenter, OpenTelemetry or connection-pool routing hints, e.g. `COMMIT /traceparent='…'/`), with extra `;`, `BEGIN ISOLATION <level>` (which opens the transaction with that isolation level, e.g. `BEGIN ISOLATION`

REPEATABLE_READ) and COMMIT RETRY <n> (a plain COMMIT outside a SQL script, which has no block to retry). A COMMIT that fails, for example on a duplicated unique key, reports the error and ends the transaction, as in PostgreSQL: the session is back in idle state and no ROLLBACK is needed.

Savepoints are not supported. SAVEPOINT <name> and RELEASE [SAVEPOINT] <name> are accepted and do nothing, but ROLLBACK TO [SAVEPOINT] <name> is refused with SQLSTATE 0A000 (feature not supported) and the transaction is marked aborted, so the client must ROLLBACK it. *(Since v26.10.1; before,* ROLLBACK TO SAVEPOINT *reported success while every write made since the savepoint stayed pending and was persisted by the next* COMMIT*.)* An ORM or driver that wraps statements in savepoints (for example a nested transaction.atomic() in Django, or psql's ON_ERROR_ROLLBACK) only works as long as it never rolls back to one.

Setting auto commit to false is not 100% supported: it does not start a transaction on its own, so a write sent after setAutoCommit(false) without a BEGIN is refused with "Transaction not begun". With JDBC, leave the default settings or set:

```
conn.setAutoCommit(true);
```

### 5.5.8. Session settings (SET, SHOW, RESET)

SET changes a setting for the current connection only: it never changes the database or any other connection, and SHOW reads it back. Since v26.10.1 it follows PostgreSQL's rules:

- a SET made inside a transaction that is rolled back, or that fails, is undone;
- SET LOCAL lasts only until the end of the current transaction (outside a transaction it has no lasting effect);
- RESET <name>, RESET ALL and SET <name> TO DEFAULT restore the value the client sent when it connected, else the server default;
- SET TIME ZONE '<zone>' is accepted as a synonym of SET TimeZone TO '<zone>', and SHOW TIME ZONE / RESET TIME ZONE as synonyms of SHOW TimeZone / RESET TimeZone;
- SHOW TRANSACTION ISOLATION LEVEL is a synonym of SHOW transaction_isolation: it answers the level of the transaction that is open (for example repeatable read after BEGIN ISOLATION REPEATABLE_READ), under the column transaction_isolation, which is also what the JDBC driver's Connection.getTransactionIsolation() reads;
- SHOW answers under PostgreSQL's spelling of the parameter (DateStyle, TimeZone), and SHOW ALL lists the parameters the server answers for plus every one the connection has set;
- a SET answers only SET, like in PostgreSQL, instead of a one-row result;
- the parameters PostgreSQL reports to drivers (DateStyle, TimeZone, application_name, client_encoding, IntervalStyle, is_superuser, server_version, ...) are sent at connection time and again whenever they change, so a driver that caches them sees the new value.

Some settings describe what the server does and cannot be changed: dates always travel in ISO format (DateStyle keeps only the field order you choose), text is always UTF8, and standard_conforming_strings is always on. A SET of a read-only setting such as server_version is refused.

A SET is answered SET only when it did what it asked. Since v26.10.1 every other SET is answered with an error, on both the simple and the extended query protocol, rather than accepted and ignored:

- a SET the server cannot parse (for example SET x, with neither = nor TO) is a syntax error (42601), reported at Parse on the extended protocol, like in PostgreSQL;
- SET ROLE <role> and SET SESSION AUTHORIZATION <user> are refused (0A000): a connection always keeps the privileges of the user it authenticated as, and a client told otherwise would believe it had dropped privileges it still holds. SET ROLE NONE, SET SESSION AUTHORIZATION DEFAULT, RESET ROLE and RESET SESSION AUTHORIZATION are accepted, since that is already the case;
- SET TRANSACTION ISOLATION LEVEL … and SET SESSION CHARACTERISTICS AS TRANSACTION ISOLATION LEVEL … (what the JDBC driver's Connection.setTransactionIsolation() sends) are accepted for the level transactions really run at (the database's READ COMMITTED by default, which is also what READ UNCOMMITTED means in PostgreSQL) and refused (0A000) for any other, such as SERIALIZABLE. To run a transaction at REPEATABLE READ, open it with BEGIN ISOLATION LEVEL REPEATABLE READ;
- READ ONLY transactions are not supported, so SET TRANSACTION READ ONLY and SET default_transaction_read_only = on are refused (0A000); READ WRITE and [NOT] DEFERRABLE are accepted;
- SET CONSTRAINTS ALL DEFERRED | IMMEDIATE is accepted without effect, as in PostgreSQL for constraints that are not deferrable, which ArcadeDB's never are;
- SET NAMES '<encoding>' and SET SCHEMA '<schema>' are accepted as synonyms of SET client_encoding and SET search_path. Since v26.11.1 search_path is accepted but not stored: a connection always resolves names in the database it is connected to, so SHOW search_path answers that database, as current_schema() does;
- statement_timeout is enforced since v26.11.1: a statement that runs longer is cancelled with 57014. It takes a number of milliseconds or a value with a unit (30s, 2min), and 0 disables it. The shorter of it and arcadedb.command.timeout applies;
- DISCARD ALL (what connection poolers such as pgbouncer send between two client sessions) resets every setting and drops the prepared statements and portals. It is refused inside a transaction block (25001). DISCARD PLANS | SEQUENCES | TEMP are accepted without effect, and DEALLOCATE [ALL | <name>] and CLOSE [ALL | <name>] are supported;
- a parameter PostgreSQL does not know is refused by SET, SHOW and RESET alike with 42704 unrecognized configuration parameter, as in PostgreSQL (for example SET bogus_param = 1 or SHOW databases). Every parameter PostgreSQL 17 knows is accepted, as is any name the client sent when it connected. A name with a dot (SET myapp.tenant = 'acme') is a custom setting: it is always accepted, and SHOW reads it back once it is set;
- a parameter PostgreSQL lets only the server configuration change, such as shared_buffers or wal_level, is refused with 55P02.

### 5.5.9. Cancelling a statement

Since v26.11.1 a cancel request works as in PostgreSQL. The CancelRequest that JDBC's Statement.cancel(), pgjdbc's setQueryTimeout() and libpq's PQcancel send stops the statement the connection is running: it fails with SQLSTATE 57014 (query_canceled), what it wrote is rolled back as after any other failed statement, and the connection stays open for the next one. A connection that

is not running a statement is not affected.

Each connection gets its own backend process id and a random 32-bit secret key, which the client receives at connect time (`BackendKeyData`) and must quote in its cancel request. The statements a connection runs are listed by the HTTP `list queries` command and by Cypher `SHOW TRANSACTIONS` with `protocol postgres` and the process id as `connectionId`, and stopped by `terminate query` or `TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS` with the same `57014`.

As on PostgreSQL, a cancel request is not authenticated: the secret key is its only credential, and process ids are sequential. A cancel request that quotes a live connection with the wrong secret stops nothing and gets no answer; the server logs it, at `WARNING` at most once a minute with the number refused since, so guessing is visible in the log. A cancel is best effort, as on PostgreSQL: one that arrives between two statements stops nothing, and one that crosses the start of the next statement may stop that one.

Three SQL functions work on connections by process id, as their PostgreSQL namesakes:

| Function | Returns |
|---|---|
| `pg_backend_pid()` | The process id of the calling connection, `null` when the statement does not run on a PostgreSQL connection. |
| `pg_cancel_backend(pid)` | Stops the statement that connection is running and leaves the connection open. `true` when the connection was signalled. |
| `pg_terminate_backend(pid)` | Stops the statement that connection is running and closes the connection, rolling back its open transaction. `true` when the connection was signalled. |

**root** may signal every connection, any other user only their own. Both signal functions answer `false` for a process id that names no connection the caller may signal. They answer `NULL` for a `NULL` process id and fail on a fractional one (such as `1.5`), as on PostgreSQL. They signal only connections of the server that runs them, and are registered with the SQL functions of the JVM once the PostgreSQL plugin starts, so SQL sent over any protocol can call them.

```
SELECT pg_backend_pid();          -- this connection's process id, e.g. 1042
SELECT pg_cancel_backend(1042);   -- stop what connection 1042 is running
SELECT pg_terminate_backend(1042);-- stop it and close the connection
```

Before v26.11.1 a cancel request closed the whole connection, and since every connection had the backend process id `0`, a cancel could reach a different connection than the one it was meant for. A client that relied on a cancel request closing the connection must now call `pg_terminate_backend()` instead.

### 5.5.10. Postgres Tools Known to Work

Some tools compatible with Postgres may execute queries on internal Postgres tables to retrieve the schema. Most of these queries - the ones asking about schemas, tables, columns and a few other well-known catalogs - are now answered generically (see above), but a tool asking about a `pg_catalog` object with no

> ArcadeDB equivalent (indexes, foreign keys, triggers, and similar) still gets an empty result for that specific question rather than an error. See tested compatible tools below. If the tool that you use to work with Postgres is not compatible with ArcadeDB, please open an issue.

**PostgreSQL Client psql**

Postgres's `psql` tool works out of the box, just like with an actual Postgres server. To install this Postgres client, see here.

Connect from a terminal or console like this:

```
psql -h localhost -p 5432 -d mydatabase -U root
```

After authenticating, you can run SQL queries as normal, and `\copy` exports a query or a type to a local file (see COPY ... TO STDOUT above). One can also submit the password via the environment:

```
PGPASSWORD=password psql -h localhost -p 5432 -d mydatabase -U root
```

or use the `postgres` protocol address:

```
psql postgres://username:password@host:port/database
```

In case the password contains special characters (like `/`, `\`, `@`, `?`, `!`, `&`), it needs to be URL encoded (also known as "percent encoding").

Note, that in the `psql` console queries or commands need to be terminated with a semi-colon `;` to be submitted.

# 5.6. MCP Server

ArcadeDB includes a built-in Model Context Protocol (MCP) server that allows AI assistants and LLM-based tools to interact with the database. The MCP server exposes database operations as tools that AI clients can discover and invoke using the standard MCP protocol.

The MCP server implements the MCP specification (version 2025-03-26) over HTTP using the JSON-RPC 2.0 protocol.

## 5.6.1. Endpoint

All MCP requests are sent as `POST` requests to a single endpoint:

```
POST /api/v1/mcp
```

Requests must include a valid `Authorization` header (Basic Auth or Bearer token) and a JSON-RPC

2.0 body.

An alternative stdio transport carries the same protocol over standard input and output, for clients that launch their MCP servers as a child process rather than connecting to one over the network.

The MCP server ships as the optional `mcp` module and is installed automatically when its jar is on the classpath, so no `SERVER_PLUGINS` entry is needed. The standard distribution includes it. A distribution assembled without it, through the `arcadedb-builder.sh` module selection described in Custom Package Builder, registers neither endpoint and answers `404` on both.

### 5.6.2. Configuration

The MCP server is configured via the file `config/mcp-config.json` in the ArcadeDB server directory. You can also manage the configuration at runtime through the configuration endpoint.

*Example* `mcp-config.json`

```
{
  "enabled": true,
  "allowReads": true,
  "allowInsert": true,
  "allowUpdate": true,
  "allowDelete": false,
  "allowSchemaChange": false,
  "allowAdmin": false,
  "profile": "rag",
  "allowedUsers": ["root", "analyst"],
  "principalProfiles": {
    "analyst": "rag"
  },
  "databases": {
    "analytics": {
      "allowInsert": false,
      "allowedUsers": ["analyst"]
    }
  }
}
```

| Property | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `enabled` | `false` | Enable or disable the MCP server. When disabled, all MCP requests return an error. |
| `allowReads` | `true` | Allow read-only queries (SELECT, MATCH, etc.). |
| `allowInsert` | `false` | Allow INSERT operations. |
| `allowUpdate` | `false` | Allow UPDATE operations. |
| `allowDelete` | `false` | Allow DELETE operations. |
| `allowSchemaChange` | `false` | Allow schema modifications (CREATE TYPE, CREATE PROPERTY, CREATE INDEX, etc.). |

| Property | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `allowAdmin` | `false` | Allow administrative operations. |
| `profile` | `"all"` | Server-global tool profile: `"all"`, `"rag"`, or `"admin"`. See Tool Profiles. |
| `principalProfiles` | `{}` | Optional per-principal tool profiles, keyed by user name or API token name. Intersected with `profile`, so an entry can only narrow the tool surface. See Per-Principal Profiles. |
| `allowedUsers` | `["root"]` | List of usernames allowed to use the MCP server. Use `"*"` to allow all authenticated users. |
| `allowedOrigins` | `[]` | Extra browser `Origin` values accepted by the HTTP transport, on top of the loopback and same-host origins that are always allowed. See Transport. |
| `databases` | `{}` | Optional per-database permission and user restrictions. See Per-Database Scoping. |

### 5.6.3. Tool Profiles

Tool profiles keep the surface presented to an agent focused. The selected profile filters `tools/list` and is enforced again by `tools/call`, so a client cannot invoke a hidden tool directly. A profile never grants an operation: read, write, schema, administrative, user, origin, and native database authorization checks remain independent and mandatory.

| Profile | Tool membership |
|---|---|
| `all` | Every tool registered by the running ArcadeDB version. This is the default. |
| `rag` | `list_databases`, `get_schema`, `query`, `sample_records`, `vector_search`, `hybrid_search`, `full_text_search`, `upsert_entity`, and `upsert_relationship`. |
| `admin` | `list_databases`, `get_schema`, `query`, `execute_command`, `server_status`, `profiler_start`, `profiler_stop`, `profiler_status`, `get_server_settings`, and `set_server_setting`. |

Only registered tools are advertised. For example, a version that does not include `hybrid_search` does not expose it merely because the name belongs to the `rag` profile. The agent-memory upsert tools in `rag` remain unavailable unless their independent write permissions are enabled; all write permissions default to false.

The `profile` setting is server-global and applies to every principal that has no entry in `principalProfiles`. Per-database overrides restrict permissions and users only; they cannot select a different profile. See Per-Database Scoping.

Profiles filter prompts as well, because a prompt's text names tools: a prompt is offered only when every tool it names survives the profile. See Prompts. Resources are not filtered by profile.

#### Per-Principal Profiles

Entries under `principalProfiles` assign a tool profile to an individual authenticated principal. The effective profile is the **intersection** of the server-global `profile` and the principal entry: a tool is

advertised and callable only when both profiles contain it. An entry can therefore only narrow the surface, and never grants a tool that the global profile hides. As with the global profile, an intersection never grants a permission: read, write, schema, administrative, database, user, and origin checks remain independent and mandatory.

A principal is keyed by its user name. An API token can be keyed either canonically as `apitoken:<token-name>` or by the bare token name, the same two spellings that `allowedUsers` accepts. When both spellings are present, the canonical `apitoken:` entry wins.

*Example: a retrieval agent restricted to the `rag` tools on an otherwise unrestricted server*

```
{
  "enabled": true,
  "profile": "all",
  "allowedUsers": ["root", "retrieval-agent", "retrieval-token"],
  "principalProfiles": {
    "retrieval-agent": "rag",
    "apitoken:retrieval-token": "rag"
  }
}
```

Profile names are case-insensitive on input and are serialized in lowercase. A `tools/call` for a tool excluded by the intersection is rejected with an error naming both profiles, so a client cannot bypass the filtered `tools/list` by invoking the tool directly. The `initialize` instructions follow the effective profile: they describe the `rag` surface when the intersection matches the `rag` profile, and otherwise describe the general or the restricted surface.

The runtime configuration endpoint merges `principalProfiles` by principal name. Set one principal to `null` to remove that entry, or set the top-level `principalProfiles` value to `null` to clear all per-principal profiles:

```
{
  "principalProfiles": {
    "retrieval-agent": null,
    "reporting-agent": "rag"
  }
}
```

### 5.6.4. Per-Database Scoping

Entries under `databases` further restrict the server-global MCP policy for named databases. An omitted local field inherits its global value. A local `false` can deny an operation, but a local `true` cannot enable an operation denied globally. Similarly, a local `allowedUsers` list is an additional restriction: an authenticated principal must satisfy both the global and local lists. ArcadeDB's native database authorization remains an independent mandatory check.

Each database override accepts `allowReads`, `allowInsert`, `allowUpdate`, `allowDelete`, `allowSchemaChange`, `allowAdmin`, and `allowedUsers`. Unknown fields are rejected rather than silently inherited. An

override naming a database that does not currently exist produces a startup warning but is retained so it can apply if that database is created later.

*Example per-database restrictions*

```
{
  "enabled": true,
  "allowReads": true,
  "allowInsert": true,
  "allowedUsers": ["root", "tenant-agent"],
  "databases": {
    "tenant-graph": {
      "allowInsert": false,
      "allowedUsers": ["tenant-agent"]
    }
  }
}
```

The runtime configuration endpoint merges updates by database name. A non-null entry replaces the complete override for that database, so fields omitted from the replacement inherit the global policy. Set one database entry to `null` to remove that override, or set the top-level `databases` value to `null` to clear all database overrides:

```
{
  "databases": {
    "tenant-graph": null,
    "reporting": {
      "allowReads": true,
      "allowInsert": false
    }
  }
}
```

Database discovery, server status, and schema resources omit databases whose effective policy denies the authenticated principal or read access.

### 5.6.5. Configuration Endpoint

The MCP configuration can be managed at runtime via the `/api/v1/mcp/config` endpoint.

**Get current configuration:**

```
curl -u root:arcadedb-password \
  http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp/config
```

**Update configuration (root user only):**

```
curl -u root:arcadedb-password \
  -X POST \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"enabled": true, "allowReads": true, "allowInsert": true}' \
  http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp/config
```

### 5.6.6. MCP Protocol Methods

The MCP server supports the following JSON-RPC 2.0 methods:

| Method | Description |
|---|---|
| `initialize` | Handshake that returns the protocol version and server capabilities. |
| `notifications/initialized` | Client notification acknowledging initialization. |
| `tools/list` | Returns the list of available tools with their JSON schemas. |
| `tools/call` | Executes a specific tool by name with the provided arguments. |
| `resources/list` | Returns the readable resources. See Resources. |
| `resources/read` | Returns the contents of one resource, addressed by URI. See Resources. |
| `prompts/list` | Returns the available guided prompt templates. See Prompts. |
| `prompts/get` | Renders one prompt with its arguments substituted. See Prompts. |
| `ping` | Health check that returns a pong response. |

The `initialize` response advertises all three surfaces under `capabilities`, as `tools`, `resources`, and `prompts`. None of them emits change notifications and resources cannot be subscribed to, so `listChanged` and `subscribe` are all false.

The response also carries an `instructions` string describing the surface the client actually received. It follows the effective tool profile, so a `rag` client is told about the retrieval and upsert tools and the guided prompts, while a client whose profile hides most of the surface is told to use only what `tools/list` returned.

**Example: Initialize**

```
curl -u root:arcadedb-password \
  -X POST \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"jsonrpc":"2.0","id":1,"method":"initialize","params":{"protocolVersion":"2025-
03-26","clientInfo":{"name":"my-client","version":"1.0"}}}' \
  http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp
```

**Example: List available tools**

```
curl -u root:arcadedb-password \
```

```
  -X POST \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"jsonrpc":"2.0","id":2,"method":"tools/list"}' \
  http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp
```

### 5.6.7. Available Tools

The MCP server exposes a version-dependent set of tools that AI clients can invoke. The commonly used tools described below include `list_databases`, `get_schema`, `query`, `execute_command`, `server_status`, `sample_records`, `vector_search`, `full_text_search`, `hybrid_search`, `upsert_entity`, and `upsert_relationship`. The operator tools `profiler_start`, `profiler_stop`, `profiler_status`, `get_server_settings`, and `set_server_setting` are described below as well. Call `tools/list` for the authoritative list, including the full input schema of every tool.

#### `list_databases`

Lists all databases accessible to the authenticated user.

**Parameters:** None

**Example:**

```
curl -u root:arcadedb-password \
  -X POST \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d
'{"jsonrpc":"2.0","id":1,"method":"tools/call","params":{"name":"list_databases","argu
ments":{}}}' \
  http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp
```

**Response:**

```
{
  "databases": ["mydb", "analytics"]
}
```

#### `get_schema`

Retrieves the full schema of a database, including all types (vertex, edge, document), their properties, and indexes.

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Required | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `database` | Yes | The name of the database. |

**Example:**

```
curl -u root:arcadedb-password \
  -X POST \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d
'{"jsonrpc":"2.0","id":1,"method":"tools/call","params":{"name":"get_schema","argument
s":{"database":"mydb"}}}' \
  http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp
```

**Response:**

```
{
  "database": "mydb",
  "types": [
    {
      "name": "Person",
      "category": "vertex",
      "parentTypes": ["V"],
      "properties": [
        {
          "name": "name",
          "type": "STRING",
          "mandatory": true,
          "readonly": false,
          "notNull": true
        }
      ],
      "indexes": [
        {
          "name": "Person[name]",
          "type": "LSM_TREE",
          "properties": ["name"],
          "unique": true
        }
      ]
    }
  ]
}
```

#### `query`

Executes a read-only (idempotent) query against a database. The server performs semantic analysis to ensure the query does not modify data. If a write operation is detected, the request is rejected.

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Required | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `database` | Yes | The name of the database. |

| Parameter | Required | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `language` | Yes | Query language: `sql`, `cypher`, `gremlin`, `graphql`, `mongo`. |
| `query` | Yes | The query string to execute. |
| `limit` | No | Maximum number of records to return, from 1 through 100,000 (default: 1000). |

**Example:**

```
curl -u root:arcadedb-password \
  -X POST \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d
'{"jsonrpc":"2.0","id":1,"method":"tools/call","params":{"name":"query","arguments":{"
database":"mydb","language":"sql","query":"SELECT FROM Person LIMIT 10"}}}' \
  http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp
```

**Response:**

```
{
  "records": [
    {"@rid": "#1:0", "@type": "Person", "name": "Alice"},
    {"@rid": "#1:1", "@type": "Person", "name": "Bob"}
  ],
  "count": 2
}
```

`execute_command`

Executes a non-idempotent command (write operations, schema changes, administrative commands). The server checks the command against the MCP configuration permissions before execution.

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Required | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `database` | Yes | The name of the database. |
| `language` | Yes | Command language: `sql`, `sqlscript`, `cypher`, `gremlin`, `graphql`, `mongo`. |
| `command` | Yes | The command string to execute. |
| `limit` | No | Maximum number of records to return, from 1 through 100,000 (default: 1000). |

**Permission mapping:**

The server analyzes the command semantics and checks against the MCP configuration:

| Operation Type | Required Permission |
|---|---|
| INSERT | `allowInsert` |
| UPDATE | `allowUpdate` |
| DELETE | `allowDelete` |
| CREATE TYPE, CREATE PROPERTY, CREATE INDEX, etc. | `allowSchemaChange` |
| Administrative operations | `allowAdmin` |
| SELECT, MATCH | `allowReads` |

**Example:**

```
curl -u root:arcadedb-password \
  -X POST \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d
'{"jsonrpc":"2.0","id":1,"method":"tools/call","params":{"name":"execute_command","arg
uments":{"database":"mydb","language":"sql","command":"INSERT INTO Person SET name =
'\''Charlie'\''"}}}' \
  http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp
```

**Response:**

```
{
  "records": [
    {"@rid": "#1:2", "@type": "Person", "name": "Charlie"}
  ],
  "count": 1
}
```

`server_status`

Returns server metadata including version, available query languages, and accessible databases.

**Parameters:** None

**Example:**

```
curl -u root:arcadedb-password \
  -X POST \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d
'{"jsonrpc":"2.0","id":1,"method":"tools/call","params":{"name":"server_status","argum
ents":{}}}' \
```

```
  http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp
```

**Response:**

```
{
  "version": "26.10.1",
  "serverName": "ArcadeDB_0",
  "languages": ["sql", "sqlscript", "cypher", "gremlin", "graphql", "mongo"],
  "databases": ["mydb", "analytics"],
  "ha": {
    "clusterName": "arcadedb",
    "leader": "server1",
    "replicas": ["server2", "server3"]
  }
}
```

The `ha` field is only included when High Availability is enabled and the user has admin permissions.

#### `sample_records`

Returns the first records in storage order from selected database types so an agent can inspect actual property-value shapes before constructing a query. This is not a random or representative sample.

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Required | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `database` | Yes | The name of the database. |
| `types` | No | Up to 20 type names. Explicit names may include edge types. When omitted, ArcadeDB selects the first 20 vertex and document type names in alphabetical order and excludes edge types. |
| `limit` | No | Maximum records per type, from 1 through 20 (default: 3). |

**Example:**

```
curl -u root:arcadedb-password \
  -X POST \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d
'{"jsonrpc":"2.0","id":1,"method":"tools/call","params":{"name":"sample_records","argu
ments":{"database":"mydb","types":["Person","Company"],"limit":3}}}' \
  http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp
```

**Response:**

```
{
  "samples": {
    "Person": [
      {"@rid": "#1:0", "@type": "Person", "name": "Alice"}
    ],
    "Company": [
      {"@rid": "#2:0", "@type": "Company", "name": "Acme"}
    ]
  },
  "sampledTypes": 2,
  "availableTypes": 2,
  "recordsReturned": 2,
  "truncated": false
}
```

`availableTypes` always reports the number of eligible vertex and document types in the database, even when `types` is supplied. When `types` is omitted, `truncated` indicates that more than 20 eligible types exist. The generated queries are checked as read-only, and serialized records do not include vertex edge collections.

#### `vector_search`

Searches a dense `LSM_VECTOR` or sparse `LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR` index with a pre-computed query vector. ArcadeDB does not generate embeddings; the caller must supply the vector produced by its embedding model.

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Required | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `database` | Yes | The name of the database. |
| `indexName` | Yes | The name of an `LSM_VECTOR` or `LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR` index. |
| `queryVector` | Yes | Dense vector values, or sparse weights corresponding to `queryIndices`. |
| `queryIndices` | Sparse only | Sparse dimension identifiers corresponding to the weights in `queryVector`. Omit to use each `queryVector` position as its dimension. |
| `k` | Yes | Maximum results, from 1 through 1,000. |
| `efSearch` | No | Dense-index search beam width. Higher values can improve recall at additional cost. This option is rejected for sparse indexes. |
| `filter` | No | Read-only SQL `WHERE` predicate applied to a bounded candidate set. |
| `sparse` | No | Use `vector.sparseNeighbors` against an `LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR` index (default: false). |

The optional `filter` is evaluated against each expanded neighbor row. Record properties are flattened into that row, and `@rid`, `@type`, `record`, plus `distance` for dense results or `score` for sparse results are also available.

**Dense-vector example:**

```
curl -u root:arcadedb-password \
  -X POST \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d
'{"jsonrpc":"2.0","id":1,"method":"tools/call","params":{"name":"vector_search","argum
ents":{"database":"research","indexName":"Paper[embedding]","queryVector":[0.12,-
0.08,0.31],"k":20,"efSearch":100,"filter":"publishedYear >= 2024"}}}' \
  http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp
```

**Response:**

```
{
  "indexName": "Paper[embedding]",
  "sparse": false,
  "scoring": "distance_lower_is_better:COSINE",
  "candidateLimit": 160,
  "truncated": true,
  "count": 20,
  "results": [
    {
      "rid": "#12:34",
      "type": "Paper",
      "distance": 0.083,
      "properties": {
        "title": "Example paper",
        "publishedYear": 2025
      }
    }
  ]
}
```

Dense results expose only `distance`, where lower is better. Sparse results expose only `score`, where higher is better. The response-level `scoring` value also records the active dense similarity function or sparse scoring modifier.

Without a filter, `candidateLimit` equals `k`. With a filter, ArcadeDB examines up to `min(k * 8, 8000)` vector candidates before applying the predicate. `truncated` is true when the returned result window is full (`count` equals `k`), so more matches may exist. When it is false, fewer than `k` matches survived the current candidate window. For a filtered search, that does not prove that no matching vectors exist beyond `candidateLimit`; increasing `k` also expands the candidate window until the 8,000-candidate ceiling is reached.

### `full_text_search`

Searches a full-text index and returns the matching records ranked by relevance score. Requires read permission.

Address the index either by `indexName`, or by `typeName` with optional `properties`. When both forms are supplied, `indexName` wins.

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Required | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `database` | Yes | The name of the database. |
| `queryText` | Yes | The full-text query. A blank query is rejected. |
| `indexName` | Either | The name of the full-text index, for example `Article[content]` or `Article[title,content]`. |
| `typeName` | Either | The type carrying the index, for example `Article`. An index declared on a supertype is named for the supertype. |
| `properties` | No | Indexed properties, used with `typeName`, given in the order the index declares them. |
| `limit` | No | Maximum results (default: 10). |

**Query syntax:**

| Form | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `+a +b` | Both terms required. |
| `a -b` | Excludes `b`. |
| `a b` | Matches either term. |
| `"exact phrase"` | All terms must appear in the same record. Term order is **not** enforced. |
| `pre*` | Prefix match. |
| `term~` | Fuzzy match. |
| `field:term` | Restricts to one property of a multi-property index. |
| `term^2` | Boosts a term. |

**Example:**

```
curl -u root:arcadedb-password \
  -X POST \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d
'{"jsonrpc":"2.0","id":1,"method":"tools/call","params":{"name":"full_text_search","ar
guments":{"database":"research","indexName":"Paper[abstract]","queryText":"+graph
+retrieval -sql","limit":5}}}' \
  http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp
```

**Response:**

```
{
  "indexName": "Paper[abstract]",
  "similarity": "BM25",
  "count": 2,
  "results": [
    {
      "rid": "#12:34",
      "score": 4.71,
      "properties": {
        "title": "Graph retrieval over citation networks"
      }
    }
  ]
}
```

The `similarity` field reports whether scores are `BM25` or legacy `CLASSIC` coordination counts. The limit is pushed down per bucket, so the search merges at most `bucket count * limit` entries rather than every match in the index. Because of that push-down, a record deleted concurrently between the index scan and the record read is skipped without being back-filled, so a search can legitimately return fewer than `limit` results.

#### `hybrid_search`

Retrieves records by fusing up to three retrieval legs into a single ranked list: a vector search, an optional full-text search, and an optional graph expansion. Requires read permission. As with `vector_search`, ArcadeDB does not generate embeddings.

The graph expansion is seeded from the records the other legs found and walks outward from them, so a neighbor of a strong match can itself rank. Expanded records carry the number of hops from their seed and the path back to it.

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Required | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `database` | Yes | The name of the database. |
| `vectorIndexName` | Yes | The name of an `LSM_VECTOR` or `LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR` index. |
| `queryVector` | Yes | Dense vector values, or sparse weights corresponding to `queryIndices`. |
| `k` | Yes | Maximum results after fusion, from 1 through 1,000. |
| `queryIndices` | Sparse only | Sparse dimension identifiers corresponding to the weights in `queryVector`. |
| `sparse` | No | Use `vector.sparseNeighbors` against an `LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR` index (default: false). |
| `efSearch` | No | Dense-index search beam width. Rejected for sparse indexes. |

| Parameter | Required | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `filter` | No | Read-only SQL `WHERE` predicate applied to the vector leg's bounded candidate set. |
| `fulltextIndexName` | With `fulltextQuery` | The full-text index for the second leg. |
| `fulltextQuery` | With `fulltextIndexName` | The full-text query for the second leg. |
| `expand` | No | Graph expansion leg. See below. |
| `fusionStrategy` | No | `RRF`, `DBSF`, or `LINEAR` (default: `RRF`). |
| `weights` | No | Per-leg fusion weights, keyed by leg name. |

Supplying only one of `fulltextIndexName` and `fulltextQuery` is rejected: half a leg is always a mistake, and ignoring it silently would return a plausible result set that quietly dropped what the caller asked for.

**The `expand` object:**

| Field | Required | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `edgeTypes` | No | Edge types to traverse. Omit to traverse every edge type. |
| `direction` | No | `out`, `in`, or `both` (default: `out`). |
| `maxDepth` | No | Hops to walk, from 1 through 3 (default: 1). |

An unknown edge type is rejected, listing the available ones. Traversing a name that matches nothing would otherwise return an empty neighborhood without an error, silently degrading the search to plain two-way fusion. `maxDepth` above 3 is rejected rather than clamped, and the cap is enforced server-side regardless of the value sent. Graph expansion requires a vertex type; requesting it against a document type is rejected.

**Fusion strategies:**

`RRF` (Reciprocal Rank Fusion) is rank-only and ignores per-row scores. `DBSF` and `LINEAR` normalize per-source scores and therefore require a numeric score on every row of every source.

The graph expansion leg ranks by traversal order and carries no score, so **`DBSF` and `LINEAR` cannot be combined with `expand`** and that combination is rejected. Both remain available for vector plus full-text fusion.

**Weights:**

`weights` accepts `vector`, `fulltext`, and `expand`. The first two default to `1.0` and `expand` defaults to `0.5`, because under `RRF` a rank-one expanded record would otherwise score exactly what the nearest neighbor scores, letting an arbitrary one-hop neighbor tie the best semantic match.

A weight naming a leg the request does not ask for is rejected, as is an unknown key, a negative value, and a non-numeric value. A weight of `0.0` is accepted: it keeps a leg's records in the candidate

set and in each result's `sources` while contributing nothing to the ranking.

**Example:**

```
curl -u root:arcadedb-password \
  -X POST \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d
'{"jsonrpc":"2.0","id":1,"method":"tools/call","params":{"name":"hybrid_search","argum
ents":{"database":"research","vectorIndexName":"Paper[embedding]","queryVector":[0.12,
-0.08,0.31],"fulltextIndexName":"Paper[abstract]","fulltextQuery":"graph
retrieval","expand":{"edgeTypes":["CITES"],"direction":"out","maxDepth":2},"fusionStra
tegy":"RRF","k":10}}}' \
  http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp
```

**Response:**


```
{
  "vectorIndexName": "Paper[embedding]",
  "sparse": false,
  "scoring": "distance_lower_is_better:COSINE",
  "fused": true,
  "fusionStrategy": "RRF",
  "fulltextIndexName": "Paper[abstract]",
  "legs": {
    "vector": { "count": 40 },
    "fulltext": { "indexName": "Paper[abstract]", "similarity": "BM25", "count": 27 },
    "expand": {
      "direction": "out",
      "edgeTypes": ["CITES"],
      "maxDepth": 2,
      "truncated": false,
      "seedCount": 61,
      "seedsTruncated": false,
      "count": 133
    }
  },
  "truncated": true,
  "count": 10,
  "results": [
    {
      "rid": "#12:34",
      "fusedScore": 0.0325,
      "sources": ["vector", "fulltext"],
      "properties": { "title": "Graph retrieval over citation networks" }
    },
    {
      "rid": "#12:99",
      "fusedScore": 0.0161,
```

```
      "sources": ["expand"],
      "depth": 1,
      "path": ["#12:34", "#12:99"],
      "properties": { "title": "Citation graphs as retrieval context" }
    }
  ]
}
```

`sources` names the legs that contributed to each result, so a fused score can be interpreted rather than taken on faith: it distinguishes a top semantic match from a record that arrived two hops from something relevant. `depth` and `path` appear only on results the expansion leg contributed, and `path` starts at the seed and ends at the result itself.

`fused` reports whether fusion actually ran. Fusion requires at least two sources, so a request naming neither `fulltextQuery` nor `expand` cannot be fused: that response sets `fused` to false and its results carry the vector leg's native `distance` or `score` instead of `fusedScore`. The full-text index name and similarity are reported under `legs` whenever that leg ran, including when it matched nothing.

The response carries several independent budgets. Top-level `truncated` means the result window filled (`count` equals `k`), so raising `k` may surface more. `legs.expand.truncated` means the traversal hit its fan-out cap, so the neighborhood was only partly explored; narrowing `edgeTypes` or `maxDepth` gives a more complete picture of the part that matters. `legs.expand.seedsTruncated` means the retrieval legs produced more candidate seeds than the traversal budget accepts, so expansion started from a subset.

For pure two-way fusion without graph expansion, `vector.fuse` remains available through the `query` tool.

#### `upsert_entity`

Creates or updates a single vertex addressed by a match key, without duplicating it. Requires **both** insert and update permission, because a merge resolves to a create or an update depending on what already exists.

The vertex is matched, or created, by the `matchKeys` property/value pairs, and then any `setProperties` are written. Repeated calls with identical `matchKeys` resolve to the same vertex. Values are bound as parameters, so they are safe to pass verbatim; identifiers are quoted.

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Required | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `database` | Yes | The name of the database. |
| `typeName` | Yes | The vertex type. Created automatically if it does not exist. |
| `matchKeys` | Yes | property/value pairs used as the match key. Must be non-empty; values should be scalars. |
| `setProperties` | No | property/value pairs to write on the matched or created vertex. |

Create a `UNIQUE` index on the `matchKeys` properties. Without one the match is a full

type scan on every call, and two concurrent upserts carrying the same keys can each create a vertex, which is exactly the duplication the tool exists to prevent.

**Example:**

```
curl -u root:arcadedb-password \
  -X POST \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d
'{"jsonrpc":"2.0","id":1,"method":"tools/call","params":{"name":"upsert_entity","argum
ents":{"database":"memory","typeName":"Person","matchKeys":{"email":"ada@example.com"}
,"setProperties":{"name":"Ada Lovelace","role":"analyst"}}}}' \
  http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp
```

#### `upsert_relationship`

Creates or updates a single directed edge between two vertices, without duplicating it. Requires **both** insert and update permission.

Each endpoint is matched, or created, by its own match keys; then the edge of type `relType` between them is matched or created, and any `relProperties` are written. Repeated calls between the same resolved endpoints with the same `relType` resolve to the same edge.

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Required | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `database` | Yes | The name of the database. |
| `fromType` | Yes | The source vertex type. Created automatically if it does not exist. |
| `fromMatchKeys` | Yes | property/value pairs identifying the source vertex. Must be non-empty. |
| `toType` | Yes | The destination vertex type. Created automatically if it does not exist. |
| `toMatchKeys` | Yes | property/value pairs identifying the destination vertex. Must be non-empty. |
| `relType` | Yes | The edge type. Created automatically if it does not exist. |
| `relProperties` | No | property/value pairs to write on the matched or created edge. |

As with `upsert_entity`, create a `UNIQUE` index on each endpoint's match-key properties. Without one each endpoint match is a full type scan, and concurrent calls can create duplicate endpoints.

**Example:**

```
curl -u root:arcadedb-password \
```

```
  -X POST \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d
'{"jsonrpc":"2.0","id":1,"method":"tools/call","params":{"name":"upsert_relationship",
"arguments":{"database":"memory","fromType":"Person","fromMatchKeys":{"email":"ada@exa
mple.com"},"toType":"Project","toMatchKeys":{"code":"ANALYTICAL-
ENGINE"},"relType":"WORKS_ON","relProperties":{"since":1843}}}}' \
  http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp
```

The edge properties are written in a trailing assignment, so the edge is keyed by its endpoints and type alone and is never duplicated by a change to its properties.

#### `profiler_start`

Starts the query profiler, which records every query with its execution time and plan. Requires admin permission.

The profiler auto-stops after `timeoutSeconds`, so a session left running does not profile indefinitely. Use `profiler_stop` to end it early and collect the results, or `profiler_status` to check progress while it runs.

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Required | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `timeoutSeconds` | No | Recording duration, from 1 through 3,600 seconds (default: 60). The profiler stops itself when it elapses. |

**Example:**

```
curl -u root:arcadedb-password \
  -X POST \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d
'{"jsonrpc":"2.0","id":1,"method":"tools/call","params":{"name":"profiler_start","argu
ments":{"timeoutSeconds":120}}}' \
  http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp
```

**Response:**

```
{
  "status": "started",
  "timeoutSeconds": 120,
  "message": "Query profiler started. It will auto-stop after 120 seconds. Use
profiler_stop to stop early and retrieve results."
}
```

Only one profiling session runs at a time. Starting the profiler while it is already recording does **not**

restart it, extend it, or raise an error: the call returns `status: "already_recording"` and leaves the session untouched, so an agent retrying a start cannot silently discard the data collected so far.

#### `profiler_stop`

Stops the query profiler and returns the data captured during the session. Requires admin permission. Takes no parameters.

Results are aggregated per query and include execution counts, timing (minimum, maximum, average, and p99), and execution-plan step costs. They are also written to disk, so a session can be retrieved after the fact.

**Example:**

```
curl -u root:arcadedb-password \
  -X POST \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d
'{"jsonrpc":"2.0","id":1,"method":"tools/call","params":{"name":"profiler_stop","argum
ents":{}}}' \
  http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp
```

If the profiler was not recording, the call returns `status: "not_recording"` rather than an error, so stopping an already-stopped profiler is safe to retry.

#### `profiler_status`

Reports whether the profiler is recording and returns the current or most recent results. Requires admin permission. Takes no parameters.

Where `profiler_stop` ends the session, this reads it without disturbing it, so it is the safe call for an agent that wants to check progress mid-session. Alongside the captured queries and their timing statistics, the response carries server metric snapshots taken during the session.

**Example:**

```
curl -u root:arcadedb-password \
  -X POST \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d
'{"jsonrpc":"2.0","id":1,"method":"tools/call","params":{"name":"profiler_status","arg
uments":{}}}' \
  http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp
```

#### `get_server_settings`

Returns the server-level configuration settings with their current values, defaults, and descriptions. Takes no parameters.

This tool requires **read** permission, not admin permission, even though it belongs to the `admin` tool profile. Profile membership and permission gating are independent: see Tool Profiles.

Only settings whose scope is the server are returned; database-scoped settings are excluded.

**Example:**

```
curl -u root:arcadedb-password \
  -X POST \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d
'{"jsonrpc":"2.0","id":1,"method":"tools/call","params":{"name":"get_server_settings",
"arguments":{}}}' \
  http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp
```

**Response:**

```
{
  "settings": [
    {
      "key": "arcadedb.asyncWorkerThreads",
      "value": 7,
      "description": "Number of asynchronous worker threads. 0 (default) = available
cores minus 1",
      "overridden": true,
      "default": 0
    },
    {
      "key": "arcadedb.ha.clusterToken",
      "value": "*****",
      "description": "Token to authenticate a server joining the cluster",
      "overridden": true,
      "default": "*****"
    }
  ]
}
```

`value` is what this server is actually running on, and `default` the built-in default. `overridden` is true when the setting has been given an explicit value rather than inheriting its default - in the server configuration file, by an embedding application, or at runtime with `set_server_setting`.

Secret settings are masked as `*` in both `value` and `default`. The rule covers the HA cluster token and every key containing `password`, and it is applied by the server rather than by the client, so a secret is never serialized into the response in the first place.

`arcadedb.server.defaultDatabases` is masked differently, because its value merely

> **embeds** credentials rather than being one: the database names, user names and groups are kept, and only each password is replaced, so `mydb[jay:hunter2:admins]` is reported as `mydb[jay:*:admins]` *(since v26.10.1)*.

### `set_server_setting`

Updates a server configuration setting at runtime. Requires admin permission.

Changes take effect immediately. Whether they survive a restart depends on the individual setting, so treat this as a runtime adjustment rather than a way to persist configuration. Call `get_server_settings` first to see the available keys and their current values.

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Required | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `key` | Yes | The configuration key, for example `arcadedb.asyncWorkerThreads`. |
| `value` | Yes | The new value, as a string. |

An unknown key is rejected by name rather than silently accepted, so a typo cannot masquerade as a successful update.

**Example:**

```
curl -u root:arcadedb-password \
  -X POST \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d
'{"jsonrpc":"2.0","id":1,"method":"tools/call","params":{"name":"set_server_setting","
arguments":{"key":"arcadedb.asyncWorkerThreads","value":"8"}}}' \
  http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp
```

**Response:**

```
{
  "key": "arcadedb.asyncWorkerThreads",
  "previousValue": "7",
  "newValue": "8",
  "message": "Setting 'arcadedb.asyncWorkerThreads' updated successfully."
}
```

The response reports the replaced value so a change can be reverted without a separate read.

> For a secret setting, `previousValue` is masked as `*`, using the same rule `get_server_settings` applies. Otherwise the setter would disclose through the value it replaced exactly what the getter withholds. The mask depends on the setting rather than on whether it currently holds a value, so an unset secret cannot be

> distinguished from a set one.

### 5.6.8. Resources

Besides tools, the MCP server exposes a read-only Resources surface. Every database publishes its schema at:

```
arcadedb://{database}/schema
```

The resource is served with the MIME type `application/json` and its `text` payload is the same document that the `get_schema` tool returns. A client that reads the resource at session start therefore obtains the schema without spending a tool call.

**Example: list resources**

```
curl -u root:arcadedb-password \
  -X POST \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"jsonrpc":"2.0","id":1,"method":"resources/list"}' \
  http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp
```

**Response:**

```
{
  "resources": [
    {
      "uri": "arcadedb://mydb/schema",
      "name": "mydb schema",
      "description": "Schema of the ArcadeDB database 'mydb': types (vertex, edge,
document), properties, indexes, inheritance.",
      "mimeType": "application/json"
    }
  ]
}
```

**Example: read a resource**

```
curl -u root:arcadedb-password \
  -X POST \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d
'{"jsonrpc":"2.0","id":2,"method":"resources/read","params":{"uri":"arcadedb://mydb/sc
hema"}}' \
  http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp
```

**Response:**

```
{
  "contents": [
    {
      "uri": "arcadedb://mydb/schema",
      "mimeType": "application/json",
      "text": "{\"database\":\"mydb\",\"types\":[...]}"
    }
  ]
}
```

Resources are gated by the same policy as reads. `allowReads` must be enabled globally, the effective per-database policy must allow the authenticated principal to read that database, and ArcadeDB's native database authorization applies as usual. Tool profiles do not filter resources: a `rag` or `admin` profile changes the tool list only.

`resources/list` is a discovery call that most clients issue unprompted at session start, so a denial is reported as an empty `resources` array rather than as an error, and databases the principal cannot read are omitted. `resources/read` rejects an unknown database, an unauthorized database, and a malformed URI identically with JSON-RPC error `-32002` (`Resource not found`), so the surface cannot be used to probe which databases exist. When `allowReads` is disabled, `resources/read` returns error `-32600`.

### 5.6.9. Prompts

The MCP server also exposes a Prompts surface: guided templates that steer a model through a task using the retrieval and agent-memory tools, instead of leaving it to hand-write vector or `MERGE` syntax. A client typically offers them to the user as named commands.

| Prompt | Purpose |
|---|---|
| `graphrag_query` | Answer a question over a database with its retrieval tools, citing the records the answer came from. |
| `build_knowledge_graph` | Extract entities and relationships from text and write them into a database without creating duplicates. |

Both prompts take two required arguments.

| Prompt | Argument | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `graphrag_query` | `database` | The name of the database to search. |
| | `question` | The question to answer from the contents of the database. |
| `build_knowledge_graph` | `database` | The name of the database to write into. |
| | `sourceText` | The text to extract entities and relationships from. |

The rendered messages are static text with the arguments substituted verbatim, so `prompts/get` opens no database and reads no data.

`graphrag_query` directs the model to load the schema first, choose between `vector_search`, `full_text_search`, `hybrid_search`, and `query` according to the shape of the question, supply its own embedding vector because ArcadeDB does not generate one, and cite every claim with the `@rid` it came from.

`build_knowledge_graph` centers on match-key selection, which is what keeps repeated extraction from duplicating vertices. It directs the model to read the existing schema and reuse its types, choose the smallest stable match key per entity, prefer one backed by a `UNIQUE` index and report a missing one rather than creating it, then call `upsert_entity` once per entity and `upsert_relationship` once per relationship, reusing exactly the same match keys for the endpoints.

#### Availability

A prompt is a script that names tools by name, so it is offered only when the caller can actually run it. Each prompt is listed, and rendered, only when both conditions hold:

- every tool its text names is allowed by the caller's effective tool profile, and
- the permissions those tools require are granted server-globally.

| Prompt | Tools named | Permissions required |
|---|---|---|
| `graphrag_query` | `get_schema`, `query`, `vector_search`, `full_text_search`, `hybrid_search` | `allowReads` |
| `build_knowledge_graph` | `get_schema`, `upsert_entity`, `upsert_relationship` | `allowReads`, `allowInsert`, `allowUpdate` |

Neither prompt is therefore available under the `admin` profile, which contains none of the retrieval or upsert tools. Under `rag` and `all`, `graphrag_query` is available whenever reads are permitted, and `build_knowledge_graph` additionally requires the two write permissions, which are false by default.

These checks are evaluated against the server-global permission flags, because no database is resolved while a prompt is rendered. Per-database overrides still apply to every tool call the model subsequently makes.

Like `resources/list`, `prompts/list` is a discovery call most clients issue unprompted at session start, so a caller entitled to no prompts receives an empty `prompts` array rather than an error. Availability is then re-checked by `prompts/get`, for the same reason `tools/call` re-checks the profile after `tools/list` has already filtered: an unavailable prompt is refused with error `-32600` even when it is requested by name. An unknown prompt name, or a missing argument, returns `-32602`.

#### Example: list prompts

```
curl -u root:arcadedb-password \
  -X POST \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"jsonrpc":"2.0","id":1,"method":"prompts/list"}' \
  http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp
```

**Response:**

```
{
  "prompts": [
    {
      "name": "graphrag_query",
      "description": "Answer a question over an ArcadeDB database using its retrieval
tools, citing the records the answer came from.",
      "arguments": [
        {"name": "database", "description": "The name of the database to search",
"required": true},
        {"name": "question", "description": "The question to answer from the contents
of the database", "required": true}
      ]
    }
  ]
}
```

**Example: render a prompt**

```
curl -u root:arcadedb-password \
  -X POST \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d
'{"jsonrpc":"2.0","id":2,"method":"prompts/get","params":{"name":"graphrag_query","arg
uments":{"database":"research","question":"Which papers cite the original RRF
paper?"}}}' \
  http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp
```

**Response:**

```
{
  "description": "Answer a question over an ArcadeDB database using its retrieval
tools, citing the records the answer came from.",
  "messages": [
    {
      "role": "user",
      "content": {
        "type": "text",
        "text": "Answer the following question using the ArcadeDB database
'research'.\n\n<question>\n..."
      }
    }
  ]
}
```

Each argument is substituted inside a delimiter block that marks it as data rather than procedure. Because the value is substituted verbatim, a value that itself carries the closing tag would end that block early and have the remaining text read as instructions. The server therefore suffixes both

delimiters with an unpredictable token whenever the value contains such a tag, which moves the boundary instead of altering the value. An ordinary argument carries no such tag and renders against the constant delimiters shown above.

### 5.6.10. Transport

The same protocol surface is served over two transports: HTTP, and standard input and output. Tools, resources, prompts, and every permission and profile rule behave identically on both; only the envelope differs.

#### HTTP

The HTTP endpoint follows the Streamable HTTP transport rules of MCP 2025-03-26.

**HTTP methods.** JSON-RPC is carried over `POST` only. The server does not offer a Server-Sent Events stream, so any other method (including `GET`) is answered with `405 Method Not Allowed` and an `Allow: POST` header.

**Requests and notifications.** A request must carry an `id` that is a string or an integer; `null`, fractional and structured ids are rejected with JSON-RPC error `-32600`. A notification is a message with a `method` and no `id`: the server never answers one, and a `POST` that carried only notifications returns `202 Accepted` with an empty body.

**Batches.** A top-level JSON array is accepted on both the HTTP and the stdio transport. Every element is dispatched independently and only the elements that are requests contribute a response, so a batch of notifications alone yields `202 Accepted` with no body and a mixed batch yields an array holding just the request responses.

```
curl -u root:arcadedb-password \
  -X POST \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d
'[{"jsonrpc":"2.0","id":1,"method":"ping"},{"jsonrpc":"2.0","id":2,"method":"tools/lis
t"}]' \
  http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp
```

**Origin validation.** To mitigate DNS rebinding, a request carrying an `Origin` header is accepted only when the origin is a loopback address, matches the host the request was addressed to, or is listed in `allowedOrigins`. Anything else is rejected with `403`. A request with no `Origin` is accepted, because non-browser MCP clients do not send one and the header is attached by the browser precisely in the case the check is meant to catch. Setting `allowedOrigins` to `["*"]` accepts any origin and disables this protection: use it only when the endpoint is fronted by a proxy that performs its own origin control.

#### Stdio

Clients that launch their MCP servers as a child process, rather than connecting to one over the network, speak JSON-RPC 2.0 over standard input and output with one message per line. The distribution ships that transport as `bin/mcp-stdio.sh`, which starts an ArcadeDB server and serves

MCP on its stdin and stdout.

```
export ARCADEDB_SETTINGS="-Darcadedb.server.rootPassword=arcadedb-password"
bin/mcp-stdio.sh
```

The root password is mandatory: the process authenticates as `root` and exits with an error if `arcadedb.server.rootPassword` is unset. Because the client owns stdout, the server redirects its own logging to stderr so that log lines cannot corrupt the JSON-RPC stream.

**Exit status.** The process exits non-zero on any fatal startup failure - a wrong root password, an HTTP port already in use, an unreadable database directory - and exits `0` only when it ended the way it is meant to, with the client closing its stdin. This matters when a supervisor launches it (a systemd unit, a container runtime, or the MCP client itself), since a zero status reads as "finished normally" and suppresses the restart and the alert *(since v26.10.1)*.

Stdio mode enables the MCP server for the lifetime of the process regardless of the `enabled` flag, since the client started it precisely to speak MCP. Everything else in `config/mcp-config.json` still applies unchanged: permissions, tool profile, per-database overrides, and the `allowedUsers` list, which must admit `root`. Origin validation does not apply, because there is no HTTP request to carry an `Origin` header.

A line holding a top-level JSON array is dispatched as a batch, exactly as over HTTP. A message that produces no response, such as a notification or a batch of them, is answered with no output line at all.

*Example client configuration*

```
{
  "mcpServers": {
    "arcadedb": {
      "command": "/opt/arcadedb/bin/mcp-stdio.sh",
      "env": {
        "ARCADEDB_SETTINGS": "-Darcadedb.server.rootPassword=arcadedb-password"
      }
    }
  }
}
```

### 5.6.11. Security

The MCP server enforces multiple layers of security:

- **Authentication** — All requests require valid ArcadeDB credentials (Basic Auth or Bearer token).
- **User authorization** — Users can only access databases they are authorized for in the ArcadeDB security configuration.
- **MCP permissions** — The MCP configuration controls which operations are allowed (reads, inserts, updates, deletes, schema changes, admin).

- **User allow-list** — The `allowedUsers` setting restricts which users can access the MCP server.
- **Per-database restrictions** — Optional database entries can further restrict operations and users without granting authority above the global policy.
- **Tool profiles** — Hidden tools are removed from discovery and rejected if invoked directly; profiles do not grant permissions.
- **Per-principal profiles** — An individual principal can be narrowed further; the effective profile is the intersection with the global one. See Per-Principal Profiles.
- **Prompt gating** — A prompt is offered, and rendered, only when the tools its text names are visible to the caller and the permissions those tools need are granted. See Prompts.
- **Origin validation** — Cross-origin browser requests are rejected to mitigate DNS rebinding. See [mcp-origin].
- **Semantic analysis** — Queries and commands are analyzed to detect their operation type and enforce the appropriate permission.
- **Error text in production mode** — In `production` server mode a tool error raised by the engine (for example a duplicated key refused by `execute_command`, whose message carries the stored key values) answers "The request failed. Check the server log for the details", and the detail is written to the server log. The validation of the tool arguments stays visible. Since v26.11.1; see Error details in production mode.

### 5.6.12. Using with AI Clients

The ArcadeDB MCP server is compatible with any MCP-compliant client. To connect an AI assistant to ArcadeDB, configure the client with the MCP endpoint URL and authentication credentials, or launch `bin/mcp-stdio.sh` as a child process for clients that prefer the stdio transport.

**Example configuration for an MCP client:**

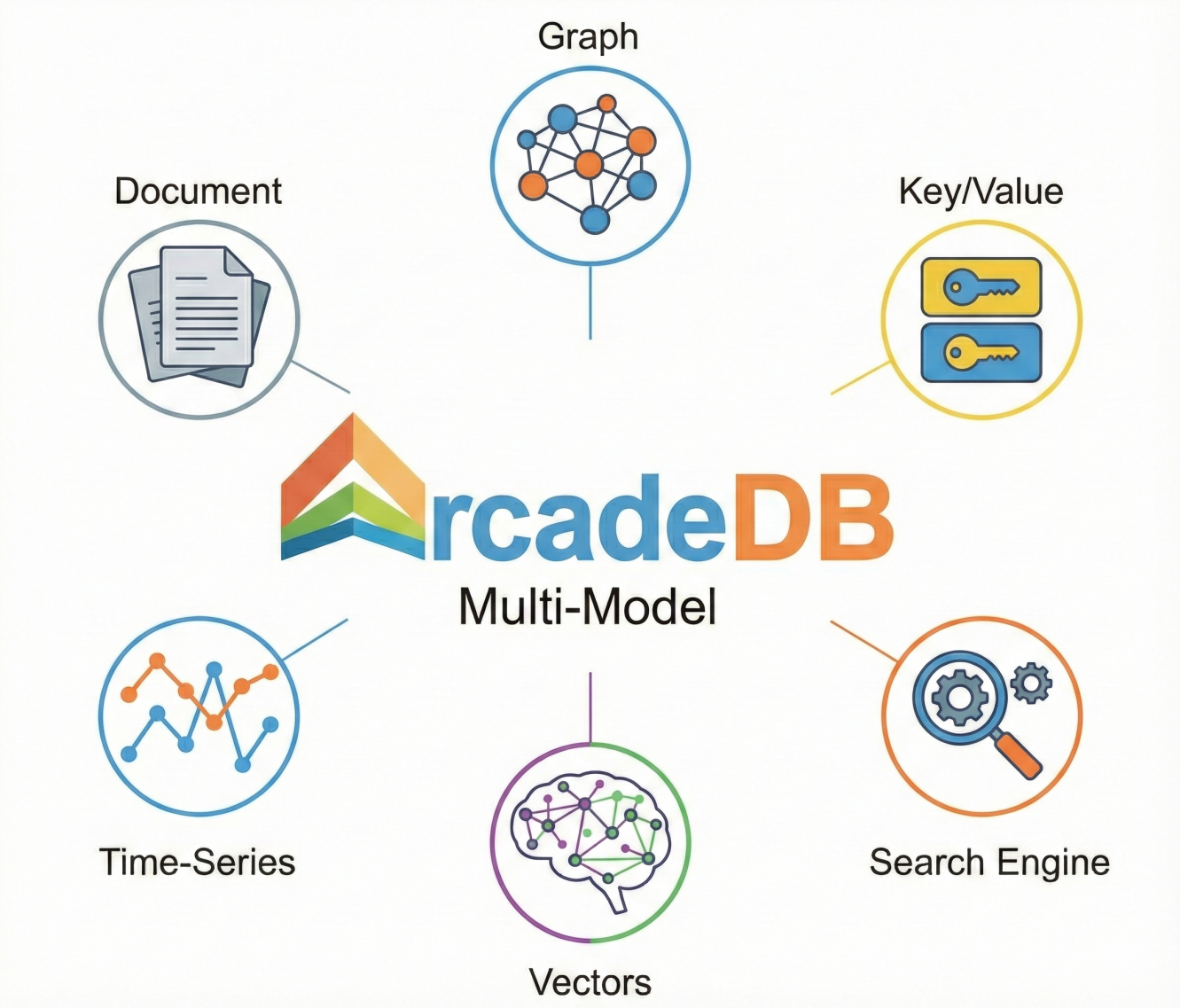
```
{
  "mcpServers": {
    "arcadedb": {
      "url": "http://localhost:2480/api/v1/mcp",
      "headers": {
        "Authorization": "Basic cm9vdDphcmNhZGVkYi1wYXNzd29yZA=="
      }
    }
  }
}
```

Once connected, the AI client automatically discovers the available tools via `tools/list` and can use them to explore databases, query data, and execute commands within the configured permissions. A client that supports the other two surfaces should also read `arcadedb://{database}/schema` from Resources at session start, which supplies the schema without spending a tool call, and offer the Prompts its profile exposes.

# Chapter 6. Data Modeling

## 6.1. Multi-Model Architecture

ArcadeDB is a multi-model database that natively supports documents, graphs, key-value, time series, full-text search, and vector embeddings within a single engine. All models share the same storage layer, the same transaction manager, and the same query infrastructure. This design eliminates the need for polyglot persistence — the practice of running separate specialized databases for different data models — and the operational complexity that comes with it.




ArcadeDB is a true **Multi-Model** DBMS, combining all the features of the supported models into one core. This is not just a thin layer of interfaces over a single underlying engine, as is common in other "multi-model" databases. The ArcadeDB engine itself was built from the ground up to support every model, which is why it can deliver speed and scalability that bolt-on approaches cannot.

### 6.1.1. Why Multi-Model Matters

Traditional architectures often pair a relational database with a graph database, a document store, a time series backend, and a vector index. Each system brings its own deployment, its own backup

strategy, its own security model, and its own failure modes. Keeping data consistent across these systems requires ETL pipelines, message queues, or change-data-capture infrastructure that adds latency and introduces synchronization bugs.

ArcadeDB collapses this stack into one process. A single ACID transaction can create a document, connect it as a vertex in a graph, and index its embedding for vector similarity — atomically. There is no replication lag between models because there is no replication; the data exists once.

### 6.1.2. The Latency Problem with Multiple Databases

With polyglot persistence, a single user request often triggers a **chain of sequential calls** across different databases. Each call adds network latency, serialization overhead, and wait time. The total response time is the *sum* of all calls.

The numbers below match the animation:

| **Polyglot Persistence (Sequential Calls)** | **Database** | **Latency** |
|---|---|---|
| Your App → MySQL | Relational | ~15ms |
| Wait… → MongoDB | Document | ~20ms |
| Wait… → Neo4j | Graph | ~12ms |
| **Total: ~47ms+** (sum of all calls + serialization overhead) | | |

| **ArcadeDB (Single Call)** | **Engine** | **Latency** |
|---|---|---|
| Your App → ArcadeDB (graph + doc + search in one query) | Multi-Model | ~5ms |
| **Total: ~5ms** (one call, zero chaining, no serialization) | | |

With a multi-model database, your application makes a **single call** that can query graphs, documents, and full-text search at the same time. No chaining, no waiting, no redundant serialization. The result? Dramatically lower latency and simpler application code.

ArcadeDB natively supports **six data models**: Graph, Document, Key-Value, Full-Text Search, Vector, and Time-Series — all within a single, embeddable database engine.

### 6.1.3. Supported Data Models

#### Document Model

The data in this model is stored inside documents. A document is a set of key/value pairs (also referred to as fields or properties), where the key allows access to its value. Values can hold primitive data types, embedded documents, or arrays of other values. Documents are not typically forced to have a schema, which can be advantageous because they remain flexible and easy to modify. Documents are stored in collections, enabling developers to group data as they decide. ArcadeDB uses the concepts of "Types" and "Buckets" as its form of "collections" for grouping documents.

ArcadeDB's document model also adds the concept of a "Relationship" between documents. You can

decide whether to embed documents or link to them directly. When you fetch a document, all the links are automatically resolved by ArcadeDB. This is a major difference compared to other document databases, like MongoDB or CouchDB, where the developer must handle every relationship between documents themselves.

Types can operate in schema-full mode (all properties declared), schema-less mode (no schema constraints), or schema-hybrid mode where some properties are enforced while others remain free-form. Document types support inheritance, allowing a subtype to extend a parent type and inherit its properties.

| Relational Model | Document Model | ArcadeDB Document Model |
|---|---|---|
| Table | Collection | Type or Bucket |
| Row | Document | Document |
| Column | Key/value pair | Document property |
| Relationship | not available | Relationship |

#### Graph Model

A graph represents a network-like structure consisting of Vertices (also known as Nodes) interconnected by Edges (also known as Arcs). ArcadeDB's graph model is represented by the concept of a property graph, which defines the following:

- **Vertex** - an entity that can be linked with other vertices and has the following mandatory properties:
  - unique identifier
  - set of incoming edges
  - set of outgoing edges
  - label that defines the type of vertex
- **Edge** - an entity that links two vertices and has the following mandatory properties:
  - unique identifier
  - link to an incoming vertex (also known as head)
  - link to an outgoing vertex (also known as tail)
  - label that defines the type of connection/relationship between head and tail vertex

In addition to mandatory properties, each vertex or edge can also hold a set of custom properties, which makes vertices and edges look similar to documents. Edges are first-class citizens stored in their own types — not join tables or adjacency lists bolted onto a relational schema. ArcadeDB supports two kinds of edges: **lightweight edges** for simple relationships that carry no properties, and **regular edges** for relationships that need their own attributes such as weight, timestamp, or label. See Lightweight Edges for when to choose each, their measured cost, and the `LIGHTWEIGHT` and `UNIQUE` type declarations. Graph traversal operates at O(1) complexity per hop through index-free adjacency.

| Relational Model | Graph Model | ArcadeDB Graph Model |
|---|---|---|
| Table | Vertex and Edge Types | Type |
| Row | Vertex | Vertex |
| Column | Vertex and Edge property | Vertex and Edge property |
| Relationship | Edge | Edge |

#### Key/Value Model

This is the simplest model: everything in the database can be reached by a key, where the values can be simple or complex types. ArcadeDB supports documents and graph elements as values, providing a richer model than typical key/value stores.

For the full description, comparison table, and HTTP usage patterns, see the dedicated Key/Value page.

#### Search-Engine Model

The search engine model is based on a full-text variant of the LSM-Tree index. To index each word, the necessary tokenization is performed by the Apache Lucene library. A full-text index is created just like any other index in ArcadeDB and participates in the same transaction as the rest of the database. Results are ranked with BM25 by default, and can be fused with vector search in a single query, see BM25 at a glance.

#### Time-Series Model

ArcadeDB includes a native time-series engine designed for high-throughput ingestion and fast analytical queries over timestamped data. The Time-Series model is integrated directly into the multi-model core — the same database that stores graphs, documents, and key/value pairs can store and query billions of time-stamped samples with specialized columnar compression, SIMD-vectorized aggregation, and automatic lifecycle management.

Key capabilities:

- **Columnar storage** with Gorilla, Delta-of-Delta, Simple-8b, and Dictionary compression — as low as 0.4 bytes per sample
- **Shard-per-core parallelism** with lock-free writes
- **InfluxDB Line Protocol** ingestion for compatibility with Telegraf, Grafana Agent, and hundreds of collection agents
- **Prometheus remote_write / remote_read** protocol for drop-in Prometheus backend usage
- **PromQL query language** with native parser and HTTP-compatible API endpoints
- **SQL analytical functions** — `ts.timeBucket`, `ts.rate`, `ts.percentile`, `ts.interpolate`, and more
- **Continuous aggregates**, **retention policies**, and **downsampling tiers** for automatic data lifecycle
- **Grafana integration** via DataFrame-compatible endpoints

- **Studio TimeSeries Explorer** with query, schema inspection, ingestion docs, and PromQL tabs

For the full reference, including DDL syntax, ingestion methods, SQL functions, PromQL support, and Grafana integration, see Time Series.

#### Vector Model

ArcadeDB provides a high-performance vector indexing solution using the LSMVectorIndex, which is built on the JVector library. It implements both the hierarchical navigable small world (HNSW) algorithm and the Vamana (DiskANN) algorithm for efficient approximate nearest neighbor (ANN) search on multi-dimensional vector data. Vector indexes participate in ACID transactions, persist on disk with automatic compaction, and integrate directly into SQL queries through `vector.neighbors()`.

For SQL and Java examples, supported similarity functions, configuration parameters, quantization, and tuning advice, see the dedicated Vector page.

### 6.1.4. Unified Query Layer

All data models are accessible through multiple query languages that operate on the same underlying records:

- **SQL** — The primary query language, extended with graph traversal, time series aggregation, and vector similarity functions
- **Cypher** — Pattern-matching queries for graph traversal
- **Gremlin** — Imperative graph traversal language (Apache TinkerPop)
- **GraphQL** — Schema-driven queries over HTTP
- **MongoDB Query Language** — Document-oriented queries for migration compatibility
- **Redis Protocol** — Key-value operations over the Redis wire protocol

Because all languages read from and write to the same storage, a record created through SQL is immediately visible to a Gremlin traversal, and an edge created through Cypher can be queried with GraphQL.

### 6.1.5. Type Inheritance Across Models

ArcadeDB types follow an object-oriented inheritance model. A type can extend another type, inheriting all of its properties, indexes, and constraints. This applies uniformly to document types, vertex types, and edge types.

For example, a `Person` vertex type can serve as the parent for both `Employee` and `Customer` types. A query against `Person` automatically includes records from all subtypes, while a query against `Employee` returns only employees. This polymorphic behavior works identically regardless of which query language is used.

### 6.1.6. Schema Flexibility

ArcadeDB supports three schema modes that can be mixed within the same database:

- **Schema-full** — Every property is declared with a type and optional constraints. Attempts to store undeclared properties are rejected.
- **Schema-less** — No schema is defined. Records accept arbitrary properties with no validation.
- **Schema-hybrid** — Some properties are declared and enforced, while additional properties can be added freely.

This flexibility allows different types in the same database to use different schema strategies. A `Transaction` type might enforce strict schema-full validation, while a `Metadata` type might operate schema-less to accommodate evolving requirements.

### 6.1.7. Cross-Model Queries

The most powerful consequence of the multi-model architecture is the ability to combine models in a single query. A SQL statement can traverse graph edges, filter on document properties, aggregate time series data, and rank results by vector similarity — all in one pass, within one transaction.

```
SELECT FROM (
  MATCH {type: User, as: u}-Follows->{type: User, as: f}
  RETURN f
) WHERE vector.cosineSimilarity(f.embedding, ?) > 0.8
```

This query traverses the `Follows` graph to find users connected to a starting set, then filters the results to only those whose embedding vectors are semantically similar to a target. No ETL, no cross-database joins, no eventual consistency — the graph traversal and the vector comparison execute against the same records in the same transaction.

## 6.2. Graph Database

ArcadeDB is a native graph database; and in this section we explain what this means and how this relates to applications.

### 6.2.1. Graph Components

Essentially a graph is tuple, or pair of sets, of vertices (aka nodes) and edges (aka arcs), whereas the set of vertices contains an (indexed) set of objects, and the set of edges contains (at least) pairs specifying a respective edge's endpoints.

A particular type of graph is the directed graph, which is characterized by oriented edges, meaning each edge's pair is ordered. A simple example of a directed graph is given by:

with:

- Vertices: V = {v_1, v_2}

- Edges: E = {e_(1,2)}

### 6.2.2. Graph Database Types

There are two prevalent data models for graph databases (both usually directed):

1. **Triple store (RDF graph)**: data is represented as subject–predicate–object triples; all facts are uniform triples and semantics are standardized (RDF, RDFS/OWL, SPARQL).
2. **Property Graph**: vertices and edges carry labels (types) and arbitrary key/value properties directly attached to them.

ArcadeDB is a property graph database: vertices and edges have labels and can store arbitrary key/value properties, supporting compact storage, fast traversals, and flexible schema evolution within its multi-model, document-oriented engine.

Practically, a vertex or edge consists of an identifier (RID), a label (type), and properties (document), plus ordered endpoint references. The latter are here vertex properties of incoming and outgoing edges, instead of edge properties of ordered vertex pairs, for technical reasons.

### 6.2.3. Why (Property) Graph Databases?

- The modeled domain is already a network.
- Fast traversal of relations instead of costly joins in relational databases.
- Naturally annotated edges instead of inconvenient reification in RDF graphs.

### 6.2.4. See Also

- Super-Nodes (Hot Vertices): how ArcadeDB handles vertices with very high or fast-growing edge counts
  - Recommendation Engine — Use case combining graph traversals with collaborative filtering
  - Fraud Detection — Use case leveraging graph patterns to detect fraudulent activity
  - Gremlin API — Tinkerpop Gremlin query language for graph traversals
  - Cypher — OpenCypher query language for pattern matching on graphs

## 6.3. Time Series

ArcadeDB includes a native Time Series engine designed for high-throughput ingestion and fast analytical queries over timestamped data. Unlike bolt-on solutions, the Time Series model is integrated directly into the multi-model core — the same database that stores graphs, documents, and key/value pairs can store and query billions of time-stamped samples with specialized columnar compression, SIMD-vectorized aggregation, and automatic lifecycle management.

Key capabilities:

- **Columnar storage** with Gorilla (float), Delta-of-Delta (timestamp), Simple-8b (integer), and Dictionary (tag) compression — 0.4 to 1.4 bytes per sample

- **Shard-per-core parallelism** with lock-free writes
- **Block-level aggregation statistics** for zero-decompression fast-path queries
- **InfluxDB Line Protocol** ingestion for compatibility with Telegraf, Grafana Agent, and hundreds of collection agents
- **Prometheus remote_write / remote_read** protocol for drop-in Prometheus backend usage
- **PromQL query language** — native parser and evaluator with HTTP-compatible API endpoints
- **SQL analytical functions** — `ts.timeBucket`, `ts.rate`, `ts.percentile`, `ts.interpolate`, window functions, and more
- **Continuous aggregates** with watermark-based incremental refresh
- **Retention policies** and **downsampling tiers** for automatic data lifecycle
- **Grafana integration** via DataFrame-compatible endpoints (works with the Infinity datasource plugin)
- **Studio TimeSeries Explorer** with query, schema inspection, ingestion docs, and PromQL tabs

### 6.3.1. Creating a TimeSeries Type

Use `CREATE TIMESERIES TYPE` to define a new time series type. Every type requires a `TIMESTAMP` column, zero or more `TAGS` (low-cardinality indexed dimensions), and one or more `FIELDS` (high-cardinality measurement values).

```
CREATE TIMESERIES TYPE SensorReading
  TIMESTAMP ts PRECISION MILLISECOND
  TAGS (sensor_id STRING, location STRING)
  FIELDS (
    temperature DOUBLE,
    humidity DOUBLE,
    pressure DOUBLE
  )
  SHARDS 8
  RETENTION 90 DAYS
  COMPACTION_INTERVAL 1 HOURS
```

Minimal syntax (defaults for everything optional):

```
CREATE TIMESERIES TYPE SensorReading
  TIMESTAMP ts
  TAGS (sensor_id STRING)
  FIELDS (temperature DOUBLE)
```

| Option | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `TIMESTAMP <name>` | *(required)* | Name of the timestamp column |

| Option | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `PRECISION` | `MILLISECOND` | Timestamp unit. Only `MILLISECOND` is accepted: timestamps are stored, ingested, retained and queried in milliseconds (see the note below) |
| `TAGS (…)` | *(none)* | Comma-separated `name TYPE` pairs for low-cardinality dimensions |
| `FIELDS (…)` | *(required)* | Comma-separated `name TYPE` pairs for measurement values |
| `SHARDS` | `arcadedb.asyncWorkerThreads` (available cores minus 1) | Number of shards for parallel writes |
| `RETENTION` | *(none)* | Automatic deletion of data older than the specified duration (e.g., `90 DAYS`, `1 HOURS`) |
| `COMPACTION_INTERVAL` | *(none)* | Cuts sealed blocks at boundaries of this interval. A block that lies inside one query bucket is answered from its statistics without decompressing it, so set it to the bucket width of your most frequent aggregation (see Choosing the layout). Without it blocks are cut by size only and a block spanning several buckets is decompressed |
| `IF NOT EXISTS` | *(none)* | Skip creation if the type already exists, instead of failing. The statement returns one row either way, carrying a `created` flag: see the note on `IF NOT EXISTS` results |

Since v26.11.1 `PRECISION` accepts only `MILLISECOND`, and `SECOND`, `MICROSECOND` and `NANOSECOND` are refused. Earlier versions accepted all four and honoured none of them: every ingestion endpoint (line protocol, Prometheus remote write, gRPC) converts its timestamps to milliseconds, and retention, downsampling and PromQL all count in milliseconds. On a `PRECISION SECOND` type fed with seconds, the first retention pass deleted every sample; on a `NANOSECOND` or `MICROSECOND` type fed with values in that unit, nothing ever expired and PromQL answered nothing.

A type declared with another precision by an earlier version keeps loading and keeps its data, but its retention and downsampling are **suspended**, because its stored timestamps may be in either unit. A warning names each such type when the maintenance scheduler first meets it, and `SELECT FROM schema:types` reports `maintenanceSuspended: true` for it. If the type's timestamps are milliseconds (always the case for data written through the ingestion endpoints), confirm it to resume them:

```
ALTER TIMESERIES TYPE SensorReading PRECISION MILLISECOND
```

The statement changes only the declaration: no stored timestamp is rewritten, so `MILLISECOND` is the only unit it accepts. A type whose timestamps really are in another unit must have them converted to milliseconds first, by copying the

> samples into a new type, before retention is resumed. A JSONL export of such a type restores with its declaration and its suspension unchanged, into an embedded database.

A type stores its columns in the order they are declared, and that order matters: a sample is a positional row, so the column order is what an export records and what a restore reads back.

The `TIMESTAMP`, `TAGS` and `FIELDS` clauses may therefore be written in any order, and `TAGS` and `FIELDS` may each appear more than once. The declaration below creates a type whose columns are `f1`, `ts`, `t1`, `f2`, in that order:

```
CREATE TIMESERIES TYPE Interleaved
  FIELDS (f1 DOUBLE)
  TIMESTAMP ts
  TAGS (t1 STRING)
  FIELDS (f2 DOUBLE)
```

The Java schema builder accepts the same orders and keeps them, so a recipe rendered as SQL - which is what the **remote** schema builder does - creates the same type as the same recipe run against an embedded database. A JSONL export therefore restores into a remote database exactly as it does into an embedded one, whatever order its columns are in.

> Before 26.10.1 the statement had exactly one slot for each clause, in the order timestamp, tags, fields. A builder recipe that interleaved them was regrouped when rendered as SQL, so the remote builder could create a type whose columns were in a different order than the embedded one - and a JSONL restore of such a type into a remote database was refused rather than silently loading the values into the wrong columns. Every statement written against the old grammar parses and means exactly what it did.

### 6.3.2. Altering a TimeSeries Type

Add downsampling policies to automatically reduce resolution of old data:

```
ALTER TIMESERIES TYPE SensorReading
  ADD DOWNSAMPLING POLICY
    AFTER 7 DAYS GRANULARITY 1 MINUTES
    AFTER 30 DAYS GRANULARITY 1 HOURS
```

Remove all downsampling policies:

```
ALTER TIMESERIES TYPE SensorReading DROP DOWNSAMPLING POLICY
```

Confirm that the timestamps of a type declared with another precision by an earlier version are milliseconds, which resumes its retention and downsampling (see the precision note above):

```
ALTER TIMESERIES TYPE SensorReading PRECISION MILLISECOND
```

A TIMESERIES type stores only its declared `TIMESTAMP`, `TAGS`, and `FIELDS` columns. It cannot be given a `SUPERTYPE`, and it cannot be used as a `SUPERTYPE` for another type: any inherited property would be silently dropped by every write, so both directions are rejected. For the same reason, `CREATE PROPERTY` on a TIMESERIES type is also rejected unless the name matches an already-declared column.

### 6.3.3. Compacting a TimeSeries Type

New samples land in each shard's mutable bucket, and the maintenance scheduler seals them into compressed blocks every 60 seconds. To seal them now, for example right after a bulk load or before measuring a query on the settled layout, run:

```
COMPACT TIMESERIES TYPE SensorReading
```

It runs the same compaction the scheduler runs, requires the `updateSchema` permission like `COMPACT INDEX`, and under HA runs on the leader. The result carries `mutableSamplesBefore` and `mutableSamples`, the samples still in the mutable buckets when it finished: rows appended while it ran stay there until the next pass.

The scheduler (and `COMPACT TIMESERIES TYPE`) also merges the small blocks a slow feed leaves behind into full-size ones, so the number of blocks follows the data volume and not the time. A read that is scanning the old blocks at the very moment they are merged is refused with a retryable error (HTTP `503`) instead of returning a partial answer: run it again. A merge rewrites the sealed file, so it needs free disk space of about the size of that file.

Since v26.11.1. Compaction, merge, retention and downsampling all rewrite a shard's sealed file, so on one shard they run one at a time. A `COMPACT TIMESERIES TYPE` issued while a retention or downsampling pass is running waits for it (and the other way round), instead of the two overwriting each other's work. Before, a retention pass that overlapped a compaction could be silently undone the next time the database was opened. Likewise, a rewrite that failed half-way no longer leaves a file behind that the next retention pass could resurrect deleted blocks from.

Reads do not need a compaction to be fast. A query for one tag, such as the newest reading of one host, skips every mutable page that holds no row of that tag without reading its rows, whether or not the tail has been sealed yet.

### 6.3.4. Dropping a TimeSeries Type

```
DROP TIMESERIES TYPE SensorReading
DROP TIMESERIES TYPE SensorReading IF EXISTS
```

### 6.3.5. Ingesting Data

There are four ways to ingest data into a TimeSeries type, listed from fastest to most convenient.

#### InfluxDB Line Protocol (Recommended for High Throughput)

The fastest remote ingestion path. ArcadeDB exposes an InfluxDB Line Protocol-compatible HTTP endpoint that skips SQL parsing entirely.

```
POST /api/v1/ts/{database}/write?precision=ns
Content-Type: text/plain

SensorReading,sensor_id=sensor-A,location=building-1
temperature=22.5,humidity=65.0,pressure=1013.25 1708430400000000000
SensorReading,sensor_id=sensor-B,location=building-2 temperature=19.1,humidity=70.0
1708430400000000000
```

Line Protocol format: `<measurement>[,<tag>=<value>⋯] <field>=<value>[,⋯] [<timestamp>]`

A malformed line is not ingested; the rest of the payload is. When any line was malformed the endpoint answers `400` with a partial-write body: `written` and `dropped` counts (a malformed line counts as one dropped sample) and `malformedLines`, the 1-based numbers of the rejected lines in the payload (the first 100). A field with no value (`temp`, `temp=` or a line cut short after a field key, such as `weather temp=21.5,hum`) makes the whole line malformed. So does a `,` separator with nothing after it, in the tags or in the fields (`weather temp=21.5,` or `weather,city=rome, temp=1`).

Since v26.10.1. Before, a malformed line was only logged and the request answered `204`, and a field missing its value at the end of a line was stored as `0.0` instead of rejecting the line. A line cut right after a `,` separator was still stored without the entries after the comma until v26.11.1.

A value its column cannot store drops only the sample that carries it, which the `400` partial-write body names in `unreadableValues` as `<measurement>.<column> (tag|field): <reason>` (the reason names the column and its type, never the value; `dropped` is the count of samples, the list holds one entry per distinct reason and the first 100). The gRPC `TimeSeriesWriteSummary` carries the same list as `unreadable_values`. *(Since v26.11.1)* the line protocol and gRPC read a value as `INSERT` does, instead of failing the whole request with a server error:

- a `DATE` or `DATETIME` column takes a number as a count in the column's own unit, digits in quotes as the same count (so `"20230101"` is the count 20230101, not the date, as for a tag filter), and any other quoted date or datetime as the instant it names (`seen="2023-11-14 22:15:23"`). A number is therefore not read as `INSERT` reads it (epoch milliseconds whatever the precision): see the note under *SQL INSERT* about the epoch counts these surfaces exchange;
- a numeric column takes a number its type can hold and numeric text; a number out of range (`300` in a `BYTE` column, a finite `1e300` in a `FLOAT`) is refused rather than truncated, while `NaN` and the infinities stay values of a floating point column;
- a `BOOLEAN` column takes a boolean and the text `true` or `false` in any case; anything else is refused,

where before any text was stored as `false`;

- a `STRING` column takes a string of at most 256 UTF-8 bytes.

Precision parameter: `ns` (nanoseconds, default), `us` (microseconds), `ms` (milliseconds), `s` (seconds).

Example with `curl`:

```
curl -X POST "http://localhost:2480/api/v1/ts/mydb/write?precision=ns" \
  -u root:password \
  -H "Content-Type: text/plain" \
  --data-binary 'SensorReading,sensor_id=sensor-A temperature=22.5 1708430400000000000
SensorReading,sensor_id=sensor-A temperature=22.6 1708430401000000000'
```

Example with Python:

```
import requests

lines = [
    "SensorReading,sensor_id=sensor-A temperature=22.5 1708430400000000000",
    "SensorReading,sensor_id=sensor-A temperature=22.6 1708430401000000000",
]

requests.post(
    "http://localhost:2480/api/v1/ts/mydb/write?precision=ns",
    auth=("root", "password"),
    headers={"Content-Type": "text/plain"},
    data="\n".join(lines),
)
```

If the type does not exist and auto-creation is enabled (`arcadedb.tsAutoCreateType=true`), the schema is inferred from the first line: measurement name becomes the type, tags become TAG columns, fields become FIELD columns with inferred types.

#### Prometheus Remote Write

ArcadeDB acts as a drop-in Prometheus remote storage backend. Configure Prometheus to write to ArcadeDB:

```
# prometheus.yml
remote_write:
  - url: "http://localhost:2480/ts/mydb/prom/write"
    basic_auth:
      username: root
      password: password
```

The endpoint accepts the standard Prometheus `remote_write` Protobuf payload (snappy-compressed). Each time series is mapped to an ArcadeDB TimeSeries type named after the `name`

label. Types are auto-created if they do not exist.

*(Since v26.11.1)* A label with an empty value is the same as an absent label, as in Prometheus: it is stored as absent and `{label=""}` selects it. A series carrying a label that the existing type does not declare as a tag is dropped and the request answers `400` naming the label (the other series of the request are stored); Prometheus does not retry a `400`. Set `arcadedb.timeSeriesUndeclaredKeys=ignore` to discard the extra label instead.

*(Since v26.10.1)* if your collector or proxy sends an `X-Request-Id` header, the request body is taken into account when deciding whether a request is a repeat of a previous one.

Before, on `prom/write` and `prom/read` only, two requests carrying **different** samples under the same `X-Request-Id` were mistaken for a retry: the second was answered with the first one's `204` and its samples were never stored. This affected collectors that stamp one id per connection, per scrape loop or per retry batch rather than per distinct payload. Prometheus' own remote-write client does not send the header and was never affected.

Genuine retries still work as before: re-sending the identical body under the same id is applied only once.

#### SQL INSERT

Standard ArcadeDB SQL syntax works for TimeSeries types:

```
-- Single row
INSERT INTO SensorReading
  SET ts = date('2026-02-20 10:00:00', 'yyyy-MM-dd HH:mm:ss'),
      sensor_id = 'sensor-A',
      location = 'building-1',
      temperature = 22.5,
      humidity = 65.0

-- Batch insert
INSERT INTO SensorReading
  (ts, sensor_id, location, temperature, humidity)
  VALUES
    (date('2026-02-20 10:00:00', 'yyyy-MM-dd HH:mm:ss'), 'sensor-A', 'building-1', 22
.5, 65.0),
    (date('2026-02-20 10:00:01', 'yyyy-MM-dd HH:mm:ss'), 'sensor-A', 'building-1', 22
.6, 64.8),
    (date('2026-02-20 10:00:02', 'yyyy-MM-dd HH:mm:ss'), 'sensor-B', 'building-2', 19
.1, 70.0)

-- CONTENT syntax
INSERT INTO SensorReading
  CONTENT { "ts": 1771581600000, "sensor_id": "sensor-A", "temperature": 22.5 }
```

*(Since v26.11.1)* `INSERT` fails if it sets a property that is not a declared tag or field of the type (for example a misspelled tag), because the sample would otherwise be filed under a different series. Set `arcadedb.timeSeriesUndeclaredKeys=ignore` on the database to discard such properties instead. The same setting governs line protocol, gRPC and Prometheus writes.

*(Since v26.11.1)* A `DATE`, `DATETIME`, `DATETIME_SECOND`, `DATETIME_MICROS` or `DATETIME_NANOS` tag or field behaves in SQL exactly like a document property of the same type. `INSERT` reads a value as such a property does: text and date/time objects as the instant they name, and a number as epoch milliseconds (epoch days for a `DATE`), whatever the column's precision. `SELECT` returns the value as the date/time object the property would return (a `java.time.LocalDateTime` for the `DATETIME` family by default), so a value read from a row can be written back as it is, and a `WHERE` condition on the column matches the same literal `INSERT` accepted, on a tag (pushed down to the storage engine) and on a field alike. An instant the column's precision cannot represent - for example a nanosecond count written to a `DATETIME_NANOS` column, which `INSERT` reads as milliseconds 53 million years from now - is refused with an error. Before, `SELECT` returned the raw epoch count in the column's own unit, which neither `INSERT` nor a filter read the same way, and such an instant was stored as `2262-04-11T23:47:16.854775807`. The engine API, line protocol, gRPC and HTTP surfaces keep exchanging these columns as epoch counts in the column's unit.

The timestamp column of a TimeSeries type is stored as a number, so `INSERT` does not accept an ISO-8601 string for it (`Cannot convert type String to LONG`): write an epoch value (as in the `CONTENT` example, milliseconds for a type with `PRECISION MILLISECOND`) or build it with the `date()` function, which interprets the text in the server's time zone. ISO-8601 strings are accepted in `WHERE` conditions on the timestamp column.

### Java Embedded API

The fastest path — bypasses all protocol and SQL overhead:

```
TimeSeriesEngine engine = database.getSchema()
    .getTimeSeriesType("SensorReading").getEngine();

long[] timestamps = { 1708430400000000000L, 1708430401000000000L };
String[] sensorIds = { "sensor-A", "sensor-A" };
double[] temperatures = { 22.5, 22.6 };

database.transaction(() -> {
  engine.appendSamples(timestamps,
      new Object[] { sensorIds, temperatures });
});
```

#### Appends and Transactions

A TimeSeries append is not part of the transaction that contains it. This is true of every ingestion method above - SQL `INSERT`, the REST write endpoint, the line protocol, Prometheus remote write and the Java embedded API alike:

- the samples are committed as they are appended, so they are durable and visible to every other connection as soon as the append returns, before you commit anything;
- rolling the enclosing transaction back does **not** remove them.

Use a session or a transaction around an append for what it does do - it holds that session's lock and principal and keeps its idle timer from reaping it while you ingest - and not for atomicity with the samples.

The reason is the shard's own append lock. Every append writes the shard's header page, which holds the sample count and the min/max timestamps, so two appends to one shard always want the same page version; serializing them behind a lock the append itself releases at its own commit is what keeps them from conflicting. An append that wrote through the caller's transaction could not be serialized that way, because the commit would belong to the caller and a shard cannot hold that lock until an arbitrary user transaction ends without blocking every other writer of that shard. Both would then stage the same page and one would lose its **whole** transaction to a concurrent-modification error that is not the shard's to retry.

#### Ingestion Method Comparison

| Method | Throughput | Overhead | Best For |
|---|---|---|---|
| Java Embedded API | ~0.5-1 us/sample | None (direct) | Embedded applications |
| InfluxDB Line Protocol | ~1-5 us/sample | Text parsing | Remote ingestion, Telegraf |
| Prometheus Remote Write | ~2-10 us/sample | Protobuf + Snappy | Prometheus ecosystems |
| SQL INSERT | ~50-100 us/sample | SQL parsing + planning | Ad-hoc inserts, small batches |

### 6.3.6. Querying Time Series Data

#### SQL Queries

Time series types support standard SQL `SELECT` with `WHERE`, `GROUP BY`, and `ORDER BY`. Time range conditions (`BETWEEN`, `>`, `>=`, `<`, `<=`, `=`) on the timestamp column are pushed down to the storage engine for efficient range scans. A time range on one branch of an `OR` never narrows the other branch, and two equalities on the same tag in one `AND` match nothing when the values differ, exactly as on a document type.

```
-- Basic range query
SELECT ts, sensor_id, temperature, humidity
FROM SensorReading
WHERE ts BETWEEN '2026-02-19' AND '2026-02-20'
  AND sensor_id = 'sensor-A'
ORDER BY ts

-- Aggregation with time bucketing
SELECT ts.timeBucket('1h', ts) AS hour,
       sensor_id,
       avg(temperature) AS avg_temp,
       max(temperature) AS max_temp,
       min(temperature) AS min_temp,
       count(*) AS sample_count
FROM SensorReading
WHERE ts BETWEEN '2026-02-19' AND '2026-02-20'
GROUP BY hour, sensor_id
ORDER BY hour
```

An aggregation that groups by the time bucket, by up to four `TAG` columns, or by both is answered by the storage engine in one pass (`AGGREGATE FROM TIMESERIES` in `EXPLAIN`), the shape of a per-host hourly report. Every projected tag must also be in the `GROUP BY`, and the aggregates are `avg`, `min`, `max`, `sum` and `count(*)` over numeric fields. A query outside that shape (a field in the `GROUP BY`, a projected tag that is not grouped by, `count(field)`, `DISTINCT`) gives the same answer through the generic row-at-a-time plan, which is slower.

An aggregation with no `GROUP BY` at all is answered by the storage engine as well, as one row over the queried range (`AGGREGATE FROM TIMESERIES ⋯ ungrouped` in `EXPLAIN`). Every sealed block lying wholly inside the range is answered from the sample count, minimum, maximum and sum it records, so only the blocks that cross a bound of the range are decompressed, and the cost of the query follows the number of blocks rather than the number of samples. Over a range holding no sample it answers one row, `0` for `count(*)` and `NULL` for every other aggregate, as SQL does.

```
SELECT count(*) AS samples, avg(temperature) AS avg_temp, max(temperature) AS max_temp
FROM SensorReading
WHERE ts >= '2026-02-19' AND ts < '2026-02-20'
```

Range conditions on a numeric `FIELD` are pushed down too: `>`, `>=`, `<`, `<=`, `=` and `BETWEEN` against a literal or a parameter, combined with `AND` (`FIELDS` in `EXPLAIN`). A sealed block whose recorded minimum and maximum rule a condition out is skipped without being read, a block whose whole range satisfies every condition is answered as if there were no condition (from its statistics, in an aggregation), and only the blocks in between are decompressed, with the condition tested on the decoded columns before any row is built. That applies to the aggregations above, so `SELECT count(*) ⋯ WHERE ts ⋯ AND temperature > 30` is answered by the storage engine, and to a plain row query, which then builds rows only for the samples that pass.

The comparisons pushed down are those SQL makes as plain numbers: a `DOUBLE` field against any

number, and a `LONG`, `INTEGER`, `SHORT` or `BYTE` field against an integer. A missing measurement never satisfies one, as `NULL > 30` does not. Any other condition - on a `FLOAT` field, `<>`, an `OR`, a comparison between two columns, a function of the field, a decimal against an integer field - gives the same answer through the generic filter.

**When upgrading to 26.11.1**: an aggregation answered by the storage engine returns the same values and Java types as the generic plan. `min` and `max` return a value of the column's declared type (a date/time object for a `DATE` or `DATETIME` column), `sum` over a `LONG`, `INTEGER`, `SHORT` or `BYTE` field returns an integer that widens to a `BigDecimal` past the `long` range (`sum` over a `FLOAT` field a float), and `avg` is a `Double`, instead of the `Double` earlier versions returned for a query grouped by the time bucket or by tags. An integral column is aggregated exactly, as 64-bit integers with a 128-bit running total, so a value past 2^53 - an epoch-nanosecond instant, a 64-bit id - is no longer rounded.

### TimeSeries SQL Functions

ArcadeDB provides a comprehensive set of `ts.*` SQL functions for time series analytics.

| Function | Description |
|---|---|
| `ts.timeBucket(interval, timestamp [, options])` | Truncates a timestamp to the nearest interval boundary for `GROUP BY` aggregation. Intervals: `'1s'`, `'5m'`, `'1h'`, `'1d'`, etc. Buckets are counted from the Unix epoch unless `options` moves the grid, see Moving the bucket grid. |
| `ts.first(value, timestamp)` | Returns the value corresponding to the earliest timestamp in the group. |
| `ts.last(value, timestamp)` | Returns the value corresponding to the latest timestamp in the group. |
| `ts.rate(value, timestamp [, counterResetDetection])` | Per-second rate of change. Optional 3rd parameter (`true`) enables Prometheus-style counter reset detection for monotonic counters. |
| `ts.delta(value, timestamp)` | Difference between the last and first values in the group. |
| `ts.movingAvg(value, window)` | Moving average with a configurable window size. |
| `ts.interpolate(value, method [, timestamp])` | Gap filling. Methods: `'zero'`, `'prev'`, `'linear'`, `'none'`. The `'linear'` method requires the timestamp parameter. |
| `ts.correlate(a, b)` | Pearson correlation coefficient between two series. |
| `ts.percentile(value, percentile)` | Approximate percentile calculation (0.0-1.0). E.g., `ts.percentile(latency, 0.99)` for p99. |
| `ts.lag(value, offset, timestamp [, default])` | Window function: returns the value from a previous row. |
| `ts.lead(value, offset, timestamp [, default])` | Window function: returns the value from a subsequent row. |
| `ts.rowNumber(timestamp)` | Window function: sequential 1-based row numbering. |

| Function | Description |
| --- | --- |
| `ts.rank(value, timestamp)` | Window function: rank with ties, gaps after ties. |

### 6.3.7. Moving the bucket grid

By default buckets are multiples of the interval counted from the Unix epoch, which was a Thursday at 00:00 UTC: a `'1w'` bucket starts on Thursday and a `'1d'` bucket starts at 08:00 in UTC+8. The optional third parameter of `ts.timeBucket` moves the grid; use one of:

```
-- weeks start on Monday
SELECT ts.timeBucket('1w', ts, {'origin': '2024-01-01T00:00:00Z'}) AS week, sum(kwh)
FROM Energy GROUP BY week

-- days start at local midnight in UTC+8
SELECT ts.timeBucket('1d', ts, {'offset': '-8h'}) AS day, sum(kwh) FROM Energy GROUP
BY day
SELECT ts.timeBucket('1d', ts, {'timezone': '+08:00'}) AS day, sum(kwh) FROM Energy
GROUP BY day
```

- `origin`: any instant a bucket starts at (a bare instant as third parameter means the same).
- `offset`: a signed duration added to the epoch grid.
- `timezone`: local midnight (local Monday for `'1w'`) of a zone with a fixed offset such as `'+08:00'`. Zones with daylight saving are refused, because their days do not all have the same length.

The same grid is used by the aggregation push-down, the HTTP/gRPC/Grafana `bucketOrigin`, continuous aggregates (write the option in the defining query) and downsampling tiers, which take an `OFFSET` clause:

```
ALTER TIMESERIES TYPE SensorReading ADD DOWNSAMPLING POLICY AFTER 30 DAYS GRANULARITY
1 DAYS OFFSET -8 HOURS
```

Blocks already downsampled are not re-bucketed if you change the offset later.

Examples:

```
-- Rate of change with counter reset detection
SELECT ts.timeBucket('5m', ts) AS window,
       ts.rate(request_count, ts, true) AS requests_per_sec
FROM HttpMetrics
WHERE ts > '2026-02-20T10:00:00Z'
GROUP BY window

-- Percentile calculation
SELECT ts.timeBucket('1h', ts) AS hour,
       ts.percentile(latency_ms, 0.99) AS p99,
       ts.percentile(latency_ms, 0.50) AS median
```

```
FROM ServiceMetrics
GROUP BY hour

-- Gap filling with linear interpolation
SELECT ts.timeBucket('1m', ts) AS minute,
       ts.interpolate(temperature, 'linear', ts) AS temp
FROM SensorReading
WHERE ts BETWEEN '2026-02-20T10:00:00Z' AND '2026-02-20T11:00:00Z'
GROUP BY minute

-- Correlation between two fields
SELECT ts.correlate(temperature, humidity) AS correlation
FROM SensorReading
WHERE ts BETWEEN '2026-02-19' AND '2026-02-20'
```

#### Dedicated JSON Query Endpoint

A simplified REST endpoint is available for programmatic access and Grafana integration:

```
POST /api/v1/ts/{database}/query
Content-Type: application/json

{
  "type": "SensorReading",
  "from": "2026-02-19T00:00:00Z",
  "to": "2026-02-20T00:00:00Z",
  "columns": ["temperature", "humidity"],
  "tags": { "sensor_id": "sensor-A" },
  "aggregation": "AVG",
  "bucketInterval": "1h"
}
```

For raw (non-aggregated) queries, omit the `aggregation` and `bucketInterval` fields.

The optional `bucketOrigin` (epoch milliseconds, also available on the Grafana endpoint, on gRPC as `bucket_origin_ms` and in the Java client as `TimeSeriesQuery.bucketOrigin()`) moves the bucket grid like the `origin` option of `ts.timeBucket`, see Moving the bucket grid.

`from`, `to`, `bucketInterval` and `maxDataPoints` must be whole numbers. A value with a fractional part is refused with `400` and a message naming the member, rather than being rounded down to something you did not ask for. A bucket width computed by division therefore has to be rounded by the client, deliberately.

To retrieve the most recent data point:

```
GET /api/v1/ts/{database}/latest?type=SensorReading&tag=sensor_id:sensor-A
```

Repeat `tag` once per tag column to narrow to a single series; every occurrence must match:

```
GET /api/v1/ts/{database}/latest?type=SensorReading&tag=sensor_id:sensor-
A&tag=region:eu
```

Since 26.10.1, a tag name that is not a `TAG` column of the type is refused with **HTTP 400**, naming it and listing the tags the type actually declares. It used to be ignored, which meant a typo **widened** the query instead of failing it: `{"tags": {"sesnor_id": "sensor-A"}}` returned every row in the range, and `?tag=sesnor_id:sensor-A` the newest sample of any series - neither distinguishable from a filter that legitimately matched everything.

On `latest`, an occurrence that is not in `name:value` form (`?tag=sensor_id`) is refused for the same reason. An empty `?tag=` is still ignored, since that is what an empty form field produces.

This applies to `POST /api/v1/ts/{database}/query`, `GET /api/v1/ts/{database}/latest`, the Grafana query endpoint (reported as that panel's error, so one bad tag does not blank the others) and the gRPC `TimeSeries` RPCs, which answer `INVALID_ARGUMENT`. The PromQL endpoint is unaffected: there an unknown label has a defined meaning under Prometheus' rules and is not a malformed request.

### Missing Values

A sample can be absent, which means "no measurement here" rather than a value of zero. You write one either as `NaN` or as `null`, and both are stored the same way on a `DOUBLE` or `FLOAT` column. Aggregations treat it that way:

- `MIN`, `MAX`, `SUM` and `AVG` skip `NaN` samples. Over a window that holds at least one real value they answer from the real values alone: `SUM` is the sum of the real samples and `AVG` divides it by the number of real samples, not by the number of samples. Over a window whose samples are **all** `NaN` they return `NaN`, meaning the window has no measurement to report.
- `count(*)` counts rows, so it counts `NaN` samples too. In SQL, `count(field)` counts only the rows where the field is not null, as on any other type, and returns a `Long`.
- A genuine `Infinity` or `-Infinity` sample is a measurement and is returned as such.
- Downsampling averages the real samples of each bucket; a bucket with no real sample is downsampled to `NaN`.

This is the semantics of SQL's `NULL` under `SUM`, `AVG` and `count(*)`. The PromQL endpoint is the one exception: its `sum`, `avg`, `sum_over_time` and `avg_over_time` propagate `NaN`, because that is what Prometheus does and a PromQL query is expected to answer what Prometheus would.

Over the REST and Grafana endpoints an absent value is serialized as JSON `null`, since JSON has no `NaN` literal. A Grafana panel therefore draws a gap for such a bucket rather than a dip to zero. Over SQL it reads back as `NULL`, both as a projected column and as the result of an aggregate with nothing to aggregate:

```
SELECT value FROM Sensor                          -- an absent sample is NULL
SELECT avg(value) FROM Sensor GROUP BY bucket     -- a bucket with no real sample is
NULL
```

A `NaN` that arithmetic itself produces over real samples - the sum of `+Infinity` and `-Infinity`, for instance - is an undefined total rather than an absence, and is returned as `NaN`.

*(Since v26.11.1)* A `LONG`, `INTEGER`, `SHORT`, `BYTE`, `BOOLEAN`, `DATE` or `DATETIME` column records absence too: a `null` written to it, or a column a `TimeSeriesBatch` row leaves unset, reads back as `null`, and `MIN`, `MAX`, `SUM`, `AVG` and `count(field)` skip it as they skip `NaN`. These types have no value to spare for absence, so a row of the mutable buffer carries a small null bitmap and a sealed block a null bitmap per column. The row layout is fixed when the type is created, so a TimeSeries type created by an earlier version keeps storing such a `null` as 0 (or `false`), which counts as a real measurement: recreate the type (for example `EXPORT` and `IMPORT`) to record gaps in its integer columns.

Before 26.10.1 a `null` measurement was stored as a real `0.0` on every column type. `AVG` therefore divided by it and `MIN` returned the zero instead of the smallest real value; only an explicitly written `NaN` was treated as absent. Samples already stored as zero by an earlier version stay zero - they are indistinguishable from a real measurement of zero - so this affects data written from 26.10.1 onwards.

Before 26.10.1 `SUM` and `AVG` returned `NaN` for the whole window as soon as one of its samples was `NaN`, and the block statistics a sealed block carries recorded that poisoned sum, so the answer stayed `NaN` even for a bucket of thousands of real samples. Since 26.10.1 every sealed block also records the count of real samples per column, which is what lets `AVG` be answered from the block statistics without decompressing the block. Blocks written by an earlier version are read as they are: a block whose recorded sum was poisoned is decompressed for every aggregate but `COUNT`, and the next compaction, downsampling or retention rewrite of the block records both statistics. The sealed store format version moved from 0 to 1 for this.

Since 26.10.1 each sealed block records an identity of its own, which is what lets a long-running read - a wide query, a PromQL range, an `EXPORT DATABASE` - find its blocks again if the shard is rewritten underneath it. On a high-availability follower that happens whenever the leader ships a newly compacted store: before this, such a read returned the rows it had reached and stopped there silently, with no error. Blocks written by an earlier version have no identity recorded and one is derived from the block itself, so they behave the same way; the next compaction, downsampling or retention rewrite records it.

The sealed store format version moved to 2 for this, so a store written by 26.10.1 cannot be opened by an earlier version - deliberately, since the alternative is an older version reading it as if it held nothing. In a cluster, keep every node on the

same version.

Before 26.9.1 an all-`NaN` window returned an internal placeholder for `MIN`/`MAX` instead - `1.7976931348623157E308` from the multi-column aggregation, `+Inf`/`-Inf` from PromQL's `min_over_time`/`max_over_time` - and those placeholders were indistinguishable from real measurements. Different query paths could also disagree with each other on the same data.

### Which Columns Can Be Aggregated

`SUM`, `AVG`, `MIN` and `MAX` read the column's values, so they need a column that is stored as a number. That means a numeric `FIELD`: `DOUBLE`, `FLOAT`, `LONG`, `INTEGER`, `SHORT`, `BYTE`, `BOOLEAN` (as 1 and 0), and the datetime types.

A column that is not stored as a number is refused, and the message names it:

```
{ "error": "Aggregation SUM cannot be applied to column 'host': a TAG column of type
STRING is not stored as a number" }
```

Tags are always stored as text, whatever type they are declared with, so a tag cannot be aggregated even when it is declared `LONG`. The same applies to a `STRING` field and to the timestamp column itself.

`COUNT` is the exception and works on any column. The SQL push-down also behaves differently: rather than refusing the query it simply falls back to the generic aggregation path, so `SELECT … max(host) … GROUP BY` and `count(field) … GROUP BY` (which skips null values) still answer. Only `count(*)` is answered by the push-down.

Before 26.10.1 such a request was not refused, it was answered wrongly: the recent samples were read as a column of zeros, so `SUM` returned `0` and `AVG` returned `0` over data that had never been measured, and the same query failed with a server error once the samples had been compacted.

The same fix corrected `BOOLEAN` fields, which are stored as numbers but were being read as zero before compaction and as their real value afterwards - so a `SUM` over a boolean field could change on its own when compaction ran, with no new data. It now answers the number of `true` samples on both.

**When upgrading**: a `BOOLEAN` field on a type created before 26.1 is stored as text rather than as a number, so `SUM`/`AVG` over it is now refused rather than silently returning `0`. Recreate the type to aggregate such a field. `COUNT` is unaffected.

### Aggregating from Embedded Java

Aggregation from embedded code goes through `TimeSeriesEngine.aggregateMulti`, which reads any number of columns in a single pass:

```
TimeSeriesEngine engine = database.getSchema()
```

```
    .getTimeSeriesType("SensorReading").getEngine();

List<ColumnDefinition> columns = ((LocalTimeSeriesType) database.getSchema()
    .getType("SensorReading")).getTsColumns();

// The position of 'temperature' inside an engine row, from its position in the
schema.
int temperature = TimeSeriesGateway.aggregationRowIndex(columns,
    TimeSeriesGateway.findColumnIndex("temperature", columns));

MultiColumnAggregationResult result = engine.aggregateMulti(fromTs, toTs,
    List.of(new MultiColumnAggregationRequest(temperature, AggregationType.AVG,
"avg_temp")),
    3_600_000L, null);

for (long bucket : result.getBucketTimestamps())
  System.out.println(bucket + " -> " + result.getValue(bucket, 0));
```

A bucket interval of `0` aggregates the whole range as one bucket, answering every sealed block wholly inside it from its statistics. The overloads of `aggregateMulti`, `aggregateGrouped` and `iterateQuery` that take a `FieldFilter` read only the samples that pass range conditions on numeric fields, judged on each block's statistics before it is read. A condition is built with `FieldFilter.range`, which returns `null` for a comparison it cannot evaluate exactly as SQL does (see the SQL Queries section above):

```
// 'temperature' by its index among the columns that are not the timestamp, the
numbering TagFilter uses
FieldFilter hot = FieldFilter.range(1, columns.get(2), 30, false, null, false); //
temperature > 30

MultiColumnAggregationResult hotSamples = engine.aggregateMulti(fromTs, toTs,
    List.of(MultiColumnAggregationRequest.count("n")), 0L, 0L, null, hot, null, 0);
```

`MultiColumnAggregationRequest.columnIndex` is the position of the value inside an **engine row**: `0` is the timestamp and `1` onward are the non-`TIMESTAMP` columns in schema order. That is not the same as the column's position in the schema unless the `TIMESTAMP` column is declared first, which is why the example above converts with `TimeSeriesGateway.aggregationRowIndex`.

**When upgrading to 26.10.1**: before this release the two halves of the aggregation engine disagreed about this number, so a type whose `TIMESTAMP` column was not declared first answered one value before compaction and another after it. Code that passed a schema index must now convert. Nothing will warn you — the request's shape is unchanged, so such code still compiles and simply aggregates a different column. No change is needed for a type whose `TIMESTAMP` column is declared first, and none at all for the SQL, HTTP, Grafana and gRPC surfaces, which resolve the column by name.

The single-column `TimeSeriesEngine.aggregate` and `TimeSeriesSealedStore.aggregate` methods, which counted columns a third way, were removed in the same release. Use `aggregateMulti` with a one-element list.

### 6.3.8. PromQL Query Language

ArcadeDB includes a native PromQL parser and evaluator, providing Prometheus-compatible query capabilities without requiring an external Prometheus server.

#### PromQL via HTTP API

The PromQL endpoints follow the Prometheus HTTP API format and return standard `{status: "success", data: {…}}` JSON responses.

**Instant query:**

```
GET /ts/{database}/prom/api/v1/query?query=avg(cpu_usage{host="srv1"})&time=1700000000
```

The `time` parameter is Unix seconds (float). Defaults to current time if omitted.

**Range query:**

```
GET
/ts/{database}/prom/api/v1/query_range?query=rate(http_requests_total[5m])&start=17000
00000&end=1700003600&step=60
```

All timestamps in Unix seconds. The `step` parameter accepts a duration string (`60s`, `1m`) or seconds as a float.

Since v26.9.1 `start`, `end`, `step` and `time` are validated before the query runs: a value that is not a number, is infinite (`NaN`, `Infinity`) or falls outside a sensible date range is refused with `400 bad_data`. A range that would produce more than 1,000,000 points is refused the same way - increase `step` or narrow the range.

Earlier versions accepted such values and could take a very long time to answer, or not answer at all, on an extremely wide range.

Since v26.11.1 selector windows are left-open, as in Prometheus: an instant selector evaluated at `t` reads the samples in `(t - lookback, t]` and a range selector `[5m]` reads `(t - 5m, t]`. A series whose last sample is exactly one lookback old is therefore stale, and `count_over_time(m[5m])` over a feed whose scrape interval divides five minutes no longer counts the sample sitting on the lower boundary. Earlier versions included that boundary sample (the Prometheus 2.x behaviour for range selectors, never Prometheus's behaviour for the lookback).

Since v26.10.1 instant and range queries read samples in a streaming fashion

instead of loading the whole lookback window into memory first. A query over a wide time range now uses memory proportional to the number of series returned, not to the number of samples scanned to compute it.

**Label discovery:**

```
GET /ts/{database}/prom/api/v1/labels
GET /ts/{database}/prom/api/v1/label/{name}/values
GET /ts/{database}/prom/api/v1/label/{name}/values?start=1700000000&end=1700003600
GET /ts/{database}/prom/api/v1/series?match[]=cpu_usage{host=~"srv.*"}
```

These endpoints follow the Prometheus data model, where a label with an empty value counts as absent. A tag that holds no value for some samples is therefore not offered as an empty entry by `label/{name}/values`, and `series` does not report a series whose only difference from another is an empty label. The generic `/api/v1/ts/{database}/query` endpoint is unaffected and still reports exactly what the samples hold.

Since v26.10.1 `label/{name}/values` honours `start` and `end` (Unix timestamps in seconds, fractional values allowed), and answers only the values a sample carries inside that window. Querying the special `name` label likewise returns only the metrics holding a sample in the window.

Both are optional. A request sending neither covers the whole series and, for `name`, names every time-series type - including one holding no sample at all - exactly as before, so existing dashboards are unaffected.

Earlier versions ignored both parameters and always answered over the whole retention period, so a Grafana variable scoped to the last hour was offered every value the label had ever held.

`start` and `end` are validated the same way as on `query_range`: a value that is not a number, is infinite, or falls outside a sensible date range is refused with `400 bad_data`, as is an `end` earlier than `start`. The same validation now applies to `series`, which previously answered `500` for a malformed value.

**Supported PromQL Features**

| Category | Supported |
|---|---|
| Vector selectors | `metric_name`, `metric{label="value"}`, `metric{label=~"regex"}`, `metric{label!="value"}`, `metric{label!~"regex"}` |
| Range selectors | `metric[5m]`, `metric[1h]`, `metric[30s]`, `metric[1d]` |
| Aggregations | `sum`, `min`, `max`, `avg`, `count`, `topk`, `bottomk`, `quantile` with `by` / `without` clauses |
| Rate functions | `rate()`, `irate()`, `increase()`, `delta()`, `idelta()` |

| Category | Supported |
|---|---|
| Over-time functions | `avg_over_time()`, `min_over_time()`, `max_over_time()`, `sum_over_time()`, `count_over_time()`, `stddev_over_time()` |
| Math functions | `abs()`, `ceil()`, `floor()`, `round()`, `sqrt()`, `exp()`, `ln()`, `log2()`, `log10()`, `clamp_min()`, `clamp_max()`, `pi()` |
| Label functions | `label_replace()`, `label_join()` |
| Other | `absent()`, `histogram_quantile()`, `vector()`, `scalar()`, `time()` |
| Operators | `+`, `-`, `*`, `/`, `%`, `^`, comparison (`==`, `!=`, `<`, `>`, `<=`, `>=`), logical (`and`, `or`, `unless`) |

#### PromQL via SQL

The `promql()` SQL function calls the PromQL evaluator from within SQL queries:

```
-- Instant query at explicit time
RETURN promql('cpu_usage{host="srv1"}', 1700000000000)

-- Rate calculation
RETURN promql('rate(http_requests_total[5m])')

-- Scalar arithmetic
RETURN promql('2 + 3 * 4', 1000)
```

The function accepts 1-2 arguments: the PromQL expression (required) and an optional evaluation timestamp in milliseconds.

#### Prometheus Remote Read

Configure Prometheus to read from ArcadeDB for long-term storage:

```
# prometheus.yml
remote_read:
  - url: "http://localhost:2480/ts/mydb/prom/read"
    basic_auth:
      username: root
      password: password
```

The endpoint accepts the standard Prometheus `remote_read` Protobuf query (snappy-compressed) and supports `=`, `!=`, `=~`, `!~` label matchers, applied with the same rules as the PromQL `/query` and `/series` endpoints. A `name` matcher that is not an equality (for example `{name=~"cpu.*"}`) selects every metric it matches among those the user can read. An invalid or unsafe regular expression is refused with HTTP `400` rather than answered with an empty result *(since v26.11.1)*.

### 6.3.9. Continuous Aggregates

Continuous aggregates are pre-computed time-bucketed rollups that are automatically refreshed

when new data is inserted. They dramatically speed up common dashboard queries by maintaining materialized summaries.

```
-- Create a continuous aggregate
CREATE CONTINUOUS AGGREGATE hourly_temps AS
  SELECT ts.timeBucket('1h', ts) AS hour,
         sensor_id,
         avg(temperature) AS avg_temp,
         max(temperature) AS max_temp,
         count(*) AS cnt
  FROM SensorReading
  GROUP BY hour, sensor_id

-- Query the aggregate like any other type
SELECT * FROM hourly_temps
WHERE hour BETWEEN '2026-02-19' AND '2026-02-20'

-- Manual refresh
REFRESH CONTINUOUS AGGREGATE hourly_temps

-- Drop
DROP CONTINUOUS AGGREGATE hourly_temps
```

The defining query must reference a TimeSeries source type and contain a `ts.timeBucket()` call with a `GROUP BY` clause. After creation, every committed insert into the source type triggers an incremental refresh using watermark tracking — only new data since the last watermark is processed.

Inspect continuous aggregates via:

```
SELECT FROM schema:continuousAggregates
```

This returns name, query, source type, bucket column, bucket interval, watermark timestamp, `watermarkSet`, status, and metrics for each aggregate. `watermarkSet` tells a watermark of `0` that has actually been reached — an aggregate whose newest bucket is the epoch — apart from an aggregate that has never been refreshed, which reports `0` as well.

The watermark is the bucket boundary of the newest row the last refresh produced. Each refresh deletes the backing rows at or after it and recomputes them from the source, so the incomplete bucket that was open when the previous refresh ran is always rebuilt rather than duplicated. A defining query may carry its own `WHERE` clause, including a disjunction: the watermark filter is added as a separate conjunct around it, so `WHERE a OR b` keeps meaning `ts >= watermark AND (a OR b)`.

### 6.3.10. Retention Policies

Retention policies automatically delete data older than a specified duration. Set the retention period during type creation:

```
CREATE TIMESERIES TYPE SensorReading
  TIMESTAMP ts
  TAGS (sensor_id STRING)
  FIELDS (temperature DOUBLE)
  RETENTION 90 DAYS
```

A background maintenance scheduler (60-second interval) automatically enforces retention and downsampling policies on all TimeSeries types.

### 6.3.11. Downsampling Policies

Downsampling reduces the resolution of old data to save storage while preserving long-term trends. Multiple tiers can be defined to progressively reduce resolution as data ages:

```
ALTER TIMESERIES TYPE SensorReading
  ADD DOWNSAMPLING POLICY
    AFTER 7 DAYS GRANULARITY 1 MINUTES
    AFTER 30 DAYS GRANULARITY 1 HOURS
```

In this example, data older than 7 days is downsampled to 1-minute resolution, and data older than 30 days is further reduced to 1-hour resolution. The downsampling process aggregates values using AVG within each granularity bucket, preserving tag groupings.

#### Reads That Cross a Downsampling Pass

Downsampling replaces samples rather than deleting them, so a read already in flight when a pass runs cannot finish coherently: the rows it has already returned are the original samples, and the rows still to come are their coarser replacements. Joining the two would report the bucket at the crossing point at two different resolutions.

Such a read is therefore **refused** rather than allowed to return a short answer:

- Over HTTP — including PromQL and the Grafana endpoints — the response is `503`, so a client that already retries on `503` recovers on its own.
- Over gRPC, Bolt, MongoDB and Postgres the equivalent retryable status is returned.
- `EXPORT DATABASE` fails only the TIMESERIES type it was reading; every other type in the database is still exported.

Re-running the read succeeds and returns a complete answer at a single resolution, because downsampling is a scheduled maintenance event rather than something that happens per request.

A **retention** pass is different. It deletes old data outright, so a read that crosses one still completes and simply returns the rows that remain.

#### What an Export Reports

The `EXPORT DATABASE` summary carries two counters for TIMESERIES data that changed underneath

it:

| Field | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `vanishedTimeSeriesBlocks` | Blocks a retention pass deleted while the export was reading them. Their samples are genuinely gone, so the export is still valid for the database as it now stands — but it is not the snapshot it would have been a moment earlier. Reported, never fatal. |
| `partialTimeSeriesTypes` | Types whose export was cut short by a downsampling pass. The rows already written for such a type are real but incomplete, and the export as a whole is reported as failed so the gap cannot pass unnoticed. Re-run the export for a complete result. |

### 6.3.12. Grafana Integration

ArcadeDB provides Grafana DataFrame-compatible HTTP endpoints that work with the Grafana Infinity datasource plugin — no custom plugin is needed.

**Endpoints:**

| Endpoint | Description |
|---|---|
| `GET /api/v1/ts/{database}/grafana/health` | Datasource health check |
| `GET /api/v1/ts/{database}/grafana/metadata` | Discovers TimeSeries types, fields, tags, and available aggregation types |
| `POST /api/v1/ts/{database}/grafana/query` | Multi-target query returning Grafana DataFrame wire format |

The query endpoint supports raw queries, aggregated queries (SUM/AVG/MIN/MAX/COUNT), tag filtering, field projection, and automatic bucket interval calculation from Grafana's `maxDataPoints` setting.

**Grafana Infinity datasource configuration:**

1. Install the Grafana Infinity datasource plugin.
2. Add a new Infinity datasource.
3. Set the base URL to `http://<arcadedb-host>:2480`.
4. Configure authentication (Basic Auth with ArcadeDB credentials).
5. Use the health endpoint for health checks.

### 6.3.13. Studio TimeSeries Explorer

The ArcadeDB Studio web interface includes a dedicated TimeSeries Explorer accessible from the main navigation sidebar.

The explorer provides four tabs:

- **Query** — Time range selector, aggregation controls, field checkboxes, interactive charts (ApexCharts with zoom), data table with pagination, auto-refresh capability
- **Schema** — Type introspection with column roles (TIMESTAMP/TAG/FIELD badges), diagnostics (total samples, shards, time range), configuration details, downsampling tiers, per-shard statistics
- **Ingestion** — Documentation and examples for all four ingestion methods with a method comparison table
- **PromQL** — PromQL expression input, instant/range toggle, time controls, chart and table rendering of results

### 6.3.14. HTTP API Reference

| Method | Endpoint | Description |
|---|---|---|
| POST | /api/v1/ts/{database}/write?precision=<ns\|us\|ms\|s> | InfluxDB Line Protocol ingestion. Body: plain text lines. Returns 204 on success. |
| POST | /api/v1/ts/{database}/query | JSON query endpoint. Supports raw and aggregated queries with tag filtering and field projection. A tags name that is no TAG column of the type is refused with 400. |
| GET | /api/v1/ts/{database}/latest?type=<name>&tag=<key>:<value> | Returns the most recent data point, with optional tag filter. Repeat tag to narrow across several tag columns; every occurrence must match. An occurrence that is malformed, or names no TAG column, is refused with 400. |
| GET | /ts/{database}/prom/api/v1/query?query=<promql>&time=<unix_seconds> | PromQL instant query. |
| GET | /ts/{database}/prom/api/v1/query_range?query=<promql>&start=<s>&end=<s>&step=<s> | PromQL range query. |
| GET | /ts/{database}/prom/api/v1/labels | List all label names (metric names and tag columns). |
| GET | /ts/{database}/prom/api/v1/label/{name}/values | List distinct values for a label. |
| GET | /ts/{database}/prom/api/v1/series?match[]=<selector> | Find series matching PromQL selector(s). |
| POST | /ts/{database}/prom/write | Prometheus remote_write endpoint (snappy-compressed Protobuf). |
| POST | /ts/{database}/prom/read | Prometheus remote_read endpoint (snappy-compressed Protobuf). |
| GET | /api/v1/ts/{database}/grafana/health | Grafana datasource health check. |
| GET | /api/v1/ts/{database}/grafana/metadata | Grafana metadata discovery. |

| Method | Endpoint | Description |
|---|---|---|
| POST | /api/v1/ts/{database}/grafana/query | Grafana DataFrame query endpoint. |

### 6.3.15. High Availability

In an HA cluster, TimeSeries data is handled as follows:

- **Mutable bucket data** (`.tstb` files) is replicated to all followers via ArcadeDB's standard page-replication protocol
- **Sealed store data** (`.ts.sealed` files) is replicated too, but by its own path: compaction, retention and downsampling run on the leader only, and the rewritten sealed file is shipped to the followers together with the change that clears the matching mutable data. Followers do not compact independently
- **Reads are consistent after failover**: the engine queries both sealed and mutable layers, so a newly promoted leader returns correct results even before its first compaction cycle
- **Compaction lag**: a node whose maintenance scheduler has not run yet (default: 60 seconds) serves the same results, just with more of the answer coming from the mutable layer
- **Backups and snapshots taken on a follower** are consistent. Because the sealed file and the clearing of the mutable data arrive together, a copy taken across that moment used to be able to capture both and restore with duplicated samples; since 26.10.1 the copy waits for the install to finish

### 6.3.16. Integrity Checking

Starting in 26.9.1, if a type's sealed store fails to open at all (for example, a corrupted `.ts.sealed` file), the type stays visible in the schema instead of disappearing. `CHECK DATABASE` reports it as corrupted and names the file; any query, write, or REST/PromQL/Grafana call against the type fails with a clear error instead of silently recreating an empty type or returning wrong results. Earlier versions dropped the type from the schema silently on the next restart.

A TimeSeries type has neither record buckets nor indexes, so `CHECK DATABASE` walks it with a pass of its own that reads all three of the on-disk formats it owns:

- the **mutable bucket** (`.tstb`) — page 0's counters are reconciled against the samples its data pages actually hold
- the **tag dictionary** (`.tstd`) — the declared entry count against the entries walked
- the **sealed store** (`.ts.sealed`) — the header, the block directory, the block bounds, and the CRC32 of every block

```
CHECK DATABASE
CHECK DATABASE TYPE SensorReading
```

The CRC32 pass reads the whole sealed file. That is deliberate: a sealed block is otherwise verified

only on the first read that touches it, so a block nothing queries is a block nothing verifies.

### The `DEEP` tier

`CHECK DATABASE DEEP` adds the checks that have to decompress the blocks. A CRC proves the bytes are the bytes that were written; it proves nothing about whether they mean what the block claims. Three things the read paths answer queries from, without ever looking at a value, are verified only here:

| Claim | What a wrong one does |
|---|---|
| Timestamps are sorted | The range iterator binary-searches them, so a query over the block silently returns a subset of the matching rows |
| Per-column `min`/`max`/`sum` | Aggregation push-down answers `MIN`/`MAX`/`SUM`/`AVG` from them without decompressing, so the query returns a wrong number |
| Distinct tag values | Block pruning skips a whole block whose declaration omits the value being filtered on, hiding those rows entirely |

Each of those produces a wrong **answer** rather than an error, which is why nothing else in the engine reports them.

`DEEP` also reports a block written before 26.9.1 whose column holds only `NaN` samples: such a block stored an internal placeholder as its `min`/`max`, and aggregation push-down returns that placeholder as if it were a measurement. The check names the column and the remedy - recompacting or downsampling the block rewrites its header. Existing data is not corrected until then.

```
CHECK DATABASE DEEP
CHECK DATABASE TYPE SensorReading FIX DEEP
```

### What `FIX` repairs

`FIX` repairs only what is **derived** from the data, and never a sample:

- the mutable bucket's page-0 counters (sample count, min and max timestamp)
- the sealed header's block count and global timestamp bounds
- the tail of a sealed append that did not complete

None of those is cosmetic. The global bounds are read straight out of the header when the file is opened rather than recomputed, so a range query pruned against a wrong bound silently misses data the file holds; and because new blocks are appended at the end of the file, a tail no reader can see also hides every block appended after it.

A sealed block that fails its CRC, or that `DEEP` finds inconsistent, is reported and left untouched. It is the only copy of the samples in it, so discarding it is an operator's decision - and in an HA cluster the sealed store is derived, so a node can rebuild one by recompacting from its replicated mutable pages.

The report carries `totalTimeSeriesTypes`, `totalTimeSeriesShards`, `totalTimeSeriesSamples` and `totalTimeSeriesSealedBlocks` alongside the findings, so a clean result can be told apart from a pass that never ran. Findings appear in `warnings` with the offending type named in `corruptedTimeSeries`; repairs are counted in `repairedTimeSeries` and listed in `timeSeriesRepairs`.

### 6.3.17. Comparison with Other TimeSeries Databases

| Feature | ArcadeDB | InfluxDB 3 | TimescaleDB | Prometheus | QuestDB |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| License | Apache 2.0 | MIT (core) | Apache 2.0 (core) | Apache 2.0 | Apache 2.0 |
| Multi-Model | Graph + Document + K/V + TimeSeries + Vector in one engine | TimeSeries only | Relational + TimeSeries (PostgreSQL extension) | Metrics only | TimeSeries only (SQL) |
| Query Languages | SQL, PromQL, Cypher, Gremlin, GraphQL, MongoDB QL | SQL, InfluxQL | Full PostgreSQL SQL | PromQL | SQL (PG wire) |
| Ingestion Protocols | Line Protocol, Prometheus remote_write, SQL, Java API | Line Protocol, SQL | SQL (INSERT, COPY) | Prometheus scrape, remote_write | Line Protocol, SQL, CSV |
| Compression | Gorilla, Delta-of-Delta, Simple-8b, Dictionary | Parquet native (Delta, Dict, Snappy/ZSTD) | Gorilla, Delta-of-delta, Simple-8b, Dictionary, LZ4 | Gorilla (~1.37 B/sample) | ZFS-level + Parquet for cold tier |
| Continuous Aggregates | Yes (watermark-based, auto-refresh on commit) | Materialized views | Yes (policy-based refresh) | Recording rules | No |
| Downsampling | Yes (multi-tier, automatic) | Via compaction | Via continuous aggregates + retention | Recording rules | No |
| Retention Policies | Yes (automatic, per-type) | Yes | Yes (per-chunk) | Yes (per-block) | Yes (per-partition) |
| Grafana Integration | DataFrame endpoints (Infinity plugin) | Native plugin | PostgreSQL datasource | Native plugin | PostgreSQL datasource |

| Feature | ArcadeDB | InfluxDB 3 | TimescaleDB | Prometheus | QuestDB |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| PromQL Support | Native (parser + evaluator + HTTP endpoints) | No | Via adapter | Native | No |
| Embeddable (in-process) | Yes (Java library) | No | No (requires PostgreSQL) | No | No (separate process) |
| SIMD Aggregation | Yes (Java Vector API) | Via DataFusion (Arrow) | No | No | Yes (AVX2) |
| Prometheus Remote Write/Read | Yes | No | Via adapter | Native | No |
| Graph + TimeSeries Queries | Yes (native cross-model) | No | No | No | No |

### 6.3.18. Choosing the layout: `COMPACTION_INTERVAL` and `SHARDS`

For a type that is bulk-loaded and then aggregated in fixed buckets (for example hourly averages), declare `COMPACTION_INTERVAL` with the bucket width of that aggregation and leave `SHARDS` at its default:

```
CREATE TIMESERIES TYPE Point TIMESTAMP ts TAGS (host STRING)
  FIELDS (uu DOUBLE, us DOUBLE, ui DOUBLE)
  COMPACTION_INTERVAL 1 HOURS
```

- A sealed block answers an aggregate from its min/max/sum statistics only when it lies inside ONE query bucket. Without an interval a block covers many hours and is decompressed (`PROFILE` reports it under `slow`); with `1 HOURS` the blocks are cut at the hour and are counted under `fast`.
- Other queries on the same type are not penalised. A last-point query (`ORDER BY ts DESC LIMIT 1`) walks the blocks newest-first and stops at the first block that has the row, and a finer bucket (`timeBucket('1m', ts)`) over a short range reads only the blocks of that range, so smaller blocks only mean less to decompress. Ingest is not slowed either: blocks are cut when the mutable data is compacted, not while samples are appended.
- The price is more, smaller blocks (each shard cuts at every interval boundary), so a very small interval on a long retention multiplies the block count. Pick the bucket of the aggregation you run most, not the smallest one you might ever run.
- `SHARDS` trades ingest parallelism for fragmentation: every shard cuts its own blocks, so doubling the shards roughly doubles the blocks per interval, and queries merge one more stream. The default (available cores minus 1) suits concurrent writers; for a type loaded by one writer and queried more than written, fewer shards are enough.
- Run `COMPACT TIMESERIES TYPE <name>` after a bulk load: mutable samples are not in sealed blocks

yet, and only sealed blocks are answered from their statistics.

### 6.3.19. Architecture

The TimeSeries engine uses a two-layer storage architecture:

- **Mutable bucket** — An append-only in-memory buffer backed by ArcadeDB's `PaginatedComponent`. New samples land here first. This layer is ACID-transactional and replicated in HA mode.
- **Sealed store** — Immutable, compressed columnar blocks on disk. The maintenance scheduler periodically compacts mutable data into sealed blocks using Gorilla, Delta-of-Delta, Simple-8b, and Dictionary codecs. Block-level min/max/sum statistics enable zero-decompression aggregation when an entire block falls within a single time bucket (for an aggregation with no `GROUP BY`, within the queried range), and let a range condition on a numeric field skip a block without reading it.

Since v26.11.1. A sealed block keeps the statistics of an integer column (`LONG`, `INTEGER`, `SHORT`, `BYTE`, `BOOLEAN` and the date/time types) exactly: the minimum and the maximum as 64-bit integers and the sum as a 128-bit integer, so `min`, `max` and `sum` of such a column past 2^53 are answered from the block headers, exactly, without decompressing anything. A block written by an earlier version is answered from its headers whenever its statistics are provably exact, and decompressed otherwise until the next compaction rewrites it. The sealed file format version is 3: an older ArcadeDB version refuses to open such a file, so keep this in mind before a downgrade.

Since v26.11.1. Integer columns (`LONG`, `DATETIME_NANOS` and the other integral types) hold the full 64-bit range. A block whose values do not all fit the compact Simple-8b packing (outside +/-2^59, such as epoch-nanosecond instants or snowflake ids) is stored as plain 64-bit values instead of making the compaction fail. Such a block is larger, and an older ArcadeDB version cannot read it, so keep this in mind before a downgrade. Before, compaction of such a type failed permanently.

Data is distributed across N shards (default: `arcadedb.asyncWorkerThreads`, the available cores minus 1) for parallel writes and reads. Each shard maintains its own mutable bucket and sealed store. Queries merge results across shards using a min-heap priority queue sorted by timestamp.

**See Also**

- Time Series Tutorial — Step-by-step hands-on guide to time series in ArcadeDB
- Realtime Analytics — Use case for streaming ingestion and real-time dashboards

## 6.4. Vector

ArcadeDB includes a native vector search engine for similarity-based retrieval of embeddings. Vector indexes are fully integrated into the SQL query engine and support ACID transactions, persistent storage, and automatic compaction.

### 6.4.1. How Vector Search Works

Vector search finds the nearest neighbors to a query vector in high-dimensional space. Instead of exact matching (like SQL `WHERE`), it finds the most *similar* items based on a distance or similarity metric.

Typical workflow:

1. Generate embeddings from your data using an external model (OpenAI, Sentence Transformers, etc.)
2. Store embeddings as vector properties on vertices or documents
3. Create a vector index on the property
4. Query with `vector.neighbors()` to find the k most similar items

### 6.4.2. LSMVectorIndex Architecture

ArcadeDB's vector index is built on two foundations:

- **LSM Tree storage** — ArcadeDB's proven LSM Tree architecture provides persistent, crash-safe storage with automatic compaction
- **JVector 4.0.0** — A high-performance vector search library that implements both HNSW (Hierarchical Navigable Small World) and Vamana (DiskANN) graph algorithms

The index stores vectors as a navigable graph where each node connects to its approximate nearest neighbors. Searches traverse this graph, narrowing in on the closest matches efficiently — typically in O(log n) time rather than O(n) brute-force scanning.

### 6.4.3. Flat vs Hierarchical Structure

The index supports two graph structures:

| | **Flat (default)** | **Hierarchical** |
|---|---|---|
| **Algorithm** | Single-layer Vamana graph | Multi-layer HNSW with exponential decay |
| **Build speed** | Faster | 10-20% slower |
| **Disk usage** | Baseline | 5-15% larger |
| **Best for** | < 100K vectors, well-clustered data | 100K+ vectors, 1024+ dimensions, diverse queries |

Enable hierarchical mode with `addHierarchy: true` in the index metadata.

### 6.4.4. Similarity Functions

Three distance metrics are available:

| Function | When to Use | Value Range |
|---|---|---|
| **COSINE** (default) | Text embeddings (BERT, GPT, Sentence Transformers). Direction matters, magnitude does not. | -1 to 1 |
| **DOT_PRODUCT** | Normalized vectors where speed matters. 10-15% faster than COSINE. | Unbounded |
| **EUCLIDEAN** | Spatial data, point clouds, continuous measurements. Absolute distance matters. | 0 to infinity |

If your embeddings are already L2-normalized (unit vectors), use DOT_PRODUCT for best performance — it produces the same ranking as COSINE but skips the normalization step.

### 6.4.5. Quantization

Quantization reduces memory usage by compressing vector components at the cost of slight accuracy loss:

| Type | Memory Reduction | Speed | Recall | Use Case |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **NONE** | Baseline | Baseline | 100% | Small datasets (< 10K vectors), maximum accuracy |
| **INT8** (recommended) | 4x (75% savings) | 10-15% faster | 95-98% | Best balance of speed and accuracy for most workloads |
| **BINARY** | 32x (97% savings) | 15-20% faster | 85-92% | Massive datasets, approximate search with reranking |
| **PRODUCT** | 16-64x | Approximate | Varies | Very large datasets (100K+), enables zero-disk-I/O graph construction |

**Use INT8 quantization for most use cases.** It provides 4x memory savings with minimal accuracy loss and significantly faster search. Only use NONE for very small datasets where maximum precision matters.

#### Why INT8 is faster

Quantization doesn't just save memory — it fundamentally changes how vectors are read during search.

Without quantization (`NONE`), each node visited during graph traversal requires a full document lookup: read the record from disk, deserialize it, and extract the vector property. With INT8, vectors are stored in compact contiguous index pages and read directly — no document deserialization needed.

In benchmarks with 500K 384-dimensional vectors (matching the `all-MiniLM-L6-v2` embedding model), INT8 reduces search latency by **2.5x** compared to NONE:

| Quantization | Mean latency | p95 latency | Vector fetch path |
|---|---|---|---|
| NONE | 3.50 ms | 4.36 ms | Document lookup (random I/O) |
| **INT8** | **1.59 ms** | **1.94 ms** | Index pages (sequential I/O) |

The difference becomes even more significant under memory pressure. With NONE quantization, vector data is 4x larger, evicting more data from memory caches and forcing real disk I/O. INT8 keeps the working set small enough to stay in memory even with constrained resources.

Quantization is transparent — queries work identically regardless of quantization setting. The index automatically quantizes on insert and dequantizes on retrieval.

When using PRODUCT quantization, the graph build uses Product Quantization scores instead of exact vector distances. PQ codes are compact and stay in memory, eliminating disk I/O during graph construction. This is most effective on large datasets (100K+ vectors) where PQ quality is sufficient.

Distances returned by a PRODUCT-quantized index are approximate, which is the trade this quantization makes for its speed and memory savings. Before v26.9.1 records written since the last index rebuild were measured exactly while the rest were measured approximately, so two records at the same true distance could come back with different values and the newer one ranked ahead of the older. If you filter on distance with `maxDistance`, your threshold was being applied to two different measurements. All records are now measured the same way.

A rebuild replaces the graph and its PQ codes a moment apart. Before v26.10.1 a query landing in between could fail with `Error performing PQ approximate search`, most often on a busy index being rebuilt in the background. Such a query now answers from the exact vectors instead, so it returns normally — a single query may take longer while the rebuild finishes, and the fast path resumes on its own.

*Table 1. Memory and performance example: 100K vectors with 384 dimensions*

| Quantization | Vector memory | Search speed |
|---|---|---|
| NONE | 156 MB | Baseline |

| Quantization | Vector memory | Search speed |
|---|---|---|
| INT8 | 39 MB | ~2.5x faster |
| BINARY | 5 MB | ~3x faster (lower recall) |

### 6.4.6. Vector Encoding (Pre-Quantized Ingest)

The `encoding` index option controls the **wire and document-storage** representation of vectors. It is distinct from `quantization`, which controls the **index-internal** compression scheme:

| Knob | What it changes | Trade-off |
|---|---|---|
| `encoding` | What the document column stores and what HTTP clients send | Wire payload, bucket bytes, client round trip |
| `quantization` | What the HNSW graph compresses internally | Index memory footprint, recall, search latency |

Two encodings are supported:

- `FLOAT32` **(default)** — the `embedding` property is `ARRAY_OF_FLOATS` (4 bytes per dimension).
- `INT8` — the `embedding` property is `BINARY` (one signed byte per dimension). Callers using providers that emit int8 directly (Cohere `int8` endpoints, OpenAI `text-embedding-3-large` reduced precision, Sentence Transformers with int8 quantization) skip a precision-losing client-side `int8 → float32 → server` round trip. The HTTP payload and document bucket storage shrink 4x.

The HNSW graph still runs on `float32` internally; the engine dequantizes on the read path using `value / 127.0f` (Cohere/OpenAI calibration). Native int8 HNSW is tracked upstream at datastax/jvector#665 — once the JVector contract widens, no schema change will be needed.

```
-- INT8-encoded ingest. Property MUST be BINARY.
CREATE PROPERTY Doc.embedding BINARY;
CREATE INDEX ON Doc (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 1024,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "encoding": "INT8"
};
```

The factory rejects two misconfigurations at index-creation time so the failure surfaces immediately rather than as silent incorrect scaling later:

- `encoding=INT8` with a non-`BINARY` property (or `encoding=FLOAT32` with a `BINARY` property) — the property type and encoding must agree.
- `encoding=INT8` combined with `quantization=INT8` — redundant: the property is already byte-quantized at the wire level, so the index-internal scalar quantizer would re-quantize the dequantized floats. Pick one (`encoding=INT8` for payload/storage savings, `quantization=INT8` for index-internal compression), not both.

When a Cohere-style int8 source is **not** the origin of the bytes, note that Java's `byte` range `[-128,`

127] includes a value the Cohere/OpenAI calibration never emits. The dequantizer clamps -128 up to -127 to keep the result inside [-1, 1] for COSINE; a one-time WARNING is logged the first time a -128 byte is encountered in a process so operators can investigate non-conforming sources.

### 6.4.7. Store Embeddings in an EXTERNAL Property

A vector embedding is typically the largest field on a record — a FLOAT32 1,536-dim embedding alone weighs 6 KB, an order of magnitude bigger than the topology (id, label, edge lists) it sits next to. Stored inline, every traversal, scan, or projection that does not touch the embedding still pages those 6 KB into the buffer cache. On a graph of a few million vertices that is enough to evict the useful topology working set long before the dataset is exhausted.

Declare the embedding property as EXTERNAL true so the bytes move to a paired **external bucket**. The main record then carries only an 8-byte pointer; the embedding is loaded lazily, on the queries that actually need it (vector search, similarity scoring, hybrid retrieval). See External property storage for the full description, including the per-bucket pairing, compression, and tiered-storage options.

```
-- FLOAT32 embedding stored in a paired external bucket.
CREATE PROPERTY Doc.embedding ARRAY_OF_FLOATS (EXTERNAL true);
CREATE INDEX ON Doc (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 1536,
  "similarity": "COSINE"
};

-- Same idea with INT8 wire/storage encoding -- still external, 4x smaller payload.
CREATE PROPERTY Doc.embedding BINARY (EXTERNAL true);
CREATE INDEX ON Doc (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 1024,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "encoding": "INT8"
};
```

When you should opt in:

- The embedding is large compared to the rest of the record (any modern dense embedding qualifies).
- Most of your workload is not vector search — graph traversals, filters by other properties, or full-record reads that project everything except the embedding all benefit immediately.
- You plan to put the heavy payload on a different volume (e.g. embeddings on bulk storage, topology on NVMe) — set arcadedb.externalPropertyBucketPath before creating the property; see Tiered storage.

When inline storage is still the right default:

- Records are tiny and the embedding is your hottest field (every query reads it). The extra

pointer lookup is a per-read cost that adds up.

- You are running a vector-only workload where every query projects `embedding`. There is nothing to save.

To migrate an existing populated type to external storage in one step, use `ALTER PROPERTY … EXTERNAL true` followed by `REBUILD TYPE`; see Migrating existing records.

### 6.4.8. Key Parameters

| Parameter | Default | Purpose |
|---|---|---|
| `dimensions` | (required) | Must match your embedding model output size |
| `similarity` | `COSINE` | Distance metric: COSINE, DOT_PRODUCT, or EUCLIDEAN |
| `encoding` | `FLOAT32` | Wire / document-storage encoding: FLOAT32 (`ARRAY_OF_FLOATS` property) or INT8 (`BINARY` property, byte per dim, 4x smaller payload). See Vector Encoding. |
| `quantization` | `NONE` | Index-internal compression: NONE, INT8, BINARY, or PRODUCT. INT8 is recommended for most use cases. |
| `efSearch` | adaptive | Search beam width at query time. Controls recall vs speed trade-off. See efSearch and Adaptive Search. |
| `maxConnections` | 32 | Graph connections per node, per layer (Vamana degree). Higher = better recall, more memory. This is **not** doubled at the base layer like hnswlib's `M`: to match an hnswlib `M`, set `maxConnections = 2 * M`. See note below. |
| `beamWidth` | 100 | Search depth during build. Higher = better index quality, slower builds |
| `addHierarchy` | false | Enable multi-layer HNSW for large/complex datasets |
| `storeVectorsInGraph` | false | Co-locate vectors in graph file for faster retrieval at large scale |
| `buildGraphNow` | true | Build the HNSW graph immediately at index creation time. Set to `false` for deferred (lazy) building on first search. |

A rebuild of the graph is always a full one — there is no incremental update, so any rebuild reindexes every vector currently in the index, not just the ones written since the last build. `close()` normally rebuilds and persists the graph before shutting down, so a later reopen finds a ready-to-search graph rather than rebuilding on first open. For an index of 1,000 vectors or more (the same threshold

efSearch's adaptive strategy and mutation-triggered rebuilds use), a session that closes with unpersisted writes pending instead defers that rebuild rather than blocking `close()` on it: the vectors themselves are already durably persisted independently of the graph, so nothing is lost, but the graph's on-disk topology is left stale or absent. The deferred rebuild then runs the next time that index is actually searched, after any reopen. A session that closes and never searches the index again pays nothing at all. Below 1,000 vectors, `close()` keeps rebuilding synchronously as before.

Since v26.9.1 that first query after a reopen does not wait for the rebuild. If the persisted graph is behind only because vectors were added after it was last built — and ArcadeDB can verify on disk that the graph still describes exactly the records it was built from — the graph is put straight back to work and only the missing vectors are searched separately, while the full rebuild runs in the background. Results are complete from the first query: a vector written after the last build is found whether it is already in the graph or still waiting to be folded into it. This applies to any session, including one that inserts before it searches, which before v26.9.1 was the one shape that still paid for a full rebuild on the querying thread.

Before v26.10.1, deleting a single vector forced a full graph rebuild on the first query after the next restart, however large the index. Updating a vector did the same, because an update is a delete followed by an insert. The reason was that what each node of the persisted graph stood for was worked out again on every open, from the list of vectors as it then stood — and a delete shifts that list, so the graph and the list no longer agreed. Several large indexes reopening together could therefore rebuild at the same time and exhaust the heap.

Since v26.10.1 the graph records what its nodes stand for, in a small file stored beside it, so nothing has to be worked out again and nothing has to be rebuilt. A deleted vector becomes a node that searches skip — which they already did correctly while the database stayed open; only restarts were affected. Those skipped nodes are removed later by the ordinary background rebuild, on the schedule and within the memory limits it already uses, rather than all at once on whichever query happens to run first.

Existing indexes rebuild once on their first open after the upgrade, write the new file, and are covered from then on. Nothing needs to be run by hand. Searches return the same results either way.

Indexes using `PRODUCT` quantization are the exception and still rebuild after a deletion, because their compressed vectors are tied to the same node numbering the rebuild reassigns.

`vectorIndex.maxConcurrentRebuilds` (1 by default) limits how many vector index graphs are rebuilt at the same time anywhere in the JVM, because concurrent rebuilds are what exhaust the heap. Before v26.10.1 that limit covered only the rebuilds ArcadeDB started in the background. A rebuild that a **query** had to run

itself, because the index had no usable graph on disk, ignored it entirely — and that is the rebuild every index of a database runs at once, on the first query to reach each of them after a restart. A cluster that reopened eight large indexes this way filled its heap and had its nodes restarted under it.

Since v26.10.1 such a query waits its turn like any other rebuild. The first query to need a graph of 1,000 vectors or more takes one of the `maxConcurrentRebuilds` slots and holds it for the build; the others wait, and answer as soon as a slot frees. Smaller indexes are exempt and keep building immediately, since they cannot threaten the heap and would only be delayed by whatever larger rebuild is running. Before the build starts, the page cache is asked to give up whatever heap the build needs, the same way a background rebuild does.

That exemption is itself bounded, from v26.10.1 on. "Too small to matter" describes one rebuild and says nothing about how many run at once, so a database of hundreds of small vector indexes reopening together used to start one rebuild per index with nothing limiting them. Exempt rebuilds now draw on a shared allowance of 1,000 vectors per `maxConcurrentRebuilds` slot: while the allowance lasts they keep building immediately, and once it is spent the next one waits for a slot like a large rebuild, because together they have become one. A thousand indexes of a few vectors each therefore still cost nothing, while a handful close to the 1,000-vector line already count. The counter `smallRebuildsOverBudget` in the index statistics reports how often a small rebuild had to wait for this reason — distinct from `searchRebuildsQueuedForPermit`, which says some **other** index was holding the slot.

A query is never **refused** a rebuild, only delayed by one: with no graph there is nothing to search, so refusing would return an empty result set rather than a slow one. If no slot frees within `vectorIndex.rebuildPermitTimeoutMs` (ten minutes by default), the query builds anyway and logs a warning, because by then the slot is being held by a rebuild that is stuck rather than slow.

Since v26.11.1 that wait no longer outlives the query. A vector search — `vector.neighbors()` in SQL, `db.index.vector.queryNodes` in Cypher, `select().nearestTo()` in the Java API — stops within a fraction of a second when its statement is cancelled (a client that disconnects, a gRPC deadline, a query terminated from the running queries list) or reaches its timeout (`arcadedb.command.timeout`, a SQL `TIMEOUT` clause, `Select.timeout()`), whether it is waiting for a slot, waiting for a build another query started, or walking the graph. It fails with the usual timeout or termination error. The build itself is not abandoned: it runs in the background, keeps its slot until it finishes, and the next search uses the graph it publishes. A command timeout shorter than the build therefore delays the first successful search on that index until the build completes, but never prevents it.

The counters `searchRebuildsQueuedForPermit` and `searchRebuildsWithoutPermit` in the index statistics report how often each happened. Persisting the graph before a restart — a clean `close()`, or `REBUILD INDEX` — avoids the whole situation: there is then nothing to rebuild on the first query.

A transaction that fails and is rolled back — most often with a concurrent-modification error, when two transactions write the same record — leaves the vector index exactly as it was. Before v26.10.1 it did not: the index had already applied the change in memory by the time the conflict was detected, and the rollback did not take it back. The index was then left holding a deletion marker for an embedding that was never replaced, so it believed vectors had been deleted and scheduled a full graph rebuild. On a busy index, retried transactions alone were enough to cause rebuild after rebuild, with no deletes anywhere in the application.

Note also that rewriting a vector property with a value identical to the stored one never marks anything deleted: ArcadeDB compares the two embeddings and skips the index when they are equal. Avoiding redundant writes in your application therefore does not reduce rebuilds; reducing write conflicts does.

Sparse vector indexes (`LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR`) had the same defect, with a different symptom, and it is fixed in the same release. A rolled-back insert could leave its entries searchable, and a rolled-back delete or embedding rewrite could leave deletion markers behind — which is the damaging half, because a marker on any dimension hides the whole document from every query mentioning that dimension, so a live document nobody deleted silently stopped being found. Neither was temporary: the index writes its in-memory entries out to disk on its own schedule, so a rolled-back transaction's work could be made permanent. Since v26.10.1 a sparse vector index holds the entries of a transaction back until the transaction has actually committed, so a rollback has nothing to undo.

Searching a vector index from inside an open transaction is safe: what the index keeps afterwards is built only from committed data.

Before v26.10.1 it was not. A search can trigger a rebuild of the index graph, and when that happened inside a transaction the rebuild read the embeddings through that transaction — so values written but not yet committed were baked into the index. A rollback took the records back but not the index, which was then left describing a row by an embedding the database does not hold: searching for that embedding returned the row, searching for its real one did not. Rolled-back inserts could be left in the index the same way. The damage was permanent for the life of the database, and survived a reopen and a backup for indexes storing their vectors in the graph file.

Since v26.10.1 a search issued inside a transaction also finds the rows that transaction has written but not yet committed, for both dense (`LSM_VECTOR`) and sparse (`LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR`) indexes. You can insert or re-embed rows and search them in the same unit of work.

Before that, you could not. Writes reach the index only when the transaction commits, so a search issued before that simply did not see them — and it did not report an error either: it returned **fewer** results, which an application cannot tell apart from "nothing matched". Full-text indexes have always merged their own transaction's writes this way; vector indexes now do too.

The two guarantees hold together: what the search **returns** includes your uncommitted rows, while what the index **stores** is still built only from committed data. Roll the transaction back and both the rows and their embeddings are gone, with nothing left behind in the index.

A related fix in the same release covers re-embedding: rewriting one record's embedding several times inside a single transaction now leaves the index holding the **last** value written. Previously every rewrite was kept, so the record could be ranked by an embedding it no longer had, and one search could return it more than once.

Vectors written since the last rebuild are searched by scanning them one by one, so that part of a query grows with how many are waiting, while the graph search it supplements grows only with the logarithm of the index size. Before v26.9.1 nothing bounded that scan: the settings that decide when to rebuild are all counted in mutations, and `vectorIndex.maxPendingMutations` is a fixed number, so from 250,000 vectors upward the same scan cost landed on an index of any size. On a 200,000-vector index at that ceiling the scan was about four fifths of query time.

Since v26.9.1 a rebuild is also triggered when the scan grows past what the graph search itself costs — measured, from the nodes searches actually visit, not estimated — and once those scans have cost as much as the rebuild will. The second condition is what keeps the first affordable: the extra rebuild work this can introduce is bounded by the query work it removes. Because it is evaluated when queries run, a write-only workload is unaffected and keeps the existing rebuild schedule.

If you are upgrading a deployment that both writes and queries heavily, expect more background rebuild activity than before — that is the fix doing its job, and it is the same deployment that was paying for the scan. Set `vectorIndex.maxDeltaScanRatio` to 0 to restore the previous behaviour exactly, lower it to keep queries faster at the cost of more rebuilds, or raise it for the opposite trade.

Since v26.9.1, opening a database does not read a vector index at all. Both structures the index keeps in memory — the graph and the map of where each vector lives — are built the first time something actually uses that index: a search, an insert, a count. Before this, every open rebuilt the location map by reading through every page of every `LSM_VECTOR` index, which took time proportional to the number of indexed vectors (around 1.4 seconds for 10 million) and was paid again on each open, even by a process that only opened the database to write one document or to read an unrelated type.

Results, counts and stats are unchanged — only the timing is. The first operation that touches an index pays the load once; on a session that searches, that was already the smaller half of the work, since loading or rebuilding the graph dominates it. A session that never touches a vector index never pays for it.

Since v26.10.1, the first search after a reopen no longer re-reads the document of every indexed vector to rebuild the graph's ordinal map, which took about 2.8 seconds at 1 million vectors and 18 seconds at 10 million. When nothing was deleted and the persisted graph still matches the index, the map saved next to the graph is verified and reused instead. Indexes with deletions or vectors added since the graph was saved use the previous paths.

To pay the load at startup instead of on the first query, call `warmUp()` on the `LSMVectorIndex` (embedded API), or run one throwaway search. The `graphLoadsFromOrdinalMap` index stat counts how many loads took the fast path.

The location map is also where a vector index learns which vector ids are already taken, so a load that does not read every entry cannot safely give out new ones. Before v26.11.1 such a load was kept for the life of the process anyway, and the inserts that followed could take ids that unread entries already held: two records then shared one vector id, and one of them dropped out of search results (`CHECK DATABASE` reports it as a vector id that a load gives to another record).

Since v26.11.1 a load stopped from outside — an `OutOfMemoryError`, an interrupted thread, a database closing under it — is discarded and done again on the next access. A load that finds a page it cannot read keeps serving searches from what it read, logs a `SEVERE` message, and refuses new vectors (an insert, or an update that changes a vector) until the index is rebuilt; deleting stays possible. `CHECK DATABASE` lists such an index among the corrupted ones, so `CHECK DATABASE FIX` (or `REBUILD INDEX <name>`) rebuilds it and lifts the refusal.

### 6.4.9. efSearch and Adaptive Search

The `efSearch` parameter controls how many candidate nodes the search explores in the vector graph. Higher values find more accurate results but take longer.

When `efSearch` is not explicitly set (either on the index or per-query), ArcadeDB uses an **adaptive two-pass strategy**:

1. **First pass** — Uses a moderate beam width (`2 x k`), which is sufficient for most queries on well-clustered data.
2. **Second pass** — If the first pass returns insufficient results, the search automatically widens the beam to `10 x k`.

For small indexes (< 10K vectors), the full default efSearch is always used since the cost is negligible.

This adaptive behavior gives you fast queries on easy lookups while still maintaining recall on harder queries — without requiring any tuning.

#### Setting efSearch

You can set efSearch at three levels:

**Per-query** (highest priority) — pass as the 4th argument to `vector.neighbors()`, either positionally

or via the named options map:

```
-- Higher efSearch for a critical query that needs maximum recall (positional)
SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Doc[embedding]', [...], 10, 500))

-- Lower efSearch for a latency-sensitive query (positional)
SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Doc[embedding]', [...], 10, 30))

-- Options map form (extensible; also supports `filter`)
SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Doc[embedding]', [...], 10, { efSearch: 500 }))
```

**Per-index** — set in the index metadata at creation time:

```
CREATE INDEX ON Doc (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  dimensions: 1024,
  similarity: 'COSINE',
  efSearch: 200
}
```

**Adaptive** (default) — when neither per-query nor per-index efSearch is specified, the adaptive strategy described above is used.

For most workloads, the adaptive default works well. Only set efSearch explicitly if you need consistently high recall regardless of query difficulty, or if you have strict latency requirements.

### 6.4.10. Filtered Search

Vector search can be combined with a logical filter on the same type by passing a `filter` option containing the allowed RIDs. The HNSW traversal restricts itself to that set, so non-matching vectors are skipped without decoding.

```
-- Find the 10 most similar documents within a specific tenant and category
SELECT vector.neighbors(
         'Document[embedding]',
         :queryVector,
         10,
         { filter: (SELECT @rid FROM Document WHERE tenantId = 'acme' AND category =
'finance') }
       )
```

The `filter` value accepts a list of RIDs, RID strings, or any `Identifiable`. It can be produced by a subquery, a query parameter, or built programmatically. A subquery may project the RID (`SELECT @rid FROM …`), the whole record (`SELECT FROM …`), or a list of RIDs that is flattened one level (`(SELECT list(@rid) AS l FROM …).l`); a `LET` variable bound to such a subquery works the same way (v26.10.1). Projecting anything that is not a RID raises an error rather than silently filtering nothing.

A `filter` narrower than `vectorIndex.prefilterMaxSelectivity` (20% of the index's live vectors by default) bypasses the HNSW walk automatically: ArcadeDB scores the filtered candidates directly instead, which gets faster as the filter narrows rather than slower. Above that threshold, a selective filter can still starve the beam trying to fill `k` from a narrower-than-expected pool; combine `filter` with a higher `efSearch` to preserve recall in that range, or lower `vectorIndex.prefilterMaxSelectivity` to route more filters through the direct-scoring path. See Settings Reference.

**Partition-aware filterable HNSW**

When the type uses `partitioned(<key>)` as its bucket selection strategy and the query's `WHERE` clause binds the partition key to a literal, the planner narrows `vector.neighbors` / `vector.sparseNeighbors` to a single per-bucket HNSW graph automatically — no `filter` option needed:

```
SELECT vector.neighbors('Document[embedding]', :queryVector, 10) AS neighbors
  FROM Document
 WHERE tenant_id = 'acme'
```

With the partition strategy in place, this query touches only `tenant_id = 'acme'`s HNSW graph instead of fanning out across every bucket. The optimisation kicks in transparently for both dense (`vector.neighbors`) and sparse (`vector.sparseNeighbors`) search and composes with explicit `filter` lists when both are present.

The two approaches are complementary:

- `partitioned(<key>)` + a `WHERE` predicate on the key prunes the **bucket set** before the HNSW traversal even starts. Best for high-cardinality scope keys (tenant, customer, region) where every query naturally carries the predicate.
- `filter: (SELECT @rid ⋯)` prunes **individual RIDs** during the HNSW traversal. Best for low-cardinality or query-shaped filters that don't map cleanly onto a partition key.

For the multi-tenant SaaS case, partition-aware HNSW is usually the right primitive. See Schema design 101: choosing a bucket strategy for picking the partition key.

### 6.4.11. Multi-Modal Search

A single vertex type can have multiple vector indexes on different properties:

```
CREATE INDEX ON Product (imageEmbedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {dimensions: 512,
similarity: 'COSINE'}
CREATE INDEX ON Product (textEmbedding)  LSM_VECTOR METADATA {dimensions: 768,
similarity: 'COSINE'}
```

Query each index independently to search by image similarity, text similarity, or combine scores.

### 6.4.12. Integration with Other Models

Vector search combines naturally with ArcadeDB's other data models:

- **Graph + Vectors** — Find similar items, then traverse relationships to discover connected context (Graph RAG pattern)
- **Full-text + Vectors** — Hybrid search combining keyword matching with semantic similarity (Knowledge Graph pattern)
- **Time Series + Vectors** — Detect behavioral anomalies by comparing embedding patterns over time (Fraud Detection pattern)

### 6.4.13. SQL Example

Create a vector index and query it:

```
-- Create vertex type and property
CREATE VERTEX TYPE Document;
CREATE PROPERTY Document.content STRING;
CREATE PROPERTY Document.embedding ARRAY_OF_FLOATS;

-- Create vector index with 384 dimensions using COSINE similarity
CREATE INDEX ON Document (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  dimensions: 384,
  similarity: 'COSINE'
};

-- Query for the 10 nearest documents
-- Returns rows with .record (full document) and .distance (0 = identical for COSINE)
SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Document[embedding]', $queryVector, 10))
```

### 6.4.14. Java Example

Create and query a vector index programmatically:

```
import com.arcadedb.index.lsm.LSMVectorIndex;
import com.arcadedb.index.lsm.LSMVectorIndexBuilder;
import com.arcadedb.index.vector.VectorSimilarityFunction;

// Create index programmatically
final LSMVectorIndexBuilder builder = new LSMVectorIndexBuilder(
    database,
    "Document",
    new String[]{"embedding"})
    .withDimensions(384)
    .withSimilarity(VectorSimilarityFunction.COSINE)
    .withMaxConnections(16)
    .withBeamWidth(100);
```

```
final LSMVectorIndex index = builder.create();

// Query the index using SQL
final ResultSet resultSet = database.query("sql",
    "SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Document[embedding]', ?, 10))",
    queryVector);
```

### 6.4.15. Configuration Parameters

When creating LSMVectorIndex instances, the following parameters can be configured:

- `dimensions`: The dimensionality of the vectors (must match your embedding model output)
- `similarity`: The distance function for similarity calculation (COSINE, DOT_PRODUCT, EUCLIDEAN, etc.)
- `maxConnections`: Maximum number of graph connections per node, per layer (default: 32, increase for better recall)
- `beamWidth`: Beam width for approximate nearest neighbor search (default: 100, increase for more accurate results)

`maxConnections` is the Vamana per-layer graph degree used by the underlying engine. It is applied to every layer, **including the base layer** — it is **not** doubled at the base layer the way hnswlib (used by Chroma and most HNSW tools) treats its `M` parameter, which allocates `2*M` links at the base layer.

If you are porting a configuration from an hnswlib-based system, set `maxConnections = 2 * M` to get the same graph density (for example, hnswlib `M=16` corresponds to `maxConnections=32`). Leaving it at half the intended value silently halves base-layer density and lowers recall. The default was raised from 16 to 32 to match hnswlib `M=16` out of the box; the extra density costs proportionally more build-time heap.

### 6.4.16. Supported Similarity Functions

| Measure | Name | Type |
|---|---|---|
| `COSINE` | Cosine Similarity | $L_2$ |
| `DOT_PRODUCT` | Inner Product | $L_2$ |
| `EUCLIDEAN` | Euclidean Distance | $L_2$ |

For more information on vector embeddings, see the Vector Embeddings section.

### 6.4.17. Sparse Vector Search

In addition to dense embeddings, ArcadeDB supports **sparse** vector retrieval via the `LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR` index. Sparse vectors carry only the non-zero dimensions of a high-dimensional space and are produced by learned-sparse retrieval models such as SPLADE, BGE-M3, OpenSearch's

opensearch-neural-sparse-encoding-multilingual-v1, and BM25-as-sparse-vector pipelines.

Looking for BM25 keyword ranking? That is provided by the FULL_TEXT index, which uses BM25 by default, see BM25 at a glance. Fuse both with dense vectors using vector.fuse.

Sparse retrieval excels where dense embeddings collapse semantically distinct queries into the same point ("freeze card after theft" vs "unfreeze card after travel"), because the per-token weights expose the discriminating terms directly.

### Storage layout

The index uses a posting-list inverted structure on the LSM-Tree backbone with composite key (int dim_id, RID rid, float weight). It inherits ACID transactions, WAL, replication, and compaction from the LSM-Tree, just like every other ArcadeDB index. Per-document data lives in two parallel array properties:

- an ARRAY_OF_INTEGERS of non-zero dimension ids, and
- an ARRAY_OF_FLOATS of the matching weights.

Both arrays must have the same length on every record. Weights must be non-negative; negative weights would corrupt the per-term upper bound used to prune during retrieval and are rejected at write time. All standard sparse models (BM25, SPLADE, BGE-M3, Cohere sparse) emit non-negative weights, so this is not a real constraint in practice.

### Schema setup

```
CREATE DOCUMENT TYPE Doc;
CREATE PROPERTY Doc.tokens  ARRAY_OF_INTEGERS;
CREATE PROPERTY Doc.weights ARRAY_OF_FLOATS;

-- LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR index. `dimensions` declares the vocabulary cap (0 = open-ended).
-- `modifier: 'IDF'` enables Robertson-Sparck-Jones IDF weighting at query time.
CREATE INDEX ON Doc (tokens, weights) LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR
  METADATA { "dimensions": 105000, "modifier": "IDF" };
```

### Querying

Use vector.sparseNeighbors to retrieve top-K records by sparse dot product:

```
SELECT expand(`vector.sparseNeighbors`(
    'Doc[tokens,weights]',
    :queryIndices, :queryValues,
    50
))
```

Options map (5th argument) supports filter (allowed-RIDs whitelist), groupBy, groupSize — see

Group-By Retrieval below.

### Top-K algorithm

Retrieval uses document-at-a-time Block-Max MaxScore. Query terms are split into an **essential** set and a **non-essential** one: a document matching only non-essential terms cannot reach the current K-th best score, so those terms stop generating candidates and are only point-probed for documents the essential terms produce. Per-block maximum weights then let whole ranges of postings be skipped without decoding them. Only dot-product similarity is supported (cosine on sparse vectors is conventionally handled by L2-normalizing both the query and stored vectors at insert time).

Earlier releases used pivot-based WAND. It was replaced because learned-sparse queries carry many terms with relatively flat weights, which keeps every term in the traversal and ends up decoding nearly every block. MaxScore prunes on the term side instead, which is the dimension that discriminates on this kind of data.

Large indexes additionally split a query across RID ranges scored in parallel, which is exact — it changes latency, not results.

Posting-weight quantization is configurable via the `weightQuantization` index `METADATA` key (`INT8` — the default — `FP16`, or `FP32`), trading index size against the precision of the stored weights. Since v26.10.1 the quantized weights only select candidates: a search rescores `k * rescoreOversample` of them exactly from the records' own weights (default `2` for `INT8` and `FP16`), so the returned ranking and scores are exact and do not depend on how the data was committed or compacted. See `CREATE INDEX` for the values and their trade-offs.

### Segment compaction and deletes

Sealed segments are merged in the background by a size-tiered policy: segments of comparable posting count that sit next to each other in write order are merged into one, which keeps the per-query merge fan-in bounded without rewriting the whole index on every flush.

A delete is recorded as a **tombstone** in the segment that is current when it happens, not in the segment holding the posting it removes, so which of two segments is newer is what decides whether a document is visible. Compaction preserves that order: a merged segment takes the position of its newest input rather than moving to the front, and a partial merge only ever takes segments that are adjacent in write order.

Since v26.9.1 a query validates the segment data it reads as it goes. A damaged segment is reported as an error naming the index and segment rather than silently producing wrong results; the fix is `REBUILD INDEX` on the named index.

Databases created before v26.9.1 may hold sparse-vector segments that were merged under the previous ordering, which could let a partial compaction outrank the segment holding a tombstone and make a deleted document reappear in `vector.sparseNeighbors` results (issue #6379). Upgrading fixes the ordering for all new merges, but a segment already written under the old rule cannot be repaired automatically — the information about where it should have sat is gone.

The server identifies such segments when the index is opened and logs a warning naming the index and the `REBUILD INDEX` to run. The marker is stored in the segment and inherited by any later merge, so it survives the affected segments being compacted away by ordinary write traffic. If a database predates v26.9.1 and its sparse-vector index has seen deletes or updates, run once per affected index:

```
REBUILD INDEX `Doc[tokens,weights]`
```

This collapses the existing segments into a single correctly ordered segment. Indexes that have only ever been appended to are unaffected.

Since v26.9.1, this is also queryable at any time, not only visible as a one-time log line at startup: `schema:indexes` (and Studio's index view) report the affected index in `upgradeWarning`, and its stats include an `untrustedSegments` count:

```
SELECT name, upgradeWarning FROM schema:indexes WHERE upgradeWarning IS
NOT NULL

SELECT untrustedSegments FROM (SELECT expand(stats) FROM schema:indexes
WHERE name = 'Doc[tokens,weights]')
```

`untrustedSegments` drops back to `0` once `REBUILD INDEX` has been run, so it can also be used to confirm the fix took effect.

### 6.4.18. Hybrid Search with `vector.fuse`

`vector.fuse` combines two or more ranked sub-pipelines into a single ranked top-K, server-side, in one query. It generalises the dense+sparse hybrid pattern but works with any source that yields `(@rid, $score)` rows: dense `vector.neighbors`, sparse `vector.sparseNeighbors`, full-text `SEARCH_INDEX`, or any plain `SELECT … ORDER BY … LIMIT N`.

```
SELECT expand(`vector.fuse`(
    `vector.neighbors`('Doc[dense]', :denseVec, 50),
    `vector.sparseNeighbors`('Doc[tokens,weights]', :qIdx, :qVal, 50),
    { fusion: 'RRF', groupBy: 'source_file', groupSize: 1 }
)) LIMIT 10
```

#### Fusion strategies

`vector.fuse` supports three strategies via the `fusion` option:

| Strategy | When to use |
|---|---|
| `RRF` (default) | Reciprocal Rank Fusion. `score = sum_i weight_i / (k + rank_i)`. Rank-only, indifferent to score scales — best when sources have wildly different score distributions (e.g. cosine in [-1, 1] plus BM25 in [0, +inf)). Default `k = 60`. |

| Strategy | When to use |
|---|---|
| DBSF | Distribution-Based Score Fusion (Qdrant 1.11+). Per-source scores normalised to [mean - 3sigma, mean + 3sigma], then weighted sum. Useful when sources produce comparable, roughly Gaussian distributions and you want score magnitude (not just rank) to influence fusion. |
| LINEAR | Per-source min-max normalisation, then weighted sum. Use when you have already-tuned weights from offline relevance experiments. Requires every source row to carry a numeric score. |

`vector.fuse` assumes "higher = better" for every source. It auto-flips the `distance` field exposed by `vector.neighbors` to a similarity at extract time so dense and sparse sources fuse without manual rescaling. If you build a custom source via `SELECT @rid, <expr> AS score FROM …`, expose `score` with similarity semantics for `LINEAR` and `DBSF` to behave correctly. `RRF` is rank-only so it tolerates either convention.

#### Weighted fusion

Per-source weights tilt the fused ranking:

```
-- Dense matters 3x more than sparse for this corpus.
SELECT expand(`vector.fuse`(
    `vector.neighbors`('Doc[dense]', :denseVec, 50),
    `vector.sparseNeighbors`('Doc[tokens,weights]', :qIdx, :qVal, 50),
    { fusion: 'RRF', weights: [3.0, 1.0] }
)) LIMIT 10
```

#### Three-way fusion (dense + sparse + full-text)

```
SELECT expand(`vector.fuse`(
    `vector.neighbors`('Doc[dense]', :denseVec, 100),
    `vector.sparseNeighbors`('Doc[tokens,weights]', :qIdx, :qVal, 100),
    (SELECT @rid, $score FROM Doc WHERE SEARCH_INDEX('Doc[content]', :keywords) =
true),
    { fusion: 'RRF', k: 60 }
)) LIMIT 10
```

#### Outer composition

The fused output is itself a result set, so it composes with outer `WHERE`, `ORDER BY`, `LIMIT`, joins, and projections:

```
-- Score threshold + projection.
SELECT title, source_file, score
FROM (
  SELECT expand(`vector.fuse`(
      `vector.neighbors`('Doc[dense]', :denseVec, 50),
```

```
      `vector.sparseNeighbors`('Doc[tokens,weights]', :qIdx, :qVal, 50),
      { fusion: 'RRF' }
  ))
)
WHERE score >= 0.02
ORDER BY score DESC
LIMIT 10
```

### 6.4.19. Group-By Retrieval

`vector.neighbors`, `vector.sparseNeighbors`, and `vector.fuse` all accept `groupBy` and `groupSize` options for diversification at retrieval time, mirroring Qdrant's `query_points_groups` semantics. Common pattern: best chunk per source document, deduped at the index level rather than over-fetched and post-partitioned in the application.

```
-- Top 10 distinct source files, best matching chunk from each.
SELECT expand(`vector.neighbors`(
    'Doc[embedding]', :queryVec, 10,
    { groupBy: 'source_file', groupSize: 1 }
))
```

The third positional argument (`limit` / `k`) becomes the **max number of distinct groups** when `groupBy` is set. Total returned rows are bounded by `limit * groupSize`. `groupSize` defaults to `1`.

`groupBy` accepts dotted nested-field paths — `metadata.author`, `provenance.source.id`, etc. Each segment after the first descends one level via `Map`-typed properties or embedded documents; a missing segment lands the row in the `null` group.

`groupBy` composes with the existing `filter` option:

```
SELECT expand(`vector.neighbors`(
    'Doc[embedding]', :queryVec, 10,
    { filter: [#5:0, #5:1, #5:2], groupBy: 'source_file', groupSize: 1 }
))
```

Grouping is integrated into the index traversal proper, not applied as a post-filter on an over-fetched candidate pool:

- **Sparse** (`vector.sparseNeighbors`) — the Block-Max MaxScore loop runs with a per-group min-heap. A new group opens only while the heap holds fewer than `limit` distinct keys; within each group, a candidate replaces the group's worst member when its score is higher. The pruning threshold tightens to the global per-group worst score once every group has reached `groupSize`, so whole posting-list regions that cannot beat any group's current worst member are skipped. `allowedRIDs` is applied inline — no over-fetch. When a group only earns its place after some of its members were already passed over, a second pass restricted to that group fills it, so every returned group holds its `groupSize` best members.
- **Dense** (`vector.neighbors`) — the HNSW traversal admits on liveness (and, with `filter`, allow-list

membership) only; the group cap is applied afterward to the walk's score-ordered output, so the `groupSize` members kept per group are genuinely its best and the `limit` groups kept are genuinely the nearest (an earlier design gated group membership inside the traversal's `Bits` filter, but `Bits` is score-blind, so groups were admitted in visit order and the truly nearest group could be locked out of its own answer — this was replaced by the current score-ordered cap). The search budget is sized to `limit * groupSize`, and the walk resumes automatically — no re-query needed — while more distinct groups are still wanted and the graph has more to give; raise `efSearch` for wider coverage if a query still comes up short of `limit` groups. When `filter` is present and narrower than `vectorIndex.prefilterMaxSelectivity` (20% of the index by default), the HNSW walk is skipped entirely: the filtered candidates are scored directly and the same group cap applied to that output.

The answer is always the `limit` groups whose best member ranks highest, each with its `groupSize` best members. This also holds for a type with several buckets (each bucket is searched separately and a bucket is asked again for the members of a winning group it did not return) and inside a transaction, where the answer includes the transaction's own uncommitted records exactly as it will after the commit.

Pathological combinations of `limit` and `groupSize` (e.g. `limit=1000, groupSize=1000` would size a per-group state past the cap) are still rejected with an explicit `over-fetch budget exceeded` error to bound memory.

### 6.4.20. Further Reading

- Vector Search Tutorial — Step-by-step hands-on guide
- Vector Embeddings How-To — Index creation, tuning, and best practices
- Java Vector API — Programmatic vector index management
- SQL Vector Functions — All 40+ vector SQL functions
- Sparse Vector Search and Hybrid Search with `vector.fuse` — This section

## 6.5. Geospatial Index

ArcadeDB's geospatial index enables spatial queries directly from SQL using the `geo.*` function namespace. Geometries are stored as Well-Known Text (WKT) strings in regular `STRING` properties — no special column type is required.

The index is built on ArcadeDB's LSM-Tree storage engine, which means ACID guarantees, write-ahead logging, high availability replication, and automatic compaction all apply without any extra configuration. Internally, the index decomposes each geometry into GeoHash tokens using a `RecursivePrefixTreeStrategy`, stores each token in the underlying LSM-Tree, and applies an exact Spatial4j predicate as a post-filter when queries are evaluated.

### 6.5.1. Creating a Geospatial Index

Create a `STRING` property, then add a `GEOSPATIAL` index to it:

```
CREATE VERTEX TYPE Location
CREATE PROPERTY Location.coords STRING
CREATE INDEX ON Location (coords) GEOSPATIAL
```

The index type keyword is `GEOSPATIAL`. Only `STRING` properties are supported (WKT values are stored as strings).

#### Configuring Precision

The precision level controls the GeoHash grid resolution used to decompose geometries. Higher precision means more tokens per geometry, finer resolution, and a larger index.

```
CREATE INDEX ON Location (coords) GEOSPATIAL
  METADATA { "precision": 9 }
```

| Precision | Cell size (approx.) | Typical use |
|---|---|---|
| 5 | ~4.9 km × 4.9 km | Country / region level |
| 7 | ~153 m × 153 m | City / neighborhood level |
| 9 | ~4.8 m × 4.8 m | Street-address precision |
| 11 (default) | ~2.4 m × 2.4 m | High precision — building footprints, GPS tracks |

Changing precision after data has been indexed requires rebuilding the index with `REBUILD INDEX`.

### 6.5.2. Inserting Geometries

Store any valid WKT string in the indexed property. Pass it as a plain string literal or use the `geo.asText()` function to convert a geometry object back to WKT:

```
-- Insert a point by WKT literal
INSERT INTO Location SET name = 'Eiffel Tower', coords = 'POINT(2.2945 48.8584)'

-- Insert a polygon by WKT literal
INSERT INTO Location SET name = 'Paris Centre', coords =
  'POLYGON((2.2945 48.8584, 2.3522 48.8566, 2.3488 48.8791, 2.2945 48.8584))'

-- Use geo.asText() to store a constructed geometry
INSERT INTO Location SET name = 'Arc de Triomphe',
  coords = geo.asText(geo.point(2.2950, 48.8738))
```

Records with null or unparsable WKT values in the indexed property are silently skipped during indexing.

### 6.5.3. Querying with Spatial Predicates

Use any `geo.*` predicate in a `WHERE` clause. When a geospatial index exists on the referenced field, the query planner automatically uses it — no hint or special syntax is required.

```
-- All locations within a bounding polygon
SELECT name FROM Location
WHERE geo.within(coords, geo.geomFromText('POLYGON((2.28 48.85, 2.40 48.85, 2.40
48.89, 2.28 48.89, 2.28 48.85))')) = true

-- All locations that intersect a line
SELECT name FROM Location
WHERE geo.intersects(coords, geo.geomFromText('LINESTRING(2.29 48.85, 2.35 48.87)')) =
true

-- All locations within 500 m of a point (full-scan fallback — see note)
SELECT name FROM Location
WHERE geo.dWithin(coords, geo.geomFromText('POINT(2.2945 48.8584)'), 0.0045) = true
```

`geo.dWithin` and `geo.disjoint` always perform a full scan because their semantics cannot be efficiently mapped to the GeoHash candidate set. All other predicates use the geospatial index automatically.

### 6.5.4. How Index-Accelerated Queries Work

1. The SQL query planner detects a spatial predicate function implementing `IndexableSQLFunction` in the `WHERE` clause.
2. It calls `allowsIndexedExecution()`, which returns `true` when the first argument is a bare field reference and a `GEOSPATIAL` index exists on that field.
3. The index decomposes the query shape into GeoHash cells and looks up candidate record IDs in the LSM-Tree.
4. The predicate function's exact Spatial4j implementation post-filters the candidates to remove false positives (GeoHash cells are rectangular approximations).

The result is correct — the index is a superset filter, and the exact predicate is always applied afterward.

### 6.5.5. geo.* Functions Reference

Geospatial functions are organised into two groups: **constructor / accessor functions** (pure computation, no index) and **spatial predicate functions** (used in `WHERE` clauses, index-accelerated where possible).

All functions accept either WKT strings or geometry objects produced by other `geo.*` functions. All predicate functions return `null` when either argument is `null` (SQL three-valued logic).

#### Constructor and Accessor Functions

#### geo.geomFromText()

Parses any WKT string into a geometry object that can be passed to other `geo.*` functions.

Syntax: `geo.geomFromText(<wkt-string>)`

```
SELECT geo.geomFromText('POINT(2.2945 48.8584)') AS geom
SELECT geo.geomFromText('POLYGON((0 0, 10 0, 10 10, 0 10, 0 0))') AS geom
```

Throws `IllegalArgumentException` for malformed WKT.

---

#### geo.point()

Creates a 2D point from longitude and latitude (or X and Y) coordinates.

Syntax: `geo.point(<x>, <y>)`

```
SELECT geo.point(2.2945, 48.8584) AS pt
```

---

#### geo.lineString()

Creates a line string from a list of points.

Syntax: `geo.lineString([<point>*])`

```
SELECT geo.lineString([geo.point(0, 0), geo.point(10, 10), geo.point(20, 0)]) AS line
```

---

#### geo.polygon()

Creates a polygon from an ordered list of points. The first and last point must be identical to close the ring.

Syntax: `geo.polygon([<point>*])`

```
SELECT geo.polygon([
  geo.point(0, 0), geo.point(10, 0),
  geo.point(10, 10), geo.point(0, 10),
  geo.point(0, 0)
]) AS poly
```

---

### geo.buffer()

Returns a new geometry that is a buffer of the given distance (in degrees) around the input geometry.

Syntax: `geo.buffer(<geometry>, <distance-in-degrees>)`

```
-- Buffer 0.01 degrees (~1.1 km) around a point
SELECT geo.buffer(geo.point(2.2945, 48.8584), 0.01) AS buffered
```

Distance is expressed in degrees. To approximate metres, divide by 111,000 (1 degree ≈ 111 km at the equator).

### geo.envelope()

Returns the minimum bounding rectangle (envelope) of a geometry as a polygon WKT.

Syntax: `geo.envelope(<geometry>)`

```
SELECT geo.envelope(geo.geomFromText('LINESTRING(0 0, 10 5, 20 0)')) AS bbox
```

### geo.distance()

Returns the distance between two points using the Haversine formula (great-circle distance).

Syntax: `geo.distance(<geometry1>, <geometry2> [, <unit>])`

The optional `unit` parameter accepts `'km'` (default) or `'m'`.

```
-- Distance in kilometres between two points on a record
SELECT geo.distance(coords, geo.geomFromText('POINT(2.3522 48.8566)')) AS dist_km
FROM Location

-- Distance in metres
SELECT geo.distance(geo.point(0, 0), geo.point(1, 1), 'm') AS dist_m
```

### geo.area()

Returns the area of a geometry in square degrees.

Syntax: `geo.area(<geometry>)`

```
SELECT geo.area(geo.geomFromText('POLYGON((0 0, 10 0, 10 10, 0 10, 0 0))')) AS area
```

#### geo.asText()

Converts a geometry object to its WKT string representation.

Syntax: `geo.asText(<geometry>)`

```
SELECT geo.asText(geo.point(2.2945, 48.8584)) AS wkt
-- Returns: 'POINT (2.2945 48.8584)'
```

#### geo.asGeoJson()

Converts a geometry object to a GeoJSON string.

Syntax: `geo.asGeoJson(<geometry>)`

```
SELECT geo.asGeoJson(geo.point(2.2945, 48.8584)) AS geojson
-- Returns: '{"type":"Point","coordinates":[2.2945,48.8584]}'
```

#### geo.x()

Extracts the X coordinate (longitude) from a point geometry.

Syntax: `geo.x(<point>)`

```
SELECT geo.x(geo.geomFromText('POINT(2.2945 48.8584)')) AS longitude
-- Returns: 2.2945
```

#### geo.y()

Extracts the Y coordinate (latitude) from a point geometry.

Syntax: `geo.y(<point>)`

```
SELECT geo.y(geo.geomFromText('POINT(2.2945 48.8584)')) AS latitude
-- Returns: 48.8584
```

### Spatial Predicate Functions

All predicate functions accept a field reference or WKT string as the first argument and a geometry (from any `geo.*` constructor) as the second. When a `GEOSPATIAL` index exists on the referenced field, the query planner uses it automatically.

| Function | Semantics | Index used? |
|---|---|---|
| `geo.within(g, shape)` | `g` is fully contained within `shape` | Yes |
| `geo.intersects(g, shape)` | `g` and `shape` share at least one point | Yes |
| `geo.contains(g, shape)` | `g` fully contains `shape` | Yes |
| `geo.equals(g, shape)` | `g` and `shape` are geometrically identical | Yes |
| `geo.crosses(g, shape)` | `g` crosses the boundary of `shape` | Yes |
| `geo.overlaps(g, shape)` | `g` and `shape` overlap (share interior but neither contains the other) | Yes |
| `geo.touches(g, shape)` | `g` touches the boundary of `shape` but interiors do not intersect | Yes |
| `geo.disjoint(g, shape)` | `g` and `shape` share no points | No — full scan |
| `geo.dWithin(g, shape, dist)` | `g` is within `dist` degrees of `shape` | No — full scan |

`geo.disjoint` cannot use the index because the index stores records that *intersect* indexed cells; records absent from the index are exactly those that are disjoint. `geo.dWithin` falls back to a full scan because correct proximity indexing requires expanding the query shape into a bounding circle first — planned as a future enhancement.

#### geo.within()

Returns `true` if the first geometry is fully within the second.

```
SELECT name FROM Location
WHERE geo.within(coords, geo.geomFromText(
  'POLYGON((2.28 48.84, 2.42 48.84, 2.42 48.90, 2.28 48.90, 2.28 48.84))'
)) = true
```

#### geo.intersects()

Returns `true` if the geometries share at least one point.

```
SELECT name FROM Location
```

```
WHERE geo.intersects(coords, geo.geomFromText('LINESTRING(0 0, 10 10)')) = true
```

#### geo.contains()

Returns `true` if the first geometry fully contains the second.

```
SELECT name FROM Zone
WHERE geo.contains(boundary, geo.geomFromText('POINT(2.2945 48.8584)')) = true
```

#### geo.dWithin()

Returns `true` if the first geometry is within the given distance (in degrees) of the second.

```
-- All locations within 0.01 degrees (~1.1 km) of the Eiffel Tower
SELECT name FROM Location
WHERE geo.dWithin(coords, geo.geomFromText('POINT(2.2945 48.8584)'), 0.01) = true
```

#### geo.disjoint()

Returns `true` if the geometries share no points.

```
SELECT name FROM Location
WHERE geo.disjoint(coords, geo.geomFromText(
  'POLYGON((0 0, 5 0, 5 5, 0 5, 0 0))'
)) = true
```

#### geo.equals()

Returns `true` if the geometries are geometrically identical.

```
SELECT * FROM Location
WHERE geo.equals(coords, geo.geomFromText('POINT(2.2945 48.8584)')) = true
```

#### geo.crosses()

Returns `true` if the geometries cross (share some but not all interior points, and the intersection is of lower dimension than the geometries).

```
SELECT name FROM Road
WHERE geo.crosses(path, geo.geomFromText('LINESTRING(0 5, 10 5)')) = true
```

#### geo.overlaps()

Returns `true` if the geometries overlap (share interior but neither contains the other).

```
SELECT name FROM Zone
WHERE geo.overlaps(boundary, geo.geomFromText(
  'POLYGON((0 0, 10 0, 10 10, 0 10, 0 0))'
)) = true
```

#### geo.touches()

Returns `true` if the geometries share boundary points but their interiors do not intersect.

```
SELECT name FROM Parcel
WHERE geo.touches(boundary, geo.geomFromText(
  'LINESTRING(0 0, 10 0)'
)) = true
```

### 6.5.6. Practical Examples

#### Points of Interest Near a Landmark

```
-- All POIs within a 500 m bounding box of the Eiffel Tower
SELECT name, coords
FROM PointOfInterest
WHERE geo.within(coords, geo.buffer(geo.point(2.2945, 48.8584), 0.0045)) = true
ORDER BY geo.distance(coords, geo.geomFromText('POINT(2.2945 48.8584)'))
LIMIT 20
```

#### Delivery Zones Containing an Address

```
SELECT zone_name, carrier
FROM DeliveryZone
WHERE geo.contains(boundary, geo.geomFromText('POINT(2.3522 48.8566)')) = true
```

#### Fleet Vehicles Inside a Geofence

```
SELECT vehicle_id, last_seen
FROM Vehicle
WHERE geo.within(last_position,
  geo.geomFromText('POLYGON((2.28 48.85, 2.42 48.85, 2.42 48.90, 2.28 48.90, 2.28
48.85))')
) = true
  AND last_seen > date('2026-01-01', 'yyyy-MM-dd')
```

#### Building Envelopes Intersecting a Road Segment

```
SELECT building_id, address
FROM Building
WHERE geo.intersects(footprint, geo.geomFromText(
  'LINESTRING(2.2900 48.8600, 2.3100 48.8700)'
)) = true
```

#### Combining Geospatial and Graph Queries

Graph traversal and spatial predicates compose naturally in the same query:

```
SELECT expand(outV())
FROM Has
WHERE geo.within(outV().location, geo.geomFromText(
  'POLYGON((2.28 48.84, 2.42 48.84, 2.42 48.90, 2.28 48.90, 2.28 48.84))'
)) = true
```

### 6.5.7. Notes and Limitations

- Geometries must be stored as WKT strings in `STRING` properties. No dedicated geometry column type is introduced; WKT is the only supported format at storage level.
- GeoJSON is not a storage format, but `geo.asGeoJson()` converts any geometry to GeoJSON for output.
- 3D geometry and raster data are not supported.
- The antimeridian and polar edge cases are handled correctly by the underlying GeoHash grid.
- Changing the precision level of an existing geospatial index requires rebuilding the index:

```
REBUILD INDEX `Location[coords]`
```

- A `GEOSPATIAL` index cannot be marked `UNIQUE`.

For related commands, see:

- `CREATE INDEX`

- `DROP INDEX`
- `REBUILD INDEX`
- Indexes

# 6.6. Full-Text Index and BM25 Ranking

ArcadeDB's full-text index is built on Apache Lucene and supports configurable analyzers, advanced Lucene query syntax, multi-property indexing, native **BM25 relevance scoring** (with tunable parameters and per-field boosts), and "More Like This" similarity search.

### BM25 at a glance

- **BM25 is the default** ranking for every newly created `FULL_TEXT` index. No configuration is needed: `ORDER BY $score DESC` returns results ranked by Okapi BM25.
- **Tunable**: `bm25_k1` (term-frequency saturation, default `1.2`) and `bm25_b` (document-length normalization, default `0.75`), see Similarity Models: BM25 and CLASSIC.
- **Per-field boosts**: weight a `title` over a `body` with `title_boost`, or boost terms at query time with the caret syntax, see Per-Field Boosts.
- **Explainable**: `EXPLAIN` and `PROFILE` show the `k1`/`b` parameters and the `df`/`idf` of every query term, see Inspecting Scores with EXPLAIN / PROFILE.
- **Hybrid retrieval**: fuse BM25 keyword relevance with dense vectors and learned-sparse vectors in a single query, and expand the graph from the fused results, see Hybrid Retrieval: Fusing BM25 with Vector Search.
- **Existing indexes** created before BM25 keep the legacy `CLASSIC` ranking until rebuilt, see Getting BM25 on Existing Indexes.

BM25 keyword ranking is a property of the `FULL_TEXT` index. It is not the same thing as the `LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR` index, which stores learned-sparse embeddings (SPLADE, BGE-M3) produced outside the database, see concepts/vector-search.pdf.

## 6.6.1. Creating a Full-Text Index

```
CREATE INDEX ON Article (content) FULL_TEXT
```

Multiple properties can be indexed together:

```
CREATE INDEX ON Article (title, body) FULL_TEXT
```

### 6.6.2. Configuring the Analyzer

Pass a `METADATA` block to choose a Lucene analyzer:

```
CREATE INDEX ON Article (content) FULL_TEXT
  METADATA {
    "analyzer": "org.apache.lucene.analysis.en.EnglishAnalyzer",
    "allowLeadingWildcard": false,
    "defaultOperator": "OR"
  }
```

#### Metadata Options

| Option | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `analyzer` | string | `org.apache.lucene.analysis.standard.StandardAnalyzer` | Lucene analyzer class used for both indexing and querying |
| `index_analyzer` | string | — | Override analyzer used only at index time |
| `query_analyzer` | string | — | Override analyzer used only at query time |
| `allowLeadingWildcard` | boolean | `false` | Allow `*term` wildcard queries |
| `defaultOperator` | `"OR"` \| `"AND"` | `"OR"` | Default operator between terms when none is specified |
| `<field>_analyzer` | string | — | Per-field analyzer override, e.g. `"title_analyzer"` |
| `similarity` | `"BM25"` \| `"CLASSIC"` | `"BM25"` | Relevance model (see Relevance Scoring). `BM25` is the default for newly created indexes; `CLASSIC` is the legacy term-coordination (match-count) model |
| `bm25_k1` | float | `1.2` | BM25 term-frequency saturation (must be >= 0). Higher values let repeated terms keep increasing the score |
| `bm25_b` | float | `0.75` | BM25 document-length normalization, in `[0, 1]` (`0` disables length normalization) |
| `<field>_boost` | float | `1.0` | Per-field BM25 boost multiplier applied to field-qualified matches on that field (must be >= 0), e.g. `"title_boost"` |

#### Common Analyzers

| Analyzer Class | Description |
|---|---|
| `org.apache.lucene.analysis.standard.StandardAnalyzer` | General-purpose tokenizer (default) |
| `org.apache.lucene.analysis.en.EnglishAnalyzer` | English stemming and stop words |

| Analyzer Class | Description |
|---|---|
| `org.apache.lucene.analysis.core.SimpleAnalyzer` | Lowercase only, no stop words |
| `org.apache.lucene.analysis.core.WhitespaceAnalyzer` | Split on whitespace only |

#### Per-Field Analyzers

For multi-property indexes, each field can use a different analyzer:

```
CREATE INDEX ON Article (title, body) FULL_TEXT
  METADATA {
    "analyzer": "org.apache.lucene.analysis.standard.StandardAnalyzer",
    "title_analyzer": "org.apache.lucene.analysis.en.EnglishAnalyzer"
  }
```

Here `title` uses the English analyzer while `body` falls back to the standard analyzer.

### 6.6.3. Searching

A full-text index is used by `CONTAINSTEXT` and by the search functions below. Exact comparisons (`=`, `IN`, `CONTAINS`, `CONTAINSANY`, `CONTAINSALL` in SQL, property equality in Cypher and Gremlin, `lookupByKey()` in Java) never use it, because it matches words rather than whole values: they always return exact matches. Add a regular index on the property if you also need fast exact lookups. *(Since v26.10.1.)*

#### SEARCH_INDEX()

Searches a named full-text index using Lucene query syntax.

```
SELECT * FROM Article
WHERE SEARCH_INDEX('Article[content]', 'java programming')
```

**Signature:** `SEARCH_INDEX(indexName, query)`

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `indexName` | string | The full index name as shown in the schema, e.g. `Article[content]` |
| `query` | string | A Lucene query string |

#### SEARCH_FIELDS()

Finds the full-text index automatically from field names, without needing to know the index name.

```
SELECT * FROM Article
WHERE SEARCH_FIELDS(['title', 'body'], 'database tutorial')
```

**Signature:** `SEARCH_FIELDS(fieldNames, query)`

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `fieldNames` | array of strings | Fields to search; a full-text index covering these fields must exist |
| `query` | string | A Lucene query string |

**Cypher: db.index.fulltext.queryNodes()**

Full-text search is also available from Cypher, so it can be combined with graph pattern matching in the same query. This is the Neo4j-compatible equivalent of `SEARCH_INDEX()`.

```
CALL db.index.fulltext.queryNodes('Article[content]', 'java programming')
YIELD node, score
RETURN node.title AS title, score
ORDER BY score DESC
```

**Signature:** `db.index.fulltext.queryNodes(indexName, query [, options])`, returning one row per match with `node` and `score` (BM25 relevance, higher is better).

For a full-text index declared on an edge type, use `db.index.fulltext.queryRelationships(indexName, query [, options])`, which yields `relationship` and `score` instead.

Results are ordered by descending score, ties broken by record id, so the optional `options` map can page through them *(since v26.10.1)*: `skip` drops that many top rows (default `0`) and `limit` caps the rows returned (default unlimited). Both must be non-negative integers.

```
CALL db.index.fulltext.queryNodes('Article[content]', 'java programming', {skip: 20,
limit: 10})
YIELD node, score
RETURN node.title AS title, score
```

Coming from Neo4j, you may reach for the `analyzer` option. ArcadeDB rejects it with an error rather than ignoring it: the analyzer is the one stored in the index metadata when the index was created, and there is no per-query override.

```
CALL db.index.fulltext.queryRelationships('Cites[note]', 'java')
YIELD relationship, score
RETURN relationship.note AS note, score
ORDER BY score DESC
```

### 6.6.4. Lucene Query Syntax

Both `SEARCH_INDEX` and `SEARCH_FIELDS` accept standard Lucene query syntax.

### Boolean Operators

| Syntax | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `java programming` | Either term (OR, default) |
| `+java +programming` | Both terms required (AND) |
| `java -python` | `java` required, `python` excluded |
| `java AND programming` | Explicit AND |
| `java OR python` | Explicit OR |

```
-- Requires both terms
SELECT * FROM Article WHERE SEARCH_INDEX('Article[content]', '+java +programming')

-- Excludes documents about python
SELECT * FROM Article WHERE SEARCH_INDEX('Article[content]', 'java -python')
```

### Phrase Queries

Wrap a phrase in double quotes to require terms to appear in order:

```
SELECT * FROM Article WHERE SEARCH_INDEX('Article[content]', '"machine learning"')
```

### Wildcard Queries

| Syntax | Matches |
|---|---|
| `data*` | database, datastore, dataset… |
| `dat?base` | database, datXbase… |
| `*base` | Requires `allowLeadingWildcard: true` |

```
SELECT * FROM Article WHERE SEARCH_INDEX('Article[content]', 'data*')
```

Wildcard, prefix, fuzzy and regexp terms are normalized by the index's analyzer, the same way the indexed tokens were: lower-cased with the default `StandardAnalyzer`, left as they are with a case-preserving analyzer such as `WhitespaceAnalyzer` (where `Fo*` matches `Foo` but not `foo`).

### Fuzzy Queries

Append `~` to match terms within an edit distance:

```
SELECT * FROM Article WHERE SEARCH_INDEX('Article[content]', 'database~')
-- also matches terms within edit distance 2 (Lucene default), e.g. "databaSe",
"databasee"
```

### Field-Qualified Queries (Multi-Property Indexes)

For indexes over multiple fields, restrict a term to a specific field:

```
-- Only match "database" in the title field
SELECT * FROM Article WHERE SEARCH_INDEX('Article[title,body]', 'title:database')

-- Combine field-specific and general terms
SELECT * FROM Article WHERE SEARCH_INDEX('Article[title,body]', '+title:"multi model"
-nosql')
```

A qualifier applies to every form of a term, phrases included: `title:"multi model"` matches the phrase in `title` only. A property indexed `BY ITEM` (for example `keywords BY ITEM` on a list) is qualified with its plain name, `keywords:graph`.

### Boosting Terms (Caret)

Append `^N` to a term, phrase, field-qualified term, or parenthesized group to weight it more (or less, with `N < 1`) when scoring. This follows the Lucene/Elasticsearch convention and applies to BM25 indexes.

| Syntax | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `java^3` | Boost the term `java` 3x |
| `java^0.5` | De-emphasize the term `java` (any `N < 1` lowers its weight) |
| `"machine learning"^2` | Boost the phrase 2x |
| `title:java^5` | Boost a field-qualified term 5x |
| `(java OR python)^3` | Boost a whole parenthesized group 3x |

```
-- Make "java" count three times as much as "database" in the ranking
SELECT title, $score FROM Article
WHERE SEARCH_INDEX('Article[content]', 'java^3 database') ORDER BY $score DESC

-- Boost a field-qualified term, combined with a required term
SELECT title, $score FROM Article
WHERE SEARCH_INDEX('Article[title,body]', '+database title:java^5') ORDER BY $score
DESC

-- Boost a whole OR group
SELECT title, $score FROM Article
WHERE SEARCH_INDEX('Article[title,body]', '(title:java OR title:python)^3
body:cooking') ORDER BY $score DESC
```

The query-time caret combines multiplicatively with any configured per-field boost (see Relevance Scoring): the effective weight is `caret * field_boost`.

### 6.6.5. Relevance Scoring

#### Similarity Models: BM25 and CLASSIC

Full-text indexes rank results with one of two similarity models, selected by the `similarity` metadata option:

| Model | Description |
|---|---|
| `BM25` (default) | Industry-standard Okapi BM25 ranking: combines term frequency (TF), inverse document frequency (IDF, so rare terms count more than common ones) and document-length normalization (shorter documents matching the same term rank higher). Tunable via `bm25_k1` and `bm25_b`. |
| `CLASSIC` | Legacy term-coordination model: the score is simply the number of distinct query terms a document matches. Kept for backward compatibility. |

`BM25` is the default for newly created indexes. Configure it explicitly, optionally tuning `bm25_k1` /`bm25_b`:

```
-- BM25 with tuned parameters
CREATE INDEX ON Article (content) FULL_TEXT
  METADATA { "similarity": "BM25", "bm25_k1": 1.2, "bm25_b": 0.75 }

-- Keep the legacy match-count scoring
CREATE INDEX ON Article (content) FULL_TEXT
  METADATA { "similarity": "CLASSIC" }
```

#### Per-Field Boosts

On a multi-property index, give a field a default BM25 weight with `<field>_boost`, so matches in that field contribute more to the score:

```
CREATE INDEX ON Article (title, body) FULL_TEXT
  METADATA { "similarity": "BM25", "title_boost": 3.0 }
```

A field boost applies to **field-qualified** query terms on that field (e.g. `title:java`). Unqualified terms score against the field-agnostic token with boost `1.0`. Per-field boosts and query-time caret boosts compose: the effective weight is `caret * field_boost`.

The key names the property as the index declares it, so for a property indexed `BY ITEM` it is `"keywords by item_boost"`; the query still qualifies it with the plain name (`keywords:graph`).

#### From the Java API

The same configuration is available on the index builder:

```
database.getSchema().buildTypeIndex("Article", new String[] { "title", "body" })
```

```
    .withType(Schema.INDEX_TYPE.FULL_TEXT).withFullTextType()
    .withBM25(1.2f, 0.75f)          // similarity = BM25, k1, b
    .withFieldBoost("title", 3.0f)  // per-field boost
    .create();
```

Use `withSimilarity("CLASSIC")` to select the legacy model instead of `withBM25(…)`.

#### Relevance Score ($score)

Every match carries a floating-point relevance score, exposed as the query variable `$score`. Use it in projections or `ORDER BY` clauses:

```
SELECT title, $score
FROM Article
WHERE SEARCH_INDEX('Article[content]', 'java programming')
ORDER BY $score DESC
```

```
SELECT title, $score AS relevance
FROM Article
WHERE SEARCH_FIELDS(['content'], 'java programming')
ORDER BY relevance DESC
LIMIT 10
```

With BM25, documents matching rarer, more discriminative terms (and shorter documents matching the same term) rank higher. With CLASSIC, documents that match more distinct query terms rank higher.

`$score` is always a floating-point number, including for `CLASSIC` indexes (where it is the match count widened to a float, e.g. `3.0`). Application code that previously read `$score` as an integer must read it as a `Number`/float.

#### Inspecting Scores with EXPLAIN / PROFILE

`EXPLAIN` (or `PROFILE`) of a query whose `WHERE` uses `SEARCH_INDEX(…)` annotates the full-text fetch step with a `SCORING` line: the similarity model, the `k1`/`b` parameters, the corpus statistics, and, per query term, its document frequency (`df`), `idf` and applied `boost`.

```
EXPLAIN SELECT title, $score FROM Article
WHERE SEARCH_INDEX('Article[content]', 'java database') = true
```

### 6.6.6. More Like This

"More Like This" finds documents similar to one or more source documents. It extracts representative terms from the sources, then searches for other documents sharing those terms.

The four full-text search functions (`searchIndex`, `searchFields`, `searchIndexMore`, `searchFieldsMore`) are registered under the `fulltext.*` namespace. The legacy snake_case names (`search_index`, `search_fields`, `search_index_more`, `search_fields_more`) remain available as aliases for backward compatibility. Both forms dispatch to the same implementation.

#### fulltext.searchIndexMore()

```
SELECT title, $score, $similarity
FROM Article
WHERE `fulltext.searchIndexMore`('Article[content]', [#10:3])
ORDER BY $similarity DESC
```

**Signature:** `fulltext.searchIndexMore(indexName, sourceRIDs [, options])` (alias: `search_index_more`)

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `indexName` | string | Full-text index name |
| `sourceRIDs` | array of RIDs | One or more source documents |
| `options` | map | Optional MLT tuning options (see More Like This Configuration). Unknown keys are rejected. |

#### fulltext.searchFieldsMore()

Same as `fulltext.searchIndexMore` but resolves the full-text index automatically from field names:

```
SELECT title, $similarity
FROM Article
WHERE `fulltext.searchFieldsMore`(['content'], [#10:3])
ORDER BY $similarity DESC
```

**Signature:** `fulltext.searchFieldsMore(fieldNames, sourceRIDs [, options])` (alias: `search_fields_more`)

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `fieldNames` | array of strings | Fields to search; a full-text index covering these fields must exist |
| `sourceRIDs` | array of RIDs | One or more source documents |
| `options` | map | Optional MLT tuning options (see More Like This Configuration). Unknown keys are rejected. |

#### Multiple Source Documents

Provide multiple RIDs to find documents similar to a combination of sources:

```
SELECT title, $similarity
FROM Article
WHERE SEARCH_INDEX_MORE('Article[content]', [#10:3, #10:4])
ORDER BY $similarity DESC
```

#### Similarity Score ($similarity)

`$similarity` is a normalized score from `0.0` to `1.0`. The most similar document in the result set always receives `1.0`.

```
SELECT title, $score, $similarity
FROM Article
WHERE SEARCH_INDEX_MORE('Article[content]', [#10:3])
ORDER BY $similarity DESC
LIMIT 5
```

#### More Like This Configuration

Pass an optional map of tuning options. Unknown keys are rejected with a descriptive error to catch typos; keys are case sensitive.

```
SELECT title, $similarity
FROM Article
WHERE `fulltext.searchFieldsMore`(['title', 'content'], [#10:3], {
  minTermFreq: 1,
  minDocFreq: 3,
  maxQueryTerms: 50,
  excludeSource: false
})
```

| Option | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `minTermFreq` | int | `2` | Minimum times a term must appear in the source document(s) to be considered |
| `minDocFreq` | int | `5` | Minimum number of index documents that must contain a term for it to be used |
| `maxDocFreqPercent` | float | `null` | Exclude terms appearing in more than this fraction of all documents (e.g. `0.5` = 50%) |
| `maxQueryTerms` | int | `25` | Maximum number of terms to use in the similarity query |
| `minWordLen` | int | `0` | Ignore terms shorter than this length (0 = no minimum) |
| `maxWordLen` | int | `0` | Ignore terms longer than this length (0 = no maximum) |

| Option | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| boostByScore | boolean | true | Weight terms by TF-IDF score rather than raw frequency |
| excludeSource | boolean | true | Exclude source documents from results |
| maxSourceDocs | int | 25 | Maximum number of source RIDs allowed |

### 6.6.7. Practical Examples

#### Blog Search with Ranking

```
SELECT title, author, $score AS relevance
FROM BlogPost
WHERE SEARCH_INDEX('BlogPost[title,body]', '+java +spring -legacy')
ORDER BY relevance DESC
LIMIT 20
```

#### Autocomplete with Prefix Wildcard

```
SELECT title
FROM Product
WHERE SEARCH_INDEX('Product[name]', 'micro*')
```

#### Stemming with English Analyzer

With `EnglishAnalyzer`, searching for `"run"` also matches `"running"`, `"runs"`, and `"ran"`:

```
CREATE INDEX ON Article (content) FULL_TEXT
  METADATA { "analyzer": "org.apache.lucene.analysis.en.EnglishAnalyzer" }

SELECT * FROM Article WHERE SEARCH_INDEX('Article[content]', 'running')
-- also returns documents containing "run", "runs", "ran"
```

#### Related Articles Recommendation

```
SELECT title, $similarity AS score
FROM Article
WHERE SEARCH_INDEX_MORE('Article[title,body]', [#10:42], {
  "minTermFreq": 1,
  "minDocFreq": 2,
  "maxQueryTerms": 30
})
ORDER BY score DESC
LIMIT 5
```

### Readers Who Liked This Also Liked

```
SELECT title, $similarity
FROM Article
WHERE SEARCH_INDEX_MORE('Article[content]', [#10:1, #10:7, #10:12])
ORDER BY $similarity DESC
LIMIT 10
```

### Hybrid Retrieval: Fusing BM25 with Vector Search

With native BM25, the full-text index becomes a first-class leg of **hybrid retrieval**: exact keyword relevance (BM25), dense semantic similarity, and learned-sparse recall can be merged into a single ranked top-K, server-side, with `vector.fuse` (see concepts/vector-search.pdf).

This is the accuracy-first pattern behind enterprise document search - for example legal/government case files, where matching an exact statute or case number (keyword) matters as much as semantic similarity. Here a `Case` type carries the report `content` (full-text, BM25), a `dense` embedding, and learned-sparse `tokens`/`weights`. `RRF` fusion tolerates the very different score scales (BM25 in `[0, +inf)`, cosine in `[-1, 1]`):

```
SELECT title, caseNumber, score
FROM (
  SELECT expand(`vector.fuse`(
      `vector.neighbors`('Case[dense]', :denseVec, 100),
      `vector.sparseNeighbors`('Case[tokens,weights]', :qIdx, :qVal, 100),
      (SELECT @rid, $score FROM Case WHERE SEARCH_INDEX('Case[content]', :keywords) =
true),
      { fusion: 'RRF', k: 60 }
  ))
)
ORDER BY score DESC
LIMIT 10
```

Because the fused candidates are records, the graph can be expanded in the same statement - rank the most relevant cases, then traverse to their related cases, circulars, and evidence:

```
SELECT caseNumber, title
FROM (
  SELECT expand(out('RELATED_TO'))
  FROM (
    SELECT expand(`vector.fuse`(
        `vector.neighbors`('Case[dense]', :denseVec, 100),
        (SELECT @rid, $score FROM Case WHERE SEARCH_INDEX('Case[content]', :keywords)
= true),
        { fusion: 'RRF' }
    )) LIMIT 10
  )
```

```
)
```

### 6.6.8. Maintenance: BM25 Corpus Statistics

BM25 maintains per-type corpus counters (document count and total document length) that feed the average-document-length normalizer. They are updated incrementally as documents are indexed and removed. Because they are not transactionally reversed on rollback, a workload with many rolled-back transactions can let them drift slightly over time, which only affects length normalization (suboptimal, never wrong, scores). The first BM25 query of a session self-corrects them with a cheap check; for an exact repair without a full reindex, run:

```
-- Re-derive the corpus statistics for one index...
REBUILD INDEX `Article[content]` WITH statsOnly = true

-- ...or for every full-text index
REBUILD INDEX * WITH statsOnly = true
```

This is also a good way to "pre-warm" the counters of a BM25 index migrated from an older version before serving traffic (otherwise the first query does a one-time full scan to build them).

### 6.6.9. Behavior Changes When Upgrading

When BM25 support was introduced, existing full-text indexes keep their `CLASSIC` ranking (BM25 is opt-in for existing data, see Getting BM25 on Existing Indexes), but the following user-visible behaviors changed for **all** full-text indexes, including CLASSIC ones. Review them before upgrading.

| Change | Impact | Migration |
|---|---|---|
| `$score` is now a **float** | It was an `Integer` match count for CLASSIC indexes and is now the same value widened to a `Float` (e.g. `3` → `3.0`). Code reading `$score` as a `java.lang.Integer` will fail (e.g. `ClassCastException`). | Read `$score` as a `Number`/`Float`, e.g. `Number) result.getProperty("$score".floatValue()`. SQL that only sorts/filters on `$score` is unaffected. |
| Cursor order is now **most-relevant-first** | The CLASSIC full-text cursor previously returned matches in **ascending** score order (least relevant first) and ignored the result `limit`. It now returns descending score (with a stable tiebreaker) and honors `limit` - consistent with BM25. Applications that consumed the raw `Index.get(…)` order without an explicit `ORDER BY` will see it reversed, and a `limit` now truncates to the top-N. | Add an explicit `ORDER BY $score ASC` if you relied on the old order; SQL queries already using `ORDER BY $score DESC` are unaffected. |

| Change | Impact | Migration |
| --- | --- | --- |
| `IndexCursorEntry` identity excludes the score (extension API) | `equals()`/`hashCode()` now use only `(record, keys)`. Code that put `IndexCursorEntry` objects into a `Set` (or used them as map keys) expecting score-differentiated entries now deduplicates on `(record, keys)` only. | Treat `(record, keys)` as the identity. Affects only code working directly with the low-level index cursor API. |

### 6.6.10. Getting BM25 on Existing Indexes

Indexes created before BM25 support open and keep scoring with `CLASSIC` (apart from the behavior changes in Behavior Changes When Upgrading). To switch existing data to BM25, **rebuild** the index: term frequencies were never stored before, so there is no in-place migration.

```
REBUILD INDEX `Article[content]`
```

### 6.6.11. Notes

- Full-text indexes require all indexed properties to be of type `STRING`.
- Full-text indexes cannot be marked `UNIQUE`.
- Without a `METADATA` block, newly created indexes use `StandardAnalyzer` with `OR` default operator, leading wildcards disabled, and **BM25** similarity.
- `$score` and `$similarity` are always available as query variables for matching documents; non-matching documents receive `0`.
- `$score` is a floating-point value (for `CLASSIC` indexes too, where it is the match count as a float).
- BM25 is scored per bucket (like an Elasticsearch shard): on a multi-bucket type, `$score` is not globally calibrated across buckets, so prefer `ORDER BY $score` over comparing absolute scores across documents in different buckets.
- The direct `Index.get(text)` Java API does simple token matching only; use `SEARCH_INDEX(…)` for the full Lucene query syntax (boolean operators, phrases, wildcards, caret boosts).

## 6.7. Key/Value

The key/value model is the simplest data model: every value is reachable through a single identifier (the key). ArcadeDB supports the key/value pattern natively without sacrificing the richer features of the multi-model engine — values can be primitive types, full documents, or even graph elements.

### 6.7.1. How Keys Work in ArcadeDB

Every record stored in ArcadeDB is automatically addressable by its Record ID (RID), a compact identifier of the form `#bucket:offset`. The RID provides O(1) direct access to any record, which means the entire database functions as a high-performance key/value store — no separate engine, no extra indexes required.

In addition to RIDs, you can layer your own keys on top:

- **Indexed keys** — create a unique LSM-Tree index on any property to look up records by an arbitrary identifier such as `userId`, `sku`, or `email`.
- **Bucket-based keys** — group records into buckets and use the bucket as a key/value namespace where records are inserted and retrieved by RID without requiring a type schema.
- **Composite keys** — create indexes spanning multiple properties when the natural key is not a single value (for example, `(tenantId, accountId)`).

### 6.7.2. Key/Value with the Redis Wire Protocol

ArcadeDB speaks the Redis wire protocol, so any Redis client (here Jedis) can use it as a drop-in key/value backend. Simple string commands (`SET`, `GET`, `INCR`, ...) operate on a fast in-memory namespace:

```
final Jedis jedis = new Jedis("localhost", 6379);

jedis.set("foo", "1");                 // store
String value = jedis.get("foo");       // read -> "1"
boolean present = jedis.exists("foo"); // check
jedis.incr("foo");                     // atomic increment -> 2
jedis.incrBy("foo", 3);                // -> 5
String removed = jedis.getDel("foo");  // read + delete atomically
```

To persist values as queryable documents, back the key with a unique index and use the hash commands. The `HGET`/`HEXISTS`/`HDEL` key uses the form `database.Type[indexName]`:

```
// One-time schema: a type plus a unique index acting as the key
database.command("sqlscript",
    "CREATE DOCUMENT TYPE Account;" +
    "CREATE PROPERTY Account.id LONG;" +
    "CREATE INDEX ON Account (id) UNIQUE;" +
    "CREATE PROPERTY Account.email STRING;" +
    "CREATE INDEX ON Account (email) UNIQUE;");

// Store a JSON value under the "Account" type
jedis.hset("mydb", "Account",
"{'id':1,'email':'jay@commodore.com','firstName':'Jay'}");

// Read it back by the indexed key (id == 1)
JSONObject doc = new JSONObject(jedis.hget("mydb.Account[id]", "1"));

// ...or by the email key
doc = new JSONObject(jedis.hget("mydb.Account[email]", "jay@commodore.com"));

boolean present = jedis.hexists("mydb.Account[id]", "1");
jedis.hdel("mydb.Account[id]", "1");   // delete by key
```

Records can also be addressed directly by their RID: `jedis.hget("mydb", "#13:432")`.

### 6.7.3. Key/Value with the Java API

Create a unique index on the property you want to use as the key, then look records up with `lookupByKey`:

```
database.command("sql",
    "CREATE DOCUMENT TYPE Account;" +
    "CREATE PROPERTY Account.id LONG;" +
    "CREATE INDEX ON Account (id) UNIQUE");

// Single-key lookup
final IndexCursor result = database.lookupByKey("Account", "id", 12345L);
if (result.hasNext())
  Document value = result.next().asDocument();

// Composite-key lookup (e.g. multi-tenant natural keys)
final IndexCursor composite = database.lookupByKey("Account",
    new String[] { "tenantId", "accountId" },
    new Object[] { "acme", 42L });
```

For ephemeral, in-memory state (session data, counters) that does not need its own type, use database global variables, which are also readable from SQL:

```
database.setGlobalVariable("myKey", "myValue");
Object value = database.getGlobalVariable("myKey");   // "myValue"
// SELECT $myKey returns the value from SQL
```

### 6.7.4. Key/Value over HTTP

Over the HTTP API, key/value access is expressed as SQL through the `/api/v1/command/<database>` endpoint. A lookup by indexed key is a simple parameterized query:

```
# Read the value whose key id = 1
curl -X POST "http://localhost:2480/api/v1/command/mydb" \
  -u root:password -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"language":"sql","command":"SELECT FROM Account WHERE id =
:id","params":{"id":1}}'

# Store / upsert a value by key
curl -X POST "http://localhost:2480/api/v1/command/mydb" \
  -u root:password -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"language":"sql","command":"UPDATE Account SET email = :e UPSERT WHERE id =
:id","params":{"id":1,"e":"jay@commodore.com"}}'
```

This makes ArcadeDB usable as a drop-in key/value backend for caches, session stores,

configuration stores, or any pattern where direct addressing by identifier is the primary access mode.

### 6.7.5. Comparison with Other Models

| Relational Model | Key/Value Model | ArcadeDB Key/Value Model |
|---|---|---|
| Table | Bucket | Bucket |
| Row | Key/Value pair | Document |
| Column | not available | Document field or Vertex/Edge property |
| Relationship | not available | Relationship |

### 6.7.6. Why ArcadeDB for Key/Value

Most key/value stores treat the value as opaque — a blob of bytes the database doesn't understand. ArcadeDB treats every value as a structured record:

- **Rich values** — values can be documents, vertices, or edges with typed properties, not just byte arrays.
- **Queryable** — the same record retrievable by RID is also queryable with SQL, Cypher, Gremlin, and other languages, without re-indexing or duplicating data.
- **Transactional** — key/value writes participate in full ACID transactions alongside graph and document operations.
- **Persistent** — LSM-Tree storage with automatic compaction ensures durability and efficient disk usage at scale.
- **Multi-protocol** — access the same data through HTTP, the Redis wire protocol, the Java API, or any other supported interface.

### 6.7.7. Further Reading

- Record ID (RID) — how RIDs work and how to use them as primary keys
- Buckets — physical storage units that double as key/value namespaces
- HTTP API — run SQL commands and queries (including key lookups) over REST
- Redis Wire Protocol — speak the Redis protocol against ArcadeDB

## 6.8. Record

A record is the smallest unit you can load from and store in the database. Records come in three types:

- Document
- Vertex
- Edge

### 6.8.1. Document

Documents are softly typed and are defined by schema types, but you can also use them in a schema-less mode too. Documents handle fields in a flexible manner. You can easily import and export them in JSON format. For example,

```
{
  "name":"Jay",
  "surname":"Miner",
  "job":"Developer",
  "creations":[{
    "name":"Amiga 1000",
    "company":"Commodore Inc."
  },{
    "name":"Amiga 500",
    "company":"Commodore Inc."
  }]
}
```

### 6.8.2. Vertex

In graph databases the vertices (also: vertices), or nodes represent the main entity that holds the information. It can be a patient, a company or a product. Vertices are themselves documents with some additional features. This means they can contain embedded records and arbitrary properties exactly like documents. Vertices are connected with other vertices through edges.

### 6.8.3. Edge

An edge, or arc, is the connection between two vertices. Edges can be unidirectional and bidirectional. One edge can only connect two vertices. Edges, like vertices, are also documents with additional features.

For more information on connecting vertices in general, see Relationships below.

### 6.8.4. Record ID

When ArcadeDB generates a record, it auto-assigns a unique identifier called a Record ID, RID for short. The syntax for the RID is the pound symbol (`#`) with the bucket identifier, colon (`:`), and the position like so:

`#<bucket-identifier>:<record-position>`.

- **bucket-identifier**: This number indicates the bucket id to which the record belongs. Positive numbers in the bucket identifier indicate persistent records. You can have up to 2,147,483,648 buckets in a database.
- **record-position**: This number defines the absolute position of the record in the bucket.

A special case is `#-1:-1` symbolizing the null RID.

The prefix character `#` is mandatory.

Each Record ID is immutable, universal, and only reused when configured to, see `bucketReuseSpaceMode`. Additionally, records can be accessed directly through their RIDs at O(1) complexity which means the query speed is constant, unaffected by database size. For this reason, you don't need to create a field to serve as the primary key as you do in relational databases.

#### Record Retrieval Complexity

Retrieving a record by RID is of complexity O(1). This is possible as the RID itself encodes both, the file a record is stored in, and the position inside it. In an RID, i.e. `#12:1000000`, the bucket identifier (here `#12`) specifies the record's associated file, while the record position (here `1000000`) describes the position inside the file. Bucket files are organized in pages (with default size `64KB`) with a maximum number records per page (by default `2048`). To determine the byte position of a record in a bucket file, the rounded down quotient of record position and maximum records per page yields the page (here `⌊1000000 / 2048⌋`), and the remainder gives the position on the page (here `⌊1000000 % 2048⌋`). In pseudo-code this computation is given by:

```
int pageId = floor(rid.getPosition() / maxRecordsInPage);
int positionInPage = floor(rid.getPosition() % maxRecordsInPage);
```

### 6.8.5. Types

The concept of type is taken from the Object Oriented Programming paradigm, sometimes known as "Class". In ArcadeDB, types define records. It is closest to the concept of a "Table" in relational databases and a "Class" in an object database.

Types can be schema-less, schema-full, or a mix. They can inherit from other types, creating a tree of types. Inheritance, in this context, means that a subtype extends a parent type, inheriting all of its properties and attributes. Practically, this is done by extending a type or setting a super-type.

Each type has its own buckets (data files). A type can support multiple buckets. When you execute a query against a type, it automatically fetches from all the buckets that are part of the type. When you create a new record, ArcadeDB selects the bucket to store it in using a configurable strategy — round-robin, per-thread, or hashed by a property.

As a default, ArcadeDB creates one bucket per type, but can be configured to for example to as many cores (processors) the host machine has, see `typeDefaultBuckets`. In this, CRUD operations can go full speed in parallel with zero contention between CPUs and/or cores. Having many buckets per type means having more files at file system level. Check if your operating system has any limitation with the number of files supported and opened at the same time (`ulimit` for Unix-like systems).

You can query the defined types by executing the following SQL query: `select from schema:types`.

### 6.8.6. Buckets

Where types provide you with a logical framework for organizing data, buckets provide physical or in-memory space in which ArcadeDB actually stores the data. Each bucket is one file at file system level. It is comparable to the "collection" in Document databases, the "table" in Relational databases and the "cluster" in OrientDB. You can have up to 2,147,483,648 buckets in a database.

A bucket can only be part of one type. This means two types can not share the same bucket. Also, sub-types have their separate buckets from their super-types.

When you create a new type, the `CREATE TYPE` statement automatically creates the physical buckets (files) that serve as the default location in which to store data for that type. ArcadeDB forms the bucket names by using the type name + underscore + a sequential number starting from 0. For example, the first bucket for the type `Beer` will be `Beer_0` and the correspondent file in the file system will be `Beer_0.31.65536.bucket`. By default ArcadeDB creates one bucket per type. For massive inserts, performance can be improved by creating additional buckets and hence taking advantage of parallelism, i.e. by creating one bucket for each CPU core on the server.

### 6.8.7. Types vs. Buckets in Queries

The combination of types and buckets is very powerful and has a number of use cases. In most case, you can work with types and you will be fine. But if you are able to split your database into multiple buckets, you could address a specific bucket based instead of the entire type. By wisely using the buckets to divide your database in a way that help you with the retrieval means zero or less use of indexes. Indexes slow down insertion and take space on disk and RAM. In most cases you need indexes to speed up your queries, but in some use cases you could totally or partially avoid using indexes and still having good performance on queries.

### 6.8.8. One bucket per period

Consider an example where you create a type `Invoice`, with one bucket per year. `Invoice_2015` and `Invoice_2016`. You can query all invoices using the type as a target with the `SELECT` statement.

```
SELECT FROM Invoice
```

In addition to this, you can filter the result set by the year. The type `Invoice` includes a `year` field, you can filter it through the `WHERE` clause.

```
SELECT FROM Invoice WHERE year = 2016
```

You can also query specific records from a single bucket. By splitting the type `Invoice` across multiple buckets, (that is, one per year in our example), you can optimize the query by narrowing the potential result set.

```
SELECT FROM BUCKET:Invoice_2016
```

By using the explicit bucket instead of the logical type, this query runs significantly faster, because ArcadeDB can narrow the search to the targeted bucket. No index is needed on the year, because all the invoices for year 2016 will be stored in the bucket `Invoice_2016` by the application.

### 6.8.9. One bucket per location

Like with the example above, we could split our records by location creating one bucket per location. Example:

```
CREATE BUCKET Customer_Europe
CREATE BUCKET Customer_Americas
CREATE BUCKET Customer_Asia
CREATE BUCKET Customer_Other

CREATE VERTEX TYPE Customer BUCKET Customer_Europe,Customer_Americas,Customer_Asia
,Customer_Other
```

Here we are using the graph model by creating a vertex type, but it's the same with documents. Use `CREATE DOCUMENT TYPE` instead.

Now in your application, store the vertices or documents in the right bucket, based on the location of such customer. You can use any API and set the bucket. If you're using SQL, this is the way you can insert a new customer into a specific bucket.

```
INSERT INTO BUCKET:Customer_Europe CONTENT { firstName: 'Enzo', lastName: 'Ferrari' }
```

Since a bucket can only be part of one type, when you use the bucket notation with SQL, the type is inferred from the bucket, "Customer" in this case.

When you're looking for customers based in Europe, you could execute this query:

```
SELECT FROM BUCKET:Customer_Europe
```

You can go even more specific by creating a bucket per country, not just for continent, and query from that bucket. Example:

```
CREATE BUCKET Customer_Europe_Italy
CREATE BUCKET Customer_Europe_Spain
```

Now get all the customers that live in Italy:

```
SELECT FROM BUCKET:Customer_Europe_Italy
```

You can also specify a list of buckets in your query. This is the query to retrieve both Italian and

Spanish customers.

```
SELECT FROM BUCKET:[Customer_Europe_Italy,Customer_Europe_Spain]
```

### 6.8.10. Bucket Selection Strategy

When a type is backed by more than one bucket, ArcadeDB has to decide which bucket should receive each new record. That decision is made by the type's **bucket selection strategy**. The strategy is set on the type (and inherited from the database default), so it is transparent to the application code that issues the `INSERT` or `CREATE`.

ArcadeDB ships with three built-in strategies, described in the sections below.

#### `round-robin`

The default strategy when a type has more than one bucket. Each new record is assigned to the next bucket in circular order; after the last bucket the counter wraps back to the first.

This is the right choice when you have no specific reason to choose otherwise. Writes are spread evenly across all buckets without any application-level coordination, and the algorithm has no per-record overhead.

The animation shows six successive inserts arriving at the producer and being routed to `Bucket 0`, `Bucket 1`, `Bucket 2`, `Bucket 0`, `Bucket 1`, `Bucket 2`.

#### `thread`

The bucket is chosen as `(threadId mod numBuckets)`, so each writer thread always lands in the same bucket. With one bucket per thread, two threads writing concurrently never touch the same bucket file or page, eliminating page-level lock contention between them.

This is the fastest strategy under heavy concurrent inserts. Best results come when the number of buckets is at least equal to the number of writer threads (e.g. one bucket per CPU core; see the `typeDefaultBuckets` setting).

The trade-off is that record distribution depends on how evenly threads insert: if one thread does most of the work, its bucket grows much faster than the others. Pick this when peak write throughput matters more than balanced bucket sizes.

The animation shows three threads firing inserts at the same instant; each thread's record always lands in its own dedicated bucket.

#### `partitioned(<property>)`

The bucket is chosen by hashing the value of a named property and mapping the hash to a bucket index. Two records that share the same key always land in the same bucket, deterministically.

The big win is on read. When you later query by that property, ArcadeDB knows exactly which bucket can possibly contain the row, so the index lookup hits a single sub-index instead of scanning every bucket's index in turn. For point lookups by key this can be much faster than `round-robin` or

`thread`.

The trade-offs:

- Inserts are slightly slower than the other strategies because of the extra hashing step.
- The distribution of records across buckets only stays balanced if the chosen property has high cardinality and reasonably uniform values. A low-cardinality key concentrates writes into a few buckets.
- The `UPSERT` clause on `UPDATE` only guarantees atomicity when the `WHERE` condition matches a `UNIQUE` index, so this strategy is most often paired with one.

The animation shows four records with `id` values `42, 17, 99, 33` flowing through `hash(id) % 3` and landing in their deterministic destination buckets (`Bucket 0`, `Bucket 2`, `Bucket 0`, `Bucket 0`).

#### Setting and changing the strategy

The strategy is inherited from a database-wide default (changeable with `ALTER DATABASE`) and can be overridden per type with `ALTER TYPE … BucketSelectionStrategy`. See the SQL reference under Bucket Selection Strategies for the exact syntax.

#### Schema design 101: choosing a bucket strategy

The default `round-robin` strategy is **safe but unconditionally generic**: it never produces hot buckets, but it also gives the planner zero query-time leverage. Most production schemas have an obvious partition axis (tenant, customer, region, organisation) that the default ignores. Picking a partitioned strategy at schema-creation time is one of the highest-leverage decisions you can make for a single-node deployment.

Use this 3-question decision tree before you create a new type:

1. **Is the data scoped to a tenant, customer, organisation, or other high-cardinality categorical key?** If yes, use `partitioned(<that-key>)`. Multi-tenant SaaS workloads, customer-scoped records, and per-organisation document stores all fit here. The planner will skip every bucket that doesn't match the scope predicate, so a `WHERE tenant_id = X` query touches one HNSW graph (or one LSM-Tree per-bucket sub-index) instead of all of them. This is the optimisation that makes filterable HNSW work for SaaS use cases (see concepts/vector-search.pdf).
2. **Is the data time-series with a hot recent / cold historical split?** If yes, prefer the `LSM_TIMESERIES` type's native partitioning (see Time series) - it understands time-window roll-off and downsampling out of the box. Generic types with `partitioned(timestamp)` can degenerate into a hot bucket for the current period.
3. **Is the workload single-tenant, mixed-cutting analytics, or a generic document store?** Stick with `round-robin` (the default). The other strategies' query-time benefit doesn't materialise without a stable partition axis.

**Anti-patterns** worth calling out:

- **Low-cardinality keys** (`status` with 3 values, `lang` with 5 values): every value

collides into one bucket. With 16 buckets and a 3-value key, ~13 buckets stay empty and the other 3 carry everything.

- **Skewed distributions** (90% of traffic on one tenant): the hot tenant's bucket becomes the bottleneck. Either pre-shard manually or pick a finer-grained key.
- **Mutable partition keys**: the strategy assumes the key value never changes after insert. ArcadeDB enforces this with an exception in `DocumentIndexer` when `UPDATE` would change a partition-key column. If you need to "move" a record to a different tenant, drop and re-insert it.
- **Composite partition keys**: `partitioned(orgId, region)` works but only helps queries that bind **both** keys. A query that filters by `orgId` alone touches every bucket.

#### `needsRepartition` flag

A schema mutation can invalidate the partition mapping for existing records:

- `ALTER TYPE Doc BUCKET +newBucket` on a partitioned type changes the modulus: `hash(tenant_id) % oldCount` no longer matches `hash(tenant_id) % newCount` for the same value. Existing records stay in their old buckets; new records go to the right bucket. The mapping is now stale.
- Same for removing a bucket.
- `ALTER TYPE Doc BucketSelectionStrategy 'partitioned(…)'` on a populated type that previously used `round-robin` puts the records under a hash they were never routed by.
- Changing the strategy's property set (e.g. `partitioned(orgId)` → `partitioned(orgId, region)`) on a populated type has the same effect.

When this happens, ArcadeDB sets a `needsRepartition` flag on the type. The flag is exposed in `SELECT FROM schema:types` and shown as a yellow warning banner in Studio's type-detail panel. **While the flag is set, partition-aware bucket pruning is suppressed**: queries fan out across every bucket and stay correct, but lose the optimisation. The flag is cleared by a successful `REBUILD TYPE … WITH repartition = true`, which walks every record, moves the misplaced ones to their hash-target bucket, and then clears the flag.

You can also chain the rebuild atomically with the schema change:

```
ALTER TYPE Doc BUCKET +newBucket WITH repartition = true
```

This runs the bucket addition and the rebuild as one logical operation; the flag never goes true to subsequent queries.

**Vertex and edge types**: a repartition rebuild deletes each misplaced record from its old bucket and re-inserts it, which gives it a new RID. For graph types this breaks integrity in two ways:

- Inbound edges from other vertices keep pointing at the old RID and silently dangle.

- Outbound-edge segments are stored on the vertex itself, so the delete+re-insert wipes them - even on a type that has no inbound references.

There is no safe in-place fix for either, so ArcadeDB refuses `REBUILD TYPE <V> WITH repartition = true` (and the chained `ALTER TYPE <V> … WITH repartition = true`) on vertex or edge types unconditionally. The supported workflow for repartitioning a populated graph type is to drop and re-import the data under the new partitioning.

**Verifying it's working**

To check whether a query is benefiting from partition pruning, prefix it with `EXPLAIN`:

```
EXPLAIN SELECT FROM Doc WHERE tenant_id = 'acme'
```

In the resulting plan, look for a `GetValueFromIndexEntryStep` line with a narrow `filtering buckets [N]` value (one bucket id rather than the full set). For Cypher, the partition-pruned path is logged in the `usedIndexName` field as `<label>[partition='<bucket>']`.

The partition key can be written as a literal or bound as a parameter (`WHERE tenant_id = ?`, `MATCH (d:Doc {tenant_id: $t})`): both prune to the bucket of the value. In SQL, the plan of a query pruned on a parameter is built for each execution rather than taken from the plan cache, because the bucket depends on the value bound. *(Since v26.11.1: before, a parameter did not prune, so `vector.neighbors()` and `vector.sparseNeighbors()` searched every bucket and answered differently with a parameter than with the same value written as a literal.)*

## 6.8.11. Relationships

ArcadeDB supports three kinds of relationships: **connections**, **referenced** and **embedded**. It can manage relationships in a schema-full or schema-less scenario.

## 6.8.12. Graph Connections

As a graph database, spanning edges between vertices is one way to express a connections between records. This is the graph model's natural way of relationsships and traversable by the SQL, Gremlin, and Cypher query languages. Internally, ArcadeDB deposes a direct (referenced) relationship for edge-wise connected vertices to ensure fast graph traversals.

Example

In ArcadeDB's SQL, edges are created via the `CREATE EDGE` command.

## 6.8.13. Referenced Relationships

In Relational databases, tables are linked through `JOIN` commands, which can prove costly on computing resources. ArcadeDB manages relationships natively without computing a `JOIN` but storing a direct `LINK` to the target object of the relationship: a property on the source record holds the target's RID, so following the relationship is a single random read rather than a join.

In the example below, the `Customer` record at `#5:23` has a property `invoice` whose value is the link `#10:2`. The `Invoice` record exists independently in its own bucket and keeps its own RID; deleting the customer does not delete the invoice.

Note that referenced relationships differ from edges: references are properties connecting any record while edges are types connecting vertices, and particularly, graph traversal is only applicable to edges.

### 6.8.14. Embedded Relationships

When using Embedded relationships, ArcadeDB stores the related record *inside* the container record, as the value of one of its properties. These relationships are stronger than referenced relationships. You can represent them as a UML Composition relationship.

Embedded records do not have their own RID, so they cannot be referenced from other records. They are only accessible by traversing the container record's property, and they are stored inside the container's record (not in a separate bucket for the embedded type). Consequently, deleting the container record also deletes its embedded records.

In the example below, the `Account` record at `#5:23` has a property `address` whose value is an embedded `Address` record. The embedded record carries its own properties (`city`, `street`) but has no RID of its own — it lives entirely within the account.

Because the embedded `Address` is reachable as `address` on `Account`, you query its inner properties through that path. The query below returns every account whose embedded address has `city = 'Rome'`:

```
SELECT FROM Account WHERE address.city = 'Rome'
```

### 6.8.15. 1:1 and n:1 Embedded Relationships

ArcadeDB expresses relationships of these kinds using the `EMBEDDED` type.

### 6.8.16. 1:n and n:n Embedded Relationships

ArcadeDB expresses relationships of these kinds using a list or a map of links, such as:

- `LIST` An ordered list of records.
- `MAP` An ordered map of records as the value and a string as the key, it doesn't accept duplicate keys.

### 6.8.17. Inverse Relationships

In ArcadeDB, all edges in the graph model are bidirectional. This differs from the document model, where relationships are always unidirectional, requiring the developer to maintain data integrity. In addition, ArcadeDB automatically maintains the consistency of all bidirectional relationships.

### 6.8.18. Edge Constraints

ArcadeDB supports edge constraints, which means limiting the admissible vertex types that can be connected by an edge type. To this end the implicit metadata properties `@in` and `@out` need to be made explicit by creating them. For example, for an edge type `HasParts` that is supposed to connect only from vertices of type `Product` to vertices of type `Component`, this can be schemed by:

```
CREATE EDGE TYPE HasParts;
CREATE PROPERTY HasParts.`@out` link OF Product;
CREATE PROPERTY HasParts.`@in` link OF Component;
```

### 6.8.19. Relationship Traversal Complexity

As a native graph database, ArcadeDB supports index free adjacency. This means constant graph traversal complexity of O(1), independent of the graph expanse (database size).

To traverse a graph structure, one needs to follow references stored by the current record. These references are always stored as RIDs, and are not only pointers to incoming and outgoing edges, but also to connected vertices. Internally, references are managed by a stack (also known as LIFO), which allows to get the latest insertion first. As not only edges, but also connected vertices are stored, neighboring nodes can be reached directly, particularly without going via the connecting edge. This is useful if edges are used purely to connect vertices and do not carry i.e. properties themselves.

See Database for the database lifecycle, URL format, and how to create one.

## 6.9. Database

A **database** is the top-level container for everything ArcadeDB stores: types, buckets, indexes, records, and the write-ahead log that makes them durable. A single ArcadeDB process — whether an embedded JVM or a standalone server — can host many databases at once; they share the JVM, the network listeners, and the global configuration, but each database is otherwise independent. There is no shared catalog and no concept of joins or transactions across databases: every query, every transaction, and every backup operates on exactly one database.

Each database is one directory on disk. Inside that directory live the bucket files (one file per bucket), the WAL, the schema definition (a JSON file), and any persisted indexes. The database name **is** the directory name, so the easiest way to think about a database is as a self-contained on-disk dataset that you can copy, archive, or move between servers by moving the folder. A server discovers its databases by scanning its data root directory at startup, which is also why dropping a directory in or out of that root is enough to register or unregister a database.

The same on-disk database is reachable from any of the supported entry points concurrently. In an embedded scenario you open it directly from Java with `DatabaseFactory.open()` or `DatabaseFactory.create()`. When run as a server, the same database is reachable through the HTTP/JSON API and through the wire-protocol plugins (PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Gremlin Server, gRPC) at the same time, all backed by the same storage, transactions, and schema.

The database name must be unique within the hosting process.

### 6.9.1. Database URL

ArcadeDB uses its own URL format of `<engine>:<db-name>`. The embedded engine is the default and can be omitted, so to open a database on the local file system you can pass the path directly as the URL.

### 6.9.2. Database lifecycle

A database must be opened before use and closed when you are done with it. The Java `Database` interface implements `AutoCloseable`, so the canonical pattern is a try-with-resources block, which guarantees the WAL is flushed and the files are released even on exception:

```
try (Database db = new DatabaseFactory("/data/mydb").open()) {
  // ... use the database ...
}
```

ArcadeDB automatically closes all opened databases when the process dies **gracefully** — i.e. not killed by force. On Unix/Linux this is the case for `SIGTERM` (Docker exit code `143`) but not `SIGKILL` (Docker exit code `137`). On a forced kill the next start replays the WAL to restore consistency, but you will pay that recovery cost; clean shutdown is always preferable.

The log tells you how the replay ended:

- `Recovery of database '<name>' completed` is logged only when every transaction in the WAL was replayed.
- `Recovery of database '<name>' completed, its WAL files are kept until an fsync of the data files succeeds` means every transaction was replayed but the replayed pages could not be forced to disk. The WAL stays the durable copy of them and is deleted automatically once a later fsync succeeds; a close whose fsync fails too keeps it, and the next open replays it again.
- `Recovery of database '<name>' did not complete` means the replay stopped early. If an error interrupted it (for example the JVM ran out of heap while replaying a large WAL), the open fails, the WAL files are left exactly as they were and the database lock is released: fix the cause and open the database again, even from the same JVM, and the replay starts over. If the WAL itself is damaged (a corrupt record followed by valid ones, or a version gap), the files are moved aside with a `.corrupt` extension for manual inspection and the database opens without the transactions that follow the damage.

### 6.9.3. Creating Databases

A new database starts empty: no types, no buckets, no indexes. You can create one through any of the supported entry points — they all hit the same underlying storage layer, so the result is identical.

#### Console

The console is the most direct way: a one-liner you can run from a terminal, a `Dockerfile`, or a CI step.

```
$ bin/console.sh "create database mydb"
```

If the server is already running, point the console at it and use the same command:

```
$ bin/console.sh "connect remote:localhost/mydb root <password>; create database mydb"
```

**Studio**

Studio exposes a **Create Database** button in the GUI. Useful when you are exploring interactively or onboarding a new team member. Studio calls the HTTP API under the hood, so the result is identical to the curl example below.

**HTTP API**

The HTTP `server` command creates a database remotely on a running server. Useful for managing databases programmatically across containers, VMs, or Kubernetes pods.

```
$ curl -u root:<password> \
       -H 'Content-Type: application/json' \
       -d '{"command": "create database mydb"}' \
       http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server
```

**Java API**

When ArcadeDB is embedded in a JVM application, use `DatabaseFactory.create()`:

```
try (Database db = new DatabaseFactory("/data/mydb").create()) {
  // schema setup, initial data, ...
}
```

`create()` fails if the directory already exists; pair it with `exists()` (or use `open()` after the first run) for idempotent setup.

**Server start-up (declarative)**

The `arcadedb.server.defaultDatabases` setting declares a comma-separated list of databases that **must** exist when the server boots. Any name in the list that is missing on disk is created automatically, optionally with a root user and seed data. This is the cleanest pattern for declarative provisioning — the server's configuration **is** the source of truth for which databases exist.

```
arcadedb.server.defaultDatabases=mydb[root|<password>]
```

Once a database exists, define its schema with `CREATE TYPE` (and the related `CREATE BUCKET` / `CREATE INDEX` commands), or import an existing dataset with `IMPORT DATABASE`.

# 6.10. Schema

ArcadeDB supports schema-less, schema-full and hybrid operation. A type (document, vertex or edge) must be declared in a database before records can be inserted into it; everything else — properties, indexes, additional buckets, triggers, materialized views — is layered on top of that type. For declared properties, all writes are validated against the property's type and constraints, while undeclared properties are accepted as long as no declared constraint is violated.

This section introduces the building blocks of an ArcadeDB schema: Types, Properties, Buckets, Indexes, Triggers, and Materialized Views. For the low-level on-disk layout (pages, record IDs, bucket files, page versioning), see Storage Internals.

## 6.10.1. Types

A type is the named "shape" of a record. ArcadeDB has three flavours, all backed by the same storage engine:

- **Document type** — schemaless or schema-full documents (JSON-like records), the analog of a table.
- **Vertex type** — documents that participate in the graph as nodes; carry edges-in / edges-out adjacency lists.
- **Edge type** — documents that connect two vertices, bidirectional by default and traversable in both directions.

Types support single inheritance via the `EXTENDS` keyword and are queryable polymorphically (a query on a parent type sees all subtypes' records). See Inheritance for the details. The SQL command surface is `CREATE TYPE`, `ALTER TYPE`, and `DROP TYPE`.

## 6.10.2. Properties

A property is a declared field on a type. Declaring a property unlocks per-field validation (data type, NOT NULL, regex, min/max, default), polymorphic queries against the field, and the `EXTERNAL` storage option for heavy values (see External Property Storage below).

Properties are managed via `CREATE PROPERTY`, `ALTER PROPERTY`, and `DROP PROPERTY`.

### External Property Storage

By default, every property of a record is serialized inline in the same page as the topology (vertex/edge identity and edges-out/edges-in lists). That keeps reads simple, but it means traversal-only queries pay for every heavy property in cache misses and I/O — even when the projection never touches them. A 4 KB embedding on every vertex pushes useful topology out of the page cache long before the working set is exhausted.

Properties marked `EXTERNAL true` are stored in a paired **external bucket** instead. The primary

record carries only a small pointer ([bucketId][position]); the value lives in a separate file that traversal-only queries never read.

Use it when:

- the property is large compared to the rest of the record (vector embeddings, long text, embedded JSON, full-text payloads), and
- most queries do not project the property.

Skip it for small, hot properties — the extra pointer indirection adds a page lookup on every read that does need the value.

**Per-bucket pairing**

Each primary bucket of a type that has at least one EXTERNAL property gets a paired bucket suffixed with _ext. The mapping is persisted in the schema and visible from SELECT FROM schema:types under the externalBuckets field, e.g. { "Person_0": "Person_0_ext" }. External buckets are internal: they are filtered out of schema:buckets by default and rejected by user-facing DML (INSERT INTO BUCKET: against an external bucket fails). To inspect them explicitly:

```
SELECT name, purpose FROM schema:buckets WHERE purpose <> 'PRIMARY'
```

External buckets show purpose: 'EXTERNAL_PROPERTY'.

**Compression**

The payload stored in the paired bucket can be LZ4-compressed via the per-property COMPRESSION attribute:

- none (default) — raw bytes; no compression overhead, no compression savings.
- lz4 — always LZ4-compressed.
- auto — try LZ4 and keep the compressed bytes only when they save more than 10% of the raw size; otherwise fall back to raw. The decision is made per record, so a single property can mix compressed and uncompressed records (text gets compressed, vector embeddings typically fall back to raw).

The compression mode is recorded in the main record's pointer byte, not inside the external blob, so reads dispatch to the right decoder without an extra header lookup.

**Migrating existing records**

Toggling EXTERNAL does not rewrite existing records eagerly. Each record is converted on its next write (insert, update, or upsert), and orphaned external values are reclaimed in the same transaction. To migrate a populated type at once, use REBUILD TYPE:

```
REBUILD TYPE Person
REBUILD TYPE Parent POLYMORPHIC
```

```
REBUILD TYPE Person WITH batchSize = 1000
```

#### Tiered storage

External buckets can be placed on a different volume from the primary buckets — for example, topology on fast NVMe and heavy payloads on cheaper bulk storage. Set the database-scope configuration `arcadedb.externalPropertyBucketPath` to the target directory before creating the EXTERNAL property; new paired buckets are created there instead of in the database directory. Existing external buckets are not relocated when this setting changes; move the files manually if you need to migrate after the fact.

#### Transactional semantics

- The primary record and its external value are written in the same transaction and WAL group, so commit, rollback, and crash recovery are atomic across both.
- Updating an EXTERNAL property updates the external record in place and does not rewrite the main record bytes.
- Deleting the primary record cascades the delete to every linked external record in the same transaction.
- If a property is toggled `EXTERNAL false`, renamed, or dropped, the orphaned external value is reclaimed on the next write of that record (or by `REBUILD TYPE`).

### 6.10.3. Buckets

A bucket is the physical storage unit for records of a type. Every type maps to one or more buckets, and each record lives in exactly one bucket. Buckets are append-friendly LSM files on disk; partitioning a type across multiple buckets unlocks per-bucket page locality and lets concurrent writers avoid contending on the same file.

The mapping between records and buckets is controlled by the type's Bucket Selection Strategy. Buckets are managed via `CREATE BUCKET`, `DROP BUCKET`, and `ALTER TYPE ⋯ BUCKET` (see `ALTER TYPE`). For the on-disk page layout and how records and RIDs are stored inside a bucket, see Storage Internals in the reference.

#### Bucket Selection Strategies

See Bucket Selection Strategy for an animated explanation of how each strategy dispatches new records.

When you create a type, it inherits the bucket selection strategy defined at the database level. By default this is `round-robin`. Change the database default with the `ALTER DATABASE` command, or override it per type with `ALTER TYPE`.

Supported strategies:

| Strategy | Description |
| --- | --- |
| `round-robin` | Selects the next bucket in a circular order, restarting once complete. |
| `thread` | Selects the next bucket by using the partition (mod) from the current thread id. This strategy gives the best results in terms of performance if you are using multiple threads and multiple buckets. |
| `partitioned(<primary-key>)` | Uses the primary key to assign a partition to the record. This allows to speedup the lookup into the index avoiding to search for a key in all the sub-indexes. Use this if you have multiple buckets and you want fast lookup but slower insertions. |

Picking the right strategy at type-creation time is one of the highest-leverage decisions you can make for query performance. See Schema design 101: choosing a bucket strategy for a 3-question decision tree, the anti-patterns to avoid, and the `WITH repartition = true` workflow for changing strategy on a populated type.

### 6.10.4. Indexes

An index is a secondary data structure that accelerates lookups, range scans, or similarity queries against a property (or composite of properties) on a type. ArcadeDB indexes are first-class schema objects: they live in their own files, are kept in sync transactionally, and survive restart and replication.

Several index implementations are available, chosen by the use case:

- `LSM_TREE` (default) — ordered key index for equality and range queries.
- `HASH_INDEX` — key-only equality lookups; smaller and faster than LSM when range scans are not needed.
- `LSM_VECTOR` — HNSW-based dense vector similarity (cosine, dot-product, Euclidean).
- `LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR` — learned-sparse retrieval (SPLADE, BGE-M3).
- `FULL_TEXT` — Lucene-backed text search with native BM25 ranking.

See Indexes in the concepts section for the algorithms, trade-offs, and the case-insensitive (COLLATE CI) variant. The SQL command surface is `CREATE INDEX`, `REBUILD INDEX`, and `DROP INDEX`.

### 6.10.5. Triggers

A trigger is a Java callback invoked by the engine on record-level events (before/after create, read, update, delete) for a given type. Triggers run inside the originating transaction, so they can validate, enrich, or reject writes, and propagate changes to external systems (web-socket fan-out, audit logs, derived caches).

The SQL command surface is `CREATE TRIGGER` / `DROP TRIGGER`; see Triggers for the registered-class contract and event-type table.

### 6.10.6. Materialized Views

A materialized view is a query result persisted as its own type, refreshed either manually, on a schedule, or incrementally as the underlying data changes. Once defined, a view is queried like any other type — the optimizer can rewrite queries to hit the view instead of the base type when the projection and filter match.

See Materialized Views for the refresh modes (manual, incremental, periodic) and the design trade-offs. SQL: `CREATE MATERIALIZED VIEW`, `ALTER MATERIALIZED VIEW`, `REFRESH MATERIALIZED VIEW`, `DROP MATERIALIZED VIEW`.

## 6.11. Inheritance

Unlike many object-relational mapping tools, ArcadeDB does not split documents between different types. Each document resides in one or a number of buckets associated with its specific type. When you execute a query against a type that has subtypes, ArcadeDB searches the buckets of the target type and all subtypes.

#### Declaring Inheritance in Schema

In developing your application, bear in mind that ArcadeDB needs to know the type inheritance relationship.

For example,

```
DocumentType account = database.getSchema().createDocumentType("Account");
DocumentType company = database.getSchema().createDocumentType("Company").
addSuperType(account);
```

#### Using Polymorphic Queries

By default, ArcadeDB treats all queries as polymorphic. Using the example above, you can run the following query from the console:

```
SELECT FROM Account WHERE name.toUpperCase() = 'GOOGLE'
```

This query returns all instances of the types `Account` and `Company` that have a property name that matches `Google`.

#### How Inheritance Works

Consider an example, where you have three types, listed here with the bucket identifier in the parentheses.

By default, ArcadeDB creates a separate bucket for each type. It indicates this bucket by the

`defaultBucketId` property in a type and indicates the bucket used by default when not specified. However, a type has a property `bucketIds`, (as `int[]`), that contains all the buckets able to contain the records of that type. The properties `bucketIds` and `defaultBucketId` are the same by default.

When you execute a query against a type, ArcadeDB limits the result-sets to only the records of the buckets contained in the `bucketIds` property. For example,

```
SELECT FROM Account WHERE name.toUpperCase() = 'GOOGLE'
```

This query returns all the records with the name property set to `GOOGLE` from all three types, given that the base type `Account` was specified. For the type `Account`, ArcadeDB searches inside the buckets `10`, `13` and `27`, following the inheritance specified in the schema.

# 6.12. Indexes

An **index** is a secondary data structure that speeds up a specific lookup pattern (equality, range, similarity, text search, spatial predicate) on a property — or on a composite of properties — of a type. Without an index, the query engine has to scan every record of the target type and evaluate the filter on each one. With the right index, it jumps straight to the matching records.

Indexes are first-class schema objects in ArcadeDB: they live in their own files, are kept in sync transactionally with the data, and survive restart and replication.

## 6.12.1. Why (and when) to add an index

Indexes are not free. Each insert, update, and delete also touches every index defined on the affected property, so a type with five indexes pays roughly five times the write cost of a type with none. The break-even point is the read/write ratio of the workload: if you read a property far more than you write it, an index is almost always worth it; if you mostly append and rarely filter, you can skip it.

Add an index when:

- You repeatedly filter by a property in `WHERE`, `JOIN`, or graph traversal (e.g. `WHERE email = ?`, `MATCH (u {username: $u})`).
- You sort or paginate by a property and need natural ordering (`ORDER BY created_at`).
- You enforce a uniqueness constraint (e.g. no two users with the same email).
- You need a **different** access pattern than ordered scans — vector similarity, full-text search, or spatial containment.

Skip an index when:

- The type is small enough that a full scan is already fast (a few thousand records).
- The property is write-hot and almost never queried.
- The selectivity is poor — indexing a boolean column with two values rarely beats a scan.

### 6.12.2. Index Types at a Glance

| Index | What it does | Use it for | SQL keyword |
|---|---|---|---|
| LSM Tree **(default)** | Ordered key index on disk. O(log N) lookups, native range scans, natural `ORDER BY`. | Equality, range, `ORDER BY`, joins, uniqueness constraints. | `LSM_TREE` |
| Hash Index | Unordered hash index with O(1) point lookups, no range support. | Primary-key access, JOINs, edge traversal where ordering is irrelevant. | `HASH` |
| Dense Vector (HNSW) | HNSW graph over `float32` (or `int8`) embeddings; configurable similarity metric. | Semantic similarity search over text/image/audio embeddings (RAG, recommendation). | `LSM_VECTOR` |
| Sparse Vector | Inverted posting lists on `(dim_id, weight)` pairs with WAND retrieval. | Learned-sparse retrieval (SPLADE, BGE-M3) with embeddings produced outside the database. For BM25 keyword ranking use the Full-Text index. | `LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR` |
| Full-Text | Lucene-backed tokeniser + analyser pipeline with native BM25 ranking (the default). | Natural-language keyword search ranked by BM25 relevance, fuzzy matching, "more like this", and the keyword leg of hybrid BM25 + vector search. | `FULL_TEXT` |
| Geospatial | Quad-key index over WKT geometries. | Spatial predicates (`geo.within`, `geo.intersects`, distance, bounding-box queries). | (geometry property) |

Each index can additionally be made **unique** (rejects duplicates), **case-insensitive** (see COLLATE CI), and configured with a **null strategy** (skip nulls, error on null, or index nulls).

### 6.12.3. LSM Tree (default)

ArcadeDB's default index uses a Log-Structured Merge Tree. New keys land in an in-memory write buffer; when the buffer fills, it is flushed to disk as an immutable sorted page. Background compaction periodically merges these pages so that lookups visit only a handful of files even as the index grows. You can also trigger a compaction on demand with `COMPACT INDEX`, for example to settle an index right after a bulk load. When you need to build a large LSM index over data that is **already loaded**, the sorted bulk build constructs it directly in compacted form and is dramatically faster than the record-at-a-time build.

Why ArcadeDB picks LSM by default:

- **Write-friendly**: inserts hit memory first, no in-place page updates, no random-write amplification.
- **Compaction is cheap**: data is already sorted, so merging two pages is a linear scan rather than a B+Tree rebalance.
- **Range and ordered access are native**: keys are stored in order, so `ORDER BY` and `WHERE x BETWEEN ?` walk the index directly without an in-memory sort.
- **Space-efficient**: keys are packed and compressed, with no half-empty B+Tree pages.

The classic B+Tree (the default in most relational databases) trades these write-side wins for slightly faster random-access reads on a steady-state index. If your workload is read-only and fits in memory, B+Tree can win small constants; under ingest pressure, mixed read/write, or large datasets on slow storage, LSM almost always wins. For the on-disk format and compaction details, see LSM-Tree Internals in the reference.

#### Large ranges: physical order and the scan fallback

Fetching records through an index costs one page access per record, in key order, which means in random order on disk. That is cheap for a selective condition and while the type fits the page cache, but a condition that matches a large share of the type - `WHERE shipdate <= '1998-09-02'` over most of a table - is then far slower than simply scanning the type. So, when the statement aggregates the rows (`count()`, `sum()`, `GROUP BY`, ...) or sorts them with an `ORDER BY` the index does not serve, the SQL engine reads the matching index entries alone, before loading any record, and decides:

- when more of them match than a share of the records the type holds, the index is set aside and the rows come from a scan of the type, filtered by the same condition;
- otherwise the matching records are loaded in **physical order** (bucket by bucket, in the order they are stored), so every page is read once, in a forward sweep, however many of its records match.

In SQL both run in parallel wherever a scan of the type would: the scan is the parallel scan, and the records loaded in physical order are shared among its workers, a slice of the sorted record addresses each. An aggregation over them runs in those workers too, together with the conditions the index does not answer. The index entries themselves are read by one thread, so the more workers the scan has, the sooner it wins: the share is `arcadedb.queryIndexMaxSelectivity` (0.6 by default) for a sequential scan, divided by (1 + W) / 2 for a scan on W workers - 24% of the type on 4 workers, 6% on 18. The OpenCypher label scan runs on one thread, so it gives way at the sequential share.

The decision is taken on every execution with the actual parameter values. `PROFILE` shows the choice under `EXTRACT VALUE FROM INDEX ENTRY` (`served by physical order`, with `loaded in parallel` when the workers loaded the records, or `served by full scan`). OpenCypher does the same for a `MATCH` anchored on an index range whose `RETURN` aggregates or has an `ORDER BY`: `PROFILE` then shows `NodeIndexRangeScan` as `served in physical order` or `served by label scan`. An OpenCypher `ORDER BY` on the indexed property itself, under a `LIMIT`, is answered from the index order instead, so the scan stops at the first rows rather than reading the whole range (see keyset pagination). Over a whole label this holds in both directions when the property is declared `MANDATORY` and `NOTNULL` (the constraint is trusted: `ALTER PROPERTY` does not validate vertices written before it), when the only

`WHERE` is `x IS NOT NULL`, and for an index created with `NULL_STRATEGY INDEX`, whose null keys are read from the end openCypher sorts them at (last ascending, first descending). Descending over a nullable property with the default null strategy still scans, because nulls sort first.

An OpenCypher `WHERE` that is an `OR` of equalities or `IN` lists on indexed properties is answered from the indexes, one seek per property with the vertices found by both returned once; with a disjunct on a property that has no index it scans. A `MATCH` whose filter uses only comparisons, arithmetic, string matching and `IN` on the node's properties (no function calls) scans its label in parallel, like the SQL scan, when the type is large enough and no transaction is open.

A statement whose result can show the order the rows arrive in keeps reading them in key order exactly as before: one that returns its rows as they come, with no aggregation and no `ORDER BY`; one using an order-sensitive aggregate such as `list()` (SQL) or `collect()` (OpenCypher); and a `GROUP BY` with `LIMIT` or `SKIP` but no `ORDER BY`. The adaptive fetch applies to `LSM_TREE` indexes with the default collation and no `BY ITEM`/`BY KEY`/`BY VALUE` property, searched with `=`, `<`, `<=`, `>`, `>=` or `BETWEEN`, and never to a point lookup on a `UNIQUE` index. Setting `arcadedb.queryIndexMaxSelectivity` to 0 turns it off.

LSM indexes come in four flavours, picked at `CREATE INDEX` time:

- `UNIQUE` — rejects duplicate keys.
- `NOTUNIQUE` — allows duplicates; the index returns every record with that key.
- `FULL_TEXT` — see Full-Text Index.
- Special variants for vector and spatial workloads — see the rest of this page.

### 6.12.4. Hash Index

When you only ever do point lookups (`WHERE id = ?`) and never sort or range-scan, a hash index is the right tool: each lookup is one or two page reads regardless of index size, with none of LSM's compaction overhead.

ArcadeDB uses extendable hashing, a disk-oriented variant:

1. Each key is hashed to a binary code; the index maintains a **global depth** — the number of leading bits used as a prefix.
2. A **directory** maps every $2^{\text{globalDepth}}$ prefix to a **bucket page**. Multiple directory entries can point at the same bucket while the bucket's **local depth** is shallower than the global depth.
3. A lookup hashes the key, reads the directory entry for the matching prefix, and scans the target bucket page: every entry has a 1-byte tag (the low byte of its key hash), so only the entries whose tag matches are compared in full.
4. When a bucket overflows, **only that bucket splits** — the local depth bumps by one, entries are redistributed, and the directory doubles only when the local depth exceeds the global depth.

| Use case | Hash | LSM Tree |
|---|---|---|
| Point lookup (`WHERE id = ?`) | **Best** — O(1), 1–2 page reads | O(log N), several page reads |

| Use case | Hash | LSM Tree |
|---|---|---|
| JOIN / edge traversal | **Best** — constant-time resolution | Good |
| Range scan (`WHERE age > 30`) | Not supported | **Best** — ordered iteration |
| `ORDER BY` on indexed field | Not supported | **Best** — natural ordering |
| Steady-state insert throughput | Consistent — no compaction | May dip during compaction |

Two modes are available: `UNIQUE_HASH` (rejects duplicates) and `NOTUNIQUE_HASH` (allows duplicates). The same null strategies as LSM are supported (`SKIP`, `ERROR`, `INDEX`): with `NULL_STRATEGY ERROR` a record whose indexed property is null or missing fails the commit, as it does on an LSM index.

A hash index answers an equality on its whole key only. A composite hash index on `(a, b)` is used when a query holds both `a` and `b` equal to a value, never for a condition on `a` alone: such a query is answered by a scan or by another index, without an error. With `NULL_STRATEGY INDEX`, a unique index (`UNIQUE` or `UNIQUE_HASH`) accepts any number of records whose key is entirely null, and `WHERE p IS NULL` returns all of them.

The entries of a bucket page are not kept in key order, so an insert appends the entry and one slot instead of shifting the slot directory. The page size defaults to 4 KB for fixed-width keys (numbers, dates, links) and 16 KB when a key column is a `STRING`, `BINARY` or `DECIMAL`; on the workloads measured this made hash inserts as fast as LSM or faster, and point lookups about three times faster. Since 26.11.1 a `NOTUNIQUE_HASH` key keeps its record ids inline in its entry while they take up to a quarter of a page; past that they move to pages of their own, and adding a record to the key writes the last of those pages only. Inserting into a key costs the same whether it holds ten record ids or millions, so `NOTUNIQUE_HASH` also suits low-cardinality columns, and the pages freed by deletions are reused. Hash indexes created before 26.11.1 keep every record id inline, where a key with thousands of records is slow to insert into, until `REBUILD INDEX` moves them to the current layout. A 26.10.1 server refuses to open a database holding a hash index created or rebuilt by 26.11.1 or later, naming the unknown layout version: before such a downgrade, drop the hash indexes and recreate them after it. Hash indexes created before version 26.10.1 keep their sorted pages (and their page size) and keep working; `REBUILD INDEX` moves them to the current layout. The layout version is part of the index file name, and a server older than 26.10.1 does not check it: it would read the new pages as sorted ones and corrupt the index. Never open a database holding a hash index created or rebuilt by 26.10.1 or later with an older server; after a downgrade, drop and recreate the hash indexes first (since 26.10.1 the bucket pages also carry a bit in the header that older servers misread). Loading many records per key into a `NOTUNIQUE_HASH` index no longer slows down as the key grows (a regression of 26.10.1 snapshots, fixed before the release). Smaller pages mean more of them (about 16 times more than at 64 KB for the same data), so expect more, smaller files, and a lookup scans the tags of the page, so an explicit page size above 16 KB makes hash lookups slower than the default, not faster; the directory is copied on every doubling and the previous copy stays in the file until the next rebuild.

### 6.12.5. Dense Vector Index (LSM_VECTOR)

`LSM_VECTOR` indexes dense `float32` (or quantized `int8`) embeddings using an HNSW graph layered on top of the LSM-Tree storage backbone. Use it for semantic similarity over text, image, or audio embeddings produced by a model — e.g. retrieval-augmented generation, "find similar products", or content-based recommendation.

What you get out of the box:

- **Similarity metrics**: `COSINE` (default), `DOT_PRODUCT`, `EUCLIDEAN`.
- **Quantization**: `NONE`, `INT8`, `BINARY`, or `PRODUCT` (index-internal compression that trades a bit of recall for a 4–8× memory reduction and a 2–3× search speed-up).
- **Wire encoding**: store the property as `ARRAY_OF_FLOATS` or as a `BINARY` byte-per-dim payload (`encoding: INT8`) to cut HTTP and bucket size 4× when your model emits int8 natively.
- **Persistent, transactional, replicated**: like every other ArcadeDB index, it survives restart, joins HA replication, and is updated inside the originating transaction.

See Vector Search for the full parameter table (dimensions, `efSearch`, `maxConnections`, beam width, multi-layer HNSW, on-graph storage) and worked examples in SQL, Cypher, and Java.

For wide vertices, declare the embedding property as `EXTERNAL true` so the bytes move out of the main bucket. Traversals that don't project the vector stop paying for it in cache misses. See Store Embeddings in an EXTERNAL Property.

### 6.12.6. Sparse Vector Index (LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR)

Where dense vectors collapse meaning into a few hundred floats, **sparse** vectors keep only the non-zero positions of a high-dimensional vocabulary — typically tens of thousands of token slots with a handful of non-zero weights per document. They are the natural output of learned-sparse retrieval models (SPLADE, BGE-M3, OpenSearch sparse encoders) and of BM25-as-sparse-vector pipelines, and they excel at exact-term recall where dense embeddings get fuzzy.

`LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR` stores the data as an inverted index — a posting list per dimension keyed by `(dim_id, rid, weight)` — and retrieves with document-at-a-time WAND, pruning postings whose cumulative upper bound cannot beat the current top-K score.

Per-document storage is two parallel array properties on the same record:

- `ARRAY_OF_INTEGERS` of non-zero dimension ids, and
- `ARRAY_OF_FLOATS` of the matching weights (non-negative).

Pair a dense and a sparse index on the same record for **hybrid retrieval**: dense vectors recover paraphrased / semantically close matches, sparse vectors anchor on exact terms, and Reciprocal Rank Fusion combines both rankings without score-scale calibration. See Sparse Vector Search and the surrounding hybrid-retrieval examples for the full reference and worked queries.

### 6.12.7. Full-Text Index

`FULL_TEXT` is built on top of ArcadeDB's LSM Tree — the index storage, ACID transactions, WAL, background compaction, replication, and HA all come for free from the underlying LSM implementation. Lucene is layered on top only for what it does best: the **analyzer** / **tokenizer** / **stemmer** pipeline that turns a free-text field into the searchable terms the LSM stores.

The result is a Lucene-quality search experience over text — tokenization, stemming, fuzzy match, "more like this" recommendations, relevance ranking — without the operational cost of running a separate Lucene index file format alongside the database.

Highlights:

- **LSM-Tree storage under the hood**: same crash-safe writes, compaction, and replication path as every other ArcadeDB index — no separate Lucene segments to manage.
- **Pluggable analyzer per field** (standard, stop-word, language-specific, custom) for tokenization and stemming.
- **Full Lucene query syntax** at query time: phrase, proximity, fuzzy (`~`), wildcards, boolean operators, and caret term boosts (`term^N`).
- **BM25 relevance scoring** (TF/IDF + document-length normalization, with tunable parameters and per-field boosts; legacy match-count `CLASSIC` scoring is still available) exposed as the `$score` query variable, so you can `ORDER BY $score DESC` and rank results.
- **"More like this"** support to find documents similar to a given record by their token distribution.

For the full create-index syntax, analyzer configuration, query language, scoring, and the MLT (more-like-this) configuration, see Full-Text Index in the data-modeling guide. To tune BM25 see Similarity Models, and to combine BM25 with vector search see Hybrid Retrieval.

### 6.12.8. Geospatial Index

A geospatial index sits on a property holding a WKT geometry string (Point, LineString, Polygon, MultiPolygon). The index encodes each shape's bounding region with a configurable quad-key precision so spatial predicates touch only the candidate cells instead of every row.

What it accelerates:

- `geo.within`, `geo.contains`, `geo.intersects` and the other `geo.*` spatial predicates.
- Bounding-box queries and "find everything within N km of point P".
- Joins between two spatial types (which features lie inside which polygons).

For the full SQL surface, precision tuning, and worked queries, see Geospatial Index in the data-modeling guide.

### 6.12.9. Case-Insensitive Indexes (COLLATE CI)

The text indexes above are case-sensitive by default: `"Hello"` and `"hello"` are different keys. Add

`COLLATE CI` to a property in the `CREATE INDEX` statement to fold case at index time. This affects LSM and Hash indexes; it does not apply to vector, sparse-vector, or full-text indexes (which have their own normalization story).

Effect:

- **Plain `=` and `IN` are case sensitive**: `WHERE Name = 'Hello World'` matches only `"Hello World"`, with or without the index. The index narrows the candidates and the condition is checked on the rows it returns, so the answer never depends on whether the optimizer used the index (since 26.11.1, issue #9403). For a case-insensitive lookup write it on `Name.toLowerCase()` (see below).
- **Range queries on the plain property** (`Name >= 'C'`, `Name BETWEEN 'a' AND 'c'`) never use the index. The index holds lower-cased keys and probes with a lower-cased bound, which is not the case-sensitive comparison the predicate asks for, so these conditions are evaluated by a scan and answer exactly as they do without the index (since 26.10.1, issue #8932). To get a case-insensitive range, write it on `Name.toLowerCase()`, which the index serves (see below).
- **Unique constraints** fold case: a `UNIQUE` index with `COLLATE CI` prevents inserting both `"Admin"` and `"admin"`.
- **Original values are preserved** in the document; only the index key is lowercased (using the root locale).
- **Sorting and aggregates ignore the index**: because the index order is the lowercased order, `ORDER BY`, SQL `min()`/`max()`, Cypher range predicates (`<`, `⇐`, `>`, `>=`), the native `select()` API range operators (including `between`) and Gremlin range `has()` on the property never use a `COLLATE CI` index for ordering, so they return the same result as without the index.

```
CREATE INDEX ON <type> (<property> COLLATE CI) <index-type>
```

Composite indexes can mix policies per property:

```
CREATE INDEX ON Product (Name COLLATE CI, Code) UNIQUE
```

Here `Name` is case-insensitive while `Code` remains case-sensitive.

The query optimizer recognizes `.toLowerCase()` on a property with a `COLLATE CI` index and rewrites the query to use the index directly:

```
SELECT FROM Product WHERE Name.toLowerCase() = 'hello world'
```

So existing applications that fold case in queries get the speedup for free.

The index is used for `=` and `IN` with any value, and the condition is still checked on the rows it returns, so `Name.toLowerCase() = 'HELLO'` (an upper-case value can never match a lower-cased name) correctly returns nothing. Ranges and `BETWEEN` on `Name.toLowerCase()` use the index only when their bounds are literals that are already lower case; with a mixed-case literal or a bound parameter the query is evaluated without the index. Since 26.10.1 the property name in

`toLowerCase()` must match the indexed property exactly, including its case (issue #8560).

When to reach for it:

- **User-facing lookups**: usernames, emails, product names — the end-user expects case-insensitive matching.
- **Deduplication**: a uniqueness constraint that ignores case.
- **Replacing `toLowerCase()` patterns**: the conversion happens once at insert time instead of on every query.

### 6.12.10. Building a large index over existing data (sorted bulk build)

Currently exposed through the Java API only (no SQL keyword yet).

Creating an index on a type that already holds data has to read every existing record and add its key to the index. The default path inserts those keys one at a time through the normal write buffer, exactly as if the records were being indexed live. That is fine for small and medium types, but it does not scale linearly: as the index grows, each insert does more work and the buffer flushes and compacts repeatedly mid-build, so the effective build rate **degrades as it runs**. On tens of millions of records the index step, not the data load, becomes the bottleneck.

The **sorted bulk build** is an opt-in, offline build strategy for exactly this situation. Instead of inserting keys one at a time, it:

1. scans the records and extracts the same index keys the normal path would (scalars, composites, list/map expansions, nulls, and collation are all preserved);
2. builds bounded, sorted runs in memory and spills them to disk when a configurable memory budget is reached, so the build stays within RAM regardless of dataset size;
3. k-way merges the runs into one globally sorted key stream; and
4. writes that stream directly as compacted on-disk pages.

Because the keys arrive already sorted, this replaces a growing sequence of against-a-growing-tree inserts with a bounded external sort followed by a sequential page write. The output is already in compacted form, so you also skip the post-build `COMPACT INDEX` step. On a 10-million-key index this reaches equivalent compacted output several times faster than the default build followed by a compaction.

```
database.getSchema().buildTypeIndex("Document", new String[] { "uri" })
    .withType(Schema.INDEX_TYPE.LSM_TREE)
    .withUnique(true)                // both unique and non-unique are supported
    .withBuildMode(IndexBuildMode.SORTED)
    .withBuildMemoryBudget(1L << 30) // optional: RAM budget in bytes; 0 (default)
auto-sizes from the heap
    .withBuildMergeFanIn(8)          // optional: number of runs merged per pass
(default 8, min 2)
    .create();
```

All three build options are optional: `withBuildMemoryBudget` bounds the RAM used before spilling (defaults to a fraction of the heap), `withBuildMergeFanIn` sets how many sorted runs are merged per pass, and `withBuildSpillDirectory(Path)` chooses where the temporary spill files are written (defaults to the database directory). They are ignored under `IndexBuildMode.DEFAULT`.

For a **unique** index, uniqueness is enforced directly on the globally sorted stream: two records that produce the same key are adjacent after the sort, so a duplicate is detected in a single pass (across all buckets, with no extra sort or in-memory hash set) and the build throws `DuplicatedKeyException` and publishes nothing. As with online unique indexes, an all-null key is exempt (SQL `NULL != NULL`), while a partial-null composite key is still constrained; the null strategy (`SKIP`, `ERROR`, `INDEX`) behaves exactly as it does for a normal build.

The sorted mode is an **explicit operator choice with strict preconditions**. It is restricted to:

- the `LSM_TREE` index type (unique or non-unique),
- a **single-server, non-replicated** database (not part of an HA cluster), and
- **no active transaction** on the calling thread (the build runs in its own exclusive window).

If any precondition is not met, the build **fails immediately, before creating any file** — it does not silently fall back to the slower default path, so you always get the strategy you asked for. Everything else (online reads and writes, HA replication) is unaffected because unsupported requests are rejected up front. Leave `withBuildMode` unset (or set it to `IndexBuildMode.DEFAULT`) to keep the standard record-at-a-time build.

Parallel construction, an automatic warn-and-fall-back mode, HA/replicated operation, and a SQL syntax are planned as follow-ups.

### 6.12.11. What can be indexed

ArcadeDB indexes can be defined on properties of nearly any type, with the right index choice per data shape:

| Property kind | Indexable | Typical index |
|---|---|---|
| Scalar (`STRING`, `INTEGER`, `LONG`, `FLOAT`, `DOUBLE`, `DATE`, `DATETIME`, `BOOLEAN`) | Yes | `LSM_TREE` for equality + range, `HASH` for point-only |
| Composite of N properties | Yes | `LSM_TREE` (ordered prefix scans) or `HASH` |
| `STRING` for natural language | Yes | `FULL_TEXT` |
| `ARRAY_OF_FLOATS` / `BINARY` embedding | Yes | `LSM_VECTOR` |
| `ARRAY_OF_INTEGERS` + `ARRAY_OF_FLOATS` (paired) | Yes | `LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR` |

| Property kind | Indexable | Typical index |
|---|---|---|
| `STRING` containing WKT geometry | Yes | Geospatial index |
| `LIST` / `ARRAY_OF_*` (per element) | Yes | `LSM_TREE` indexed by values |
| `MAP` | Yes | `LSM_TREE` indexed by keys or by values |

A `MAP` value indexed as a whole (without `BY KEY`/`BY VALUE`) is ordered by its sorted (key, value) pairs since v26.9.1, independently of the insertion order of the entries. An index of this kind created with an earlier version must be rebuilt after upgrading (`REBUILD INDEX`).

Unique and non-unique modes are available for the scalar and composite cases. For the exact SQL command syntax, see `CREATE INDEX`; to drop or rebuild after a schema change, see `DROP INDEX` and `REBUILD INDEX`; to force a compaction on demand (for example after a bulk load), see `COMPACT INDEX`.

### 6.12.12. See also

- Indexes in the Schema concepts page — the one-paragraph entry point with cross-refs.
- Sorted bulk build — fast offline construction of a large LSM index over existing data.
- LSM-Tree Internals — on-disk format, compaction, page layout.
- Vector Search — full reference for dense and sparse vectors and hybrid retrieval.
- Full-Text Index — analyzers, query syntax, scoring, MLT.
- Geospatial Index — precision tuning and spatial predicates.

## 6.13. Transactions

A transaction comprises a unit of work performed within a database management system (or similar system) against a database, and treated in a coherent and reliable way independent of other transactions. Transactions in a database environment have two main purposes:

- to provide reliable units of work that allow correct recovery from failures and keep a database consistent even in cases of system failure, when execution stops (completely or partially) and many operations upon a database remain uncompleted, with unclear status
- to provide isolation between programs accessing a database concurrently. If this isolation is not provided, the program's outcome are possibly erroneous.

A database transaction, by definition, must be atomic, consistent, isolated and durable. Database practitioners often refer to these properties of database transactions using the acronym ACID). - Wikipedia

ArcadeDB is an ACID compliant DBMS.

ArcadeDB keeps the transaction in the host's RAM, so the transaction size is affected by the available RAM (Heap memory) on JVM. For transactions involving many records, consider to split it in multiple transactions.

### 6.13.1. ACID Properties

### 6.13.2. Atomicity

"Atomicity requires that each transaction is 'all or nothing': if one part of the transaction fails, the entire transaction fails, and the database state is left unchanged. An atomic system must guarantee atomicity in each and every situation, including power failures, errors, and crashes. To the outside world, a committed transaction appears (by its effects on the database) to be indivisible ("atomic"), and an aborted transaction does not happen." - Wikipedia

### 6.13.3. Consistency

"The consistency property ensures that any transaction will bring the database from one valid state to another. Any data written to the database must be valid according to all defined rules, including but not limited to constraints, cascades, triggers, and any combination thereof. This does not guarantee correctness of the transaction in all ways the application programmer might have wanted (that is the responsibility of application-level code) but merely that any programming errors do not violate any defined rules." - Wikipedia

ArcadeDB uses the MVCC to assure consistency by versioning the page where the record are stored.

Look at this example:

| **Sequence** | **Client/Thread 1** | **Client/Thread 2** | **Version of page containing record X** |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Begin of Transaction | | |
| 2 | read(x) | | 10 |
| 3 | | Begin of Transaction | |
| 4 | | read(x) | 10 |
| 5 | | write(x) | 10 |
| 6 | | commit | 10 → 11 |
| 7 | write(x) | | 10 |
| 8 | commit | | 10 → 11 = Error, in database x already is at 11 |

### 6.13.4. Isolation

"The isolation property ensures that the concurrent execution of transactions results in a system state that would be obtained if transactions were executed serially, i.e. one after the other. Providing isolation is the main goal of concurrency control

method, the effects of an incomplete transaction might not even be visible to another transaction." - Wikipedia

The SQL standard defines the following phenomena which are prohibited at various levels are:

- **Dirty Read**: a transaction reads data written by a concurrent uncommitted transaction. This is never possible with ArcadeDB.
- **Non Repeatable Read**: a transaction re-reads data it has previously read and finds that data has been modified by another transaction (that committed since the initial read).
- **Phantom Read**: a transaction re-executes a query returning a set of rows that satisfy a search condition and finds that the set of rows satisfying the condition has changed due to another recently-committed transaction. This happens also when records are deleted or inserted during the transaction and they could become visible during the transaction.

The SQL standard transaction isolation levels are described in the table below:

| Isolation Level | Dirty Read | Non repeatable Read | Phantom Read |
|---|---|---|---|
| `READ_COMMITTED` (default) | Not possible | Possible | Possible |
| `REPEATABLE_READ` | Not possible | Not possible | Possible |

The SQL `SERIALIZABLE` level is not supported by ArcadeDB.

Under `REPEATABLE_READ` the pages a transaction reads are kept and read again from there, so a record read twice returns the same content. A record larger than a page spans several pages, and the transaction may already hold its first page from reading another record stored there. If another transaction rewrites the large record before it is read, the version that page belongs to can no longer be read whole, so the transaction reads the complete new version instead, never parts of two versions, and every later read of that record in the same transaction returns that same version. The other record keeps reading as it did. Updating the large record in that transaction fails with a retryable `ConcurrentModificationException`, because the page the transaction holds predates the rewrite: retrying the transaction applies the update on the new version *(since v26.11.1)*.

**Lost updates.** Under `READ_COMMITTED`, reading a record and then writing a value computed from it is protected against a concurrent change: if another transaction committed a change to the record after you read it, saving a property on it fails with a retryable `ConcurrentModificationException`, instead of silently overwriting that change. Retrying the transaction, for example with `database.transaction(…)`, reads the record again and applies the write on the new value.

This holds for records of any size, including documents larger than a page. Likewise, a `DELETE` that selected a record which another transaction then deleted and committed fails with a retryable `ConcurrentModificationException`, so the retry simply no longer finds the record.

```
database.transaction(() -> {
  Vertex v = rid.asVertex();
  v.modify().set("n", v.getInteger("n") + 1).save(); // retried, never lost
});
```

Adding or removing edges on a vertex is never refused, and a record kept from an earlier transaction is refreshed as before. The check can be disabled with the `txStaleReadCheck` setting *(since v26.10.1)*.

**Edges to a deleted vertex.** Creating an edge of a `UNIDIRECTIONAL` type to a vertex that another transaction deleted and committed meanwhile fails with a retryable `ConcurrentModificationException`, as it already did for bidirectional edges, so no edge is left pointing at a deleted vertex. Likewise, a transaction deleting a vertex fails and can be retried if another transaction committed an edge of a `UNIDIRECTIONAL` type ending in that bucket after the delete looked for its incoming edges *(since v26.10.1)*.

Using `remote` access all the commands are executed on the server, so out of transaction scope. Look below for more information.

Look at these examples:

| Sequence | Client/Thread 1 | Client/Thread 2 |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Begin of Transaction | |
| 2 | read(x) | |
| 3 | | Begin of Transaction |
| 4 | | read(x) |
| 5 | | write(x) |
| 6 | | commit |
| 7 | read(x) | |
| 8 | commit | |

At operation 7 the client 1 continues to read the same version of x read in operation 2.

| Sequence | Client/Thread 1 | Client/Thread 2 |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Begin of Transaction | |
| 2 | read(x) | |
| 3 | | Begin of Transaction |
| 4 | | read(y) |
| 5 | | write(y) |
| 6 | | commit |
| 7 | read(y) | |
| 8 | commit | |

At operation 7 the client 1 reads the version of y which was written at operation 6 by client 2. This is because it never reads y before.

### 6.13.5. Durability

"Durability means that once a transaction has been committed, it will remain so, even in the event of power loss, crashes, or errors. In a relational database, for instance, once a group of SQL statements execute, the results need to be stored permanently (even if the database crashes immediately thereafter). To defend against power loss, transactions (or their effects) must be recorded in a non-volatile memory." - Wikipedia

#### Fail-over

An ArcadeDB instance can fail for several reasons:

- Hardware problems, such as loss of power or disk error
- Software problems, such as a operating system crash
- Application problems, such as a bug that crashes your application that is connected to the ArcadeDB engine.

You can use the ArcadeDB engine directly in the same process of your application. This gives superior performance due to the lack of inter-process communication. In this case, should your application crash (for any reason), the ArcadeDB engine also crashes.

If you're connected to an ArcadeDB server remotely, and if your application crashes but the engine continues to work, any pending transaction owned by the client will be rolled back.

#### Auto-recovery

At start-up the ArcadeDB engine checks to if it is restarting from a crash. In this case, the auto-recovery phase starts which rolls back all pending transactions.

ArcadeDB has different levels of durability based on storage type, configuration and settings.

#### WAL Flush and Durability

ArcadeDB uses a Write-Ahead Log (WAL) to guarantee transaction durability. The `arcadedb.txWalFlush` setting controls whether the WAL is flushed (fsynced) to disk at commit time:

| Value | Behavior | Durability guarantee |
|---|---|---|
| `0` (default) | No flush. WAL is written to the OS page cache but not fsynced. | Safe against process crashes (OS page cache survives). **Not safe against power loss or OS crash** - committed transactions may be lost. |
| `1` | Flush without metadata (`fdatasync`). WAL content is fsynced to the storage device. | Safe against power loss. Recommended for production. |

| Value | Behavior | Durability guarantee |
|---|---|---|
| `2` | Full flush (`fsync`). WAL content and all filesystem metadata (including timestamps) are fsynced. | No additional recovery value over `1`: `fdatasync` already flushes the metadata needed to read back the appended records (POSIX). Benchmarks show no measurable performance difference either. |

#### Why write order is not persistence order

At commit time ArcadeDB always issues the WAL `write()` **before** the data pages are published, so the write-ahead ordering holds in program order. With `txWalFlush=0`, however, both writes only land in the OS page cache as dirty pages: the kernel's writeback persists dirty pages based on memory pressure, LRU and expiry timers, **with no ordering guarantee between them**, and the block layer and the drive cache can reorder further. Ordering on the physical medium is only ever enforced by an explicit barrier (`fsync`/`fdatasync`). On a power loss or kernel panic it is therefore possible for a data page to have reached the disk while its WAL record did not - despite the WAL having been written first.

The consequence is worse than losing the most recent transactions: a multi-page transaction can persist some pages and not others, with **no WAL record to replay or repair from** - torn records across pages and indexes pointing at data that never persisted. This is structural corruption, which is why `txWalFlush=1` is the production recommendation: it makes the WAL record durable at commit, after which data pages may lag arbitrarily because recovery replays them from the WAL.

Two technical notes:

- `txWalFlush=1` (`fdatasync`-class) is sufficient for the WAL's append-only pattern: POSIX `fdatasync` also flushes the metadata needed to **read the data back**, which includes the file-size extension of an append. Level `2` adds only timestamp-class metadata, with no recovery value - benchmarks show no measurable difference between the two.
- `txWalFlush=0` **is** safe against process crashes (the OS page cache survives the process), only power loss and kernel panics are at risk.

#### Data files and WAL deletion

A WAL file is deleted in three places: on a clean close of the database, when the background WAL rotation retires a full WAL file, and at the end of the recovery that replayed it after a crash. Before each deletion ArcadeDB forces to disk the data files that the WAL still protects, because once the WAL is gone the data files are the only copy of those pages.

Only the files that need it are forced: a data file is forced when a page was written to it, or when it was created or renamed, since its last successful fsync. A file that was only read is skipped, since it holds nothing that is not already on disk. A file with page writes only is forced with `fdatasync`, which also persists the file-size change of an append. A created or renamed file is forced with a full `fsync`, followed by an fsync of its directory, so its directory entry survives a power loss too. If an fsync fails, the WAL is kept, and the next pass retries the fsync. If a clean close cannot complete it, the WAL and the lock file stay on disk, and the next open runs recovery.

Up to version 26.9.x, a clean close forced every data file of the database, including the files that nothing had written. Each of those fsyncs costs a flush of the device write cache, about half a millisecond per file on a laptop NVMe drive and more on network or cloud block storage. So the close of a database with 100 indexed types took about 100 ms even after a read-only session. Now a close after a read-only session forces no file. After a crash, recovery forces every data file once, because it is not known which writes of the crashed process reached the disk.

**Measured cost**

Commit-heavy benchmark (one small insert per transaction, so the WAL flush dominates; Apple silicon laptop, macOS):

| Level | TPS (1 thread) | Latency (1 thread) | TPS (8 threads) | Latency (8 threads) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `0` (no flush) | 24,813 | 40 us | 68,772 | 116 us |
| `1` (fdatasync) | 282 | 3.5 ms | 587 | 13.6 ms |
| `2` (full fsync) | 305 | 3.3 ms | 620 | 12.9 ms |

The dramatic gap on macOS is platform-specific: Java's `force()` issues `F_FULLFSYNC` there, which drains the entire drive write cache (~3 ms on Apple SSDs). On Linux server hardware with NVMe, `fdatasync` typically costs 30-100 us, so the production penalty is far smaller than this laptop measurement suggests. Reproduce on your own hardware with `mvn -pl engine test -Dtest=WALFlushBenchmark` from the ArcadeDB source tree.

In `production` server mode (`arcadedb.server.mode=production`), ArcadeDB automatically sets `txWalFlush=1` if you have not explicitly configured it. This ensures that production deployments are durable by default. If you explicitly set `txWalFlush=0` in production mode, a warning is logged at startup. Note the server mode **defaults to** `development`, so a server that never sets the mode - and any embedded application - runs with `txWalFlush=0`: set the mode (or the setting) explicitly for durability.

The WAL flush setting can also be changed per-database or per-thread via the Java API:

```
// Per-database: every thread's transactions, from now on
database.setWALFlush(WALFile.FlushType.YES_NOMETADATA);

// Per-thread: this thread's transactions, from now on, whatever the database setting
says
database.getTransaction().setWALFlush(WALFile.FlushType.YES_FULL);

// Hand the thread back to the database setting
database.getTransaction().setWALFlush(null);
```

```
// Per async executor
database.async().setTransactionSync(WALFile.FlushType.YES_NOMETADATA);
```

`setUseWAL()` and `setAsyncFlush()` follow the same rule: on `Database` they apply to every thread, on `getTransaction()` to the calling thread only, and the thread's own setting wins. Until either is called, the `arcadedb.txWAL` and `arcadedb.txWalFlush` configuration applies.

Before 26.10.1, `Database.setWALFlush()`, `setUseWAL()` and `setAsyncFlush()` changed only the calling thread's transactions, despite reading as database-wide. A multi-threaded application that called `setWALFlush(YES_FULL)` once at startup had its commits flushed on that thread only (issue #8352). They are database-wide now. An application that relied on the old per-thread scope, for example a bulk loader turning the WAL off on its own thread while other threads keep writing, must call the same setter on `database.getTransaction()` instead.

If your storage hardware has battery-backed write cache (BBU/BBWC) or power-loss protection (common in enterprise SSDs and cloud block storage like AWS EBS), `txWalFlush=0` is safe even in production because the hardware guarantees that buffered writes reach persistent storage on power loss.

### 6.13.6. Optimistic Transaction

This mode uses the well known Multi Version Control System MVCC by allowing multiple reads and writes on the same records. The integrity check is made on commit. If the record has been saved by another transaction in the interim, then an `ConcurrentModificationException` will be thrown. The application can choose either to repeat the transaction or abort it.

ArcadeDB keeps the whole transaction in the host's RAM, so the transaction size is affected by the available RAM (Heap) memory on JVM. For transactions involving many records, consider to split it in multiple transactions.

A `ConcurrentModificationException` always means another transaction wrote the record: it is never raised because of something the transaction did to itself. In particular, updating a record that the same transaction has already deleted is not a conflict, it simply has no effect - the delete wins, since the record will not exist once the transaction commits. The order of the two operations does not matter.

### 6.13.7. Nested transactions and propagation

ArcadeDB does support nested transaction. If a `begin()` is called after a transaction is already begun, then the new transaction is the current one until commit or rollback. When this nested transaction is completed, the previous transaction becomes the current transaction again.

## 6.14. Data Types

ArcadeDB supports several data types natively. Below is the complete table.

| Type | SQL type | Description | Java type | Minimum — Maximum | Auto-conversion from/to |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Boolean | BOOLEAN | Handles only the values **True** or **False** | `java.lang.Boolean` or `boolean` | 0 — 1 | String |
| Integer | INTEGER | 32-bit signed Integers | `java.lang.Integer` or `int` | -2,147,483,648 — +2,147,483,647 | Any Number, String |
| Short | SHORT | Small 16-bit signed integers | `java.lang.Short` or `short` | -32,768 — 32,767 | Any Number, String |
| Long | LONG | Big 64-bit signed integers | `java.lang.Long` or `long` | $-2^{63}$ — $+2^{63}-1$ | Any Number, String |
| Float | FLOAT | Decimal numbers | `java.lang.Float` or `float` | $2^{-149}$ — $(2-2^{-23})*2^{127}$ | Any Number, String |
| Double | DOUBLE | Decimal numbers with high precision | `java.lang.Double` or `double` | $2^{-1074}$ — $(2-2^{-52})*2^{1023}$ | Any Number, String |
| Datetime | DATETIME | Any date with the precision up to milliseconds. To know more about it, look at Managing Dates | `java.util.Date` | | Date, Long, String |
| String | STRING | Any string as alphanumeric sequence of chars | `java.lang.String` | | |
| Binary | BINARY | Can contain any value as byte array | `byte[]` | 0 — 2,147,483,647 | String |
| Embedded | EMBEDDED | The Record is contained inside the owner. The contained record has no RID | `EmbeddedDocument` | | EmbeddedDocument |

| Type | SQL type | Description | Java type | Minimum — Maximum | Auto-conversion from/to |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Embedded list | LIST | The Records are contained inside the owner. The contained records have no RIDs and are reachable only by navigating the owner record | `List<EmbeddedDocument>` | 0 — 41,000,000 items | String |
| Embedded map | MAP | The Records are contained inside the owner as values of the entries, while the keys can only be Strings. The contained records have no RIDs and are reachable only by navigating the owner Record | `Map<String, EmbeddedDocument>` | 0 — 41,000,000 items | `Collection<? extends EmbeddedDocument<?>>`, `String` |
| Link | LINK | Link to another Record. It's a common one-to-one relationship | `RID`, `<? extends Record>` | 1:-1 — 32767:$2^{63}$ -1 | String |
| Byte | BYTE | Single byte. Useful to store small 8-bit signed integers | `java.lang.Byte` or `byte` | -128 — +127 | Any Number, String |
| Decimal | DECIMAL | Decimal numbers without rounding | `java.math.BigDecimal` | | Any Number, String |

| Type | SQL type | Description | Java type | Minimum — Maximum | Auto-conversion from/to |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Vector | ARRAY_OF_? | Vector of scalar types: SHORTS, INTEGERS, LONGS, FLOATS, DOUBLES. A full type is for example then ARRAY_OF_FLOATS | | | Tuples |

Embedded types, like `EMBEDDED` (document), (embedded) `LIST`, and (embedded) `MAP` are non-scalar types.

A vector type can be either `LIST OF SHORT|INTEGER|LONG|FLOAT|DOUBLE` or `ARRAY_OF_SHORTS|INTEGERS|LONGS|FLOATS|DOUBLES`.

An equality lookup (`=`, `<>`, `IN`) on a `FLOAT` or `DOUBLE` property converts the operand to the property's type, with or without an index. A `FLOAT` holding `0.1` is therefore found by the double `0.10000000149011612` (what you get by reading the `FLOAT` back as a double), and a `DOUBLE` is found by the `BigDecimal` that rounds to it. Ordering (`<`, `>`) is unchanged and reads a `FLOAT` by its decimal value, so a value can satisfy both `=` and `<` against the same operand.

A write to a declared property is refused, with an error naming the property, when the value cannot be held by the type: a boolean, list, map or date for a numeric property, an empty string for a numeric property, a number outside the 64-bit range for a `LONG` (or a finite number that overflows a `FLOAT` or `DOUBLE`), an empty or digit-only string for a `DATETIME`, a string for a `BINARY`, a non-link value for a `LINK`, or an array for a `STRING`. A `STRING` holding a lone UTF-16 surrogate (for example `"\uD83D"`, which cannot be encoded as UTF-8) is refused with a validation error instead of being stored as `?` *(since v26.10.1)*. Such a value is never stored as `NULL`, `0` or as a value of another type, with or without an index. A number written to a `BOOLEAN` is `false` only when it is `0`.

A `java.math.BigInteger` written to a property with no declared type keeps its exact value: inside the 64-bit range it is stored as an `INTEGER` or `LONG`, outside it as a `DECIMAL` (it reads back as a `BigDecimal` with the same digits), never as a rounded `DOUBLE`.

Equality lookups give the same answer with or without an index. Two `DECIMAL` values are equal when they have the same numeric value, whatever their scale

(`19.9` equals `19.90`). A `DATETIME` property is matched by a `java.time.Instant`, `ZonedDateTime` or `OffsetDateTime` of the same moment. A `BOOLEAN` property is matched by `true`/`false` as a string or by a number (`0` is false, anything else is true); an operand that does not read as a boolean matches nothing.

When serializing floating point types `FLOAT` and `DOUBLE` to JSON, `NaN`, `Inf`, and `-Inf` are cast to `null`, wherever they appear, including inside lists and arrays (before v26.10.1 a non-finite value inside a list was written as `0`) *(since v26.10.1)*.

**Embedded `MAP` vs `EMBEDDED` Document**

A `MAP` type and an `EMBEDDED` type are both a hierarchy of key-value pairs (think JSON); but the `EMBEDDED` type needs to know which document type it is an instance of. Hence, to embed a document, a document type needs to be declared beforehand, such that upon embedding validity of constrains (if existing) can be checked.

The embedded type is taken from either of two places:

- a `@type` property in the value's top-level, naming an existing document type, or
- the property's own declared embedded type, when the property was created with one (`CREATE PROPERTY Person.address EMBEDDED OF Address`).

If the property declares an embedded type, a plain map is enough and you do not have to repeat `@type`:

```
person.set("address", Map.of("city", "Rome"));
```

A `@type` in the value still takes precedence where present, which is how you store a subtype of the declared one. If neither is available, the value is rejected.

## 6.15. Binary Types (BLOB)

While some DBMSs (like OrientDB) specifically support BLOBs (Binary Large OBjects) record types, with ArcadeDB the binary content must be stored as a property in documents, vertices and edges.

To create a BLOB like type, you can define a "Blob" document type and add a property of type `BINARY`. Then you can set and retrieve the binary content as byte array (`byte[]`). Example:

```
database.transaction(() -> {
  // DEFINE THE BLOB TYPE
  DocumentType blobType = database.getSchema().createDocumentType("Blob");
  blobType.createProperty("binary", Type.BINARY);
  ...
  // STORE SOME BINARY CONTENT IN THE DOCUMENT PROPERTY
  final MutableDocument blob = database.newDocument("Blob");
  blob.set("binary", "This is a test".getBytes());
  blob.save(); // THE DOCUMENT IS SAVED IN THE DATABASE ONLY WHEN `.save()` IS CALLED
```

```
  ...
  // RETRIEVE THE BINARY CONTENT FROM THE DOCUMENT PROPERTY
  final Document blob = database.iterateType("Blob", false).next().asDocument();
  byte[] binaryContent = blob.getBinary("binary");
});
```

## 6.16. Managing Dates

ArcadeDB treats dates as first class citizens. Internally, it saves dates in the Unix time format. Meaning, it stores dates as a `long` variable, which contains the count in milliseconds since the Unix Epoch, (that is, 1 January 1970).

ArcadeDB fully supports the new Java Time API with a custom precision from second to nanoseconds. The data types to manage date/time are:

- `DATE`, to handle dates without a time. Example: `01/01/2023`
- `DATETIME_SECOND`, to handle datetime with the precision of the second. Example: `01/01/2023 10:30:00`
- `DATETIME`, to handle datetime with the precision of the millisecond. Example: `01/01/2023 10:30:00.333`
- `DATETIME_MICROS`, to handle datetime with the precision of the microsecond. Example: `01/01/2023 10:30:00`
- `DATETIME_NANOS`, to handle datetime with the precision of the nanosecond. Example: `01/01/2023 10:30:00`

using high precision types increase the space used on disk. For example, using nanosecond precision instead of millisecond increase the space requested to store the datetime of a factor of 2X.

*(Since v26.11.1)* a value outside the range its precision can represent is refused with an error instead of being stored as a different instant. Each type stores a 64-bit count of its unit since the epoch, so `DATETIME_NANOS` holds instants from 1677-09-21 to 2262-04-11 and `DATETIME_MICROS` about 292,000 years either way. Before, an instant past the range - for example a "no expiration" date such as `9999-12-31` written to a `DATETIME_NANOS` property - was stored as `2262-04-11T23:47:16.854775807`. Comparing values is unaffected: a date past the range still compares after every date inside it.

#### Dates Inside Lists and Maps over HTTP

A datetime stored inside a `LIST` or a `MAP` is returned by the HTTP API as a formatted string that keeps its full precision (for example `"2026-10-03 12:34:56.123457"`), exactly like a scalar datetime property. Before 26.10.1 list items were returned as epoch milliseconds, and map values lost their fractional seconds. *(Available since v26.10.1)*

#### Precision on Undeclared Properties

If a property is not declared in the schema, ArcadeDB stores every datetime at the precision of the value itself, so a microsecond value keeps its microseconds without any declaration.

Creating an index or a constraint on such a property with Cypher (`CREATE INDEX`, `CREATE CONSTRAINT`) declares it in the schema, and the type is inferred from the data already stored: ArcadeDB picks the highest precision it finds, so existing microsecond values give `DATETIME_MICROS`. Milliseconds are the minimum, so a property holding only whole seconds is declared `DATETIME` and not `DATETIME_SECOND`.

To choose the precision yourself rather than relying on the inference, declare the property before creating the index:

```
CREATE PROPERTY Event.created_at DATETIME_MICROS
```

If you're working with the Java API, by default ArcadeDB uses the new Java Time API on deserialization: `DATE` values are returned as `java.time.LocalDate` and `DATETIME` values as `java.time.LocalDateTime`. These defaults are controlled by the `arcadedb.dateImplementation` and `arcadedb.dateTimeImplementation` settings.

The supported implementations are:

- for `DATE`: `java.time.LocalDate` (default), `java.util.Date`, `java.util.Calendar`, `java.time.LocalDateTime` (midnight of the day)
- for `DATETIME`: `java.time.LocalDateTime` (default), `java.util.Date`, `java.util.Calendar`, `java.time.ZonedDateTime`, `java.time.Instant`

`java.util.Date` and `java.util.Calendar` can only handle precision down to the millisecond. When `arcadedb.dateTimeImplementation` is set to one of them, `DATETIME_MICROS` and `DATETIME_NANOS` values are returned as `java.time.LocalDateTime`, so no precision is lost; `DATETIME` and `DATETIME_SECOND` values are returned as the configured class. Before 26.10.1 such `DATETIME_MICROS`/`DATETIME_NANOS` values were read back as `NULL` (the data on disk was intact and reads correctly after the upgrade).

before 26.11.1, `arcadedb.dateImplementation=java.time.LocalDateTime` read every `DATE` as a timestamp in January 1970 and the value read could not be written back. A `DATE` now reads as midnight of its day, and writing a `LocalDateTime` to a `DATE` property keeps only the day. The data on disk was never affected.

stored `DATETIME` values keep no time zone. In an openCypher comparison a stored value takes the zone of the datetime it is compared with, so `e.ts = datetime('2026-01-01T11:00:00Z')` and `e.ts = datetime('2026-01-01T12:00:00+01:00')` both match the same instant, whatever `arcadedb.dateTimeImplementation` is set to. Before 26.11.1, with `java.time.ZonedDateTime` a stored value did not equal the `Z` literal for its own instant, and with `java.util.Date` or `java.time.Instant` it matched `Z` but not the same instant in another zone.

before 26.10.1, setting `arcadedb.dateImplementation` to `java.util.Date` or `java.util.Calendar` was not applied to `DATE` properties: values were stored as a full timestamp and read back as a `java.time.LocalDateTime`. If you used that setting, `DATE` properties written by an earlier version hold a timestamp rather than a day, and the extra time of day is still there when you read them.

If you prefer the legacy `java.util.Date` (for example, for compatibility with existing code), you can change the defaults at the database level:

```
alter database `arcadedb.dateTimeImplementation` `java.util.Date`
alter database `arcadedb.dateImplementation` `java.util.Date`
```

#### Time of Day, Zoned Datetime and Duration Types

*(Available since v26.11.1)* Four more types hold what the openCypher `time()`, `localtime()`, `datetime()` and `duration()` functions return, without losing the offset, the zone or the months/days parts:

- `OFFSET_TIME`, a time of day with a UTC offset (`java.time.OffsetTime`). Example: `09:00:00-05:00`
- `LOCAL_TIME`, a time of day without an offset (`java.time.LocalTime`). Example: `10:15:30`
- `ZONED_DATETIME`, a datetime with the zone or offset it was written with (`java.time.ZonedDateTime`). Example: `2024-01-01T10:00:00+01:00[Europe/Rome]`
- `DURATION`, an openCypher duration with months, days, seconds and nanoseconds (`DURATION` values read back as `com.arcadedb.query.opencypher.temporal.CypherDuration`). Example: `P1M2DT3S`

openCypher stores these four natively, so a value always reads back as what it was written as, with no guessing from its text. A String that merely looks temporal, such as the opening hours `09:00-17:00` or a code like `P100D`, is a String and stays a String. Before 26.11.1 these four types were stored as Strings and openCypher guessed their type when reading an undeclared property, so `09:00-17:00` came back as a time and `WHERE l.hours = '09:00-17:00'` matched nothing.

All four can be indexed, with both `LSM_TREE` and `HASH`. A `ZONED_DATETIME` and an `OFFSET_TIME` compare as in openCypher and Neo4j: the same instant in two zones is two different values, so `12:00:00+01:00` does not equal `11:00:00Z`, with or without an index, and a unique index accepts both. Values are ordered by instant, then by UTC offset from west to east, then by zone name.

If a property is declared with one of these types and a record holds a String for it, the String is converted when the record is read and saved in the native type the next time the record is written. A String that cannot be converted is read as it is.

a zoned `datetime()` written to a property declared `DATETIME` is stored as an instant and reads back as the UTC wall clock, like any other `java.time` value. Before 26.11.1 it kept the local wall clock of its zone.

In JSON, these four types are written as their ISO text, for example `"2026-01-01T00:30+02:00"` for a `ZONED_DATETIME` and `"00:30+02:00"` for an `OFFSET_TIME`, also inside a `LIST` or a `MAP`. This is what the HTTP API always returned, and *(since v26.11.1)* `Result.toJSON()`, the SQL `asJSON()` method and the PostgreSQL wire protocol agree with it. Before 26.11.1 they wrote a `ZONED_DATETIME` as epoch

milliseconds, which lost the zone, and an `OFFSET_TIME` as `null`.

### Migrating Cypher Temporals Stored as Strings

A database written by an earlier version holds these values as Strings in undeclared properties, and they are now read as Strings. To get native values back, declare the property with its type and copy the String into it. `UPDATE Place SET hours = hours` does not do it: with the property declared the read has already converted the String, so the value looks unchanged and ArcadeDB skips the write.

The script parks the String in a scratch property, declares the property, and copies the String back. Run it with `sqlscript`, once per property, replacing `Place`, `hours` and `OFFSET_TIME` (use `LOCAL_TIME`, `ZONED_DATETIME` or `DURATION` for the other types):

```
BEGIN;
UPDATE Place SET hours_old = hours;
UPDATE Place REMOVE hours;
COMMIT;

CREATE PROPERTY Place.hours OFFSET_TIME;

BEGIN;
UPDATE Place SET hours = hours_old WHERE hours_old IS NOT NULL;
UPDATE Place REMOVE hours_old;
COMMIT;
```

Only run it on a property that holds temporal Strings, and take a backup first. Do not remove `hours_old` until you have checked that every record has its `hours` value (`SELECT count(*) FROM Place WHERE hours_old IS NOT NULL AND hours IS NULL` must be `0`). On a large type, run the `UPDATE` statements in batches with `LIMIT`.

#### Date and Datetime Formats

In order to make the internal count from the Unix Epoch into something human readable, ArcadeDB formats the count into date and datetime formats. By default, these formats are ISO 8601:

- Date Format: `yyyy-MM-dd`
- Datetime Format: `yyyy-MM-dd HH:mm:ss`

A `DATE` is a calendar day, not an instant, so it is always rendered as the day it was stored: the result does not change with the time zone of the server that answers the request. Only `DATETIME` values carry a time of day.

When a `DATE` is written as a JSON number (for example in the result of a projection such as `SELECT day FROM Event`), it is the milliseconds of that day at midnight UTC, whatever the time zone of the server. Before 26.10.1 the midnight was taken in the server's own time zone, so the number changed from one server to another.

#### Accepted Input Strings

The configured formats above are what ArcadeDB **renders**. On input, a string assigned to a `DATE` or `DATETIME*` property is accepted in any of these spellings, tried in order:

1. ISO 8601 without a zone, e.g. `2024-02-29T13:45:10.123456`;
2. ISO 8601 with an offset or `Z`, e.g. `2024-02-29T13:45:10.123456+01:00`;
3. the database's `DATETIMEFORMAT`;
4. the database's `DATEFORMAT`;
5. the SQL timestamp spelling: an ISO date, a **space**, an optional time with an optional fractional second of any precision, and an optional offset - e.g. `2024-02-29 13:45:10.123456`, `2024-02-29 13:45:10.123456+01`, `2024-02-29 13:45`, `2024-02-29`. This is what PostgreSQL prints and what `psqlodbc` binds a timestamp as.

The database's own formats are tried before the last one, so customizing them can never be overridden by it.

How an offset in the string is treated depends on the type the value is stored as, which is set by `arcadedb.dateTimeImplementation`. With the default `java.time.LocalDateTime` the time is kept as written and the offset is not applied, so `13:45:10+01:00` is stored as `13:45:10`. With an instant-bearing type such as `java.time.Instant` or `java.util.Date` the offset is honoured and the value is stored as the instant it names.

A string that matches **none** of these is rejected: the `INSERT` or `UPDATE` fails with an error naming the property. It is never stored as `NULL`. The same applies to the `date()` function and the `.asDatetime()` method when called without an explicit format, except that `date()` keeps its documented `NULL` answer for a value it cannot read.

Before 26.10.1 an unparseable date string was silently stored as `NULL` and the write reported success.

In the event that these default formats are not sufficient for the needs of your application, you can customize them through `ALTER DATABASE … DATEFORMAT` and `DATETIMEFORMAT` commands. For instance,

```
arcadedb> ALTER DATABASE DATEFORMAT "dd MMMM yyyy"
```

This command updates the current database to use the English format for dates. That is, 14 Febr 2015.

#### SQL Functions and Methods

To simplify the management of dates, ArcadeDB SQL automatically parses dates to and from strings and longs. These functions and methods provide you with more control to manage dates:

| SQL | Description |
|---|---|
| `date()` | Function converts dates to and from strings and dates, also uses custom formats. |
| `sysdate()` | Function returns the current date. |
| `.format()` | Method returns the date in different formats. |
| `.asDate()` | Method converts any type into a date. |
| `.asDatetime()` | Method converts any type into datetime. |
| `.asLong()` | Method converts any date into long format, (that is, Unix time). |
| `.precision()` | Method modifies the precision of a datetime property. For example, `.precision('millisecond')` returns the datetime property with millisecond precision |

For example, consider a case where you need to extract only the years for date entries and to arrange them in order. You can use the `.format` method to extract dates into different formats.

```
arcadedb> SELECT @RID, id, date.format('yyyy') AS year FROM Order
```

```
+--------+----+------+
| @RID   | id | year |
+--------+----+------+
| #31:10 | 92 | 2015 |
| #31:10 | 44 | 2014 |
| #31:10 | 32 | 2014 |
| #31:10 | 21 | 2013 |
+--------+----+------+
```

In addition to this, you can also group the results. For instance, extracting the number of orders grouped by year.

```
arcadedb> SELECT date.format('yyyy') AS Year, COUNT(*) AS Total FROM Order ORDER BY
Year
```

```
+------+--------+
| Year |  Total |
+------+--------+
| 2015 |      1 |
| 2014 |      2 |
| 2013 |      1 |
+------+--------+
```

#### Dates before 1970

While you may find the default system for managing dates in ArcadeDB sufficient for your needs, there are some cases where it may not prove so. For instance, consider a database of archaeological finds, a number of which date to periods not only before 1970 but possibly even before the Common Era. You can manage this by defining an era or epoch variable in your dates.

For example, consider an instance where you want to add a record noting the date for the foundation of Rome, which is traditionally referred to as April 21, 753 BC. To enter dates before the Common Era, first run the [`ALTER DATABASE DATETIMEFORMAT`] command to add the `GG` variable to use in referencing the epoch.

```
arcadedb> ALTER DATABASE DATETIMEFORMAT "yyyy-MM-dd HH:mm:ss GG"
```

Once you've run this command, you can create a record that references date and datetime by epoch.

```
arcadedb> CREATE VERTEX V SET city = "Rome", date = DATE("0753-04-21 00:00:00 BC")
arcadedb> SELECT @RID, city, date FROM V
```

```
+-------+------+-----------------------+
| @RID  | city | date                  |
+-------+------+-----------------------+
| #9:10 | Rome | 0753-04-21 00:00:00 BC |
+-------+------+-----------------------+
```

#### Using `.format()` on Insertion

In addition to the above method, instead of changing the date and datetime formats for the database, you can format the results as you insert the date.

```
arcadedb> CREATE VERTEX V SET city = "Rome", date = DATE("yyyy-MM-dd HH:mm:ss GG")
arcadedb>  SELECT @RID, city, date FROM V
```

```
+------+------+-----------------------+
| @RID | city | date                  |
+------+------+-----------------------+
| #9:4 | Rome | 0753-04-21 00:00:00 BC |
+------+------+-----------------------+
```

Here, you again create a vertex for the traditional date of the foundation of Rome. However, instead of altering the database, you format the date field in `CREATE VERTEX` command.

#### Viewing Unix Time

In addition to the formatted date and datetime, you can also view the underlying count from the Unix Epoch, using the `asLong()` method for records. For example,

```
arcadedb> SELECT @RID, city, date.asLong() FROM #9:4
```

```
+------+------+-----------------------+
| @RID | city | date                  |
+------+------+-----------------------+
| #9:4 | Rome | -85889120400000       |
+------+------+-----------------------+
```

Meaning that, ArcadeDB represents the date of April 21, 753 BC, as -85889120400000 in Unix time. You can also work with dates directly as longs.

*Since v26.10.1*, a number with a fractional part is rounded down to the unit that contains it (for a datetime in milliseconds, `-1.5` is millisecond `-2`), and a number that is not a real instant (`NaN`, `Infinity`, or a value outside the supported range) is refused with an error instead of being stored as 1970-01-01 or as an unrelated date.

```
arcadedb> CREATE VERTEX V SET city = "Rome", date = DATE(-85889120400000)
arcadedb> SELECT @RID, city, date FROM V
```

```
+-------+------+-----------------------+
| @RID  | city | date                  |
+-------+------+-----------------------+
| #9:11 | Rome | 0753-04-21 00:00:00 BC |
+-------+------+-----------------------+
```

#### Use ISO 8601 Dates

According to ISO 8601, Combined date and time in UTC: 2014-12-20T00:00:00. To use this standard change the date time format in the database:

```
ALTER DATABASE DATETIMEFORMAT "yyyy-MM-dd'T'HH:mm:ss.SSS'Z'"
```

#### Arithmetic with dates

Dates can be added and subtracted. If you want to know the difference in terms of seconds between two dates, you can use the `-` (minus) operator. Example:

```
SELECT sysdate() - lastActivity as secondsFromLastActivity FROM UserActivity
```

Returns `1212113.232000000`.

if the date supports the fractional part of the second, then it's returned as nanoseconds as decimal part. In the example above, `sysdate()` function returns a datetime with, by default, precision to the millisecond.

#### Time Units

The units of time used in the `duration()` function and `precision()` method are the following strings:

- `'year'`
- `'month'`
- `'week'`
- `'day'`
- `'hour'`
- `'minute'`
- `'second'`
- `'millisecond'`
- `'microsecond'`
- `'nanosecond'`

## 6.17. Materialized Views

A materialized view is a schema-level object that stores the result of a SQL `SELECT` query as a backing document type. Unlike regular views (which re-execute the query on every access), a materialized view holds a pre-computed snapshot of data that can be queried directly for fast reads.

A materialized view:

- Wraps a SQL `SELECT` query as its *defining query*
- Stores results in a backing `DocumentType` with standard buckets
- Supports three *refresh modes*: manual, incremental (post-commit), and periodic (scheduled)
- Persists its definition and metadata in `schema.json` alongside other schema objects
- Can be created, dropped, refreshed, and altered via SQL DDL statements or the Java Schema API

### 6.17.1. Refresh Modes

#### MANUAL

The view data is never automatically updated. You must trigger a refresh explicitly via `REFRESH MATERIALIZED VIEW` or the Java API. Use this when you control refresh timing yourself or when source data changes infrequently.

#### INCREMENTAL

After every committed transaction that modifies a source type, ArcadeDB automatically refreshes the view in a post-commit callback. The refresh is:

- **Transactionally safe**: runs after the source transaction commits successfully; rolled-back transactions do not trigger a refresh
- **Batched per transaction**: multiple record changes in a single transaction result in one refresh, not one per record
- For **simple queries** (single source type, no aggregates, no `GROUP BY`, no subqueries, no `JOIN`s): performs a full refresh
- For **complex queries** (aggregates, `GROUP BY`, etc.): also performs a full refresh (per-record incremental optimization is planned for a future release)

If the refresh fails, the view is marked `STALE` and a warning is logged. A manual refresh can recover it.

#### PERIODIC

A background scheduler thread runs a full refresh at the specified interval after each successful refresh completes. Intervals are specified in seconds, minutes, or hours:

```
REFRESH EVERY 30 SECOND
REFRESH EVERY 5 MINUTE
REFRESH EVERY 1 HOUR
```

The scheduler uses a single daemon thread (`ArcadeDB-MV-Scheduler`) shared across all periodic views. If the database is closed, all scheduled tasks are cancelled automatically.

### 6.17.2. View Status

Each view tracks a `status` field that reflects its current state:

| Status | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `VALID` | Data is up to date with the last refresh |
| `STALE` | A refresh failed or was interrupted; data may be outdated |
| `BUILDING` | A refresh is currently in progress |
| `ERROR` | The last refresh encountered a fatal error |

If the database crashes while a view is `BUILDING`, the status is reset to `STALE` on the next startup to signal that the data may be incomplete.

### 6.17.3. Querying a Materialized View

Query a materialized view exactly like any other document type:

```
SELECT * FROM ActiveUsers
SELECT name FROM ActiveUsers WHERE name LIKE 'A%'
SELECT count(*) FROM RecentOrders
```

### 6.17.4. Java API

#### Creating a view

```
database.transaction(() -> {
    database.getSchema().buildMaterializedView()
        .withName("ActiveUsers")
        .withQuery("SELECT name, email FROM User WHERE active = true")
        .withRefreshMode(MaterializedViewRefreshMode.MANUAL)
        .create();
});
```

Builder options:

| Method | Description |
|---|---|
| `withName(String)` | Name for the view (required) |
| `withQuery(String)` | Defining SQL `SELECT` query (required) |
| `withRefreshMode(MaterializedViewRefreshMode)` | `MANUAL`, `INCREMENTAL`, or `PERIODIC` (default: `MANUAL`) |
| `withTotalBuckets(int)` | Number of buckets for the backing type |
| `withPageSize(int)` | Page size for the backing type |
| `withRefreshInterval(long)` | Interval in milliseconds for `PERIODIC` mode. Only `PERIODIC` accepts an interval: `create()` refuses one on a `MANUAL` or `INCREMENTAL` view, embedded and remote alike |
| `withIgnoreIfExists(boolean)` | When `true`, returns existing view instead of throwing |

#### Querying schema

```
Schema schema = database.getSchema();

// Check existence
boolean exists = schema.existsMaterializedView("ActiveUsers");

// Get a specific view
MaterializedView view = schema.getMaterializedView("ActiveUsers");

// List all views
MaterializedView[] views = schema.getMaterializedViews();
```

**Refreshing and dropping**

```
// Programmatic refresh
database.getSchema().getMaterializedView("ActiveUsers").refresh();

// Drop via schema
database.getSchema().dropMaterializedView("ActiveUsers");

// Drop via the view itself
database.getSchema().getMaterializedView("ActiveUsers").drop();
```

**Inspecting a view**

```
MaterializedView view = database.getSchema().getMaterializedView("HourlySummary");

view.getName();             // "HourlySummary"
view.getQuery();            // the defining SQL query
view.getRefreshMode();      // MaterializedViewRefreshMode.PERIODIC
view.getStatus();           // "VALID", "STALE", "BUILDING", or "ERROR"
view.getLastRefreshTime();  // epoch millis of last successful refresh
view.isSimpleQuery();       // true if eligible for per-record optimization
view.getSourceTypeNames();  // list of source type names parsed from the query
view.getBackingType();      // the underlying DocumentType
```

### 6.17.5. Behavior and Constraints

- **Backing type protection**: You cannot `DROP TYPE` on a type that backs a materialized view. Drop the materialized view first.
- **Name uniqueness**: The view name must not match any existing type or materialized view.
- **Source type validation**: All types referenced in the `FROM` clause must exist when the view is created.
- **Persistence**: View definitions are stored in `schema.json` under a `"materializedViews"` key and survive database restarts. Listener registration for `INCREMENTAL` views and scheduler tasks for `PERIODIC` views are re-established on startup.
- **Transaction safety**: The initial full refresh and all subsequent refreshes run inside their own transactions.
- **Query result columns**: Only non-internal properties (those not starting with `@`) are copied into the backing type during refresh.
- **No schema on backing type**: The backing document type is schema-less; property types are not enforced.

### 6.17.6. Error Handling

- If a post-commit refresh fails (`INCREMENTAL` mode), the view is marked `STALE` and a `WARNING` is logged. The source transaction is unaffected.

- If a periodic refresh fails, the view is marked `ERROR` and a `SEVERE` log entry is written. The scheduler continues running and will retry on the next interval.
- Callback errors in the transaction callback system are logged at `WARNING` level and do not affect the triggering transaction or other callbacks.

### 6.17.7. Limitations

- `ALTER MATERIALIZED VIEW` is not yet implemented.
- Per-record incremental refresh (tracking `_sourceRID` to update individual view rows) is a planned future optimization. Currently, all refresh operations perform a full truncate-and-reload.
- No support for cross-database queries in the defining query.
- Server replication: materialized view data lives in the local backing type and is replicated like any other document type in an HA cluster, but refresh triggering is local to the node that executes the write.

### 6.17.8. Example: Sales Dashboard

```
-- Source type
CREATE DOCUMENT TYPE Sale;

-- A periodic summary refreshed every minute
CREATE MATERIALIZED VIEW SalesByProduct
  AS SELECT product, sum(amount) AS total, count(*) AS count
     FROM Sale
     GROUP BY product
  REFRESH EVERY 1 MINUTE;

-- An incremental view of recent activity (simple query)
CREATE MATERIALIZED VIEW RecentSales
  AS SELECT product, amount, date
     FROM Sale
     WHERE date >= '2026-01-01'
  REFRESH INCREMENTAL;

-- Query the views
SELECT * FROM SalesByProduct ORDER BY total DESC;
SELECT product, amount FROM RecentSales WHERE amount > 1000;

-- Manual refresh after a bulk import
REFRESH MATERIALIZED VIEW SalesByProduct;

-- Teardown
DROP MATERIALIZED VIEW SalesByProduct;
DROP MATERIALIZED VIEW RecentSales;
```

For more information, see:

- `CREATE MATERIALIZED VIEW`
- `DROP MATERIALIZED VIEW`
- `REFRESH MATERIALIZED VIEW`
- `ALTER MATERIALIZED VIEW`

# 6.18. Vector Embeddings

This guide covers practical decisions for working with vector embeddings in ArcadeDB: choosing dimensions, creating indexes, tuning parameters, and combining vector search with other query types.

## 6.18.1. Choosing an Embedding Model

Your embedding model determines the `dimensions` parameter for the index:

| Model | Dimensions | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| OpenAI `text-embedding-3-small` | 1536 | General purpose, high quality |
| OpenAI `text-embedding-3-large` | 3072 | Highest quality, largest memory footprint |
| Sentence Transformers `all-MiniLM-L6-v2` | 384 | Fast, open source, good quality |
| Sentence Transformers `all-mpnet-base-v2` | 768 | Better quality, slower |
| Cohere `embed-english-v3.0` | 1024 | Good balance of quality and size |
| CLIP (image + text) | 512 | Multi-modal image/text |

Start with 384 dimensions (MiniLM) for prototyping. Move to 768+ for production quality. Use quantization to manage memory at higher dimensions.

## 6.18.2. Creating a Vector Index

Recommended index creation with INT8 quantization:

```
CREATE VERTEX TYPE Document
CREATE PROPERTY Document.content STRING
CREATE PROPERTY Document.embedding LIST OF FLOAT

CREATE INDEX ON Document (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  dimensions: 384,
  similarity: 'COSINE',
  quantization: 'INT8'
}
```

INT8 quantization is recommended for all production workloads. It provides 2.5x faster search and

4x lower memory usage with negligible accuracy loss (see concepts/vector-search.pdf). Only omit quantization for very small datasets (< 10K vectors) where maximum precision matters.

Production-ready index with additional tuning:

```
CREATE INDEX ON Document (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  dimensions: 384,
  similarity: 'COSINE',
  quantization: 'INT8',
  maxConnections: 16,
  beamWidth: 100
}
```

### 6.18.3. Choosing a Similarity Function

| Function | Choose When | Avoid When |
|---|---|---|
| **COSINE** | Using text embedding models (most common). Vectors may have varying magnitudes. | Vectors represent absolute quantities (distances, counts). |
| **DOT_PRODUCT** | Vectors are already L2-normalized. You need maximum query speed. | Vectors are not normalized (results will be incorrect). |
| **EUCLIDEAN** | Working with spatial data, sensor readings, or continuous measurements. | Comparing text embeddings of different lengths. |

### 6.18.4. Quantization Trade-offs

Use INT8 quantization for most use cases. It provides 4x memory savings with minimal accuracy loss and significantly faster ingestion and search:

- **< 10K vectors**: `NONE` is fine, but `INT8` works well too
- **10K - 1M vectors**: Use `INT8` (4x memory savings, < 2% accuracy loss) — **recommended**
- **> 1M vectors**: Use `INT8` for general use, or `PRODUCT` for zero-disk-I/O graph construction on very large datasets
- **Extreme compression**: Use `BINARY` for first-pass filtering, then rerank with full vectors

```
-- INT8: recommended for most workloads
CREATE INDEX ON Doc (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  dimensions: 768,
  similarity: 'COSINE',
  quantization: 'INT8'
}

-- PRODUCT: for very large datasets, enables in-memory graph build
CREATE INDEX ON Doc (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
```

```
  dimensions: 1024,
  similarity: 'COSINE',
  quantization: 'PRODUCT'
}
```

### 6.18.5. INT8 Pre-Quantized Ingest

See Vector Encoding for the underlying concept.

When your embedding provider already emits signed-int8 vectors (Cohere `int8` endpoints, OpenAI `text-embedding-3-large` reduced precision, Sentence Transformers with int8 quantization), use `encoding: 'INT8'` to keep the bytes byte-shaped end-to-end:

```
CREATE PROPERTY Doc.embedding BINARY;
CREATE INDEX ON Doc (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  "dimensions": 1024,
  "similarity": "COSINE",
  "encoding": "INT8"
};
```

What this saves:

- HTTP payload: 4x smaller (1 byte/dim vs 4 bytes/dim) when sending vectors with the typed-marker convention — see HTTP wire convention.
- Document bucket storage: 4x smaller, since the property column is `BINARY` instead of `ARRAY_OF_FLOATS`.
- No client-side `int8 → float32 → server` round trip; the precision the provider already discarded does not get padded back out for the wire.

What this does **not** change today:

- HNSW graph and search internally still run on `float32` (JVector 4.0.0-rc.8 contract). The engine dequantizes once on the read path. Native int8 HNSW is tracked upstream at datastax/jvector#665.
- `encoding` is independent of `quantization`. Combining `encoding: 'INT8'` with `quantization: 'INT8'` is rejected at index creation — pick one, not both.

When **not** to use INT8 encoding:

- Your provider emits `float32` (or `float64`) and you do not have an int8 quantizer client-side. The default `FLOAT32` encoding skips the dequantize hop on every search and keeps full precision in the documents.
- You want the index-internal compression benefit (search-time memory footprint). That is `quantization: 'INT8'`, not `encoding: 'INT8'`. They are orthogonal.

### 6.18.6. Tuning for Recall vs Speed

Adjust `maxConnections` and `beamWidth` based on your priorities:

| Profile | maxConnections | beamWidth | Trade-off |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Default** | 32 | 100 | Balanced for most workloads; matches hnswlib `M=16` density |
| **High recall** | 48 | 200 | Better accuracy, slower builds, more memory |
| **Fast indexing** | 24 | 80 | Faster builds, slightly lower recall |
| **Memory constrained** | 16 | 60 | Minimal memory footprint |

`maxConnections` is the Vamana per-layer graph degree; unlike hnswlib's `M` it is not doubled at the base layer, so to match an hnswlib `M` set `maxConnections = 2 * M`.

For datasets over 100K vectors or with 1024+ dimensions, enable hierarchical mode:

```
CREATE INDEX ON Doc (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  dimensions: 1536,
  similarity: 'COSINE',
  quantization: 'INT8',
  addHierarchy: true,
  maxConnections: 32,
  beamWidth: 200
}
```

### 6.18.7. Tuning efSearch

The `efSearch` parameter controls how many candidates the search explores at query time. By default, ArcadeDB uses an adaptive strategy that works well for most workloads. You only need to tune efSearch if you have specific recall or latency requirements.

| Profile | efSearch | Trade-off |
|---|---|---|
| **Adaptive** (default) | auto | Two-pass: fast first pass (`2×k`), wider retry (`10×k`) if needed |
| **High recall** | 200-500 | Consistent high accuracy, higher latency |
| **Low latency** | 20-50 | Fast responses, lower recall on hard queries |

You can override efSearch per-query without changing the index:

```
-- High recall for a critical search
SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Doc[embedding]', $queryVector, 10, 500))
```

```
-- Low latency for autocomplete/typeahead
SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Doc[embedding]', $queryVector, 5, 30))
```

Or set a default on the index:

```
CREATE INDEX ON Doc (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  dimensions: 768,
  similarity: 'COSINE',
  quantization: 'INT8',
  efSearch: 200
}
```

### 6.18.8. Multi-Modal Embeddings

Store multiple embeddings per record for different search modalities:

```
CREATE VERTEX TYPE Product
CREATE PROPERTY Product.imageEmbedding ARRAY_OF_FLOATS
CREATE PROPERTY Product.textEmbedding  ARRAY_OF_FLOATS

CREATE INDEX ON Product (imageEmbedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {dimensions: 512,
similarity: 'COSINE'}
CREATE INDEX ON Product (textEmbedding)  LSM_VECTOR METADATA {dimensions: 768,
similarity: 'COSINE'}
```

Query each index independently:

```
-- Search by image similarity
SELECT name, distance FROM (
  SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Product[imageEmbedding]', $imageVector, 10))
)

-- Search by text similarity
SELECT name, distance FROM (
  SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Product[textEmbedding]', $textVector, 10))
)
```

### 6.18.9. Searching a Type Hierarchy

The type in the index spec decides which records are searched. A parent spec covers the parent and all its sub-types, like `SELECT FROM Parent`. A sub-type spec covers only that sub-type and its own sub-types:

```
CREATE VERTEX TYPE Embedding
CREATE PROPERTY Embedding.vector ARRAY_OF_FLOATS
CREATE INDEX ON Embedding (vector) LSM_VECTOR METADATA { dimensions: 768, similarity:
```

```
'COSINE' }
CREATE VERTEX TYPE EmbeddingImage EXTENDS Embedding
CREATE VERTEX TYPE EmbeddingText  EXTENDS Embedding

-- images and texts (and any record of Embedding itself)
SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Embedding[vector]', $q, 10))

-- images only
SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('EmbeddingImage[vector]', $q, 10))
```

The same rule applies to `vector.sparseNeighbors`, the Cypher procedure `db.index.vector.queryNodes` and the Java Select API `select().fromType(..).nearestTo(..)`.

### 6.18.10. Hybrid Search: Dense + Sparse + Full-Text

Combine dense vector similarity with sparse retrieval and/or keyword matching in a single server-side query. `vector.fuse` accepts any number of ranked sub-pipelines plus a fusion strategy (`RRF`, `DBSF`, `LINEAR`) and returns one ranked top-K:

```
-- Schema: dense + sparse properties + indexes (sparse needs LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR).
CREATE PROPERTY Document.dense   ARRAY_OF_FLOATS;
CREATE PROPERTY Document.tokens  ARRAY_OF_INTEGERS;
CREATE PROPERTY Document.weights ARRAY_OF_FLOATS;

CREATE INDEX ON Document (dense) LSM_VECTOR
  METADATA { dimensions: 384, similarity: 'COSINE' }

CREATE INDEX ON Document (tokens, weights) LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR
  METADATA { dimensions: 30000, modifier: 'IDF' }

-- Hybrid retrieval in one statement.
SELECT expand(`vector.fuse`(
    `vector.neighbors`('Document[dense]', :denseVec, 50),
    `vector.sparseNeighbors`('Document[tokens,weights]', :qIdx, :qVal, 50),
    { fusion: 'RRF', groupBy: 'source_file', groupSize: 1 }
)) LIMIT 10
```

- `vector.neighbors` exposes `distance` (lower = better); `vector.fuse` auto-flips it so dense and sparse sources compose without manual rescaling.
- `groupBy` + `groupSize` collapse same-source duplicates server-side. Drop the option to return chunk-level results.
- Pre-fusion grouping is also possible by attaching `{ groupBy: 'source_file', groupSize: 1 }` to each individual source.

To include full-text alongside dense/sparse, add a third source built from `SEARCH_INDEX`:

```
SELECT expand(`vector.fuse`(
```

```
    `vector.neighbors`('Document[dense]', :denseVec, 100),
    `vector.sparseNeighbors`('Document[tokens,weights]', :qIdx, :qVal, 100),
    (SELECT @rid, $score FROM Document
     WHERE SEARCH_INDEX('Document[content]', 'machine learning') = true),
    { fusion: 'RRF' }
)) LIMIT 10
```

Pick the strategy that matches your scoring shape:

- `RRF` — rank-only, indifferent to score scales. Default, safest with mixed source types.
- `DBSF` — mean +/- 3sigma normalisation per source then weighted sum. Use when scores are roughly Gaussian on each side.
- `LINEAR` — per-source min-max normalisation then weighted sum. Use with already-tuned offline weights.

For the legacy two-query workaround (still supported via `vector.rrfScore` and `vector.hybridScore` on already-computed scores), see the SQL Vector Functions reference.

### 6.18.11. Batch Ingestion

For bulk loading vectors, batch your inserts within transactions:

```
BEGIN

CREATE VERTEX Document SET content = 'First document',  embedding = [0.1, 0.2, ...]
CREATE VERTEX Document SET content = 'Second document', embedding = [0.3, 0.4, ...]
-- ... more inserts ...

COMMIT
```

For large bulk loads, increase `mutationsBeforeRebuild` to delay index rebuilds until after the load completes, then trigger a rebuild.

Since v26.10.1 a bulk load through `GraphBatch` - which is what `GraphImporter`, the `arcadedb-integration` importers and the HTTP batch endpoint use - needs none of that tuning. ArcadeDB holds the automatic graph rebuild off for the whole load and runs it once at the end. Before that, the rebuild was triggered by the index going quiet, which during a load means the loader paused for an index compaction or a garbage collection rather than that it had finished: a 4.2M-vertex load rebuilt the graph four times, each over a partial dataset and each made obsolete by the rest of the load, and had not completed after six and a half hours. The same release also bounds the memory the waiting vectors occupy (see `deltaCacheSize` under Settings) - together these are what let a load with a vector index finish in the same time as one without.

When vectors are inserted below the rebuild threshold, an inactivity timer ensures

the graph is still rebuilt after a period of no new mutations (default: 15 seconds). On a small graph (under 1,000 vectors) this rebuild is cheap and fires for any number of pending mutations, so buffered vectors never sit in the brute-force delta buffer for long during low-volume ingestion. On a larger graph a rebuild re-indexes the whole graph, so the timer only fires once pending mutations reach at least 10% of the effective rebuild threshold - a single stray insert into a large, otherwise-settled index no longer costs a full graph rebuild on the next quiet period. "How large" is measured against the vectors the index actually holds, not against the part of the graph the current session has loaded: the graph loads lazily on the first query, so a process that reopens a database, writes and then goes idle without ever querying it is gated exactly like one that queried first. Configure the timer via `inactivityRebuildTimeoutMs` (per-index metadata or `arcadedb.vectorIndex.inactivityRebuildTimeoutMs` globally); set to 0 to disable it.

Since v26.10.1 the same thresholds also decide what happens on the **first search after reopening a database**. Vectors written since the graph was last persisted are read back into the delta buffer and answered from there, and the rebuild that folds them into the graph is scheduled only once they reach the threshold, or once the delta scan they cause grows expensive (see `maxDeltaScanRatio`). Previously that first search always started a full rebuild however small the gap, so a process that opened a database, searched once and exited re-indexed the whole graph for a single buffered vector, waited for that rebuild on `close()`, and found the same vector waiting again on the next open - the rebuild having been cancelled before it could be persisted.

### 6.18.12. Searching Vectors Not Yet in the Graph

Between rebuilds, everything written since the last one lives in an in-memory delta buffer rather than in the HNSW graph. Those vectors are still searchable: every query scores the buffer and merges the result into the graph's own, in distance order, so a search never returns a corpus older than the last write. The cost is linear in the size of the buffer, which is what `mutationsBeforeRebuild`, `rebuildGraphRatio` and the inactivity timer between them decide.

A graph build also occasionally leaves a vector with no incoming edges, which no search can reach at any `efSearch` however close it is to the query. Those are served from the delta buffer too, and since v26.10.1 the list of them is stored next to the graph, so they stay findable after a restart. `unreachableGraphNodes` reports how many the current graph has, readable straight after a reopen and before the first query:

```
-- Normally 0, or a handful in a large index. A high value means the corpus holds many
near-identical vectors,
-- which a build cannot link into a navigable graph, and every query pays a scan for
them
SELECT unreachableGraphNodes, deltaVectorsCount FROM (SELECT expand(stats) FROM
schema:indexes WHERE name = 'Document[embedding]')
```

Before v26.10.1 that list lived only in the memory of the session that built the

graph. After a restart those vectors were absent from every search while the index still counted them, and since a query still returned `k` results there was nothing to indicate it.

Before v26.9.1 this was true of every query **except** a grouped one. Adding `groupBy` routed the search down a path that read the graph only, so it answered from the corpus as of the last rebuild while the same query without `groupBy`, on the same index at the same instant, returned the newer rows - with no error, no warning and nothing in the statistics to say so. On default settings the invisible window was as wide as `rebuildGraphRatio` allows the buffer to grow, and stayed open for as long as writes kept arriving. If you worked around this by dropping `groupBy` and grouping in the application, that workaround is no longer needed.

The `groupedSearchesMergingDelta` counter reports how many grouped searches actually took rows out of the buffer:

```
-- Rising in step with your grouped query rate means the graph is persistently behind
the write rate,
-- and every grouped query is paying a linear scan of the buffer; deltaVectorsCount is
how long that scan is
SELECT groupedSearchesMergingDelta, deltaVectorsCount FROM (SELECT expand(stats) FROM
schema:indexes WHERE name = 'Document[embedding]')
```

A high value is not itself a fault - it is the index doing what it should under ingestion. It is the signal to shorten the scan by lowering `mutationsBeforeRebuild` or `rebuildGraphRatio`, if query latency matters more than the CPU the extra rebuilds cost.

### 6.18.13. Rebuild Memory and Deferred Rebuilds

A graph rebuild is the most memory-hungry thing a vector index does, and an *online* rebuild - one triggered by the mutation threshold or the inactivity timer while the index keeps serving queries - is the most expensive kind. The graph being replaced stays resident so searches keep working, and the new build pays for its own working set on top of it (the build cache, the graph under construction, the ordinal map). Measured on a 50,000 x 128 corpus built and rebuilt inside one session, that is roughly 1.7x the peak of building the same index from nothing. It is much less after a reopen, where the graph being replaced is served from pages rather than from the heap: since v26.10.1 the gate measures what that graph actually costs instead of assuming a second copy of it in memory.

Two behaviours follow from that, both new in v26.9.1:

- **The auto-sized search cache budgets against available heap, not total heap.** `searchCacheMaxHeapPercent` is a share of the heap actually free at the time, so a rebuild holding the old graph resident asks for a smaller cache instead of the same one. Previously it was a share of `-Xmx`, which meant a larger heap grew the cache proportionally and a rebuild that did not fit still did not fit after raising it.
- **A rebuild that will not fit is deferred instead of attempted.** Before starting, the estimated

peak is compared against `arcadedb.vectorIndex.rebuildMaxHeapPercent` (default 90) of the available heap. If it does not fit, the cycle is skipped rather than run into an `OutOfMemoryError`. Nothing is lost: the pending vectors remain fully searchable through the in-memory delta buffer, so the cost is a longer brute-force scan per query until a later rebuild succeeds. Since v26.11.1, before deferring, the rebuild first tries to keep the old graph on disk instead of in memory (the persisted copy is read from pages while the new graph builds), which usually makes it fit. Searches are somewhat slower until the new graph is published; this is counted as `residentGraphDemotions` in the index statistics, and a deferral warning is logged only once until a rebuild gets through.

Since v26.10.1 both sides of that comparison are more accurate, and a large index in a tight heap that used to log deferrals indefinitely may now rebuild:

- **What keeping the old graph resident costs is measured, not assumed.** After a reopen the graph being replaced lives in pages, so it retains a fraction of what a freshly built one does. Charging it as a second in-memory graph could refuse a rebuild that fitted comfortably - and one no larger than the rebuild the close path runs without asking.
- **The page cache counts as reclaimable, because it is.** Available heap is measured after the last collection, and cached pages count as used even though the engine can drop any of them and read them back from disk. When a rebuild fits only by giving some of that up, exactly the shortfall is evicted first - oldest pages, across every open database, since the cache is shared - and if the cache cannot actually hand those bytes over the rebuild is still deferred rather than run on heap it was not given. Expect a few slower queries afterwards while the evicted pages are read back.

Since v26.10.1 the graph-build cache is sized differently from the search cache, and the difference matters when you are planning a large ingest:

- `graphBuildCacheMaxHeapPercent` **is a share of** `-Xmx`**, capped at 90% of the heap currently available.** Taking the percentage of free heap made the same corpus build very differently depending on how the data got in. A server that has just ingested the corpus over HTTP holds it in its own heap, so the free-heap reading is small and the default paid for a fraction of the corpus; an embedded build of the identical data, held outside the JVM until the build, saw almost the whole heap free and cached everything. On a 10M x 96-dim corpus with the same `-Xmx` that was a 3.4x difference in build time from the same default, and two identical runs could differ 4x between themselves depending on when the JVM had last collected. Taking the percentage of the ceiling makes the choice a property of your configuration rather than of the moment; the available-heap cap is what still shrinks the cache when an online rebuild is genuinely holding the old graph.
- **The percentage now applies to inline-quantized (**`INT8`**,** `BINARY`**) indexes too.** It previously did nothing for them: their build cache was pinned at 100,000 vectors whatever the setting said, and only an explicit `graphBuildCacheSize` moved it. Note the consequence for a tight heap - an `INT8` index that used to hold ~45 MB of build cache at 96 dimensions will now use up to its share of `-Xmx`, because the cache holds decoded `float` vectors regardless of how they are stored. Set `graphBuildCacheMaxHeapPercent` lower, or pin `graphBuildCacheSize`, if that share is not available to you.
- **The chosen capacity is logged next to the corpus size**, as `cache enabled: size=3674697 of`

9990000, so a cache that is too small to cover the corpus is visible in one line at INFO.

A deferral is deliberately visible. It logs a warning naming what to change, and increments the rebuildsDeferredForMemory counter in the index statistics:

```
-- Non-zero and climbing means rebuilds keep being declined for lack of heap:
-- the graph is going stale and every query is paying a longer delta scan for it
SELECT rebuildsDeferredForMemory FROM (SELECT expand(stats) FROM schema:indexes WHERE
name = 'Document[embedding]')
```

If it keeps climbing, give the JVM more heap, lower arcadedb.vectorIndex.graphBuildCacheMaxHeapPercent so the build asks for less, or split the index. Setting arcadedb.vectorIndex.rebuildMaxHeapPercent to 0 disables the check and restores the previous attempt-regardless behaviour.

Because a deferral does not consume the mutations that triggered it, the trigger would otherwise fire again on the very next query. arcadedb.vectorIndex.rebuildDeferralCooldownMs (default 30 seconds) is the minimum gap before another attempt; a rebuild that completes clears it immediately.

Only online rebuilds are subject to this check. A first build, the rebuild performed when a database closes, an explicit REBUILD INDEX and COMPACT INDEX are never declined - nothing would retry them, so declining one would mean it never happens at all.

If you create the index *before* inserting data (e.g., during schema setup), set buildGraphNow: false to skip the initial (empty) graph build. The graph will be built lazily on the first search:

```
-- Schema setup phase: defer graph build since no data exists yet
CREATE INDEX ON Document (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  dimensions: 384,
  similarity: 'COSINE',
  quantization: 'INT8',
  buildGraphNow: false
}

-- Bulk load data...
-- Graph is built automatically on first vector.neighbors() query
```

If you create the index *after* data is already loaded, leave buildGraphNow at its default (true) so the index is immediately ready to query.

### 6.18.14. Global Configuration

Set database-wide defaults for vector index parameters:

```
ALTER DATABASE `arcadedb.vectorIndex.locationCacheSize` 100000
```

```
ALTER DATABASE `arcadedb.vectorIndex.graphBuildCacheSize` 10000
ALTER DATABASE `arcadedb.vectorIndex.mutationsBeforeRebuild` 100
ALTER DATABASE `arcadedb.vectorIndex.inactivityRebuildTimeoutMs` 15000
```

Per-index metadata overrides these global settings.

### 6.18.15. Further Reading

- Vector Search Concepts — Architecture and algorithm details
- Vector Search Tutorial — Step-by-step hands-on guide
- Java Vector API — Programmatic index management
- SQL Vector Functions — Complete function reference

# Chapter 7. Import & Migration

## 7.1. Importer

ArcadeDB provides some basic ETL capabilities for automatically importing datasets in any of the following formats:

- OrientDB database export
- Neo4j database export
- GraphML database export
- GraphSON database export
- Generic XML files
- Generic JSON files
- Generic JSONL files
- Generic CSV files
- Generic RDF files

From file of types:

- Plain text
- Compressed with ZIP (the first entry in the archive is read, unless you select one - see below)
- Compressed with GZip

Located on:

- **local** file system (just provide the path or use `file://` in the URL)
- **remote**, by specifying `http://` or `https://` in the URL
- **classpath**, by using `classpath://` as a prefix

*(Since v26.10.1: format detection on a remote (`http://`/`https://`) source could stop reading in the middle of the stream on a slow or chunked connection, and guess the file's format from a partial first line. A local file was never affected. One consequence of the fix: a remote source that stops sending data without closing the connection now makes the import wait rather than fail immediately - there is no read timeout yet.)*

To import one specific entry out of a ZIP archive that contains several, append `:::` and the entry name to the URL:

```
IMPORT DATABASE file://data.zip:::nodes.csv
```

Without `:::`, the first entry in the archive is imported.

The easiest way is to use the console and the SQL `IMPORT DATABASE` command. You can also use

directly the Java API located in `com.arcadedb.integration.importer.Importer`.

To restore an export into a database you reach **over the network**, send `IMPORT DATABASE` as a command like any other: the server runs the import against its own local database, so the file path is resolved on the server. The Java `Importer` class loads into an embedded database only.

```
IMPORT DATABASE file:///path/on/the/server/export.jsonl.tgz
```

To start importing it's super easy as providing the URL where the source file to import is located. URLs can be local paths (use `file://`) or from the Internet by using `http://` and `https://`.

For security reasons, importing from an `http://`/`https://` URL refuses by default to reach a local-file, loopback, link-local, or private-network address, including a redirect that lands on one. This protects the server from being made to fetch from internal-only hosts (e.g. a cloud metadata endpoint) via a crafted or hijacked import URL. Running `IMPORT DATABASE` directly (from the console or the SQL API) is gated by `arcadedb.server.security.importBlockLocalNetworks`, which defaults to `true`; set it to `false` on the server if you need to import from such an address (for example, an internal artifact server). The `import database <dbname> <url>` server command is gated instead by `arcadedb.server.restoreImportAllowLocalUrls` - the same setting documented for restoring a database - which must be set to `true` for the equivalent override.

the `import:` startup command of `arcadedb.server.defaultDatabases` obeys `arcadedb.server.security.importBlockLocalNetworks` as set on that server. Before v26.10.1 it read the process-wide value instead, so setting the flag on a single server instance did not apply to that server's own boot-time import.

Example of loading the Freebase RDF dataset:

```
> CREATE DATABASE FreeBase
{FreeBase}> IMPORT DATABASE http://commondatastorage.googleapis.com/freebase-public
/rdf/freebase-rdf-latest.gz
```

```
Analyzing url: http://commondatastorage.googleapis.com/freebase-public/rdf/freebase-
rdf-latest.gz... [SourceDiscovery]
Recognized format RDF (limitBytes=9.54MB limitEntries=0) [SourceDiscovery]
Creating type 'Node' of type VERTEX [Importer]
Creating type 'Relationship' of type EDGE [Importer]
Parsed 144951 (28990/sec) - 0 documents (0/sec) - 143055 vertices (28611/sec) - 144951
edges (28990/sec) [Importer]
Parsed 362000 (54256/sec) - 0 documents (0/sec) - 164118 vertices (5260/sec) - 362000
edges (54256/sec) [Importer]
...
```

An RDF source is recognised from the shape of its first statement - `subject predicate object` with an optional closing `.` - so quoted literal objects, language tags (`@en`), typed literals (`^^<datatype>`), blank nodes (`:b1`) and Windows (CRLF) line endings are all read as RDF, and the character separating the terms is used as the field delimiter. _(Since v26.10.1: a file using any of those was analysed as delimited text instead and the import failed with a number-parsing error naming an IRI. If a file still cannot be recognised, set the separator explicitly with the delimiter setting.)

Every line of an RDF source is data: unlike CSV, these formats have no header row, so nothing is skipped unless you ask for it - with `edgesSkipEntries` on the `edges` route, `verticesSkipEntries` on `vertices`, or `documentsSkipEntries` on `documents` and on a plain `url` import. *(Since v26.10.1: the first statement of every RDF file was dropped as if it were a header, so N triples produced N-1 edges. If you were passing `edgesSkipEntries = 0` to work around that, you can remove it. Also since v26.10.1: an RDF file imported through `vertices` or `documents` only honoured `edgesSkipEntries`, ignoring the matching option for that route.)*

If you supply the column names yourself - with `documentsHeader`, `verticesHeader` or `edgesHeader` - the file is taken to have no header row, so its first line is imported as data. *(Since v26.10.1: on the `vertices` and `edges` routes the first line was dropped regardless, so supplying a header silently cost you one record. If you were passing `verticesSkipEntries = 0` or `edgesSkipEntries = 0` together with a header to work around that, you can remove it.)* Setting a `⋯SkipEntries` option explicitly always wins over both defaults.

Lines at the top of a source that start with `#` or `//` are treated as comments and ignored, for every format - CSV, RDF, XML, JSON and JSONL alike. *(Since v26.10.1: the comment was examined as if it were the first line of data, which could make the file be recognised as the wrong format and fail to import. Also since v26.10.1: once recognised, the comment lines were still handed to the importer for every format except CSV and RDF, and could make XML and JSON imports fail.)*

Example of loading the Discogs dataset in the database on path "/temp/discogs":

```
> IMPORT DATABASE https://discogs-data.s3-us-west-2.amazonaws.com/data/2018
/discogs_20180901_releases.xml.gz
```

Note that in this case the URL is `https` and the file is compressed with `GZip`.

Example of importing New York Taxi dataset in CSV format. The first line of the CSV file set the property names:

```
> IMPORT DATABASE file:///personal/Downloads/data-society-uber-pickups-in-nyc/
original/uber-raw-data-april-15.csv/uber-raw-data-april-15.csv
```

See also:

- SQL Import Database command,
- Graph Importer (high-performance, declarative graph import from XML, CSV, JSONL with JSON configuration)

- JSON Importer
- Neo4j Importer,
- OrientDB Importer

### 7.1.1. Additional Settings

The Importer takes additional settings as pairs of setting name and value. With the SQL `IMPORT DATABASE` command, this is the syntax:

```
IMPORT DATABASE <url> [ WITH ( <setting-name> = <setting-value> [,] )* ]
```

Example:

```
> IMPORT DATABASE file:///import/file.csv WITH forceDatabaseCreate = true, commitEvery
= 100
```

### 7.1.2. Transactions

By default an import manages its own transactions, committing every `commitEvery` records, so nothing is left open when it finishes.

If a transaction is already open when the import starts - because you are using the Java API against your own `Database`, or you ran `IMPORT DATABASE` inside an explicit transaction - the import does **not** take it over. It adds the imported records to your transaction and leaves it as it found it: still open, still yours to commit or roll back. Nothing is made durable until you commit, and rolling back discards the imported records along with your own pending changes.

In that case `commitEvery` has no effect, since the import commits nothing of its own. For large imports prefer letting the import manage its own transaction, so it can commit in batches instead of holding everything in memory until you commit.

An import that fails still leaves your transaction alone: it discards only its own pending work and reports the error. *(Since v26.10.1: a JSON import committed each record on its own even inside your transaction, so your rollback did not take them back. A JSON import whose commit failed could roll your transaction back instead, silently discarding the changes you had pending. A failed GraphSON import could leave its own transaction open on top of yours, so your next commit published the failed import's partial work and discarded your own. A CSV import as edges or documents whose own periodic or final commit failed could similarly leak its own open transaction instead of rolling it back.) (Since v26.11.1: a GraphML import, or a GraphSON import with RID ids, committed your open transaction, so your rollback did not take the imported records back. A standalone GraphML or GraphSON import that failed could leave its last batch open on the thread instead of rolling it back.)*

### 7.1.3. CSV rows and the header

A CSV row is matched against the header by column count.

A row with **fewer** columns than the header is imported with the columns it does supply; the remaining properties are left unset, and the row is counted under `warnings`.

A row with **more** columns than the header cannot be imported as it stands - the extra values have no field name to be stored under - so by default the import fails, naming the line and both column counts. Set `onRowError` to `skip` to have such rows skipped and counted under `errors` instead.

*(Since v26.10.1: a row with more columns used to abort the import with an error naming neither the file nor the line, and `onRowError = skip` could not reach it, because the failure happened while the schema was being analysed. A row with fewer columns used to abort as well. Note the consequence for large files: `analysisLimitEntries` and `analysisLimitBytes` bound only the analysis, so a row with extra columns beyond that window now fails the import where it previously imported with the extra values silently dropped.)*

If the analysis reads only rows it has to refuse, it cannot derive any property and the import fails saying so, naming the analysis limit when one is set - widening it is usually the fix.

### 7.1.4. Import report

An import returns a summary of what it did, with the counters that apply to the source: `parsedRecords`, `createdDocuments`, `createdVertices`, `createdEdges`, `skippedRecords`, `skippedEdges`, `errors` and `warnings`. A counter is left out of the summary when it is zero.

`parsedRecords` counts every row read from every file of the import, including any header row and any row that was skipped. It is therefore normally higher than the number of records created. *(Since v26.10.1: when an import read more than one file - for instance `vertices` and `edges` - this counted only the last file's rows for most formats, so the same import could report the figure two different ways depending on which file came last.)*

`skippedRecords` counts rows that were skipped on purpose - by a `*SkipEntries` setting, or by the default header-row skip - and `skippedEdges` counts edges that were not created because their `from` or `to` reference did not match any vertex. Neither is counted as an error: `parsedRecords` equals `createdDocuments` + `createdVertices` + `createdEdges` + `skippedRecords` + `skippedEdges` + `errors`. *(New in v26.10.1: before this, a row missing from the created count for either of these two reasons looked identical to a row dropped by `onRowError = skip`, and the usual explanation - "the file has a bad row" - was wrong for the first two.)*

Below you can find all the supported settings for the Importer.

| Setting | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| url | | url of the file to import |
| database | ./databases/imported | Path of the final imported database |
| forceDatabaseCreate | false | If true, the database is created brand new at every import |

| Setting | Default | Description |
| --- | --- | --- |
| wal | false | Use the WAL (journal) for the importing. If the WAL is enabled the importing process will be much slower and will require much more RAM |
| commitEvery | 5000 | Create transactions that commit every X records |
| onRowError | abort | `abort` fails the whole import as soon as one record (document, vertex or edge) cannot be imported. `skip` logs the error, counts it in the `errors` result, and continues with the next record instead - trading import throughput (each record then commits in its own transaction) for the guarantee that a bad record can never take a good one down with it, nor leave a partially-written record behind. Applies to the JSON, JSONL and CSV importers. *(Since v26.10.1 it also governs a CSV row with more columns than the header - see CSV rows and the header. It does not rescue a source from which the analysis could derive no property at all: that fails either way, since the alternative is an import that completes having produced nothing.)* |
| parallel | Half of the available cores - 1. If you have 8 cores, the default is 3 | The number of concurrent threads used |
| typeIdProperty | | Property that represents the ID of the vertex. Also used by an RDF/N-Triples source to key its subjects and objects, where it defaults to `id`. *(Since v26.10.1: an explicit value is honoured for RDF too; before, recognising a source as RDF silently replaced it with `id`, and that replacement then applied to the other files of the same import as well)* |
| typeIdUnique | false | True creates a unique index on the type id property, otherwise a non unique index |
| typeIdType | String | Type of the id property |
| trimText | true | True if the imported text is trimmed from heading and tailing spaces |
| maxProperties | 512 | Maximum number of properties per type (CSV) |
| maxPropertySize | 4096 | Maximum size of a property in bytes (CSV) |

| Setting | Default | Description |
| --- | --- | --- |
| delimiter | , | Delimiter used to separate fields (CSV). When not set, it is auto-detected from the first line for files whose name does not end in `.csv`. A delimiter set explicitly always wins over the detected one; the precedence is the per-entity delimiter (`documentsDelimiter`, `verticesDelimiter`, `edgesDelimiter`), then `delimiter`, then the detected one. Each file of the same import resolves its own delimiter. A delimiter longer than one character is supported *(since v26.10.1; before, the schema analysis used only its first character while the load used the whole string, so values could land under the wrong property names with no error reported)*. An empty delimiter is refused with an error |
| analysisLimitBytes | 100,000 | Maximum number of bytes parsed from the source to determine the source file type. *(Since v26.10.1 also applies to XML sources; before it was CSV-only and XML analysis was unbounded)* |
| analysisLimitEntries | 10,000 | Maximum number of entries (if applicable) parsed from the source to determine the source file type. *(Since v26.10.1 also applies to XML sources)* |
| parsingLimitBytes | | Maximum number of bytes parsed from the source to be imported. *(Since v26.10.1 enforced on every format; before it had no effect at all)* |
| parsingLimitEntries | | Maximum number of entries imported. *(Since v26.10.1 this is a cap of exactly N entries, enforced on every format; before it only worked on XML, and there it imported N+1)* |
| mapping | null | |
| probeOnly | false | Only probe if url is reachable or file path is readable |
| documents | | url of the file to import containing documents only. This is useful when the database is split in separate files |
| documentsFileType | | The format of the file containing documents (csv, graphml, graphson). `graphml` and `graphson` require the optional `arcadedb-gremlin` module on the classpath; without it the import is refused *(since v26.10.1: it used to be read as generic XML and reported as successful, losing the graph)* |
| documentsDelimiter | | Delimiter used to separate documents |

| Setting | Default | Description |
| --- | --- | --- |
| documentsHeader | | Header containing the properties in the CSV document. One property per column. If not defined it is parsed from the first line. When you do define it, the file is assumed to contain no header row, so its first line is imported as data *(Since v26.10.1: on the `vertices` and `edges` routes the first line was dropped anyway, silently losing one record)*. The names are separated by the delimiter in force, not by a comma *(since v26.10.1; before, a header for a source using any other delimiter came back as a single column)* |
| documentsSkipEntries | | Number of rows to skip from the documents file. When not set, the first line is skipped as the header for delimited text - unless you supplied `documentsHeader`, in which case nothing is skipped - and nothing is skipped for RDF sources, which have no header row. Setting it explicitly always wins |
| documentPropertiesInclude | * | List of property to import from documents. * means all |
| documentType | Document | Name of the type defined in the schema when importing documents |
| vertices | | url of the file to import containing vertices only. This is useful when the database is split in separate files |
| verticesFileType | | The format of the file containing vertices (csv, graphml, graphson). See `documentsFileType` for the `arcadedb-gremlin` requirement |
| verticesDelimiter | | Delimiter used to separate vertices |
| verticesHeader | | Header containing the properties in the CSV vertices. One property per column. If not defined it is parsed from the first line. When you do define it, the file is assumed to contain no header row, so its first line is imported as data *(Since v26.10.1: on the `vertices` and `edges` routes the first line was dropped anyway, silently losing one record)*. The names are separated by the delimiter in force, not by a comma *(since v26.10.1; before, a header for a source using any other delimiter came back as a single column)* |
| verticesSkipEntries | | Number of rows to skip from the vertices file. When not set, the first line is skipped as the header for delimited text - unless you supplied `verticesHeader`, in which case nothing is skipped - and nothing is skipped for RDF sources, which have no header row. Setting it explicitly always wins |

| Setting | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| expectedVertices | 0 | Number of vertices expected. This is useful to determine the ETA of the importing process of vertices. 0 means unknown |
| vertexType | Vertex | Name of the type defined in the schema when importing vertices |
| vertexPropertiesInclude | * | List of property to import from vertices. * means all |
| edges | | url of the file to import containing edges only. This is useful when the database is split in separate files |
| edgesFileType | | The format of the file containing edges (csv, graphml, graphson). See `documentsFileType` for the `arcadedb-gremlin` requirement |
| edgesDelimiter | | Delimiter used to separate edges |
| edgesHeader | | Header containing the properties in the CSV edges. One property per column. If not defined it is parsed from the first line. When you do define it, the file is assumed to contain no header row, so its first line is imported as data *(Since v26.10.1: on the `vertices` and `edges` routes the first line was dropped anyway, silently losing one record)*. The names are separated by the delimiter in force, not by a comma *(since v26.10.1; before, a header for a source using any other delimiter came back as a single column)* |
| edgesSkipEntries | | Number of rows to skip from the edges file. When not set, the first line is skipped as the header for delimited text - unless you supplied `edgesHeader`, in which case nothing is skipped - and nothing is skipped for RDF sources, which have no header row. Setting it explicitly always wins |
| expectedEdges | 0 | Number of edges expected. This is useful to determine the ETA of the importing process of edges. 0 means unknown |
| maxRAMIncomingEdges | 256MB | Maximum RAM used to create edges. The more RAM, the faster. |
| edgeType | Edge | Name of the type defined in the schema when importing edges |
| edgePropertiesInclude | * | List of property to import from edges. * means all |
| edgeFromField | | Name of the property containing the starting vertex |
| edgeToField | | Name of the property containing the ending vertex |
| edgeBidirectional | true | When creating edges, create bidirectional edges if true, otherwise unidirectional |
| distanceFunction | `innerproduct` | Type of distance measure, see similarity measures. |

| Setting | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| efConstruction | 256 | Size of dynamic neighbor candidate list of (during insert). |
| ef | 256 | Number of nearest neighbors to return (in layer search). |
| m | 16 | Maximum number of connections per layer in the HNSW index. Higher values improve recall but increase memory usage |
| vectorType | `float` | The data type of a vector element, for example 'float'. |
| idProperty | `"name"` | Name of the property that will be used as the unique identifier for vertices during import |

The `probeOnly` setting can also be used to send a GET request to another service or HTTP API, for example to report a previous import is finished.

## 7.2. Graph Importer

The `GraphImporter` is a high-performance, declarative graph importer that uses a two-pass CSR-first architecture to bulk-load graph data from XML, CSV, and JSONL files into ArcadeDB. It is designed for importing large datasets (millions of vertices and edges) with minimal memory overhead.

The importer is located in the `integration` module (`com.arcadedb.integration.importer.graph.GraphImporter`).

Never run the importer against a database directory that an ArcadeDB Server (or any other process) already has open. It opens the database files directly, bypassing the server, and two processes writing to the same database at once can corrupt it. To load data into a database a server is serving, use the server's remote protocol instead, or stop the server for the duration of the import.

### 7.2.1. How It Works

The import runs in two passes:

1. **Pass 1** — Process each vertex source once: create vertices with full properties, and collect the edges a vertex source declares (foreign keys, split fields) as compressed int arrays
2. **Pass 2** — Create all edges using GraphBatch, one batch per edge type with bidirectional edges for full IN+OUT traversal: first the collected ones, then each edge-only source, streamed from its file straight into its batch *(since v26.11.1; before, edge-only sources were collected in memory first)*
3. **Vector graphs** — Build the graph of every `LSM_VECTOR` index on a type the import wrote to, so the index answers at index speed the moment `run()` returns (see Loading into a type with a vector index)

The speculative background maintenance of the database's indexes (the vector index's inactivity rebuild) is held off for the whole run, not only while one of the batches is open: a stall between the two passes must not be read as "the load is over".

### 7.2.2. Memory and Progress

What the importer keeps in memory grows with the number of vertices, not with the number of edges *(since v26.11.1)*. Per vertex it holds:

- its RID (8 bytes);
- its identity in a hash map (11 to 17 bytes, or 17 to 26 when the key does not fit in an `int`);
- while the edges are written, the head of its two edge lists in the edge batch (32 to 48 bytes).

That is roughly 12 to 17 GB of heap for 200 million vertices. The page cache (`arcadedb.maxPageRAM`, a quarter of the heap by default) comes on top of it. Size `-Xmx` for both, or lower `arcadedb.maxPageRAM` to leave the importer more of the heap.

Edge segments are created at the size their edges need. No empty segment is pre-allocated for each vertex: before v26.11.1 the vertex pass wrote 2 KB per vertex, about 400 GB for 200 million vertices.

Each pass logs how far it has got every 30 seconds, with the rate, the heap in use and the share of the time spent in garbage collection pauses:

```
  WORK         48,350,000 vertices so far (152,331/s, heap 9.12GB of 16.00GB, 3% of
the time in GC)
  CITE         412,876,800 edge rows so far (391,004/s, heap 13.71GB of 16.00GB, 4% of
the time in GC)
```

When more than half of an interval goes to garbage collection, a warning says the heap is too small for the load. A JVM short of heap rarely fails with an `OutOfMemoryError`: it collects back to back and the load slows to a crawl, which from the outside looks like a hang. Restart the import with a larger `-Xmx` or a smaller `arcadedb.maxPageRAM`.

A row of an edge-only source that cannot be read aborts the import. The edges of the rows before it are already written and connected, and a `PARTIAL` warning says how many, the same way a failing vertex source reports the vertices its earlier commits made durable.

### 7.2.3. Command-Line Usage

```
java -cp arcadedb-integration-*.jar
com.arcadedb.integration.importer.graph.GraphImporter \
  <json-config-file> <database-path> [data-dir]
```

- `json-config-file` — Path to the JSON configuration file (see JSON Configuration below)
- `database-path` — Path where the database will be created (any existing database at this path is deleted)
- `data-dir` — Optional base directory for resolving relative file paths in the JSON config (defaults to the JSON file's parent directory)

### 7.2.4. Java API

The importer can also be used programmatically via a fluent Builder API. It commits in batches of its own, so `run()` must be called with no transaction open: it fails with an `IllegalStateException` otherwise, rather than committing work your rollback could not undo *(since v26.10.1)*.

```
try (GraphImporter importer = GraphImporter.builder(database)
    .vertex("User", new CsvRowSource("users.csv"), v -> {
        v.id("Id");
        v.intProperty("reputation", "Reputation");
        v.property("name", "DisplayName");
    })
    .vertex("Question", new XmlRowSource("posts.xml"), v -> {
        v.id("Id");
        v.filter("PostTypeId", "1");
        v.property("title", "Title");
        v.edgeIn("OwnerUserId", "ASKED", "User");
        v.splitEdge("Tags", "TAGGED_WITH", "Tag", "|");
    })
    .edgeSource("LINKED_TO", new CsvRowSource("links.csv"), e -> {
        e.from("PostId", "Question");
        e.to("RelatedId", "Question");
        e.intProperty("linkType", "LinkTypeId");
    })
    .limit(10000)
    .build()) {

  importer.run();
  System.out.printf("Vertices: %,d, Edges: %,d%n",
      importer.getVertexCount(), importer.getEdgeCount());
}
```

Or from a JSON configuration file:

```
String json = new String(Files.readAllBytes(jsonFile.toPath()));
JSONObject config = new JSONObject(json);

GraphImporter.createSchemaFromConfig(database, config);

try (GraphImporter importer = GraphImporter.fromJSON(database, config, dataDir)) {
  importer.run();
}

GraphImporter.executePostImportCommands(database, config);
```

### 7.2.5. JSON Configuration

The JSON configuration file defines vertex types, edge types, data sources, property mappings, and

optional post-import commands.

### Vertex Definitions

Each entry in the `vertices` array defines a vertex type and its data source:

| Key | Required | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `type` | Yes | ArcadeDB vertex type name (auto-created if it does not exist) |
| `file` | Yes | Source file path, relative to the data directory. Format is auto-detected from extension: `.xml`, `.csv`, `.jsonl` |
| `id` | Yes | Source attribute used as the primary key for edge resolution between types. The value is taken as written, so an integer, a value too large for an integer, and a string such as `W13696992` all work. Two spellings the file keeps apart stay two different keys: `007` and `7` are not the same vertex. An empty value registers no key |
| `nameId` | No | Secondary key, used by `split` edges and by `byName` edges to resolve values by name. Declare it only when a type is referenced through two different keys — a numeric id from one file and a name from another. A single string key needs nothing more than `id` |
| `filter` | No | Row filter in the format `attribute=value`. Only matching rows are imported. This enables splitting one file into multiple vertex types. An empty value (`attribute=`) selects the rows that do not set the attribute |
| `element` | No | For XML files: element name to read (defaults to `row`) |
| `properties` | No | Maps ArcadeDB property names to source attributes, optionally with a type prefix. See Property Types |
| `edges` | No | Array of edge definitions derived from foreign key attributes in this vertex's source file |

### Property Types

A property mapping is `"dbPropertyName": "sourceAttribute"`, where the source attribute may carry a type prefix. Without a prefix the value is imported as a string. The same prefixes are accepted in vertex `properties` and in edge-source `properties`.

Before 26.10.1 an `edgeSources` entry understood only `int:`, `long:` and `double:`, and quietly ignored any other mapping. If you have a configuration that declares other property types on an edge source, those properties are now actually imported.

An empty value means "not set" in every source format. Before 26.10.1 that was true only for CSV: the same blank column stored an empty string when the row came from a JSONL or XML file, so `IS NULL` and mandatory-property checks answered differently depending on which format the data had been exported to.

| Prefix | Stored type | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| *(none)* | `STRING` | Null or empty source values are skipped |
| `int:` | `INTEGER` | Missing or empty values default to `0` |
| `long:` | `LONG` | Missing or empty values default to `0` |
| `double:` | `DOUBLE` | Missing or empty values default to `0.0` |
| `bool:` | `BOOLEAN` | `true` when the value is `True`/`true` |
| `datetime:` | `DATETIME` | Default format `yyyy-MM-dd HH:mm:ss`. For a custom pattern use `datetime:FORMAT\|attribute`, with both halves present |
| `vector:` | `ARRAY_OF_FLOATS` (`float[]`) | A dense float vector (an embedding). JSONL reads the JSON array natively; CSV and XML parse the textual form `[0.1,0.2,0.3]`. See Arrays in a CSV file |
| `list:` | `LIST` | A generic array, e.g. a list of tags |

Every prefix has to be followed by the name of the source attribute to read: a value such as `"int:"` on its own, or a `datetime:` pattern missing one half of its `FORMAT|attribute` pair, is reported as a configuration error. The same goes for a missing `type`, `edge`, `target`, `attribute` or `file` key: the message names the key, the source that declares it, and what the value is for. *(Since v26.10.1: these were accepted and then matched nothing, so the import ran and the property was simply never filled in.)*

#### Importing Vector Embeddings

Embedding pipelines usually emit JSONL with the vector inline as a JSON array:

```
{"id": 1, "title": "The Hitchhiker's Guide to the Galaxy", "tags": ["scifi",
"comedy"],
 "embedding": [-0.31142, 0.51346, -0.02326, -0.29451, 0.57215]}
```

Declare the column with the `vector:` prefix and create the index afterwards with a post-import command:

```
{
  "vertices": [
    {
      "type": "Book", "file": "books.jsonl", "id": "id",
      "properties": {
        "title": "title",
        "tags": "list:tags",
        "embedding": "vector:embedding"
      }
    }
  ],
```

```
  "postImportCommands": [
    { "language": "sql",
      "command": "CREATE INDEX ON Book (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA { dimensions:
5, similarity: 'COSINE' }" }
  ]
}
```

The property is stored as a primitive `float[]`, not as a list of boxed numbers: a 768-dimension embedding costs roughly 3KB per vertex instead of 18KB, which matters on a bulk load of millions of rows, and it is the exact representation the vector index consumes, so building the index converts nothing.

Use `vector:` only for numeric arrays. `list:` keeps the array as a generic list and is the right choice for heterogeneous or non-numeric arrays such as tags.

The equivalent Java API calls are `floatArrayProperty(name, attribute)` and `listProperty(name, attribute)`.

#### Loading into a type with a vector index

The index can also exist before the import. Every vector the load writes goes into the index's delta buffer, where it is searchable by a linear scan, and the HNSW graph that makes the search fast is built afterwards. Left to the index, that build starts once the index has been quiet for its inactivity window, on a background thread - and a `database.close()` right after `run()`, which is what a loader normally does, cancels it and throws the work away.

So the importer builds it itself: when `run()` returns, every `LSM_VECTOR` index on a type the import wrote to has its graph built and persisted, and the process can close the database at once. The build is logged with its progress and takes as long as `CREATE INDEX` would over the same vectors. An index whose graph is already current is skipped.

To leave the build to the index's background rebuild instead - only worth it when the database stays open long enough for that build to complete - set `"vectorGraphBuild": false` in the JSON configuration, or `.withVectorGraphBuild(false)` on the builder.

#### Arrays in a CSV file

CSV and XML have no array of their own, so an array column is read from its textual form `[0.1,0.2,0.3]`. In a CSV file, choose a delimiter the array does not contain - `;` rather than the default `,` - because the CSV reader splits on the delimiter without honouring quotes, and a comma-delimited file would cut the array across several columns:

```
Id;Title;Embedding
1;The Hitchhiker's Guide to the Galaxy;[-0.31142,0.51346,-0.02326]
```

If the array is split anyway, the import stops and says so, naming the property and the delimiter.

### Edge Definitions (within a vertex)

Each entry in a vertex's `edges` array defines how to create edges from foreign key attributes:

| Key | Required | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `attribute` | Yes | Source attribute containing the foreign key value |
| `edge` | Yes | ArcadeDB edge type name (auto-created if it does not exist) |
| `target` | Yes | Target vertex type the foreign key references |
| `direction` | No | `out` (default): this vertex → target. `in`: target → this vertex |
| `split` | No | Delimiter for multi-value fields (e.g., `\|`). One edge is created per value, resolved by the target's `nameId` |

### Edge-Only Sources

The `edgeSources` array defines edges where both endpoints already exist as vertices. No vertices are created from these sources, and their rows are streamed into the database rather than held in memory, so an edge file of billions of rows needs no more heap than a small one (see Memory and Progress):

| Key | Required | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `edge` | Yes | ArcadeDB edge type name |
| `file` | Yes | Source file path |
| `from` | Yes | Compact format `attribute:vertexType` — source attribute and its vertex type. Matched against that type's `id`, whatever the value looks like |
| `to` | Yes | Compact format `attribute:vertexType` — target attribute and its vertex type |
| `properties` | No | Property mappings (same format as vertex properties) |

### General Options

| Key | Required | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `limit` | No | Maximum records per source (for testing). Omit or set to 0 for unlimited |
| `vectorGraphBuild` | No | Whether to build the graph of every `LSM_VECTOR` index on a type the import wrote to before `run()` returns (default `true`). See Loading into a type with a vector index |

### Post-Import Commands

The `postImportCommands` array defines commands to execute automatically after the graph import completes. This is useful for creating indexes, analytical views, or running any database command that depends on the imported data being present.

| Key | Required | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `language` | Yes | Query language to use: `sql`, `opencypher`, etc. |
| `command` | Yes | The command text to execute |

Commands are executed sequentially in the order they appear. If a command fails, a warning is logged and the remaining commands continue to execute.

The entries are validated before the import starts, so a missing or empty `language` or `command` is reported straight away rather than after every row has been read. *(Since v26.10.1.)*

If any post-import command triggers an asynchronous Graph Analytical View build, the importer automatically waits (up to 10 minutes) for all views to reach READY status before returning.

Example:

```
"postImportCommands": [
  {
    "language": "sql",
    "command": "CREATE INDEX ON Question (Id) UNIQUE"
  },
  {
    "language": "sql",
    "command": "CREATE GRAPH ANALYTICAL VIEW IF NOT EXISTS myGraph PROPERTIES
(`!Body`, `!Text`) UPDATE MODE SYNCHRONOUS"
  }
]
```

### 7.2.6. Complete Example

Below is a complete JSON configuration for importing a StackOverflow data dump:

```
{
  "vertices": [
    {
      "type": "Tag", "file": "Tags.xml", "id": "Id", "nameId": "TagName",
      "properties": { "Id": "int:Id", "TagName": "TagName", "Count": "int:Count" }
    },
    {
      "type": "User", "file": "Users.xml", "id": "Id",
      "properties": {
        "Id": "int:Id", "DisplayName": "DisplayName", "Reputation": "int:Reputation",
        "CreationDate": "CreationDate", "Views": "int:Views"
      }
    },
    {
      "type": "Question", "file": "Posts.xml", "id": "Id", "filter": "PostTypeId=1",
      "properties": {
        "Id": "int:Id", "Title": "Title", "Body": "Body",
```

```
        "Score": "int:Score", "ViewCount": "int:ViewCount", "Tags": "Tags"
      },
      "edges": [
        { "attribute": "OwnerUserId", "edge": "ASKED", "target": "User", "direction":
"in" },
        { "attribute": "Tags", "edge": "TAGGED_WITH", "target": "Tag", "split": "|" }
      ]
    },
    {
      "type": "Answer", "file": "Posts.xml", "id": "Id", "filter": "PostTypeId=2",
      "properties": {
        "Id": "int:Id", "Body": "Body", "Score": "int:Score"
      },
      "edges": [
        { "attribute": "OwnerUserId", "edge": "ANSWERED", "target": "User",
"direction": "in" },
        { "attribute": "ParentId", "edge": "HAS_ANSWER", "target": "Question",
"direction": "in" }
      ]
    }
  ],

  "edgeSources": [
    {
      "edge": "ACCEPTED_ANSWER", "file": "Posts.xml",
      "from": "Id:Question", "to": "AcceptedAnswerId:Answer"
    },
    {
      "edge": "LINKED_TO", "file": "PostLinks.xml",
      "from": "PostId:Question", "to": "RelatedPostId:Question",
      "properties": { "LinkType": "int:LinkTypeId" }
    }
  ],

  "postImportCommands": [
    {
      "language": "sql",
      "command": "CREATE GRAPH ANALYTICAL VIEW IF NOT EXISTS stackoverflow PROPERTIES
(`!Body`, `!Text`) UPDATE MODE SYNCHRONOUS"
    }
  ]
}
```

### 7.2.7. Identities and Missing Edges

Every edge is resolved by matching the value of a foreign key against the `id` of the vertex type it points at. The importer compares those values as text, so any key your files already use works without being converted first:

```
{"id": "W13696992", "title": "A paper", "publication_year": 2008}
```

```
from_id,to_id
2257721487,28031933
```

Before 26.10.1 both of these failed: an identity had to fit an `int`, so a string key or one larger than about two billion aborted the import. Vertex ids of `0` were also unusable as an edge endpoint. No configuration change is needed to benefit from the fix.

When an edge names a key that no vertex carries, the edge is skipped — there is nothing to attach it to — but the importer now counts it and logs a warning per source, and the total is available from `getUnresolvedEdgeCount()` in the Java API. A graph that comes out smaller than the files you fed in no longer does so silently.

Four configurations that could only ever produce zero edges are now rejected with an error before anything is written, instead of importing a quietly incomplete graph:

- an edge pointing at a vertex type that no source imports (usually a typo in the type name)
- an edge pointing at a vertex type that is imported **after** the source referencing it. A vertex source can only resolve against types already imported, so declare the target's source first
- an edge resolving against the `id` of a type that declares only `nameId`, or the reverse
- two vertex sources declaring the same type name

### 7.2.8. Supported File Formats

The file format is auto-detected from the file extension:

| Extension | Format |
|---|---|
| `.xml` | XML elements (configurable element name, defaults to `row`) |
| `.csv` | CSV with header row (first line defines property names) |
| `.jsonl` | JSON Lines (one JSON object per line) |

### 7.2.9. Data Sources (Java API)

When using the Java API, you can use the following `RecordSource` implementations:

- `CsvRowSource` — reads CSV files
- `XmlRowSource` — reads XML files
- `JsonlRowSource` — reads JSONL files

Custom data sources can be implemented via the `RecordSource` interface.

## 7.3. JSON Importer

ArcadeDB is able to import data from JSON format. Thanks to the flexible mapping, it's possible to define the rules of conversion between the input json file and the graph.

Let's start from this simple JSON file to import as an example. The file contains a flat structure of records with a relationship of employee and manager:

```
{
  "Users":[
    {
      "EmployeeID":"1234",
      "ManagerID":"1230",
      "Name":"Marcus"
    },
    {
      "EmployeeID":"1230",
      "ManagerID":"1231",
      "Name":"Win"
    }
  ]
}
```

First, create a new database "employees" by using the console:

```
> CREATE DATABASE employees
```

Then execute the following command (assuming the file above is saved in the local directory as `employees.json`:

```
{employees}> IMPORT DATABASE employees.json WITH mapping = {
    "Users": [{
            "@cat": "v",
            "@type": "User",
            "@id": "id",
            "@idType": "string",
            "@strategy": "merge",
            "EmployeeID": "@ignore",
            "ManagerID": {
                    "@cat": "e",
                    "@type": "HAS_MANAGER",
                    "@cardinality": "no-duplicates",
                    "@in": {
                            "@cat": "v",
                            "@type": "User",
                            "@id": "id",
                            "@idType": "string",
```

```
                        "@strategy": "merge",
                        "EmployeeID": "@ignore",
                        "id": "<../ManagerID>"
                    }
            }
    }]
}
```

The mapping file is a JSON snippet with directives about what to import, what to ignore and how to map edges with JSON objects. Below all the supported tags:

- `@cat`: is the category of record to use between "v" for vertex, "e" for edge and "d" for document
- `@type`: is the type name to use on record creation. If the type doesn't exist, it's implicitly created during the import
- `@id`: is the property that works as primary key. if not already defined, a unique index is created on the configured `@id` property
- `@idType`: is the type of the primary key in the `@id` property. If not defined, the type is taken from the first value found. In case of numbers, the JSON parser always uses DOUBLE as a type. You can, for example, use LONG to force using LONG instead of DOUBLE
- `@cardinality`: if "no-duplicates", the edges are not created if there is an edge of the same type between the two vertices
- `@strategy`: represents the strategy to use when the record with the configured `@id` already exists By default the existent record is used, but the "merge" strategy allows to merge the current record with the existent one. The current properties will overwrite the existent ones
- `@in`: used for edges and represents the destination vertex for the edge
- `@ignore`: ignore the property, do not import into the database

Note the "id" property in the manager is taken by using `"<../ManagerID>"` that means get the property "ManagerID" from the parent (`../`).

How to import a JSON file with a hierarchical structure? Let's look at the second example coming from the JSON export of food and nutrients from the U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE website (USDA). USDA provides updated files to download in both CSV and JSON format.

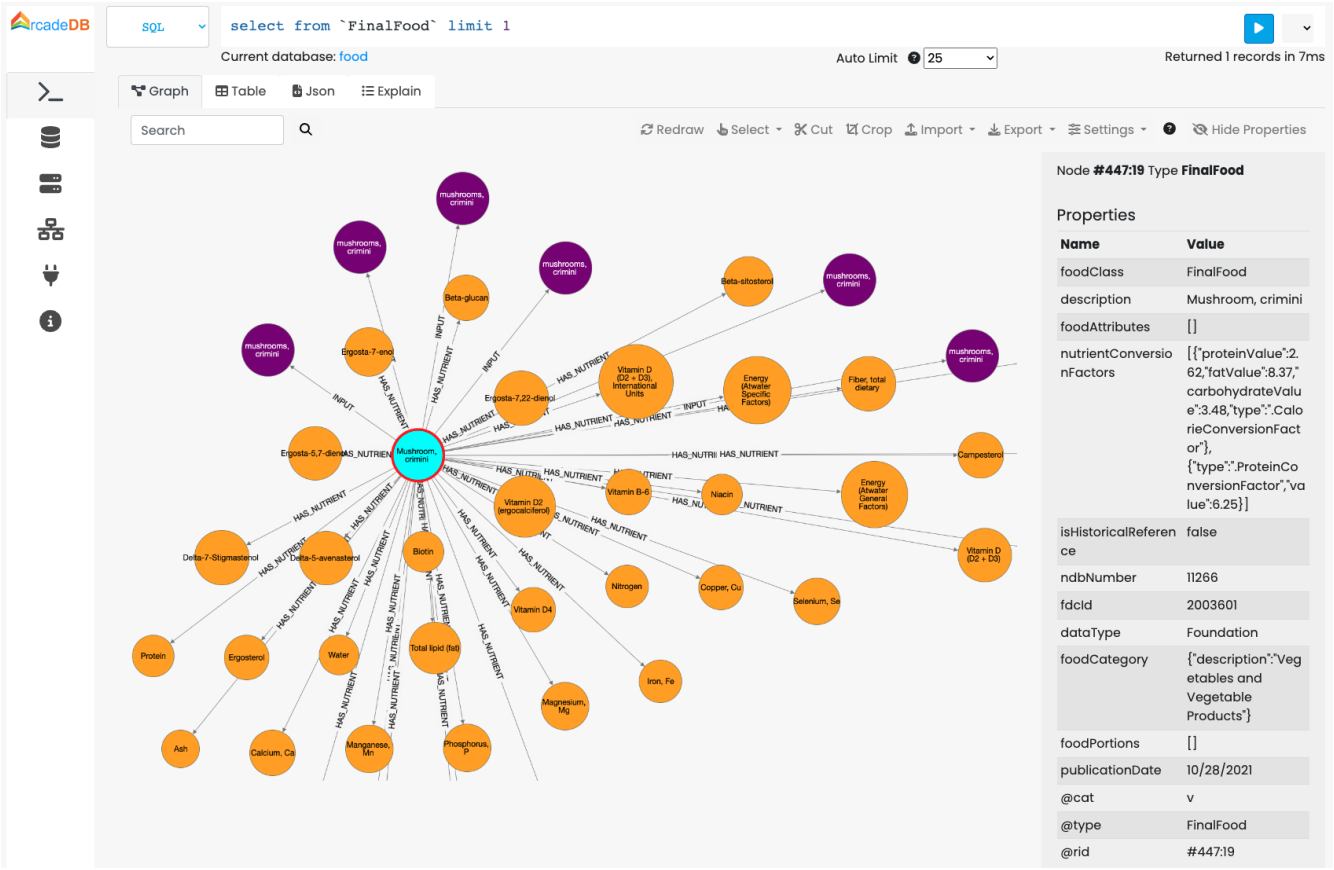
First, create a new database "food" by using the console:

```
> CREATE DATABASE food
```

Then execute the following command:

```
{food}> IMPORT DATABASE https://fdc.nal.usda.gov/fdc-datasets
/FoodData_Central_foundation_food_json_2022-10-28.zip WITH mapping = {
    "FoundationFoods": [{
        "@cat": "v",
        "@type": "<foodClass>",
```

```
        "foodNutrients": [{
            "@cat": "e",
            "@type": "HAS_NUTRIENT",
            "@in": "nutrient",
            "@cardinality": "no-duplicates",
            "nutrient": {
                "@cat": "v",
                "@type": "Nutrient",
                "@id": "id",
                "@idType": "long",
                "@strategy": "merge"
            },
            "foodNutrientDerivation": "@ignore"
        }],
        "inputFoods": [{
            "@cat": "e",
            "@type": "INPUT",
            "@in": "inputFood",
            "@cardinality": "no-duplicates",
            "inputFood": {
                "@cat": "v",
                "@type": "<foodClass>",
                "@id": "fdcId",
                "@idType": "long",
                "@strategy": "merge",
                "foodCategory": {
                    "@cat": "e",
                    "@type": "HAS_CATEGORY",
                    "@cardinality": "no-duplicates",
                    "@in": {
                        "@cat": "v",
                        "@type": "FoodCategory",
                        "@id": "id",
                        "@idType": "long",
                        "@strategy": "merge"
                    }
                }
            }
        }]
    }]
}
```




This command downloads the zip file from the USDA website and uses the mapping to create the graph from the JSON file.

The mapping file is a JSON snippet with directives about what to import, what to ignore and how to map edges with JSON objects. Below all the supported tags:

- `@cat`: is the category of record to use between "v" for vertex, "e" for edge and "d" for document
- `@type`: is the type name to use on record creation. If the type doesn't exist, it's implicitly created during the import
- `@id`: is the property that works as primary key. if not already defined, a unique index is created on the configured `@id` property
- `@idType`: is the type of the primary key in the `@id` property. If not defined, the type is taken from the first value found. In case of numbers, the JSON parser always uses DOUBLE as a type. You can, for example, use LONG to force using LONG instead of DOUBLE
- `@cardinality`: if "no-duplicates", the edges are not created if there is an edge of the same type between the two vertices
- `@strategy`: represents the strategy to use when the record with the configured `@id` already exists By default the existent record is used, but the "merge" strategy allows to merge the current record with the existent one. The current properties will overwrite the existent ones
- `@in`: used for edges and represents the destination vertex for the edge
- `@ignore`: ignore the property, do not import into the database

# 7.4. OrientDB Importer

Migrating from OrientDB? The ArcadeDB Academy offers a **free** course on OrientDB-to-ArcadeDB migration with hands-on exercises and a certification at the end.

ArcadeDB is able to import a database exported from OrientDB in JSON format.

For more information about how to export a database from OrientDB, look at Export Database.

To import a database use the Import Database command from API, Studio or Console. Below you can find an example of importing a OrientDB database by using ArcadeDB Console.

```
> CREATE DATABASE MyDatabase
{MyDatabase}> IMPORT DATABASE file:///temp/orientdb-export.tgz
```

## 7.4.1. What the import preserves

- **Property types**: numbers are imported with the type OrientDB exported them with, not as floating point values. Integers stay integers, LONG values keep every digit (including those above 2^53), DECIMAL keeps its precision and FLOAT does not widen to DOUBLE. This applies both to properties the OrientDB schema declared and to schemaless ones.
- **Indexes**: unique and non-unique indexes are recreated, including multi-column (composite) ones, so a uniqueness constraint the source database enforced is still enforced after the migration. Any property an index needs that the export did not declare is created for it.
- An index whose key type has no ArcadeDB equivalent (`LINKBAG`, for example) is skipped and reported in the import log. The rest of the import is unaffected.

## 7.4.2. Differences with OrientDB

ArcadeDB was created from the same original developers of OrientDB, but it was built from scratch with a completely new codebase and architecture. While many concepts will feel familiar to OrientDB users, there are important differences to be aware of when migrating.

## 7.4.3. Architecture

- **No classes hierarchy**: ArcadeDB uses Types instead of Classes. Types support single inheritance but do not support the polymorphic class hierarchy that OrientDB offered.
- **Buckets instead of Clusters**: What OrientDB called "clusters" are called "buckets" in ArcadeDB. They serve a similar purpose of physically grouping records, but the API and behavior differ.
- **No Record-level security**: ArcadeDB does not implement record-level security. Security is managed at the database and server level.
- **Embedded only or Client-Server**: ArcadeDB runs either as an embedded database or in client-server mode. There is no "remote" storage engine concept as in OrientDB.
- **Component-based storage**: ArcadeDB uses an LSM-Tree based storage engine, which is

fundamentally different from OrientDB's plocal/memory storage engines.

### 7.4.4. Data Model

- **No BLOB/Binary type**: ArcadeDB does not have a dedicated BLOB or ORecordBytes type. Binary data should be stored as Base64-encoded strings or managed externally.
- **No LINKBAG**: ArcadeDB uses simpler edge management for graphs and does not use the LINKBAG (ridbag) structure.
- **No CUSTOM field type**: The `CUSTOM` field type from OrientDB is not available.
- **No embedded geometry types**: ArcadeDB has no `OPoint`, `OLineString`, or `OPolygon` embedded types. Geometries are stored as WKT strings in `STRING` properties (see Geospatial Data below).
- **Record IDs**: ArcadeDB uses Record IDs (RIDs) with the same `#bucket:position` format, but the internal storage is different.

### 7.4.5. Geospatial Data (OPoint and other spatial types)

OrientDB's spatial module stored geometries as embedded documents of dedicated classes such as `OPoint`, `OLineString`, and `OPolygon`, each with a `coordinates` field. ArcadeDB has no embedded geometry type: geometries are stored as a plain `STRING` property containing the geometry in Well-Known Text (WKT) format, and are queried with the built-in `geo.*` SQL functions (backed by JTS and Spatial4j). See Geospatial Index for the full reference.

Both engines use the same axis order, **longitude first then latitude** (the GeoJSON/WKT convention), so coordinate values migrate directly without swapping.

| | OrientDB | ArcadeDB |
|---|---|---|
| Storage | Embedded `OPoint` with `coordinates: [lon, lat]` | `STRING` property with WKT: `POINT (lon lat)` |
| Construction | `ST_GeomFromText('POINT(12.5 41.9)')` | `geo.point(12.5, 41.9)` or the literal WKT string |
| Functions | `ST_*` (e.g. `ST_Distance`, `ST_Within`) | `geo.*` (e.g. `geo.distance`, `geo.within`) |
| Index | Lucene spatial index | `CREATE INDEX … GEOSPATIAL` (see Creating a Geospatial Index) |

To migrate `OPoint` data:

1. Define the target property as `STRING`:

```
CREATE PROPERTY City.location STRING
```

2. Convert each `OPoint` to WKT on insert. An OrientDB export serializes an `OPoint` as `{"@class":"OPoint","coordinates":[12.5,41.9]}`; map `coordinates[0]` to longitude (x) and `coordinates[1]` to latitude (y):

```
INSERT INTO City SET name = 'Rome', location = 'POINT (12.5 41.9)'
-- or build it from the coordinates programmatically:
INSERT INTO City SET name = 'Rome', location = geo.point(12.5, 41.9)
```

3. Create a geospatial index (used automatically by `geo.within` and `geo.intersects`):

```
CREATE INDEX ON City (location) GEOSPATIAL
```

4. Translate `ST_*` queries to their `geo.*` equivalents:

```
-- distance with the Haversine formula (unit: 'km' default, or 'm')
SELECT geo.distance(location, geo.point(12.49, 41.90), 'km') AS dist_km FROM City

-- containment / proximity (index-accelerated). geo.buffer distance is in degrees
-- (~0.01 deg ≈ 1.1 km at the equator)
SELECT FROM City WHERE geo.within(location, geo.buffer(geo.point(12.5, 41.9), 0.
01)) = true
```

The same pattern applies to other OrientDB spatial types: use `geo.lineString(…)` for `OLineString` and `geo.polygon(…)` for `OPolygon`, or insert the corresponding `LINESTRING (…)` / `POLYGON …` WKT directly. Use `geo.x()` / `geo.y()` to extract raw coordinates (for example to validate migrated values against the originals) and `geo.asGeoJson()` for GeoJSON output.

### 7.4.6. SQL

- **Mostly compatible**: ArcadeDB SQL is largely compatible with OrientDB SQL, with some differences:
  - `LET` blocks in queries have some syntax differences.
  - `TRAVERSE` is supported but deprecated in favor of `MATCH` and recursive queries.
  - The `.asSet()`, `.asList()`, `.asMap()` methods are kept for OrientDB compatibility.
  - `DELETE … UNSAFE` is kept only for compatibility but has no effect.
  - Some OrientDB-specific functions may not be available.
- **New SQL extensions**: ArcadeDB adds SQL commands not found in OrientDB, such as `ALIGN DATABASE`, `IMPORT DATABASE` with multiple format support, and enhanced `MATCH` syntax.

### 7.4.7. API

- **No ODocument/OVertex/OEdge**: ArcadeDB has its own API with `Document`, `Vertex`, and `Edge` interfaces that are similar in concept but different in implementation.
- **No ODatabaseDocument**: Use `Database` or `DatabaseFactory` in ArcadeDB.
- **No OClass**: Use `DocumentType`, `VertexType`, and `EdgeType` instead.
- **Multi-model API**: ArcadeDB provides a unified multi-model API from the start, supporting

Document, Graph, Key/Value, Search Engine, Time Series, Vector, and Geospatial models.

### 7.4.8. Connectivity

- **HTTP/JSON API**: ArcadeDB provides a REST API that is different from OrientDB's REST API. The endpoints and JSON format are not compatible.
- **Postgres wire protocol**: ArcadeDB supports the PostgreSQL wire protocol, allowing connections from any PostgreSQL-compatible client. OrientDB did not offer this.
- **MongoDB wire protocol**: ArcadeDB supports the MongoDB wire protocol natively.
- **Redis wire protocol**: ArcadeDB supports a subset of the Redis protocol.
- **Bolt protocol**: ArcadeDB supports the Neo4j Bolt protocol, enabling connections from Neo4j-compatible clients and drivers.
- **gRPC protocol**: ArcadeDB supports gRPC for high-performance client-server communication.
- **No binary protocol**: ArcadeDB does not use a custom binary protocol like OrientDB's. Instead, it relies on HTTP/JSON and standard database wire protocols (PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Bolt, gRPC).
- **Gremlin**: ArcadeDB supports Apache TinkerPop Gremlin, similar to OrientDB, but through an embedded Gremlin engine rather than as a TinkerPop server.

### 7.4.9. Migration

To migrate from OrientDB to ArcadeDB:

1. **Export from OrientDB**: Export your OrientDB database using the OrientDB console `EXPORT DATABASE` command in JSON format.
2. **Import into ArcadeDB**: Use the ArcadeDB OrientDB Importer or the `IMPORT DATABASE` SQL command:

```
IMPORT DATABASE url=file:///path/to/orientdb-export.json.gz
```

3. **Update application code**: Adapt your application to use ArcadeDB's API, drivers, and connection protocols.
4. **Test thoroughly**: Verify that queries, data integrity, and application logic work correctly with ArcadeDB.

For more details on importing, see the OrientDB Importer section.

## 7.5. Neo4j Importer

Migrating from Neo4j? The ArcadeDB Academy offers a **free** course on Neo4j-to-ArcadeDB migration with hands-on exercises and a certification at the end.

ArcadeDB is able to import a database exported from Neo4j in JSONL format (one json per line).

To export a Neo4j database follow the instructions in Export in JSON. The resulting file contains one json per line.

### 7.5.1. Performance

The Neo4j importer uses the high-performance `GraphBatch` API internally:

- **Vertices** are created with pre-allocated edge segments, eliminating lazy allocation during edge creation.
- **Edges** are buffered in flat primitive arrays and flushed sorted by source vertex, converting random I/O into sequential I/O. Light edges (no edge record on disk) are used when an edge has no properties.
- **WAL is disabled** during import for maximum throughput.
- **ID mapping** uses a primitive `long[]`-based hash map when Neo4j IDs are numeric (the common case with APOC exports), using only ~24 bytes per vertex. For non-numeric IDs, the importer automatically falls back to a standard `HashMap`. This makes it possible to import databases with hundreds of millions of vertices within a few gigabytes of heap.

### 7.5.2. Multi-label handling

Neo4j supports multiple labels per node, while in ArcadeDB a node (vertex) must have only one type. The Neo4j importer will simulate multiple labels by creating new types with the following name: `<label1>[~<labelN>]*`. Example:

```
{"type":"node","id":"1","labels":["User", "Administrator"],"properties":{"name":"Jim"
,"age":42}}
```

This vertex will be created in ArcadeDB with type "Administrator~User" (the labels are always sorted alphabetically) that extends both "Administrator" and "User" types.

In this way you can use the polymorphism of ArcadeDB to retrieve all the nodes of type "User" and the record of User and all its subtypes will be returned.

### 7.5.3. Importing via SQL

To import a database use the Import Database command from API, Studio or Console. Below you can find an example of importing the Neo4j's PanamaPapers database by using ArcadeDB Console.

```
> CREATE DATABASE PanamaPapers
{PanamaPapers}> IMPORT DATABASE file:///temp/panama-papers-neo4j.jsonl
```

```
ArcadeDB 26.10.1 - Neo4j Importer
Importing Neo4j database from file 'panama-papers-neo4j.jsonl' to
'databases/PanamaPapers'
- Creation of the schema: types, properties and indexes
```

```
- Creation of vertices started
- Creation of vertices completed: created 3 vertices, skipped 1 edges (0 vertices/sec
elapsed=0 secs)
- ID mapping mode: numeric (primitive long[])
- Creation of edges started: creating edges between vertices
- Creation of edges completed: created 1 edges, (0 edges/sec elapsed=0 secs)
********************************************************************************
*************
Import of Neo4j database completed in 0 secs with 0 errors and 0 warnings.
```

### 7.5.4. Importing via command line

The Neo4j importer can also be used directly from the command line:

```
java -cp lib/* com.arcadedb.integration.importer.Neo4jImporter -i <input-file> -d
<database-path> [options]
```

**Options:**

| Option | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `-i <file>` | | Path to the Neo4j JSONL export file (required) |
| `-d <path>` | | Path where the ArcadeDB database will be created (required) |
| `-o` | false | Overwrite the database if it already exists |
| `-b <size>` | 10,000 | Number of records per transaction batch |
| `-decimalType <type>` | DECIMAL | Type for decimal values: FLOAT, DOUBLE, or DECIMAL |
| `-bucketBits <n>` | 10 | Bits allocated for bucket IDs in the internal RID packing. The default supports up to 1,023 buckets, which is sufficient for most databases. Increase this value only if you have a very large number of types and buckets (e.g. `-bucketBits 16` supports up to 65,535 buckets) |

**Example:**

```
java -cp lib/* com.arcadedb.integration.importer.Neo4jImporter \
  -i /data/neo4j-export.jsonl -d /data/arcadedb/mydb -o -decimalType double
```

### 7.5.5. Memory considerations

For large imports (hundreds of millions of vertices), the main memory consumer is the ID mapping table that translates Neo4j node IDs to ArcadeDB record IDs. The table size depends on the ID format:

| ID format | Memory per vertex | Example: 100M vertices |
|---|---|---|
| Numeric (e.g. "0", "12345") | ~24 bytes | ~2.2 GB |
| String (e.g. "node-abc") | ~140 bytes | ~13 GB |

Neo4j APOC exports use numeric IDs by default, so most imports will use the compact primitive map. If the importer encounters a non-numeric ID, it automatically migrates to the string-based map and logs a message:

```
- Non-numeric Neo4j ID detected, switching to string-based ID mapping
```

For very large imports, allocate enough heap memory. For example, to import a database with 500M vertices using numeric IDs, you would need approximately 12 GB for the ID mapping table alone, plus memory for ArcadeDB's internal buffers. A setting of `-Xmx24G` or more is recommended.

### 7.5.6. Differences with Neo4j

ArcadeDB is fully compatible with Neo4j at the wire-protocol and query-language level — your existing applications can connect to ArcadeDB by changing the connection URL alone — but the engine underneath is multi-model, embeddable, and Apache 2.0 licensed. This page summarises what carries over, what is new, and how to migrate.

### 7.5.7. What's compatible

ArcadeDB ships several drop-in compatibility layers so existing Neo4j codebases keep working with minimal changes:

- **OpenCypher** — ArcadeDB implements OpenCypher (97.8% TCK pass rate) on every supported data model. Most Cypher queries written against Neo4j run unmodified.
- **Bolt protocol** — ArcadeDB exposes a Bolt server compatible with Bolt v3.0, v4.0, and v4.4. Official Neo4j drivers (Java, Python, JavaScript, .NET, Go, Ruby) connect by switching the URL and credentials; existing application code stays untouched.
- **APOC** — A subset of Neo4j's APOC procedures is available through ArcadeDB's Extended Functions.

### 7.5.8. Where ArcadeDB goes further

Beyond Neo4j compatibility, ArcadeDB adds capabilities that typically require multiple databases on the Neo4j stack:

- **Multi-model** — graph, document, key/value, search, time-series, vector, and geospatial data live in a single engine and a single transaction. Neo4j is graph-only.
- **Multi-language** — beyond Cypher, ArcadeDB speaks SQL, Gremlin, GraphQL, MongoDB Query Language, and Redis commands.

- **Native vector search** — built-in JVector (DiskANN + HNSW with SIMD acceleration). No external vector database required.
- **Built-in full-text search** with fuzzy matching, integrated with the query languages.
- **High Availability and replication** are part of the open-source distribution. Neo4j requires the (paid) Enterprise edition for HA.
- **Embeddable** — ArcadeDB runs inside a JVM application with a few-megabyte footprint (as low as 16 MB heap). Neo4j Embedded is Enterprise-only.
- **Apache 2.0 licence** — free for commercial use, no copyleft. Neo4j Community is GPL, which forces distributed applications to publish their source.

### 7.5.9. Performance comparison

The LDBC Graphalytics benchmark shows the following timings on identical workloads (lower is better):

| Algorithm | ArcadeDB | Neo4j |
|---|---|---|
| PageRank | **0.48 s** | 11.15 s |
| Weakly Connected Components (WCC) | **0.30 s** | 0.75 s |
| Breadth-First Search (BFS) | **0.13 s** | 1.91 s |
| Local Clustering Coefficient (LCC) | **27.41 s** | 45.78 s |
| Single-Source Shortest Path (SSSP) | **3.53 s** | not available |
| Community Detection (CDLP) | **3.67 s** | 6.43 s |

ArcadeDB's Graph OLAP engine delivers up to 400× faster analytics than Neo4j on the same hardware.

### 7.5.10. Connecting an existing Neo4j application

The quickest path is the Bolt server: keep using Neo4j's official drivers and only change the connection URL and credentials.

```
// Existing Neo4j code works unchanged when pointed at ArcadeDB's Bolt port.
Driver driver = GraphDatabase.driver(
    "bolt://localhost:7687",
    AuthTokens.basic("root", "arcadedb_password"),
    Config.builder().withoutEncryption().build());

try (Session session = driver.session(SessionConfig.forDatabase("mydb"))) {
  Result rs = session.run(
      "MATCH (p:Person)-[:KNOWS]->(f) WHERE p.name = $n RETURN f.name AS name",
      Map.of("n", "Alice"));
  rs.list().forEach(r -> System.out.println(r.get("name").asString()));
}
```

See Neo4j Bolt Protocol Plugin for server configuration and supported clients.

### 7.5.11. Importing a Neo4j database

ArcadeDB ships a Neo4j importer that reads APOC's JSONL export format and rebuilds the graph on top of ArcadeDB's storage.

1. Export the source database from Neo4j using APOC:

   ```
   CALL apoc.export.json.all("neo4j-export.jsonl", {})
   ```

   APOC writes one JSON object per line — vertices first, then relationships:

   ```
   {"type":"node","id":"0","labels":["User"],"properties":{"name":"Adam","age":42}}
   {"type":"node","id":"1","labels":["User"],"properties":{"name":"Jim","age":42}}
   {"type":"relationship","label":"KNOWS","properties":{"since":1993},
    "start":{"id":"0","labels":["User"]},"end":{"id":"1","labels":["User"]}}
   ```

2. Import into ArcadeDB through the console:

   ```
   > CREATE DATABASE MyDatabase
   {MyDatabase}> IMPORT DATABASE file:///path/to/neo4j-export.jsonl
   ```

   or programmatically through the Java API:

   ```
   Neo4jImporter importer = new Neo4jImporter(
       "-i", "/path/to/neo4j-export.jsonl",
       "-d", "./databases/MyDatabase",
       "-o");                                // overwrite if exists
   importer.run();
   ```

The importer runs three passes: schema reconciliation, vertex creation, and edge creation.

### 7.5.12. Multi-label nodes

Neo4j allows a single node to carry several labels (for example `[User, Administrator]`). ArcadeDB models the same idea with type inheritance: the importer creates a synthetic type `Administrator~User` (labels sorted alphabetically and joined with `~`) that extends both `Administrator` and `User`. Polymorphic queries work as expected — `SELECT FROM User` returns ordinary `User` vertices and every `Administrator~User` vertex.

### 7.5.13. Schema and constraints

Neo4j's `CREATE CONSTRAINT … REQUIRE … IS UNIQUE` translates to a small block of ArcadeDB SQL DDL:

```
-- Neo4j
-- CREATE CONSTRAINT FOR (p:Person) REQUIRE p.id IS UNIQUE

CREATE VERTEX TYPE Person
CREATE EDGE TYPE KNOWS
CREATE PROPERTY Person.id LONG
CREATE INDEX ON Person (id) UNIQUE
```

### 7.5.14. Embedding ArcadeDB

The native Java API skips the Bolt round-trip entirely and gives you full multi-model access in-process. This mode is exclusive to Apache 2.0 — no Enterprise licence required.

```
Database database = new DatabaseFactory("./databases/mydb").open();

database.transaction(() -> {
  MutableVertex alice = database.newVertex("Person");
  alice.set("name", "Alice");
  alice.set("born", 1985);
  alice.save();

  MutableVertex bob = database.newVertex("Person");
  bob.set("name", "Bob");
  bob.set("born", 1990);
  bob.save();

  alice.newEdge("KNOWS", bob, "since", 2015);
});

// Native graph traversal — no string queries, no parser overhead.
Vertex alice = database.lookupByKey("Person", "name", "Alice").next().asVertex();
for (Vertex friend : alice.getVertices(Vertex.DIRECTION.OUT, "KNOWS"))
  System.out.println(friend.getString("name"));
```

For sustained inserts, use the asynchronous API to fan operations across all available threads:

```
database.async().onError(Throwable::printStackTrace);
for (int i = 0; i < 1_000_000; i++) {
  MutableVertex v = database.newVertex("Person");
  v.set("id", i);
  v.set("name", "Person_" + i);
  database.async().createRecord(v, null);
}
```

### 7.5.15. Further reading

- Cypher in ArcadeDB — language overview and compatibility notes.
- Cypher Compatibility — the exact subset of OpenCypher TCK ArcadeDB passes.
- Bolt Protocol — wire-protocol setup for Neo4j drivers.
- Neo4j Importer — full reference for the JSONL importer used above.
- Graph OLAP Engine — the analytics engine behind the benchmark numbers.

# Chapter 8. Self-Managed Deployment

## 8.1. Installations from Binaries

ArcadeDB is released for both Java 17 and Java 21.

Java 21 packages are available through GitHub releases page or Maven central.

Java 17 packages are available through Github packages page.

Download the package suitable for your platform and follow the instructions below.

1. Unpack `tar -xzf arcadedb-26.10.1.tar.gz`
   - Change into directory: `cd arcadedb-26.10.1`
2. Launch server
   - Linux / MacOS: `bin/server.sh`
   - Windows: `bin\server.bat`
3. Exit server via **CTRL+C**
4. Interact with server
   - Studio: `http://localhost:2480`
   - Console:
     - Linux / MacOS: `bin/console.sh`
     - Windows: `bin\console.bat`
5. Exit server via **CTRL+C**

### 8.1.1. Binaries

| | Linux / Mac | Windows |
|---|---|---|
| Server | `bin/server.sh` | `bin\server.bat` |
| Console | `bin/console.sh` | `bin\console.bat` |

### 8.1.2. macOS via Homebrew

ArcadeDB is available as an official Homebrew formula. Install it with:

```
brew install arcadedb
```

After installation the following commands are available on your `PATH`:

```
arcadedb-server
arcadedb-console
```

Use these instead of `bin/server.sh` and `bin/console.sh` mentioned above.

On the first launch, set the `root` password by passing it on the command line:

```
arcadedb-server -Darcadedb.server.rootPassword=<your-password>
```

Replace `<your-password>` with a strong password. The server stores the (hashed) credential under its configuration directory, so subsequent launches can be started with `arcadedb-server` alone.

To upgrade to the latest release:

```
brew update
brew upgrade arcadedb
```

### 8.1.3. Manual installation on macOS

If you prefer not to use Homebrew:

1. Download the latest release from https://github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb/releases
2. Extract the archive to your preferred location (e.g., `/usr/local/arcadedb`)
3. Add the `bin` directory to your `PATH`:

```
echo 'export PATH="/usr/local/arcadedb/bin:$PATH"' >> ~/.zshrc
source ~/.zshrc
```

### 8.1.4. Windows via Scoop

Instead of using manual install you can use Scoop installer, instructions are available on their project website.

```
scoop bucket add extras
scoop install arcadedb
```

This downloads and installs ArcadeDB on your box and makes following two commands available:

```
arcadedb-console
arcadedb-server
```

You should use these instead of `bin\console.bat` and `bin\server.bat` mentioned above.

### 8.1.5. Custom Package Builder

The ArcadeDB Modular Distribution Builder (`arcadedb-builder.sh`) allows you to create custom

ArcadeDB packages containing only the modules you need. This results in smaller distributions, reduced dependencies, and simplified deployments.

### 8.1.6. Prerequisites

The builder requires the following tools:

- `curl` or `wget` - for downloading files
- `tar` - for extracting and creating archives
- `unzip` and `zip` - for creating zip archives
- `sha256sum` or `shasum` - for checksum verification
- `docker` (optional) - for Docker image generation

### 8.1.7. Quick Start

**Run directly with curl (one-liner):**

```
curl -fsSL https://github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb/releases/download/26.10.1/arcadedb-builder.sh | bash -s -- --version=26.10.1 --modules=gremlin,studio
```

**Download and run interactively:**

```
curl -fsSLO https://github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb/releases/download/26.10.1/arcadedb-builder.sh
chmod +x arcadedb-builder.sh
./arcadedb-builder.sh
```

**Preview without building (dry run):**

```
./arcadedb-builder.sh --version=26.10.1 --modules=gremlin,studio --dry-run
```

### 8.1.8. Available Modules

**Core Modules (always included)**

- `engine` - Database engine
- `server` - HTTP/REST API, clustering
- `network` - Network communication

**Optional Modules**

| Module | Description |
|---|---|
| `console` | Interactive database console |

| Module | Description |
|---|---|
| `studio` | Web-based administration interface |
| `gremlin` | Apache Tinkerpop Gremlin support |
| `postgresw` | PostgreSQL wire protocol compatibility |
| `mongodbw` | MongoDB wire protocol compatibility |
| `redisw` | Redis wire protocol compatibility |
| `grpcw` | gRPC wire protocol support |
| `graphql` | GraphQL API support |
| `metrics` | Prometheus metrics integration |
| `mcp` | Model Context Protocol server for LLM clients. See MCP Server. |

Omitting `mcp` produces a distribution that registers no `/api/v1/mcp` endpoint at all.

### 8.1.9. Usage Examples

**Minimal build (PostgreSQL protocol only):**

```
./arcadedb-builder.sh --version={revnumber} --modules=postgresw
```

**Development build:**

```
./arcadedb-builder.sh \
  --version=26.10.1 \
  --modules=console,gremlin,studio \
  --output-name=arcadedb-dev
```

**Production build (no Studio):**

```
./arcadedb-builder.sh \
  --version=26.10.1 \
  --modules=postgresw,metrics \
  --output-name=arcadedb-prod
```

**CI/CD build:**

```
./arcadedb-builder.sh \
  --version=26.10.1 \
  --modules=gremlin,studio \
  --quiet \
  --skip-docker \
  --output-dir=/tmp/builds
```

### 8.1.10. Command-Line Options

| Option | Description |
|---|---|
| `--version=VERSION` | ArcadeDB version to build (required for non-interactive mode) |
| `--modules=MODULES` | Comma-separated list of modules |
| `--output-name=NAME` | Custom name for distribution |
| `--output-dir=DIR` | Output directory (default: current directory) |
| `--local-repo[=PATH]` | Use local Maven repository or custom JAR directory |
| `--local-base=FILE` | Use local base distribution file |
| `--docker-tag=TAG` | Build Docker image with specified tag |
| `--skip-docker` | Skip Docker image build |
| `--dockerfile-only` | Only generate Dockerfile, don't build image |
| `--dry-run` | Show what would be done without executing |
| `-v, --verbose` | Enable verbose output |
| `-q, --quiet` | Suppress non-error output |
| `-h, --help` | Show help message |

### 8.1.11. Output Files

The builder creates:

- `{output-name}.zip` - Zip archive
- `{output-name}.tar.gz` - Compressed tarball
- Docker image with tag `{docker-tag}` (if not skipped)

For more detailed documentation, see the Builder README and Modular Builder Guide.

## 8.2. Installation with Docker

ArcadeDB can be run in a Docker container. Images for both Java 21 and Java 17 are available.

Java 21 ArcadeDB is available as a Docker image on DockerHub: DockerHub.

Java 17 ArcadeDB is available as a Docker image on GitHub Container Registry: https://github.com/orgs/ArcadeData/packages?ecosystem=container

To pull the latest Java 21 image from DockerHub:

```
docker pull arcadedb/arcadedb:26.10.1
```

To pull the latest Java 17 image from GitHub Container Registry:

```
docker pull ghcr.io/arcadedata/arcadedb:26.10.1-java17
```

## 8.3. Kubernetes

ArcadeDB officially supports deployment on Kubernetes via the arcadedb-helm chart, published at `https://helm.arcadedb.com/`. The chart deploys ArcadeDB as a `StatefulSet` and, when `replicaCount` is greater than 1, automatically configures a Raft-based High Availability cluster. The reference for the configuration values below targets chart version **26.4.2**; confirm against your installation with `helm show values arcadedb/arcadedb`.

### 8.3.1. Prerequisites

- Kubernetes 1.27 or later
- Helm 3.16 or later
- `kubectl` configured for your target cluster
- A storage class that provides `ReadWriteOnce` volumes (the cluster defaults on EKS, GKE, AKS, and DigitalOcean all work)
- (Optional) `kind` 0.24 or later and Docker for the local quickstart below

### 8.3.2. Quickstart with kind

This walkthrough mirrors `ArcadeData/arcadedb-deployments/kubernetes` and produces a 3-node ArcadeDB cluster on a local kind cluster in roughly five minutes.

1. Create a local Kubernetes cluster:

   ```
   kind create cluster --name arcadedb
   ```

2. Create the secret holding the `root` user password (replace `<password>`):

   ```
   kubectl create secret generic arcadedb-credentials \
     --from-literal=rootPassword='<password>'
   ```

3. Add the ArcadeDB Helm repository and update:

   ```
   helm repo add arcadedb https://helm.arcadedb.com/
   helm repo update
   ```

4. Save the following overrides to `values.yaml`:

   ```
   replicaCount: 3
   image:
   ```

```
  tag: "26.4.2"
service:
  http:
    type: ClusterIP
arcadedb:
  credentials:
    rootPassword:
      secret:
        name: arcadedb-credentials
        key: rootPassword
```

5. Install the chart:

```
helm install my-arcadedb arcadedb/arcadedb -f values.yaml --wait
```

6. Forward the HTTP port to your laptop:

```
kubectl port-forward svc/my-arcadedb-http 2480:2480
```

7. Open http://localhost:2480 in a browser to reach Studio, or use `curl`:

```
curl -u root:<password> http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server
```

For a scripted version (with `start.sh`, `stop.sh`, and `test.sh`), see the reference deployment.

### 8.3.3. Installing the chart

For production deployments, follow the same broad shape as the quickstart but tailor `values.yaml` to your environment.

1. Add the Helm repository:

```
helm repo add arcadedb https://helm.arcadedb.com/
helm repo update
```

2. Create a `Secret` containing the `root` password. The chart references this secret by name — it does not store the password in the chart values:

```
kubectl create secret generic arcadedb-credentials \
  --from-literal=rootPassword='<password>'
```

3. Prepare a `values.yaml` override file that fits your environment. At a minimum, set `replicaCount`, `image.tag`, and the `arcadedb.credentials.rootPassword.secret` block. See the configuration reference for the full set of options including persistence, ingress, resources, autoscaling, and

security context.

4. Install the chart:

```
helm install my-arcadedb arcadedb/arcadedb \
  --namespace arcadedb --create-namespace \
  --values values.yaml \
  --wait
```

5. Verify the deployment:

```
kubectl -n arcadedb get statefulset
kubectl -n arcadedb get pods
kubectl -n arcadedb get svc
```

The pods are named `my-arcadedb-0`, `my-arcadedb-1`, … and reach the `Ready` state once the readiness probe succeeds.

### 8.3.4. Configuration reference

The values exposed by the chart are grouped below. This reference targets chart version **26.4.2**; confirm the current set against your installation with:

```
helm show values arcadedb/arcadedb
```

The complete and authoritative source is the chart's `values.yaml`. The example snippets below show keys at the top level (the chart is installed directly as `arcadedb/arcadedb`); if you consume the chart as a **subchart** under a parent named `arcadedb`, wrap each snippet under a top-level `arcadedb:` key.

#### Image

Selects the container image, pull policy, and pull secrets. Override `image.tag` to pin to a specific ArcadeDB release; otherwise the chart's `appVersion` is used.

| Key | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `image.registry` | `arcadedata` | Container registry hosting the image |
| `image.repository` | `arcadedb` | Image repository name |
| `image.tag` | (chart `appVersion`) | Image tag; pin to a specific ArcadeDB version for reproducible deployments |
| `image.pullPolicy` | `IfNotPresent` | Kubernetes image pull policy |
| `imagePullSecrets` | `[]` | List of `Secret` references for private registries |
| `nameOverride` | `""` | Overrides the chart name used in resource names |
| `fullnameOverride` | `""` | Overrides the fully-qualified app name used in resource names |

Example override:

```
image:
  tag: "26.4.2"
  pullPolicy: IfNotPresent
imagePullSecrets:
  - name: my-registry-secret
```

### Replicas

`replicaCount` controls how many ArcadeDB pods the `StatefulSet` runs. A single replica (`1`) gives a standalone instance; three replicas is the smallest cluster that tolerates one node failure under Raft majority quorum. See High Availability on Kubernetes for the implications of running a multi-replica cluster.

| Key | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `replicaCount` | `1` | Number of ArcadeDB pods. Values greater than 1 enable Raft HA automatically; the minimum recommended HA size is 3. |

Example override:

```
replicaCount: 3
```

Raising `replicaCount` on a running HA cluster is enough: the new pods join the existing cluster on their own, and the pods already running accept them without any change to `ha.serverList`. This relies on the headless service publishing the address of a pod that is not Ready yet (`publishNotReadyAddresses: true`, which the chart sets), because a pod becomes Ready only once it has joined.

Before v26.10.1 the running pods rejected the new pod's connection, so it never joined and stayed `NOT_READY`. If you are on an older version, upgrade or restart every pod with the enlarged `ha.serverList`.

### Credentials

The chart never stores the root password in its own values; it reads it from a Kubernetes `Secret` at install time. If `arcadedb.credentials.rootPassword.secret.name` is `null`, a 32-character random password is auto-generated in a `Secret` named `arcadedb-credentials-secret` — note that GitOps tools such as ArgoCD regenerate this secret on every render, so supply your own secret for production. Pods that start without a resolvable secret crash-loop immediately; see Troubleshooting for the symptom and fix.

| Key | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `arcadedb.credentials.rootPassword.secret.name` | `null` | Name of an existing `Secret` containing the root password. `null` triggers auto-generation. |
| `arcadedb.credentials.rootPassword.secret.key` | `null` | Key within the named `Secret` whose value is the root password. |

Create the secret first (see the Quickstart for the full command), then reference it in your `values.yaml`:

```
arcadedb:
  credentials:
    rootPassword:
      secret:
        name: arcadedb-credentials
        key: rootPassword
```

#### Database

These keys control where ArcadeDB stores databases inside the container, which databases to create at startup, additional JVM arguments, and arbitrary environment variables passed to the container process.

| Key | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `arcadedb.databaseDirectory` | `/home/arcadedb/databases` | Path inside the container where database files are stored. Must be the `persistence` mount path, or a subdirectory of it, if a PVC is used. |
| `arcadedb.defaultDatabases` | `""` | Databases to create automatically at first startup. Use the form `Name[user:password]`, e.g. `Universe[admin:secret]`. Empty string means no databases are pre-created. |
| `arcadedb.extraCommands` | `[-Darcadedb.server.mode=production]` | List of additional JVM `-D` arguments appended to the ArcadeDB startup command. |
| `arcadedb.extraEnvironment` | `[]` | List of extra environment variables (in `name`/`value` map form) injected into the container. |

Example override:

```
arcadedb:
  extraCommands:
    - -Darcadedb.server.mode=production
    - -Darcadedb.txWalFiles=2
  extraEnvironment:
    - name: ARCADEDB_OPTS_GC
```

```
      value: "-XX:+UseG1GC"
```

Select the collector with `ARCADEDB_OPTS_GC`, which replaces the image's ZGC. Passing it through `JAVA_TOOL_OPTIONS` or `JAVA_OPTS` adds a second collector to the command line, and the JVM refuses to start ("Multiple garbage collectors selected"). See JVM settings inside a fixed memory budget.

### Plugins

ArcadeDB supports multiple wire protocols alongside its native HTTP API; each protocol is enabled by adding the corresponding key under `arcadedb.plugins`. The chart ships with named slots for `gremlin`, `postgres`, `mongo`, `redis`, and `prometheus`, plus support for any user-supplied key (e.g. `myPlugin`) for custom plugins. By default, `arcadedb.plugins` is an empty map (`{}`), meaning no wire-protocol plugins are activated.

| Key | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `arcadedb.plugins.gremlin.enabled` | (absent) | Enable the Apache TinkerPop Gremlin server plugin. |
| `arcadedb.plugins.gremlin.port` | (absent — see example) | Port the Gremlin plugin listens on; conventionally `8182`. |
| `arcadedb.plugins.postgres.enabled` | (absent) | Enable the PostgreSQL wire-protocol plugin. |
| `arcadedb.plugins.postgres.port` | (absent — see example) | Port the PostgreSQL plugin listens on; conventionally `5432`. |
| `arcadedb.plugins.mongo.enabled` | (absent) | Enable the MongoDB wire-protocol plugin. |
| `arcadedb.plugins.mongo.port` | (absent — see example) | Port the MongoDB plugin listens on; conventionally `27017`. |
| `arcadedb.plugins.redis.enabled` | (absent) | Enable the Redis wire-protocol plugin. |
| `arcadedb.plugins.redis.port` | (absent — see example) | Port the Redis plugin listens on; conventionally `6379`. |
| `arcadedb.plugins.prometheus.enabled` | (absent) | Enable the Prometheus metrics endpoint. |

Example override (enabling the PostgreSQL and MongoDB wire protocols):

```
arcadedb:
  plugins:
    postgres:
      enabled: true
      port: 5432
    mongo:
      enabled: true
      port: 27017
```

### Service

The chart creates two Kubernetes `Service` objects for each ArcadeDB deployment. The **HTTP service** (named `<release>-http`) exposes port 2480 where Studio and all REST/HTTP clients connect; its type is configurable below. The **RPC service** is a headless `ClusterIP` service used only for Raft peer discovery between pods — it is internal-only and not directly controlled by these values.

| Key | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `service.http.type` | `ClusterIP` | Kubernetes service type for the HTTP service. Use `LoadBalancer` to obtain an external IP, or leave `ClusterIP` and configure Ingress for a single-entry-point setup. |
| `service.http.port` | `2480` | Port exposed by the HTTP service. Studio and all REST/HTTP clients connect to this port. |
| `service.rpc.port` | `2434` | Raft gRPC port used for HA peer communication. This port is exposed only on the headless internal service; do not expose it externally. |

Example override:

```
service:
  http:
    type: LoadBalancer
    port: 2480
```

### Ingress

Use an `Ingress` resource when you want a single external entry point with host-based routing and TLS termination at the edge controller, without assigning a cloud load-balancer IP per service. For simpler setups or clouds where a managed load-balancer IP is acceptable, `service.http.type: LoadBalancer` is the lower-configuration alternative.

| Key | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `ingress.enabled` | `false` | Set to `true` to create an `Ingress` resource for the HTTP service. |
| `ingress.className` | `""` | IngressClass name (e.g. `nginx`, `traefik`). Empty string uses the cluster-default class. |
| `ingress.annotations` | `{}` | Annotations added to the `Ingress` object. Commonly used to configure the ingress controller behavior (e.g. `cert-manager.io/cluster-issuer`). |
| `ingress.hosts` | (see description) | List of host rules. Each entry has a `host` string and a `paths` list (each with `path` and `pathType`). Default example uses host `chart-example.local` with path `/`. |

| Key | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `ingress.tls` | `[]` | TLS configuration. Each entry specifies a `secretName` (holding the TLS certificate) and the list of `hosts` it covers. |

Example override (single-host ingress with TLS via cert-manager):

```
ingress:
  enabled: true
  className: nginx
  annotations:
    cert-manager.io/cluster-issuer: letsencrypt-prod
  hosts:
    - host: arcadedb.example.com
      paths:
        - path: /
          pathType: Prefix
  tls:
    - secretName: arcadedb-tls
      hosts:
        - arcadedb.example.com
```

Studio and the HTTP API authenticate every request, but do not expose them directly to the public internet without an extra layer. Place public access behind the ingress controller with TLS (as above), an OIDC/SSO authentication proxy, or a VPN, so the database is never the sole gatekeeper of a publicly reachable endpoint.

**Persistence**

ArcadeDB stores its database files under `arcadedb.databaseDirectory` (default `/home/arcadedb/databases`). The chart uses a `volumeClaimTemplates` block in the `StatefulSet`, so Kubernetes provisions one `PersistentVolumeClaim` per pod rather than sharing a single volume across replicas.

Only directories that contain a database (a `schema.json` file) are opened at startup. Other directories in the database directory, such as the `lost+found` folder of a freshly formatted ext4 volume, are skipped and left untouched.

PVCs created by the StatefulSet survive `helm uninstall` by design — Kubernetes preserves data volumes when a workload is deleted. To remove them along with the release, run:

```
kubectl delete pvc -l app.kubernetes.io/name=arcadedb -n <namespace>
```

| Key | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `persistence.enabled` | `true` | Enable PVC-backed storage. Set to `false` only for ephemeral development deployments; all data is lost when the pod restarts. |
| `persistence.size` | `8Gi` | Requested PVC capacity. Size the volume to hold your databases plus headroom for growth. |
| `persistence.accessMode` | `ReadWriteOnce` | PVC access mode. `ReadWriteOnce` is correct for the `StatefulSet` pattern (one pod per volume). |
| `persistence.storageClass` | `""` | StorageClass name. Empty string uses the cluster-default class (e.g. `standard` on GKE, `gp2` on EKS). Set explicitly to select a faster or differently-billed class. |

Example override (50 Gi PVC on the `gp3` storage class on AWS EKS):

```
persistence:
  enabled: true
  size: 50Gi
  storageClass: gp3
```

### Resources

Container resource requests and limits are deliberately left unset in the chart defaults (`resources: {}`), so you must supply them for any production deployment. Set `limits.memory` first: *since v26.9.1* the container image derives the JVM heap from it (`-XX:MaxRAMPercentage=75`) unless you pin the heap yourself, so the limit is what decides how much memory ArcadeDB actually uses. Then size the memory request to the heap you expect, so the scheduler places the pod on a node with enough RAM.

Do **not** set a CPU limit on ArcadeDB pods. Kubernetes CPU throttling operates on a 100 ms accounting window; when a CPU limit is hit mid-GC cycle, the JVM thread is suspended until the next window, turning a millisecond collection into a multi-hundred-millisecond pause. Set a CPU **request** so the scheduler reserves the right amount of CPU for scheduling purposes, and rely on node-level CPU sharing — not a hard limit — to bound consumption. Memory limits are safe and recommended: the JVM respects its heap ceiling, and a hard memory limit prevents a runaway process from affecting other pods on the node.

| Key | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `resources.requests.cpu` | (absent) | CPU request used by the scheduler to place the pod. Recommended starting point: `500m`. No CPU limit should be set — see the note above. |
| `resources.requests.memory` | (absent) | Memory request. Should equal or slightly exceed the heap to guarantee the node has enough RAM at scheduling time. |

| Key | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `resources.limits.memory` | (absent) | Memory limit, and the value the heap is sized against unless you pin it: 75% of this becomes the heap, leaving the rest for off-heap buffers (e.g. `4Gi` gives a 3 Gi heap). Also prevents a single pod from consuming all node memory. |

Example override (2 Gi heap, 4 Gi limit, CPU request only — no CPU limit):

```
resources:
  requests:
    cpu: 500m
    memory: 2Gi
  limits:
    memory: 4Gi
```

#### Probes

Kubernetes uses **liveness probes** to decide when to kill and restart a container, and **readiness probes** to decide when a pod is safe to receive traffic. Both probes matter for ArcadeDB: on a cold start the JVM and optional persistence rehydration can take several seconds, so tuning `initialDelaySeconds` prevents premature restarts before the server is ready.

The chart configures both probes to poll `GET /api/v1/ready` on the HTTP port (2480). Only `httpGet.path` and `httpGet.port` are set by default; all other sub-keys (`initialDelaySeconds`, `periodSeconds`, `timeoutSeconds`, `failureThreshold`, `successThreshold`) are absent and fall back to Kubernetes defaults (0 s delay, 10 s period, 1 s timeout, 3 failures, 1 success).

| Key | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `livenessProbe.httpGet.path` | `/api/v1/ready` | HTTP path polled by the liveness probe. Returns 200 when the server is alive. |
| `livenessProbe.httpGet.port` | `http` | Named port (`http`, resolving to 2480) used by the liveness probe. |
| `livenessProbe.initialDelaySeconds` | (absent — Kubernetes default: `0`) | Seconds to wait after container start before the first liveness check. Increase for slow-start environments (cold JVM + persistence rehydration). |
| `livenessProbe.periodSeconds` | (absent — Kubernetes default: `10`) | How often (in seconds) to run the liveness probe. |
| `livenessProbe.timeoutSeconds` | (absent — Kubernetes default: `1`) | Seconds after which a probe attempt times out. |

| Key | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `livenessProbe.failureThreshold` | (absent — Kubernetes default: `3`) | Number of consecutive failures before the container is killed and restarted. |
| `livenessProbe.successThreshold` | (absent — Kubernetes default: `1`) | Consecutive successes required to mark the container as live again after a failure. |
| `readinessProbe.httpGet.path` | `/api/v1/ready` | HTTP path polled by the readiness probe. Returns 200 when the server is ready to accept traffic. |
| `readinessProbe.httpGet.port` | `http` | Named port (`http`, resolving to 2480) used by the readiness probe. |
| `readinessProbe.initialDelaySeconds` | (absent — Kubernetes default: `0`) | Seconds to wait after container start before the first readiness check. Increase when the server needs time to rehydrate databases from a PVC before accepting connections. |
| `readinessProbe.periodSeconds` | (absent — Kubernetes default: `10`) | How often (in seconds) to run the readiness probe. |
| `readinessProbe.timeoutSeconds` | (absent — Kubernetes default: `1`) | Seconds after which a probe attempt times out. |
| `readinessProbe.failureThreshold` | (absent — Kubernetes default: `3`) | Number of consecutive failures before the pod is removed from Service endpoints. |
| `readinessProbe.successThreshold` | (absent — Kubernetes default: `1`) | Consecutive successes required to add the pod back to Service endpoints. |

Example override (bumping the initial delay for a slow-start environment with large persisted databases):

```
livenessProbe:
  httpGet:
    path: /api/v1/health
    port: http
  initialDelaySeconds: 30
  periodSeconds: 10
  timeoutSeconds: 5
  failureThreshold: 6
readinessProbe:
  httpGet:
    path: /api/v1/ready
    port: http
  initialDelaySeconds: 20
  periodSeconds: 10
```

```
  timeoutSeconds: 5
  failureThreshold: 3
```

Prefer the dedicated liveness endpoint `/api/v1/health` for the liveness probe: it never reports a busy state, so a warming-up node is not restarted. Keep `/api/v1/ready` for the readiness probe. The chart's default value tables below reflect the chart's current defaults; override `livenessProbe.httpGet.path` to `/api/v1/health` as shown above. See Health probes.

On a High Availability cluster, set `arcadedb.server.readinessRequiresHA=true` (env `ARCADEDB_SERVER_READINESSREQUIRESHA=true`) to withhold traffic from a node until it has joined the Raft group and, once joined, until it is a member of the current Raft configuration and has caught up to within `arcadedb.server.readinessHAMaxLag` log entries (default `100`, env `ARCADEDB_SERVER_READINESSHAMAXLAG`) of the commit index. This keeps a restarted follower with a wiped or lagging log out of Service endpoints during a rolling update, so the write quorum is not dropped. The check also fails closed if the node's internal Raft engine is unhealthy, even while the server process itself is still running and responding.

This setting decides how strict the probe is about a node that is merely **behind**. It does not apply to a node whose replication has **stopped** - one that cannot write its replication log, or that hit an error it cannot apply. Such a node answers `503` whatever this setting says, because waiting for it would never help. See When a node has stopped for good for the two fields that name the cause. *(Since v26.10.1: with this setting off, such a node used to keep answering as ready.)*

### Autoscaling

The chart supports Kubernetes `HorizontalPodAutoscaler` (HPA) to scale the number of ArcadeDB pods based on CPU utilization. Autoscaling is disabled by default; enable it only after verifying that your storage class supports `ReadWriteOnce` volumes on all potential target nodes, and that your HA configuration can tolerate dynamic replica counts.

When autoscaling is enabled in an HA configuration, ensure `minReplicas >= floor(maxReplicas / 2) + 1` so the cluster always retains a Raft majority. Falling below the quorum threshold causes writes to stall until enough peers rejoin. For example, with `maxReplicas: 5` the minimum safe `minReplicas` is `3`. See High Availability on Kubernetes for further guidance on Raft quorum sizing.

The chart also pre-sizes the internal server list to `maxReplicas` for auto-join purposes; set `maxReplicas` conservatively to avoid advertising pod addresses that may never exist.

| Key | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `autoscaling.enabled` | `false` | Set to `true` to create an `HorizontalPodAutoscaler` that scales the `StatefulSet` based on CPU utilization. |

| Key | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `autoscaling.minReplicas` | `1` | Minimum number of replicas the HPA will scale down to. In an HA cluster this must be at least `floor(maxReplicas / 2) + 1` to preserve Raft quorum. |
| `autoscaling.maxReplicas` | `5` | Maximum number of replicas the HPA will scale up to. Set conservatively — the chart pre-sizes the peer list to this value. |
| `autoscaling.targetCPUUtilizationPercentage` | `80` | Average CPU utilization target (as a percentage of the pod's CPU request) that triggers scale-out. Lower values scale out earlier; higher values pack more load per pod. |

Example override (autoscaling with Raft-safe quorum bounds):

```
autoscaling:
  enabled: true
  minReplicas: 3
  maxReplicas: 5
  targetCPUUtilizationPercentage: 70
```

#### Security context

The chart sets a restrictive security posture by default. At the pod level, `podSecurityContext` ensures all processes run as a non-root user and that the filesystem group matches the `arcadedb` user (`1000`) created in the Docker image, so mounted volumes are writable without `chmod`. At the container level, `securityContext` pins the UID/GID to `1000`, blocks privilege escalation, and drops all Linux capabilities — the server needs none.

| Key | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `podSecurityContext.runAsNonRoot` | `true` | Require that the pod's entry-point process runs as a non-root UID. Kubernetes rejects the pod if the image's `USER` is `0`. |
| `podSecurityContext.fsGroup` | `1000` | Supplemental GID applied to mounted volumes. Set to match the `arcadedb` user so PVC data directories are writable by the container process. |
| `securityContext.runAsUser` | `1000` | UID used by the container process. Matches the `arcadedb` user in the image. |
| `securityContext.runAsGroup` | `1000` | Primary GID used by the container process. |
| `securityContext.allowPrivilegeEscalation` | `false` | Prevents the container process from gaining more privileges than its parent (blocks `setuid` binaries, no `CAP_SYS_ADMIN`, etc.). |
| `securityContext.capabilities.drop` | `[ALL]` | Drops every Linux capability from the container. ArcadeDB requires none of the default capabilities. |

Example override (adding `readOnlyRootFilesystem` for maximum hardening — ArcadeDB writes

only to its data directory, which is a mounted volume):

```
podSecurityContext:
  runAsNonRoot: true
  fsGroup: 1000
securityContext:
  runAsUser: 1000
  runAsGroup: 1000
  allowPrivilegeEscalation: false
  capabilities:
    drop: [ALL]
  readOnlyRootFilesystem: true
```

`readOnlyRootFilesystem: true` is not set by the chart's default but is safe to add when persistence is enabled — ArcadeDB writes database files to the PVC mount path, not to the container root filesystem. If you run without persistence (`persistence.enabled: false`), omit this flag because the container writes databases to the root filesystem.

With `readOnlyRootFilesystem: true` you must also relocate the **log directory** to a writable mount, otherwise the server fails at startup with `java.nio.file.FileSystemException: ./log/arcadedb.log.0.lck: Read-only file system`. By default the server writes logs to `./log` (relative to the working directory), which is read-only under this hardening. Mount a writable volume (for example an `emptyDir`) and point the log directory at it by forwarding the `ARCADEDB_LOG_DIR` environment variable (it maps to the `arcadedb.server.logsDirectory` setting):

```
extraEnvironment:
  - name: ARCADEDB_LOG_DIR
    value: /writable/log
volumes:
  - name: arcadedb-log
    emptyDir: {}
volumeMounts:
  - name: arcadedb-log
    mountPath: /writable/log
```

When running an HA cluster with `readOnlyRootFilesystem: true`, also relocate the **Raft storage directory**. By default each node creates a dynamically-named `raft-storage-<nodeName>` folder under the server root path, which is both read-only under this hardening and awkward to mount in a `StatefulSet` because the name varies per pod. Set `arcadedb.ha.raftStorageDirectory` to a fixed, writable path backed by a per-pod PVC (an extra `volumeClaimTemplates` entry), so the `raft-storage-*` folder is always created under the same configured path:

```
extraCommands:
```

```
  - -Darcadedb.ha.raftStorageDirectory=/var/lib/arcadedb/raft
```

### Service account

The chart creates a dedicated `ServiceAccount` for ArcadeDB pods by default. Disable creation and supply an existing `ServiceAccount` name when you manage service accounts outside Helm — for example, to attach an IRSA annotation (AWS EKS) or a Workload Identity annotation (GKE) that grants the pod cloud-provider permissions such as reading secrets from AWS Secrets Manager or Google Secret Manager.

| Key | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `serviceAccount.create` | `true` | Create a `ServiceAccount` as part of the release. Set to `false` to reuse a pre-existing account (supply its name in `serviceAccount.name`). |
| `serviceAccount.automount` | `false` | Mount the service account token into pods. ArcadeDB does not call the Kubernetes API, so the token is unnecessary; keeping it unmounted reduces the attack surface. |
| `serviceAccount.annotations` | `{}` | Annotations applied to the `ServiceAccount` object. Used for cloud-provider workload identity (e.g. `eks.amazonaws.com/role-arn` for IRSA, `iam.gke.io/gcp-service-account` for GKE Workload Identity). |
| `serviceAccount.name` | `""` | Name of the `ServiceAccount` to use. When empty and `serviceAccount.create` is `true`, the chart generates a name from the release. |

Example override (reusing an existing service account with a GKE Workload Identity annotation):

```
serviceAccount:
  create: false
  name: arcadedb-wi-sa
  annotations:
    iam.gke.io/gcp-service-account: arcadedb@my-gcp-project.iam.gserviceaccount.com
```

### Scheduling

`nodeSelector`, `tolerations`, and `affinity` control which nodes the ArcadeDB pods are placed on. The chart ships with a default `podAntiAffinity` rule (weight 100) that prefers scheduling each pod on a different node — the most useful pattern for Raft-based HA clusters, since it distributes quorum peers across failure domains and keeps the cluster alive when a single node goes down.

| Key | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `nodeSelector` | `{}` | Map of node labels that pods must match. Use to restrict ArcadeDB to a specific node pool (e.g. `cloud.google.com/gke-nodepool: db-pool`). |

| Key | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `tolerations` | `[]` | List of Kubernetes `Toleration` objects. Needed when ArcadeDB should run on tainted nodes (e.g. dedicated database nodes marked with `NoSchedule`). |
| `affinity` | (pod anti-affinity — see below) | Full `affinity` stanza. The default contains a `preferredDuringSchedulingIgnoredDuringExecution` pod anti-affinity rule that spreads pods across distinct hostnames. Override the entire key to replace it. |

The chart's built-in `affinity` default:

```
affinity:
  podAntiAffinity:
    preferredDuringSchedulingIgnoredDuringExecution:
      - weight: 100
        podAffinityTerm:
          labelSelector:
            matchExpressions:
              - key: app.kubernetes.io/name
                operator: In
                values:
                  - arcadedb
          topologyKey: kubernetes.io/hostname
```

Example override (required anti-affinity across availability zones — stricter than the default preference-based rule):

```
affinity:
  podAntiAffinity:
    requiredDuringSchedulingIgnoredDuringExecution:
      - labelSelector:
          matchExpressions:
            - key: app.kubernetes.io/instance
              operator: In
              values:
                - my-arcadedb
        topologyKey: topology.kubernetes.io/zone
```

Switching from `preferredDuringScheduling` to `requiredDuringScheduling` means Kubernetes will leave pods `Pending` rather than co-locate them when there are fewer zones than replicas. Verify that your cluster has at least as many zones (or nodes) as `replicaCount` before using `required` rules.

### Pod metadata

`podAnnotations` and `podLabels` attach metadata directly to the pod objects created by the `StatefulSet`.

Annotations are the standard integration point for cluster tooling: Prometheus scrape configuration, secret injection sidecars (Vault Agent, External Secrets), and service mesh proxy injection all rely on pod annotations. Labels supplement the chart-generated selectors and are useful for observability grouping, cost allocation, or policy enforcement tools that filter by label.

| Key | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `podAnnotations` | `{}` | Annotations applied to every pod. Common uses: Prometheus scrape hints, Vault Agent injection, Datadog APM tracing, Istio sidecar policy. |
| `podLabels` | `{}` | Extra labels applied to every pod. Merged with the chart-generated labels (`app.kubernetes.io/*`). Useful for cost-allocation labels, Cilium network policies that match on custom labels, or PodDisruptionBudget selectors. |

Example override (Prometheus scrape annotations):

```
podAnnotations:
  prometheus.io/scrape: "true"
  prometheus.io/port: "2480"
  prometheus.io/path: "/metrics"
```

The Prometheus annotations shown above work with the community `prometheus/prometheus` scrape-config style. If you use the Prometheus Operator (`ServiceMonitor`/`PodMonitor` CRDs), configure a `PodMonitor` resource instead and omit these annotations. Enable the Prometheus plugin (`arcadedb.plugins.prometheus.enabled: true`) to expose the `/metrics` endpoint.

### Network policy

Setting `networkPolicy.enabled: true` creates a Kubernetes `NetworkPolicy` that restricts traffic to and from ArcadeDB pods: the HTTP port (2480) accepts connections from any pod in the cluster, while the Raft gRPC port (2434) is locked down to ArcadeDB pods only. This requires a CNI plugin that enforces `NetworkPolicy` resources — Calico, Cilium, Weave Net, and most managed Kubernetes offerings (GKE, EKS with VPC CNI + policy, ASK Azure CNI) support this; vanilla `kubenet` does not.

| Key | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `networkPolicy.enabled` | `false` | Create `NetworkPolicy` resources for the release. When `true`, inbound HTTP (2480) is permitted from all pods in the cluster; Raft gRPC (2434) is restricted to pods belonging to the same ArcadeDB release. |

Example override:

```
networkPolicy:
```

```
  enabled: true
```

Enabling `networkPolicy` has no effect if your cluster's CNI does not enforce `NetworkPolicy` objects. Verify enforcement with `kubectl auth can-i create networkpolicies` and test the policy with a known-blocked source after enabling it.

#### Extras

The escape-hatch keys let you attach resources that the named chart values do not cover: extra Kubernetes manifests rendered alongside the chart, extra volumes and volume mounts injected into the container spec, and additional `volumeClaimTemplates` for the `StatefulSet`. These are advanced options intended for cases where a named value does not exist — for example, mounting a `ConfigMap` as a configuration file, adding a sidecar's shared `emptyDir`, or provisioning a separate PVC for WAL logs.

| Key | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `extraManifests` | `{}` | Map of arbitrary Kubernetes manifests rendered as part of the Helm release. Use to co-deploy `ConfigMap`, `ExternalSecret`, or other objects that must live in the same namespace and lifecycle as the chart. |
| `volumes` | `[]` | List of extra `volume` entries added to the pod spec. Pair with `volumeMounts` to expose the volume inside the container. |
| `volumeMounts` | `[]` | List of extra `volumeMount` entries added to the ArcadeDB container spec. The `mountPath` must not overlap with the persistence mount (`/home/arcadedb/databases`). |
| `volumeClaimTemplates` | `[]` | Extra `volumeClaimTemplates` for the `StatefulSet` (e.g. a dedicated PVC for WAL files, replication logs, or backups). The primary database PVC is controlled by `persistence.enabled` — see Persistence. |

Example override (mounting an extra `ConfigMap` as a config file):

```
volumes:
  - name: custom-config
    configMap:
      name: arcadedb-extra-config
volumeMounts:
  - name: custom-config
    mountPath: /home/arcadedb/config/custom.json
    subPath: custom.json
    readOnly: true
```

The corresponding `ConfigMap` can be co-deployed via `extraManifests`:

```
extraManifests:
  arcadedb-extra-config:
    apiVersion: v1
    kind: ConfigMap
    metadata:
      name: arcadedb-extra-config
    data:
      custom.json: |
        {
          "key": "value"
        }
```

### 8.3.5. Operating the cluster

#### Inspecting cluster status and testing failover

The `/api/v1/server` endpoint reports the live HA state — current leader, replicas, and roles. Port-forward the HTTP service and read the `ha` object:

```
kubectl -n arcadedb port-forward svc/my-arcadedb-http 2480:2480 &
curl -u root:<password> http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server | jq .ha
```

To confirm automatic failover works, delete the leader pod and watch the cluster re-elect a new leader and restart the deleted pod:

```
kubectl -n arcadedb delete pod my-arcadedb-0
kubectl -n arcadedb get pods -w
```

The cluster re-elects a leader within seconds; the `StatefulSet` then recreates the deleted pod, which rejoins as a replica and catches up via the Raft log. See High Availability for the underlying election and catch-up semantics.

#### Scaling

Use `helm upgrade` to change the replica count persistently:

```
helm upgrade my-arcadedb arcadedb/arcadedb \
  --namespace arcadedb \
  --reuse-values \
  --set replicaCount=5
```

`kubectl scale statefulset` also works for an immediate, one-off change:

```
kubectl -n arcadedb scale statefulset my-arcadedb --replicas=5
```

A `kubectl scale` change is reverted on the next `helm upgrade` because Helm reapplies the `replicaCount` from the chart values. For persistent changes, prefer `helm upgrade --set replicaCount=N` (or update the values file).

Scaling does not pause the workload. New pods auto-join the Raft cluster, and pods removed during scale-down auto-leave via the `preStop` hook (see High Availability on Kubernetes).

For cluster sizing, three to five nodes covers most workloads; seven is the practical upper end before Raft replication overhead outweighs the added fault tolerance. When scaling down, remove one pod at a time and never drop below the Raft majority — losing quorum stalls writes until enough peers rejoin.

#### Upgrading the chart

```
helm repo update
helm upgrade my-arcadedb arcadedb/arcadedb \
  --namespace arcadedb \
  --reuse-values
```

Pin `image.tag` to a specific ArcadeDB version for reproducible upgrades.

#### Backups

Direct the backup output to a volume **outside** the database PVC — for example a dedicated `volumeClaimTemplates` entry (see Extras) or an object-store target — so a backup never competes with live data for space and survives deletion of the database volume. In an HA cluster, take the backup at the **leader** for a consistent snapshot of committed state.

#### Observability

Enable the Prometheus plugin (`arcadedb.plugins.prometheus.enabled: true`) to expose ArcadeDB metrics on the HTTP port, then scrape them with Prometheus (see Pod metadata for scrape annotations or a `PodMonitor`). Beyond the usual host and JVM metrics, alert on:

- **Raft leader changes** — frequent re-elections signal node instability or network problems.
- **replication lag** — a follower falling persistently behind risks a full snapshot transfer and weakens read freshness.
- **PVC capacity** — ArcadeDB stops accepting writes when the database volume fills; alert well before the PVC is full.

#### Uninstalling

```
helm uninstall my-arcadedb --namespace arcadedb
```

Persistent volume claims **survive uninstall** by design. To remove them too:

```
kubectl -n arcadedb delete pvc -l app.kubernetes.io/name=arcadedb
```

The `Secret` holding the root password is not managed by Helm and is also retained. Delete it explicitly if no longer needed.

### 8.3.6. High Availability on Kubernetes

ArcadeDB on Kubernetes uses the standard `StatefulSet` + headless `Service` pattern (the same pattern used by `etcd`, CockroachDB, and Apache Ozone). The chart pre-computes the full peer list from `replicaCount` and injects it into each pod via environment variables, so users do not configure `arcadedb.ha.serverList` by hand.

The chart sets the equivalent of:

```
arcadedb.ha.enabled=true
arcadedb.ha.k8s=true
arcadedb.ha.k8sSuffix=.my-arcadedb.arcadedb.svc.cluster.local
arcadedb.ha.serverList=my-arcadedb-0.my-
arcadedb.arcadedb.svc.cluster.local:2434:2480,my-arcadedb-1.my-
arcadedb.arcadedb.svc.cluster.local:2434:2480,my-arcadedb-2.my-
arcadedb.arcadedb.svc.cluster.local:2434:2480
```

(Substitute your release name and namespace.)

**Auto-join on scale-up**

When `arcadedb.ha.k8s=true` and a new pod starts without an existing Raft storage directory, the server automatically joins the existing cluster via the Raft `SetConfiguration(ADD)` admin API. This enables zero-downtime scale-up: `helm upgrade --set replicaCount=N` (or `kubectl scale statefulset`) adds new pods that join the existing cluster without restarting any existing peer.

**Auto-leave on scale-down**

The chart installs a `preStop` hook that calls `POST /api/v1/cluster/leave` so the terminating pod cleanly transfers leadership (if it holds it) and removes itself from the Raft group before shutdown.

**Securing the Raft port with mTLS (since `26.9.1`)**

The Raft gRPC port carries AppendEntries, RequestVote and the Ratis admin/client calls in plaintext by default, guarded only by an IP-based peer allowlist. On a shared cluster, enable mTLS with `arcadedb.ha.tls.*` and pair it with a `NetworkPolicy` restricting the port to the StatefulSet's own pods. cert-manager is the natural issuer here: a `Certificate` writes a `Secret` holding exactly the three files the settings need (`tls.crt`, `tls.key`, `ca.crt`). Two details are easy to get wrong on Kubernetes — the certificate's SAN must be the pod's stable headless-service DNS name (`my-arcadedb-0.my-arcadedb.arcadedb.svc.cluster.local`) rather than the pod IP, and `privateKey.encoding` must be set to `PKCS8`, because cert-manager defaults to `PKCS1`, which the Raft transport does not parse. Mount the `Secret` read-only through the chart's `volumes` / `volumeMounts` (see Extras) with `defaultMode: 0400`, and point the settings at it via `arcadedb.extraCommands`. Auto-join needs no extra configuration: the join probe inherits the server's transport settings, so it

speaks TLS exactly when the cluster does. For the manifests, the openssl equivalent, and the certificate-rotation caveat, see mTLS for the Raft gRPC transport.

**Users and API tokens on a restarted pod (since `26.10.1`)**

The server users, groups and API tokens live in the server's `config/` directory, not in a database, so a pod whose data volume is persistent but whose `config/` directory is not comes back without them. Because it is still a member of the Raft group, it is not re-admitted, and before 26.10.1 it was never re-seeded either: it served only the users created from its own environment at bootstrap and rejected logins that worked on every other pod. Such a pod now asks the leader for the current documents shortly after it first sees one, so no action is needed. With `arcadedb.server.readinessRequiresHA=true`, a pod added by auto-join on scale-up, or one caught up by a snapshot, also stays out of the Service endpoints until those documents arrive, for at most `arcadedb.ha.securityConvergenceReadinessTimeout` (30 s by default); see security-convergence readiness. Persisting `config/` is still worth doing if you want a pod to come back with them already in place; see Cluster security documents. Since 26.10.1 you can mount a persistent volume through the chart's `volumes` / `volumeMounts` (see Extras) and point `arcadedb.server.configDirectory` at it with an entry in `arcadedb.extraCommands`; see Relocating the configuration directory for what moves and what does not.

For the rest of the Raft semantics — quorum, named peers, snapshot threshold, election timeouts, cluster token, replication failure handling — see High Availability.

**Pre-staging the database on every pod**

When you want to scale a single-pod ArcadeDB deployment up to N pods after importing a large (1+ GB) database, pre-stage identical database files on every pod's PVC and let the cluster recognise the matching state at first formation, rather than letting the leader stream the full database to every new replica over HTTP.

The chart leaves the bootstrap feature enabled by default (`arcadedb.ha.bootstrapFromLocalDatabase=true`). Operator workflow:

1. Install the chart with `replicaCount: 1` (no HA) and import the dataset.
2. After import is complete, tar the database directory or take a regular full ArcadeDB backup.
3. Distribute the archive into every pod's PVC. Common patterns: an init container that pulls from S3/GCS, an `nfs:` volume mount with the archive, baking the archive into the container image, or `kubectl cp` for one-off operator workflows. Each pod's PVC must contain the same database files under `arcadedb.databaseDirectory`.
4. `helm upgrade` the release with `replicaCount: 3` (or more). The new pods come up with non-empty databases and the same fingerprint; the cluster elects the bootstrap source automatically and forms in seconds.

For the underlying protocol and edge cases (different-age peers, late newer joiner, cluster restart with stale data on a node), see Offline Cluster Bootstrap.

### 8.3.7. Troubleshooting

The most common deployment failure is a missing or incorrectly named `rootPassword` `Secret` — pods

crash-loop with an authentication-related error in the log. Verify the secret exists and that the chart's `arcadedb.credentials.rootPassword.secret.name` and `.key` match it.

Inspect a pod's events:

```
kubectl -n arcadedb describe pod my-arcadedb-0
```

Read the server log:

```
kubectl -n arcadedb logs my-arcadedb-0
```

(Replace `my-arcadedb-0` with the pod name you want to inspect.)

To tear down a stuck cluster and start over:

```
helm uninstall my-arcadedb --namespace arcadedb
kubectl -n arcadedb delete pvc -l app.kubernetes.io/name=arcadedb
```

Then re-run `helm install` with corrected values.

### 8.3.8. Reference deployment

The `ArcadeData/arcadedb-deployments` repository hosts a working, scripted reference deployment under `kubernetes/`. It pairs a kind cluster with the official chart and provides:

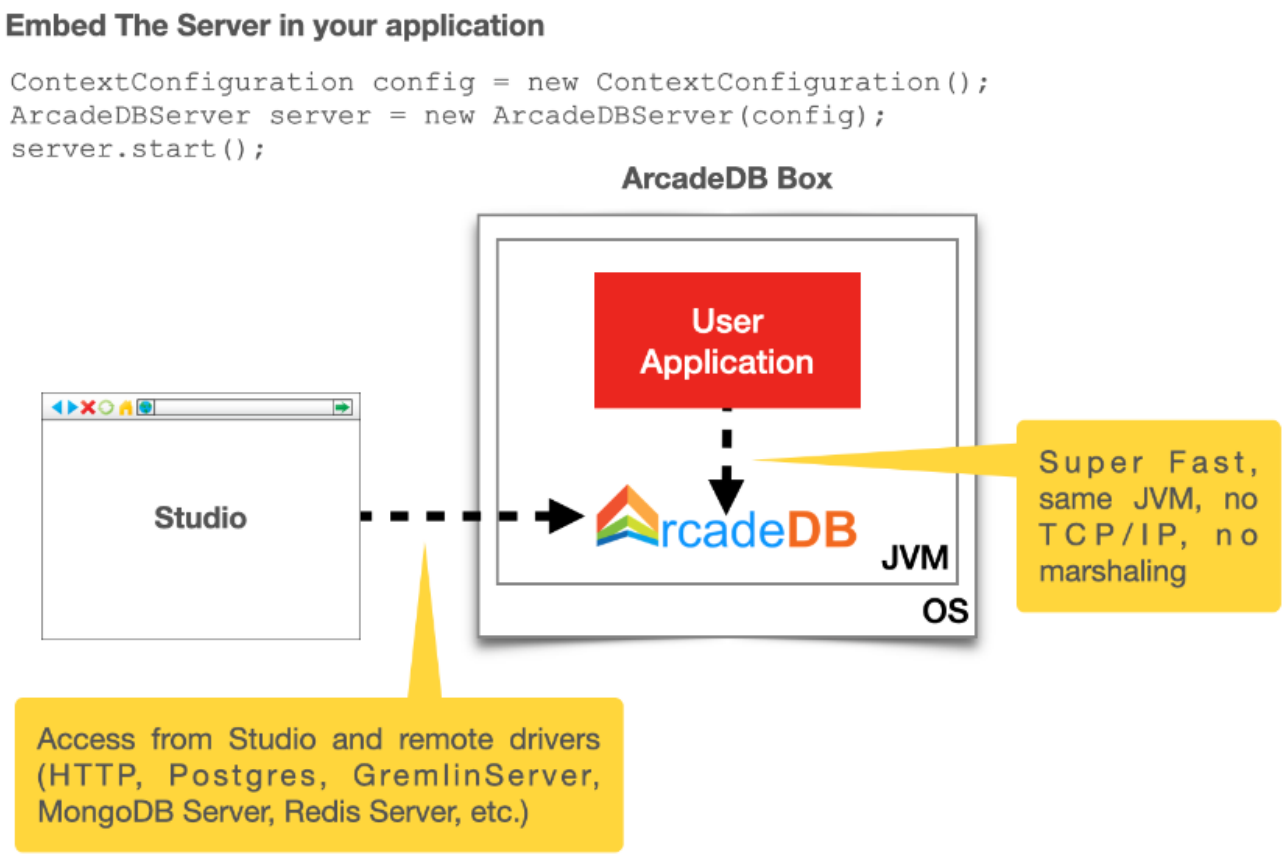
- `start.sh` — creates the kind cluster, runs `helm dependency update` + `helm install --wait`, and starts a port-forward to `localhost:2480`.
- `stop.sh` — terminates the port-forward, runs `helm uninstall`, and destroys the kind cluster.
- `test.sh` — validates that the cluster is functional.
- `values.yaml` — the values overrides used by `start.sh`. Note that this file wraps overrides under a top-level `arcadedb:` key because it consumes the chart as a **subchart**; when installing the chart directly (the path documented above), use the same overrides at the top level.

Use this repository as a starting point for your own setup and as a reproducible bug-report environment.

## 8.4. Embedded Server

Embedding the server in your JVM allows to have all the benefits of working in embedded mode with ArcadeDB (zero cost for network transport and marshalling) and still having the database accessible from the outside, such as Studio, remote API, Postgres, REDIS and MongoDB drivers.

We call this configuration an "ArcadeDB Box".




First, add the server library in your classpath. If you're using Maven include this dependency in your `pom.xml` file.

```
<dependency>
    <groupId>com.arcadedb</groupId>
    <artifactId>arcadedb-server</artifactId>
    <version>26.10.1</version>
</dependency>
```

This library depends on `arcadedb-network-<version>.jar`. If you're using Maven or Gradle, it will be imported automatically as a dependency, otherwise please add also the `arcadedb-network` library to your classpath.

The `arcadedb-server` dependency will only start the ArcadeDB server. You will see the HTTP URL for the server along with the port number displayed, for example, `http://localhost:2480`. However, if you try to access this URL to see the ArcadeDB studio, you will receive a `"Not Found"` message. This is because the arcadedb-server dependency only adds the embedded server. If you need to access the ArcadeDB studio to execute graph database queries, then you will need to add the following dependency:

```
<dependency>
    <groupId>com.arcadedb</groupId>
    <artifactId>arcadedb-studio</artifactId>
    <version>26.10.1</version>
```

```
</dependency>
```

### 8.4.1. Java 17 notes

Java 17 packages are available through GitHub package. To use them, you need to add the GitHub package repository to your `pom.xml` file:

```
<repositories>
  <repository>
    <id>github</id>
    <url>https://maven.pkg.github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb</url>
    <snapshots>
      <enabled>true</enabled>
    </snapshots>
  </repository>
</repositories>
```

Then, you can add the `arcadedb-server` dependency with the `-java17` suffix to use the Java 17 compatible version:

```
<dependency>
    <groupId>com.arcadedb</groupId>
    <artifactId>arcadedb-server</artifactId>
    <version>26.10.1-java17</version>
</dependency>
```

### 8.4.2. Start the server in the JVM

To start a server as embedded, create it with an empty configuration, so all the setting will be the default ones:

```
ContextConfiguration config = new ContextConfiguration();
ArcadeDBServer server = new ArcadeDBServer(config);
server.start();
```

To start a server in distributed configuration (with replicas), you can set your settings in the `ContextConfiguration`:

```
config.setValue(GlobalConfiguration.HA_SERVER_LIST,
"192.168.10.1,192.168.10.2,192.168.10.3");
config.setValue(GlobalConfiguration.HA_REPLICATION_INCOMING_HOST, "0.0.0.0");
config.setValue(GlobalConfiguration.HA_ENABLED, true);
```

High availability is no longer part of `arcadedb-server`. Since the migration to

> Apache Ratis, the HA implementation lives in a separate module, `arcadedb-ha-raft`, and is discovered at startup via the Java `ServiceLoader`. If you embed only `arcadedb-server`, setting `HA_ENABLED=true` (or a non-blank `HA_SERVER_LIST`) is **not** enough: with no HA plugin on the classpath the node starts STANDALONE with no replication. Add the dependency explicitly:

```
<dependency>
    <groupId>com.arcadedb</groupId>
    <artifactId>arcadedb-ha-raft</artifactId>
    <version>26.10.1</version>
</dependency>
```

The official server distribution and Docker image already bundle this module, so this step only applies to embedded deployments that manage their own dependencies. When HA is requested but no plugin is found, the server logs a `WARNING` at startup and records a server event under the `HA` component.

When you embed the server, you should always get the database instance from the server itself. This assures the database instance is just one in the entire JVM. If you try to create or open another database instance from the `DatabaseFactory`, you will receive an error that the underlying database is locked by another process.

```
Database database = server.getDatabase(<URL>);
```

Or this if you want to create a new database if not exists:

```
Database database = server.getOrCreateDatabase(<URL>);
```

### 8.4.3. Create custom HTTP commands

You can easily add custom HTTP commands on ArcadeDB's Undertow HTTP Server by creating a Server Plugin (look at `MongoDBProtocolPlugin` plugin implementation for a real example) and implementing the `registerAPI` method. Example for the HTTP POST API `/myapi/test`:

```
package com.yourpackage;

public class MyTest implements ServerPlugin {
  // ...

  @Override
  public void registerAPI(HttpServer httpServer, final PathHandler routes) {
    routes.addPrefixPath("/myapi",//
      Handlers.routing()//
        .get("/account/{id}", new RetieveeAccount(this))// YOU CAN ADD YOUR HANDLERS
UNDER THE SAME PREFIX PATH
        .post("/test/{name}", new MyTestAPI(this))//
```

```
    );
  }
}
```

You can use `GET`, `POST` or any HTTP methods when you register your handler. Note that multiple handlers are defined under the same prefix `/myapi`. Below you can find the implementation of a "Test" handler that can be called by using the HTTP POST method against the URL `/myapi/test/{name}` where `{name}` is the name passed as an argument. Note that the `MyTestAPI` class is inheriting `DatabaseAbstractHandler` to have the database instance as a parameter. If the user is not authenticated, the `execute()` method is not called at all, but an authentication error is returned. If you don't need to access to the database, then you can extend the `AbstractHandler` class instead.

```
public class MyTestAPI extends DatabaseAbstractHandler {

  public MyTestAPI(final HttpServer httpServer) {
    super(httpServer);
  }

  @Override
  public void execute(final HttpServerExchange exchange, ServerSecurityUser user,
final Database database) throws IOException {
    final Deque<String> namePar = exchange.getQueryParameters().get("name");
    if (namePar == null || namePar.isEmpty()) {
      exchange.setStatusCode(400);
      exchange.getResponseSender().send("{ \"error\" : \"name is null\"}");
      return;
    }

    final String name = namePar.getFirst();

    // DO SOMETHING MEANINGFUL HERE
    // ...

    exchange.setStatusCode(204);
    exchange.getResponseSender().send("");
  }
}
```

At startup, ArcadeDB server will initiate your plugin and register your API. To start the server with your plugin, register the full class in `arcadedb.server.plugins` setting:

Example:

```
$ java ... -Darcadedb.server.plugins=MyPlugin:com.yourpackage.MyPlugin ...
```

### 8.4.4. HTTPS connection

In order to enable HTTPS on ArcadeDB server, you have to set the following configuration before the server starts:

```
configuration.setValue(GlobalConfiguration.NETWORK_USE_SSL, true);
configuration.setValue(GlobalConfiguration.NETWORK_SSL_KEYSTORE,
"src/test/resources/master.jks");
configuration.setValue(GlobalConfiguration.NETWORK_SSL_KEYSTORE_PASSWORD,
"keypassword");
configuration.setValue(GlobalConfiguration.NETWORK_SSL_TRUSTSTORE,
"src/test/resources/master.jks");
configuration.setValue(GlobalConfiguration.NETWORK_SSL_TRUSTSTORE_PASSWORD,
"storepassword");
```

Where:

- `NETWORK_USE_SSL` enable the SSL support for the HTTP Server
- `NETWORK_SSL_KEYSTORE` is the path where is located the keystore file
- `NETWORK_SSL_KEYSTORE_PASSWORD` is the keystore password
- `NETWORK_SSL_TRUSTSTORE` is the path where is located the truststore file
- `NETWORK_SSL_TRUSTSTORE_PASSWORD` is the truststore password

Note that the default port for HTTPs is configured via the global setting:

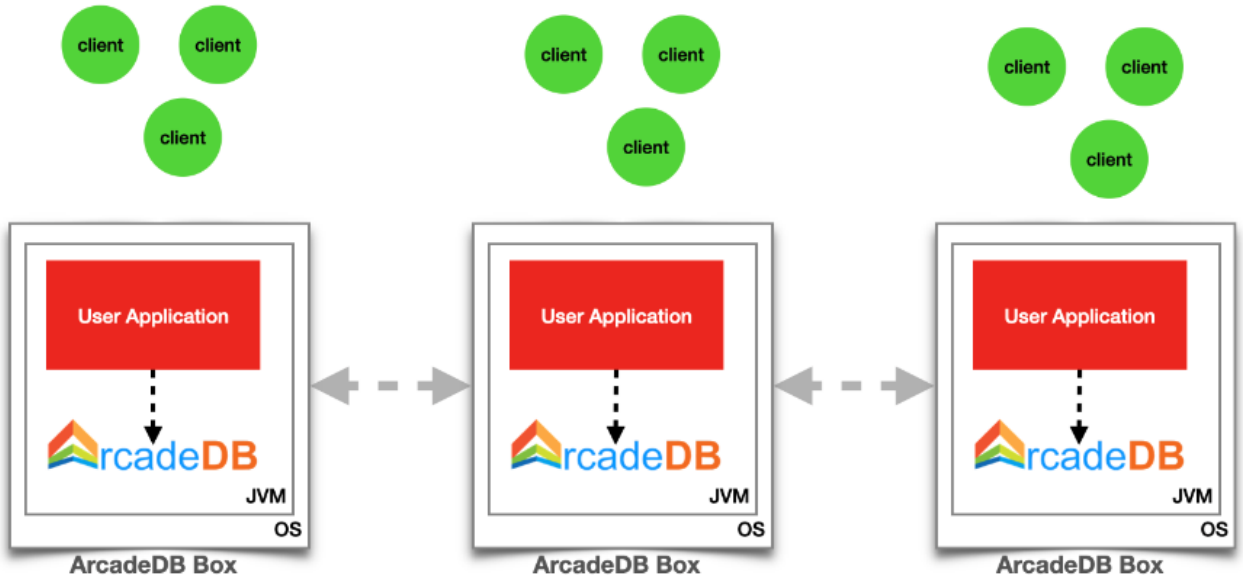
```
GlobalConfiguration.SERVER_HTTPS_INCOMING_PORT
```

And by default starts from 2490 to 2499 (increases the port if it's already occupied).

if HTTP or HTTPS port are already used, the next ports are used. With the default range of 2480-2489 for HTTP and 2490-2499 for HTTPS, if the port 2480 is not available, then the next port for both HTTP and HTTPS will be used, namely 2481 for HTTP and 2491 for HTTPS

### 8.4.5. Replication between boxes

You can replicate databases across multiple boxes to have true high availability:




Best of latency between User Application and Database Server + Replication for High Availability

## 8.5. Server

To start ArcadeDB as a server run the script `server.sh` under the `bin` directory of ArcadeDB distribution. If you're using MS Windows OS, replace `server.sh` with `server.bat`.

```
$ bin/server.sh

 ▒▒▒▒▒▒╗  ▒▒▒▒▒▒▒╗   ▒▒▒▒▒▒▒╗  ▒▒▒▒▒▒╗  ▒▒▒▒▒▒▒╗  ▒▒▒▒▒▒▒▒╗ ▒▒▒▒▒▒▒╗  ▒▒▒▒▒▒▒╗
▒▒ ╔═══▒▒╗ ▒▒ ╔═══▒▒╗ ▒▒ ╔═══════╝ ▒▒ ╔═══▒▒╗ ▒▒ ╔═══▒▒╗ ▒▒ ╔═══════╝ ▒▒ ╔═══▒▒╗ ▒▒ ╔═
═══▒▒╗
▒▒▒▒▒▒▒▒ || ▒▒▒▒▒▒▒ ╔═╝ ▒▒ ||        ▒▒▒▒▒▒▒▒ || ▒▒ ||    ▒▒ || ▒▒▒▒▒▒╗    ▒▒ ||    ▒▒ || ▒▒▒▒▒▒▒ ╔═╝
▒▒ ╔═══▒▒ || ▒▒ ╔═══▒▒╗ ▒▒ ||        ▒▒ ╔═══▒▒ || ▒▒ ||    ▒▒ || ▒▒ ╔═══╝     ▒▒ ||    ▒▒ || ▒▒ ╔═══▒▒╗
▒▒ ||    ▒▒ || ▒▒ ||    ▒▒ || ╚▒▒▒▒▒▒▒╗ ▒▒ ||    ▒▒ || ▒▒▒▒▒▒▒ ╔═╝ ▒▒▒▒▒▒▒▒╗ ▒▒▒▒▒▒▒ ╔═╝ ▒▒▒▒▒▒▒ ╔═╝
 ╚═══╝    ╚═══╝ ╚═══╝    ╚═══╝ ╚═══════╝ ╚═══╝    ╚═══╝ ╚═══════╝ ╚═══════╝ ╚═══════╝
 ╚═══════╝ ╚═══════╝  ╚═══════╝

PLAY WITH DATA                                    arcadedb.com

2025-12-09 22:22:22.839 INFO  [ArcadeDBServer] <ArcadeDB_0> ArcadeDB Server v26.10.1
is starting up...
2025-12-09 22:22:22.841 INFO  [ArcadeDBServer] <ArcadeDB_0> Running on Mac OS X 15.6 -
OpenJDK 64-Bit Server VM 25.0.1 (Homebrew)
2025-12-09 22:22:22.843 INFO  [ArcadeDBServer] <ArcadeDB_0> Starting ArcadeDB Server
in development mode with plugins [] ...
2025-12-09 22:22:22.878 INFO  [ArcadeDBServer] <ArcadeDB_0> - Metrics Collection
Started...
2025-12-09 22:22:22.891 INFO  [ArcadeDBServer] <ArcadeDB_0> Server root path: .
2025-12-09 22:22:22.891 INFO  [ArcadeDBServer] <ArcadeDB_0> Databases directory:
./databases
```

```
2025-12-09 22:22:22.891 INFO  [ArcadeDBServer] <ArcadeDB_0> Backups directory:
./backups

+--------------------------------------------------------------------+
|                WARNING: FIRST RUN CONFIGURATION                    |
+--------------------------------------------------------------------+
| This is the first time the server is running. Please type a        |
| password of your choice for the 'root' user or leave it blank      |
| to auto-generate it.                                               |
|                                                                    |
| To avoid this message set the environment variable or JVM          |
| setting `arcadedb.server.rootPassword` to the root password to use.|
+--------------------------------------------------------------------+

Root password [BLANK=auto generate it]: *
```

The first time the server is running, the root password must be inserted and confirmed. The hash (+salt) of the inserted password will be stored in the file `config/server-users.json`. The password length must be between 8 and 256 characters. To know more about this topic, look at Security. Delete this file and restart the server to reinsert the password for server's root user.

The default rules of security are pretty basic. You can implement your own security policy. Check the Security Policy.

You can skip the request for the password by passing it as a setting. Example:

```
-Darcadedb.server.rootPassword=this_is_a_password
```

Alternatively the password can be passed file-based. Example:

```
-Darcadedb.server.rootPasswordPath=/run/secrets/root
```

which is particularly useful for container-based deployments.

The password file is a plain-text file and should not contain any line breaks / new lines.

Once inserted the password for the root user, you should see this output.

```
Root password [BLANK=auto generate it]: *********
*Please type the root password for confirmation (copy and paste will not work):
*********

2025-12-09 22:23:33.719 INFO  [HttpServer] <ArcadeDB_0> - Starting HTTP Server (host
=0.0.0.0 port=[2480, 2489] httpsPort=[2490, 2499])...
2025-12-09 22:23:33.738 INFO  [undertow] starting server: Undertow - 2.3.20.Final
2025-12-09 22:23:33.741 INFO  [xnio] XNIO version 3.8.16.Final
```

```
2025-12-09 22:23:33.744 INFO  [nio] XNIO NIO Implementation Version 3.8.16.Final
2025-12-09 22:23:33.803 INFO  [HttpServer] <ArcadeDB_0> - HTTP Server started (host
=0.0.0.0 port=2480 httpsPort=2490)
2025-12-09 22:23:33.908 INFO  [ArcadeDBServer] <ArcadeDB_0> Available query languages:
[sqlscript, mongo, gremlin, java, cypher, js, graphql, sql]
2025-12-09 22:23:33.909 INFO  [ArcadeDBServer] <ArcadeDB_0> ArcadeDB Server started in
'development' mode (CPUs=8 MAXRAM=4,00GB)
2025-12-09 22:23:33.910 INFO  [ArcadeDBServer] <ArcadeDB_0> Studio web tool available
at http://192.168.1.102:2480
```

A warning `WARNING: Using incubator modules: jdk.incubator.vector` in the log can be safely ignored.

By default, the following components start with the server:

- JMX Metrics, to monitor server performance and statistics (served via port 9999).
- HTTP Server, that listens on port 2480 by default. If port 2480 is already occupied, then the next is taken up to 2489.

In the output above, the name `ArcadeDB_0` is the server name. By default, `ArcadeDB_0` is used. To specify a different name define it with the setting `server.name`, example:

```
$ bin/server.sh -Darcadedb.server.name=ArcadeDB_Europe_0
```

In a high availability (HA) configuration, it's mandatory that all the servers in an cluster have different names.

### 8.5.1. Start server hint

To start the server from a location different than the ArcadeDB folder, for example, if starting the server as a service, set the environment variable `ARCADEDB_HOME` to the ArcadeDB folder:

```
$ export ARCADEDB_HOME=/path/to/arcadedb
```

### 8.5.2. Server modes

The server can be started in one of three modes, which affect the studio, logging, and security defaults:

| Mode | Studio | Logging | WAL Flush | LOAD CSV file access |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `development` | Yes | Detailed | No flush (`0`) | Enabled |
| `test` | Yes | Brief | No flush (`0`) | Enabled |
| `production` | No (can be force-enabled) | Brief | Auto-set to `1` if not configured | Auto-disabled if not configured |

The mode is controlled by the `server.mode` setting with a default mode `development`.

In `production` mode the Studio web tool is not served by default, to reduce the attack surface. If you need it (for example to inspect a database running in production), force-enable it with the `studio.enabled` setting:

```
$ bin/server.sh -Darcadedb.server.mode=production -Darcadedb.studio.enabled=true
```

When enabling Studio in production, restrict network access to the HTTP port (for example with a firewall, a reverse proxy, or by enabling SSL), since it exposes a web UI on the public-facing server.

#### Production mode defaults

When the server starts in `production` mode, ArcadeDB automatically applies safe defaults for settings that have not been explicitly configured:

- **WAL flush** (`arcadedb.txWalFlush`): set to `1` (flush without metadata) for transaction durability. If you explicitly set it to `0`, a warning is logged. See concepts/transactions.pdf for details.
- **LOAD CSV file access** (`arcadedb.opencypher.loadCsv.allowFileUrls`): disabled to prevent Cypher queries from reading local files on the server. Set to `true` explicitly if needed.
- **Studio web tool** (`arcadedb.studio.enabled`): the Studio web UI is not served. Set it to `true` to force-enable Studio in production (see Server modes).

These defaults are only applied when the setting has not been explicitly configured by the user (via system property, environment variable, or API call). Explicit settings are always respected.

At startup, a production checklist is logged summarizing the security-relevant configuration:

```
INFO  Production checklist:
INFO  - WAL flush: 1 (flush without metadata) [OK]
INFO  - SSL: disabled. Consider enabling for encrypted connections
INFO  - High availability: disabled. Consider enabling for fault tolerance
INFO  - LOAD CSV file access: disabled [OK]
INFO  - Backup support: enabled [OK]
INFO  - Studio web tool: disabled [OK]
```

#### Error details in production mode

In `production` mode no wire surface sends the engine's own error text to clients. That text can carry stored data (the values of a duplicated key) or details of the server (file paths, URLs), so it is replaced by one generic message, the same on every surface and for every failure: "The request failed. Check the server log for the details". The full error is written to the server log instead. This applies to:

- **HTTP**: the `detail` field is left out of the error response.
- **gRPC**: the status description carries the generic message.

- **PostgreSQL**: the error message (the `M` field) carries the generic message. The SQLSTATE code is kept, so drivers still tell a duplicated key (`23505`) or a syntax error (`42601`) apart.
- **MongoDB**: the protocol words its own error messages and keeps the engine message in the server log.
- **Gremlin Server**: the default WebSocket channelizer answers with the generic message, see Gremlin security.
- **Bolt**: the `FAILURE` message carries the generic message. The Neo4j status code is kept, so drivers still classify and retry the failure. A Cypher syntax error is concealed too, and keeps its `Neo.ClientError.Statement.*` code.
- **Redis**: the text of an error reply after its `ERR`, `TRYAGAIN` or `NOPERM` prefix is the generic message. Errors of the RESP protocol itself, such as `wrong number of arguments` or `value is not an integer or out of range`, and the refusal of a credential or a permission stay visible.
- **`/ws` insert session**: the `error` frames and the `message` of each entry of a `batchAck errors` array carry the generic message. The `code` and the exception class are kept. Text the protocol writes about the request itself, such as a missing `keyColumns`, an invalid option or an expired session, stays visible, as it is what the client needs to fix the request.
- **`/ws` change-event subscriptions**: the `error` frames of a failed action carry the generic message.
- **MCP**: a tool error, and the `Internal error` of a JSON-RPC error, carry the generic message. The validation of the tool arguments (a missing `database`, an unknown tool, a limit out of range) stays visible.

The structured part a client branches on (an error code, a Neo4j status, a RESP prefix, an exception class name) is never concealed, and neither is text the protocol layer writes itself about the request, which carries no stored data. In the server log, a failure the client did not cause is logged at `SEVERE` with its stack trace, and a failure the client caused (a duplicated key, a syntax error, a validation refusal) is logged with its message only: at `INFO`, or at `FINE` for the per-row errors of a `/ws` insert session, where a bulk load can refuse thousands of rows by design.

The values of a duplicated key are stored data, so they never reach the client in production mode. When a unique index refuses a write, a remote client still receives the exception type, the index name and the existing record's RID, but `DuplicatedKeyException.getKeys()` returns `[concealed]` instead of the key values. HTTP (`exceptionArgs`), gRPC (the `arcadedb-dup-keys` trailer), PostgreSQL and MongoDB behave the same way; on Bolt, Redis, the `/ws` insert session and MCP the whole message is concealed. In `development` and `test` mode the key values and the full error messages are returned as before.

Before v26.11.1 the `/ws` insert session, `/ws` subscriptions, Bolt, Redis and MCP returned the engine's error message as is in every mode, duplicated key values included. A client of these protocols that parses the error text receives the generic message in production mode now: branch on the error code, the Neo4j status or the RESP prefix instead, and read the detail from the server log.

### 8.5.3. Create default database(s)

Instead of starting a server and then connect to it, to create the default databases, ArcadeDB Server

takes an initial default databases list by using the setting `server.defaultDatabases`.

```
$ bin/server.sh "-Darcadedb.server.defaultDatabases=Universe[albert:einstein]"
```

With the example above the database "Universe" will be created if doesn't exist, with user "albert", password "einstein".

Due to the use of `[]`, the command line argument needs to be wrapped in quotes.

A default database without users still needs to include empty brackets, ie: `-Darcadedb.server.defaultDatabases=Multiverse[]`

An entry the server cannot parse (no `[…]` block, a `[` or a `{` never closed) stops the list there: that entry and the ones after it are not loaded, and the server logs a WARNING naming the malformed entry. Since 26.11.1 the WARNING quotes only that entry, with its passwords masked the same way the settings reports mask them (`Universe[albert:*]`, and from the first `:` on for an entry written without brackets), and an unclosed `[` is reported this way instead of aborting the server start.

A database entry may be followed by `{restore:<URL>}`, which restores that database from a backup archive at start-up, replacing any copy already on disk (e.g. `-Darcadedb.server.defaultDatabases=Universe[albert:einstein]{restore:/tmp/universe.zip}`).

In a cluster, `restore:` acts on the node that is starting and on that node only: the other nodes keep their current copy of the database and are not told anything. This is intentional - it is per-node boot configuration, so a rolling restart does not wipe the database cluster-wide - but it does mean a node can come back with different content than its peers. Since 26.10.1 the server logs a WARNING naming the database whenever this replaces a replicated one, so the divergence is visible in the log.

A client can reach the server while it is still booting and start a backup, restore or import of the same database. Since 26.10.1 the `restore:` command waits for that operation to finish instead of refusing at once, for up to `arcadedb.server.startupRestoreSlotWaitMs` (60000 ms by default). While it waits the server logs at INFO:

```
The startup 'restore:' command for database 'Universe' is waiting up to 60000ms for
<operation> that was running on it to finish
```

If the other operation is still running when the wait runs out, the command refuses, the database on disk is left untouched, and the server boot fails. Set the value to `0` (or a negative number) to refuse immediately, as earlier versions did.

Once the server is started, multiple clients can be connected to the server by using one of the supported protocols:

- HTTP/JSON

- Postgres
- MongoDB
- Redis

### 8.5.4. Logging

The log files are created in the folder `./log` with the filenames `arcadedb.log.X`, where `X` is a number between 0 to 9, set up for log rotate. The current log file has the number 0, and is rotated based on server starts or file size.

By default ArcadeDB does not log debug messages into the console and file. You can change this settings by editing the file `config/arcadedb-log.properties`. The file is a standard logging configuration file.

The default configuration is the following.

```
1  handlers = java.util.logging.ConsoleHandler, java.util.logging.FileHandler
2  .level = INFO
3  com.arcadedb.level = INFO
4  java.util.logging.ConsoleHandler.level = INFO
5  java.util.logging.ConsoleHandler.formatter = com.arcadedb.utility.AnsiLogFormatter
6  java.util.logging.FileHandler.level = INFO
7  java.util.logging.FileHandler.pattern=./log/arcadedb.log
8  java.util.logging.FileHandler.formatter = com.arcadedb.log.LogFormatter
9  java.util.logging.FileHandler.limit=100000000
10 java.util.logging.FileHandler.count=10
```

Where:

- Line 1 contains 2 loggers, the console and the file. This means logs will be written in both console (process output) and configured file (see line 7)
- Line 2 sets INFO (information) as the default logging level for all the Java classes between `FINER`, `FINE`, `INFO`, `WARNING`, `SEVERE`
- Line 3 is as (line 2) but sets the level for ArcadeDB package only `SEVERE`
- Line 4 sets the minimum level the console logger filters the log file (below `INFO` level will be discarded)
- Line 5 sets the formatter used for the console. The `AnsiLogFormatter` supports ANSI color codes
- Line 6 sets the minimum level the file logger filters the log file (below `INFO` level will be discarded)
- Line 7 sets the path where to write the log file (the file will have a counter suffix, see line 10)
- Line 8 sets the formatter used for the file
- Line 9 sets the maximum file size for the log, before creating a new file. By default it is 100MB
- Line 10 sets the number of files to keep in the directory. By default it is 10. This means that after the 10th file, the oldest file will be removed

If you're running ArcadeDB in embedded mode, make sure you're using the logging setting by specifying the `arcadedb-log.properties` file at JVM startup:

```
$ java ... -Djava.util.logging.config.file=$ARCADEDB_HOME/config/arcadedb-
log.properties ...
```

You can also use your own configuration for logging. In this case replace the path above with your own file.

### 8.5.5. Server Plugins (Extend The Server)

You can extend ArcadeDB server by creating custom plugins. A plugin is a Java class that implements the interface `com.arcadedb.server.ServerPlugin`:

```
public interface ServerPlugin {
  void startService();

  default void stopService() {
  }

  default void configure(ArcadeDBServer arcadeDBServer, ContextConfiguration
configuration) {
  }

  default void registerAPI(final HttpServer httpServer, final PathHandler routes) {
  }
}
```

Once registered, the plugin (see below), ArcadeDB Server will instantiate your plugin class and will call the method `configure()` passing the server configuration. At startup of the server, the `startService()` method will be invoked. When the server is shut down, the `stopService()` will be invoked where you can free any resources used by the plugin. The method `registerAPI()`, if implemented, will be invoked when the HTTP server is initializing where one's own HTTP commands can be registered. For more information about how to create custom HTTP commands, look at Custom HTTP commands.

Example:

```
package com.yourpackage;

public class MyPlugin implements ServerPlugin {
  @Override
  public void startService() {
    System.out.println( "Plugin started" );
  }

  @Override
```

```
  public void stopService() {
    System.out.println( "Plugin halted" );
  }

  @Override
  default void configure(ArcadeDBServer arcadeDBServer, ContextConfiguration
configuration) {
    System.out.println( "Plugin configured" );
  }

  @Override
  default void registerAPI(final HttpServer httpServer, final PathHandler routes) {
    System.out.println( "Registering HTTP commands" );
  }
}
```

To register your plugin, register the name and add your class (with full package name) in `arcadedb.server.plugins` setting:

Example:

```
$ java ... -Darcadedb.server.plugins=MyPlugin:com.yourpackage.MyPlugin ...
```

In case of multiple plugins, use a comma (`,`) to separate them.

A common use of a Server Plugin is to register **custom Java functions** on a standalone server. Since there is no auto-discovery, drop your JAR in `lib/` (or `lib/plugins/`), call `database.getSchema().registerFunctionLibrary(…)` from the plugin's `startService()` method, and enable the plugin via `arcadedb.server.plugins`. See User Functions in Java for a complete example.

### 8.5.6. Metrics

The ArcadeDB server can collect, log and publish metrics. To activate the collection of metrics use the setting:

```
$ ... -Darcadedb.serverMetrics=true
```

To log the metrics to the standard output use the setting:

```
$ ... -Darcadedb.serverMetrics.logging=true
```

To publish the metrics as Prometheus via HTTP, add the plugin:

```
$ ... -Darcadedb.server.plugins
```

```
="Prometheus:com.arcadedb.metrics.prometheus.PrometheusMetricsPlugin"
```

Then, under `http://localhost:2480/prometheus` (or the respective ArcadeDB host) the metrics can be requested given server credentials. For details about the response format see the Prometheus docs.

# 8.6. Changing Settings

To change the default value of a setting, always put `arcadedb.` as a prefix. Example:

```
$ java -Darcadedb.dumpConfigAtStartup=true ...
```

To change the same setting via Java code:

```
GlobalConfiguration.findByKey("arcadedb.dumpConfigAtStartup").setValue(true);
```

Check the Appendix for all the available settings.

## 8.6.1. Environment Variables

The server script parses a set of environment variables which are summarized below:

| | |
|---|---|
| `JAVA_HOME` | JVM location |
| `JAVA_OPTS` | JVM options |
| `ARCADEDB_SETTINGS` | ArcadeDB settings, as `-Darcadedb.*` arguments |
| `ARCADEDB_HOME` | ArcadeDB location |
| `ARCADEDB_PID` | `arcadedb.pid` file location |
| `ARCADEDB_OPTS_MEMORY` | JVM memory options |
| `ARCADEDB_OPTS_GC` | JVM garbage collector options (*since v26.9.1*) |
| `ARCADEDB_OPTS_HEADERS` | JVM object header options (*since v26.10.1*, `server.sh` only) |

Since v26.10.1 `server.sh` enables compact object headers (JEP 519, `-XX:+UseCompactObjectHeaders`), which shrink every object header and cut allocation, when the JVM accepts the flag. It asks the JVM first (`java -XX:+UseCompactObjectHeaders -version`) and adds the flag only when that succeeds, so Java 25 and later get it while Java 21 still starts without it. The flag lives in `ARCADEDB_OPTS_HEADERS`, so setting `JAVA_OPTS` does not lose it. Setting `ARCADEDB_OPTS_HEADERS` skips the probe and uses your value instead, and an empty value opts out:

```
$ export ARCADEDB_OPTS_HEADERS=""
$ bin/server.sh
```

Use `ARCADEDB_SETTINGS` for ArcadeDB's own settings and leave `JAVA_OPTS` for JVM flags. They are separate variables so that setting one never discards the other: this matters in containers, where the image supplies its own values for `ARCADEDB_OPTS_GC` and `ARCADEDB_OPTS_MEMORY` and an environment variable is replaced rather than appended to.

```
$ export ARCADEDB_SETTINGS="-Darcadedb.server.rootPassword=playwithdata"
$ bin/server.sh
```

For default values see the `server.sh` and `server.bat` scripts.

### 8.6.2. RAM Configuration

The ArcadeDB server, by default, uses a dynamic allocation for the used RAM. Sometimes you want to limit this to a specific amount. You can define the environment variable `ARCADEDB_OPTS_MEMORY` to tune the JVM settings for the usage of the RAM.

Example to use 800M fixed RAM for ArcadeDB server:

```
$ export ARCADEDB_OPTS_MEMORY="-Xms800M -Xmx800M"
$ bin/server.sh
```

ArcadeDB can run with as little as 16M for RAM. In case you're running ArcadeDB with less than 800M of RAM, you should set the "low-ram" as profile:

```
$ export ARCADEDB_OPTS_MEMORY="-Xms128M -Xmx128M"
$ bin/server.sh -Darcadedb.profile=low-ram
```

Setting a profile is like executing a macro that changes multiple settings at once. You can tune them individually, check Settings.

In case of memory latency problems under Linux systems, the following JVM setting can improve performance:

```
$ export ARCADEDB_OPTS_MEMORY="-XX:+PerfDisableSharedMem"
```

for more information, see https://www.evanjones.ca/jvm-mmap-pause.html

The Java heap memory is by default configured for desktop use; for custom containers, memory configuration can be adapted by:

```
$ export ARCADEDB_OPTS_MEMORY="-XX:InitialRAMPercentage=50.0
```

```
-XX:MaxRAMPercentage=75.0"
```

More information about Java memory configuration see this article.

# 8.7. High Availability

ArcadeDB is designed for continuous operation. Its high availability (HA) architecture ensures that your database remains accessible even when individual servers fail, providing both fault tolerance and horizontal read scalability.

This page explains the concepts behind ArcadeDB's HA architecture. For step-by-step setup instructions, see HA Configuration.

ArcadeDB's HA is powered by Apache Ratis, a battle-tested implementation of the Raft consensus protocol also used by Apache Ozone, Apache IoTDB, and Alluxio. The change is transparent to clients: the HTTP API, drivers, and query languages are unchanged.

## 8.7.1. Leader-Replica Replication Model

ArcadeDB uses a leader-replica replication model. At any point in time, a cluster has exactly one **leader** server and zero or more **replica** servers.

- The **leader** coordinates all write operations and distributes changes to replicas through the Raft log.
- **Replicas** serve read requests (queries) independently, allowing the cluster to scale read throughput horizontally.

Clients can connect to any server in the cluster. If a client sends a write request to a replica, the replica transparently forwards it to the leader over HTTP. Applications do not need to distinguish between leader and replica servers — the cluster handles routing internally.

## 8.7.2. Server Roles and Election

Every server in the cluster operates in one of two roles:

**LEADER**

The single server responsible for accepting and coordinating all write operations. Only one leader exists at any time.

**REPLICA**

A server that maintains a copy of the data and serves read requests. Replicas receive changes from the leader and can be promoted to leader if the current leader fails.

When a server starts, it joins the cluster and participates in a Raft election. Raft guarantees that the cluster agrees on exactly one leader at all times. Apache Ratis implements the full Raft protocol, including **pre-vote** (prevents disrupted elections from partitioned nodes), **leader lease**, and **parallel voting** for fast convergence.

If the cluster already has a healthy leader, the new server simply joins as a replica and catches up via the Raft log or, if it has fallen too far behind, a full snapshot download. If no leader exists — for example, during initial cluster formation or after a leader failure — an election determines which server becomes the new leader.

### 8.7.3. Replication and the Raft Log

The leader replicates changes to replicas through the Raft log, which combines a write-ahead log with distributed consensus. Each server maintains its own local copy of the Raft log.

When the leader processes a write operation, ArcadeDB uses a **replicate-first, commit-after** three-phase commit:

1. **Phase 1** — the leader captures the write-ahead log (WAL) pages produced by the transaction.
2. **Phase 2** — the captured payload is appended to the Raft log and replicated to followers. The commit is acknowledged only after a quorum of nodes has persisted the entry.
3. **Phase 3** — the leader applies the pages locally and returns success to the client.

If replication fails at Phase 2, no local writes are applied: the transaction is rolled back and no divergence can occur between the leader and the followers.

Multiple concurrent transactions are automatically batched into a single Raft round-trip via **group commit**, dramatically increasing throughput under concurrent load.

Schema DDL takes a different path: each schema change is replicated as its own entry type, carrying the schema document rather than WAL pages. Since v26.10.1 that entry can carry just a delta against the schema the followers already hold, and a schema-only SQL script is replicated as a single entry. See Schema replication.

### 8.7.4. Write Quorum

ArcadeDB uses a configurable **write quorum** to control the trade-off between durability and availability. The quorum defines how many servers must acknowledge a write before it is considered committed.

The default quorum is `MAJORITY` — more than half of the servers in the cluster must confirm the write. This is the standard Raft quorum and provides a strong balance between durability and availability: data is stored on a majority of nodes while tolerating the failure of any minority.

Two quorum modes are supported:

`majority` **(default)**

: A standard Raft quorum. Writes are committed as soon as a majority of peers acknowledge, so the cluster keeps serving writes as long as a majority is alive.

`all`

: Every configured peer must acknowledge the write. Strongest durability, but a single unavailable peer stops writes.

The legacy values `none`, `one`, `two`, `three` are **not supported** and will cause a startup error. They were part of the old custom HA protocol; with Raft only `majority` and `all` are meaningful. If you were using a granular quorum value, update your configuration before upgrading.

If the quorum cannot be met — for example, because too many peers are unavailable — the transaction is rolled back and an error is returned to the client. This prevents partially committed writes.

For more on how transactions interact with replication, see Transactions. For quorum and other cluster settings, see Server Settings.

### 8.7.5. Read Consistency

When a client sends a read request to a replica, ArcadeDB supports three consistency levels that trade latency for freshness:

`eventual`

The replica reads locally without waiting. Fastest, but may return slightly stale data.

`read_your_writes` **(default)**

The replica waits until the Raft log index corresponding to the client's most recent write has been applied locally before serving the read. This ensures the client always observes its own writes, even when those writes went to the leader and the read goes to a replica.

`linearizable`

The replica issues a Ratis `ReadIndex` request to the leader and waits until its local applied index reaches the leader's committed index at the time of the request. This is the strongest guarantee and survives leader changes without serving stale data, at the cost of higher latency.

The default is set via `arcadedb.ha.readConsistency`. Clients can also override it per request with the `X-ArcadeDB-Read-Consistency` HTTP header. For read-your-writes, the client takes the commit index the server returned in the `X-ArcadeDB-Commit-Index` response header and sends it back on the next read as `X-ArcadeDB-Read-After`, so the replica waits only for that index. Every response carries the bookmark, including streamed query responses and error responses.

### 8.7.6. Automatic Failover

ArcadeDB handles leader failure automatically. When replicas stop receiving heartbeats from the leader, they initiate a new election using the Raft protocol. A replica with an up-to-date log is elected as the new leader, and the cluster resumes normal operation.

This failover process is transparent to clients: after a brief interruption during the election, clients reconnect (or are proxied) to the new leader and continue operating without manual intervention.

Common causes of leader unavailability include process termination, server shutdown or reboot, and network partitions that isolate the leader from the rest of the cluster.

### 8.7.7. Split-Brain Protection

A **split-brain** occurs when a network partition divides a cluster into two or more groups, each believing it should operate independently. This can lead to conflicting writes and data divergence.

ArcadeDB prevents split-brain scenarios through the Raft majority quorum requirement. Because a leader must receive acknowledgment from a majority of servers to commit writes, at most one partition can ever hold a majority. Any minority partition cannot elect a leader or commit writes, so it effectively becomes read-only until the network heals. Pre-vote further prevents a partitioned node from forcing a disruptive election when it regains connectivity.

This design guarantees that the cluster never produces conflicting committed data, even during network failures.

### 8.7.8. Snapshots and Catch-Up

As the Raft log grows, ArcadeDB periodically takes a snapshot of the database state. The snapshot allows old log segments to be compacted, preventing unbounded disk growth.

When a replica falls too far behind the leader (for example, after a long network partition), ArcadeDB automatically transfers a fresh snapshot: the follower downloads a ZIP of the database from the leader over HTTP and installs it atomically. Once the snapshot is installed, the follower resumes normal log-based replication from the snapshot index.

### 8.7.9. Cluster Bootstrap from Pre-Staged Data

When a multi-node cluster forms for the first time on top of a pre-imported database, ArcadeDB skips the leader-streamed snapshot phase entirely. Every peer reports the fingerprint and `lastTxId` of its local database; the peer with the highest `lastTxId` becomes the bootstrap source via Raft leadership transfer; peers whose fingerprint matches bootstrap locally with zero bytes transferred. This makes "import the dataset once, then scale to N pods" a seconds-not-hours operation, and the cluster forms with everyone already at the same state.

The bootstrap path is gated on every peer's Raft log being empty, so subsequent cluster restarts continue to use the regular log replay and snapshot paths. For the operator-facing workflow and configuration flags, see Offline Cluster Bootstrap.

### 8.7.10. Dynamic Membership

Cluster membership can be changed at runtime without restarting the cluster. Operators can add peers, remove peers, transfer leadership, or have a node gracefully leave the cluster through the cluster REST API. On Kubernetes, scaling a StatefulSet up or down automatically adds and removes peers.

### 8.7.11. Cluster Discovery and Configuration

Servers discover each other through a configured list of peers (`arcadedb.ha.serverList`). Each entry can use the readable object form `[name@]host:{raft:2434,http:2480,https:2490,priority:10}` (recommended) or the positional form `[name@]host:raftPort:httpPort[:priority[:httpsPort]]`,

where the Raft gRPC port (default `2434`) is used for consensus, the HTTP port for command forwarding, and the optional HTTPS port for encrypted peer-to-peer transfers when TLS is enabled. The optional `name@` prefix lets operators give each peer a stable, human-readable name (for example, `frankfurt`, `london`, `nyc`) shown in logs and Studio. See Server List Entry Format for details.

You can run multiple independent clusters on the same network by assigning each cluster a unique name via `arcadedb.ha.clusterName`. Inter-node communication is authenticated with a shared **cluster token** automatically derived from the cluster name and the root password.

For detailed configuration options and deployment instructions, see HA Configuration.

### 8.7.12. Continuous Correctness Testing with Jepsen

Distributed systems are easy to claim correct and hard to prove correct. To know how ArcadeDB actually behaves under partitions, process kills, clock skew, and simulated power loss — rather than how we hope it behaves — the team maintains a public Jepsen test suite at ArcadeData/arcadedb-jepsen.

Jepsen is the de-facto framework for testing distributed systems under faults. It pairs aggressive failure injection with two model checkers — **Knossos** for linearizability and **Elle** for transactional isolation — that build a history of every operation the cluster acknowledged and then look for any execution that no correct system could have produced. Both checkers are model-driven, so a system can't pass them by being merely fast or quiet under load.

ArcadeDB is **not** officially Jepsen-certified — that requires an independent engagement with Jepsen LLC. The tests in this section are a self-hosted suite using the open-source Jepsen framework. We publish them in full so the community can review, reproduce, and extend them.

#### What gets tested

The suite combines **six workloads** with **eight fault models** (nemeses), so the cluster is exercised the way users actually break it in production:

| Workload | What it verifies |
|---|---|
| `bank` | ACID conservation across concurrent transfers between accounts; the total balance must stay constant under any failure schedule. |
| `set` | No acknowledged write is ever lost; every successfully-inserted element survives partitions, kills, and replays. |
| `elle` | Multi-key transaction isolation. The Elle checker rejects G0, G1a, G1b, G2, and lost-update anomalies via dependency-graph cycle detection. |
| `register` | Single-key linearizability when reading from the leader. |
| `register-follower` | Linearizability for follower reads via Raft `ReadIndex`. |
| `register-bookmark` | Read-your-writes consistency through commit-index bookmarks (the same mechanism documented in Read Consistency). |

| Nemesis | What it injects |
|---|---|
| `partition` | Network partitions that isolate one or more nodes from the rest of the cluster. |
| `kill` | Hard process termination of randomly chosen servers. |
| `pause` | `SIGSTOP` / `SIGCONT` pairs that freeze a server's process for seconds at a time. |
| `clock` | Bidirectional clock skew on individual nodes. |
| `lazyfs` | LazyFS-backed simulated power loss — drops un-fsynced writes to test recovery from crashes that lose the OS page cache. |
| `all` | Random combinations of `partition` + `kill` + `pause`. |
| `all+clock` | `all` plus simultaneous clock skew. |
| `all+lazyfs` | `all` plus simulated power loss. |

The full matrix runs in Docker against a five-node cluster (`n1`–`n5`) and is reproducible end-to-end from the repository's `run-all-tests.sh`.

### Current status

At the time of writing, the suite reports **all tests passing** — leader linearizability, follower linearizability via `ReadIndex`, ACID conservation, replication completeness, and read-your-writes — across every nemesis combination, including the LazyFS power-loss workloads added most recently. See the launch announcement for the methodology and original results, and the repository for the up-to-date matrix.

Concretely, this means that under every failure pattern we exercise:

- every write the cluster acknowledged remains durable after recovery,
- concurrent transactions remain ACID — Elle finds no isolation anomaly,
- single-key operations are linearizable on the leader and on followers using `ReadIndex`,
- clients reading their own writes never observe regressed state, even when their reads land on a different replica than the write.

### What's not (yet) tested

Honesty matters more than green checkmarks. The suite does **not** yet cover:

- multi-hour or multi-day soak runs that surface slow leaks and pathological GC interactions,
- Byzantine-fsync scenarios (a filesystem that lies about durability beyond what LazyFS simulates),
- geo-distributed clusters with sustained tens-of-milliseconds latency between nodes,
- every imaginable compounded worst case — for example, an expired leader lease **plus** clock skew **plus** an active partition all happening at once.

These are explicitly tracked as future work. Pull requests for additional workloads, tighter checkers, or longer-duration runs are very welcome.

**Mission**

The reason the project exists is straightforward: we want to know what ArcadeDB actually does under failure before we ask anyone else to trust it. Jepsen is the highest-leverage way the industry has found to answer that question, and we run it in public so the answer is verifiable rather than assertive. If you find a workload that breaks, please open an issue at arcadedb-jepsen/issues — that is exactly what the suite is for.

# 8.8. High Availability

ArcadeDB supports a High Availability (HA) mode where multiple servers share the same databases via Raft-based replication. All servers of a cluster serve the same set of databases.

HA is powered by Apache Ratis, a production-grade implementation of the Raft consensus protocol. The old custom replication protocol has been removed. For the underlying concepts, see High Availability Concepts.

## 8.8.1. Quick Start

To start an ArcadeDB server with HA enabled, at minimum you need to:

1. Set `arcadedb.ha.enabled` to `true`.
2. Define the list of peers in the cluster via `arcadedb.ha.serverList` (if you are deploying on Kubernetes, see Kubernetes). The value is a comma-separated list of peer entries. Each entry can use the readable **object form** `host:{raft:2434,http:2480,https:2490,priority:10}` (recommended) or the **positional form** `host:raftPort:httpPort[:priority[:httpsPort]]`; see Server List Entry Format. The optional `name@` prefix is described in Named Peers.
3. Optionally set the local server name via `arcadedb.server.name`. Each node must have a unique name. If not specified, the default is `ArcadeDB_0`.

Example starting a 3-node cluster on a single host (different ports):

```
$ bin/server.sh -Darcadedb.ha.enabled=true \
                -Darcadedb.server.name=node1 \
                -Darcadedb.ha.serverList
=localhost:2434:2480,localhost:2435:2481,localhost:2436:2482
```

The Raft gRPC port is `2434` by default and is configurable via `arcadedb.ha.raftPort`. The HTTP port in each entry is required so that replicas can forward non-idempotent requests to the leader over HTTP.

The cluster name is `arcadedb` by default; set `arcadedb.ha.clusterName=<name>` to run multiple independent clusters on the same network.

### 8.8.2. Server List Entry Format

Each comma-separated entry in `arcadedb.ha.serverList` can be written in either of two interchangeable forms. The two forms may be freely mixed in the same list, and both accept the optional `name@` prefix (see Named Peers).

#### Object form (recommended)

A brace-delimited set of named fields, which avoids the positional ambiguity of long colon-separated entries:

```
[name@]host:{raft:2434,http:2480,https:2490,priority:10}
```

Fields are unordered and all optional, with these defaults:

| Field | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `raft` | Raft gRPC consensus port. Defaults to `arcadedb.ha.raftPort` (`2434`) when omitted. |
| `http` | HTTP port, used by replicas to forward non-idempotent requests to the leader. Omit if not needed. |
| `https` | HTTPS port, used for **encrypted** peer-to-peer transfers (e.g. snapshot download) when `arcadedb.ssl.enabled=true`. See TLS/SSL. |
| `bolt` | Client-reachable BOLT port, advertised in the BOLT routing table so `neo4j://` drivers find the leader and the followers. See Client Routing Ports. |
| `grpc` | Client-reachable gRPC port, advertised when a gRPC call refused on a follower names the leader to retry against. See Client Routing Ports. *(Since v26.9.1)* |
| `priority` | Leader-election preference (integer, default `0`). The node with the highest priority is preferred as leader. |

`bolt` and `grpc` have no positional equivalent - an entry declaring either must use the object form.

#### Positional form

A colon-separated entry where each field is identified by position:

```
[name@]host:raftPort:httpPort:priority:httpsPort
```

Trailing fields are optional, so `host`, `host:raftPort`, `host:raftPort:httpPort`, and `host:raftPort:httpPort:priority` are all valid. The `httpsPort` is the fifth field and therefore requires `priority` to be present.

Prefer the object form when an entry specifies a priority or an HTTPS port - it is far easier to read `db1:{raft:2434,http:2480,https:2490,priority:10}` than

`db1:2434:2480:10:2490`.

The following two entries are equivalent:

```
# Object form (recommended)
-Darcadedb.ha.serverList=db1:{raft:2434,http:2480,https:2490,priority:10}

# Positional form
-Darcadedb.ha.serverList=db1:2434:2480:10:2490
```

### 8.8.3. Client Routing Ports (`bolt`, `grpc`)

A client protocol's routing view tells a driver which node to send writes to and which nodes it may read from, so it deals in the ports **clients** dial - never the Raft port the cluster uses to talk to itself, and not necessarily the HTTP port either.

**Declare `bolt` and `grpc` whenever your nodes do not all listen on the same port for that protocol.** With the field omitted, a peer's address for that protocol is derived as *that peer's host* plus *this node's own port*. That is correct only for a homogeneous deployment where every node listens on the same port - a Kubernetes StatefulSet, for example - and a one-time WARNING per protocol is logged whenever the fallback is used.

```
# Three nodes on one host: same host, different ports - what the fallback cannot
express
-Darcadedb.ha.serverList=n0@localhost:{raft:2434,http:2480,bolt:7687,grpc:50051
},n1@localhost:{raft:2435,http:2481,bolt:7688,grpc:50052},n2@localhost:{raft:2436,http
:2482,bolt:7689,grpc:50053}
```

On a cluster like that one, leaving the ports undeclared makes every peer derive to the **same** address - and an address two peers both claim identifies neither of them, since two listening sockets cannot share one `host:port`. Rather than advertise a leader address that is really the address of the node answering (which would send a self-redirecting client straight back to the node that just refused it), ArcadeDB advertises nothing for that protocol: BOLT then offers this node as READ and ROUTE but never as writer, and a refused gRPC call falls back to naming the leader's HTTP address. A WARNING naming the field to declare is logged once per protocol. *(Since v26.9.1)*

A declared address always wins over a derived one. Declaring the ports of the nodes that differ is enough; the rest may keep deriving.

### 8.8.4. Peer-to-Peer Endpoints (`http`, `https`)

The same derive-from-this-node's-port fallback applies to the endpoints the **nodes** use to reach each other: a follower downloading a snapshot from the leader, a cluster verify comparing checksums with a peer, and the database presence matrix (`GET /api/v1/cluster?presence=true`). When two peers resolve to one `host:port`, that address identifies at most one of them and nothing can say which, so ArcadeDB **withholds** it rather than guessing: the operation is refused and

reported as refused - a peer comes back `ERROR` / "not verified" from a verify, and unreachable from a presence matrix - instead of quietly answering for the wrong node. *(Since v26.9.1)*

The refusal is visible in three places:

- a one-time WARNING per protocol, naming the peers that could not be told apart, the address they share, and the field to declare;
- `httpAddressAmbiguous: true` next to that peer's `httpAddress` in `GET /api/v1/cluster`, and a warning line on the node's card in the Studio Cluster dashboard;
- the error text of whichever operation was refused.

`http` and `https` are checked independently, because they are read from independent fields with independent fallbacks. A cluster that declares distinct `http` ports and omits the `https` ones passes the HTTP check with every peer's HTTPS endpoint still collapsed onto this node's own; the encrypted transfer then falls back to the (guarded) plain-HTTP endpoint.

One request is exempt: the **capability check**, in which the leader asks each peer which replication formats its build understands so it can use a compact one only when every node can read it. That call changes nothing on the peer and its reply says who answered, so ArcadeDB dials the shared address anyway and credits the answer to the node that identified itself. A cluster that has never declared its `http` ports therefore still gets the compact formats, instead of falling back to the verbose ones forever with nothing to explain why. *(Since v26.10.1)*

On the common single-host layout where every node shares an address and the Raft and HTTP ports move in step (`2434/2480`, `2435/2481`, ...), the capability check derives each peer's HTTP port from that same offset, so it reaches the peers the shared-address fallback cannot name. The derived port is used for the capability check only - never for a snapshot download, a cluster verify or a forwarded write, which keep refusing a shared address. *(Since v26.10.1)*

A peer that still did not answer carries `capabilitiesUnknownReason` next to its entry in `GET /api/v1/cluster`, saying whether it is unreachable, running an older build, or not identified by any address of its own - the last being the one you fix by declaring its `http` port. *(Since v26.10.1)*

Every node also **learns** the HTTP address of a peer it cannot reach where it resolves it, the same way on every node. *(Since v26.11.1)* Each node states its own HTTP port and address in the capability check it sends to the others, and each answer carries the addresses the answering node holds for the other members. Neither is trusted on its own: an address is used only after the peer it names answers there under its own id. From then on that address serves every peer-to-peer call (snapshot downloads, verifies, forwarded writes) and is passed on to the other nodes. In practice, a peer admitted without an `http` port (`connect cluster host:raftPort`, `POST /api/v1/cluster/peer`), or declared on one node only, becomes reachable from every node within a capability round or two, whatever the port layout. An address this node's own `arcadedb.ha.serverList` declares is never replaced. Only the **port** is learnt: an offered address is accepted only on the peer's own Raft host. On a cluster with `arcadedb.ssl.enabled`, offered addresses are not probed at all, because the probe carries the cluster token and would send it over plain HTTP.

Before v26.11.1, the node that served an admission without an `http` port wrote a

`raftPort + offset` guess for the new peer. Every other node derived the peer's Raft host plus its **own** HTTP port, so two nodes could dial the same member on two different addresses. A declared address reached only the node it was typed on and the leader.

Ask **any** node when you want to compare what the nodes understand: every node asks the others, so every node can report each peer's `capabilities`. This is what lets you check "is the rolling upgrade finished" through a Kubernetes Service or a load balancer, neither of which routes you to the leader. *(Since v26.10.1: only the leader asked, so a follower omitted the field for every peer but itself and you had to find the leader first.)*

Because every node asks, the probe traffic grows with the square of the cluster size. At normal Raft cluster sizes that is a few small HTTP calls every five seconds; it is worth knowing only if you run an unusually large voter set.

### 8.8.5. Named Peers

By default, each node identifies its slot in `arcadedb.ha.serverList` from the numeric suffix of `arcadedb.server.name` (for example, `ArcadeDB_0` maps to the first entry, `ArcadeDB_1` to the second, and so on). Display names shown in logs and Studio are then synthesized from the local node's prefix. This positional convention works well for Kubernetes StatefulSets but is awkward when nodes have human-readable names such as `frankfurt`, `london`, `nyc`.

You can add an optional `name@` prefix to any entry in `arcadedb.ha.serverList` to give each peer a stable, human-readable name:

```
$ bin/server.sh -Darcadedb.ha.enabled=true \
                -Darcadedb.server.name=frankfurt \
                -Darcadedb.ha.serverList
=frankfurt@10.0.0.1:2434:2480,london@10.0.0.2:2434:2480,nyc@10.0.0.3:2434:2480
```

When peer names are configured, each node identifies its slot by matching `arcadedb.server.name` against the configured peer names first; if no match is found, it falls back to the legacy `prefix_N` / `prefix-N` suffix resolution. This means:

- Server names no longer require a numeric suffix when peer names are used.
- Display names shown in logs and Studio reflect the configured peer name (e.g. `frankfurt (10.0.0.1:2480)` instead of `ArcadeDB_0 (10.0.0.1:2480)`).
- Mixed clusters work: entries with `name@` get their explicit name; entries without it fall back to the existing positional synthesis.
- Peer names must be unique within the cluster.

The Raft peer ID is still derived from the address (e.g. `10.0.0.1_2434`), so changing or omitting peer names does not affect Raft identity stability.

### 8.8.6. Architecture

ArcadeDB uses a leader/replica model with Raft consensus. At any time one server holds leadership and accepts writes; the others are replicas that serve reads and stand by for failover.

*Cluster of Servers*

Each server persists its own Raft log segments under `<rootPath>/raft-storage/`. The log is used for recovery after restart and to replicate state to peers that fall behind.

Size the Raft storage volume for the log, not only for the databases. If the volume fills, Ratis marks the log as failed at the first entry it could not write and the node rejects every following append while still reporting itself `RUNNING`. Since v26.9.1 the node recovers from that state on its own: the health monitor (`arcadedb.ha.healthCheckInterval`) restarts the Raft server in place as soon as the volume has room for two log segments again - which the periodic log compaction (`arcadedb.ha.snapshotInterval`, escalated below `arcadedb.ha.raftStorageMinFreeSpacePerc`) normally provides - and logs a throttled SEVERE while it is waiting. The in-place restarts are bounded by `arcadedb.ha.ratisRestartMaxRetries` per incident, so a failure that is not about space (a failing disk, a permission change) is left to the operator instead of restarting the node on every tick. For the same reason, a follower that reinstalls a database from the leader's snapshot first purges its own Raft log when that volume is under pressure, and refuses the download up front when the volume cannot hold the archive, instead of failing halfway through the extraction.

Any read (query) can execute on any server in the cluster. All writes must go through the leader: a replica that receives a write transparently forwards it to the current leader via HTTP.

*Write request executed on a replica (proxied to leader)*

Internally, every committed write follows a **replicate-first, commit-after** three-phase commit:

1. Phase 1 (read lock): capture the WAL pages produced by the transaction, validated against the page versions the node holds.
2. Phase 2 (no lock): append the payload to the Raft log and wait for quorum acknowledgment.
3. Phase 3: apply the pages to the local database and return to the client.

If Phase 2 times out or fails, Phase 3 never runs: no local writes, no divergence. Multiple concurrent transactions are batched into fewer Raft round-trips via group commit (`HA_RAFT_GROUP_COMMIT_BATCH_SIZE`).

Phase 3 runs on the Raft apply thread of every node, the leader included, when the entry reaches its position in the log: the leader publishes the pages its transaction prepared, a replica applies the entry's WAL bytes. Every node therefore writes its pages in log order, and the leader's own commit can never overtake or trail the apply of a neighbouring entry.

Two transactions validated on different nodes against the same version of a page (for example two documents that share a page, each written by a different node) are both shipped to the leader with the same next version. The leader validates every entry, page by page, against the versions the log

has already assigned, at the point that decides the log order, and refuses the second one **before appending it**: the originator receives a retryable `ConcurrentModificationException`, exactly as it would for a conflict on a single node, re-reads the page and retries. An entry is never merged onto another one region by region, so a node can neither lose an acknowledged write nor drift from its peers. While such an entry is in flight, a transaction on the leader that touches one of its pages fails its own Phase 1 with the same retryable error, without a round trip.

### 8.8.7. Schema Replication

Schema DDL does not travel through the WAL pages described above. A schema change is recorded in a **schema recording session**, and when the outermost session on the thread closes, the leader replicates it as its own Raft entry type (`SCHEMA_ENTRY`), carrying the schema document and any bucket or index files the change created. One session is one entry.

Normally each DDL statement is one session. Since v26.10.1 a SQL script made only of schema definition statements runs as a single session when `arcadedb.schemaBulkDDLScript` is on (the default), and so does a Java `Schema.bulkChange()` block: the whole batch is one Raft entry (see reference/sql/sql-script.pdf). The trade-off is that the database write lock is held for the whole script.

That matters on the leader. Before appending an ordinary transaction, a commit waits for an active schema session to finish, so the transaction cannot reach the log ahead of the schema entry that creates the files it writes to. The wait lasts at most `arcadedb.ha.quorumTimeout` (10 s by default); after that the commit goes ahead anyway. A DDL script that runs longer than that leaves concurrent writers racing the schema entry. A long index build already opens the same window, so this is not new, but batching makes long sessions more common. Keep DDL scripts to schema definition, run data loads separately, or set `arcadedb.schemaBulkDDLScript=false` to go back to one entry per statement.

On the follower, since v26.10.1, a DDL entry is applied incrementally: only the components for the files the entry created are instantiated, instead of every component in the database being rebuilt (`arcadedb.ha.schemaIncrementalApply`, on by default). Building a large schema used to cost time quadratic in the number of types.

### 8.8.8. Schema Delta Replication (from v26.10.1)

By default each `SCHEMA_ENTRY` carries the whole schema document, so on a schema of several megabytes a one-property `CREATE PROPERTY` costs megabytes on the leader's CPU, on the wire, in every node's Raft log and in each follower's rewrite of `schema.json`. With `arcadedb.ha.schemaDelta` (on by default) the leader ships a delta against the schema the followers already hold. It falls back to the whole document whenever a delta cannot be trusted: the first schema entry after it becomes leader, an entry shipped in instalments, a compaction entry, or a change too large for a delta to be worth it.

**Upgrades need no ordering.** A node running a version that predates the delta cannot see it: it would apply an empty schema change and its schema would diverge from the leader's without an error. To prevent that, the leader asks every peer in the Raft configuration, through `POST /api/v1/cluster/capabilities`, whether it can decode a delta, and ships whole documents unless every peer has said yes. A peer that is unknown, unreachable, too old to have the endpoint, or

whose answer has gone stale counts as no. During a rolling upgrade, deltas start on their own once the last node runs v26.10.1 or later.

**A rolling downgrade below v26.10.1 is not protected.** The negotiation controls what the leader writes from now on, not the delta entries already committed to the Raft log. A node restarted on an older build replays those entries with a decoder that cannot see the delta, applies empty schema changes and diverges silently. To roll a node back that far, rebuild it from a snapshot (reinstall its databases from a current leader and discard its Raft storage) instead of restarting it on its retained log.

While the setting is on, the leader keeps one parsed copy of the schema document per replicated database in heap to diff the next change against: tens of MB per database on a multi-MB schema. Turning the setting off releases it and forces whole documents, which is also useful when diagnosing a schema divergence. Turning it off is safe at any time; turning it back on costs one whole-document entry per database to rebuild the diff base.

Whether deltas are actually being shipped is not exposed through metrics yet. The counters are available only from Java, through `RaftReplicatedDatabase.getSchemaDeltasShipped()` and `getSchemaDocumentsShipped()`, and with `arcadedb.ha.logVerbose=2` a follower logs `Applying a <n>-char schema delta to database '<name>' …` for each one.

### 8.8.9. Write Quorum

A **quorum** is the number of peers that must acknowledge a write before it commits. Configure it via `arcadedb.ha.quorum`:

- `majority` (default) — a majority of peers must acknowledge (standard Raft).
- `all` — every configured peer must acknowledge.

If the configured quorum is not met within `arcadedb.ha.quorumTimeout` milliseconds, the transaction is rolled back and an error is returned to the client.

The legacy quorum values `none`, `one`, `two`, `three` are **not supported** and will cause a startup error. If you were using any of those values, update your configuration to `majority` or `all` before upgrading.

### 8.8.10. Read Consistency

When a read runs on a replica, ArcadeDB offers three consistency levels, configurable per-server via `arcadedb.ha.readConsistency`:

| Level | Behavior |
|---|---|
| `eventual` | Read locally without waiting. Fastest, but may return data that was committed on the leader after the replica's last apply. |
| `read_your_writes` (default) | The replica waits until the Raft log index corresponding to the client's most recent write has been applied locally before serving the read. |

| Level | Behavior |
|---|---|
| `linearizable` | The replica issues a Raft `ReadIndex` request to the leader and waits until its local applied index reaches the leader's committed index for that request. Strongest guarantee, highest latency. |

A node that is no longer a member of the Raft configuration (it left with `leaveCluster` or was removed with `DELETE /api/v1/cluster/peer/{id}`) receives no more entries. On such a node, `linearizable` reads and `read_your_writes` reads whose bookmark it has not applied are refused with a retryable error naming the reason, so the client can retry on a member. This includes reads that were already waiting when the node was removed: they are refused within a second instead of after the quorum timeout. `eventual` reads, and `read_your_writes` reads whose bookmark the node already applied, are still served. *(Since v26.11.1: such reads waited the whole quorum timeout, and a `read_your_writes` read then served data missing the write its bookmark named.)*

Clients communicate the consistency contract through three HTTP headers:

| Header | Direction | Purpose |
|---|---|---|
| `X-ArcadeDB-Read-Consistency` | request | Overrides the server default for this request. Accepts `eventual`, `read_your_writes`, or `linearizable`. |
| `X-ArcadeDB-Read-After` | request | Client-supplied bookmark: the Raft commit index the replica must have applied before serving the read. Used to implement read-your-writes across connections. |
| `X-ArcadeDB-Commit-Index` | response | Current last-applied commit index, echoed on every response, including error responses and streamed (`Accept: application/x-ndjson`) query responses. Clients capture this value and send it back as `X-ArcadeDB-Read-After` on subsequent reads. |

Older clients that sent `X-ArcadeDB-Commit-Index` on requests are still accepted as a backward-compatible fallback.

The bookmark is a lower bound: it says the server had applied **at least** that index when it answered. That holds on a refused request too, so a client can keep its read-your-writes barrier after an error instead of falling back to a stale one.

The one endpoint where it is not a header is the streaming bulk load, `POST /api/v1/batch/{database}` with `Accept: application/x-ndjson`. There the response has already started by the time the commit index is known, and a header set at that point would be dropped silently, so the value travels in the body instead, as `commitIndex` on the terminal `summary` or `error` line. The Java driver handles this transparently: `RemoteDatabase.getLastCommitIndex()` advances the same way whichever encoding was used.

### 8.8.11. Load Shedding and Backpressure

The Raft group-commit queue is bounded (`arcadedb.ha.groupCommitQueueSize`, default 10000 pending transactions). When a write arrives but the queue is full, the server waits up to

`arcadedb.ha.groupCommitOfferTimeout` ms (default 100) for a slot, and if still full throws `ReplicationQueueFullException` — a `NeedRetryException` that clients automatically retry with backoff. This protects the server from OOM under sustained write overload and lets clients back off gracefully.

### 8.8.12. Witness / Read-Scale Nodes

Set `arcadedb.ha.serverRole=replica` to pin a node as a permanent replica. The node's Raft priority is set to 0 at startup so it is never elected leader, while still receiving all writes and serving reads. Useful for read-scale deployments or for cross-DC witnesses that should not take over as leader.

### 8.8.13. Automatic Failover

If the leader becomes unreachable, replicas start a new Raft election. A replica with an up-to-date log is elected as the new leader and the cluster resumes serving writes. Pre-vote prevents partitioned nodes from triggering disruptive elections.

Common causes of leader unavailability include:

- The ArcadeDB server process has been terminated.
- The physical or virtual host has been shut down or rebooted.
- Network issues prevent the leader from reaching a majority of peers.

When a replica rejoins after being offline, it catches up via the Raft log automatically; if it has fallen behind past the log purge boundary, the leader streams a full database snapshot over HTTP and the replica installs it atomically.

The leader also **auto-recovers a follower's replication channel** that is wedged on a stale peer address — for example after a Kubernetes pod is rescheduled onto a new IP: it re-resolves the peer and re-establishes the channel on its own, instead of leaving the follower silently disconnected and the cluster at bare quorum until an operator forces a leadership transfer. See Replication-Channel Self-Healing.

### 8.8.14. Replication-Channel Self-Healing

A follower can be up, healthy, and reachable by every other node, and still receive nothing from the leader. The leader keeps one long-lived gRPC channel per follower. If that channel is wedged on a peer address that is no longer valid (the classic case is a Kubernetes pod restarting onto a new IP inside the JVM's positive DNS cache window), the leader's appender for that follower keeps writing into a socket that goes nowhere. The follower's `matchIndex` stops advancing, or never advances at all (`matchIndex=-1`), while the rest of the cluster commits normally. Quorum is unaffected as long as a majority is still healthy, so the cluster keeps serving writes at reduced redundancy and nothing fails loudly.

ArcadeDB detects and repairs this on its own, in three escalating steps.

**1. Detect: the follower is reported unreachable.** The leader's cluster monitor tracks the time since the last successful RPC to each follower. Once that exceeds `arcadedb.ha.peerUnreachableThreshold` (default 10s), the follower is reported **unreachable**. This is a

diagnostic signal only: it does not change Raft membership, quorum, or the write path. It is, however, the input every step below depends on, so setting it to `0` disables the whole self-healing sequence.

**2. Reset: rebuild that one follower's channel.** Once a follower has stayed continuously unreachable for `arcadedb.ha.peerChannelResetDuration` (default 60s), the leader closes that follower's replication channel so the next send re-resolves DNS and reconnects. Only the unreachable peer's channel is touched; the other followers, and leadership itself, are left alone, so there is no flapping risk. A follower that reconnects inside the interval clears the streak and is never reset, so an in-progress reconnection is not disrupted.

A single reset does not always stick, because the rebuilt channel may still resolve the stale address if the JVM DNS cache has not expired. The reset is therefore retried once per interval, **up to 5 attempts**. The counter re-arms as soon as the follower becomes reachable again. Set the duration to `0` to disable the automatic reset and keep only the manual leadership transfer.

**3. Escalate: transfer leadership to rebuild the appender.** The retry budget alone leaves a gap: the streak only re-arms when the follower becomes reachable, so a permanently wedged channel would sit in the given-up state until an operator restarted the leader process. `arcadedb.ha.peerChannelResetEscalation` (default `true`) closes it. When the budget is exhausted and the channel is still dead, the leader **transfers leadership to a healthy peer**, so the new leader builds a brand-new appender to the stuck follower.

The target is selected with the same rules as a manual step-down and is never the wedged follower itself. If no healthy peer is eligible, the leader logs at SEVERE and leaves the follower for the operator.

The escalation is bounded, not perpetual. Leadership transfer is exactly what makes a **new** leader inherit the problem, so each healthy peer escalates a given follower **at most once per 30-minute cooldown**. If the follower is unreachable for a reason a fresh appender cannot fix (it is genuinely down, or partitioned away), the cluster passes leadership around at most once per peer and then settles on the operator-intervention path instead of churning. Set the flag to `false` to keep the detection and logging but never move leadership automatically.

#### Log lines to look for

The whole sequence is visible in the leader's log. Searching for these strings tells you which step the cluster reached:

| Log line | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `Replica '<peer>' has NEVER received a single append (matchIndex=-1) …` | SEVERE. The follower's replication path is dead: it has not received one entry since the leader took office. This is the symptom, logged before any repair is attempted. |
| `Follower '<peer>' unreachable for <n>ms; triggering a replication-channel reset (attempt N/5) …` | WARNING. Step 2. `N` tells you how much of the retry budget is left. Repeated lines climbing to `5/5` mean the resets are not sticking. |

| Log line | Meaning |
| --- | --- |
| `Follower '<peer>' still unreachable after 5 replication-channel resets over <n>ms; escalating to rebuild the appender for it.` | SEVERE. The budget is exhausted and escalation is enabled. The leadership transfer follows. |
| `Transferring leadership to '<target>' to rebuild the replication appender for wedged follower '<peer>'.` | WARNING. Step 3 firing. A leader change in the logs immediately after this one is intentional, not a failure. |
| `… giving up automatic channel recovery - operator intervention (e.g. a leadership transfer) is required.` | SEVERE. Escalation is disabled (`peerChannelResetEscalation=false`), no healthy peer was eligible, or the 30-minute cooldown already covered this follower. Nothing further is automatic: investigate the follower. |

If you reach the last line, the follower is not suffering from a stale address, and rebuilding the channel will not help. Check that the follower process is alive, that its Raft port is reachable from the leader, and that its address resolves to an entry in `arcadedb.ha.serverList`. A peer that moved to an address outside the list is rejected by the peer allowlist described under Security.

### 8.8.15. Durable Raft Storage

`arcadedb.ha.raftPersistStorage` defaults to `true`. The per-node Raft log under `raft-storage-<nodeName>` is **persisted across restarts**, and `arcadedb.ha.raftStorageDirectory` must live on **durable** storage (a persistent volume, not an ephemeral or `tmpfs` mount).

With ephemeral Raft storage, wiping the log on restart could leave the cluster in a broken state:

- a lagging follower that came back after a **full-cluster cold restart** could permanently diverge and fail to rejoin, surfacing as a `WALVersionGapException`; or
- the cluster could silently re-form as a fresh single-node cluster, dropping committed history.

Durable storage lets a restarted node rejoin by **replaying its own persisted log** rather than always requiring a full snapshot resync from the leader.

**Migration:** the per-node directory is named `raft-storage-<nodeName>` dynamically, which container runtimes and Kubernetes cannot mount as a volume (a wildcard like `raft-storage- is created as a literal directory, not expanded). Set arcadedb.ha.raftStorageDirectory to a *static` path (e.g. `/home/arcadedb/raft-storage`) and mount **that** path on durable storage before upgrading. On Kubernetes, back it with a `PersistentVolumeClaim` — see Kubernetes. On a plain filesystem you can instead copy the existing `raft-storage-<nodeName>` directory across the upgrade. A throwaway or test cluster that intentionally wants ephemeral behavior can opt out with `arcadedb.ha.raftPersistStorage=false`.

### 8.8.16. Committed-remotely response contract

When a write is forwarded from a replica to the leader (or issued directly to the leader), it is

possible for the transaction to be **committed cluster-wide by quorum** and then fail to apply on the node that is answering the client. This is a distinct outcome from an ordinary failure: the data is durably committed, so retrying would create a duplicate.

This case has its own contract. The server raises a `TransactionCommittedRemotelyException`, mapped over HTTP to **status `409 Conflict`**. A client that receives it must **not** retry the transaction — the write already succeeded cluster-wide; it should instead re-read to observe the committed state. This is different from a transient conflict (a genuine write-write conflict or `DeadlockException`), which remains safe to retry.

### 8.8.17. Running statements on a cluster

Each server keeps its own list of running statements: the HTTP `list queries` and `terminate query` server commands and Cypher `SHOW TRANSACTIONS` and `TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS` run on the server that receives them, a replica included, and are never forwarded to the leader. A statement id names a statement on the server that issued it.

Since v26.11.1 a write that a replica forwards to the leader can be followed and stopped from either side:

- On the replica it is listed with `forwardedTo`, the name of the leader running it.
- On the leader it is listed with `forwardedFrom`, the id it has on the replica, and with the tag the client sent (`X-ArcadeDB-Query-Tag`), so `list queries tag <label>` finds it on the leader too.
- `terminate query <replica id>` sent to the replica stops the work on the leader as well, and the client receives the termination error of its protocol.
- `terminate query <replica id>` sent to the leader finds the statement by the replica's id too.

The forward carries the statement's id under the cluster token, which an HA cluster always has configured (see Security). The usual visibility rule applies on both servers: **root** sees and stops every statement, any other user only their own.

### 8.8.18. Offline Cluster Bootstrap

By default, when an HA cluster forms for the **first time** and one or more peers already hold a non-empty database on local disk, the peers do **not** download the database over HTTP from a single source. Instead, every peer reports a `(fingerprint, lastTxId)` tuple per database, the cluster elects the peer with the highest `lastTxId` as the source via leadership transfer, and any peer whose fingerprint matches the source bootstraps locally in seconds with zero bytes transferred.

This is the recommended path for scaling a single-instance ArcadeDB deployment up to a multi-node HA cluster after a large dataset has already been imported. Operator workflow:

1. Import the dataset into a single ArcadeDB instance with HA disabled.
2. Tar the database directory, or take a regular full backup.
3. Distribute the archive out-of-band to every peer's filesystem (init container from S3, NFS read-only mount, baked image layer, `kubectl cp`).
4. Start every peer with HA enabled (`arcadedb.ha.enabled=true`) and the usual

`arcadedb.ha.serverList`. No special flag is required; the bootstrap path is on by default via `arcadedb.ha.bootstrapFromLocalDatabase=true`.

5. The peers form the Raft group with everyone already at the same state.

Time-to-cluster goes from "minutes-to-hours of HTTP snapshot transfer per replica" to "seconds, because everyone already has the bytes". For the Kubernetes recipe, see Pre-staging the database on every pod.

The bootstrap protocol handles the following cases automatically:

- **Identical pre-staged databases**: every peer's fingerprint matches the elected source, all peers bootstrap locally with zero bytes transferred.
- **Different-age peers**: the peer with the highest `lastTxId` is elected as the source. Older peers reinstall the leader-shipped full snapshot; subsequent transactions are picked up by native Raft replication.
- **Late newer joiner**: a peer with a strictly newer `lastTxId` than the cluster's chosen baseline refuses to start and logs a SEVERE with the recovery procedure. This prevents a misconfigured rolling deploy from silently overwriting newer data with older data.
- **Cluster restart**: the bootstrap path is gated on every peer's Raft log being empty. After the cluster has committed at least one Raft entry, restarts use the regular Raft log replay or leader-shipped snapshot path; the bootstrap path does not engage, and stale local data on a single pod cannot cause divergence.
- **Databases created while the cluster forms**: an application that creates and seeds its databases right after the first leader election is not baselined against them. The peer that sourced the baseline is never refused for its own copy advancing past the sampled `lastTxId`, and a baseline committed for a database that already has Raft history on a node is ignored on every node alike, because replication - not bootstrap - keeps those copies in step. *(Since v26.9.1: before, the election could sample a database the leader had just created and then refuse the leader's own copy as "fresher", and the cluster never converged.)*

While the cluster is deciding which copy to keep, **every** node - the leader included - answers `503` on `/api/v1/ready` and refuses client requests on the databases being decided, then serves normally as soon as the decision is applied. This usually takes seconds; if a peer is unreachable it can last up to `arcadedb.ha.bootstrapTimeoutMs`. *(Since v26.10.1 the leader is held too: before, it served its own copy while collecting, and a write accepted there could stop the cluster from ever agreeing on a baseline.)*

The committed bootstrap baseline (`fingerprint` and `lastTxId` per database) is visible in the response to `GET /api/v1/cluster` and in the Studio cluster dashboard.

### 8.8.19. When a node has stopped for good

Most problems a node reports are temporary: it is catching up, or downloading a snapshot, and it rejoins on its own. Two are not, and since v26.10.1 `GET /api/v1/cluster` says so directly:

- `criticalHalt` - a replicated change could not be applied, so this node has stopped applying changes altogether. Its databases are frozen at that point and stay there until the node is restarted. If the reason mentions an unknown entry type, a newer node is writing a format this

one cannot read: upgrade this node first, or it stops again at the same place.

- `raftLogFailure` - the node cannot write to its replication log, almost always a full or read-only disk. It recovers by itself once there is room again.

Both are `null` on a healthy node, and both raise a matching entry in `alerts`. A third field, `crashLoopEscalated`, is `true` once the node has given up restarting itself and needs to be restarted by hand.

`alerts` also distinguishes two situations that used to look the same. `bootstrap-diverged-databases` means this node **kept** a copy that the cluster never adopted - the data is here and intact. `bootstrap-database-missing` means the opposite: this node is **missing** a database the cluster has. Do not copy a node's database directory to the other nodes when it is the one missing the database; run `POST /api/v1/cluster/resync/{database}` on it instead, transferring leadership first if that node is the leader.

The full text of the error behind `criticalHalt` and `raftLogFailure` is shown to the `root` user only. Other users see the condition, the position and the time, which is what a monitoring rule needs.

A node in either state answers `503` on `/api/v1/ready`, so Kubernetes takes it out of the Service. *(Since v26.10.1 this no longer depends on `arcadedb.server.readinessRequiresHA`: a node whose replication has stopped is never ready, whatever that setting says.)*

### 8.8.20. Cluster Management REST API

Cluster membership and leadership can be changed at runtime through dedicated REST endpoints. All endpoints require authentication as the `root` user.

| Method | Path | Description |
| --- | --- | --- |
| GET | `/api/v1/cluster` | Return the current cluster status: current leader, peers and their roles, current term, commit and applied indices, per-follower replication lag, and the `alerts` array. Every peer carries `inConfiguration`: `true` for a member of the live Raft configuration, `false` for a peer that `arcadedb.ha.serverList` declares but the cluster no longer contains (removed with `DELETE /api/v1/cluster/peer/{peerId}`, or dropped by a build predating v26.9.1 while it was down). Such a peer has `role` `NOT_IN_CONFIGURATION` instead of `FOLLOWER`, and the divergence raises the `peers-not-in-configuration` alert (`critical` when the missing peer is the node answering, `warning` otherwise); a member added at runtime but absent from the server list raises the informational `peers-not-in-server-list` alert. Two peer ids on one Raft address raise the `peers-share-address` warning: only one process answers there but both ids vote, so remove the extra id with `DELETE /api/v1/cluster/peer/{peerId}`. *(Since v26.10.1: two concurrent add-peer requests for one address under different ids could both commit; the add now refuses the second.) (Since v26.9.1: previously every declared peer was reported as a healthy* `FOLLOWER` *regardless of the live configuration.)* |

| Method | Path | Description |
|---|---|---|
| POST | `/api/v1/cluster/peer` | Add a peer to the running cluster. Body: `{"peerId":"<id>","address":"host:raftPort:httpPort","name":"<friendlyName>","priority":0}`. The optional `name` is the human-readable display name shown in logs and Studio. The optional `priority` (non-negative integer, default `0`) sets the new peer's leader-election priority the same way a `priority` in `arcadedb.ha.serverList` does - use `0` for a witness that must never become leader, a higher value for a preferred one. The new peer is seeded with the current user list so authentication works immediately. This call adds the named peer to **this** server's cluster; it does not make this server join another one, and an address that resolves to this server is refused with `400`. *(Since v26.10.1: `priority` can be set here too, and adding this server's own address is refused instead of silently doing nothing.)* A peer that cannot join - it answers a connection but never catches up - is reported after `arcadedb.ha.membershipChangeTimeout` at the latest, and a peer that turns out to belong to a **different** cluster is refused at once, naming `arcadedb.ha.clusterName` as the thing to check. *(Since v26.10.1: the call could run about half a minute past the budget.)* |
| DELETE | `/api/v1/cluster/peer/{peerId}` | Remove a peer from the cluster. The removed node also loses its access to the Raft port, including on Kubernetes, where the headless service keeps publishing a pod's address until the pod itself terminates. *(Since v26.10.1: on Kubernetes the peer was removed from the cluster but its address kept being admitted while its pod was running.)* |
| POST | `/api/v1/cluster/leader` | Transfer leadership. Body: `{"peerId":"<target>","timeoutMs":30000}`. If `peerId` is omitted, Raft picks a new leader automatically. Must be sent to the leader: any other server answers `409` and names the current leader. |
| POST | `/api/v1/cluster/stepdown` | Make the current leader step down. The cluster elects a new leader. Must be sent to the leader: any other server answers `409` and names the current leader. |
| POST | `/api/v1/cluster/leave` | Gracefully remove this server from the cluster. If the local server is the leader, leadership is transferred first. This endpoint is used by the Kubernetes `preStop` hook. |

| Method | Path | Description |
|---|---|---|
| POST | `/api/v1/cluster/verify/{database}` | Compare component file checksums for the given database across all peers. Useful to confirm that all nodes have converged. See Verify Outcomes for the values `overallStatus` can take. |
| GET | `/api/v1/ha/snapshot/{database}` | Leader-only: stream a ZIP of the database for follower catch-up. Requires the cluster token and is used internally by snapshot recovery. |
| POST | `/api/v1/cluster/security-seed` | Leader-only: replicate the cluster security documents to the calling node. Requires the cluster token and is called by peers, not by operators. The caller may send digests of the copies it already holds, in which case a node already in step is answered without anything being written. Any other server answers `409` and names the current leader. *(Since v26.10.1.)* See Cluster security documents. |

**Send leadership changes to the leader.** Since 26.10.1, `/api/v1/cluster/leader` and `/api/v1/cluster/stepdown` answer `409 Conflict` when the server receiving them is not the leader, and the message names the leader to retry against.

This matters if you call them through a Kubernetes Service or any load balancer, which spreads requests over every ready pod: previously such a request reached a follower, was routed on to the leader anyway, and caused an election you did not intend - while the follower replied `200 OK`.

Example: add a new peer at runtime.

```
$ curl -u root:<password> \
       -X POST http://leader:2480/api/v1/cluster/peer \
       -H 'Content-Type: application/json' \
       -d '{"peerId":"node4","address":"10.0.0.4:2434:2480"}'
```

Adding a peer with a human-readable name:

```
$ curl -u root:<password> \
       -X POST http://leader:2480/api/v1/cluster/peer \
       -H 'Content-Type: application/json' \
       -d
'{"peerId":"10.0.0.4_2434","address":"10.0.0.4:2434:2480","name":"frankfurt"}'
```

Adding a peer as a non-voting witness, which will never become leader:

```
$ curl -u root:<password> \
       -X POST http://leader:2480/api/v1/cluster/peer \
```

```
        -H 'Content-Type: application/json' \
        -d '{"peerId":"10.0.0.4_2434","address":"10.0.0.4:2434:2480","priority":0}'
```

### 8.8.21. Verify Outcomes

`POST /api/v1/cluster/verify/{database}` reports one `status` per peer and rolls them up into a single `result.overallStatus`:

| `overallStatus` | **Meaning** |
|---|---|
| `ALL_CONSISTENT` | Every peer was contacted and every peer's checksums match this node's. |
| `INCONSISTENCY_DETECTED` | At least one peer was contacted and its checksums differ - a divergence somebody has actually observed. |
| `VERIFICATION_INCOMPLETE` | No divergence was observed, but at least one peer could not be verified: it was unreachable, or its address does not identify it (see Peer-to-Peer Endpoints). Such a peer is reported with `status: ERROR` and an `error` naming what to fix. *(Since v26.9.1)* It is also reported when the TimeSeries sealed stores could not be fully compared - see below. *(Since v26.10.1)* |

`ALL_CONSISTENT` therefore means what it says: it is not reachable while any peer is unverified. An unverified peer is deliberately **not** rolled up as an observed divergence, which would send an operator hunting for something nobody saw.

Alerting that keys on `overallStatus != "ALL_CONSISTENT"` is unaffected by the third value. Alerting that keys on `overallStatus == "INCONSISTENCY_DETECTED"` must add `VERIFICATION_INCOMPLETE` to keep catching an unreachable or unidentifiable node.

#### TimeSeries Sealed Stores

*(Since v26.10.1)* The verify also compares the TimeSeries sealed stores (`.ts.sealed`), the files holding compacted historical samples. They were previously left out, which mattered because they are replicated by their own path rather than with the data pages: a node whose sealed store failed to install, or was repaired by hand, reported a perfect match while holding different history from the leader.

Two fields report how far that comparison got:

| **Field** | **Meaning** |
|---|---|
| `peers[].uncomparedSealedStores` | The peer runs a build older than 26.10.1 and does not report these files, so they were left out of the comparison with it. Present only during a rolling upgrade; the value is how many were skipped. |
| `result.incompleteSealedStores`, `peers[].incompleteSealedStores` | A sealed store could not be read, so that side's answer is short of one. The peer is not rolled up as agreeing, and `overallStatus` becomes `VERIFICATION_INCOMPLETE`. |

Both mean the same thing for alerting: a `CONSISTENT` that did not compare every sealed store is a

weaker statement than one that did, so neither is reported as `ALL_CONSISTENT`.

### 8.8.22. Studio Cluster Dashboard

ArcadeDB Studio exposes a **Cluster** tab (visible when HA is enabled) that displays the current leader, peer roles, Raft term and commit index, per-follower replication lag, and provides buttons for leadership transfer, peer add/remove, and database verification. See Studio.

### 8.8.23. Security

**Cluster token**

Inter-node HTTP forwarding (replica → leader proxy, snapshot downloads) is authenticated with a shared **cluster token** sent as the `X-ArcadeDB-Cluster-Token` HTTP header. If `arcadedb.ha.clusterToken` is not set explicitly, the token is derived deterministically from `arcadedb.ha.clusterName` and the `root` password via PBKDF2-HMAC-SHA256 — it is **not** persisted on disk. Every node that starts with the same cluster name and the same root password ends up with the same token automatically. Set `arcadedb.ha.clusterToken` (or `HA_CLUSTER_TOKEN`) explicitly when you need to rotate the token without changing the root password, or when each peer has a different root password. To keep the secret off the command line (and out of `ps` /`/proc/<pid>/cmdline`), set `arcadedb.ha.clusterTokenPath` to a file the server reads at startup, e.g. a Kubernetes Secret mounted on `tmpfs`. It is read only when `arcadedb.ha.clusterToken` is not set, and its content is trimmed of surrounding whitespace so a trailing newline does not break the token comparison between nodes.

**Peer allowlist**

Inbound Raft gRPC connections are filtered against the DNS-resolved hosts in `arcadedb.ha.serverList`; connections from other addresses are rejected. This closes the "any host that knows the port can inject log entries" vector. It is, however, IP-based, so a spoofed source address or a compromised peer defeats it. Treat it as a best-effort default rather than a substitute for TLS: on an untrusted network, enable mTLS on the Raft gRPC transport, which binds peer identity to a certificate instead of to an address.

On Kubernetes a pod's headless-service DNS record is only published once the pod is `Ready`, so peers routinely come up before each other's names resolve and the allowlist starts out incomplete. To avoid a self-inflicted partition during that window, the filter is hardened in three ways:

- **Fast convergence**: while the allowlist has never been complete, a connection from an unknown address re-resolves DNS on a short floor (~1s) instead of waiting the full `arcadedb.ha.grpcAllowlistRefreshMs` interval.
- **Sticky entries**: when a host that resolved before temporarily stops resolving (transient DNS outage, pod-IP churn mid-restart), its last-known-good IPs are retained for `arcadedb.ha.peerAllowlistStickyTtlMs` (default 5 min) rather than being evicted immediately.
- **Startup fail-open grace**: until every peer host has resolved at least once, and for at most `arcadedb.ha.peerAllowlistStartupGraceMs` (default 60s) from startup, an unmatched address is accepted with a warning instead of rejected. Once the peer set has fully resolved once, or the window elapses, the filter enforces strictly and does not fail open again.

For a security-strict deployment that should reject from the very first connection, set `arcadedb.ha.peerAllowlistStartupGraceMs=0`. If you previously saw `Rejecting Raft gRPC connection from non-peer address` storms with peers failing to form a cluster on startup, this hardening removes that failure mode.

**Cluster security documents**

The server users, groups and API tokens are held in `server-users.jsonl`, `server-groups.json` and `server-api-tokens.json`, in the server's `config/` directory. They live outside the databases, so a database snapshot does not carry them: they are replicated to the other nodes as their own Raft entries.

A node is seeded with the current set when it is admitted to the cluster, and, since v26.10.1, also re-seeds itself when it rejoins one it never left. That second case is the one that used to bite on Kubernetes: a pod whose data volume is persistent but whose `config/` directory is not comes back as an existing cluster member, so it is never re-admitted, and before v26.10.1 it was never re-seeded either. It came back holding only the users created from its own environment at bootstrap, and rejected logins that worked on every other node. A node now asks the leader for the current documents shortly after it first sees one, and again after it receives a snapshot, sending digests of the copies it already holds so that a node already in step costs one HTTP request and no Raft entries.

*(Since v26.10.1: a rare internal scheduling hiccup while queuing that request could silently drop it, leaving the node believing it had already asked when it never had, so it would not try again on its own until it saw another leader change or snapshot. This is now fixed, and the request is retried instead of dropped.)*

With `arcadedb.server.readinessRequiresHA` on, a node that joined at runtime or was caught up by a snapshot is held NOT READY until its documents converge, for at most `arcadedb.ha.securityConvergenceReadinessTimeout` (30 s by default), so a load balancer does not route logins to it while it still enforces stale credentials. See security-convergence readiness.

A node that is already leading the cluster by the time its catch-up runs has no peer to ask, so its own copy becomes the cluster's reference. It says so once, at `INFO`, starting with `This node leads the cluster by the time its security catch-up ran`. If that node's `config/` directory was restored out of band, re-apply the security changes made while it was away.

## 8.8.24. TLS/SSL for peer-to-peer transfers

This section covers the **HTTP side channels** only — every node-to-node call that is not Raft itself. It does not encrypt the Raft gRPC port, which carries AppendEntries, RequestVote and the Ratis admin/client calls. That is a separate axis, configured with `arcadedb.ha.tls.*`; see mTLS for the Raft gRPC transport. Enabling one does nothing for the other.

When `arcadedb.ssl.enabled=true`, the server binds an HTTPS listener on `arcadedb.server.httpsIncomingPort` (default `2490`) **in addition to** the plain HTTP listener on `arcadedb.server.httpIncomingPort` (default `2480`). The two listeners use different ports.

The side channels covered here are the snapshot download, the cross-node verify, the follower-to-leader command forward, the peer capability and auth-session probes, the stalled-replica resync, the bootstrap-state probe, the security-document seed and the remote shutdown command. Every one of them carries the cluster token, so on a cluster with `arcadedb.ssl.enabled` they should all travel encrypted. To send them encrypted, declare each peer's HTTPS port in `arcadedb.ha.serverList` using the `https` field (object form) or the fifth positional field:

```
$ bin/server.sh -Darcadedb.ha.enabled=true \
                -Darcadedb.ssl.enabled=true \
                -Darcadedb.ssl.keyStore=/etc/arcadedb/keystore.p12 \
                -Darcadedb.ssl.keyStorePassword=... \
                -Darcadedb.ssl.trustStore=/etc/arcadedb/truststore.jks \
                -Darcadedb.ssl.trustStorePassword=... \
                -Darcadedb.ha.serverList=db1:{raft:2434,http:2480,https:2490},db2:
{raft:2434,http:2480,https:2490},db3:{raft:2434,http:2480,https:2490}
```

The peer certificate is validated against the configured **trust store** (`arcadedb.ssl.trustStore`), and its name is verified against the name the peer was dialled by.

The HTTPS listener is configured with a single keystore (`arcadedb.ssl.keyStore`), so it serves **one** identity, and the name a dial advertises in SNI selects nothing: every name is answered with the same certificate. The name a peer is dialled by is the one in `arcadedb.ha.serverList`, or the peer's Raft host when the entry omits an explicit endpoint. So every name any node can be reached by has to be a subject alternative name of that one certificate. On Kubernetes that usually means listing the pod's DNS name, the headless-service name and, if you declare peers by address, the pod IP. A name that is missing fails the handshake at the first peer-to-peer call rather than at startup.

If the `https` port is omitted on a homogeneous cluster (every node listens on the same HTTPS port, e.g. a Kubernetes StatefulSet), each peer's HTTPS endpoint is derived automatically from the peer host plus this node's local HTTPS port, so no extra configuration is needed. Only when no HTTPS endpoint can be resolved does the transfer fall back to plain HTTP. The plain listener is the one that is always bound, so falling back keeps a cluster that never declared its `https` ports able to bootstrap, resync and be administered — but it does put the cluster token on the wire in clear text, so it is announced once per JVM:

```
WARNING: SSL is enabled but no HTTPS address is known for a peer; probing its
bootstrap-state over plain HTTP,
which puts the cluster token on the wire in clear text. Declare each node's 'https'
port in
arcadedb.ha.serverList to avoid it.
```

One such line is logged per JVM for the whole family of side channels, naming whichever happened to fall back first; the remedy is the same for all of them. Seeing it on a cluster you believe is encrypted end to end means at least one peer has no resolvable HTTPS endpoint — check that the `https` field is declared for every entry, and see Peer-to-Peer Endpoints for the case where it is

declared but shared between two nodes.

Declaring an HTTPS port that points at the plain HTTP port (e.g. `https:2480`) causes a TLS handshake failure (`Unsupported or unrecognized SSL message`). Always point `https` at the HTTPS listener's port.

### 8.8.25. mTLS for the Raft gRPC transport (from v26.9.1)

The previous section covers the HTTP side channels. This one covers the **Raft gRPC port** (`arcadedb.ha.raftPort`, default `2434`), which carries AppendEntries, RequestVote, InstallSnapshot and the Ratis admin/client calls.

The two are independent axes. `arcadedb.ssl.*` does nothing for the gRPC port, and `arcadedb.ha.tls.*` does nothing for the HTTP listeners; a hardened cluster wants both. Nor does gRPC TLS replace the `X-ArcadeDB-Cluster-Token` check described in Security — that check still authenticates the HTTP forwarding and snapshot-download traffic.

TLS on the Raft port is **off by default**, so a development or test cluster still starts with no configuration at all. Turn it on with four settings:

```
$ bin/server.sh -Darcadedb.ha.enabled=true \
                -Darcadedb.ha.tls.enabled=true \
                -Darcadedb.ha.tls.certChainFile=/etc/arcadedb/tls/tls.crt \
                -Darcadedb.ha.tls.privateKeyFile=/etc/arcadedb/tls/tls.key \
                -Darcadedb.ha.tls.trustCertCollectionFile=/etc/arcadedb/tls/ca.crt \
                -Darcadedb.ha.serverList=db1:2434:2480,db2:2434:2480,db3:2434:2480
```

One setting covers all three gRPC endpoints (admin, client, and server-to-server), so there is nothing further to switch on per message type. Mutual authentication is on by default; see Server-only TLS to relax it.

When `arcadedb.ha.tls.enabled=true`, all three file settings must name a readable PEM file or **the node refuses to start**, with a `ConfigurationException` naming the offending setting:

```
arcadedb.ha.tls.certChainFile must be set when arcadedb.ha.tls.enabled is true
arcadedb.ha.tls.privateKeyFile (/etc/arcadedb/tls/tls.key) is not a readable file:
Raft gRPC TLS cannot be initialized
```

The paths are validated at startup rather than left to the TLS layer, so a typo or an unmounted Secret volume fails once and clearly, instead of surfacing later as an opaque handshake error on every peer connection.

The private key must be **PKCS#8** — the PEM whose armor labels it simply `PRIVATE KEY`. A PKCS#1 key, which the armor labels `RSA PRIVATE KEY` instead and which several toolchains emit by default, is not accepted. Convert one with `openssl pkcs8 -topk8 -nocrypt`.

### What the certificate has to look like

The startup checks confirm the three files are **readable**. They cannot confirm the certificate is the right **kind** of certificate. Both mistakes below produce a TLS handshake failure at the first peer connection, not a startup error, so they are worth getting right up front.

#### Both the `serverAuth` and `clientAuth` extended key usages

Every node both accepts and initiates Raft connections. With `arcadedb.ha.tls.mutualAuth=true` (the default), the certificate in `certChainFile` is presented as the TLS **server** certificate to peers that dial in **and** as the **client** certificate when this node dials out — one certificate, two roles. A CA configured to issue single-purpose certificates therefore produces a file that is perfectly readable and simply the wrong kind. Ask for both EKUs explicitly; do not assume the issuer's default profile includes them.

#### A subject alternative name matching the address peers dial

The SAN must match the host as it appears in the other nodes' `arcadedb.ha.serverList`, not whatever the node calls itself locally. On Kubernetes that is the pod's stable headless-service DNS name (`my-arcadedb-0.my-arcadedb.arcadedb.svc.cluster.local`), never the pod IP, which changes on every restart.

`certChainFile` holds this node's certificate followed by any intermediate CA certificates, in that order. `trustCertCollectionFile` holds the cluster CA certificate(s) that sign every node certificate: a peer presenting a certificate that does not chain to this collection is rejected during the handshake, before any Raft message is read.

### Server-only TLS

Setting `arcadedb.ha.tls.mutualAuth=false` encrypts the traffic but stops requiring a client certificate from peers that dial in. That leaves the Raft port open to any client that trusts the cluster CA, which is the back door mutual authentication exists to close, so the server logs a `WARNING` at startup:

```
Raft gRPC TLS is enabled with arcadedb.ha.tls.mutualAuth=false: the transport is
encrypted but the
dialling peer is NOT authenticated, so any client trusting the cluster CA can still
open a Raft stream
```

Turning mutual authentication off does **not** make `arcadedb.ha.tls.trustCertCollectionFile` optional. It only governs what this node demands of peers dialing **in**; when this node dials **out** it still needs the cluster CA to validate the certificate the other node presents. All three file settings stay mandatory whenever `arcadedb.ha.tls.enabled=true`.

### Private key permissions

The server logs a `WARNING` when the private key file is readable by the group or by others, because any local account that can read it can present this node's identity to the cluster:

```
The Raft gRPC private key arcadedb.ha.tls.privateKeyFile (/etc/arcadedb/tls/tls.key)
is readable
beyond its owner: any local account that can read it can present this node's identity
to the
cluster. Restrict it to owner-only (chmod 600)
```

It is deliberately a warning and not a refusal: a container image or a mounted Secret may arrive with permissions the node cannot change, and refusing to start would be the worse outcome. The check is a no-op on filesystems with no POSIX permission view.

#### Issuing a cluster CA and node certificates with openssl

For a fixed-size cluster outside Kubernetes, one self-signed CA plus one certificate per node is enough. Create the CA once, on a host that is not a cluster node:

```
$ openssl req -x509 -newkey rsa:4096 -sha256 -days 3650 -nodes \
      -keyout cluster-ca.pem -out ca.crt \
      -subj "/CN=arcadedb-cluster-ca"
```

Then, for each node (`db1` here), generate a key and a certificate signing request:

```
$ openssl req -newkey rsa:2048 -nodes \
      -keyout db1-pkcs1.pem -out db1.csr \
      -subj "/CN=db1"
```

Sign it with an extension file that carries **both** EKUs and the SAN peers will dial. This file is the part that is easy to get wrong:

*db1.ext*

```
basicConstraints = critical,CA:FALSE
keyUsage         = critical,digitalSignature,keyEncipherment
extendedKeyUsage = serverAuth,clientAuth
subjectAltName   = DNS:db1,DNS:db1.internal.example.com
```

```
$ openssl x509 -req -in db1.csr -CA ca.crt -CAkey cluster-ca.pem -CAcreateserial \
      -days 365 -sha256 -extfile db1.ext -out db1.crt
```

Finally, convert the key to PKCS#8 and lock it down:

```
$ openssl pkcs8 -topk8 -nocrypt -in db1-pkcs1.pem -out db1-key.pem
$ chmod 600 db1-key.pem
```

Node `db1` is then configured with `certChainFile=db1.crt`, `privateKeyFile=db1-key.pem` and

`trustCertCollectionFile=ca.crt`. Every node in the cluster gets the same `ca.crt` and its own certificate and key.

Confirm a certificate before rolling it out — the two lines that matter are the SAN and the EKU:

```
$ openssl x509 -in db1.crt -noout -ext subjectAltName,extendedKeyUsage
$ openssl verify -CAfile ca.crt db1.crt
```

#### Issuing certificates with cert-manager

On Kubernetes, cert-manager is the natural issuer: it writes a `Secret` with exactly the three files these settings need (`tls.crt`, `tls.key`, `ca.crt`) and renews it automatically.

Start from a CA `Issuer` backed by a self-signed root, or by your existing PKI:

```
apiVersion: cert-manager.io/v1
kind: Issuer
metadata:
  name: arcadedb-cluster-ca
  namespace: arcadedb
spec:
  ca:
    secretName: arcadedb-cluster-ca-tls
```

Then one `Certificate` per pod, named for the pod's headless-service DNS record:

```
apiVersion: cert-manager.io/v1
kind: Certificate
metadata:
  name: arcadedb-raft-0
  namespace: arcadedb
spec:
  secretName: arcadedb-raft-0-tls
  duration: 2160h    # 90 days
  renewBefore: 360h  # 15 days
  privateKey:
    algorithm: RSA
    size: 2048
    encoding: PKCS8           # cert-manager defaults to PKCS1, which is not accepted
  usages:
    - server auth             # both are required: every node dials and is dialled
    - client auth
    - digital signature
    - key encipherment
  dnsNames:
    - my-arcadedb-0.my-arcadedb.arcadedb.svc.cluster.local
  issuerRef:
    name: arcadedb-cluster-ca
```

```
    kind: Issuer
```

`privateKey.encoding` must be set to `PKCS8` explicitly. cert-manager's default is `PKCS1`, which the Raft transport does not parse.

Two `usages` entries do the work of the `extendedKeyUsage` line in the openssl recipe: `server auth` and `client auth`. Omitting either one is the single-purpose-certificate mistake, and it will only show up as a handshake failure between two running nodes.

Per-pod `Certificate` objects give each node its own identity, which is what makes a compromised node's certificate revocable on its own. The shortcut of one shared `Certificate` listing every pod's DNS name works, and is simpler for a fixed-size cluster, but every node then holds an identity valid for every other node.

With HashiCorp Vault as the issuer instead, the equivalent of the two EKUs is a PKI role created with both flags set:

```
$ vault write pki/roles/arcadedb-raft \
      allowed_domains="my-arcadedb.arcadedb.svc.cluster.local" \
      allow_subdomains=true \
      server_flag=true \
      client_flag=true \
      key_type=rsa key_bits=2048 \
      max_ttl=2160h
```

#### Mounting the Secret

Mount the certificate `Secret` read-only and point the three settings at the mount path. Using the Helm chart, append to `volumes` and `volumeMounts`, and set the values via `arcadedb.extraCommands`:

```
volumes:
  - name: raft-tls
    secret:
      secretName: arcadedb-raft-0-tls
      defaultMode: 0400
volumeMounts:
  - name: raft-tls
    mountPath: /etc/arcadedb/tls
    readOnly: true

arcadedb:
  extraCommands:
    - -Darcadedb.ha.tls.enabled=true
    - -Darcadedb.ha.tls.certChainFile=/etc/arcadedb/tls/tls.crt
    - -Darcadedb.ha.tls.privateKeyFile=/etc/arcadedb/tls/tls.key
    - -Darcadedb.ha.tls.trustCertCollectionFile=/etc/arcadedb/tls/ca.crt
```

`defaultMode: 0400` keeps the private-key permission warning quiet. This is the same pattern as `arcadedb.ha.clusterTokenPath` in Security: the secret stays off the command line and out of `ps`.

Because each pod needs the certificate issued for **its own** DNS name, a per-pod `Secret` cannot be mounted from a single chart-wide value. Either render one `StatefulSet`-per-replica, or use cert-manager's csi-driver, which issues a short-lived certificate into an ephemeral volume at pod start and needs no `Secret` at all.

No extra configuration is needed for Kubernetes auto-join: the join probe is built from the same transport parameters as the local server, so it speaks TLS exactly when the cluster does. See High Availability on Kubernetes.

#### Known limitations

**No certificate rotation without a restart**

The PEM files are read once, when the Raft transport is built. Renewing a certificate — including a cert-manager renewal that rewrites the mounted `Secret` in place — takes effect only after the node is restarted. Roll the nodes one at a time and wait for each to rejoin, so the cluster keeps its quorum throughout. Choose a `duration` that makes the restart cadence acceptable.

**No KMS integration**

The private key is read from a file on disk. There is no HSM, PKCS#11 or cloud-KMS path; protecting the key is the deployment's responsibility (owner-only permissions, a `tmpfs`-backed mount, or a csi-driver volume that never touches durable storage).

### 8.8.26. Kubernetes

For Kubernetes deployments using the official Helm chart — including the `StatefulSet` + headless `Service` pattern, auto-join on scale-up, and the `preStop` auto-leave hook — see High Availability on Kubernetes in the Kubernetes guide.

### 8.8.27. Troubleshooting

#### Performance: insertion is slow

ArcadeDB uses an optimistic concurrency model: if two threads try to update the same page, the first wins, the second throws a `ConcurrentModificationException` and the client retries (configurable number of times). In HA mode the retry window is wider because file locks are held during the Raft round-trip, and the same rule applies across nodes: two nodes writing the same page concurrently are ordered by the leader, and the second one is refused with the same retryable error.

If you are inserting many records in parallel, allocate one bucket per thread to eliminate contention. Example for the vertex type `User`:

```
ALTER TYPE User BucketSelectionStrategy `thread`
```

With enough buckets, parallel insertions avoid page contention entirely and do not hit the retry path.

#### A database is missing after a restart, and the log names `.snapshot-pending`

A follower that is killed while it is installing a snapshot from the leader — a liveness-probe kill, an OOM kill, a node drain — leaves `databases/<name>/` holding a mix of the previous database and the incoming one. It is neither, and opening it would register and serve that mix. The installer marks the directory with a `.snapshot-pending` file before it touches a single byte and removes the file only once the installed copy has been reopened successfully, so the marker's presence is the node's own record that the install did not finish.

While that marker exists, the database is **not opened by anything**: not the startup scan, not the default-database configuration (`arcadedb.server.defaultDatabases`), and not a client request naming it. A request for it is answered with `Database '<name>' is not available: an interrupted HA snapshot install left '.snapshot-pending' in its directory`. The refusal lasts as long as the marker does — it is a statement about the directory, not about a phase of startup. *(Since v26.10.1)*

The node still starts. HA snapshot recovery runs during startup and either completes the interrupted swap (the download had finished) or rolls it back to the previous copy (it had not); either way it removes the marker, and the database is opened before the server reports itself online. In the normal case the only trace is one INFO line naming the deferred database.

This includes a swap interrupted by a release older than v26.10.1, which recorded no phase: recovery works out from the files whether the new copy was already going in (it finishes the install) or the old copy was still being moved aside (it restores the old database). In the rare case a file of the incoming copy has to be set aside to let the old database open, it is moved to `databases/<name>/.snapshot-orphans/` and a WARNING names it; it is safe to delete once the database is verified. *(Since v26.10.1)*

The marker survives startup in two cases:

- **The node is not running HA** — `arcadedb.ha.enabled=false`, or the `arcadedb-ha-raft` module is absent from an embedded deployment. Nothing runs the recovery pass, so nothing reconciles the directory.
- **Recovery ran and deliberately declined to act.** When there is neither a completed download nor a backup to restore from, and the directory does not hold a loadable schema, recovery leaves it and the marker untouched for inspection rather than blessing an incomplete directory as a healthy database.

Both are reported at SEVERE, naming the database:

```
Database '<name>' was NOT opened: snapshot recovery did not clear its '.snapshot-
pending' marker,
so its directory is still neither the previous database nor the installed snapshot.
```

To resolve it, let the cluster replace the copy: on a follower joined to a healthy cluster, `POST /api/v1/cluster/resync/{database}` reinstalls the database from the leader, reconciling the interrupted install before it downloads anything. It works on a deferred database — the resync never needs to open the local copy first. If the node cannot reach a leader, or it is running standalone, the directory has to be dealt with on the volume: `databases/<name>/.snapshot-backup/`

holds the previous copy when one was taken, and removing `databases/<name>/` entirely lets the node re-acquire the database from the leader on the next reconcile. Inspect before deleting — when no backup was taken, that directory is the only copy the node has.

*(Since v26.10.1.)* Deleting `databases/<name>/` and restarting now reliably brings the database back on a node that had it before. Earlier versions could restart without it: the node kept a record, stored next to the database directories rather than inside them, saying the database had already been checked, so deleting the directory left that record behind and the node concluded there was nothing to do. It logged that the check had completed and carried on without the database.

A node that cannot complete the reinstall — no leader reachable yet, for example — now reports the database in `GET /api/v1/cluster` and retries periodically until it succeeds, instead of running short of it silently.

#### Writes on a replica fail with a retry error during a schema change

While the leader runs a schema change (for example `CREATE INDEX` on a large type), or drops or reinstalls a database, it refuses write transactions that other nodes send for that database with a retryable error, and accepts them again as soon as the operation ends. Retry the write; a long index build means retries for as long as it runs. *(Since v26.10.1: those writes were previously accepted and could be applied inconsistently around the schema change.)*

A write on a replica is also refused with a retryable error when its transaction began before the replica had applied a schema change the leader has already applied (for example a new index), so that it cannot leave a record out of that index. The retry waits for the schema change to be applied locally and then succeeds. Callers that do not retry see a `ConcurrentModificationException` during DDL bursts; set transaction retries accordingly. One peer that is older, not yet probed or offline turns this protection off for every writer, and it is best-effort across a leader restart. Set `arcadedb.ha.txSchemaCheck=false` on the writing nodes to switch it off. *(Since v26.10.1.)*

#### Verbose HA logging

Enable detailed HA logging for diagnostics via `arcadedb.ha.logVerbose`:

- `0` — off (default).
- `1` — basic: elections, leader changes, peer membership.
- `2` — detailed: commands, WAL replication, schema.
- `3` — trace: every state machine apply.

#### Ratis warning: snapshot "has missing MD5 file"

Versions before 26.10.1 log this WARNING on every checkpoint and every restart, more often the longer a node runs:

```
Snapshot file SingleFileSnapshotInfo(t:1, i:7293):[.../sm/snapshot.1_7293] has missing
MD5 file.
```

It never meant corruption. ArcadeDB's real snapshot is the set of database files the transaction manager has already flushed to disk. The file Ratis inspects is a zero-byte marker whose name carries the `(term, index)` pair used to decide which Raft log segments can be purged, and it deliberately has no `.md5` companion. Since 26.10.1 the warning is filtered out (see Per-package verbosity); other messages from the same Ratis logger are still logged.

### 8.8.28. HA Settings

The following settings control HA behavior. A complete list of all HA parameters is available in Server Settings.

| Setting | Description | Default Value |
|---|---|---|
| `arcadedb.ha.enabled` | Enables HA for this server | false |
| `arcadedb.ha.clusterName` | Cluster name. Useful when running multiple clusters in the same network | arcadedb |
| `arcadedb.ha.serverList` | Comma-separated list of peers. Each entry uses the readable object form `[name@]host:{raft:2434,http:2480,https:2490,priority:10}` (recommended) or the positional form `[name@]host:raftPort:httpPort[:priority[:httpsPort]]`; see Server List Entry Format. The optional `name@` prefix gives the peer a human-readable name used in logs and Studio; see Named Peers. The optional priority (integer, default 0) prefers higher-valued nodes during elections. The optional `https` port encrypts peer-to-peer transfers when `arcadedb.ssl.enabled=true`; see TLS/SSL. Example: `frankfurt@db1:{raft:2434,http:2480,https:2490,priority:10},london@db2:{raft:2434,http:2480,https:2490}` | (empty) |

| Setting | Description | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- |
| `arcadedb.ha.txSchemaCheck` | Replicated transactions state the Raft index their node had applied when they began, so the leader refuses (retryably) a replica transaction prepared before a schema change it already applied. See the Troubleshooting section | true |
| `arcadedb.ha.raftPort` | Default Raft gRPC port used when an entry in `serverList` does not specify one | 2434 |
| `arcadedb.ha.quorum` | Write quorum: `majority` or `all` | majority |
| `arcadedb.ha.quorumTimeout` | Timeout in ms waiting for the quorum acknowledgment | 10000 |
| `arcadedb.ha.schemaDelta` | Ship schema changes as a delta instead of the whole schema document, once every peer has confirmed it can decode one. See Schema Delta Replication (from v26.10.1) | true |
| `arcadedb.ha.schemaIncrementalApply` | Followers apply a DDL entry by creating only the components for the files it added, instead of rebuilding all of them. See Schema Replication | true |
| `arcadedb.ha.readConsistency` | Default read consistency for follower reads: `eventual`, `read_your_writes`, `linearizable` | read_your_writes |
| `arcadedb.ha.electionTimeoutMin` / `arcadedb.ha.electionTimeoutMax` | Minimum and maximum Raft election timeout in ms. Increase for WAN clusters | 2000 / 5000 |
| `arcadedb.ha.serverRole` | Node role: `any` (default) or `replica` (pinned follower, never elected leader) | any |
| `arcadedb.ha.snapshotThreshold` | Number of Raft log entries after which the leader takes a snapshot | 100000 |

| Setting | Description | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- |
| `arcadedb.ha.bootstrapFromLocalDatabase` | When `true` (default), at first cluster formation peers exchange `(fingerprint, lastTxId)` per database and the highest-`lastTxId` peer is elected as the bootstrap source. See Offline Cluster Bootstrap. | true |
| `arcadedb.ha.bootstrapTimeoutMs` | Maximum time in ms the bootstrap leader waits for every peer in `serverList` to report its bootstrap state before proceeding. | 120000 |
| `arcadedb.ha.groupCommitQueueSize` / `arcadedb.ha.groupCommitOfferTimeout` | Bounded queue size and offer timeout (ms) for Raft group-commit backpressure | 10000 / 100 |
| `arcadedb.ha.raftPersistStorage` | If true, the Raft storage directory is preserved across restarts, enabling rejoin by replaying the persisted log instead of a full snapshot resync. **Defaults to `true`**; ensure `raftStorageDirectory` lives on durable storage. See Durable Raft Storage | true |
| `arcadedb.ha.raftStorageDirectory` | Parent directory for the per-node `raft-storage-<nodeName>` sub-folder. Empty (default) uses the server root path. With durable storage enabled by default, point this at a persistent volume. See Durable Raft Storage | (empty) |
| `arcadedb.ha.peerUnreachableThreshold` | Time in ms since the last successful RPC to a follower before the leader reports it as unreachable. Diagnostic only — it does not change membership or quorum — but it is the signal the channel reset below depends on. 0 disables it, and with it the whole self-healing sequence. See Replication-Channel Self-Healing | 10000 |

| Setting | Description | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- |
| `arcadedb.ha.peerChannelResetDuration` | Time in ms a follower must stay continuously unreachable before the leader resets that one follower's replication channel, forcing a fresh DNS resolution and reconnect. Retried once per interval, up to 5 attempts. 0 disables. See Replication-Channel Self-Healing | 60000 |
| `arcadedb.ha.peerChannelResetEscalation` | When the reset retry budget is exhausted and the channel is still dead, transfer leadership to a healthy peer so the new leader builds a fresh appender to that follower. Bounded by a 30-minute per-follower cooldown on each peer. `false` logs only. See Replication-Channel Self-Healing | true |
| `arcadedb.ha.stalledReplicaResyncDurationMs` | How long in ms a replica must stay STALLED (its `matchIndex` not advancing while the leader commits) before the leader forces it to resync. A follower still at `matchIndex=-1` counts as STALLED regardless of the numeric lag. 0 disables leader-driven recovery; the condition is still logged | 60000 |
| `arcadedb.ha.stopServerOnReplicationFailure` | If true, the JVM exits after exhausting step-down retries on a phase-2 replication failure. Default false keeps the server up and logs CRITICAL | false |
| `arcadedb.ha.clusterToken` | Shared secret for inter-node authentication. If empty, auto-generated at first startup and persisted under `raft-storage/` | (empty) |

| Setting | Description | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- |
| `arcadedb.ha.clusterTokenPath` | Path to a file containing the cluster token. Read only when `arcadedb.ha.clusterToken` is not set; the content is trimmed. Keeps the secret off the command line (e.g. a Kubernetes Secret mounted on `tmpfs`) | null |
| `arcadedb.ha.tls.enabled` | Negotiate TLS on the Raft gRPC transport (AppendEntries, RequestVote, and the Ratis admin/client calls). When true, the three file settings below must all name a readable PEM file or the node refuses to start. Independent of `arcadedb.ssl.enabled`, which covers the HTTP side channels. See mTLS for the Raft gRPC transport. *Since v26.9.1* | false |
| `arcadedb.ha.tls.certChainFile` | PEM file with this node's Raft certificate followed by any intermediate CAs. The certificate needs a SAN matching the address peers dial in `arcadedb.ha.serverList`, and both the `serverAuth` and `clientAuth` extended key usages. Required when `arcadedb.ha.tls.enabled` is true. *Since v26.9.1* | (empty) |
| `arcadedb.ha.tls.privateKeyFile` | PEM file with the **PKCS#8** private key matching `certChainFile`. Required when `arcadedb.ha.tls.enabled` is true. A `WARNING` is logged if the file is readable beyond its owner. *Since v26.9.1* | (empty) |
| `arcadedb.ha.tls.trustCertCollectionFile` | PEM file with the cluster CA certificate(s) signing every node certificate. Required when `arcadedb.ha.tls.enabled` is true, including with `mutualAuth=false`. *Since v26.9.1* | (empty) |

| Setting | Description | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- |
| `arcadedb.ha.tls.mutualAuth` | Require the dialing peer to present a client certificate signed by the cluster CA, binding peer identity to a certificate rather than a source IP. `false` gives server-only TLS, which encrypts the traffic but leaves the Raft port open to any client trusting the cluster CA. See Server-only TLS. *Since v26.9.1* | true |
| `arcadedb.ha.logVerbose` | Verbose HA logging: 0=off, 1=basic, 2=detailed, 3=trace | 0 |
| `arcadedb.ha.k8s` | The server is running inside Kubernetes (enables auto-join) | false |
| `arcadedb.ha.k8sSuffix` | DNS suffix used to reach the other servers in Kubernetes, e.g. `.arcadedb.default.svc.cluster.local` | (empty) |

# 8.9. Backup of a Database

ArcadeDB allows to execute a non-stop backup of a database while it is used without blocking writes or affecting performance.

A backup, and a `CHECK DATABASE` verification, always reflect every transaction committed before they started. *(Since v26.10.1: under specific timing, one of these operations starting right as another one on the same database was finishing could very rarely produce a snapshot a few milliseconds out of date, missing the most recently committed transaction(s). This is now fixed.)*

There are two ways to perform backups:

- **Manual backup** - Execute a one-time backup using SQL or the Studio UI
- **Automatic backup** - Schedule recurring backups with retention policies (see Automatic Backup Scheduler)

For manual backups, you can execute the backup of a database from SQL. Look at Backup Database SQL command for more information.

## 8.9.1. Consistency of TimeSeries data

A backup captures the database schema at a single point in time. TimeSeries types keep their compacted history in separate `.ts.sealed` files, which are archived alongside it.

*(Since v26.10.1)* the schema and the list of those files are captured together, so an archive can no longer declare a TIMESERIES type whose data it does not contain. Previously a `DROP TYPE` running at

the same moment as a backup could produce exactly that, and the backup still reported success.

*(Since v26.10.1)* if one of those files cannot be read while the backup runs, the backup now **fails with an error naming the file** instead of skipping it and reporting success.

This is deliberate. An archive that silently omits data its own schema declares looks valid until a restore is attempted, which is the worst moment to discover it. A failed backup is visible, and simply running it again produces a consistent archive. The same applies when the database directory cannot be listed at all: that is an error rather than being read as "this database has no TimeSeries data".

Note that this costs nothing in availability. The database is locked only long enough to take the snapshot and list the files, not for the duration of the backup, so schema changes still run normally while a backup is in progress.

### 8.9.2. Configuration

- `-f <backup-file>` (string) filename of, or path to the backup file to create.
- `-d <database-path>` (string) path on local filesystem where to find the ArcadeDB database.
- `-o` (boolean) true to overwrite the backup if already exists. If false and the `backup-path` already exists, an error is thrown. Default is false.

### 8.9.3. Cloud Backups

In a container setting it may become necessary to send backups to an S3 bucket instead of a mounted volume. Currently, ArcadeDB does not support writing a backup to S3 directly, but there are two ways of achieving this:

1. Using an intermediary container which forwards a volume's contents to an S3 bucket. The project docker-s3-volume makes this easy.
2. Mounting an S3 bucket inside the ArcadeDB container directly with the S3 file system via filesystem in userspace.

## 8.10. Automatic Backup Scheduler

ArcadeDB provides an automatic backup scheduler that runs as a server plugin. This feature allows you to configure scheduled backups for all databases with flexible scheduling options, tiered retention policies, and high availability cluster support.

The auto-backup scheduler is activated when a `backup.json` configuration file exists in the server's configuration directory: `config/` under the server root by default, or the directory set by `arcadedb.server.configDirectory` (since v26.10.1).

### 8.10.1. Features

- **Frequency-based scheduling** - Run backups every N minutes

- **CRON-based scheduling** - Use CRON expressions for precise scheduling (e.g., daily at 2 AM)
- **Time windows** - Restrict backups to specific time periods (e.g., off-peak hours)
- **Tiered retention** - Keep hourly, daily, weekly, monthly, and yearly backups
- **Per-database configuration** - Override defaults for specific databases
- **HA cluster awareness** - Configure which node runs backups in a cluster
- **Follows the database lifecycle** - New databases are scheduled automatically, dropped or closed ones stop
- **Studio integration** - Configure and monitor backups through the web UI

### 8.10.2. Configuration File

Create a file named `backup.json` in the `config` directory of your ArcadeDB installation. The server will automatically detect this file on startup and enable the auto-backup scheduler.

*Example backup.json*

```
{
  "version": 1,
  "enabled": true,
  "backupDirectory": "./backups",
  "defaults": {
    "enabled": true,
    "runOnServer": "$leader",
    "schedule": {
      "type": "frequency",
      "frequencyMinutes": 60,
      "timeWindow": {
        "start": "02:00",
        "end": "06:00"
      }
    },
    "retention": {
      "maxFiles": 10,
      "tiered": {
        "hourly": 24,
        "daily": 7,
        "weekly": 4,
        "monthly": 12,
        "yearly": 3
      }
    }
  },
  "databases": {
    "production": {
      "schedule": {
        "type": "cron",
        "expression": "0 0 2 * * ?"
      },
```

```
      "retention": {
        "maxFiles": 20
      }
    },
    "analytics": {
      "enabled": false
    }
  }
}
```

### 8.10.3. Configuration Options

#### Global Settings

| Setting | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `version` | `1` | Configuration file version (for future compatibility) |
| `enabled` | `true` | Enable or disable the auto-backup scheduler globally |
| `backupDirectory` | `./backups` | Directory where backups are stored (must be a relative path within server root) |

The `backupDirectory` must be a relative path and cannot contain `..` for security reasons. Absolute paths are rejected to prevent writing outside the server directory.

#### Default Settings

The `defaults` section defines settings applied to all databases unless overridden.

| Setting | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `defaults.enabled` | `true` | Enable backups for databases by default |
| `defaults.runOnServer` | `$leader` | Which server runs backups (see HA Cluster Support) |

#### Schedule Settings

| Setting | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `schedule.type` | `frequency` | Schedule type: `frequency` or `cron` |
| `schedule.frequencyMinutes` | `60` | Minutes between backups (when type is `frequency`) |
| `schedule.expression` | - | CRON expression (when type is `cron`) |
| `schedule.timeWindow.start` | - | Time window start (HH:mm format, e.g., "02:00") |
| `schedule.timeWindow.end` | - | Time window end (HH:mm format, e.g., "06:00") |

#### Retention Settings

| Setting | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `retention.maxFiles` | `10` | Maximum backup files to keep per database |
| `retention.tiered.hourly` | `24` | Number of hourly backups to retain |
| `retention.tiered.daily` | `7` | Number of daily backups to retain |
| `retention.tiered.weekly` | `4` | Number of weekly backups to retain |
| `retention.tiered.monthly` | `12` | Number of monthly backups to retain |
| `retention.tiered.yearly` | `3` | Number of yearly backups to retain |

When tiered retention is configured, the scheduler keeps the oldest backup of each of the most recent time buckets of every tier, and deletes the backups no tier keeps (the most recent backup is always kept). For example, with `hourly: 24`, it keeps one backup per hour for the last 24 hours. Weeks are ISO weeks, starting on Monday, so a week that spans a year end is one bucket.

Since v26.10.1. Before, a weekly bucket was labelled by calendar year plus ISO week number, so the last days of December and the first week of January of the same year shared one bucket and a recent backup could be deleted in favor of one a year older.

#### Per-Database Overrides

The `databases` section allows overriding any default setting for specific databases. Only specify the settings you want to override; unspecified settings inherit from defaults.

```
{
  "databases": {
    "critical-db": {
      "schedule": {
        "type": "cron",
        "expression": "0 0 * * * ?"
      },
      "retention": {
        "maxFiles": 48,
        "tiered": {
          "hourly": 48,
          "daily": 14
        }
      }
    },
    "dev-db": {
      "enabled": false
    }
  }
}
```

### 8.10.4. CRON Expressions

The auto-backup scheduler supports 6-field CRON expressions:

```
┌──────────────────────────── second (0 - 59)
│ ┌────────────────────────── minute (0 - 59)
│ │ ┌──────────────────────── hour (0 - 23)
│ │ │ ┌────────────────────── day of month (1 - 31)
│ │ │ │ ┌──────────────────── month (1 - 12)
│ │ │ │ │ ┌────────────────── day of week (0 - 6, Sunday = 0)
│ │ │ │ │ │
* * * * * *
```

*Table 2. Common CRON Examples*

| Expression | Description |
|---|---|
| `0 0 2 * * ?` | Every day at 2:00 AM |
| `0 0 */6 * * ?` | Every 6 hours |
| `0 30 1 * * 0` | Every Sunday at 1:30 AM |
| `0 0 3 1 * ?` | First day of every month at 3:00 AM |
| `0 0 0 * * 1-5` | Every weekday at midnight |

Supported special characters:

- `*` - matches all values
- `?` - no specific value (use for day-of-week or day-of-month)
- `-` - range (e.g., `1-5` for Monday through Friday)
- `/` - step (e.g., `*/15` for every 15 units)

### 8.10.5. HA Cluster Support

In a high availability cluster, you can control which server performs backups using the `runOnServer` setting:

| Value | Description |
|---|---|
| `$leader` | Only the current leader node runs backups (default, recommended) |
| `*` | All nodes run backups independently |
| `node-name` | Only the specified node runs backups (e.g., `"ArcadeDB_Replica1"`) |

Using `$leader` is recommended because:

- Ensures exactly one backup is created per schedule
- Automatically fails over if the leader changes
- Avoids duplicate backups across the cluster

*Example: Replica-based backup*

```
{
  "defaults": {
    "runOnServer": "ArcadeDB_Replica1"
  },
  "databases": {
    "analytics": {
      "runOnServer": "ArcadeDB_Replica2"
    }
  }
}
```

### 8.10.6. Backup Directory Structure

Backups are organized by database name:

```
backups/
├─── database1/
│    ├─── database1-backup-20250115-020000041.zip
│    ├─── database1-backup-20250116-020000038.zip
│    └─── database1-backup-20250117-020000105.zip
└─── database2/
     ├─── database2-backup-20250115-020000062.zip
     └─── database2-backup-20250116-020000057.zip
```

The backup filename format is: `<database>-backup-<YYYYMMDD>-<HHMMSSmmm>.zip`, where the last three digits are milliseconds.

Before 26.9.1 the name stopped at the second. Archives created by an older version keep their name and are still listed and rotated normally, so nothing needs to be renamed after an upgrade.

### 8.10.7. Monitoring

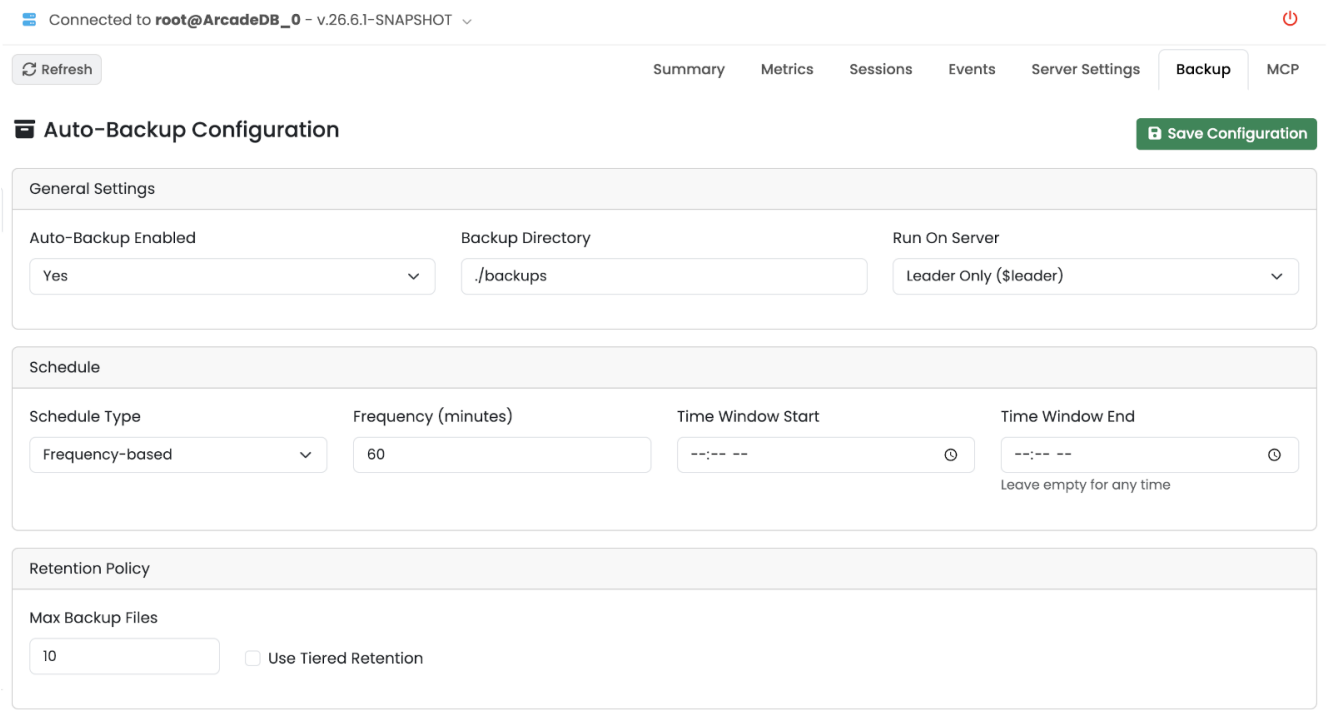
The auto-backup scheduler logs its activity:

```
INFO  [AutoBackupSchedulerPlugin] Auto-backup scheduler started. Backup directory:
./backups
INFO  [AutoBackupSchedulerPlugin] Scheduled automatic backup for database 'production'
INFO  [BackupScheduler] Starting scheduled backup for database 'production'
INFO  [BackupScheduler] Backup completed: production-backup-20250115-020000041.zip
(15.2 MB)
INFO  [BackupRetentionManager] Retained 10 backups, deleted 2 for database
'production'
```

Backup events are also recorded in the Server Event Log, accessible from the Studio Server panel.

### 8.10.8. Studio Integration

The auto-backup scheduler can be configured and monitored through the ArcadeDB Studio web interface. See Studio Backup Panel for details.




From the Studio, you can:

- View and modify the backup configuration
- Trigger immediate backups for any database
- View the list of available backups per database
- Monitor backup statistics and disk usage

### 8.10.9. Triggering Manual Backups

You can trigger an immediate backup through the Studio UI or via the HTTP API:

*HTTP API*

```
curl -X POST "http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server" \
  -u root:password \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"command": "trigger backup myDatabase"}'
```

*SQL Command*

```
BACKUP DATABASE
```

### Where an On-Demand Backup Goes

`trigger backup`, `list backups`, `delete backup`, `restore backup` and the SQL `BACKUP DATABASE` statement all use one definition of the backup directory, so an archive one of them writes the others can see, whether or not the scheduler is running. The directory is resolved in this order, first hit wins:

1. the `backupDirectory` of the running auto-backup plugin;
2. the `backupDirectory` in `config/backup.json`, even when that file sets `"enabled": false`;
3. the server setting `arcadedb.server.backupDirectory`.

It is resolved per command, so a `set backup config` that moves the directory is picked up by the next one.

Archives always live under `<backupDirectory>/<database>/`. `get backup config` reports the resolved directory as `backupDirectory` next to the configuration. A configured directory that fails validation (an absolute path, or one escaping the server root) makes every backup command fail with an error naming it, where `list backups` used to answer an empty list; `get backup config` reports the same failure as `backupDirectoryError`. A `config/backup.json` that cannot be read or parsed is skipped with a warning in the server log, and the chain continues to the server setting.

Since 26.10.1 the SQL `BACKUP DATABASE` statement is on this chain too. Before that it read `arcadedb.server.backupDirectory` directly, so whenever `config/backup.json` named a different directory the archive it wrote landed where `list backups` did not look and `delete backup` and `restore backup` could not reach: invisible through the API and never retention-pruned.

As a consequence `BACKUP DATABASE` now fails, rather than quietly writing elsewhere, when the configured directory fails the validation above. Embedded databases and remote connections are unaffected: with no server configuration in play the statement uses `arcadedb.server.backupDirectory` exactly as before.

Retention runs only while the scheduler is enabled: with auto-backup off, an on-demand archive stays on disk until it is removed with `delete backup`. While it is enabled, both on-demand entry points - `trigger backup` and, since 26.11.1, the SQL `BACKUP DATABASE` statement - prune the database's directory after a successful backup with its effective policy, including for a database that is not named in the configuration (the `defaults` retention applies). Only archives named `<database>-backup-<timestamp>.zip` are subject to retention; one named with `BACKUP DATABASE '<name>'` is never deleted by it.

### One Backup at a Time

A database is backed up by one backup at a time. If you ask for a backup while another one of the same database is still running - a manual trigger during a scheduled run, or two clicks in a row - the second request is refused rather than run alongside the first: a second copy of the same data adds nothing, and it would only compete for disk and CPU with the run already in progress.

The HTTP API answers with status `409` and the message `A backup of database '<name>' is already in progress`. Studio shows the same message. A scheduled run that arrives at a busy moment is simply skipped, with a warning in the log, and the next scheduled run covers the database as usual.

### 8.10.10. Database Lifecycle

Schedules follow their database, so you do not have to edit `backup.json` every time a database comes or goes:

- A database created, restored or imported while the server is running is scheduled straight away, with the same defaults (or per-database override) any other database gets.
- Dropping or closing a database cancels its schedule. The backups already on disk are left alone: a backup taken before the drop is exactly what you would restore from.
- A scheduled backup never opens a database by itself. If the database is not available on this server when its turn comes, that run is skipped.

The last point matters when you close a database deliberately, for maintenance for example: the scheduler will not reopen it behind your back.

### 8.10.11. Troubleshooting

#### Backup scheduler not starting

Verify that:

1. The `backup.json` file exists in the `config` directory
2. The JSON syntax is valid
3. The `enabled` field is set to `true`
4. Check the server log for error messages

#### Backups not being created

Check:

1. The backup directory exists and is writable
2. The `timeWindow` settings (backups only run within the window)
3. In HA mode, verify `runOnServer` matches the current server
4. Sufficient disk space is available

#### Permission denied errors

The backup directory must be:

- A relative path (e.g., `./backups`, not `/backups`)
- Within the server's root directory
- Writable by the server process

## 8.11. Restore a Database

ArcadeDB allows to restore a database previously backed up.

### 8.11.1. Restore via HTTP API (recommended)

The easiest way to restore a database on a running server is via the server command HTTP API. This supports both local files and remote URLs:

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server \
       -d '{"command": "restore database mydb file:///path/to/mydb-backup.zip"}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

Restoring from a remote URL (e.g., a backup hosted on a server or cloud storage):

```
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server \
       -d '{"command": "restore database mydb https://example.com/backups/mydb-
backup.zip"}' \
       -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
       --user root:arcadedb-password
```

The database must not already exist. The server downloads the backup file, extracts it, and opens the database automatically.

For security reasons, restoring from an `http://`/`https://` URL refuses by default to reach a local-file, loopback, link-local, or private-network address, including a redirect that lands on one. This protects the server from being made to fetch from internal-only hosts (e.g. a cloud metadata endpoint) via a crafted or hijacked backup URL. If you need to restore from a backup hosted on such an address (for example, an internal artifact server), set `arcadedb.server.restoreImportAllowLocalUrls=true` on the server.

### 8.11.2. Restore via command line

If the server is not running, you can restore a database using the command-line tool.

If a server is running, it must be restarted in order to access a database restored via command line.

#### Example

Example for restoring the database "mydb" from the backup located in `backups/mysb/mydb-backup-20210921-172750767.zip`.

```
$ bin/restore.sh -f backups/mysb/mydb-backup-20210921-172750767.zip -d databases/mydb
```

A restore forces every restored file to disk (fsync) before it reports success, together with the database directory and its parent. A power loss after the restore

completes cannot leave the restored database partially written.

### 8.11.3. Configuration

- `-f <backup-file>` (string) path to the backup file to restore.
- `-d <database-path>` (string) path on local filesystem where to create the ArcadeDB database.
- `-o` (boolean) true to overwrite the database if already exists. If false and the `database-path` already exists, an error is thrown. Default is false.

## 8.12. Monitoring

ArcadeDB provides built-in metrics collection and integration with Prometheus and Grafana for production monitoring.

### 8.12.1. Enabling Metrics

Metrics are enabled by default. Verify with:

```
SELECT FROM ( SELECT expand(settings) FROM schema:database ) WHERE key =
'arcadedb.serverMetrics'
```

Or set in `arcadedb-server.properties`:

```
arcadedb.serverMetrics=true
arcadedb.serverMetrics.logging=true
```

### 8.12.2. Prometheus Integration

The Prometheus metrics plugin auto-registers when the `metrics` module is on the classpath (included in the standard distributions) and metrics are enabled (`arcadedb.serverMetrics=true`, the default). It exposes a scrape endpoint at `http://localhost:2480/prometheus`.

Authentication on the scrape endpoint is on by default; set `arcadedb.serverMetrics.prometheus.requireAuthentication=false` to allow unauthenticated scraping.

This setting accepts only `true` or `false`. Anything else (`yes`, `1`, `on`, or a misspelling) is refused with a warning at startup and the endpoint stays authenticated, so a typo cannot expose it by accident. See Settings.

Configure Prometheus to scrape ArcadeDB:

```
# prometheus.yml
scrape_configs:
  - job_name: 'arcadedb'
    scrape_interval: 15s
```

```
    metrics_path: /prometheus
    static_configs:
      - targets: ['localhost:2480']
    basic_auth:
      username: root
      password: arcadedb
```

### 8.12.3. Available Metrics

ArcadeDB exposes metrics for:

- **Database operations** — Query count, command count, read/write throughput
- **Cache** — Page cache hits, misses, evictions
- **Disk** — Read/write operations, compaction activity
- **Transactions** — Active transactions, commits, rollbacks
- **Network** — HTTP request count, response times
- **JVM** — Heap usage, GC pauses, thread count
- **Backup** — Point-in-time window activity (see below)
- **Time series reads** — How much data each query actually had to read (see below)

#### Disk space

`diskFreeSpace`, `diskTotalSpace` and `diskFreeSpacePerc` (on `GET /api/v1/server` and on the **Databases Disk** card in Studio) describe the filesystem holding the configured database directory (`arcadedb.server.databaseDirectory`), which on a container is normally a mounted volume rather than the filesystem the server process was started in. The `diskDirectory` field names the measured directory, so it is always clear which filesystem the figures refer to.

Free space is what the server process can actually write, so any quota or reserved space is already subtracted.

#### Backup point-in-time windows

A full backup, an HA database verify and an HA snapshot ship read a point-in-time image of the database. By default that image is served from a copy-on-write shadow, so writers keep running at full speed while it is read. When the shadow cannot be used the operation still completes, but by freezing the data files instead - which throttles every writer until it finishes.

That fallback is invisible from the outside: the backup succeeds either way. These counters are what make it alertable:

| Metric | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `arcadedb_engine_snapshot_windows_overflowed_total` | The shadow reached `arcadedb.pageSnapshotMaxSize`. Raise it, or give the spill volume more room. |

| Metric | Meaning |
|---|---|
| arcadedb_engine_snapshot_windows_failed_total | A page pre-image could not be read or written. Look at the disk. |
| arcadedb_engine_snapshot_barrier_failed_total | The window could not be opened at all. Split by cause below. |
| arcadedb_engine_snapshot_barrier_failed_suspend_total | Transient and expected under sustained load. |
| arcadedb_engine_snapshot_barrier_failed_flush_total | A pending write never landed. Points at the disk. |

Any of these rising means backups have quietly gone back to throttling writers. See `arcadedb.pageSnapshotMaxSize`, `arcadedb.pageSnapshotMaxRAM` and `arcadedb.pageSnapshotSpillPath` in Settings.

### Time series reads

A time series query does not read everything in its range. Older data is stored in compacted blocks, each carrying a summary of what it holds, so a query can skip a block entirely or answer from its summary without decompressing it. These counters say how often that is working for your data, and are tagged by `db`, `type` and `surface` (the endpoint that made the read).

| Metric | Meaning |
|---|---|
| arcadedb_timeseries_read_blocks_total | Compacted blocks, split by `outcome`: `skipped` (not read at all), `fast-path` (answered from the block summary) and `slow-path` (decompressed in full). |
| arcadedb_timeseries_read_pages_total | Pages of recent, not-yet-compacted data, split by `outcome`: `scanned` or `skipped`. |
| arcadedb_timeseries_read_rows_total | Rows actually materialised, i.e. the ones that survived every filter. |
| arcadedb_timeseries_read_overflow_buckets_total | Aggregation buckets that fell outside the pre-sized window. Results are correct either way, but a rising value means the range estimate is coming up short. |
| arcadedb_timeseries_read_phase_seconds | Time spent per `phase`: `io`, `decompress-timestamps`, `decompress-values`, `accumulate`. |

The ratio worth watching is `slow-path` against `skipped` and `fast-path`. A high `slow-path` share means queries are decompressing blocks they could have skipped - usually because the query filters on something the block summaries cannot narrow, or because the blocks predate the summary they would need.

These counters are collected only while metrics are enabled; with metrics off the read path is unchanged and nothing is measured.

### 8.12.4. Periodic Metric Dumps

For environments without Prometheus, enable periodic metric logging:

```
arcadedb.dumpMetricsEvery=60
```

This dumps metrics to the server log every 60 seconds.

### 8.12.5. Grafana Dashboard Setup

1. Install Grafana and add a Prometheus datasource pointing to your Prometheus instance
2. Import or create dashboards using ArcadeDB metrics
3. For time series data visualization, use ArcadeDB's native Grafana integration endpoints with the Infinity datasource plugin

### 8.12.6. Health Checks

Use the server info endpoint for health monitoring:

```
curl http://localhost:2480/api/v1/server
```

For time series health:

```
curl http://localhost:2480/api/v1/ts/mydb/grafana/health
```

### 8.12.7. Server health warnings

Since v26.10.1 the server runs a health monitor that samples, every ten seconds, three things a running server can degrade on:

- free disk space on the filesystem holding the databases — the same filesystem the `diskFreeSpace` figures above describe, and the warning that precedes a database that can no longer write;
- available heap;
- JVM pause times.

When one of them degrades, a `WARNING` event is written to the server event log, visible in Studio and through `GET /api/v1/server/events`. Each kind of warning is rate limited so a server that stays degraded reports it periodically rather than on every sample: once a day for low disk, once every 30 minutes for heap and JVM pauses.

Set `arcadedb.server.healthCheck.enabled=false` to turn the monitor off.

The monitor is enabled by default. On an in-place upgrade a server already close to those thresholds starts producing event-log warnings it did not produce before.

### 8.12.8. Further Reading

- Cloud Observability — RED metrics, OTLP export, tracing, structured logging, and health probes
- Server Settings — All configuration parameters
- Time Series — Grafana DataFrame endpoints for time series dashboards
- Realtime Analytics Use Case — Complete monitoring example with Grafana

## 8.13. Cloud Observability

ArcadeDB exposes a vendor-neutral observability stack for production (Kubernetes) deployments: always-on RED metrics, OpenTelemetry distributed tracing, structured JSON logging with correlation IDs, and standard health probes. Everything described here is **opt-in and behavior-preserving** — with no new configuration, an upgraded server behaves exactly as before. The existing `/prometheus` scrape endpoint, `/api/v1/server` JSON, and `/api/v1/ready` semantics are never changed, only added to.

The design follows an *instrument-once* principle: each hot path (HTTP request, query/command, transaction) is wrapped in a single Micrometer `Observation`. When only metrics are enabled, an `Observation` is a timer; when the optional tracing plugin is loaded, the **same** instrumentation also emits a span. A correlation ID then ties the resulting metric, span, and log line together.

### 8.13.1. Metrics depth

ArcadeDB builds on the Micrometer framework already in the server. Metrics are enabled by default (`arcadedb.serverMetrics=true`) and exposed on the Prometheus scrape endpoint `/prometheus` (see Monitoring for scrape and Grafana setup). The series below are **additive** — existing metrics and the `/prometheus` output shape are unchanged.

#### RED latency timers

Two always-on timers record request/query latency with a percentile histogram (server-side p50/p95/p99). Query text is never used as a tag, keeping cardinality bounded.

| Timer | Tags | Prometheus series |
|---|---|---|
| `arcadedb.http.requests` | `method`, `path` (route template, e.g. `/query/{database}` — never the raw URI), `status`, `db` (the database name, or `unknown` when the request names a database that does not exist) | `arcadedb_http_requests_seconds_*` |
| `arcadedb.query.duration` | `protocol` (`http`, `bolt`, `postgres`, `mongo`, `grpc`, `redis`, `internal`), `db`, `language` (`sql`, `opencypher`, `gremlin`, `graphql`, `mongo`), `type` (`query` or `command`) | `arcadedb_query_duration_seconds_*` |

The `protocol` tag defaults to `internal` for embedded/in-process callers; dashboards typically filter `protocol!="internal"` to isolate client traffic. Redis commands and

unfiltered Mongo scans do not pass through the query engine and are therefore not recorded by `arcadedb.query.duration`.

Since v26.9.1 the `db` tag of `arcadedb.http.requests` carries a database name only when that database exists on the server, and the constant `unknown` otherwise. The `{database}` path parameter matches any URL segment, and the timer is also recorded for requests answered `401`, so echoing it verbatim let any caller register one permanent series per invented name. Requests against a non-existent database are therefore grouped under `db="unknown"` rather than appearing one series per name.

#### Engine gauges

`EngineMetricsBinder` bridges the internal engine `Profiler` into Micrometer gauges (engine-wide aggregates, refreshed from a one-second-memoized snapshot):

| Gauge | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `arcadedb.engine.page.cache.hits` / `.page.cache.misses` | Page cache hit/miss counters |
| `arcadedb.engine.pages.read` / `.pages.written` | Pages read from / written to disk |
| `arcadedb.engine.wal.bytes.written` / `.wal.files` | Write-ahead-log bytes and file count |
| `arcadedb.engine.mvcc.conflicts` | MVCC concurrent-modification conflicts |
| `arcadedb.engine.files.open` | Open file handles |
| `arcadedb.engine.tx.write` / `.tx.read` / `.tx.rollbacks` | Write/read transactions and rollbacks |
| `arcadedb.engine.queries` / `.commands` | Query and command counts |
| `arcadedb.engine.databases` | Number of open databases |
| `arcadedb.engine.async.boundary.commits` | Asynchronous batch transactions cut short by a durability-flag change |
| `arcadedb.engine.async.workers.retiring` | Asynchronous workers a lowered parallel level retired and that are still draining |

The last two describe the asynchronous executor and are worth reading together with the throughput of your ingestion.

`async.boundary.commits` counts how often a change to `setTransactionUseWAL()` / `setTransactionSync()` forced a worker to close its open batch transaction early. Occasional increments are normal - a bulk load flips those flags at its start and end. A rate that stays high while asynchronous throughput drops means two callers are flipping them against each other on the same database, so batching is degrading towards one commit per task.

`async.workers.retiring` is a gauge, not a counter: it goes back to zero as the retired workers finish. Zero is the normal reading, and a brief spike during a `setParallelLevel()` call is expected. A reading that stays above zero means a retired worker is stuck inside user code and will never finish draining - a resize deliberately never interrupts one - so the thread stays alive until the database is

closed.

**Optional OTLP metrics export**

To push metrics to an OpenTelemetry Collector (in addition to the unchanged `/prometheus` scrape), enable the OTLP registry:

```
arcadedb.serverMetrics.otlp.enabled=true
arcadedb.serverMetrics.otlp.endpoint=http://otel-collector:4318/v1/metrics
# optional: push every 15 seconds instead of every minute (minimum 1000 ms)
arcadedb.serverMetrics.otlp.step=15000
```

The metrics exporter speaks **OTLP/HTTP** (protobuf), not gRPC, so the endpoint is the collector's HTTP receiver: port `4318`, path `/v1/metrics` (this is also the default). Port `4317` is the gRPC receiver and does not work for metrics; the server logs a warning if it is configured. A URL without a path gets `/v1/metrics` appended. Tracing is different: it uses OTLP/gRPC on port `4317` (see below).

The metrics and tracing plugins report the OpenTelemetry `service.name` resource attribute. The standard `OTEL_SERVICE_NAME` environment variable is honored and takes precedence over `OTEL_RESOURCE_ATTRIBUTES` and over the `arcadedb.serverMetrics.serviceName` setting (default `arcadedb`), so in a container set it with `-e OTEL_SERVICE_NAME=my-arcadedb`.

This registers an OTLP meter registry alongside Prometheus; the scrape path is unaffected whether or not OTLP is enabled. The OTLP exporter lives in the optional `metrics` module bundled with the standard distributions.

### 8.13.2. Distributed tracing

Distributed tracing is an **optional plugin** (the `tracing` module, shipped only in the `full` distribution). When absent or disabled, the in-core `Observation` calls are no-ops with zero span overhead. When enabled, the same instrumentation points used by the metrics timers also emit OpenTelemetry spans.

Enable tracing and point it at your OTLP collector:

```
arcadedb.serverMetrics.tracing.enabled=true
arcadedb.serverMetrics.tracing.endpoint=http://otel-collector:4317
arcadedb.serverMetrics.tracing.samplingRate=0.1
```

- `tracing.endpoint` is an **OTLP/gRPC** endpoint (default port `4317`).
- `tracing.samplingRate` is a parent-based ratio in `[0.0, 1.0]`: `1.0` samples every trace, `0.0` (default) disables sampling.
- If the endpoint is unreachable, tracing self-disables and logs an error — server startup is never blocked.

Two span types are produced and nest correctly (query spans are children of the HTTP span within one trace):

| Span | Attributes |
| --- | --- |
| `arcadedb.http.server.requests` | `method`, `path` (route template), `db`, `status` |
| `arcadedb.query` | `protocol`, `db`, `language`, `type`, and `db.statement` (the full query/command text) |

The `db.statement` span attribute contains the full query/command text, which may include sensitive data. Secure your OTLP collector endpoint and apply collector-side redaction if required.

ArcadeDB continues an upstream trace by reading the inbound W3C `traceparent` HTTP header. Resource attributes (`service.name`, `service.instance.id`), `OTEL_RESOURCE_ATTRIBUTES`, and trace-context propagation over the replication (Raft) and binary wire protocols are not yet implemented; each non-HTTP request starts a fresh root span.

### 8.13.3. Structured logging and correlation IDs

By default the server logs human-readable text, byte-identical to previous releases. Set `arcadedb.server.logFormat=json` to emit one JSON object per line instead, suitable for log shippers (Loki, ELK):

```
arcadedb.server.logFormat=json
```

See Logging for the configuration underneath this setting: log levels, rotation, log directory, and routing the engine through SLF4J when embedding.

Each JSON line contains: `timestamp` (local time, `yyyy-MM-dd'T'HH:mm:ss.SSS`), `level`, `logger`, `thread`, `message`, and — when present — `requestId`, `db`, `traceId`, `spanId`, and `exception` (full stack trace). Example:

```
{"timestamp":"2026-06-16T10:15:30.123","level":"INFO","logger"
:"com.arcadedb.server.ArcadeDBServer","thread":"http-1","message":"Query executed"
,"requestId":"req-abc","db":"mydb","traceId":"4bf92f3577b34da6a3ce929d0e0e4736"
,"spanId":"0123456789abcdef"}
```

#### Correlation IDs

Every HTTP request is tagged with a `requestId`: ArcadeDB reuses the inbound `X-Request-Id` header when present (sanitized, capped at 128 characters) or generates a UUID, and echoes it on the response. The `db` field is taken from the request's database path parameter. When the tracing plugin is active, `traceId`/`spanId` are added too — but `requestId` works for correlation even with tracing disabled.

For operators who keep text logs, `arcadedb.server.logIncludeTrace=true` appends ` [traceId=...]` to each line while a trace is active (default off, preserving current output):

```
arcadedb.server.logIncludeTrace=true
```

### 8.13.4. Health probes

ArcadeDB exposes two complementary, unauthenticated endpoints so orchestrators can tell a **live** process from a **ready** one. See the HTTP API reference for response details.

| Endpoint | Probe | Behavior |
|---|---|---|
| `GET, HEAD /api/v1/health` | liveness | Returns `204` whenever the HTTP layer is up. Performs no database I/O and never returns a busy/`503` status, so a node that is merely warming up is not killed. On a High Availability cluster it returns `503` if the node has given up recovering from a crash loop, so the orchestrator restarts a node that otherwise cannot recover on its own. |
| `GET, HEAD /api/v1/ready` | readiness | Returns `204` once the server is `ONLINE`; `503` (`Server not started yet`) before that. On a High Availability cluster it also returns `503` while this node's replication log writer has failed — a node in that state cannot catch up, so everything it serves is frozen at the moment the writer failed. It rejoins on its own once the writer recovers. *(Since v26.10.1; this check is not behind* `server.readinessRequiresHA`*, see below.)* Otherwise unchanged by default. |

Both endpoints also accept `HEAD`, so healthcheck tools that probe with a HEAD request (e.g. `wget --spider`, common in Docker `HEALTHCHECK` instructions) work without a body being returned.

Use `/api/v1/health` for the liveness probe and `/api/v1/ready` for the readiness probe:

```
livenessProbe:
  httpGet:
    path: /api/v1/health
    port: 2480
  initialDelaySeconds: 10
  periodSeconds: 10
readinessProbe:
  httpGet:
    path: /api/v1/ready
    port: 2480
  initialDelaySeconds: 20
  periodSeconds: 10
```

#### HA-aware readiness

On a High Availability cluster you can make readiness reflect Raft membership so traffic is withheld until a node has joined the group:

```
arcadedb.server.readinessRequiresHA=true
```

When this flag is `true` and HA is active, `/api/v1/ready` returns `503` (`Node has not yet joined the Raft group`) until a leader has been elected. Once a leader is known, a second gate checks that the node is a member of the current Raft configuration and, for a follower, that it has caught up to within `arcadedb.server.readinessHAMaxLag` log entries (default `100`) of the commit index; until then it keeps returning `503` (`Node is not yet in the Raft configuration or has not caught up`). Only then does it return `204`. This prevents a (re)joined follower with a wiped or lagging log from being marked ready mid-catch-up, which would otherwise let a rolling restart drop the write quorum. The default (`false` for `readinessRequiresHA`) preserves current readiness behavior.

With `readinessRequiresHA` on, a third reason can hold a node at `503` *(since v26.10.1)*: its users, groups and API tokens may not be the cluster's. These live in `server-users.jsonl`, `server-groups.json` and `server-api-tokens.json`, outside the databases, so no snapshot carries them (see Cluster security documents). Two kinds of node are held:

- a node added to the cluster while running (`POST /api/v1/cluster/peer`, `connect cluster` or a Kubernetes auto-join) that has not yet installed the documents the leader seeds to it;
- a node caught up by a snapshot install from the leader, until the leader confirms its copies or sends new ones.

Until then the node enforces its own copies, so a user dropped, a group narrowed or a token revoked while it was away would still work there. `/api/v1/ready` answers `503` with `Cluster security documents have not reached this node yet: <documents>`. A statically configured member that simply restarts is not held, and neither is a node while it leads, because nobody else can confirm its copies.

The hold is bounded by `arcadedb.ha.securityConvergenceReadinessTimeout` (default `30000` ms; `0` turns it off). When the window expires the node reports ready anyway, so a scale-up or rolling restart cannot stall behind a seed that never arrives, and logs a single SEVERE line naming the documents:

```
Reporting READY after waiting 30000ms for the cluster's security documents, which
never reached this node: server-groups.json. ...
```

When you see it, re-run `connect cluster` or re-POST the node to `/api/v1/cluster/peer` to send the seed again, or reissue the security change. The gRPC `Ready` RPC uses the same check.

The replication-log-writer check described in the table above is deliberately **not** behind this flag. This flag gates a node that is merely behind and which you may reasonably choose to serve from; a node whose log writer has failed cannot catch up at all, so it is withheld from traffic whether or not the flag is set. See Kubernetes deployment for the full StatefulSet example.

### 8.13.5. Further reading

- Monitoring — Prometheus and Grafana setup
- Kubernetes deployment — Helm chart and probe configuration

- Settings — all configuration keys

# 8.14. Logging

ArcadeDB writes its own logs through a small internal facade, `com.arcadedb.log.Logger`, which has two implementations:

- **`DefaultLogger`** (the default) writes to `java.util.logging` (JUL), configured by `config/arcadedb-log.properties`. This is what the server distribution uses, and its output is the familiar colored console plus a rotating file under `log/`.
- **`Slf4jLogger`** (opt-in) routes every line through the SLF4J facade instead, so an application that embeds ArcadeDB receives the engine's logs in whatever backend it already uses (Logback, Log4j2, reload4j, or JUL again via `slf4j-jdk14`).

Selecting an implementation is a startup decision, made with a system property and no code change:

```
-Darcadedb.log.impl=slf4j     # default, or omitted: java.util.logging
```

An unrecognized value falls back to the default logger and reports the fact on `stderr`, so a typo does not silently look like a working configuration.

## 8.14.1. The default logger (java.util.logging)

The server reads its JUL configuration from the first of these that exists:

1. The file named by the `java.util.logging.config.file` system property. The `server.sh` and `server.bat` scripts set this to `$ARCADEDB_HOME/config/arcadedb-log.properties`, anchored to the installation directory rather than the working directory.
2. An `arcadedb-log.properties` resource on the classpath, which is how embedded applications ship their own configuration.
3. `config/arcadedb-log.properties`, relative to the working directory.

If none is found, JUL defaults apply and a warning goes to `stderr`.

The shipped file configures a console handler and a rotating file handler:

```
handlers = java.util.logging.ConsoleHandler, java.util.logging.FileHandler

.level = INFO
com.arcadedb.level = INFO

java.util.logging.ConsoleHandler.level = INFO
java.util.logging.ConsoleHandler.formatter = com.arcadedb.utility.AnsiLogFormatter

java.util.logging.FileHandler.level = INFO
java.util.logging.FileHandler.pattern = ${arcadedb.server.logsDirectory}/arcadedb.log
```

```
java.util.logging.FileHandler.formatter = com.arcadedb.log.LogFormatter
java.util.logging.FileHandler.limit = 100000000
java.util.logging.FileHandler.count = 10
```

`limit` and `count` give ten rotating files of 100 MB each, so the log directory is bounded at roughly 1 GB.

### 8.14.2. Per-package verbosity

Logger names follow the emitting class, so any package prefix can be given its own level. To trace one subsystem without drowning in everything else:

```
com.arcadedb.level = INFO
com.arcadedb.query.sql.level = FINE
com.arcadedb.server.ha.level = FINE
```

The same mechanism silences noisy third-party libraries. The shipped configuration uses it to suppress the Apache Ratis per-retry replication flood, which repeats while a follower is briefly unreachable:

```
org.apache.ratis.grpc.server.GrpcLogAppender.level = SEVERE
```

Not every suppression is a line in this file. A properties entry sets one threshold for a whole logger, which is fine when everything that logger says at WARNING is noise. When a logger mixes expected noise with real failures, ArcadeDB installs a `java.util.logging.Filter` in code that drops only the one message. Since v26.10.1 the server does this for the Ratis warning

```
Snapshot file SingleFileSnapshotInfo(t:N, i:M):[.../sm/snapshot.N_M] has missing MD5
file.
```

through `com.arcadedb.server.ha.raft.ratis.RatisSnapshotDigestWarningFilter`. The same logger, `org.apache.ratis.statemachine.impl.SimpleStateMachineStorage`, also reports `Failed to updateLatestSnapshot from …` when the snapshot directory cannot be read, a genuine I/O failure. Raising that logger to `SEVERE` would hide both. The filter drops the record only at WARNING or below, so if a future Ratis release logged the same text at SEVERE it would still show up. You will not find this suppression in `arcadedb-log.properties`, and there is no setting to bring the warning back; see the HA troubleshooting entry for why it is harmless.

Handlers filter independently of loggers, so raising a logger to `FINE` also requires lowering the handler: a `ConsoleHandler.level` of `INFO` discards `FINE` records no matter what the logger allows.

### 8.14.3. Log directory

The file handler pattern supports `${…}` placeholders, resolved before JUL opens the file. The default pattern uses `${arcadedb.server.logsDirectory}`, which resolves, in order, from:

1. the `arcadedb.server.logsDirectory` system property,
2. the environment variable of the same name,
3. the `server.logsDirectory` setting,
4. the default `./log`.

The `server.sh` and `server.bat` scripts forward the `ARCADEDB_LOG_DIR` environment variable to that system property, which is the usual way to relocate logs in a container:

```
ARCADEDB_LOG_DIR=/var/log/arcadedb ./bin/server.sh
```

This matters on a read-only root filesystem, such as a Kubernetes pod with `readOnlyRootFilesystem: true`, where `./log` is not writable. Point `ARCADEDB_LOG_DIR` at a writable volume mount. The directory is created at startup if it does not exist.

An unresolvable placeholder falls back to `./log` rather than failing startup, so a typo in the pattern shows up as logs in an unexpected place rather than as a dead server.

### 8.14.4. Console format

The console formatter is chosen by the `server.logFormat` setting: `text` (the default, human-readable and colored) or `json` (one JSON object per line, for log shippers such as Loki or ELK). The JSON form carries the correlation fields `requestId`, `db`, `traceId`, and `spanId` when they are present. See Structured logging and correlation IDs for the field list and examples, and `server.logIncludeTrace` for appending the trace ID to text lines.

To leave the console handler entirely alone, so that only `arcadedb-log.properties` decides the formatter, disable the automatic install:

```
-Darcadedb.installCustomFormatter=false
```

### 8.14.5. Routing through SLF4J when embedding

An application that embeds ArcadeDB usually already has a logging backend and wants the engine's output in it, in the same format, filtered by the same rules. Setting `arcadedb.log.impl=slf4j` makes ArcadeDB log through `slf4j-api` and nothing else: the engine pins no backend, so the host application keeps whichever one it uses, and needs no dependency exclusions.

Add exactly one SLF4J binding. With Logback, which Spring Boot already brings in:

```
<dependency>
  <groupId>ch.qos.logback</groupId>
  <artifactId>logback-classic</artifactId>
</dependency>
```

With Log4j2:

```
<dependency>
  <groupId>org.apache.logging.log4j</groupId>
  <artifactId>log4j-slf4j2-impl</artifactId>
</dependency>
<dependency>
  <groupId>org.apache.logging.log4j</groupId>
  <artifactId>log4j-core</artifactId>
</dependency>
```

Then select the logger at startup:

```
java -Darcadedb.log.impl=slf4j -jar my-application.jar
```

or programmatically, before the first database is opened:

```
LogManager.instance().setLogger(new Slf4jLogger());
```

Levels map onto SLF4J's five by numeric weight, so custom JUL levels also resolve: `SEVERE` to `ERROR`, `WARNING` to `WARN`, `INFO` to `INFO`, `FINE` to `DEBUG`, anything lower to `TRACE`. Logger names are unchanged (`com.arcadedb.*`), so the per-package filtering above translates directly:

```
<logger name="com.arcadedb" level="INFO"/>
<logger name="com.arcadedb.query.sql" level="DEBUG"/>
```

Per-request correlation is published to the SLF4J MDC, namespaced so it cannot clobber the host application's own keys: `arcadedb.requestId`, `arcadedb.database`, `arcadedb.traceId`, and `arcadedb.spanId`. Reference them from a pattern with `%X{arcadedb.requestId}`, or rely on a JSON encoder, which includes the MDC automatically. Any value already present under one of those keys is restored after the call.

Ready-to-use `logback.xml` and `log4j2.xml` files, reproducing both native formats, are in `examples/logging` in the source repository.

The SLF4J logger leaves all configuration to the backend and therefore never reads `config/arcadedb-log.properties`. On a packaged server, which bundles the `slf4j-jdk14` binding, setting `arcadedb.log.impl=slf4j` still logs through JUL, but the file handler and formatters declared in that file are not installed, so the rotating `log/arcadedb.log.*` files stop being written. Either keep the default logger on the standalone server, or point JUL at the file yourself with `-Djava.util.logging.config.file=config/arcadedb-log.properties`.

### 8.14.6. Custom logger implementations

Both implementations satisfy `com.arcadedb.log.Logger`, a two-method interface. An application that needs to capture the engine's output directly, rather than route it to a backend, can install its own:

```
LogManager.instance().setLogger(new MyLogger());
```

Message parameters use printf-style formatting (`%s`), not SLF4J's `{}` placeholders, because that is how ArcadeDB messages are written. A custom implementation should check whether the level is enabled before formatting, since the engine passes format arguments unformatted precisely so that a disabled level costs nothing.

### 8.14.7. Further Reading

- Cloud Observability — RED metrics, OTLP export, tracing, and health probes
- Structured logging and correlation IDs — the JSON console format and correlation fields
- Server Settings — `server.logFormat`, `server.logIncludeTrace`, `server.logsDirectory`
- Kubernetes deployment — read-only root filesystems and log volume mounts

## 8.15. Upgrade ArcadeDB

ArcadeDB automatically upgrades a database to a newer on-disk format when a newer version of ArcadeDB opens it. The migration is transparent and happens lazily on first open, so the only operator step is to point the new binaries at your existing data.

### 8.15.1. Breaking changes

This section lists behavior changes that may require action when upgrading.

#### 26.11.1 - Client requests wait in a queue when the server is busy

Every request of a remote client (HTTP, Postgres, BOLT, Redis, gRPC, Gremlin Server, MCP, MongoDB) now goes through a query admission gate: at most twice the number of cores run at once, and a request that arrives when they are all taken, or when the running queries hold more than 80% of the query heap budget, waits in a queue and starts in arrival order (issue #9518). Before, every request started at once, and under a burst of heavy queries the last ones were refused by the heap budget or exhausted the heap.

**Impact:** under load a request can wait before it starts, up to `arcadedb.queryQueueTimeout` (30 seconds by default), and is refused as retryable once that runs out or when `arcadedb.queryQueueMaxSize` requests already wait (HTTP `503`). A MongoDB request is refused at once instead of waiting. A BOLT result stream that is not read to the end keeps its slot until it is.

**Action:** none for most installations. Size the gate with `arcadedb.queryMaxConcurrent`, `arcadedb.queryAdmissionHeapWatermark`, `arcadedb.queryQueueTimeout` and `arcadedb.queryQueueMaxSize` (see Settings), or set `arcadedb.queryMaxConcurrent=0` for the previous behavior.

#### 26.11.1 - The Gremlin plugin fails the server start when its port is busy

If the Gremlin port (`gremlin.port`, default `8182`) is already in use, the server now stops with an error. Before, it started without a Gremlin listener and still advertised the port in `GET /api/v1/server`

(issue #9319). With `gremlin.port=0` a free port is chosen at startup and advertised.

**Impact:** a server that used to start while another process held the Gremlin port no longer starts.

**Action:** free the port or set `gremlin.port` to a free one.

#### 26.11.1 - A plain `=` / `IN` on a `COLLATE CI` index is case sensitive

The planner used to return every case variant for `WHERE Name = 'JOHN'` when a `COLLATE CI` index served the query, while the same predicate evaluated by a scan was case sensitive (issue #9403). The index no longer changes the answer: a plain `=` or `IN` is case sensitive with or without it.

**Impact:** a query that relied on `Name = 'john'` finding `"John"` through a `COLLATE CI` index now returns fewer rows.

**Action:** write the lookup on `Name.toLowerCase()`, for example `WHERE Name.toLowerCase() = 'john'`, which the index serves. See Case-insensitive indexes.

#### 26.11.1 - Cypher `DURATION` arithmetic is exact, and `date * duration` is an error

Durations stored in a property are read back as durations, including short ones such as `P1D`, so `ORDER BY` and comparisons on them now work (issue #9338). Duration arithmetic raises an arithmetic error when the result does not fit, instead of returning a wrong value. A date or time combined with a duration using `*`, `/` or `%` is now a type error, and `duration + date` is accepted.

**Impact:** a query that relied on a stored duration being plain text, or on `date * duration` returning a date, changes.

**Action:** none for normal use. A range index on a duration property still orders by its text form (issue #9348).

#### 26.11.1 - Sparse-vector top-K is split across workers from 50,000 postings

`vector.sparseNeighbors` on an `LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR` index now splits a query across the scoring workers once its terms hold 50,000 postings in total (setting `arcadedb.sparseVectorScoringMinPostingsForPartitioning`, default `50000`, was `200000`). Queries between 50,000 and 200,000 postings used to run on one thread and set the slowest latencies. A query just past the threshold uses two ranges and leaves the other workers free; wider queries use more (issue #9482).

**Impact:** results are the same. Queries in that size range are faster, and use more CPU when the server is otherwise idle.

**Action:** none. On a small or shared server where CPU matters more than latency, raise `arcadedb.sparseVectorScoringMinPostingsForPartitioning` (for example back to `200000`).

#### 26.11.1 - Production mode conceals error text on Bolt, Redis, `/ws` and MCP

In `production` server mode the `/ws` insert session, `/ws` change-event subscriptions, Bolt, Redis and MCP now answer an engine failure with "The request failed. Check the server log for the details" and write the detail to the server log, as HTTP, gRPC, PostgreSQL, MongoDB and Gremlin Server

already did (issue #8749). Before, they returned the engine's message as is, including the stored values of a duplicated key.

**Impact:** a client of these protocols that reads the error text in production gets the generic message. Error codes, Neo4j status codes, RESP prefixes and exception class names are unchanged, and so is text the protocol writes about the request itself.

**Action:** branch on the code rather than on the message, and read the detail from the server log. See Error details in production mode.

#### 26.11.1 - Graph algorithms answer the incoming side of unidirectional edge types

The `algo.` and `path.` procedures, the path-finding SQL functions (`dijkstra()`, `astar()`, `bellmanFord()`, `cchShortestPath()`, `duanSSSP()`) and the `node.degree*` / `node.relationship.*` functions now follow the edges of a `UNIDIRECTIONAL` type from their target too, as a Graph Analytical View already did (issue #8629). Before, they saw such an edge from its source only, so for example a walk with direction `IN` or `BOTH` missed it. `refactor.mergeNodes`, `refactor.cloneNodesWithRelationships` and changing a node's labels in Cypher no longer drop the incoming unidirectional edges of the node.

**Impact:** results over unidirectional edge types can change (more paths, higher in-degrees, different scores), and now match the results with a Graph Analytical View.

**Action:** none. See `CREATE TYPE` for the heap a walk from the target takes.

#### 26.11.1 - Cypher counts match an undirected self loop once

An undirected relationship pattern such as `(n)-[:KNOWS]-(m)` matches a self loop (an edge from a vertex to itself) once, as the openCypher specification and Neo4j do. The rows of such a pattern always did, but the counts computed without materializing the rows counted it twice: `MATCH (a)-[:KNOWS]-(b) RETURN count(), a count()` grouped by the start node, `OPTIONAL MATCH ⋯ WITH n, count(m)` and the `COUNT { }` subquery, with and without a Graph Analytical View (issues #8750, #9540). The same release corrects the count of a chain with an inequality such as `WHERE a <> c` when the chain has a labelled or multi-hop part before or after the two positions the inequality compares.

**Impact:** those counts can be lower than before on graphs with self loops, or on such chains, and now equal the number of rows the same `MATCH` returns.

**Action:** none.

#### 26.11.1 - Cypher `count(*)` of an `OPTIONAL MATCH` with several arms, and of a Cartesian product

A `count(*)` over a star pattern no longer counts an `OPTIONAL MATCH` that reaches the central node from two sides, or holds two patterns, as two independent optional matches: when one side finds nothing the clause contributes one row, not the number of matches of the other side. A star next to a node pattern that shares no variable with it, `MATCH (a)-[:R]→(b), (a)-[:S]→(c), (t:Tag)`, now multiplies by the `Tag` count, which it used to leave out. Both were answered by the count push-down without building the rows (issue #9596).

`count(*)` over parts of a `MATCH` that share no variable is now the product of the parts' counts and

builds no row, so a count whose result does not fit a 64-bit integer raises an error instead of running until the command timeout.

**Impact:** the counts of those two star shapes change, and now equal the number of rows the same `MATCH` returns.

**Action:** none.

#### 26.11.1 - A Postgres cancel request stops the statement and keeps the connection

A `CancelRequest` (what JDBC `Statement.cancel()`, pgjdbc's `setQueryTimeout()` and libpq's `PQcancel` send) now stops the statement the connection is running with SQLSTATE `57014` and leaves the connection open, as PostgreSQL does (issue #9689). Before, it closed the whole connection, and since every connection had the backend process id `0`, a cancel could reach a different connection than the one it named.

**Impact:** after a cancel or a query timeout the connection stays usable instead of being closed.

**Action:** a client that relied on a cancel request closing the connection must call `pg_terminate_backend(pid)` instead. See Cancelling a statement.

#### 26.11.1 - An HTTP client that disconnects terminates its statement

A client that closes its connection while its statement runs (its own timeout, a killed process, `curl --max-time`) now terminates the statement, and what it wrote is rolled back unless it had already committed, instead of leaving the server working on it until it completes or reaches `arcadedb.command.timeout` (issue #9689). This applies to plain HTTP/1.x connections, not to TLS or HTTP/2. Likewise a gRPC client that cancels a call, or whose deadline expires, terminates the server-side work.

**Impact:** a client that sends a write and closes the connection without waiting for the answer can find the write rolled back.

**Action:** wait for the response of a write before closing the connection. See List and terminate running queries.

#### 26.10.1 — Sparse-vector top-K scores a window of documents at a time

`vector.sparseNeighbors` on an `LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR` index now scores documents in windows (setting `arcadedb.sparseVectorScoringWindow`, default `16384`). On wide queries this is about twice as fast, and queries no longer wait for a `COMPACT INDEX` or a memtable flush to finish (issues #9200, #9209, #9210).

**Impact:** scores can differ from earlier versions in the last bit, so documents with exactly equal scores may rank in a different order.

**Action:** none. Set `arcadedb.sparseVectorScoringWindow` to `0` to go back to the previous traversal.

#### 26.10.1 — The remote `ArcadeGraph` connects to the Gremlin port the server is bound to

The remote `ArcadeGraph` client used to connect to Gremlin Server on the fixed port `8182`. It now uses

the port the server advertises (`GET /api/v1/server?mode=cluster`, `ports.gremlin`), and falls back to `8182` when the server advertises none (issue #8578).

**Impact:** only a client that reaches Gremlin Server through a port mapping (for example a container or load balancer publishing `8182` to a different internal port), which worked by accident before.

**Action:** set the client setting `arcadedb.gremlin.client.port` to the port the client must connect to.

#### 26.10.1 — Negative zero equals zero, and a few query results change

`-0.0` is now equal to `0.0` everywhere (SQL and Cypher, `=`, `IN`, ordering, indexed or not), as IEEE 754 and openCypher define it.

**Action:** a HASH index over a `FLOAT` or `DOUBLE` property that already stores `-0.0`, or an LSM index that stored both `-0.0` and `0.0`, should be rebuilt once after upgrading:

```
REBUILD INDEX `Measure[value]`
```

Other results that change:

- `vector.neighbors`, `vector.sparseNeighbors` and `db.index.vector.queryNodes` on a parent type spec (`Parent[prop]`) now also search the records of its sub-types. Use the sub-type name in the spec to search only that sub-type.
- A `FLOAT` property is equal to the `DOUBLE` bound that narrows to it, so `<`, `⇐`, `>` and `>=` agree with `=` and with an index (`v = 16777217.0` finds `16777216f`, and `v < 16777217.0` no longer does).
- An integer bound above 2^53 on a `DOUBLE` property, or above 2^24 on a `FLOAT` property, is answered by a scan instead of the index, so the result is exact.

#### 26.10.1 — HASH indexes on a DECIMAL property need one `REBUILD INDEX` after upgrading

A `DECIMAL` keeps the scale it was written with, so `5` and `5.00` are the same number stored two different ways. The `LSM_TREE` index family already treated them as one key; the `HASH` family did not, because it settles key identity on the serialized bytes and the two spell out differently. A `UNIQUE_HASH` index on a `DECIMAL` property therefore accepted both as separate rows, and a lookup for one spelling could not find a row stored under the other. Fixed in 26.10.1 (issue #7767).

**Impact:** any `HASH`/`UNIQUE_HASH`/`NOTUNIQUE_HASH` index on a `DECIMAL` property created before 26.10.1. `LSM_TREE`/`UNIQUE`/`NOTUNIQUE` indexes are unaffected.

**Action:** run `REBUILD INDEX` once, after upgrading, on every HASH index over a `DECIMAL` property:

```
REBUILD INDEX `Invoice[amount]`
```

Until it is rebuilt, the index file still holds the keys in their original form and lookups stay unreliable. If duplicates slipped in while a `UNIQUE_HASH` constraint was not being enforced, the rebuild reports them as a duplicated key — correct the data, then rebuild again.

#### 26.10.1 — Case-insensitive HASH indexes need one `REBUILD INDEX` after upgrading

A `HASH`/`UNIQUE_HASH`/`NOTUNIQUE_HASH` index created with `COLLATE CI` did not actually fold case: an existing key and its differently-cased duplicate could both be inserted into a `UNIQUE_HASH` index, and a case-insensitive query answered through such an index could return fewer rows than the same query without an index. Fixed in 26.10.1 (issue #7766).

**Impact:** any `HASH`-family index with `COLLATE CI` created before 26.10.1. `LSM_TREE`/`UNIQUE`/`NOTUNIQUE` indexes with `COLLATE CI` already folded case correctly and are unaffected.

**Action:** run `REBUILD INDEX` once, after upgrading, on every case-insensitive HASH index:

```
REBUILD INDEX `Product[name]`
```

This rewrites the index with the keys folded correctly. See Case-insensitive indexes.

#### 26.10.1 - Writes that used to store NULL or a coerced value now fail

A value that the declared property type cannot take is refused with an error naming the property, instead of being stored silently as `NULL` or coerced (issues #8090, #9110). This covers:

- an unparsable datetime string written to a `DATETIME`/`DATE` property (the SQL timestamp form `2024-02-29 13:45:10.123456`, which PostgreSQL clients send, is now parsed instead of being stored as `NULL`);
- a number that overflows a `LONG`, `FLOAT` or `DOUBLE` property, an empty string written to a number, a fraction written to a `BOOLEAN`, and wrong-typed values written to `DECIMAL`, `DATETIME`, `BINARY` or `LINK` properties;
- a typed property set from a bare sub-query, for example `UPDATE Order SET id = (SELECT max(id) FROM Order)`, which used to store `NULL` and now fails with `Cannot convert type ArrayList to INTEGER`.

Schemaless properties are unaffected.

**Action:** fix the statements that now fail. For a sub-query, extract the scalar, for example `SET id = (SELECT max(id) AS m FROM Order)[0].m`.

#### 26.10.1 - A write computed from a stale read is refused

A property write on a record that another transaction changed after the current transaction read it is refused with a retryable `ConcurrentModificationException`, instead of silently overwriting the concurrent change (issue #8610). SQL `UPDATE` and Cypher `SET`/`MERGE`/`REMOVE` are not affected, since they compute their values from the latest data. See Isolation.

**Action:** retry the transaction on `ConcurrentModificationException` (the `database.transaction(…, retries)` API does). Set `arcadedb.txStaleReadCheck=false` to restore the previous last-writer-wins behavior.

#### 26.10.1 - `TRUNCATE TYPE` refuses a vertex or edge type that holds records

The refusal was documented but never fired, so `TRUNCATE TYPE` silently emptied live vertex and edge types (issue #8042).

**Action:** add `UNSAFE` where the truncation is intended. See TRUNCATE TYPE.

#### 26.10.1 - Postgres wire: `ROLLBACK TO SAVEPOINT` is refused

It used to answer success while keeping every write made since the savepoint, so the next `COMMIT` persisted them. It now fails with SQLSTATE `0A000` and the transaction must be rolled back. See Savepoints.

#### 26.10.1 - Stricter authorization for schema DDL and Gremlin scripting

- `ALTER TYPE` (including the edge-type `lightweight` and `unique` settings) and `REBUILD TYPE` require the `updateSchema` permission (security advisory GHSA-9c7g-grf7-j2r5).
- Gremlin capabilities that run code or touch files on the host are reserved to `root`: the `groovy` engine (and the `auto` fallback to it) over HTTP, Gremlin Server scripts in a language other than `gremlin-lang`, bytecode that carries a lambda, and the `io()` step on every engine (security advisory GHSA-h2j4-28h8-cj5v). Plain `gremlin-lang` traversals are unchanged. Embedded use without a bound user is unaffected.

**Action:** grant `updateSchema` to the users that manage types, and run Groovy scripts, lambdas and `io()` as `root` or rewrite them as `gremlin-lang` traversals. See Gremlin security.

#### 26.10.1 - API tokens minted over plain HTTP are logged

`POST /api/v1/server/api-tokens` over plain HTTP from a non-loopback peer still works, but logs a WARNING. The new gRPC `CreateApiToken` RPC always requires TLS or a loopback peer. With `arcadedb.server.apiTokenRequireSecureTransport=true` it is refused with `412`, and **the default of that setting is scheduled to change to `true` in 27.1.1**.

**Action:** mint tokens over HTTPS, from localhost, or through a reverse proxy listed in `arcadedb.server.apiTokenTrustedProxies`. See Create an API token and, for the Docker first-run flow on `http://localhost:2480`, Docker.

#### 26.10.1 - HA defaults that changed

| Setting | Before 26.10.1 | From 26.10.1 |
|---|---|---|
| `ha.securityConvergenceReadinessTimeout` | no gate | With `server.readinessRequiresHA` on, a node that joined at runtime or installed a snapshot reports NOT READY for up to 30 s until its users, groups and API tokens match the leader's (issues #7819, #8414). `0` disables it. |

| Setting | Before 26.10.1 | From 26.10.1 |
|---|---|---|
| `ha.securityEntryCapabilityGate` | n/a | `true`: creating or changing a group or API token is refused with `409` while any peer is down or still runs an older version, so a rolling upgrade never halts an old node. It succeeds once every node is up on 26.10.1. |
| `ha.txSchemaCheck` | n/a | `true`: a replica transaction prepared before a schema change the leader already applied is refused with a retryable `ConcurrentModificationException`. Expect retries on replicas during DDL. |
| `ha.divergedFollowerRecoveryDurationMs` | shared `ha.staleFollowerRecoveryDurationMs` (60000) | separate window, default 20000. A deployment that raised the old setting to delay the reformat of a diverged follower must raise this one. |
| `ha.grpcMaxConnectionIdleMs` | unbounded | 300000: an idle inbound Raft gRPC connection is closed with a GOAWAY and reopened on the next call. `0` restores the old behavior. |
| `ha.jvmPauseCloseThresholdMs` | Ratis closed the Raft division after a 60 s JVM pause | `0`: the division is not closed; a long pause still steps a leader down and the health monitor decides on recovery. Set `60000` to restore the old behavior. |

See HA cluster upgrade for the rolling-upgrade procedure.

#### 26.9.1 — Sparse-vector indexes need one `REBUILD INDEX` after upgrading

A partial compaction of an `LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR` index could give the merged segment a position ahead of a segment it had not merged. When that skipped segment held the tombstone for a document an older merged segment still had a live posting for, the delete was overruled and the document reappeared in `vector.sparseNeighbors` results — permanently, because the next full compaction then discarded the tombstone as the loser. The same inversion could restore a stale weight after an update. Fixed in 26.9.1 (issue #6379).

**Impact:** `LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR` indexes on databases created before 26.9.1 that have seen deletes or updates. Upgrading corrects the ordering for every new merge, but a segment already written under the old rule cannot be repaired automatically — the record of where it should have sat is gone.

**How to tell:** the server reports it once per affected index, when the index is opened:

```
Sparse-vector index 'Doc[tokens,weights]' holds 3 segment(s) whose precedence predates
the
recency-epoch fix (issue #6379); a document deleted before those segments were merged
may still
be returned by queries. Run 'REBUILD INDEX Doc[tokens,weights]' once to rewrite them
in the
```

```
correct order.
```

The flag behind that message is stored in the segment and inherited by any later merge, so ordinary write traffic compacting the affected segments away does not silence it. Nothing else distinguishes an affected index: queries succeed and the data looks intact.

**Action:** run once per sparse-vector index, after upgrading:

```
REBUILD INDEX `Doc[tokens,weights]`
```

This collapses the existing segments into a single correctly ordered segment. Indexes that have only ever been appended to are unaffected, as are databases created on 26.9.1 or later. See Sparse Vector Search.

**HA rolling upgrade:** the corrected ordering is recorded in the segment file, but reading it correctly requires the fix. During a staged rollout, a node still on the older build that receives a segment merged by an upgraded leader falls back to ordering by segment id and can still return a deleted document, until it is upgraded too. Upgrade every node before running the `REBUILD INDEX` above, and treat sparse-vector query results from a mixed-version cluster as provisional.

### 8.15.2. Single-server upgrade

1. Download and extract the new ArcadeDB release in a separate directory (do not overwrite the old install).
2. Stop the running server (or close every open database via the HTTP `close database` command).
3. Copy the directories listed in What to copy from the old install into the new install, preserving the original paths.
4. Start the new server.

When the server starts, every database is opened with the new code and any required format migration is applied in place.

### 8.15.3. What to copy

ArcadeDB's root directory contains a fixed set of folders. Only a few of them hold user-owned state; the rest are recreated from the release archive on every install.

| Folder | Action | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| `databases/` | **Copy** | The actual database data. Every subdirectory is one database. This is the only folder strictly required for an upgrade. |
| `config/` | **Copy selected files** | The release ships a default `config/` directory. Carry over only the files you have actually modified — listing below. |

| Folder | Action | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| `backups/` | Copy if you want history | Backup archives produced by manual or automatic backups. The server does not need them to start; copy them only if you want to keep the backup history reachable from the Studio Backup tab and from `RESTORE DATABASE` commands. |
| `log/` | Skip | Server log files. Safe to start with an empty `log/` directory; the release ships an empty one. Copy only if you want to keep historical logs alongside the new install. |
| `raft-storage-<peerId>/` (HA only) | **Copy** | Per-node Raft log segments, created at runtime when HA is enabled. This storage is **durable by default** (`arcadedb.ha.raftPersistStorage=true`) and must be preserved so a node can rejoin by replaying its log instead of a full snapshot resync. When `raftPersistStorage` is explicitly `false`, it is ephemeral and can be skipped. See HA cluster upgrade for details. |
| `replication/` | Skip | Legacy directory from the pre-Raft replication implementation. Not used by the current HA stack. |
| `lib/`, `bin/` | Use the new release as-is | Java artifacts and start scripts. Always take them from the new release — do not copy from the old install. The only exception is custom JARs you have dropped into `lib/` yourself; carry those over by hand. |

#### Files to carry over from `config/`

The `config/` directory ships with a small set of defaults. You only need to copy the files that you have actually changed:

| File | When to copy |
|---|---|
| `server-users.jsonl` | Always, unless you create users only via REST/SQL on every upgrade. This is where ArcadeDB persists local users and their per-database group assignments. |
| `server-groups.json` | If you have customised the security policy (custom groups, type-level permissions, result-set limits). See Security Policy. |
| `backup.json` | If you have configured the auto-backup scheduler (schedule, retention, target directory). See Automatic Backup. |
| `arcadedb-log.properties` | If you have tuned `java.util.logging` settings (log levels, rolling file size, etc.). |
| `gremlin-server.yaml`, `gremlin-server.groovy`, `gremlin-server.properties` | Only if you use the embedded Gremlin Server and have edited any of these. |

Everything else under `config/` (`arcadedb-log-all.properties`, `arcadedb-statefulset.yaml`, …) ships unchanged with each release; take the new version.

ArcadeDB does **not** read a `config/server-configuration.json` file in normal operation. Server-wide settings come from JVM system properties, environment variables and the `arcadedb-server.sh` arguments — see Server Configuration.

### 8.15.4. HA cluster upgrade

An HA cluster (see High Availability) is upgraded one node at a time. The per-node procedure is the same as single-server above, with the following clarifications.

What to migrate on each node:

- `databases/` — copy, exactly as in the single-server case.
- `config/` — copy the same files as in the single-server case. The cluster's identity is derived from `arcadedb.ha.clusterName` and the `root` password (the inter-node token is computed from them at startup), so as long as every node keeps the same cluster name and the same root password, the upgraded cluster reattaches to itself without any extra step.
- `raft-storage-<peerId>/` — **copy**. The local Raft log is durable by default (`arcadedb.ha.raftPersistStorage=true`), so preserve this directory across the upgrade to let the node rejoin by replaying its own log. Whether or not it is preserved, after the upgraded node rejoins the cluster the leader replays any missing entries via Raft or, if the node has fallen behind the purge boundary, streams a full snapshot over HTTP automatically. With `raftPersistStorage=false` this directory is ephemeral and can be skipped.
- `backups/` **and** `log/` — same as single-server.

Recommended rolling upgrade flow (zero downtime, requires quorum at all times):

1. Pick a non-leader node first.
2. Stop the node, install the new release in a separate directory, copy the folders listed above, start the new binary.
3. Wait until `GET /api/v1/cluster` reports the node as healthy and caught up (replication lag near zero).
    a. The Studio Cluster tab shows the same information visually.
4. Repeat for every remaining replica.
5. Step the leader down with `POST /api/v1/cluster/stepdown` (or simply stop it — Raft will elect a new leader) and upgrade it last.

From 26.10.1, a node that receives replicated TIMESERIES data for a type it does not have — or for a type that exists locally but is not a TIMESERIES one — refuses the entry, which quarantines that database and triggers an automatic resync from the leader. Earlier releases logged the problem and carried on, which left the node's copy of that type permanently behind the leader's with nothing but a log line to say so.

This should not occur during an ordinary rolling upgrade, since the entry that creates a type is always applied before data for it arrives. It is a safeguard for the

> case where it does — for instance a mixed-version window in which one node's build cannot construct a type another node has. If you see a database quarantined with a message about a TimeSeries sealed store, the resync will restore it; complete the rollout so every node runs the same build.

For first-time HA bring-up with a pre-existing database (e.g. when you scale a single-node install into a cluster), see Offline Cluster Bootstrap.

### 8.15.5. Docker / Kubernetes

When you run ArcadeDB from the official container image, the release is replaced atomically by changing the image tag. The only data that survives across container restarts is what lives on a persistent volume, so:

- Mount `/home/arcadedb/databases` on a persistent volume — this is the equivalent of "copy the `databases/` folder".
- Mount `/home/arcadedb/config` only if you have edited the files listed in Files to carry over from `config/`; otherwise let the image ship its defaults.
- Set `arcadedb.ha.raftStorageDirectory` to a static path (e.g. `/home/arcadedb/raft-storage`) and mount **that** path on a persistent volume. The default per-node directory is named `raft-storage-<nodeName>` dynamically, which a container runtime or Kubernetes cannot mount as a volume (a wildcard like `/home/arcadedb/raft-storage-*` is created literally, not expanded) — this is exactly what `raftStorageDirectory` is for. The Raft log is durable by default (`arcadedb.ha.raftPersistStorage=true`) so a restarted pod can replay its own log instead of resyncing from peers. With `raftPersistStorage=false`, the log is ephemeral and this mount is unnecessary.
- Mount `/home/arcadedb/backups` if you want to retain backup archives across pod restarts.

For Kubernetes specifics (StatefulSet, headless service, init container for pre-staging a database), see Kubernetes.

### 8.15.6. Downgrade ArcadeDB

In case you need to downgrade to an older version of ArcadeDB, check the binary compatibility between the versions. ArcadeDB uses semantic versioning with 100% on-disk compatibility for migration of databases up or down between **patch** versions (the `Z` in `X.Y.Z`). For minor or major downgrades the safest path is to export the database with the newer version and re-import it with the older version.

### 8.15.7. Downgrading a node of an HA cluster

A cluster running v26.10.1 or later replicates schema changes in a compact format that earlier builds cannot read. Those entries stay in the Raft log, so a node that is restarted on an older build replays them and ends up with a schema that no longer matches the rest of the cluster - silently.

**A node of a cluster that has run v26.10.1 or later must not be rolled back below it by restarting it on its existing Raft log.** If you have to go back that far, rebuild the node instead: stop it, delete its `raft-storage-<peerId>/` directory and its `databases/` folder, and start the older build so it

rejoins empty and takes a fresh copy from the leader.

This applies only to the Raft log, not to your data. Database files themselves keep the usual patch-version compatibility described above.

# Chapter 9. Security

## 9.1. Users

Users are stored in the file `config/server-users.jsonl` file. The JSONL format means one json per line. When the server starts always checks if there are any users configured. If the user file is empty, the `root` user is created with a password the user must enter in the console where the server is starting. Example:

```
+--------------------------------------------------------------------+
|                WARNING: FIRST RUN CONFIGURATION                    |
+--------------------------------------------------------------------+
| This is the first time the server is running. Please type a        |
| password of your choice for the 'root' user or leave it blank      |
| to auto-generate it.                                               |
|                                                                    |
| To avoid this message set the environment variable or JVM          |
| setting `arcadedb.server.rootPassword` to the root password to use.|
+--------------------------------------------------------------------+

Root password [BLANK=auto generate it]: ************
Please type the root password for confirmation (copy and paste will not work):
************
```

Example of `config/server-users.jsonl` file:

```
{"name":"root","password":"PBKDF2WithHmacSHA256$65536$hcv0joKV/o/q+KOVmcwNUqhEq1w2/j8O
VnEkkVjzkeg=$2q2u4rjUlJjgoKBX9sG0rV0bOh6aHo+RhHsOkXneGkM=","databases":{"*":["admin"]}
}
```

In the users file the following information are stored per user:

- Name, mandatory
- Password. It is always saved hashed by using the algorithm `PBKDF2` with a configurable salt (default = 32). The password is mandatory for all the users, but root. In the case root has no password, then ArcadeDB server asks to insert a password at startup (see above).
- Databases, as the map database name and set of groups for that database. "*" is a special wildcard and means any. The configuration `"databases":{"*":["admin"]}` means use the "admin" group for any database.

**Replication of user changes (clusters).** Since version 26.9.1, creating, updating and deleting a user is replicated to every server of the cluster whichever way it is done: the `/api/v1/server/users` endpoints (which Studio uses), the `create user` / `drop user` server commands, and the Cypher `CREATE USER`, `ALTER USER … SET PASSWORD` and `DROP USER` statements.

> Before 26.9.1 only the server commands replicated. A user created through the REST endpoints or through Cypher existed on the serving node alone, so behind a load balancer it authenticated only intermittently - and a deletion answered `200` while the credentials kept working on every other node.
>
> Deleting a user or changing its password also revokes that user's active login tokens immediately, on every node - see Token-Based Authentication.
>
> Since 26.10.1 each server also keeps `config/server-security-cluster.json` beside the user, group and API-token files. It holds only a checksum of the last security document that server received from the cluster, which is what lets it tell a change it has already applied from one built on an out-of-date view. Keep it with the rest of the configuration directory; if it is lost the server rebuilds it on the next security change.
>
> Before 26.10.1 a cluster whose servers were started from a static server list - rather than joined with `connect cluster` or the `addpeer` endpoint - could accept the first user change on only one node, because each server hashes passwords with its own random salt and so starts with a different user file. Upgrade every server to 26.10.1; if a user exists on only some nodes, reissue the change once and the cluster converges.
>
> If a server cannot write `config/server-users.jsonl` - a full or read-only volume - it logs a SEVERE error and keeps running, applying the change in memory so it takes effect there straight away (before 26.10.1 the server stopped, and restarted into the same failure). Only saving the file failed, and that is not retried: after fixing the volume, reissue the user change, or that server reverts to the previous users on its next restart.

ArcadeDB allows each user to belong to zero or multiple groups. If no groups are defined, the default setting for the group `*` are used.

The following configuration defines "Jay" user to belong to "BlogWriters" in "Blog" database and "Editors" in the "Library" database:

```
{
  "databases": {
    "Blog": ["BlogWriters"],
    "Library": ["Editors"]
  }
}
```

The declaration above implicitly assigns Jay to the default group for any other database configured. The default configuration for the default group is no access, where the user cannot read or write in the database.

### 9.1.1. Via Console

Alternatively, users can be created via the console, see `Create User` Console Command and Server Command.

### 9.1.2. Via Cypher

Users can also be managed using Cypher commands when running in server mode:

```
SHOW USERS
CREATE USER bob SET PASSWORD 'SecurePass123!'
ALTER USER bob SET PASSWORD 'NewPass456!'
DROP USER bob
```

See Cypher User Management for the full reference.

### 9.1.3. Password hash format

The recommended way to create or update a user's password is through the HTTP API (`POST /api/v1/server/users`), the Console (`CREATE USER`), or Cypher (`CREATE USER … SET PASSWORD …`). All three paths produce a correctly-formatted hash for you. Hand-editing `config/server-users.jsonl` is supported but error-prone; the rest of this section only matters if you are generating the hash yourself (for example from a provisioning script).

Each password is stored as a single string with four dollar-separated fields:

```
<algorithm>$<iterations>$<salt-base64>$<derived-key-base64>
```

Example:

```
PBKDF2WithHmacSHA256$65536$hcv0joKV/o/q+KOVmcwNUqhEq1w2/j8OVnEkkVjzkeg=$2q2u4rjUlJjgoK
BX9sG0rV0bOh6aHo+RhHsOkXneGkM=
```

Field meaning:

| Field | Description |
|---|---|
| `algorithm` | Default `PBKDF2WithHmacSHA256`. Configured by `arcadedb.server.securityAlgorithm`. |
| `iterations` | Default `65536`. Configured by `arcadedb.server.saltIterations`. |
| `salt-base64` | 32 random bytes, Base64-encoded. See the note below for the subtle detail. |
| `derived-key-base64` | The 256-bit (32-byte) PBKDF2 output, Base64-encoded. |

When verifying a password, the server feeds PBKDF2 the **UTF-8 bytes of the Base64 salt string**, not the raw 32 salt bytes. In other words, the text that appears between the second and third `$` characters is taken verbatim and hashed with the user-supplied password. Any external tool that generates this hash must do the same, otherwise the stored hash will never match at login time and the user will be rejected with `403 User/Password not valid`.

This is an implementation detail of the current storage format, preserved for compatibility with existing user files. It is not a security weakness, only a thing to be aware of when generating hashes outside the server.

The following Python snippet produces a hash that the server accepts:

```
import base64, hashlib, secrets

def hash_password(plaintext: str, iterations: int = 65536) -> str:
    raw = secrets.token_bytes(32)
    salt_b64 = base64.b64encode(raw).decode("ascii")
    derived = hashlib.pbkdf2_hmac(
        "sha256",
        plaintext.encode("utf-8"),
        salt_b64.encode("utf-8"),   # the Base64 string, NOT the raw bytes
        iterations,
        dklen=32,
    )
    derived_b64 = base64.b64encode(derived).decode("ascii")
    return f"PBKDF2WithHmacSHA256${iterations}${salt_b64}${derived_b64}"
```

## 9.2. Groups

If a user has not assigned group in a database, the default group “*” is taken. The wildcard “*” represents all the groups that are not defined in this configuration. By default, such a group has no access to the database in read and write. Below you can find the default configuration for the default group “*”.

```
{ "*": {
  "types": {"*": {"access": []}},
  "access": [],
  "readTimeout": -1,
  "resultSetLimit": -1
} }
```

Where:

- `types` is the map of type and access level. The wildcard “*” represents all the types that are not defined in this configuration.

- `access` is the array containing the allowed permissions for the group. The supported permission at group level are:
  - `updateSecurity`: to update the security settings (create, modify and delete users, groups, etc.). This also gates defining a JavaScript function via `DEFINE FUNCTION ⋯ LANGUAGE js` — see User Functions.
  - `updateSchema`: to update the database schema (create, modify and drop buckets, types and indexes, including every `ALTER TYPE` form and the `REBUILD TYPE` and `REBUILD INDEX` maintenance commands)
  - `updateDatabaseSettings`: to change per-database settings — e.g. `ALTER DATABASE`, `ALTER TYPE ⋯ BUCKETSELECTIONSTRATEGY`, materialized-view / continuous-aggregate refresh and downsampling policies. The LOAD CSV access settings (`arcadedb.opencypher.loadCsv.allowRemoteUrls`, `allowFileUrls`, `importDirectory` and `blockedIpRanges`) are security controls, so changing them with `ALTER DATABASE` also requires `updateSecurity`.
- `readTimeout` if present, specify the maximum timeout for read operations. -1 means no limits. If set, all the read operations (lookups and queries) will be limited to maximum `<readTimeout>` milliseconds. This is useful to limit users to execute expensive commands and queries impacting the performance of the server and therefore other connected users.
- `resultSetLimit` if present, specify the maximum number of entries in the result set returning from a command or query. -1 means no limits. If set, any query or command will be interrupted when this limit is reached. This is useful to limit users to retrieve huge result sets impacting the performance of the server and therefore other connected users.

You can profile the access of each group up to the type level.

- `createRecord`, allows creating new records
- `readRecord`, allows reading records
- `updateRecord`, allows updating records
- `deleteRecord`, allows deleting records

creating an edge is technically 2 operations: (1) create a new edge record and (2) update the vertices with the reference. For this reason, if you want to allow a user to create edges, you have to grant the `createRecord` permission on the edge type and `updateRecord` on the vertex type.

Example of the definition of the group for a Blog writer, where he can only read from the "Blog" type and have full access to the "Post" type:

```
{
  "types": {
    "*": {
      "access": []
    },
    "Blog": {
      "access": [
```

```
        "readRecord"
      ]
    },
    "Post": {
      "access": [
        "createRecord",
        "readRecord",
        "updateRecord",
        "deleteRecord"
      ]
    }
  }
}
```

The default settings for the `admin` group are:

```
{
  "access": [
    "updateSecurity",
    "updateSchema",
    "updateDatabaseSettings"
  ],
  "resultSetLimit": -1,
  "readTimeout": -1,
  "types": {
    "*": {
      "access": [
        "createRecord",
        "readRecord",
        "updateRecord",
        "deleteRecord"
      ]
    }
  }
}
```

Which allows to execute any operation against the security, the schema, the database settings and records.

When ArcadeDB opens a `server-groups.json` written before the `updateDatabaseSettings` permission existed, it automatically migrates existing `admin` groups to include it, so upgraded clusters keep full administrative access without a manual edit.

Here is an example for an append-only group:

```
"appendonly": {
  "access": [],
```

```
  "resultSetLimit": -1,
  "readTimeout": -1,
  "types": {
    "*": {
      "access": [
        "createRecord",
        "readRecord"
      ]
    }
  }
}
```

Which allows the group members to read and create, but not to update or delete records. Such a group can be useful for ledgers, block chains, or data provenance.

You can use any JSON editor to edit the file `config/server-groups.json`. It's recommended to keep a copy of the current file before editing the groups. In this way if there are any errors, it's easy to restore the previous file.



Since version 26.9.1, a change to a group takes effect immediately for users that are already connected, whether it is made through the `/api/v1/server/groups` endpoints or by editing `config/server-groups.json`.

Before 26.9.1 the database-level permissions (`updateSchema`, `updateSecurity`, `updateDatabaseSettings`) and the `resultSetLimit` / `readTimeout` limits were read only the first time a user touched a database and never re-read, so a revoked permission stayed usable - and a newly granted one stayed unusable - until the server was restarted. If you have been restarting the server to apply group changes, you no longer need to.

Since version 26.11.1, the same applies to the user itself on the PostgreSQL, Bolt, MongoDB and Redis protocols: if a user is deleted, its database access is removed or its password is changed, the connections it already had open are refused on their next request, as on HTTP. Open Bolt transactions of that user are rolled back.

## 9.3. Security Policy

The default rules of security are pretty basic. The username must be between 4 and 256 characters. The password length must be between 8 and 256 characters. You can implement your own security policy by providing your own implementation:

```
server.getSecurity().setCredentialsValidator( new DefaultCredentialsValidator(){
  @Override
  public void validateCredentials(final String userName, final String userPassword)
throws ServerSecurityException {
    if( userPassword.equals("12345678") )
      throw new ServerSecurityException("Guess who was not attending security
lesson!");
```

```
  }
});
```

## 9.4. Handling Secrets

Passing secrets, like passwords, safely to the server, especially in containers, can be tricky. For example, the settings:

```
-Darcadedb.server.rootPassword=password
```

for the root password, or:

```
-Darcadedb.server.defaultDatabases=database[username:password]
```

for database and user generation are comfortable, but present the issue that passwords passed this way are readable in plaint text in applications like `htop` or `docker compose top`. This is the case because these settings are passed ultimately via command-line to the JVM (even if using `JAVA_OPTS` or `ARCADEDB_SETTINGS`).

In the following, an approach is presented to avoid this problem. The idea is to use the special environment variable `JAVA_TOOL_OPTIONS` to pass the settings directly into the JVM (alternatively `JDK_JAVA_OPTIONS` or the undocumented `_JAVA_OPTIONS` may be used). However, just using this particular environment variable would mean that the JVM writes the contents of this variable to the standard error stream, which means the secrets would appear in logs.

For the root password this can be avoided using the setting:

```
-Darcadedb.server.rootPasswordPath=/path/to/root_secret
```

which passes the secret via a plain text file which is mounted to a known path inside the container. This is a common practice to pass secrets to containers, for example with Docker compose, and it is how the example Kubernetes manifest supplies the root password, from a mounted `Secret`. A trailing newline, which most editors and `echo` append, is not treated as part of the password, and an empty file is rejected with an error naming it rather than silently accepted (*since v26.9.1*).

The same file-based approach is available for the High Availability cluster token using:

```
-Darcadedb.ha.clusterTokenPath=/path/to/cluster_token
```

It is read only when `arcadedb.ha.clusterToken` is not set, and the file content is trimmed of surrounding whitespace, so a trailing newline added by most editors or `echo` does not break the token comparison between nodes.

To suppress this logging for non-root secrets, a workaround can be used by providing the secret

also file-based and wrapping the `server.sh` script:

```
#!/bin/sh

export JAVA_TOOL_OPTIONS="-Darcadedb.server.defaultDatabases=database1[user1:`cat
/path/to/user_secret`]"
./bin/server.sh 2> >(grep -v "^Picked up JAVA_TOOL_OPTIONS:") &

PID="$!"

unset JAVA_TOOL_OPTIONS

wait $PID
```

This way the secrets are passed directly into the JVM without being resolved before, and the `stderr` logging is filtered. The server is send to the background and its process ID saved. Then, by unsetting the `JAVA_TOOL_OPTIONS` variable immediately after using it, ensures the secrets will not linger in the environment.

## 9.5. Gremlin Security

ArcadeDB provides two Gremlin execution engines with different security profiles.

**CRITICAL SECURITY NOTICE**: The Groovy Gremlin engine is **NOT SECURE** and should **NOT be used in production environments** or with untrusted users. Despite security restrictions, it remains vulnerable to remote code execution (RCE) attacks. Always use the Java engine (default) for production deployments.

### 9.5.1. Execution Engines

**Java Engine (Default - Secure)**

The native Java engine parses Gremlin queries using a restricted grammar and generates bytecode. This engine:

- Only accepts valid Gremlin traversal syntax
- Cannot execute arbitrary Java code
- Blocks `Runtime.getRuntime().exec()` and similar attacks
- **Recommended for ALL deployments**
- **Required for production and security-critical environments**

**Groovy Engine (Legacy - INSECURE)**

**SECURITY VULNERABILITY**: The Groovy engine is vulnerable to Remote Code Execution (RCE) attacks. Authenticated users can execute arbitrary operating system commands. **DO NOT USE IN PRODUCTION.**

The Groovy engine provides dynamic scripting capabilities but has critical security limitations:

- Supports Groovy-specific syntax and dynamic features
- **Cannot be adequately secured** - `SecureASTCustomizer` has known bypasses
- Vulnerable to: `Runtime.exec()`, `ProcessBuilder`, file system access, reflection
- **Only use for development/testing in fully trusted environments**
- Will display a security warning at startup

### 9.5.2. Who Can Evaluate Groovy

Evaluating Groovy is running arbitrary code on the server host, so its reach is the whole server, not one database. Since 26.10.1 ArcadeDB reserves it to the server administrator (`root`) on every entry point. A per-database grant, including a database administrator holding `updateSecurity`, is not enough:

- **HTTP command endpoint** (`POST /api/v1/command/{database}` with `"language": "gremlin"`): when the database runs the `groovy` engine, or the `auto` engine falls back to Groovy, any other user gets `403 Forbidden`. Under the default `java` engine nothing changes: every authorized user keeps running traversals.
- **Gremlin Server** (port 8182): a string script submitted in a language other than `gremlin-lang` is refused for any other user. A script with no language is evaluated by TinkerPop as `gremlin-groovy`, so it is refused too. The same applies to a bytecode traversal carrying a lambda (e.g. `Lambda.function(…)`), whose body is Groovy source. Bytecode traversals without lambdas, and string scripts submitted with language `gremlin-lang`, stay available to every authorized user:

  ```
  client.submit("g.V().count()", RequestOptions.build().language("gremlin-lang"
  ).create());
  ```

The `io()` step (`g.io('/path/file.xml').read()` / `.write()`) reads or writes a file at a caller-chosen path on the server host, so it is reserved to `root` as well, on every engine including `java`. The restriction cannot be lifted from the request: a `withoutStrategies(…)` naming the strategy that enforces it is ignored. Use EXPORT DATABASE and IMPORT DATABASE to move data in and out of a database.

In embedded mode no user is bound to the request, so none of these checks apply.

### 9.5.3. Configuration

Set the engine via database configuration:

```
-- Secure (default)
ALTER DATABASE `arcadedb.gremlin.engine` 'java';

-- Legacy with security restrictions (use only if needed)
ALTER DATABASE `arcadedb.gremlin.engine` 'groovy';
```

```
-- Auto-detect (not recommended for production)
ALTER DATABASE `arcadedb.gremlin.engine` 'auto';
```

Or via JVM startup parameters:

```
# Set to Java engine (secure)
java -Darcadedb.gremlin.engine=java ...

# Set to Groovy engine (use only if needed)
java -Darcadedb.gremlin.engine=groovy ...
```

### 9.5.4. Security Best Practices

1. **Use Java Engine**: **ALWAYS** use `'java'` engine in production - this is non-negotiable for security
2. **Never Use Groovy in Production**: The Groovy engine is vulnerable to RCE and cannot be secured
3. **Least Privilege**: Grant Gremlin query permissions only to fully trusted administrators
4. **Input Validation**: Never accept Gremlin queries from untrusted sources
5. **Audit Logging**: Monitor all Gremlin query execution for suspicious patterns
6. **Network Isolation**: Run ArcadeDB in isolated network segments
7. **Authentication Required**: Always require authentication for Gremlin access

### 9.5.5. Security Limitations (Groovy Engine)

Despite attempts to restrict dangerous operations, the Groovy engine remains vulnerable to:

- **Process execution**: `Runtime.exec()`, `ProcessBuilder` - **NOT BLOCKED**
- **File system access**: `File`, `FileInputStream`, `Files`, `Paths` - **NOT BLOCKED**
- **Reflection**: `Method`, `Field`, `Constructor`, `Class.forName()` - **NOT BLOCKED**
- **Class loading**: `ClassLoader`, `GroovyClassLoader` - **NOT BLOCKED**
- **Network operations**: `URL`, `URLConnection`, `Socket` - **NOT BLOCKED**
- **System operations**: `System.exit()`, `System.load()` - **NOT BLOCKED**

The `SecureASTCustomizer` has inherent limitations that prevent effective sandboxing of Groovy scripts.

### 9.5.6. Migration from Groovy to Java Engine

If you are currently using the Groovy engine and want to migrate to the more secure Java engine:

1. **Test your queries**: Run your existing Gremlin queries with the Java engine to verify compatibility

2. **Update configuration**: Change the `arcadedb.gremlin.engine` setting to `'java'`
3. **Refactor if needed**: If you have Groovy-specific syntax, refactor to standard Gremlin traversal syntax
4. **Verify results**: Ensure query results are consistent between engines

Most standard Gremlin queries work identically on both engines. The Java engine is faster and more secure.

### 9.5.7. Security Considerations

**CRITICAL: Remote Code Execution Vulnerability**

The Groovy engine has a **CRITICAL SECURITY VULNERABILITY** that allows Remote Code Execution (RCE):

- **Vulnerability**: Authenticated users can execute arbitrary operating system commands
- **Impact**: Complete server compromise - attackers can read files, execute processes, access network
- **Mitigation**: The `SecureASTCustomizer` security restrictions are **INSUFFICIENT** and can be bypassed
- **Recommendation**: **NEVER use Groovy engine in production or with untrusted users**

Example of vulnerable code that executes successfully:

```
Runtime.getRuntime().exec("touch /tmp/owned")
new File("/etc/passwd").text
```

The Java engine (default) is **NOT vulnerable** to these attacks.

**Default Engine**: the default Gremlin engine is `'java'`, not `'auto'`, for security reasons. This protects users from RCE attacks.

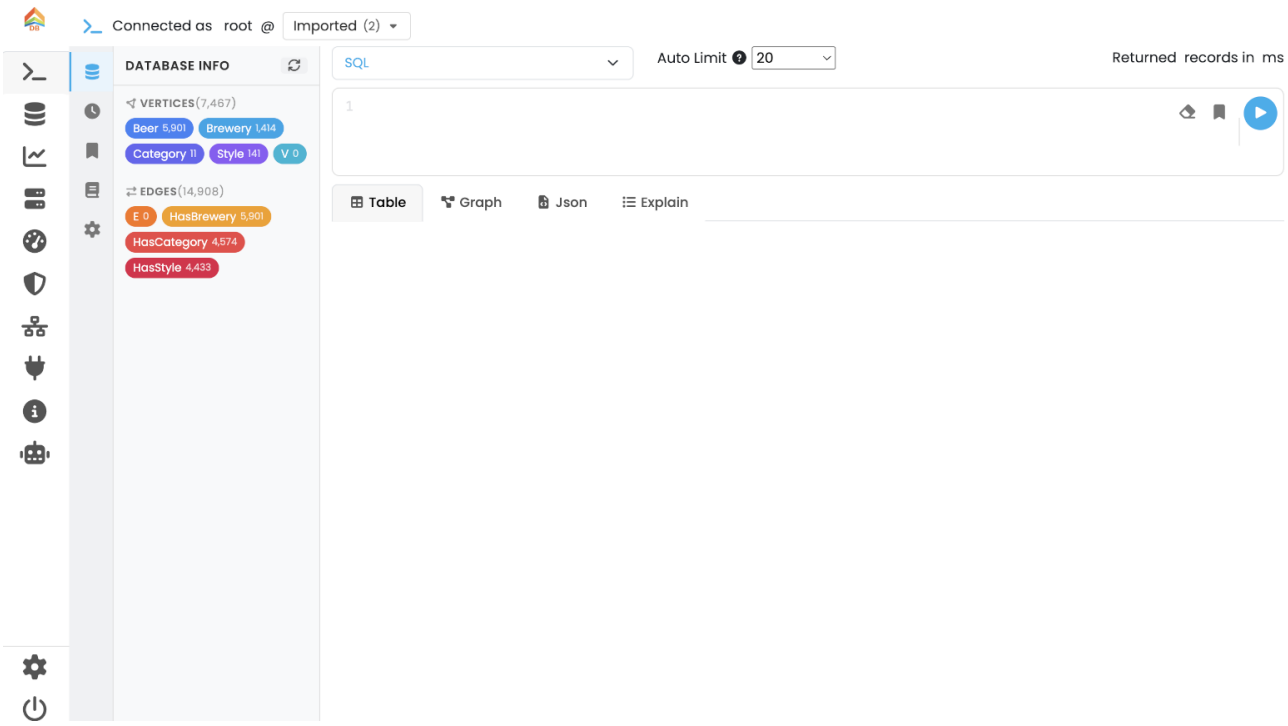
If you explicitly enable the Groovy engine (`arcadedb.gremlin.engine=groovy`), you will receive a **security warning** at startup, and your system will be vulnerable to RCE attacks.

**Error messages in production mode**: when the server runs with `arcadedb.server.mode=production`, the Gremlin Server (WebSocket, default channelizer) answers engine failures with the generic message "The request failed. Check the server log for the details" and no stack trace, so stored key values are not sent to the client. The real message is written to the server log. Another channelizer chosen in `gremlin-server.yaml` (for example HTTP) does not apply this, and the server logs a warning at startup.

# Chapter 10. Tools

## 10.1. Studio

ArcadeDB Studio is the web-based workbench that ships with every ArcadeDB server. You can open it by pointing a browser at the server and port that host the ArcadeDB server (in "development" or "test" mode); for a default local install this is http://localhost:2480 .




### 10.1.1. Main menu

The vertical icon bar on the left is the main navigation. Each icon opens one tab in the main canvas:

| Icon | Tab | Needs a selected database |
|---|---|---|
| □ | Query — write and execute commands in SQL, SQL Script, Open Cypher, Apache TinkerPop Gremlin, GraphQL, MongoDB, Redis or PromQL, or search a vector, hybrid or full-text index; visualise results as Table, Graph, Chart, JSON or Explain | Yes |
| □ | Database — manage schema, buckets, indexes, dictionary, time series (Time Series sub-tab), metrics, settings and per-database backups | Yes |
| □ | Server — server health summary, metrics, sessions, events, server-wide settings, auto-backup and MCP configuration | No |
| □ | Profiler — record and analyse query execution across protocols, save runs, optionally analyse with AI | No |

| Icon | Tab | Needs a selected database |
|---|---|---|
| □ | Security — manage users, user groups (roles) and API tokens | No |
| □ | Cluster — replication topology, leader election, peer add/remove | No |
| □ | API — browse and try the HTTP API endpoints from an interactive playground | No |
| □ | Info — quick links into this documentation | No |
| □ | AI Assistant — natural-language assistant for schema, queries and data modelling (paid add-on) | Yes |
| □ | Settings — Studio appearance (light/dark/system theme) | No |

The current user and database selector are shown at the top of every tab that operates on a database. Tabs that do not need a database (Server, Profiler, Security, Cluster, API, Info, AI, Settings) are enabled as soon as you sign in.

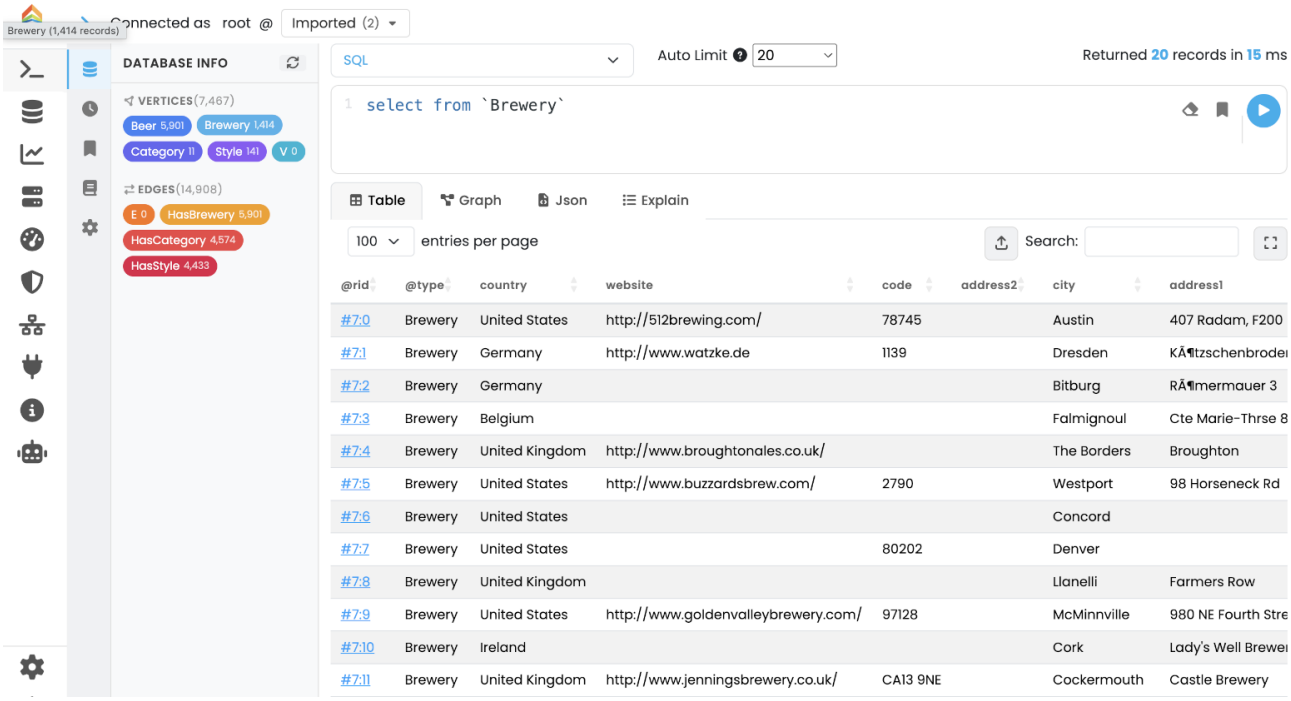
### 10.1.2. Login and themes

Studio uses the same users as the server (see Security). The theme (Light, Dark or System) is set from the Settings tab and persists across sessions.

A **Logout** button sits at the very bottom of the icon sidebar.

## 10.2. Query Panel

The **Query** panel is the everyday workspace: write a command in any supported language, run it against the selected database, and inspect the result as a table, a graph, a chart, a JSON document, or an execution plan.

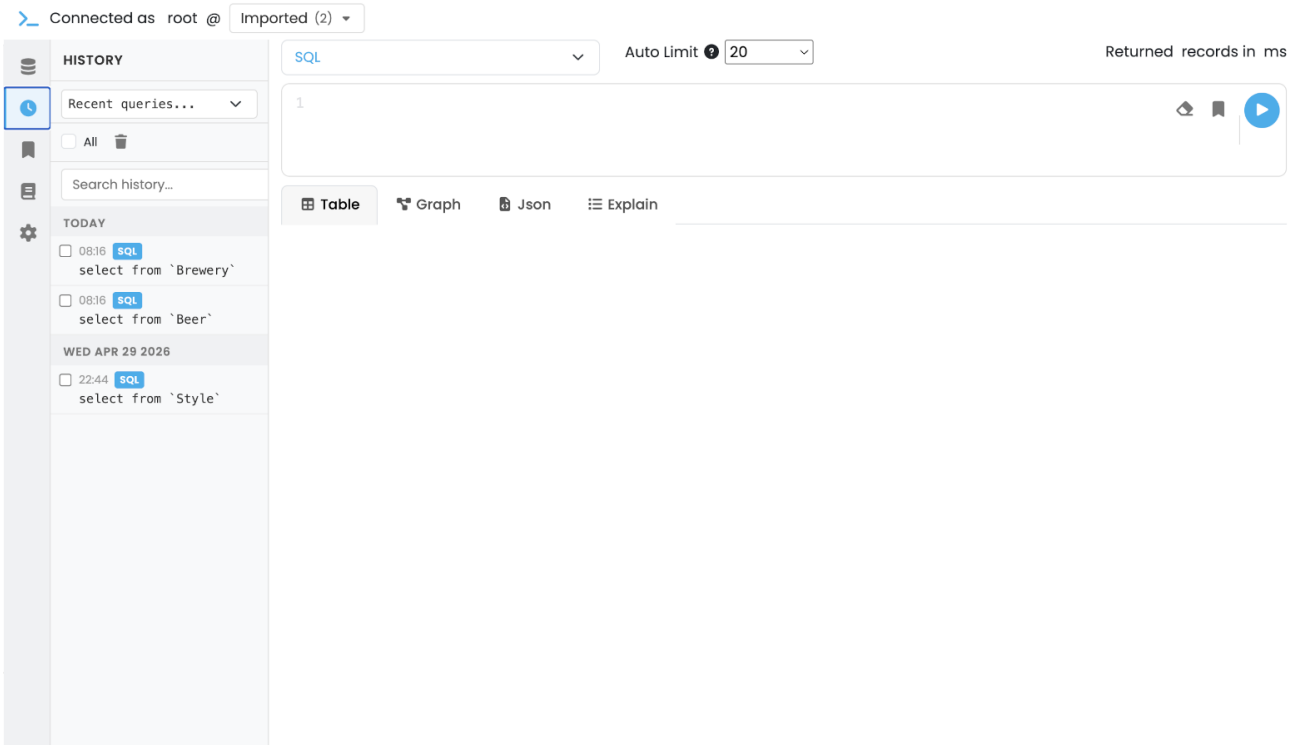



The header shows the current user and the **Database Selector**; pick the database to run against here. The status bar at the top right reports `Returned X records in Y ms` after every execution.

### 10.2.1. Left icon sidebar

The narrow icon column on the left of the editor switches between auxiliary panes; the main editor and results stay in place.

- **Overview** — summary information about the selected database (default view).
- **History** — list of recently executed commands. Click an entry to load it back into the editor.
- **Saved** — saved queries. Use the **Save Query** button in the editor toolbar to add the current command to this list.
- **Reference** — searchable reference of SQL functions and methods plus quick links to the other query languages.
- **Settings** — editor preferences (theme, font size, key bindings).

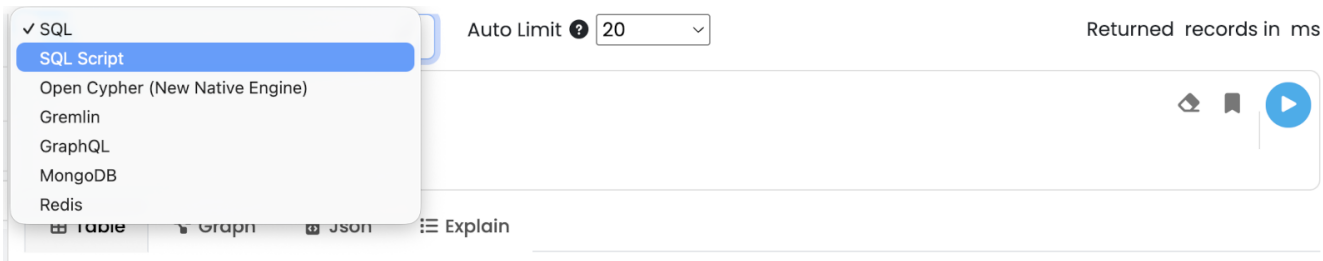



## 10.2.2. Editor and toolbar

The editor is a CodeMirror instance with syntax highlighting that follows the selected language.

The toolbar above the editor exposes:

- **Language** selector with: **SQL**, **SQL Script** (multi-statement), **Open Cypher** (native engine), **Apache TinkerPop Gremlin**, **GraphQL**, **MongoDB**, **Redis**, **PromQL (Time Series)**, and under **Index search**: **Vector search**, **Hybrid search**, **Full-text search** (see Index search).
- **Auto Limit** dropdown — caps the number of rows returned by interactive runs (`20`, `50`, `100`, `500`, **No Limits**). Useful to stay safe on large datasets; the cap is applied as a `LIMIT` when the language supports it.
- **Clear** — empties the editor.
- **Save Query** — adds the current command to the Saved pane in the sidebar.
- **Run** (or kbd:[Ctrl+Enter] / kbd:[Cmd+Enter]) — executes the command.




## 10.2.3. Index search (Vector, Hybrid, Full-text)

The last three entries of the **Language** selector query an index instead of running a command. Selecting one replaces the editor with a small form, while **Auto Limit** is hidden because the form carries its own `k` or limit. **Run**, **Clear**, **Save Query**, the history and the result views (Table, Json,

Explain) work as for any other language.

- **Vector search** - pick an `LSM_VECTOR` or `LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR` index, enter the query vector (`[0.12, -0.5, 0.33]` or `0.12, -0.5, 0.33`), `k`, an optional SQL `WHERE` filter, and for a dense index `efSearch`. For a sparse index you can also enter the sparse dimension ids.
- **Hybrid search** - the vector inputs above plus a full-text leg (index and Lucene query), the fusion strategy, per-leg weights and an optional graph expansion (edge types, direction, max depth).
- **Full-text search** - pick a `FULL_TEXT` index, enter a Lucene query (for example `+java -python`) and a limit.

The form checks what it can before sending: a vector whose length differs from the index dimensions is refused without a round trip, and the limits for `k`, `efSearch`, `limit` and `maxDepth` are read from the server, so they always match the running version. The index list is read from the database schema; a database without a vector or full-text index shows a note instead.

Each hit is one table row: `@rid`, `@type`, then the ranking value (`distance`, `score` or `fusedScore`, and for hybrid the `sources`), then the record properties. The **Json** tab holds the raw response, and the **Explain** tab summarizes which index answered, how it ranks, and whether the result window was filled. When the count reads **(truncated)**, more matches exist: raise `k`.

The form runs the same operations as the HTTP endpoints `POST /api/v1/vector/{database}/search`, `/hybrid` and `/fulltext`. These searches used to live in a separate **Vector** tab, which was removed.

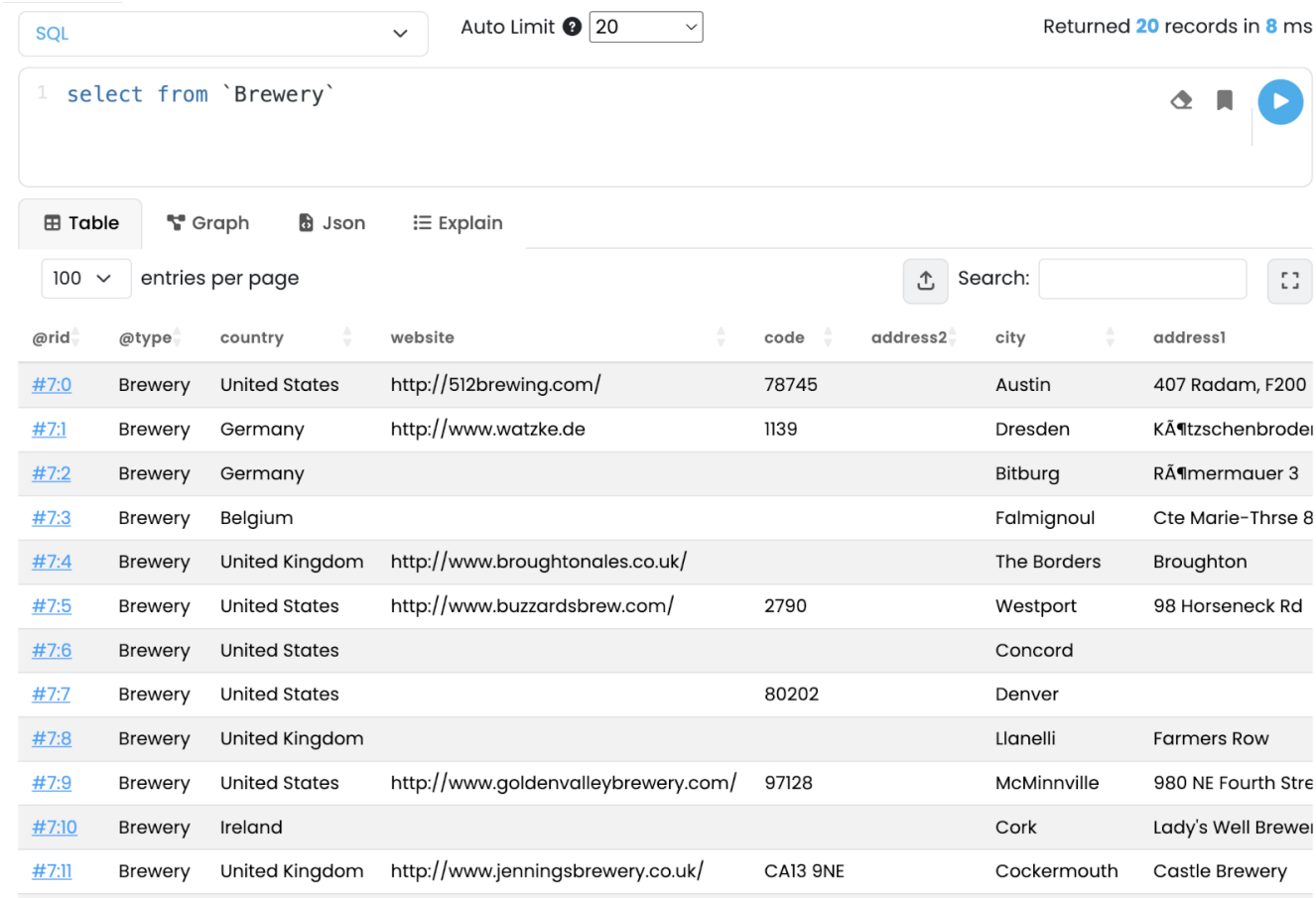
### 10.2.4. Result views

The result area sits below the editor and exposes four tabs. Studio automatically picks the most appropriate one for the result type, but you can switch at any time.

#### Table

Tabular view backed by DataTables with sorting, paging and per-column search.

- **Click a cell** to open the **Record Editor** in a modal overlay, where you can edit fields and save the record back to the database.
- The header tools allow exporting the current result to CSV.




| @rid | @type | country | website | code | address2 | city | address1 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| #7:0 | Brewery | United States | http://512brewing.com/ | 78745 | | Austin | 407 Radam, F200 |
| #7:1 | Brewery | Germany | http://www.watzke.de | 1139 | | Dresden | KÃ¶tzschenbroder |
| #7:2 | Brewery | Germany | | | | Bitburg | RÃ¶mermauer 3 |
| #7:3 | Brewery | Belgium | | | | Falmignoul | Cte Marie-Thrse 8 |
| #7:4 | Brewery | United Kingdom | http://www.broughtonales.co.uk/ | | | The Borders | Broughton |
| #7:5 | Brewery | United States | http://www.buzzardsbrew.com/ | 2790 | | Westport | 98 Horseneck Rd |
| #7:6 | Brewery | United States | | | | Concord | |
| #7:7 | Brewery | United States | | 80202 | | Denver | |
| #7:8 | Brewery | United Kingdom | | | | Llanelli | Farmers Row |
| #7:9 | Brewery | United States | http://www.goldenvalleybrewery.com/ | 97128 | | McMinnville | 980 NE Fourth Stre |
| #7:10 | Brewery | Ireland | | | | Cork | Lady's Well Brewe |
| #7:11 | Brewery | United Kingdom | http://www.jenningsbrewery.co.uk/ | CA13 9NE | | Cockermouth | Castle Brewery |

### Graph

Force-directed graph view powered by Cytoscape.js. Vertices and edges returned by the command are added to the canvas; existing nodes are kept so you can incrementally explore the graph.

Toolbar actions:

- **Search** — locate a node by `@rid` or a property value.
- **Redraw** — reapply the layout.
- **Select** — selection helpers: **Direct Neighbors**, **Orphans**, **Invert Selection**, **Shortest Path**.
- **Cut** / **Crop** — remove the selected nodes / keep only the selected nodes.
- **Import** / **Export** — JSON, GraphML, PNG, JPEG.
- **Settings** — per-type style overrides (label, color, size, icon).
- **Fullscreen** — expand the canvas to the full browser window.

Interactions:

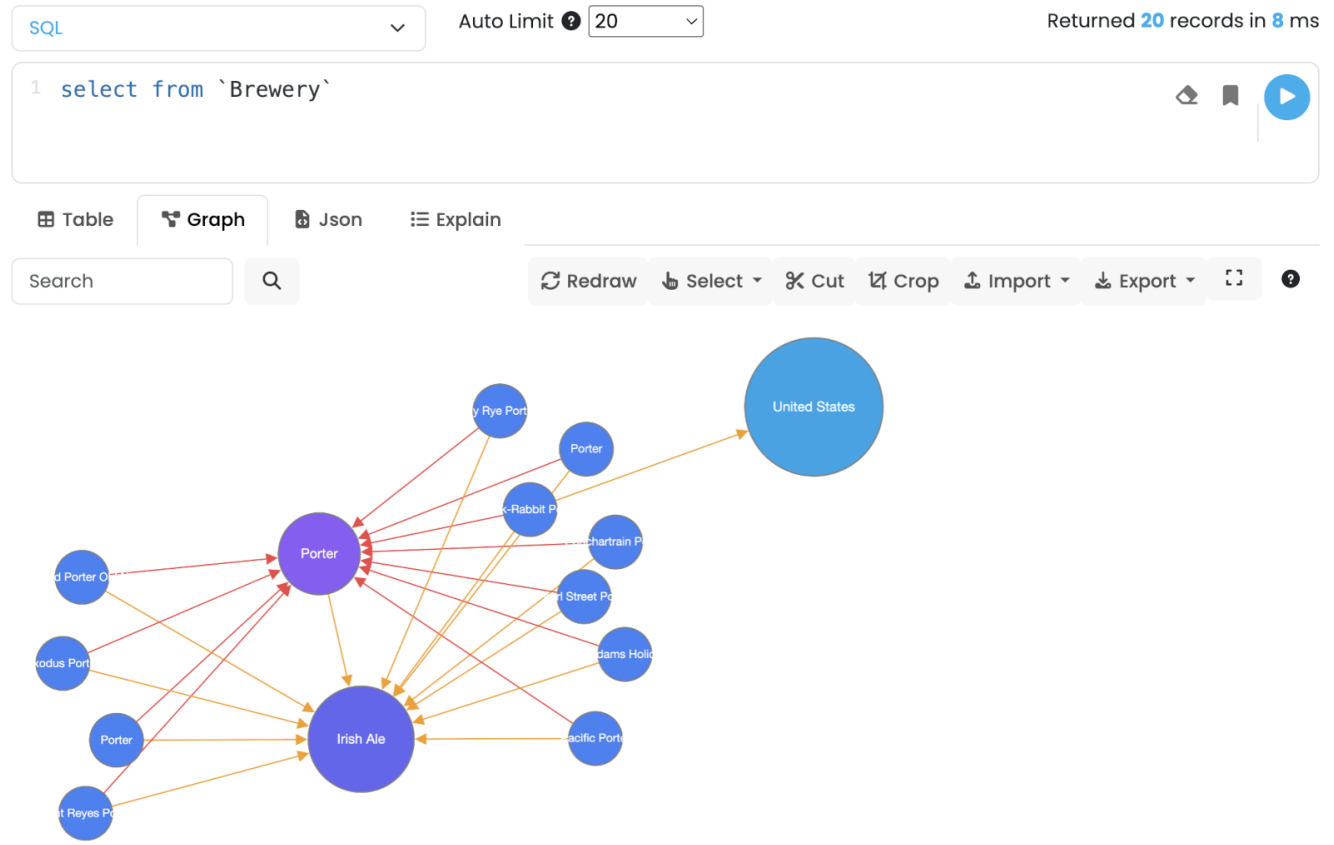
- **Click** on a node selects it; kbd:[Cmd]/kbd:[Ctrl]-drag rubber-bands a block selection.
- **Hold the mouse** on a node opens its context menu (load neighbors, edit, delete).
- **Double-click** on a node loads its direct neighbors.

The node context menu offers four ways to expand:

- the three arrows load **all** neighbours - both directions, outgoing only, incoming only;

- the **funnel** opens the relationship picker, where you choose exactly what to add.

The picker lists one row per relationship type and direction with its edge count, largest first, so you can add only the `Bought` edges going out and the `Knows` edges coming in, rather than everything at once. A **Max elements per direction** box caps how much a single expansion may add. This is what keeps a node with thousands of connections from filling the canvas with a hairball; the counts are computed on the server, so opening the picker does not download those edges just to count them. Available since 26.10.1.




### Chart

The **Chart** tab plots the rows of the last result, whatever language produced them: SQL, Open Cypher, Gremlin, PromQL and so on. The role of each column is inferred from its values, and every choice can be changed in the tab:

- **X axis** - the first time column (epoch milliseconds or an ISO date string), otherwise the first text column, otherwise the row number. A time axis is sorted; a text axis keeps the row order, so a `GROUP BY` result becomes a bar-friendly category chart.
- **Measures** - the numeric columns to plot, one line, area or bar series each.

- **Split by** - a text column to turn into one series per value. On a time chart it defaults to the first text column with at most 12 distinct values (a host, a metric label), so a result with `ts, host, usage` draws one line per host.
- **Line**, **Area**, **Bar** - the chart type.

Record metadata (`@rid`, `@type`) and nested values are not plotted, and a value that is not a number leaves a gap rather than a zero. Chart does not run anything by itself: run a query as usual, then open the tab.

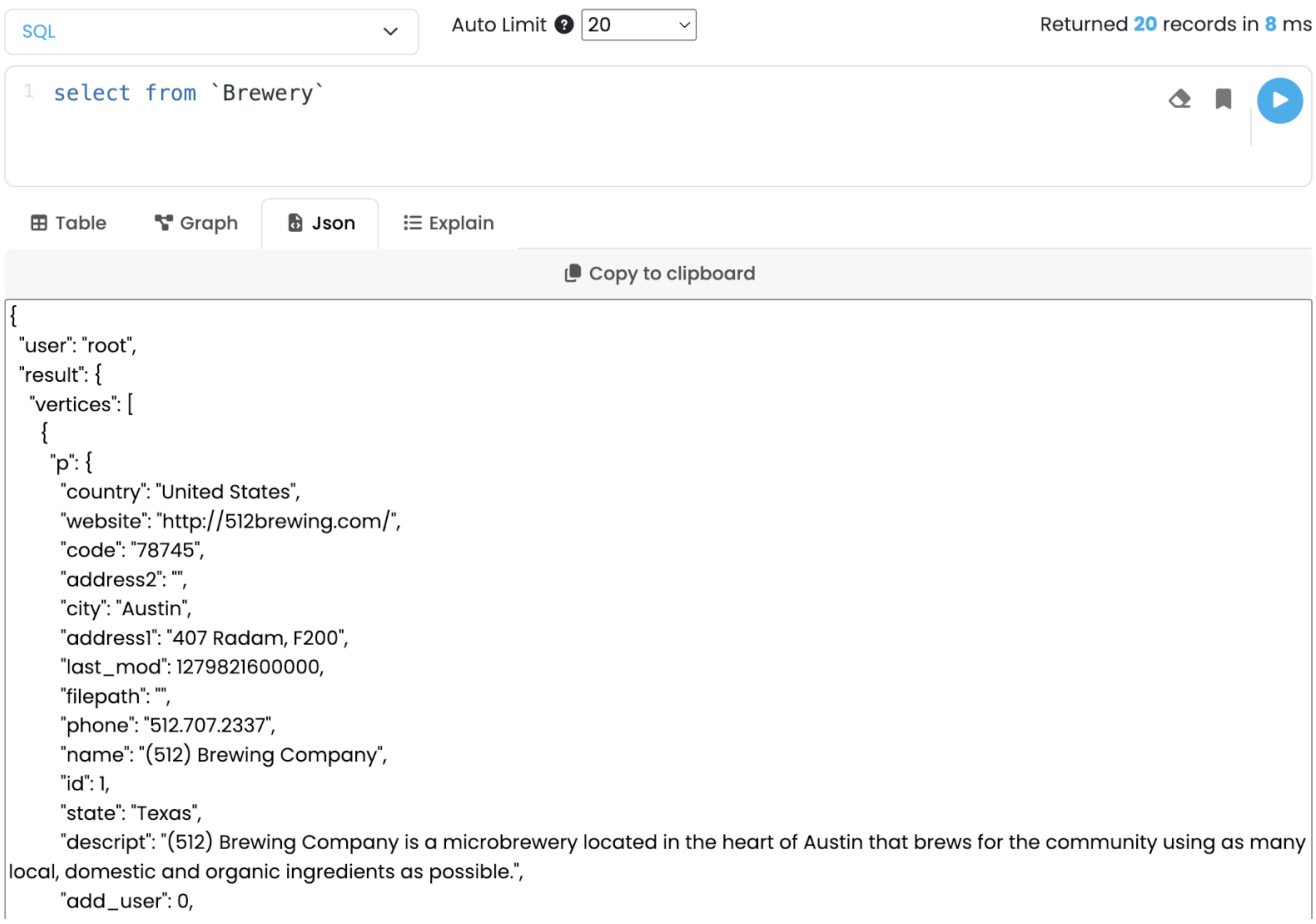
```
SELECT ts, host, usage FROM Cpu
```

### PromQL

Selecting **PromQL (Time Series)** in the language selector lets you type a PromQL expression, for example `Cpu{host="a"}`. **Auto Limit** is replaced by a **Range** (last 5 minutes to 7 days) and a **Step** (1 second to 1 hour). The expression runs as a range query against the database's Prometheus-compatible endpoint, and the points arrive as rows `timestamp`, `metric`, `value`, so they can be read in the Table and Json tabs; the Chart tab opens automatically, with one series per `metric`.

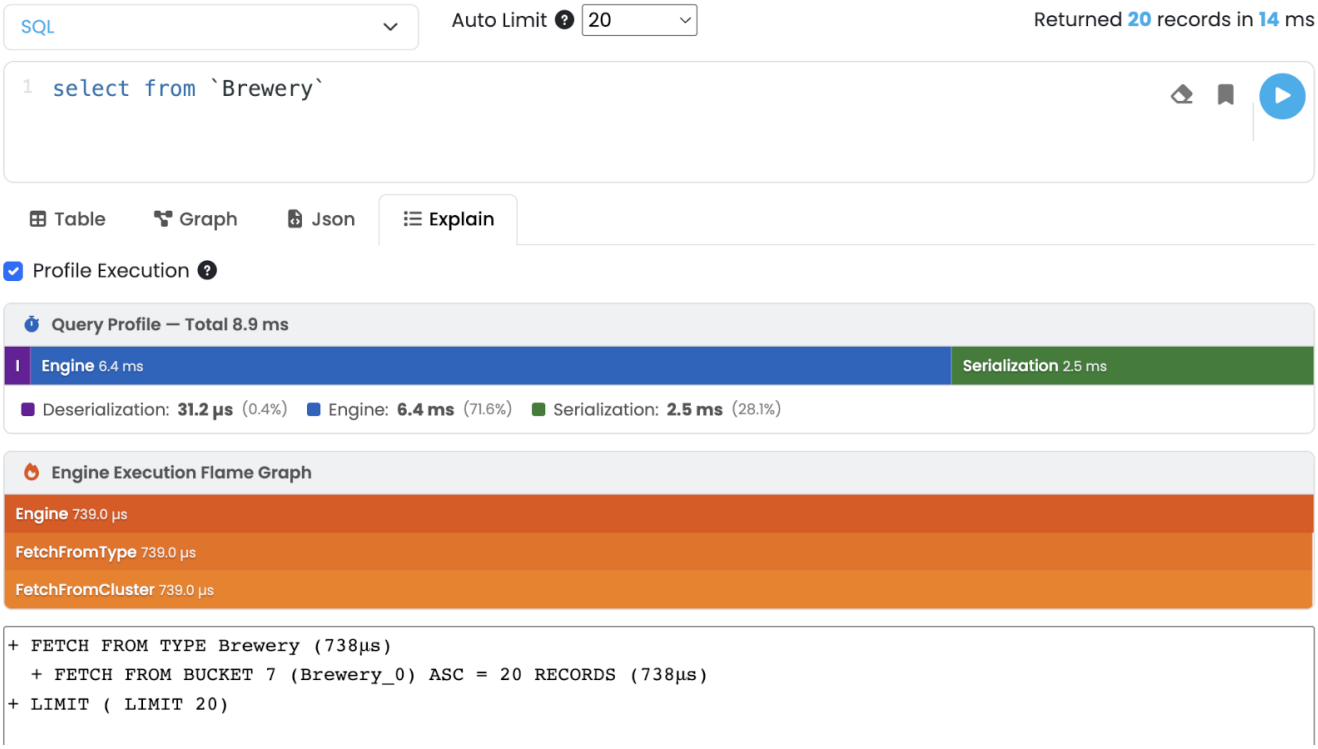
### JSON

The raw response is rendered as pretty-printed JSON in a read-only viewer. A **Copy to Clipboard** button copies the full payload.



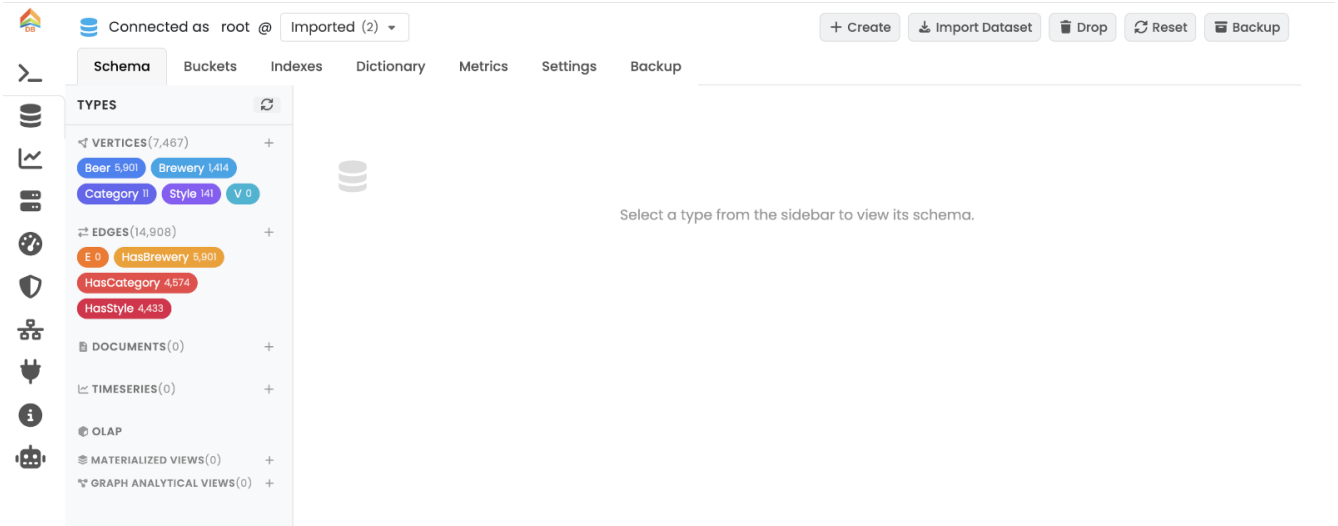
### Explain

Shows the execution plan for the current command. Tick **Profile Execution** before running to collect per-step timings; the result is rendered as a flame graph on top of the textual plan, so you can spot the heaviest steps at a glance. Profiling times the query as it normally runs, without changing how it is executed, so the numbers describe the same work the query does when profiling is off.




# 10.3. Database Panel

The **Database** panel manages everything that lives inside one database: schema, storage layout, indexes, dictionary, time series, metrics, settings and per-database backups.




The header shows the current user, the database selector, and the database-level actions:

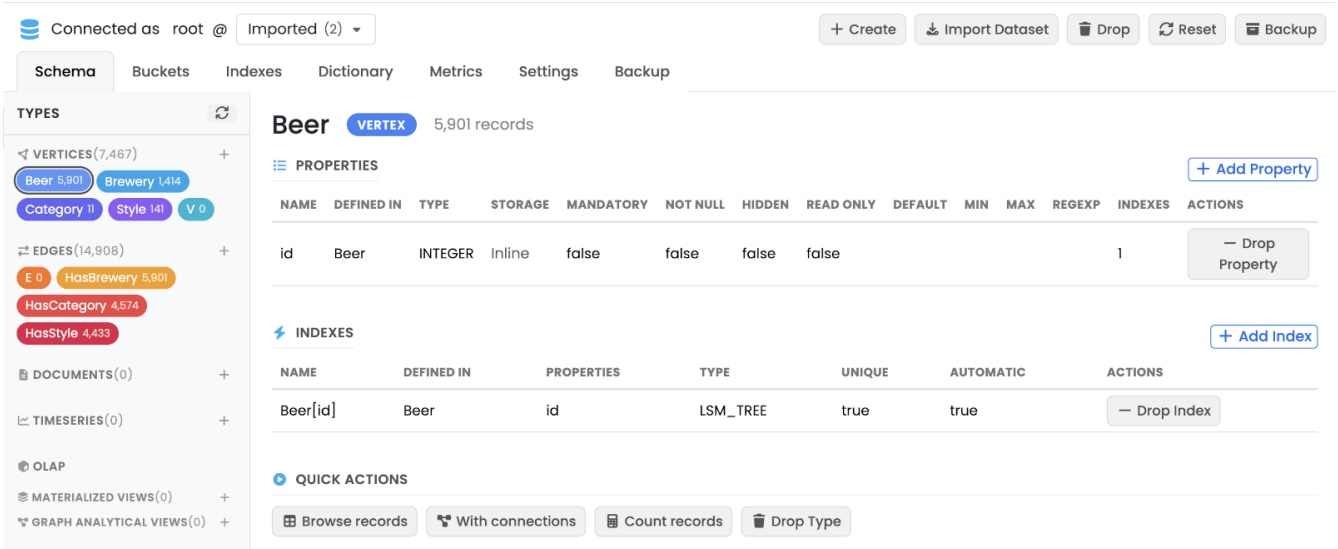
- **Create Database** — create a new database from a name.

- **Import Dataset** — open a modal to import a dataset (e.g. importer formats, JSON, OrientDB or Neo4j export).
- **Drop Database** — ***irreversible*** removal of the current database.
- **Reset Database** — drop all data and schema while keeping the database file.
- **Backup Database** — trigger an immediate backup of the current database. The resulting file is written under `backups/<db-name>/<db-name>-backup-<timestamp>.zip`. See Backup.

The panel is split into seven sub-tabs.

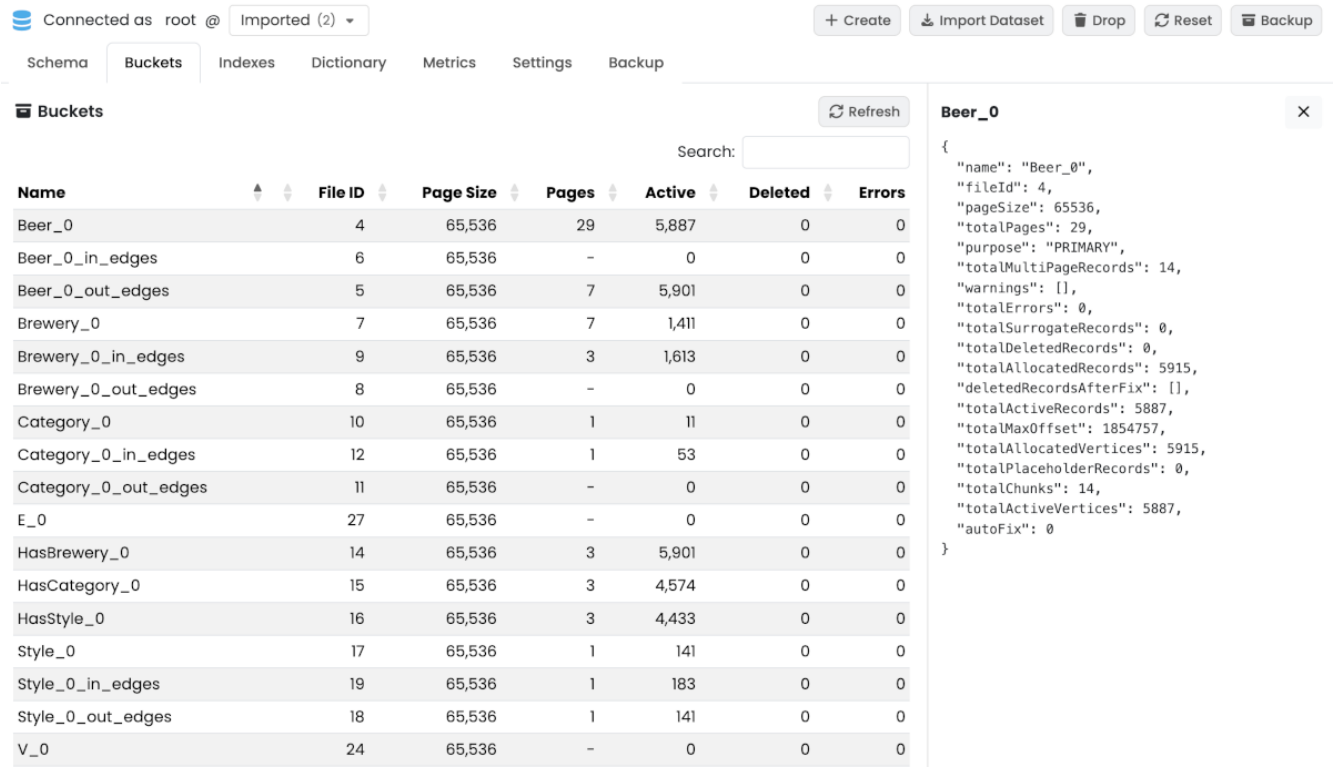
### 10.3.1. Schema

Lists every type in the database (document types, vertex types and edge types) in a scrollable left sidebar. Selecting a type loads its detail on the right: declared properties (name, type, constraints), indexes built on the type, parent / child types, and quick-action buttons.



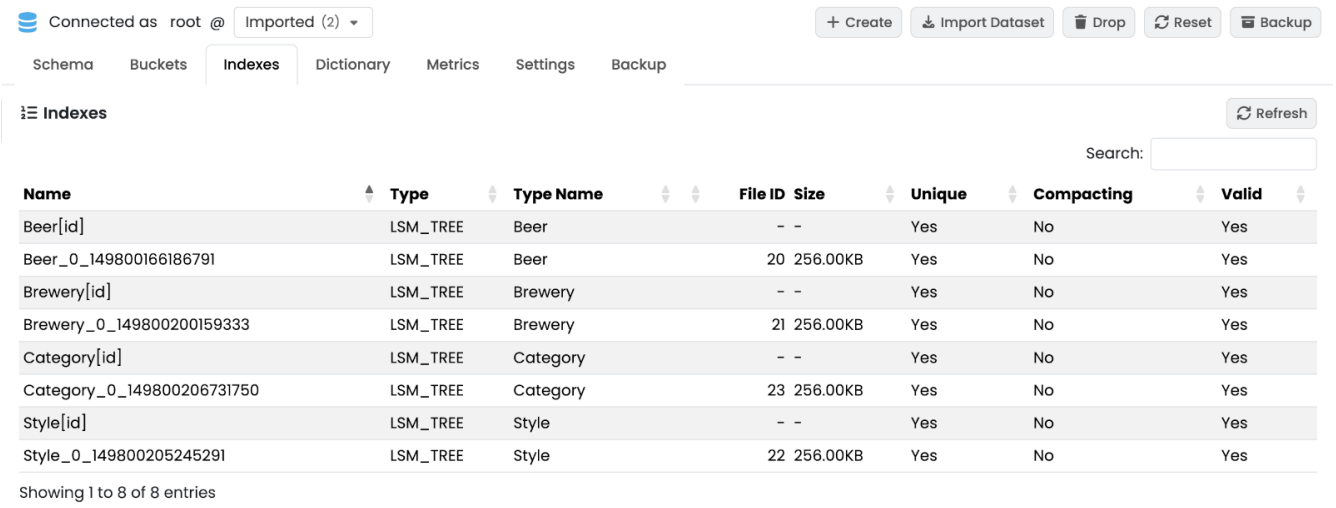

### 10.3.2. Buckets

Lists the storage buckets that back the database. Selecting a row opens a detail panel on the right with file path, record count, page count and per-bucket counters.



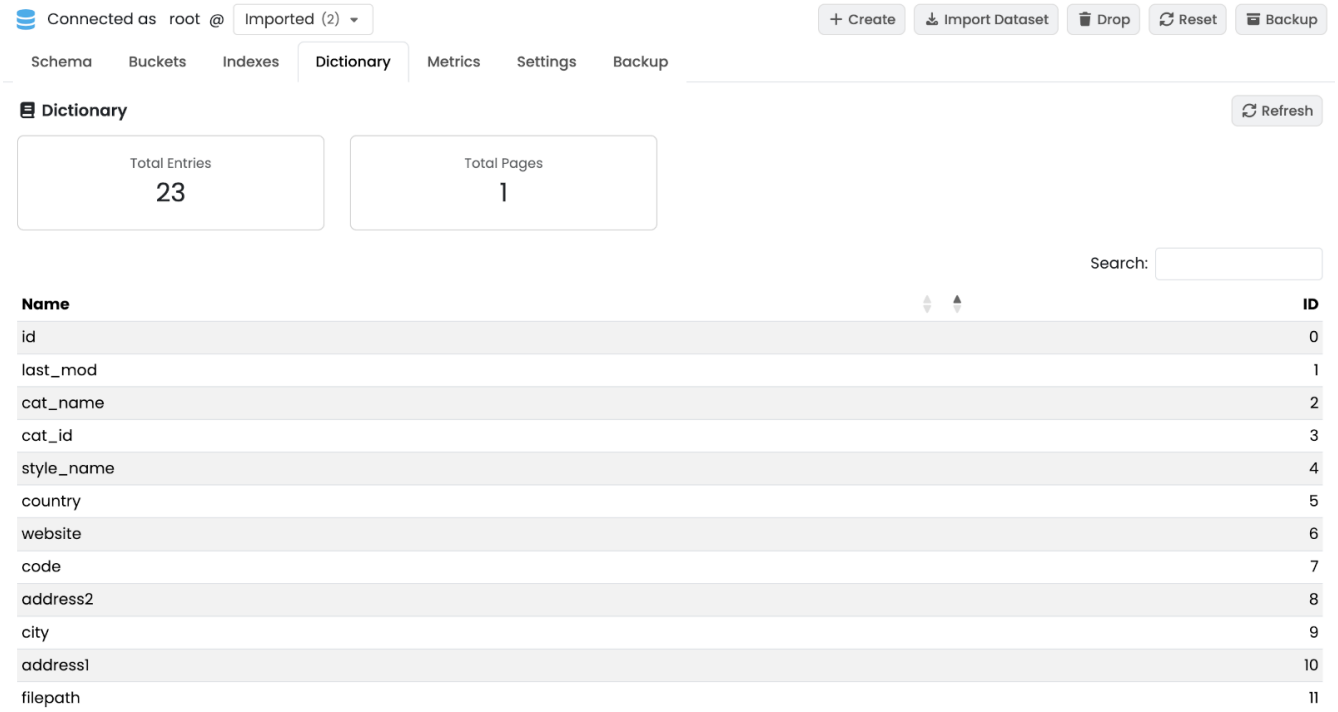

## 10.3.3. Indexes

Lists every index defined on the database with type, properties, status and entry count. Selecting a row opens a detail panel with the index definition and statistics.




## 10.3.4. Dictionary

The dictionary deduplicates property names and string values across the database. The sub-tab shows summary cards (total entries, total pages) and a paginated table of the dictionary entries.



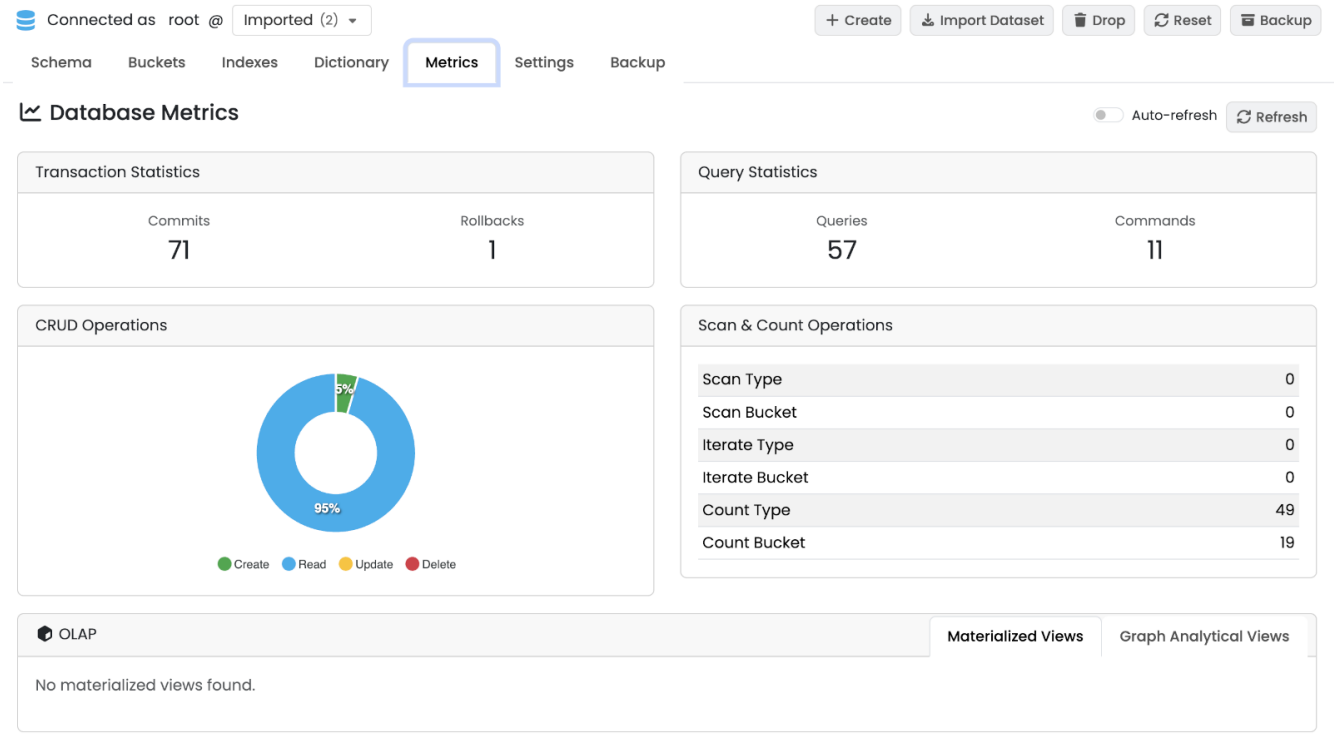

### 10.3.5. Time Series

The **Time Series** sub-tab holds everything about the database's time-series types: create and drop a type, query it with the builder or PromQL, and find ingestion snippets. It is described in Time Series sub-tab. Time series types also appear in the Schema sidebar, and any time-series result can be charted from the Query panel (see Chart).

### 10.3.6. Metrics

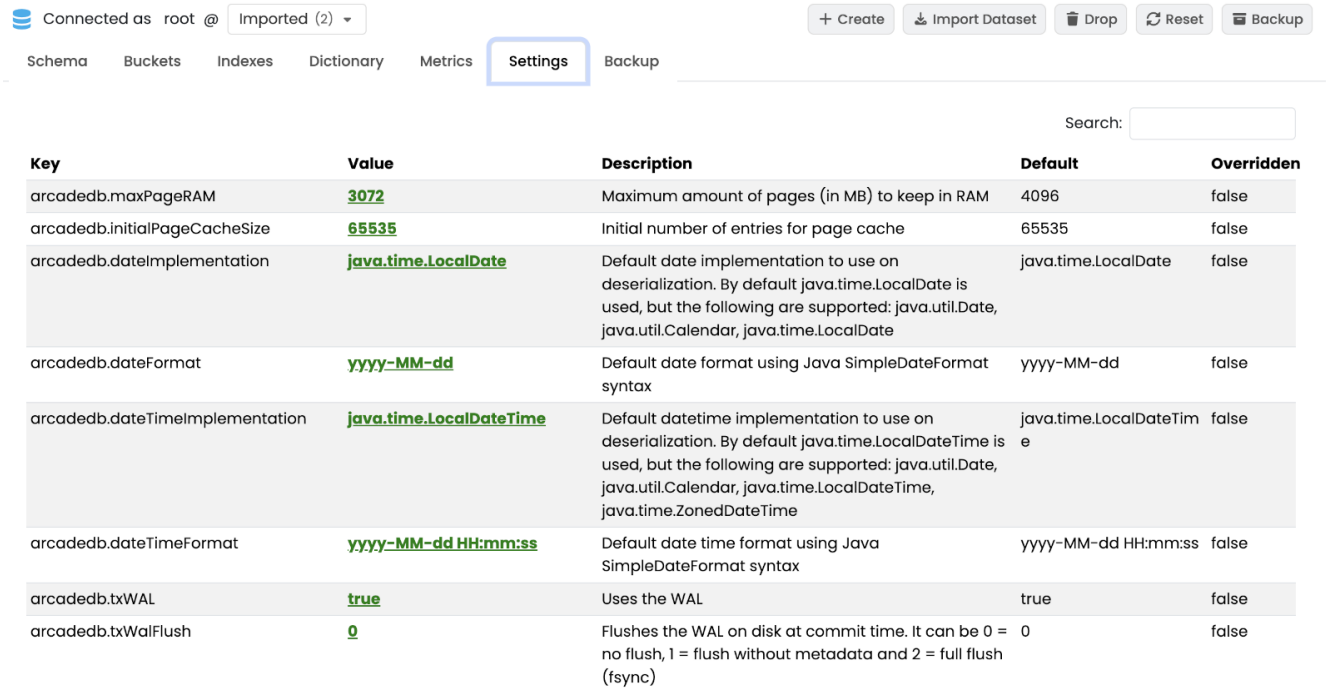
Live counters and charts for the selected database. **Auto Refresh** keeps the values updated at a fixed interval.

- **Transaction Statistics** — commits and rollbacks since startup.
- **Query Statistics** — queries and commands executed.
- **CRUD Chart** — running chart of creates, reads, updates and deletes.
- **Scan & Count** — full-scan and count operations per type.
- **OLAP** — nested tabs for Materialized Views and Graph Analytical Views: refresh status, last computation, row counts.




## 10.3.7. Database Settings

Key-value table of the database-scoped configuration settings. Values are editable by users with database-settings permission; others see a read-only view. See Settings for the full setting reference.




| Key | Value | Description | Default | Overridden |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| arcadedb.maxPageRAM | 3072 | Maximum amount of pages (in MB) to keep in RAM | 4096 | false |
| arcadedb.initialPageCacheSize | 65535 | Initial number of entries for page cache | 65535 | false |
| arcadedb.dateImplementation | java.time.LocalDate | Default date implementation to use on deserialization. By default java.time.LocalDate is used, but the following are supported: java.util.Date, java.util.Calendar, java.time.LocalDate | java.time.LocalDate | false |
| arcadedb.dateFormat | yyyy-MM-dd | Default date format using Java SimpleDateFormat syntax | yyyy-MM-dd | false |
| arcadedb.dateTimeImplementation | java.time.LocalDateTime | Default datetime implementation to use on deserialization. By default java.time.LocalDateTime is used, but the following are supported: java.util.Date, java.util.Calendar, java.time.LocalDateTime, java.time.ZonedDateTime | java.time.LocalDateTime | false |
| arcadedb.dateTimeFormat | yyyy-MM-dd HH:mm:ss | Default date time format using Java SimpleDateFormat syntax | yyyy-MM-dd HH:mm:ss | false |
| arcadedb.txWAL | true | Uses the WAL | true | false |
| arcadedb.txWalFlush | 0 | Flushes the WAL on disk at commit time. It can be 0 = no flush, 1 = flush without metadata and 2 = full flush (fsync) | 0 | false |

## 10.3.8. Backup

Per-database backup management.

The sub-tab displays:

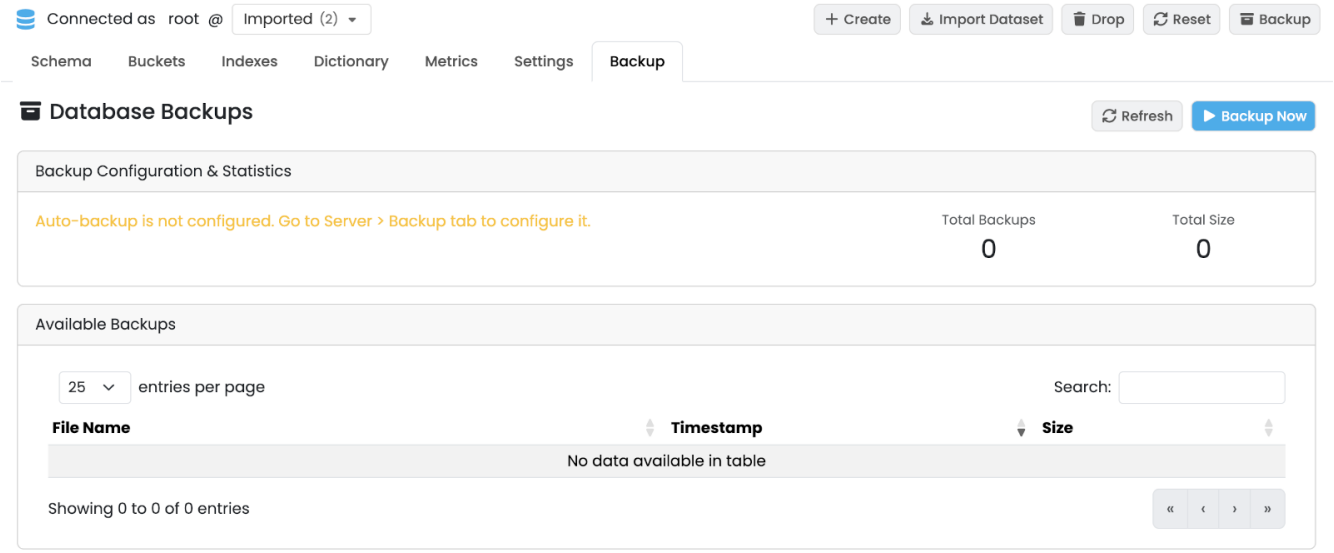
- **Backup Configuration** — current schedule and retention settings for this database (read-only

here; configured server-wide in the Server › Backup panel).

- **Statistics** — total number of backups and disk space used.
- **Available Backups** — paginated list of backup files with timestamps and sizes.

From this sub-tab you can:

- Click **Refresh** to reload the list.
- Click **Backup Now** to trigger an immediate backup of the current database.
- Restore or delete an individual backup from the row actions.




# 10.4. Time Series Sub-tab

The **Time Series** sub-tab of the Database panel is the UI for ArcadeDB's native time-series types: create and drop types, query them with a builder or PromQL, see the result as a chart and a raw table, and find ready-made ingestion snippets for InfluxDB Line Protocol, SQL, Java and Grafana.

See Time Series for the underlying concepts.

Under the sub-tab bar, a toolbar shows the **Type Selector**, which lists every TimeSeries type in the selected database along with its record count. Two buttons sit next to it:

- **Create TimeSeries Type** — open a modal to define a new type (timestamp column, tags, fields, sharding, retention, downsampling).
- **Drop Type** — ***irreversibly*** delete the selected type.

The sub-tab has three inner tabs: Query, Schema and Quick Tour.

To chart a time series from the Query panel instead, pick the **PromQL (Time Series)** language there, or run a SQL query against the type and open the **Chart** tab (see Chart).

### 10.4.1. Query

The default sub-tab. It has two modes, toggled at the top:

**Builder mode** offers structured controls — no need to write a query by hand:

- **Time Range** — `Last 5 min`, `1h`, `24h`, `7d`, `All`, or `Custom` (which exposes **From** and **To** datetime inputs).
- **Aggregation** — `None`, `AVG`, `SUM`, `MIN`, `MAX`, `COUNT`.
- **Bucket Interval** — `1s`, `10s`, `1m`, `5m`, `1h`, `1d`.
- **Tag Filters** — one input per indexed tag of the selected type.
- **Fields** — checkboxes to pick which numeric measures to plot.
- **Query** — run with the current filters.
- **Latest** — fetch the most recent point per series.
- **Auto-Refresh** — `Off`, `10s`, `30s`, `1m`.

**PromQL mode** exposes a textarea where you can type a PromQL expression and execute it with the **Run** button or kbd:[Ctrl+Enter] / kbd:[Cmd+Enter].

Below the controls the panel shows the **Query Stats** label (`record count + elapsed ms`), the **Chart** and the **Data Table**. Each of the two visualisations can be toggled on or off independently.



The **Chart** is an ApexCharts line/area chart; toggle the style from the chart toolbar. The **Data Table** is a paginated grid of the raw (or aggregated) values returned by the query.

### 10.4.2. Schema

Shows the schema of the selected type: timestamp column, indexed tag dimensions, numeric fields, shard count, retention policy and downsampling policies.

### 10.4.3. Quick Tour

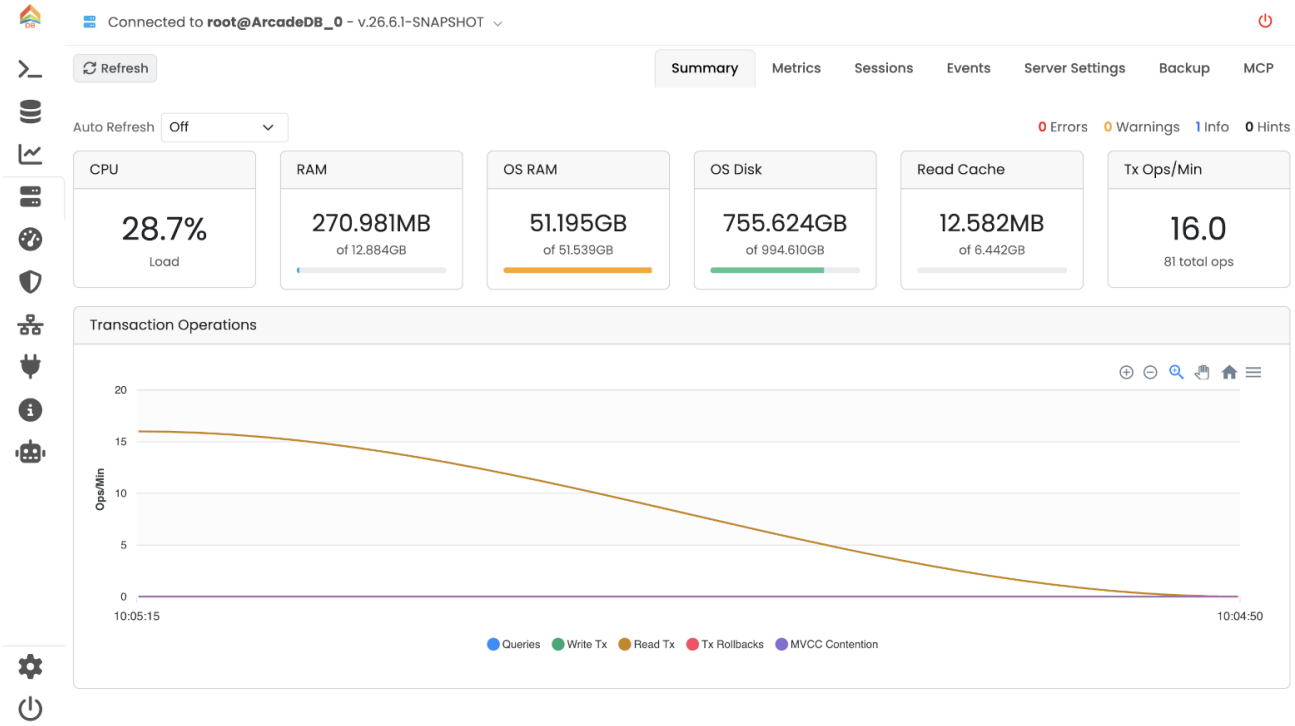
Inline documentation cards with copy-ready snippets for common tasks:

- Creating a TimeSeries type in SQL.
- Ingesting data via InfluxDB Line Protocol (`curl` example).
- Inserting points with SQL `INSERT`.
- Using the Java API to write points.
- Analytical SQL functions (`ts.rate()`, `ts.percentile()`, etc.).
- Configuring downsampling and retention.

A second section covers the **Grafana integration**: how to point the Infinity datasource at ArcadeDB, the available HTTP endpoints (`/health`, `/metadata`, `/query`), metadata discovery, the DataFrame format and a `curl` example.

## 10.5. Server Panel

The **Server** panel is the operational console for the ArcadeDB server itself: health summary, live metrics, active sessions, running queries, events, server-wide settings, automated backups and MCP integration.




The header shows a **server info** label (click it to open a popover with version, JVM details, host, uptime, etc.) and a **Refresh** button. A **Shutdown** button is available under the **Cluster** tab — see Cluster Panel.

The panel has eight sub-tabs.

## 10.5.1. Summary

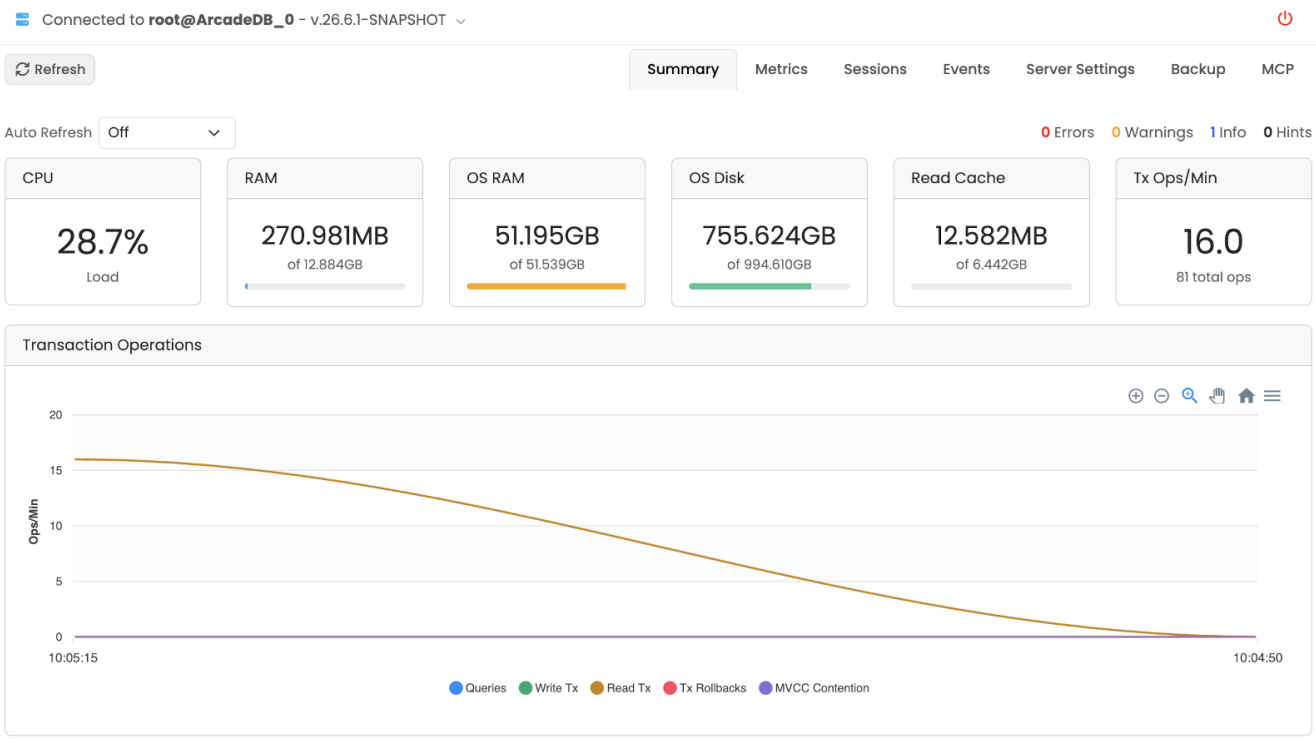
The default sub-tab. **Auto Refresh** keeps the page in sync at a fixed interval (`Off`, `10s`, `30s`, `1m`, `5m`).

The top row shows clickable event counters — Errors, Warnings, Info and Hints — that jump straight to the Events sub-tab filtered on that level.

Below them, system-resource cards report:

- **CPU Load** of the server process.
- **RAM (used / max)** of the JVM, with a progress bar.
- **OS RAM** available on the host.
- **OS Disk** free on the data directory.
- **Read Cache** hit ratio and size.
- **Transaction Ops/Min** throughput.

A **Transaction Operations** chart at the bottom plots ops/min over a rolling window.



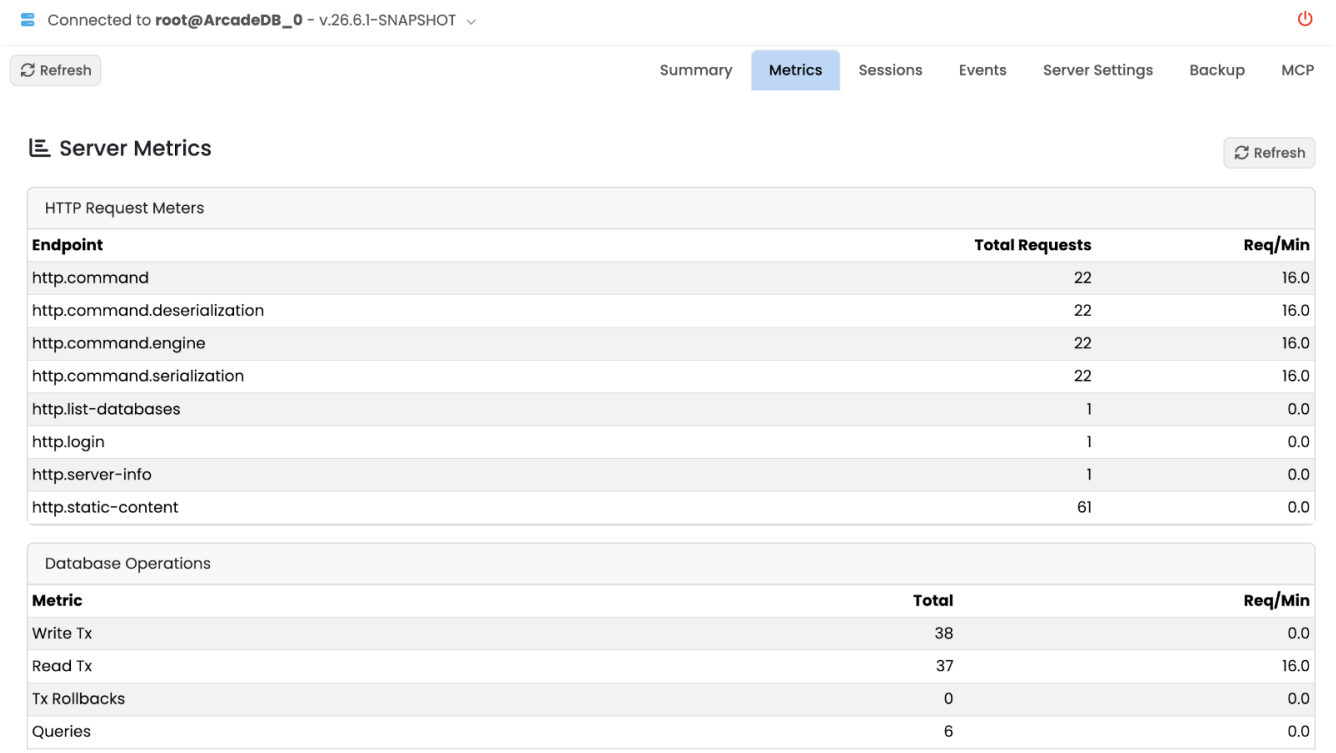

## 10.5.2. Metrics

Detailed numeric metrics for the server:

- **HTTP Request Meters** — per endpoint, total requests and req/min.
- **Database Operations** — per metric, total and req/min.
- **Profiler Details** — internal profiler counters.
- **Executor Pools** — thread pools (active vs. allocated threads, queue depth, completed tasks, fallbacks, reclaimed).

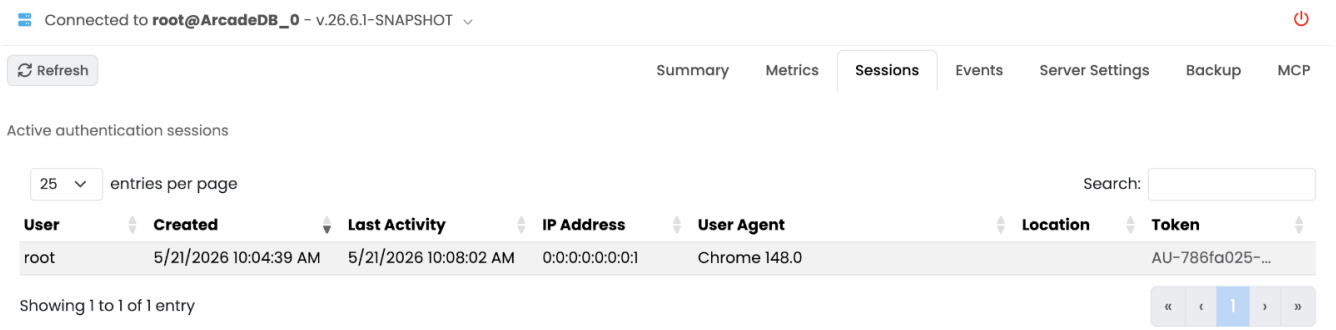
  Two of those columns look similar and mean opposite things. **Caller-Run Fallbacks** counts tasks that ran on the submitting thread because the pool's queue was **full**; sustained growth there means the pool is undersized for your workload and is the signal to raise its size. **Reclaimed** counts tasks a waiting caller took back and ran itself because the pool was **busy** rather than full: that is normal, healthy behaviour and needs no action.

- **Sparse Vector Indexes** — counters for vector indexes when present.




## 10.5.3. Sessions

Table of active authentication sessions: user, source, started, last-seen. Use it to spot stale or unexpected connections.




## 10.5.4. Running Queries

Table of the statements the server is running, from every protocol (HTTP, PostgreSQL, Bolt, gRPC, MongoDB, Redis, Gremlin): id, database, user, protocol, language, statement, tag, elapsed time and status (`running`, or `terminating` once it was asked to stop). The **root** user sees every statement, any other user only their own. Available since 26.11.1.

**Auto Refresh** reloads the table every 2, 5 or 10 seconds (`Off` by default).

The **Terminate** button at the end of a row stops that statement after a confirmation, and rolls back what it wrote. A notification then says what happened: the statement was terminated, it completed before it could be terminated (what it did stands), it was asked to stop and has not stopped yet, or it was no longer running.

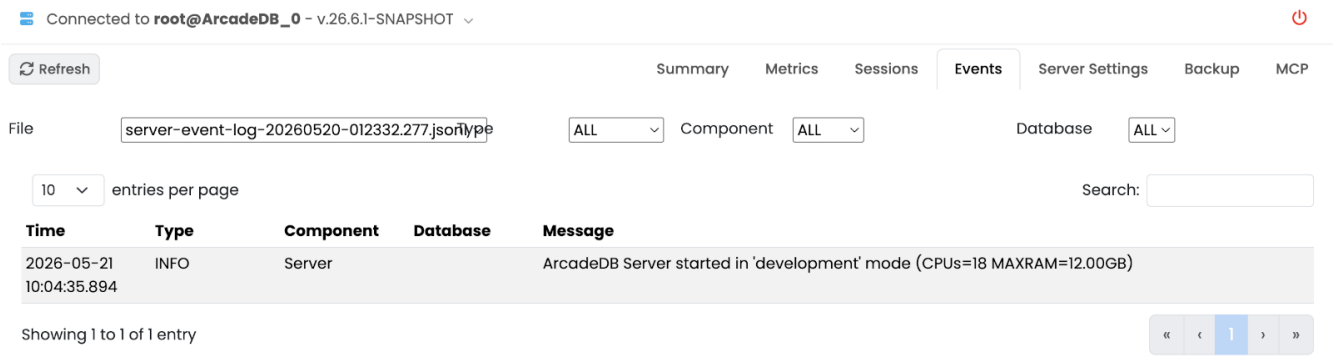
The tab is built on the `list queries` and `terminate query` server commands; see there for how a statement is labelled with a tag and how each protocol reports the termination to its client.

### 10.5.5. Events

Browsable server event log. Filter dropdowns above the table:

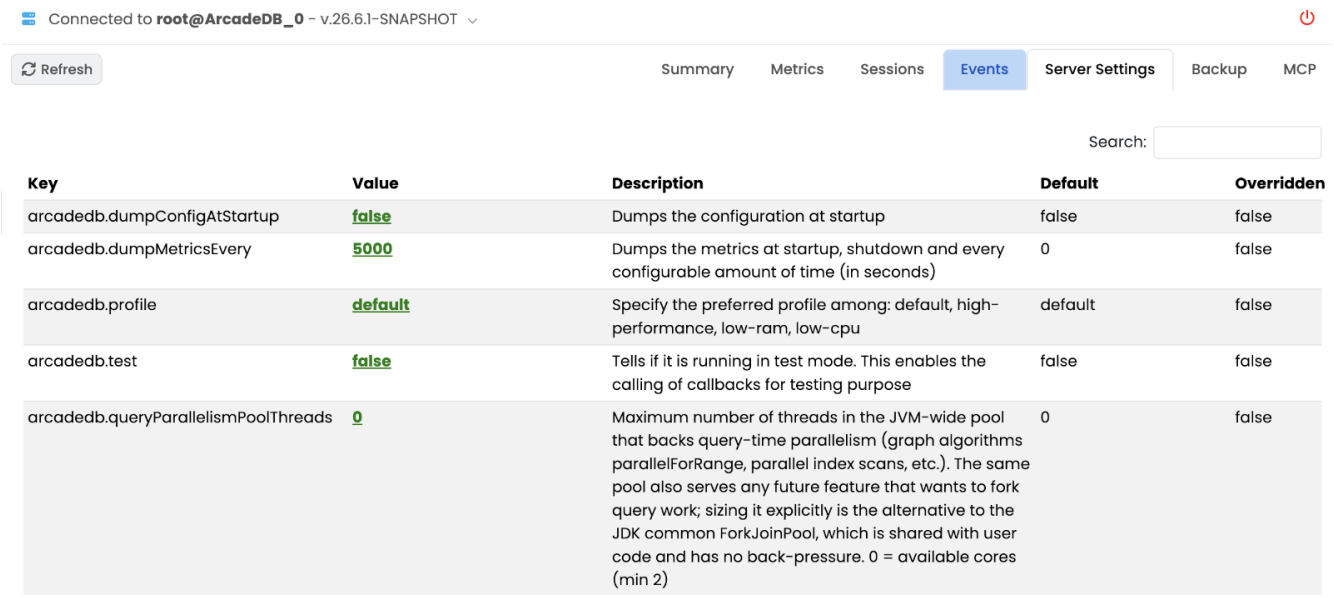
- **File** — pick a log file.
- **Type** — `ALL`, `CRITICAL`, `WARNING`, `INFO`, `HINT`.
- **Component** — server subsystem (HTTP, transactions, indexes, …).
- **Database** — limit to events scoped to one database.

Each row shows timestamp, level and message.




### 10.5.6. Server Settings

Key-value table of the server-scoped configuration. See Settings for the full setting reference.



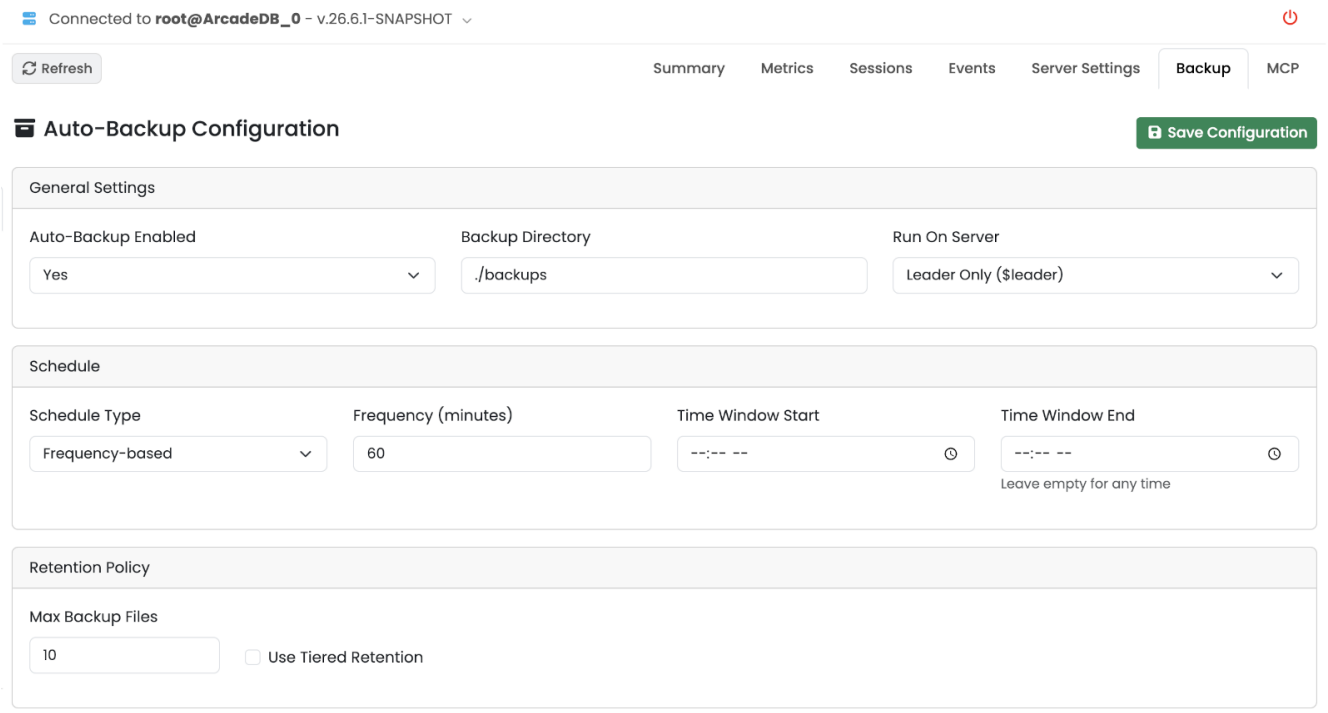

### 10.5.7. Backup

Server-wide auto-backup configuration.

- **Auto-Backup Configuration** — toggle to enable or disable automatic backups, set the backup directory, and choose whether backups run on the leader only or on every server in a cluster.
- **Backup Schedule** — pick **Frequency** (every N minutes/hours/days) or a full **CRON** expression.

- **Retention Policy** — **Max files** (simple ring) or **Tiered** (per-bucket keep counts: Hourly, Daily, Weekly, Monthly, Yearly).
- **Backup Status** — last run, next run, files produced.

See Automatic Backup for the underlying configuration and CLI equivalents. Per-database backup history is managed from the Database › Backup sub-tab.




### 10.5.8. MCP

Configures the embedded Model Context Protocol server so AI tools (Claude Desktop, Claude Code, Cursor, …) can talk to ArcadeDB.

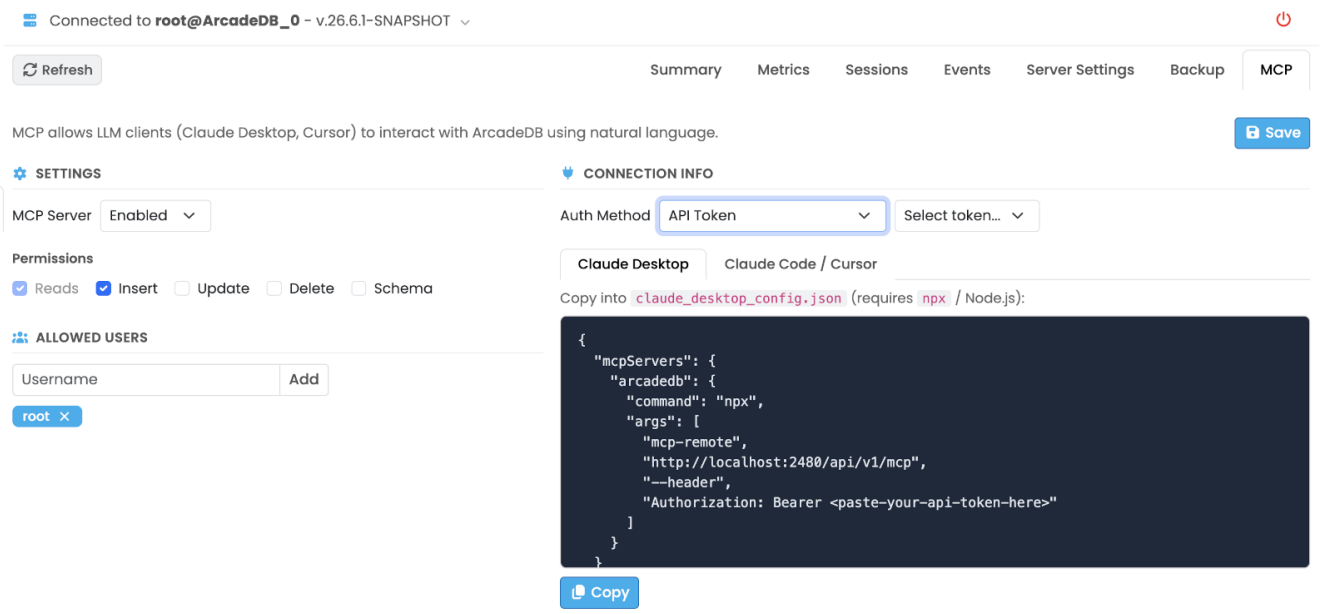
The left column controls **Settings**:

- Enable or disable the MCP endpoint.
- Per-operation permissions: **Reads**, **Inserts**, **Updates**, **Deletes**, **Schema**.
- **Allowed Users** — add or remove users that may authenticate against MCP.

The right column shows **Connection Info**:

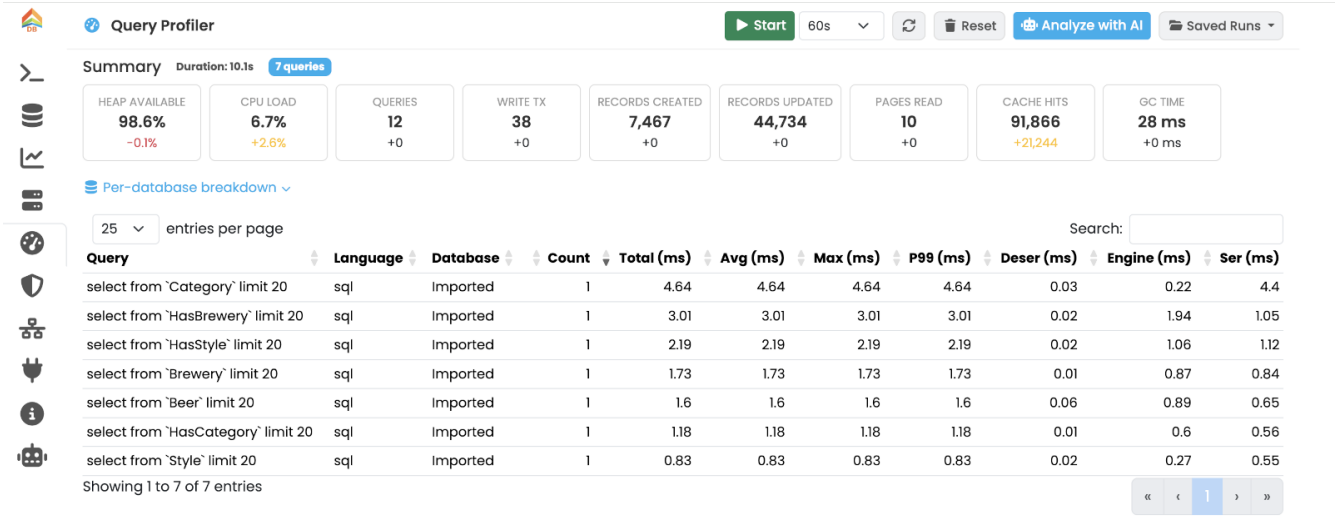
- **Auth Method** — Basic auth or API token.
- Ready-to-paste configuration snippets for **Claude Desktop** and for **Claude Code** / **Cursor**, each with a **Copy** button.

See MCP Server for the protocol reference.




# 10.6. Profiler Panel

The **Profiler** panel records the queries executed on the server across every protocol (HTTP, Java embedded, BOLT, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, MCP), aggregates them by canonical form, and lets you drill into per-step timings to find slow paths. Runs can be saved for later comparison, and an **Analyze with AI** button (requires the AI Assistant subscription) produces a natural-language commentary on the captured run.




## 10.6.1. Toolbar

- **Start** — begin a new recording. A **Timeout** selector next to it caps the run length (`30s` to `10m`, default `60s`); recording stops automatically when the timeout elapses.
- **Stop** — stop the recording before the timeout (only visible while recording).
- **Refresh** — re-pull the current run from the server.
- **Reset** (trash icon) — clear the current run.
- **Analyze with AI** — open the AI commentary panel (only shown when results are available and the subscription is active).

- **Saved Runs** — dropdown of previously saved sessions; pick one to load it back into the view.

A run saved by a build older than 26.10.1 does not record how many executions each step was timed in, so Studio flags it at the top of the view and marks such steps `not timed` rather than showing a figure it cannot vouch for. Record the run again on a current build to get complete step timings.

### 10.6.2. Summary

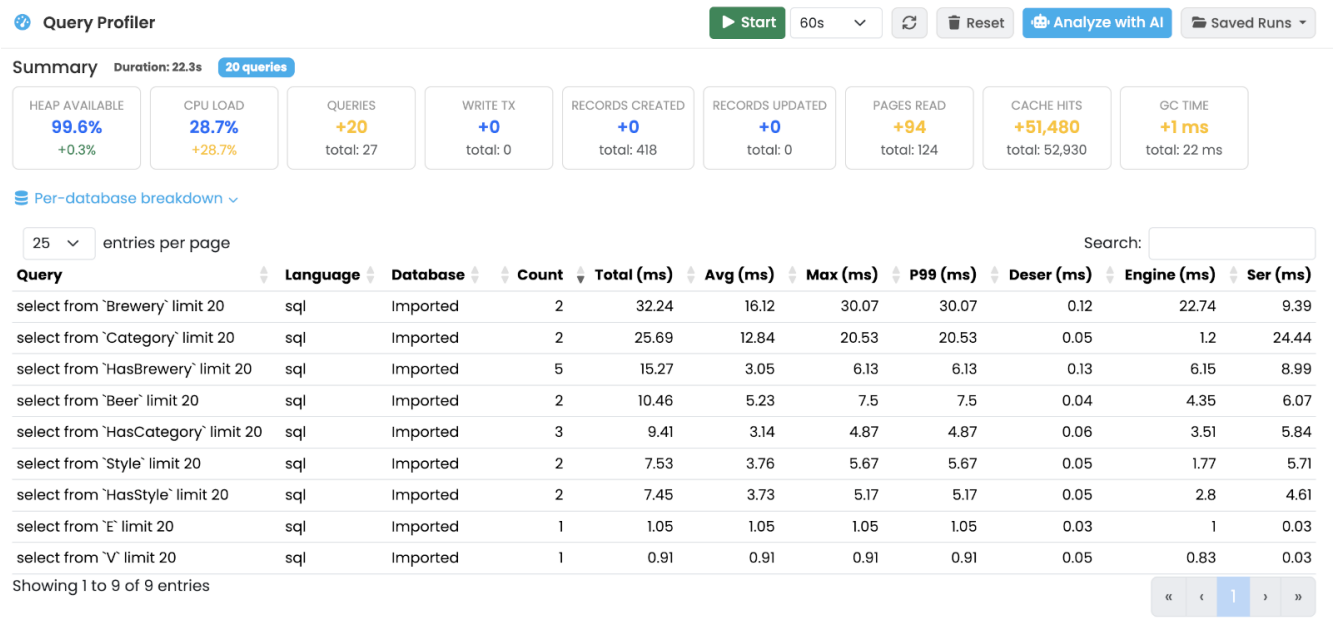
Once a recording exists, a summary header appears at the top:

- **Duration** of the recording.
- **Total Queries** captured.
- **Metric Delta** cards comparing this run to the baseline (where applicable).
- Per-database breakdown, collapsible.

### 10.6.3. Query list

The default view is a table of distinct queries collected during the run. Columns: **Query** (canonical text), **Language**, **Database**, **Count** (executions), **Total**, **Avg**, **Max**, **P99** (ms), and per-stage timings **Deser**, **Engine**, **Ser** (ms).

Click a row to drill into that query.




### 10.6.4. Query detail

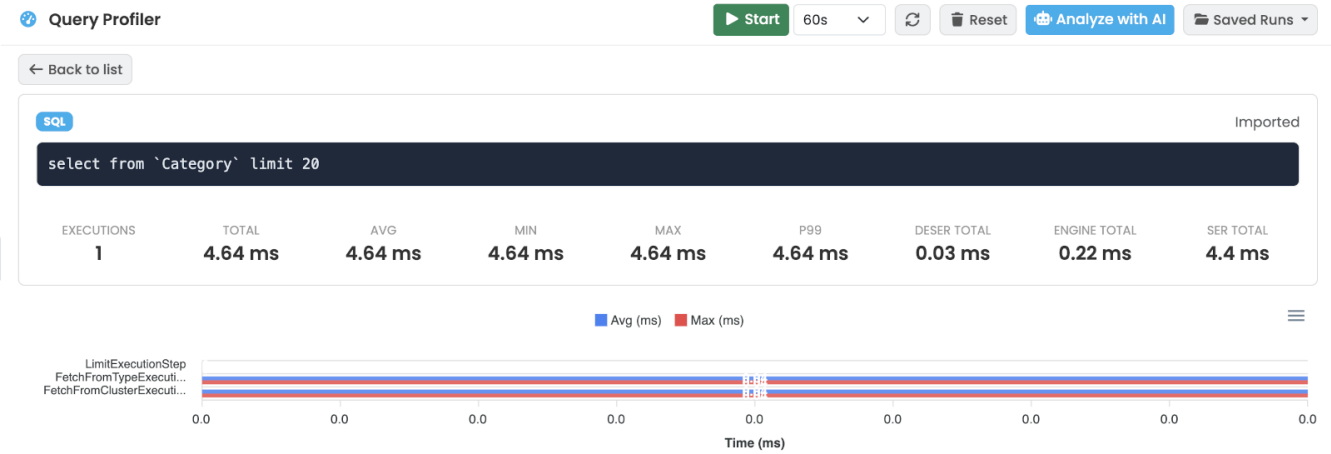
The detail view exposes:

- **Back to List** button to return.
- Query card with the **Language** badge, **Database**, the canonical query text and stat cards ( **Count**, **Total**, **Avg**, **Max**, **P99**).

- **Step Chart** — ApexCharts breakdown of execution-step timings. Only steps that were actually timed are plotted.
- **Step table** — for each execution step: name, count, **measured**, total, min, avg, max, p99 (ms). **Measured** is how many of those executions the step was actually timed in, so an average drawn from 3 of 100 executions says so instead of reading as if it covered all 100. *(Since v26.10.1)*

Step timings are the time each step spent in its **own** work - never the time the steps below it spent in theirs - summed over every occurrence of that step across all the executions of the query. Because no step counts another step's time, the rows add up to at most the query's **Engine** total and never more, and the largest row is the step actually worth optimising. A step the engine did not time is shown as `not timed` rather than as `0 ms`, so it is not mistaken for work that completed instantly. A step whose only job is to hand work to the steps below it therefore appears with a count but without timings: the time is reported on the step that did the work.

Gremlin traversals are timed on the same run that returns their results, so recording does not execute a traversal twice, and a write traversal (`addV`, `addE`, …) is still applied only once. Their steps (`GraphStep`, `HasStep`, …) appear in the step table and chart like SQL and Cypher steps. *(Since v26.10.1)*



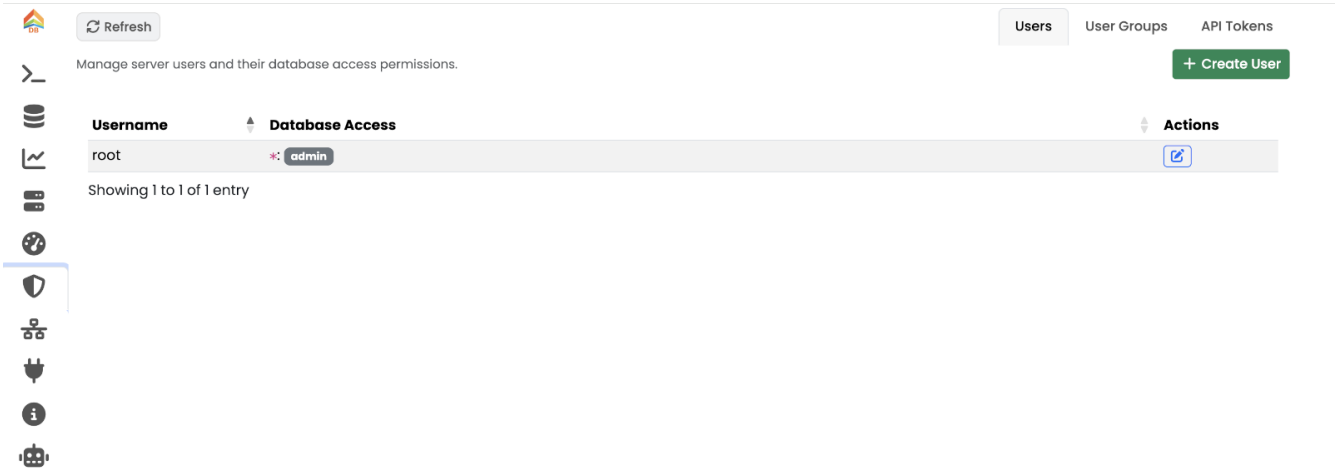

| Step | Count | Total (ms) | Min (ms) | Avg (ms) | Max (ms) | P99 (ms) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| LimitExecutionStep | 1 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| FetchFromTypeExecutionStep | 1 | 0.04 | 0.04 | 0.04 | 0.04 | 0.04 |
| FetchFromClusterExecutionStep | 1 | 0.04 | 0.04 | 0.04 | 0.04 | 0.04 |

### 10.6.5. AI analysis

When you click **Analyze with AI**, a panel slides in with AI-generated insights — likely bottlenecks, suggested rewrites, indexes that may help. Closing the panel keeps the underlying run intact.

# 10.7. Security Panel

The **Security** panel manages who can log into the server, with which permissions, and which automated clients have API tokens. It is the UI front-end of the ArcadeDB security model — see Users, Groups and Security Policy for the underlying concepts.




The header has a **Refresh** button. The panel is split into three sub-tabs.

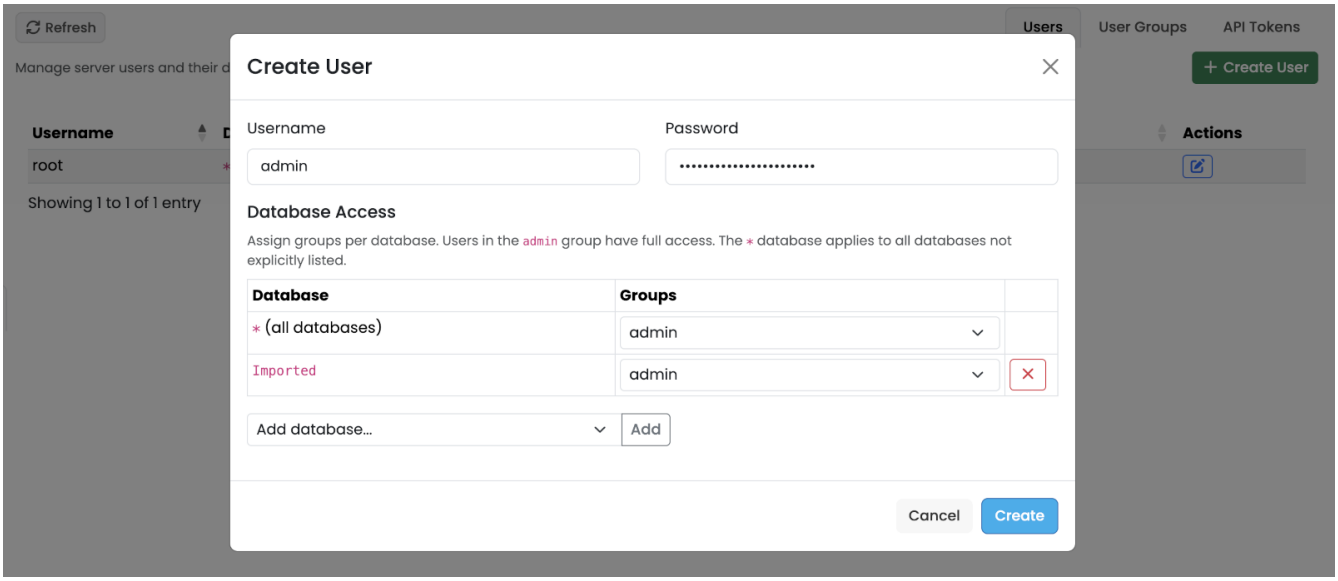
## 10.7.1. Users

Lists every user known to the server: username, e-mail, and the groups they belong to in each database.

- **Create User** — open the **Create User** modal.
- Per-row actions: **Edit**, **Delete**.

The **Create User** modal asks for:

- **Username** and **Password**.
- **Database Access** — a table mapping each database to a group. The wildcard `*` row represents the default group used for any database not listed. Use the `*Add Database` dropdown to grant access to additional databases with a specific group.



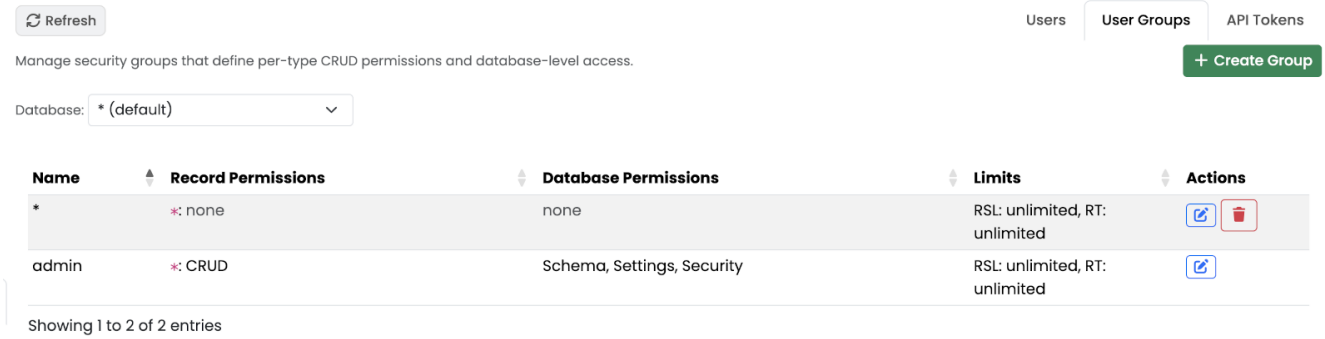

## 10.7.2. User Groups

Groups (aka roles) bundle the permissions granted to the users that belong to them.

- **Database** filter at the top — limit the table to groups defined for a specific database.
- **Create Group** — open the **Create Group** modal.
- Table columns: **Name**, **Result Set Limit**, **Read Timeout**, type-level CRUD checkboxes, database-level permission checkboxes.

The **Create / Edit Group** modal exposes:

- **Database** and **Name**.
- **Result Set Limit** — cap the number of rows returned per query.
- **Read Timeout** — cap on the duration of read queries (ms).
- **Type Permissions** — per-type **Create**, **Read**, **Update**, **Delete** checkboxes. The `row is the default applied to types not explicitly listed; use the *Add Type` dropdown to override the default for specific types.
- **Database Permissions** — **Schema Changes**, **Database Settings**, **Security**.




## 10.7.3. API Tokens

Long-lived bearer tokens you can issue to scripts and services in place of username/password

authentication.

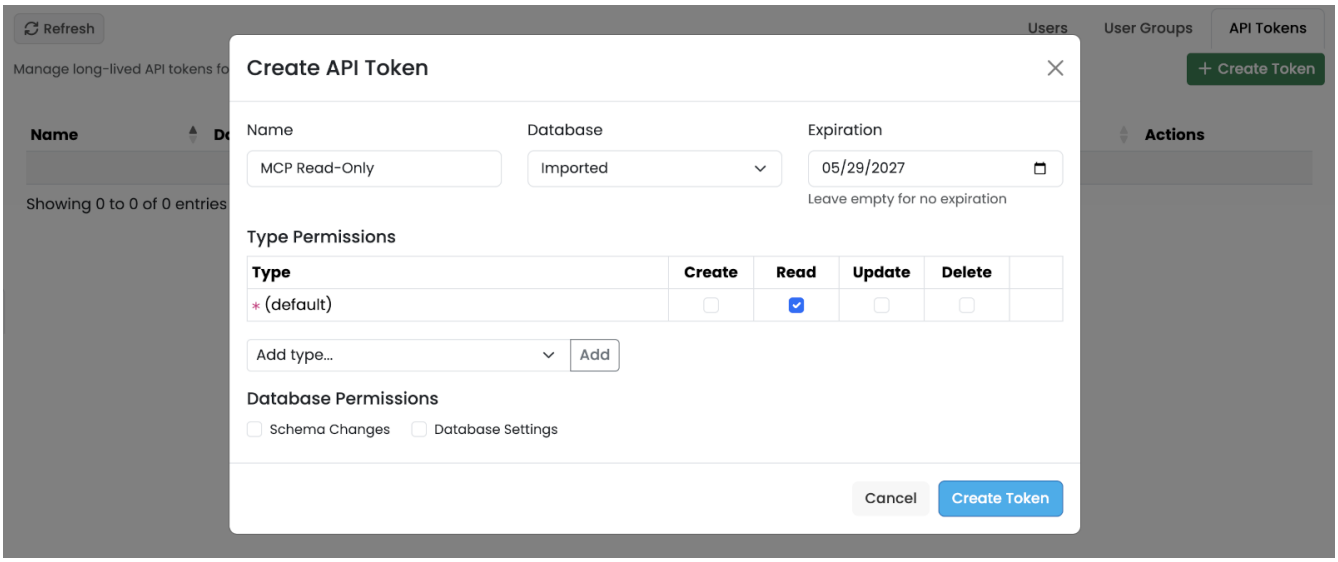
- **Create Token** — open the **Create Token** modal.
- Table columns: **Name**, **Database**, **Expiration**, **Status** (Active / Expired), **Actions** (View / Revoke).

The **Create Token** modal asks for:

- **Name** and **Database**.
- **Expiration** date.
- **Type Permissions** and **Database Permissions** — same structure as the Groups modal.

When you submit the form the new token is shown once in the **Token Created** modal, with a **Copy** button. The token is **not** shown again, so copy and store it before closing the dialog.

An expired token authenticates nobody from the moment it expires, but it stays in the list, marked as expired, until the next token is created or revoked - that is when expired entries are cleared out. You can reuse the name of an expired token for its replacement. *(Since v26.10.1: an expired token disappeared at the next server restart instead, which in a cluster made the nodes disagree about the token set and could block further token administration on the node that dropped it first.)*




## 10.7.4. Group and Token Changes During a Rolling Upgrade

On a cluster, a group or API-token change is replicated to every node, and the leader refuses it while any node cannot yet understand it — including a node that is simply unreachable. Nothing is submitted when it is refused, so nothing changes anywhere and the same request succeeds unaltered once the cluster is whole again.

Since 26.10.1 Studio shows this before you act instead of after: **Create Group** and **Create Token** are disabled while the cluster is not ready, with a notice above the table naming the nodes that are holding it back and why. The Create / Edit Group dialog carries the same notice, because editing an existing group is replicated the same way. Revoking a token is refused by the same rule — the control stays available, and the refusal explains itself.

See Cluster Readiness on the Cluster panel for the same information per node. Nothing of this

appears on a single server or on a fully upgraded cluster.

# 10.8. Cluster Panel

The **Cluster** panel shows the live topology and health of an ArcadeDB High Availability cluster, the current leader, and exposes membership-management actions on the leader.



The header shows:

- **Cluster Name**.
- A **Role** badge for the local node (**Leader** or **Follower**).
- A **Health** badge (color-coded).
- **Refresh** button.
- **Auto-Refresh** dropdown (`Off`, `5s`, `10s`, `30s`, `1m`).

The panel has three sub-tabs.

## 10.8.1. Overview

Top info row: **Leader** name, **Leader HTTP** address, **Local Peer** identifier, **Server count**.

Below it, a grid of **Node Cards** — one per node — each showing status, uptime, hosted databases and key metrics. Each card also lists what that node's build supports, or, when the leader has not been able to ask it, the reason why nothing is known about it.

A **Cluster Readiness** banner appears above the cards when a group or API-token change would be refused right now. Those changes are replicated to every node, and a node that cannot understand the change stops rather than skip it, so the leader refuses the whole change until the last node is upgraded and reachable. The banner names which nodes are holding the cluster back and why, so a rolling upgrade that is not finished is visible before you attempt an administrative change rather than after. It is hidden entirely on a single server, on a fully upgraded cluster, and on a follower - only the leader polls the other nodes, so only the leader can answer for them. Available since 26.10.1.

### 10.8.2. Metrics

Summary cards:

- **Elections** — number of leader elections since startup.
- **Last Election** — timestamp of the most recent election.
- **Uptime** — cluster uptime.

### 10.8.3. Management

Membership and lifecycle actions.

The left column exposes:

- **Cluster Membership** — list the current peers and add or remove them. This action is only available on the leader; on a follower the controls are read-only.
- **Bootstrap Baselines** — when applicable, shows the per-database fingerprints used to validate new peers.

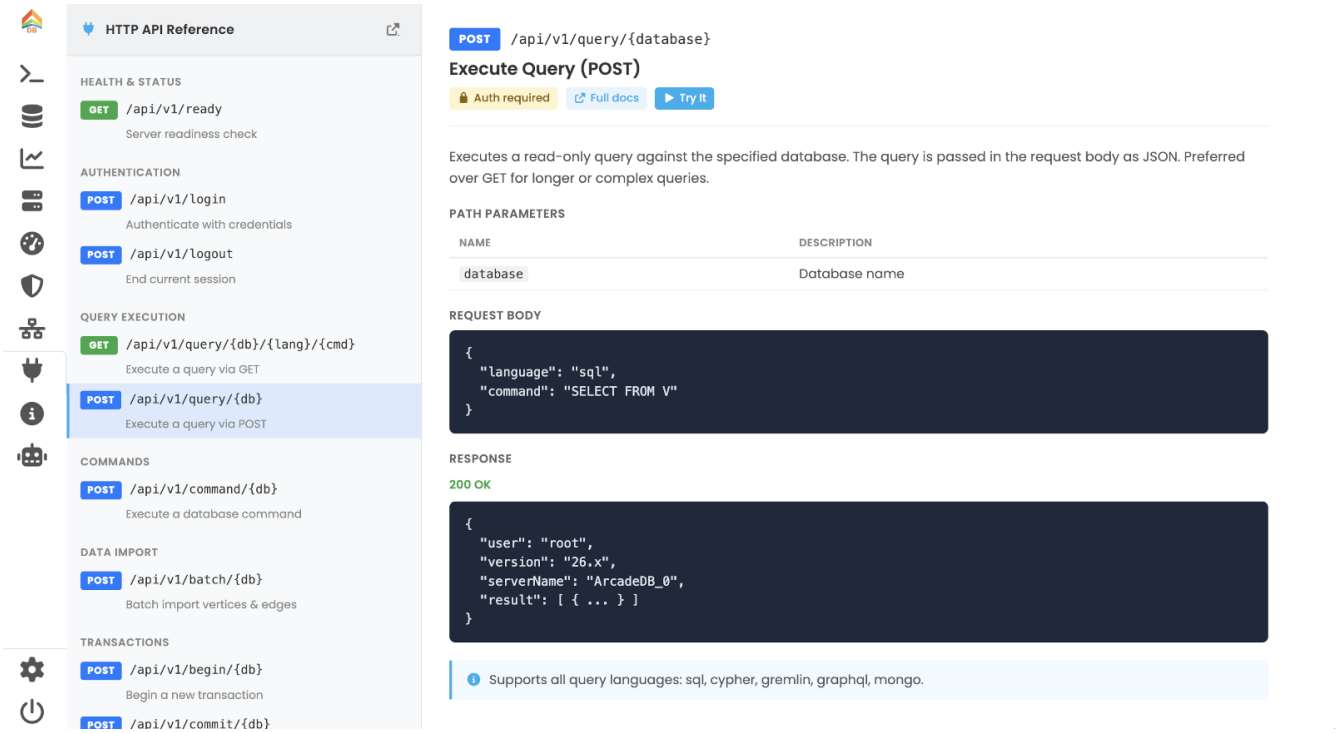
The right column contains a **Danger Zone** with the **Shutdown This Server** button. Shutting a server down is irreversible from the UI; in HA the rest of the cluster keeps running.

## 10.9. API Panel

The **API** panel is an interactive browser for the HTTP API exposed by the current ArcadeDB server.

Pick an endpoint from the left sidebar to see its contract on the right; flip the **Try It** toggle to send a real request from the built-in playground.

See HTTP API for the full reference.




## 10.9.1. Endpoint sidebar

The left sidebar groups the API surface by topic:

- **Health & Status**
- **Authentication**
- **Query Execution**
- **Commands**
- **Data Import**
- **Transactions**
- **Server Management**
- **Database Management**
- **TimeSeries**
- **Documentation**

Each entry shows the HTTP verb badge (`GET`, `POST`, `PUT`, `DELETE`), the path, and a one-line description. Clicking an entry loads its detail in the right pane.

## 10.9.2. Detail pane

For the selected endpoint the right pane shows:

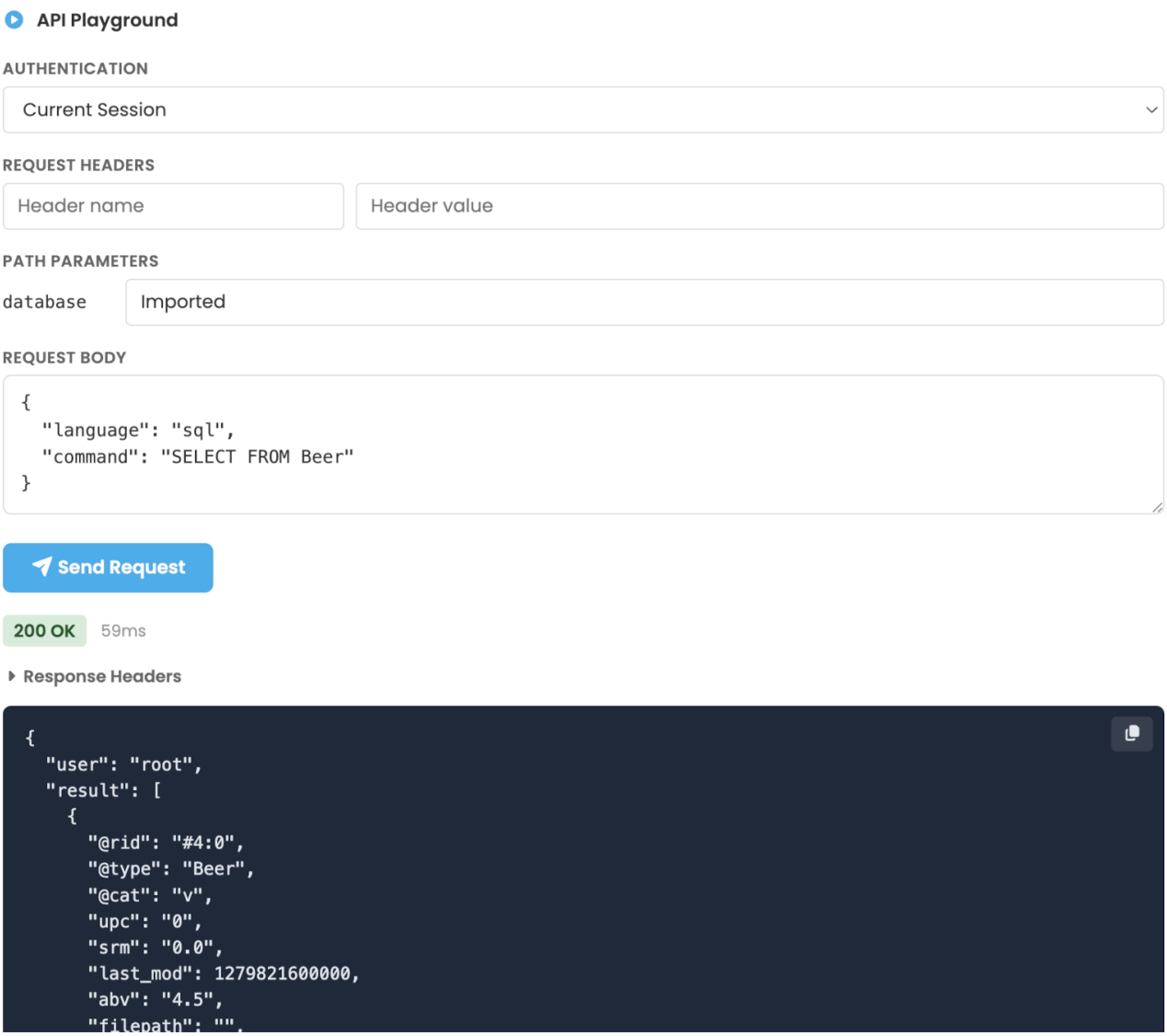
- The verb and path, the human-readable title and the long description.
- Badges for **Auth required** / **No auth**, and a **Full Docs** link that jumps to the relevant page in this manual.
- **Path Parameters**, **Query Parameters** and **Request Headers** tables.
- The **Request Body** example (pretty-printed).
- The **Response** example with the typical status code, body and optional headers.
- Implementation **Notes** — quirks, defaults, references to related endpoints.

### 10.9.3. Try It playground

Toggle **Try It** to reveal a request playground for the selected endpoint:

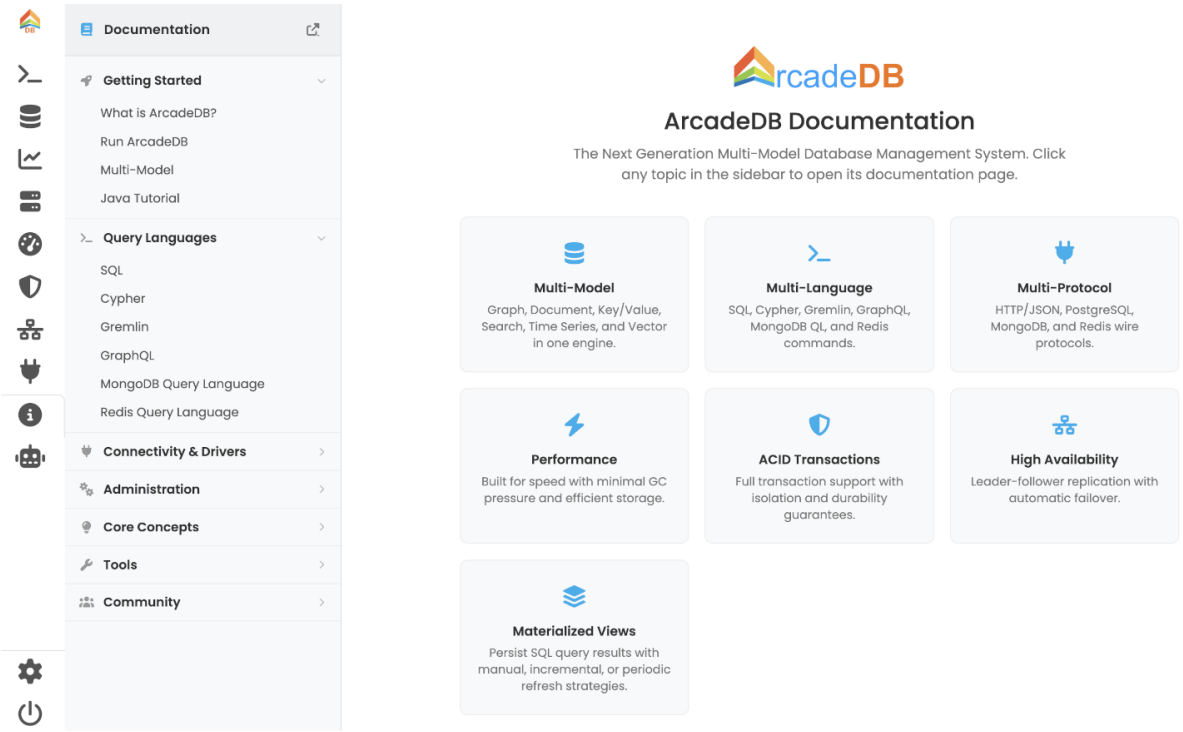
- **Auth** — pick **Current Session** (reuse the Studio login), **Basic** (username + password), **Bearer** (API token) or **None**.
- **Request Headers** — add custom headers.
- **Path Parameters** and **Query Parameters** — inputs are pre-filled with sensible defaults where applicable.
- **Request Body** editor with syntax highlighting.
- **Send Request** — execute and view the response status, headers (collapsible) and body, with a **Copy** button.

For transactional flows the playground automatically captures the `arcadedb-session-id` returned by `POST /api/v1/begin/{db}` and re-injects it in the following `command`, `commit` and `rollback` calls — so you can walk through a complete transaction without copy-pasting the session header.




# 10.10. Info Panel

The **Info** panel is a quick-reference launcher into this documentation and a short feature overview, all without leaving Studio.




### 10.10.1. Documentation sidebar

The left sidebar is a collapsible table of contents grouped by topic:

- **Getting Started** — What is ArcadeDB, Run, Multi-Model overview, Java Tutorial.
- **Query Languages** — SQL, Cypher, Gremlin, GraphQL, MongoDB, Redis.
- **Connectivity & Drivers** — HTTP, Java, JDBC, Python, PostgreSQL wire, MongoDB wire, Redis wire.
- **Administration** — Installation, Docker, Kubernetes, Backup, Security, High Availability, Settings.
- **Core Concepts** — Graph, Schema, Indexes, Transactions, Materialized Views.
- **Tools** — Console, Importer.
- **Community** — GitHub, Issues, Discussions.

Each entry opens the corresponding page on `docs.arcadedb.com` in a new browser tab.

### 10.10.2. Feature overview

The right pane shows a welcome card and a grid of feature cards (Multi-Model, Multi-Language, Multi-Protocol, Performance, ACID Transactions, High Availability, Materialized Views) plus **Quick Links** to the full documentation, the GitHub repository and the community discussions.

## 10.11. AI Assistant Panel

The AI Assistant Panel turns Studio into a chat-driven workspace where you can ask questions about your database in natural language and get answers, schema insights, and executable queries back. The assistant can read your schema, run read-only queries on your behalf, and propose

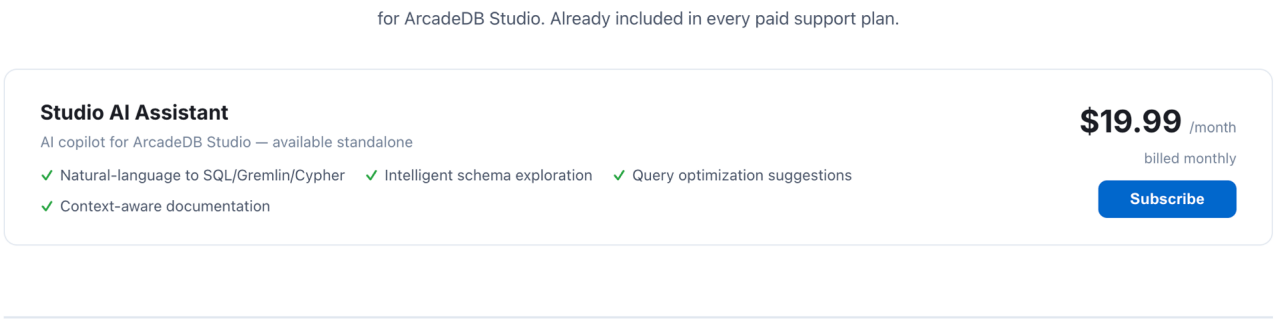
commands you can execute with one click directly from the conversation.

Typical use cases include:

- Schema review and optimization
- Query optimization and troubleshooting
- Data modeling recommendations
- Server profiling analysis
- Synthetic data generation
- Translating natural language into SQL, Apache Tinkerpop Gremlin or Open Cypher

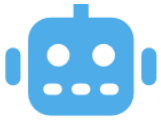
### 10.11.1. Subscription

The AI Assistant is a paid add-on for ArcadeDB Studio. You can subscribe to it standalone or get it bundled with any ArcadeDB paid support plan from the Pricing page.




### 10.11.2. Activation

The first time you open the **AI Assistant** tab from the Studio main menu, you are asked to activate your subscription. Enter the subscription key you received after purchase and click **Activate**.




If you do not have a key yet, click **Get one here** to be redirected to the ArcadeDB pricing page.

When you activate, you are shown the AI Assistant Terms of Use. You must accept them to start using the service. The key points are:

- **Data transmission.** To provide AI-powered assistance, information from your database — such as schema definitions, metadata, query structures and small data excerpts — is transmitted to a third-party Large Language Model (LLM) provider for processing.
- **No training on your data.** Your data is never used to train any AI or machine learning model and is not retained by the LLM provider beyond the duration of the request.
- **Use of test data recommended.** For maximum privacy protection, use the AI Assistant with non-production, test, or anonymized datasets whenever possible.
- **User responsibility.** You are responsible for ensuring that your use of the AI Assistant complies with all applicable data protection regulations (GDPR, CCPA, and equivalent legislation).

Once activated, the subscription is stored on the ArcadeDB server and is shared by all Studio users connected to it.

### 10.11.3. Using the assistant

After activation, the panel switches to chat mode. The layout is composed of:

- **Chat history** on the left, grouping past conversations as **Today**, **Yesterday**, **This Week** and **Older**. You can create a new chat with **New Chat** or delete a previous one with the trash icon.
- **Database selector** at the top of the chat area. The assistant only operates on the database you select here, so make sure to pick the right one before sending a message.
- **Mode toggle** at the top right, see Modes.
- **Messages area** with the conversation between you and the assistant.
- **Input box** at the bottom: type your question and press **Enter** (use **Shift+Enter** to insert a newline) or click **Send**. While a response is being generated, the **Send** button turns into a **Stop** button you can use to cancel the request.

The assistant renders answers as Markdown, including formatted text, lists and syntax-highlighted code blocks.

### 10.11.4. Modes

The AI Assistant supports two modes, switchable at any time from the toggle at the top right of the panel. The selected mode is remembered across sessions.

- **Auto Run Read Only Queries** — the assistant can autonomously execute read-only queries (for example to inspect the schema or sample data) and use the results to compose its answer. Every tool call performed during a turn is shown in the message as a transparent log, so you can always see which queries were run.
- **Review First** — the assistant never runs anything on its own. It can still propose commands, but it is up to you to inspect and run them.

In both modes, **write** operations (inserts, updates, deletes, schema changes) are never executed automatically: they are always returned as command blocks for you to review.

### 10.11.5. Executing suggested commands

When the assistant proposes one or more commands, each is rendered in a dedicated block showing:

- A short **purpose** describing what the command does
- A language badge (`SQL`, `SQL Script`, `GREMLIN`, `CYPHER`, `MONGO`, `GRAPHQL`)
- The command itself
- Action buttons:
  - **Copy** to copy the command to the clipboard

- **Open in Query** to switch to the Query panel with the command and language preloaded, ready to be tweaked and executed
- **Execute** to run the command in place against the currently selected database; the outcome (success with result count, or error) is shown right below the block

If the assistant returns multiple commands, an additional **Execute All** button runs them sequentially in the order they were proposed, stopping at the first error.

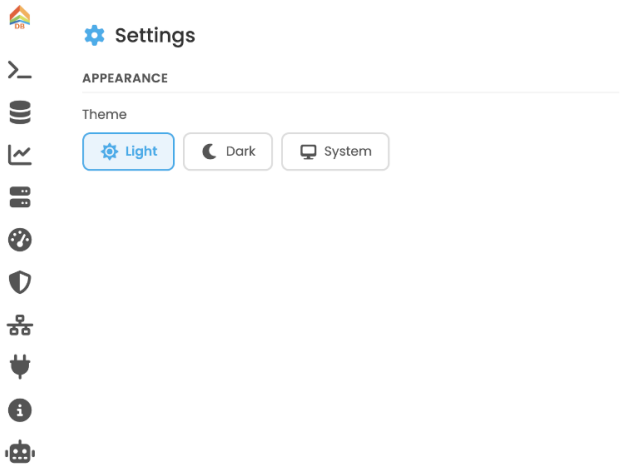
Multi-statement SQL blocks are automatically executed as `sqlscript` so that several statements separated by `;` can run in a single request.

### 10.11.6. Privacy and security notes

- The assistant only operates on the database explicitly selected in the panel.
- All requests are sent over the same authenticated connection used by the rest of Studio.
- The subscription key is validated on every request; if the key is invalid, expired or has been disabled, the panel switches back to the activation screen.
- For sensitive workloads, prefer the **Review First** mode and use a dedicated read-only Studio user when granting access to the AI Assistant.

## 10.12. Settings Panel

The **Settings** panel controls Studio's own appearance. It is pinned at the bottom of the icon sidebar.




### 10.12.1. Appearance

The **Theme** control offers three options:

- **Light** — light theme.
- **Dark** — dark theme.
- **System** — follow the operating-system theme; Studio listens for OS changes and switches on the fly.

The choice is stored in browser local storage (`studio-theme`) and persists across sessions.

Server- and database-scoped configuration lives elsewhere: see Server › Server Settings and Database › Database Settings.

## 10.13. Console

Run the console by executing `console.sh` under `bin` directory from the `arcadedb` directory:

```
$ bin/console.sh

ArcadeDB Console v26.10.1 - Copyrights (c) 2021 Arcade Data Ltd (https://arcadedb.com)

>
```

A warning `WARNING: Using incubator modules: jdk.incubator.vector` in the log can be safely ignored.

The following command-line arguments are supported by the console:

- `-D` allows to pass settings,
- `-b` enables batch mode which exits after executing all commands passed via the command-lines.
- `-fae` fail-at-end if error occurs during batch (normally batch mode breaks execution at an error).

In batch mode the console exits with code `1` when any command failed, and `0` only when everything succeeded, so a script or CI step can rely on the exit code. This includes a failure raised when the write is committed - a unique-index violation, a full disk - also with `SET asyncMode = true`. *(Since v26.10.1: such a failure was printed but the console still exited `0`.)*

The console supports these direct commands (not evaluated by the query engine):

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Console** | HELP / ? | QUIT / EXIT | PWD |
| **Server** | CONNECT | CLOSE | LIST DATABASES |
| **User** | CREATE USER | DROP USER | |
| **Database** | CREATE DATABASE | DROP DATABASE | CHECK DATABASE |
| **Schema** | INFO TYPES | INFO TYPE | INFO TRANSACTION |
| **Transaction** | BEGIN | COMMIT | ROLLBACK |
| **Scripting** | SET LANGUAGE | LOAD | `--` (Comment) |

for which you can retrieve the following help by typing `HELP` or just `?`:

```
begin                                                    -> begins a new
transaction
check database                                           -> check database
integrity
```

```
close |<path>|remote:<url> <user> <pw>                          -> closes the database
commit                                                          -> commits current
transaction
connect <path>|local:<url>|remote:<url> <user> [<pw>]           -> connects to a
database
create database <path>|remote:<url> <user> [<pw>]               -> creates a new
database
create user <user> identified by [<pw>] [grant connect to <db>[:<group>]*] -> creates
a user
drop database <path>|remote:<url> <user> [<pw>]                 -> deletes a database
drop user <user>                                                -> deletes a user
help|?                                                          -> ask for this help
info types                                                      -> prints available
types
info type <type>                                                -> prints details about
type
info transaction                                                -> prints current
transaction
list databases |remote:<url> <user> [<pw>]                      -> lists databases
load <path>                                                     -> runs local script
pwd                                                             -> returns current
directory
rollback                                                        -> rolls back current
transaction
set language = sql|sqlscript|cypher|gremlin|mongo|graphql       -> sets console query
language
-- <comment>                                                    -> comment (no
operation)
quit|exit                                                       -> exits from the
console

Omit <pw> to be asked for the password with the echo hidden, so it is never written to
the .history file nor echoed to the output in batch mode.
```

The `close` command can be used without path or url, then it closes the currently connected database.

The password can be left out of `connect`, `create database`, `drop database`, `list databases` and `create user`. The console then asks for it and hides what you type. This is the recommended form: a password written on the command line ends up in the console's `.history` file, and in the build log when the console runs with `-b`. The console masks passwords in both places, but a password you never type in full cannot leak at all. A password containing spaces is accepted.

Long-running maintenance commands (`CHECK DATABASE`, `REBUILD INDEX`, `COMPACT INDEX`, `BACKUP DATABASE`, `IMPORT DATABASE`) render a live progress line while they run, showing the current step and percentage, e.g. `check database fix [step 3/9] Checking vertices 'Account' |======== | 42%`. The same progress is available in

Studio and via the HTTP progress endpoint.

It can be useful to wrap longer scripts called via `LOAD myscript.sql` in a transaction via `BEGIN; LOAD myscript.sql; COMMIT;` to ensure completion of write operations.

Every statement in a script run with `LOAD` must end with `;`, except optionally the very last one. A `;` is what tells `LOAD` a statement is complete, so it can also span multiple lines.

With `SET LANGUAGE = sqlscript`, `LOAD` sends the whole file as a single script instead of one statement at a time, so `LET` variables, `FOREACH`, `IF` and `WHILE` work across statements exactly as in Studio's SQL Script language.

The comment command `--` is useful for scripts.

The console does line-by-line processing, so commands and queries need to be in a single line.

The console passes backslashes to the query language untouched, so a statement means the same typed at the prompt, passed with `-b`, or replayed with `LOAD` as it does over the HTTP API. Escaping is the query language's business: in SQL a string literal needs two backslashes for one, so a Windows path is written `'C:\\Users\\bob'` and a regular expression `'\\d+'`. Before 26.9.1 the console consumed one of the two, so those statements could not be entered at all.

The multi-line comment syntax `/* ⋯ */` is not supported in the console, since the console reads from the terminal and script files line by line. It is required and recommended to use the single-line comment syntax `--` for inline code docu or headers.

### 10.13.1. Tutorial

Let's create our first database, located in our local filesystem. To identify the database you specify in a connection string. It could be either absolute, or relative to the database directory. The database directory can be explicitly set, when you start the console, like

```
$ ./bin/console.sh -Darcadedb.server.databaseDirectory=/databases
```

If no database directory is given at startup, it is the `databases` directory under the root path of the arcadedb server by default. To create a new database under the database directory, you would run the following command in the console

```
> CREATE DATABASE mydb
```

If you want to create your database somewhere else in the local filesystem, you can specify a different path to the database:

```
> CREATE DATABASE data/mydb
```

Once the database has been created, you can simply connect to it:

```
> CONNECT mydb
```

Or if on a different path, specify the path where the database is located:

```
> CONNECT data/mydb
```

If you're using the ArcadeDB Server, you can create the database through the server:

```
> CREATE DATABASE remote:localhost/mydb root arcadedb-password
```

Once created, you can always connect to the server with the following command:

```
> CONNECT remote:localhost/mydb root arcadedb-password
```

Let's also create a user with access to "mydb":

```
> CREATE USER albert IDENTIFIED BY einstein GRANT CONNECT TO mydb
```

Now let's create a "Profile" type:

```
{mydb}> CREATE DOCUMENT TYPE Profile
```

```
+---------+--------------------+
|NAME     |VALUE               |
+---------+--------------------+
|operation|create document type|
|typeName |Profile             |
+---------+--------------------+
Command executed in 99ms
```

Check your new type is there:

```
{mydb}> INFO TYPES
```

```
AVAILABLE TYPES
+-------+--------+----------+-------------------------------------+----------
+-------------+
|NAME   |TYPE    |SUPER TYPES|BUCKETS                              |PROPERTIES |SYNC
STRATEGY|
+-------+--------+----------+-------------------------------------+----------
+-------------+
|Profile|Document|0[]        |8[Profile_0,...,Profile_7]|0[]       |round-robin|
|
+-------+--------+----------+-------------------------------------+----------
+-------------+
```

You can also query the defined types by executing the following SQL query: `select from schema:types`.

Finally, let's create a document of type "Profile":

```
{mydb}> INSERT INTO Profile SET name = 'Jay', lastName = 'Miner'
```

```
DOCUMENT @type:Profile @rid:#1:0
+--------+-----+
|NAME    |VALUE|
+--------+-----+
|name    |Jay  |
|lastName|Miner|
+--------+-----+
Command executed in 17ms
```

You can see your brand new record with RID `#1:0`. Now let's query the database to see if our new document can be found:

```
{mydb}> SELECT FROM Profile
```

```
DOCUMENT @type:Profile @rid:#1:0
+--------+-----+
|NAME    |VALUE|
+--------+-----+
|name    |Jay  |
|lastName|Miner|
+--------+-----+
Command executed in 37ms
```

Here we go: our document is there.

Remember that a transaction is automatically started. In order to make changes persistent, execute

a `COMMIT` command. When the console exists (`exit` or `quit` command), the pending transaction is committed automatically.

### 10.13.2. Settings

The console provides specific settings accessible via:

```
> SET <setting> = <value>
```

The following console settings are available:

| Setting | Type | Default |
|---|---|---|
| asyncmode | boolean | false |
| expandresultset | boolean | false |
| language | string | sql |
| limit | integer | 20 |
| maxmultivalueentries | integer | 10 |
| maxwidth | integer | 150 |
| transactionbatchsize | integer | 0 |
| verbose | integer | 3 |

The `language` setting can be `sql`, `sqlscript`, `cypher`, `gremlin`, `mongo`, or `graphql`.

Other settings can be changed this way, too.

Here is an example using `SQLscript`:

```
{mydb}> SET language = sqlscript
```

```
{mydb}> IF (1 = 1) { \ SELECT 1; \ }
```

### 10.13.3. Scripting

The console can also run local SQL scripts using the `LOAD` command:

```
$ bin/console.sh -b "LOAD myscript.sql"
```

or passing the commands as string argument:

```
$ bin/console.sh "CREATE DATABASE test; CREATE DOCUMENT TYPE doc; BACKUP DATABASE;
```

```
exit;"
```

Make sure to `create database` or `connect` to a database first in the script before using SQL commands.

All commands (of a script) are executed, disregarding if a previous command failed.

### 10.13.4. Console-Server Interaction

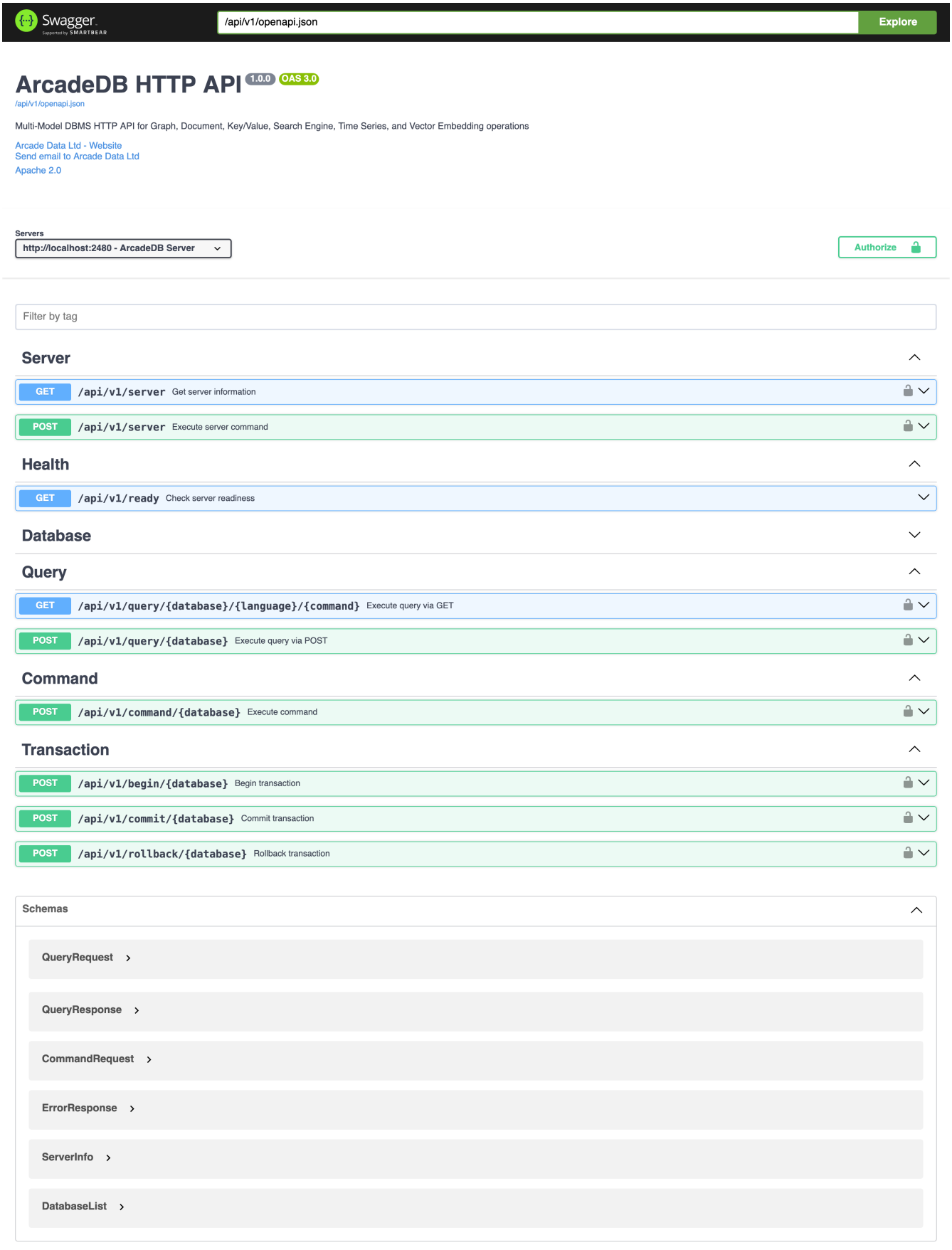
The console cannot access a database via local connection when a server is running.

When the server is running it locks all (opened) databases, hence the console cannot access these databases via local connection which utilizes the file system. Nonetheless, the console can still connect to these databases via a remote connection, particularly, using `localhost` if the console is running on the same machine as the server:

```
> CONNECT remote:localhost/mydb root arcadedb-password
```

## 10.14. Swagger-UI

To use the Swagger-UI, point your web browser to the server and port that hosts the ArcadeDB server at the `/api/v1/docs` endpoint. For instance, when running ArcadeDB locally with the default port this means: http://localhost:2480/api/v1/docs .




With the Swagger UI you can hands-on explore the HTTP API and test requests.

# 10.15. Compatible Tools

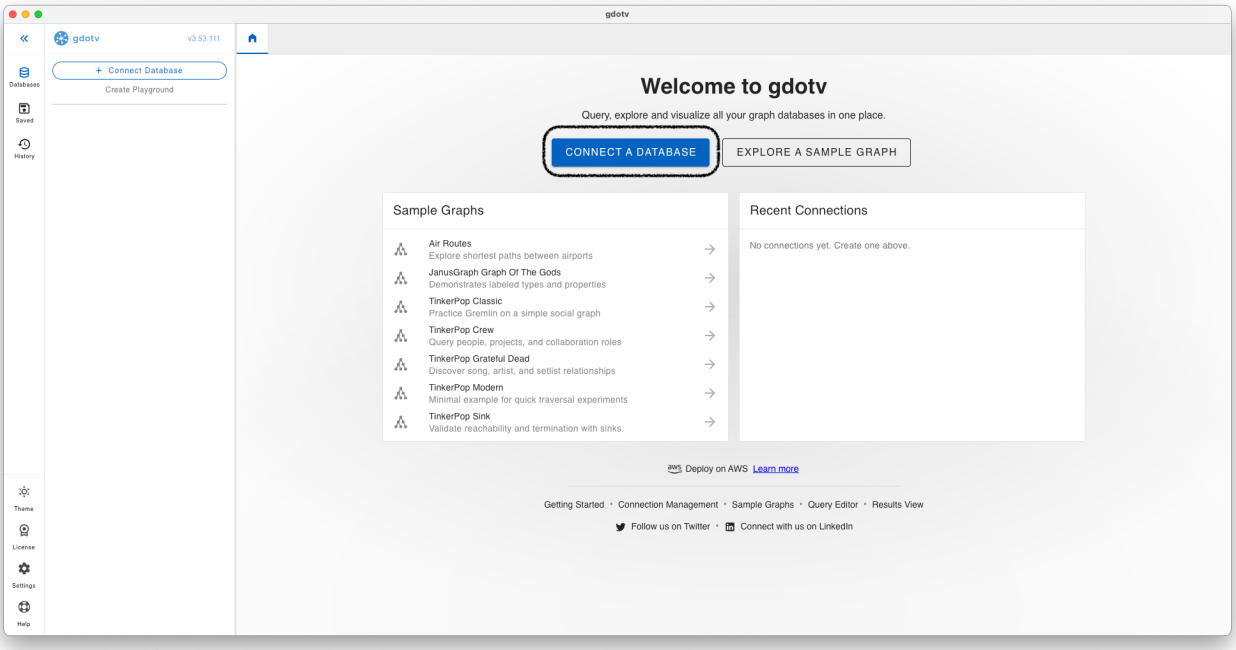
## 10.15.1. gdotv

ArcadeDB is fully compatible with gdotv, so no particular configurations need to be made. The only requirement is loading the Gremlin plugin via the server setting:

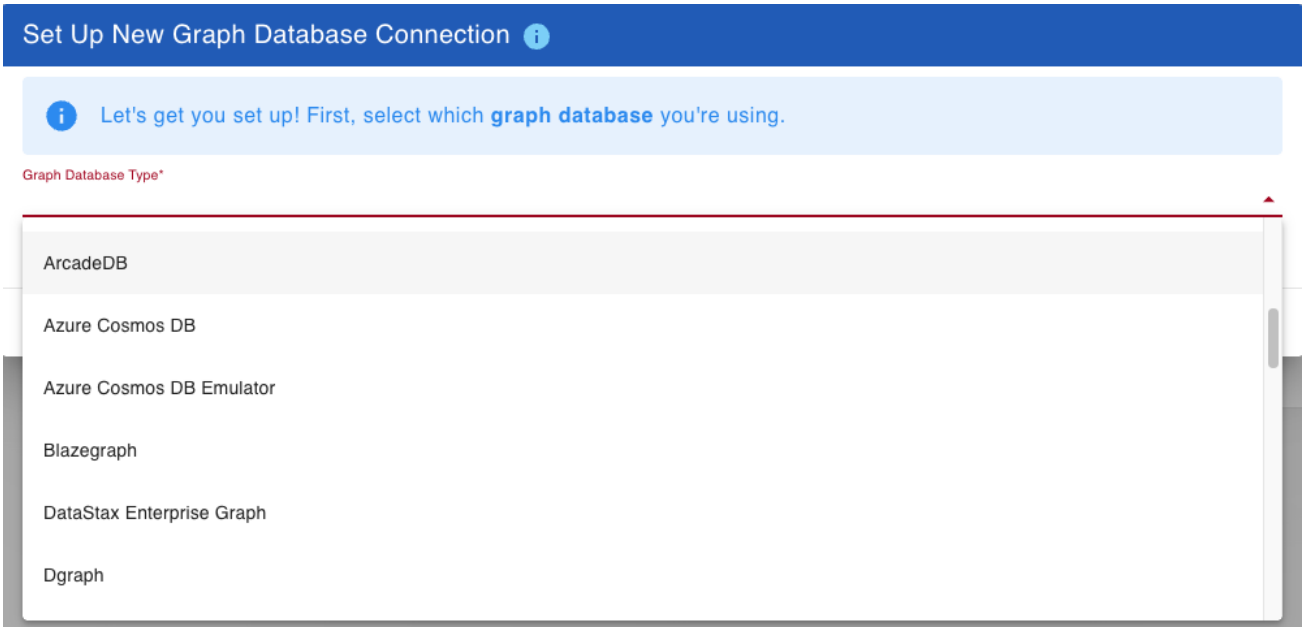
```
"_
Darcadedb.server.plugins=GremlinServer:com.arcadedb.server.gremlin.GremlinServerPlugin
"
```

▼ *Details*

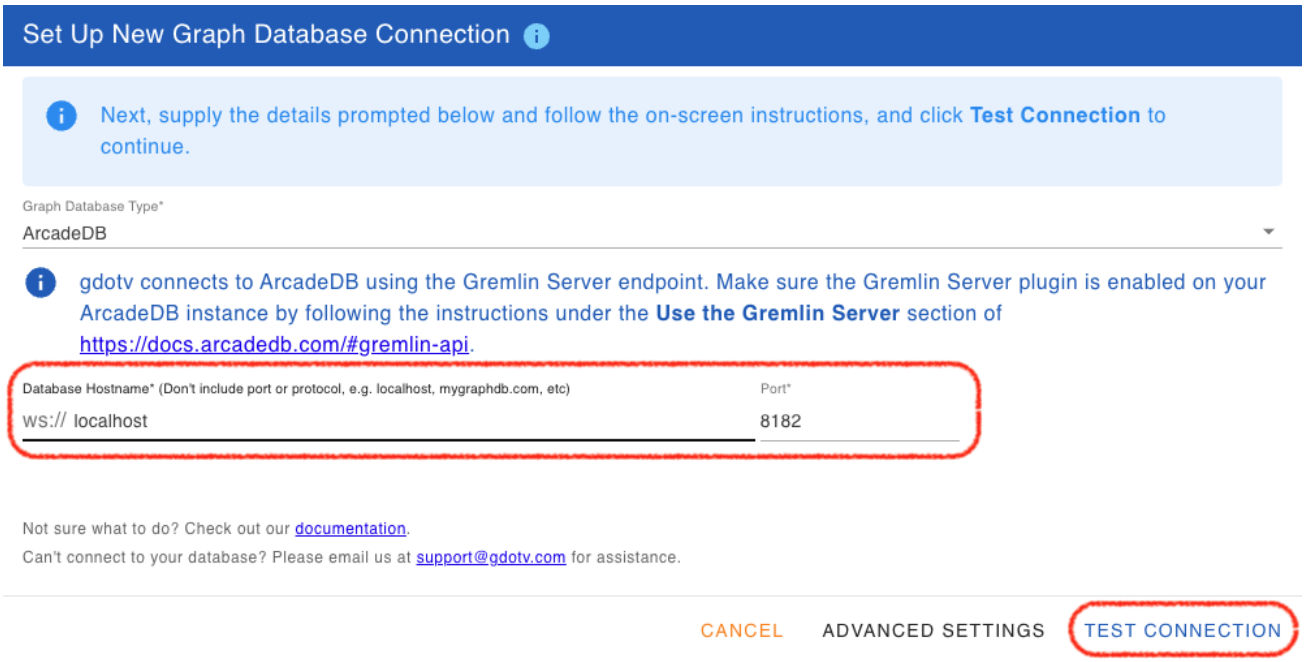
On the title screen, create a new connection:



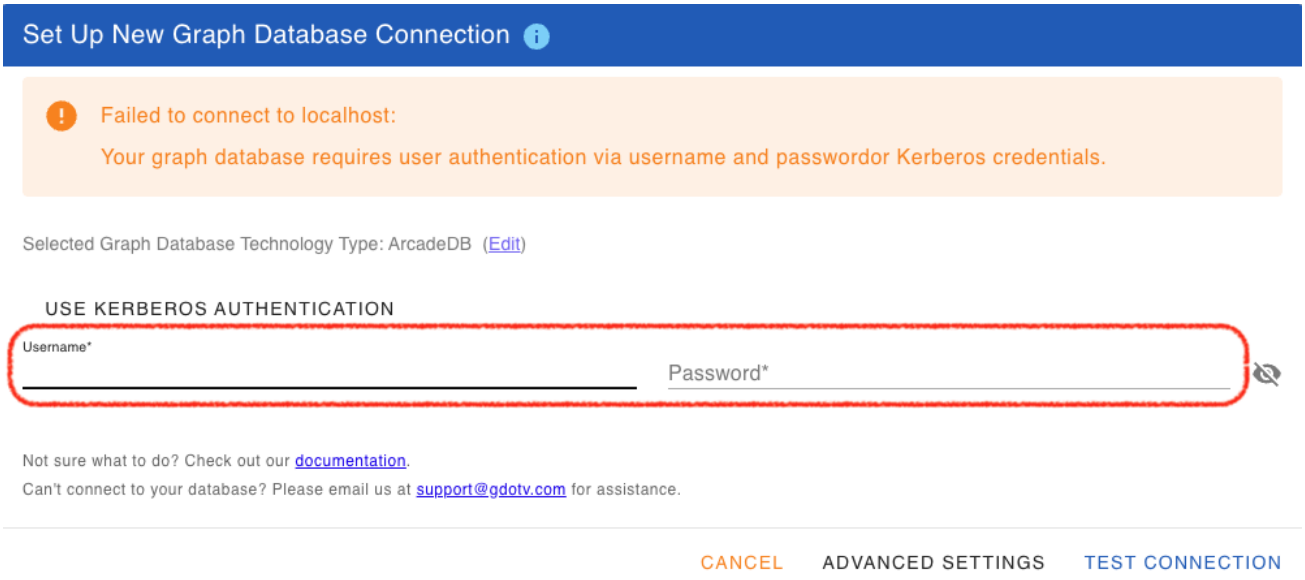

choose ArcadeDB from the list of graph database types:




enter the host name of the ArcadeDB server:




and enter username and password:



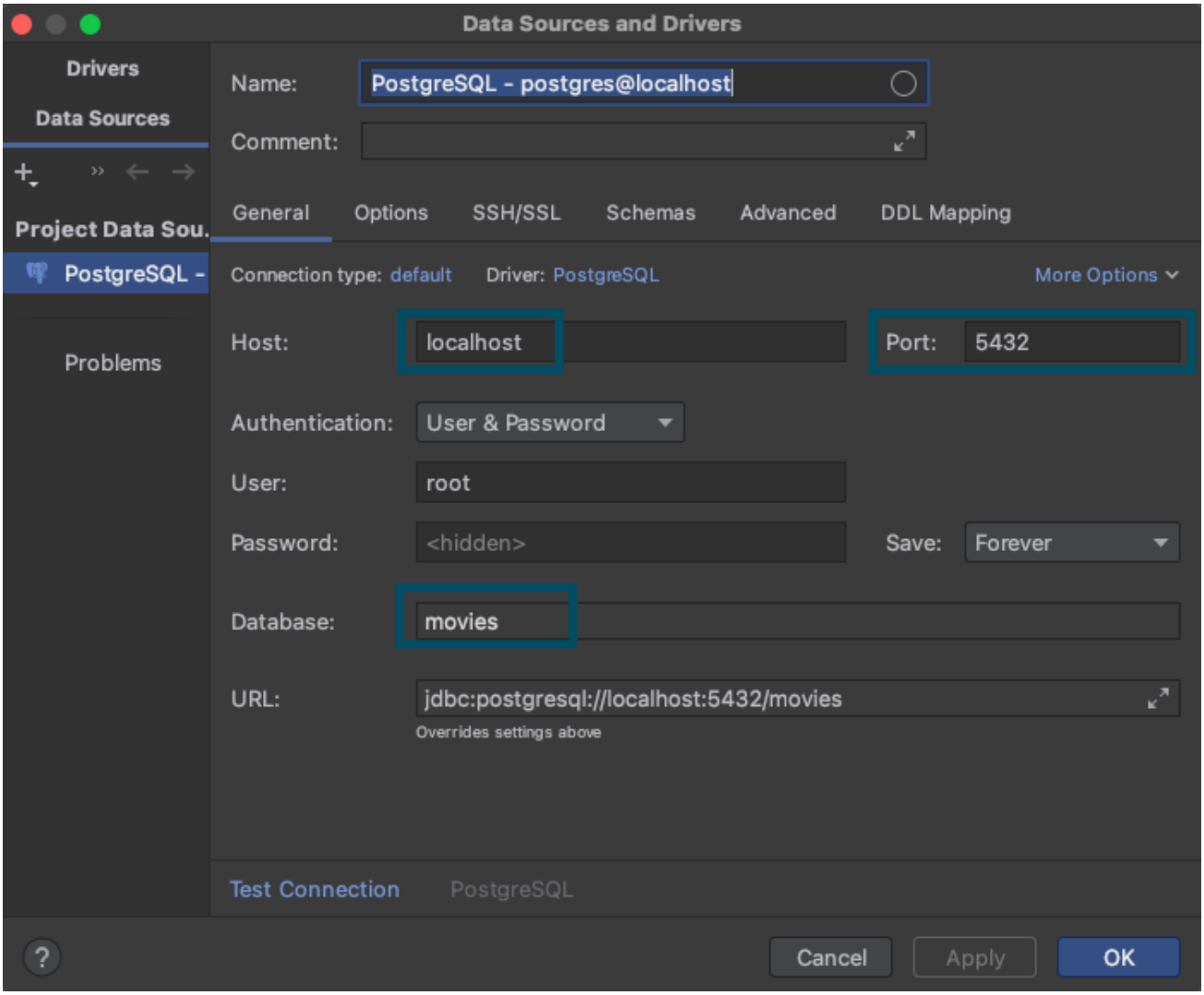

In case of non-standard configurations of the server, under "Advanced Settings" more fine-grained settings can be made.

### 10.15.2. JetBrains DataGrip/Database Plugin

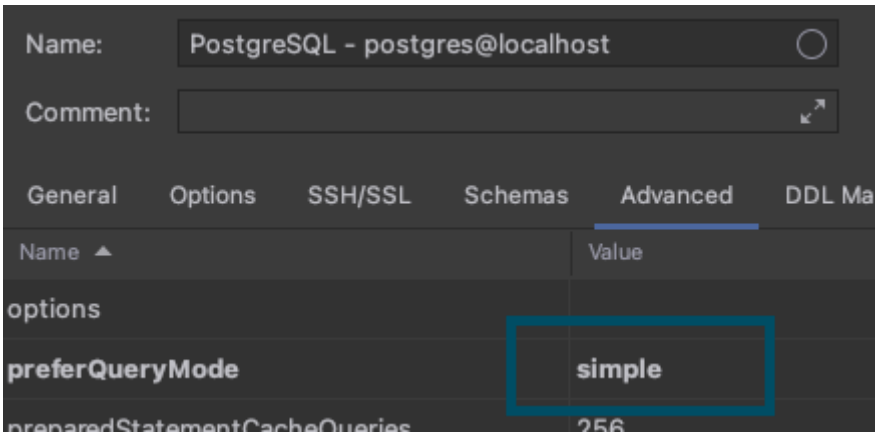
Connecting via JetBrains DataGrip database plugin is relatively straightforward. The introspection features aren't working yet, but the basics seem to work well.

▼ *Details*

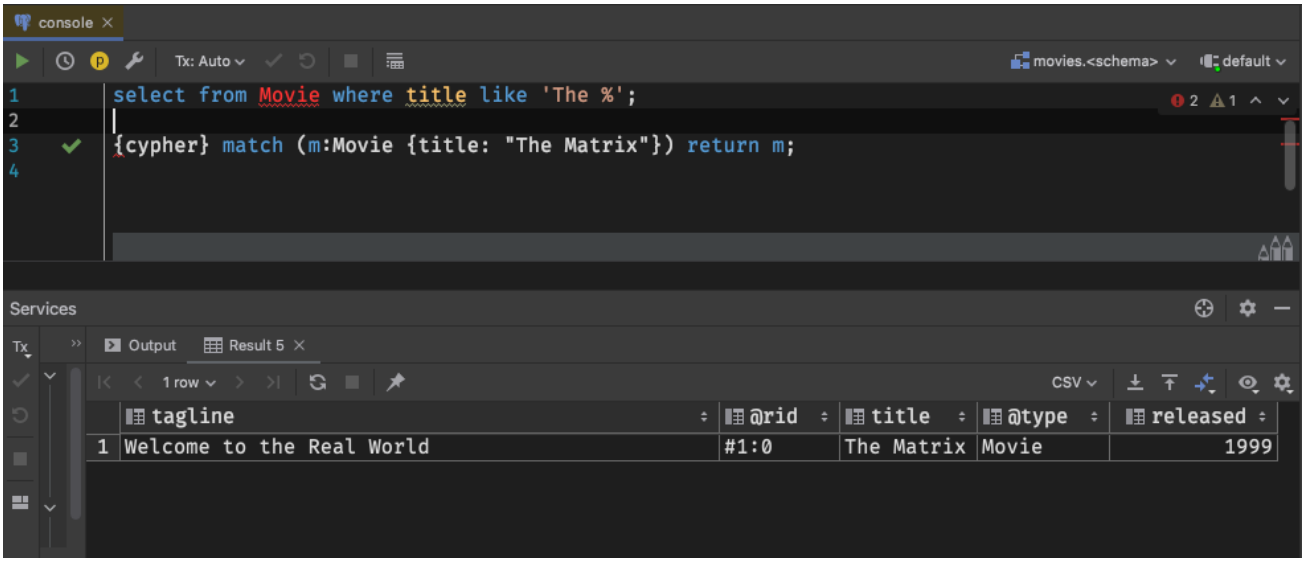
To connect, create a new Postgres datasource and point it to the IP/port of your ArcadeDB server. (0.0.0.0:5432 by default) You will need to fill out the database field, or you'll get an error on connection. At present, changing the current database requires editing the datasource.




Next, you'll need to set `preferQueryMode` to **simple** on the Advanced tab, like this:




You can then run queries via a console. Even non-SQL queries will work, though expect squigglies!

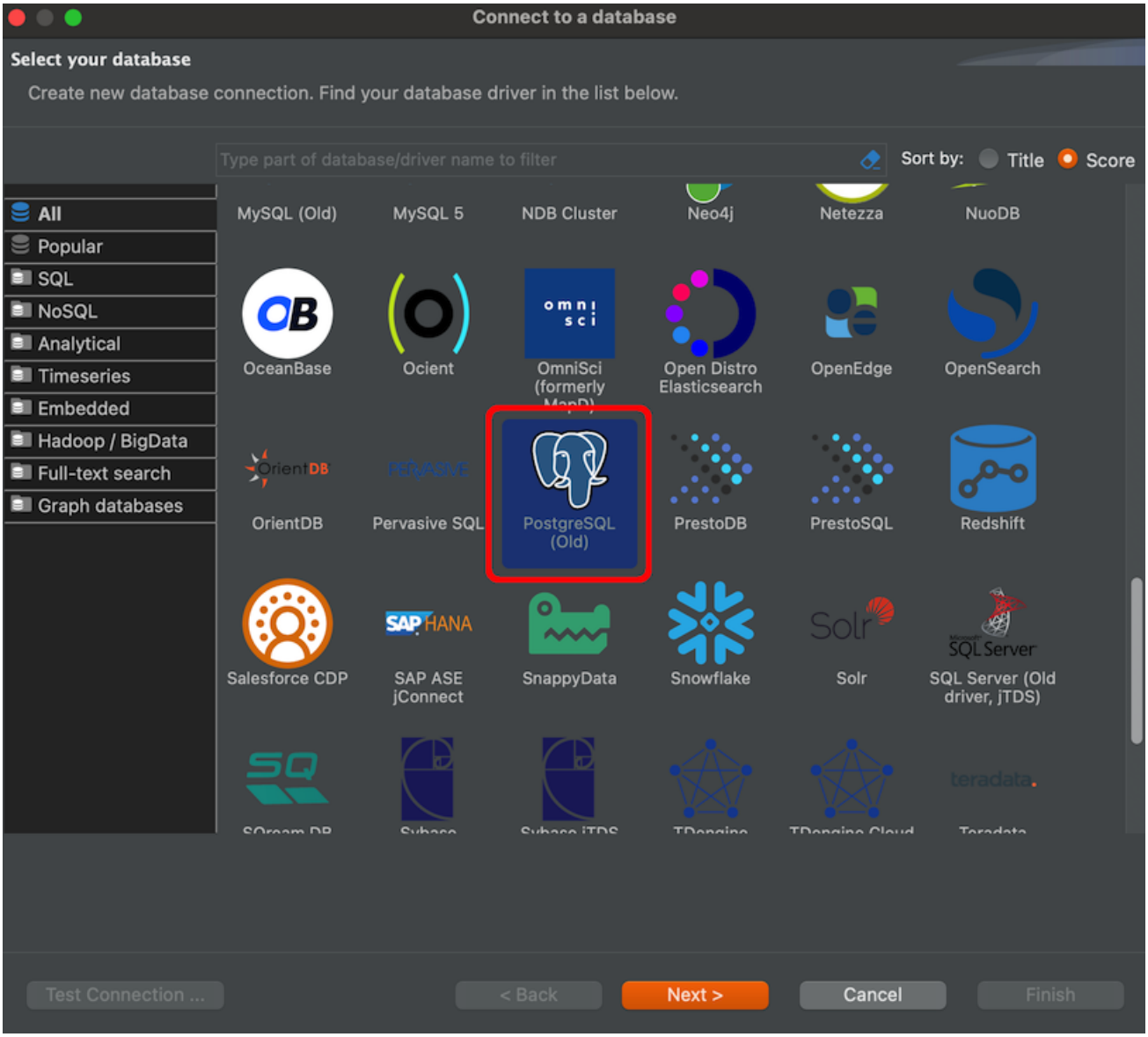



### 10.15.3. DBeaver

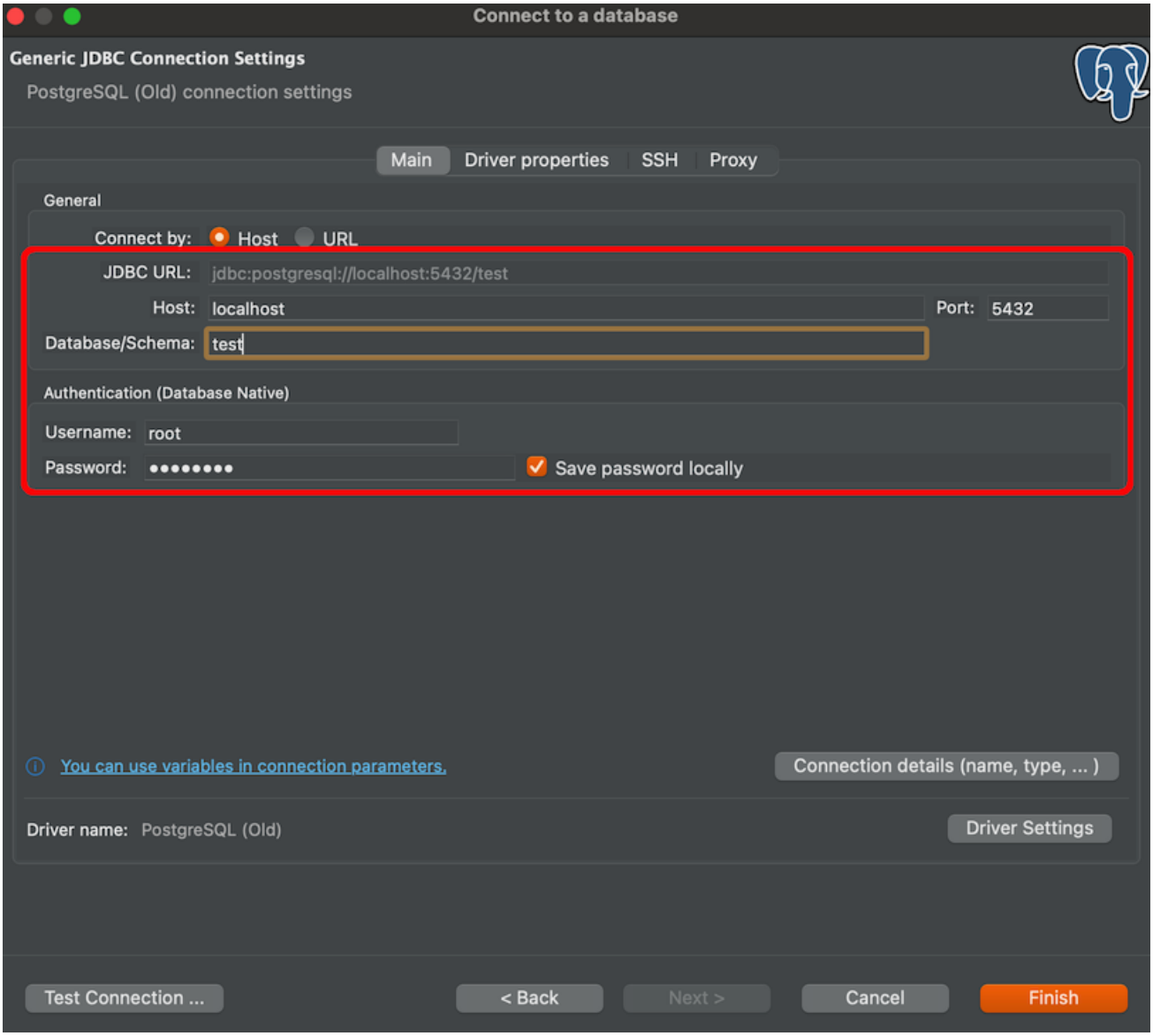
The universal database tool DBeaver has basic compatibility via the legacy Postgres connector.

▼ *Details*

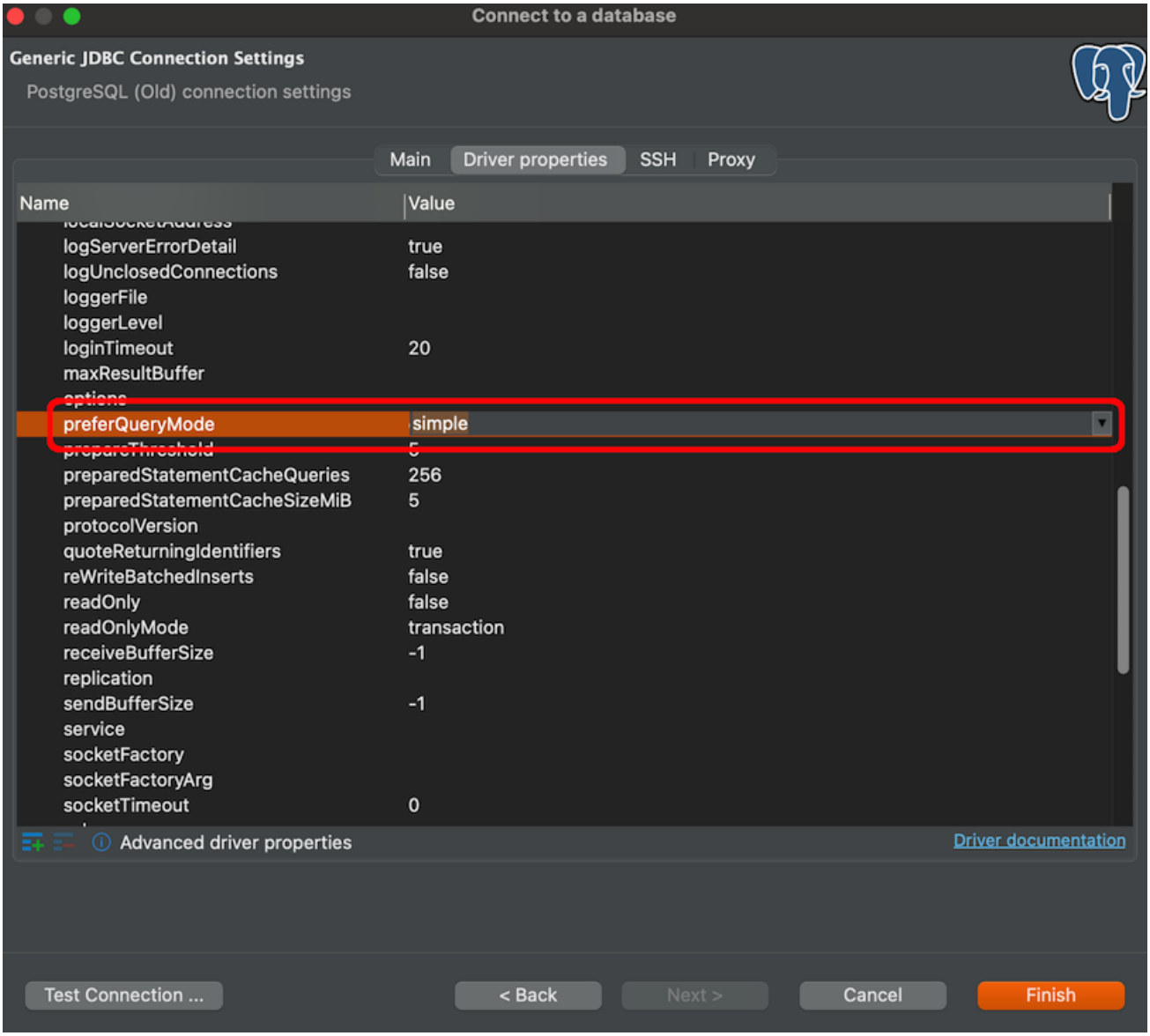
Create a new connection with the "PostgreSQL (Old)" driver:



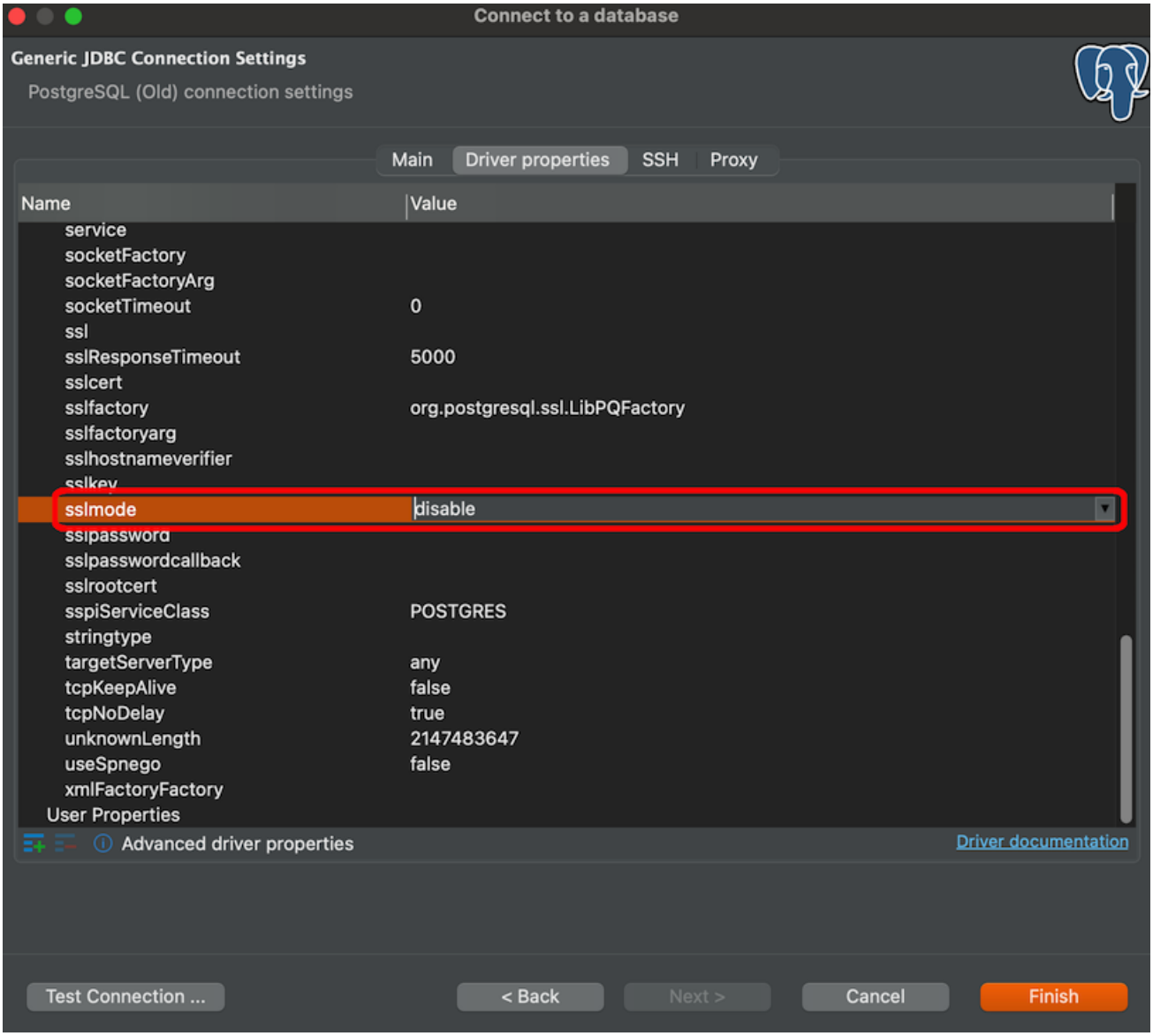

Add your host, port, database, username and password to the general connection settings:



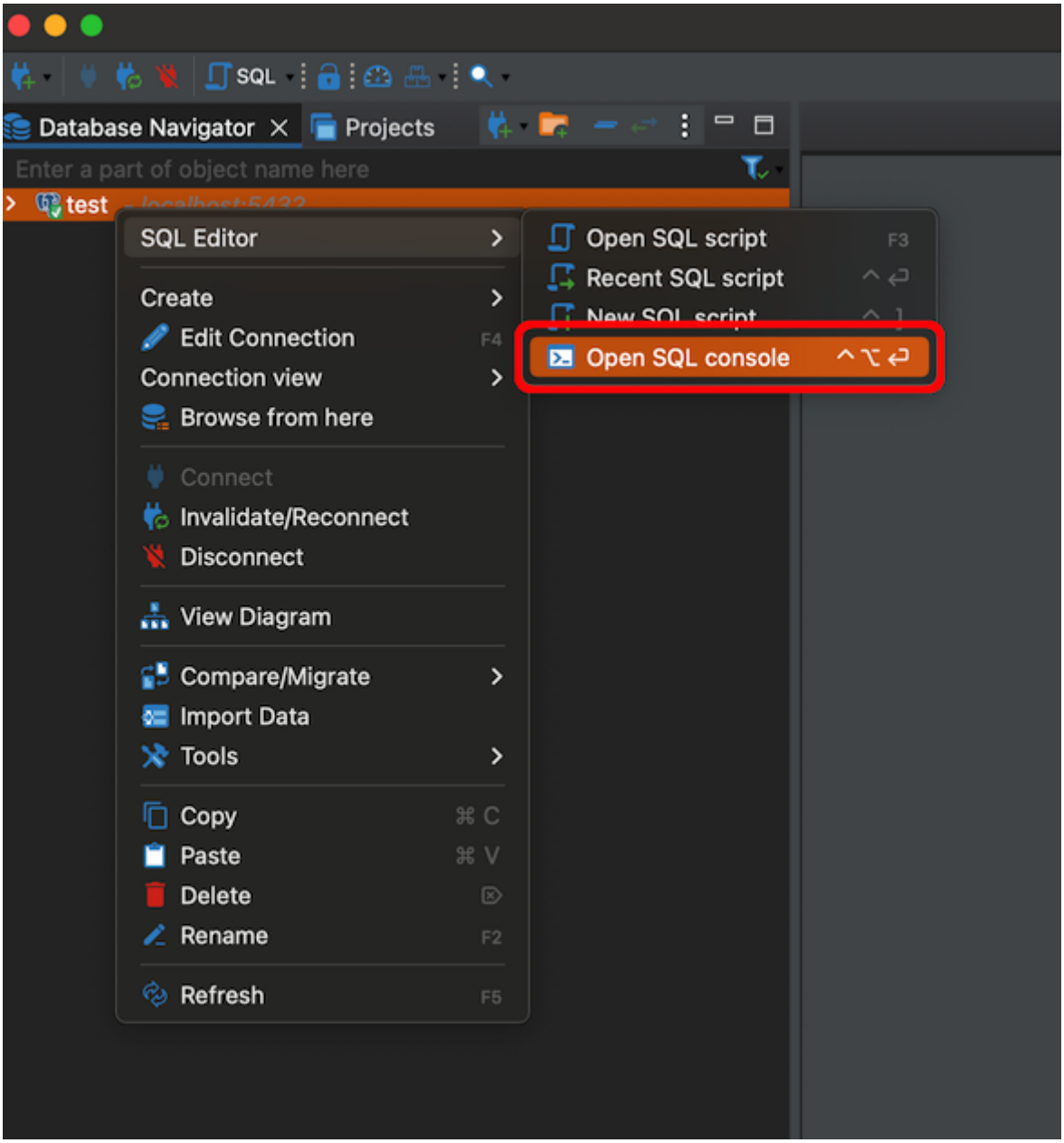

Set the `preferQueryMode` option to `simple` on "Driver Properties" tab:




Set the `sslmode` option to `disable`:




The "Finish" the connection wizard and double click the created connection to connect. Then with a right-click the SQL console can be started:




Now the SQL console can be used to communicate via DBeaver with ArcadeDB.

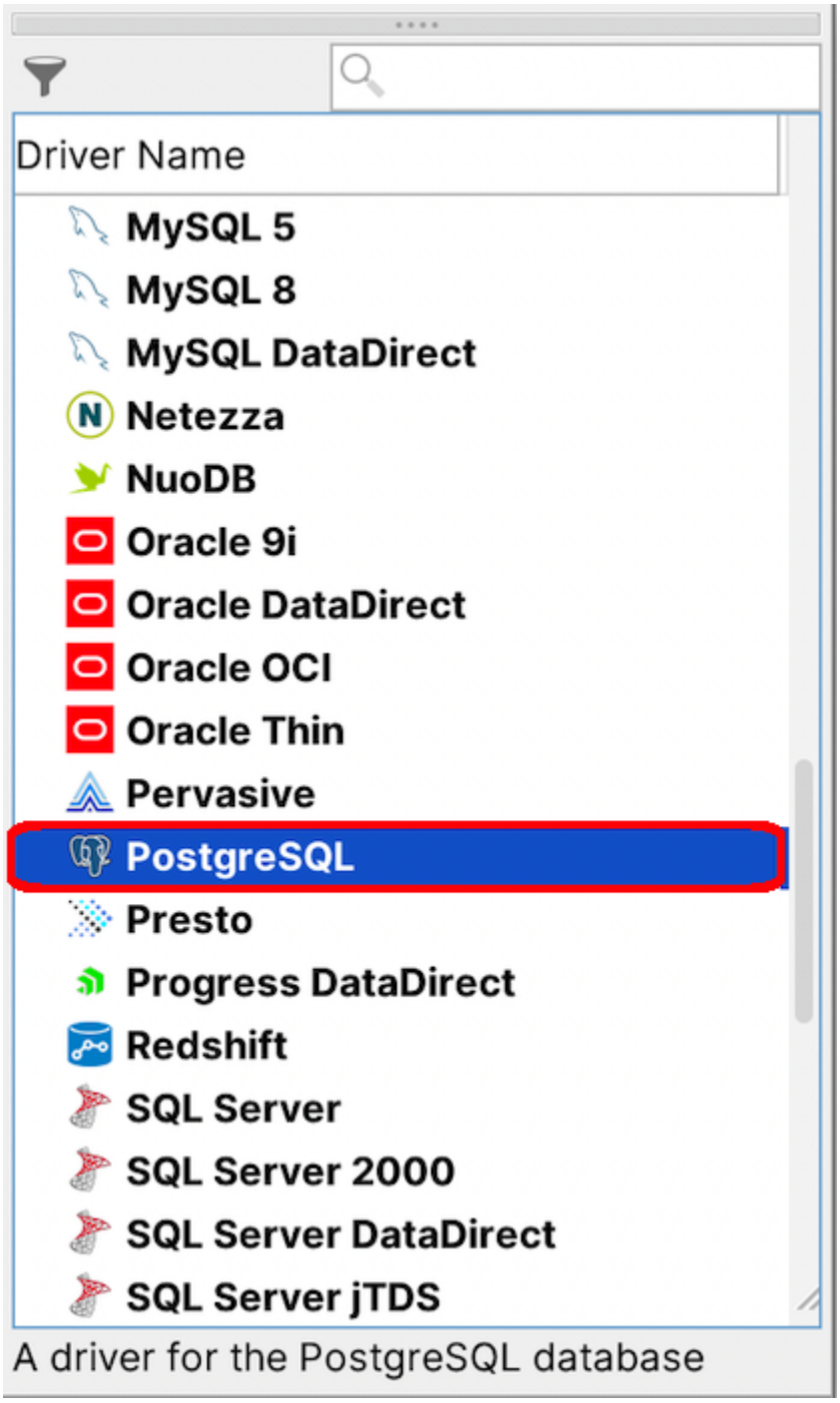
Note that this is only a basic support using a generic relational driver for a NoSQL database, so various functionalities can result in errors.

### 10.15.4. DbVisualizer

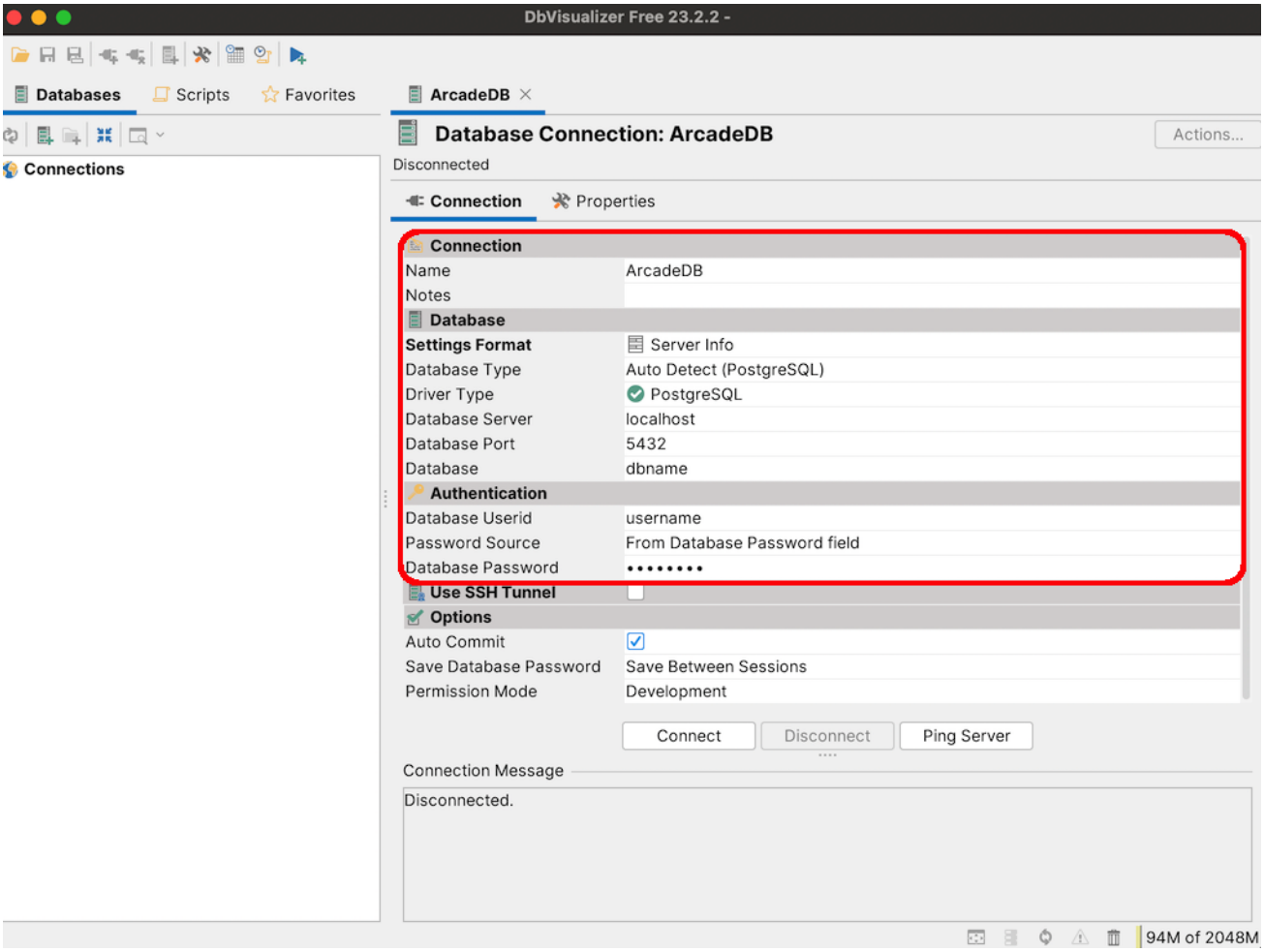
The database client DbVisualizer can also be used via its PostgreSQL driver.

▼ *Details*

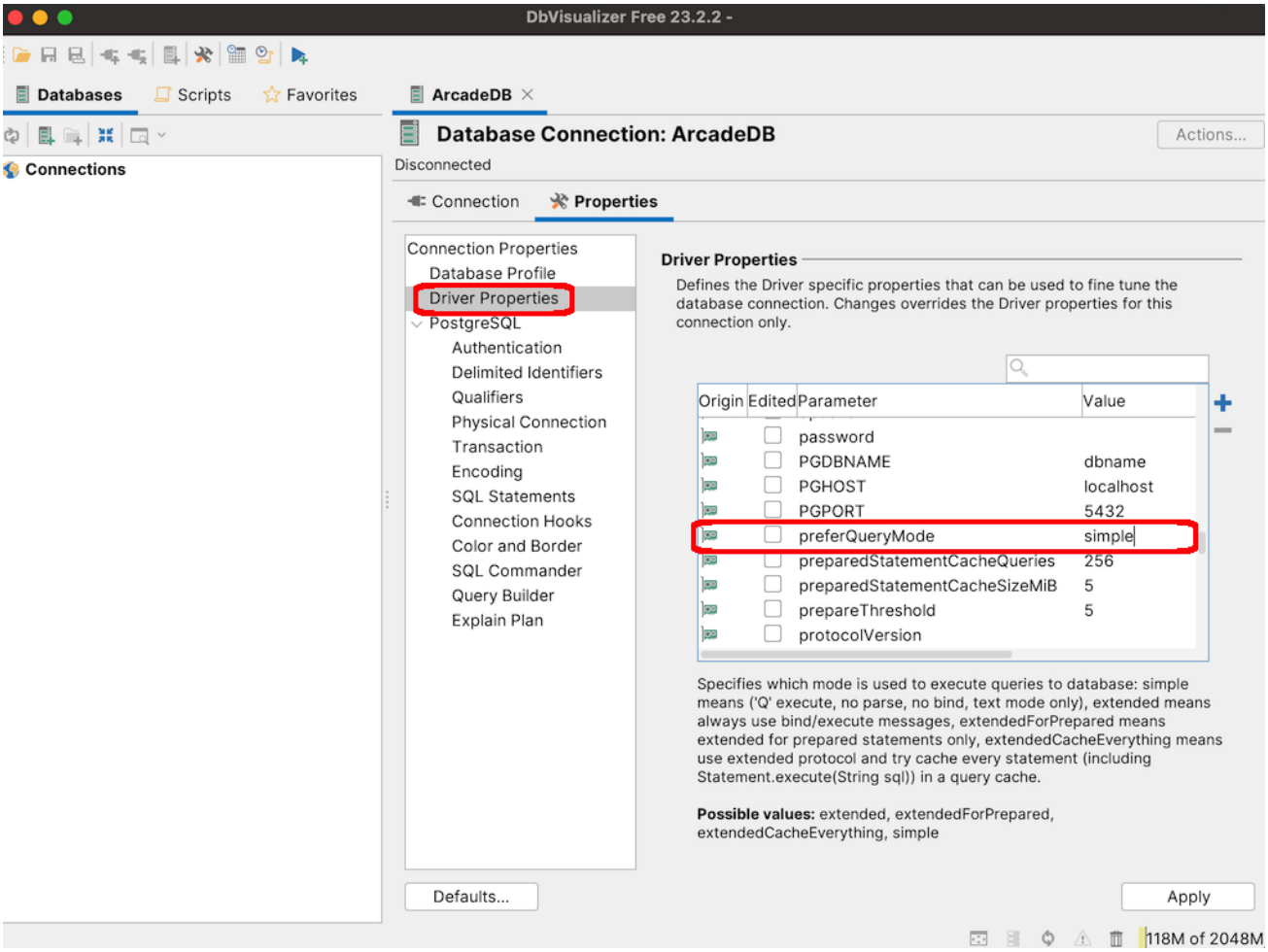
Create a new connection and select "PostgreSQL":



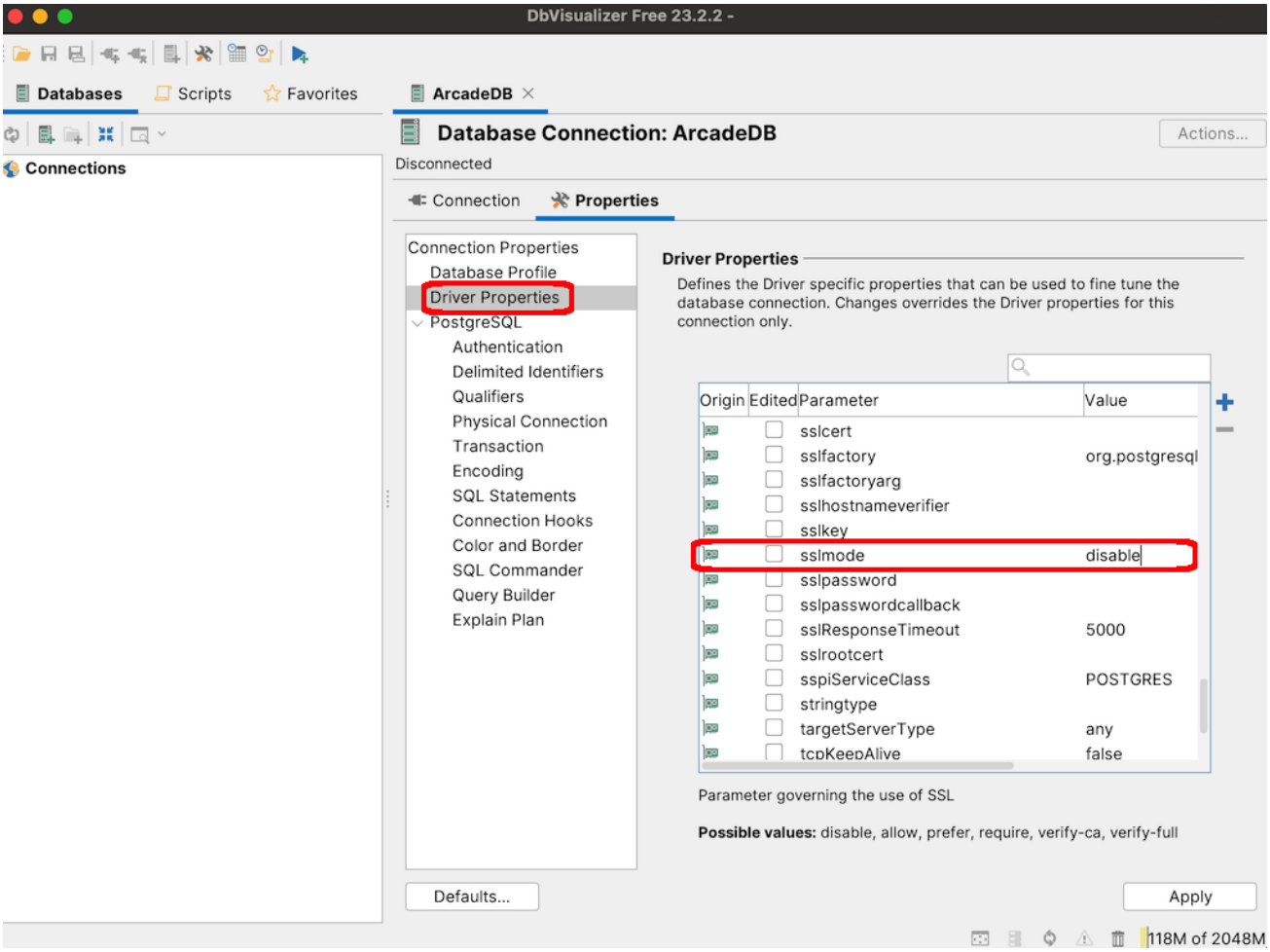

Enter server, port, database, userid, and password:



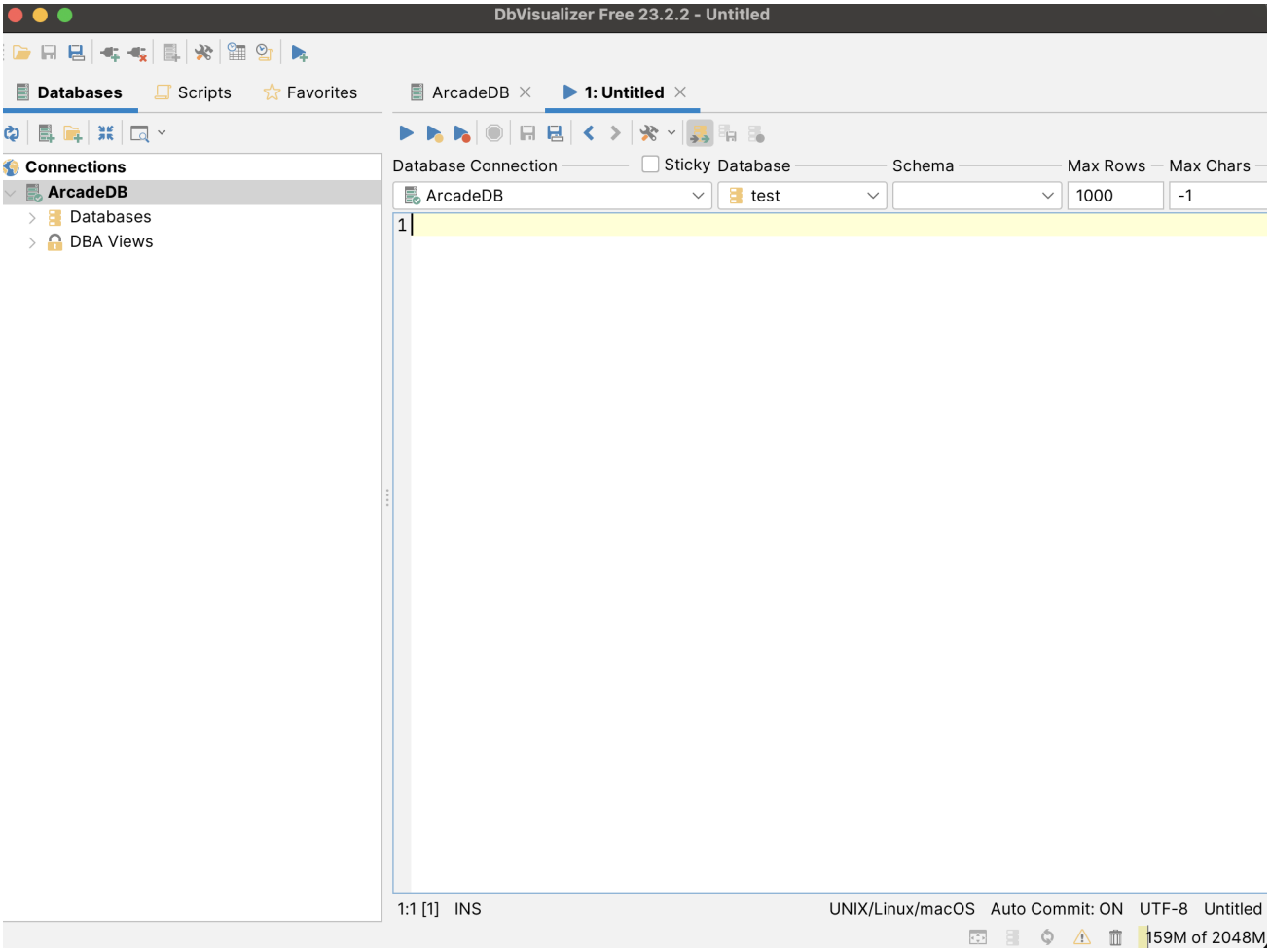

Go to the "Properties" tab and set `preferQueryMode` to `simple`:




Also set `sslmode` to `disable`:




After applying the changes and connecting the SQL commander is available:

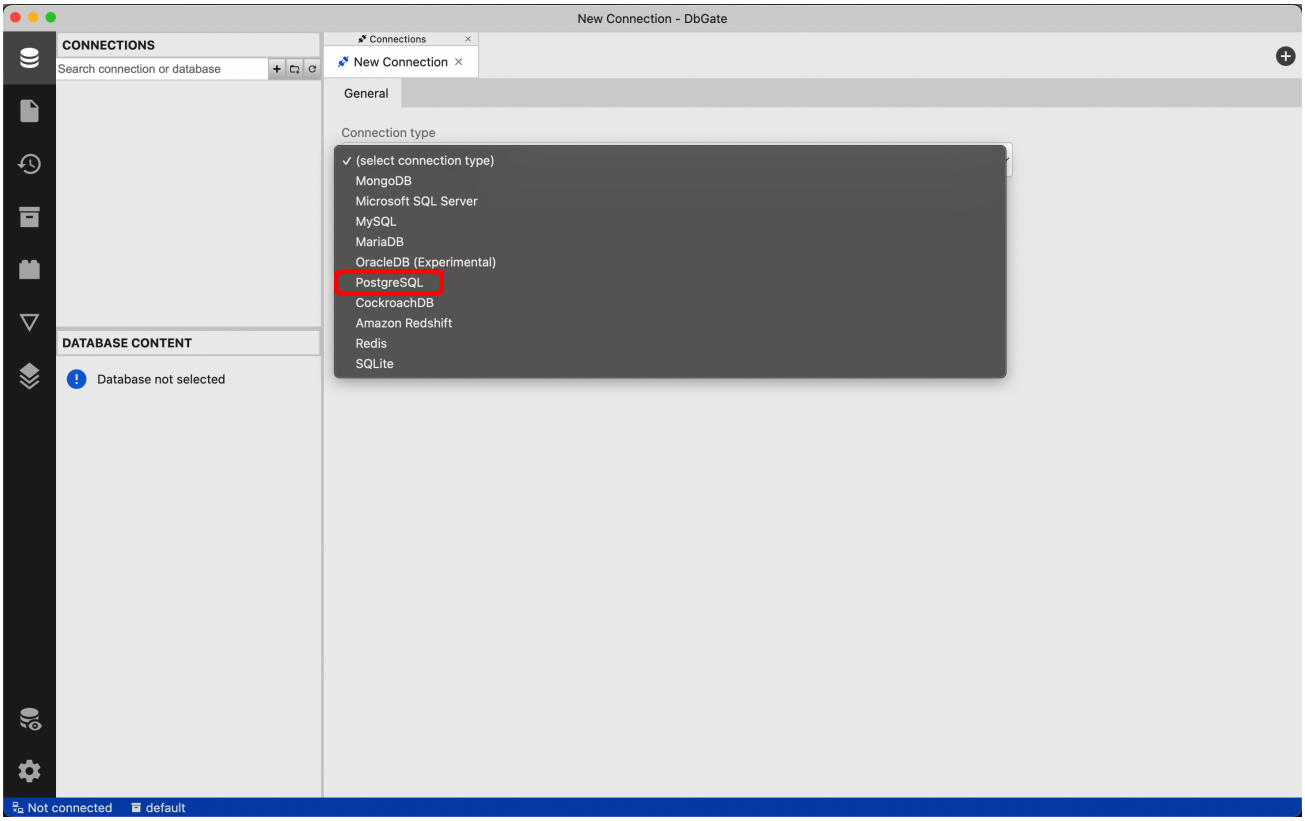



## 10.15.5. DbGate

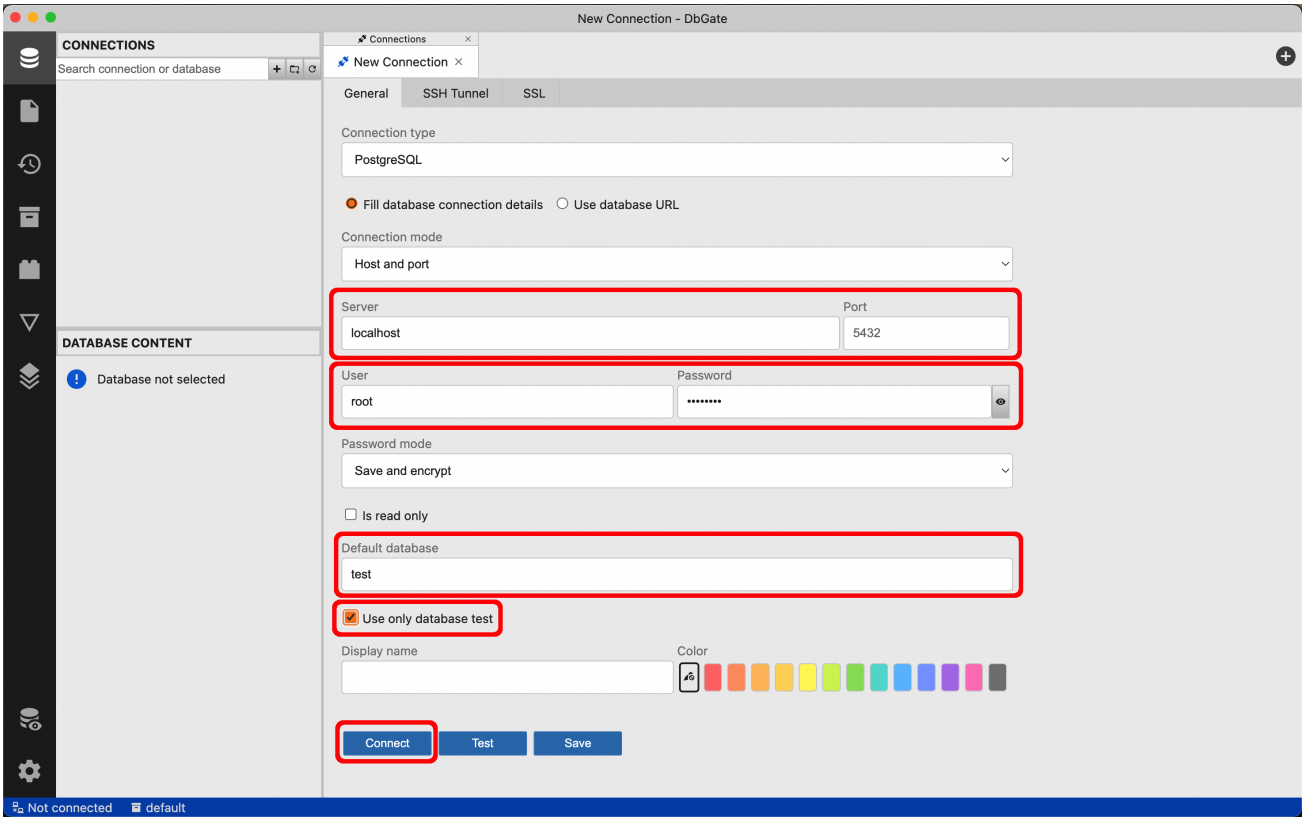
The SQL+noSQL database client DbGate is compatible via the PostgreSQL driver.

▼ *Details*

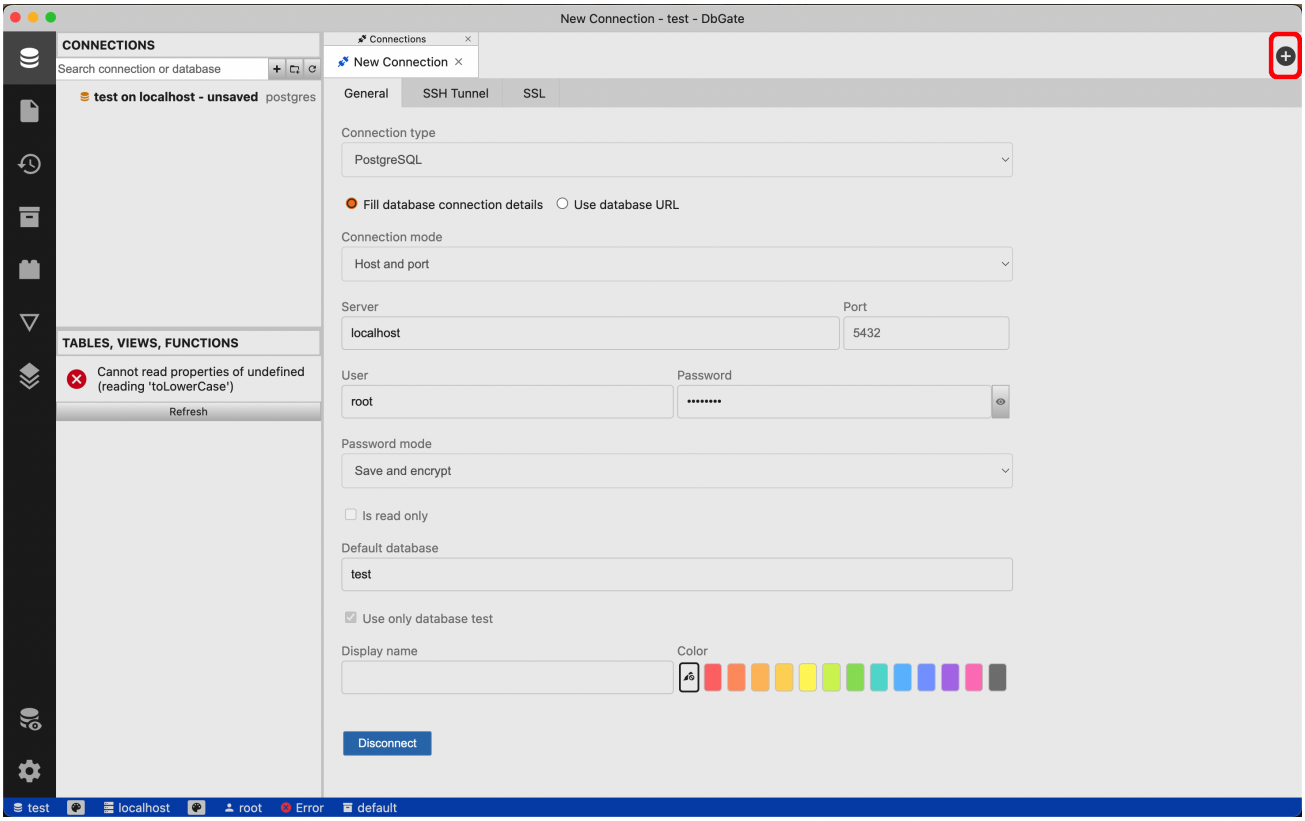
Add a new connection of type PostgreSQL:




Enter host, port, user, password, database, make sure to check "Use only database <db>", and connect:




It seems the reported error can be ignored, so now new queries can be composed by:

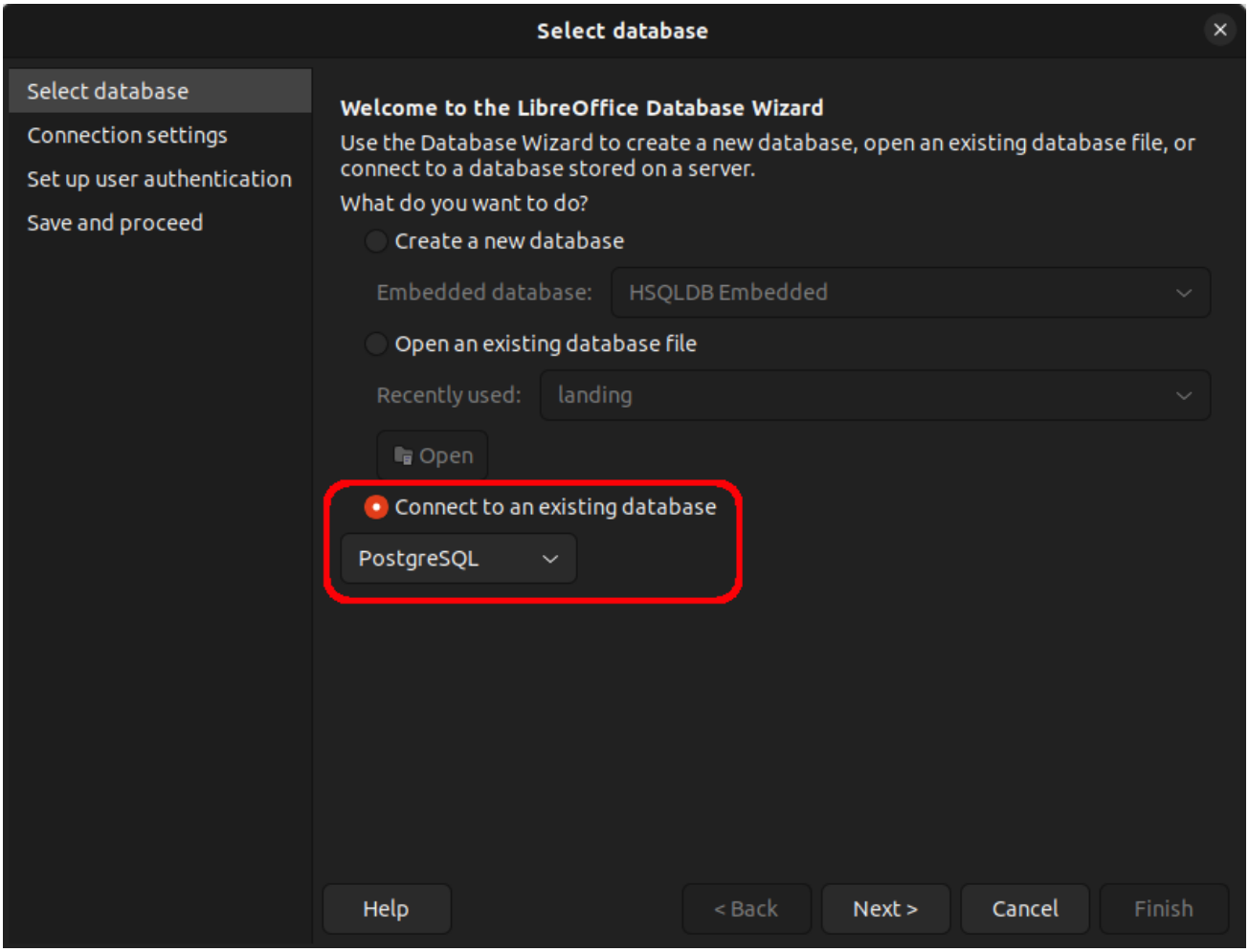



## 10.15.6. LibreOffice Base

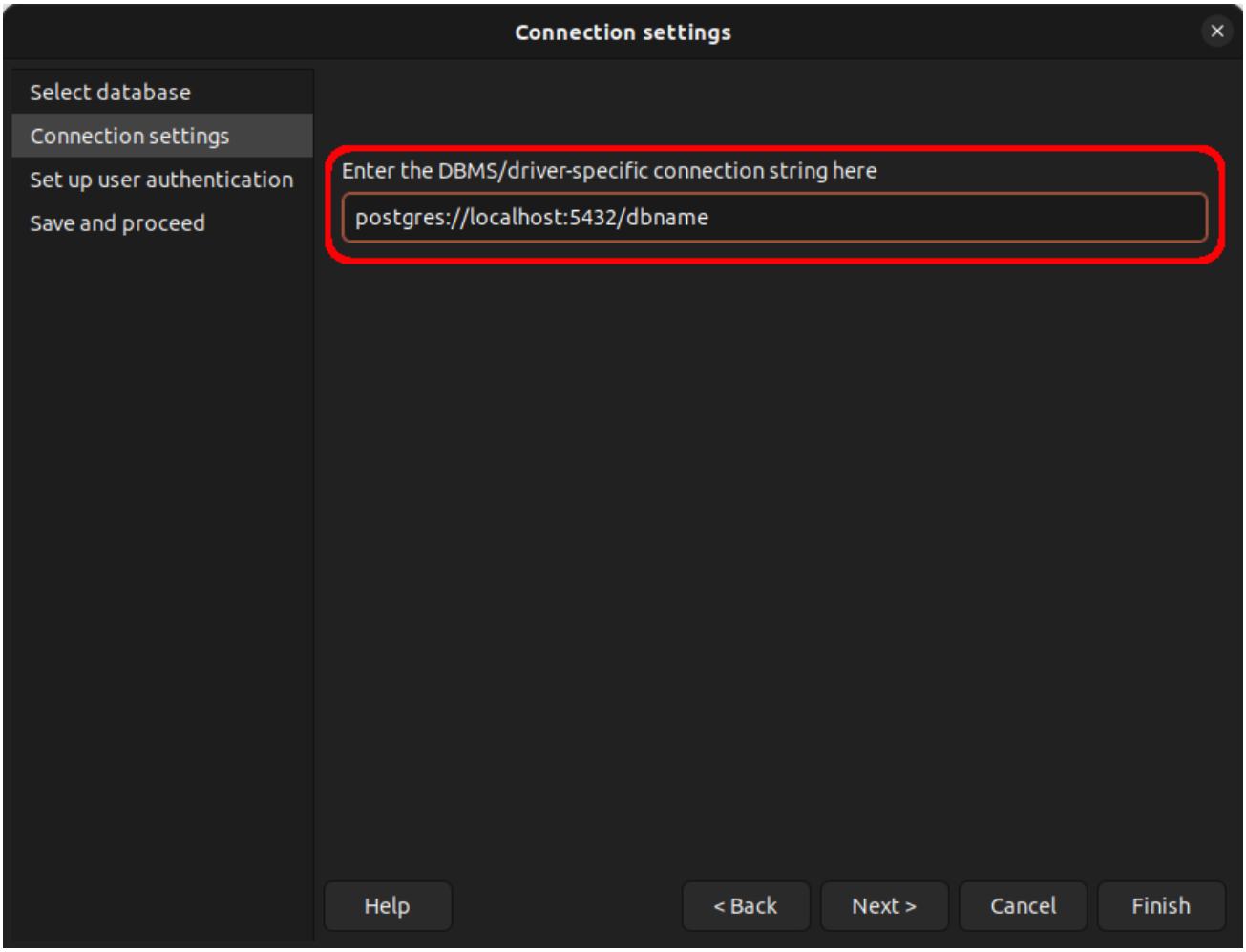
There is minimal support for ArcadeDB in LibreOffice Base via a PostgreSQL connection:

▼ *Details*

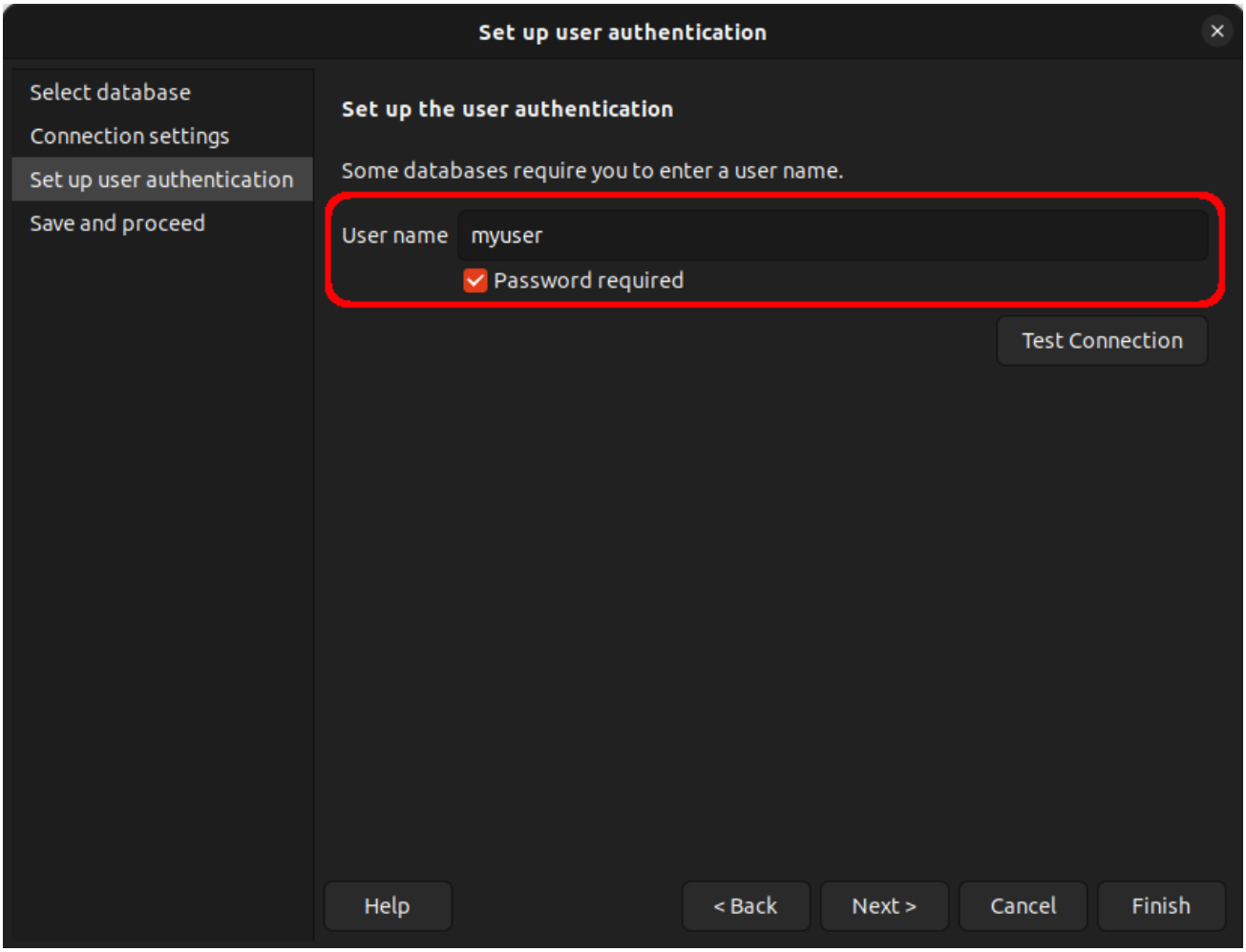
Select "Connect to existing database" and choose "PostgreSQL"



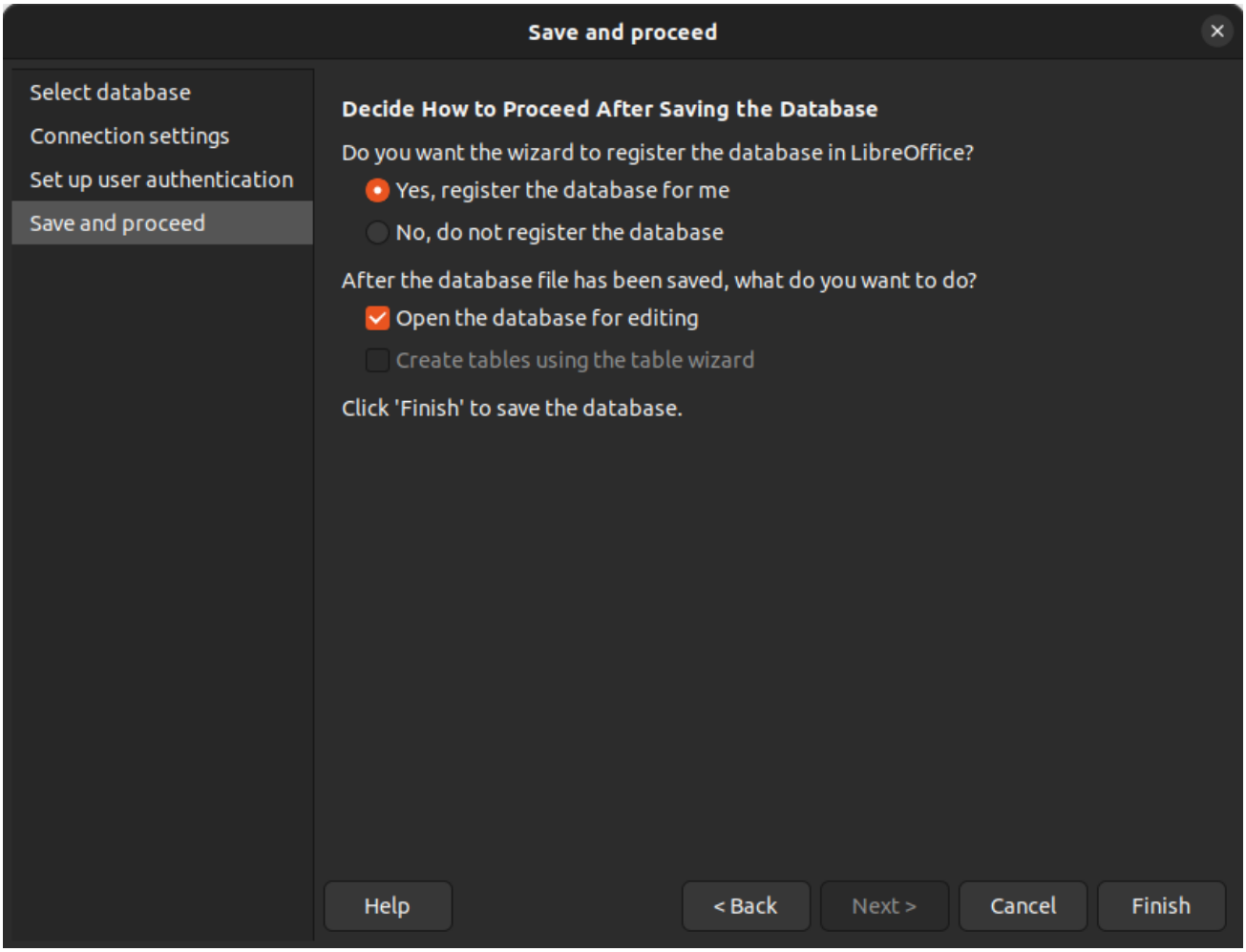

Enter the postgres protocol connection string (without username and password), for example: `postgres://localhost:5432/dbname`



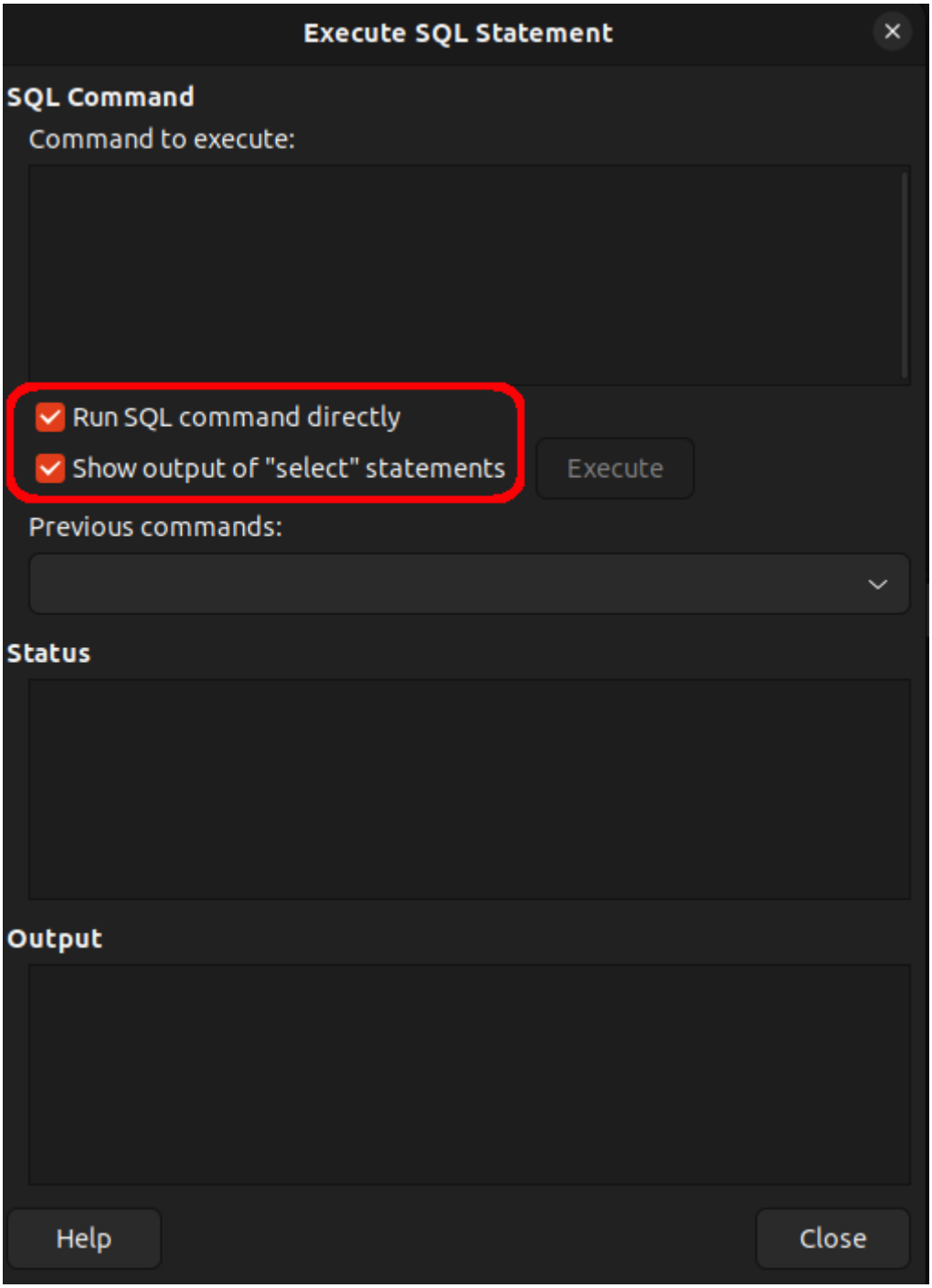

Enter the user name and check that a password is required (try with the "Test Connection" button)




Choose if you want to register the database in LibreOffice, select to open for editing, and "Finish" the wizard.




Now, in the menu under "Tools" → "SQL..." queries and commands can be send to ArcadeDB.




Make sure that "Run SQL command directly" is selected, and to view results check "Show output ..."

# Chapter 11. BI & Analytics

## 11.1. BI and Analytics Integration

Most modern BI tools speak SQL over PostgreSQL — and so does ArcadeDB. The PostgreSQL wire protocol on port 5432 lets virtually any Postgres-compatible tool connect to ArcadeDB without a custom driver, an ODBC bridge, or middleware. For tools that need richer integration than ANSI SQL provides, ArcadeDB also ships native plugins (Grafana today, more on the roadmap).

### 11.1.1. Connection paths

There are two ways a BI tool talks to ArcadeDB. Pick the one your tool supports:

| Path | What it is | When to use |
|---|---|---|
| **Native plugin / data source** | A tool-specific extension that ArcadeData publishes (or that the tool ships out of the box) which knows ArcadeDB-specific features — graph queries, multiple query languages, time-series macros, graph visualization. | Use whenever ArcadeDB ships a native plugin (today: Grafana). Always preferred over the generic Postgres path because it surfaces graph-aware visualizations, multi-language queries, and time-series-aware query builders. |
| **PostgreSQL wire protocol** | ArcadeDB exposes port 5432 as a Postgres-compatible endpoint. Any tool with a built-in PostgreSQL connector — or any Java tool that loads the standard PostgreSQL JDBC driver — points at that endpoint and runs ArcadeDB SQL exactly as it would against Postgres. | Use for tools that already speak Postgres natively: Apache Superset, Metabase, Tableau, Power BI, DBeaver, dbt, Looker, and so on. |

ArcadeDB does not ship its own JDBC driver. Tools that require a JDBC URL connect through the standard PostgreSQL JDBC driver (`org.postgresql:postgresql`); the connection target is ArcadeDB's port 5432 instead of a real PostgreSQL server. Functionally it is the same wire-level path as the built-in Postgres connectors — same protocol, same auth, same query surface — and the same set of language prefixes works (see "Sending non-SQL queries" below).

### 11.1.2. Supported tools

| Tool | Connection path | ArcadeDB-specific features |
|---|---|---|
| Grafana | Native plugin (recommended); Postgres data source fallback | Visual time-series query builder, ArcadeDB SQL with `$__timeFilter` macros, OpenCypher with Node-Graph visualization, Gremlin traversals, full alerting support. |

| Tool | Connection path | ArcadeDB-specific features |
|---|---|---|
| Apache Superset | PostgreSQL wire protocol (SQLAlchemy + psycopg2) | ArcadeDB SQL through Superset's SQL Lab and dashboards. Cross-database joins via Superset's virtual datasets. |
| Metabase | Built-in PostgreSQL JDBC connector | ArcadeDB SQL through Metabase's question editor and dashboards. |
| Tableau | Built-in PostgreSQL connector | ArcadeDB SQL via Tableau's PostgreSQL data source. Live or extract mode. |
| Power BI | Built-in PostgreSQL connector | ArcadeDB SQL via Power BI's PostgreSQL connector. Import or DirectQuery mode. |

### 11.1.3. Setting up the Postgres endpoint

The Postgres protocol plugin is bundled with the standard distribution; you only need to enable it. See Postgres Protocol Plugin for the exact server-side configuration. Once enabled, ArcadeDB listens on port 5432 (TLS optional) and the tool sees it as a regular PostgreSQL server — same hostname/port/database/username/password fields you already know.

For Java tools that connect via JDBC, drop the standard PostgreSQL JDBC driver (`org.postgresql:postgresql`) on the classpath and use a JDBC URL of the form:

```
jdbc:postgresql://<host>:5432/<database>
```

with `<database>` being your ArcadeDB database name. There is no ArcadeDB-specific driver to install — the wire protocol is what carries the connection.

### 11.1.4. Sending non-SQL queries from a Postgres-only tool

The PostgreSQL connection lets you send any ArcadeDB SQL query, including graph traversals (`MATCH`, `TRAVERSE`) and vector functions. To send **Cypher**, **Gremlin**, **GraphQL**, **MongoDB QL**, or a multi-statement **SQL Script** from a tool that only speaks SQL, prefix the query with the language tag:

```
{cypher} MATCH (m:Movie)<-[a:ACTED_IN]-(p:Person) WHERE id(m) = '#1:0' RETURN *
```

The `{cypher}` prefix tells ArcadeDB to route the query to the OpenCypher engine instead of the SQL planner. The same pattern works for `{gremlin}`, `{graphql}`, `{mongo}`, and `{sqlscript}`. The result set is returned over the Postgres protocol like any other query, so the BI tool can chart it without knowing it came from a non-SQL engine.

### 11.1.5. Suggesting a missing tool

If your favourite BI or analytics tool is not in the list above and it supports PostgreSQL, it almost certainly works against ArcadeDB out of the box — try it and let us know how it goes on GitHub Discussions. If the tool needs a dedicated plugin or has rough edges over the Postgres protocol, open

an issue at https://github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb/issues — community-driven plugin work is very welcome.

## 11.2. Apache Superset

Apache Superset is the most popular open-source BI and data exploration platform. It connects to ArcadeDB via the PostgreSQL wire protocol using SQLAlchemy and psycopg2.

### 11.2.1. Setup

1. In Superset, go to **Settings** > **Database Connections** > + **Database**.
2. Select **PostgreSQL**.
3. Enter the connection details:

| | |
|---|---|
| Host | `localhost` (or your ArcadeDB server host) |
| Port | `5432` |
| Database | Your ArcadeDB database name |
| Username | Your ArcadeDB username |
| Password | Your ArcadeDB password |

   Or use the SQLAlchemy URI:

```
postgresql+psycopg2://root:arcadedb@localhost:5432/mydb
```

4. In the **Advanced** tab, add the following to **Extra** to disable SSL:

```
{
  "connect_args": {
    "sslmode": "disable"
  }
}
```

5. Click **Test Connection**, then **Connect**.

### 11.2.2. Usage

Use **SQL Lab** to run queries:

```
SELECT name, age, city FROM Person LIMIT 100
```

Graph traversals work via ArcadeDB SQL:

```
SELECT name, out('FriendOf').size() AS friends
```

```
FROM Person
WHERE out('FriendOf').size() > 3
```

Cypher queries work with the language prefix:

```
{cypher}MATCH (p:Person)-[:FRIEND_OF]->(f:Person)
RETURN p.name AS person, f.name AS friend LIMIT 50
```

Charts and dashboards can be created from SQL Lab results or by selecting an ArcadeDB type as a table in the chart builder.

### 11.2.3. Known Limitations

- Schema introspection is partial - Superset may not discover all types or columns automatically
- Language prefixes (`{cypher}`, `{gremlin}`) work in SQL Lab but not in the visual chart builder
- Some ArcadeDB SQL extensions (e.g., `out()`, `in()`) may confuse Superset's query parser in the visual builder
- SSL is not supported - the `sslmode=disable` setting is required
- No graph visualization (Superset does not have a network chart type)

## 11.3. Grafana

Grafana is the leading open-source platform for monitoring and observability. ArcadeDB provides two integration paths: a dedicated Grafana plugin (recommended) and a fallback via the built-in PostgreSQL data source.

### 11.3.1. ArcadeDB Grafana Plugin (Recommended)

The ArcadeDB Grafana plugin provides a native integration with dedicated query editors, time series visual builder, and graph visualization via Grafana's Node Graph panel.

**Features:**

- **Time Series mode** - visual query builder with auto-discovered types, fields, tags, and aggregation functions (SUM, AVG, MIN, MAX, COUNT)
- **SQL mode** - ArcadeDB SQL with macro expansion (`$timeFrom`, `$timeTo`, `$timeFilter(col)`, `$interval`)
- **Cypher mode** - OpenCypher queries with optional Node Graph visualization
- **Gremlin mode** - Apache Gremlin traversals with optional Node Graph visualization
- **Alerting** - full Grafana alerting support via the Go backend
- **Template variables** - dashboard variables populated from ArcadeDB queries

**Installation:**

```
grafana-cli plugins install arcadedb-arcadedb-datasource
```

Or build from source:

```
git clone https://github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb-grafana-datasource.git
cd arcadedb-grafana-datasource
mage -v build:linux
```

For self-hosted Grafana with unsigned plugins, add to `grafana.ini`:

```
[plugins]
allow_loading_unsigned_plugins = arcadedb-arcadedb-datasource
```

**Configuration:**

1. Go to **Connections** > **Data Sources** > **Add data source** and search for **ArcadeDB**.
2. Set the **URL** to your ArcadeDB HTTP API (e.g., `http://localhost:2480`).
3. Enable **Basic Auth** and enter your ArcadeDB credentials.
4. Set the **Database** name in the ArcadeDB section.
5. Click **Save & Test**.

**Time Series query example:**

1. Select **Time Series** mode.
2. Choose a type (e.g., `cpu_metrics`), fields (e.g., `usage`), and optional tag filters.
3. Add an aggregation: AVG on `usage` with a bucket interval or leave it to auto-calculate.

**SQL query example:**

```
SELECT ts, temperature FROM weather
WHERE $__timeFilter(ts)
ORDER BY ts
```

**Cypher query with Node Graph:**

Enable the **Node Graph** toggle, then:

```
MATCH (p:Person)-[r:FRIEND_OF]->(f:Person)
RETURN p, r, f LIMIT 100
```

The result renders as an interactive graph in Grafana's Node Graph panel.

### 11.3.2. PostgreSQL Data Source (Fallback)

If you cannot install the ArcadeDB plugin, use Grafana's built-in PostgreSQL data source with ArcadeDB's PostgreSQL wire protocol.

1. Go to **Connections** > **Data Sources** > **Add data source** and select **PostgreSQL**.
2. Set **Host** to `localhost:5432`, enter the **Database** name and credentials.
3. Set **TLS/SSL Mode** to `disable`.
4. Click **Save & Test**.

In panels, switch to **Code** mode and write SQL:

```
SELECT name, age FROM Person LIMIT 100
```

Use the `{cypher}` prefix for Cypher queries:

```
{cypher}MATCH (p:Person) RETURN p.name, p.age LIMIT 100
```

The PostgreSQL fallback does not support the time series visual builder, Node Graph visualization, ArcadeDB-specific macros, or alerting optimizations. Use the dedicated plugin for the full experience.

### 11.3.3. Grafana Time Series Endpoints

ArcadeDB also provides native Grafana DataFrame-compatible HTTP endpoints for time series data. See Time Series for full documentation of the `/grafana/health`, `/grafana/metadata`, and `/grafana/query` endpoints, as well as the PromQL-compatible endpoints.

## 11.4. Metabase

Metabase is a popular open-source BI tool known for its ease of use. It connects to ArcadeDB via the built-in PostgreSQL JDBC driver.

### 11.4.1. Setup

1. In Metabase, go to **Settings** > **Admin** > **Databases** > **Add database**.
2. Select **PostgreSQL**.
3. Enter the connection details:

| | |
|---|---|
| Display name | `ArcadeDB` |
| Host | `localhost` |
| Port | `5432` |
| Database name | Your ArcadeDB database name |

| | |
|---|---|
| Username | Your ArcadeDB username |
| Password | Your ArcadeDB password |

4. Expand **Additional JDBC connection string options** and add:

```
sslmode=disable
```

5. Click **Save**. Metabase will sync the schema.

### 11.4.2. Usage

Click + **New** > **SQL query**, select your ArcadeDB database, and write queries:

```
SELECT name, age FROM Person ORDER BY name LIMIT 50
```

Graph traversal via ArcadeDB SQL:

```
SELECT name, out('FriendOf').size() AS friendCount
FROM Person
WHERE out('FriendOf').size() > 2
```

Cypher via language prefix in native query mode:

```
{cypher}MATCH (p:Person)-[:FRIEND_OF]->(f:Person)
RETURN p.name AS person, f.name AS friend LIMIT 50
```

Metabase's "Simple question" and "Custom question" builders show ArcadeDB types as tables with their properties as columns.

### 11.4.3. Known Limitations

- Schema sync may not discover all types or properties
- The visual question builders work for basic queries but may have gaps for complex filter types
- Language prefixes only work in native query mode, not the visual builders
- Auto-generated queries from Metabase may occasionally use PostgreSQL-specific syntax that ArcadeDB does not support
- SSL is not supported

## 11.5. Power BI

Microsoft Power BI connects to ArcadeDB via its PostgreSQL connector.

### 11.5.1. Setup

1. In Power BI Desktop, click **Get Data** > **More...** > **Database** > **PostgreSQL database**.
2. Click **Connect**.
3. Enter the connection details:

| | |
|---|---|
| Server | `localhost:5432` (include the port) |
| Database | Your ArcadeDB database name |
| Data Connectivity mode | Import (recommended) |

4. When prompted for credentials, select **Database** and enter your ArcadeDB username and password.
5. If prompted about encryption, choose to connect without encryption.

### 11.5.2. Usage

For custom queries, use the **Advanced options** in the connection dialog:

1. In the **SQL statement** field, enter your query:

```
SELECT name, age, city FROM Person LIMIT 1000
```

2. Click **OK**.

Graph traversals and Cypher via language prefix:

```
SELECT name, out('FriendOf').size() AS friendCount FROM Person WHERE age > 25
```

```
{cypher}MATCH (p:Person)-[:FRIEND_OF]->(f:Person)
RETURN p.name AS person, f.name AS friend, p.city AS city
```

After loading data, build visualizations by dragging fields from the Fields panel. For graph/network visualizations, install a custom visual from AppSource (e.g., "Network Graph by Powerviz").

Use **Import** mode instead of **DirectQuery**. DirectQuery works for basic queries but may have issues with complex types or ArcadeDB-specific SQL extensions.

### 11.5.3. Known Limitations

- DirectQuery mode may not work reliably for all query types - Import mode is recommended
- The Navigator dialog may show incomplete or no tables - use native SQL queries instead
- Language prefixes work in the SQL statement field but not through the visual query builder

- No built-in graph/network visualization - requires a marketplace custom visual
- SSL is not supported - connections must be unencrypted
- Refreshing data in Power BI Service requires a gateway configured for PostgreSQL connections

## 11.6. Tableau

Tableau is a leading commercial BI platform. It connects to ArcadeDB via the built-in PostgreSQL connector.

### 11.6.1. Setup

1. In Tableau Desktop, go to **Connect** > **To a Server** > **PostgreSQL**.
2. Enter the connection details:

| | |
|---|---|
| Server | `localhost` |
| Port | `5432` |
| Database | Your ArcadeDB database name |
| Username | Your ArcadeDB username |
| Password | Your ArcadeDB password |
| Require SSL | Unchecked |

3. Click **Sign In**.

### 11.6.2. Usage

For the best experience with ArcadeDB, use **Custom SQL** rather than dragging tables:

1. In the Data Source tab, click **New Custom SQL**.
2. Enter your query:

```
SELECT name, age, city FROM Person
```

Or with graph traversal:

```
SELECT name, out('FriendOf').size() AS friendCount, city
FROM Person
```

3. Click **OK**. Tableau executes the query and shows the result schema.
4. Drag fields to rows/columns to build visualizations.

Cypher queries work via the language prefix in Custom SQL:

```
{cypher}MATCH (p:Person)-[:FRIEND_OF]->(f:Person)
RETURN p.name AS person, p.city AS city, COUNT(f) AS friendCount
```

Use **Import** mode (extract) rather than **Live Connection** for large datasets or when ArcadeDB-specific SQL extensions cause issues with Tableau's query rewriting.

### 11.6.3. Known Limitations

- Schema discovery may show incomplete table/column lists - prefer Custom SQL
- Tableau may rewrite queries using PostgreSQL-specific syntax that ArcadeDB does not fully support
- Relationships between tables must be defined manually via Custom SQL
- No built-in graph/network visualization type
- SSL is not supported - ensure "Require SSL" is unchecked

# Chapter 12. Advanced

## 12.1. Performance Tuning

This guide covers common performance optimizations for ArcadeDB in production.

### 12.1.1. Memory Configuration

ArcadeDB uses both JVM heap and off-heap memory. Key settings:

```
# JVM heap (set via JAVA_OPTS or bin/server.sh)
JAVA_OPTS="-Xms2g -Xmx4g"

# Page cache size in MB (default: 25% of the maximum heap, so 4096 MB under -Xmx16g)
arcadedb.maxPageRAM=8192
```

The page cache lives inside the JVM heap. When the database is larger than the cache, pages are evicted and read again from disk, so a dedicated embedded or server process with a database bigger than a quarter of its heap benefits from a larger share: 40-50% of `Xmx` is a good starting point, leaving the rest for transactions, query working sets and indexes. A value above 80% of the heap is reduced automatically. Grow `Xmx` first if the heap is the limit.

#### JVM settings inside a fixed memory budget

When a container, a pod or a VM caps the memory of the process, the heap is only a part of what counts against the cap: the JVM also needs metaspace, thread stacks, direct buffers, the code cache and the collector's own structures, and the OS needs file cache for the database files. Which share of the cap goes to the heap depends on who owns the process:

| Deployment | Intended setting | Why |
|---|---|---|
| **Server in the Docker image or in Kubernetes** | The image's defaults: `-XX:MaxRAMPercentage=75` and generational ZGC, no `-Xms`. Give the container the memory you want ArcadeDB to have and the heap follows. | The cap covers heap and non-heap memory, so 75% leaves a quarter of it for the rest. ZGC keeps pauses short on a large heap, and an unpinned heap grows with the working set instead of being filled before the first collection. |
| **Embedded, in your own JVM** | There is no default: ArcadeDB does not start the JVM. Start with a heap of 50% of the budget when the application or the OS file cache needs room, up to 75% for a process that only runs ArcadeDB, and leave the collector at the JVM default (G1). | The application's own memory, and the OS file cache that serves the database files, share the budget with the heap. |

Pinning `-Xms` to `-Xmx` fills the heap with garbage before the first young collection on

> G1, so the process memory climbs towards the heap size whatever the live working set is. A "peak memory" measured under a pinned heap reports the setting, not what ArcadeDB needs. To compare memory across engines, either leave `-Xms` small and fix only `-Xmx`, or report the live heap (the `Heap used` gauge in Studio, or `jcmd <pid> GC.heap_info` after a full collection) beside the peak.

The collector is chosen by `ARCADEDB_OPTS_GC`, not by `JAVA_OPTS` or `JAVA_TOOL_OPTIONS`: the image sets `ARCADEDB_OPTS_GC="-XX:+UseZGC -XX:+ZGenerational"`, and a second collector flag on the same command line makes the JVM refuse to start ("Multiple garbage collectors selected"). To run G1 in the image, replace the variable (`ARCADEDB_OPTS_GC="-XX:+UseG1GC"`), or set it to an empty value to take the JVM default.

### 12.1.2. Index Selection

ArcadeDB supports multiple index types. Choose based on your access pattern:

| Index Type | Best For | Trade-off |
|---|---|---|
| **LSM-Tree** (default) | Range queries, `ORDER BY` on the key, prefix scans | Slower point lookups than Hash |
| **Hash** | Keys only read, updated and deleted by equality (`WHERE key = value`), such as ids and tokens | No range queries and no ordering |
| **LSM_VECTOR** | Vector similarity search | Specialized for ANN queries |
| **FULL_TEXT** | Text search (`SEARCH_INDEX()`) | Specialized for keyword search |
| **GEOSPATIAL** | Spatial queries (`geo.*()`) | Specialized for geometry |

Create appropriate indexes for your query patterns:

```
-- LSM-Tree for range queries (default)
CREATE INDEX ON User (email) UNIQUE

-- Hash for exact lookups
CREATE INDEX ON Session (token) UNIQUE_HASH

-- Composite index for multi-column queries
CREATE INDEX ON Order (customerId, orderDate) NOTUNIQUE
```

### 12.1.3. Query Optimization

Use `EXPLAIN` and `PROFILE` to understand query execution:

```
-- Show the query plan without executing
EXPLAIN SELECT FROM User WHERE email = 'alice@example.com'

-- Execute and show actual timings
```

```
PROFILE SELECT FROM User WHERE email = 'alice@example.com'
```

`PROFILE` really executes the statement, so it counts as a read only when the statement it wraps is a read. `PROFILE INSERT …` is refused on the read-only query endpoint (`GET`/`POST /api/v1/query`) and needs the command endpoint and write permission, like the plain `INSERT`. `EXPLAIN` never executes, so it is always allowed there.

Common optimizations:

- **Add indexes** for `WHERE` clause predicates — check `EXPLAIN` output for full scans
- **Limit result sets** — Use `LIMIT` to avoid fetching unnecessary records
- **Project only needed fields** — `SELECT name, email FROM User` is faster than `SELECT * FROM User`
- **Use parameterized queries** — Avoid SQL parsing overhead for repeated queries

Parameters are worth more than they look, especially in Cypher. A parsed query is cached by its exact text, so writing the value inside the query produces a new text on every call and the cache is never reused:

```
-- a different query text every time: re-parsed on every call, and
fills the cache with single-use entries
MATCH (p:Person) WHERE p.id = 1234 RETURN p.name, p.age

-- one text, parsed once, reused from then on
MATCH (p:Person) WHERE p.id = $id RETURN p.name, p.age
```

For a small indexed lookup the parse dominates the cost of the whole query, so this single change is often the difference between the two forms being several times apart in latency.

### 12.1.4. Bucket Configuration

ArcadeDB distributes records across buckets for parallel access. By default a new type gets one bucket (the `arcadedb.typeDefaultBuckets` setting is `1`); set a higher value, or pass the number of buckets when creating the type, to get more.

For write-heavy types, add buckets to the type. `ALTER TYPE` adds and removes buckets by name (`+` adds, `-` removes), and a bucket that does not exist is created:

```
ALTER TYPE HighWriteType BUCKET +HighWriteType_extra1
ALTER TYPE HighWriteType BUCKET +HighWriteType_extra2
```

For read-heavy types with few writes, fewer buckets reduce overhead; remove a bucket by name:

```
ALTER TYPE LookupTable BUCKET -LookupTable_extra1
```

### 12.1.5. Page Size Tuning

The default bucket page size (64KB) works well for most workloads. It applies to types created after the change, existing types keep theirs. Adjust for specific patterns:

```
# Larger pages for sequential scan workloads (analytics)
arcadedb.bucketDefaultPageSize=131072

# Smaller pages for random access workloads
arcadedb.bucketDefaultPageSize=32768
```

LSM-Tree indexes have their own page size (default 256KB), set with `arcadedb.indexDefaultPageSize` (new indexes only). A transaction that changes a page works on a private copy of the whole page, so write-heavy workloads of small transactions pay less with smaller index pages (for example `arcadedb.indexDefaultPageSize=32768`), while lookups are slightly faster with larger ones.

### 12.1.6. Connection Pool Settings

For remote applications, size the HTTP worker threads (there is no setting for a maximum number of connections) and the async queue based on concurrency:

```
# Threads executing HTTP requests
arcadedb.server.httpWorkerThreads=256

# Async queue size
arcadedb.asyncOperationsQueueSize=1024
```

### 12.1.7. Concurrent Requests (Query Admission Gate)

*(since v26.11.1)* Every request of a remote client passes through a queue before it runs. When the server is busy, requests wait and start in arrival order (FIFO). Without the queue they would all start at once, and under a burst of heavy queries the last ones would be refused by the query heap budget or exhaust the heap.

**How it works**

- A request starts at once when fewer than `arcadedb.queryMaxConcurrent` requests are running and the running queries hold less than `arcadedb.queryAdmissionHeapWatermark` percent of the query heap budget (`arcadedb.queryMaxHeapRAM`). Otherwise it waits in the queue.
- The wait happens before anything of the request runs. A query started from inside a running request, such as a function or a script, does not queue again.
- A request that waits longer than `arcadedb.queryQueueTimeout`, or finds `arcadedb.queryQueueMaxSize` requests already waiting, is refused with a retryable error. Nothing

of it ran, so the client can send it again as it is.

- When no admitted request is running, the next one starts whatever the heap, so memory held by work outside the queue cannot block it.

**What goes through the queue**

| Protocol | Gated | Refused with |
|---|---|---|
| HTTP | Every database request: query, command, batch load, vector and full-text search, time series, PromQL and Grafana. Begin, rollback and the health probe are exempt | `503` |
| Postgres | Every statement | SQLSTATE `40001` |
| BOLT | Every query. A result stream keeps its slot until it is read to the end or discarded | transient error |
| Redis | Every command but `PING` and `SELECT` | `TRYAGAIN` |
| gRPC | Queries, commands, record operations, searches and time series. Begin and rollback, the admin service and the streaming loads are exempt | `ABORTED` |
| Gremlin Server | Scripts and traversals (sessions are not gated) | error response |
| MCP | The tools that read or write data | tool error |
| MongoDB | Every command, but it never waits: one that cannot start at once is refused | `ExceededTimeLimit` (262) |

The embedded Java API does not go through the queue.

**Sizing**

- `arcadedb.queryMaxConcurrent` defaults to twice the number of cores, at least 4. Each running request holds one slot for as long as it runs, so long analytical queries next to short ones need room for both: a handful of long queries holding every slot makes the short ones wait and, past the timeout, be refused.
- Lower it to protect memory when most queries are heavy. Raise it when many requests spend their time waiting on disk or on clients rather than on CPU.
- Keep `arcadedb.queryQueueMaxSize` (default 256) below `arcadedb.server.httpWorkerThreads` (default 500): each waiting HTTP request parks a worker thread.
- Keep `arcadedb.queryQueueTimeout` (default 30 seconds) below your clients' own timeouts, so they receive the retryable refusal rather than a timeout of their own.
- A transaction that took explicit locks (`LOCK TYPE`, `LOCK BUCKET`) keeps them while one of its requests waits in the queue.

```
# At most 16 requests at once, the next ones wait up to 10 seconds
arcadedb.queryMaxConcurrent=16
arcadedb.queryQueueTimeout=10000

# Disable the queue: every request starts at once (the behavior before v26.11.1)
# arcadedb.queryMaxConcurrent=0
```

**Monitoring**

Studio shows the queue in the Server tab, under Executor Pools, as "Query Admission Gate": the running requests against the limit, the waiting ones, and the refused ones. The same numbers are exported as metrics (`pool=query_admission`) and reported by the profiler (`queryAdmission*`).

- Refusals that keep growing mean the server is undersized for the load, or the limit is too tight for it.
- `queryAdmissionHeapDeferrals` growing while requests wait means the heap budget, not the number of slots, holds them back: give the server more heap, raise `arcadedb.queryMaxHeapRAM`, or reduce the size of the queries.

### 12.1.8. Write Optimization

- **Batch transactions** — Group related writes in a single transaction to amortize commit overhead
- **Async operations** — Use the async API for non-blocking writes (Java Async API)
- **Bulk loading** — Use `BulkInsert` via gRPC or the Java embedded API for initial data loads
- **WAL flush tuning** — The `arcadedb.txWalFlush` setting controls whether each commit triggers an fsync. In `production` mode it defaults to `1` (fsync without metadata). For bulk imports or when your storage has battery-backed write cache, you can set it to `0` for maximum throughput. See concepts/transactions.pdf

### 12.1.9. Read Optimization

- **Page cache** — Increase `arcadedb.maxPageRAM` if cache hit rate is low
- **Index coverage** — Ensure queries hit indexes (check with `EXPLAIN`)
- **Projections** — Select only the fields you need
- **Materialized views** — Pre-compute expensive aggregations

### 12.1.10. High Availability Resync

- **Snapshot compression** — A follower that falls too far behind is resynced with a full snapshot of the database, compressed by the leader on a single thread per transfer. At the Deflater default (level 6) this can cap a resync at a few MB/s on a fast private network. Since v26.11.1 `arcadedb.ha.snapshotCompressionLevel` defaults to `1` (fastest DEFLATE), which keeps most of the size reduction of database pages at a fraction of the CPU. Use `0` to ship the files stored on very fast links, or `-1` to restore the previous level on a WAN or metered link where bytes cost more

than CPU

- **Concurrent followers** — Two followers of the same database are served at the same time, up to `arcadedb.ha.snapshotMaxConcurrent` (default 2). Raise it only if more than two followers can resync together and the leader has I/O and CPU to spare

### 12.1.11. Further Reading

- Server Settings — Complete list of all configuration parameters
- Monitoring — Track performance metrics with Prometheus
- LSM-Tree Architecture — Understanding the storage engine

## 12.2. Settings

ArcadeDB allows changing settings at JVM (server or embedded) and per database level.

| Server/Embedded (JVM) Level | Database Level |
|---|---|
| Those settings are valid for all the databases open in the same Server or JVM when run embedded. If defined, they override the default value (look at the table below to see the default values). They are used only if a database does not override them. Such settings are not saved, so you need to set them everytime. | Database level settings are stored in the database and override the Server/Embedded (JVM) settings if present. You can change these settings via SQL or API when run embedded. |

### 12.2.1. JVM startup (server/embedded only)

All the settings modified at JVM startup are not persistent and need to be set everytime you're running ArcadeDB server or your embedded application. If you're updating a setting at JVM level, prefix the setting name with `arcadedb.` by using this syntax:

```
$ java ... -Darcadedb.<name>=<value> ...
```

Where `<name>` is the name of the setting and `<value>` the value you want to override. Example to change the server mode from development (default) to production:

```
$ java ... -Darcadedb.server.mode=production ...
```

Example to increase the default page size for buckets to 1 MB:

```
$ java ... -Darcadedb.bucketDefaultPageSize=1048576 ...
```

Alternatively, these settings can be set via the environment variable `ARCADEDB_SETTINGS`, which the launcher scripts (`bin/server.sh`, `bin/console.sh` and friends) put on the JVM command line:

```
ARCADEDB_SETTINGS="-Darcadedb.server.rootPassword=playwithdata" bin/server.sh
```

`JAVA_OPTS` is passed through as well, but it is meant for JVM flags: keeping settings in `ARCADEDB_SETTINGS` means overriding one variable never discards the other.

#### Boolean values

A setting of type `Boolean` accepts only `true` or `false` (in any casing, surrounding spaces are ignored). Anything else — `yes`, `1`, `on`, or a misspelling such as `ture` — is refused: the setting keeps its default and a warning naming the setting and the rejected value is logged at startup. This holds however the value is provided: a JVM system property, an environment variable, `ARCADEDB_SETTINGS`, the server configuration file, or an admin command. *(The server configuration file is checked this way since v26.10.1.)*

The point is that a typo can never quietly mean `false`. For a setting that guards something — for example `ha.tls.mutualAuth` or `ha.peerAllowlist.enabled`, both of which default to `true` — silently reading an unrecognised value as `false` would have turned the protection off while it looked enabled. If a setting is not taking effect, check the server log for that warning.

#### Settings with a fixed list of values

Some settings accept only a given set of words — `server.mode` is `development`, `test` or `production`, for instance. Since v26.10.1 a value outside the list is refused wherever it is written, including the server configuration file, and the setting keeps its previous value with a warning naming what was allowed. Casing does not matter: `Production` is accepted and understood the same as `production`.

#### Setting names

A setting name is case-insensitive, and the `arcadedb.` prefix is optional in the server configuration file: `server.mode`, `Server.Mode` and `arcadedb.server.mode` all name the same setting. *(Since v26.10.1. Before that, a name written in a different case was accepted and then ignored, so the setting silently kept its default — with nothing in the log to say so, and, for settings that log what they do at startup, with every appearance of having been applied.)*

A name in the server configuration file that matches no setting — a typo, or a leftover from an older version — is ignored and reported with a warning naming it, so it no longer disappears in silence.

#### Server-level settings

A setting documented as server level can be written in the server configuration file, with `SET SERVER SETTING`, or as a `-D` JVM property, and all three take effect. *(Before v26.10.1 a number of them were only ever read from `-D` or an environment variable: a value written in the configuration file was accepted and then ignored, with nothing in the log to say so. This affected, among others, `server.mode` and `studio.enabled`, the HA snapshot and peer-allowlist settings, and the ports and limits of the Bolt, Postgres, Redis and gRPC protocols.)*

A setting that accepts only a fixed set of values — `server.mode`, `ha.quorum`, `ha.serverRole` and the others whose description lists their values — refuses anything outside that set, whichever channel writes it: the configuration file, a `-D` property, `SET SERVER SETTING`, `ALTER DATABASE … SETTING`, the

gRPC settings call or the `set_server_setting` MCP tool. The setting keeps the value it had and the refusal names the values it accepts.

*(Since v26.10.1.)* Before this, the administrative channels stored an unaccepted value without complaint. A typo such as `SET SERVER SETTING arcadedb.server.mode prodction` was answered with `200` and stored as written; every reader compares the value against `production`, found it different, and kept the **development** behaviour — so a server you believed was in production mode was not, and nothing said so.

If you have scripts that write one of these settings, check the values they send before upgrading: a value that was silently ignored before now returns an error.

### 12.2.2. SQL (Database Level)

All the changes executed via SQL Alter Database command are relative to the current database only and are persistent. Here is an example to increase the default page size for buckets to 1 MB:

```
ALTER DATABASE `arcadedb.bucketDefaultPageSize` 1048576
```

The current settings can be listed from SQL using:

```
SELECT expand(settings) FROM schema:database
```

### 12.2.3. Programmatically (Server/Embedded and Database levels)

You can access to the database configuration with `database.getConfiguration()` to read and write per database settings. Example to increase the default page size for all the buckets to 1 MB on the current database:

```
database.getConfiguration().setValue(GlobalConfiguration.BUCKET_DEFAULT_PAGE_SIZE,
1048576);
```

To change a setting at Server/Embedded (JVM) level, set the value in the `GlobalConfiguration` enum. Example to increase the default page size for buckets to 1 MB for all the databases open in the current JVM (server/embedded):

```
GlobalConfiguration.BUCKET_DEFAULT_PAGE_SIZE.setValue(1048576);
```

### 12.2.4. Available settings by scope (in alphabetic order):

The tables that follow contains all the available settings in ArcadeDB separated by scope:

- `JVM`, as the settings applied at the JVM level, so to both clients and servers

- `SERVER`, as the settings that only apply to the ArcadeDB Server. If you're embedding a server in your Java application you can use these settings
- `DATABASE` are all the settings that can be saved in the database configuration and are restored once the database is open

**JVM**

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
|---|---|---|---|
| `dumpConfigAtStartup` | Dumps the configuration at startup | Boolean | false |
| `dumpMetricsEvery` | Dumps the metrics at startup, shutdown and every configurable amount of time (in seconds) | Long | 0 |
| `opencypher.idBucketBits` | Number of bits reserved for the bucketId when packing a RID into the numeric value returned by the Cypher `id()` function (and SQL's `.asCypherRID()` method). Out of the 63 usable bits (the sign bit is kept clear so `id(n)` is never negative), this many go to the bucketId and the rest to the record position. The default of 16 allows up to 65536 buckets and ~1.4e14 positions per bucket. Increase it for databases with many buckets, decrease it for buckets holding a very high number of records. Must be between 1 and 31. Changing it alters the `id()` output, so encode and decode must use the same value | Integer | 16 |
| `profile` | Specify the preferred profile among: default, high-performance, low-ram, low-cpu | String | default |
| `queryAdmissionHeapWatermark` | Percentage of `queryMaxHeapRAM` above which the query admission gate (see `queryMaxConcurrent`) stops starting new queries and lets them wait in its queue until the running ones give heap back. A running query keeps growing after it started, so this is headroom, not a guarantee: the heap budget still refuses the query that would exceed it. When no query admitted by the gate is running, the next one starts whatever the heap, so a budget held by other work (for example queries run through the embedded API) cannot stall the queue for good. Ignored when the gate or the heap budget is disabled. 0 or a negative value admits on the number of running queries alone. The profiler counts as `queryAdmissionHeapDeferrals` the times the head of the queue had a free slot but found the heap above the watermark *(since v26.11.1)* | Integer | 80 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| queryMaxConcurrent | Maximum number of requests of remote clients that may run at once in the JVM, across every database (see Concurrent Requests for how the queue works and how to size it). It counts every HTTP request that runs work in a database (query, command, batch load, vector and full-text search, time series, PromQL and Grafana), and the requests received over Postgres, BOLT, Redis, gRPC, Gremlin Server, MCP and MongoDB. A request that arrives when this many are running, or when the heap the running queries hold reserved is above queryAdmissionHeapWatermark, waits in a queue and starts in arrival order (FIFO) as soon as both allow it, instead of running at once and risking a refusal from the heap budget (queryMaxHeapRAM). The wait happens before anything of the request runs, never in the middle of it, and a query started from inside a running one (a function, a script) shares its slot. A request that waits longer than queryQueueTimeout, or that finds queryQueueMaxSize requests already waiting, fails with QueryAdmissionException, which every protocol answers as retryable: HTTP 503, Postgres SQLSTATE 40001, a BOLT transient error, Redis TRYAGAIN, gRPC ABORTED, MongoDB ExceededTimeLimit (262). Nothing of it ran, so it can be retried as it is. Waiting requests park the thread that received them, so keep queryQueueMaxSize below server.httpWorkerThreads to leave HTTP threads for the other requests. The MongoDB protocol runs its requests on threads shared by other connections, so it never waits: a request that cannot start at once is refused. Never held behind the queries: beginning and rolling back a transaction (HTTP sessions, gRPC), the Grafana health probe, Redis PING, the MCP tools that only report on the server, the gRPC admin service. Not gated: the embedded API, which the server's own work (security, schema, replication, triggers) also uses, Gremlin Server sessions and the gRPC client-streaming loads. A request holds its slot for as long as it runs, so with long analytical queries next to short ones, size the limit for both: a handful of long queries holding every slot makes the short ones wait and, past the timeout, be refused. A transaction that took explicit locks (LOCK TYPE, LOCK BUCKET) keeps them while one of its requests waits in the queue, which lengthens the wait of the writers that need them; a request waiting for an explicit lock gives its slot back first, so the lock holder can always be admitted. A | Integer | (2 x cores, min 4) |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `queryMaxHeapRAM` | Maximum heap (in MB) the in-memory buffers of all the queries running in the JVM may hold at once, across every database: the rows an `ORDER BY` sorts, the keys a `DISTINCT` or a `UNION` remembers, the groups a `GROUP BY` keeps, and in OpenCypher also the values `collect()` gathers, the rows a Cartesian product or a hash join buffers and the eager read ahead of a write. Every buffer reserves its estimated size from this budget as it grows and gives it back once its rows are served, when its query closes, or - for a result set the application abandoned without closing it - once the garbage collector reclaims it. Where `queryMaxHeapElementsAllowedPerOp` stops one runaway query, this budget stops many large queries running together from exhausting the heap although each one stays under that limit. A query whose buffers would take the reservations past the budget fails with `QueryHeapBudgetExceededException`, which is transient: the same query can succeed once the others release what they hold, and HTTP answers it with `503` (the other protocols classify it as retryable). A query that alone needs more than the whole budget fails with a plain `CommandExecutionException` instead, since no retry can help it. The first 256KB a query buffers are not reserved, so small queries never contend on the budget. A `GROUP BY` computed by a parallel scan reserves about one copy of its groups plus a small partial per worker, whatever the number of cores: a worker merges its groups into one shared set once it holds its share of the budget, and a `GROUP BY` of many keys aggregates the keys a worker does not hold in one shared set partitioned by key (see `queryParallelScan`) *(since v26.11.1)*. The reservations in use, their peak and the refusals are reported by the profiler as `queryHeapReserved`, `queryHeapReservedPeak`, `queryHeapBudget` and `queryHeapRefusals`. A scan of a type with large records reads ahead less as the budget fills (see `queryBatchMaxBytes`), which slows it: the profiler counts those batches as `queryHeapScanShrinks`, and `PROFILE` marks the scan step with `[read-ahead reduced in N batches by memory pressure]`, so a slow scan can be traced to a low budget *(since v26.11.1)*. The budget counts estimated sizes, not the heap itself: the estimate counts a record a buffer holds at its full size, so it errs on the high side when the page cache already holds the same pages, but leave some headroom rather than sizing it to the last megabyte of free heap. Left at the default it is half | Long | (heap/2) |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
|---|---|---|---|
| `queryQueueMaxSize` | Maximum number of queries that may wait in the queue of the query admission gate (see `queryMaxConcurrent`) at once. A query that finds the queue full fails at once with `QueryAdmissionException` (HTTP `503`) without having run. Each waiting query parks the HTTP worker thread that received it, so this bounds how many of those threads the queue can take away from the other requests. The `low-ram` profile sets it to 8. 0 or a negative value disables the queue: a query that cannot start at once is refused *(since v26.11.1)* | Integer | 256 |
| `queryQueueTimeout` | Maximum time in milliseconds a query waits in the queue of the query admission gate (see `queryMaxConcurrent`) before it fails with `QueryAdmissionException` (HTTP `503`) without having run. 0 or a negative value does not wait: a query that cannot start at once is refused *(since v26.11.1)* | Long | 30000 |
| `sparseVectorScoringWindow` | Size, in RID positions, of the window the `LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR` top-K traversal scores at a time. Measured about 1.8x faster at the median and 2.4x at p99 than the document-at-a-time traversal on learned-sparse corpora. Scores can differ in the last bit, so the order among exact ties may change. `0` or a negative value selects the classic document-at-a-time Block-Max MaxScore traversal. Rounded up to a multiple of 64 and capped at 1048576. Re-read on every query. Since v26.10.1. | Integer | 16384 |
| `test` | Tells if it is running in test mode. This enables the calling of callbacks for testing purpose | Boolean | false |

### Available Plugins

The following plugins are available for ArcadeDB Server:

- `MongoDB` (`com.arcadedb.mongo.MongoDBProtocolPlugin`) - Implements the MongoDB wire protocol
- `Postgres` (`com.arcadedb.postgres.PostgresProtocolPlugin`) - Implements the Postgres wire protocol
- `Redis` (`com.arcadedb.redis.RedisProtocolPlugin`) - Implements the Redis wire protocol
- `Http` (`com.arcadedb.server.http.HttpServerPlugin`) - Implements the HTTP/REST API
- `gRPC` (`com.arcadedb.server.grpc.GrpcServerPlugin`) - Implements the gRPC API. Bundled in the `full` distribution but not started until it is added to `server.plugins` (see gRPC settings)

**SERVER**

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
|---|---|---|---|
| `backup.enabled` | State of backup lock. Disable for increased performance of massive insertions. | Boolean | True |
| `ha.addPeerProbeTimeout` | Milliseconds to wait for a TCP connection to a peer's Raft address before an add-peer request (`POST /api/v1/cluster/peer`, `connect cluster`, gRPC `ConnectCluster`) is refused as unreachable with HTTP 400 / gRPC `INVALID_ARGUMENT`. A successful probe is not proof of a healthy peer and changes nothing. `0` skips the probe. Since v26.10.1. | Long | 2000 |
| `ha.appendBufferSize` | AppendEntries batch byte limit for replication (e.g. '32MB'). | String | 32MB |
| `ha.appendElementLimit` | Maximum number of Raft log entries per AppendEntries batch. Bounds the per-batch in-memory footprint on the follower during catch-up resync, where many batches may queue before the state machine can apply them. Lowering this value reduces peak heap pressure on followers catching up from a far-behind state. The byte limit (`ha.appendBufferSize`) remains the dominant per-batch heap bound; this element count is the secondary cap that governs when entries are small enough that many fit under the byte limit. Must be a positive integer (>= 1). | Integer | 64 |
| `ha.clientElectionRetryCount` | Number of retries performed by RemoteDatabase after receiving HTTP 503 NeedRetryException during an election. | Integer | 3 |
| `ha.clientElectionRetryDelayMs` | Delay in ms between RemoteDatabase election retries. A longer `Retry-After` sent by the server takes precedence, up to `network.retryAfterMaxWait` *(since v26.10.1)*. | Long | 2000 |
| `ha.bootstrapFromLocalDatabase` | When true (default), at first cluster formation peers exchange `(fingerprint, lastTxId)` per database; the highest-`lastTxId` peer is elected as bootstrap source via leadership transfer. Matching peers bootstrap locally with zero bytes transferred; mismatched peers reinstall the leader-shipped full snapshot. | Boolean | true |
| `ha.bootstrapTimeoutMs` | Maximum time in ms the bootstrap leader waits for every configured peer to report its bootstrap state before proceeding. | Long | 120000 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
|---|---|---|---|
| `ha.clusterName` | Cluster name. Useful in case of multiple clusters in the same network | String | arcadedb |
| `ha.clusterToken` | Shared secret for inter-node authentication. If empty, auto-generated at first startup and persisted under `raft-storage/`. | String | |
| `ha.clusterTokenPath` | Path to a file containing the shared secret for inter-node authentication. Read only when `ha.clusterToken` is not set; the file content is trimmed of surrounding whitespace. Keeps the secret off the command line (e.g. a Kubernetes Secret mounted on `tmpfs`). | String | null |
| `ha.divergedFollowerRecoveryDurationMs` | How long in ms a follower must stay stuck at a stale term, without its applied index advancing, before it reformats its Raft storage and rejoins. Any advance of the applied index restarts the window. Floored at 2x `ha.electionTimeoutMax`. Since v26.10.1: this window used to be `ha.staleFollowerRecoveryDurationMs` (default 60000); a deployment that raised the old setting to delay the reformat must raise this one instead. | Long | 20000 |
| `ha.electionTimeoutMin` | Minimum Raft election timeout in ms. Increase for high-latency WAN clusters. | Integer | 5000 |
| `ha.electionTimeoutMax` | Maximum Raft election timeout in ms. Increase for high-latency WAN clusters. Must be above `ha.electionTimeoutMin`: a value at or below it is widened to twice the minimum (with a warning), because without a spread between the two the nodes of a cluster that lost its leader keep splitting the vote. To shorten the timeout, lower both. *Since v26.10.1* | Integer | 10000 |
| `ha.enabled` | True if HA is enabled for the current server | Boolean | false |
| `ha.errorRetries` | Number of automatic retries in case of IO errors with a specific server. 0 (default) is to retry against all the configured servers | Integer | 0 |
| `ha.grpcAllowlistRefreshMs` | Rate-limiting interval in ms for DNS re-resolution in the gRPC peer address allowlist filter. | Long | 30000 |
| `ha.grpcFlowControlWindow` | gRPC flow control window size in bytes for Raft AppendEntries traffic. Larger values help catch-up replication after partitions. | Long | 4194304 |
| `ha.groupCommitBatchSize` | Maximum number of Raft log entries to batch in a single group commit flush. Higher values improve throughput under concurrent load. | Integer | 500 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `ha.groupCommitOfferTimeout` | Timeout in ms waiting for space in the group-commit queue before throwing ReplicationQueueFullException. | Integer | 100 |
| `ha.groupCommitQueueSize` | Maximum pending transactions allowed in the Raft group-commit queue. When full, the server sheds load by throwing ReplicationQueueFullException (NeedRetryException). | Integer | 10000 |
| `ha.grpcMaxConnectionAgeGraceMs` | How long in ms the RPCs still running on a Raft gRPC connection that reached `ha.grpcMaxConnectionAgeMs` have to finish before the connection is closed. Read only when that setting is non-zero. `0` cancels them at the age boundary. Since v26.10.1. | Long | 5000 |
| `ha.grpcMaxConnectionAgeMs` | How long in ms an inbound Raft gRPC connection may live before the server closes it with a graceful GOAWAY, whether busy or idle. Bounds a connection that is never idle, such as a removed peer that keeps campaigning, at the price of recycling healthy replication streams once per period. gRPC applies a +/-10% jitter and a 1 second floor. Set it well above the Raft election timeout. `0` leaves connections unbounded in age. Since v26.10.1. | Long | 0 |
| `ha.grpcMaxConnectionIdleMs` | How long in ms an inbound Raft gRPC connection may carry no RPC before the server closes it with a graceful GOAWAY. Closes quiet connections, such as the socket of a peer removed from the allowlist; it never reaps an active replication stream. Values below 1 second are raised to 1 second. `0` leaves connections unbounded (the behavior before v26.10.1). Since v26.10.1. | Long | 300000 |
| `ha.healthCheckInterval` | Interval in ms for the Raft health monitor to check for CLOSED/EXCEPTION state and auto-recover. Since v26.9.1 the same tick also restarts in place a node whose Raft log writer failed (for example `No space left on device`) once the Raft storage volume has room again. 0 disables. | Long | 3000 |
| `ha.idempotencyCacheMaxBodyBytes` | Maximum size in bytes of a single response body eligible for caching in the HTTP idempotency cache. Larger responses are not cached, so a retry of that request executes again. See reference/http-api/http.pdf | Long | 1048576 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
|---|---|---|---|
| `ha.idempotencyCacheMaxBytes` | Maximum total size in bytes of the cached response bodies in the HTTP idempotency cache. Oldest entries are evicted when exceeded. | Long | 67108864 |
| `ha.idempotencyCacheMaxEntries` | Maximum number of entries in the HTTP idempotency cache. | Integer | 10000 |
| `ha.idempotencyCacheTtlMs` | Time-to-live in ms for entries in the HTTP idempotency cache: how long a retry with the same `X-Request-Id` is replayed rather than executed again. See reference/http-api/http.pdf | Long | 60000 |
| `ha.jvmPauseCloseThresholdMs` | JVM-pause length in ms above which Ratis closes this node's Raft division (Ratis default: 60000). `0` or a negative value disables the close: a long pause still steps a leader down, and the ArcadeDB health monitor decides whether the node needs recovery. Set a positive value to restore the Ratis behavior. Since v26.10.1. | Long | 0 |
| `ha.k8s` | The server is running inside Kubernetes (enables auto-join on scale-up) | Boolean | false |
| `ha.k8sSuffix` | When running inside Kubernetes use this suffix to reach the other servers. Example: arcadedb.default.svc.cluster.local | String | |
| `ha.logPurgeGap` | Number of Raft log entries retained after a snapshot as a buffer for slightly lagging followers. Lower values free disk faster but raise the chance a slow follower needs a full snapshot resync. | Integer | 1024 |
| `ha.logPurgeUptoSnapshot` | When true, deletes old Raft log segments after each snapshot to bound disk growth. Set to false to retain full log history for debugging/auditing. | Boolean | true |
| `ha.logSegmentSize` | Maximum Raft log segment size (e.g. '64MB', '128MB'). | String | 64MB |
| `ha.logVerbose` | Verbose HA logging: 0=off, 1=basic (elections), 2=detailed (replication), 3=trace (every state machine apply). | Integer | 0 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `ha.membershipChangeTimeout` | Time in ms an add-peer or remove-peer keeps re-issuing the Raft configuration change before reporting it as not committed. Bounds the whole request, not one attempt: an attempt that cannot finish in what is left of the budget is not started. A peer that answers a connection but never catches up (a legitimately large snapshot install, or a listener that is not a peer of this cluster) is what reaches the full budget; a peer that belongs to a different cluster is refused at once instead. Lower it below a load balancer's idle timeout so you get the error rather than a dropped connection, remembering that an attempt whose network call hangs can take up to about 31s on its own. Read at server start. | Long | 90000 |
| `ha.peerAllowlist.enabled` | Reject inbound Raft gRPC connections whose remote address does not resolve to a cluster peer. The accepted hosts are those in `ha.serverList` (expanded with `ha.k8sSuffix` when `ha.k8s` is set), plus the current members of the cluster, which are picked up automatically so a node that joins at runtime is accepted; on Kubernetes the pods of the headless service named by `ha.k8sSuffix` are accepted too, so a StatefulSet scale-up completes without changing any setting. Loopback is always allowed. Not a substitute for mTLS on untrusted networks. | Boolean | true |
| `ha.peerAllowlistStartupGraceMs` | Startup grace window in ms during which the gRPC peer allowlist fails OPEN (accepts and logs a warning) for an unmatched address, as long as it has never resolved every host in `ha.serverList` at least once. Prevents a self-inflicted partition on Kubernetes, where a peer's headless-service DNS record is only published once its pod is Ready, so a restarting peer connects before its own name resolves. Measured from filter creation; enforces normally once all peers resolve once or the window elapses. 0 disables fail-open. | Long | 60000 |
| `ha.peerAllowlistStickyTtlMs` | How long in ms the gRPC peer allowlist keeps the last successfully-resolved IPs of a peer host when a later DNS re-resolution of that host fails. Bridges transient DNS outages and pod-IP churn so a peer that resolved moments ago is not evicted by a momentary lookup failure. 0 disables stickiness. | Long | 300000 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `ha.peerChannelResetDuration` | Time in ms a follower must stay continuously unreachable before the leader resets that one follower's replication gRPC channel, so the next send re-resolves DNS and reconnects. Recovers a leader appender stuck on a stale DNS result after a follower restarts with a new address (e.g. a Kubernetes pod-IP change). Retried once per interval, up to 5 attempts, then the leader gives up or escalates (see `ha.peerChannelResetEscalation`); the counter re-arms when the follower reconnects. Only the unreachable peer's channel is touched. Requires `ha.peerUnreachableThreshold` > 0. Set to 0 to disable. See Replication-Channel Self-Healing. | Long | 60000 |
| `ha.peerChannelResetEscalation` | When the `ha.peerChannelResetDuration` retry budget is exhausted and the follower's replication channel is still dead, transfer leadership to a healthy peer so the new leader builds a fresh appender to that follower. Without it the leader stays wedged until an operator restarts the process, because the reset streak only re-arms when the follower becomes reachable again. The target is chosen with the same rules as a manual step-down and is never the wedged follower; when no healthy target exists the leader logs for operator intervention instead. Each healthy peer escalates a given follower at most once per 30-minute cooldown, so leadership churn is bounded rather than perpetual. Set to `false` to only log. See Replication-Channel Self-Healing. | Boolean | true |
| `ha.peerUnreachableThreshold` | Time in ms since the last successful RPC to a follower before the leader reports it as unreachable in the resync narrative. Also the "unreachable" signal `ha.peerChannelResetDuration` depends on. Does not change Raft membership or quorum. Set to 0 to disable, which also disables the channel-reset recovery built on it. | Long | 10000 |
| `ha.proxyBatchReadTimeout` | Timeout in ms a follower waits for the leader to answer a batch load it relayed via `POST /api/v1/batch`, before answering the client HTTP 504. Separate from `ha.proxyReadTimeout` because a bulk load's duration depends on the payload size, not a fixed control-plane budget. | Long | 600000 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
|---|---|---|---|
| `ha.proxyCommandTimeout` | Fallback timeout in ms a follower waits for the leader to answer a forwarded SQL/DDL write, used only when the database has no `arcadedb.command.timeout` of its own. *(Since v26.10.1 the budget is read from the database's configuration, not from the configuration passed to the call.)* | Long | 3600000 |
| `ha.proxyConnectTimeout` | Connect timeout in ms for the leader proxy (replica-to-leader forwarding). Since 26.10.1 it also applies when the cluster uses SSL, where the connection previously had a fixed 5s timeout the setting could not change. Read when the connection is created, so a change needs a restart. | Long | 5000 |
| `ha.proxyLongCommandTimeout` | Milliseconds a follower waits for the leader to answer a forwarded `restore backup`, `restore database` or `import database` before answering the client HTTP 504. These commands legitimately run for minutes, so `ha.proxyReadTimeout` does not apply to them. `0` or a negative value does not disable it. Since v26.10.1. | Long | 3600000 |
| `ha.proxyReadTimeout` | Read timeout in ms for the leader proxy. Covers long-running queries forwarded from a replica. | Long | 30000 |
| `ha.quorum` | Write quorum: `majority` or `all`. *The legacy values* `none`, `one`, `two`, `three` *are not supported* | String | majority |
| `ha.quorumTimeout` | Timeout in ms waiting for the quorum acknowledgment | Long | 10000 |
| `ha.raftPort` | TCP/IP port for Raft gRPC communication. Used as the default when HA_SERVER_LIST entries do not specify an explicit port. | Integer | 2434 |
| `ha.raftPersistStorage` | If true, the Raft storage directory is preserved across restarts, enabling node rejoin by replaying its persisted log instead of a full snapshot resync. **Defaults to `true`**: wiping the Raft log on restart could permanently diverge a lagging follower after a full-cluster cold restart (`WALVersionGapException`) or silently re-form a fresh single-node cluster. Ensure `ha.raftStorageDirectory` lives on durable storage. A throwaway/test cluster can opt out with `false`. | Boolean | true |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
|---|---|---|---|
| `ha.raftStorageDirectory` | Parent directory under which the per-node Raft storage sub-folders (`raft-storage-<nodeName>`) are created. When empty (the default), the server root path (`arcadedb.server.rootPath`) is used. Because `ha.raftPersistStorage` now defaults to `true`, this directory must live on **durable** storage (a persistent volume, not an ephemeral/`tmpfs` mount) so a restarted node can replay its log and rejoin without a full snapshot resync. Set this to a writable, statically-named path (e.g. a PVC mount) on Kubernetes StatefulSets with `readOnlyRootFilesystem: true`, where the dynamically-named `raft-storage-*` directory under the read-only server root cannot be created or mounted. | String | |
| `ha.ratisRestartMaxRetries` | Maximum consecutive Ratis restart attempts by the health monitor before the server shuts down for cluster-level recovery. Also bounds, per incident, the in-place restarts that recover a failed Raft log writer (since v26.9.1). | Integer | 10 |
| `ha.readConsistency` | Default read consistency for replica reads: `eventual`, `read_your_writes`, `linearizable`. | String | read_your_writes |
| `ha.replicationChunkMaxSize` | Maximum channel chunk size for replicating messages between servers | Integer | 16777216 |
| `ha.replicationLagWarning` | Raft log index gap threshold for replication lag warnings. 0 to disable. | Long | 1000 |
| `ha.schemaDelta` | Ships a schema change to the followers as a delta against the schema they already hold, instead of the whole schema document on every DDL. On a large schema that is kilobytes instead of megabytes per Raft entry. The leader sends the whole document anyway after it becomes leader, for a compaction entry, an entry shipped in instalments, a change too large for a delta to pay off, and whenever any peer has not confirmed it can decode a delta, so a rolling **upgrade** needs no ordering. A rolling **downgrade** to a version older than v26.10.1 does: see Schema delta replication. While on, the leader keeps one parsed copy of the schema per replicated database in heap. Turning it off is safe at any time. *(Since v26.10.1)* | Boolean | true |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `ha.schemaIncrementalApply` | A follower applying a DDL entry creates only the components for the files that entry added, instead of rebuilding every component in the database. The full rebuild costs time proportional to all the files per entry, which made building a large schema quadratic (a 1209-type schema took about 2h53m to replicate). Entries the incremental path cannot express (a file retired, a compacted index, a bloom filter, a new dictionary) fall back to the full rebuild on their own. Read per entry, so a change takes effect without a restart. Set to `false` only to rule out a suspected incremental-apply bug. *(Since v26.10.1)* | Boolean | true |
| `ha.txSchemaCheck` | Have every transaction a node replicates carry the Raft log index that node had applied when the transaction began, so the leader can refuse a transaction prepared before a schema change it has already applied. Without it a replica that has not yet applied a committed `CREATE INDEX` can ship a transaction whose record ends up missing from the new index on every node, with no error. The refusal is a retryable `ConcurrentModificationException`, so expect retries on replicas during DDL; callers that do not retry (the default for plain HTTP commands) see the error. The index is written only once every peer advertises the capability, so a mixed-version cluster is unprotected until the last node is upgraded. This setting controls only whether THIS node states an index. Since v26.10.1. | Boolean | true |
| `ha.securityConvergenceReadinessTimeout` | How long in ms `/api/v1/ready` (and the gRPC `Ready` RPC) keeps answering NOT READY on a node that may be enforcing stale users, groups or API tokens: one added to the cluster while running (`POST /api/v1/cluster/peer`, `connect cluster`, Kubernetes auto-join) that has not yet installed the cluster's security documents, or one caught up by a snapshot install whose copies the leader has not yet confirmed. Requires `server.readinessRequiresHA`. When the window expires the node reports READY and logs once at SEVERE which documents never converged. `0` disables the wait. See Health probes. *(Since v26.10.1)* | Long | 30000 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `ha.securityEntryCapabilityGate` | Refuse a group or API-token change (HTTP 409 / gRPC `FAILED_PRECONDITION`, naming the peer) while any peer of the Raft configuration has not proved, via `POST /api/v1/cluster/capabilities`, that it can decode the log entry the change is replicated as. Protects a rolling upgrade: an older node would halt on the unknown entry. An unreachable peer counts as a no, so admin security changes are refused while any node is down. Turn it off only when you know every node runs v26.10.1 or later. Since v26.10.1. | Boolean | true |
| `ha.securitySeedRetryTimeout` | Time budget in ms a peer-admission call (`POST /api/v1/cluster/peer`, `connect cluster`) spends retrying, with exponential backoff, the security documents (`server-users.jsonl`, `server-groups.json`, `server-api-tokens.json`) it seeds to the newly joined peer. A snapshot install does not carry them. `0` leaves a single best-effort attempt. Since v26.10.1. | Long | 3000 |
| `ha.serverList` | Servers in the cluster, comma-separated. Each entry uses the readable object form `[name@]host:{raft:2434,http:2480,https:2490,priority:10}` (recommended) or the positional form `[name@]host:raftPort:httpPort[:priority[:httpsPort]]`. The httpPort is required for replica-to-leader HTTP forwarding. The optional `name@` prefix gives the peer a human-readable name used in logs and Studio. The optional priority (default 0) prefers higher-valued nodes during elections. The optional httpsPort encrypts peer-to-peer transfers (e.g. snapshot download) when `ssl.enabled` is true; on a homogeneous cluster it is derived from this node's local HTTPS port when omitted. Example: `frankfurt@db1:{raft:2434,http:2480,https:2490,priority:10},london@db2:{raft:2434,http:2480,https:2490}` | String | |
| `ha.serverRole` | Node role in the cluster: `any` (default, eligible for leader election) or `replica` (never elected leader; Raft priority set to 0). Useful for witness/read-scale nodes. | String | any |
| `ha.snapshotCompressionLevel` | DEFLATE level the leader applies to the ZIP stream of a database snapshot shipped to a follower: 0 (stored) to 9 (smallest, slowest), or -1 for the Deflater default (level 6). A value outside -1..9 is ignored and the default is used. Only the serving side reads it. *Since v26.11.1: default changed from -1 to 1* | Integer | 1 |
| `ha.snapshotDownloadTimeout` | Read timeout in ms for downloading a database snapshot from the leader during follower resync. | Integer | 300000 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `ha.snapshotGapTolerance` | Maximum acceptable gap between the snapshot index and persisted applied index before triggering a snapshot download. | Long | 10 |
| `ha.snapshotInstallBackupWaitMs` | Milliseconds a snapshot install, or the apply of a replicated drop database, waits for a backup, export or import of the same database already running on this node before it replaces or drops the database files anyway (logging a warning). `0` does not wait. Since v26.10.1. | Long | 60000 |
| `ha.snapshotInstallRetries` | Maximum retry attempts for snapshot download from the leader during snapshot installation. | Integer | 3 |
| `ha.snapshotInstallRetryBaseMs` | Base delay in ms for exponential backoff between snapshot download retries. Actual delay is baseMs * 2^attempt. | Long | 5000 |
| `ha.snapshotMaxConcurrent` | Maximum number of concurrent snapshot downloads served by the leader. Requests over this limit receive HTTP 503. | Integer | 2 |
| `ha.snapshotMaxEntrySize` | Maximum uncompressed size in bytes for a single entry in a snapshot ZIP. Decompression-bomb guard. Set 0 or a negative value to keep the built-in default: the guard cannot be switched off. *Configurable since v26.10.1* | Long | 10737418240 |
| `ha.snapshotThreshold` | Number of Raft log entries after which the leader automatically takes a snapshot. | Long | 100000 |
| `ha.snapshotWatchdogTimeout` | Delay in ms before the snapshot-gap watchdog triggers a download. Floored at 4x `ha.electionTimeoutMax`. | Long | 30000 |
| `ha.snapshotWriteTimeout` | Timeout in ms for writing a snapshot to a follower. If the transfer stalls beyond this duration, the connection is force-closed. | Long | 300000 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `ha.stalledReplicaResyncDurationMs` | How long in ms a replica must stay continuously STALLED — its `matchIndex` not advancing while the leader keeps committing — before the **leader** forces it to resync. This is the leader-driven counterpart to a follower detecting its own lag: it covers the case where the follower cannot self-detect the stall because its own commit index never advances. A follower still at the never-appended sentinel (`matchIndex=-1` while the leader holds committed entries) is treated as STALLED regardless of the numeric lag, so it is recovered even when the leader is only a few entries ahead and the lag stays below `ha.replicationLagWarning`. The same duration doubles as the grace period before a replica's status flips from HEALTHY to STALLED, so a brief join or snapshot-install window is not misreported. Set to 0 to disable leader-driven recovery; the STALLED condition is still detected and logged. | Long | 60000 |
| `ha.stopServerOnReplicationFailure` | After a phase-2 replication failure, step-down is attempted first. If every step-down fails and this flag is true, the JVM exits so an orchestrator can restart. Default is false: the server keeps running and logs CRITICAL. | Boolean | false |
| `ha.tls.enabled` | Negotiate TLS on the Raft gRPC transport, which carries AppendEntries, RequestVote and the Ratis admin/client calls between the nodes of a cluster. When true, `ha.tls.certChainFile`, `ha.tls.privateKeyFile` and `ha.tls.trustCertCollectionFile` must all name a readable PEM file or the node refuses to start with a ConfigurationException naming the offending setting. Default is false so a development or test cluster still starts with no configuration at all; the peer-address allowlist (`ha.peerAllowlist.enabled`) is IP-based and is defeated by a spoofed source address or a compromised peer, so it is a best-effort default rather than a substitute for TLS on an untrusted network. TLS on the gRPC port does not replace the `X-ArcadeDB-Cluster-Token` check on the HTTP side channels (snapshot download, database verify), nor is it affected by `ssl.enabled`, which covers those side channels only. See mTLS for the Raft gRPC transport. *Since v26.9.1* | Boolean | false |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `ha.tls.certChainFile` | PEM file holding this node's Raft gRPC certificate followed by any intermediate CA certificates. The certificate must carry a subject alternative name matching the address the other nodes use to dial this node in `ha.serverList` (on Kubernetes, the pod's stable headless-service DNS name, not the pod IP). Every node both accepts and initiates Raft connections, so with `ha.tls.mutualAuth=true` this one certificate is presented as the TLS server certificate AND as the client certificate: it needs BOTH the `serverAuth` and `clientAuth` extended key usages. A CA that issues single-purpose certificates otherwise produces a handshake failure the startup file checks cannot catch, because the file is perfectly readable and merely the wrong kind of certificate. Required when `ha.tls.enabled` is true. *Since v26.9.1* | String | |
| `ha.tls.privateKeyFile` | PEM file holding the PKCS#8 private key that matches `ha.tls.certChainFile` — the PEM armor labels it simply `PRIVATE KEY`, whereas a PKCS#1 key is labeled `RSA PRIVATE KEY` and is not accepted. A WARNING is logged when the file is readable by the group or by others, since any local account that can read it can present this node's identity to the cluster; it is a warning and not a refusal, because a mounted secret may arrive with permissions the node cannot change. Required when `ha.tls.enabled` is true. *Since v26.9.1* | String | |
| `ha.tls.trustCertCollectionFile` | PEM file holding the cluster CA certificate(s) that sign every node certificate. A peer presenting a certificate this collection does not chain to is rejected during the TLS handshake, before any Raft message is read. Required when `ha.tls.enabled` is true — including with `ha.tls.mutualAuth=false`, since the dialing node still needs the cluster CA to validate the certificate presented by the node it dials. *Since v26.9.1* | String | |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `ha.tls.mutualAuth` | Require the dialing peer to present a client certificate signed by the CA collection in `ha.tls.trustCertCollectionFile`, binding peer identity to the certificate rather than to a source IP address. Set to false for server-only TLS, which encrypts the traffic but leaves the Raft port open to any client that trusts the cluster CA — the back door this setting exists to close, so the server logs a WARNING at startup when it is off. Turning it off does NOT make `ha.tls.trustCertCollectionFile` optional. Only meaningful when `ha.tls.enabled` is true. *Since v26.9.1* | Boolean | true |
| `ha.writeBufferSize` | Raft log write buffer size (e.g. '40MB'). Must be at least `ha.appendBufferSize` + 8 bytes; otherwise the server fails to start with ConfigurationException. | String | 40MB |
| `network.sameServerErrorRetry` | Number of automatic retries in case of IO errors with a specific server. If replica servers are configured, look also at `HA_ERROR_RETRY` setting. 0 (default) = no retry | Integer | 0 |
| `network.retryAfterMaxWait` | Upper bound, in milliseconds, on how long the remote client honors the `Retry-After` a server sends with a request it refused before running it (a `503` from a node installing a snapshot): the transaction retry loop of `RemoteDatabase.transaction()` and the election retry loop wait at least that long before retrying, and the hint is capped at this value, so a misbehaving server cannot park the client. A random spread of up to a tenth of the hint is added on top, so the clients a node refused together do not all come back at once. The most a refused request can wait is therefore 1.1 times this value per retry: `txRetries - 1` pauses for a transaction, `ha.clientElectionRetryCount` for a command. 0 ignores `Retry-After`, leaving only the retry backoff *(since v26.10.1)* | Long | 30000 |
| `network.socketTimeout` | TCP/IP Socket timeout (in ms) | Integer | 30000 |
| `network.remoteFetchConnectTimeout` | Connect timeout, in milliseconds, for an outbound fetch of a URL you supply - `IMPORT DATABASE`, `RESTORE DATABASE` and the openCypher `LOAD CSV` - applied to every hop of a redirect chain. 0 means no timeout at all, so a host that neither accepts nor refuses the connection blocks the calling thread indefinitely. *Since v26.10.1* | Integer | 30000 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `network.remoteFetchReadTimeout` | Read timeout, in milliseconds, for an outbound fetch of a URL you supply - `IMPORT DATABASE`, `RESTORE DATABASE` and the openCypher `LOAD CSV`. It bounds EACH read, not the whole transfer: a large remote source may legitimately take much longer than this to arrive, as long as it keeps sending. 0 means no timeout at all, so a source that stops sending and never closes the socket - a hung HTTP connection, or a proxy holding the socket open after the origin died - blocks the calling thread for as long as that socket lives. Raise it for a genuinely slow origin rather than disabling it; when it fires, the error names the URL, the wait and this setting. *Since v26.10.1* | Integer | 30000 |
| `network.maxPreAuthConnections` | Maximum number of connections a binary wire-protocol listener (Postgres, Redis, BOLT) may hold in the phase before authentication. Each accepted socket costs one thread and one file descriptor before the client has proved who it is, and `network.socketTimeout` only bounds how long each one may stay there, not how many there can be. Past this cap the listener closes further connections immediately rather than accepting and then timing them out. The cap is per listener, so a flood against one protocol cannot use up the budget that lets clients of another log in. 0 means unlimited. *Since v26.9.1* | Integer | 500 |
| `network.socketKeepAlive` | Enable TCP keepalive (SO_KEEPALIVE) on every wire-protocol socket. The Postgres and Redis executors drop the socket read timeout to infinite once a connection is authenticated, because an authenticated client legitimately holds an idle connection open, and those protocols carry no application-level heartbeat. With keepalive off, a peer that dies without a FIN/RST (host crash, silent partition) leaves the server thread blocked in a read forever, leaking a thread and a file descriptor per event. Keepalive lets the OS discover the dead peer and fail the read. *Since v26.9.1* | Boolean | true |
| `network.socketKeepAliveIdle` | Seconds an authenticated connection may sit idle before the OS sends the first TCP keepalive probe. Only applied where the JDK and the platform expose TCP_KEEPIDLE (Linux and macOS do); elsewhere the system-wide default applies, typically 2 hours. 0 leaves the system default in place. *Since v26.9.1* | Integer | 120 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| network.socketKeepAliveInterval | Seconds between TCP keepalive probes once the first one has gone unanswered. 0 leaves the system default in place. *Since v26.9.1* | Integer | 15 |
| network.socketKeepAliveCount | Number of unanswered TCP keepalive probes after which the connection is declared dead. With the defaults a dead peer is detected about 3 minutes after the connection goes idle. 0 leaves the system default in place. *Since v26.9.1* | Integer | 4 |
| ssl.keyStore | Path where the SSL certificates are stored | String | null |
| ssl.keyStorePassword | Password to open the SSL key store | String | null |
| ssl.trustStore | Path to the SSL trust store | String | null |
| ssl.trustStorePassword | Password to open the SSL trust store | String | null |
| ssl.enabled | Use SSL for client connections | Boolean | false |
| postgres.debug | Enables the printing of Postgres protocol to the console. Default is false | Boolean | false |
| postgres.host | TCP/IP host name used for incoming connections for Postgres plugin. Default is '0.0.0.0' | String | 0.0.0.0 |
| postgres.port | TCP/IP port number used for incoming connections for Postgres plugin. Default is 5432 | Integer | 5432 |
| postgres.ssl | TLS mode for Postgres wire protocol connections, using the shared SSL key/trust store settings (ssl.*): DISABLED (no TLS, default), OPTIONAL (TLS or plain text, the client chooses), REQUIRED (TLS only, plain text startup is refused). *Since v26.10.1* | String | DISABLED |
| postgres.queryMaxRows | Maximum number of rows the result of one statement may occupy server-side before the first row is sent to a Postgres client, on both the simple-query and the extended-query (Parse/Bind/Describe/Execute) protocol. The server has to see the whole result before it can announce the column set, and the portal fetch size only bounds what each Execute sends, not what the server holds. A statement exceeding the limit is refused with an error; narrow it with a WHERE or LIMIT clause or raise the limit. 0 means unlimited. *Since v26.9.1* | Integer | 1000000 |
| redis.defaultDatabase | Default database name for Redis protocol connections. If set, RAM commands (SET, GET, etc.) will use this database's globalVariables. Empty means no default (requires SELECT command or key prefix) | String | |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
|---|---|---|---|
| `redis.host` | TCP/IP host name used for incoming connections for Redis plugin. Default is '0.0.0.0' | String | 0.0.0.0 |
| `redis.port` | TCP/IP port number used for incoming connections for Redis plugin. Default is 6379 | Integer | 6379 |
| `mongo.host` | TCP/IP host name used for incoming connections for Mongo plugin. Default is '0.0.0.0' | String | 0.0.0.0 |
| `mongo.port` | TCP/IP port number used for incoming connections for Mongo plugin. Default is 27017 | Integer | 27017 |
| `server.databaseLoadAtStartup` | Open all the available databases at server startup | Boolean | true |
| `server.databaseDirectory` | Directory containing the database | String | ${arcadedb.server.rootPath}/databases |
| `server.backupDirectory` | Directory containing the backups | String | ${arcadedb.server.rootPath}/backups |
| `server.configDirectory` | Directory the server reads and writes its configuration files in: `server-configuration.json`, the security files (`server-users.jsonl`, `server-groups.json`, `server-api-tokens.json`), `backup.json`, `ai.json`, `mcp-config.json` and `gremlin-server.yaml`. Set it as a `-D` system property or in `ARCADEDB_SETTINGS`, never in `server-configuration.json`, which lives inside it. Read once at startup; the directory is created if missing. `arcadedb-log.properties` is not read from here: logging is still configured with `-Djava.util.logging.config.file`. See Relocating the configuration directory. *(Since v26.10.1)* | String | ${arcadedb.server.rootPath}/config |
| `instance.id` | Optional instance id (`adb-` followed by a lowercase UUID) to use instead of the one ArcadeDB generates and saves in the file `.instance.id` of the databases directory (older versions: `instance.id` of the configuration directory). Set it when no directory is writable or persistent. It identifies the instance to ArcadeData support and is never a credential. Empty means generated. See The instance id. | String | |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `instance.derived` | Computes the instance id from `ha.clusterName` and `server.name` instead of saving it, so a server with no persistent directory (a container without a volume, a Kubernetes StatefulSet pod) keeps the same id on every restart. The names must be unique per node and stable. Ignored when `instance.id` is set. See The instance id. | Boolean | false |
| `support.url` | Base URL of the ArcadeData customer portal used by the Support tab of Studio and by `connect portal`. HTTPS only (plain HTTP is accepted for `localhost`). Overrides the value registered in `support.json`. See Support. | String | https://portal.arcadedb.com |
| `support.clientId` | Client ID (workspace id) of the customer portal. Together with `support.clientKey` it registers the server without Studio (containers, Kubernetes secrets) and overrides `support.json`. Empty means not set. | String | |
| `support.clientKey` | Client key (`wsk_…`) of the customer portal. A credential: masked when settings are listed or dumped, never returned by any API and never logged. Empty means not set. | String | |
| `support.autoRegister` | Registers the server as an installation of its workspace in the customer portal without anybody opening Studio: once shortly after the start of a server that holds a support key (`support.clientKey` or `support.json`), and then once a day. It sends the same redacted diagnostics Studio sends (never logs, never database contents) and only fills fields the portal has blank. Set it to `false` to register only from Studio or the console. See Support. | Boolean | true |
| `server.logsDirectory` | Directory where the server writes its log files. Useful on read-only root filesystems (e.g. Kubernetes `readOnlyRootFilesystem` pods) to relocate logs to a writable mount. The value is resolved very early at startup from, in order, the system property `arcadedb.server.logsDirectory`, the environment variable, then this setting, and supports `${…}` placeholders. The `server.sh`/`server.bat` scripts forward the `ARCADEDB_LOG_DIR` environment variable to this setting. | String | ./log |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
|---|---|---|---|
| server.defaultDatabases | The default databases created when the server starts. The format is (<database-name>[(<user-name>:<user-passwd>[:<user-group>])][{import\|restore:<URL>}][;]'. Pay attention on using `; to separate databases and , to separate credentials. The supported actions are import and restore. A failing import or restore now aborts server startup with an error (since v26.10.1; before, a failed import silently left the database created but empty). Only one WITH setting can be passed to import; a comma inside {…} starts a new command, not a second setting. Example: Universe[albert:einstein:admin];Amiga[Jay:Miner,Jack:Tramiel]{import:/tmp/movies.tgz} | String | |
| server.startupRestoreSlotWaitMs | Milliseconds the restore: command of server.defaultDatabases waits for a backup, restore or import of the same database, already running on this server, to finish before it refuses. A refusal stops the server boot. 0 or a negative value refuses immediately. See Create default database(s). *(Since v26.10.1)* | Long | 60000 |
| server.defaultDatabaseMode | The default mode to load pre-existing databases. The value must match a com.arcadedb.engine.PaginatedFile.MODE enum value: {READ_ONLY, READ_WRITE}Databases which are newly created will always be opened READ_WRITE. | String | READ_WRITE |
| server.httpIncomingHost | TCP/IP host name used for incoming HTTP connections | String | 0.0.0.0 |
| server.httpIncomingPort | TCP/IP port number used for incoming HTTP connections. Specify a single port or a range <from>-<to>. Default is 2480-2489 to accept a range of ports in case they are occupied. | String | 2480-2489 |
| server.httpsIncomingPort | TCP/IP port number used for incoming HTTPS connections. Specify a single port or a range <from>-<to>. Default is 2490-2499 to accept a range of ports in case they are occupied. | String | 2490-2499 |
| server.httpsIoThreads | Number of threads to use in the HTTP server | Integer | 2 per core |
| server.httpSessionExpireTimeout | Timeout in seconds for a HTTP session (managing a transaction) to expire | Long | 5 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `server.httpBodyContentMaxSize` | Maximum size in bytes for HTTP request body content, measured on the wire. Set to -1 for unlimited size. A request that declares a `Content-Encoding` is additionally limited by `server.httpBodyContentDecompressedMaxSize` once decoded. Default is 100MB | Integer | 100 |
| `server.httpBodyContentDecompressedMaxSize` | Maximum size in bytes an HTTP request body may expand to once its `Content-Encoding` has been decoded. `server.httpBodyContentMaxSize` limits only the bytes that arrive, so on the endpoints that decode a body - the InfluxDB line protocol ingest (gzip) and the Prometheus `remote_write` and `remote_read` endpoints (Snappy) - it would otherwise act as a compression-ratio multiplier rather than a limit. A body that decodes past this value is refused with `413` before the decoded bytes are allocated. Set to -1 (the default) to use the same value as `server.httpBodyContentMaxSize`, including its own -1 meaning unlimited; set to 0 for unlimited. *(Available since v26.10.1)* | Long | -1 |
| `server.httpTerminateOnClientDisconnect` | Terminates the statement of an HTTP request whose client closes the connection while it runs, so a client that gives up does not leave the server working on an answer nobody will read. Applies to plain HTTP/1.x connections once the request body has been read. A client that half-closes its side of the connection after sending the request and still waits for the response is taken for one that left: set to `false` for such clients. In a transaction session opened with `/begin`, a terminated command (`/command`, `/batch`) also rolls the session's transaction back and ends the session, as its failure would; a terminated read (`GET`/`POST /query`) or time-series, vector, PromQL or Grafana request leaves the session and its transaction as they were. Since v26.11.1. | Boolean | true |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
|---|---|---|---|
| `server.httpStreamingWriteTimeout` | Budget in ms a single blocking write of a streamed HTTP response (`/batch` results, `Accept: application/x-ndjson` on `/query` and `/command`, Server-Sent Events of AI chat and long-running server commands) may make no progress. When a client stops reading, the connection is closed and the worker thread released. The timer is re-armed for each chunk of at most 64 KB, so a slow but reading client never trips it. `0` or a negative value leaves streamed writes unbounded. Since v26.10.1. | Integer | 60000 |
| `server.httpStreamingKeepAliveInterval` | Interval in ms after which a streamed answer (`Accept: application/x-ndjson` on `/query`, `/command` and `/batch`) that has had nothing to send writes a bare newline, which consumers skip. Keeps a client or proxy that bounds silence (the Java remote client does) from failing a healthy slow query. Keep it well below the smallest silence budget of clients and proxies. `0` or a negative value sends no keep-alive. Since v26.10.1. | Integer | 5000 |
| `server.httpAuthSessionExpireTimeout` | Timeout in seconds for a HTTP authentication session to expire. This timeout is computed from the latest request using the auth token. See Token-Based Authentication. | Long | 1800 |
| `server.httpAuthSessionMax` | Maximum number of concurrent HTTP authentication sessions the server keeps in memory. Once reached, a further `POST /api/v1/login` is answered `503` instead of growing the session map without bound; expired sessions are reclaimed before refusing. Set to `0` for unlimited (not recommended). *(Available since v26.9.1)* | Integer | 10000 |
| `server.httpAuthSessionMaxPerUser` | Maximum number of concurrent HTTP authentication sessions a single user may hold. Beyond it, that user's oldest session is invalidated to make room for the new one, so a login loop recycles only its own sessions and never affects other users. Set to `0` for unlimited (not recommended). *(Available since v26.9.1)* | Integer | 100 |
| `server.mode` | Server mode between 'development', 'test' and 'production' | String | development |
| `server.name` | Server name | String | ArcadeDB_0 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `server.plugins` | Server plugins to load, see available plugins. Format as comma separated list of: `<pluginName>:<pluginFullClass>`. | String | |
| `server.rootPassword` | Password for root user to use at first startup of the server. Set this to avoid asking the password to the user | String | null |
| `server.rootPasswordPath` | Path to file with password for root user to use at first startup of the server. Set this to avoid asking the password to the user | String | null |
| `server.rootPath` | Root path in the file system where the server is looking for files. By default is the current directory | String | null |
| `server.securityAlgorithm` | Default encryption algorithm used for passwords hashing | String | PBKDF2WithHmacSHA256 |
| `server.reloadEvery` | Time in milliseconds of checking if the server security files have been modified to be reloaded | Integer | 5000 |
| `server.securitySaltCacheSize` | Cache size of hashed salt passwords. The cache works as LRU. Use 0 to disable the cache | Integer | 64 |
| `server.apiTokenRequireSecureTransport` | When true, `POST /api/v1/server/api-tokens` refuses to mint an API token unless the request arrived over HTTPS, from a loopback peer, or through a reverse proxy listed in `server.apiTokenTrustedProxies` that reports `https`. A refused mint is answered `412`. When false, an unprotected mint goes ahead and is logged at WARNING. **The default is scheduled to change to `true` in 27.1.1**; see Create an API token. *(Since v26.10.1)* | Boolean | false |
| `server.apiTokenTrustedProxies` | Comma-separated literal IP addresses or CIDR ranges (IPv4 and IPv6) of the reverse proxies allowed to vouch, through `X-Forwarded-Proto` or the RFC 7239 `Forwarded` header, that an API token mint reached them over HTTPS. Applies to the HTTP route and to the gRPC `CreateApiToken` RPC. Headers from any other peer are ignored. Hostnames are rejected, not resolved, and a list that does not parse is treated as empty and logged at SEVERE. List only an L7 proxy that sets or overwrites the header, never an L4 balancer that passes the client's headers through. Empty trusts no proxy. *(Since v26.10.1)* | String | |
| `server.saltIterations` | Number of iterations to generate the salt or user password. Changing this setting does not affect stored passwords | Integer | 65536 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `server.eventBusQueueSize` | Size of the queue used as a buffer for unserviced database change events. | Integer | 1000 |
| `server.eventBusMaxPendingBytes` | Maximum number of bytes of change-stream frames that may be outstanding towards a single WebSocket subscriber before it is evicted. Frames are sent asynchronously, so a subscriber that never reads accumulates them in the server's send buffer: the producer-side queue is bounded but a slow consumer is charged to the server's heap, not to its own. Past this cap the subscription is dropped and the channel closed, which is what the client would experience anyway. 0 disables the cap. *Since v26.9.1* | Long | 16777216 |
| `server.wsMaxPendingControlBytes` | Maximum number of bytes of WebSocket request-answer frames - a subscription acknowledgement/error, or an insert-session `started`/`batchAck`/`committed`/error - that may be outstanding towards a single `/ws` connection before it is closed. This bounds the answer side of the connection; `server.eventBusMaxPendingBytes` bounds only the change-stream push frames a client subscribed to. 0 disables the cap. *Since v26.10.1* | Long | 16777216 |
| `server.wsInsertSessionExpireTimeout` | Timeout in seconds for a `/ws` duplex insert session to expire, counted from the latest frame received on it. An expired session is rolled back and the client is told with an unsolicited error frame. Since v26.10.1. | Long | 60 |
| `server.wsMaxControlFrameSize` | Maximum size in bytes of a single text frame accepted on `/ws` before an insert session is started on that connection, and of every binary frame. A larger frame closes the connection with `1009 TOO_BIG` as soon as it crosses the cap. `0` or a negative value restores the unbounded behavior. Since v26.10.1. | Long | 65536 |
| `server.wsMaxInsertFrameSize` | Maximum size in bytes of a single text frame accepted on a `/ws` connection while it has a duplex insert session open. Up to 64 frames may wait per connection, so the per-connection buffering to budget for is this value times 64. `0` or a negative value restores the unbounded behavior. Since v26.10.1. | Long | 16777216 |
| `server.wsMaxInsertChunkRows` | Maximum number of records a single `/ws chunk` frame may carry. A chunk over the cap is refused with an error frame naming the limit and the session stays open, so the client can split its batch and carry on. `0` or a negative value disables the cap. Since v26.10.1. | Integer | 100000 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `server.healthCheck.enabled` | Run the server health monitor: one background thread that samples free disk space on the filesystem holding the databases, available heap, and JVM pause times, and writes a WARNING to the server event log when one of them degrades. Each warning is rate limited - 24h for low disk, 30 minutes for heap and JVM pauses - so a server that stays degraded reports it periodically rather than on every 10-second sample. Read at server start. *Since v26.10.1* | Boolean | true |
| `server.readinessRequiresHA` | When true and HA is active, `/api/v1/ready` also requires the node to have joined the Raft group (a leader has been elected). Default false preserves current readiness behavior. See Health probes. | Boolean | false |
| `server.readinessHAMaxLag` | When `server.readinessRequiresHA` is true, the maximum number of Raft log entries a follower may lag behind the commit index (`commitIndex - lastAppliedIndex`) and still report Ready. Keeps `/api/v1/ready` returning 503 until a (re)joined follower has replayed the committed log, so a rolling restart does not drop the write quorum. See Health probes. | Long | 100 |
| `server.logFormat` | Console log format: `text` (default, human-readable) or `json` (one JSON object per line with correlation fields). Can be set from the server configuration file, `SET SERVER SETTING` or as a `-D` JVM property; an explicit `-D` wins over the configuration file. See Structured logging. *(Honoured outside `-D` since v26.10.1)* | String | text |
| `server.logIncludeTrace` | In text log mode, append `[traceId=…]` to each line while a trace is active. Default false preserves current text output. | Boolean | false |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `server.grpcQueryMaxResultRows` | Hard ceiling on the number of rows the gRPC unary `ExecuteQuery` materializes. A request limit at or below this cap is honored; a result that would exceed it fails the call with `RESOURCE_EXHAUSTED` (consistent with the `StreamQuery` `MATERIALIZE_ALL` path) rather than silently truncating, and a client cannot bypass it with a larger limit. It bounds the unary `ExecuteCommand` the same way (the remote schema reload and every `command()` call of the gRPC client go through it): this ceiling is the default when the request carries no `max_rows`, and a larger `max_rows` cannot bypass it. Bounds heap usage and protects against limitless-query denial-of-service. The default is lower than `server.grpcStreamMaxMaterializedRows` because the unary response is built and returned as a single gRPC message (also bounded by the max message size), whereas `StreamQuery` emits incrementally. Set to `-1` or `0` for unlimited (removes the DoS protection). | Integer | 100000 |
| `server.grpcStreamMaxMaterializedRows` | Maximum number of rows the gRPC `StreamQuery` `MATERIALIZE_ALL` retrieval mode buffers in memory before emitting. Exceeding the cap fails the call with `RESOURCE_EXHAUSTED` so clients fall back to `CURSOR`/`PAGED` streaming instead of running the server out of memory. Set to `-1` or `0` for unlimited (removes the DoS protection). | Integer | 1000000 |
| `server.grpcTimeSeriesMaxResultRows` | Hard ceiling on the number of rows - or aggregation buckets - one gRPC `TimeSeriesQuery` answers with. A request limit at or below this cap is honored; a request limit above it is refused **before the first message** with `RESOURCE_EXHAUSTED`, so a client is never handed a partial series it cannot tell apart from a complete one. Separate from `server.grpcQueryMaxResultRows` because `TimeSeriesQuery` is a server-streaming RPC, so the single-message rationale that keeps the unary ceiling low does not apply to it. The default matches the HTTP twin `POST /api/v1/ts/{database}/query` (`server.httpQueryMaxResultRows`), so the same range is served over both protocols. Set to `-1` or `0` for unlimited (the aggregated path materializes every bucket before emitting any, so this removes its DoS protection; the raw path stays lazy either way). | Integer | 1000000 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| server.grpcStreamWriteTimeoutMs | Maximum time in milliseconds a gRPC StreamQuery worker waits for the client transport to become ready to accept the next batch before aborting the stream. Prevents a slow or abandoned client from pinning the worker thread (and the open ResultSet/transaction) indefinitely. Set to -1 to wait forever (removes the DoS protection). | Long | 60000 |
| serverMetrics | True to enable metrics | Boolean | true |
| serverMetrics.logging | True to enable metrics logging | Boolean | false |
| serverMetrics.prometheus.requireAuthentication | Require authentication on the /prometheus scrape endpoint exposed by the Prometheus metrics plugin (plugin-level key, read by the optional metrics module). Since v26.10.1 the endpoint reads this on every scrape, so a change through SET SERVER SETTING takes effect at once; before that it kept the value it was started with until the server was restarted. | Boolean | true |
| serverMetrics.otlp.enabled | Register an OTLP metrics registry alongside the /prometheus scrape, pushing metrics to serverMetrics.otlp.endpoint. Requires serverMetrics=true. Plugin-level key read by the optional metrics module. See Metrics depth. | Boolean | false |
| serverMetrics.otlp.endpoint | OTLP metrics export endpoint, used when serverMetrics.otlp.enabled=true. Metrics use OTLP/HTTP (port 4318, path /v1/metrics), not gRPC; a URL without a path gets /v1/metrics appended. | String | http://localhost:4318/v1/metrics |
| serverMetrics.otlp.step | How often metrics are pushed to serverMetrics.otlp.endpoint, in milliseconds. Also the window rates and maxima are measured over. Not positive keeps the default of one minute; a positive value below 1000 is raised to 1000. Read when the metrics plugin starts. | Long | 60000 |
| serverMetrics.serviceName | The OpenTelemetry service.name resource attribute reported by the tracing and OTLP metrics plugins. OTEL_SERVICE_NAME, then a service.name entry in OTEL_RESOURCE_ATTRIBUTES, take precedence. Read when the plugins start. Since v26.10.1. | String | arcadedb |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
|---|---|---|---|
| `serverMetrics.tracing.enabled` | Enable OpenTelemetry distributed tracing (requires the optional `tracing` plugin on the classpath, shipped in the `full` distribution). Query/command spans include the statement text as the `db.statement` span attribute, which may contain sensitive data, so secure the OTLP collector endpoint. See Distributed tracing. | Boolean | false |
| `serverMetrics.tracing.endpoint` | OTLP trace export endpoint (gRPC). | String | http://localhost:4317 |
| `serverMetrics.tracing.samplingRate` | Parent-based trace sampling ratio in [0.0,1.0]. `1.0` samples everything, `0.0` disables sampling. | Float | 0.0 |
| `serverMetrics.tracing.excludedPaths` | Comma-separated HTTP request paths that never produce a trace span, matched exactly (query string excluded, one trailing slash ignored, no wildcards). The default leaves out the readiness and health probes. The `arcadedb.http.requests` timer still counts them. An empty string traces every request. Read when the tracing plugin starts. Since v26.10.1. | String | /api/v1/ready, /api/v1/health |
| `studio.enabled` | Force-enable the Studio web tool even when the server runs in `production` mode. In `development` and `test` mode Studio is always served; in `production` mode it is disabled by default and this setting can re-enable it. See how-to/operations/server.pdf | Boolean | false |

**DATABASE**

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
|---|---|---|---|
| `asyncOperationsQueueImpl` | Queue implementation to use between 'standard' and 'fast'. 'standard' consumes less CPU than the 'fast' implementation, but it could be slower with high loads | String | standard |
| `asyncOperationsQueueSize` | Size of the total asynchronous operation queues (it is divided by the number of parallel threads in the pool) | Integer | 1024 |
| `asyncBackPressure` | When the asynchronous queue is full at a certain percentage, back pressure is applied | Integer | 0 |
| `asyncTxBatchSize` | Maximum number of operations to commit in batch by async thread | Integer | 10240 |
| `asyncWorkerThreads` | Number of asynchronous worker threads. By default it is cores minus 1, but at least 1 | Integer | (machine dependent) |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `indexDefaultPageSize` | Default page size in bytes for new plain LSM-tree indexes (not full-text, geo or vector ones) created without an explicit page size (SQL `CREATE INDEX` has no page-size clause). A transaction copies every page it changes, so smaller pages make small write transactions cheaper while larger ones make lookups slightly faster. Existing indexes keep their page size. Minimum is 8192. In a cluster, keep it identical on all the servers. *Since v26.10.1* | Integer | 262144 |
| `bucketDefaultPageSize` | Default page size in bytes for buckets. Default is 65536 | Integer | 65536 |
| `bucketReuseSpaceMode` | Mode used to reuse space in pages. Use 'low' to have faster updates consuming more space on disk, `medium` for balance. Default is 'high'. Applies per database, so `ALTER DATABASE` on one database no longer affects the others *(fixed in v26.10.1)* | String | high |
| `bucketWipeOutOnDelete` | Wipe out record content on delete. If enabled, assures deleted records cannot be analyzed by parsing the raw files and backups will be more compressed, but it also makes deletes a little bit slower | Boolean | true |
| `command.timeout` | Default timeout for commands (in ms). On a cluster, a write a follower forwards to the leader carries the follower database's budget, and the leader enforces that budget in place of its own setting. *(Since v26.10.1: previously the leader enforced its own value, which could differ from the one the follower waited for.)* | Long | 0 |
| `command.warningsEvery` | Reduce warnings in commands to print in console only every X occurrences. Use 0 to disable warnings with commands | Integer | 100 |
| `commitLockTimeout` | Timeout in ms to lock resources during commit. A bulk index build uses `index.buildCommitLockTimeout` instead for its own commits *(since v26.10.1)* | Long | 5000 |
| `explicitLockTimeout` | Timeout in ms to acquire the resources of an explicit `LOCK`. Separate from `commitLockTimeout`, which bounds the locking the engine does for you at commit time *(honoured since v26.10.1)* | Long | 5000 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `cypher.algoMaxWorkingMemory` | Maximum heap, in bytes, that a single `algo.*` procedure call may reserve for its dense working set: walk buffers, embedding matrices, `nodeCount x nodeCount` distance/similarity/neighbor matrices, terminal-pair tables, and (as of v26.9.1) the loaded graph itself (vertex list, RID index, adjacency list). A call over budget is refused before allocating, naming the offending component. Negative means no limit. Default auto-scales with the JVM max heap (1/8 of it, never below 64MB). *Graph load coverage added in v26.9.1* | Long | 64MB (auto-scaled) |
| `opencypher.planCache` | Maximum number of OpenCypher execution plans to keep in cache (frequency-based eviction) | Integer | 300 |
| `opencypher.statementCache` | Maximum number of parsed OpenCypher statements to keep in cache. A statement must be hit twice to be protected from a burst of one-off query texts. Queries that differ only in the values they embed share one entry (see `queryLiteralParameterization`, *since v26.11.1*), so raise this value only if you generate many queries of different shapes. This is the setting that sizes Cypher statement caching; the `cypher.statementCache` that used to be listed here had no reader and was removed in v26.10.1 | Integer | 300 |
| `opencypher.loadCsv.allowFileUrls` | Allow LOAD CSV to access local files via `file:///` URLs and bare file paths. Disable for security in multi-tenant server deployments. In `production` server mode, this is automatically set to `false` if not explicitly configured. See how-to/operations/server.pdf | Boolean | true |
| `opencypher.loadCsv.importDirectory` | Root directory for LOAD CSV `file:///` URLs. When set, file paths are resolved relative to this directory and path traversal (`../`) is blocked. Empty string means no restriction | String | (empty) |
| `dateFormat` | Default date format using Java SimpleDateFormat syntax. Textual fields (month or day names, e.g. `MMM`, `EEE`) always use the English locale, whatever the JVM locale of the server, so every node of a cluster writes and reads the same value (v26.9.1) | String | yyyy-MM-dd |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `dateImplementation` | Default date implementation to use on deserialization. By default java.time.LocalDate is used, but the following are supported: java.util.Calendar, java.util.Date, java.time.LocalDateTime | Class | java.time.LocalDate |
| `dateTimeFormat` | Default date time format using Java SimpleDateFormat syntax. Textual fields always use the English locale, see `dateFormat` | String | yyyy-MM-dd HH:mm:ss |
| `dateTimeImplementation` | Default datetime implementation to use on deserialization. By default java.time.LocalDateTime is used, but the following are supported: java.util.Date, java.util.Calendar, java.time.LocalDateTime, java.time.ZonedDateTime, java.time.Instant. java.util.Date and java.util.Calendar cannot carry sub-millisecond precision, so with them DATETIME_MICROS and DATETIME_NANOS values are returned as java.time.LocalDateTime | Class | class java.time.LocalDateTime |
| `deleteTolerateBrokenChain` | When true, a `DELETE` of a record whose multi-page chunk chain is structurally corrupted removes the record anyway, skipping the index cleanup it cannot read and leaving any unreachable chunks for `CHECK DATABASE FIX` to reclaim. When false (the default) such a delete is refused with a `BrokenChunkChainException` naming the record, so corruption is never removed silently. Genuine transaction conflicts are unaffected by this setting: they keep retrying either way. `CHECK DATABASE FIX` removes a corrupted record regardless of this setting | Boolean | false |
| `freePageRAM` | Percentage (0-100) of memory to free when Page RAM is full | Integer | 50 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `gavCchMaxArcsPerEdge` | Upper bound on the size of a Customizable Contraction Hierarchy (CCH) attached to a Graph Analytical View, as supergraph arcs (edges plus shortcuts) per edge of the routed graph. Road, logistics and utility networks need a small multiple of their edge count; graphs without small separators (social graphs, graphs with supernodes) need far more, and building them would exhaust the heap. A hierarchy that would exceed the bound is not built: the view reports it as `UNSUITABLE` and shortest-path queries keep answering through bidirectional Dijkstra. Graphs small enough to need fewer than 100,000 arcs are always accepted. Each arc costs about 52 bytes of heap (topology plus the directed metric) and 20 more once undirected (`BOTH`) queries are served too, so the worst case at the default is about 830 bytes, or 1.2 KB, per routed edge. See Shortest Paths with Contraction Hierarchies | Integer | 16 |
| `gavPersistCsr` | When true, a Graph Analytical View (GAV/CSR) that is READY (with no pending overlay changes) when the database closes cleanly writes its CSR to disk alongside a freshness certificate (the database's last committed transaction id at build time). If nothing was committed to the database between that close and the next open, the certificate still matches and the persisted CSR is reused as-is instead of being rebuilt by a full graph scan. Any commit in between invalidates the certificate and falls back to the previous behavior: an async rebuild triggered on open. Set to false to disable persisting the CSR file (e.g. to avoid its disk footprint or the extra write at close). See Graph OLAP Engine. *Since v26.9.1* | Boolean | true |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `gavRestoreAwaitTimeout` | Milliseconds `database.open()` blocks waiting for Graph Analytical Views (GAV/CSR) restored from persisted definitions to reach READY before returning. 0 (default) does not wait: when no persisted CSR plausibly applies, the full rebuild is still triggered immediately in the background, but `open()` returns before it completes and queries issued right after run unaccelerated until it does; when a persisted CSR does plausibly apply (see `gavPersistCsr`), nothing is even started at `open()` time as of v26.9.1 - it is deferred to whichever query touches the view first (see Lazy Restore), so the fast path costs nothing for a session that never queries it. A positive value here forces the wait either way, trading a slower `open()` for the restored/rebuilt view being usable by the query that triggered the reopen. See Graph OLAP Engine | Long | 0 |
| `gavQueryRestoreAwaitTimeout` | Milliseconds a query waits, while it is planned or starts, for a Graph Analytical View (GAV/CSR) whose deferred restore from disk is still in flight, so the first count push-down, `MATCH`, shortest path or other graph function after a reopen runs on the restored view instead of reading every record. Covers the SQL and OpenCypher planners and the SQL graph functions; the `algo.*` procedures have their own budget (`gavAlgoRestoreAwaitTimeout`). The wait ends early when the restore finishes, and a view that is only rebuilding after a commit is never waited for. `0` does not wait: the call takes the record path. The wait is not tied to the command timeout, so keep it small. Since v26.11.1. | Long | 5000 |
| `gavAlgoRestoreAwaitTimeout` | Milliseconds a whole-graph algorithm (`algo.wcc`, `algo.pagerank`, `algo.bfs` and the other `algo.*` procedures) waits for a Graph Analytical View whose deferred restore from disk is still in flight, so the first call after a reopen runs on the restored view instead of scanning every record. The wait ends early when the restore finishes or the command timeout expires. `0` does not wait. A command without its own timeout can block for the whole budget, so lower it if such commands must answer quickly. Separate from `gavRestoreAwaitTimeout`, which makes `open()` itself block. Since v26.10.1. | Long | 60000 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `graph.edgeAppendMerge` | At commit, when the only conflict on an edge-list page is concurrent in-chunk edge appends (which commute), re-apply the appends on top of the newer page version instead of failing the whole transaction with a retryable conflict. Removes the retry storm on super-node (hot vertex) edge insertion. See Super-Nodes. | Boolean | true |
| `graph.edgeListInitialChunkSize` | Size in bytes of the first chunk of a vertex's edge list. Each further chunk doubles the previous one up to 8192, so the space a vertex allocates is the sum of that series - a smaller first chunk does not necessarily use less space, it just takes more chunks (each with its own header) to reach the same capacity. The best value follows the degree distribution: around 128 suits an average degree near 10, the default suits very sparse graphs, and above degree 100 the setting barely matters. Values below 32 are clamped. See Lightweight Edges. | Integer | 64 |
| `graph.supernodeThreshold` | Approximate number of edges (per vertex, per direction) after which the vertex's edge list is promoted to the striped super-node layout, spreading further appends over multiple files so concurrent insertions on the same hot vertex do not contend. **Forward-incompatible on first use**: promotion writes a new record type, so once any vertex promotes the database can no longer be opened by older releases; promotion is one-way. Iteration order on promoted vertices is approximate (newest-generation-first) instead of strict reverse-insertion. 0 disables promotion entirely (databases stay fully readable by older releases). See Super-Nodes. | Integer | 4096 |
| `graph.supernodeStripes` | Number of stripes (separate edge-list files) a super-node's edge list is spread over at promotion. The stripes are hosted in a per-type bucket pool of this many files, created once per type at its first promotion (types without super-nodes cost no files). Write parallelism saturates at the number of concurrent writers, so values beyond the CPU cores rarely help. Values below 2 disable promotion entirely. Recorded per vertex at promotion time. See Super-Nodes. | Integer | 16 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
|---|---|---|---|
| `gremlin.engine` | Gremlin engine to use. By default the native `java` engine is used. The `auto` setting uses the legacy `groovy` engine in case parameters are set, otherwise the native `java` one, and is not recommended for security-critical deployments. If you have compatibility issues with gremlin statements that use lambdas or in general, switch to the `groovy` one | String | java |
| `gremlin.client.port` | Port of the Gremlin Server the remote `ArcadeGraph` client connects to. `0` uses the port the server advertises, falling back to `8182`. Set it when the port is reached through a mapping the server does not know about | Integer | 0 |
| `gremlin.timeout` | Default timeout for gremlin commands (in ms). Deprecated | Long | 30000 |
| `index.buildCommitLockTimeout` | Timeout in ms a bulk index build waits for the file locks of one of its commits, replacing `commitLockTimeout` for those commits only. A vector index build commits in chunks, and each of those commits is a step of a build that can cost tens of minutes, so losing one to the interactive timeout discarded the whole build - while the contender it was queued behind was an ordinary commit that would be done in milliseconds. This bounds only how long the build **waits**, never how long it holds a lock, so raising it cannot make any other transaction slower. 0 or less waits indefinitely. The effective value is clamped to be at least `commitLockTimeout`, so setting it lower has no effect. *Since v26.10.1* | Long | 60000 |
| `indexCompactionMinPagesSchedule` | Minimum number of mutable pages for an index to be schedule for automatic compaction. 0 = disabled | Integer | 10 |
| `indexCompactionRAM` | Maximum amount of RAM to use for index compaction, in MB | Long | 300 |
| `initialPageCacheSize` | Initial number of entries for page cache | Integer | 65535 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `vectorIndex.graphBuildCacheSize` | Maximum number of vectors to cache in memory during HNSW graph building. Higher values speed up construction but use more RAM. RAM usage = cacheSize × (dimensions × 4 + 64) bytes. 0 (the default) sizes it automatically: the cache holds the whole corpus when it fits `vectorIndex.graphBuildCacheMaxHeapPercent`, for indexes whose vectors live in the documents (no quantization, or PRODUCT) and, *since v26.10.1*, for inline-quantized ones (INT8/BINARY) as well. Setting an explicit value opts out of that auto-sizing | Integer | 0 |
| `vectorIndex.graphBuildCacheMaxHeapPercent` | Maximum share of the JVM heap the auto-sized graph-build cache may use. Only applies when `vectorIndex.graphBuildCacheSize` is left at 0. A corpus larger than this budget still builds: the cache evicts instead of holding everything. *Since v26.10.1* it is measured against the `-Xmx` ceiling and then capped at 90% of the heap currently available, so the same corpus gets the same cache whether it was ingested into this JVM first or not, while an online rebuild holding the old graph resident still asks for less. Before v26.10.1 it was a share of the available heap only, and did not apply to INT8/BINARY indexes at all. Values above 90 are clamped to 90 | Integer | 25 |
| `vectorIndex.searchCacheSize` | Maximum number of vectors kept in the per-index search cache. The cache is shared by every query on the index and survives across queries, so a working set that fits stays resident instead of being re-read from the documents (or from the quantized index pages) on every beam-search hop. RAM usage = cacheSize × (dimensions × 4 + 64) bytes. 0 (the default) sizes it automatically from the number of indexed vectors, capped by `vectorIndex.searchCacheMaxHeapPercent`. -1 disables the cache entirely | Integer | 0 |
| `vectorIndex.searchCacheMaxHeapPercent` | Upper bound, as a percentage of the JVM heap currently **available** rather than of `-Xmx`, on the RAM an automatically sized per-index search cache may use (see `vectorIndex.searchCacheSize`). Ignored when the cache size is set explicitly. Values above 90 are clamped to 90 | Integer | 25 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `vectorIndex.deltaCacheSize` | Maximum number of vectors written since the last graph rebuild that keep a copy in memory. Every write is appended to a delta buffer so the vector is searchable before it reaches the HNSW graph, and only a rebuild drains that buffer - so an ingest that outruns the rebuilds used to grow a second full copy of the corpus in RAM, which is what made a 4.2M x 768-dimension bulk load run out of memory at `-Xmx16g`. The vector is written to disk before it is buffered, so entries past this cap keep only their identity and the vector is read back from disk when a query needs it. RAM usage = deltaCacheSize × (dimensions × 4 + 64) bytes. 0 (the default) sizes it automatically from `vectorIndex.deltaCacheMaxHeapPercent`. -1 keeps every buffered vector in memory, which is the behaviour before v26.10.1 and is unbounded. Reported by the index statistics as `deltaResidentVectors` and `deltaResidentVectorsCapacity`. *Since v26.10.1* | Integer | 0 |
| `vectorIndex.deltaCacheMaxHeapPercent` | Share of the `-Xmx` ceiling the automatically sized delta buffer cache may use, then capped at 90% of the heap currently available - the same measure `vectorIndex.graphBuildCacheMaxHeapPercent` uses, so a rebuild holding the old graph and an ingest filling the buffer are judged against the same free heap. Ignored when `vectorIndex.deltaCacheSize` is set explicitly. This is a margin rather than a reservation: neither cache reserves heap from the other, and what keeps them in check is that memory one of them keeps lowers the next reading for both. Values above 90 are clamped to 90. *Since v26.10.1* | Integer | 10 |
| `vectorIndex.locationCacheSize` | Maximum number of vector locations to cache in memory per vector index. Set to -1 for unlimited. Each entry uses ~56 bytes. Recommended: 100000 for datasets with 1M+ vectors | Integer | -1 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `vectorIndex.prefilterMaxSelectivity` | Maximum fraction of an index's live vectors that a query's RID allow-list may cover and still resolve the allow-list to its ordinals and score them directly, instead of paying for a `Bits`-filtered HNSW graph walk that gets more expensive, not less, as the allow-list narrows (a filter is only checked once a node is popped from the search beam, so a very selective filter can make the walk expand trying to fill `k` instead of shrinking). Applies to plain k-NN search and to `groupBy` search; see `vectorIndex.prefilterApproximateMaxSelectivity` for the separate threshold the PQ-approximate (zero-disk-I/O) search path uses. Set to 0 to always use the graph walk. *Since v26.9.1* | Float | 0.2 |
| `vectorIndex.prefilterApproximateMaxSelectivity` | The `vectorIndex.prefilterMaxSelectivity` threshold, but for PQ-approximate (zero-disk-I/O) vector search. Kept as a separate, lower setting because PQ scores a candidate from in-memory codes roughly an order of magnitude cheaper than the exact path's page/document read, so its graph walk stays the cheaper option down to a narrower allow-list than the exact path's. Set to 0 to always use the graph walk. *Since v26.9.1* | Float | 0.05 |
| `vectorIndex.mutationsBeforeRebuild` | Number of mutations (inserts/updates/deletes) before rebuilding the HNSW graph index. Higher values reduce rebuild cost but may return slightly stale results. Recommended: 50-200 for read-heavy, 200-500 for write-heavy workloads | Integer | 100 |
| `vectorIndex.rebuildGraphRatio` | Fraction of the current graph size that must accumulate as pending mutations before the HNSW graph is rebuilt, on top of the absolute `vectorIndex.mutationsBeforeRebuild` floor. A rebuild always reindexes the whole graph, so a fixed count makes it cost O(index size) for every few new vectors and turns bulk ingestion quadratic; scaling the threshold with the graph amortizes rebuilds instead. Vectors waiting for the next rebuild stay exactly searchable in memory meanwhile, so a higher ratio trades a slightly longer per-query scan of those vectors for far less rebuild CPU. Set to 0 to use only the absolute threshold | Float | 0.2 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `vectorIndex.maxPendingMutations` | Ceiling on the threshold computed from `vectorIndex.rebuildGraphRatio`. Set to 0 for no ceiling. Being a fixed count, it stops scaling once the ratio-derived threshold reaches it (at the defaults, from 250,000 vectors upward), so past that point the same absolute per-query scan cost lands on an index of any size. `vectorIndex.maxDeltaScanRatio` is the size-independent bound and is the setting to reach for when query latency, rather than rebuild frequency, is what needs protecting. Note that this bounds how often a rebuild is triggered, not how many vectors wait for one: writes keep arriving between rebuilds regardless. What bounds the **memory** those waiting vectors occupy is `vectorIndex.deltaCacheSize`, *since v26.10.1* | Integer | 50000 |
| `vectorIndex.maxDeltaScanRatio` | How much work a query may spend scanning vectors written since the last graph rebuild, as a multiple of the work its graph search already does, before a rebuild is triggered to absorb them. Those vectors are answered by a straight scan, so that part of a query grows with how many are waiting while the graph search it supplements grows only with the logarithm of the index size: at the default `vectorIndex.maxPendingMutations` the scan has been measured at four fifths of query time. The count-based settings cannot bound it, so this one is measured rather than assumed - ArcadeDB records how many nodes its graph searches actually visit and compares the waiting vectors against that. 1.0 lets the scan cost about as much as the search. Lower it for latency-sensitive read-heavy workloads, raise it to rebuild less often, set 0 to disable. A rebuild is only triggered once the scans have also cost as much as the rebuild will, so the extra rebuild CPU this can introduce is bounded by the query CPU it removes. Because it is evaluated when queries run, a write-only workload never triggers it. Reported by the index statistics as `deltaScanBudget`, `deltaScanWorkSinceRebuild` and `deltaScanWorkTarget`. *Since v26.9.1* | Float | 1.0 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `vectorIndex.inactivityRebuildTimeoutMs` | Inactivity timeout in milliseconds before flushing buffered vectors and rebuilding the HNSW graph. When mutations exist but haven't reached the rebuild threshold, a timer starts after the last mutation. On a graph under 1,000 vectors the rebuild is cheap and fires for any pending mutation count; on a larger graph it only fires once pending mutations reach at least 10% of the effective rebuild threshold, so a single stray insert does not force a full graph rebuild. The size compared against is the number of vectors the index holds, not the part of the graph the session has loaded, so an ingest-then-idle process that never queries is gated the same way. *Since v26.10.1* the timer does not fire while a bulk load is open on the database (`GraphBatch`, and therefore `GraphImporter` and the HTTP batch endpoint): a loader that pauses for an index compaction or a garbage collection looks idle to this timer, and the rebuild it used to start covered only the part of the dataset loaded so far and was made obsolete by the rest of the load. The rebuild is now scheduled once, when the load finishes. Set to 0 to disable. Recommended: 10000-30000 for low-volume ingestion | Integer | 15000 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `vectorIndex.rebuildMaxHeapPercent` | Share of the currently **available** heap that an online vector graph rebuild's estimated peak footprint may occupy before the rebuild is deferred instead of attempted. An online rebuild keeps the old graph resident so searches keep working and pays for a full new build's working set on top of it; with no gate it simply attempts the rebuild and dies with an OutOfMemoryError when it does not fit. Since v26.10.1 what keeping the old graph resident costs is measured rather than assumed, so a graph served from pages - the shape after a reopen - is not charged as a second copy of itself in memory, and the available heap it is judged against counts the page read cache as reclaimable: a rebuild that fits only by giving some of it up evicts exactly that shortfall first (oldest pages, across every open database, since the cache is shared) and is still deferred if the cache cannot hand those bytes over. A deferred cycle is not lost: pending vectors stay exactly searchable through the in-memory delta buffer, so the cost is a longer delta scan per query rather than wrong or missing results, and the deferral is logged and counted as `rebuildsDeferredForMemory` in the index statistics. Applies to online rebuilds only - a first build, a rebuild on close, `REBUILD INDEX` and `COMPACT INDEX` are never declined. Since v26.11.1, when the rebuild does not fit beside the in-memory graph, the graph is first swapped for its persisted on-disk copy (searches read it from pages until the new graph is published, counted as `residentGraphDemotions`) and the rebuild is deferred only if it still does not fit. Values above 90 are clamped to 90. Set to 0 to disable the gate. *Since v26.9.1* | Integer | 90 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `vectorIndex.rebuildDeferralCooldownMs` | Minimum time in milliseconds before another online vector graph rebuild may be attempted after one was deferred for lack of heap (see `vectorIndex.rebuildMaxHeapPercent`). A deferral does not consume the pending mutations that triggered it - only a successful build does - so without a cooldown the next search re-triggers it immediately, and since a search checks on every query a large heap-constrained index would spawn a rebuild thread, take the JVM-wide rebuild permit and log a warning once per query. A rebuild that completes clears the cooldown. Set to 0 to retry on the next trigger. *Since v26.9.1* | Integer | 30000 |
| `maxPageRAM` | Maximum amount of pages (in MB) to keep in RAM. When unset it is a quarter of the maximum JVM heap (4096 MB under `-Xmx16g`). A value above 80% of the heap is reduced to half of it | Long | 25% of the max heap |
| `pageFlushQueue` | Size of the asynchronous page flush queue | Integer | 512 |
| `pageSnapshotEnabled` | When true (the default), a full backup, an HA database verify and an HA snapshot ship read a point-in-time image served from a page-level copy-on-write shadow, so writers keep running at full speed for the duration. When false, or when the shadow exceeds `pageSnapshotMaxSize`, they fall back to freezing the data files instead, which throttles every writer until the operation finishes | Boolean | true |
| `pageSnapshotMaxRAM` | Memory budget in MB for the copy-on-write shadow of a single point-in-time window. The shadow only holds the pages **modified** while the window is open, once each, so a short backup on a moderately busy database often never touches the disk at all. Beyond this budget the shadow spills to a scratch file (see `pageSnapshotSpillPath`) | Long | 64 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `pageSnapshotMaxSize` | Hard limit in MB (memory plus spill file) on a single copy-on-write shadow before the window is abandoned and its consumer falls back to freezing the data files. The default `-1` sizes the limit automatically when the window opens: the smaller of the size the page files occupy at that instant - which the shadow provably cannot exceed - and half the space free on the spill volume, but never less than `pageSnapshotMaxRAM`, since that part of the budget never touches the disk. Set a positive value to pin an absolute limit in MB, or `0` for no limit | Long | -1 |
| `pageSnapshotSpillPath` | Directory for the scratch file a copy-on-write shadow spills into once `pageSnapshotMaxRAM` is exhausted. Empty (the default) uses the database directory, where the shadow competes for space with the very files it is protecting. The file is pure scratch: created on demand, deleted when the window closes, and never read by recovery | String | |
| `polyglotCommand.timeout` | Default timeout for polyglot commands (in ms) | Long | 10000 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `queryMaxHeapElementsAllowedPerOp` | Maximum number of elements (records) allowed in a single query for memory-intensive operations (eg. ORDER BY in heap). If exceeded, the query fails with an OCommandExecutionException. Negative number means no limit. In OpenCypher it also bounds the rows a Cartesian product or a hash join of disconnected patterns buffers, `ORDER BY`, `DISTINCT`, `UNION`, the groups of an aggregation, `collect()` and the eager read ahead of a write *(since v26.10.1)*. This setting is intended as a safety measure against excessive resource consumption from a single query (eg. prevent OutOfMemory). A `GROUP BY` computed by a parallel scan checks the limit on each thread and on the final groups, so its peak memory can reach the limit times the number of threads. A SQL time series aggregation (`ts.timeBucket()` with `GROUP BY`) that returns more buckets than this fails instead of exhausting the heap, as the HTTP, gRPC and Grafana time series endpoints already did *(since v26.10.1)*. It also bounds the index the delete of a vertex keeps in heap to find the incoming edges of unidirectional edge types: past it, each delete scans the types instead. This limit bounds one operation of one query; `queryMaxHeapRAM` bounds the heap the buffers of all the running queries hold together | Long | 500000 |
| `parallelScanAbandonedTimeout` | Milliseconds a parallel scan waits for a result set that is neither read nor closed before giving up: the scan then frees its threads and the next read of that result set fails instead of silently returning fewer rows. A query whose `LIMIT` is reached releases its scan at once, without waiting for this timeout, and a result set left open never stalls other queries: they only run less in parallel until it is closed. Raise it for clients that keep cursors open with long pauses. 0 disables the timeout | Long | 600000 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `queryIndexMaxSelectivity` | Share of a type's records above which an index search gives way to a full scan of the type, when the scan runs on one thread. Before loading any record, the matching index entries are read alone: when more of them match than this share of the records the type holds, the rows come from a scan filtered by the same condition, otherwise the matching records are loaded in physical order rather than in key order. A scan split across W workers of a parallel scan gives way sooner, at this share divided by (1 + W) / 2, because the index entries are read by one thread whatever the parallelism: with the default, 60% of the type for a sequential scan, 24% on 4 workers, 6% on 18. Applies, in SQL and OpenCypher, only where the order the rows arrive in cannot show in the result - the statement aggregates them or sorts them with an `ORDER BY` the index does not serve - and where the scan answers the same rows. 0 disables it *(since v26.10.1)* | Float | 0.6 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `queryLiteralParameterization` | When true, the literal values written in a SQL or OpenCypher query are extracted into generated parameters before the statement and plan caches are looked up, so queries that differ only in those values (`··· WHERE id = 12345`, `··· WHERE id = 67890`) share one parsed statement and one execution plan instead of being parsed and planned again for every value. This is what queries generated by an application, a query builder or an LLM (text-to-SQL, text-to-Cypher, GraphRAG tools) typically look like. A literal is extracted only where a parameter means exactly what the literal meant, so the result, its column names and the Java types of its values are the same: the literals of a projection without an alias (the column is named after its text), of `ORDER BY`, `GROUP BY`, `SKIP`, `LIMIT` and `TIMEOUT`, of a SQL `FROM` target, of OpenCypher procedure arguments and of schema statements stay in the text, as do booleans, `null` and empty strings. A query that already uses parameters, or that is run again with the same text, costs the same as before, and the first query of a shape runs as written, so a workload that never repeats a shape pays one parse per query as before. The shared plan is the one built for the second query of the shape, as a plan with parameters is built for the first values it is run with: where values are so skewed that some need a plan of their own, turn the setting off for that database. `EXPLAIN` and `PROFILE` plan the text as written, so they show the values you wrote. A query that itself mentions a name starting with `_lit` is not parameterized. Set to false to key the caches on the exact query text *(since v26.11.1)* | Boolean | true |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `queryParallelScan` | When true, a full scan of a type is read by several threads, for more throughput on multi-core machines: with or without a `WHERE` clause, and with `count`, `sum`, `avg`, `min`, `max` and their `GROUP BY` computed on those threads too, in SQL and in OpenCypher, as is a plain `SELECT DISTINCT` of fields over a type of at least 10,000 records *(since v26.10.1)*. Rows and groups come back in the same order as a sequential scan, but the sum or average of floating-point values may differ in the last digits from one run to the next, as the threads add in no fixed order. A `GROUP BY` of many keys, where every thread would otherwise build its own group for nearly every key, switches to a key exchange once a thread has created a few thousand groups: from then on the rows of the keys that thread does not hold are aggregated in one set of groups shared by the threads and partitioned by key, so each of those keys is held and aggregated once rather than once per thread. This roughly halves the memory such a query reserves from `queryMaxHeapRAM` and makes it faster, and it changes nothing for a `GROUP BY` of few keys. `EXPLAIN`/`PROFILE` reports it on the aggregation step as `N groups by key exchange` *(since v26.11.1)*. Used only outside an explicit transaction | Boolean | true |
| `queryParallelScanMinBuckets` | Minimum number of buckets a type needs for its full scans to run in parallel. A type with fewer buckets is scanned sequentially, unless one of its buckets is large enough to be split in page ranges (see `queryParallelScanPagesPerUnit`) | Integer | 2 |
| `queryParallelScanPagesPerUnit` | Minimum number of pages of the unit of work a parallel scan cuts a bucket in: a bucket of at least twice as many pages is read by several threads, each on a range of its pages, so a type with a single bucket (the default) is scanned in parallel too. 0 disables the split: each bucket is then read by one thread *(since v26.10.1)* | Integer | 32 |
| `queryParallelScanMaxBatchBytes` | Maximum bytes of record content one batch of a parallel scan holds in memory. The parallel scan reads records on its worker threads and hands them over in batches of up to 256 rows; with large records this bound closes a batch earlier. 0 or a negative value removes the bound (row count only) *(since v26.10.1)* | Long | 16777216 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `queryBatchMaxBytes` | Maximum bytes a scan of a bucket reads ahead of the query in one batch. A scan prefetches up to 1,024 records per bucket; with records that span several pages (a vertex with a big nested document) that is a lot of memory no query budget accounts for, and many concurrent queries could exhaust the heap. The batch ends once the bytes it copied out of the pages reach this size, whatever the record count (records that fit their own page are views of the cached page and are not counted). The limit also shrinks as running queries take the heap budget (see `queryMaxHeapRAM`): a scan reads ahead at most a sixty-fourth of what is left of it, down to one record at a time. The shares of the pool and of the budget are read once per batch and are not reservations, so the worst case is the number of scans running times the buckets each reads times the smaller of this setting and a sixty-fourth of what is left of the budget. A batch always holds at least one record. The `low-ram` profile sets it to 200KB. A scan that read under this pressure is slower for it, and says so: `PROFILE` marks its step with `[read-ahead reduced in N batches by memory pressure]` and the profiler counts it as `queryHeapScanShrinks`. 0 or a negative value removes the bound and the shrinking *(since v26.11.1)* | Long | 1048576 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `queryScanReadAheadMaxRAM` | Maximum memory (in MB) the scans of all the queries running in the JVM may hold read ahead at once, across every bucket of every database. `queryBatchMaxBytes` bounds the batch of one scan; this limit bounds the sum of all of them, so many concurrent scans cannot hold that many times the bound. Each scan starts with its full batch and reads less as the pool fills (a thirty-second of what is left of it), down to one record at a time. The limit is soft: a batch always holds at least one record, and its bytes are reserved after it is read, so scans that start together can each read a full batch before any of them reserves (the pool can overshoot by about the number of scans times `queryBatchMaxBytes`), and a single record larger than `queryBatchMaxBytes` is still read whole. The bytes go back to the pool when a batch is handed over, and, for a scan the application abandoned, when the garbage collector reclaims it. The pool is reported by the profiler as `scanReadAheadReserved`, `scanReadAheadReservedPeak` and `scanReadAheadLimit`. 0 or a negative value disables the pool. The `low-ram` profile sets it to 16 *(since v26.11.1)* | Long | 200 |
| `schemaBulkDDLScript` | Runs a SQL script of two or more statements that are ALL schema definition DDL (`CREATE TYPE`, `CREATE PROPERTY`, `CREATE INDEX` on a type the script creates, ...) as one schema session, so the schema file is written once for the whole script instead of once per statement and, under HA, the batch is replicated as one Raft entry. The database write lock is held for the whole script instead of once per statement; under HA a leader commit waits for the session at most `ha.quorumTimeout` before proceeding, so keep such scripts short. There is no rollback: if a statement fails, the ones before it stay applied and are published. A script that mixes in other statements (DML, `REBUILD`, `TRUNCATE`, `REFRESH`, `COMPACT INDEX`, materialized views, repartitioning, an index on a type that already existed) runs one session per statement regardless. Set to `false` to always use one session per statement. See reference/sql/sql-script.pdf and reference/storage.pdf. *(Since v26.10.1)* | Boolean | true |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `sql.letSubqueryCacheSize` | Maximum number of distinct outer values whose result a per-record LET subquery (`SELECT ⋯ LET $x = (SELECT ⋯)`) remembers within one execution of the query. When many rows feed the subquery the same values (rows sharing one parent, office or category), it runs once per distinct value instead of once per row. The subquery is keyed on the outer values it actually reads, including a single field read as `$parent.$current.<field>`. Subqueries calling non-deterministic or user-defined functions, or that are not read-only, are never cached, and any change to the database drops the cache. Results larger than 1000 rows are not cached. 0 disables the cache *(since v26.10.1)* | Integer | 128 |
| `sql.maxExpressionDepth` | Maximum nesting depth of parentheses, brackets, braces (map and JSON literals) and `CASE` expressions allowed in a single SQL statement (since v26.10.1 also brackets, braces and `CASE`). A query past the limit is refused at parse time, which stops a deeply nested expression from tying up a worker thread for a very long time. Raise it for one database with `ALTER DATABASE` when a legitimately deep query needs it *(the per-database value is actually read since v26.10.1; before that only the server-wide value had any effect)* | Integer | 200 |
| `cypher.maxExpressionDepth` | The same limit for OpenCypher, covering nested parentheses, list and map literals, function arguments, pattern parentheses, `CALL`/`EXISTS`/`COUNT`/`COLLECT` subqueries (all counted together), and the length of a chain of `AND`/`OR` terms *(per-database since v26.10.1, see `sql.maxExpressionDepth`)* | Integer | 200 |
| `cypher.maxClauses` | Maximum number of clauses (`MATCH`, `WITH`, `CREATE`, ...) in one OpenCypher query or subquery body. A longer chain is refused at parse time, because it would otherwise exhaust the thread stack while the query runs. Each `UNION` branch counts on its own. A value below 1 falls back to the default *(since v26.10.1)* | Integer | 500 |
| `sqlStatementCache` | Maximum number of parsed statements to keep in cache. A statement must be hit twice to be protected from a burst of one-off query texts. Statements that differ only in the values they embed share one entry (see `queryLiteralParameterization`, *since v26.11.1*), so raise this value only if you generate many statements of different shapes | Integer | 300 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| `timeSeriesDecodedBlockCacheRAM` | Memory budget, in MB and **per shard**, for keeping decoded TimeSeries data in memory so that reading the same compacted block twice decodes it once. This is what makes a repeated query - a dashboard polling the latest point of a host, for example - answer without re-reading and re-decoding the block it already read. Since the budget is per shard, the worst case for one type is this value times its `SHARDS`, and it is only reached by queries that actually touch that many distinct blocks. A shard sizes its cache when it is opened, so changing this on a running database applies to shards opened afterwards; reopen the database to apply it everywhere. Set to 0 to disable caching. Left at the default it scales with the JVM maximum heap (heap/512, never below 4MB) | Long | (auto) |
| `txRetries` | Number of retries in case of MVCC exception | Integer | 3 |
| `txRetryDelay` | Cap, in milliseconds, on the random wait before the next transaction retry: an exponential backoff with full jitter, drawn from `1` to `min(txRetryDelay, txRetryDelayBase * 2^attempt)`. Helpful in case of high concurrency on the same pages (multi-thread insertion over the same bucket). Applied by the embedded `transaction()`, by `COMMIT RETRY` and, since v26.10.1, by the remote `RemoteDatabase.transaction()` too. Since v26.11.1 it is also applied between the replays of an asynchronous batch commit that hit a conflict. 0 disables the delay | Integer | 100 |
| `txRetryDelayBase` | Starting size, in milliseconds, of the transaction retry backoff window, doubled on each further attempt up to `txRetryDelay` | Integer | 2 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
|---|---|---|---|
| txStaleReadCheck | Refuses, with a retryable ConcurrentModificationException, a property write on a record read in the current transaction when another transaction committed a change to that record in between, so a value computed from the older read can never overwrite the concurrent change (a lost update under READ_COMMITTED). Adding or removing edges on a vertex is never refused. Only direct property assignment and removal is checked, not an in-place change to a list, map or embedded document got from the record. SQL UPDATE and Cypher SET/MERGE/REMOVE already compute their values from the latest data and are not affected. Set to false to restore the previous last-writer-wins behavior *(since v26.10.1)* | Boolean | true |
| txWAL | Uses the WAL | Boolean | true |
| txWalFiles | Number of concurrent files to use for tx log. 0 or a negative value = available cores, which is also the default | Integer | (machine dependent) |
| txWalFlush | Flushes the WAL on disk at commit time. It can be 0 = no flush, 1 = flush without metadata and 2 = full flush (fsync). In production server mode, this is automatically set to 1 if not explicitly configured. See concepts/transactions.pdf | Integer | 0 |
| typeDefaultBuckets | Default number of buckets to create per type | Integer | 1 |

**Available Plugins**

| Name | server.plugins-String |
|---|---|
| Gremlin | GremlinServer:com.arcadedb.server.gremlin.GremlinServerPlugin |
| gRPC | gRPC:com.arcadedb.server.grpc.GrpcServerPlugin |
| MongoDB | MongoDB:com.arcadedb.mongo.MongoDBProtocolPlugin |
| Postgres | Postgres:com.arcadedb.postgres.PostgresProtocolPlugin |
| Prometheus | Prometheus:com.arcadedb.metrics.prometheus.PrometheusMetricsPlugin |
| Redis | Redis:com.arcadedb.redis.RedisProtocolPlugin |

**gRPC**

The gRPC server is implemented by the GrpcServerPlugin, which is bundled in the full distribution

but **not started by default**. To enable it, register the plugin in `server.plugins` (see available plugins):

```
-Darcadedb.server.plugins=gRPC:com.arcadedb.server.grpc.GrpcServerPlugin
```

Once enabled, the server listens on port `50051` by default. Since v26.11.1 every `grpc.` setting below is a registered server setting, so it can be supplied in the server configuration file, as an environment variable or as a JVM system property (`-Darcadedb.grpc.`). Before that, only `grpc.port` was, and the others worked as system properties only: a `grpc.tls.enabled` written in the configuration file was ignored and the endpoint stayed in cleartext. An invalid `grpc.mode` now makes the server refuse to start instead of starting no listener. The `server.plugins` setting itself is a standard server setting and can be supplied the same ways.

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
|---|---|---|---|
| `grpc.enabled` | Start the gRPC server when the plugin is registered. Set to `false` to keep the plugin loaded but the listener stopped | Boolean | true |
| `grpc.port` | Port for the standard gRPC server. A registered server setting since v26.9.1 (so it is also resolved from environment variables and listed in the settings API), because HA reads it to advertise a peer's gRPC endpoint - see the `grpc` field of `arcadedb.ha.serverList` | Integer | 50051 |
| `grpc.host` | Host/interface to bind to: every local address the name resolves to. Applies to the standard server only; the xDS server (mode `xds` or `both`) has no host setting and listens on every interface. Before 26.11.1 the setting was read but never applied | String | 0.0.0.0 |
| `grpc.mode` | Server mode: `standard`, `xds`, or `both` | String | standard |
| `grpc.xds.port` | Port for the xDS server (used when `grpc.mode` is `xds` or `both`) | Integer | 50052 |
| `grpc.tls.enabled` | Enable TLS for the gRPC server. Only `true` or `false` are accepted: any other value (for example `yes`) makes the server refuse to start instead of running without TLS | Boolean | false |
| `grpc.tls.cert` | Path to the TLS certificate chain file (required when `grpc.tls.enabled=true`) | String | (none) |
| `grpc.tls.key` | Path to the TLS private key file (required when `grpc.tls.enabled=true`) | String | (none) |
| `grpc.maxMessageSize` | Maximum inbound message size, in MB | Integer | 100 |

| Name | Description | Type | Default Value |
|---|---|---|---|
| `grpc.reflection.enabled` | Enable the gRPC server reflection service (used by tools such as `grpcurl`) | Boolean | true |
| `grpc.health.enabled` | Enable the standard gRPC health-checking service | Boolean | true |
| `grpc.compression.enabled` | Understand compressed requests and offer compression. When `false` the endpoint answers `UNIMPLEMENTED` to a compressed request, never compresses a response, and `grpc.compression.force` is ignored with a warning *(since v26.11.1)* | Boolean | true |
| `grpc.compression.force` | Force compression on all outbound messages, to a client that accepts the codec. Needs `grpc.compression.enabled=true` | Boolean | false |
| `grpc.compression.type` | Compression algorithm used when `grpc.compression.force=true` | String | gzip |

In addition to the plugin-level keys above, the gRPC service honors four registered SERVER settings that bound result materialization and protect against limitless or slow clients pinning worker threads and exhausting heap: `server.grpcQueryMaxResultRows`, `server.grpcTimeSeriesMaxResultRows`, `server.grpcStreamMaxMaterializedRows`, and `server.grpcStreamWriteTimeoutMs` (see the SERVER settings table). Unlike the `grpc.*` keys, these are standard server settings and can be supplied as JVM system properties or environment variables.

# 12.3. SQL Syntax

ArcadeDB Query Language is an SQL dialect.

This page lists all the details about its syntax.

**Comments**

Comments in the ArcadeDB SQL scripts can be C-Style block comments, which are enclosed by `/*` and `*/`,

```
/* This is a single-line comment */

/* This is a multi-
   line comment */
```

as well as classic SQL end of line comments, started by `--` (note the space after the two dashes),

```
SELECT true; -- This is an end of line comment
```

### Identifiers

An identifier is a name that identifies an entity in ArcadeDB schema. Identifiers can refer to

- type names
- property names
- index names
- aliases
- bucket names
- method names
- named parameters
- variable names (LET)

An identifier is a sequence of characters delimited by back-ticks `. Examples of valid identifiers are

- `` `surname` ``
- `` `name and surname` ``
- `` `foo.bar` ``
- `` `a + b` ``
- `` `select` ``

The back-tick character can be used as a valid character for identifiers, but it has to be escaped with a backslash, eg.

- `` `foo \` bar` ``

The following are reserved identifiers, they can NEVER be used with a different meaning (upper or lower case):

- `@rid`: record ID
- `@type`: document type
- `@cat`: type category
- `@props`: property types
- `@in`: incoming edges
- `@out`: outgoing edges
- `@this`: current record
- `@size`: current record size

### Simplified identifiers

Identifiers that start with a letter or with `$` and that contain only numbers, letters and underscores, can be written without back-tick quoting. Reserved words cannot be used as simplified identifiers. Valid simplified identifiers are

- `name`
- `name_and_surname`
- `$foo`
- `name_12`

Examples of INVALID queries for wrong identifier syntax

```
/* INVALID - `from` is a reserved keyword */
SELECT from from from
/* CORRECT */
SELECT `from` from `from`

/* INVALID - simplified identifiers cannot start with a number */
SELECT name as 1name from Foo
/* CORRECT */
SELECT name as `1name` from Foo

/* INVALID - simplified identifiers cannot contain `-` character, `and` is a reserved
keyword */
SELECT name-and-surname from Foo
/* CORRECT 1 - `name-and-surname` is a single field name */
SELECT `name-and-surname` from Foo
/* CORRECT 2 - `name`, `and` and `surname` are numbers and the result is the
subtraction */
SELECT name-`and`-surname from Foo
/* CORRECT 2 - with spaces  */
SELECT name - `and` - surname from Foo

/* INVALID - wrong back-tick escaping */
SELECT `foo`bar` from Foo
/* CORRECT */
SELECT `foo\`bar` from Foo
```

**Case sensitivity**

In current version, type names are case **insensitive**, all the other identifiers are case sensitive, particularly also bucket names.

**Reserved words**

In ArcadeDB SQL the following are reserved words

- AFTER
- AND
- AS
- ASC
- BATCH

- BEFORE
- BETWEEN
- BREADTH_FIRST
- BY
- BUCKET
- CONSOLE
- CONTAINS
- CONTAINSALL
- CONTAINSKEY
- CONTAINSTEXT
- CONTAINSVALUE
- CREATE
- DEFAULT
- DEFINED
- DELETE
- DEPTH_FIRST
- DESC
- DISTINCT
- DOCUMENT
- EDGE
- ERROR
- FROM
- ILIKE
- IN
- INCREMENT
- INSERT
- INSTANCEOF
- INTO
- IS
- LET
- LIKE
- LIMIT
- MATCH
- MATCHES
- MAXDEPTH

- NOCACHE
- NOT
- NULL
- OR
- PARALLEL
- POLYMORPHIC
- RETRY
- RETURN
- SELECT
- SKIP
- STRATEGY
- TIMEOUT
- TRAVERSE
- UNSAFE
- UNWIND
- UPDATE
- UPSERT
- VERTEX
- WAIT
- WHERE
- WHILE

**Base types**

Accepted base types in ArcadeDB SQL are:

- **integer numbers**:

Valid integers are

```
(32bit)
1
12345678
-45

(64bit)
1L
12345678L
-45L
```

- **floating point numbers**: single or double precision

Valid floating point numbers are:

```
(double precision, the default)
1.5
12345678.65432
-45.0
0.23D
.23D

(single precision)
1.5F
-45.0f
```

- **absolute precision, decimal numbers**: like BigDecimal in Java

Convert a string with the `asDecimal()` method (e.g. `'124.4'.asDecimal()`) to explicitly instantiate an absolute precision number.

- **strings**: delimited by `'` or by `"`. Single quotes, double quotes and back-slash inside strings can escaped using a back-slash

Valid strings are:

```
"foo bar"
'foo bar'
"foo \" bar"
'foo \' bar'
'foo \\ bar'
```

- **booleans**: boolean values are case sensitive

Valid boolean values are

```
true
false
```

Boolean value constants are case insensitive, so also `TRUE`, `True` and so on are valid.

- **links**: A link is a pointer to a document in the database

In SQL a link is represented as follows (short and extended notation):

```
#<bucket-id>:<bucket-position>

or

{"@rid": "#<bucket-id>:<bucket-position>"}
```

eg.

```
#12:15

or

{"@rid": "#12:15"}
```

The bracket notation is mandatory inside JSON, as the short notation is not a valid value in JSON.

The extended notation can hold any expression, a parameter included: `WHERE @rid = {"@rid": ?}` selects the record whose RID is bound to the parameter, exactly like `WHERE @rid = ?`. Since v26.11.1 this form is resolved like the others when the statement is planned; earlier versions failed it with `Cannot convert to RID` (or a `NullPointerException` for a parameter) in a `WHERE @rid = ⋯` condition, while accepting it in `@rid IN [⋯]`.

- **null**: case insensitive (for consistency with IS NULL and IS NOT NULL conditions, that are case insensitive)

Valid null expressions include

```
NULL
null
Null
nUll
...
```

**Numbers**

ArcadeDB can store five different types of numbers

- Integer: 32bit signed
- Long: 64bit signed
- Float: decimal 32bit signed
- Double: decimal 64bit signed
- BigDecimal: absolute precision

**Integers** are represented in SQL as plain numbers, eg. `123`. If the number represented exceeds the Integer maximum size (see Java java.lang.Integer `MAX_VALUE` and `MIN_VALUE`), then it's automatically converted to a Long.

When an integer is saved to a schemaful property of another numerical type, it is automatically converted.

**Longs** are represented in SQL as numbers with `L` suffix, eg. `123L` (L can be uppercase or lowercase). Plain numbers (without L prefix) that exceed the Integer range are also automatically converted to Long. If the number represented exceeds the Long maximum size (see Java java.lang.Long

MAX_VALUE and MIN_VALUE), then the statement fails with a parsing error (Invalid integer);

Integer and Long numbers can be represented in base 10 (decimal), 8 (octal) or 16 (hexadecimal):

- decimal: ["-"] ("0" | ( ("1"-"9") ("0"-"9")* ) ["l"|"L"], eg.
- 15, 15L
- -164
- 999999999999
- octal: ["-"] "0" ("0"-"7")+ ["l"|"L"], eg.
- 01, 01L (equivalent to decimal 1)
- 010, 010L (equivalent to decimal 8)
- -065, -065L (equivalent to decimal 53)
- hexadecimal: ["-"] "0" ("x"|"X") ("0"-"9"," a"-"f", "A"-"F")+ ["l"|"L"], eg.
- 0x1, 0X1, 0x1L (equivalent to 1 decimal)
- 0x10 (equivalent to decimal 16)
- 0xff, 0xFF (equivalent to decimal 255)
- -0xff, -0xFF (equivalent to decimal -255)

**Float** numbers are represented in SQL as [-][<number>].<number>F (F can be uppercase or lowercase), eg. valid Float values are 1.5f, -1567.0F, .556767F. If the number represented exceeds the Float maximum size (see Java java.lang.Float MAX_VALUE and MIN_VALUE), then the result is infinity.

**Double** numbers are represented in SQL as [-][<number>].<number>[D] (D can be uppercase or lowercase and is optional), eg. valid Double values are 1.5, -1567.0, .556767, 1.5d, -1567.0D, .556767D. A floating point literal written without a suffix is a Double: this is what 0.05 means in a comparison against a DOUBLE or DECIMAL property, and writing it as a single precision Float instead would move it to 0.05000000074505806 and silently exclude every record holding exactly 0.05. If the number represented exceeds the Double maximum size (see Java java.lang.Double MAX_VALUE and MIN_VALUE), then the result is NULL

before v26.10.1 a floating point literal with no suffix was parsed as a single precision Float, so WHERE discount >= 0.05 on a DOUBLE property returned the same records as WHERE discount > 0.05. Add the F suffix to any literal that has to keep the old single precision meaning.

a suffix-less literal with 18 or more significant digits that a Double cannot hold exactly (for example 12345678901234567890.123456789012345678) is kept as an exact DECIMAL value, so it is stored and compared without losing digits. Up to 17 digits it stays a Double. A comparison between a DOUBLE property and such a literal is exact, and the result of doubleProp * <long literal> is a DECIMAL. Add the D suffix to force a Double.

Float and Double numbers can be represented as decimal, decimal with exponent, hexadecimal and hexadecimal with exponent. Here is the full syntax:

```
FLOATING_POINT_LITERAL: ["-"] ( <DECIMAL_FLOATING_POINT_LITERAL> |
<HEXADECIMAL_FLOATING_POINT_LITERAL> )

DECIMAL_FLOATING_POINT_LITERAL:
      (["0"-"9"])+ "." (["0"-"9"])* (<DECIMAL_EXPONENT>)? (["f","F","d","D"])?
      | "." (["0"-"9"])+ (<DECIMAL_EXPONENT>)? (["f","F","d","D"])?
      | (["0"-"9"])+ <DECIMAL_EXPONENT> (["f","F","d","D"])?
      | (["0"-"9"])+ (<DECIMAL_EXPONENT>)? ["f","F","d","D"]

DECIMAL_EXPONENT: ["e","E"] (["+","-"])? (["0"-"9"])+

HEXADECIMAL_FLOATING_POINT_LITERAL:
        "0" ["x", "X"] (["0"-"9","a"-"f","A"-"F"])+ (".")? <HEXADECIMAL_EXPONENT>
(["f","F","d","D"])?
      | "0" ["x", "X"] (["0"-"9","a"-"f","A"-"F"])* "." (["0"-"9","a"-"f","A"-"F"])+
<HEXADECIMAL_EXPONENT> (["f","F","d","D"])?

HEXADECIMAL_EXPONENT: ["p","P"] (["+","-"])? (["0"-"9"])+
```

Eg. - base 10 - `0.5` - `0.5f`, `0.5F`, `2f` (ATTENTION, this is NOT hexadecimal) - `0.5d`, `0.5D`, `2D` (ATTENTION, this is NOT hexadecimal) - `3.21e2d` equivalent to `3.21 * 10^2 = 321` - base 16 - `0x3p4d` equivalent to `3 * 2^4 = 48` - `0x3.5p4d` equivalent to `3.5(base 16) * 2^4`

**BigDecimal** in ArcadeDB is represented as a Java BigDecimal. The instantiation of BigDecimal can be done explicitly, using the `asDecimal()` method, eg. `'124.4'.asDecimal()`

**Mathematical operations**

Mathematical Operations with numbers follow these rules:

- Operations are calculated from left to right, following the operand priority.
- When an operation involves two numbers of different type, both are converted to the higher precision type between the two.

Eg.

```
15 + 20L = 15L + 20L     // the 15 is converted to 15L

15L + 20 = 15L + 20L     // the 20 is converted to 20L

15 + 20.3 = 15.0 + 20.3     // the 15 is converted to 15.0

15.0 + 20.3D = 15.0D + 20.3D     // the 15.0 is converted to 15.0D
```

an Integer operation that exceeds the Integer range is promoted to Long (`2147483647 + 1` returns `2147483648`, where Java would wrap around), while a Long operation that exceeds the Long range fails with an `ArithmeticErrorException: long overflow` (Java would wrap around silently).

The conversion of a string to BigDecimal can be done explicitly, using the `asDecimal()` method, eg. `'124.4'.asDecimal()`

**Collections**

ArcadeDB supports one type of collection:

- **Lists**: ordered, allow duplicates

The SQL notation allows to create `Lists` with square bracket notation, eg.

```
[1, 3, 2, 2, 4]
```

For OrientDB compatibility, the `.asSet()` method is available to remove duplicates from a `List`:

```
[1, 3, 2, 2, 4].asSet() = [1, 3, 2, 4] -- The order of the elements in the resulting
set is not guaranteed
```

**Binary data**

ArcadeDB can store binary data (byte arrays) in document fields. There is no native representation of binary data in SQL syntax, insert/update a binary field you have to use `decode(<base64string>, "base64")` function.

To obtain the base64 string representation of a byte array, you can use the function `encode(<byteArray>, "base64")`

**Expressions**

Expressions can be used as:

- single projections
- operands in a condition
- items in a GROUP BY
- items in an ORDER BY
- right argument of a LET assignment

Valid expressions are:

- `<base type value>` (string, number, boolean)
- `<field name>`
- `<@attribute name>`
- `<function invocation>`
- `<expression> <binary operator> <expression>`: for operator precedence, see below table.
- `<unary operator> <expression>`

- `( <expression> )`: expression between parenthesis, for precedences
- `( <query> )`: query between parenthesis
- `[ <expression> (, <expression>)* ]`: a list, an ordered collection that allows duplicates, eg. `["a", "b", "c"]`)
- `{ <expression>: <expression> (, <expression>: <expression>)* }`: the result is a map, with `<field>:<value>` values, eg. `{"a":1, "b": 1+2+3, "c": foo.bar.size() }`. The key name is converted to a string if it is not
- `<expression> <modifier> ( <modifier> )*`: a chain of modifiers (see below)
- `<json>`: is translated to a map, nested JSON is allowed and is translated to nested maps
- `<expression> IS NULL`: check for null value of an expression
- `<expression> IS NOT NULL`: check for non null value of an expression

**Modifiers**

A modifier can be - a dot-separated field chain, eg. `foo.bar`. Dot notation is used to navigate relationships and document fields. eg.

```
john = {
          name: "John",
          surname: "Jones",
          address: {
             city: {
                name: "London"
             }
          }
       }

john.address.city.name = "London"
```

- a method invocation, eg. `foo.size()`.

Method invocations can be chained, eg. `foo.toLowerCase().substring(2, 4)`

- a square bracket filter, eg. `foo[1]` or `foo[name = 'John']`

**Square bracket filters**

Square brackets can be used to filter collections or maps.

`field[ ( <expression> | <range> | <condition> ) ]`

Based on what is between brackets, the square bracket filtering has different effects:

- `<expression>`: If the expression returns an Integer or Long value (i), the result of the square bracket filtering is the i-th element of the collection/map. If the result of the expression (K) is not a number, the filtering returns the value corresponding to the key K in the map field. If the field is not a collection/map, the square bracket filtering returns `null`. The result of this filtering is

ALWAYS a single value.

- `<range>`: A range is something like `M..N` or `M⋯N` where M and N are integer/long numbers, eg. `fieldName[2..5]`. The result of range filtering is a collection that is a subet of the original field value, containing all the items from position M (included) to position N (excluded for `..`, included for `⋯`). Eg. if `fieldName = ['a', 'b', 'c', 'd', 'e']`, `fieldName[1..3] = ['b', 'c']`, `fieldName[1⋯3] = ['b', 'c', 'd']`. Ranges start from `0`. The result of this filtering is ALWAYS a list (ordered collection, allowing duplicates). If the original collection was ordered, then the result will preserve the order.
- `<condition>`: A normal SQL condition, that is applied to each element in the `fieldName` collection. The result is a sub-collection that contains only items that match the condition. Eg. `fieldName = [{foo = 1},{foo = 2},{foo = 5},{foo = 8}]`, `fieldName[foo > 4] = [{foo = 5},{foo = 8}]`. The result of this filtering is ALWAYS a list (ordered collection, allowing duplicates). If the original collection was ordered, then the result will preserve the order.

#### Nested projections

Colon prefixed curly braces can be used to project maps or JSON documents.

```
map:{ ( * | (([!]<identifier>[*] | <expression>) [AS <identifier>] [,*] ) }
```

As for projections in the `SELECT` statement, nested projection consist of a comma separated list of projections.

#### Conditions

A condition is an expression that returns a boolean value.

An expression that returns something different from a boolean value is always evaluated to `false`.

#### Comparison Operators

- `=` **(equals)**: If used in an expression, it is the boolean equals (eg. `select from Foo where name = 'John'`. If used in an SET section of INSERT/UPDATE statements or on a LET statement, it represents a variable assignment (eg. `insert into Foo set name = 'John'`)
- `==` **(equals)**: same as `=`
- `<=>` **(null-safe equals)**
- `!=` **(not equals)**: inequality operator.
- `<>` **(not equals)**: same as `!=`
- `>` **(greater than)**
- `>=` **(greater or equal)**
- `<` **(less than)**
- `<=` **(less or equal)**

#### Math Operators

- `+` **(plus)**: addition if both operands are numbers, string concatenation (with string conversion) if one of the operands is not a number. The order of calculation (and conversion) is from left to

right, eg `'a' + 1 + 2 = 'a12'`, `1 + 2 + 'a' = '3a'`. It can also be used as a unary operator (no effect).

- `-` **(minus)**: subtraction between numbers. Non-number operands are evaluated to zero. Null values are treated as a zero, eg `1 - null = 1`. Minus can also be used as a unary operator, to invert the sign of a number. Between a date/time value and another date/time value, `-` returns the `Duration` between the two. A date/time value minus `null` (or a missing field) returns the date/time value unchanged; `null` minus a date/time value returns `null`.
- `*` **(multiplication)**: multiplication between numbers. If one of the operands is null, the multiplication will evaluate to null.
- `/` **(division)**: division between numbers. If one of the operands is null, the division will evaluate to null. Integer, long and decimal division (and modulo) by zero fail with an `ArithmeticErrorException`, while a double division by zero returns `Infinity`.

  Integer division that does not come out even produces a floating point result, so `10 / 4` is `2.5`, not `2`.

  When either operand is a `DECIMAL` or a big integer, the division is exact: the result keeps as many decimals as it needs, and never fewer than the left operand had. So `1 / 2` is `0.5` and `10.00 / 2.00` is `5.00`. A division with no exact result, such as `1 / 3`, is rounded to 34 significant digits.

- `%` **(modulo)**: modulo between numbers. If one of the operands is null, the modulo will evaluate to null.
- `>>` **(bitwise right shift)**: shifts bits on the right operand by a number of positions equal to the right operand. Eg. `8 >> 2 = 2`. Both operands have to be Integer or Long values, otherwise the result will be null.
- `>>>` **(unsigned bitwise right shift)** The same as `>>`, but with negative numbers it will fill with `1` on the left. Both operands have to be Integer or Long values, otherwise the result will be null.
- `[` **(bitwise right shift)** shifts bits on the left, eg. `2 [ 2 = 8`. Both operands have to be Integer or Long values, otherwise the result will be null.
- `&` **(bitwise AND)** executes a bitwise AND operation. Both operands have to be Integer or Long values, otherwise the result will be null.
- `|` **(bitwise OR)** executes a bitwise OR operation. Both operands have to be Integer or Long values, otherwise the result will be null.
- `^` **(bitwise XOR)** executes a bitwise XOR operation. Both operands have to be Integer or Long values, otherwise the result will be null.
- `||`: array concatenation (see below for details).

**Math Operators precedence**

| type | Operators |
|---|---|
| multiplicative | * / % |
| additive | + - |
| shift | [ >> >>> |

| type | Operators |
|---|---|
| bitwise AND | `&` |
| bitwise exclusive OR | `^` |
| bitwise inclusive OR | `\|` |
| array concatenation | `\|\|` |

**Math + Assign operators**

These operators can be used in UPDATE statements to update and set values. The semantics is the same as the operation plus the assignment, eg. `a += 2` is just a shortcut for `a = a + 2`.

- `+=` **(add and assign)**: adds right operand to left operand and assigns the value to the left operand. Returns the final value of the left operand. If one of the operands is not a number, then this operator acts as a `concatenate string values and assign`
- `-=` **(subtract and assign)**: subtracts right operand from left operand and assigns the value to the left operand. Returns the final value of the left operand
- `*=` **(multiply and assign)**: multiplies left operand and right operand and assigns the value to the left operand. Returns the final value of the left operand
- `/=` **(divide and assign)**: divides left operand by right operand and assigns the value to the left operand. Returns the final value of the left operand
- `%=` **(modulo and assign)**: calculates left operand modulo right operand and assigns the value to the left operand. Returns the final value of the left operand

**Array concatenation**

The `||` operator concatenates two arrays.

```
[1, 2, 3] || [4, 5] = [1, 2, 3, 4, 5]
```

If one of the elements is not an array, then it's converted to an array of one element, before the concatenation operation is executed

```
[1, 2, 3] || 4 = [1, 2, 3, 4]

1 || [2, 3, 4] = [1, 2, 3, 4]

1 || 2 || 3 || 4 = [1, 2, 3, 4]
```

To add an array, you have to wrap the array element in another array:

```
[[1, 2], [3, 4]] || [5, 6] = [[1, 2], [3, 4], 5, 6]

[[1, 2], [3, 4]] || [[5, 6]] = [[1, 2], [3, 4], [5, 6]]
```

The result of an array concatenation is always a List (ordered and with duplicates). The order of the elements in the list is the same as the order in the elements in the source arrays, in the order they appear in the original expression.

To transform the result of an array concatenation in a Set (remove duplicates), just use the `.asSet()` method

```
[1, 2] || [2, 3] = [1, 2, 2, 3]

([1, 2] || [2, 3]).asSet() = [1, 2, 3]
```

**Specific behavior of NULL**

Null value has no effect when applied to a `||` operation. eg.

```
[1, 2] || null = [1, 2]

null || [1, 2] = [1, 2]
```

To add null values to a collection, you have to explicitly wrap them in another collection, eg.

```
[1, 2] || [null] = [1, 2, null]
```

**Boolean Operators**

- `AND`: logical AND
- `OR`: logical OR
- `NOT` (unary): logical NOT
- `CONTAINS`: checks if the left collection contains the right element. The left argument has to be a collection, otherwise it returns FALSE. It's NOT the check of collection intersections, so `['a', 'b', 'c'] CONTAINS ['a', 'b']` will return FALSE, while `['a', 'b', 'c'] CONTAINS 'a'` will return TRUE. With a condition on the right, it is true if the condition holds for at least one element of the left collection, and the condition is evaluated against that element rather than against the row being filtered, eg. `SELECT FROM Order LET $items = out('Contains') WHERE $items CONTAINS (price > 100)` returns the orders having at least one item over 100. The condition can itself use a sub-query, eg. `$items CONTAINS (@rid IN (SELECT item FROM Discounted))`.
- `IN`: the same as CONTAINS, but with inverted operands.
- `CONTAINSKEY`: for maps, the same as for CONTAINS, but checks on the map keys
- `CONTAINSVALUE`: for maps, the same as for CONTAINS, but checks on the map values
- `CONTAINSANY`: for collections, true if the left collection contains at least one element of the right collection (or, with a condition on the right, if the condition holds for at least one element of the left collection)
- `CONTAINSALL`: for collections, true if the left collection contains every element of the right

collection (or, with a condition on the right, if the condition holds for every element of the left collection)

- `CONTAINSTEXT`: for strings, checks if a string contains another string (meant for indexed fields).
- `LIKE`: for strings, checks if a string contains another string. `%` is used as a wildcard, eg. `'foobar CONTAINS '%ooba%''`
- `ILIKE`: for strings, checks if a string contains another string disregarding case. `%` is used as a wildcard, eg. `'FOOBAR CONTAINS '%ooba%''`
- `IS NULL` (unary): returns TRUE if a field is `null`
- `IS NOT NULL` (unary): returns TRUE if a field is not `null`
- `IS DEFINED` (unary): returns TRUE is a field is defined in a document
- `IS NOT DEFINED` (unary): returns TRUE is a field is not defined in a document
- `BETWEEN - AND` (ternary): returns TRUE is a value is between two values, eg. `5 BETWEEN 1 AND 10`
- `MATCHES`: checks if a string matches a regular expression
- `INSTANCEOF`: checks the type of a value, the right operand has to be the a String representing a type name, eg. `father INSTANCEOF 'Person'`

# 12.4. Graph OLAP Engine

The Graph OLAP Engine maintains a read-optimized, columnar representation of your graph alongside the live OLTP data. It uses **Compressed Sparse Row (CSR)** encoding and flat primitive arrays to deliver 5x–400x speedups on analytical workloads — multi-hop traversals, graph algorithms, and property aggregations — without sacrificing transactional safety.

## 12.4.1. Why Graph OLAP?

ArcadeDB's OLTP engine is optimized for point lookups and ACID transactions. Analytical workloads — PageRank, community detection, multi-hop traversals — access millions of edges in tight loops. The row-oriented, pointer-chasing nature of OLTP storage causes cache misses, object overhead, and GC pressure.

The OLAP engine solves this by encoding graph topology as flat `int[]` arrays and properties as typed columns:

- **Sequential memory access** — cache-line friendly, no pointer chasing
- **Zero object allocation** — no GC pressure during traversal
- **SIMD-friendly** — enables JVM vectorized operations
- **9x more compact** — flat arrays vs. Java object overhead

## 12.4.2. Graph Analytical View (GAV)

A Graph Analytical View is a named, schema-persisted OLAP snapshot of selected vertex types, edge types, and properties.

```
GraphAnalyticalView gav = GraphAnalyticalView.builder(database)
    .withName("social")
    .withVertexTypes("Person", "Company")
    .withEdgeTypes("FOLLOWS", "WORKS_AT")
    .withProperties("name", "age", "status")
    .withUpdateMode(UpdateMode.SYNCHRONOUS)
    .build();
```

Named views are persisted in `schema.json` and automatically restored on database restart. As of ArcadeDB v26.9.1, a `READY` view's CSR snapshot itself can also be persisted to disk at a clean database close and reused on the next open without rescanning the graph; see CSR Persistence.

### 12.4.3. SQL

**Creating a view**

```
CREATE GRAPH ANALYTICAL VIEW social
  VERTEX TYPES (Person, Company)
  EDGE TYPES (FOLLOWS, WORKS_AT)
  PROPERTIES (name, age, status)
  UPDATE MODE SYNCHRONOUS
```

All clauses after the view name are optional. A minimal view covering the entire graph:

```
CREATE GRAPH ANALYTICAL VIEW fullGraph
```

Use `IF NOT EXISTS` to avoid errors if the view already exists:

```
CREATE GRAPH ANALYTICAL VIEW IF NOT EXISTS social
  VERTEX TYPES (Person)
  EDGE TYPES (FOLLOWS)
  UPDATE MODE SYNCHRONOUS
```

You can also materialize edge properties (e.g., weights):

```
CREATE GRAPH ANALYTICAL VIEW weighted
  VERTEX TYPES (City)
  EDGE TYPES (ROAD)
  EDGE PROPERTIES (distance, toll)
  UPDATE MODE SYNCHRONOUS
  COMPACTION THRESHOLD 50000
```

Add `CCH (…)` to keep a Customizable Contraction Hierarchy per weight property, for fast point-to-point shortest paths. A weight listed there is materialized as an edge property even when `EDGE`

`PROPERTIES` does not name it:

```
CREATE GRAPH ANALYTICAL VIEW roads
  EDGE TYPES (ROAD)
  UPDATE MODE SYNCHRONOUS
  CCH (distance, travelTime)
```

#### Edge sub-types

Listing an edge type in `EDGE TYPES` also materializes its sub-types, and a hop on that type answers with the sub-types' edges too, as it does without a view. The view keeps one slice per concrete type, so the order the types are listed in does not matter. Views persisted by an earlier release are rebuilt once.

#### Altering a view

Change the update mode or compaction threshold of an existing view:

```
ALTER GRAPH ANALYTICAL VIEW social UPDATE MODE ASYNCHRONOUS
ALTER GRAPH ANALYTICAL VIEW social COMPACTION THRESHOLD 20000
```

#### Rebuilding a view

Force a full rebuild of the CSR snapshot:

```
REBUILD GRAPH ANALYTICAL VIEW social
```

#### Dropping a view

```
DROP GRAPH ANALYTICAL VIEW social
DROP GRAPH ANALYTICAL VIEW IF EXISTS social
```

#### Listing views

```
SELECT FROM schema:graphAnalyticalViews
```

### 12.4.4. Builder Options

| Method | Description | Default |
|---|---|---|
| `withName(String)` | Named registration + schema persistence | anonymous |
| `withVertexTypes(String…)` | Filter to specific vertex types | all |
| `withEdgeTypes(String…)` | Filter to specific edge types | all |
| `withProperties(String…)` | Materialize specific vertex properties | all |

| Method | Description | Default |
|---|---|---|
| `withEdgeProperties(String…)` | Materialize edge properties (e.g., weights) | none |
| `withUpdateMode(UpdateMode)` | OFF, SYNCHRONOUS, or ASYNCHRONOUS | OFF |
| `withCompactionThreshold(int)` | Rebuild CSR after N accumulated delta edges | 10,000 |
| `withContractionHierarchy(String, String…)` | Keep a contraction hierarchy for a weight property, over the given edge types (all of the view's when none) | none |

### 12.4.5. Async Build for Large Graphs

For large graphs, use `buildAsync()` to avoid blocking the calling thread:

```
GraphAnalyticalView gav = GraphAnalyticalView.builder(database)
    .withName("large-graph")
    .withUpdateMode(UpdateMode.ASYNCHRONOUS)
    .buildAsync();

// Wait for build completion
boolean ready = gav.awaitReady(30, TimeUnit.SECONDS);
```

### 12.4.6. Update Modes

The GAV supports three synchronization modes between OLTP and OLAP:

| Mode | Behavior | Staleness | Use Case |
|---|---|---|---|
| **OFF** | Marks view STALE on commit; requires manual rebuild | Until rebuild | Batch analytics, static snapshots |
| **SYNCHRONOUS** | Applies an overlay on each commit | Zero | Real-time analytics, consistent reads |
| **ASYNCHRONOUS** | Triggers background rebuild on commit | Brief BUILDING window | Large graphs, tolerable brief inconsistency |

In **SYNCHRONOUS** mode, the engine captures transaction deltas (new/deleted vertices, added/removed edges, property changes) and merges them into an immutable overlay on top of the base CSR. Readers always see a consistent snapshot via an atomic volatile reference swap.

**Writes during a build or rebuild.** A view starts tracking changes before it scans the graph, so a transaction that commits while the view is being built or rebuilt is never lost: in **SYNCHRONOUS** mode it is applied on top of the finished view (checked against what the scan already read, so nothing is counted twice), in **OFF** mode the view is published STALE, and in **ASYNCHRONOUS** mode it rebuilds once more. Writers are not blocked by a running build, including `REBUILD GRAPH ANALYTICAL VIEW`.

In **SYNCHRONOUS** mode the view being rebuilt keeps serving queries, and keeps absorbing commits, until the rebuild publishes its new CSR: only the caller of `REBUILD GRAPH ANALYTICAL VIEW` (or of `build()`) waits for the scan. Since v26.10.1 the scan no longer runs while holding the view's lock, so neither a committing transaction nor a status check waits behind it (issue #8403); before, the view served during a blocking rebuild lagged the commits until the rebuild finished. A rebuild superseded by a newer one while it scans waits for the newer one and reports its outcome (success or error); a rebuild interrupted by the database closing fails with an error rather than reporting success.

Before 26.10.1, a transaction committed while a view was building could be missing from the view permanently, with the view still reporting itself READY and not stale (issue #8378). Rebuild a view created on an earlier version while writes were running if its answers must match the graph exactly. When the overlay accumulates too many changes (configurable threshold, default 10,000 edges), a background compaction rebuilds the full CSR.

**Lightweight edges and bulk loads.** A lightweight edge is tracked like any other edge in every mode: its creation and its deletion reach the overlay in **SYNCHRONOUS** mode, mark an **OFF** view STALE and rebuild an **ASYNCHRONOUS** one. Each copy of a duplicated lightweight edge counts as an edge of its own, and a delete removes one copy. Copies have no identity to tell an old one from a new one, so when lightweight edges of a pair change while the view is being built or rebuilt, the view checks that pair against the graph before serving it; if a duplicated copy made them disagree, it rebuilds rather than serve the pair one copy off. Edges loaded with GraphBatch (and so by the graph importer, the HTTP batch endpoint and the gRPC batch load) are written in bulk, without an event per edge, so the view learns of them when the batch closes: **OFF** goes STALE, **ASYNCHRONOUS** rebuilds, and **SYNCHRONOUS** rebuilds too rather than absorbing millions of edges into the overlay. While that rebuild runs the view is not READY, so queries take the ordinary path and never answer without the load. During the batch itself the view still serves what it held before the batch started.

Before 26.11.1 a view never learned about a lightweight edge created after its build, nor about any edge written by `GraphBatch`: a **SYNCHRONOUS** view answered as if those edges did not exist, and a transaction or batch that touched nothing else left an **OFF** view READY (issue #9572). Rebuild a view on such a graph after upgrading.

### 12.4.7. CSR Persistence

Available since ArcadeDB v26.9.1.

Before v26.9.1, a named view's CSR was never itself persisted: only its definition (types, properties, update mode) was, in `schema.json`. Every database open therefore rebuilt the CSR from a full graph scan, and because `shutdown()` waits for any in-flight rebuild, the cost of that scan landed on `close()` rather than `open()` - at 1M vertices, closing a database with a view took over 4 seconds even for a session that ran no query at all.

A `READY` view (with no pending overlay changes) now writes its CSR to disk at a clean database close,

alongside a freshness certificate: the database's last committed transaction id at the time the CSR was built. On the next open, if a persisted file plausibly applies (see arcadedb.gavPersistCsr below), the view is marked `READY` immediately, but the file itself is not read yet - see Lazy Restore. That deferred read either:

- finds the database's current last committed transaction id still matches the certificate - nothing was committed to the database in between, so the persisted CSR is loaded from disk as-is instead of being rebuilt; or
- finds a mismatch - anything was committed in between, to any type, not only the ones the view covers - and falls back to the previous behavior: an async rebuild.

This means the speedup only applies to reopening a database that was **not written to** since its last clean close. A database that receives writes between every session still pays the rebuild on every open, exactly as before v26.9.1.

Persistence is controlled by the `arcadedb.gavPersistCsr` database-level setting (default `true`). Set it to `false` to skip writing the CSR file, for example to avoid its disk footprint or the extra write at close.

Serving queries against a stale CSR while a delta is applied in the background (the way `SYNCHRONOUS` mode's overlay already does for live updates) is not part of this: a CSR's contiguous array layout makes partial coverage expensive to retrofit, so an invalidated certificate always means a full rebuild, not a partial one.

#### Lazy Restore

Available since ArcadeDB v26.9.1.

A persisted CSR that plausibly applies is not read from disk during `open()`. Reading and deserializing it is a real, if bounded, cost - up to roughly a second at 10M vertices - and a session that opens a database and never queries the view got nothing for paying it. Instead, `open()` marks the view `READY` immediately without touching the file, and the actual read is deferred to whichever of these happens first:

- a query that actually needs the view's data; or
- an explicit call to the view's `awaitReady()` method.

Either trigger re-verifies the freshness certificate from scratch at that point (not the one implied at `open()` time), so a commit that lands after `open()` but before the first query is still caught correctly and falls back to a rebuild rather than serving stale data. A session that opens and closes a database without ever touching the view now costs what the no-view baseline costs, not what a restore costs - `close()` does not wait for a restore that was never triggered either.

Since v26.11.1 a query that looks a view up while its restore is in flight (for example the first count push-down, `MATCH` or `shortestPath()` after a reopen) waits for the restore instead of taking the slower record path. The wait is bounded by the `arcadedb.gavQueryRestoreAwaitTimeout` database-level setting (default `5000` ms, `0` disables the wait).

A query that runs while a view is not ready yet (its restore past that wait, its first build still running, or the view stale and not allowed to serve stale results) takes the record path. Since v26.11.1 that is

no longer remembered: the OpenCypher plan cached for the query is planned again as soon as the view is ready, so the following runs of the same query use the view.

The `arcadedb.gavRestoreAwaitTimeout` database-level setting (default `0`) forces the wait at `open()` time instead, for either the deferred restore or a full rebuild: set it to a positive number of milliseconds to trade a slower `open()` for the view being immediately usable by the query that triggered the reopen, rather than the first query racing (and possibly missing) it.

### 12.4.8. How CSR Works

The graph topology is stored as two pairs of arrays (forward for outgoing edges, backward for incoming):

```
Forward CSR (outgoing edges):
  offsets:   [0, 3, 5, 8, ...]     -- one entry per vertex + sentinel
  neighbors: [1, 5, 7, 2, 6, ...]  -- dense neighbor IDs, contiguous per source

  Outgoing neighbors of vertex v = neighbors[offsets[v] .. offsets[v+1])
  Out-degree of vertex v         = offsets[v+1] - offsets[v]   -- O(1)
```

This layout enables sequential memory access (cache-line friendly) and O(1) degree lookups.

### 12.4.9. Columnar Property Storage

Properties are stored as typed flat arrays — `int[]`, `long[]`, `double[]`, or dictionary-encoded `int[]` for strings. Each column has a compact null bitmap (1 bit per vertex). Dictionary encoding maps unique string values to integer codes, achieving near-100% compression for low-cardinality fields.

#### Edge Properties and Pending Changes

Behavior changed in ArcadeDB v26.9.1.

Edge property columns (`EDGE PROPERTIES (…)`, used as weights by the shortest-path and spanning-tree algorithms) are laid out in the order the graph had when the view was built. In `SYNCHRONOUS` mode a commit is absorbed into a pending-changes overlay rather than rebuilding, so from that moment the neighbour list and the columns describe two different orderings.

Before v26.9.1 the view resolved this by reporting no edge properties at all as soon as an overlay existed, and every weighted algorithm silently went back to reading edge records - after every single commit. The view now reconciles the two instead: an edge already in the base graph keeps answering from its column, and an edge the overlay added answers from the value recorded when it was committed. Weighted algorithms therefore keep the fast columnar path while a view is being updated.

Two cases remain that the view cannot answer, and for those the algorithm reads the edge records directly - exact, only slower:

- several parallel edges join the same two vertices and only some of them were deleted, since the

overlay counts deletions per vertex pair and cannot say which of the parallel edges went;

- a property of an existing edge was changed while another edge of the same type joins the same two vertices, until the rebuild that refreshes the columns completes, since the view cannot tell which of the two changed. Since v26.11.1, a change to an edge that is the only one of its type between its two vertices is kept in the overlay and answered from there, with no rebuild (issue #9437). Adding and deleting edges never have this effect.

### 12.4.10. Memory Usage

The OLAP representation is significantly more compact than the OLTP equivalent:

- **CSR topology**: ~8 bytes per edge (bidirectional)
- **Node ID mapping**: ~8 bytes per vertex
- **Columnar properties**: 4–8 bytes per vertex per column
- **Null bitmaps**: 1 bit per vertex per column

Example: for a graph with 500K vertices and 8M edges, the GAV uses **134.6 MB** compared to an estimated **~1.2 GB** for the OLTP representation — **9.3x more compact**.

```
long bytes = gav.getMemoryUsageBytes();
```

### 12.4.11. Graph Algorithms

The module includes parallelized graph algorithms that operate directly on CSR arrays with zero GC pressure:

| Algorithm | Description |
|---|---|
| PageRank | Pull-based, parallel, configurable damping factor and iterations |
| Connected Components | Parallel union-find for weakly connected components |
| BFS | Breadth-first search with distance arrays |
| SSSP (Dijkstra) | Single-source shortest path for weighted graphs |
| Label Propagation | Community detection |
| Triangle Counting | Count 3-cliques in the graph |
| Local Clustering Coefficient | Per-vertex clustering coefficients |

```
GraphAlgorithms algos = new GraphAlgorithms();

// PageRank (20 iterations, damping 0.85)
double[] ranks = algos.pageRank(gav, 20, 0.85);

// Connected Components
int[] components = algos.connectedComponents(gav);
```

```
// BFS from a source vertex
int[] distances = algos.bfs(gav, sourceNodeId);
```

#### Algorithms and Pending Changes

Behavior changed in ArcadeDB v26.9.1.

In `SYNCHRONOUS` mode a committed change is absorbed into a pending-changes overlay rather than rebuilding the view. The overlay keeps the slot of a deleted vertex and numbers an added vertex above the base graph, so from that moment the view's vertex count and the range of its internal vertex numbers stop being the same figure.

Before v26.9.1 the `algo.*` procedures took them for one and the same, with two consequences:

- a vertex added after the view was built could be missing from the answer of every procedure, with no error to say so;
- once the additions outnumbered the deletions, the CSR-accelerated procedures (`algo.wcc`, `algo.pagerank`, `algo.labelpropagation`, `algo.localClusteringCoefficient`, `algo.bfs`) failed with an `ArrayIndexOutOfBoundsException` - one added vertex was enough.

Both are fixed. The vertices a view holds are renumbered onto a gapless range before any algorithm sees them, so every `algo.*` procedure answers for exactly the vertices that are live at the time of the call - the added ones included, the deleted ones excluded.

While a view is holding pending changes the whole-graph procedures also stop using the parallel kernels listed above, which read the base CSR arrays directly and know nothing of the overlay: they would otherwise answer for the graph as it stood at the last build. Those calls still run off the view's adjacency, single-threaded rather than parallel, and the compaction that folds the overlay back into the base graph (by default after 10,000 pending edges) restores the parallel path.

### 12.4.12. Shortest Paths with Contraction Hierarchies (CCH)

A view can keep a **Customizable Contraction Hierarchy** for a weight property: a precomputed structure that answers point-to-point shortest paths in a time that depends on the depth of the hierarchy rather than on how far apart the two vertices are. It is meant for road, logistics, utility and other infrastructure networks that serve many routing queries.

```
CREATE GRAPH ANALYTICAL VIEW roads EDGE TYPES (ROAD) UPDATE MODE SYNCHRONOUS CCH
(distance)
```

```
GraphAnalyticalView roads = GraphAnalyticalView.builder(database)
    .withName("roads")
    .withEdgeTypes("ROAD")
    .withUpdateMode(UpdateMode.SYNCHRONOUS)
    .withContractionHierarchy("distance")
```

```
    .build();
```

Queries go through algo.cch.shortestPath (Cypher) or cchShortestPath() (SQL). A query is answered by the hierarchy when its weight property and relationship types are exactly those of a hierarchy on a ready view; otherwise, and whenever the hierarchy cannot answer for the view's current state, it is answered by bidirectional Dijkstra. Answers are exact either way, and a transaction holding uncommitted changes always sees them.

**How it works**

1. **Order** - a nested-dissection order of the vertices, computed from the topology alone: small vertex separators (minimum vertex cuts) split the graph recursively, and each separator is ranked above the pieces it separates.
2. **Contraction** - eliminating the vertices in that order adds shortcut edges, giving the chordal supergraph of the hierarchy.
3. **Customization** - the weight of every edge and shortcut, computed bottom-up from the edge weights. This is the only step that depends on the weights.
4. **Query** - the two endpoints climb the hierarchy and meet at the top; shortcuts are then unpacked into the edges they stand for.

On grids, the hardest case for this technique, a query on 360,000 vertices takes about 0.5 ms for a route across the whole grid against about 50 ms for Dijkstra, and the gap grows with the size of the graph. Road networks have much smaller separators than grids and benefit more.

**Keeping up with changes**

The hierarchy follows the view: every change the view absorbs is followed by a background preparation, on the view's build executor. In `SYNCHRONOUS` mode most changes are caught up in milliseconds:

- A weight change, a closed road (an infinite weight) or a deleted edge re-customizes only the part of the hierarchy above the edges that changed. The view keeps its CSR: the new weight of an edge that is the only one of its type between its two vertices is served from the view's change overlay, without rebuilding anything.
- A new edge between two vertices the hierarchy already joins is handled the same way.
- A new edge between two vertices it does not join, or a new vertex with edges, needs a new contraction. The existing vertex order is kept, with new vertices ranked first, so this costs a contraction and a customization rather than a full build.
- A weight change on an edge that has a parallel twin of the same type between the same two vertices makes the view rebuild its CSR in the background, because the view cannot tell which of the two changed. The hierarchy then catches up from the rebuilt view.
- While a preparation is running, queries are answered by bidirectional Dijkstra, so an answer never reflects an older state than the view itself.
- Directed (`OUT`/`IN`) queries are prepared from the start. Undirected (`BOTH`) ones need a second metric, customized the first time a `BOTH` query asks for it, so that first query and any during its customization are answered by Dijkstra.

Measured on the California road network (DIMACS `USA-road-d.CAL`: 1.9M vertices, 4.7M arcs) through a database: a query takes 0.04 to 0.1 ms at any distance, against 18 to 230 ms for Dijkstra; updating 1, 10 and 100 weights takes about 0.7, 8 and 65 ms from commit until the hierarchy answers for it; closing a road about 4 ms; adding a road the hierarchy does not join about 0.9 s; the first build about 13 s. Each query needs a few tens of KB of scratch, sized to the depth of the hierarchy rather than to the graph.

The order is persisted next to the view's CSR at a clean close (see CSR Persistence) and reused when the database is reopened with nothing committed in between, so a reopen only contracts and customizes.

**Suitability**

The technique relies on small separators. Graphs without them, such as social graphs or graphs with supernodes, would need a supergraph many times larger than themselves. A hierarchy that would exceed `arcadedb.gavCchMaxArcsPerEdge` supergraph arcs per edge (default 16) is not built: it reports `UNSUITABLE`, and queries keep using bidirectional Dijkstra. A `REBUILD GRAPH ANALYTICAL VIEW` tries again.

**Monitoring**

`SELECT FROM schema:graphAnalyticalViews` and `GraphAnalyticalView.getStats()` list each hierarchy with its status (`PREPARING`, `READY`, `UNSUITABLE`, `UNAVAILABLE`), size in arcs and memory, how many topologies were built or restored, how many customizations ran, and how many queries it answered or handed back to Dijkstra.

The weight of an edge is the numeric value of its weight property; an edge without one weighs `1`, and an edge whose value is negative is not walked.

## 12.4.13. Query Planner Integration

The Cypher query planner automatically detects ready GAVs and substitutes OLTP traversal operators with CSR-based operators when:

- A named GAV is registered and in READY state
- The GAV covers the required vertex and edge types
- The query does not return edge variables as first-class records (edges in CSR have no RID; edge **properties** are fully supported)

No query changes are needed — the optimizer transparently accelerates matching traversal patterns.

**Relationship uniqueness.** Cypher binds a relationship at most once per `MATCH` clause, so `MATCH (a)-[:KNOWS]-(b)-[:KNOWS]-(c)` never walks back to `a` over the edge it just took. A view holds adjacency, not edge records, so since v26.10.1 a hop that could reuse a relationship of another hop in its clause - they share an edge type, or either is untyped - is walked one edge type and direction at a time and remembers which relationship it took, and `EXPLAIN` marks it `unique relationships`. Such a clause is served from the view when every one of those hops is anonymous and has a fixed length; a named relationship variable or a variable-length relationship among them sends all of them to the records

instead. Hops that cannot collide - `(a)-[:KNOWS]→(b)-[:WORKS_AT]→(c)` - are unaffected. Before v26.10.1 a view answered such patterns without the rule, counting for example every friend-of-a-friend path that returns to its start over the same edge, and every path that took a self-loop twice (issue #8394). An undirected chain of several hops also counted each self-loop once per adjacency list it sits in, even across separate `MATCH` clauses.

**Views over some of the vertex types.** A view built with `VERTEX TYPES (…)` holds only the vertices of those types, so the edges that leave them are missing from its adjacency. Edge types do not declare which vertex types they connect, so the planner cannot know that a traversal stays inside the view: since v26.11.1 a view is used for SQL `out()`, `in()`, `both()`, `MATCH`, `TRAVERSE`, shortest path, the count push-downs and the `algo.*` procedures only when it covers every vertex type of the database that holds a vertex, and these statements otherwise read the records. Before that they answered with the covered part of the graph, for example 0 rows for `MATCH (b:B)-[:E]→(c:C)` on a view over `(A, B)` (issue #9301). A type with no vertex of its own does not count, because no traversal can reach it: a parent type whose records all live in the sub-types the view lists (`Message` over `Post` and `Comment`), or a type not used yet. The first vertex created in such a type makes the view partial again, without any schema change. A view over a subset of the types still serves a one-hop Cypher scan whose labels it holds. To accelerate the other statements, list every vertex type that holds vertices.

**Stale views.** A view that is STALE (in `OFF` mode after a commit, or after a failed rebuild) is not used by the planner unless `arcadedb.gavUseWhenStale` is `true`, in which case queries read the snapshot as of its last build. The setting is per database, and applies to every view of that database immediately, including views already built and views restored at open (since v26.10.1; before, only the JVM-wide `-Darcadedb.gavUseWhenStale` had any effect, issue #7875):

```
ALTER DATABASE `arcadedb.gavUseWhenStale` true
```

The builder's `withUseWhenStale(boolean)` overrides it for one view, and that override is saved with the view's definition.

A one-hop pattern feeding an aggregation, such as

```
MATCH (p:Person)-[:KNOWS]->(f:Person)
WHERE p.city = f.city
RETURN p.city AS city, avg(f.age) AS avgAge, count(*) AS n
```

is read entirely from the view since v26.10.1: the sources are the view's nodes carrying the source label, both endpoints read their properties from the view's columns, and every edge reaches the aggregation as a lightweight row rather than a copied record. `EXPLAIN` shows it as `GAV ONE-HOP SCAN`. This applies when the statement is a single `MATCH` of one fixed-length relationship feeding an aggregating `RETURN`, with no relationship or path variable and no inline property map, the optimizer would otherwise scan the source label (not seek it through an index), and the view is not stale and covers every vertex type the two labels can match. A count per endpoint alone (`RETURN p.city, count(*)`) keeps its own, even cheaper, edge-count plan, and an order-sensitive aggregate such as `collect()`, or a grouped `LIMIT`/`SKIP` without `ORDER BY`, keeps the regular plan.

**Counts that build no row.** A statement whose only output is `count(*)` - and a `COUNT { }` subquery -

is answered by a count push-down when its pattern is a chain, a star around one node, or one of the LSQB shapes; `EXPLAIN` shows it under `Using Count Push-Down`. Since v26.11.1 the push-downs also take:

- a property predicate on a node of a chain, a star, the anti-join of LSQB Q8/Q9 or the pair join of LSQB Q2, written inline (`(:Message {kind: 'Post'})`) or as a `WHERE` conjunct that reads that node alone (`WHERE m.kind = 'Post'`, `WHERE m.created > $since`). It is checked once per distinct vertex the position reaches, on the vertex itself, so it costs one record read per such vertex instead of the rows of the whole pattern (issues #9595, #9608). A conjunct that compares two nodes (`WHERE a.x < b.x`), a property value read off another node (`{kind: a.kind}`), `rand()` and pattern predicates still leave the count to the regular plan. A predicate written at one position of a variable holds at every position the variable is written at, and two nodes whose inline maps give one property two different string, boolean or integer values (`(c:Message {kind: 'Comment'})`, `(p:Message {kind: 'Post'})`) are known to be different vertices, which proves their relationships different edges the way two unrelated labels do.
- a `MATCH` made of parts that share no variable, such as `MATCH (a:Person), (b:Person), (c:Person)`: each part is counted on its own, by its own push-down or plan, and the counts are multiplied. An `OPTIONAL MATCH` part counts at least one row. Two parts of one `MATCH` clause are multiplied only when the schema proves their relationships cannot be the same edge, since a clause binds every relationship once. A product that does not fit a 64-bit integer is an error (issue #9596).
- a `WITH` that only passes variables on, `*` and aliases included (`WITH message, creator`, `WITH m AS x`), with no aggregation, `DISTINCT`, `WHERE`, `ORDER BY`, `SKIP` or `LIMIT`: it leaves the number of rows alone, so the statement is counted as if the clauses on both sides were one query part (issue #9597).
- `count(x)` of a node or relationship variable a non-optional `MATCH` binds, which counts the same rows as `count()`; a single relationship between two unconstrained nodes, `MATCH ()-[e:KNOWS]→() RETURN count(e)` (untyped, with several types or undirected too), read from the view's per-type totals, or without a view in one walk of the edge lists that loads no edge; and `MATCH (n) RETURN count(n)`, the sum of the vertex types' counters (issue #9600). Unlike the SQL `SELECT count() FROM KNOWS`, which counts edge records, the relationship count includes lightweight edges, which keep no record.
- the same pattern however it is written: the comma-separated parts of a `MATCH` are read as the graph they describe, so a chain cut into parts is counted as the chain, and a cycle such as LSQB Q2 (a `KNOWS` hop closed by a three-hop chain, or the same cycle written as four one-hop patterns starting from the post) is split into the probe hop and the chain by the statistics - the fan-out of each hop sampled on the label it leaves - rather than by the order of the text (issue #9599).
- an `OPTIONAL MATCH` only tested for absence (`OPTIONAL MATCH (c)-[h:HAS_TAG]→(t) WITH ⋯ WHERE h IS NULL`), which is planned as `WHERE NOT (c)-[:HAS_TAG]→(t)` and so reaches the anti-join push-down (issue #9598, see OPTIONAL MATCH).

**Multi-hop chains on the view.** A chain of labeled hops such as `MATCH (a:P)-[:K]→(b:P)-[:K]→(c:P)` is walked on the view (`EXPLAIN` shows `GAVFusedChain`). Since v26.11.1 a `count()`, or `count(x)` of a variable of the chain, is counted during the walk with up to two grouping keys that are chain variables, in a `RETURN` or a `WITH` (`RETURN a, count() AS n`); `EXPLAIN` shows it on the chain as `fused count(*) AS n`. When the statement returns the paths' rows instead, they are produced in bounded batches, so memory no longer grows with the number of paths and a `LIMIT` stops the walk early (issue #9738). If the view is rebuilt while such a result is still being read, the query fails with a

retryable error rather than mixing rows from two builds: run it again.

A transaction that holds uncommitted changes - any change, even to types the view does not cover - does not use the view: the view serves the committed graph only, and a query inside the transaction must see the transaction's own writes. Such a query, Cypher, Gremlin or a graph algorithm, runs on the records until the transaction commits, which `PROFILE` shows as a plan without the view. Run analytical queries outside write transactions, or after committing, to keep the acceleration.

### 12.4.14. Lifecycle

```
// Check status
if (gav.isReady()) { /* safe to query */ }

// Status values: NOT_BUILT, BUILDING, READY, STALE
Status status = gav.getStatus();

// Drop (removes from registry + schema)
gav.drop();

// Shutdown (release resources, schema definition persists)
gav.shutdown();
```

### 12.4.15. Benchmark Results

On a graph with 500K vertices and ~8M edges:

| Benchmark | OLTP | OLAP | Speedup |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1-hop count | 6.9 µs | 1.2 µs | 5.7x |
| 2-hop | 101.4 µs | 5.1 µs | 19.8x |
| 3-hop | 1,037 µs | 56.4 µs | 18.4x |
| 5-hop | 194,046 µs | 5,141 µs | 37.7x |
| Shortest Path | 394 ms/pair | 7.5 ms/pair | 52.8x |
| PageRank (20 iter) | 124,563 ms | 316 ms | 394.2x |
| Connected Components | 5,591 ms | 197 ms | 28.4x |
| Label Propagation | 62,619 ms | 645 ms | 97.1x |

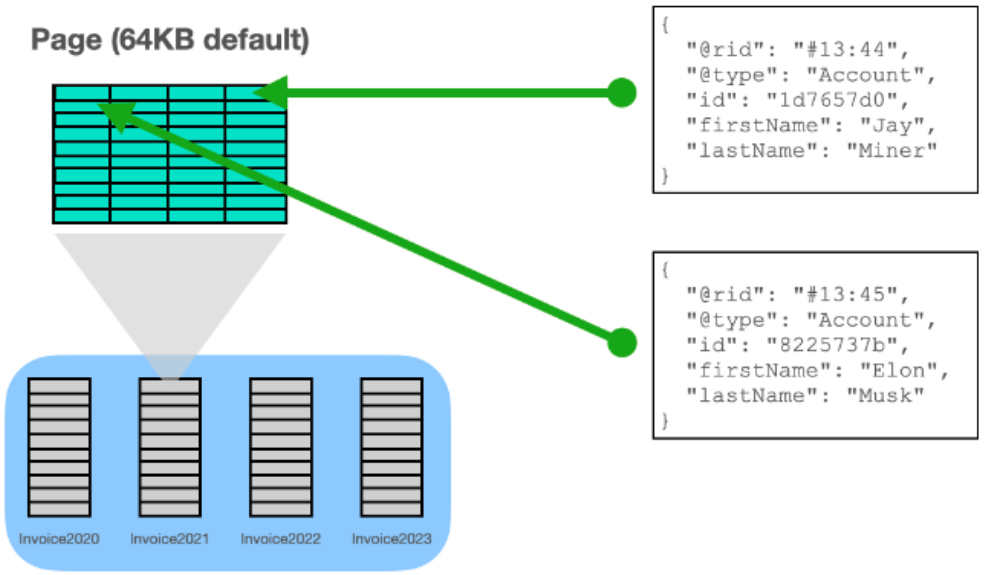
### 12.4.16. Limitations

- CSR uses `int[]` arrays — maximum ~2.1 billion vertices per bucket and ~2.1 billion edges per direction
- Edges in CSR do not carry their own RID; the Cypher query planner falls back to OLTP only when the query returns an edge variable as a first-class record (e.g., `RETURN r`). Edge **properties** are fully supported via `withEdgeProperties()`
- Dictionary encoding applies only to string properties

- Initial build requires a full scan of selected vertex/edge types. A rebuild triggered by an invalidated persisted CSR certificate (or by `OFF` mode, or by exceeding the `SYNCHRONOUS`/`ASYNCHRONOUS` compaction threshold) also requires a full scan - only a clean-close-to-unchanged-reopen cycle skips it

# 12.5. Storage Internals

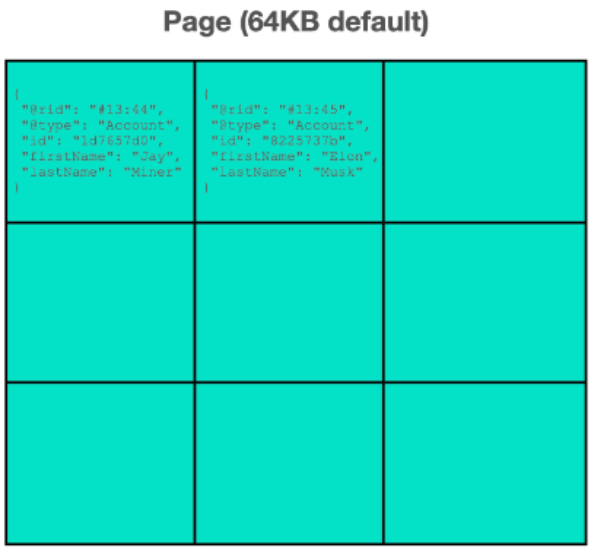
## 12.5.1. Pages and Record IDs




Records (Vertices, Edges and Documents) are stored in one or more pages. At creation time, the **unique** Record ID (**RID**) is assigned as the physical position where the beginning of record is stored.

RIDs cannot be changed and when a record is deleted are never recycled.

## 12.5.2. Zero Copy Objects



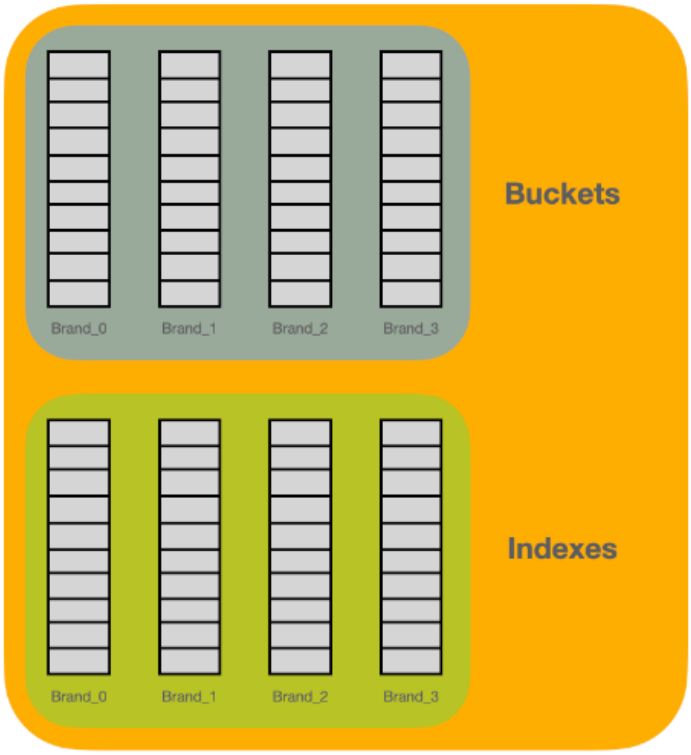

Pages are loaded in RAM as `ByteBuffer` objects (backed by byte arrays - `byte[]`). When a record is read, an in **immutable** vertex object is created which points to the portion of the `ByteBuffer` relative at the record.

All the immutable vertices point to the byte buffers with **zero copy** and no Java `Map` involved.

This greatly reduce the pressure on the Garbage Collection because most of the objects are big chunks of `byte[]`.

### 12.5.3. How Buckets Work

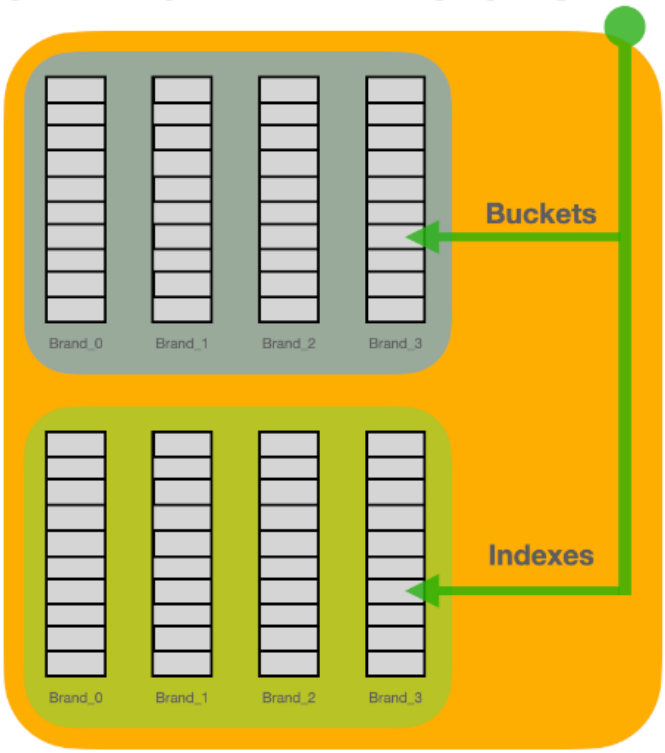
```
sql> create vertex type Brand
```




**Buckets** are physical files made of pages of 64KB (configurable). It's where the records are stored. Multiple buckets (files) per type allow to execute many jobs in parallel using all the CPU cores available.

**Indexes**, one per bucket, uses the **Log-structured merge-tree** (**LSM-Tree**) algorithm for efficient insertion speed and background concurrent compaction.

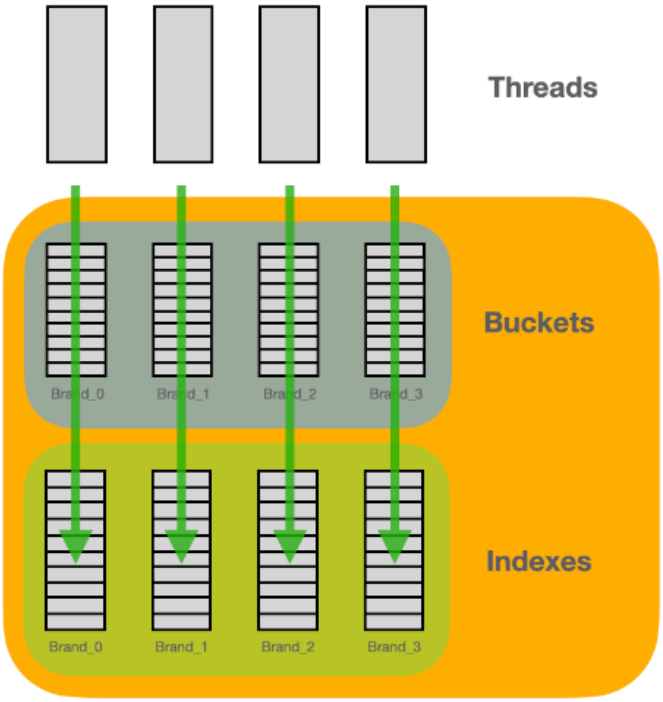
```
gremlin> g.addV('Brand').property('name', 'Maserati')
```




Round-Robin Strategy: **selected bucket = 3**

At insertion time the bucket is selected by using a (pluggable) strategy. By default is **Round-Robin**, but **Thread** and **Partitioned** strategies are available.


```
gremlin> g.addV('Brand').property('name', 'Maserati')
```

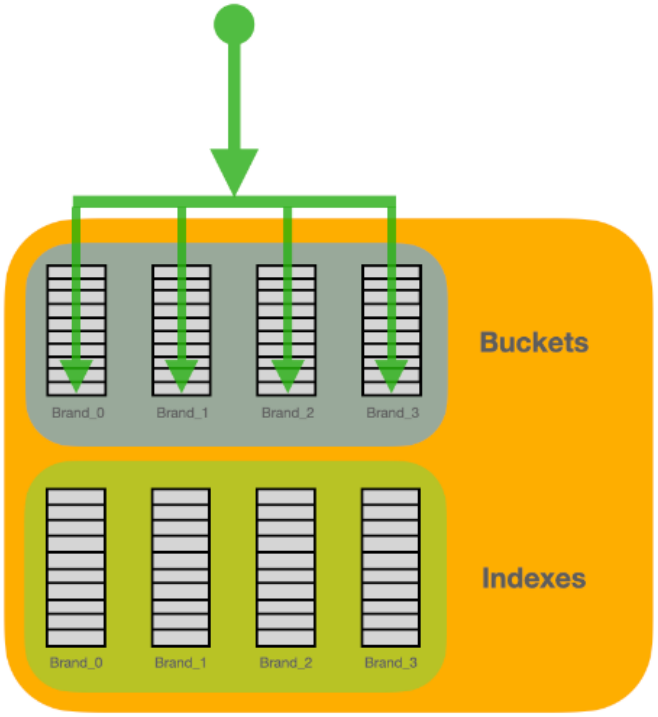




**Thread** strategy is preferable with multi-thread insertion where each thread insert on the same bucket and index files with zero contention with other threads.

```
bucket = threadId % available buckets
```

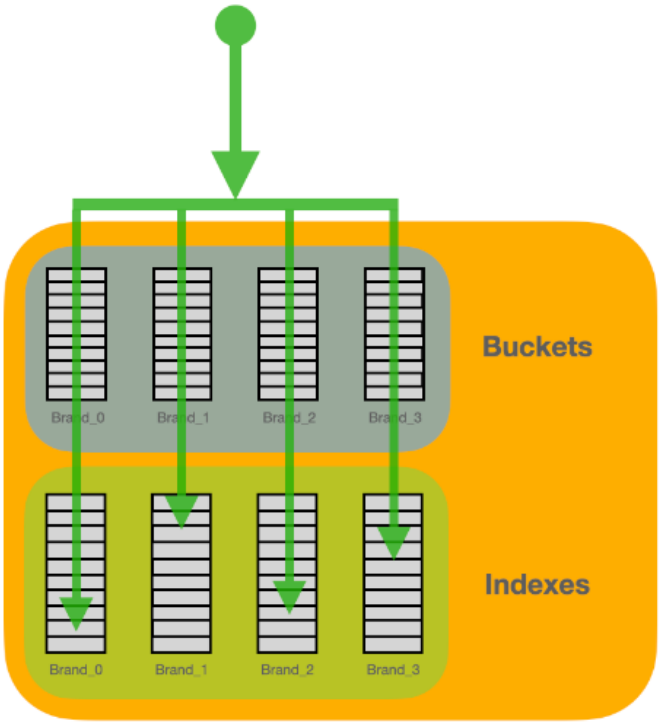
On a 2019 MacBook Pro ArcadeDB can insert **3.5 Million vertices/s** without index and **1.6 Million vertices/s** with one index

```
gremlin> g.V().hasLabel('Brand')
```




When no indexes are involved, the entire type is scanned. ArcadeDB browses all the buckets associated with the type.

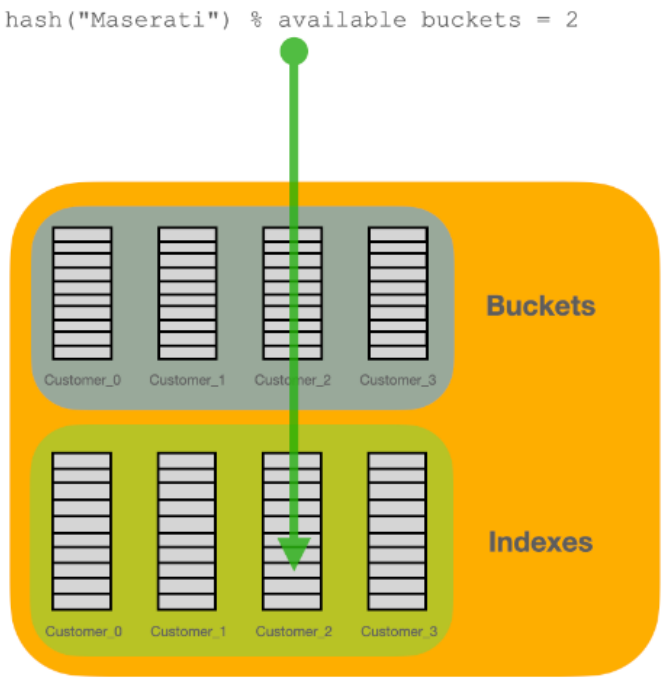
```
gremlin> g.V().hasLabel('Brand').has('name', 'Maserati')
```




When an index is used, a lookup on all the index per bucket is executed because the vertex could be in any of the configured buckets.

### 12.5.4. Bucket Partitioning

```
gremlin> g.V().hasLabel('Brand').has('name', 'Maserati')
```




It's possible to partition data based on one or more properties. This has the great advantage to involve only one index instead of all the indexes when a lookup by key is executed. It must be configured before the insertion:

1. Define a unique index on the property used for partitioning. In this example the brand's name:

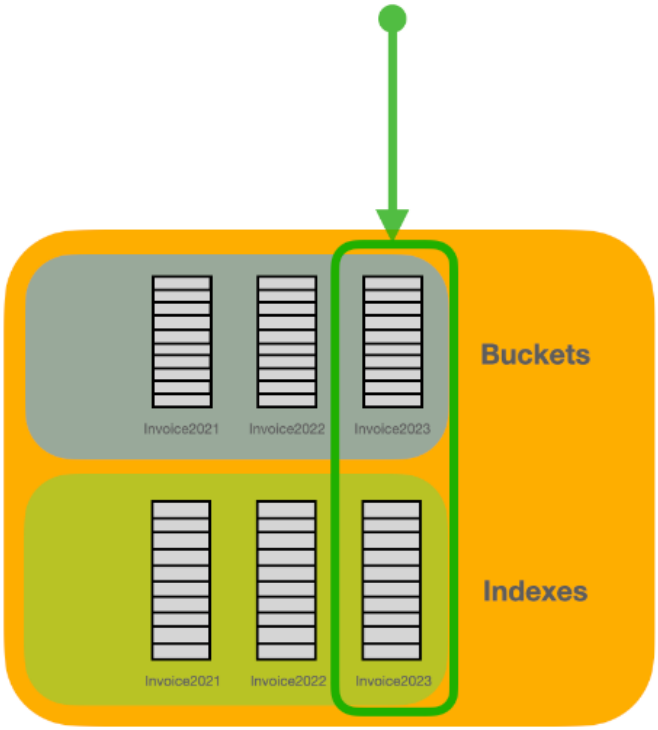
```
create index on Brand (name) unique
```

2. Use the bucket selection strategy "partitioned(name)":

```
alter type Brand BucketSelectionStrategy
`partitioned(name)`
```

### 12.5.5. Add and Remove Buckets from Types

```
sql> ALTER TYPE Invoice BUCKET +Invoice2023
```



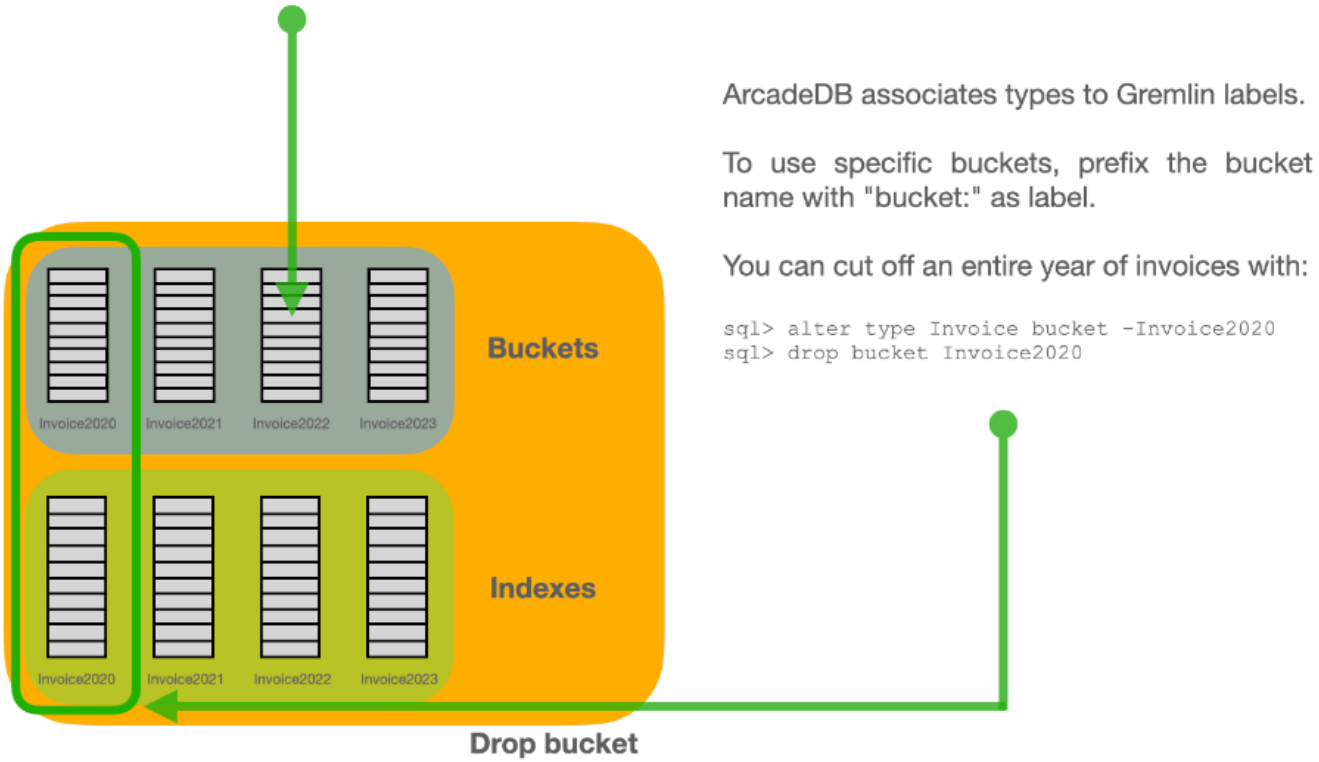

When a new bucket is added to a type, ArcadeDB creates automatically the underlying index.

Having one index per bucket is useful when a bucket is deleted and the entire sub-index is deleted with it.

Also, you could have the most recent data on a bucket stored on a fast SSD and move the old ones on a slower (but cheaper) HDD.

In the future could be possible to move buckets (and associated sub-indexes) to different servers for a distributed partitioning.

```
gremlin> g.V().addV('bucket:Invoice2022').property('id', '123')
gremlin> g.V().hasLabel('bucket:Invoice2022').has('id', '123')
```




### 12.5.6. Page Version

Records are stored in pages. Each page has its own version number, which increments on each update. At creation the page version is zero. In optimistic transactions, ArcadeDB checks the version in order to avoid conflicts at commit time.

### 12.5.7. Schema File Persistence

The schema of a database lives in two JSON files in the database directory: `schema.json`, the current generation, and `schema.prev.json`, the generation it replaced. Every DDL statement rewrites them, once (see Cost of a Schema Change, and Batching Many).

Since v26.10.1, both files are published by an **atomic replacement**: the new content is written to a temporary sibling file, flushed to disk, and then renamed over its target. A process reading `schema.json` from the filesystem - an external backup, a monitoring script, a snapshot tool - therefore always observes one complete generation. It is never truncated, and it never disappears.

Before v26.10.1, saving the schema renamed `schema.json` aside to `schema.prev.json` and only then wrote the replacement. For the duration of that write, `schema.json` did not exist, and a process killed inside that window left a database whose schema file was missing and recoverable only from `schema.prev.json`. If you have tooling that copies a database directory while the database is running, and that tooling tolerates a missing or empty `schema.json`, that workaround is no longer needed.

Since v26.10.1 a full backup archives `schema.prev.json` as well, so a restored database keeps the

same fallback copy as the database it came from. A database whose schema has never been re-saved has no previous generation yet, and the archive simply does not contain one.

The previous generation is saved by creating a second hard link to the bytes already on disk where the file system supports it, so `schema.json` and `schema.prev.json` can share one inode until the next DDL statement replaces `schema.json`. This is invisible to anything that reads or copies the files - `cp`, `tar`, a backup archive and a restore all produce two independent files - but a tool that reports inode identity or disk usage will see the two names counted once. File systems without hard links (FAT/exFAT, some network mounts) fall back to a byte copy automatically.

On a file system that cannot rename atomically at all, ArcadeDB falls back to a plain replacement and logs a warning once per JVM. The schema still saves; only the crash-time guarantee is lost.

### 12.5.8. Cost of a Schema Change, and Batching Many

Each schema write is durable: the new `schema.json` is flushed to disk and the directory that holds it is flushed once, after both files are published. On a real disk that is a few milliseconds to a few tens of milliseconds per write, depending on the device, against a fraction of a millisecond on `tmpfs`. Since v26.10.1 every DDL statement writes the schema exactly once, however many bucket and index files and internal steps it involves. Before, a `CREATE TYPE` wrote it five or six times, a `CREATE PROPERTY` or a `CREATE INDEX` twice, and each write flushed the directory twice.

An application or a test suite that creates hundreds of types pays that write once per statement. To pay it once for a whole batch:

- **SQL**: send the statements as one `sqlscript`. A script made only of schema definition statements runs as one schema session and writes the schema once (setting `schemaBulkDDLScript`, on by default). Under HA the batch is also replicated as one Raft entry.
- **Java**: wrap the calls in `db.getSchema().bulkChange(() -> { … })`, which does the same for any sequence of schema API calls.
- **Any API**: run the DDL inside a transaction. The schema write is postponed to the end of the transaction.

Creating the bucket and index files themselves is cheap: about a millisecond per type with one index, once the schema writes are batched.

Schema changes are not transactional. A DDL statement run inside a transaction takes effect immediately and is visible to every other session; a rollback does not undo it. Its types, properties and files stay, and the schema is written at the end of the transaction whether it commits or rolls back. A crash before that write leaves the new bucket and index files on disk without a schema entry naming them: the database opens normally without the new types, and running the same DDL again succeeds. The window lasts as long as the transaction, so it is worth keeping a transaction that creates types or indexes short, and creating them before a long import rather than inside it. Records another session committed into such a type before the crash are in those files too, and are not reachable after the restart: recreate the type and they stay unreferenced. Because a schema change is not transactional, the next commit on any session writes it, including a session that

> only writes records, and the type it names may belong to a transaction that has not ended yet. The transaction that ran the DDL is not exposed to this for its own records: the schema is written just before its commit becomes durable, so `begin(); CREATE TYPE; INSERT; commit()` never leaves acknowledged records in files the schema does not name. Under HA, each DDL statement inside a transaction is still replicated on its own, so prefer a script or `bulkChange()` there.

# 12.6. LSM-Tree Algorithm

ArcadeDB's default index algorithm is the LSM Tree. For equality-only lookups, ArcadeDB also provides a Hash Index based on extendible hashing.

## 12.6.1. Quick Overview

The LSM-Tree index is optimized for writes with a complexity of O(1) in writing because it does not require a re-balancing of the tree (like the B+Tree) and O(log(N)) to O(log(N)^2) with reads, depending on how fragmented (non compacted) the index is at a point of time.

The class LSMTreeIndex is the main entrypoint for the index. This class contains an instance of a LSMTreeIndexMutable class that manages the current mutable index and a subIndex in case there is a compacted index connected.

ArcadeDB uses pages to store index entries. Those pages are immutable once full and cannot be changed. This is why it is considered an append-only index. After a while, ArcadeDB runs the compactor that compacts the index by reading the content of the pages from disk, compresses the content and write them back into new pages to disk. This process happens in background while the index can be used by the application.

The LSMTreeIndexMutable class holds the current page in RAM so new entries can be quickly appended to the page. When the database is closed or when the page is full, the page is serialized to disk and becomes immutable. Since the pages are immutable, deletion are managed with special placeholders to mark the entries as removed.

Since the LSM-Tree is append only, the most updated entries are at the end of the index. If an entry is created and then deleted, the deletion will always be after the creation. For this reason cursors start from the last pages back to the first one available. While the cursor is browsing the pages back, it keeps track of the deleted values encountered.

### Compaction

During compaction, new compressed version of the pages are stored. The pages are stored in segments where the root page is the first page of the segment. A file can have multiple segments. The compaction requires a lot of RAM to properly compact large indexes and make them efficient. To control the amount of RAM the compaction task is using, the setting `arcadedb.indexCompactionRAM` is used to determine the maximum amount of RAM allowed to use for compaction. By default is 300MB of RAM. Also, the setting `arcadedb.indexCompactionMinPagesSchedule` tells the index when it is time for scheduling a compaction. By default the minimum is 10 pages not compacted. If you set `0`, the automatic compaction is disabled.

If, for example, the compaction task finds 20 pages to compact, but the RAM requirements allow only 10 pages to be compacted, then the task will process the first 10 pages in one segment and the remaining 10 pages in the following segment. Having multiple segments in the same file allows to run the compaction with a minimum amount of RAM if needed.

**Page layout**

There are 2 types of pages: root page and data page. The pages are populated from the head of the page by storing the pointers to the pair of key/value that are written from the tail. A page is full when there is no space between the head (key pointers) and the tail (key/value pairs). When a page is full, another page is created, waiting for a compaction.

**Root Page**

It's the first page of a segment of pages. The header contains more information than the Data Page (see below). Both root pages and data pages store keys. With mutable indexes the only difference is that the root page has a larger header. For compacted indexes, the root page does not store entries, but contains pointers to the data pages with the first key indexed on the page of the current segment.

Header:

```
[offsetFreeKeyValueContent(int:4),numberOfEntries(int:4),mutable(boolean:1),compactedP
ageNumberOfSeries(int:4),subIndexFileId(int:4),numberOfKeys(byte:1),keyType(byte:1)*]
```

- **offsetFreeKeyValueContent** is the offset in the page of free space to store key/value pairs. When a page is new, the offset points to the end of the page because the pairs are filled from the end to the beginning
- **numberOfEntries** number of entries (pairs) in the current page
- **mutable** 1 means mutable, 0 immutable. Immutable pages cannot be modified, only compacted and then removed at the end of compaction cycle
- **compactedPageNumberOfSeries** number of pages in the compacted segment. This is stored in the last page of the segment and it is used to count the pages of the current segment and therefore finding the root page of the segment
- **subIndexFileId** file id of compacted page segment
- **numberOfKeys** number of keys. If you're using a composite index, multiple keys are used, otherwise only 1
- **keyType** an array of key types. If the numberOfKeys is 3, then 3 bytes for keyType are written

**Data Page**

Header:

```
[offsetFreeKeyValueContent(int:4),numberOfEntries(int:4),mutable(boolean:1),compactedP
ageNumberOfSeries(int:4)]
```

Look the root page for the meaning of the header fields.

### Mutable Structure

Before being compacted, the LSM-Tree index is conceptually simple: new entries are always inserted in the last page of the file that is the only mutable page of the index. If the page is full, a new mutable page is created and the old mutable page become immutable and stored on disk. The entries in the page are written already ordered by key. This means a cursor can just browse the page from the first entry to the last to have ordered items. The search of a key is executed with the dichotomy algorithm. Pages can have entries with the same key, because have been added later in the index. On writing, the order of the keys is maintained inside the same page. This means to have a true ordered iterator, a virtual iterator is created with pointers to all the pages. Every time you move forward in the iterator, the next available key in the page pointer is compared among each other and the minor is returned. This can become quite expensive in the case of millions of entries and hundreds of pages. For this reason a periodic compaction is needed to keep values ordered together in the same page and also to remove deleted items.

# Chapter 13. Help

## 13.1. Community

Join our growing community around the world, for ideas, discussions and help regarding ArcadeDB.

- Chat live with us on Discord: https://discord.gg/w2Npx2B7hZ
- Follow us on Twitter: https://twitter.com/arcade_db
- or on Bluesky: https://bsky.app/profile/arcadedb.bsky.social
- Connect with us on LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/products/arcadedb
- or on Facebook: https://www.facebook.com/arcadedb
- Questions tagged `#arcadedb` on Stack Overflow: https://stackoverflow.com/questions/tagged/arcadedb
- View our official Blog: https://blog.arcadedb.com/

### 13.1.1. Professional Support

Need guaranteed response times and dedicated assistance for your production environment? ArcadeDB offers professional support plans to help you get the most out of your deployment.

- View available plans: Pricing
- Service level details: SLA

### 13.1.2. Frequently Asked Questions

- What is ArcadeDB's release cycle?
  - There are typically monthly releases with occasional bi-monthly releases.
- How do I build or contribute to ArcadeDB?
  - See the contributing guide in the ArcadeDB github repository: CONTRIBUTING.md
- What is a good introductory book about NoSQL or Graph databases?
  - Try **SQL and NoSQL Databases**. It teaches basics on relational (SQL), document (Mongo), and graph (Cypher) databases.
- How do I protect prepared statements against SQL injection?
  - A good starting point is the OWASP SQL Injection Prevention Cheat Sheet. To use escaping as defense, the characters `\`, `"`, `'`, need to be escaped with `\\`, `\"`, `\'` respectively. Furthermore, the strings `;` and `--` need to be replaced, for example with similar unicode characters like `;` (greek question mark, `\u037E`) and – (en dash, `\u2013`). Please note, that this escaping and replacing is merely a minimal protection, and generally not sufficient.
- How are duplicate keys handled in map properties or inserted content?
  - As in the ECMAScript Specification (Note 2), duplicate keys in JSON objects are resolved by

keeping the last one read and discarding previous ones.

- How can strictly ascending unique identifiers be data modeled with ArcadeDB?
  - One can use a unique index together with transactions of `next_id = max(id) + 1`. See https://www.cybertec-postgresql.com/en/postgresql-sequences-vs-invoice-numbers/ for more details.
- How can "prepared statements" be formed for ArcadeDB?
  - Prepared statements can be directly used via the Postgres driver and the JDBC driver. Furthermore, the Java API and the HTTP/JSON API provide parameterized queries and commands which can manually be extended to prepared statements by wrapping the respective method or request calls in a function and forwarding the function arguments to the parameterized query or command.
- How can database schema be maintained?
  - One can use `.sql` files listing the SQL commands creating the schema. To keep this script idempotent the DDL commands have to have the suffix `IF NOT EXISTS`. Such a SQL script can then be parsed using the `LOAD` command of the console, which can also run commands passed as command-line arguments.

# 13.2. Get the Latest Build

ArcadeDB ships a new official release roughly once a month, but every commit merged into the `main` branch is also packaged as a development build (a **SNAPSHOT**). If your fix has already landed on `main` and you don't want to wait for the next monthly release, you have two options:

1. **Build it yourself locally** — fastest if you already have a JDK and Maven, and produces the same artifacts the CI does.
2. **Pull the SNAPSHOT from Maven Central** — no toolchain required; just wait ~15 minutes after the commit lands.

Both options give you the **exact same code** — the difference is whether the bytes are produced on your machine or on the GitHub Actions runner.

## 13.2.1. Option 1: Build it Yourself

You'll need:

- **JDK 21 or newer** — check with `java -version`.
- **Maven 3.9+** — check with `mvn -version`.
- (optional) **Docker Desktop** — only required if you want a local Docker image; skip the `-Pdocker` profile otherwise.

Steps:

```
# 1. Clone the repository
git clone https://github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb.git
cd arcadedb
```

```
# 2. Build the project (skip tests for a faster build)
mvn clean install -DskipTests -Pdocker
```

The `-Pdocker` profile additionally builds and tags Docker images on your local Docker daemon. After the build completes you'll find them with:

```
docker images | grep arcadedata/arcadedb
```

You will see images such as `arcadedata/arcadedb:latest`, `arcadedata/arcadedb-minimal:latest`, and `arcadedata/arcadedb-headless:latest`, each also tagged with the snapshot version (for example `26.5.1-SNAPSHOT`). If you don't need Docker, just drop `-Pdocker` from the command.

The packaged distributions (`tar.gz` and `zip`) are produced in:

```
package/target/
```

Look for files named `arcadedb-<version>-SNAPSHOT-base.tar.gz`, `arcadedb-<version>-SNAPSHOT-base.zip`, and the `headless` variants. Unpack one of them and follow the same launch instructions as a stable release — see Installation from Binaries.

A clean build from scratch typically takes 2–4 minutes on a modern laptop. Re-runs are noticeably faster thanks to Maven's incremental compilation and dependency cache.

### 13.2.2. Option 2: Wait ~15 Minutes for the Maven Central SNAPSHOT

Every push to `main` triggers a GitHub Actions deploy workflow. As long as the build passes, it publishes the artifacts to Maven Central's snapshots repository — typically within ~15 minutes from the commit.

To consume the SNAPSHOT in your own project, point your build at the Maven Central snapshots repository.

**Maven (`pom.xml`)**:

```
<repositories>
  <repository>
    <id>central-snapshots</id>
    <url>https://central.sonatype.com/repository/maven-snapshots/</url>
    <releases><enabled>false</enabled></releases>
    <snapshots><enabled>true</enabled></snapshots>
  </repository>
</repositories>

<dependencies>
```

```
  <dependency>
    <groupId>com.arcadedb</groupId>
    <artifactId>arcadedb-engine</artifactId>
    <version>26.10.1-SNAPSHOT</version>
  </dependency>
</dependencies>
```

**Gradle (`build.gradle`):**

```
repositories {
  maven { url 'https://central.sonatype.com/repository/maven-snapshots/' }
}

dependencies {
  implementation 'com.arcadedb:arcadedb-engine:26.10.1-SNAPSHOT'
}
```

Replace `26.10.1-SNAPSHOT` with the version reported in the `pom.xml` of the `main` branch at the time of your build. The version is bumped after each official release, so the value changes over time.

To force Maven to re-resolve the latest snapshot (instead of using the locally cached one), pass the `-U` flag: `mvn -U clean install`.

### 13.2.3. Verifying You Have the Build You Expect

A SNAPSHOT distribution includes a `build.number` file at its root. Open it to confirm the exact commit hash and build timestamp:

```
cat arcadedb-<version>-SNAPSHOT/build.number
```

If you open an issue against a SNAPSHOT build, please include the contents of this file — see Report an Issue.

### 13.2.4. When to Use Which Option

| If you… | Use |
|---|---|
| Need to test a fix immediately and have JDK/Maven installed | Build it yourself |
| Want a Docker image of the snapshot on your local machine | Build it yourself with `-Pdocker` |
| Don’t want to install a toolchain | Wait for the Maven Central snapshot |

| If you… | Use |
| --- | --- |
| Are integrating ArcadeDB as a library dependency in your own project | Maven Central snapshot (with the repository declared in your build) |
| Need to reproduce CI behavior exactly | Maven Central snapshot |

## 13.3. Report an Issue

Very often when a new issue is open it lacks some fundamental information. This slows down the entire process because the first question from the ArcadeDB team is always "What release of ArcadeDB are you using?" and every time a Ferret dies in the world.

So please add more information about your issue:

1. ArcadeDB **release**? (If you're using a SNAPSHOT please attach also the build number found in "build.number" file)
2. What **steps** will reproduce the problem?
3. **Settings**. If you're using custom settings please provide them below (to dump all the settings run the application using the JVM argument `-Darcadedb.environment.dumpCfgAtStartup=true`)
4. What is the **expected behavior** or output? What do you get or see instead?
5. If you're describing a performance or memory problem the **profiler** dump can be very useful

Now you're ready to create a new issue on GitHub.

## 13.4. Requirements

### 13.4.1. Memory

ArcadeDB's memory (RAM) requirements depend on the configured profile:

- `default` profile: 800MB
- `low-ram` profile: 16MB

see also RAM Configuration.

### 13.4.2. Java

ArcadeDB runs on the Java Runtime Environment (JRE) in versions **21** (LTS) and **25** (LTS); tested JREs are:

- OpenJDK 17 is **NOT** compatible,
- OpenJDK 21 is compatible and the suggested version to use.
- Corretto 21 is also compatible.

The **headless** variants of JRE packages are compatible to ArcadeDB.

For now, a separate Java 17 branch and packages are maintained, see the README.

**Java 17**

Java 17 is supported through a special `java17` branch.

# Query Languages

# Chapter 14. SQL

## 14.1. SQL

ArcadeDB speaks SQL as its primary query language, extended for graph traversal, full-text search, time series, and vector similarity. Nine out of ten developers can write their first ArcadeDB query without learning anything new — the differences are covered in the ArcadeDB SQL dialect section below.

### 14.1.1. Introduction to SQL

When it comes to query languages, SQL is the most widely recognized standard. The majority of developers have experience and are comfortable with SQL. For this reason ArcadeDB uses SQL as its query language and adds some extensions to enable graph functionality. There are a few differences between the standard SQL syntax and that supported by ArcadeDB, but for the most part, it should feel very natural. The differences are covered in the ArcadeDB SQL dialect section of this page.

If you are looking for the most efficient way to traverse a graph, we suggest using MATCH instead.

Many SQL commands share the WHERE condition. Keywords are case insensitive, but type names, property names and values are case sensitive. In the following examples keywords are in uppercase but this is not strictly required.

For example, if you have a type `MyType` with a field named `id`, then the following SQL statements are equivalent:

```
SELECT * FROM MyType WHERE id = 1
select * from MyType where id = 1
```

The following is NOT equivalent. Notice that the field name 'ID' is not the same as 'id'.

```
SELECT * FROM MyType WHERE ID = 1
```

Also the following query is NOT equivalent because of the type 'mytype ' is not the same as 'MyType'.

```
SELECT * FROM mytype WHERE id = 1
```

### 14.1.2. Automatic usage of indexes

ArcadeDB allows you to execute queries against any field, indexed or not-indexed. The SQL engine automatically recognizes if any indexes can be used to speed up execution. You can also query any indexes directly by using `INDEX:<index-name>` as a target. Example:

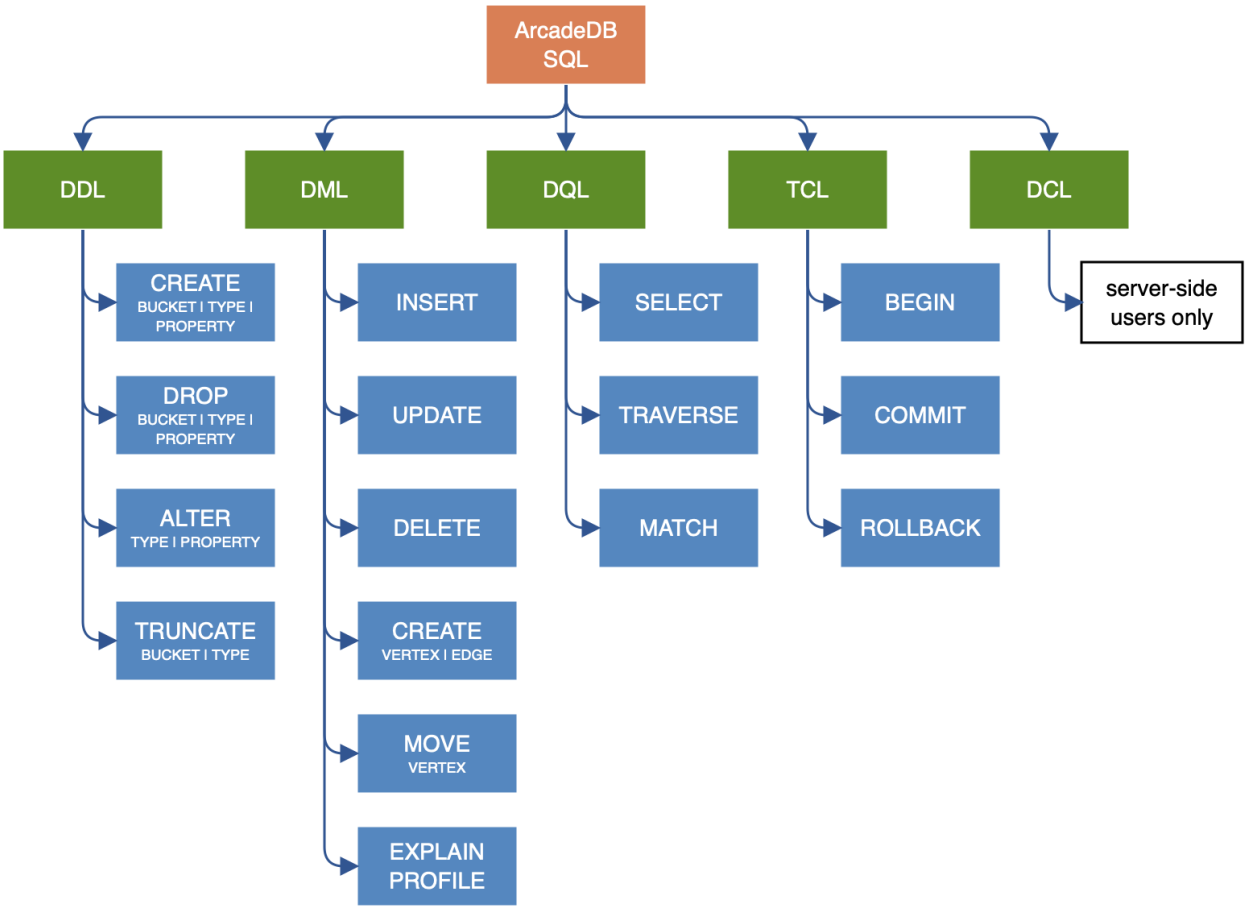
```
SELECT * FROM INDEX:myIndex WHERE key = 'Jay'
```

### 14.1.3. Extra resources

- Syntax
- Projections
- Where clause
- Operators
- Pagination
- SQL Script
- Match for traversing graphs

### 14.1.4. ArcadeDB SQL dialect

ArcadeDB supports SQL as a query language with some differences compared with SQL. The ArcadeDB team decided to avoid creating Yet-Another-Query-Language. Instead we started from familiar SQL with extensions to work with graphs. We prefer to focus on standards.



### 14.1.5. Learning SQL

If you want to learn SQL, there are many online courses such as:

- KhanAcademy
- Introduction to SQL at W3 Schools
- Beginner guide to SQL
- SQLCourse.com
- YouTube channel Basic SQL Training by Joey Blue

alternatively, order a book such as:

- SQL in 10 Minutes a Day
- or any of these.

For details on ArcadeDB's dialect, see ArcadeDB SQL Syntax. You can also download a SQL Command Cheat Sheet (pdf).

The simplest SQL query just returns a constant, and is given by:

```
SELECT 1
```

and could have practical use, for example, as a connection test. Furthermore, such constant queries can be used as a calculator:

```
SELECT sqrt(6.0 * 7.0)
```

A typical ArcadeDB SQL query has the following components:

```
SELECT projections
FROM type
WHERE predicate
GROUP BY property
ORDER BY projection
SKIP number
LIMIT number
```

for further components or details, see the SELECT command. As for classic SQL the execution order in ArcadeDB SQL is:

1. FROM
2. WHERE
3. GROUP BY
4. SELECT

5. `ORDER BY`
6. `SKIP`
7. `LIMIT`

### 14.1.6. No JOINs

The most important difference between ArcadeDB and a Relational Database is that relationships are represented by `LINKS` instead of JOINs.

For this reason, the typical JOIN syntax of relational databases is not supported. ArcadeDB uses the "dot (`.`) notation" to navigate `LINKS`. Example 1 : In SQL you might create a join such as:

```
SELECT *
FROM Employee A, City B
WHERE A.city = B.id
  AND B.name = 'Rome'
```

In ArcadeDB, an equivalent operation would be:

```
SELECT *
FROM Employee
WHERE city.name = 'Rome'
```

Another example:

```
SELECT *
FROM Employee A, City B, Country C
WHERE A.city = B.id
  AND B.country = C.id
  AND C.name = 'Italy'
```

In ArcadeDB, an equivalent operation would be:

```
SELECT *
FROM Employee
WHERE city.country.name = 'Italy'
```

Furthermore, RIDs can be resolved by nested projections.

### 14.1.7. Projection

In SQL, projections are mandatory and you can use the star character `*` to include all of the fields. With ArcadeDB this type of projection is optional. Example: In SQL to select all of the columns of Customer you would write:

```
SELECT * FROM Customer
```

In ArcadeDB, the * may be omitted:

```
SELECT FROM Customer
```

### 14.1.8. System Types

ArcadeDB exposes several read-only virtual types under the `schema:` prefix that let you introspect the database from SQL. They behave like any other type: projections, filters, `ORDER BY`, `LIMIT` and aggregations all work, and you can `expand()` collection-valued properties.

| Virtual type | What it returns |
|---|---|
| `schema:types` | One row per defined document/vertex/edge/timeseries type. Properties: `name`, `type` (`document`/`vertex`/`edge`/`timeseries`), `records` (count), `buckets`, `bucketSelectionStrategy`, `parentTypes`, nested `properties` (with `name`, `type`, `mandatory`, `readOnly`, `notNull`, `min`, `max`, `default`, `regexp`, `compression`, `custom`, ...) and nested `indexes`. For external properties also `externalBuckets`. For time series types, additional time-series metadata. |
| `schema:buckets` | One row per bucket (the physical storage unit). Properties: `name`, `fileId`, `records` (count), `purpose` (e.g. `PRIMARY`; filter with `WHERE purpose = 'PRIMARY'` to hide internal buckets like external-property pairs). |
| `schema:indexes` | One row per index. Properties: `name`, `indexType`, `typeName`, `properties`, `keyTypes`, `unique`, `automatic`, `compacting`, `fileId`, `size`, `supportsOrderedIterations`, `associatedBucketId`, `nullStrategy`. |
| `schema:database` | A single row with database-wide metadata: `name`, `path`, `mode`, `size`, `dateFormat`, `dateTimeFormat`, `timezone`, `encoding`, plus a `settings` array of all `DATABASE`-scoped global settings (`key`, `value`, `default`, `description`, `overridden`). Use `SELECT expand(settings) FROM schema:database` to list current settings, or wrap it in a subquery to filter: `SELECT FROM ( SELECT expand(settings) FROM schema:database ) WHERE key = '<setting>'`. Password values are masked. |
| `schema:materializedviews` | One row per materialized view. Properties: `name`, `query`, `backingType`, `refreshMode`, `refreshInterval`, `simpleQuery`, `lastRefreshTime`, `status`, `sourceTypes`, plus runtime metrics: `refreshCount`, `refreshTotalTimeMs`, `refreshMinTimeMs`, `refreshMaxTimeMs`, `refreshAvgTimeMs`, `errorCount`, `lastRefreshDurationMs`. |
| `schema:graphanalyticalviews` | One row per graph analytical view. Properties: `name`, `vertexTypes`, `edgeTypes`, `propertyFilter`, `edgePropertyFilter`, `updateMode`, `compactionThreshold`, plus live stats when the view is built: `status`, `nodeCount`, `edgeCount`, `memoryUsageBytes`, `buildTimestamp`, `buildDurationMs`. |

| Virtual type | What it returns |
| --- | --- |
| `schema:continuousaggregates` | One row per continuous aggregate (incremental rollup over a time-series source). Properties: `name`, `query`, `backingType`, `sourceType`, `bucketIntervalMs`, `bucketColumn`, `timestampColumn`, `watermarkTs`, `lastRefreshTime`, `status`, plus runtime metrics: `refreshCount`, `refreshTotalTimeMs`, `refreshMinTimeMs`, `refreshMaxTimeMs`, `refreshAvgTimeMs`, `errorCount`, `lastRefreshDurationMs`. |
| `schema:triggers` | One row per trigger. Properties: `name`, `typeName`, `timing` (`BEFORE`/`AFTER`), `event` (`CREATE`/`READ`/`UPDATE`/`DELETE`), `actionType` (`SQL`/`JAVASCRIPT`/`JAVA`) and `actionCode`. Triggers whose type the current user cannot read are omitted. Available since 26.10.1. |
| `schema:stats` | A single row with per-database runtime statistics (`databaseName` plus all entries returned by `Database.getStats()` — counters, cache hits/misses, page I/O and the like). Useful for ad-hoc diagnostics from the SQL console. |
| `schema:dictionary` | A single row describing the database property dictionary (the internal mapping of property names to numeric ids used to keep records compact): `totalEntries`, `totalPages`, and `entries` (a map of property name → dictionary id). |

Examples:

```
SELECT FROM schema:types
```

```
SELECT name, records FROM schema:buckets WHERE purpose = 'PRIMARY' ORDER BY records
DESC
```

```
SELECT FROM ( SELECT expand(settings) FROM schema:database ) WHERE key =
'arcadedb.serverMetrics'
```

### 14.1.9. DISTINCT

You can use DISTINCT keyword exactly as in a relational database:

```
SELECT DISTINCT name FROM City
```

### 14.1.10. HAVING

ArcadeDB does not support the `HAVING` keyword, but with a nested query it's easy to obtain the same result. Example in SQL:

```
SELECT city, sum(salary) AS salary
FROM Employee
GROUP BY city
```

```
HAVING salary > 1000
```

This groups all of the salaries by city and extracts the result of aggregates with the total salary greater than 1000 dollars. In ArcadeDB the `HAVING` conditions go in a select statement in the predicate:

```
SELECT
FROM ( SELECT city, SUM(salary) AS salary FROM Employee GROUP BY city )
WHERE salary > 1000
```

### 14.1.11. Multiple targets

ArcadeDB allows only one type (types are equivalent to tables in this discussion) as opposed to SQL, which allows for many tables as the target. If you want to select from 2 types, you have to execute 2 sub queries and join them with the `UNIONALL` function:

```
SELECT FROM E, V
```

In ArcadeDB, you can accomplish this with a few variable definitions and by using the `expand` function to the union:

**`DISTINCT` vs `distinct()`**

Query results without duplicates can be realized either using the keyword `DISTINCT` or the function `distinct()`. The keyword `DISTINCT` is be used if the entire projection should be unique, while the `distinct` function returns unique elements only for its argument field

**`UNWIND` vs `expand()`**

Collections fields can be spread into a set of results by either using the keyword `UNWIND` or the function `expand()`. Both produce similar results but via different semantics and constraints.

### 14.1.12. SQL Differences

Following are some basic differences between ArcadeDB and PostgreSQL.

| Postgres | ArcadeDB |
|---|---|
| `CREATE TABLE` | `CREATE TYPE` |
| `ALTER TABLE` | `ALTER TYPE` |
| `ADD COLUMN` | `CREATE PROPERTY` |
| `ALTER COLUMN` | `ALTER PROPERTY` |
| `SELECT * FROM information_schema.tables` | `SELECT FROM schema:types` |
| `SELECT * FROM pg_indexes` | `SELECT FROM schema:indexes` |
| `SELECT * FROM pg_database` | `SELECT FROM schema:database` |

However, there is a SQL condition where the two systems do differ. When you use functions that do not affect the column name, SQL defines that function name as the column name. In ArcadeDB, since we're projecting from a record, the resulting name remains the property name.

For instance, in SQL:

```
SELECT count(*) FROM Employee
```

would result in a data set with one column named "count(*)".

The ArcadeDB equivalent is:

```
SELECT count(*) FROM Employee
```

resulting in a data set with one column name of "count". If you specify a name for a column in a projection using the AS keyword, both SQL and ArcadeDB would use the provided name.

If you prefer having the function name as the column name, like standard SQL, use AS, like:

```
SELECT count(*) as _count_ FROM Employee
```

### 14.1.13. Commands

While the ArcadeDB SQL syntax is very similar to SQL-92, commands are similar but different. For more commands, see the diagram above.

### 14.1.14. Comments

Use `-- ` (two dashes followed by a space) for single line comments:

```
-- This is a single line comment
```

Use `/* ⋯ */` for multi-line comments.

```
/* this is a
   multiline comment */
```

## 14.2. SQL - SELECT

ArcadeDB supports the SQL language to execute queries against the database engine. For more information, see operators and functions. For more information on the differences between this implementation and the SQL-92 standard, please refer to this section.

**Syntax**:

```
SELECT [ [DISTINCT] <Projections> ]
    [ FROM <Target> [ [AS] <Alias> ] [ LET <Assignment>* ] ]
    [ WHERE <Condition>* ]
    [ GROUP BY <Field>* ]
    [ ORDER BY <Fields>* [ ASC|DESC ] * ]
    [ UNWIND <Field>* ]
    [ SKIP <SkipRecords> ]
    [ LIMIT <MaxRecords> ]
    [ TIMEOUT <MilliSeconds> [ <STRATEGY> ] ]
```

- `Projections` Indicates the data you want to extract from the query as the result-set. Note: In ArcadeDB, this variable is optional. In the projections you can define aliases for single fields, using the `AS` keyword; in current release aliases cannot be used in the WHERE condition, GROUP BY and ORDER BY (they will be evaluated to null)
  - `DISTINCT` enforces unique projection results.
- `FROM` Designates the object to query. This can be a type, bucket, single RID, set of RID index values sorted by ascending or descending key order.
  - When querying a type, for `<target>` use the type name.
  - When querying a bucket, for `<target>` use `BUCKET:<bucket-name>` (eg. `BUCKET:person`) or `BUCKET:<bucket-id>` ( eg. `BUCKET:12`). This causes the query to execute only on records in that bucket.
  - When querying record ID's, you can specific one or a small set of records to query. This is useful when you need to specify a starting point in navigating graphs.
  - To query the schema you can use one of the read-only `schema:*` virtual types (see System Types for the full list and the fields each one returns):
    - `select from schema:types` — defined types
    - `select from schema:buckets` — physical buckets
    - `select from schema:indexes` — defined indexes
    - `select from schema:database` — database metadata and settings
    - `select from schema:materializedviews` — materialized views
    - `select from schema:graphanalyticalviews` — graph analytical views
    - `select from schema:continuousaggregates` — continuous aggregates over time series
    - `select from schema:triggers` — defined triggers
    - `select from schema:stats` — per-database runtime statistics
    - `select from schema:dictionary` — property-name dictionary

      The `schema:*` targets support `WHERE`, `ORDER BY`, `SKIP` and `LIMIT` like any other target.
  - When querying indexes, use the following prefixes:

    - `INDEXVALUES:<index>` and `INDEXVALUESASC:<index>` sorts values into an ascending order of index keys.
    - `INDEXVALUESDESC:<index>` sorts the values into a descending order of index keys.
- **`AS <Alias>`** Optionally names the records the target returns, so the rest of the statement can refer to them by that name. The `AS` keyword is optional: `FROM Person p` and `FROM Person AS p` are the same. The alias can be used in the projections, `WHERE`, `LET`, `GROUP BY` and `ORDER BY`, and in `UPDATE` and `DELETE`, which take the same `FROM` clause. `p.name` is the record's `name` property and a bare `p` is the record itself, so `SELECT p FROM Person p` and `SELECT FROM Person` return the same thing. Qualifying a property with the alias does not cost you an index: `SELECT FROM Person p WHERE p.name = 'Luke'` uses an index on `Person.name` exactly as the unqualified form does. When a projection gives a column the same name as the target alias, `ORDER BY` and `GROUP BY` mean the column.
- **`WHERE`** Designates conditions to filter the result-set.
- **`LET`** Binds context variables to use in projections, conditions or sub-queries.
- **`GROUP BY`** Designates field on which to group the result-set.
- **`ORDER BY`** Designates the field with which to order the result-set. Use the optional `ASC` and `DESC` operators, or `true` (= `ASC`) and `false` (= `DESC`), to define the direction of the order. The default is ascending. Additionally, if you are using a projection, you need to include the `ORDER BY` field in the projection. An aggregate function can be used in `ORDER BY` together with `GROUP BY`, for example `SELECT k, sum(v) FROM T GROUP BY k ORDER BY sum(v) DESC`, and the groups are sorted by the aggregate.
- **`GROUP BY`** and **`ORDER BY`** may contain comments between the two words (`ORDER /* by id */ BY id`), like anywhere else in the statement.
- **Integer literals** can be written in decimal or hexadecimal (`0xFF`, or `0xFFL` for a long). A hexadecimal value above `2147483647` is a long, it is not read as a negative number.
- **`UNWIND`** Designates the field on which to unwind the collection.
- **`SKIP`** Defines the number of records you want to skip from the start of the result-set. You may find this useful in Pagination, when using it in conjunction with `LIMIT`.
- **`LIMIT`** Defines the maximum number of records in the result-set. You may find this useful in Pagination, when using it in conjunction with `SKIP`.
- **`TIMEOUT`** Defines the maximum time in milliseconds for the query. By default, queries have no timeouts. If you don't specify a timeout strategy, it defaults to `EXCEPTION`. These are the available timeout strategies:
    - `RETURN` Truncate the result-set, returning the data collected up to the timeout.
    - `EXCEPTION` Raises an exception.

### Examples

- Return all records of the type `Person`, where the name starts with `Luk`:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM Person WHERE name LIKE 'Luk%'
```

- The same query, naming the target `p` and referring to it in the filter:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM Person p WHERE p.name LIKE 'Luk%'
```

Alternatively, you might also use either of these queries:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM Person WHERE name.left(3) = 'Luk'
ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM Person WHERE name.substring(0,3) = 'Luk'
```

- Return all records of the type `!AnimalType` where the collection `races` contains at least one entry where the first character is `e`, ignoring case:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM animaltype WHERE races CONTAINS( name.toLowerCase().subString(
            0, 1) = 'e' )
```

- Return all records of type `!AnimalType` where the collection `races` contains at least one entry with names `European` or `Asiatic`:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT * FROM animaltype WHERE races CONTAINS(name in ['European',
            'Asiatic'])
```

- Return all records in the type `Profile` where any field contains the word `danger`:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM Profile WHERE @this.values().asString() LIKE '%danger%'
```

- Return all results on type `Profile`, ordered by the field `name` in descending order:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM Profile ORDER BY name DESC
```

- Return the number of records in the type `Account` per city:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT SUM(*) FROM Account GROUP BY city
```

- Return only a limited set of records:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM [#10:3, #10:4, #10:5]
```

- Return three fields from the type `Profile`:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT nick, followings, followers FROM Profile
```

- Return the field `name` in uppercase and the field country name of the linked city of the address:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT name.toUppercase(), address.city.country.name FROM Profile
```

- Return records from the type `Profile` in descending order of their creation:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM Profile ORDER BY @rid DESC
```

- Return value of `email` which is stored in a JSON field `data` (type EMBEDDED) of the type `Person`, where the name starts with `Luk`:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT data.email FROM Person WHERE name LIKE 'Luk%'
```

ArcadeDB can open an inverse cursor against buckets. This is very fast and doesn't require the typical ordering resources, CPU and RAM.

**Projections**

In the standard implementations of SQL, projections are mandatory. In ArcadeDB, the omission of projects translates to its returning the entire record. That is, it reads no projection as the equivalent of the `*` wildcard.

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM Account
```

For all projections except the wildcard `*`, it creates a new temporary document, which does not include the `@rid` fields of the original record.

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT name, age FROM Account
```

The naming convention for the returned document fields are:

- Field name for plain fields, like `invoice` becoming `invoice`.
- First field name for chained fields, like `invoice.customer.name` becoming `invoice`.
- Function name for functions, like `MAX(salary)` becoming `max`.

In the event that the target field exists, it uses a numeric progression. For instance,

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT MAX(incoming), MAX(cost) FROM Balance

------+------
 max  | max2
------+------
 1342 | 2478
```

```
------+------
```

To override the display for the field names, use the `AS`.

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT MAX(incoming) AS max_incoming, MAX(cost) AS max_cost FROM Balance

---------------+----------
 max_incoming  | max_cost
---------------+----------
 1342          | 2478
---------------+----------
```

With the dollar sign `$`, you can access the context variables. Each time you run the command, ArcadeDB accesses the context to read and write the variables. For instance, say you want to display the path and depth levels up to the fifth of a `TRAVERSE` on all records in the `Movie` type.

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT $path, $depth FROM ( TRAVERSE out() FROM Movie WHERE $depth <= 5 )
```

### 14.2.1. `LET` Block

The `LET` block contains context variables to assign each time ArcadeDB evaluates a record. It destroys these values once the query execution ends. You can use context variables in projections, conditions, and sub-queries.

#### Assigning Fields for Reuse

ArcadeDB allows for crossing relationships. In single queries, you need to evaluate the same branch of the nested relationship. This is better than using a context variable that refers to the full relationship.

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM Profile WHERE address.city.name LIKE '%Saint%"' AND
          ( address.city.country.name = 'Italy' OR
            address.city.country.name = 'France' )
```

Using the `LET` makes the query shorter and faster, because it traverses the relationships only once:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM Profile LET $city = address.city WHERE $city.name LIKE
          '%Saint%"' AND ($city.country.name = 'Italy' OR $city.country.name =
'France')
```

In this case, it traverses the path till `address.city` only once.

### 14.2.2. Sub-query

The `LET` block allows you to assign a context variable to the result of a sub-query.

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM Document LET $temp = ( SELECT @rid, $depth FROM (TRAVERSE
          V.OUT, E.IN FROM $parent.current ) WHERE @type = 'Concept' AND
          ( id = 'first concept' OR id = 'second concept' )) WHERE $temp.SIZE() > 0
```

#### `LET` Block in Projection

You can use context variables as part of a result-set in projections. For instance, the query below displays the city name from the previous example:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT $temp.name FROM Profile LET $temp = address.city WHERE $city.name
          LIKE '%Saint%"' AND ( $city.country.name = 'Italy' OR
          $city.country.name = 'France' )
```

### 14.2.3. Unwinding

ArcadeDB allows unwinding of collection fields and obtaining multiple records as a result, one for each element in the collection:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT name, OUT("Friend").name AS friendName FROM Person

--------+------------------
 name   | friendName
--------+------------------
 'John' | ['Mark', 'Steve']
--------+------------------
```

In the event if you want one record for each element in `friendName`, you can rewrite the query using `UNWIND`:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT name, OUT("Friend").name AS friendName FROM Person UNWIND friendName

--------+-------------
 name   | friendName
--------+-------------
 'John' | 'Mark'
 'John' | 'Steve'
--------+-------------
```

`UNWIND` works the same way on the array types (`SHORT[]`, `INTEGER[]`, `LONG[]`, `FLOAT[]`, `DOUBLE[]`), giving one record per element. A `BINARY` property is left untouched: it is an opaque blob, not a sequence of values, so it is never split into one record per byte.

## 14.3. SQL - `INSERT`

The `INSERT` command creates a new record in the database. Records can be schema-less or follow

rules specified in your model.

**Syntax**:

```
INSERT INTO [TYPE:]<type>|BUCKET:<bucket>|INDEX:<index>
  [(<field>[,]*) VALUES (<expression>[,]*)[,]*]|
  [SET <field> = <expression>|<sub-command>[,]*]|
  [CONTENT {<JSON>}|[{<JSON>}[,]*]]
  [ON DUPLICATE KEY SKIP]
  [RETURN <expression>]
  [FROM <query>]
```

- `SET` Abbreviated syntax to set field values.
- `CONTENT` Defines JSON data as an option to set field values of one (object) or multiple (in an array of objects) records.
- `ON DUPLICATE KEY SKIP` When inserting multiple records, skips any record that would violate a **unique** index instead of aborting the whole command. Each result row tells you whether that record was inserted or skipped. Any other kind of error (for example, a missing mandatory field) still aborts the command as usual.
- `RETURN` Defines an expression to return instead of the number of inserted records. You can use any valid SQL expression. The most common use-cases,
  - `@rid` Returns the Record ID of the new record.
  - `@this` Returns the entire new record.
- `FROM` Defines where you want to insert the result-set.

To insert only documents, vertices, or edges with a certain **unique** property, use a unique index.

`INSERT INTO <timeseries type>` is the one `INSERT` target that is **not atomic with the transaction containing it**. The samples are committed as they are appended: they are durable and visible to every other connection as soon as the statement returns, and rolling the transaction back does not take them back. Every other `INSERT` target behaves normally, which is exactly why this one surprises people. See Appends and Transactions for why, and for the same statement about the other ingestion paths.

If multiple documents are inserted as JSON "CONTENT", and one document causes an error, for example due to a schema error, the remaining documents in the JSON array are not inserted. Add `ON DUPLICATE KEY SKIP` if you only want to skip records that clash with a unique index, instead of aborting the rest of the batch.

**Examples**

- Inserts a new record with the name `Jay` and surname `Miner`.

As an example, in the SQL-92 standard, such as with a Relational database, you might use:

```
ArcadeDB> INSERT INTO Profile (name, surname)
            VALUES ('Jay', 'Miner')
```

Alternatively, in the ArcadeDB abbreviated syntax, the query would be written as,

```
ArcadeDB> INSERT INTO Profile SET name = 'Jay', surname = 'Miner'
```

In JSON content syntax, it would be written as this,

```
ArcadeDB> INSERT INTO Profile CONTENT {"name": "Jay", "surname": "Miner"}
```

- Insert a new record of the type `Profile`, but in a different bucket from the default.

In SQL-92 syntax:

```
ArcadeDB> INSERT INTO Profile BUCKET profile_recent (name, surname) VALUES
            ('Jay', 'Miner')
```

Alternative, in the ArcadeDB abbreviated syntax:

```
ArcadeDB> INSERT INTO Profile BUCKET profile_recent SET name = 'Jay',
            surname = 'Miner'
```

- Insert several records at the same time:

```
ArcadeDB> INSERT INTO Profile (name, surname) VALUES ('Jay', 'Miner'),
            ('Frank', 'Hermier'), ('Emily', 'Sout')
```

again in JSON content syntax, a JSON array of the to-be-inserted objects is passed:

```
ArcadeDB> INSERT INTO Profile CONTENT [{"name": "Jay", "surname": "Miner"},
            {"name": "Frank", "surname": "Hermier"},{"name": "Emily", "surname":
"Sout"}]
```

- Insert several records, skipping any that clash with a unique index:

```
ArcadeDB> INSERT INTO Product CONTENT [{"sku": "A1", "name": "Widget"},
            {"sku": "A2", "name": "Gadget"}] ON DUPLICATE KEY SKIP
```

If `Product.sku` is a unique index and a record with `sku = 'A1'` already exists, that record is skipped and the rest are still inserted.

- Insert a new record, adding a relationship.

In SQL-92 syntax:

```
ArcadeDB> INSERT INTO Employee (name, boss) VALUES ('jack', #11:9)
```

In the ArcadeDB abbreviated syntax:

```
ArcadeDB> INSERT INTO Employee SET name = 'jack', boss = #11:99
```

- Insert a new record, add a collection of relationships.

In SQL-93 syntax:

```
ArcadeDB> INSERT INTO Profile (name, friends) VALUES ('Luca', [#10:3, #10:4])
```

In the ArcadeDB abbreviated syntax:

```
ArcadeDB> INSERT INTO Profiles SET name = 'Luca', friends = [#10:3, #10:4]
```

- Inserts using `SELECT` sub-queries

```
ArcadeDB> INSERT INTO Diver SET name = 'Luca', buddy = (SELECT FROM Diver
            WHERE name = 'Marko')
```

- Inserts using `INSERT` sub-queries:

```
ArcadeDB> INSERT INTO Diver SET name = 'Luca', buddy = (INSERT INTO Diver
            SET name = 'Marko')
```

- Inserting into a different bucket:

```
ArcadeDB> INSERT INTO BUCKET:asiaemployee (name) VALUES ('Matthew')
```

However, note that the document has no assigned type. To create a document of a certain type, but in a different bucket than the default, instead use:

```
ArcadeDB> INSERT INTO BUCKET:asiaemployee (@type, content) VALUES
```

```
            ('Employee', 'Matthew')
```

That inserts the document of the type `Employee` into the bucket `asiaemployee`.

- Insert a new record, adding it as an embedded document:

```
ArcadeDB> INSERT INTO Profile (name, address) VALUES ('Luca', { "@type": "d",
            "street": "Melrose Avenue"})
```

- Insert a record with a list property:

```
ArcadeDB> INSERT INTO Profile SET friends = list("Joe","Jack","John")
```

- Insert a record with a map property:

```
ArcadeDB> INSERT INTO Profile SET address = map("home","Avenue Lane")
```

- Insert from a query.

To copy records from another type, use:

```
ArcadeDB> INSERT INTO GermanyClient FROM SELECT FROM Client WHERE
            country = 'Germany'
```

This inserts all the records from the type `Client` where the country is Germany, in the type `GermanyClient`.

To copy records from one type into another, while adding a field:

```
ArcadeDB> INSERT INTO GermanyClient FROM SELECT *, true AS copied FROM Client
            WHERE country = 'Germany'
```

This inserts all records from the type `Client` where the country is Germany into the type `GermanClient`, with the addition field `copied` to the value `true`.

- Insert a vertex.

Besides the specialized command CREATE VERTEX, vertices and edges can be inserted via the `INSERT` command:

```
ArcadeDB> INSERT INTO MyVertexType SET name = 'John Doe'
```

However, edges have to be created with CREATE EDGE.

## 14.4. SQL - UPDATE

Update one or more records in the current database. Remember: ArcadeDB can work in schema-less mode, so you can create any field on-the-fly. Furthermore, the command also supports extensions to work on collections.

**Syntax**:

```
UPDATE <type>|BUCKET:<bucket>|<recordID>
  [SET|REMOVE <field-name> = <field-value>[,]*]|[CONTENT|MERGE <JSON>]
  [UPSERT]
  [APPLY DEFAULTS]
  [RETURN <returning> [<returning-expression>]]
  [WHERE <conditions>]
  [LIMIT <max-records>] [BATCH <batch-size>] [TIMEOUT <MilliSeconds>]
```

- `SET` Defines the fields to update. On an edge, `SET @in = <rid>` / `SET @out = <rid>` re-points the edge to another vertex. The other metadata names (`@rid`, `@type`, `@cat`, `@props`, `@this`) are not properties and are refused (since v26.11.1: earlier versions stored them as properties no query could read back, and reported the record as updated).
- `REMOVE` Removes an item in collection and map fields or a property.
- `CONTENT` Replaces the record content with a JSON document.
- `MERGE` Merges the record content with a JSON document.
- `UPSERT` Updates a record if it exists or inserts a new record if it doesn't. This avoids the need to execute two commands, (one for each condition, inserting and updating). `UPSERT` requires a `WHERE` clause and a type target. There are further limitations on `UPSERT`, explained below. Practically `UPSERT` means: `UPDATE` if the `WHERE` condition is fulfilled, otherwise `INSERT`. `UPSERT` works on document types **and on vertex types**: when the target is a vertex type and no existing record matches, a brand new vertex (not a plain document) is created, with all the graph capabilities (incoming/outgoing edges, `@in`/`@out` projections, etc.). For edge types, `UPSERT` is not available because edges always require `FROM` and `TO` endpoints; use `CREATE EDGE … IF NOT EXISTS` instead.
- `APPLY DEFAULTS` applies a properties' default attribute on an update again.
- `RETURN` Specifies an expression to return instead of the record and what to do with the result-set returned by the expression. The available return operators are:
  - `COUNT` Returns the number of updated records. This is the default return operator.
  - `BEFORE` Returns the records before the update.
  - `AFTER` Return the records after the update.
- `WHERE` Defines the subset of records to be updated.
- `LIMIT` Defines the maximum number of records to update.

Since 26.10.1, when an index serves the `WHERE` and the statement changes a property of that index (for example `UPDATE V SET a = a + 10 WHERE a BETWEEN 0`

> AND 1000), the set of records to update is fixed before the first one is changed. Each record is updated once, even when its new key falls inside the range. Records are then updated in storage order rather than in index order, which can change the order of the rows returned by RETURN BEFORE and RETURN AFTER.

- BATCH Defines the number of records to update in each transaction batch. When set, the command commits the current transaction every <batch-size> records and begins a new one. This is essential for updating large datasets (e.g., millions of records) that would otherwise consume too much memory in a single transaction.

> Because BATCH commits as it goes, an UPDATE ⋯ BATCH is not atomic: a failure part way through leaves the records committed up to the last batch boundary in place. For the same reason, running it inside a transaction opened by your application makes that transaction no longer atomic either, and a rollback cannot undo what the batches already committed. A transaction() block with retries does not retry in that case: the conflict is propagated to your application instead, since repeating the block would apply the already committed records a second time. Since 26.10.1 a SQL Script BEGIN ⋯ COMMIT RETRY <n> block behaves the same way.

- TIMEOUT Defines the time you want to allow the update run before it times out.

**Examples**

- Update to change the value of a field:

```
ArcadeDB> UPDATE Profile SET nick = 'Luca' WHERE nick IS NULL
```

- Update to remove a field from all records:

```
ArcadeDB> UPDATE Profile REMOVE nick
```

- Update to remove a value from a collection, if you know the exact value that you want to remove:

Remove an element from a link list or set:

```
ArcadeDB> UPDATE Account REMOVE address = #12:0
```

Remove an element from a list or set of strings:

```
ArcadeDB> UPDATE Account REMOVE addresses = 'Foo'
```

Append an element to a list or set of strings:

```
ArcadeDB> UPDATE Account SET addresses += 'Foo'
```

- Update to remove a value, filtering on value attributes.

Remove addresses based in the city of Rome:

```
ArcadeDB> UPDATE Account REMOVE addresses = addresses[city = 'Rome']
```

- Update to remove a value, filtering based on position in the collection.

```
ArcadeDB> UPDATE Account REMOVE addresses = addresses[1]
```

This remove the second element from a list, (position numbers start from `0`, so `addresses[1]` is the second element).

- Update a map entry

```
ArcadeDB> UPDATE #87:0 SET pages += { "homePage": "doctor.html" }
```

- Update a single map key or list position in place

```
ArcadeDB> UPDATE Account SET settings.theme = 'dark'
ArcadeDB> UPDATE Account SET settings['theme'] = 'dark'
ArcadeDB> UPDATE Account SET addresses[0] = 'Foo'
```

Before 26.10.1 these nested assignments were reported as successful but were never stored. If you relied on them on an earlier release, re-check the affected records. Before the same release, a positional assignment on a property whose value is a **set** always failed with a `ConcurrentModificationException` and left the value truncated.

A positional assignment past the end of a collection, such as `addresses[5] = 'Foo'` on a 3-element list, pads the missing positions with `null`. A property whose value is a **set** is the exception: a set cannot hold `null` more than once, so several missing positions collapse into one and the value lands right after it - `[a, b, c, null, Foo]` rather than `[a, b, c, null, null, Foo]`. Declare the property as `LIST` if every position must be addressable.

- Update to remove a value from a map

```
ArcadeDB> UPDATE Account REMOVE addresses = 'Luca'
```

- Update to remove a property values from records

```
ArcadeDB> UPDATE Account REMOVE addresses WHERE addresses = 'unknown'
```

- Update an embedded document. The `UPDATE` command can take JSON as a value to update.

```
ArcadeDB> UPDATE Account SET address={ "street": "Melrose Avenue", "city": {
            "name": "Beverly Hills" } }
```

- Update the first twenty records that satisfy a condition:

```
ArcadeDB> UPDATE Profile SET nick = 'Luca' WHERE nick IS NULL LIMIT 20
```

- Update millions of records in batches of 10,000 to avoid loading all records into a single transaction:

```
ArcadeDB> UPDATE Profile SET verified = true WHERE verified IS NULL BATCH 10000
```

- Update a record or insert if it doesn't already exist:

```
ArcadeDB> UPDATE Profile SET nick = 'Luca' UPSERT WHERE nick = 'Luca'
```

- Upsert a vertex by a natural key. With a `UNIQUE` index on `Person.email`, this either updates the existing person or creates a new vertex (not a plain document) of type `Person`:

```
ArcadeDB> UPDATE Person SET name = 'Luca', email = 'luca@example.com'
            UPSERT WHERE email = 'luca@example.com'
```

The newly created record is a real vertex, so it can immediately participate in graph traversals and be the source/target of `CREATE EDGE`.

- Updates using the `RETURN` keyword:

```
ArcadeDB> UPDATE #7:0 SET gender='male' RETURN AFTER @rid
ArcadeDB> UPDATE #7:0 SET gender='male' RETURN AFTER @this
ArcadeDB> UPDATE #7:0 SET gender='male' RETURN AFTER
$current.exclude("really_big_field")
```

In the event that a single field is returned, ArcadeDB wraps the result-set in a record storing the value in the field `result`. This avoids introducing a new serialization, as there is no primitive values collection serialization in the binary protocol. Additionally, it provides useful fields like `version` and `rid` from the original record in corresponding fields. The new syntax allows for optimization of

client-server network traffic.

For more information on SQL syntax, see SELECT.

**Limitations of the UPSERT Clause**

The UPSERT clause only guarantees atomicity when you use a UNIQUE index and perform the look-up on the index through the WHERE condition. This applies to both document and vertex types.

```
ArcadeDB> UPDATE Client SET id = 23 UPSERT WHERE id = 23
```

Here, you must have a unique index on Client.id to guarantee uniqueness on concurrent operations.

The same rule applies when upserting vertices: define a UNIQUE index on the natural key first.

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON Person (email) UNIQUE
ArcadeDB> UPDATE Person SET name = 'Luca', email = 'luca@example.com'
            UPSERT WHERE email = 'luca@example.com'
```

Additional restrictions:

- the WHERE condition must be a non-null equality on **every** property of a UNIQUE index. A non-unique index, a partial match of a composite index (key prefix), a range, an IN list or a null value is rejected with the error "Upsert must involve a UNIQUE index to retrieve the records", because it could create duplicate records.
- the WHERE condition cannot use OR. Only an AND chain of equality conditions is supported, because each equality term is also reused as the initial value of the property when a new record has to be created.
- UPSERT is not available on edge types. To create an edge only if it does not already exist, use CREATE EDGE ⋯ IF NOT EXISTS.

## 14.5. SQL - DELETE

Removes one or more records from the database. You can refine the set of records that it removes using the WHERE clause.

**Syntax:**

```
DELETE FROM <Type>|BUCKET:<bucket>|INDEX:<index> [RETURN <returning>]
  [WHERE <Condition>*] [LIMIT <MaxRecords>] [BATCH <batch-size>]
  [TIMEOUT <MilliSeconds>] [UNSAFE]
```

- RETURN Defines what values the database returns. It takes one of the following values:
  - COUNT Returns the number of deleted records. This is the default option.

    - `BEFORE` Returns the number of records before the removal.
- `WHERE` Filters to the records you want to delete.
- `LIMIT` Defines the maximum number of records to delete.
- `BATCH` Defines the number of records to delete in each transaction batch. When set, the command commits the current transaction every `<batch-size>` records and begins a new one. This is essential for deleting large datasets (e.g., millions of records) that would otherwise consume too much memory in a single transaction.
- `TIMEOUT` Defines the time period to allow the operation to run, before it times out.
- `UNSAFE` no use, is kept only for compatibility with OrientDB SQL and it could be removed in the future versions of the SQL language.

**Examples:**

- Delete all records with the surname `unknown`, ignoring case:

```
ArcadeDB> DELETE FROM Profile WHERE surname.toLowerCase() = 'unknown'
```

- Delete all records of the type `Document`, due to an improper JSON import, or record creation command (note the use of the backticks):

```
ArcadeDB> DELETE FROM `Document`
```

- Delete all records from a large type in batches of 20,000 to avoid loading millions of records into a single transaction:

```
ArcadeDB> DELETE FROM LargeDataset BATCH 20000
```

- Delete matching records from a large type with a condition, committing every 10,000 records:

```
ArcadeDB> DELETE FROM LogEntry WHERE createdAt < '2025-01-01' BATCH 10000
```

## 14.6. SQL - `MATCH`

Queries the database in a declarative manner, using pattern matching (inspired by Cypher).

Let's start with some examples.

The following examples are based on this sample data-set from the type `People`:

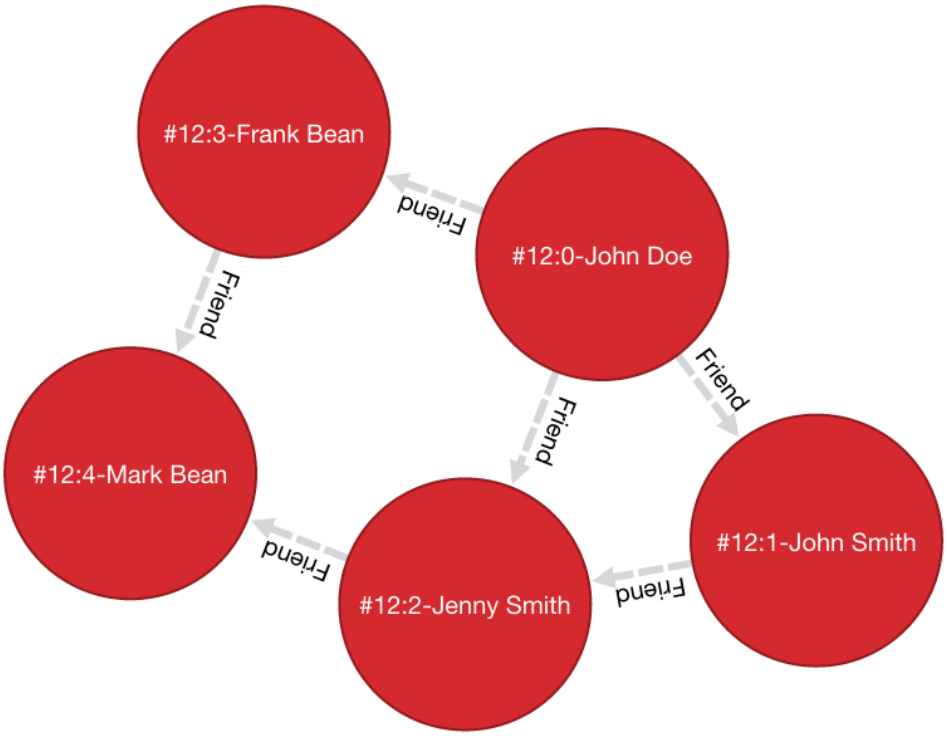
COMMAND

select from person

| METADATA | | | PROPERTIES | | | IN | OUT |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| @rid | @version | @class | surname | name | fullName | Friend | Friend |
| #12:0 | 8 | Person | Doe | John | #12:0-John Doe | | #12:1 #12:3 #12:2 |
| #12:1 | 7 | Person | Smith | John | #12:1-John Smith | #12:0 | #12:2 |
| #12:2 | 8 | Person | Smith | Jenny | #12:2-Jenny Smith | #12:1 #12:0 | #12:4 |
| #12:3 | 7 | Person | Bean | Frank | #12:3-Frank Bean | #12:0 | #12:4 |
| #12:4 | 7 | Person | Bean | Mark | #12:4-Mark Bean | #12:3 #12:2 | |

10 25 50 100 1000 5000

Query executed in 0.009 sec. Returned 5 record(s). Limit: 20 (change it) Table Raw




- Find all people with the name John:

```
ArcadeDB> MATCH {type: Person, as: people, where: (name = 'John')}
            RETURN people

---------
  people
---------
  #12:0
```

```
  #12:1
---------
```

- Find all people with the name John and the surname Smith:

```
ArcadeDB> MATCH  {type: Person, as: people, where: (name = 'John' AND surname =
'Smith')}
            RETURN people

-------
people
-------
 #12:1
-------
```

- Find people named John with their friends:

```
ArcadeDB> MATCH {type: Person, as: person, where: (name = 'John')}.both('Friend') {as:
friend}
            RETURN person, friend

--------+---------
 person | friend
--------+---------
 #12:0  | #12:1
 #12:0  | #12:2
 #12:0  | #12:3
 #12:1  | #12:0
 #12:1  | #12:2
--------+---------
```

- Find friends of friends:

```
ArcadeDB> MATCH {type: Person, as: person, where: (name = 'John' AND surname = 'Doe')}
            .both('Friend').both('Friend') {as: friendOfFriend}
            RETURN person, friendOfFriend

--------+----------------
 person | friendOfFriend
--------+----------------
 #12:0  | #12:0
 #12:0  | #12:1
 #12:0  | #12:2
 #12:0  | #12:3
 #12:0  | #12:4
--------+----------------
```

- Correlate two patterns by a property, here the files whose `path` equals the `filePath` stored on the matched source:

```
ArcadeDB> MATCH {type: Source, as: s, where: (id = 's1')},
            {type: File, as: f, where: (path = $matched.s.filePath)}
          RETURN f.path AS path, $matched.s.filePath AS sourcePath
```

- Find people, excluding the current user:

```
ArcadeDB> MATCH {type: Person, as: person, where: (name = 'John' AND
            surname = 'Doe')}.both('Friend').both('Friend'){as: friendOfFriend,
            where: ($matched.person != $currentMatch)}
            RETURN person, friendOfFriend

--------+----------------
 person | friendOfFriend
--------+----------------
 #12:0  | #12:1
 #12:0  | #12:2
 #12:0  | #12:3
 #12:0  | #12:4
--------+----------------
```

- Find friends of friends to the sixth degree of separation:

```
ArcadeDB> MATCH {type: Person, as: person, where: (name = 'John' AND
            surname = 'Doe')}.both('Friend'){as: friend,
            where: ($matched.person != $currentMatch), while: ($depth < 6)}
            RETURN person, friend

--------+---------
 person | friend
--------+---------
 #12:0  | #12:0
 #12:0  | #12:1
 #12:0  | #12:2
 #12:0  | #12:3
 #12:0  | #12:4
--------+---------
```

- Finding friends of friends to six degrees of separation, since a particular date:

```
ArcadeDB> MATCH {type: Person, as: person,
            where: (name = 'John')}.(bothE('Friend'){
            where: (date < ?)}.bothV()){as: friend,
            while: ($depth < 6)} RETURN person, friend
```

In this case, the condition `$depth < 6` refers to traversing the block `bothE('Friend')` six times.

- Find friends of my friends who are also my friends, using multiple paths:

```
ArcadeDB> MATCH {type: Person, as: person, where: (name = 'John' AND
            surname = 'Doe')}.both('Friend').both('Friend'){as: friend},
            { as: person }.both('Friend'){ as: friend }
            RETURN person, friend

--------+--------
 person | friend
--------+--------
 #12:0  | #12:1
 #12:0  | #12:2
--------+--------
```

In this case, the statement matches two expression: the first to friends of friends, the second to direct friends. Each expression shares the common aliases (`person` and `friend`). To match the whole statement, the result must match both expressions, where the alias values for the first expression are the same as that of the second.

- Find common friends of John and Jenny:

```
ArcadeDB> MATCH {type: Person, where: (name = 'John' AND
            surname = 'Doe')}.both('Friend'){as: friend}.both('Friend')
            {type: Person, where: (name = 'Jenny')} RETURN friend

--------
 friend
--------
 #12:1
--------
```

The same, with two match expressions:

```
ArcadeDB> MATCH {type: Person, where: (name = 'John' AND
            surname = 'Doe')}.both('Friend'){as: friend},
            {type: Person, where: (name = 'Jenny')}.both('Friend')
            {as: friend} RETURN friend
```

### 14.6.1. Simplified Syntax

```
MATCH
  {
    [type: <type>],
    [as: <alias>],
```

```
    [where: (<whereCondition>)]
  }
  .<functionName>(){
    [type: <typeName>],
    [as: <alias>],
    [where: (<whereCondition>)],
    [while: (<whileCondition>)],
    [maxDepth: <number>],
    [depthAlias: <identifier> ],
    [pathAlias: <identifier> ],
    [optional: (true | false)]
  }*
  [,
    [NOT]
    {
      [as: <alias>],
      [type: <type>],
      [where: (<whereCondition>)]
    }
    .<functionName>(){
      [type: <typeName>],
      [as: <alias>],
      [where: (<whereCondition>)],
      [while: (<whileCondition>)],
      [maxDepth: <number>],
      [depthAlias: <identifier> ],
      [pathAlias: <identifier> ],
      [optional: (true | false)]
    }*
  ]*
RETURN [DISTINCT] <expression> [ AS <alias> ] [, <expression> [ AS <alias> ]]*
[ GROUP BY <expression> [, <expression>]* ]
[ ORDER BY <expression> [, <expression>]* ]
[ UNWIND <Field>* ]
[ SKIP <number> ]
[ LIMIT <number> ]
```

- **`<type>`** Defines a valid target type.
- **`as: <alias>`** Defines an alias for a node in the pattern.
- **`<whereCondition>`** Defines a filter condition to match a node in the pattern. It supports the normal SQL `WHERE` clause. You can also use the `$currentMatch` and `$matched` context variables.
- **`<functionName>`** Defines a graph function to represent the connection between two nodes. For instance, `out()`, `in()`, `outE()`, `inE()`, etc. For out(), in(), both() also a shortened *arrow* syntax is supported:
- `{…}.out(){…}` can be written as `{…}-->{…}`
- `{…}.out("EdgeType"){…}` can be written as `{…}-EdgeType->{…}`
- `{…}.in(){…}` can be written as `{…}<--{…}`

- `{…}.in("EdgeType"){…}` can be written as `{…}<-EdgeType-{…}`
- `{…}.both(){…}` can be written as `{…}--{…}`
- `{…}.both("EdgeType"){…}` can be written as `{…}-EdgeType-{…}`
- `<whileCondition>` Defines a condition that the statement must meet to allow the traversal of this path. It supports the normal SQL `WHERE` clause. You can also use the `$currentMatch`, `$matched` and `$depth` context variables. For more information, see Deep Traversal While Condition, below.
- `<maxDepth>` Defines the maximum depth for this single path.
- `<depthAlias>` This is valid only if you have a `while` or a `maxDepth`. It defines the alias to be used to store the depth of this traversal. This alias can be used in the `RETURN` block to retrieve the depth of current traversal.
- `<pathAlias>` This is valid only if you have a `while` or a `maxDepth`. It defines the alias to be used to store the elements traversed to reach this alias. This alias can be used in the `RETURN` block to retrieve the elements traversed to reach this alias.
- `RETURN <expression> [ AS <alias> ]` Defines elements in the pattern that you want returned. It can use one of the following:
- Aliases defined in the `as:` block.
- `$matches` Indicating all defined aliases.
- `$paths` Indicating the full traversed paths.
- `$elements` Indicating that all the elements that would be returned by the $matches have to be returned flattened, without duplicates.
- `$pathElements` Indicating that all the elements that would be returned by the $paths have to be returned flattened, without duplicates.
- `optional` if set to true, allows to evaluate and return a pattern even if that particular node does not match the pattern itself (ie. there is no value for that node in the pattern). In current version, `optional` is supported only on right terminal nodes, eg. `{} --> {optional:true}`. On any other node (the first node or a node in the middle of the pattern, eg. `{optional:true} <-- {}`) the engine does not raise an error, but the flag is not applied, so do not rely on it there.
- `NOT` **patterns** Together with normal patterns, you can also define negative patterns. A result will be returned only if it also DOES NOT match any of the negative patterns, ie. if it matches at least one of the negative patterns it won't be returned.
- `UNWIND` Designates the field on which to unwind the collection.

### 14.6.2. Arrow notation

`out()`, `in()` and `both()` operators can be replaced with arrow notation `-->`, `<--` and `--`

Eg. the query

```
MATCH {type: V, as: a}.out(){}.out(){}.out(){as:b}
RETURN a, b
```

can be written as

```
MATCH {type: V, as: a}-->{}-->{}-->{as:b}
RETURN a, b
```

Eg. the query (things that belong to friends)

```
MATCH {type: Person, as: a}.out('Friend'){as:friend}.in('BelongsTo'){as:b}
RETURN a, b
```

can be written as

```
MATCH {type: Person, as: a}-Friend->{as:friend}<-BelongsTo-{as:b}
RETURN a, b
```

Using arrow notation the curly braces are mandatory on both sides. eg:

```
MATCH {type: Person, as: a}-->{}-->{as:b} RETURN a, b  -- is allowed

MATCH {type: Person, as: a}-->-->{as:b} RETURN a, b  -- is NOT allowed

MATCH {type: Person, as: a}.out().out(){as:b} RETURN a, b  -- is allowed

MATCH {type: Person, as: a}.out(){}.out(){as:b} RETURN a, b  -- is allowed
```

**Negative (NOT) patterns**

Together with normal patterns, you can also define negative patterns. A result will be returned only if it also DOES NOT match any of the negative patterns, ie. if the result matches at least one of the negative patterns it won't be returned.

As an example, consider the following problem: given a social network, choose a single person and return all the people that are friends of their friends, but that are not their direct friends.

The pattern can be calculated as follows:

```
MATCH
  {type:Person, as:a, where:(name = "John")}-FriendOf->{as:b}-FriendOf-> {as:c},
  NOT {as:a}-FriendOf->{as:c}
RETURN c.name
```

**DISTINCT**

The `MATCH`` statement returns all the occurrences of a pattern, even if they are duplicated. To have unique, distinct records as a result, you have to specify the `DISTINCT` keyword in the `RETURN`

statement.

Example: suppose you have a dataset made like following:

```
INSERT INTO V SET name = 'John', surname = 'Smith';
INSERT INTO V SET name = 'John', surname = 'Harris'
INSERT INTO V SET name = 'Jenny', surname = 'Rose'
```

This is the result of the query without a `DISTINCT` clause:

```
ArcadeDB> MATCH {type: Person, as:p} RETURN p.name as name

--------
 name
--------
 John
--------
 John
--------
 Jenny
--------
```

And this is the result of the query with a DISTINCT clause:

```
ArcadeDB> MATCH {type: Person, as:p} RETURN DISTINCT p.name as name

--------
 name
--------
 John
--------
 Jenny
--------
```

**Context Variables**

When running these queries, you can use any of the following context variables:

| Variable | Description |
| --- | --- |
| `$matched` | Gives the current partial match: a record whose attributes are the aliases matched so far, so `$matched.<alias>` is the record bound to that alias and `$matched.<alias>.<property>` one of its properties. You can use this in the `where:` and `while:` conditions to refer to current partial matches or as part of the `RETURN` value. A `where:` that reads another alias through `$matched` is evaluated once that alias is bound, whether the two nodes are connected by a path or belong to different comma-separated patterns: in the latter case the pattern reading the alias runs once per match of the pattern binding it, which correlates the two patterns by property (v26.10.1). |
| `$currentMatch` | Gives the current complete node during the match. |
| `$depth` | Gives the traversal depth, following a single path item where a `while:` condition is defined. |

**Use Cases**

**Expanding Attributes**

You can run this statement as a sub-query inside of another statement. Doing this allows you to obtain details and aggregate data from the inner `SELECT` query.

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT person.name AS name, person.surname AS surname,
          friend.name AS friendName, friend.surname AS friendSurname
          FROM (MATCH {type: Person, as: person,
          where: (name = 'John')}.both('Friend'){as: friend}
          RETURN person, friend)

--------+----------+------------+---------------
 name   | surname  | friendName | friendSurname
--------+----------+------------+---------------
 John   | Doe      | John       | Smith
 John   | Doe      | Jenny      | Smith
 John   | Doe      | Frank      | Bean
 John   | Smith    | John       | Doe
 John   | Smith    | Jenny      | Smith
--------+----------+------------+---------------
```

As an alternative, you can use the following:

```
ArcadeDB> MATCH {type: Person, as: person,
          where: (name = 'John')}.both('Friend'){as: friend}
          RETURN
          person.name as name, person.surname as surname,
          friend.name as friendName, friend.surname as friendSurname

--------+----------+------------+--------------
 name   | surname  | friendName | friendSurname
--------+----------+------------+--------------
 John   | Doe      | John       | Smith
 John   | Doe      | Jenny      | Smith
 John   | Doe      | Frank      | Bean
 John   | Smith    | John       | Doe
 John   | Smith    | Jenny      | Smith
--------+----------+------------+--------------
```

**Incomplete Hierarchy**

Consider building a database for a company that shows a hierarchy of departments within the company. For instance,

```
          [manager] department
          (employees in department)

                [m0]0
                 (e1)
                 /   \
                /     \
               /       \
           [m1]1        [m2]2
          (e2, e3)     (e4, e5)
             / \          / \
            3   4        5   6
          (e6) (e7)    (e8)  (e9)
          /  \
      [m3]7    8
      (e10)   (e11)
       /
      9
  (e12, e13)
```

This loosely shows that, - Department `0` is the company itself, manager 0 (`m0`) is the CEO - `e10` works at department `7`, his manager is `m3` - `e12` works at department `9`, this department has no direct manager, so `e12s manager is `m3` (the upper manager)

In this case, you would use the following query to find out who's the manager to a particular employee:

```
ArcadeDB> MATCH {type:Employee, where: (name = ?)}.out('WorksAt').out
('ParentDepartment')
          {while: (out('Manager').size() == 0),
          where: (out('Manager').size() > 0)}.out('Manager')
          {as: manager} RETURN expand(manager)
```

**Deep Traversal**

Match path items act in a different manners, depending on whether or not you use `while:` conditions in the statement.

For instance, consider the following graph:

```
[name='a'] -FriendOf-> [name='b'] -FriendOf-> [name='c']
```

Running the following statement on this graph only returns `b`:

```
ArcadeDB> MATCH {type: Person, where: (name = 'a')}.out("FriendOf")
          {as: friend} RETURN friend

--------
 friend
--------
 b
--------
```

What this means is that it traverses the path item `out("FriendOf")` exactly once. It only returns the result of that traversal.

If you add a `while` condition:

```
ArcadeDB> MATCH {type: Person, where: (name = 'a')}.out("FriendOf")
          {as: friend, while: ($depth < 2)} RETURN friend

---------
 friend
---------
 a
 b
---------
```

Including a `while:` condition on the match path item causes ArcadeDB to evaluate this item as zero to *n* times. That means that it returns the starting node, (`a`, in this case), as the result of zero traversal.

To exclude the starting point, you need to add a `where:` condition, such as:

```
ArcadeDB> MATCH {type: Person, where: (name = 'a')}.out("FriendOf")
          {as: friend, while: ($depth < 2), where: ($depth > 0)}
          RETURN friend
```

As a general rule,

- `while` **Conditions:** Define this if it must execute the next traversal, (it evaluates at level zero, on the origin node).
- `where` **Condition:** Define this if the current element, (the origin node at the zero iteration the right node on the iteration is greater than zero), must be returned as a result of the traversal.

For instance, suppose that you have a genealogical tree. In the tree, you want to show a person, grandparent and the grandparent of that grandparent, and so on. The result: saying that the person is at level zero, parents at level one, grandparents at level two, etc., you would see all ancestors on even levels. That is, `level % 2 == 0`.

To get this, you might use the following query:

```
ArcadeDB> MATCH {type: Person, where: (name = 'a')}.out("Parent")
          {as: ancestor, while: (true), where: ($depth % 2 = 0)}
          RETURN ancestor
```

**Best practices**

Queries can involve multiple operations, based on the domain model and use case. In some cases, like projection and aggregation, you can easily manage them with a `SELECT` query. With others, such as pattern matching and deep traversal, `MATCH` statements are more appropriate.

Use `SELECT` and `MATCH` statements together (that is, through sub-queries), to give each statement the correct responsibilities. Here,

**Filtering Record Attributes for a Single Type**

Filtering based on record attributes for a single type is a trivial operation through both statements. That is, finding all people named John can be written as:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM Person WHERE name = 'John'
```

You can also write it as,

```
ArcadeDB> MATCH {type: Person, as: person, where: (name = 'John')}
          RETURN person
```

The efficiency remains the same. Both queries use an index. With `SELECT`, you obtain expanded records, while with `MATCH`, you only obtain the Record ID's. If you want to return expanded records from the MATCH, use the `expand()` function in the return statement:

```
ArcadeDB> MATCH {type: Person, as: person, where: (name = 'John')}
          RETURN expand(person)
```

#### Filtering on Record Attributes of Connected Elements

Filtering based on the record attributes of connected elements, such as neighboring vertices, can grow trick when using `SELECT`, while with `MATCH` it is simple.

For instance, find all people living in Rome that have a friend called John. There are three different ways you can write this, using `SELECT`:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM Person WHERE BOTH('Friend').name CONTAINS 'John'
          AND out('LivesIn').name CONTAINS 'Rome'

ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM (SELECT BOTH('Friend') FROM Person WHERE name =
          'John') WHERE out('LivesIn').name CONTAINS 'Rome'

ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM (SELECT in('LivesIn') FROM City WHERE name = 'Rome')
          WHERE BOTH('Friend').name CONTAINS 'John'
```

In the first version, the query is more readable, but it does not use indexes, so it is less optimal in terms of execution time. The second and third use indexes if they exist, (on `Person.name` or `City.name`, both in the sub-query), but they're harder to read. Which index they use depends only on the way you write the query. That is, if you only have an index on `City.name` and not `Person.name`, the second version doesn't use an index.

Using a `MATCH` statement, the query becomes:

```
ArcadeDB> MATCH {type: Person, where: (name = 'John')}.both("Friend")
          {as: result}.out('LivesIn'){type: City, where: (name = 'Rome')}
          RETURN result
```

Here, the query executor optimizes the query for you, choosing indexes where they exist. Moreover, the query becomes more readable, especially in complex cases, such as multiple nested `SELECT` queries.

#### `TRAVERSE` Alternative

There are similar limitations to using `TRAVERSE`. You may benefit from using `MATCH` as an alternative.

For instance, consider a simple `TRAVERSE` statement, like:

```
ArcadeDB> TRAVERSE out('Friend') FROM (SELECT FROM Person WHERE name = 'John')
          WHILE $depth < 3
```

Using a `MATCH` statement, you can write the same query as:

```
ArcadeDB> MATCH {type: Person, where: (name = 'John')}.both("Friend")
          {as: friend, while: ($depth < 3)} RETURN friend
```

Consider a case where you have a `since` date property on the edge `Friend`. You want to traverse the relationship only for edges where the `since` value is greater than a given date. In a `TRAVERSE` statement, you might write the query as:

```
ArcadeDB> TRAVERSE bothE('Friend')[since > date('2012-07-02', 'yyyy-MM-dd')].bothV()
          FROM (SELECT FROM Person WHERE name = 'John') WHILE $depth < 3
```

Unfortunately, this statement DOESN'T WORK in the current release. However, you can get the results you want using a `MATCH` statement:

```
ArcadeDB> MATCH {type: Person, where: (name = 'John')}.(bothE("Friend")
          {where: (since > date('2012-07-02', 'yyyy-MM-dd'))}.bothV())
          {as: friend, while: ($depth < 3)} RETURN friend
```

**Projections and Grouping Operations**

Projections and grouping operations are better expressed with a `SELECT` query. If you need to filter and do projection or aggregation in the same query, you can use `SELECT` and `MATCH` in the same statement.

This is particular important when you expect a result that contains attributes from different connected records (cartesian product). For instance, to retrieve names, their friends and the date since they became friends:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT person.name AS name, friendship.since AS since, friend.name
          AS friend FROM (MATCH {type: Person, as: person}.bothE('Friend')
          {as: friendship}.bothV(){as: friend,
          where: ($matched.person != $currentMatch)}
          RETURN person, friendship, friend)
```

The same can be also achieved with the MATCH only:

```
ArcadeDB> MATCH {type: Person, as: person}.bothE('Friend')
          {as: friendship}.bothV(){as: friend,
          where: ($matched.person != $currentMatch)}
          RETURN person.name as name, friendship.since as since, friend.name as friend
```

**RETURN expressions**

In the RETURN section you can use:

**multiple expressions**, with or without an alias (if no alias is defined, ArcadeDB will generate a

default alias for you), comma separated

```
MATCH
  {type: Person, as: person}
  .bothE('Friend'){as: friendship}
  .bothV(){as: friend, where: ($matched.person != $currentMatch)}
RETURN person, friendship, friend

result:

| person | friendship | friend |
-------------------------------
| #12:0  | #13:0      | #12:2  |
| #12:0  | #13:1      | #12:3  |
| #12:1  | #13:2      | #12:3  |
```

```
MATCH
  {type: Person, as: person}
  .bothE('Friend'){as: friendship}
  .bothV(){as: friend, where: ($matched.person != $currentMatch)}
RETURN person.name as name, friendship.since as since, friend.name as friend

result:

| name | since | friend |
-------------------------
| John | 2015  | Frank  |
| John | 2015  | Jenny  |
| Joe  | 2016  | Jenny  |
```

```
MATCH
  {type: Person, as: person}
  .bothE('Friend'){as: friendship}
  .bothV(){as: friend, where: ($matched.person != $currentMatch)}
RETURN person.name + " is a friend of " + friend.name as friends

result:

| friends                    |
------------------------------
| John is a friend of Frank  |
| John is a friend of Jenny  |
| Joe is a friend of Jenny   |
```

**$matches**, to return all the patterns that match current statement. Each row in the result set will be a single pattern, containing only nodes in the statement that have an `as:` defined

```
MATCH
  {type: Person, as: person}
  .bothE('Friend'){}  -- no 'as:friendship' in this case
  .bothV(){as: friend, where: ($matched.person != $currentMatch)}
RETURN $matches

result:

| person |  friend |
--------------------
| #12:0  |  #12:2  |
| #12:0  |  #12:3  |
| #12:1  |  #12:3  |
```

**$paths**, to return all the patterns that match current statement. Each row in the result set will be a single pattern, containing all th nodes in the statement. For nodes that have an `as:`, the alias will be returned, for the others a default alias is generated (automatically generated aliases start with `$ORIENT_DEFAULT_ALIAS_`)

```
MATCH
  {type: Person, as: person}
  .bothE('Friend'){}  -- no 'as:friendship' in this case
  .bothV(){as: friend, where: ($matched.person != $currentMatch)}
RETURN $paths

result:

| person | friend | $ORIENT_DEFAULT_ALIAS_0 |
-------------------------------------------
| #12:0  | #12:2  | #13:0                   |
| #12:0  | #12:3  | #13:1                   |
| #12:1  | #12:3  | #13:2                   |
```

**$elements** the same as `$matches`, but for each node present in the pattern, a single row is created in the result set (no duplicates)

```
MATCH
  {type: Person, as: person}
  .bothE('Friend'){}  -- no 'as:friendship' in this case
  .bothV(){as: friend, where: ($matched.person != $currentMatch)}
RETURN $elements

result:

| @rid   |  @type | name   |  .....   |
---------------------------------------
| #12:0  |  Person | John   |  .....   |
| #12:1  |  Person | Joe    |  .....   |
```

```
| #12:2  |  Person | Frank  |  .....   |
| #12:3  |  Person | Jenny  |  .....   |
```

**$pathElements** the same as $paths, but for each node present in the pattern, a single row is created in the result set (no duplicates)

```
MATCH
  {type: Person, as: person}
  .bothE('Friend'){}  -- no 'as:friendship' in this case
  .bothV(){as: friend, where: ($matched.person != $currentMatch)}
RETURN $pathElements

result:

| @rid   |  @type | name   | since  |  .....   |
-----------------------------------------------
| #12:0  |  Person | John   |        |  .....   |
| #12:1  |  Person | Joe    |        |  .....   |
| #12:2  |  Person | Frank  |        |  .....   |
| #12:3  |  Person | Jenny  |        |  .....   |
| #13:0  |  Friend |        |  2015  |  .....   |
| #13:1  |  Friend |        |  2015  |  .....   |
| #13:2  |  Friend |        |  2016  |  .....   |
```

**NOTE**: When using the MATCH statement in ArcadeDB Studio Graph panel you have to use $elements or $pathElements as return type, to let the Graph panel render the matched patterns correctly.

## 14.7. SQL - TRAVERSE

Retrieves connected records crossing relationships. This works with both the Document and Graph API's, meaning that you can traverse relationships between say invoices and customers on a graph, without the need to model the domain using the Graph API.

In many cases, you may find it more efficient to use SELECT, which can result in shorter and faster queries. For more information, see TRAVERSE versus SELECT below.

**Syntax**

```
TRAVERSE <projection> [, <projection>]*   (a field, or a function such as out(), in()
or both())
         [FROM <target>]
         [
           MAXDEPTH <number>
           |
           WHILE <condition>
```

```
        ]
        [LIMIT <max-records>]
        [STRATEGY DEPTH_FIRST|BREADTH_FIRST]
```

- `<fields>` Defines the fields you want to traverse.
- `<target>` Defines the target you want to traverse. This can be a type, one or more buckets, a single Record ID, set of Record ID's, or a sub-query.
- `MAXDEPTH` Defines the maximum depth of the traversal. `0` indicates that you only want to traverse the root node. Negative values are invalid.
- `WHILE` Defines the condition for continuing the traversal while it is true.
- `LIMIT` Defines the maximum number of results the command can return.
- `STRATEGY` Defines strategy for traversing the graph.

The use of the `WHERE` clause has been deprecated for this command.

There is a difference between `MAXDEPTH N` and `WHILE DEPTH <= N`: the `MAXDEPTH` will evaluate exactly N levels, while the `WHILE` will evaluate N+1 levels and will discard the N+1th, so the `MAXDEPTH` in general has better performance.

**Examples**

In a social network-like domain, a user profile is connected to friend through links. The following examples consider common operations on a user with the record ID `#10:1234`.

- Traverse the outgoing edges of the root record (`*` is not accepted after `TRAVERSE`; use `out()`, `in()` or `both()`):

```
ArcadeDB> TRAVERSE out() FROM #10:1234
```

- Specify fields and depth up to the third level, using the `BREADTH_FIRST` strategy:

```
ArcadeDB> TRAVERSE out("Friend") FROM #10:1234 MAXDEPTH 3
           STRATEGY BREADTH_FIRST
```

- Execute the same command, this time filtering for a minimum depth to exclude the first target vertex:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM (TRAVERSE out("Friend") FROM #10:1234 MAXDEPTH 3)
           WHERE $depth >= 1
```

You can also define the maximum depth in the `SELECT` command, but it's much more efficient to set it at the inner `TRAVERSE` statement because the returning record sets are already filtered by depth.

- Combine traversal with `SELECT` command to filter the result-set. Repeat the above example, filtering for users in Rome:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM (TRAVERSE out("Friend") FROM #10:1234 MAXDEPTH 3)
            WHERE city = 'Rome'
```

- Extract movies of actors that have worked, at least once, in any movie produced by J.J. Abrams:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM (TRAVERSE out("Actors"), out("Movies") FROM (SELECT FROM
            Movie WHERE producer = "J.J. Abrams") MAXDEPTH 3) WHERE
            @type = 'Movie'
```

- Display the current path in the traversal:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT $path FROM ( TRAVERSE out() FROM V MAXDEPTH 10 )
```

**Supported Variables**

**Fields**

Defines the fields that you want to traverse. If set to `*`, then it traverses all fields. This can prove costly to performance and resource usage, so it is recommended that you optimize the command to only traverse the pertinent fields.

In addition to his, you can specify the fields at a type-level. Inheritance is supported. By specifying `Person.city` and the type `Customer` extends person, you also traverse fields in `Customer`.

Field names are case-sensitive, types not.

**Target**

Targets for traversal can be:

- `<type>` Defines the type that you want to traverse.
- `BUCKET:<bucket>` Defines the bucket you want to traverse.
- `<record-id>` Individual root Record ID that you want to traverse.
- `[<record-id>,<record-id>,…]` Set of Record ID's that you want to traverse. This is useful when navigating graphs starting from the same root nodes.

**Context Variables**

In addition to the above, you can use the following context variables in traversals:

- `$parent` Gives the parent context, if any. You may find this useful when traversing from a sub-query.
- `$current` Gives the current record in the iteration. To get the upper-level record in nested

queries, you can use `$parent.$current`.

- `$depth` Gives the current depth of nesting.
- `$path` Gives a string representation of the current path. For instance, `#5:0.out`. You can also display it through `SELECT`:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT $path FROM (TRAVERSE out() FROM V)
```

**Use Cases**

**`TRAVERSE` versus `SELECT`**

When you already know traversal information, such as relationship names and depth-level, consider using `SELECT` instead of `TRAVERSE` as it is faster in some cases.

For example, this query traverses the `follow` relationship on Twitter accounts, getting the second level of friendship:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM (TRAVERSE out('follow') FROM TwitterAccounts MAXDEPTH 2 )
          WHERE $depth = 2
```

But, you could also express this same query using `SELECT` operation, in a way that is also shorter and faster:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT out('follow').out('follow') FROM TwitterAccounts
```

**`TRAVERSE` with the Graph Model and API**

While you can use the `TRAVERSE` command with any domain model, it provides the greatest utility with the Graph Model.

This model is based on the concepts of the Vertex (or Node) and the Edge (or Arc, Connection, Link, etc.) If you want to traverse in a direction, you have to use the type name when declaring the traversing fields. The supported directions are:

- **Vertex to outgoing edges** Using `outE()` or `outE('EdgeTypeName')`. That is, going out from a vertex and into the outgoing edges.
- **Vertex to incoming edges** Using `inE()` or `inE('EdgeTypeName')`. That is, going from a vertex and into the incoming edges.
- **Vertex to all edges** Using `bothE()` or `bothE('EdgeTypeName')`. That is, going from a vertex and into all the connected edges.
- **Edge to Vertex (end point)** Using `inV()` . That is, going out from an edge and into a vertex.
- **Edge to Vertex (starting point)** Using `outV()` . That is, going back from an edge and into a vertex.
- **Edge to Vertex (both sizes)** Using `bothV()` . That is, going from an edge and into connected

vertices.

- **Vertex to Vertex (outgoing edges)** Using `out()` or `out('EdgeTypeName')`. This is the same as `outE().inV()`
- **Vertex to Vertex (incoming edges)** Using `in()` or `in('EdgeTypeName')`. This is the same as `inE().outV()`
- **Vertex to Vertex (all directions)** Using `both()` or `both('EdgeTypeName')`.

For instance, traversing outgoing edges on the record `#10:3434`:

```
ArcadeDB> TRAVERSE out() FROM #10:3434
```

In a domain for emails, to find all messages sent on January 1, 2012 from the user Luca, assuming that they are stored in the vertex type `User` and that the messages are contained in the vertex type `Message`. Sent messages are stored as `out` connections on the edge type `SentMessage`:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM (TRAVERSE outE(), inV() FROM (SELECT FROM User WHERE
          name = 'Luca') MAXDEPTH 2 AND (@type = 'Message' or
          (@type = 'SentMessage' AND sentOn = '01/01/2012') )) WHERE
          @type = 'Message'
```

### 14.7.1. Traversal Strategies

When ArcadeDB traverses a graph it can use one of two available approaches, either explore every branch to its leaf before backtracking (depth-first), or visiting each child before progressing down the next level (breadth-first), see:

- `DEPTH_FIRST` Strategy
- `BREADTH_FIRST` Strategy

By default, the depth-first strategy is used.

## 14.8. SQL - `MOVE VERTEX`

Moves one or more vertices into another type or bucket.

```
MOVE VERTEX <source> TO <TYPE|BUCKET>:<destination> [SET|REMOVE <field-name> = <field-
value>[,]*]|[CONTENT|MERGE <JSON>] [BATCH <number>]
```

- `<source>` the vertex (RID) or vertices (Array of RIDs) to be moved.
- `<TYPE|BUCKET>` determines if a type or bucket is the target.
- `<destination>` the target type or bucket of the moved vertex or vertices.
- `<number>` size of vertices moved at once. Using `-1` moves all vertices at once.

This is command is similar to the UPDATE command.

**Examples**

```
MOVE VERTEX #4:1 TO Type:MyType
```

```
MOVE VERTEX [#4:16,#4:20,#4:24] TO BUCKET:MyBucket
```

```
MOVE VERTEX (SELECT FROM User) TO TYPE:NewUsers BATCH 4
```

## 14.9. SQL - CREATE VERTEX

Creates a new vertex in the database.

The Vertex and Edge are the main components of a Graph database. ArcadeDB supports polymorphism on vertices.

**Syntax**

```
CREATE VERTEX [<type>] [BUCKET <bucket>]
  [SET <field> = <expression>[,]*]|
  [CONTENT {<JSON>}|[{<JSON>}[,]*]]
```

- `<type>` Defines the type to which the vertex belongs.
- `<bucket>` Defines the bucket in which it stores the vertex.
- `<field>` Defines the field you want to set.
- `<expression>` Defines the express to set for the field.

When using a distributed database, you can create vertices through two steps (creation and update). Doing so can break constraints defined at the type-level for vertices. To avoid these issues, disable constraints in the vertex type.

**Examples**

- Create a new vertex type, then create a vertex in that type:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE VERTEX TYPE V1
ArcadeDB> CREATE VERTEX V1
```

- Create a new vertex within a particular bucket:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE VERTEX V1 BUCKET recent
```

- Create a new vertex, defining its properties:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE VERTEX SET brand = 'fiat'
```

- Create a new vertex of the type `V1`, defining its properties:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE VERTEX V1 SET brand = 'fiat', name = 'wow'
```

- Create a vertex using JSON content:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE VERTEX Employee CONTENT { "name" : "Jay", "surname" : "Miner" }
```

- Create multiple vertices using JSON content:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE VERTEX Employee CONTENT [{"name" : "Jay", "surname" : "Miner"},
            {"name": "Frank", "surname": "Hermier"},{"name": "Emily", "surname":
"Sout"}]
```

**Idempotent vertex creation (upsert)**

`CREATE VERTEX` does not have an `UPSERT` clause. To create a vertex **only if it does not already exist**, or update it otherwise, use the `UPDATE … UPSERT` command against the vertex type. When the target type is a vertex type, `UPSERT` creates a real vertex (not a plain document), so it can be used as the endpoint of an edge right away.

The lookup must be backed by a `UNIQUE` index on the property used in the `WHERE` clause; this is what makes the operation atomic under concurrent writers.

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE VERTEX TYPE Person
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Person.email STRING
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON Person (email) UNIQUE

ArcadeDB> UPDATE Person SET name = 'Luca', email = 'luca@example.com'
            UPSERT WHERE email = 'luca@example.com'
```

Re-running the same `UPDATE … UPSERT` updates the existing vertex instead of creating a duplicate. See `UPDATE` for the full syntax and the upsert limitations.

For more information, see:

- `CREATE EDGE`

- `UPDATE` (`UPSERT` clause)

## 14.10. SQL - `CREATE EDGE`

Creates a new edge between vertices in the database. An edge can connect from and to a vertex record, an array of vertex records, or a query result of vertex records.

**Syntax**

```
CREATE EDGE <type> [BUCKET <bucket>] FROM <rid>|[<rid>[,]*]|(<query>) TO <rid>|[<rid
>[,]*]|(<query>)
                   [UNIDIRECTIONAL]
                   [IF NOT EXISTS]
                   [SET <field> = <expression>[,]*]|CONTENT {<JSON>}
                   [RETRY <retry> [WAIT <pauseBetweenRetriesInMs]]
                   [BATCH <batch-size>]
```

- `<type>` defines the type name for the edge.
- `<bucket>` defines the bucket in which you want to store the edge.
- `UNIDIRECTIONAL` creates a unidirectional edge; by default edges are bidirectional.
- `IF NOT EXISTS` skips the creation of the edge if another edge already exists with the same direction (same from/to) and same edge type.
- `JSON` provides JSON content to set as the record. Use this instead of entering data field by field.
- `RETRY` defines the number of retries to attempt in the event of conflict (optimistic approach).
- `WAIT` defines the time to delay between retries in milliseconds.
- `BATCH` defines whether it breaks the command down into smaller blocks and the size of the batches. This helps to avoid memory issues when the number of vertices is too high. By default, it is set to `100`.

Edges and Vertices form the main components of a Graph database. ArcadeDB supports polymorphism on edges.

When no edges fail to create, ArcadeDB throws a `CommandExecutionException` error. This makes it easier to integrate edge creation in transactions. In such cases, if the source or target vertices don't exist, it rolls back the transaction.

**Examples**

- Create a new edge type and an edge of the new type:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE EDGE TYPE E1
ArcadeDB> CREATE EDGE E1 FROM #10:3 TO #11:4
```

- Create an edge in a specific bucket:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE EDGE E1 BUCKET EuropeEdges FROM #10:3 TO #11:4
```

- Create an edge and define its properties:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE EDGE FROM #10:3 TO #11:4 SET brand = 'fiat'
```

- Create an edge of the type `E1` and define its properties:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE EDGE E1 FROM #10:3 TO #11:4 SET brand = 'fiat', name = 'wow'
```

- Create multiple edges from a single source vertex to many destination records:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE EDGE E FROM #1:0 TO [#4:0, #7:0];
```

- Create no edges from a single source vertex (this is useful when using subqueries for the destination):

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE EDGE E FROM #1:0 TO [];
```

- Create edges of the type `Watched` between all action movies in the database and the user Luca, using sub-queries:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE EDGE Watched FROM (SELECT FROM account WHERE name = 'Luca') TO
            (SELECT FROM movies WHERE type.name = 'action')
```

- Create an edge using JSON content:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE EDGE E FROM #22:33 TO #22:55 CONTENT { "name": "Jay",
            "surname": "Miner" }
```

- Create an edge only if not previously created:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX Watched_out_in ON Watched (`@out`, `@in`) UNIQUE
ArcadeDB> CREATE EDGE Watched FROM (SELECT FROM account WHERE name = 'Luca') TO
            (SELECT FROM movies WHERE type.name = 'action') IF NOT EXISTS
```

**Why there is no `UPSERT` for edges**

The `UPDATE … UPSERT` clause is supported on document and vertex types, but not on edge types: an edge always needs `FROM` and `TO` endpoints, which an `UPDATE WHERE` clause cannot supply. The idempotent equivalent for edges is `CREATE EDGE … IF NOT EXISTS`, ideally combined with a `UNIQUE`

index on `(@out, @in)` so the uniqueness check is atomic under concurrent writers (see the example above).

A common pattern is to upsert the two vertices first, then connect them:

```
ArcadeDB> UPDATE Person SET name = 'Luca', email = 'luca@example.com'
            UPSERT WHERE email = 'luca@example.com'
ArcadeDB> UPDATE City   SET name = 'London'
            UPSERT WHERE name = 'London'
ArcadeDB> CREATE EDGE Lives
            FROM (SELECT FROM Person WHERE email = 'luca@example.com')
            TO   (SELECT FROM City   WHERE name  = 'London')
            IF NOT EXISTS
```

For an end-to-end multi-statement version (with retry on conflict), see SQL Script.

For more information, see:

- `CREATE VERTEX`
- `UPDATE` (`UPSERT` clause)

# 14.11. Types

## 14.11.1. SQL - `CREATE TYPE`

Creates a new type in the schema.

**Syntax**

```
CREATE <DOCUMENT|VERTEX|EDGE> TYPE <type>
[UNIDIRECTIONAL] [LIGHTWEIGHT] [UNIQUE] [ IF NOT EXISTS ]
[EXTENDS <super-type>] [BUCKET <bucket-id>[,]*] [BUCKETS <total-bucket-number>]
[PAGESIZE <page-size>]
[CUSTOM <custom-key> = <custom-value>[,]*]
```

- Use `<DOCUMENT|VERTEX|EDGE>` if you are creating respectively a document, vertex or edge type.
- `<type>` Defines the name of the type you want to create. You must use a letter, underscore or dollar for the first character, for all other characters you can use alphanumeric characters, underscores and dollar.
- **UNIDIRECTIONAL** Defines an edge types (only) to be of single direction instead of the default bi-directional edge. An edge of such a type is written on its source vertex only, which halves the write cost of the edge list, but the target vertex keeps no trace of it: walking the vertex API from the target (`vertex.getVertices(IN, …)`, Gremlin's `in()`) finds nothing, and so do the SQL functions `in()`, `inE()`, `both()`, `bothE()` and `shortestPath()` called on their own (`SELECT in('E') FROM …`), which read what the vertex stores, as the vertex API does embedded, remote and through Gremlin. A pattern is answered whichever way it is written: Cypher and SQL `MATCH` start

the walk from the source side whenever the pattern allows it, and a walk that has to start from the target (the target is bound by an earlier clause, the hop is undirected, a pattern expression such as `COUNT { (t)<-[:E]-() }`, a Cypher `shortestPath()`) is answered by scanning the edges of the type once per query. That scan is held in heap and counts against `arcadedb.queryMaxHeapElementsAllowedPerOp` and `arcadedb.queryMaxHeapRAM`, so declare an edge type unidirectional only when its edges are queried from their source: a workload that looks up the incoming side often (many small queries by target, or a loop that commits between a write and a read) pays that scan every time, and is better served by a bidirectional type.

Graph algorithms and path procedures ask about the graph rather than about what a vertex stores, so they always answer the incoming side of a unidirectional edge type, the same as with a Graph Analytical View: the Cypher `algo.` procedures, the `path.` procedures (`path.expand`, `path.expandConfig`, `path.spanningTree`, `path.subgraphNodes`, `path.subgraphAll`), the SQL functions `dijkstra()`, `astar()`, `bellmanFord()`, `cchShortestPath()` and `duanSSSP()`, and the functions `node.degree`, `node.degree.in`, `node.relationship.exists` and `node.relationship.types`. An `algo.` procedure that loads the whole graph derives the incoming side from the outgoing lists of the vertices it loaded, with no scan. A walk that goes vertex by vertex (the `path.` procedures, the SQL path-finding functions, the `node.*` functions) builds one in-heap index per unidirectional type the first time it needs it, the scan described above, bounded by `arcadedb.queryMaxHeapElementsAllowedPerOp`. `refactor.mergeNodes`, `refactor.cloneNodesWithRelationships` and adding or removing a node's labels in Cypher (which moves the vertex to another type) carry the incoming unidirectional edges of the node over too, instead of dropping them. The SQL functions `in()`, `inE()`, `both()`, `bothE()` and `shortestPath()` called on their own keep reading what the vertex stores, as before.

Up to 26.10.1 a query walking a unidirectional edge type from its target returned no rows and raised no error, and the planners could pick that direction on their own for a pattern written from the source. Since 26.10.1 those patterns return every matching edge. Up to 26.10.1 the graph algorithms, path procedures and path-finding functions listed above saw a unidirectional edge from its source only, and `refactor.mergeNodes`, `refactor.cloneNodesWithRelationships` and a Cypher label change dropped the incoming unidirectional edges of the node; since 26.11.1 they answer and keep both sides.

- **LIGHTWEIGHT** Defines an edge type (only) whose edges are stored inside the two vertices they connect, with no edge record and therefore no properties. Orthogonal to `UNIDIRECTIONAL`. See Lightweight Edges.
- **UNIQUE** Defines an edge type (only) that allows at most one edge per ordered `(out, in)` pair of vertices. On a regular edge type this creates a unique index on `(@out, @in)`; on a `LIGHTWEIGHT` type there are no records to index and the check scans the source vertex's edge list instead. See Lightweight Edges.
- **IF NOT EXISTS** Specifying this option, the type creation will just be ignored if the type already exists (instead of failing with an error)
- `<super-type>` Defines the super-type you want to extend with this type.
- `<bucket-id>` Defines in a comma-separated list the ID's of the buckets you want this type to use.

- `<total-bucket-number>` Defines the total number of buckets you want to create for this type. When omitted, the default is taken from the `arcadedb.typeDefaultBuckets` global configuration setting (`TYPE_DEFAULT_BUCKETS`), which is `1` by default.
- `<page-size>` Defines the page size of the type.
- `<custom-key>` Name of a custom property to set on the new type. Multiple pairs can be listed, separated by commas.
- `<custom-value>` Value for the custom property. All data types are supported as values.

In the event that a bucket of the same name exists in the bucket, the new type uses this bucket by default. If you do not define a bucket in the command and a bucket of this name does not exist, ArcadeDB creates one. The new bucket has the same name as the type, but in lower-case.

When working with multiple cores, it is recommended that you use multiple buckets to improve concurrency during inserts. To change the number of buckets created by default, `ALTER DATABASE` command to update the `minimumbuckets` property. You can also define the number of buckets you want to create using the `BUCKETS` option when you create the type.

**Examples**

- Create the document type `Account`:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE DOCUMENT TYPE Account
```

- Create the vertex type `Car` to extend `Vehicle`:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE VERTEX TYPE Car EXTENDS Vehicle
```

- Create the vertex type `Car`, using the bucket with name 'Car_classic' and 'Car_modern':

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE VERTEX TYPE Car BUCKET Car_classic,Car_modern
```

- Create the document type `Account` with the custom property 'description':

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE DOCUMENT TYPE Account CUSTOM description = 'All users'
```

- Create the vertex type `Car` with multiple custom properties:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE VERTEX TYPE Car CUSTOM icon = 'car.png', owner = 'fleet-team'
```

Declaring `CUSTOM` inline is equivalent to running `ALTER TYPE … CUSTOM` right after the creation, but it happens in the same statement. When `IF NOT EXISTS` is used and the type is already there, the whole statement is skipped, so the custom properties are not applied to the existing type.

`IF NOT EXISTS` always returns exactly one row, whether the object was created or was already there. The `created` property tells the two apart, so a retry never looks like a failure to a client that checks the number of returned rows:

```
CREATE DOCUMENT TYPE Person IF NOT EXISTS
--> { "operation": "create document type", "typeName": "Person",
"created": true }

CREATE DOCUMENT TYPE Person IF NOT EXISTS
--> { "operation": "create document type", "typeName": "Person",
"created": false }
```

The same applies to `CREATE PROPERTY`, `CREATE BUCKET`, `CREATE INDEX`, `CREATE TIMESERIES TYPE`, `CREATE TRIGGER`, `CREATE GRAPH ANALYTICAL VIEW`, `CREATE MATERIALIZED VIEW` and `CREATE CONTINUOUS AGGREGATE`.

*Since v26.10.1.* Before that version, `CREATE TYPE`, `CREATE PROPERTY`, `CREATE BUCKET` and `CREATE TIMESERIES TYPE` returned no rows at all when the object already existed.

A type inherits the bucket selection strategy defined at the database level (`round-robin` by default). For the full list of supported strategies, the decision tree for picking one, and the `WITH repartition = true` workflow for changing strategy on a populated type, see Bucket Selection Strategies in the Schema concepts section and Bucket Selection Strategy for the animated walkthrough.

For more information, see:

- `ALTER TYPE`
- `DROP TYPE`
- `CREATE BUCKET`
- Schema design 101: choosing a bucket strategy

### 14.11.2. SQL - `ALTER TYPE`

Change a type defined in the schema. The change is persistent.

**Syntax**

```
ALTER TYPE <type> <change> [, <change> ]*
```

Where each `<change>` is either `<attribute-name> <attribute-value>` or `CUSTOM <custom-key> = <custom-value>`.

- **`<type>`** Defines the type you want to change.
- **`<attribute-name>`** Defines the attribute you want to change. For a list of supported attributes, see the table below.

- `<attribute-value>` Defines the value you want to set.
- `<custom-key>` Name of the custom property to set.
- `<custom-value>` Value for the custom property. All data types are supported as values.

A custom property can be deleted by setting its value to `null`.

Several changes can be applied in one statement, separated by commas, and they are applied in the order written:

```
ALTER TYPE Employee NAME Staff, SUPERTYPE +Person
```

*Since v26.10.1.* Before that version the comma-separated form parsed and answered `"result": "OK"`, but only the last change was actually applied.

**Examples**

- Add `Person` to the super types:

```
ArcadeDB> ALTER TYPE Employee SUPERTYPE +Person
```

- Remove a super-type:

```
ArcadeDB> ALTER TYPE Employee SUPERTYPE -Person
```

Removing a super-type also removes the indexes the type inherited from it. Those indexes were created when the super-type was assigned, they cover a property the type no longer has, and the super-type's `UNIQUE` constraints stop applying to the type's records. Assigning the super-type again re-creates and rebuilds them.

- Add the "account2" bucket to the type `Account`.

```
ArcadeDB> ALTER TYPE Account BUCKET +account2
```

In the event that the bucket does not exist, it automatically creates it.

- Remove the bucket `account_34` from the type `Account` (buckets are referenced by name):

```
ArcadeDB> ALTER TYPE Account BUCKET -account_34
```

- Modify the bucket selection strategy to `partitioned` selecting the property id as partition key:

```
ArcadeDB> ALTER TYPE Account BucketSelectionStrategy `partitioned('id')`
```

- Set the custom value with key 'description':

```
ArcadeDB> ALTER TYPE Account CUSTOM description = 'All users'
```

- Set the custom nested value with key 'meta':

```
ArcadeDB> ALTER TYPE Account CUSTOM meta = { abool: true, alist: [1,2,3,4,5]};
```

- Change the type name from 'Account' to 'Client':

```
ArcadeDB> ALTER TYPE Account NAME Client;
```

- Add the former type name 'Account' as alias for 'Client':

```
ArcadeDB> ALTER TYPE Client ALIASES Account;
```

Using `ALIASES` overwrites any previous `ALIASES` of this type.

For more information, see:

- `CREATE TYPE`
- `DROP TYPE`.

**Supported Attributes**

| Attribute | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `NAME` | Identifier | Changes the type name. |
| `ALIASES` | Identifier(s) | Add one or more (comma-separated) alternate name(s) for the type name. |
| `SUPERTYPE` | Identifier | Defines a super-type for the type. Use `NULL` to remove a super-type assignment. It supports multiple inheritances. To set or add a new type, you can use the syntax `+<type>`, to remove it use `-<type>`. |
| `BUCKET` | Identifier | Name of the bucket: `+` to add a bucket and `-` to remove it from the type. If the bucket doesn't exist, it creates a physical bucket. Adding buckets to a type is also useful in storing records in distributed servers. |

| Attribute | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| BUCKETSELECTIONSTRATEGY | Identifier | Change the selection of the bucket when new records are created. Using partitioned() is recommended when your have a unique id |

### 14.11.3. SQL - DROP TYPE

Removes a type from the schema. To drop a type (safely), first, all its instances need to be removed.

#### Syntax

```
DROP TYPE <type> [IF EXISTS] [UNSAFE]
```

- <type> Defines the type you want to remove.
- IF EXISTS Prevent errors if the type does not exist when attempting to drop it.
- UNSAFE Defines whether the command drops non-empty edge and vertex types. Note, this can disrupt data consistency. Be sure to create a backup before running it.

Bear in mind, that the schema must remain coherent. For instance, avoid removing types that are super-types to others. This operation won't delete the associated bucket.

A database written by a version affected by issue #8169 can still contain a type that was dropped but came back after a restart with no buckets: inserting into it fails with Cannot retrieve a bucket for type ⋯ because there are no buckets associated. Since v26.10.1 the database logs a warning at open naming every type that has no buckets and no subtypes, and DROP TYPE <name> removes such a type permanently.

IF EXISTS always returns exactly one row, whether the object was dropped or wasn't there to begin with. The dropped property tells the two apart:

```
DROP TYPE Person IF EXISTS
--> { "operation": "drop type", "typeName": "Person", "dropped": true }

DROP TYPE Person IF EXISTS
--> { "operation": "drop type", "typeName": "Person", "dropped": false
}
```

The same applies to DROP BUCKET and DROP PROPERTY.

*Since v26.10.1.* Before that version, these three commands returned no rows at all when the object didn't exist.

#### Examples

- Remove the type `Account`:

```
ArcadeDB> DROP TYPE Account
```

For more information, see:

- `CREATE TYPE`
- `ALTER TYPE`

### 14.11.4. SQL - `TRUNCATE TYPE`

Deletes records of all buckets defined as part of the type.

By default, every type has an associated bucket with the same name. This command operates at a lower level than `DELETE`. This commands ignores sub-types, (That is, their records remain in their buckets). If you want to also remove all records from the type hierarchy, you need to use the `POLYMORPHIC` keyword.

Truncation is not permitted on a vertex or edge type that holds records, but you can force its execution using the `UNSAFE` keyword. Forcing truncation is strongly discouraged, as it can leave the graph in an inconsistent state. With `POLYMORPHIC`, the refusal covers the whole hierarchy below the type, and the error names the type that actually holds the records.

**Behaviour change in v26.10.1.** This refusal never actually fired before that release: the check asked whether the type inherited from types named `V` or `E`, which no type ArcadeDB creates does, so `TRUNCATE TYPE` silently emptied live vertex and edge types without the `UNSAFE` its own error message promised to require. It now refuses as documented, which means a statement that used to succeed can start failing. Add `UNSAFE` where the truncation is intended:

```
TRUNCATE TYPE Person UNSAFE
```

Note that `TRUNCATE BUCKET` has always refused correctly, so the two commands now agree on the same data.

**Syntax**

```
TRUNCATE TYPE <type> [ POLYMORPHIC ] [ UNSAFE ]
```

- `<type>` Defines the type you want to truncate.
- `POLYMORPHIC` Defines whether the command also truncates the type hierarchy.
- `UNSAFE` Defines whether the command forces the truncation on vertex or edge types.

**Transactions**

`TRUNCATE TYPE` behaves differently depending on whether a transaction is already active when it runs, and the result set reports which of the two applied through the `transactional` field:

- **Inside a transaction** (`transactional: true`) the truncate is part of that transaction: the records are deleted with the type's indexes maintained record by record, and a `ROLLBACK` puts every record back. This is the behaviour to rely on when the truncate is one half of a reload, e.g. `BEGIN; TRUNCATE TYPE Staging UNSAFE; INSERT …; COMMIT;` - if the insert fails, the previous contents survive. The `arcadedb.truncateBatchSize` setting does not apply.
- **With no transaction active** (`transactional: false`) the command owns a transaction of its own and takes a faster path: it drops the type's indexes, deletes the records in batches of `arcadedb.truncateBatchSize` (default 1000), each committed separately, and recreates the (empty) indexes at the end. This is considerably cheaper on a large type, but the command commits as it goes, so it cannot be undone.

Over HTTP the request's auto-commit transaction is what makes the command transactional; pass `"autoCommit": false` in the request payload to select the faster, non-undoable path for a bulk clear.

Before v26.9.1 the command always took the second path, even inside a transaction - it committed the caller's transaction from the inside, so a `ROLLBACK` after a `TRUNCATE TYPE` recovered at most the records of the last uncommitted batch, and none at all when the type had any index.

A lightweight edge type with a subtype is an exception to "ignores sub-types by default": since a lightweight edge has no bucket of its own, the command refuses without `POLYMORPHIC` instead of silently truncating only part of the hierarchy.

**Examples**

- Remove all records of the type `Profile`:

```
ArcadeDB> TRUNCATE TYPE Profile
```

For more information, see:

- `DELETE`
- `TRUNCATE BUCKET`
- `CREATE TYPE`

# 14.12. Properties

## 14.12.1. SQL - `CREATE PROPERTY`

Creates a new property in the schema. It requires that the type for the property already exist on the database.

**Syntax**

```
CREATE PROPERTY
<type>.<property> [IF NOT EXISTS] <data-type> [OF <embd-type>]
[(<property-constraint>[,]*)]
[CUSTOM <custom-key> = <custom-value>[,]*]
```

- `<type>` Defines the type for the new property.
- `<property>` Defines the logical name for the property.
- `<data-type>` Defines the property data type. For supported types, see the table below.
- `<embd-type>` Defines the property's embedded type (only for embedding property types `EMBEDDED`, `LIST`, `MAP`, as well as `LINK`).
- `<custom-key>` Name of a custom property to set on the new property. Multiple pairs can be listed, separated by commas.
- `<custom-value>` Value for the custom property. All data types are supported as values.
- `<property-constraint>` See `ALTER PROPERTY <attribute-name> * <attribute-value>`
  - `mandatory <true|false>` If true, the property must be present. Default is **false**
  - `notnull <true|false>` If true, the property, must be present and cannot be null. Default is **false**
  - `readonly <true|false>` If true, the property cannot be changed after the creation of the record. Default is **false**
  - `hidden <true|false>` **Deprecated, accepted but ignored.** See the note below. Default is **false**
  - `min <number|string>` Defines the minimum value for this property. For number types it is the minimum number as a value. For strings it represents the minimum number of characters. For dates is the minimum date (uses the database date format). For collections (lists, sets, maps) this attribute determines the minimally required number of elements.
  - `max <number|string>` Defines the maximum value for this property. For number types it is the maximum number as a value. For strings it represents the maximum number of characters. For dates is the maximum date (uses the database date format). For collections (lists, sets, maps) this attribute determines the maximally allowed number of elements.
  - `regexp <string>` Defines the mask to validate the input as a Regular Expression. A pattern is matched against the text form of the value. *(Since v26.11.1)* It is refused when it is declared if no value could ever pass it: on a `BINARY`, `LIST`, `MAP`, `EMBEDDED`, `LINK` or `ARRAY_OF_*` property, on a `BOOLEAN` when it matches neither `true` nor `false`, or when it is not a valid regular expression. A pattern on a number or a date is allowed (e.g. `'[0-9]{5}'` on a `LONG`). A database that already holds such a declaration still opens with a warning; `ALTER PROPERTY ⋯ REGEXP null` removes it.
  - `default <any>` Defines the value to use when the property is not present. The value is an **SQL expression**, evaluated once per new record, not a literal: write `default 'active'` for the string `active`, since an unquoted `active` is a field reference. The expression is compiled and validated when the property is declared, so a malformed one is rejected right there rather than silently producing garbage on every record. A default that evaluates to `null` fills in nothing, which makes it equivalent to declaring no default at all - see the note below.

- `external <true|false>` If true, the property's value is stored in a paired **external bucket** instead of inline in the primary record. The main record carries only a pointer (`[bucketId][position]`) to the external record. This keeps the primary bucket pages dense for graph traversal and pushes heavy payloads (vector embeddings, long strings, embedded JSON, full-text payloads) to a separate file that traversal-only queries do not touch. Default is **false**. See External property storage in the concepts section for details.
- `compression '<none|lz4|auto>'` Only meaningful together with `external true`. Controls compression of the value stored in the paired bucket: `none` (default) writes raw bytes, `lz4` always LZ4-compresses, `auto` tries LZ4 and keeps the compressed form only if it saves more than 10% (decided per record, so a single property can mix compressed and uncompressed records).
- `IF NOT EXISTS` If specified, create the property only if not exists. The statement returns one row either way, carrying a `created` flag: see the note on `IF NOT EXISTS` results. If a property with the same name already exists in the type, then no error is returned

The `hidden` attribute was **removed** and there is **no plan to reimplement it**. It is still accepted by the parser and stored in the schema so that existing scripts and databases keep working, but it no longer has any effect on queries: a property flagged as `hidden` is returned by `SELECT * FROM` exactly like any other property. Do not use it to conceal data: to keep a property out of a result set, list the properties you want explicitly (`SELECT name, email FROM …`) instead of using *; to restrict who can read a property, use the security layer.

When you create a property, ArcadeDB reads the records already stored in the type (including its subtypes) and checks them against the declaration: the declared type (a value that cannot be read as that type, such as `'abc'` for an `INTEGER`, is refused), `mandatory`, `notnull`, `min`, `max` and `regexp`. If a record does not satisfy the declaration, the statement fails, names the first offending record, and the property is not created. `ALTER PROPERTY … MIN`, `MAX` and `REGEXP`, and the openCypher `NOT NULL` and `NODE KEY` constraints, make the same check. On a type with many records this scan takes time proportional to the number of records.

A `LIST OF <type>` or `MAP OF <type>` property only accepts elements of that type. A single value written to a `LIST OF <type>` property is stored as a one-element list, converted to the element type like the elements of a list are: `longs = 5` stores `[5]` as a `LONG`. A number outside the range of the element type is refused instead of being clamped *(since v26.10.1)*. For a document type, a plain map becomes an embedded document of that type, and a value that is not a document of that type (a number, a string, a map typed as another type) is refused.

When constraints are set, such as `mandatory`, `read-only`, etc., it's not possible to use the Gremlin syntax to add vertices and edges without incurring in a Validation exception. The issue is that Gremlin API sets the properties after the creation of the vertex and edge.

Properties of the type `LINK` may have the value `NULL`, furthermore accessing a `LINK`

property which is not set results also in a `NULL` value.

**A default value of `NULL` is the same as no default value at all**

A default exists to supply a value when one is missing, so a default that evaluates to `NULL` supplies nothing and the property is left unset: `has()` returns false and the key is absent from the stored record, exactly as if no default had been declared. This holds however the `NULL` arises - `default null`, or an expression that evaluates to it such as `ifnull(NULL, NULL)`.

It follows that a `NULL` default cannot satisfy `mandatory`: nothing is filled in, so the record is rejected with `is mandatory, but not found`, which points at the missing value rather than at the default. Conversely it never trips `notnull`, which only applies to a property that is present.

**Changed in 26.9.1**

A default evaluating to `NULL` used to **set** the property to `NULL` instead of leaving it unset, so `has()` returned true and the key was written into every record. A `mandatory` property could therefore be satisfied by giving it an explicit `NULL` default such as `ifnull(NULL, NULL)`. That no longer works: the property is left unset, so the insert now fails with `is mandatory, but not found`. Drop `mandatory`, or give the property a default that actually produces a value.

### Examples

- Create the property `name` of the string type in the type `User`:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY User.name STRING
```

- Create a property called `tags` in the type `Profile` only allowing list members of type string:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Profile.tags LIST OF STRING
```

- Create the property `friends`, as an embedded map:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Profile.friends MAP
```

- Create the property `address`, as an embedded document:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Profile.address EMBEDDED
```

- Create the property `createdOn` of type date with additional constraints:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Transaction.createdOn DATE (mandatory true, notnull true,
readonly true, min "2010-01-01")
```

- Create the property `salary` only if it does not exist:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Employee.salary IF NOT EXISTS double
```

- Create the property `hiredAt` with the time of creation being the default value:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Employee.hiredAt DATETIME (readonly, default sysdate('YYYY-
MM-DD HH:MM:SS'))
```

- Create the property `embedding` for vector data, stored in a paired external bucket so traversal-only queries do not pay for it:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Person.embedding ARRAY_OF_FLOATS (EXTERNAL true)
```

- Create the property `body` stored externally with adaptive LZ4 compression (compresses text, falls back to raw when compression would not pay off):

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Doc.body STRING (EXTERNAL true, COMPRESSION 'auto')
```

- Create the property `num` with the custom property 'oflines':

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Doc.num INTEGER (readonly true) CUSTOM oflines = 1
```

- Create the property `width` with multiple custom properties:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Doc.width FLOAT CUSTOM unit = 'meters', scale = 2
```

Declaring `CUSTOM` inline is equivalent to running `ALTER PROPERTY … CUSTOM` right after the creation, but it happens in the same statement. When `IF NOT EXISTS` is used and the property is already there, the whole statement is skipped, so the custom properties are not applied to the existing property.

For more information, see:

- `ALTER PROPERTY`
- `DROP PROPERTY`
- External property storage

**Supported Types**

ArcadeDB supports the following data types for standard properties:

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| BOOLEAN | BYTE | SHORT | INTEGER | LONG |
| STRING | LINK | BINARY | DATE | DATETIME |
| FLOAT | DOUBLE | DECIMAL | | |

It supports the following data types for container properties:

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| LIST | MAP | EMBEDDED |

### 14.12.2. SQL - ALTER PROPERTY

Change a property defined in the schema. The change is persistent.

**Syntax**

```
ALTER PROPERTY <type-name>.<property-name> <attribute-name> <attribute-value> [CUSTOM
<custom-key> = <custom-value>]

ALTER PROPERTY <type-name>.<property-name> NAME <new-property-name>
```

- `<type-name>` Defines the type where the property is defined
- `<property-name>` Defines the property in the `type-name` you want to change
- `<attribute-name>` Defines the attribute you want to change. For a list of supported attributes, see the table below
- `<attribute-value>` Defines the value you want to set
  - `name <new-property-name>` Renames the property. This is a schema-metadata-only rename: it does not touch existing records. Records keep answering under the old name until they are next written, at which point they pick up the new name. Not allowed on an indexed property, on a column declared directly on a TIME SERIES type, or if `<new-property-name>` already exists on the type.
  - `mandatory <true|false>` If true, the property must be present. Default is false. Setting it to true scans the existing records and is refused, naming the first offending record, if any of them has no value for the property.
  - `notnull <true|false>` If true, the property, if present, cannot be null. Default is false. Setting it to true is refused, naming the first offending record, if an existing record holds a null for the property.
  - `readonly <true|false>` If true, the property cannot be changed after the creation of the record. Default is false
  - `hidden <true|false>` **Deprecated, accepted but ignored.** See the note below.
  - `min <number|string>` Defines the minimum value for this property. For number types it is the minimum number as a value. For strings, it represents the minimum number of characters.

For dates is the minimum date (uses the database date format). For collections (lists, sets, maps) this attribute determines the minimally required number of elements.

- `max <number|string>` Defines the maximum value for this property. For number types it is the maximum number as a value. For strings, it represents the maximum number of characters. For dates is the maximum date (uses the database date format). For collections (lists, sets, maps) this attribute determines the maximally allowed number of elements.
- `regexp <string>` Defines the mask to validate the input as a Regular Expression. Refused when no value of the property could pass it, as for `CREATE PROPERTY`.
- `default <any>` Defines the value to use when the property is not present, as an **SQL expression** evaluated once per new record. Quote a literal (`default 'active'`); an unquoted `active` is a field reference and is rejected. A default that evaluates to `null` is equivalent to no default at all - see `CREATE PROPERTY`.
- `external <true|false>` Toggles external storage of the property's value (see External property storage). Switching the flag does not migrate existing records eagerly; they are converted lazily on the next write, or all at once with `REBUILD TYPE`.
- `compression '<none|lz4|auto>'` Sets the compression mode for an EXTERNAL property's payload (`none`, `lz4`, or `auto`). Has no effect on inline properties.

- **`<custom-key>`** Name of the custom property to set
- **`<custom-value>`** Value for the custom property. All data types are supported as values.

The `hidden` attribute was **removed** and there is **no plan to reimplement it**. It is still accepted and persisted in the schema for backward compatibility, but it has no effect on queries. See `CREATE PROPERTY` for details.

A custom property can be deleted by setting its value to `null`.

**Examples**

- Set the property 'subscribedOn' as mandatory:

```
ArcadeDB> ALTER PROPERTY User.subscribedOn MANDATORY true
```

- Set the property 'createdOn' as read-only

```
ArcadeDB> ALTER PROPERTY User.createdOn READONLY true
```

- Set the custom value with key 'description':

```
ArcadeDB> ALTER PROPERTY Account.signedOn CUSTOM description = 'First Sign In'
```

- Move an existing property to external storage and enable adaptive LZ4 compression:

```
ArcadeDB> ALTER PROPERTY Doc.body EXTERNAL true
ArcadeDB> ALTER PROPERTY Doc.body COMPRESSION 'auto'
```

- Move a property back to inline storage:

```
ArcadeDB> ALTER PROPERTY Doc.body EXTERNAL false
```

- Rename the property 'surname' to 'lastName':

```
ArcadeDB> ALTER PROPERTY User.surname NAME lastName
```

For more information, see:

- `CREATE PROPERTY`
- `DROP PROPERTY`
- `ALTER TYPE`
- External property storage

### 14.12.3. SQL - `DROP PROPERTY`

Removes a property from the schema. Does not remove the property values in the records, it just changes the schema information. Records continue to have the property values, if any. Anything declared on the property, such as a `DEFAULT` value or a constraint, stops applying at once: new records are created without it.

**Syntax**

```
DROP PROPERTY <type>.<property> [IF EXISTS] [FORCE]
```

- `<type>` Defines the type where the property exists.
- `<property>` Defines the property you want to remove.
- `IF EXISTS` Prevent errors if the property does not exist when attempting to drop it. See here for the shape of the result.
- `FORCE` In case one or more indexes are defined on the property, the command will throw an exception. Use `FORCE` to drop indexes together with the property

**Examples**

- Remove the `name` property from the type `User`:

```
ArcadeDB> DROP PROPERTY User.name
```

For more information, see:

- `ALTER PROPERTY`
- `CREATE PROPERTY`

# 14.13. Indexes

## 14.13.1. SQL - `CREATE INDEX`

Creates a new index. Indexes can be:

- **Unique** Where they don't allow duplicates (LSM Tree).
- **Not Unique** Where they allow duplicates (LSM Tree).
- **Unique Hash** O(1) equality lookups, no duplicates (Hash Index).
- **Not Unique Hash** O(1) equality lookups, allows duplicates (Hash Index).
- **Full Text** Where they index any single word of text.
- **Geospatial** Where they index WKT geometry strings for spatial queries.
- **HNSW** (Hierarchical Navigable Small World) vector index.
- **LSMVectorIndex** LSM Tree-based vector index for persistent similarity search.

> There are several index algorithms available to determine how ArcadeDB indexes your database. For more information on these, see Indexes.

**Syntax**

```
CREATE INDEX [<manual-index-name>]
[ IF NOT EXISTS ]
[ ON <type> (<property> [BY KEY|VALUE|ITEM] [COLLATE CI][,]*) ]
<index-type> [<key-type>]
[ NULL_STRATEGY SKIP|ERROR|INDEX]
```

- `<manual-index-name>` Only for manual indexes, defines the logical name for the index. For automatic indexes, the index name is assigned automatically by ArcadeDB at creation as `<type>[<property>[,]*]`. For example, the index created on type Friend, properties "firstName" and "lastName", it will be named "Friend[firstName,lastName]"
- `IF NOT EXISTS` Specifying this option, the index creation will just be ignored if the index already exists (instead of failing with an error). An index counts as already existing when it covers the same properties with the same index type, either on the type named in the statement or on one of its **super types**: an index declared on a super type indexes the records of all its sub types, so there is nothing left to create. An index of the same name on an unrelated type, on a **sub** type, on different properties, or of a different index type is still reported as an error, because none of those provides what the statement asked for. It is safe to send the same statement from several connections at once: exactly one of them builds the index and returns `created: true`, and the

others wait for it and return `created: false` (see the note on `IF NOT EXISTS` results).

```
CREATE INDEX `Element_uuid` IF NOT EXISTS ON `Element` (uuid) UNIQUE;
-- ignored: the index on the super type already covers UnidentifiedElement
CREATE INDEX `Element_uuid` IF NOT EXISTS ON `UnidentifiedElement` (uuid) UNIQUE;
```

- `<type>` Defines the type to create an automatic index for. The type must already exist.
- `<property>` Defines the property you want to automatically index. The property must already exist.
  - `BY KEY` index by key names for map properties.
  - `BY VALUE` index by values for map properties.
  - `BY ITEM` index by values for list elements.
  - `COLLATE CI` enables case-insensitive collation for this property. Values are stored in lowercase internally, so lookups match regardless of case. Can be specified independently for each property in a composite index. The only accepted values are `CI` and `DEFAULT`, in any letter case; anything else is reported as an error rather than ignored, so a misspelled collation cannot silently produce a case-sensitive index. See concepts/indexes.pdf for details.
- `<index-type>` Defines the index type you want to use:
  - `UNIQUE` does not allow duplicate keys (LSM Tree),
  - `NOTUNIQUE` allows duplicate keys (LSM Tree),
  - `UNIQUE_HASH` does not allow duplicate keys (Hash Index — O(1) equality lookups, no range queries),
  - `NOTUNIQUE_HASH` allows duplicate keys (Hash Index — O(1) equality lookups, no range queries),
  - `FULL_TEXT` based on any single word of text. Uses Apache Lucene for tokenization and supports configurable analyzers, multi-property indexing, advanced query syntax, and BM25 relevance scoring. See how-to/data-modeling/full-text-index.pdf for full documentation.
  - `GEOSPATIAL` indexes WKT geometry strings stored in `STRING` properties, enabling spatial queries via the `geo.*` SQL function namespace. See how-to/data-modeling/geospatial.pdf for full documentation.
  - `HNSW` vector index (Hierarchical Navigable Small World).
  - `LSMVECTORINDEX` LSM Tree-based vector index.
  - `LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR` posting-list inverted index for sparse-vector retrieval (BM25-style, SPLADE, BGE-M3, OpenSearch sparse). See Sparse Vector Search for full documentation.
- `<key-type>` Defines the key type. With automatic indexes, the key type is automatically selected when the database reads the target schema property. For manual indexes, when not specified, it selects the key at run-time during the first insertion by reading the type of the type. In creating composite indexes, it uses a comma-separated list of types.

To create an automatic index bound to the schema property, use the `ON` clause. In order to create an

index, the schema must already exist in your database.

In the event that the `ON` and `<key-type>` clauses both exist, the database validates the specified property types. If the property types don't equal those specified in the key type list, it throws an exception.

The `NULL_STRATEGY` determines how null values are indexed:

- `SKIP` (default) excludes null values from the index,
- `ERROR` throws an error in case a null value is found during indexing,
- `INDEX` adds null values to the index.

With the default `SKIP`, an ascending `ORDER BY` on an indexed property has to scan the type for records with a null value, because nulls sort first and are not in the index. The scan is skipped when the property is declared `NOTNULL` or the `WHERE` clause excludes nulls (`IS NOT NULL`, `=`, `<`, `>`). For optional properties read in order with a `LIMIT`, create the index with `NULL_STRATEGY INDEX`.

A unique index does not regard derived types or embedded documents of the indexed type.

While `CREATE INDEX` is still building the index, queries do not use it: `SELECT`, `database.select()` and Cypher scan the type instead, so their results are complete, and `lookupByKey()` answers as if the index did not exist yet. Queries use the index as soon as the command completes. Since 26.11.1.

> You can use list key types when creating manual composite indexes, but bear in mind that such indexes are not yet fully supported.

**Examples**

- Create an automatic index bound to the new property `id` in the type `User`:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY User.id BINARY
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON User (id) UNIQUE
```

- Create a series of automatic indexes for the `thumbs` map property in the type `Movie`. `BY KEY` indexes the map's keys, `BY VALUE` its values. They are usually `NOTUNIQUE`, since the same key (or value) normally appears across many records:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON Movie (thumbs BY KEY) NOTUNIQUE
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON Movie (thumbs BY VALUE) NOTUNIQUE
```

Once created, these indexes are automatically used when filtering a map by key or by value:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM Movie WHERE thumbs CONTAINSKEY 'poster'
ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM Movie WHERE thumbs CONTAINSVALUE 'poster.png'
```

- Create a index for the `actors` list property in the type `Movie`. `BY ITEM` indexes each element of the list, so a filter on a single value uses the index:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON Movie (actors BY ITEM) NOTUNIQUE
ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM Movie WHERE actors = 'Keanu Reeves'
```

The key type of a `BY ITEM` index is the declared item type of the list (`LIST OF DOUBLE` is keyed as DOUBLE), so `WHERE prices CONTAINS 7` finds a stored `7.0` with or without the index. A list without a declared item type is keyed as STRING. An index created before this rule keeps its STRING keys until it is rebuilt (`REBUILD INDEX`).

- Create a series of properties and on them create a composite index:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Book.author STRING
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Book.title STRING
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Book.publicationYears LIST
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON Book (author, title, publicationYears) UNIQUE
```

- Create an index on an edge's date range:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE VERTEX TYPE File
ArcadeDB> CREATE EDGE TYPE Has
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Has.started DATETIME
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Has.ended DATETIME
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON Has (started, ended) NOTUNIQUE
```

You can create indexes on edge types only if they contain the begin and end date range of validity. This is use case is very common with historical graphs, such as the example above.

- Using the above index, retrieve all the edges that existed in the year 2014:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT FROM Has WHERE started >= '2014-01-01 00:00:00.000' AND
           ended < '2015-01-01 00:00:00.000'
```

- Using the above index, retrieve all edges that existed in 2014 and write them to the parent file:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT outV() FROM Has WHERE started >= '2014-01-01 00:00:00.000'
           AND ended < '2015-01-01 00:00:00.000'
```

- Using the above index, retrieve all the 2014 edges and connect them to children files:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT inV() FROM Has WHERE started >= '2014-01-01 00:00:00.000'
            AND ended < '2015-01-01 00:00:00.000'
```

- Create an index that includes null values.

By default, indexes ignore null values. Queries against null values that use an index returns no entries. To return an error in case of null values, append `NULL_STRATEGY ERROR` when you create the index.

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON Employee (address) NOTUNIQUE NULL_STRATEGY ERROR
```

- Create a case-insensitive index on a string property:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Product.Name STRING
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON Product (Name COLLATE CI) NOTUNIQUE
```

Queries like `SELECT FROM Product WHERE Name = 'Hello World'` will now match `"Hello World"`, `"HELLO WORLD"`, `"hello world"`, etc. A plain equality or `IN` is case sensitive (since 26.11.1) and a range (`>`, `>=`, `<`, `<=`, `BETWEEN`) on the plain property does not use the index; use `Name.toLowerCase() = 'john'` or `Name.toLowerCase() >= 'c'` for a case-insensitive lookup or range.

- Create a case-insensitive unique index to prevent duplicate entries ignoring case:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY User.username STRING
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON User (username COLLATE CI) UNIQUE
```

This prevents inserting both `"Admin"` and `"admin"`, since they are treated as the same key.

- Create a composite index with case-insensitive collation on some properties only:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Product.Name STRING
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Product.Code STRING
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON Product (Name COLLATE CI, Code) UNIQUE
```

In this example, `Name` uses case-insensitive collation while `Code` uses the default (case-sensitive) collation.

When a `COLLATE CI` index exists on a property, the query optimizer also recognizes queries that use `.toLowerCase()` (e.g., `WHERE Name.toLowerCase() = 'hello world'`) and will use the case-insensitive index for these queries.

- Create a unique hash index for O(1) primary key lookups:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY User.email STRING
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON User (email) UNIQUE_HASH
```

- Create a non-unique hash index for fast equality lookups:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Order.status STRING
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON Order (status) NOTUNIQUE_HASH
```

Hash indexes use extendable hashing and provide O(1) equality lookups — significantly faster than LSM Tree for point queries (`WHERE key = value`). However, they do not support range scans (`<`, `>`, `BETWEEN`) or ordered iteration (`ORDER BY`). Use `UNIQUE`/`NOTUNIQUE` (LSM Tree) when you need range queries or ordering.

- Build an index over a large existing type with the sorted build:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON LineItem (shipdate) NOTUNIQUE METADATA {buildMode: 'SORTED'}
```

`buildMode` is `DEFAULT` (records are added one at a time) or `SORTED` (a bounded external sort writes the ordered entries straight into the index). `SORTED` is meant for bulk builds on large types, works on `UNIQUE` and `NOTUNIQUE` indexes only, and cannot run inside a transaction or on a replicated database.

- Create a full-text index and search it using `SEARCH_INDEX()`:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON Employee (address) FULL_TEXT
```

```
SELECT * FROM Employee
WHERE SEARCH_INDEX('Employee[address]', 'New York')
```

`LIKE` and `ILIKE` do not use full-text indexes. See how-to/data-modeling/full-text-index.pdf for analyzer configuration, Lucene query syntax, relevance scoring, and More Like This.

- Create a basic LSMVectorIndex for similarity search on vector embeddings:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE VERTEX TYPE Doc
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Doc.embedding ARRAY_OF_FLOATS
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON Doc (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {dimensions: 100,
similarity: 'COSINE'}
```

By default, `CREATE INDEX ⋯ LSM_VECTOR` builds the HNSW graph immediately, so

> the index is ready to query as soon as the command completes. This is the recommended behavior for most use cases. If you prefer to defer graph construction to the first search (lazy mode), set `buildGraphNow: false` in the metadata.

- Create an LSMVectorIndex with deferred graph building (useful when bulk-loading data after index creation):

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON Doc (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {dimensions: 100,
similarity: 'COSINE', buildGraphNow: false}
```

The graph will be built lazily on the first `vector.neighbors()` query or when `REBUILD INDEX` is executed.

- Create an LSMVectorIndex with DOT_PRODUCT similarity metric:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE VERTEX TYPE Image
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Image.featureVector ARRAY_OF_FLOATS
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON Image (featureVector) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {dimensions: 512,
similarity: 'DOT_PRODUCT'}
```

- Create an LSMVectorIndex with EUCLIDEAN distance metric and custom performance parameters:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE VERTEX TYPE Product
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Product.attributes ARRAY_OF_FLOATS
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON Product (attributes) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {dimensions: 256,
similarity: 'EUCLIDEAN', maxConnections: 32, beamWidth: 200}
```

- Create an LSMVectorIndex with minimal metadata:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE VERTEX TYPE CompactDoc
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY CompactDoc.vec ARRAY_OF_FLOATS
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX IF NOT EXISTS ON CompactDoc (vec) LSM_VECTOR METADATA
{dimensions: 4, similarity: 'COSINE'}
```

- Create an LSMVectorIndex with tuned performance parameters for large-scale indexing:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE VERTEX TYPE VectorVertex
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY VectorVertex.embedding ARRAY_OF_FLOATS
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX IF NOT EXISTS ON VectorVertex (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA
{dimensions: 1024, similarity: 'COSINE', maxConnections: 16, beamWidth: 100}
```

- Create an LSMVectorIndex with a custom efSearch for consistent high recall:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON Doc (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {dimensions: 768,
similarity: 'COSINE', quantization: 'INT8', efSearch: 200}
```

When `efSearch` is set in the index metadata, all queries on this index use the specified beam width by default. Individual queries can still override it by passing efSearch as the 4th argument to `vector.neighbors()`.

- Create an LSMVectorIndex on embeddings with metadata about source:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE VERTEX TYPE Doc
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Doc.content STRING
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Doc.embedding ARRAY_OF_FLOATS
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Doc.source STRING
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON Doc (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {dimensions: 384,
similarity: 'COSINE', maxConnections: 16, beamWidth: 100}
```

Then query for similar documents:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('Doc[embedding]', [0.1, 0.2, 0.3], 10))
```

- Create multiple LSMVectorIndexes on different properties in the same type (multi-modal embeddings):

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE VERTEX TYPE MultiModalRecord
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY MultiModalRecord.imageEmbedding ARRAY_OF_FLOATS
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY MultiModalRecord.textEmbedding ARRAY_OF_FLOATS
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON MultiModalRecord (imageEmbedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA
{dimensions: 512, similarity: 'COSINE', maxConnections: 16, beamWidth: 100}
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON MultiModalRecord (textEmbedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA
{dimensions: 768, similarity: 'COSINE', maxConnections: 16, beamWidth: 100}
```

Query for similar records using the image embedding:

```
ArcadeDB> SELECT expand(vector.neighbors('MultiModalRecord[imageEmbedding]', [0.1,
0.2, 0.3], 5))
```

- Create an LSMVectorIndex with tuned parameters for high-dimensional data:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE VERTEX TYPE Word
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY Word.vector ARRAY_OF_FLOATS
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON Word (vector) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {dimensions: 100,
similarity: 'COSINE', maxConnections: 16, beamWidth: 100}
```

- Create an LSMVectorIndex with INT8 quantization for 4x memory savings:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE VERTEX TYPE LargeCorpus
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY LargeCorpus.embedding ARRAY_OF_FLOATS
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON LargeCorpus (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {dimensions:
1536, similarity: 'COSINE', quantization: 'INT8'}
```

The index will automatically quantize vectors on insert and dequantize on retrieval, reducing memory usage by 75% with minimal accuracy loss (<2%).

- Create an LSMVectorIndex with BINARY quantization for extreme compression (32x memory savings):

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE VERTEX TYPE MassiveDataset
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY MassiveDataset.embedding ARRAY_OF_FLOATS
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON MassiveDataset (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {dimensions:
1536, similarity: 'COSINE', quantization: 'BINARY'}
```

Binary quantization compresses each dimension to 1 bit, achieving 97% memory reduction. Suitable for approximate search with reranking.

- Create an LSMVectorIndex with PRODUCT quantization for zero-disk-I/O graph construction on large datasets:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE VERTEX TYPE BigDataset
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY BigDataset.embedding ARRAY_OF_FLOATS
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON BigDataset (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {dimensions:
1024, similarity: 'COSINE', quantization: 'PRODUCT'}
```

Product quantization builds the graph using compact PQ codes that stay in memory, eliminating disk I/O during construction. Most effective on large datasets (100K+ vectors).

Quantization types: `NONE` (default, no compression), `INT8` (recommended, 4x compression, <2% accuracy loss), `BINARY` (32x compression, approximate search), `PRODUCT` (16-64x compression, zero-disk-I/O graph build). Quantization is transparent - vectors are stored compressed but queries work the same way.

- Create an LSMVectorIndex with inline vector storage for large-scale deployments (100K+ vectors):

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE VERTEX TYPE LargeScale
ArcadeDB> CREATE PROPERTY LargeScale.embedding ARRAY_OF_FLOATS
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON LargeScale (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  dimensions: 1536,
  similarity: 'COSINE',
  quantization: 'INT8',
  storeVectorsInGraph: true,
  mutationsBeforeRebuild: 1000
```

```
}
```

The `storeVectorsInGraph` option stores vectors inline within the JVector graph file, eliminating expensive document lookups during search operations. This dramatically reduces RAM pressure for large indexes (100K+ vectors) by avoiding document page cache thrashing.

**When to use `storeVectorsInGraph`:**

- **Enable** (`true`) for: Large indexes (100K+ vectors), high search throughput, read-heavy workloads, RAM-constrained environments
- **Disable** (`false`, default) for: Small indexes (<10K vectors), frequent vector updates, write-heavy workloads

**Trade-offs:**

- **Benefit**: 70-80% RAM reduction for large indexes by co-locating vectors with graph topology
- **Cost**: Vectors duplicated on disk (stored in both documents and graph file)
- **Best with**: Combine with `quantization=INT8` or `BINARY` for maximum efficiency (reduced disk + reduced RAM)

**Example - optimal large-scale configuration:**

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE INDEX ON LargeScale (embedding) LSM_VECTOR METADATA {
  dimensions: 1536,
  similarity: 'COSINE',
  quantization: 'INT8',              -- 4x memory reduction (recommended)
  storeVectorsInGraph: true,         -- Fast co-located access
  efSearch: 200,                     -- Consistent high recall
  maxConnections: 32,                -- Vamana per-layer degree (default); = hnswlib
M=16
  beamWidth: 100,
  locationCacheSize: 200000,         -- Cache hot vectors
  mutationsBeforeRebuild: 1000,      -- Reduce rebuild frequency
  inactivityRebuildTimeoutMs: 30000  -- Flush buffered vectors after 30s of inactivity
}
```

- Create a geospatial index on a WKT property and query it:

```
CREATE VERTEX TYPE Location
CREATE PROPERTY Location.coords STRING
CREATE INDEX ON Location (coords) GEOSPATIAL

INSERT INTO Location SET name = 'Eiffel Tower', coords = 'POINT(2.2945 48.8584)'

SELECT name FROM Location
WHERE geo.within(coords, geo.geomFromText(
  'POLYGON((2.28 48.84, 2.42 48.84, 2.42 48.90, 2.28 48.90, 2.28 48.84))'
```

```
)) = true
```

See how-to/data-modeling/geospatial.pdf for full documentation on geometry formats, predicate functions, and precision configuration.

- Create a sparse vector index for SPLADE / BM25 / BGE-M3 hybrid retrieval.

```
CREATE DOCUMENT TYPE Doc
CREATE PROPERTY Doc.tokens  ARRAY_OF_INTEGERS
CREATE PROPERTY Doc.weights ARRAY_OF_FLOATS

CREATE INDEX ON Doc (tokens, weights) LSM_SPARSE_VECTOR
  METADATA { dimensions: 105000, modifier: 'IDF', weightQuantization: 'FP32' }
```

The two parallel array properties carry the non-zero dimension ids and matching weights for each record. `dimensions` declares the vocabulary cap and rejects out-of-range ids at write time (set to `0` to disable the cap). `modifier: 'IDF'` enables Robertson-Sparck-Jones IDF weighting at query time; omit it (or set to `'NONE'`) for plain dot-product scoring.

`weightQuantization` controls how posting weights are stored on disk, bringing the sparse index to parity with the dense `LSM_VECTOR` index's quantization knob:

| Value | Storage / trade-off |
|---|---|
| `INT8` | 1 byte per weight (the default). Smallest index; the stored weights are approximate, the returned scores are exact (see `rescoreOversample` below). |
| `FP16` | 2 bytes per weight. Half the size of `FP32` with near-exact stored weights; the returned scores are exact (see `rescoreOversample` below). |
| `FP32` | 4 bytes per weight. Exact stored weights; largest index. |

Omit `weightQuantization` to keep the `INT8` default. The setting is fixed at index-creation time; to change it, drop and recreate (or `REBUILD INDEX`) the index.

`FP16` stores weights as IEEE 754 half-precision, subnormals included, so magnitudes down to `6e-8` keep their value rather than flushing to zero. A weight whose magnitude exceeds the format's largest finite value (`65504`) is saturated to it rather than stored as infinity, and `NaN` is rejected at write time.

`rescoreOversample` controls **exact rescoring**. With `INT8` or `FP16` weights, a search fetches `k * rescoreOversample` candidates from the index, recomputes each one's score from the record's own full-precision `weights` (with the IDF weighting too, when `modifier: 'IDF'` is set), and returns the best `k` by that exact score. The quantized weights only choose the candidates, so the results and their scores do not depend on the quantization, or on how the data was committed and compacted, which otherwise shifts `INT8` weights a little at every segment merge. This applies to `groupBy` searches as well.

| Value | Behavior |
|---|---|
| *omitted* | `2` for `INT8` and `FP16`, off for `FP32` (whose stored weights are already exact). On the BigANN sparse track (SPLADE, top-10) this takes `INT8` recall from 0.995 to 1.0, for 10-20% more query time. |
| `0` | Off: results are ranked by the quantized scores, as before v26.10.1. |
| `1` | Exact scores for the returned results, without widening the candidate set. |
| `2` .. `100` | Candidates fetched per requested result. |

A sparse-vector index can be created on a type that already holds records: the build indexes the existing rows.

Query with `vector.sparseNeighbors`:

```
SELECT expand(`vector.sparseNeighbors`('Doc[tokens,weights]', :qIdx, :qVal, 50))
```

For server-side hybrid retrieval (dense + sparse + full-text fused into one ranked top-K), see Hybrid Search with `vector.fuse`.

After a large bulk load, run `COMPACT INDEX` to merge the index segments and get lower, more stable query latency without waiting for the background compaction.

For more information, see:

- `COMPACT INDEX`
- `DROP INDEX`
- `Indexes`

### 14.13.2. SQL - `REBUILD INDEX`

Rebuilds automatic indexes.

**Syntax**

```
REBUILD INDEX <index-name>
```

- `<index-name>` It is the index name that you want to rebuild. Use `*` to rebuild all automatic indexes. Quote the index name if it contains special characters like square brackets.

During the rebuild, any idempotent queries made against the index, skip the index and perform sequential scans. This means that queries run slower during this operation. Non-idempotent commands, such as `INSERT`, `UPDATE`, and `DELETE` are blocked waiting until the indexes are rebuilt.

During normal operations an index rebuild is not necessary. Rebuild an index only

if it breaks.

If the rebuild fails (for example because a stored record has a null key and the index null strategy is `ERROR`), the statement reports the error and the index is put back as it was, with its unique constraint. If the original null strategy cannot be applied to the stored data, the index is restored with `SKIP` and the original strategy is set in memory only, so after a restart it uses `SKIP` again. Since 26.10.1.

To build a large `LSM_TREE` index (unique or non-unique) over data that is already loaded (single-server, no active transaction), the Java API offers a much faster offline **sorted bulk build** that constructs the index directly in compacted form. See Sorted bulk build.

**Examples**

- Rebuild an index on the `email` property on the type `Profile`:

```
ArcadeDB> REBUILD INDEX `Profile[email]`
```

- Rebuild all indexes:

```
ArcadeDB> REBUILD INDEX *
```

For more information, see:

- `CREATE INDEX`
- `COMPACT INDEX`
- `DROP INDEX`
- Indexes

### 14.13.3. SQL - `COMPACT INDEX`

Forces an immediate compaction of automatic indexes, merging their on-disk segments into a compacted form.

ArcadeDB compacts indexes automatically in the background. `COMPACT INDEX` lets you trigger it on demand, which is useful right after a bulk load to settle an index and get lower, more stable query latency without waiting for the background schedule. Unlike `REBUILD INDEX`, it does not re-index the data: it only merges the existing segments, so it is much faster.

It works for standard LSM-Tree indexes as well as vector and sparse-vector indexes, and runs synchronously (it returns when the compaction has finished). On a sparse-vector index it also seals the in-memory buffer of recent writes, so afterwards the whole index sits in a single segment. Because it is a regular SQL command, it can be executed from any client, including the HTTP `/command` endpoint.

**Syntax**

```
COMPACT INDEX <index-name>
```

- `<index-name>` It is the index name that you want to compact. Use `*` to compact all automatic indexes. Quote the index name if it contains special characters like square brackets.

**Examples**

- Compact the sparse-vector index on the `tokens` and `weights` properties of the type `Doc`:

```
ArcadeDB> COMPACT INDEX `Doc[tokens,weights]`
```

- Compact all indexes:

```
ArcadeDB> COMPACT INDEX *
```

For more information, see:

- `CREATE INDEX`
- `REBUILD INDEX`
- Indexes

### 14.13.4. SQL - `DROP INDEX`

Removes an index from a property defined in the schema.

If the index does not exist, this call just returns with no errors.

**Syntax**

```
DROP INDEX <index-name> [ IF EXISTS ]
```

- `<index-name>` Defines the name of the index.

**Examples**

- Remove the index on the `Id` property of the `Users` type:

```
ArcadeDB> DROP INDEX `Users[Id]`
```

For more information, see:

- `CREATE INDEX`

- Indexes

# 14.14. Buckets

## 14.14.1. SQL - `CREATE BUCKET`

Creates a new bucket in the database. Once created, you can use the bucket to save records by specifying its name during saves. If you want to add the new bucket to a type, follow its creation with the `ALTER TYPE` command.

**Syntax**

```
CREATE BUCKET <bucket> [IF NOT EXISTS] [ID <bucket-id>]
```

- `<bucket>` Defines the name of the bucket you want to create. You must use a letter for the first character, for all other characters, you can use alphanumeric characters, underscores and dashes.
- **IF NOT EXISTS** Specifying this option, the bucket creation is just ignored if the bucket already exists, instead of failing with an error. The statement returns one row either way, carrying a `created` flag: see the note on `IF NOT EXISTS` results.
- `<bucket-id>` Defines the numeric ID you want to use for the bucket.

**Examples**

- Create the bucket `account`:

```
ArcadeDB> CREATE BUCKET account
```

> For more information see:

- `DROP BUCKET`

## 14.14.2. SQL - `DROP BUCKET`

Removes the bucket and all of its content. This operation is permanent and cannot be rolled back.

**Syntax**

```
DROP BUCKET <bucket-name>|<bucket-id> [IF EXISTS]
```

- `<bucket-name>` Defines the name of the bucket you want to remove.
- `<bucket-id>` Defines the ID of the bucket you want to remove.
- `IF EXISTS` Prevent errors if the bucket does not exist when attempting to drop it. See here for the shape of the result.

**Examples**

- Remove the bucket `Account`:

```
ArcadeDB> DROP BUCKET Account
```

For more information, see:

- `CREATE BUCKET`
- `DROP TYPE`

### 14.14.3. SQL - `TRUNCATE BUCKET`

Deletes all records of a bucket. This command operates at a lower level than the standard `DELETE` command.

Truncation is not permitted on vertex or edge types, but you can force its execution using the `UNSAFE` keyword. Forcing truncation is strongly discouraged, as it can leave the graph in an inconsistent state.

**Syntax**

```
TRUNCATE BUCKET <bucket>
```

- **`<bucket>`** Defines the bucket to delete.
- **`UNSAFE`** Defines whether the command forces the truncation on vertex or edge types.

**Transactions**

As with `TRUNCATE TYPE`, the command is part of the caller's transaction when one is active - a `ROLLBACK` puts every record back - and owns a transaction of its own, committing one batch of `arcadedb.truncateBatchSize` records at a time, when none is. The result set reports which applied through the `transactional` field.

Before v26.9.1 the command always committed as it went, even inside a transaction, so a `ROLLBACK` after a `TRUNCATE BUCKET` recovered at most the records of the last uncommitted batch.

**Examples**

- Remove all records in the bucket `profile`:

```
ArcadeDB> TRUNCATE BUCKET profile
```

For more information, see:

- DELETE
- TRUNCATE TYPE

# 14.15. Triggers (DDL)

## 14.15.1. SQL - CREATE TRIGGER

Creates a new database trigger that automatically executes SQL statements, JavaScript code, or Java classes in response to record events.

Triggers enable you to implement business logic, data validation, audit trails, and automated workflows directly in your database.

**Syntax**

```
CREATE TRIGGER [IF NOT EXISTS] <trigger-name>
  (BEFORE|AFTER) (CREATE|READ|UPDATE|DELETE)
  ON [TYPE] <type-name>
  EXECUTE (SQL|JAVASCRIPT|JAVA) '<code-or-class-name>'
```

- IF NOT EXISTS Optional: skip creation if trigger already exists (instead of failing with an error)
- <trigger-name> Unique name for the trigger
- BEFORE|AFTER When to execute the trigger:
  - BEFORE - Execute before the event occurs
  - AFTER - Execute after the event occurs
- CREATE|READ|UPDATE|DELETE Which database event to respond to:
  - CREATE - When a new record is created
  - READ - When a record is read from the database
  - UPDATE - When a record is modified
  - DELETE - When a record is deleted
- <type-name> The document, vertex, or edge type to monitor
- SQL|JAVASCRIPT|JAVA The language/type of the trigger action:
  - SQL - Execute SQL statements
  - JAVASCRIPT - Execute JavaScript code using GraalVM
  - JAVA - Execute a Java class implementing the JavaTrigger interface
- <code-or-class-name> The SQL statement, JavaScript code, or fully qualified Java class name to execute

**Context Variables**

Triggers have access to the following context variables:

- **SQL Triggers**:
  - `$record` or `record` - The current record being operated on
- **JavaScript Triggers**:
  - `record` or `$record` - The current record being operated on
  - `oldRecord` or `$oldRecord` - The original record (for UPDATE operations only)
  - `database` - The database instance
- **Java Triggers**:
  - Parameters passed to the `execute()` method

**Return Values**

- **SQL Triggers**: If the SELECT statement returns no results, the trigger fails and the operation is aborted
- **JavaScript Triggers**: Return `false` to abort the operation (BEFORE triggers only), or throw an exception
- **Java Triggers**: Return `false` to abort the operation (BEFORE triggers only), or throw an exception

**Examples**

- Create an audit log that tracks all user creations:

```
CREATE DOCUMENT TYPE AuditLog;

CREATE TRIGGER user_audit AFTER CREATE ON TYPE User
EXECUTE SQL 'INSERT INTO AuditLog SET action = "user_created", userName =
$record.name, timestamp = sysdate()';
```

- Validate email format before creating users using JavaScript:

```
CREATE TRIGGER validate_email BEFORE CREATE ON TYPE User
EXECUTE JAVASCRIPT 'if (!record.email || !record.email.includes("@")) {\nthrow new
Error("Invalid email address");\n}';
```

- Automatically set timestamps using JavaScript:

```
CREATE TRIGGER user_defaults BEFORE CREATE ON TYPE User
EXECUTE JAVASCRIPT 'record.createdAt = new Date();\nif (!record.username &&
record.email) {\nrecord.username = record.email.split("@")[0];\n}';
```

- Ensure product prices are positive using SQL validation:

```
CREATE TRIGGER validate_price BEFORE CREATE ON TYPE Product
```

```
EXECUTE SQL 'SELECT FROM Product WHERE @this = $record AND price > 0';
```

- Update related records when parent changes:

```
CREATE TRIGGER customer_email_update AFTER UPDATE ON TYPE Customer
EXECUTE SQL 'UPDATE Order SET customerEmail = $record.email WHERE customerId =
$record.@rid';
```

- Use a Java class for maximum performance (class must be in the classpath):

```
CREATE TRIGGER validate_email BEFORE CREATE ON TYPE User
EXECUTE JAVA 'com.example.triggers.EmailValidationTrigger';
```

**Java Trigger Example**

To create a Java trigger, implement the `com.arcadedb.schema.trigger.JavaTrigger` interface:

```
package com.example.triggers;

import com.arcadedb.database.Database;
import com.arcadedb.database.Document;
import com.arcadedb.database.Record;
import com.arcadedb.schema.trigger.JavaTrigger;

public class EmailValidationTrigger implements JavaTrigger {

  @Override
  public boolean execute(Database database, Record record, Record oldRecord) throws
Exception {
    if (record instanceof Document) {
      Document doc = (Document) record;
      String email = doc.getString("email");

      if (email == null || !email.contains("@")) {
        throw new IllegalArgumentException("Invalid email address");
      }
    }
    return true;  // Continue with the operation
  }
}
```

For more information and advanced examples, see Triggers.

### 14.15.2. Listing triggers

Query the read-only `schema:triggers` virtual type to see the triggers a database defines. It works the same way locally and against a remote server.

```
SELECT FROM schema:triggers
```

Each row carries `name`, `typeName`, `timing` (`BEFORE`/`AFTER`), `event` (`CREATE`/`READ`/`UPDATE`/`DELETE`), `actionType` (`SQL`/`JAVASCRIPT`/`JAVA`) and `actionCode`. Filter and project it like any other type:

```
SELECT name, timing, event FROM schema:triggers WHERE typeName = 'User'
```

Triggers defined on a type the current user cannot read are omitted rather than failing the query.

Available since 26.10.1. See System Types for the other `schema:*` virtual types.

### 14.15.3. SQL - `DROP TRIGGER`

Removes a trigger from the database.

**Syntax**

```
DROP TRIGGER [IF EXISTS] <trigger-name>
```

- `IF EXISTS` Optional: do not fail if the trigger does not exist
- `<trigger-name>` The name of the trigger to remove

**Examples**

- Drop a trigger:

```
DROP TRIGGER user_audit;
```

- Drop a trigger only if it exists:

```
DROP TRIGGER IF EXISTS old_trigger;
```

For more information about triggers, see Triggers.

## 14.16. Materialized Views

### 14.16.1. SQL - `CREATE MATERIALIZED VIEW`

Creates a new materialized view in the schema. A materialized view stores the result of a SQL `SELECT` query in a backing document type for fast reads. The defining query is executed immediately on creation to perform the initial data load.

**Syntax**

```
CREATE MATERIALIZED VIEW [IF NOT EXISTS] <name>
  AS <select-query>
  [REFRESH MANUAL | REFRESH INCREMENTAL | REFRESH EVERY <n> SECOND | MINUTE | HOUR]
  [BUCKETS <n>]
```

- `<name>` Defines the name of the materialized view. It must not conflict with any existing type or materialized view.
- `IF NOT EXISTS` Silently skips creation if a view with the same name already exists, instead of raising an error. See here for the shape of the result.
- `<select-query>` A SQL `SELECT` statement that defines the data for the view. All source types referenced must exist at creation time.
- `REFRESH MANUAL` (default) The view is only refreshed when triggered explicitly.
- `REFRESH INCREMENTAL` The view is automatically refreshed after each committed transaction that modifies a source type.
- `REFRESH EVERY <n> SECOND | MINUTE | HOUR` The view is refreshed on a schedule at the given interval.
- `BUCKETS <n>` Sets the number of buckets for the backing document type.

**Examples**

- Create a simple manual-refresh view:

```
CREATE MATERIALIZED VIEW ActiveUsers
  AS SELECT name, email FROM User WHERE active = true
```

- Create a view that updates automatically after each relevant commit:

```
CREATE MATERIALIZED VIEW RecentOrders
  AS SELECT customer, amount FROM Order WHERE status = 'PENDING'
  REFRESH INCREMENTAL
```

- Create a view that refreshes on a schedule:

```
CREATE MATERIALIZED VIEW HourlySummary
  AS SELECT product, sum(amount) AS total FROM Sale GROUP BY product
  REFRESH EVERY 1 HOUR
```

- Skip creation if the view already exists:

```
CREATE MATERIALIZED VIEW IF NOT EXISTS ActiveUsers
  AS SELECT name FROM User WHERE active = true
```

- Create a view with a custom bucket count for large result sets:

```
CREATE MATERIALIZED VIEW BigView
  AS SELECT * FROM HugeType
  BUCKETS 8
```

For more information, see:

- Materialized Views
- `DROP MATERIALIZED VIEW`
- `REFRESH MATERIALIZED VIEW`
- `ALTER MATERIALIZED VIEW`

### 14.16.2. SQL - `ALTER MATERIALIZED VIEW`

Changes the refresh mode of an existing materialized view.

`ALTER MATERIALIZED VIEW` is planned for a future release and is not yet implemented.

**Syntax**

```
ALTER MATERIALIZED VIEW <name>
  REFRESH MANUAL | REFRESH INCREMENTAL | REFRESH EVERY <n> SECOND | MINUTE | HOUR
```

- `<name>` The name of the materialized view to alter.
- `REFRESH MANUAL` Switches the view to manual refresh mode.
- `REFRESH INCREMENTAL` Switches the view to incremental refresh mode (automatic after each relevant commit).
- `REFRESH EVERY <n> SECOND | MINUTE | HOUR` Switches the view to periodic refresh mode at the specified interval.

For more information, see:

- Materialized Views
- `CREATE MATERIALIZED VIEW`
- `REFRESH MATERIALIZED VIEW`

### 14.16.3. SQL - `DROP MATERIALIZED VIEW`

Removes a materialized view and its backing document type, including all stored data.

**Syntax**

```
DROP MATERIALIZED VIEW [IF EXISTS] <name>
```

- `<name>` The name of the materialized view to remove.
- `IF EXISTS` Suppresses errors when the view does not exist.

**Examples**

- Drop a materialized view:

```
DROP MATERIALIZED VIEW ActiveUsers
```

- Drop a view only if it exists:

```
DROP MATERIALIZED VIEW IF EXISTS NonExistentView
```

You cannot drop the backing document type of a materialized view directly using `DROP TYPE`. Drop the materialized view first.

For more information, see:

- Materialized Views
- `CREATE MATERIALIZED VIEW`

### 14.16.4. SQL - `REFRESH MATERIALIZED VIEW`

Triggers an immediate full refresh of a materialized view's data. The operation truncates all existing data in the backing type and reloads it by re-executing the defining query. The refresh runs inside its own transaction.

This command is useful for `MANUAL` refresh mode views and for recovering a `STALE` view after a failed automatic refresh.

**Syntax**

```
REFRESH MATERIALIZED VIEW <name>
```

- `<name>` The name of the materialized view to refresh.

**Examples**

- Refresh a view immediately:

```
REFRESH MATERIALIZED VIEW HourlySummary
```

- Refresh after a bulk import to bring a manual view up to date:

```
REFRESH MATERIALIZED VIEW SalesByProduct
```

For more information, see:

- Materialized Views
- `CREATE MATERIALIZED VIEW`
- `ALTER MATERIALIZED VIEW`

# 14.17. Database Admin

## 14.17.1. SQL - `ALIGN DATABASE`

Executes a distributed alignment of the database. It must be executed on the Leader server. The alignment computes a checksum of each file and sends them to the replica nodes. Each replica node will compute the checksum on its own files. The files that are mismatching are requested by the replica to the leader. In the future single pages could be transferred instead of the entire file.

Align Database command is available only when the server is running with the HA module active.

**Syntax**

```
ALIGN DATABASE
```

The command returns which page have been aligned on each server.

**Examples**

- Align the current database.

```
ArcadeDB> ALIGN DATABASE
```

## 14.17.2. SQL - `ALTER DATABASE`

Change a database setting. You can find the available settings in Settings appendix. The update is persistent.

**Syntax**

```
ALTER DATABASE <setting-name> <setting-value>
```

- `<setting-name>` Check the available settings in Settings appendix. Since the setting name

contains `.` characters, surround the setting name with `` ` ``.

- `<setting-value>` The new value to set

Only **database** settings can be set this way. Since v26.10.1 a setting that belongs to the whole server or to the JVM is refused, naming its scope: use `SET SERVER SETTING` for a server setting, or a `-D` JVM property for a JVM one. Before v26.10.1 such a value was accepted and saved into the database configuration, where nothing would ever read it back.

The value reported back is the one that took effect, which is not always the one you sent: a setting with a valid range is corrected to fit. For example `arcadedb.maxPageRAM` is reduced when the page cache asked for is larger than the heap can accommodate.

**Examples**

- Set the date time format to support milliseconds (the default is 'yyyy-MM-dd HH:mm:ss').

```
ArcadeDB> ALTER DATABASE `arcadedb.dateTimeFormat` 'yyyy-MM-dd HH:mm:ss.SSS'
```

- Set the default page size for buckets to 262,144 bytes. This is useful when importing database with records bigger than the default page.

```
ArcadeDB> ALTER DATABASE `arcadedb.bucketDefaultPageSize` 262144
```

### 14.17.3. SQL - `BACKUP DATABASE`

Executes a backup of the current database. The resulting file is a compressed archive using ZIP as algorithm. The archive contains the database directory without the transaction logs. The backup is executed taking a snapshot of the database at the time the command is executed. Any pending transaction will not be in the backup archive. ArcadeDB allows to execute a non-stop backup of a database while it is used without blocking writes or affecting performance. A close requested while a backup is running waits for the backup to complete, and the database keeps serving in the meantime: the archive is always complete, and the close goes ahead right after.

Since 26.10.1, one database runs one whole-database maintenance operation at a time: backup, restore, import, export and `drop database`. A second one on the same database is refused immediately with an `operation in progress` error naming the one already running, rather than proceeding alongside it - simply retry once the first has finished. Two exceptions: several exports of one database may run together (they read only), and a `drop database` conflicts with everything, including another drop.

Previously a `drop database` issued during a backup, restore or import could delete the database directory while that operation was still using it.

### Syntax

```
BACKUP DATABASE [ <backup-file-url> ]
```

- **<backup-file-url>** Optional, defines the name of the backup archive. If not specified, the backup file will be backups/<db-name>/<db-name>-backup-<timestamp>.tgz, where the timestamp is expresses from the year to the millisecond. Example of backup file name backups/TheMatrix/TheMatrix-backup-20210921-172750767.zip.

<backup-file-url> must be a bare file name (e.g. mybackup.zip), never a path or a file:// URL that carries one. BACKUP DATABASE always writes into the server's backup directory so the archive's location cannot be steered elsewhere through SQL; a value with a directory component - /, \, or .. in it - is rejected with Backup file cannot contain path change because the directory is specified. Use the standalone Backup class or the embedded API directly (not through SQL) if a full path is genuinely needed.

Since 26.10.1 the backup directory is the one every other backup command uses - the running auto-backup plugin's configuration, then config/backup.json even when the schedule is off, then arcadedb.server.backupDirectory - so an archive written here is visible to list backups and reachable by delete backup and restore backup. See Where an On-Demand Backup Goes.

Previously the statement read arcadedb.server.backupDirectory on its own, so with a config/backup.json naming a different directory the archive landed out of reach of those commands and was never retention-pruned. One consequence of the change: BACKUP DATABASE now fails if that configured directory is invalid (absolute, or escaping the server root), which is the same refusal the other backup commands already gave.

Since 26.11.1 the statement applies the retention policy after a successful backup, as trigger backup and the auto-backup scheduler do. Retention works off the archives in backups/<db-name> rather than off the databases registered with the scheduler, so a database that is not named in config/backup.json is pruned by the defaults retention (maxFiles, or the tiered policy) instead of growing its directory without bound. The archive just written is always kept.

Only archives named <db-name>-backup-<timestamp>.zip are subject to retention. An archive you name yourself with BACKUP DATABASE 'before-the-upgrade.zip' is never deleted by it. With the auto-backup scheduler disabled nothing is pruned, which is the behavior of an on-demand backup without a scheduler.

### Examples

- Execute the backup of the current database with the default filename.

```
ArcadeDB> BACKUP DATABASE
```

### 14.17.4. SQL - CHECK DATABASE

Executes an integrity check and in case of a repair of the database. This command analyzes the following things:

- buckets: all the pages and records are scanned and checked if can be loaded (no physical corruption)
- vertices: all the vertices are loaded and all the connected edges are checked. In case some edges point to records that have been deleted they can be fixed automatically if the `FIX` option is enabled.
- edges: scan all the edges and check the incoming and outgoing links are consistent in the relative vertices. If not, the edges can be automatically removed if the `FIX` option is enabled.
- TimeSeries types: every shard's mutable bucket, sealed store and shared tag dictionary is validated, including the CRC32 of every sealed block. See TimeSeries integrity below.
- indexes: the structure of each index is validated. A corrupted index is dropped and rebuilt if the `FIX` option is enabled, keeping its name and its configuration - a full-text index's analyzers and BM25 parameters, a geospatial index's precision, a vector index's dimensions.
- existence constraints: *since v26.10.1*, every record of a type that declares a `MANDATORY` or `NOTNULL` property is checked against it. See Existence constraints below.
- cached record counters: *since v26.10.1*, the counter `count(*)` answers from is compared against the records the bucket scan actually found. See Cached record counters below.

the index check is **structural**: it validates the index's own pages, not that every record of the type appears in the index. An index that is intact but incomplete - for example one whose build was interrupted by a crash - is therefore reported as healthy. If you suspect that, run `REBUILD INDEX` on it: rebuilding re-reads every record and also preserves the index configuration.

When a vertex's edge list is unreadable (for example a lost or corrupted chunk of the adjacency linked list), the `FIX` mode does not delete anything: every edge record stores its own endpoint identities, so the adjacency list is rebuilt from the surviving edge records. After the rebuild, a full-scope `FIX` (no `TYPE`/`BUCKET` filter) also reclaims the orphaned edge-list segments the old, unreachable chains left on disk.

The other shape is a **dangling reference**: an adjacency entry that points at a record which no longer exists, typically left behind by a vertex deleted by an old release, before edge removal became strict. There is nothing to rebuild in that case - the record the entry names is gone - so `FIX` drops the entry instead.

*Since v26.9.1*, an application that reaches such a record before the repair has run is told so plainly, and always in the same way. Removing an entry from the edge list of a vertex whose own record is missing, adding one to it, and deleting that vertex outright all raise `VertexNotFoundException`, a `RecordNotFoundException` (answered as HTTP `404`) that names the vertex and points at `CHECK DATABASE`

`FIX`. Creating an edge whose **endpoint** is such a record raises it too, naming the endpoint - which is not the vertex the statement named. It is deliberately **not** a `NeedRetryException`: the record is gone rather than temporarily unreadable, so a retry can only fail identically, and a job walking possibly-stale references can skip that entry instead of spending its retry budget and rolling back the whole transaction. An unreadable **chunk** of a vertex that does exist keeps raising the retryable `ConcurrentModificationException` described above - the two are told apart by which record the failure names.

A `DELETE VERTEX` refused this way is refused before it touches anything: the vertex's record is checked first, so the failure does not cost a walk over an adjacency list that is about to be rolled back.

the same answer now covers the genuinely concurrent case. A vertex that **another** transaction deletes while this one is removing its edges used to be reported as a retryable `ConcurrentModificationException`; it is a `VertexNotFoundException` like every other "the vertex is not there", because the record is equally gone either way and a retry could only rediscover that on the next attempt. An application that wraps its vertex deletes in its own `catch (ConcurrentModificationException)` retry loop no longer catches that case: catch `RecordNotFoundException` alongside the conflict and treat it as already deleted, which is the conclusion the loop would have reached after spending its retries.

That up-front check reads the vertex's record, so deleting a vertex needs the `readRecord` permission on its type as well as `deleteRecord` (see groups). This is not a new requirement in practice, since every way of obtaining the vertex in order to delete it already reads it, but a group granting `deleteRecord` alone now fails at the first statement of the delete rather than part of the way through it.

the `RECORD` scope cannot repair a dangling reference. The RID in the message is the record that is missing, so there is no edge list to rebuild there, and the entry to drop lives on the vertex at the **other** end. No index maps a vertex back to the lists that reference it, so finding that vertex takes a scan - which is why the message names the database-wide form.

While the check runs, its progress (current step and percentage) is visible live in the console, in Studio, and through the HTTP progress endpoint. Run `FIX` in a maintenance window: like every repair, it assumes no concurrent writers.

**Syntax**

```
CHECK DATABASE [ TYPE <type-name>[,]* ] [ BUCKET <bucket-name>[,]* ] [ RECORD <rid>
[,]* ]
              [ FIX ] [ DELETE ORPHANS ] [ DELETE INVALID RECORDS ] [ RECLAIM
UNREFERENCED FILES ]
              [ DEEP ] [ COMPRESS ]
```

The optional clauses must appear in the order shown above.

- `<type-name>` Optional, if specified limit the check (and the fix) only to the specific types
- `<bucket-name>` Optional, if specified limit the check (and the fix) only to the specific buckets
- `<rid>` Optional, limits the check to the listed records instead of scanning whole types. Cannot be combined with `TYPE` or `BUCKET`. Useful when a single vertex's edge list is broken and a full scan is not worth its cost. The listed records must exist: repairing a reference that points at a **deleted** record is a database-wide `FIX`, not this scope
- `FIX` Optional, if used auto fix the issue found with the check
- `DELETE ORPHANS` Optional, requires `FIX`. Removes orphan edge records: edge records whose endpoints are valid vertices but which no vertex's edge list references. A clause of its own because the same shape is also produced by a vertex that merely lost its head-chunk pointer, whose edges are still recoverable. Without it the finding is still reported, under `unreachableEdgeRecords`
- `DELETE INVALID RECORDS` Optional, requires `FIX`, *since v26.10.1*. Removes the records that do not satisfy their own type's existence constraints. A clause of its own because `ALTER PROPERTY ... MANDATORY TRUE` on a type that already holds records makes every one of them a finding while they hold real data - see Existence constraints. Without it the finding is still reported, under `constraintViolatingRecords`
- `RECLAIM UNREFERENCED FILES` Optional, requires `FIX`. Deletes files this node holds that no schema component was ever built for. Without it the finding is still reported, under `unreferencedFiles`
- `DEEP` Optional, adds the checks that decode the stored data rather than reconciling what describes it. Today only the TimeSeries pass has a deeper tier - see TimeSeries integrity. Independent of `FIX`: nothing this tier finds is repairable
- `COMPRESS` Optional, if used compresses the database with the check, packing every page to reclaim the space a deleted or shrunk record left behind. Independent of `FIX`: while it runs, it also removes any record-table slot whose declared size cannot fit the page - a physical-corruption shape it walked past and left in place before `26.9.1` - so a database compressed with this release repairs that class of corruption even without `FIX`

The command returns the integrity check report in one record with the fields:

| Field | Description |
|---|---|
| `avgPageUsed` | average space used in a page. This is a percentage value, where 100% means all the pages are full. If a record is too big, a page is split into multiple pages and multiple reads are necessary. Sometimes it helps to create buckets with larger pages to accommodate large records, see the `bucketDefaultPageSize` setting. |
| `warnings` | set of warning messages. |
| `totalSurrogateRecords` | number of records that have been moved between pages. This happens when a record is updated and doesn't fit the original page, so a surrogate (placeholder) is set to point to the new page/position or it's a piece of a record stored on multiple pages. Internal, can be ignored. |
| `totalPlaceholderRecords` | see above. Internal, can be ignored. |

| Field | Description |
| --- | --- |
| `pageSize` | internal, can be ignored. |
| `totalDeletedRecords` | number of records deleted in the database (allocated minus active). When a record is deleted, it's RID is not recycled! |
| `totalAllocatedRecords` | total number of records created in the database. A record can be of type document, vertex or edge. |
| `totalAllocatedDocuments` | see above, but only documents records. |
| `totalAllocatedVertices` | see above, but only vertex records. |
| `totalAllocatedEdges` | see above, but only edge records. |
| `totalActiveRecords` | total number of records that are "active" (not deleted). A record can be of type document, vertex or edge. |
| `totalActiveDocuments` | see above, but only vertex document. |
| `totalActiveVertices` | see above, but only vertex records. |
| `totalActiveEdges` | see above, but only edge records. |
| `totalMaxOffset` | internal, can be ignored. |
| `deletedRecordsAfterFix` | holds the list of RIDs deleted after a fix. |
| `corruptedRecords` | records that are present but cannot be read or are inconsistent. This should be zero; if not, it means there is a bug in the graph operations that doesn't keep operations 100% transactional. Please report this. A record that simply no longer exists is **not** listed here: an edge whose vertex was deleted is reported under `topMissingReferences` instead, and only the edge itself is counted as corrupted. The distinction matters because `FIX` rebuilds every index on a bucket that holds a corrupted record, which is wasted work when the record is not there at all. |
| `totalPages` | total number of pages in the database. |
| `rebuiltIndexes` | list of indexes that have been rebuilt automatically if corrupted records were found. |
| `corruptedIndexes` | names of the indexes the check found damaged on their own, independently of record corruption. The findings are in `warnings`. A `FIX` rebuilds each of them, and they are listed in `rebuiltIndexes` as well. See Vector indexes for the `LSM_VECTOR` finding. |
| `topMissingReferences` | records an edge points at that could not be loaded, each with the number of edges that reference it - the usual shape after vertices were deleted while their edges survived. One line per target rather than per edge, so a single missing vertex referenced by millions of edges stays readable. |
| `distinctMissingReferences` | how many distinct targets `topMissingReferences` summarises. |
| `operation` | can be ignored, set by the console. |
| `invalidLinks` | similar to corrupted records; should be zero. |

| Field | Description |
|---|---|
| totalErrors | counter of errors encountered while checking the database. It should be zero. |
| autoFix | counter of autofix operations executed by the check database under the hood when corrupted records have been encountered. Some operations, like broken edges, can be fixed and restored automatically. |
| orphanedEdgeSegments | number of unreachable edge-list segments found in the dedicated edge-list buckets (garbage left behind by repaired adjacency lists). Only present on a full-scope FIX. |
| orphanedEdgeSegmentsReclaimed | number of orphaned edge-list segments actually deleted by the FIX. Only present on a full-scope FIX. |
| totalTimeSeriesTypes | number of TimeSeries types the check walked. Zero on a database with none, so a clean report can be told apart from a pass that never ran. |
| totalTimeSeriesShards | number of TimeSeries shards walked, across all types. |
| totalTimeSeriesSamples | number of samples those shards hold, mutable and sealed together. |
| totalTimeSeriesSealedBlocks | number of compressed columnar blocks in the sealed stores. |
| corruptedTimeSeries | names of the TimeSeries types with at least one finding. The findings themselves are in warnings. |
| repairedTimeSeries | number of TimeSeries repairs a FIX applied. Deliberately not folded into autoFix, which counts record actions only. |
| timeSeriesRepairs | one line per repair applied, naming the type, the shard and what was rewritten. |
| constraintViolatingRecords | *since v26.10.1*, records that load correctly but do not satisfy an existence constraint (MANDATORY, NOTNULL) of their own type. Deliberately not listed under corruptedRecords: such a record reads, deserialises and indexes correctly, and flagging it as corrupt would have FIX rebuild every index on its bucket for nothing. |
| totalConstraintViolations | how many such records the check found. Exact even when the list above is capped. |
| deletedConstraintViolatingRecords | which of them a FIX DELETE INVALID RECORDS actually removed. Empty on every other run, and capped like every other RID list - read the exact count from totalDeletedConstraintViolatingRecords, never from this list's size. |
| totalDeletedConstraintViolatingRecords | how many were removed. A record that another write completed while the check was running is **not** removed and not counted here: the repair re-checks each record immediately before deleting it. |

### Vector indexes

*Since v26.10.1* the check reads the pages of every LSM_VECTOR index and reports one that has two records on the same vector id. The index appears under corruptedIndexes, and warnings carries how

many records are affected and the first few RIDs, each with the record that took its id.

Such an index never keeps its persisted graph. A graph build counts both records, while every load of the same pages keeps only the one written last, so the graph holds more nodes than the load has live vectors and is rejected as stale on the next load. Each search that finds it rejected waits for a full rebuild of the graph, and the rebuild produces the same graph again. The record that lost its vector id is not returned by a vector search until its vector is indexed again. A graph build now logs those records by RID and keeps one record per id, which ends the loop but does not restore them.

While an index has records left out this way it does not compact, because a compaction would erase the shared ids from the pages. The index keeps growing until it is rebuilt. `getStats()` exposes `compactionBlockedBySharedIds` and `recordsLeftOutBySharedIds` so this can be monitored. The check reads every page of each vector index and holds that index's read lock while it does, so writes to the index wait for the scan.

`CHECK DATABASE` alone only reports. `FIX` rebuilds the index from the records, which gives every record that holds an embedding a vector id of its own. The rebuild reads every vector of the type, so on a large index it takes as long as a `REBUILD INDEX`: run it off-peak. In a cluster the statement runs on the leader, wherever it is issued, and the rebuilt index reaches the followers as replicated data like any other `FIX` of an index.

**Existence constraints**

*Since v26.10.1* the check also asks a schema question: does every record satisfy the `MANDATORY` and `NOTNULL` constraints its own type declares? It is the one question nothing else in the database could answer, and a record that fails it is not merely untidy - every later write to it fails, because the update path validates the whole document, so the record reads as broken to the application long before anyone thinks to look at the schema.

A record can end up in that state three ways, and only the first is a fault:

- an openCypher `CREATE`/`MERGE` pattern commits the record before the `SET` that completes it has run - which is what makes the standard `MERGE (n:L {id: $id}) SET n.prop = $v` upsert work the way it does in Neo4j - and the process dies, or the connection is killed, before the end of the statement;
- a `RESTORE DOCUMENT`/`VERTEX`/`EDGE` run by a release older than `26.9.1`, which did not apply the schema contract;
- a schema change that no existing record was measured against: `ALTER PROPERTY … MANDATORY TRUE` on a type that already holds records, which does not validate them, or renaming a `MANDATORY` property, which relabels the schema and leaves every record that predates it carrying the old name. Every one of them becomes a finding while holding data that is exactly as real as it was the day before the DDL ran.

Because the third is legitimate and the state it leaves is identical to the first, the **removal is a clause of its own**: a `FIX` that deleted by default would answer a DDL by destroying the type's contents. Reporting is always on.

There are two repairs, and which one is right depends on whether the records hold data:

- complete the record with a **single** `UPDATE` supplying every missing property. It has to be a single statement - the write path validates the whole document, so supplying two missing mandatory properties in two statements fails on the first;
- remove the records with `CHECK DATABASE FIX DELETE INVALID RECORDS`.

The two are safe to use together, including at the same time: the repair re-reads and re-checks every record inside the transaction that deletes it, so a record an `UPDATE` completed while the check was running is reported and left in place rather than deleted. A removal a `beforeDelete` trigger refuses is reported too, and not counted as removed. The removal is committed in batches sized by `arcadedb.checkDatabaseRepairBatchPages`, like every other `CHECK DATABASE … FIX` repair, so a bulk removal stays inside the replicated-entry limit under HA.

The pass costs nothing on a database whose types declare no such constraint: the types to scan are resolved from the schema before a record is read, so a database with none runs no pass at all and its report simply says zero.

#### Cached record counters

`SELECT count(*)` does not scan: every bucket keeps a record counter that each commit folds its delta into, and the counter is what the query answers from. That counter is persisted in the database's `statistics.json` and restored when the database is opened, so a counter that goes wrong stays wrong across restarts and nothing recomputes it until something invalidates it.

*Since v26.10.1* the bucket pass compares the two. It already reads every slot of every bucket, so the authoritative number is in hand, and a disagreement is reported as an error naming the bucket, both numbers and the direction:

```
cached record count of bucket 'Order_0' is 10869 but the bucket holds 10906 records:
count(*) on this bucket under-reports by 37; run CHECK DATABASE FIX to recompute the
counter
```

`FIX` recomputes it - the counter is invalidated, and the next `count()` rescans and republishes it. A read-only run only reports, and the report carries `staleRecordCounters` and, under `FIX`, `staleRecordCountersFixed`. Both count *buckets*, not records: one per bucket whose counter disagreed, whatever the size of the disagreement. They sit next to record tallies such as `totalActiveRecords` in the same JSON, so the distinction is worth reading twice.

This is the symptom to look for when `count()` disagrees with a forced full scan such as `SELECT count() FROM <type> WHERE @rid IS NOT NULL`, in **either** direction. On a replicated database the drift is per node and per bucket, so the replicas disagree with each other while holding identical data, which looks exactly like HA state divergence until a full scan rules it out.

a bucket whose counter has never been computed is not reported - there is nothing to be wrong yet - and neither is one the current transaction has pending changes on, nor one this same run has just repaired, since in those cases the two sides of the comparison describe different moments. The same applies to a read-only check that another transaction committed into while it was scanning, so running `CHECK DATABASE` on a live node under write load does not raise a false alarm.

**Counters written by a release older than 26.10.1**

Releases up to and including `26.9.1` could fold a replicated transaction's record-count delta twice when a Raft entry was replayed on a node that had been restarted **cleanly**, which includes every rolling upgrade and every Kubernetes pod rotation. Nothing in `statistics.json` says which counters that happened to, so `26.10.1` does not trust any of them: the file now carries a format version, counts written without one are discarded when the database is opened, and each affected bucket recomputes on its next `count()`. That is one extra bucket scan, once, and the marker is written back on the next clean close. A `WARNING` in the server log says how many buckets it applied to, so the first `count()` that changes after an upgrade is not a mystery.

**TimeSeries integrity**

A TimeSeries type has neither record buckets nor indexes, so it is walked by a pass of its own that reads the three on-disk formats it owns: the mutable bucket (`.tstb`), the shared tag dictionary (`.tstd`) and the sealed store (`.ts.sealed`). The default tier reconciles every header and directory against the data it describes and verifies the CRC32 of every sealed block - which means it reads the whole sealed file, the same cost class as the record scan the check already runs over every bucket. A block is otherwise CRC-checked only on the first read that touches it, so a block nothing queries is a block nothing verifies.

`DEEP` adds the checks that have to decompress. A CRC proves the bytes are the bytes that were written; it proves nothing about whether they mean what the block claims. Three things every read path answers queries from, without ever looking at a value, are verified only under `DEEP`:

- the block's timestamps are sorted — the range iterator binary-searches them, so an unsorted block silently returns a subset of the rows that match
- the block's declared per-column min/max/sum are what its values actually add up to — aggregation push-down answers `MIN`/`MAX`/`SUM`/`AVG` straight from them without decompressing
- the block's declared distinct tag values cover the values it holds — block pruning skips a whole block whose declaration does not list the value being filtered on

Each of those, when wrong, produces a wrong answer rather than an error, so nothing else in the engine reports it.

`FIX` repairs only what is **derived** and never a sample: the mutable bucket's page-0 counters, the sealed header's block count and global timestamp bounds, and the tail of an interrupted sealed append. Those matter beyond tidiness - a wrong global bound is read straight out of the header when the file is opened, so a range query pruned against it silently misses data the file holds, and a tail no reader can see also hides every block appended after it.

A sealed block that fails its CRC, or that `DEEP` finds inconsistent, is reported and left untouched. It is the only copy of the samples in it, so discarding it is a decision for an operator, who under HA can also rebuild a sealed store by recompacting from the replicated mutable pages.

**Examples**

- Execute the integrity check of the entire database without fixing any issue found.

```
ArcadeDB> CHECK DATABASE
```

- Execute the integrity check of the types 'Account' and 'Bill' without fixing any issue found.

```
ArcadeDB> CHECK DATABASE TYPE Account, Bill
```

- Execute the integrity check only on the bucket 'Account_Europe' without fixing any issue found.

```
ArcadeDB> CHECK DATABASE BUCKET Account_Europe
```

- Execute the integrity check of the entire database and auto fix any issues found.

```
ArcadeDB> CHECK DATABASE FIX
```

- Execute the deeper integrity check, which decodes the stored TimeSeries data instead of only reconciling what describes it.

```
ArcadeDB> CHECK DATABASE DEEP
```

- Execute the deeper check on one TimeSeries type, repairing the derived counters it finds wrong.

```
ArcadeDB> CHECK DATABASE TYPE SensorReading FIX DEEP
```

### 14.17.5. SQL - EXPORT DATABASE

Exports a database in the `exports` directory under the root directory where ArcadeDB is running.

**Syntax**

```
EXPORT DATABASE [<url>] [WITH ( <setting-name> = <setting-value> [,] )* ]
```

- `<url>` Optional, defines the location of the file to export. Use:
  - `file://` as prefix for files located on the same file system where ArcadeDB is running. For security reasons, it is not possible to provide an absolute or relative path to the file
  - By default the file name is set to `exports/<db-name>-export-<timestamp>.<format>.tgz`.
- `WITH` Optional settings as comma-separated key/value pairs:
  - `format` The format of the export. Default is `jsonl`.
    - `jsonl` exports in JSONL format - a newline-delimited JSON variant
    - `graphml` exports in the popular GraphML format. GraphML is supported by all the major

Graph DBMS. This format does not support complex types, like collection of elements. Using `graphson` instead of `graphml` is recommended

- **`graphson`** exports in the GraphSON format supported by all the major Graph DBMS

`graphml` and `graphson` are provided by the optional `arcadedb-gremlin` module. Without it on the classpath the export is refused, naming the format and the module. *(Since v26.10.1: a failed `graphml` lookup could fall through to the GraphSON exporter and write a GraphSON archive into the file you named `.graphml`.)*

◦ **`overwrite`** Set to `true` to overwrite the export file if it already exists. Default is `false`.

Since 26.10.1 an export claims its target file for its duration, so two exports that resolve to the same file no longer write into it at the same time - the second one fails immediately with `Another export to '<file>' is already in progress` instead of producing a corrupt archive. This applies with `overwrite = true` as well, which previously skipped the check altogether.

The claim is held in a sidecar file next to the target, so an export file name ending in `.exporting` is rejected as a reserved name. A running export now also publishes its progress, so it is visible on the progress endpoint, in the console and in Studio.

Since 26.9.1 the `jsonl` export includes TIMESERIES types: their definition (columns, shards, precision, retention, compaction interval and downsampling tiers) and their samples, so a JSONL export is a complete backup of a TIMESERIES type. Earlier versions wrote a file that could not be imported at all when the database contained one.

The same release also restores type-level `CUSTOM` metadata, type aliases and the bucket-selection strategy on import, and stops writing each vertex's edge identifiers into the export - no importer ever read them, and on a densely connected graph they were the bulk of the file. Edges are unaffected and are rebuilt as before.

Since 26.10.1 importing a `jsonl` export also restores the parts of the schema that live outside the types: triggers, materialized views, continuous aggregates, `DEFINE FUNCTION` libraries and module extensions. The export has always contained them; earlier versions simply skipped them on import and still reported success.

They are restored after the records, so a restored trigger does not fire again for data the source database had already processed. If one of them cannot be recreated - a trigger whose type no longer exists, for example - it is counted as a warning and the rest of the restore still completes.

Installing a `JAVASCRIPT` or `JAVA` trigger, or a `js` function library, from an imported file requires the same `updateSecurity` permission that creating one by hand does, since either is code that runs inside the server.

### Examples

- Export the current database under the `exports/` directory with the default format and filename:

```
EXPORT DATABASE
```

- Export the current database to a specific file:

```
EXPORT DATABASE file://database.jsonl.tgz
```

- Export the current database in GraphSON format, overwriting any existing file:

```
EXPORT DATABASE file://Movies.graphson.tgz WITH format = 'graphson', overwrite = true
```

- Export overwriting a previously exported file without specifying a URL:

```
EXPORT DATABASE WITH overwrite = true
```

A `jsonl` export of a TimeSeries type records each column's compression codec, because it cannot be worked out again from the column's data type alone. *(Since v26.10.1)* importing such an export into a remote database preserves that codec exactly, even if the default codec for that data type changed between the two versions. Earlier versions could silently give the restored column the newer default instead.

### 14.17.6. SQL - IMPORT DATABASE

Executes an import of the database into the current one. Usually an import database is executed on an empty database, but it is possible to execute on any database. In case of conflict (unique index key already existent, etc.), the conflicting records will not be imported. The importer automatically recognize the file between the following formats:

- **OrientDB** database export
- **Neo4J** database export
- **GraphML** database export. This format does not support complex types, like collection of elements. Using GraphSON instead of GraphML is recommended
- **GraphSON** database export
- **JSON** documents or responses
- **JSON Lines** documents or responses

**Syntax**

```
IMPORT DATABASE <url> [WITH ( <setting-name> = <setting-value> [,] )* ]
```

- `<url>` Defines the location of the file to import. Use:
  - `file://` as prefix for files located on the same file system where ArcadeDB is running.
  - `https://` and `http://` as prefix for remote files.

**Examples**

- Import the public OpenBeer database available as demo database for OrientDB and exported in TGZ file

```
IMPORT DATABASE https://github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb-
datasets/raw/main/orientdb/OpenBeer.gz
```

- Import the Movie database used in Neo4j's examples:

```
IMPORT DATABASE https://github.com/ArcadeData/arcadedb-
datasets/raw/main/neo4j/movies.graphson.tgz
```

- Import a JSON response into document type `mytype`

```
IMPORT DATABASE http://echo.jsontest.com/key/value/one/two WITH documentType =
'mytype'
```

- Test data source

```
IMPORT DATABASE http://echo.jsontest.com/key/value/one/two WITH probeOnly = true
```

- Import a graph from CSV, with vertices in a `vertices.csv` which contains a column `Id`, and edges in a `edges.csv` which contains columns `From` and `To`, both placed in the ArcadeDB base folder:

```
IMPORT DATABASE file://empty.csv WITH vertices="file://vertices.csv",
verticesFileType=csv, typeIdProperty=Id, typeIdType=Long, edges="file://edges.csv",
edgesFileType=csv, edgeFromField="From", edgeToField="To"
```

**Result**

The statement returns a single row with a `result` column: `OK` when the import completed, or `FAIL` when the source or one of the settings could not be used, in which case a `reason` column explains why. Any other failure raises an error.

*(Since v26.10.1: the `FAIL` answer was overwritten with `OK` before it reached the client, so an import of an unusable source reported success with no rows and no statistics. Scripts that check `result` now detect these failures.)*

See also Importer for a description of the settings.

# 14.18. Inspection

## 14.18.1. SQL - `EXPLAIN`

EXPLAIN SQL command returns information about query execution planning of a specific statement, without executing the statement itself.

**Syntax**

```
EXPLAIN <command>
```

- `<command>` Defines the command that you want to profile, eg. a SELECT statement

**Examples**

- Profile a query that executes on a type filtering based on an attribute:

```
ArcadeDB {db=foo}> explain select from v where name = 'a'

Profiled command '[{

executionPlan:{...},

executionPlanAsString:

+ FETCH FROM TYPE v
  + FETCH FROM BUCKET 9 ASC
  + FETCH FROM BUCKET 10 ASC
  + FETCH FROM BUCKET 11 ASC
  + FETCH FROM BUCKET 12 ASC
  + FETCH FROM BUCKET 13 ASC
  + FETCH FROM BUCKET 14 ASC
  + FETCH FROM BUCKET 15 ASC
  + FETCH FROM BUCKET 16 ASC
  + FETCH NEW RECORDS FROM CURRENT TRANSACTION SCOPE (if any)
+ FILTER ITEMS WHERE
  name = 'a'

}]' in 0,022000 sec(s):
```

For more information, see:

- SQL Commands
- PROFILE

### 14.18.2. SQL - PROFILE

The PROFILE SQL command returns information about query execution planning and statistics for a specific statement. The statement is actually executed to provide the execution stats.

The result is the execution plan of the query (like for EXPLAIN ) with additional information about execution time spent on each step, in microseconds.

**Syntax**

```
PROFILE <command>
```

- <command> Defines the command that you want to profile, eg. a SELECT statement

**Examples**

```
PROFILE SELECT sum(Amount), OrderDate
FROM Orders
WHERE OrderDate > date("2012-12-09", "yyyy-MM-dd")
GROUP BY OrderDate
```

result:

```
+ FETCH FROM INDEX Orders.OrderDate (1.445µs)
  OrderDate > date("2012-12-09", "yyyy-MM-dd")
+ EXTRACT VALUE FROM INDEX ENTRY
+ FILTER ITEMS BY TYPE
  Orders
+ CALCULATE PROJECTIONS (5.065µs)
  Amount AS _$$$OALIAS$$_1, OrderDate
+ CALCULATE AGGREGATE PROJECTIONS (3.182µs)
  sum(_$$$OALIAS$$_1) AS _$$$OALIAS$$_0, OrderDate
  GROUP BY OrderDate
+ CALCULATE PROJECTIONS (1.116µs)
  _$$$OALIAS$$_0 AS `sum(Amount)`, OrderDate
```

You can see the (1.445µs) at the end of the first line, it means that fetching from index Orders.OrderDate took 1.445 microseconds (1.4 milliseconds)

For more information, see:

- EXPLAIN

### 14.18.3. SQL - CONSOLE

Writes a string message of given log-level to the log. Log-levels are:

- output (none)

- `log` (`INFO`)
- `error` (`SEVERE`)
- `warn` (`WARNING`)
- `debug` (`FINE`)

This command is useful for SQL scripts.

To flush to the log, suffix the message with a newline `\n`.

**Syntax**

```
CONSOLE.logLevel <expression>
```

The command returns which page have been aligned on each server.

**Examples**

- Write a message of level `INFO` to the log.

```
CONSOLE.log map('Hello','World')
```

# 14.19. Projections

A projection is a value that is returned by a query statement (SELECT, MATCH).

Eg. the following query

```
SELECT name AS firstName, age * 12 AS ageInMonths, out("Friend")
FROM Person
WHERE surname = 'Smith'
```

has three projections:

- `name as firstName`
- `age * 12 as ageInMonths`
- `out("Friend")`

## Syntax

A **projection** has the following syntax:

`<expression> [<nestedProjection>] [ AS <alias> ]`

- `<expression>` is an expression (see SQL Syntax) that represents the way to calculate the value of

the single projection

- `<alias>` is the Identifier (see SQL Syntax) representing the field name used to return the value in the result set

A projection block has the following syntax:

```
[DISTINCT] <projection> [, <projection> ]*
```

- `DISTINCT`: removes duplicates from the result-set

### 14.19.1. Query result

By default, a query returns a different result-set based on the projections it has:

- **no projections**: The result set is made of records as they arrive from the target, with the original `@rid` and `@type` attributes (if any)
- `*` **alone**: same behavior as without `*`.
- `*` **plus other projections**: records of the original target, merged with the other projection values, with `@rid` and `@type` of the original record.
- `expand(<projection>)`: The result set is made of the records returned by the projection, expanded (if the projection result is a link or a collection of links) and unwinded (if the projection result is a collection or an array, one record per element). Any other value - a number, a string, a map - gives one record holding that value. A `BINARY` property is one such value: it is an opaque blob, so it is never split into one record per byte.
- **one or more projections**: temporary records (with temporary `@rid` and no `@type`). Projections that represent links are returned as simple @rid values, unless differently specified in the fetch plan.

Projection values can be overwritten in the final result, the overwrite happens from left to right.

eg.

```
SELECT 1 AS a, 2 AS a
```

will return `[{"a":2}]`

eg.

Having the record `{"@type":"Foo", "name":"bar", "@rid":"#12:0"}`

```
SELECT *, "hey" AS name FROM Foo
```

will return `[{"@type":"Foo", "@rid":"#12:0", "name":"hey"}]`

`*` is accepted only as the first projection item: `SELECT "hey" AS name, * FROM Foo` is

a syntax error.

When saving back a record with a valid rid, you will overwrite the existing record! So pay attention when using * together with other projections.

The result of the query can be further unwound using the UNWIND operator.

expand() cannot be used together with GROUP BY.

**Aliases**

The alias is the field name that a projection will have in the result-set.

An alias can be implicit, if declared with the AS keyword, eg.

```
SELECT name + " " + surname AS full_name FROM Person
```

Result: [{"full_name":"John Smith"}]

An alias can be implicit, when no AS is defined, eg.

```
SELECT name FROM Person
```

Result: [{"name":"John"}]

An implicit alias is calculated based on how the projection is written. By default, ArcadeDB uses the plain string representation of the projection as alias.

```
SELECT 1+2 AS sum
```

Result: [{"sum": 3}]

```
SELECT parent.name+" "+parent.surname AS full_name FROM Node
```

Result: [{"full_name": "John Smith"}]

The string representation of a projection is the exact representation of the projection string, without spaces before and after dots and brackets, no spaces before commands, a single space before and after operators.

eg.

```
SELECT 1+2
```

Result: `[{"1 + 2": 3}]`

Note the space before and after the plus symbol.

```
SELECT parent.name+" "+parent.surname FROM Node
```

Result: `[{"parent.name + \" \" + parent.nurname": "John Smith"}]`

```
SELECT items[4] from Node
```

Result: `[{"items[4]": "John Smith"}]`

### 14.19.2. Nested projections

**Syntax**:

`":{" ( * | (["!"] <identifier> ["*"] (<comma> ["!"] <identifier> ["*"])* ) ) "}"`

A projection can refer to a link or to a collection of links, eg. a LIST or MAP. In some cases you can be interested in the expanded object instead of the RID.

Here is an example to remove the `@rid` and `@type` properties from the record (a nested projection cannot follow `*`, so apply it to `@this`):

```
SELECT @this:{!@rid,!@type} FROM doc
```

Let's clarify this with another example. This is our dataset:

| @rid | name | surname | parent |
|---|---|---|---|
| #12:0 | foo | fooz | |
| #12:1 | bar | barz | #12:0 |
| #12:2 | baz | bazz | #12:1 |

Given this query:

```
SELECT name, parent FROM TheType WHERE name = 'baz'
```

The result is

```
{
   "name": "baz",
   "parent": #12:1
}
```

Now suppose you want to expand the link and retrieve some properties of the linked object. You can do it explicitly do it with other projections:

```
SELECT name, parent.name FROM TheType WHERE name = 'baz'
```

```
{
   "name": "baz",
   "parent.name": "bar"
}
```

but this will force you to list them one by one, and it's not always possible, especially when you don't know all their names.

Another alternative is to use nested projections, eg.

```
SELECT name, parent:{name} FROM TheType WHERE name = 'baz'
```

```
{
   "name": "baz",
   "parent": {
      "name": "bar"
   }
}
```

or with multiple attributes

```
SELECT name, parent:{name, surname} FROM TheType WHERE name = 'baz'
```

```
{
   "name": "baz",
   "parent": {
      "name": "bar"
      "surname": "barz"
   }
}
```

or using a wildcard

```
SELECT name, parent:{*} FROM TheType WHERE name = 'baz'
```

```
{
   "name": "baz",
```

```
   "parent": {
      "name": "bar"
      "surname": "barz"
      "parent": #12:0
   }
}
```

You can also use the `!` exclude syntax to define which attributes you want to *exclude* from the nested projection:

```
SELECT name, parent:{!surname} FROM TheType WHERE name = 'baz'
```

```
{
   "name": "baz",
   "parent": {
      "name": "bar"
      "parent": #12:0
   }
}
```

You can also use a wildcard on the right of property names, to specify the inclusion of attributes that start with a prefix, eg.

```
SELECT name, parent:{surna*} FROM TheType WHERE name = 'baz'
```

```
{
   "name": "baz",
   "parent": {
      "surname": "barz"
   }
}
```

or their exclusion

```
SELECT name, parent:{!surna*} FROM TheType WHERE name = 'baz'
```

```
{
   "name": "baz",
   "parent": {
      "name": "bar",
      "parent": #12:0
   }
}
```

Nested projection syntax allows for multiple level depth expressions, eg. you can go three levels deep as follows:

```
SELECT name, parent:{name, surname, parent:{name, surname}} FROM TheType WHERE name =
'baz'
```

```
{
   "name": "baz",
   "parent": {
      "name": "bar"
      "surname": "barz"
      "parent": {
         "name": "foo"
         "surname": "fooz"
      }
   }
}
```

You can also use expressions and aliases in nested projections:

```
SELECT name, parent.parent:{name, surname} as grandparent FROM TheType WHERE name =
'baz'
```

```
{
   "name": "baz",
   "grandparent": {
      "name": "foo"
      "surname": "fooz"
   }
}
```

Finally, you can rename fields with `AS`:

```
SELECT name, parent.parent:{name AS givenname} as grandparent FROM TheType WHERE name
= 'baz'
```

```
{
   "name": "baz",
   "grandparent": {
      "givenname": "fooz"
   }
}
```

### CASE Expression

The `CASE` expression provides conditional logic similar to if-then-else statements in programming languages. It supports two forms: **searched CASE** and **simple CASE**.

### Searched CASE Syntax

Evaluates conditions sequentially and returns the result of the first matching condition:

```
CASE
  WHEN <condition1> THEN <result1>
  WHEN <condition2> THEN <result2>
  [ELSE <default_result>]
END
```

### Simple CASE Syntax

Compares an expression against multiple values:

```
CASE <expression>
  WHEN <value1> THEN <result1>
  WHEN <value2> THEN <result2>
  [ELSE <default_result>]
END
```

### Behavior

- The `CASE` expression evaluates conditions in order and returns the result of the first matching `WHEN` clause
- If no conditions match and an `ELSE` clause is provided, the `ELSE` result is returned
- If no conditions match and there is no `ELSE` clause, `null` is returned
- Multiple `WHEN` clauses can be specified
- Can be used in `SELECT` projections, `WHERE` clauses, `MATCH` statements, `LET` clauses, and expressions
- Supports nested `CASE` expressions for complex conditional logic
- `NULL` values in conditions follow SQL three-valued logic (NULL comparisons return NULL, which is treated as false)

### Examples

Searched CASE with conditions in SELECT:

```
SELECT
  name,
  CASE
    WHEN age < 18 THEN 'Minor'
    WHEN age >= 18 AND age < 65 THEN 'Adult'
```

```
    ELSE 'Senior'
  END as ageGroup
FROM Person
```

Simple CASE with value matching:

```
SELECT
  name,
  CASE status
    WHEN 'active' THEN 1
    WHEN 'inactive' THEN 0
    ELSE -1
  END as statusCode
FROM Account
```

CASE without ELSE (returns null if no match):

```
SELECT
  name,
  CASE
    WHEN score > 90 THEN 'Excellent'
    WHEN score > 75 THEN 'Good'
  END as grade
FROM Student
```

CASE in WHERE clause for filtering:

```
SELECT name, age
FROM Person
WHERE CASE
  WHEN age IS NULL THEN false
  WHEN age < 18 THEN 'minor'
  ELSE 'adult'
END = 'adult'
```

CASE in MATCH WHERE clause (enum-to-string conversion with pattern matching):

```
MATCH {type: Product, as: prod,
  where: ((CASE
    WHEN color = 1 THEN 'red'
    WHEN color = 2 THEN 'blue'
    WHEN color = 3 THEN 'green'
  END) ILIKE '%ed%')}
RETURN prod.name
```

This is particularly useful for converting enum values (stored as integers) to human-readable

strings that can be filtered with wildcards.

CASE in MATCH RETURN clause:

```
MATCH {type: Person, as: p, where: (age IS NOT NULL)}
RETURN p.name,
  CASE
    WHEN p.age < 18 THEN 'minor'
    WHEN p.age < 65 THEN 'adult'
    ELSE 'senior'
  END as category
ORDER BY p.name
```

Nested CASE expressions:

```
SELECT
  name,
  CASE
    WHEN balance > 0 THEN
      CASE
        WHEN balance > 10000 THEN 'Premium'
        ELSE 'Standard'
      END
    ELSE 'Overdrawn'
  END as accountStatus
FROM Account
```

CASE in LET clause:

```
SELECT $category
FROM Product
LET $category = CASE
  WHEN price < 10 THEN 'Budget'
  WHEN price < 100 THEN 'Standard'
  ELSE 'Premium'
END
```

CASE with NULL handling:

```
SELECT
  name,
  CASE
    WHEN age IS NULL THEN 'Unknown'
    WHEN age < 18 THEN 'Minor'
    ELSE 'Adult'
  END as status
```

```
FROM Person
```

# 14.20. Pagination

ArcadeDB supports pagination natively. Pagination doesn't consume server side resources because no cursors are used. Only Record ID's are used as pointers to the physical position in the bucket.

There are 2 ways to achieve pagination:

### Use the SKIP-LIMIT

The first and simpler way to do pagination is to use the `SKIP`/`LIMIT` approach. This is the slower way because ArcadeDB repeats the query and just skips the first X records from the result. Syntax:

```
SELECT FROM <target> [WHERE ...] SKIP <records-to-skip> LIMIT <max-records>
```

Where: - **records-to-skip** is the number of records to skip before starting to collect them as the result set - **max-records** is the maximum number of records returned by the query

### Use the RID-LIMIT

This method is faster than the `SKIP-LIMIT` because ArcadeDB will begin the scan from the starting RID. ArcadeDB can seek the first record in about O(1) time. The downside is that it's more complex to use.

The trick here is to execute the query multiple times setting the `LIMIT` as the page size and using the greater than `>` operator against `@rid`. The **lower-rid** is the starting point to search, for example `#10:300`.

Syntax:

```
SELECT FROM <target> WHERE @rid > <lower-rid> ... [LIMIT <max-records>]
```

Where: - **lower-rid** is the exclusive lower bound of the range as RID - **max-records** is the maximum number of records returned by the query

In this way, ArcadeDB will start to scan the bucket from the given position **lower-rid** + 1. After the first call, the **lower-rid** will be the rid of the last record returned by the previous call. To scan the cluster from the beginning, use `#-1:-1` as **lower-rid** .

# 14.21. Filtering

The `WHERE` condition is shared among many SQL commands. A condition results in a boolean; and a compound condition, consisting of multiple conditions that are combined with logical operators, is resolved from left to right.

### Syntax

```
[<item>] <operator> <item>
```

### Items

And `item` can be:

| What | Description | Example |
|---|---|---|
| field | Document field | `WHERE price > 1000000` |
| field<indexes> | Document field part. To know more about field part look at the full syntax: Document-API-Property | `WHERE tags[name='Hi'] OR tags[0...3] IN ('Hello') AND employees IS NOT NULL` |
| record attribute | Record attribute name with `@` as prefix | `WHERE @type = 'Profile'` |
| Functions | Any Function between the defined ones | `WHERE distance(x, y, 52.20, 0.14) <= 30` |
| `$variable` | Context variable prefixed with `$` | `WHERE $depth <= 3` |

#### Record attributes

| Name | Description | Example |
|---|---|---|
| `@this` | returns the record itself | `SELECT @this.toJSON() FROM Account` |
| `@rid` | returns the RID in the form `bucket:position`. It is null for embedded records. *NOTE:* using `@rid` in a "Where" condition slows down queries. Much better to use the RID as target. Example: change `SELECT FROM Profile WHERE @rid = #10:44` to `SELECT FROM #10:44` | `@rid = #11:0` |
| `@size` | returns the record size in bytes | `@size > 1024` |
| `@type` | returns the record type between: 'document', 'column', 'flat', 'bytes' | `@type = 'flat'` |

## 14.21.1. Operators

#### Conditional Operators

| Apply to | Operator | Description | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| any | `=` or `==` | Equals. A list on the right side is compared as a whole, so `name = ['a','b']` matches nothing, with or without an index; use `IN` to match any of several values *(since v26.11.1; before, an index expanded the list like `IN`)* | `name = 'Luke'` |
| any | `<=>` | Null-safe-equals, is also true if left and right operands are `NULL` | `name <=> word` |
| string | `LIKE` | Similar to equals, but allows the wildcards '%' that means "any characters" and '?' that means "any single character". `LIKE` is case sensitive. A pattern with a literal start (`'Luk%'`) uses an ordered index on the property, except a case insensitive one; a pattern starting with a wildcard does not. | `name LIKE 'Luk%'` |
| string | `ILIKE` | Similar to `LIKE`, but `ILIKE` is case insensitive. | `name ILIKE 'lUk%'` |
| string | `NOT LIKE` | Negation of `LIKE`, equivalent to `NOT (x LIKE y)` | `name NOT LIKE 'Leia'` |
| string | `NOT ILIKE` | Negation of `ILIKE`, equivalent to `NOT (x ILIKE y)` | `name NOT ILIKE 'lEIA'` |
| any | `<` | Less than | `age < 40` |
| any | `<=` | Less or equal to | `age <= 40` |
| any | `>` | Greater than | `age > 40` |
| any | `>=` | Greater or equal to | `age >= 40` |
| any | `<>` or `!=` | Not equal to | `age <> 40` |

| Apply to | Operator | Description | Example |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| any | `BETWEEN` | The value is between a range. It's equivalent to `<field> >= <from-value> AND <field> <= <to-value>` | `price BETWEEN 10 AND 30` |
| any | `IS` | Used to test if a value is `NULL` | `children IS NULL` |
| any | `IS NOT` | Used to test if a value is not `NULL` | `children IS NOT NULL` |
| record, string (as type name) | `INSTANCEOF` | Used to check if the record extends a type | `@this INSTANCEOF 'Customer' OR @type INSTANCEOF 'Provider'` |

| Apply to | Operator | Description | Example |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| collection | `IN` | contains any of the elements listed. Uses the index on the property, including the leading columns of a composite index (`transactionId IN (...)` on an index over `(transactionId, date)`), with every list form: `IN (a, b)`, `IN [a, b]` and a bound parameter. The listed values are looked up in index order, so an `ORDER BY` on the indexed columns needs no extra sort step. The searched value is converted to the type of the listed items when needed, so `? IN doubleList` with the String `'7'` finds `7.0` with or without an index, like `CONTAINS`. A property on the left side is never converted: `stringProp IN [7.0]` does not match `'7'`, exactly like `stringProp = 7.0` and the index. Without an index, `IN (?)` with a single parameter and `IN (SELECT ...)` compare numbers and dates by value too, so a Long `7` matches an Integer `7`, and `1.50` matches `1.5` *(since v26.10.1)* | `name IN ['European','Asiatic']` |

| Apply to | Operator | Description | Example |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| collection | `NOT IN` | contains all of the elements not listed. Does not use index: an index can look up the listed values, not their complement, so the type is scanned. If the type is large, add a second indexed condition to the query to drive the lookup | `name NOT IN ['European','Asiatic']` |
| collection | `CONTAINS` | true if the collection contains at least one element that satisfy the next condition. Use `@this` as right item for lists. Condition can be a single item: in this case the behaviour is like the `IN` operator | `children CONTAINS (name = 'Luke')`; `map.values() CONTAINS (name = 'Luke')`; `['a','b'] CONTAINS (@this ILIKE 'A')` |
| collection | `CONTAINSALL` | true if every element of the right collection is contained in the left collection. A single value on the left is treated as a one-element collection *(since v26.10.1; before, it was always false)*. `CONTAINSALL (<condition>)` is true when every element satisfies any condition, e.g. `items CONTAINSALL (name IS NOT NULL)` *(any condition since v26.10.1; before, only OR conditions)* | `children.name CONTAINSALL ['Luke','Leia']` |

| Apply to | Operator | Description | Example |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| collection | `CONTAINSANY` | true if at least one element of the right collection is contained in the left collection. A single value on the left is treated as a one-element collection, so `uuid CONTAINSANY ['u1','u2']` answers like `uuid IN ['u1','u2']` *(since v26.10.1; before, it was always false).* `CONTAINSANY (<condition>)` is true when at least one element satisfies the condition, so it is false on an empty collection *(since v26.10.1; before, it behaved like CONTAINSALL)* | `children.name CONTAINSANY ['Jacen','Jaina','Ben']` |
| map | `CONTAINSKEY` | true if the map contains at least one key equals to the requested. You can also use `map.keys() CONTAINS` in place of it | `connections CONTAINSKEY 'Luke'` |
| map | `CONTAINSVALUE` | true if the map contains at least one value equals to the requested. You can also use `map.values() CONTAINS` in place of it | `connections CONTAINSVALUE 10:3` |
| string | `CONTAINSTEXT` | When used against an indexed field, a lookup in the index will be performed with the text specified as key. When there is no index a simple Java `indexOf` will be performed. So the result set could be different if you have an index or not on that field | `text CONTAINSTEXT 'jay'` |

| Apply to | Operator | Description | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| string | `MATCHES` | Matches the string using a Regular Expression. Use the modifier `(?s)` to make `.` match also newlines, and `(?i)` for case insensitive patterns. | ``text MATCHES `\b[A-Z0-9.%+-@[A-Z0-9.-]\.[A-Z]{2,4}\b]` `` |

`LIKE`, `ILIKE`, `MATCHES` are not using full-text indexes.

A full-text index matches words, not whole values, so it only answers `CONTAINSTEXT` and the full-text search functions. Exact operators (`=`, `IN`, `CONTAINS`, `CONTAINSANY`, `CONTAINSALL`) never use it and always return exact matches, also on a list indexed `BY ITEM`. To have an exact lookup indexed, create a regular (`UNIQUE`/`NOTUNIQUE`) index. *(Since v26.10.1: before, `name = 'x'` on a full-text indexed property also returned every record sharing a word with `'x'`.)*

`CONTAINS` asks whether the collection on the left holds a **single** value: either one matching the condition, or, when the right side is a plain value, one equal to it. Put a collection on the right and it is searched for as one element, so `tags CONTAINS ['red','blue']` matches a row whose `tags` holds the nested list `['red','blue']`, and not a row whose `tags` is `['red','green','blue']`. To compare two collections, use `CONTAINSALL` (every element of the right is present on the left) or `CONTAINSANY` (at least one is). This applies equally when the right side is produced by an expression such as `'red blue'.split(' ')`.

### Logical Operators

| Operator | Description | Example |
|---|---|---|
| AND | true if both the conditions are true | `name = 'Luke' AND surname LIKE 'Sky%'` |
| OR | true if at least one of the condition is true | `name = 'Luke' OR surname LIKE 'Sky%'` |
| NOT | true if the condition is false. `NOT` needs parenthesis on the right with the condition to negate | `NOT (name = 'Luke')` |

### NULL and unknown

Comparing with a missing or `NULL` value is neither true nor false but *unknown*, as in standard SQL. This applies to `=`, `<>`, `!=`, `<`, `<=`, `>`, `>=` and `BETWEEN`. A `WHERE` keeps a record only when the condition is true, and `NOT` of an unknown stays unknown, so `WHERE age <> 5` and `WHERE NOT (age = 5)` do not return records without `age`, the same as `age NOT IN [5]`. Likewise `age = NULL` and `age <> NULL` match nothing, and a boolean used as a value (`SELECT age <> 5`, `CASE WHEN age <> 5 ...`) is `NULL` for those

records.

To test for a missing value use `IS NULL`, `IS NOT NULL` or the null-safe `<=>`. To keep the records without a value, write it out: `WHERE age <> 5 OR age IS NULL`.

#### Mathematics Operators

| Apply to | Operator | Description | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| Numbers | + | Plus | `age + 34` |
| Numbers | - | Minus | `salary - 34` |
| Numbers | * | Multiply | `factor * 1.3` |
| Numbers | / | Divide | `total / 12` |
| Numbers | % | Mod | `total % 3` |

#### Methods

Also called "Field Operators", are SQL-Methods.

## Variables

ArcadeDB supports variables managed in the context of the command/query. By default, some variables are created. Below the table with the available variables:

| Name | Description | Command(s) |
|---|---|---|
| `$parent` | Get the parent context from a sub-query. Example: `SELECT FROM V LET $type = (TRAVERSE out() FROM $parent.$current.children)` | SELECT and TRAVERSE |
| `$current` | Current record to use in sub-queries to refer from the parent's variable | SELECT and TRAVERSE |
| `$depth` | The current depth of nesting | TRAVERSE |
| `$path` | The string representation of the current path. Example: `#6:0.in.#5:0#.out`. You can also display it with `SELECT $path FROM (TRAVERSE out() FROM V)` | TRAVERSE |
| `$stack` | The List of operation in the stack. Use it to access to the history of the traversal | TRAVERSE |
| `$history` | The set of all the records traversed as a `Set<RID>` | TRAVERSE |

To set custom variable use the LET keyword.

### Wildcards

| Symbol | Description | Example |
|---|---|---|
| `%` | Matches all strings that contain an unknown substring of any length at the position of `%` | "%DB" "A%DB" "Arcade%" all match "ArcadeDB" |
| `?` | Matches all strings that contain an unknown character at the position of `?` | "N?SQL" matches "NoSQL" but not "NewSQL" |

Filtering for strings containing wildcards characters can be done by escaping with backslash, i.e. `\%`, `\?`.

# 14.22. SQL Script

SQL Script (`sqlscript`) is ArcadeDB's server-side scripting engine. A script is a sequence of SQL statements — including the regular DML/DDL commands plus a small set of script-only constructs (transactions, control flow, variables, locks) — that the server parses and runs as a single unit.

## 14.22.1. Why use SQL Script

Single-statement SQL is fine for ad-hoc queries, but most real workloads (especially graph workloads) need to do several things together: look up a vertex, create another, connect them with an edge, then return the result. Doing that as separate client calls has two problems: each call pays a network round-trip, and there is no transaction across them.

SQL Script solves both:

- **One round-trip instead of many.** The whole script is sent to the server once. A graph mutation that takes 5 commands no longer pays 5x the latency — the server runs them locally and sends back one response.
- **Implicit transaction.** A script is automatically wrapped in a transaction (unless you open one yourself with `BEGIN`), so it is all-or-nothing for records: any failure rolls back every record change in the script. Schema changes are the exception, see below.
- **Automatic retry on conflict.** Wrap the body in `BEGIN ⋯ COMMIT RETRY <n>` and ArcadeDB will retry the transaction on `NeedRetryException` (typically a concurrent-modification or transient lock-timeout). This is what lets you run the same script in parallel from many clients without writing your own retry loop — the server resolves the contention.
- **Server-side variables and control flow.** `LET`, `IF`, `WHILE`, `FOREACH`, `RETURN`, etc. let you express small pieces of imperative logic without leaving SQL.

A typical use case is a graph upsert: find or create a vertex, then attach an edge to it, possibly conditionally. With SQL Script that is one network call and one transaction; the server handles concurrency.

A script is a transaction. The atomicity guarantee — "all-or-nothing" — applies to

the records a script changes: if any statement fails (and is not caught by a retry/else clause), every record change made by the script is rolled back.

Schema DDL (`CREATE TYPE`, `CREATE PROPERTY`, `CREATE INDEX`, `ALTER …`, `DROP …`) is not transactional and is never rolled back. If a script fails part way, the schema statements that ran before the failure stay applied, and the error is returned. Do not write a migration script that assumes a failed run leaves the schema untouched: make each statement safe to run again (for example with `IF NOT EXISTS`) and rerun the script. See reference/storage.pdf.

### 14.22.2. Schema-only scripts run as one schema change

Since v26.10.1 a script of two or more statements that are **all** schema definition DDL runs as a single schema change: the schema file is written once for the whole script and, under High Availability, the batch is replicated as one Raft entry instead of one per statement. The database write lock is held for the whole script, so keep such scripts to schema definition and out of data loads. If a statement fails, the statements before it are kept and published to the cluster as one change, so every node agrees on the same partially applied schema, and the original error is returned. Set the database setting `schemaBulkDDLScript` to `false` to go back to one schema change per statement.

A script that contains any statement other than schema definition runs statement by statement, as before. That includes DML and these DDL statements, which work on records or files rather than definitions:

- `REBUILD INDEX`, `REBUILD TYPE`, `REBUILD GRAPH ANALYTICAL VIEW`
- `TRUNCATE TYPE`, `TRUNCATE BUCKET`
- `REFRESH MATERIALIZED VIEW`, `REFRESH CONTINUOUS AGGREGATE`
- `COMPACT INDEX`
- `CREATE MATERIALIZED VIEW`, `CREATE CONTINUOUS AGGREGATE`
- the other graph analytical view statements
- `ALTER TYPE … WITH repartition = true`
- `CREATE INDEX` on a type that existed before the script started

For a **bulk** load of vertices and edges (as opposed to the occasional multi-statement upsert above), `sqlscript` is not the fastest path: each `CREATE VERTEX`/`CREATE EDGE` statement is parsed and planned individually. The `/api/v1/batch` HTTP endpoint and the `GraphBatch` Java API are purpose-built for this and measure several times faster on large imports.

### 14.22.3. Differences between `sql` and `sqlscript`

| **Feature** | `sql` **(single command)** | `sqlscript` **(batch)** |
|---|---|---|
| Number of statements | Exactly one | One or more, separated by `;` |

| Feature | `sql` (single command) | `sqlscript` (batch) |
|---|---|---|
| Transaction | Not transactional by itself | Implicit transaction (or explicit `BEGIN`/`COMMIT`) |
| Variables | Only inside `SELECT ⋯ LET` | `LET` and `SET GLOBAL` across statements |
| Control flow | None | `IF`, `WHILE`, `FOREACH`, `BREAK`, `RETURN` |
| Explicit transaction control | Not allowed | `BEGIN`, `COMMIT [RETRY ⋯ ELSE ⋯]`, `ROLLBACK` |
| Retry on conflict | No | `COMMIT RETRY <n>` |
| Locks | No | `LOCK TYPE` / `LOCK BUCKET` |

To pick the engine, pass `"sqlscript"` as the language parameter (Java driver, HTTP `language` field, console `LANGUAGE` setting, etc.).

### 14.22.4. Syntax reference

A SQL Script supports every SQL command plus the following script-only statements.

| Statement | Purpose |
|---|---|
| `BEGIN [ISOLATION <level>]` | Open an explicit transaction (`READ_COMMITTED` or `REPEATABLE_READ`). |
| `COMMIT [RETRY <n> [ELSE { ⋯ } [AND] (FAIL\|CONTINUE)]]` | Commit the transaction; optionally retry on conflict and run a fallback block. |
| `ROLLBACK` | Abort the current transaction. |
| `LOCK TYPE\|BUCKET <name>[, <name>]*` | Take an explicit type-level or bucket-level lock for the rest of the transaction. |
| `LET <var> = <SQL or expression>` | Bind the result of a statement or expression to a script variable. Reference it as `$var`. |
| `SET GLOBAL <var> = <expression>` | Set a database-scoped variable that survives across scripts and queries until the database is closed. |
| `IF (<cond>) { ⋯ } [ELSE { ⋯ }]` | Conditional execution. |
| `FOREACH (<var> IN <expression>) { ⋯ }` | Loop over the items of a collection or query result. |
| `WHILE (<cond>) { ⋯ }` | Loop while a boolean condition holds. |
| `BREAK` | Exit the innermost `FOREACH` or `WHILE`. |
| `RETURN [<expression>]` | Stop the script and return a value (literal, variable, query, array or map). |
| `SLEEP <ms>` | Pause the script for the given number of milliseconds. |
| `CONSOLE.(log\|output\|error\|warn\|debug) <expression>` | Write a message to the server log or stdout/stderr (server-side only). |

Statements are separated by `;`. Inside `IF`/`WHILE`/`FOREACH` blocks the trailing `;` after each inner statement is optional. Keywords are case insensitive.

### 14.22.5. BEGIN — start an explicit transaction

```
BEGIN [ISOLATION <READ_COMMITTED | REPEATABLE_READ>]
```

By default a script runs inside an implicit `READ_COMMITTED` transaction. Use `BEGIN` only when you want to set a different isolation level, or to mark the start of a `BEGIN ⋯ COMMIT RETRY` block.

- `READ_COMMITTED` (default): each `SELECT` sees the latest committed data.
- `REPEATABLE_READ`: subsequent reads of the same record return the same snapshot for the lifetime of the transaction.

```
BEGIN ISOLATION REPEATABLE_READ;
LET v1 = SELECT FROM Account WHERE id = 1;
-- ... other work ...
LET v2 = SELECT FROM Account WHERE id = 1;  -- guaranteed to match v1
COMMIT;
```

### 14.22.6. COMMIT — commit, retry, fallback

```
COMMIT [RETRY <n> [ELSE { <statements> } [AND] (FAIL | CONTINUE)]]
```

- Without arguments, `COMMIT` simply commits the current transaction.
- `RETRY <n>` makes the server re-run the whole `BEGIN ⋯ COMMIT` block on a retryable failure, up to `n` times. Retryable failures include `NeedRetryException` (concurrent modification, MVCC conflicts) and transient transaction-lock timeouts. Between attempts the server waits a random delay capped by `arcadedb.txRetryDelay` (default 100 ms).
- `ELSE { ⋯ }` is the fallback block executed when retries are exhausted.
- `AND FAIL` (the default when `ELSE` is omitted) re-throws the original exception after the fallback runs.
- `AND CONTINUE` swallows the exception and lets the script keep going.

This is the building block that makes server-side scripts safe to run from many concurrent clients: each conflict is resolved on the server, and the client only sees the final result.

A retry re-runs the block from the beginning, so it is only safe while the block has published nothing yet. A statement with an explicit batch boundary — `UPDATE`, `DELETE` or `MOVE VERTEX` with `BATCH <n>` — commits as it goes, so part of the block is already stored by the time a later statement fails, and a rollback cannot take it back.

> Since 26.10.1, when that has happened the block is **not** retried: the conflict is raised to the caller, who is the only one able to compensate for the part that is already stored. In that case the `ELSE` block does not run and `AND CONTINUE` does not suppress the error either — `ELSE` statements are written for a block that did nothing, and returning an empty result would hide a conflict you need to see. A block that committed nothing before failing is still retried the full `<n>` times, as before.
>
> Before 26.10.1 the block was replayed, applying the already stored records a second time on every remaining attempt, and the script could still report success.

Examples:

```
-- retry up to 100 times, fail if still conflicting
BEGIN;
LET account = CREATE VERTEX Account SET name = 'Luke';
LET city    = SELECT FROM City WHERE name = 'London';
LET e       = CREATE EDGE Lives FROM $account TO $city;
COMMIT RETRY 100;
RETURN $e;
```

```
-- retry, otherwise log to a dead-letter type and continue
BEGIN;
UPDATE Account SET balance = balance - 100 WHERE id = 1;
UPDATE Account SET balance = balance + 100 WHERE id = 2;
COMMIT RETRY 10 ELSE {
  INSERT INTO TransferDLQ SET fromId = 1, toId = 2, amount = 100, ts = sysdate();
} AND CONTINUE;
```

### 14.22.7. LOCK — explicit type or bucket lock

```
LOCK TYPE   <type-name>  [, <type-name>]*
LOCK BUCKET <bucket-name>[, <bucket-name>]*
```

`LOCK` takes an exclusive lock on one or more types or buckets for the rest of the current transaction. The lock is released automatically on `COMMIT` or `ROLLBACK`.

Use it when an MVCC retry would not be enough — typically for a "read-modify-write" sequence that must see a consistent snapshot of an entire type, or for serializing work on a hot bucket.

```
BEGIN;
LOCK TYPE Account, Audit;                       -- nobody else can modify Account or
Audit until we commit
LET total = SELECT sum(balance) FROM Account;
INSERT INTO Audit SET kind = 'snapshot', total = $total[0].sum, ts = sysdate();
```

```
COMMIT;
```

Every type written in the transaction has to be locked. Committing a transaction that modified a type (or bucket) that was not locked fails with `Cannot commit transaction because not all the modified resources were locked`. In the example above `Audit` is written, so it is listed in `LOCK TYPE` together with `Account`.

`LOCK TYPE` also locks every subtype, and for a vertex type every file its vertices write: the edge-list buckets and the super-node stripe buckets. *(Since v26.11.1: adding an edge to a vertex of a subtype, or to a super-node, under `LOCK TYPE` failed the commit with the error above.)*

```
BEGIN;
LOCK BUCKET orders_2026_q2;                    -- serialize writes on a hot bucket
INSERT INTO Order BUCKET orders_2026_q2 SET ...;
COMMIT;
```

### 14.22.8. LET — script variables

```
LET <var> = <expression>
LET <var> = <SQL statement>
LET <var1> = <expr1>, <var2> = <expr2>, ...
```

`LET` evaluates the right-hand side and binds the result to a variable. Reference it later with `$var`. The right-hand side can be:

- an expression (literal, arithmetic, function call): `LET total = 0;`
- a SQL command: `LET city = SELECT FROM City WHERE name = 'London';`
- multiple bindings in one statement, separated by commas.

A `LET` whose value is a `SELECT` acts as an ephemeral view — the result is materialized into a list and can be referenced repeatedly without re-running the query.

`LET` variables have dynamic scope: they are visible to every statement that runs after them in the same script (and inside nested blocks).

```
LET hubs = SELECT FROM City WHERE category = 'hub';
LET count = $hubs.size();
INSERT INTO Stat SET name = 'hub-count', value = $count;
RETURN $count;
```

**Dynamic typing.** Type names in `SELECT`, `INSERT`, `CREATE`, etc. can come from a variable — but only when the statement is itself the right-hand side of a `LET`:

```
LET mytype = 'vec';
```

```
LET r = SELECT FROM $mytype WHERE num > 0;
RETURN $r;
```

```
LET myedge = 'Lives';
LET r = CREATE EDGE $myedge FROM #1:0 TO #1:1;
RETURN $r;
```

### 14.22.9. SET GLOBAL — database-scoped variables

```
SET GLOBAL <var> = <BOOLEAN | STRING | NUMBER | LIST | MAP>
```

`SET GLOBAL` stores a transient variable on the database itself. It is visible to every subsequent SQL or Cypher query running against that database, until the database is closed or the variable is set to `NULL`. Use it for small bits of session-like state (a feature flag, a tenant id, a timestamp).

```
SET GLOBAL tenant = 'acme';
-- later, in any query on this database:
SELECT FROM Account WHERE tenantId = $tenant;
```

### 14.22.10. RETURN — end the script with a value

```
RETURN [<expression>]
```

`RETURN` ends script execution immediately. The argument can be:

- a literal: `RETURN 3;`
- a variable: `RETURN $a;`
- a query: `RETURN (SELECT FROM Foo);`
- an array (HTTP only): `RETURN [ $a, $b ];`
- a map (HTTP only): `RETURN { 'first': $a, 'second': $b };`
- nothing — exits the script with an empty result.

To return arrays or maps in a way that works on every protocol and driver (Java, Node.js, etc.), wrap the result in a `SELECT`:

```
RETURN (SELECT $a AS first, $b AS second)
```

To return an empty result use `RETURN []`.

### 14.22.11. IF — conditional execution

```
IF (<sql-predicate>) {
  <statement>;
  <statement>;
  ...
} [ELSE {
  <statement>;
  ...
}]
```

`<sql-predicate>` is any boolean expression that would be valid in a `WHERE` clause.

```
LET existing = SELECT FROM User WHERE email = 'luke@example.com';
IF ($existing.size() = 0) {
  INSERT INTO User SET email = 'luke@example.com', createdAt = sysdate();
} ELSE {
  UPDATE User SET lastSeen = sysdate() WHERE email = 'luke@example.com';
}
```

```
IF ($a.size() > 0) {
  ROLLBACK;
}
```

### 14.22.12. FOREACH — iterate a collection

```
FOREACH (<variable> IN <expression>) {
  <statement>;
  <statement>;
  ...
}
```

The expression must evaluate to a collection: a literal array, a variable, or the result of a sub-query.

```
FOREACH ($i IN [1, 2, 3]) {
  INSERT INTO Foo SET value = $i;
}
```

```
-- bulk-create edges from a query result
LET people = SELECT FROM Person WHERE city = 'London';
FOREACH ($p IN $people) {
  CREATE EDGE LivesIn FROM $p TO (SELECT FROM City WHERE name = 'London');
}
```

### 14.22.13. WHILE — loop on a condition

```
WHILE (<condition>) {
  <statement>;
  <statement>;
  ...
}
```

```
LET $i = 0;
WHILE ($i < 10) {
  INSERT INTO Foo SET value = $i;
  LET $i = $i + 1;
}
```

### 14.22.14. BREAK — exit the current loop

`BREAK` exits the innermost `FOREACH` or `WHILE`.

```
FOREACH ($i IN [1, 2, 3, 4, 5]) {
  IF ($i > 2) {
    BREAK;
  }
  CONSOLE.log $i;
}
```

```
-- sum positive amounts until you hit a negative one
LET total = 0;
FOREACH ($record IN (SELECT FROM CustomerAccount)) {
  IF ($record.amount < 0) {
    BREAK;
  }
  LET total = $total + $record.amount;
}
RETURN $total;
```

### 14.22.15. SLEEP — pause execution

```
SLEEP <milliseconds>
```

Pauses the script for the given number of milliseconds. Mostly useful for tests, throttling, or staggering retries.

```
FOREACH ($url IN $urls) {
```

```
  INSERT INTO FetchJob SET url = $url, status = 'queued';
  SLEEP 50;                                   -- be polite to a downstream system
}
```

### 14.22.16. CONSOLE — log from a script

```
CONSOLE.log    <expression>
CONSOLE.output <expression>
CONSOLE.error  <expression>
CONSOLE.warn   <expression>
CONSOLE.debug  <expression>
```

Writes a message from the server side. `log`/`warn`/`debug` go to the server log at the matching level, `output` to stdout, `error` to stderr (and the log at SEVERE level). Useful for debugging long-running or scheduled scripts.

```
LET count = SELECT count(*) AS c FROM Order WHERE status = 'pending';
IF ($count[0].c > 1000) {
  CONSOLE.warn 'Pending order backlog is ' + $count[0].c;
}
```

### 14.22.17. End-to-end example: a graph upsert with retry

This is the canonical use case for SQL Script: a single script that **upserts** two vertices (insert if missing, update if present), idempotently connects them with an edge, retries on conflict, and returns the result. Many clients can run this in parallel against the same server — each conflict triggers a server-side retry, no client-side bookkeeping required.

The script uses the `UPDATE … UPSERT` clause for the vertices. `UPSERT` is atomic only when the `WHERE` condition matches a `UNIQUE` index, so the schema needs those indexes first (one-time setup):

```
CREATE VERTEX TYPE City   IF NOT EXISTS;
CREATE VERTEX TYPE Account IF NOT EXISTS;
CREATE EDGE   TYPE Lives   IF NOT EXISTS;

CREATE INDEX IF NOT EXISTS ON City    (name)  UNIQUE;
CREATE INDEX IF NOT EXISTS ON Account (email) UNIQUE;
```

The upsert script itself:

```
BEGIN;

-- 1. Upsert the city. UNIQUE index on City.name makes this atomic.
--    `RETURN AFTER` returns the upserted row directly, so we capture
--    the vertex (and its RID) in $city without a second roundtrip.
```

```
LET city    = UPDATE City SET name = 'London', country = 'UK'
              UPSERT RETURN AFTER WHERE name = 'London';

-- 2. Upsert the person. UNIQUE index on Account.email makes this atomic.
LET account = UPDATE Account SET name = 'Luke', email = 'luke@example.com',
                                 updatedAt = sysdate()
              UPSERT RETURN AFTER WHERE email = 'luke@example.com';

-- 3. Idempotently connect them. CREATE EDGE has no UPSERT clause,
--    so check for an existing edge first.
LET existing = SELECT FROM Lives
               WHERE @out = $account[0] AND @in = $city[0];
IF ($existing.size() = 0) {
  CREATE EDGE Lives FROM $account TO $city SET since = sysdate();
}

COMMIT RETRY 100;

RETURN (SELECT FROM Lives
        WHERE @out = $account[0] AND @in = $city[0]);
```

What makes this a **real** upsert:

- **Vertices** — `UPDATE … UPSERT WHERE` either updates the existing row matched by the unique key or inserts a new one. The `RETURN AFTER` clause makes the statement emit the upserted row (with `@rid`) regardless of which branch was taken, so we capture it into a `LET` variable in one statement instead of issuing a separate `SELECT` lookup. Run the script twice with the same `email`/`name` and you still end up with exactly one `Account` and one `City`.
- **Edge** — `CREATE EDGE` does not have its own `UPSERT` clause, so the script does the equivalent by hand: a `SELECT` against the edge's `@out`/`@in` endpoints, then `CREATE EDGE` only when the lookup is empty. Re-running the script does not produce duplicate edges.
- **Concurrency** — the whole `BEGIN … COMMIT RETRY 100` block is the unit that gets retried. If two clients run this script at the same time and one of them hits a `NeedRetryException` (typically from the unique-index conflict), the server transparently rolls back and re-executes the block up to 100 times.

The result of the final `SELECT` (the existing or newly-created `Lives` edge) is what the client receives.

### 14.22.18. Running scripts

You can run a SQL script from any of the supported entry points:

- **Java driver**: `database.command("sqlscript", "BEGIN; … COMMIT;")`.
- **HTTP API**: `POST /api/v1/command/<db>` with `{"language": "sqlscript", "command": "…"}`.
- **Console**: switch the language with `set language sqlscript;` then paste the script.
- **Studio**: pick "SQL Script" in the language selector before running.

In an HA cluster, scripts are routed to the leader so that the implicit transaction can be applied with

quorum.

## 14.23. Functions

SQL Functions are all the functions bundled with ArcadeDB SQL engine. Look also to SQL Methods.

**Extended Functions Available**

ArcadeDB provides 100+ additional functions organized by namespace (`text.*`, `map.*`, `convert.*`, `date.*`, `util.*`, `agg.*`, etc.). These functions are available in both SQL and Cypher queries. See reference/extended-functions.pdf for the complete reference.

These extended functions are also APOC-compatible, supporting the `apoc.` prefix for seamless Neo4j migration.

The functions `expand()` and `distinct()` are special functions, as those have constraints in terms of admissible use inside projections.

SQL Functions can work in 2 ways based on the fact that they can receive one or more parameters:

### 14.23.1. Aggregated mode

When only one parameter is passed, the function aggregates the result in only one record. The classic example is the `sum()` function:

```
SELECT sum(salary) FROM employee
```

This will always return one record: the sum of salary fields across every employee record.

### 14.23.2. Inline mode

When two or more parameters are passed:

```
SELECT sum(salary, extra, benefits) AS total FROM employee
```

This will return the sum of the field "salary", "extra" and "benefits" as "total".

In case you need to use a function inline, when you only have one parameter, then add "null" as the second parameter:

```
SELECT first(out('friends').name, NULL) AS firstFriend FROM Profiles
```

In the above example, the `first()` function doesn't aggregate everything in only one record, but rather returns one record per `Profile`, where the `firstFriend` is the first item of the collection

received as the parameter.

### 14.23.3. Function Reference

#### abs() math

Returns the absolute value. It works with Integer, Long, Short, Double, Float, BigInteger, BigDecimal, and null.

Syntax: `abs(<field>)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT abs(score) FROM Account
```

```
SELECT abs(-2332) FROM Account
```

```
SELECT abs(999) FROM Account
```

---

#### astar() graph

The A* algorithm describes how to find the cheapest path from one node to another node in a directed weighted graph with a heuristic function.

The first parameter is source record. The second parameter is destination record. The third parameter is a name of property that represents weight and fourth represents the map of options.

An edge without the weight property (or whose value is not a number) weighs 1, and an edge whose weight is negative, NaN or infinite is not walked: use `bellmanFord()` for negative weights. Every weighted path function reads the weight by this same rule. The resulting path is returned as list of RIDs.

When several edges connect the same pair of vertices, the cheapest one is used.

Syntax: `astar(<sourceVertex>, <destinationVertex>, <weightEdgeFieldName>, [<options>])`

options:

```
{
  direction:"OUT", //the edge direction (OUT, IN, BOTH)
  edgeTypeNames:[],
  vertexAxisNames:[],
  parallel : false,
  tieBreaker:true,
  maxDepth:99999,
```

```
  dFactor:1.0,
  customHeuristicFormula:'custom_Function_Name_here'  // (MANHATTAN, MAXAXIS,
DIAGONAL, EUCLIDEAN, EUCLIDEANNOSQR, CUSTOM)
}
```

`edgeTypeNames` and `vertexAxisNames` accept either a list (`['Road']`) or a comma-separated string (`'Road,Rail'`). Any other type is rejected with an error.

`DIAGONAL` is the octile distance (a diagonal step costs `sqrt(2) * dFactor`), admissible on 8-connected grids. The two-axis `tieBreaker` penalizes a node's distance from the straight line between source and destination.

**Examples**

```
SELECT astar($current, #8:10, 'weight') FROM Vehicle
```

See also: Graph Algorithms: A* for the Cypher procedure variant with geographic heuristics.

---

### avg() math

Returns the arithmetic mean. The mean of integer values is a `DOUBLE`, even when their sum is too large for a `LONG`; the mean of `DECIMAL` values is a `DECIMAL`.

Syntax: `avg(<field|value> [,<field|value>]*)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT avg(salary) FROM Account
```

```
SELECT avg(1, 2, 3)
```

---

### bool_and() misc

Aggregates a field, an expression or value by the logical AND operator and returns true or false, null values are ignored.

Syntax: `bool_and(<field|expression|value>)`

**Examples**

Test if all salaries are greater than zero:

```
SELECT bool_and((salary > 0)) FROM Account
```

### bool_or() misc

Aggregates a field, an expression or value by the logical OR operator and returns true or false, null values are ignored.

Syntax: `bool_or(<field|expression|value>)`

#### Examples

Test if a null value is present in the salary field:

```
SELECT bool_or((salary IS NULL)) FROM Account
```

### both() graph

Get the adjacent outgoing and incoming vertices starting from the current record as vertex.

Syntax: `both([<label1>] [,<label-n>]*)`

#### Examples

Get all the incoming and outgoing vertices from vertex with RID `#13:33`:

```
SELECT both() FROM #13:33
```

Get all the incoming and outgoing "Vehicle" vertices connected by edges with label (class) "Trucks" and "Cars":

```
SELECT both('Trucks', 'Cars') FROM Vehicle
```

### bothE() graph

Get the adjacent outgoing and incoming edges starting from the current record as vertex.

Syntax: `bothE([<label1>] [,<label-n>]*)`

#### Examples

Get both incoming and outgoing edges from all the "Vehicle" vertices:

```
SELECT bothE() FROM Vehicle
```

Get all the incoming and outgoing edges of type "Friend" from the profiles with "nickname" "Jay"

```
SELECT bothE('Friend') FROM Profile WHERE nickname = 'Jay'
```

---

#### bothV() graph

Get the adjacent outgoing and incoming vertices starting from the current record as edge.

Syntax: `bothV()`

#### Examples

Get both incoming and outgoing vertices from the "Friend" edges:

```
SELECT bothV() FROM Friend
```

---

#### cchShortestPath() graph

Returns the cheapest path between two vertices, answered by a Customizable Contraction Hierarchy when a Graph Analytical View keeps one for the weight property and edge types asked for, and by bidirectional Dijkstra otherwise. Direction can be OUT (default), IN or BOTH. The resulting path is returned as list of RIDs, empty when the destination cannot be reached.

An edge without the weight property (or whose value is not a number) weighs 1, and an edge whose weight is negative, NaN or infinite is not walked: use `bellmanFord()` for negative weights. Every weighted path function reads the weight by this same rule. Among parallel edges only the cheapest counts.

Syntax: `cchShortestPath(<sourceVertex>, <destinationVertex>, <weightEdgeFieldName> [, <direction> | { direction, edgeTypeNames }])`

#### Examples

```
SELECT cchShortestPath(#12:0, #12:5, 'distance', { direction: 'OUT', edgeTypeNames:
['ROAD'] }) AS path
```

See also: algo.cch.shortestPath for the Cypher procedure variant, and reference/graph-algorithms/sql-path-functions.pdf for the full SQL function reference.

---

#### circle() geo

Creates a 2D circle from two numbers specifying X- and Y-coordinate of circle’s center and a number describing the circle’s radius.

---

Syntax: `circle(<center-x>, <center-y>, <radius>)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT circle(10, 10, 10) AS circle
```

---

### coalesce() misc

Returns the first field/value argument not being null parameter. If no field/value is not null, `null` is returned.

Syntax: `coalesce(<field|value> [,<field-n|value-n>]*)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT coalesce(amount, amount2, amount3) FROM Account
```

---

### concat() text

Aggregates field (or string) by implicitly casting to string and concatenate. Optionally, a second field or string can be passed and is record-wise appended.

Syntax: `concat(<field|string> [,<field|string>]*)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT concat(name) FROM names
```

---

### count() math

Counts the records that match the query condition. If `*` is used as field, then all record will be counted, otherwise only records with field content that is not null.

Syntax: `count([DISTINCT] <field>)`

With `DISTINCT` each distinct value is counted once, with or without `GROUP BY`. Numbers that are equal count once whatever their type or scale (`1` and `1.0`, `19.9` and `19.90`), as in `SELECT DISTINCT` and `GROUP BY`; a null is never counted. `DISTINCT` is accepted by the other aggregate functions too, e.g. `sum(DISTINCT <field>)` and `avg(DISTINCT <field>)`.

**Examples**

```
SELECT count(*) FROM Account
SELECT count(DISTINCT country) FROM Account
SELECT type, count(DISTINCT country) AS countries FROM Account GROUP BY type
```

---

### cypherRID() graph

Converts a Cypher-style numeric id (the value returned by the OpenCypher `id()` function and the SQL `.asCypherRID()` method) back into a native RID. It is the explicit inverse of `.asCypherRID()` and shares its configurable bit split (`arcadedb.opencypher.idBucketBits`). Its main use is as the **target** of a `SELECT`/`UPDATE`/`DELETE`, where the record is then resolved in O(1) - the same cost as a native `#bucketId:offset` literal. A negative input is rejected, since a valid Cypher id is never negative.

Syntax: `cypherRID(<cypherId>)`

#### Examples

Resolve a record by its Cypher id (named parameter):

```
SELECT FROM cypherRID(:id) LIMIT 1
```

Use a bare numeric literal, or update/delete by Cypher id:

```
SELECT FROM cypherRID(30064771072) LIMIT 1
UPDATE cypherRID(:id) SET verified = true
DELETE FROM cypherRID(:id)
```

The value passed to `cypherRID()` is exactly what `id()` (Cypher) or `.asCypherRID()` (SQL) produced for that record.

---

### date() date

Returns a date as `DATETIME` from a string. <date-as-string> is the date in string format, and <format> is the date format of <date-as-string> following these rules. If no format is specified, then the default database format is used. To know more about it, look at Managing Dates.

Syntax: `date(<date-as-string> [,<format>] [,<timezone>])`

If no argument is given, `date()` returns the current time as a UTC wall clock, like `sysdate()`.

#### Examples

```
SELECT FROM Account WHERE created <= date('2012-07-02', 'yyyy-MM-dd')
```

### decode() misc

Decodes a value into binary data (`base64` and `base64url` are the only supported formats). The `<value>` must contain base64 encoded information.

Syntax: `decode(<value>, <format>)`

The decode function returns a binary type, which can be converted to a string via `asString()`.

#### Examples

Decode a value into binary format from base64.

```
SELECT decode('QXJjYWRlREI=', 'base64')
```

```
SELECT decode('QXJjYWRlREI', 'base64url').asString()
```

### difference() collections

Syntax: `difference(<field> [,<field-n>]*)`

Works as aggregate or inline. If only one argument is passed then it aggregates, otherwise it executes and returns the DIFFERENCE between the collections received as parameters.

#### Examples

```
SELECT difference(tags) FROM book
```

```
SELECT difference(inEdges, outEdges) FROM OGraphVertex
```

### dijkstra() graph

Returns the cheapest path between two vertices using the Dijkstra's algorithm where the **weightEdgeFieldName** parameter is the field containing the weight. Direction can be OUT (default), IN or BOTH. The resulting path is returned as list of RIDs.

When several edges connect the same pair of vertices, the cheapest one is used. An edge without

the weight property (or whose value is not a number) weighs 1, and an edge whose weight is negative, NaN or infinite is not walked: use `bellmanFord()` for negative weights. Every weighted path function reads the weight by this same rule.

Syntax: `dijkstra(<sourceVertex>, <destinationVertex>, <weightEdgeFieldName> [, <direction>])`

**Examples**

```
SELECT dijkstra($current, #8:10, 'weight') FROM Vehicle
```

See also: Graph Algorithms: Dijkstra for the Cypher procedure variant, and reference/graph-algorithms/sql-path-functions.pdf for the full SQL function reference in the appendix.

---

#### distance() geo

Returns the distance between two points in the globe using the Haversine algorithm. Coordinates must be in degrees.

Syntax: `distance(<x-field>, <y-field>, <x-value>, <y-value>)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT FROM POI WHERE distance(x, y, 52.20472, 0.14056 ) <= 30
```

---

#### distinct() collections

Retrieves only unique data entries depending on the field you have specified as argument. The main difference compared to standard SQL DISTINCT is that with ArcadeDB, a function with parenthesis and only one field can be specified.

Syntax: `distinct(<field>)`

The `distinct()` function has to be the sole projection component if used.

**Examples**

```
SELECT distinct(name) FROM City
```

---

#### duration() date

Returns a Java duration object, which can be useful to compare periods of time.

Syntax: `duration(<field|integer>, '<string>')`

The admissible second argument values are given here.

**Examples**

```
SELECT duration(start, 'year') FROM Employees
```

---

### duanSSSP() graph

Returns the cheapest path between two vertices, through the same engine as cchShortestPath() (a Customizable Contraction Hierarchy when a Graph Analytical View keeps one, bidirectional Dijkstra otherwise). The weight property is optional and defaults to `weight`. Direction can be OUT (default), IN or BOTH. The resulting path is returned as list of RIDs, empty when the destination cannot be reached.

An edge without the weight property (or whose value is not a number) weighs 1, and an edge whose weight is negative, NaN or infinite is not walked: use `bellmanFord()` for negative weights. Every weighted path function reads the weight by this same rule.

Syntax: `duanSSSP(<sourceVertex>, <destinationVertex> [, <weightEdgeFieldName>] [, <direction> | { direction, edgeTypeNames }])`

**Examples**

```
SELECT duanSSSP(#12:0, #12:5, 'distance', { edgeTypeNames: ['ROAD'] }) AS path
```

See also: reference/graph-algorithms/sql-path-functions.pdf for the full SQL function reference.

---

### encode() misc

Encode binary data into the specified format (`base64` and `base64url` are the only supported formats). The `<binaryfields>` must be a property containing binary data.

Syntax: `encode(<binaryfield|stringfield|string>, <format>)`

To encode RIDs, they need to be converted to strings first via `asString()` otherwise the link target is encoded.

**Examples**

Encode binary data into base64.

```
SELECT encode(raw, 'base64') FROM Blob
```

### expand() collections

This function has two meanings:

- When used on a collection field, it unwinds the collection in the field <field> and use it as result.
- When used on a link (RID) field, it expands the document pointed by that link.

A single non-collection, non-link value (a number, string, boolean or map) is treated as a one-element result: it produces one row, exposed as a `value` property (or the alias, if one is given).

Syntax: `expand(<field>)`

You can also use the SQL operator `UNWIND` in select to obtain the same result.

As `expand()` may change its return type based on the argument, no modifiers (method calls, suffix identifiers or array indexing) are permitted on the return value of `expand()`.

#### Examples

```
SELECT expand(addresses) FROM Account
```

### first() collections

Retrieves only the first item of multi-value fields (arrays, collections and maps). For non multi-value types just returns the value.

Syntax: `first(<field>)`

#### Examples

```
SELECT first(addresses) FROM Account
```

### format() text

Formats a value using the String.format() conventions. Look here for more information on the format string syntax.

Syntax: `format(<format> [,<arg1> ] [,<arg-n>]*)`

To escape the percent symbol (`%`) use `%%`.

#### Examples

```
SELECT format("%d - Mr. %s %s (%s)", id, name, surname, address) FROM Account
```

---

#### if() misc

Syntax: `if(<expression>, <result-if-true> [,<result-if-false>])`

Evaluates a condition (first parameter) and returns the second parameter if the condition is true, and the third parameter otherwise. The third parameter is optional: if it is omitted and the condition is false, `null` is returned.

**Examples**

```
SELECT if( (name = 'John'), "My name is John", "My name is not John") FROM Person
```

Omitting the false branch, so that non-matching records get `null`:

```
SELECT if( (name = 'John'), "My name is John") FROM Person
```

---

#### ifempty() misc

Returns the passed field/value, or optional parameter *return_value_if_not_empty*. If field/value is an empty string or collection, *return_value_if_empty* is returned.

Syntax: `ifempty(<field|value>, <return_value_if_empty> [,<return_value_if_not_empty>])`

**Examples**

```
SELECT ifempty(name, "No Name") FROM Account
```

---

#### ifnull() misc

Returns the passed field/value, or optional parameter *return_value_if_not_null*. If field/value is null, *return_value_if_null* is returned.

Syntax: `ifnull(<field|value>, <return_value_if_null> [,<return_value_if_not_null>])`

**Examples**

```
SELECT ifnull(salary, 0) FROM Account
```

---

### in() graph

Get the adjacent incoming vertices starting from the current record as vertex.

Syntax: `in([<label-1>] [,<label-n>]*)`

#### Examples

Get all the incoming vertices from all the "Vehicle" vertices:

```
SELECT in() FROM Vehicle
```

Get all the incoming vertices connected with edges with label (class) "Trucks" and "Cars":

```
SELECT in('Trucks', 'Cars') FROM Vehicle
```

`in()`, `inE()`, `both()` and `bothE()` return what the vertex stores, as the Java vertex API does. An edge type declared `UNIDIRECTIONAL` stores no incoming side, so on its own `SELECT in('Follows') FROM Account` returns nothing for such a type. A hop of a SQL `MATCH` pattern (`{as: a}.in('Follows'){as: b}`, `{as: a}<-Follows-{as: b}`) and a Cypher pattern return the incoming edges of a unidirectional type too (since 26.10.1). An `in()` written inside a `where:` or `while:` condition of a `MATCH` is an expression, and answers as the function does anywhere else. A Graph Analytical View does not change these answers, it only makes them faster (since 26.10.1). The path-finding functions `dijkstra()`, `astar()`, `bellmanFord()`, `cchShortestPath()` and `duanSSSP()` always follow the incoming edges of a unidirectional type (since 26.11.1); see `CREATE TYPE`.

---

### inE() graph

Get the adjacent incoming edges starting from the current record as Vertex.

Syntax: `inE([<label1>] [,<label-n>]*)`

#### Examples

Get all the incoming edges from all the "Vehicle" vertices:

```
SELECT inE() FROM Vehicle
```

Get all the incoming edges of type "Eats" from the "Restaurant" "Bella Napoli":

```
SELECT inE('Eats') FROM Restaurant WHERE name = 'Bella Napoli'
```

### intersect() collections

Works as aggregate or inline. If only one argument is passed then it aggregates, otherwise executes and returns the INTERSECTION of the collections received as parameters.

Syntax: `intersect(<field> [,<field-n>]*)`

#### Examples

```
SELECT intersect(friends) FROM profile WHERE jobTitle = 'programmer'
```

```
SELECT intersect(inEdges, outEdges) FROM GraphVertex
```

### inV() graph

Get incoming vertices starting from the current record as edge.

Syntax: `inV()`

#### Examples

Get incoming vertices from the "Friend" edges

```
SELECT inV() FROM Friend
```

### last() collections

Retrieves only the last item of multi-value fields (arrays, collections and maps). For non multi-value types just returns the value.

Syntax: `last(<field>)`

#### Examples

```
SELECT last(addresses) FROM Account
```

### list() collections

Creates or adds a value to a list. If `<field|value>` is a collection, then is merged with the list, otherwise `<field|value>` is added to the list.

Syntax: `list(<field|value>[,]*)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT name, list(roles.name) AS roles FROM User
```

---

### lineString() geo

Creates a chain of 2D lines from a list of points. A string of lines is not necessarily closed.

Syntax: `lineString([<point>*])`

**Examples**

```
SELECT lineString([point(10, 10), point(20, 10), point(20, 20), point(10, 20), point
(30, 30)]) AS linesString
```

---

### map() collections

Creates a map. The arguments have to be pairs of keys and values, hence the number of arguments has to be even. The `<key>` argument(s) have to be strings.

Syntax: `map(<key>, <value>[,]*)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT map(name, roles.name) FROM User
```

---

### max() math

Returns the maximum value. If invoked with more than one parameter, the function doesn't aggregate, but returns the maximum value between all the arguments.

Syntax: `max(<field> [,<field-n>]*)`

**Examples**

Returns the maximum salary of all the "Account" records:

```
SELECT max(salary) FROM Account.
```

Returns the maximum value between "salary1", "salary2" and "salary3" fields.

```
SELECT max(salary1, salary2, salary3) FROM Account
```

### median() math

Returns the middle value or an interpolated value that represent the middle value after the values are sorted. Nulls are ignored in the calculation.

Syntax: `median(<field>)`

#### Examples

```
SELECT median(salary) FROM Account
```

### min() math

Returns the minimum value. If invoked with more than one parameter, the function doesn't aggregate but returns the minimum value between all the arguments.

Syntax: `min(<field> [, <field-n>]*)`

#### Examples

Returns the minimum salary of all the "Account" records:

```
SELECT min(salary) FROM Account
```

Returns the minimum value between "salary1", "salary2" and "salary3" fields.

```
SELECT min(salary1, salary2, salary3) FROM Account
```

### mode() math

Returns the values that occur with the greatest frequency. Nulls are ignored in the calculation.

Syntax: `mode(<field>)`

#### Examples

```
SELECT mode(salary) FROM Account
```

### out() graph

Get the adjacent outgoing vertices starting from the current record as vertex.

Syntax: `out([<label-1>] [,<label-n>]*)`

#### Examples

Get all the outgoing vertices from all the "Vehicle" vertices:

```
SELECT out() FROM Vehicle
```

Get all the outgoing vertices connected with edges with label (class) "Eats" and "Favorited" from all the "Restaurant" vertices in "Rome":

```
SELECT out('Eats', 'Favorited') FROM Restaurant WHERE city = 'Rome'
```

---

### outE() graph

Get the adjacent outgoing edges starting from the current record as vertex.

Syntax: `outE([<label1>] [,<label-n>]*)`

#### Examples

Get all the outgoing edges from all the "Vehicle" vertices:

```
SELECT outE() FROM Vehicle
```

Get all the outgoing edges of type "Eats" from all the "SocialNetworkProfile" vertices:

```
SELECT outE('Eats') FROM SocialNetworkProfile
```

---

### outV() graph

Get outgoing vertices starting from the current record as edge.

Syntax: `outV()`

#### Examples

Get outgoing vertices from the "Friend" edges

```
SELECT outV() FROM Friend
```

### percentile() math

Returns the nth percentiles (the values that cut off the first n percent of the field values when it is sorted in ascending order). Nulls are ignored in the calculation. The quantiles have to be in the range 0—1

Syntax: `percentile(<field> [, <quantile-n>]*)`

#### Examples

```
SELECT percentile(salary, 0.95) FROM Account
```

```
SELECT percentile(salary, 0.25, 0.75) AS IQR FROM Account
```

### point() geo

Creates a 2D point from two numbers specifying X- and Y-coordinate.

Syntax: `point(<x>, <y>)`

#### Examples

```
SELECT point(10, 20) AS point
```

### polygon() geo

Creates a 2D polygon from a list of points. The lines making up a polygon are closed.

Syntax: `polygon([<point>*])`

#### Examples

```
SELECT polygon([point(10, 10), point(20, 10), point(20, 20), point(10, 20), point(10,
10)]) AS polygon
```

### pow() math

Returns the power of the `base` argument to the `exponent` argument. It works with Integer, Long, Short, Double, Float, BigInteger, BigDecimal, and null.

Syntax: `pow(<base>, <exponent>)`

#### Examples

```
SELECT pow(2, 10) AS oneKibi
```

---

### randomInt() math

Returns an integer drawn from a uniform pseudo-random distribution in the range from (inclusively) zero up to (exclusively) the argument `max`.

Syntax: `randomInt(<max>)`

#### Examples

```
SELECT randomInt(10) AS rand
```

You can use it in SQL Scripts to wait a random amount of milliseconds.

```
SLEEP randomInt(500);
```

---

### rectangle() geo

Creates a 2D rectangle from four numbers specifying the left boundary X-, top boundary Y-, right boundary X- and bottom boundary Y-values.

Syntax: `rectangle(<left-x>, <top-y>, <right-x>, <bottom-y>)`

#### Examples

```
SELECT rectangle(10, 10, 20, 20) AS rectangle
```

---

### set() collections

Creates or adds a value to a set. If `<value>` is a collection, then it is merged with the set, otherwise `<field|value>` is added to the set.

Syntax: `set(<field|value>[,]*)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT name, set(roles.name) AS roles FROM User
```

---

### shortestPath() graph

Returns the shortest path between two vertices. Direction can be OUT (default), IN or BOTH.

Syntax: `shortestPath(<sourceVertex>, <destinationVertex> [, <direction> [, <edgeClassName> [, <additionalParams>]]])`

Where:

- `sourceVertex` is the source vertex where to start the path
- `destinationVertex` is the destination vertex where the path ends - `direction`, optional, is the direction of traversing. By default is "BOTH" (in+out). Supported values are "BOTH" (incoming and outgoing), "OUT" (outgoing) and "IN" (incoming)
- `edgeClassName`, optional, is the edge class to traverse. By default all edges are crossed. This can also be a list of edge class names (eg. `["edgeType1", "edgeType2"]`)
- `additionalParams`, optional, here you can pass a map of additional parameters (Map<String, Object> in Java, JSON from SQL). Currently allowed parameters are
- 'maxDepth': integer, maximum depth for paths (ignore path longer that 'maxDepth')

**Examples**

on finding the shortest path between vertices `#8:32` and `#8:10`

```
SELECT shortestPath(#8:32, #8:10)
```

**Examples**

on finding the shortest path between vertices `#8:32` and `#8:10` only crossing outgoing edges

```
SELECT shortestPath(#8:32, #8:10, 'OUT')
```

**Examples**

on finding the shortest path between vertices `#8:32 and `#8:10` only crossing incoming edges of type "Friend"

```
SELECT shortestPath(#8:32, #8:10, 'IN', 'Friend')
```

#### Examples

on finding the shortest path between vertices `#8:32 and `#8:10 only crossing incoming edges of type "Friend" or "Colleague"

```
SELECT shortestPath(#8:32, #8:10, 'IN', ['Friend', 'Colleague'])
```

#### Examples

on finding the shortest path between vertices #8:32 and #8:10, long at most five hops

```
SELECT shortestPath(#8:32, #8:10, null, null, {"maxDepth": 5})
```

See also: Graph Algorithms: shortestPath() for the full function reference, and Graph Algorithms Appendix for a comprehensive reference of all graph algorithms.

---

### sqrt() math

Returns the absolute value. It works with Integer, Long, Short, Double, Float, BigInteger, BigDecimal, and null.

Integer arguments are rounded down and negative arguments result in null.

Syntax: `sqrt(<field>)`

#### Examples

```
SELECT sqrt(score) FROM Account
```

```
SELECT sqrt(2.0)
```

```
SELECT sqrt(63)
```

---

### stddev() math

Returns the standard deviation: the measure of how spread out values are. Nulls are ignored in the calculation.

Syntax: `stddev(<field>)`

#### Examples

```
SELECT stddev(salary) FROM Account
```

---

### strcmpci() text

Compares two string ignoring case. Return value is -1 if first string ignoring case is less than second, 0 if strings ignoring case are equals, 1 if second string ignoring case is less than first one. Before comparison both strings are transformed to lowercase and then compared.

Syntax: `strcmpci(<first_string>, <second_string>)`

#### Examples

Select all records where state name ignoring case is equal to "washington"

```
SELECT * FROM State WHERE strcmpci('washington', name) = 0
```

---

### sum() math

Returns the sum of all the values returned.

Integers widen instead of wrapping: a sum of `INTEGER` values that does not fit an `INTEGER` is returned as a `LONG`, and a sum of `LONG` values that does not fit a `LONG` is returned as a `DECIMAL` (`BigDecimal`). Clients that read the result as a `LONG` can see a `DECIMAL` when the total overflows.

Over an empty group, or a group where every value is `NULL`, `sum()` returns `NULL` (as `avg()`, `min()` and `max()` do), not `0`. *(Since v26.11.1)* Use `ifnull(sum(<field>), 0)` to get `0`. In OpenCypher, `sum()` still returns `0`.

Syntax: `sum(<field>)`

#### Examples

```
SELECT sum(salary) FROM Account
```

---

### symmetricDifference() collections

Works as aggregate or inline. If only one argument is passed then it aggregates, otherwise executes and returns the SYMMETRIC DIFFERENCE between the collections received as parameters.

Syntax: `symmetricDifference(<field> [,<field-n>]*)`

#### Examples

```
SELECT symmetricDifference(tags) FROM book
```

```
SELECT symmetricDifference(inEdges, outEdges) FROM GraphVertex
```

---

#### sysdate() date

Returns the current date time as DateTime object. To know more about it, look at Managing Dates.

The clock is read as an instant, so the value stored in a `DATETIME` property is the real current moment whatever the time zone of the JVM (a `DATETIME` is stored as a UTC wall clock). With a zone argument, `sysdate('Asia/Seoul')`, the clock is read in that zone.

The default format is controlled by the setting `arcadedb.dateFormat`.

Syntax: `sysdate([<zoneid>])`

**Examples**

```
SELECT sysdate() FROM Account
```

---

#### unionall() collections

Works as aggregate or inline. If only one argument is passed then aggregates, otherwise executes and returns a UNION of all the collections received as parameters. Also works with no collection values.

Syntax: `unionall(<field> [,<field-n>]*)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT unionall(friends) FROM profile
```

```
SELECT unionall(inEdges, outEdges) FROM GraphVertex WHERE label = 'test'
```

---

#### uuid() misc

Generates a UUID as a 128-bits value using the Leach-Salz variant. For more information look at: http://docs.oracle.com/javase/6/docs/api/java/util/UUID.html.

Syntax: `uuid()`

---

### Examples

Insert a new record with an automatic generated id:

```
INSERT INTO Account SET id = UUID()
```

---

### variance() math

Returns the middle variance: the average of the squared differences from the mean. Nulls are ignored in the calculation.

Syntax: `variance(<field>)`

### Examples

```
SELECT variance(salary) FROM Account
```

---

#### Vector Function Namespace

Every vector function has two equivalent names: the namespaced `vector.<name>()` form and a camelCase alias (`vectorXXX()`) kept for backward compatibility. Both resolve to the same function, are case-insensitive, and can be called without back-ticks.

**Use the namespaced `vector.<name>()` form** in new queries: it is consistent with the other extended namespaces (`geo.`, `math.`, ...) and reads more clearly. The full reference is in reference/extended-functions.pdf. The headings below keep the legacy `vectorXXX()` spelling for continuity; the mapping is:

| Legacy alias | Recommended (namespaced) |
|---|---|
| `vectorNeighbors()` | `vector.neighbors()` |
| `vectorDimension()` | `vector.dimension()` |
| `vectorNormalize()` | `vector.normalize()` |
| `vectorL2Distance()` | `vector.l2Distance()` |
| `vectorCosineSimilarity()` | `vector.cosineSimilarity()` |
| `vectorDotProduct()` | `vector.dotProduct()` |
| `vectorMagnitude()` | `vector.magnitude()` |
| `vectorL2Norm()` | `vector.l2Norm()` (alias of `vector.magnitude()`) |
| `vectorAdd()` | `vector.add()` |
| `vectorSubtract()` | `vector.subtract()` |

| Legacy alias | Recommended (namespaced) |
|---|---|
| `vectorScale()` | `vector.scale()` |
| `vectorClamp()` | `vector.clamp()` (alias of `vector.clip()`) |
| `vectorQuantizeInt8()` | `vector.quantizeInt8()` |
| `vectorQuantizeBinary()` | `vector.quantizeBinary()` |

#### vectorAdd() vector

Returns vector of element-wise sums of argument vectors, which are expected to be of the same size. Alternatively, when one argument is a scalar the scalar is added to every element (broadcasting).

Syntax: `vectorAdd(<vector|field>, <vector|field|scalar>)`

#### Examples

```
SELECT vectorAdd([1.0, 2.0, 3.0], [2.0, 3.0, 4.0])

SELECT vectorAdd([1.0, 2.0, 3.0], 4.0)
-- Returns: [5.0, 6.0, 7.0]
```

---

#### vectorApproxDistance() vector

Computes approximate distance between quantized vectors without intermediate full dequantization. When the arguments are the result objects of `vectorQuantizeInt8()` /`vectorQuantizeBinary()` the mode is inferred and the third argument can be omitted; raw byte arrays still need the explicit mode. Two modes are supported:

- `'INT8'` L2 distance computed on the int8 codes without materialising the dequantized vectors. Each `vectorQuantizeInt8()` result carries its own `min`/`max` band, and every code is mapped back through its own band, so the answer approximates the true L2 distance (within the quantization step) whatever the scale and offset of the two vectors. Two raw int8 byte arrays carry no band: they must have been quantized on one shared scale, and their distance is measured in code units. A result object and a raw array cannot be compared and are rejected.
- `'BINARY'` very fast (count differing bits), reduces operations eight-fold, returns normalized Hamming distance. Requires the `vectorQuantizeBinary()` result object (raw packed bits are not enough). Each bit is drawn against that vector's own median, so the distance compares the shape of the two vectors and ignores their scale and offset: a cosine-like proxy, not an L2 one

Syntax: `vectorApproxDistance(<quantized>, <quantized> [, <string>])`

#### Examples

```
SELECT vectorApproxDistance(vectorQuantizeInt8([1.0, 2.0, 3.0]), vectorQuantizeInt8([
```

```
1.0, 3.0, 3.0]))
```

#### vectorAvg() vector

Aggregate function computing element-wise arithmetic average of vectors.

Syntax: `vectorAvg(<field>)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT vectorAvg(myvector) FROM doc
```

#### vectorClip() vector

Forces every vector element to the range between min and max arguments, where min less or equal to max is assumed. Elements exceeding this ranged are set to min or max respectively. Also available as `vectorClamp()` (the standard Java/Math term).

Syntax: `vectorClip(<vector|field>, <scalar>, <scalar>)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT vectorClip([1.0, 5.0, 10.0], 2.0, 8.0)

SELECT vectorClamp([1.0, 5.0, 10.0], 2.0, 8.0)
-- Returns: [2.0, 5.0, 8.0]  (clamp is an alias of clip)
```

#### vectorCosineSimilarity() vector

Computes the cosine similarity between two vectors. Returns a value between -1 and 1, where 1 means same proportional, 0 means orthogonal, and -1 means opposite vectors.

Syntax: `vector(<vector|field>, <vector|field>)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT vectorCosineSimilarity([1.0, 2.0, 3.0], [2.0, 2.0, 3.0])
```

#### vectorDenseToSparse() vector

converts a dense to a sparse vector representation, whereas a sparse element is determined by the optional threshold argument which is exact zero (0.0) by default.

Syntax: `vectorDenseToSparse(<vector|field>)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT vectorDenseToSparse([0.5, 0.0, 0.1], 0.2)
```

---

#### vectorDequantizeInt8() vector

Dequantized byte array to float vector using min-max scaling, recovering original vector only approximately. Pass the result of `vectorQuantizeInt8()` directly (min/max read from it), or supply the bytes with explicit `min`/`max`.

Syntax: `vectorDequantizeInt8(<result>)` or `vectorDequantizeInt8(<bytes>, <min>, <max>)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT vectorDequantizeInt8(vectorQuantizeInt8([1.0, 2.0, 3.0]))
```

---

#### vectorDimension() vector

Returns the dimension of argument vector, being the length of its underlying array. A `NULL` argument returns `0` (consistent with `.size()`/`.length()`).

Syntax: `vectorDimension(<vector|field>)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT vectorDimension([1.0, 2.0, 3.0])

SELECT vectorDimension(null)
-- Returns: 0
```

---

#### vectorDotProduct() vector

Computes standard dot product (inner product) between two argument vectors.

Syntax: `vectorDotProduct(<vector|field>, <vector|field>)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT vectorDotProduct([1.0, 0.0, 1.0], [0.0, 1.0, 1.0])
```

---

### vectorHasInf() vector

Returns true if one or more elements in argument vector are positive or negative infinity. A `NULL` element is treated as NaN (not infinite) and does not trigger a true result.

Syntax: `vectorHasInf(<vector|field>)`

```
SELECT vectorHasInf([1.0, 10e400, 2.0])
```

---

### vectorHasNaN() vector

Returns true if one or more elements in argument vector are NaN (not-a-number), a special value in IEEE floating point numbers. A `NULL` element (e.g. from an invalid math op such as `sqrt(-1.0)` coerced to `NULL` inside a collection) is treated as NaN.

Syntax: `vectorHasNaN(<vector|field>)`

```
SELECT vectorHasNaN([1.0, sqrt(-1.0), 3.0])
-- Returns: true
```

---

### vectorHasNull() vector

Returns true if one or more elements in argument vector are `NULL`. Unlike `vectorHasNaN()`, this distinguishes a genuine `NULL` (missing element) from a NaN float value. Primitive array inputs can never hold a `NULL` and therefore always return false.

Syntax: `vectorHasNull(<vector|field>)`

```
SELECT vectorHasNull([1.0, sqrt(-1.0), 3.0])
-- Returns: true
```

---

### vectorHybridScore() vector

Computes weighted average of two numbers with argument weight alpha.

Syntax: `vectorHybridScore(<scalar>, <scalar>, <scalar>)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT vectorHybridScore(1.0, 2.0, 0.5)
```

---

#### vectorIsNormalized() vector

Checks if the argument vector is normalized, meaning if its length (L2 norm) is one, up to an optional threshold argument, which is taken as `0.001` by default.

Syntax: `vectorIsNormalized(<vector|field> [, <tolerance>])`

**Examples**

```
SELECT vectorIsNormalized([1.0, 0.0, 1.0], 1.0)
```

---

#### vectorL1Norm() vector

Computes L1 norm (Manhattan norm) of argument `vector`.

Syntax: `vectorL1Norm(<vector|field>)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT vectorL1Norm([1.0, 2.0, 3.0])
```

---

#### vectorL2Distance() vector

Computes the L2 distance (Euclidean distance) between two argument vectors.

Syntax: `vectorL2Distance(<vector|field>, <vector|field>)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT vectorL2Distance([1.0, 2.0, 3.0], [2.0, 2.0, 3.0])
```

---

#### vectorLInfNorm() vector

Computes L∞-norm (Maximum norm) of argument vector.

Syntax: `vectorLInfNorm(<vector|field>)`

---

**Examples**

```
SELECT vectorLInfNorm([1.0, 2.0, 3.0])
```

---

### vectorMagnitude() vector

Computes L2 norm (Euclidean norm) of argument vector. Also available as `vectorL2Norm()`, symmetric with `vectorL1Norm()` and `vectorLInfNorm()`.

Syntax: `vectorMagnitude(<vector|field>)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT vectorMagnitude([1.0, 2.0, 3.0])

SELECT vectorL2Norm([3.0, 4.0])
-- Returns: 5.0  (l2Norm is an alias of magnitude)
```

---

### vectorMax() vector

Aggregate function computing element-wise maximum of vectors.

Syntax: `vectorMax(<field>)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT vectorMax(myvector) FROM doc
```

---

### vectorMin() vector

Aggregate function computing element-wise minimum of vectors.

Syntax: `vectorMin(<field>)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT vectorMin(myvector) FROM doc
```

---

### vectorMultiScore() vector

Combines multiple scores form different vectors using a fusion method. The scores are assumed to be represented in a vector, the fusion method is selected by a string. The weights vector is only required for the weighted average method and expected to be of the same size as the score vector. Available fusion methods:

- `MAX` maximum score (ColBERT style)
- `AVG` arithmetic average of scores
- `MIN` minimum score
- `WEIGHTED` weighted average

Syntax: `vectorMultiScore(<vector>, <string> [, <vector>])`

#### Examples

```
SELECT vectorMultiScore([0.9, 0.7, 0.8], 'MAX')
```

---

### vectorNeighbors() vector

Returns the k nearest neighbors from a vector index. When an index is defined on a parent type with inheritance, you can search across all types (using the parent type name) or filter to a specific child type (using the child type name).

Syntax: `vectorNeighbors(<index-spec>, <vector|key>, <k>)`

Where:

- `<index-spec>` - Index specification in the format `'TypeName[propertyName]'`. Use the parent type to search all records, or a child type to search only that type's records.
- `<vector|key>` - Query vector (array of floats) or a key identifier to look up the vector.
- `<k>` - Number of nearest neighbors to return.

#### Examples

Basic usage:

```
SELECT vectorNeighbors('Document[embedding]', [0.1, 0.2, 0.3], 5)
```

#### Type-Specific Search with Inheritance

When a vector index is created on a parent type, sub-indexes are automatically created for child types. You can search within a specific child type by specifying the child type name:

```
-- Schema: EMBEDDING (parent) with children EMBEDDING_IMAGE, EMBEDDING_DOCUMENT
```

```
-- Index created on: EMBEDDING.vector

-- Search ONLY in EMBEDDING_IMAGE records
SELECT vectorNeighbors('EMBEDDING_IMAGE[vector]', $queryVector, 10) AS neighbors
FROM EMBEDDING_IMAGE LIMIT 1

-- Search across ALL types (parent + all children)
SELECT vectorNeighbors('EMBEDDING[vector]', $queryVector, 10) AS neighbors
FROM EMBEDDING LIMIT 1
```

---

#### vectorNormalize() vector

Normalizes vector to unit length (1.0), in the L2 norm.

Syntax: `vectorNormalize(<vector|field>)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT vectorNormalize([1.0, 2.0, 3.0])
```

---

#### vectorNormalizeScores() vector

Normalizes a vector to unit range ([0, 1]) using min-max normalization.

Syntax: `vectorNormalizeScores(<vector>)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT vectorNormalizeScores([1.0, 2.0, 3.0])
```

---

#### vectorQuantizeInt8() vector

Quantize argument vector to byte elements (8 bit per dimension) using min-max scaling. The result carries the vector's own `min` and `max`, which `vectorDequantizeInt8()` and `vectorApproxDistance()` apply. Every element must be finite: since 26.11.1 a `NaN` or an infinite value is rejected with an error, because it has no position inside a min-max band.

Syntax: `vectorQuantizeInt8(<vector|field>)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT vectorQuantizeInt8([0.1, 0.5, 0.9])
```

### vectorQuantizeBinary() vector

Quantize argument vector to binary elements (1 bit per dimension) using median threshold. The median is used (rather than a fixed value like 0) so the bits split ~50/50, maximizing the information retained per bit for arbitrarily-centered embeddings.

Syntax: `vectorQuantizeBinary(<vector|field>)`

#### Examples

```
SELECT vectorQuantizeBinary([0.1, 0.5, 0.9])
```

### vectorDequantizeBinary() vector

Reconstructs an approximate float vector from a binary-quantized result. Lossy: binary quantization keeps only the sign relative to the median, so each bit maps to `highValue` (default `1.0`) when set or `lowValue` (default `-1.0`) when clear. Accepts the result of `vectorQuantizeBinary()` directly.

Syntax: `vectorDequantizeBinary(<quantized> [, <lowValue>, <highValue>])`

#### Examples

```
SELECT vectorDequantizeBinary(vectorQuantizeBinary([0.1, 0.5, 0.9]))
-- Returns: [-1.0, 1.0, 1.0]
```

### vectorRRFScore() vector

Compute reciprocal rank fusion (RRF) for combining multiple ranks. Ranks may be passed as variadic arguments or grouped in a single array/list. Every positional numeric argument is a rank. The center constant `k` (default `60`) is set only via a trailing options map `{ k: <long> }` - a bare trailing number is always a rank, never `k`.

Syntax: `vectorRRFScore(<rank>, <rank>, ⋯ [, { k }])` or `vectorRRFScore([<ranks>], [{ k }])`

#### Examples

```
SELECT vectorRRFScore(1, 2, 4)

SELECT vectorRRFScore([1, 2, 4], { k: 100 })
```

### vectorScale() vector

Scales argument vector element-wise by argument scalar.

Syntax: `vectorScale(<vector|field>, <scalar|field>)`

#### Examples

```
SELECT vectorScale([1.0, 2.0, 3.0], 4.0)
```

---

### vectorScoreTransform() vector

Transform score to reshape score distribution. Supported transformations:

- `'LINEAR'` no transformation
- `'SIGMOID'` S-shaped curve, see Logistic function
- `'TANH'` hyperbolic tangent, S-shaped curve to (-1, 1)
- `'LOG'` / `'LN'` natural logarithm (requires a positive score); `LN` is the clearer synonym
- `'EXP'` exponential function

Syntax: `vectorScoreTransform(<scalar>, <string>)`

#### Examples

```
SELECT vectorScoreTransform(0.5, 'SIGMOID')

SELECT vectorScoreTransform(0.5, 'TANH')

SELECT vectorScoreTransform(2.5, 'LN')
```

---

### vectorSparseCreate() vector

Create sparse vector from indices and value arrays. By default the dimension is inferred form the index array. Optionally, the dimension can be set via the dimension argument.

Syntax: `vectorSparseCreate(<vector|field>, <vector|field> [, <integer>])`

#### Examples

```
SELECT vectorSparseCreate([0, 2, 5], [0.5, 0.3, 0.8], 7)
```

---

### vectorSparseDot() vector

Computes dot product (inner product) between two sparse vectors.

Syntax: `vectorSparseDot(<sparsevector>, <sparsevector>)`

#### Examples

```
SELECT vectorSparseDot(vectorDenseToSparse([1.0, 2.0, 3.0]), vectorDenseToSparse([1.0, 1.0, 1.0]))
```

---

### vectorSparseToDense() vector

Converts a sparse vector to dense vector representation.

Syntax: `vectorSparseToDense(<sparsevector>)`

#### Examples

```
SELECT vectorSparseToDense(vectorSparseCreate([0, 2], [0.5, 0.3]))
```

---

### vectorSparsity() vector

Returns a sparsity measure of an argument vector. The threshold is optional and defaults to `sqrt(eps)` for float (~3.45e-4). An optional third argument selects the measure: `'FRACTION'` (default, fraction of elements with `|x| < threshold`), `'L0'` (the L0 pseudonorm, count of elements with `|x| >= threshold`), or `'GMEAN'` (geometric mean of absolute values, `0` if any element is `0`).

Syntax: `vectorSparsity(<vector> [, <scalar> [, <string>]])`

#### Examples

```
SELECT vectorSparsity([0.01, 0.1, 0.05, 0.02], 0.06)
-- Returns: 0.75

SELECT vectorSparsity([0.0, 1.0, 2.0, 3.0])
-- Returns: 0.25  (uses the default threshold)

SELECT vectorSparsity([0.0, 1.0, 2.0, 3.0], 0.5, 'L0')
-- Returns: 3

SELECT vectorSparsity([1.0, 2.0, 4.0], 0.0, 'GMEAN')
-- Returns: 2.0
```

---

### vectorStdDev() vector

Computes the standard deviation (square-root of variance) of an argument vector.

Syntax: `vectorStdDev(<vector|field>)`

#### Examples

```
SELECT vectorStdDev([1.0, 2.0, 3.0])
```

---

### vectorSubtract() vector

Returns vector of element-wise differences of argument vectors, which are expected to be of the same size. Alternatively, when one argument is a scalar it is broadcast against the vector, preserving order: `vector - scalar` subtracts the scalar from each element, while `scalar - vector` subtracts each element from the scalar.

Syntax: `vectorSubtract(<vector|field|scalar>, <vector|field|scalar>)`

#### Examples

```
SELECT vectorSubtract([1.0, 2.0, 3.0], [2.0, 3.0, 4.0])

SELECT vectorSubtract([1.0, 2.0, 3.0], 1.0)
-- Returns: [0.0, 1.0, 2.0]

SELECT vectorSubtract(10.0, [1.0, 2.0, 3.0])
-- Returns: [9.0, 8.0, 7.0]
```

---

### vectorSum() vector

Aggregate function computing element-wise sum of vectors.

Syntax: `vectorSum(<field>)`

#### Examples

```
SELECT vectorSum(myvector) FROM doc
```

---

### vectorToString() vector

Convert argument vector to string representation in various formats. Equivalent to the `asString()` method on a vector value (e.g. `embedding.asString('PYTHON')`); both share the same formatter.

- `'COMPACT'` Single line, i.e. `"[1.0, 2.0, 3.0]"` (default)
- `'PRETTY'` Multi-line with formatting
- `'PYTHON'` Python list format
- `'MATLAB'` space-separated row vector `[1.0 2.0 3.0]`
- `'MATLAB_COLUMN'` semicolon-separated column vector `[1.0; 2.0; 3.0]`
- `'JULIA'` Julia vector literal `[1.0, 2.0, 3.0]`
- `'NUMPY'` bare comma-separated `1.0, 2.0, 3.0` (no brackets), for `numpy.fromstring(…, sep=",")`

Syntax: `vectorToString(<vector|field> [, <string>])`

**Examples**

```
SELECT vectorToString([0.5, 0.25, 0.75])

SELECT vectorToString([0.5, 0.25, 0.75], 'NUMPY')
-- Returns: 0.5, 0.25, 0.75
```

---

#### vectorVariance() vector

Computes the variance (average spread) of an argument vector.

Syntax: `vectorVariance(<vector|field>)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT vectorVariance([1.0, 2.0, 3.0])
```

---

#### version() misc

Returns the ArcadeDB version number and build as string.

Syntax: `version()`

**Examples**

```
SELECT version()
```

---

**Full-Text Function Namespace**

> The four full-text search functions live under the `fulltext.*` namespace. The original snake_case names remain available as aliases for backward compatibility.
>
> | Legacy alias | Canonical name |
> | --- | --- |
> | `search_fields()` | `fulltext.searchFields()` |
> | `search_index()` | `fulltext.searchIndex()` |
> | `search_fields_more()` | `fulltext.searchFieldsMore()` |
> | `search_index_more()` | `fulltext.searchIndexMore()` |
>
> Both forms dispatch to the same implementation. The namespaced form is recommended for new code.

#### fulltext.searchIndex() search

Searches a named full-text index using Lucene query syntax. Returns `true` for matching documents; use `$score` to rank results. See how-to/data-modeling/full-text-index.pdf for full documentation, Lucene syntax, and examples.

Syntax: `fulltext.searchIndex(indexName, query)` (alias: `search_index`)

**Examples**

```
SELECT title, $score
FROM Article
WHERE `fulltext.searchIndex`('Article[content]', '+java +spring')
ORDER BY $score DESC
```

---

#### fulltext.searchFields() search

Searches a full-text index resolved automatically from field names. Equivalent to `fulltext.searchIndex` but without needing to know the index name. See how-to/data-modeling/full-text-index.pdf for full documentation.

Syntax: `fulltext.searchFields(fieldNames, query)` (alias: `search_fields`)

**Examples**

```
SELECT title, $score
FROM Article
WHERE `fulltext.searchFields`(['title', 'body'], 'database tutorial')
ORDER BY $score DESC
```

---

### fulltext.searchIndexMore() search

Finds documents similar to one or more source documents ("More Like This"). Use `$similarity` (0.0-1.0) to rank results. See how-to/data-modeling/full-text-index.pdf for full documentation including configuration options.

Syntax:

```
fulltext.searchIndexMore(indexName, sourceRIDs)
fulltext.searchIndexMore(indexName, sourceRIDs, { <option>: <value>, ... })
```

Alias: `search_index_more`.

The optional trailing argument is a map of tuning options. Accepted keys: `minTermFreq`, `minDocFreq`, `maxDocFreqPercent`, `maxQueryTerms`, `minWordLen`, `maxWordLen`, `boostByScore`, `excludeSource`, `maxSourceDocs`. Unknown keys are rejected with a descriptive error.

#### Examples

```
SELECT title, $similarity
FROM Article
WHERE `fulltext.searchIndexMore`('Article[content]', [#10:3], { minTermFreq: 1,
boostByScore: true })
ORDER BY $similarity DESC
LIMIT 5
```

---

### fulltext.searchFieldsMore() search

Same as `fulltext.searchIndexMore` but resolves the full-text index automatically from field names. See how-to/data-modeling/full-text-index.pdf for full documentation.

Syntax:

```
fulltext.searchFieldsMore(fieldNames, sourceRIDs)
fulltext.searchFieldsMore(fieldNames, sourceRIDs, { <option>: <value>, ... })
```

Alias: `search_fields_more`. Options map keys are the same as `fulltext.searchIndexMore`.

#### Examples

```
SELECT title, $similarity
FROM Article
WHERE `fulltext.searchFieldsMore`(['content'], [#10:3], { minTermFreq: 1,
excludeSource: true })
ORDER BY $similarity DESC
```

# 14.24. Methods

SQL Methods are similar to SQL Functions but they apply to values. In Object-Oriented paradigm they are called "methods", as functions related to a type. So what's the difference between a function and a method?

This is a SQL Function:

```
SELECT FROM sum( salary ) FROM employee
```

This is a SQL method:

```
SELECT FROM salary.asJSON() FROM employee
```

As you can see the method is executed against a field/value. Methods can receive parameters, like functions. You can concatenate N operators in sequence.

`<name>.<method>(⋯)` is read as a call of the namespaced function `<name>.<method>` when `<name>` is one of the function namespaces (`ts`, `geo`, `text`, `math`, `convert`, `date`, `util`, `coll`, `map`, `agg`, `node`, `rel`, `path`, `create`), even if `<name>` is a property of the record. Do not name properties like a namespace when you call methods on them (`date.asLong()` fails with `Unknown function name 'date.asLong'`); use another property name, such as `created`. Enclosing the name in backticks works for some of them (e.g. `date`), but not for all (`map` still fails).

methods are case-insensitive.

## 14.24.1. Method Reference

### []

Execute an expression against the item. An item can be a multi-value object like a map, a list, an array or a document. For documents and maps, the item must be a string. For lists and arrays, the index is a number.

Syntax: `<value>[<expression>]`

Applies to the following types:

- document,
- map,
- list,
- array

**Examples**

Get the item with key "phone" in a map:

```
SELECT FROM Profile WHERE '+39' IN contacts[phone].left(3)
```

Get the first 10 tags of posts:

```
SELECT FROM tags[0...9] FROM Posts
```

---

### append()

Appends one or more string to the result. A `null` argument is skipped, wherever it appears, and the remaining arguments are still appended: `'x'.append(null, 'A', 'B')` returns `xAB`. A `null` receiver returns `null`.

Syntax: `<value>.append(<value>[,<value>]*)`

Applies to the following types:

- string

**Examples**

```
SELECT name.append(' ').append(surname) FROM Employee
```

---

### asBoolean()

Transforms the field into a Boolean type. If the origin type is a string, then `"true"` (or `"TRUE"`, `"True"`, ...) means `TRUE`, all other strings transform to `FALSE`. If it is a number type, then `0` means `FALSE` while all other numbers transform to `TRUE`. In case a `NULL` is passed then `NULL` is also returned.

Syntax: `<value>.asBoolean()`

Applies to the following types:

- string,
- short,
- int,
- long

**Examples**

```
SELECT FROM Users WHERE online.asBoolean() = true
```

---

#### asByte()

Transforms the field into a Byte type.

Syntax: `<value>.asByte()`

A `null` value, an empty string, or a string of only whitespace returns `null`.

Applies to the following types:

- short,
- int,
- long,
- float,
- double

---

#### asCypherRID()

Converts a record or RID into the numeric (`Long`) form returned by the native OpenCypher `id()` function, so SQL queries can produce values that round-trip with Cypher. The two components of an ArcadeDB RID (`bucketId`, `position`) are packed into a single non-negative number using 63 of the 64 bits (the sign bit is kept clear). The split between bucketId and position is controlled by the global setting `arcadedb.opencypher.idBucketBits` (default `16`, see Settings); the same value must be used to encode and decode, and the method fails with an error if a component does not fit the reserved bits.

Syntax: `<value>.asCypherRID()`

Applies to the following types:

- record,
- RID,
- string (in the `#bucketId:position` form),
- number (returned unchanged)

**Examples**

```
SELECT @rid.asCypherRID() AS ident FROM Person WHERE name = 'Alice'
```

To resolve a record back from a Cypher id, use the inverse `cypherRID()` function, e.g. `SELECT FROM`

`cypherRID(:id)`.

---

#### asDate()

Transforms the field into a Date type.

Syntax: `<value>.asDate([<format>])`

Where:

- `format`, optional, is the format of the date to convert if the value is a string

Applies to the following types:

- string,
- long

#### Examples

Returns all the records where time is before the year 2010:

```
SELECT FROM Log WHERE time.asDate() < '01-01-2010'
```

---

#### asDateTime()

Transforms the field into a Date type but parsing also the time information.

Syntax: `<value>.asDateTime([<format>])`

Where:

- `format`, optional, is the format of the date to convert if the value is a string

Applies to the following types:

- string,
- long

#### Examples

Time is stored as long type measuring milliseconds since a particular day. Returns all the records where time is before the year 2010:

```
SELECT FROM Log WHERE time.asDateTime() < '01-01-2010 00:00:00'
```

This example returns the dates stored as strings following the ISO 8601 format:

```
SELECT timeAsString.asDateTime("yyyy-MM-dd'T'HH:mm:ss'Z'") AS time FROM Log
```

---

### asDecimal()

Transforms the field into an Decimal type. Use Decimal type when treat currencies.

Syntax: `<value>.asDecimal()`

A `null` value, an empty string, or a string of only whitespace returns `null`.

Applies to the following types:

- any

#### Examples

```
SELECT salary.asDecimal() FROM Employee
```

---

### asDouble()

Transforms the field into a double type.

Syntax: `<value>.asDouble()`

A `null` value, an empty string, or a string of only whitespace returns `null`.

Applies to the following types:

- any

#### Examples

```
SELECT (ray.asDouble() > 3.14) AS bigger FROM Rays
```

---

### asFloat()

Transforms the field into a float type.

Syntax: `<value>.asFloat()`

A `null` value, an empty string, or a string of only whitespace returns `null`.

Applies to the following types:

- any

**Examples**

```
SELECT (ray.asFloat() > 3.14) AS bigger FROM Rays
```

---

### asInteger()

Transforms the field into an integer type.

Syntax: `<value>.asInteger()`

A `null` value, an empty string, or a string of only whitespace returns `null`.

Applies to the following types:

- any

Float values are rounded towards zero (truncated).

**Examples**

Converts the first 3 chars of 'value' field in an integer:

```
SELECT value.left(3).asInteger() FROM Log
```

---

### asJSON()

Returns the record(s) in JSON format. If it's executed on a result set, then the result set is completely browsed and the result set iteration exhausted (if browsed again, it will contain no records). If you need to access to the result set multiple times, transform it into a list with `asList()` and work with the list instead.

Syntax: `<value>.asJSON()`

The method takes no arguments.

Applies to the following types:

- record

**Examples**

```
CREATE VERTEX TYPE Test

INSERT INTO Test CONTENT {"attr1": "value 1", "attr2": "value 2"}

SELECT @this.asJSON() FROM Test
```

---

#### asList()

Transforms the value in a List. A collection, an array (for example a list parameter) or an iterable becomes a list of its elements. If it's a single item, a new list is created.

Syntax: `<value>.asList()`

Applies to the following types:

- any

**Examples**

```
SELECT tags.asList() FROM Friend
```

---

#### asLong()

Transforms the field into a Long type.

Syntax: `<value>.asLong()`

A `null` value, an empty string, or a string of only whitespace returns `null`.

Applies to the following types:

- any

**Examples**

```
SELECT created.asLong() FROM Log
```

---

#### asMap()

Transforms the value in a Map where even items are the keys and odd items are values.

Syntax: `<value>.asMap()`

Applies to the following types:

- collections

**Examples**

```
SELECT tags.asMap() FROM Friend
```

---

**asRecord()**

Transforms the field into the linked record type

Syntax: `<value>.asRecord()`

Applies to the following types:

- link
- string

**Examples**

Transform link to a record:

```
SELECT "#1:0".asRecord()
```

---

**asRID()**

Transforms the field into an RID link type.

Syntax: `<value>.asRID()`

Applies to the following types:

- string

**Examples**

Transform string holding an RID to a link:

```
SELECT "#1:0".asRID()
```

---

### asSet()

Transforms the value in a Set. If it's a single item, a new set is created. Sets do not allow duplicates.

Syntax: `<value>.asSet()`

Applies to the following types:

- any

#### Examples

```
SELECT tags.asSet() FROM Friend
```

---

### asShort()

Transforms the field into a short type.

Syntax: `<value>.asShort()`

A `null` value, an empty string, or a string of only whitespace returns `null`.

Applies to the following types:

- any

Float values are rounded towards zero (truncated).

#### Examples

Converts the first 3 chars of 'value' field in a short integer:

```
SELECT value.left(3).asShort() FROM Log
```

---

### asString()

Transforms the field into a string type.

For numeric vectors (a `float[]`/`double[]` field, or an array/list of numbers) it produces the same output as `vector.toString()`. An optional format argument selects the layout: `'COMPACT'` (default), `'PRETTY'`, `'PYTHON'`, `'MATLAB'` (space-separated row), `'MATLAB_COLUMN'` (semicolon-separated column), `'JULIA'`, or `'NUMPY'` (bare comma-separated for `numpy.fromstring`). Non-vector values are returned in their natural string form. A non-numeric array is rendered as the list of its elements (`['a','b']`), exactly like a list. The inverse (string to vector) is `asVector()`.

Syntax: `<value>.asString([<format>])`

Applies to the following types:

- any

**Examples**

Get all the salaries with decimals:

```
SELECT (salary.asString().indexof('.') > -1) AS hasDecimals FROM Employee
```

Render an embedding vector field in different formats:

```
SELECT embedding.asString() FROM docs
-- e.g. [0.5, 0.25, 0.75]

SELECT embedding.asString('PYTHON') FROM docs

SELECT embedding.asString('NUMPY') FROM docs
-- e.g. 0.5, 0.25, 0.75   (no brackets, for numpy.fromstring)
```

---

### asVector()

Parses a value into a vector (`float[]`). This is the inverse of `asString()` for vectors and accepts every format `asString()` / `vector.toString()` can emit: bracketed or bare, comma-separated (COMPACT/PYTHON/JULIA/NUMPY), space-separated (MATLAB), semicolon-separated (MATLAB_COLUMN) and multi-line (PRETTY). It also accepts an array/list of numbers (normalized to `float[]`) and a single number (wrapped into a one-element vector).

Syntax: `<value>.asVector()`

Applies to the following types:

- string
- array / list of numbers
- number

**Examples**

```
SELECT '[1.0, 2.0, 3.0]'.asVector()
-- Returns: [1.0, 2.0, 3.0]

SELECT '[1.0 2.0 3.0]'.asVector()
-- Returns: [1.0, 2.0, 3.0]   (MATLAB form)

SELECT '1.0, 2.0, 3.0'.asVector()
-- Returns: [1.0, 2.0, 3.0]   (NUMPY form)
```

```
-- Round-trips with asString():
SELECT embedding.asString('MATLAB').asVector() FROM docs
```

---

### asSparse()

Converts a dense vector value into a sparse vector, dropping elements whose absolute value is at or below an optional threshold (default `0.0`, i.e. drops exact zeros). The method form of `vector.denseToSparse()`, consistent with `asString()` / `asVector()`.

Syntax: `<value>.asSparse([<threshold>])`

Applies to the following types:

- array / list of numbers

#### Examples

```
SELECT [0.5, 0.0, 0.3].asSparse()
-- sparse vector with indices [0, 2] and values [0.5, 0.3]

SELECT embedding.asSparse(0.01) FROM docs
-- drops values with |value| <= 0.01
```

---

### capitalize()

Returns a string where each word (group of characters bounded by whitespace) is transformed such that its first character (if it is a letter) is converted to upper case, and the remaining characters (that are letters) are converted to lower case.

Syntax: `<value>.capitalize()`

Applies to the following types:

- string

#### Examples

Return a capitalized string:

```
SELECT 'hi there'.capitalize()
```

---

### charAt()

Returns the character of the string contained in the position 'position'. 'position' starts from 0 to string length.

Syntax: `<value>.charAt(<position>)`

Applies to the following types:

- string

#### Examples

Get the first character of the users' name:

```
SELECT FROM User WHERE name.charAt( 0 ) = 'L'
```

---

### convert()

Convert a value to another type.

Syntax: `<value>.convert(<type>)`

Applies to the following types:

- any

#### Examples

```
SELECT dob.convert( 'date' ) FROM User
```

---

### exclude()

Excludes some properties in the resulting document.

Syntax: `<value>.exclude(<field-name>[,]*)`

Applies to the following types:

- document record

#### Examples

```
SELECT expand( @this.exclude( 'password' ) ) FROM User
```

You can specify a wildcard as ending character to exclude all the fields that start with a certain

string. Example to exclude all the outgoing and incoming edges:

```
SELECT expand( @this.exclude( 'out_*', 'in_*' ) ) FROM V
```

This function can be used to remove internal properties like `@rid`, `@type`, etc.

```
SELECT @this.exclude('@*') FROM doc
```

---

### field()

Returns a sub-property from an embedded document property. This method is useful for dynamic property names of types.

Syntax: `<property>.field(<string>)`

Applies to the following types:

- embedded document

#### Examples

Returns a field named `test` from the embedded document property `embdoc`:

```
SELECT embdoc.field('test') FROM doc
```

---

### first()

Returns the first item of a collection (list, set, array, or the values of a map), or `null` when the collection is empty. For scalar types this method is an identity. This is the method form of the `first()` SQL function.

Syntax: `<value>.first()`

Applies to the following types:

- collection

#### Examples

```
SELECT 'a,b,c'.split(',').first()
SELECT tags.first() FROM Post
```

---

### format() [Method]

Returns the value formatted using the common "printf" syntax. For the complete reference goto Java Formatter JavaDoc.

Syntax: `<value>.format(<format>)`

Applies to the following types:

- any

Number formatting (`%f`, `%e`, `%d`, etc.) is always locale-independent (e.g. `.` as decimal separator), regardless of the server's configured locale.

#### Examples

Formats salaries as number with 11 digits filling with 0 at left:

```
SELECT salary.format("%-011d") FROM Employee
```

---

### hash()

Returns the hash of the field. Supports all the algorithms available in the JVM.

Syntax: `<value>.hash([<algorithm>])`

Applies to the following types:

- string

#### Examples

Get the SHA-512 of the field "password" in the type User:

```
SELECT password.hash('SHA-512') FROM User
```

---

### ifempty()

Return argument if empty results from value/field/expression, otherwise return result.

Syntax: `<value/field/expression>.ifempty(<value>)`

Applies to the following types:

- string
- list

**Examples**

```
SELECT "".ifempty("Empty")
```

---

### ifnull() [Method]

Return argument if null results from value/field/expression, otherwise return result.

Syntax: `<value/field/expression>.ifnull(<value>)`

Applies to the following types:

- any

**Examples**

```
SELECT name.ifnull("John Doe") FROM names
```

---

### include()

Include only some properties in the resulting document.

Syntax: `<value>.include(<value>[,]*)`

Applies to the following types:

- document record

**Examples**

```
SELECT expand( @this.include('name') ) FROM User
```

You can specify a wildcard as ending character to inclide all the fields that start with a certain string. Example to include all the fields that starts with `amount`:

```
SELECT expand( @this.include('amount*') ) FROM V
```

---

### indexOf()

Returns the position of the 'string-to-search' inside the value. It returns -1 if no occurrences are found. 'begin-position' is the optional position where to start, otherwise the beginning of the string is taken (=0).

Syntax: `<value>.indexOf(<string-to-search> [,<begin-position>])`

Applies to the following types:

- string

**Examples**

Returns all the UK numbers:

```
SELECT FROM Contact WHERE phone.indexOf('+44') > -1
```

---

### intersectsWith()

Returns Boolean answering if argument shape intersects with shape instance.

Syntax:
`<point|circle|rectangle|linestring|polygon>.intersectsWith(<point|circle|rectangle|linestring|polygon>)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT linestring( [ [10,10], [20,10], [20,20], [10,20], [10,10] ] ).intersectsWith(
rectangle(10,10,20,20) ) AS collision
```

---

### isWithin()

Returns Boolean answering if argument shape is fully inside shape instance.

Syntax:
`<point|circle|rectangle|linestring|polygon>.isWithin(<point|circle|rectangle|linestring|polygon>)`

**Examples**

```
SELECT point(11,11).isWithin( circle(10,10,10) ) AS inside
```

---

### javaType()

Returns the corresponding Java Type.

Syntax: `<value>.javaType()`

Applies to the following types:

- any

**Examples**

Prints the Java type used to store dates:

```
SELECT created.javaType() FROM Events
```

---

### join()

Returns all elements of a collection converted to a string and concatenated, with strings separated by the argument string that has the default value `','`. A scalar receiver is returned as its string form.

Syntax: `<value>.join([<separator>])`

Applies to the following types:

- lists
- sets
- arrays (for example a list parameter)

**Examples**

```
SELECT [1,2,3].join('|')
SELECT 'a,b,c'.split(',').join('-')
```

---

### keys()

Returns the map's keys as a separate set. Useful to use in conjunction with IN, CONTAINS and CONTAINSALL operators.

Syntax: `<value>.keys()`

Applies to the following types:

- maps
- documents

**Examples**

```
SELECT FROM Actor WHERE 'Luke' IN attributes.keys()
```

---

### last()

Returns the last item of a collection (list, set, array, or the values of a map), or `null` when the collection is empty. For scalar types this method is an identity. This is the method form of the `last()` SQL function.

Syntax: `<value>.last()`

Applies to the following types:

- collection

#### Examples

```
SELECT 'a,b,c'.split(',').last()
SELECT tags.last() FROM Post
```

---

### lastIndexOf()

Returns the position of the 'string-to-search' inside the value starting from from the end. It returns -1 if no occurrences are found. 'begin-position' is the optional position where to start, otherwise the end of the string is taken (=0).

Syntax: `<value>.lastIndexOf(<string-to-search> [,<begin-position>])`

Applies to the following types:

- string

```
SELECT 'Hello Albert'.lastIndexOf('l')
```

---

### left()

Returns a substring of the original cutting from the begin and getting 'len' characters.

Syntax: `<value>.left(<length>)`

Applies to the following types:

- string

#### Examples

```
SELECT FROM Actors WHERE name.left( 4 ) = 'Luke'
```

---

### length()

Returns the string length of the input. If `null`, 0 will be returned.

Syntax: `<value>.length()`

Applies to the following types:

- any

This method first converts its input to a string and then returns the string's length. For obtaining a collection's lengths use the size() method.

#### Examples

```
SELECT FROM Providers WHERE name.length() > 0
```

---

### normalize()

Unicode normalization form can be NDF, NFD, NFKC, NFKD, the default is NDF. Pattern-matching, if not defined is the regular expression `"\p{InCombiningDiacriticalMarks}+"`. For more information look at Unicode Standard.

Syntax: `<value>.normalize( [<form>] [,<pattern-matching>] )`

Applies to the following types:

- string

#### Examples

```
SELECT FROM V WHERE name.normalize() AND name.normalize('NFD')
```

---

### precision()

Adapts the returned date or time format to the argument target precision.

Syntax: `<value>.precision('<string>')`

The admissible argument values are given here.

Applies to the following types:

- datetime

- date

**Examples**

```
SELECT sysdate().precision('millisecond')
```

---

### prefix()

Prefixes a string to another one. A `null` base value results in a `null`.

Syntax: `<value>.prefix('<string>')`

Applies to the following types:

- string

**Examples**

```
SELECT name.prefix('Mr. ') FROM Profile
```

---

### remove()

Removes the first occurrence of the passed items.

Syntax: `<value>.remove(<item>*)`

Applies to the following types:

- collection

**Examples**

```
SELECT [1,2,3,1].remove(1)
```

```
SELECT out().in().remove( @this ) FROM V
```

A `null` argument is honoured wherever it appears in the list: it removes a `null` element from the collection, and never discards the other arguments.

---

### removeAll()

Removes all the occurrences of the passed items.

Syntax: `<value>.removeAll(<item>*)`

Applies to the following types:

- collection

**Examples**

```
SELECT [1,2,3,1].removeAll(1)
```

```
SELECT out().in().removeAll( @this ) FROM V
```

A `null` argument is honoured wherever it appears in the list: it removes every `null` element from the collection, and never discards the other arguments.

---

**replace()**

Replace a string with another one.

Syntax: `<value>.replace(<to-find>, <to-replace>)`

Applies to the following types:

- string

**Examples**

```
SELECT name.replace('Mr.', 'Ms.') FROM User
```

---

**right()**

Returns a substring of the original cutting from the end of the string 'length' characters.

Syntax: `<value>.right(<length>)`

Applies to the following types:

- string

**Examples**

Returns all the vertices where the name ends by "ke".

```
SELECT FROM V WHERE name.right( 2 ) = 'ke'
```

### size()

Returns the size of the collection.

Syntax: `<value>.size()`

Applies to the following types:

- collection

#### Examples

Returns all the items in a tree with children:

```
SELECT FROM TreeItem WHERE children.size() > 0
```

### sort()

Returns a sorted copy of the collection as a list. The direction is controlled by a boolean argument, which sets ascending direction for a `true` value (default), and descending for `false`.

Only list of a single type can be sorted.

For scalar types this method is an identity.

Syntax: `<value>.sort([<dir>])`

Applies to the following types:

- lists
- sets
- arrays (for example a list parameter)

#### Examples

Sort inline lists:

```
SELECT [4,1,9,23].sort()
SELECT ["a","Y","b","9"].sort(false)
SELECT 'c,a,b'.split(',').sort()
```

### split()

Returns a list from a string separated by the provided delimiter. The delimiter is matched literally, not as a regular expression. The result is a list, so every collection method can be chained on it: `'a,b'.split(',').join('-')`, `.sort()`, `.first()`, `.last()`, `.size()`.

Syntax: `<value>.split(<string>)`

Applies to the following types:

- string

#### Examples

Returns string of comma separated values as list

```
SELECT 'a,b,c,d,e'.split(',')
```

---

### subString()

Returns a substring of the original cutting from 'begin' index up to 'end' index (not included).

Syntax: `<value>.subString(<begin> [,<end>] )`

Applies to the following types:

- string

#### Examples

Get all the items where the name begins with an "L":

```
SELECT FROM StockItems WHERE name.substring( 0, 1 ) = 'L'
```

Substring of `ArcadeDB`

```
SELECT "ArcadeDB".substring(0,6)
```

returns `Arcade`

---

### transform()

Returns the underlying collection to which one or more methods (passed as string arguments) are applied element-wise.

Syntax: `<value>.transform(<string>[,<string>]*)`

Applies to the following types:

- collection

The argument methods cannot take arguments themselves.

**Examples**

```
SELECT FROM Car WHERE options.transform( 'trim', 'toLowercase' ) CONTAINSALL ['a/c',
'airbags']
```

---

### trim()

Returns the original string removing white spaces from the begin and the end.

Syntax: `<value>.trim()`

Applies to the following types:

- string

**Examples**

```
SELECT name.trim() FROM Actors
```

---

### trimPrefix()

Returns the original string removing argument from the front, if exists.

Syntax: `<value>.trimPrefix(<value>)`

Applies to the following types:

- string

**Examples**

```
SELECT name.trimPrefix("Mr. ") FROM Actors
```

---

### trimSuffix()

Returns the original string removing argument from the end, if exists.

Syntax: `<value>.trimSuffix(<value>)`

Applies to the following types:

- string

#### Examples

```
SELECT name.trimSuffix(";") FROM Actors
```

---

### toLowerCase()

Returns the string in lower case.

Syntax: `<value>.toLowerCase()`

Applies to the following types:

- string

#### Examples

```
SELECT name.toLowerCase() FROM Actors
```

---

### toUpperCase()

Returns the string in upper case.

Syntax: `<value>.toUpperCase()`

Applies to the following types:

- string

#### Examples

```
SELECT name.toUpperCase() FROM Actors
```

---

### type()

Returns the value's ArcadeDB type as string. The potential return values are listed as "**SQL type**" here.

The returned strings are all capitals.

Syntax: `<value>.type()`

Applies to the following types:

- any

#### Examples

Prints the type used to store dates:

```
SELECT created.type() FROM Events
```

---

### values()

Returns the map's values as a separate collection. Useful to use in conjunction with IN, CONTAINS and CONTAINSALL operators.

Syntax: `<value>.values()`

Applies to the following types:

- maps
- documents
- query result rows (a sub-query row, a `LET` variable)

`keys()` and `values()` are an index-aligned pair: the n-th value belongs to the n-th key. For a document or a result row the values are those of the properties `keys()` lists, without the record metadata (`@cat`, `@type`, `@rid`, and `@in` and `@out` of an edge). A row that overrides a property of its record answers the row's value in that position (*since v26.11.1*; before, a result row also returned the metadata and the record's value).

#### Examples

```
SELECT FROM Clients WHERE attributes.values() CONTAINSALL (@this IS NOT NULL)
```

A property named like a function namespace (`map`, `geo`, `math`, ...) must be back-ticked to be read as a property: `` `map`.values() ``. Unquoted, `map.values()` calls the `map.*` function.

---

# 14.25. Triggers

ArcadeDB supports database triggers that automatically execute SQL statements, JavaScript code, or Java classes in response to record events. Triggers enable you to implement business logic, data validation, audit trails, and automated workflows directly in your database.

## 14.25.1. Overview

A **trigger** is a named database object that automatically executes when specific events occur on records of a particular type. Triggers can execute SQL statements, JavaScript code, or Java classes, giving you flexibility in how you implement your logic.

### Key Features

- **Event-driven**: Triggers fire automatically on CREATE, READ, UPDATE, or DELETE operations
- **Timing control**: Execute BEFORE or AFTER the event
- **Multi-language**: Choose between SQL statements, JavaScript code, or Java classes
- **High performance**: Java class triggers offer maximum performance with compiled code
- **Persistent**: Triggers are stored in the schema and survive database restarts
- **Type-specific**: Each trigger applies to a specific document/vertex/edge type

## 14.25.2. Trigger Events

Triggers can respond to eight different combinations of timing and events:

| Event | Description |
|---|---|
| `BEFORE CREATE` | Before a new record is created |
| `AFTER CREATE` | After a new record is created |
| `BEFORE READ` | Before a record is read from database |
| `AFTER READ` | After a record is read from database |
| `BEFORE UPDATE` | Before a record is modified |
| `AFTER UPDATE` | After a record is modified |
| `BEFORE DELETE` | Before a record is deleted |
| `AFTER DELETE` | After a record is deleted |

Re-pointing an edge (`UPDATE … SET @in = …` / `@out = …`, or `set("@in", …)` from Java) replaces its record with a new one. `AFTER CREATE` fires for the replacement and `AFTER DELETE` for the edge it replaces. `BEFORE DELETE` does not fire, because a veto there would leave both edges in place. *(Since v26.11.1: only the replacement's `AFTER CREATE` fired, so a listener keeping derived state, such as a graph analytical view, kept the old edge too.)*

### 14.25.3. SQL Triggers

SQL triggers execute SQL statements. They have access to the current record through context variables.

#### Context Variables

- `$record` - The current record being operated on. Supports property and attribute navigation, e.g. `$record.name` or `$record.@rid`
- `$oldRecord` - The original record (for UPDATE operations), not set otherwise
- `$rid` - For `BEFORE READ` only: the identity of the record about to be read. `BEFORE READ` fires before the record exists, so `$record` is not set for this timing - see BEFORE READ triggers below

#### Return Value

A SQL trigger body's result decides whether the operation continues, for `BEFORE` triggers only. A body that evaluates to a single scalar `false` - one row with one property, holding `false` - aborts the operation, silently: no exception is thrown, the record is simply not created/updated/deleted (or, for `BEFORE READ`, not read). `SELECT false` and `SELECT (<condition>) AS ok` both have this shape when `<condition>` evaluates to `false`.

Any other result - multiple rows, multiple columns, no rows, or a `DML` statement (`INSERT`/`UPDATE`/`DELETE`) - is not treated as a veto and the operation proceeds, even though the body still runs. This keeps the contract unambiguous: only a body that looks like a single yes/no answer can say no.

#### BEFORE READ triggers

`BEFORE READ` fires from inside the read itself, before the record has been materialized, so the body cannot see `$record` - only `$rid`, the identity of the record about to be read:

```
CREATE TRIGGER audit_read BEFORE READ ON TYPE Document
EXECUTE SQL 'SELECT ($rid IS NOT NULL) AS ok';
```

A trigger that needs the record's content wants `AFTER READ` instead, which does receive `$record`.

The body of `EXECUTE SQL` and `EXECUTE JAVASCRIPT` is a quoted string, and a literal line break inside a quoted string is not allowed. Write the body on one line, or use `\n` for a line break (as the examples below do for multi-line JavaScript bodies).

#### Example: Audit Trail

Create an audit log that tracks all user creations:

```
-- Create the audit log type
CREATE DOCUMENT TYPE AuditLog;

-- Create trigger to log user creations
```

```
CREATE TRIGGER user_audit AFTER CREATE ON TYPE User
EXECUTE SQL 'INSERT INTO AuditLog SET action = "user_created", userName =
$record.name, timestamp = sysdate()';
```

Now every time a User is created, an entry is automatically added to the AuditLog:

```
-- Create a user
INSERT INTO User SET name = 'Alice', email = 'alice@example.com';

-- Check the audit log
SELECT * FROM AuditLog;
-- Returns: {action: "user_created", userName: "Alice", timestamp: ...}
```

**Example: Auto-increment Counter**

Automatically set a sequence number on new documents:

```
-- Create a counter type
CREATE DOCUMENT TYPE Counter;
INSERT INTO Counter SET name = 'order_sequence', value = 1000;

-- Create trigger to auto-increment order numbers
CREATE TRIGGER order_number BEFORE CREATE ON TYPE Order
EXECUTE SQL 'UPDATE Counter SET value = value + 1 WHERE name = "order_sequence";
UPDATE $record SET orderNumber = (SELECT value FROM Counter WHERE name =
"order_sequence")';
```

**Example: Cascade Updates**

Update related records when the parent changes:

```
-- Update all orders when customer email changes
CREATE TRIGGER customer_email_update AFTER UPDATE ON TYPE Customer
EXECUTE SQL 'UPDATE Order SET customerEmail = $record.email WHERE customerId =
$record.@rid';
```

**Example: Data Validation**

Enforce business rules using BEFORE triggers. The body evaluates a condition against `$record` and projects it as a single named column; when it evaluates to `false`, the operation is silently aborted (see Return Value above):

```
-- Ensure product prices are positive
CREATE TRIGGER validate_price BEFORE CREATE ON TYPE Product
EXECUTE SQL 'SELECT ($record.price > 0) AS ok';
```

```
-- Rejected: nothing is inserted, no exception is thrown
INSERT INTO Product SET name = 'Bad', price = -5;

-- Accepted
INSERT INTO Product SET name = 'Good', price = 5;
```

### 14.25.4. JavaScript Triggers

JavaScript triggers offer more flexibility and can implement complex logic with conditional statements, loops, and calculations.

Since v26.11.1 terminating the statement that fired a JavaScript trigger (HTTP `terminate query`, Cypher `TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS` or Studio) interrupts the trigger's script too, through GraalVM, so a trigger caught in an endless loop does not hold the statement forever.

#### Context Variables

- `record` or `$record` - The current record being operated on
- `oldRecord` or `$oldRecord` - The original record (for UPDATE operations), null otherwise
- `database` - The database instance

#### Return Value

JavaScript triggers can return `false` to abort the operation (for BEFORE triggers only).

#### Example: Data Validation

Validate email format before creating users:

```
CREATE TRIGGER validate_email BEFORE CREATE ON TYPE User
EXECUTE JAVASCRIPT 'if (!record.email || !record.email.includes("@")) {\nthrow new
Error("Invalid email address");\n}';
```

#### Example: Auto-populate Fields

Automatically set timestamps and computed fields:

```
CREATE TRIGGER user_defaults BEFORE CREATE ON TYPE User
EXECUTE JAVASCRIPT '// Set creation timestamp\nrecord.createdAt = new Date();\n//
Generate username from email if not provided\nif (!record.username && record.email)
{\nrecord.username = record.email.split("@")[0];\n}\n// Set default role\nif
(!record.role) {\nrecord.role = "user";\n}';
```

#### Example: Complex Business Logic

Implement discount rules based on order total:

```
CREATE TRIGGER calculate_discount BEFORE CREATE ON TYPE Order
EXECUTE JAVASCRIPT 'var total = record.total || 0;\nvar discount = 0;\n// Apply
discount based on order total\nif (total > 1000) {\ndiscount = 0.15;  // 15%
discount\n} else if (total > 500) {\ndiscount = 0.10;  // 10% discount\n} else if
(total > 100) {\ndiscount = 0.05;  // 5% discount\n}\nrecord.discountPercent =
discount * 100;\nrecord.discountAmount = total * discount;\nrecord.finalTotal = total
- (total * discount);';
```

**Example: Conditional Abort**

Prevent operations based on business rules:

```
CREATE TRIGGER prevent_weekend_orders BEFORE CREATE ON TYPE Order
EXECUTE JAVASCRIPT 'var day = new Date().getDay();\nif (day === 0 || day === 6) {
\nthrow new Error("Orders cannot be placed on weekends");\n}';
```

**Example: Audit with Details**

Create detailed audit logs with JavaScript:

```
CREATE TRIGGER audit_update AFTER UPDATE ON TYPE Product
EXECUTE JAVASCRIPT 'database.command("sql",\n"INSERT INTO AuditLog SET action = ?,
productId = ?, productName = ?, timestamp = sysdate()",\n"product_updated",
\nrecord["@rid"],\nrecord.name\n);';
```

### 14.25.5. Java Triggers

Java triggers offer maximum performance by executing compiled Java code. They require implementing the `JavaTrigger` interface and must be available in the classpath.

**Creating a Java Trigger Class**

First, create a Java class that implements the `com.arcadedb.schema.trigger.JavaTrigger` interface:

```
package com.example.triggers;

import com.arcadedb.database.Database;
import com.arcadedb.database.Document;
import com.arcadedb.database.Record;
import com.arcadedb.schema.trigger.JavaTrigger;

public class EmailValidationTrigger implements JavaTrigger {

  @Override
  public boolean execute(Database database, Record record, Record oldRecord) throws
Exception {
```

```
    if (record instanceof Document) {
      Document doc = (Document) record;
      String email = doc.getString("email");

      if (email == null || !email.contains("@")) {
        throw new IllegalArgumentException("Invalid email address");
      }
    }
    return true;  // Continue with the operation
  }
}
```

#### JavaTrigger Interface

```
public interface JavaTrigger {
  /**
   * Execute the trigger logic.
   *
   * @param database  The database instance
   * @param record    The current record being operated on
   * @param oldRecord The original record (for UPDATE operations), null otherwise
   * @return true to continue the operation, false to abort (BEFORE triggers only)
   * @throws Exception to abort the operation with an error message
   */
  boolean execute(Database database, Record record, Record oldRecord) throws
Exception;
}
```

#### Registering Java Triggers

Once your class is compiled and in the classpath, register it using SQL:

```
CREATE TRIGGER validate_email BEFORE CREATE ON TYPE User
EXECUTE JAVA 'com.example.triggers.EmailValidationTrigger';
```

#### Example: Data Validation

Validate complex business rules with full Java capabilities:

```
package com.example.triggers;

import com.arcadedb.database.Database;
import com.arcadedb.database.Document;
import com.arcadedb.database.Record;
import com.arcadedb.schema.trigger.JavaTrigger;
import java.math.BigDecimal;
```

```
public class PriceValidationTrigger implements JavaTrigger {

  private static final BigDecimal MIN_PRICE = new BigDecimal("0.01");
  private static final BigDecimal MAX_PRICE = new BigDecimal("999999.99");

  @Override
  public boolean execute(Database database, Record record, Record oldRecord) throws
Exception {
    if (record instanceof Document) {
      Document doc = (Document) record;
      BigDecimal price = doc.get("price");

      if (price == null) {
        throw new IllegalArgumentException("Price is required");
      }

      if (price.compareTo(MIN_PRICE) < 0) {
        throw new IllegalArgumentException("Price must be at least " + MIN_PRICE);
      }

      if (price.compareTo(MAX_PRICE) > 0) {
        throw new IllegalArgumentException("Price cannot exceed " + MAX_PRICE);
      }
    }
    return true;
  }
}
```

**Example: Database Queries**

Execute queries within the trigger:

```
package com.example.triggers;

import com.arcadedb.database.Database;
import com.arcadedb.database.Document;
import com.arcadedb.database.Record;
import com.arcadedb.query.sql.executor.ResultSet;
import com.arcadedb.schema.trigger.JavaTrigger;

public class StockCheckTrigger implements JavaTrigger {

  @Override
  public boolean execute(Database database, Record record, Record oldRecord) throws
Exception {
    if (record instanceof Document) {
      Document doc = (Document) record;
      String productId = doc.getString("productId");
      Integer quantity = doc.getInteger("quantity");
```

```
      ResultSet result = database.query("sql",
          "SELECT stock FROM Product WHERE @rid = ?", productId);

      if (result.hasNext()) {
        Document product = result.next().toElement().asDocument();
        Integer stock = product.getInteger("stock");

        if (stock < quantity) {
          throw new IllegalStateException(
              "Insufficient stock. Available: " + stock + ", Requested: " + quantity);
        }
      }
    }
    return true;
  }
}
```

**Java Trigger Advantages**

1. **Performance**: Compiled code executes faster than interpreted JavaScript
2. **Type Safety**: Compile-time type checking prevents runtime errors
3. **Full Java Ecosystem**: Access to all Java libraries and frameworks
4. **IDE Support**: Code completion, refactoring, and debugging
5. **Testability**: Unit test your triggers like any Java class
6. **Reusability**: Share trigger code across projects

**Java Trigger Considerations**

1. **Classpath**: Trigger classes must be in the ArcadeDB classpath at runtime
2. **Deployment**: Requires redeployment when trigger logic changes
3. **Error Handling**: Exceptions abort the operation and rollback the transaction
4. **Thread Safety**: Trigger instances may be reused across threads; ensure thread-safety
5. **No State**: Avoid instance variables; triggers should be stateless

## 14.25.6. Use Cases

**1. Audit Trails**

Track who changed what and when:

```
CREATE TRIGGER audit_all AFTER UPDATE ON TYPE ImportantData
EXECUTE SQL 'INSERT INTO AuditLog SET tableName = "ImportantData", recordId =
$record.@rid, modifiedAt = sysdate()';
```

#### 2. Data Integrity

Ensure referential integrity and business rules:

```
CREATE TRIGGER check_inventory BEFORE CREATE ON TYPE OrderItem
EXECUTE JAVASCRIPT 'var result = database.query("sql",\n"SELECT stock FROM Product
WHERE @rid = ?",\nrecord.productId\n);\nif (result.hasNext()) {\nvar product =
result.next();\nif (product.stock < record.quantity) {\nthrow new Error("Insufficient
stock");\n}\n}';
```

#### 3. Denormalization

Maintain computed or cached values:

```
CREATE TRIGGER update_order_total AFTER CREATE ON TYPE OrderItem
EXECUTE SQL 'UPDATE Order SET totalAmount = (SELECT sum(price * quantity) FROM
OrderItem WHERE orderId = $record.orderId) WHERE @rid = $record.orderId';
```

#### 4. Notifications

Send alerts or trigger external processes:

```
CREATE TRIGGER low_stock_alert AFTER UPDATE ON TYPE Product
EXECUTE JAVASCRIPT 'if (record.stock < 10) {\ndatabase.command("sql",\n"INSERT INTO
Notification SET type = ?, productId = ?, message = ?",\n"low_stock",\n
record["@rid"],\n"Product stock low: " + record.stock\n);\n}';
```

#### 5. Workflow Automation

Automatically progress through workflow states:

```
CREATE TRIGGER order_workflow AFTER UPDATE ON TYPE Order
EXECUTE JAVASCRIPT '// Auto-approve small orders\nif (record.status === "pending" &&
record.total < 100) {\nrecord.status = "approved";\nrecord.approvedAt = new Date();
\n}';
```

### 14.25.7. Performance Considerations

#### Benchmark Results

Performance tests measuring trigger execution overhead on document creation with identical operations (100,000 iterations, Java 21, macOS). All triggers perform the same operation: `INSERT INTO AuditLog SET triggered = true`.

| Trigger Type | Avg Time (µs) | Overhead (µs) | Overhead (%) |
|---|---|---|---|
| No Trigger (Baseline) | 95 | — | — |
| **Java Trigger** | **147** | **+52** | **+54.7%** |
| SQL Trigger | 150 | +55 | +57.9% |
| JavaScript Trigger | 187 | +92 | +96.8% |

**Key Findings:**

1. **Java and SQL triggers have nearly identical performance**: Only 2% difference (147 vs 150 µs), both execute compiled code paths efficiently.
2. **JavaScript triggers are ~27% slower**: GraalVM JavaScript execution adds noticeable overhead compared to native execution.
3. **All triggers add overhead**: Expect ~50-95% overhead depending on trigger type, which is acceptable for most use cases.
4. **Trigger overhead is predictable**: The performance impact is consistent and can be factored into capacity planning.

**Performance Recommendations**

- **Minimize Work**: Keep trigger code as lightweight as possible
- **Choose the Right Type**:
  - Use **Java triggers** when you need type safety, IDE support, and debugging capabilities
  - Use **SQL triggers** for database operations - performance is nearly identical to Java
  - Use **JavaScript triggers** for dynamic logic where ~30% slower performance is acceptable
- **Avoid Complex Queries**: Heavy queries in triggers can slow down operations
- **Consider Batch Operations**: Triggers fire for each record, which can be expensive in bulk operations
- **Monitor Impact**: Test performance with realistic data volumes
- **Profile Your Workload**: Measure actual impact in your specific use case

**Internal Optimizations**

ArcadeDB optimizes JavaScript trigger performance through engine pooling:

- **Shared GraalVM Engine**: All JavaScript triggers share a single GraalVM Polyglot Engine instance across the entire database process, reducing memory overhead and initialization time
- **Lightweight Contexts**: Each trigger creates a lightweight execution context that reuses the shared engine
- **Lazy Initialization**: Engine and context creation is deferred until the trigger first executes
- **Automatic Resource Management**: Contexts are properly closed when triggers are removed, while the shared engine persists for the lifetime of the database process

This architecture ensures that creating multiple JavaScript triggers does not linearly increase memory consumption or initialization overhead.

**When to Use Each Type**

**Java Triggers** - Best for:

- Complex validation requiring type safety and compile-time checks
- Integration with existing Java libraries
- Code that benefits from IDE support and refactoring
- Unit testing requirements
- Team prefers strongly-typed languages

**SQL Triggers** - Best for:

- Simple database operations (audit logs, denormalization)
- Prototyping and development (no compilation step)
- Deployment simplicity (embedded in schema)
- Operations that are primarily SQL-based
- **Performance-critical paths** (nearly identical performance to Java)

**JavaScript Triggers** - Best for:

- Moderate complexity business logic
- Rapid development and iteration
- Dynamic validation rules that change frequently
- Scenarios where scripting flexibility outweighs performance
- Teams comfortable with JavaScript

## 14.25.8. Best Practices

**1. Keep Triggers Simple**

Triggers execute synchronously and can impact performance. Keep logic simple and fast:

```
-- Good: Simple, fast operation
CREATE TRIGGER set_timestamp BEFORE CREATE ON TYPE Document
EXECUTE JAVASCRIPT 'record.createdAt = new Date();';

-- Avoid: Complex calculations that could be done elsewhere
```

**2. Use Meaningful Names**

Name triggers clearly to indicate their purpose:

```
-- Good naming
CREATE TRIGGER audit_user_creation AFTER CREATE ON TYPE User ...
CREATE TRIGGER validate_email BEFORE CREATE ON TYPE User ...

-- Poor naming
CREATE TRIGGER trigger1 AFTER CREATE ON TYPE User ...
```

#### 3. Handle Errors Gracefully

In JavaScript triggers, throw descriptive errors:

```
CREATE TRIGGER validate_age BEFORE CREATE ON TYPE User
EXECUTE JAVASCRIPT 'if (!record.age || record.age < 18) {\nthrow new Error("User must
be at least 18 years old");\n}';
```

#### 4. Avoid Infinite Loops

Be careful not to create circular trigger dependencies:

```
-- DANGER: This could create an infinite loop if not careful
-- Trigger A updates Type B, which triggers B updates Type A, etc.
```

#### 5. Test Thoroughly

Test triggers with various scenarios:

- Normal operations
- Edge cases (null values, empty strings, etc.)
- Error conditions
- Performance with large datasets

### 14.25.9. Managing Triggers

#### List All Triggers

Use the Java API to list all triggers:

```
Trigger[] triggers = database.getSchema().getTriggers();
for (Trigger trigger : triggers) {
  System.out.println(trigger.getName() + " on " + trigger.getTypeName());
}
```

#### Check if Trigger Exists

```
boolean exists = database.getSchema().existsTrigger("trigger_name");
```

#### Get Triggers for a Type

```
Trigger[] triggers = database.getSchema().getTriggersForType("User");
```

#### Remove a Trigger

```
DROP TRIGGER user_audit;
```

### 14.25.10. Limitations

1. **Synchronous Execution**: Triggers execute synchronously within the transaction. Long-running triggers can impact performance.
2. **Type Matching**: Triggers match the exact type name. Polymorphic matching (inheriting triggers from parent types) is not currently supported.
3. **Order of Execution**: When multiple triggers exist for the same event on the same type, they execute in alphabetical order by trigger name.
4. **BEFORE READ Limitation**: BEFORE READ triggers receive only the RID and must load the record, which can cause a double-read.
5. **Transaction Context**: Triggers execute within the same transaction as the triggering operation. If a trigger fails, the entire transaction rolls back.
6. **JavaScript Sandboxing**: JavaScript triggers run in a sandboxed GraalVM environment with a restricted host-class allow-list. The allow-list is limited to the benign value packages `java.util.`, `java.time.` and `java.math.`; `java.lang.` was removed so a trigger can no longer look up `java.lang.Runtime` and reach `Runtime.getRuntime().exec(…)` for OS command execution (advisory `GHSA-x9f9-r4m8-9xc2`). JavaScript's native `String`, `Math` and `Number` cover most trigger logic, so dropping `java.lang.*` rarely affects real triggers.

### 14.25.11. See Also

- CREATE TRIGGER
- DROP TRIGGER
- SQL Script
- User Functions

## 14.26. User Functions

ArcadeDB can be extended with user-defined functions written in SQL, JavaScript, OpenCypher, or Java. Functions defined in any language are callable from ALL query languages (SQL, Cypher,

Gremlin, GraphQL, MongoDB).

### 14.26.1. Overview

User functions provide a powerful way to encapsulate business logic and reuse it across different query languages:

- **SQL Functions**: Use SQL queries as function bodies
- **JavaScript Functions**: Use JavaScript for complex calculations
- **OpenCypher Functions**: Use Cypher queries for graph operations
- **Java Functions**: Use Java for maximum performance

**Universal Function Registry**

Functions are stored in a global registry and are accessible from any query language:

```
-- Define once in SQL
DEFINE FUNCTION math.sum "SELECT :a + :b" PARAMETERS [a,b] LANGUAGE sql

-- Call from SQL
SELECT `math.sum`(3, 5) AS result

-- Call from Cypher
RETURN math.sum(3, 5) AS result

-- Call from Gremlin, GraphQL, MongoDB queries...
```

### 14.26.2. Database's Functions

Look at the Database Interface page for built-in database functions.

### 14.26.3. Defining User Functions

User functions can be defined via SQL using the following command:

```
DEFINE FUNCTION <library>.<name> "<body>" [PARAMETERS [<parameter>,*]] LANGUAGE
<language>
```

- `<library>` - A namespace to group related functions
- `<name>` - The function's name
- `<body>` - The function's body as a string in the chosen language's syntax. Inside the quoted body you can use the standard string escapes: `\"` for a double quote, `\'` for a single quote, `\\` for a backslash and `\n` for a newline (a literal line break inside the quotes is not allowed, use `\n` instead)

- `[<parameter>,*]` - A list of parameter identifiers used in the function body. Omit the `PARAMETERS []` block for functions without parameters
- `<language>` - One of: `sql`, `js` (JavaScript), or `opencypher` (alias `cypher`), case-insensitive. Java is not a valid `LANGUAGE` value: Java functions are registered programmatically (see User Functions in Java below). A library holds functions of one language only: the first `DEFINE FUNCTION` on a library sets its language, and defining a function of another language in it (or in a Java library registered programmatically) is refused with an error naming both languages

**Persistence**

Functions defined with `DEFINE FUNCTION` (SQL, JavaScript and OpenCypher) are stored with the database schema: they survive a restart and, in a High Availability cluster, are automatically replicated to all the servers. `DELETE FUNCTION` removes them permanently. Java functions are the exception, they are registered programmatically at startup (see User Functions in Java below).

**Required privileges**

Defining a function over a remote connection is gated by the caller's group permissions (see Groups):

- `DEFINE FUNCTION ⋯ LANGUAGE sql` and `LANGUAGE opencypher` require the `updateSchema` permission, like any other schema change.
- `DEFINE FUNCTION ⋯ LANGUAGE js` requires the stronger `updateSecurity` permission, because a JavaScript body runs host code.

Embedded databases, schema loading and HA replication are unaffected — the guard only applies to remote commands.

### SQL Language Functions

SQL functions execute SQL queries and return the result of the first row's projection.

The return value in a SQL function is determined by the projection named `'result'` or the first column if only one column is returned.

### Examples

```
-- Simple arithmetic function
DEFINE FUNCTION math.add "SELECT :a + :b AS result" PARAMETERS [a,b] LANGUAGE sql;
SELECT `math.add`(10, 5) AS sum;  -- Returns 15

-- Function returning a string
DEFINE FUNCTION the.answer 'SELECT "forty-two" AS result' LANGUAGE sql;
SELECT `the.answer`();  -- Returns "forty-two"

-- Function with no parameters
DEFINE FUNCTION utils.currentYear 'SELECT sysdate().format("yyyy") AS result' LANGUAGE
```

```
sql;
SELECT `utils.currentYear`();
```

### JavaScript Language Functions

JavaScript functions use GraalVM's JavaScript engine for complex calculations and data transformations.

**Sandbox**

The polyglot engine that runs a `LANGUAGE js` function is locked down: it executes with host file/URL access disabled (`IOAccess.NONE`, so `load(path|url)` cannot read local files or reach network resources) and cross-language access disabled (`PolyglotAccess.NONE`, so it cannot pivot into another guest language). Nor can a script reach the security state of the request it runs in: the thread context returned by `database.getContext()` and the user objects (the current user and its permissions) are not accessible from a script, so a function cannot read or replace the user it runs as. Combined with the `updateSecurity` requirement above, this confines JavaScript functions to pure in-process computation over their arguments.

Since v26.11.1 a statement that calls a JavaScript function can be stopped while the function runs, by the HTTP `terminate query` server command, Cypher `TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS` or Studio: the function is interrupted through GraalVM, so even an endless loop in it stops.

#### Examples

```
-- Fused multiply-add function
DEFINE FUNCTION my.fma 'return a + b * c' PARAMETERS [a,b,c] LANGUAGE js;
SELECT `my.fma`(1, 2, 3);  -- Returns 7

-- String manipulation
DEFINE FUNCTION text.greet 'return "Hello, " + name + "!"' PARAMETERS [name] LANGUAGE
js;
SELECT `text.greet`('World');  -- Returns "Hello, World!"

-- Complex JSON processing
DEFINE FUNCTION json.extract 'return JSON.parse(data).users.length' PARAMETERS [data]
LANGUAGE js;
SELECT `json.extract`('{"users":[1,2,3]}');  -- Returns 3
```

### OpenCypher Language Functions

OpenCypher functions execute Cypher queries, perfect for graph traversals and pattern matching.

You can use either `opencypher` or `cypher` as the language identifier (they are aliases).

#### Examples

```
-- Simple calculation using Cypher
DEFINE FUNCTION cypher.double "RETURN $x * 2" PARAMETERS [x] LANGUAGE opencypher;
SELECT `cypher.double`(5);  -- Returns 10

-- Graph query function
DEFINE FUNCTION graph.countNeighbors
  "MATCH (n) WHERE id(n) = $nodeId MATCH (n)-[]->() RETURN count(*) AS cnt"
  PARAMETERS [nodeId] LANGUAGE cypher;

-- Use in SQL query
SELECT `graph.countNeighbors`('#1:0') AS neighbors;

-- Use in Cypher query
MATCH (n:Person) RETURN n.name, graph.countNeighbors(id(n)) AS friendCount;

-- Complex graph pattern function
DEFINE FUNCTION graph.findCommonFriends
  "MATCH (a)-[:KNOWS]->(common)<-[:KNOWS]-(b)
   WHERE id(a) = $id1 AND id(b) = $id2
   RETURN count(DISTINCT common) AS cnt"
  PARAMETERS [id1, id2] LANGUAGE opencypher;
```

#### Calling User Functions

Functions can be called from any supported query language:

| Language | Syntax | Example |
|---|---|---|
| SQL | `library.function(args)` | `SELECT `math.sum(3, 5)` |
| Cypher | `library.function(args)` | `RETURN math.sum(3, 5)` |
| Cypher CALL | `CALL library.function(args) YIELD result` | `CALL math.sum(3, 5) YIELD result RETURN result` |
| Gremlin | Standard function call | Access via SQL bridge |
| GraphQL | In query fields | Access via SQL bridge |

#### Cross-Language Function Calls

One of ArcadeDB's unique features is the ability to define a function in one language and call it from any other:

```
-- Define in SQL
DEFINE FUNCTION sql.concat "SELECT :a || :b" PARAMETERS [a,b] LANGUAGE sql;

-- Define in JavaScript
DEFINE FUNCTION js.power "return Math.pow(x, y)" PARAMETERS [x,y] LANGUAGE js;

-- Define in Cypher
DEFINE FUNCTION cypher.shortestPath
```

```
  "MATCH path=shortestPath((a)-[*]-(b))
   WHERE id(a)=$from AND id(b)=$to
   RETURN length(path)"
  PARAMETERS [from, to] LANGUAGE opencypher;

-- Call all from Cypher
RETURN sql.concat('Hello', ' World') AS greeting,
       js.power(2, 10) AS power,
       cypher.shortestPath('#1:0', '#1:100') AS pathLen;

-- Call all from SQL
SELECT `sql.concat`('foo', 'bar') AS str,
       `js.power`(3, 3) AS cube,
       `cypher.shortestPath`('#1:0', '#1:100') AS dist;
```

#### Deleting User Functions

A user function can be deleted via SQL using the following command:

```
DELETE FUNCTION <library>.<name>
```

#### Example

```
DELETE FUNCTION extra.tsum;
DELETE FUNCTION math.obsolete;
```

### 14.26.4. User Functions in Java

Java functions provide maximum performance and access to the full Java ecosystem. Unlike the SQL, JavaScript and OpenCypher functions described above, Java functions **cannot** be created with `DEFINE FUNCTION … LANGUAGE java`: they must be registered programmatically through the Java API. There is no auto-discovery (no `ServiceLoader`, no annotation or classpath scan) for user functions: registration is always an explicit API call.

**Where does the JAR go, and when is the function registered?**

1. **Deploy the JAR.** Copy the JAR containing your function classes into the `lib/` directory of the ArcadeDB installation (`$ARCADEDB_HOME/lib/`). The server start script (`server.sh` / `server.bat`) puts the whole `lib/` folder on the classpath (`-cp "$ARCADEDB_HOME/lib/*"`), so your classes become loadable with `Class.forName(…)`.
2. **Register the function.** Because there is no auto-discovery, you must call the registration API yourself. **When** and **where** depends on how you run ArcadeDB:
   - **Embedded** (ArcadeDB as a library inside your application): register right after opening the database, before running queries that use the function.

- **Standalone server**: registration has to run inside the server JVM. Package the registration logic as a Server Plugin and register the function from its `startService()` method (see the server example below). Drop the same JAR in `lib/plugins/` and enable it with the `arcadedb.server.plugins` setting.

There are two independent ways to expose Java code as functions.

#### Option A: Register a Java class or method as a function library

A function library registered on the schema is callable from **all** query languages, exactly like the SQL/JavaScript/Cypher functions above. Use `JavaClassFunctionLibraryDefinition` to expose every public method of a class, or `JavaMethodFunctionLibraryDefinition` to expose a single method. The library name becomes the namespace and each method name becomes a function in it.

Given this class deployed in a JAR under `lib/`:

```
package com.example;

public class MathFunctions {
  // Instance method: invoked on a new instance created via the no-arg constructor
  public int sum(final int a, final int b) {
    return a + b;
  }

  // Static method: invoked directly, no instance needed
  public static double max(final double a, final double b) {
    return Math.max(a, b);
  }
}
```

Register it on the database schema (embedded usage shown):

```
// Register the whole class as a library named "math".
// Every public method (sum, max, ...) becomes a function in that library.
database.getSchema().registerFunctionLibrary(
    new JavaClassFunctionLibraryDefinition("math", "com.example.MathFunctions"));

// ...or pass the Class directly:
database.getSchema().registerFunctionLibrary(
    new JavaClassFunctionLibraryDefinition("math", com.example.MathFunctions.class));

// ...or register a single method as a one-function library. A non-static method is
invoked on a
// new instance of its class, created by the library through the public no-arg
constructor:
database.getSchema().registerFunctionLibrary(
    new JavaMethodFunctionLibraryDefinition("math",
        com.example.MathFunctions.class.getMethod("sum", Integer.TYPE, Integer.
TYPE)));
```

```
// ...or on an instance of your own, when the method needs state or dependencies the
no-arg
// constructor cannot supply:
database.getSchema().registerFunctionLibrary(
    new JavaMethodFunctionLibraryDefinition("math", new com.example.MathFunctions(),
        com.example.MathFunctions.class.getMethod("sum", Integer.TYPE, Integer.
TYPE)));
```

A library name can be registered only once. Re-registering the same name throws `IllegalArgumentException`. Remove it first with `database.getSchema().unregisterFunctionLibrary("math")`.

If a class has overloaded public methods (e.g. `format(String)` and `format(String, int)`), every overload is registered and the matching one is picked at call time by the number and, if needed, the type of the arguments passed - including varargs and standard Java numeric widening (an `int` argument matches a `long` parameter, for example). When several overloads accept the arguments, the one with the narrowest primitive parameters wins, as in Java: `twice(int)` over `twice(long)` for an `int` argument, `scale(long)` over `scale(double)` (v26.9.1). A call that no overload accepts more specifically than the others (e.g. both `format(Object)` and `format(String)` for a `String` argument, whose reference types are not ranked) is rejected as ambiguous rather than silently picking one.

Once registered, call the function from any query language using the `library.name` form:

```
// Direct invocation through the API
Object r = database.getSchema().getFunction("math", "sum").execute(20, 7);  // 27

// From SQL (backtick-quote the library.function reference)
database.command("sql", "SELECT `math.sum`(20, 7) AS result");

// From Cypher
database.query("opencypher", "RETURN math.sum(20, 7) AS result");
```

#### Option B: The dedicated "java" query engine

The `java` query engine invokes a Java method directly as a command, without going through the schema. For security, every class or method must be added to an allow-list with `registerFunctions(…)` before it can be called; calling anything that was not registered throws a `SecurityException`.

```
// Allow-list a single method (Class::method) or a whole class
database.getQueryEngine("java").registerFunctions("com.example.MathFunctions::sum");
database.getQueryEngine("java").registerFunctions("com.example.MathFunctions"); // all
methods

// Invoke it (positional parameters follow the command string)
ResultSet result = database.command("java", "com.example.MathFunctions::sum", 5, 3);
```

```
int value = (int) result.next().getProperty("value");  // 8

// Remove the allow-list when done
database.getQueryEngine("java").unregisterFunctions();
```

The `java` engine supports only `command(…)` (not `query(…)`) and positional parameters; it matches overloaded methods by argument count and type.

#### Registering Java functions on a standalone server

On a standalone server there is no application code to call `registerFunctionLibrary(…)`, so wrap the registration in a Server Plugin. Build a JAR containing both the function class and a plugin like the one below, place it in `lib/plugins/`, and enable it.

```
package com.example;

import com.arcadedb.ContextConfiguration;
import com.arcadedb.function.java.JavaClassFunctionLibraryDefinition;
import com.arcadedb.server.ArcadeDBServer;
import com.arcadedb.server.ServerPlugin;

public class MathFunctionsPlugin implements ServerPlugin {
  private ArcadeDBServer server;

  @Override
  public void configure(final ArcadeDBServer arcadeDBServer, final
ContextConfiguration configuration) {
    this.server = arcadeDBServer;
  }

  @Override
  // Run after the databases are open so they are available for registration
  public PluginInstallationPriority getInstallationPriority() {
    return PluginInstallationPriority.AFTER_DATABASES_OPEN;
  }

  @Override
  public void startService() {
    // Register the library on every database that needs it
    server.getDatabase("mydb").getSchema().registerFunctionLibrary(
        new JavaClassFunctionLibraryDefinition("math", "com.example.MathFunctions"));
  }
}
```

Enable the plugin with the `arcadedb.server.plugins` setting, using the `<pluginName>:<pluginFullClassName>` format (comma-separate multiple plugins):

```
-Darcadedb.server.plugins=Math:com.example.MathFunctionsPlugin
```

After the server starts, the functions are available from SQL, Cypher and the other query languages (for example `SELECT `math.sum(20, 7)``), including over the HTTP/REST API.

### 14.26.5. Best Practices

1. **Choose the Right Language**:
   - Use SQL for data transformations and aggregations
   - Use JavaScript for complex business logic and calculations
   - Use OpenCypher for graph traversals and pattern matching
   - Use Java for maximum performance
2. **Namespace Organization**: Group related functions under the same library namespace [source,sql] ---- DEFINE FUNCTION math.sum … DEFINE FUNCTION math.avg … DEFINE FUNCTION utils.formatDate … DEFINE FUNCTION graph.shortestPath … ----
3. **Function Naming**: Use descriptive names that indicate what the function does
4. **Performance Considerations**:
   - User functions are evaluated for each row/result
   - For heavy operations, consider caching or materialized views
   - Java functions provide the best performance
5. **Error Handling**: Functions should handle null inputs gracefully

### 14.26.6. Advantages Over Neo4j

Unlike Neo4j which only supports Java-based user-defined procedures requiring compilation and deployment:

 **Dynamic Definition**: Define functions at runtime without restart
 **Persistent & Replicated**: Survive restarts and are automatically shared across an HA cluster
 **4 Languages**: SQL, JavaScript, OpenCypher, and Java
 **Universal Access**: Call from any query language
 **No Compilation**: Interpreted languages work immediately
 **Easy Management**: Simple SQL commands to define/delete functions

## 14.27. SQL SELECT Statements Execution

The execution flow of a SELECT statement is made of many steps. Understanding these steps will help you to write better and more optimized queries.

The SELECT query execution, at a very high level, is made of three steps: - Query optimization - Creation of execution plans - Choice of the optimal execution plan - Actual execution

### Query optimization

The first step for the query executor is to run a query optimizer. This operation can change the internal structure of the SQL statement to make it more efficient, preserving the same semantics of

the original query.

Typical optimization steps are:

- Early calculation of expressions

eg. consider the following statement

```
SELECT FROM Person WHERE fullName = "John" + " " + "Smith"
```

The result of the string concatenation `"John" + " " + "Smith"` does not depend on the query context (eg. the content of a record in the result set), so it can be calculated only once in the execution phase. The result of the optimization of this query will be the equivalent of

```
SELECT FROM Person WHERE fullName = "John Smith"
```

## Early calculation of sub-queries

eg. consider the following statement

```
SELECT FROM Person WHERE father in (SELECT FROM Person WHERE name = 'John')
```

The result of the subquery does not depend on the parent query context, so it can be executed only once, and then use the result as an argument for the parent query:

```
LET $a = (SELECT FROM Person WHERE name = 'John');
SELECT FROM Person WHERE father in $a
```

It is possible only if the subquery does not depend on the context of the parent query, so for example the following cannot be split:

```
SELECT FROM Person WHERE father in (SELECT FROM Person WHERE name = 'John' and surname
= $parent.$current.surname)
```

## Refactoring of the WHERE conditions

eg. consider the following:

```
SELECT FROM Person
WHERE
(name = 'John' AND surname = 'Smith')
OR (name = 'John' AND surname = 'Doe')
OR (name = 'John' AND surname = 'Travolta')
OR (name = 'John' AND surname = 'Lennon')
```

```
OR (name = 'John' AND surname = 'Nash')
```

If the WHERE condition is evaluated as is, the condition `name = 'John'` has to be evaluated five times for each record that does not have a 'John' as a name. This query can be rewritten as:

```
SELECT FROM Person
WHERE
name = 'John' AND (
  surname = 'Smith'
  OR surname = 'Doe'
  OR surname = 'Travolta'
  OR surname = 'Lennon'
  OR surname = 'Nash'
)
```

Sometimes, like in case of full type scan, this is convenient. In other cases it's not. Eg. if `Person` type has an index on `<name, surname>`, the original query can be executed as the union of five index lookups. The query optimizer will create multiple versions of optimized conditions, for different execution plans (see below).

## Creation of execution plans

An execution plan is a sequence of operations that the query engine has to execute to calculate the query result.

Each step in the execution plan typically does a single operation, eg. fetch data from a type, filter results, calculate projections and so on.

For the same query, ArcadeDB can calculate multiple execution plans, based on involvement of indexes, optimized sorting and so on.

An execution plan has an execution cost that depends on the number of processed records, the number of operations performed and the elaboration time. The query executor uses the execution cost as the main criterion to choose the optimal execution plan.

**Choice of the optimal execution plan**

If the query executor produces multiple execution plans, then it has to choose the more convenient one to actually execute the query. This choice is made based on the execution cost: the execution plan with the minimum cost is chosen.

**Actual execution**

After choosing the optimal execution plan, it is just executed.

The execution of an execution plan is just the execution of all the steps that it represents.

**Query Execution Plan**

As described above, an execution plan is a sequence of steps that have to be executed to calculate a query result.

Different queries will have different execution plans.

The typical execution plan is made of the following steps:

- fetch from query target (that can be a type, a bucket, an index and so on)
- evaluate LET expressions
- calculate query projections
- filter results
- aggregate data (eg. aggregate functions + GROUP BY)
- `UNWIND` projections
- sort result (ORDER BY)
- SKIP
- LIMIT

Obviously, a simple query like `SELECT FROM Person` will have a very simple execution plan made of a single step (the fetch from `Person` type), while a complex query will have an execution plan made of multiple steps

To display the execution plan of a query, without executing it, you can just execute the query prefixing it with `EXPLAIN`, eg.

```
EXPLAIN SELECT FROM Person
```

# Chapter 15. Cypher (openCypher)

## 15.1. Introduction

ArcadeDB provides native support for the Cypher query language through a new, high-performance implementation built from the ground up. This native OpenCypher module uses an ANTLR4-based parser with the official Cypher v25 grammar, providing excellent compatibility and performance.

**Deprecation Notice: Legacy Cypher Implementation**

ArcadeDB includes two Cypher implementations:

- `opencypher` (NEW) - Native implementation with direct execution. This is the recommended query language for new projects.
- `cypher` (DEPRECATED) - Legacy implementation based on Cypher for Gremlin. This will be removed in a future release.

The legacy `cypher` query language translates Cypher queries to Gremlin, which results in slower performance (up to 20x slower for complex queries) and limited feature support. We strongly recommend migrating to `opencypher` for all new and existing projects.

**To migrate**: Simply change your query language from `cypher` to `opencypher`. The syntax is identical for supported features.

### 15.1.1. Key Features

The native OpenCypher implementation provides:

- **High Performance**: Direct execution without Gremlin translation, comparable to native SQL
- **Full Read/Write Support**: MATCH, CREATE, MERGE, SET, DELETE with automatic transaction handling
- **Advanced Pattern Matching**: Variable-length paths with path modes (WALK, TRAIL, ACYCLIC), OPTIONAL MATCH, multiple MATCH clauses
- **Query Composition**: UNION/UNION ALL for combining results, WITH for query chaining
- **Procedures and Profiling**: CALL for invoking built-in procedures and custom functions, PROFILE for performance analysis
- **Rich Function Library**: 23+ native Cypher functions plus bridge to 100+ ArcadeDB SQL functions
- **Cost-Based Optimizer**: Intelligent query planning with index selection and join ordering
- **100% Test Coverage**: Comprehensive test suite with 295+ passing tests

### 15.1.2. Using OpenCypher

To execute OpenCypher queries, use `opencypher` as the query language identifier.

**From Java API:**

```
ResultSet result = database.query("opencypher",
    "MATCH (p:Person) WHERE p.age >= $minAge RETURN p.name, p.age ORDER BY p.age",
    "minAge", 25);
```

**Through Neo4j BOLT Protocol:**

Connect using any Neo4j driver via the BOLT protocol:

```
Driver driver = GraphDatabase.driver("bolt://localhost:7687", AuthTokens.basic("root",
"password"));
Session session = driver.session(SessionConfig.forDatabase("mydatabase"));
Result result = session.run("MATCH (p:Person) WHERE p.age >= 25 RETURN p.name, p.age
ORDER BY p.age");
```

**Through PostgreSQL Driver:**

Prefix your query with `{opencypher}`:

```
"{opencypher} MATCH (p:Person) WHERE p.age >= 25 RETURN p.name, p.age ORDER BY p.age"
```

**Through HTTP/JSON API (GET - idempotent queries):**

```
curl "http://localhost:2480/query/graph/opencypher/MATCH%20(p:Person)%20RETURN%20p"
```

**Through HTTP/JSON API (POST - updates):**

```
curl -X POST "http://localhost:2480/command/graph" \
  -d "{'language': 'opencypher', 'command': 'CREATE (p:Person {name: \"Alice\", age:
30})'}"
```

### 15.1.3. Using Record IDs (RIDs)

You can use ArcadeDB's RecordIDs (RID) in Cypher queries to start from a specific vertex. RIDs in Cypher are always strings, so they must be contained between single or double quotes.

```
MATCH (m:Movie)<-[a:ACTED_IN]-(p:Person) WHERE id(m) = '#1:0' RETURN *
```

### 15.1.4. Parameters

OpenCypher supports parameterized queries using the `$paramName` syntax:

```
MATCH (p:Person) WHERE p.age >= $minAge AND p.city = $city RETURN p
```

Parameters are passed as key-value pairs after the query string:

```
ResultSet result = database.query("opencypher",
    "MATCH (p:Person) WHERE p.age >= $minAge RETURN p",
    "minAge", 25);
```

### 15.1.5. Automatic Transaction Handling

All write operations (CREATE, SET, DELETE, MERGE) automatically handle transactions:

- If no transaction is active, the operation creates, executes, and commits its own transaction
- If a transaction is already active, the operation reuses it without committing
- Proper rollback on errors for self-managed transactions

```
// Automatic transaction - commits automatically
database.command("opencypher", "CREATE (n:Person {name: 'Alice'})");

// Manual transaction - you control commit/rollback
database.transaction(() -> {
    database.command("opencypher", "CREATE (a:Person {name: 'Alice'})");
    database.command("opencypher", "CREATE (b:Person {name: 'Bob'})");
    database.command("opencypher", "MATCH (a:Person {name: 'Alice'}), (b:Person {name:
'Bob'}) CREATE (a)-[:KNOWS]->(b)");
    // Commits when lambda completes successfully
});
```

### 15.1.6. Performance Considerations

The native OpenCypher implementation includes a cost-based query optimizer that:

- Automatically selects optimal indexes for node lookups
- Uses range index scans for inequality predicates (`>`, `<`, `>=`, `⇐`)
- Drives a single-hop relationship pattern from the edge type's own index when the `WHERE` clause pins the relationship's indexed properties and neither endpoint is selective, e.g. `MATCH ()-[t:TRANSFER]→() WHERE t.transactionId IN ['A', 'B'] RETURN t`. An equality, an `IN` list or an `OR` of equalities on the same property all qualify, and a leading prefix of a composite index is enough: with an index on `(transactionId, date)`, filtering `transactionId` alone walks that prefix of the index instead of scanning every edge. The plan shows it as `MATCH EDGE BY INDEX`

- Optimizes join order based on cardinality estimation
- Detects bounded patterns for efficient relationship traversal
- Joins the parts of a pattern no relationship connects - `MATCH (a:Person), (c:City)`, or two `MATCH` clauses - on the `WHERE` conjuncts that relate them instead of crossing every row with every row *(since v26.10.1)*. A conjunct that reads one part alone narrows that part before the join. Cypher does not fix the order conjuncts are evaluated in, so a conjunct that reads one part, like either side of a join key, is evaluated once per row of that part rather than per pair, and ahead of the conjuncts written before it: `rand()` there is drawn per row, and an expression that can fail, such as `1 / 0`, can fail on a row the written order would have skipped. A `c.property = expression` conjunct over an indexed property seeks the index once per row of the other part (`IndexNestedLoopJoin` in the plan), which holds nothing in memory; any other `left = right` conjunct is answered by a hash join (`ValueHashJoin`). Only parts nothing relates are crossed (`CartesianProduct`). The rows a join buffers count against `arcadedb.queryMaxHeapElementsAllowedPerOp` and reserve their heap from the budget all the running queries share, `arcadedb.queryMaxHeapRAM`, and past a few thousand rows a query that only reads, or only adds entities (`CREATE`, `MERGE` without `SET` actions), holds them by record identity rather than in full (`[compact buffer]` in the plan)

For best performance:

- Create indexes on frequently queried properties
- Use labeled nodes in MATCH patterns for faster type filtering
- Prefer specific property constraints over full scans
- Use parameters for queries executed multiple times (enables query plan caching). Since v26.11.1 queries that differ only in the literal values they embed share a cached plan too (see the `queryLiteralParameterization` setting), but parameters also keep values out of the query text

### 15.1.7. Comparison with Legacy Cypher

| **Feature** | `opencypher` **(NEW)** | `cypher` **(DEPRECATED)** |
|---|---|---|
| Execution | Native, direct | Gremlin translation |
| Performance | Fast (comparable to SQL) | Slow (up to 20x slower) |
| Write Operations | Full support | Limited support |
| OPTIONAL MATCH | Supported | Partial support |
| Variable-length Paths | Supported | Limited |
| UNION / UNION ALL | Supported | Not supported |
| CALL Procedures | Supported | Not supported |
| PROFILE | Supported | Not supported |
| Aggregations | Full support | Limited |
| Functions | 100+ functions | Limited |
| Transaction Handling | Automatic | Manual |

| Feature | `opencypher` (NEW) | `cypher` (DEPRECATED) |
|---|---|---|
| Active Development | Yes | No (abandoned upstream) |

### 15.1.8. Resources

- OpenCypher Specification
- Neo4j Cypher Manual (reference)
- Learn Cypher in Y Minutes

## 15.2. Cypher Tutorial

Prefer a guided, video-based walkthrough? The ArcadeDB Academy offers a **free** course on Cypher with hands-on exercises and a certification at the end.

This tutorial introduces you to Cypher, a declarative graph query language. By the end of this tutorial, you'll be able to create, query, and manipulate graph data in ArcadeDB using Cypher.

### 15.2.1. What is Cypher?

Cypher is a pattern-matching query language designed specifically for graphs. It uses ASCII-art syntax to represent graph patterns, making queries intuitive and readable. For example, `(a)-[:KNOWS]→(b)` visually represents a KNOWS relationship from node `a` to node `b`.

### 15.2.2. Setting Up

Before running Cypher queries, ensure you have:

1. ArcadeDB server running
2. A database created (we'll use `tutorial` in examples)

Create vertex types for our tutorial:

```
CREATE VERTEX TYPE Person
CREATE VERTEX TYPE Movie
CREATE VERTEX TYPE Company
CREATE EDGE TYPE ACTED_IN
CREATE EDGE TYPE DIRECTED
CREATE EDGE TYPE WORKS_AT
CREATE EDGE TYPE KNOWS
```

### 15.2.3. Part 1: Creating Data

#### Creating Nodes

Use the `CREATE` clause to add nodes (vertices) to your graph.

**Create a single node:**

```
CREATE (p:Person {name: 'Alice', age: 30, city: 'New York'})
```

This creates a node with:

- Label `Person` (the type)
- Properties: `name`, `age`, and `city`

**Create multiple nodes:**

```
CREATE (a:Person {name: 'Bob', age: 35}),
       (b:Person {name: 'Charlie', age: 28}),
       (c:Person {name: 'Diana', age: 32})
```

### Creating Relationships

Relationships (edges) connect nodes. Create them with the arrow syntax.

**Create a relationship between new nodes:**

```
CREATE (a:Person {name: 'Eve'})-[:KNOWS {since: 2020}]->(b:Person {name: 'Frank'})
```

**Create a relationship between existing nodes:**

```
MATCH (a:Person {name: 'Alice'}), (b:Person {name: 'Bob'})
CREATE (a)-[:KNOWS {since: 2019}]->(b)
```

### Sample Dataset

Let's create a sample movie database:

```
// Create people
CREATE (keanu:Person {name: 'Keanu Reeves', born: 1964})
CREATE (carrie:Person {name: 'Carrie-Anne Moss', born: 1967})
CREATE (laurence:Person {name: 'Laurence Fishburne', born: 1961})
CREATE (lana:Person {name: 'Lana Wachowski', born: 1965})
CREATE (lilly:Person {name: 'Lilly Wachowski', born: 1967})

// Create movies
CREATE (matrix:Movie {title: 'The Matrix', released: 1999})
CREATE (reloaded:Movie {title: 'The Matrix Reloaded', released: 2003})

// Create relationships
MATCH (keanu:Person {name: 'Keanu Reeves'}), (matrix:Movie {title: 'The Matrix'})
```

```
CREATE (keanu)-[:ACTED_IN {role: 'Neo'}]->(matrix)

MATCH (carrie:Person {name: 'Carrie-Anne Moss'}), (matrix:Movie {title: 'The Matrix'})
CREATE (carrie)-[:ACTED_IN {role: 'Trinity'}]->(matrix)

MATCH (laurence:Person {name: 'Laurence Fishburne'}), (matrix:Movie {title: 'The
Matrix'})
CREATE (laurence)-[:ACTED_IN {role: 'Morpheus'}]->(matrix)

MATCH (lana:Person {name: 'Lana Wachowski'}), (matrix:Movie {title: 'The Matrix'})
CREATE (lana)-[:DIRECTED]->(matrix)

MATCH (lilly:Person {name: 'Lilly Wachowski'}), (matrix:Movie {title: 'The Matrix'})
CREATE (lilly)-[:DIRECTED]->(matrix)
```

### 15.2.4. Part 2: Reading Data

#### Basic MATCH Queries

The `MATCH` clause finds patterns in your graph.

**Find all nodes of a type:**

```
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p
```

**Find nodes with specific properties:**

```
MATCH (p:Person {name: 'Alice'})
RETURN p
```

**Return specific properties:**

```
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p.name, p.age
```

#### Filtering with WHERE

Use `WHERE` for complex conditions:

```
MATCH (p:Person)
WHERE p.age > 30
RETURN p.name, p.age
```

**Multiple conditions:**

```
MATCH (p:Person)
WHERE p.age >= 25 AND p.age <= 35 AND p.city IS NOT NULL
RETURN p.name, p.age, p.city
```

**String matching:**

```
// Names starting with 'A'
MATCH (p:Person) WHERE p.name STARTS WITH 'A' RETURN p.name

// Names containing 'an'
MATCH (p:Person) WHERE p.name CONTAINS 'an' RETURN p.name

// Email pattern matching
MATCH (p:Person) WHERE p.email =~ '.*@gmail.com' RETURN p.name, p.email
```

**IN operator:**

```
MATCH (p:Person)
WHERE p.name IN ['Alice', 'Bob', 'Charlie']
RETURN p
```

### Traversing Relationships

Find connected nodes by specifying relationship patterns:

**Find direct connections:**

```
MATCH (p:Person)-[:ACTED_IN]->(m:Movie)
RETURN p.name, m.title
```

**Find connections with relationship properties:**

```
MATCH (p:Person)-[r:ACTED_IN]->(m:Movie)
RETURN p.name, r.role, m.title
```

**Find bidirectional connections (either direction):**

```
MATCH (p:Person)-[:KNOWS]-(other:Person)
RETURN p.name, other.name
```

**Multi-hop traversals:**

```
MATCH (a:Person)-[:KNOWS]->(b:Person)-[:KNOWS]->(c:Person)
```

```
WHERE a.name = 'Alice'
RETURN a.name, b.name, c.name
```

#### Variable-Length Paths

Find paths of varying lengths:

```
// Find all people within 1 to 3 hops
MATCH (a:Person {name: 'Alice'})-[:KNOWS*1..3]->(b:Person)
RETURN b.name
```

**Named paths:**

```
MATCH p = (a:Person)-[:KNOWS*1..3]->(b:Person)
WHERE a.name = 'Alice'
RETURN p
```

#### OPTIONAL MATCH

Like a LEFT OUTER JOIN - returns NULL for missing matches:

```
MATCH (p:Person)
OPTIONAL MATCH (p)-[:ACTED_IN]->(m:Movie)
RETURN p.name, m.title
```

This returns all people, with `m.title` as NULL for those who haven't acted in any movie.

#### Sorting and Pagination

**ORDER BY:**

```
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p.name, p.age
ORDER BY p.age DESC
```

**Multiple sort keys:**

```
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p.name, p.age
ORDER BY p.age DESC, p.name ASC
```

**SKIP and LIMIT:**

```
MATCH (p:Person)
```

```
RETURN p.name
ORDER BY p.name
SKIP 10
LIMIT 5
```

### 15.2.5. Part 3: Aggregations

#### Basic Aggregations

```
// Count all people
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN count(p) AS totalPeople

// Count, sum, average
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN count(p) AS total, sum(p.age) AS totalAge, avg(p.age) AS averageAge

// Min and max
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN min(p.age) AS youngest, max(p.age) AS oldest
```

#### Grouping (Implicit GROUP BY)

Cypher automatically groups by non-aggregated expressions:

```
// Count people by city
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p.city, count(p) AS residents
ORDER BY residents DESC
```

#### Multiple grouping keys:

```
MATCH (p:Person)-[:WORKS_AT]->(c:Company)
RETURN c.name, p.department, count(p) AS employees
ORDER BY c.name, employees DESC
```

#### COLLECT

Collect values into a list:

```
// Collect all names
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN collect(p.name) AS allNames

// Group and collect
MATCH (p:Person)-[:ACTED_IN]->(m:Movie)
```

```
RETURN m.title, collect(p.name) AS actors
```

### 15.2.6. Part 4: Data Modification

#### Updating with SET

```
// Update a single property
MATCH (p:Person {name: 'Alice'})
SET p.age = 31

// Update multiple properties
MATCH (p:Person {name: 'Alice'})
SET p.age = 31, p.city = 'Boston'
```

#### MERGE (Upsert)

MERGE finds or creates a pattern:

```
// Create if not exists
MERGE (p:Person {name: 'Grace'})

// With ON CREATE and ON MATCH actions
MERGE (p:Person {name: 'Grace'})
ON CREATE SET p.created = true, p.visits = 1
ON MATCH SET p.visits = p.visits + 1
```

**MERGE relationships:**

```
MATCH (a:Person {name: 'Alice'}), (b:Person {name: 'Bob'})
MERGE (a)-[r:KNOWS]->(b)
ON CREATE SET r.since = 2024
ON MATCH SET r.lastContact = 2024
```

#### DELETE

**Delete a relationship:**

```
MATCH (a:Person {name: 'Alice'})-[r:KNOWS]->(b:Person {name: 'Bob'})
DELETE r
```

**Delete a node (must have no relationships):**

```
MATCH (p:Person {name: 'TestPerson'})
DELETE p
```

**DETACH DELETE (delete node and its relationships):**

```
MATCH (p:Person {name: 'TestPerson'})
DETACH DELETE p
```

### 15.2.7. Part 5: Advanced Queries

#### WITH Clause

Use `WITH` to chain query parts:

```
// Filter and project before continuing
MATCH (p:Person)
WITH p.name AS name, p.age AS age
WHERE age > 30
RETURN name ORDER BY name
```

**Aggregation with WITH:**

```
MATCH (p:Person)-[:ACTED_IN]->(m:Movie)
WITH m.title AS movie, count(p) AS actorCount
WHERE actorCount > 2
RETURN movie, actorCount
```

#### UNWIND

Expand a list into rows:

```
// Unwind a literal list
UNWIND [1, 2, 3] AS x
RETURN x

// Unwind a property array
MATCH (p:Person {name: 'Alice'})
UNWIND p.hobbies AS hobby
RETURN p.name, hobby

// Create multiple nodes from a list
UNWIND ['Alice', 'Bob', 'Charlie'] AS name
CREATE (p:Person {name: name})
```

#### Pattern Predicates

Check if patterns exist:

```
// Find people who know someone
MATCH (p:Person)
WHERE (p)-[:KNOWS]->()
RETURN p.name

// Find people who don't know anyone
MATCH (p:Person)
WHERE NOT (p)-[:KNOWS]->()
RETURN p.name

// Find people who know a specific person
MATCH (a:Person {name: 'Alice'}), (p:Person)
WHERE (p)-[:KNOWS]->(a)
RETURN p.name AS knowsAlice
```

#### CASE Expressions

Conditional logic in queries:

```
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p.name,
       CASE
         WHEN p.age < 18 THEN 'minor'
         WHEN p.age < 65 THEN 'adult'
         ELSE 'senior'
       END AS ageGroup
```

### 15.2.8. Part 6: Using Functions

#### String Functions

```
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN toUpper(p.name) AS upperName,
       toLower(p.name) AS lowerName,
       substring(p.name, 0, 3) AS initials
```

#### Math Functions

```
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p.name,
       abs(p.balance) AS absBalance,
       round(p.salary / 1000.0) AS salaryK
```

**List Functions**

```
MATCH (p:Person)-[:ACTED_IN]->(m:Movie)
WITH p.name AS actor, collect(m.title) AS movies
RETURN actor,
       size(movies) AS movieCount,
       head(movies) AS firstMovie,
       last(movies) AS lastMovie
```

**Node/Relationship Functions**

```
MATCH (p:Person)-[r:ACTED_IN]->(m:Movie)
RETURN id(p) AS personId,
       labels(p) AS personLabels,
       type(r) AS relationshipType,
       keys(m) AS movieProperties
```

### 15.2.9. Part 7: Best Practices

**1. Use Labels**

Always specify labels in MATCH patterns for better performance:

```
// Good - uses index on Person
MATCH (p:Person {name: 'Alice'}) RETURN p

// Avoid - scans all nodes
MATCH (n {name: 'Alice'}) RETURN n
```

**2. Create Indexes**

Create indexes on frequently queried properties:

```
CREATE INDEX ON Person (name) NOTUNIQUE
CREATE INDEX ON Movie (title) NOTUNIQUE
```

**3. Use Parameters**

For repeated queries, use parameters instead of string concatenation:

```
MATCH (p:Person)
WHERE p.name = $name AND p.age >= $minAge
RETURN p
```

Since v26.11.1 a query that writes its values in the text (`WHERE p.name = 'Alice'`) is

> not parsed and planned again for every value: ArcadeDB extracts the literals into parameters itself, so all the queries of the same shape share one cached plan (see the `queryLiteralParameterization` setting). Parameters remain the better choice: they keep values out of the query text, which rules out injection, and they let every value share the plan, including the ones written where a literal is kept, such as `SKIP` and `LIMIT`.

**4. Limit Results**

Use LIMIT for exploratory queries:

```
MATCH (p:Person)-[:KNOWS*1..5]->(other)
RETURN p.name, other.name
LIMIT 100
```

**5. Use WITH for Complex Queries**

Break complex queries into steps with WITH:

```
MATCH (p:Person)-[:ACTED_IN]->(m:Movie)
WITH p, count(m) AS movieCount
WHERE movieCount > 5
MATCH (p)-[:DIRECTED]->(d:Movie)
RETURN p.name, movieCount, collect(d.title) AS directed
```

# 15.3. MATCH

The `MATCH` clause is used to search for patterns in the graph. It is the primary read operation in Cypher.

**Syntax:**

```
MATCH pattern [, pattern ...]
[WHERE condition]
```

**Pattern Syntax:**

- `(variable)` - Match any node
- `(variable:Label)` - Match nodes with specific label
- `(variable:Label {prop: value})` - Match nodes with properties
- `(a)-[r]→(b)` - Match directed relationship
- `(a)-[r]-(b)` - Match relationship in either direction
- `(a)-[r:TYPE]→(b)` - Match relationship with specific type
- `(a)-[r:TYPE1|TYPE2]→(b)` - Match relationship with multiple types

- `(a)-[*min..max]→(b)` - Match variable-length path

**Examples:**

```
// Match all Person nodes
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p

// Match with property filter
MATCH (p:Person {name: 'Alice', age: 30})
RETURN p

// Match relationships
MATCH (p:Person)-[r:KNOWS]->(friend:Person)
RETURN p.name, friend.name

// Match with relationship properties
MATCH (p:Person)-[r:WORKS_AT {since: 2020}]->(c:Company)
RETURN p.name, c.name

// Variable-length paths
MATCH (a:Person)-[:KNOWS*1..3]->(b:Person)
WHERE a.name = 'Alice'
RETURN b.name

// Named paths
MATCH path = (a:Person)-[:KNOWS*]->(b:Person)
WHERE a.name = 'Alice'
RETURN path

// Comma-separated patterns (Cartesian product)
MATCH (a:Person), (b:Company)
RETURN a.name, b.name

// Comma-separated patterns related in WHERE: joined, not crossed
MATCH (a:Person), (b:Company)
WHERE b.id = a.companyId AND b.country = 'IT'
RETURN a.name, b.name

// Multiple MATCH clauses
MATCH (a:Person {name: 'Alice'})
MATCH (b:Person {name: 'Bob'})
RETURN a, b
```

### 15.3.1. Path Mode (WALK, TRAIL, ACYCLIC)

Path modes control how variable-length traversals handle cycles. They are placed after the optional path variable assignment and before the pattern.

**Syntax:**

```
MATCH [variable =] [WALK | TRAIL | ACYCLIC] (a)-[*min..max]->(b)
```

**Modes:**

| Mode | Behavior | Default? |
|---|---|---|
| TRAIL | Edges must be unique per path. Vertices **can** repeat. | Yes (default) |
| ACYCLIC | No vertex repeated per path (strongest restriction). Implies edge uniqueness. | |
| WALK | No restrictions — vertices and edges can be revisited. Requires an explicit max hop bound. | |

TRAIL is the default path mode per the GQL/Cypher v25 standard. If no mode is specified, TRAIL semantics apply.

**Examples:**

```
// TRAIL (default): edges unique, vertices can repeat.
// On a cycle A→B→C→D→A, this can traverse the full cycle.
MATCH (a:Person {name: 'Alice'})-[:KNOWS*1..5]->(b)
RETURN b.name

// ACYCLIC: no vertex revisited — stops before completing a cycle.
MATCH ACYCLIC (a:Person {name: 'Alice'})-[:KNOWS*1..5]->(b)
RETURN b.name

// WALK: no restrictions. Edges and vertices can be reused.
// Requires explicit max hops to prevent infinite traversal.
MATCH WALK (a:Person {name: 'Alice'})-[:KNOWS*1..6]->(b)
RETURN b.name

// Path mode with named path variable
MATCH p = TRAIL (a:Person)-[:KNOWS*1..4]->(b)
RETURN p, length(p)
```

**Comparison on a cyclic graph** (A → B → C → D → A):

| Mode | Reachable from A with *1..5 hops |
|---|---|
| TRAIL | B, C, D, **A** (vertex A revisited after full cycle — edges stay unique) |
| ACYCLIC | B, C, D (stops — cannot revisit A) |
| WALK | B, C, D, A, B, C, … (repeats edges and vertices up to max hops) |

`WALK` mode without an explicit maximum hop bound will throw an error. Always specify an upper bound, e.g., `[*1..10]`.

The path mode applies to a variable-length pattern predicate too: `WHERE (a)-[]→(a)` is true when a cycle leads back to a, as `MATCH (a)-[]→(a)` finds it, and `WHERE (a)-[*0..]→(a)` is true through the zero-length path.

---

### 15.3.2. Matching a Bound Relationship List

When the relationship variable of a variable-length pattern is already bound to a list of relationships by an earlier clause, the pattern matches exactly that list: it does not expand the graph, it checks that the relationships, in list order, form a path leaving the left-hand node in the pattern's direction.

```
MATCH (:A)-[r1]->(:B)-[r2]->(:C)
WITH [r1, r2] AS rs
MATCH (first)-[rs*]->(second)
RETURN first, second   // one row: (:A), (:C)
```

- The list is read in written order: its first relationship touches the left-hand node of the pattern. With the list above, `(second)←[rs*]-(first)` matches nothing, while `[r2, r1]` would match it.
- Every other constraint of the pattern still applies: the hop range (`-[rs*1..1]→` refuses a two-element list), the relationship types, the inline property map, the inline `WHERE` and the path mode (under the default `TRAIL`, a list naming the same relationship twice matches nothing).
- A `null` list, or a list containing `null`, matches nothing. A value that is not a list of relationships raises a `TypeError`.
- The same rule applies to a pattern predicate (`WHERE (a)-[rs*]→(b)`), a pattern comprehension and an `EXISTS { }` or `COUNT { }` subquery.

Inside a pattern comprehension, the relationship variable of a variable-length hop is the list of relationships walked, as in `MATCH`: `[(a)-[r*]→(x) | size(r)]` returns the length of each path, and a zero-length hop binds the empty list.

---

### 15.3.3. Named Paths

Assigning a variable to a pattern with `=` binds the whole matched path to that variable, which can then be passed to `length()`, `nodes()` and `relationships()` (see Expressions and Functions).

**Syntax:**

```
MATCH variable = pattern
```

A pattern with no relationship binds a **zero-length path**: one node, no relationships.

**Examples:**

```
// A one-hop path: length 1, two nodes, one relationship
MATCH p = (a:Person {name: 'Alice'})-[:KNOWS]->(b:Person)
RETURN length(p), nodes(p), relationships(p)

// A zero-length path: length 0, nodes(p) is [Alice], relationships(p) is []
MATCH p = (n:Person {name: 'Alice'})
RETURN length(p), nodes(p), relationships(p)
```

A named path can be one part of a comma-separated pattern, in any position, and the node it covers may already be bound by an earlier part or an earlier clause:

```
MATCH (x:Person)
OPTIONAL MATCH p = (x), (x)-[:KNOWS]->(z)
RETURN x.name, p, z.name
```

Inside an `OPTIONAL MATCH`, a path variable follows the same rule as every other variable the clause introduces: it is bound when the **whole** pattern matches and NULL when it does not. In the example above `p` is a zero-length path on the rows where `x` has an outgoing `KNOWS`, and NULL on the rows where it has none - even though `(x)` on its own would always match.

### 15.3.4. OPTIONAL MATCH

`OPTIONAL MATCH` works like `MATCH`, but returns NULL values for missing parts of the pattern instead of filtering out rows. It behaves like a LEFT OUTER JOIN in SQL.

**Syntax:**

```
MATCH pattern
OPTIONAL MATCH optional_pattern
[WHERE condition]
RETURN ...
```

**Examples:**

```
// Find all people and their optional movies
MATCH (p:Person)
OPTIONAL MATCH (p)-[r:ACTED_IN]->(m:Movie)
RETURN p.name, m.title
```

```
// With WHERE clause scoped to OPTIONAL MATCH
MATCH (p:Person)
OPTIONAL MATCH (p)-[:KNOWS]->(friend:Person)
WHERE friend.age > 30
RETURN p.name, friend.name
```

The WHERE clause after OPTIONAL MATCH filters the optional match results, but preserves rows where the match failed (with NULL values).

**Testing for absence.** An `OPTIONAL MATCH` whose new variable is then tested for `IS NULL` keeps exactly the rows for which the pattern does not exist, which is what `WHERE NOT pattern` says. Since v26.11.1 it is planned that way: when the variables the `OPTIONAL MATCH` introduces are read by nothing but that test (a conjunct of the `WHERE` of the `WITH`, or `FILTER`, right after it), the nodes it shares with the earlier `MATCH` clauses are never null, and that `WITH` neither aggregates nor orders nor pages, the two spellings below run the same plan, including the anti-join count push-down (issue #9598):

```
MATCH (t1:Tag)<-[:HAS_TAG]-(m:Message)<-[:REPLY_OF]-(c:Comment)-[:HAS_TAG]->(t2:Tag)
OPTIONAL MATCH (c)-[h:HAS_TAG]->(t1)
WITH t1, t2, h WHERE t1 <> t2 AND h IS NULL
RETURN count(*)

MATCH (t1:Tag)<-[:HAS_TAG]-(m:Message)<-[:REPLY_OF]-(c:Comment)-[:HAS_TAG]->(t2:Tag)
WHERE NOT (c)-[:HAS_TAG]->(t1) AND t1 <> t2
RETURN count(*)
```

A variable read anywhere else (returned, counted, renamed, carried to a `RETURN *`), an `OPTIONAL MATCH` with its own `WHERE` or starting from a node an earlier `OPTIONAL MATCH` may have left null, and a statement that writes keep the `OPTIONAL MATCH` as written.

---

### 15.3.5. WHERE

The `WHERE` clause filters results based on conditions.

**Syntax:**

```
WHERE condition
```

**Operators:**

| Type | Operators | Example |
|---|---|---|
| Comparison | `=`, `<>`, `<`, `>`, `⇐`, `>=` | `WHERE n.age >= 25` |
| Logical | `AND`, `OR`, `NOT` | `WHERE n.age > 25 AND n.city = 'NYC'` |
| Null check | `IS NULL`, `IS NOT NULL` | `WHERE n.email IS NOT NULL` |

| Type | Operators | Example |
|---|---|---|
| List | `IN` | `WHERE n.name IN ['Alice', 'Bob']` |
| String | `STARTS WITH`, `ENDS WITH`, `CONTAINS` | `WHERE n.name STARTS WITH 'A'` |
| Regex | `=~` | `WHERE n.email =~ '.*@gmail.com'` |

**Examples:**

```
// Simple comparison
MATCH (p:Person)
WHERE p.age > 30
RETURN p.name

// Multiple conditions
MATCH (p:Person)
WHERE p.age >= 25 AND p.age <= 40 AND p.city = 'NYC'
RETURN p

// NULL checks
MATCH (p:Person)
WHERE p.email IS NOT NULL
RETURN p.name, p.email

// IN operator
MATCH (p:Person)
WHERE p.name IN ['Alice', 'Bob', 'Charlie']
RETURN p

// String matching
MATCH (p:Person)
WHERE p.name STARTS WITH 'A'
RETURN p

// Regular expression
MATCH (p:Person)
WHERE p.email =~ '.*@example.com'
RETURN p

// Parenthesized expressions
MATCH (p:Person)
WHERE (p.age < 25 OR p.age > 60) AND p.status = 'active'
RETURN p

// Pattern predicates
MATCH (p:Person)
WHERE (p)-[:KNOWS]->()
RETURN p.name AS hasConnections
```

### 15.3.6. RETURN

The `RETURN` clause specifies what to include in the query result.

**Syntax:**

```
RETURN expression [AS alias] [, expression [AS alias] ...]
```

**Examples:**

```
// Return nodes
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p

// Return properties
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p.name, p.age

// Return with aliases
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p.name AS personName, p.age AS personAge

// Return all: *
MATCH (a:Person)-[r:KNOWS]->(b:Person)
RETURN *

// Return expressions
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p.name, toUpper(p.city) AS upperCity

// Aggregations
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN count(p) AS total, avg(p.age) AS avgAge

// RETURN DISTINCT - removes duplicate rows
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN DISTINCT p.city AS city

// DISTINCT with multiple columns
UNWIND [1, 2, 2, 3, 3, 3] AS n
RETURN DISTINCT n

// Aggregations with DISTINCT
UNWIND [1, 1, 2, 3] AS n
RETURN count(DISTINCT n) AS uniqueCount, sum(DISTINCT n) AS uniqueSum

// Standalone expressions (no MATCH)
RETURN abs(-42), sqrt(16), range(1, 5)
```

### 15.3.7. CREATE

The `CREATE` clause creates new nodes and relationships.

**Syntax:**

```
CREATE pattern [, pattern ...]
```

**Examples:**

```
// Create a node
CREATE (p:Person {name: 'Alice', age: 30})

// Create multiple nodes
CREATE (a:Person {name: 'Bob'}), (b:Person {name: 'Charlie'})

// Create a relationship between new nodes
CREATE (a:Person {name: 'Alice'})-[:KNOWS]->(b:Person {name: 'Bob'})

// Create a relationship with properties
CREATE (a:Person {name: 'Alice'})-[:WORKS_AT {since: 2020}]->(c:Company {name:
'ArcadeDB'})

// Create relationship between existing nodes
MATCH (a:Person {name: 'Alice'}), (b:Person {name: 'Bob'})
CREATE (a)-[:KNOWS {since: 2024}]->(b)

// Create chained paths
CREATE (a:Person {name: 'A'})-[:KNOWS]->(b:Person {name: 'B'})-[:KNOWS]->(c:Person
{name: 'C'})
```

A property value follows the same rule as `SET`: it must be a scalar, a list of scalars, or a `point()` value.

A relationship type name cannot contain `~`, since that character is reserved internally for multi-label vertex types.

---

### 15.3.8. MERGE

The `MERGE` clause creates nodes or relationships if they don't exist, or matches them if they do (upsert operation).

**Syntax:**

```
[path_variable =] MERGE pattern
[ON CREATE SET ...]
[ON MATCH SET ...]
```

`ON CREATE SET` and `ON MATCH SET` accept every form the `SET` clause does.

Like `MATCH`, `MERGE` can name the path it matched or created. The path spans the whole pattern, so `length()`, `nodes()` and `relationships()` report what they would for the equivalent `MATCH`, whether or not the individual nodes and relationships were given names of their own:

```
// length(p) is 2, nodes(p) has 3 entries and relationships(p) has 2,
// even though only the first node is named
MERGE p = (a:Person {name: 'Alice'})-[:KNOWS]->(:Person {name: 'Bob'})-[:KNOWS]->
(:Person {name: 'Carol'})
RETURN length(p), nodes(p), relationships(p)
```

**Examples:**

```
// Find or create a node
MERGE (p:Person {name: 'Alice'})

// With ON CREATE action
MERGE (p:Person {name: 'Bob'})
ON CREATE SET p.created = true, p.timestamp = timestamp()

// With ON MATCH action
MERGE (p:Person {name: 'Alice'})
ON MATCH SET p.lastSeen = timestamp(), p.visits = p.visits + 1

// Both ON CREATE and ON MATCH
MERGE (p:Person {name: 'Charlie'})
ON CREATE SET p.created = true, p.count = 1
ON MATCH SET p.count = p.count + 1, p.updated = true

// Merge relationship between existing nodes
MATCH (a:Person {name: 'Alice'}), (b:Person {name: 'Bob'})
MERGE (a)-[r:KNOWS]->(b)
ON CREATE SET r.since = 2024
ON MATCH SET r.lastContact = timestamp()

// Copy the defaults onto a node that was just created
MATCH (defaults:Settings {scope: 'person'})
MERGE (p:Person {name: 'Dave'})
ON CREATE SET p += defaults
```

A property value in the pattern follows the same rule as `SET`: it must be a scalar, a list of scalars, or a `point()` value.

### 15.3.9. SET

The `SET` clause updates properties and labels on nodes and relationships.

**Syntax:**

```
SET variable.property = value [, ...]     // one property
SET variable[keyExpression] = value       // property name computed at runtime
SET variable = source                     // replace all properties
SET variable += source                    // add to the existing properties
SET variable:Label [, ...]                // add a label
```

For the `=` and `+=` forms, `source` is a map, a node or a relationship. Copying from a node or a relationship takes all of its properties, which is the usual way to clone one.

**Examples:**

```
// Update a single property
MATCH (p:Person {name: 'Alice'})
SET p.age = 31

// Update multiple properties
MATCH (p:Person {name: 'Alice'})
SET p.age = 31, p.city = 'Boston', p.updated = true

// Update relationship property
MATCH (a:Person)-[r:KNOWS]->(b:Person)
WHERE a.name = 'Alice' AND b.name = 'Bob'
SET r.strength = 10

// Replace every property with the ones in the map: 'age' and 'city' are dropped
MATCH (p:Person {name: 'Alice'})
SET p = {name: 'Alice', role: 'admin'}

// Add to the existing properties, keeping the ones not mentioned
MATCH (p:Person {name: 'Alice'})
SET p += {role: 'admin'}

// Copy every property of one node onto another
MATCH (source:Person {name: 'Alice'}), (target:Person {name: 'Alice2'})
SET target = source

// Add a label
MATCH (p:Person {name: 'Alice'})
SET p:Employee
```

`SET` is a simultaneous assignment: every value is read as it was before the clause

ran, so `SET p.a = p.b, p.b = p.a` swaps the two rather than copying one onto the other.

A property value must be a scalar, a list of scalars, or a `point()` value. A map value (`SET p.address = {city: 'Rome'}`), or a right-hand side of `=` / `+=` that is neither a map nor an entity (`SET p = 5`), is rejected with a `TypeError` and no part of the clause is written.

**Concurrent updates.** A `SET` (stand-alone, or in `MERGE … ON CREATE SET` / `ON MATCH SET`) computes the value it writes from the latest committed version of the record, even under the default `READ_COMMITTED` isolation. So `SET n.count = n.count + 1` run by concurrent transactions never silently loses an increment: a change committed by another transaction after that point makes the commit fail with a retryable conflict. Two things follow:

- under contention the right-hand side can be evaluated more than once, so keep it free of side effects;
- a `MERGE … ON MATCH SET` that assigns a value the matched record already holds writes nothing, so read-mostly `MERGE` workloads do not conflict. It keeps a different value committed concurrently after the match.

---

### 15.3.10. DELETE

The `DELETE` clause removes nodes and relationships from the graph.

**Syntax:**

```
DELETE variable [, variable ...]
DETACH DELETE variable [, variable ...]
```

A node cannot be deleted if it has relationships. Use `DETACH DELETE` to delete a node and all its relationships.

The check runs once the whole statement is processed, so `MATCH (n)-[r]-() DELETE r, n` deletes a node that has several relationships. A node that still has a relationship at the end fails the statement and nothing is deleted *(since v26.10.1)*.

This includes the incoming edges of a unidirectional edge type, which the node itself does not store: `DELETE` refuses a node they still point to, and `DETACH DELETE` removes them *(since v26.10.1)*. Deleting a vertex through the Java API or SQL `DELETE VERTEX` removes them too. The first vertex deleted in a transaction scans the unidirectional edge types to find them, so on a very large unidirectional type prefer deleting many vertices in one transaction.

**Examples:**

```
// Delete a relationship
```

```
MATCH (a:Person)-[r:KNOWS]->(b:Person)
WHERE a.name = 'Alice' AND b.name = 'Bob'
DELETE r

// Delete a node (must have no relationships)
MATCH (p:Person {name: 'TestNode'})
DELETE p

// Delete node with all its relationships
MATCH (p:Person {name: 'Alice'})
DETACH DELETE p

// Delete multiple elements
MATCH (a:Person)-[r:TEMP]->(b:Person)
DELETE a, r, b
```

### 15.3.11. Reads and Writes in the Same Query

A query never sees the vertices and edges it creates itself. Everything the pattern matched before the query wrote anything is what it returns - the reading clauses are evaluated against the graph as it was, not against the rows the writes behind them add.

This matters whenever a write can produce something an earlier pattern would match:

```
// [r] has no type, so it would match the SCORED edges this query creates.
// It does not: the row count is the number of edges that existed beforehand.
MATCH (a:Person)-[r]->(b:Person)
MERGE (a)-[:SCORED]->(b)
RETURN count(*)
```

To make that hold, ArcadeDB reads the whole result of the pattern into memory before applying the first write. You can see where this happens in `EXPLAIN`, as an `EAGER (read/write barrier)` step. Two things follow from it, and they only apply to the queries that actually get one:

- the matched rows are held in memory until the last write is applied, so a query over a very large match needs the memory for it;
- a `LIMIT` no longer stops the scan early - the write runs for every matched row.

Queries whose writes cannot feed a preceding pattern are left alone and keep streaming, which covers the usual bulk shapes:

```
// Nothing is read, so nothing can be re-read.
UNWIND range(1, 1000000) AS i CREATE (:LogEntry {seq: i})

// KNOWS is read, SCORED is written: no overlap.
```

```
MATCH (a:Person)-[:KNOWS]->(b:Person) CREATE (a)-[:SCORED]->(b)
```

A call to a procedure that writes (`merge.node`, `merge.relationship`, the `refactor.*` procedures) always counts as a conflicting write, because what it creates is only known once it runs.

---

### 15.3.12. WITH

The `WITH` clause allows query chaining by passing results from one part of a query to another. It can project, filter, aggregate, and paginate intermediate results.

**Syntax:**

```
WITH expression [AS alias] [, expression [AS alias] ...]
[WHERE condition]
[ORDER BY expression [ASC|DESC]]
[SKIP n]
[LIMIT n]
```

**Examples:**

```
// Basic projection
MATCH (p:Person)
WITH p.name AS name, p.age AS age
RETURN name, age ORDER BY name

// Filter after projection
MATCH (p:Person)
WITH p.name AS name, p.age AS age
WHERE age > 30
RETURN name

// Aggregation with WITH
MATCH (p:Person)-[:ACTED_IN]->(m:Movie)
WITH m.title AS movie, count(p) AS actorCount
WHERE actorCount > 2
RETURN movie, actorCount

// WITH DISTINCT
MATCH (p:Person)
WITH DISTINCT p.city AS city
RETURN city ORDER BY city

// Pagination with WITH
MATCH (p:Person)
WITH p.name AS name
ORDER BY name
SKIP 5
```

```
LIMIT 10
RETURN name

// Multiple WITH clauses
MATCH (p:Person)
WITH p.name AS name, p.age AS age
WHERE age > 25
WITH name, age
WHERE age < 50
RETURN name ORDER BY name

// WITH * (pass all variables)
MATCH (p:Person)
WITH *
WHERE p.age > 30
RETURN p.name
```

### 15.3.13. UNWIND

The `UNWIND` clause expands a list into individual rows.

**Syntax:**

```
UNWIND list AS variable
```

**Examples:**

```
// Unwind a literal list
UNWIND [1, 2, 3] AS x
RETURN x

// Unwind with range
UNWIND range(1, 10) AS num
RETURN num

// Unwind property array
MATCH (p:Person {name: 'Alice'})
UNWIND p.hobbies AS hobby
RETURN p.name, hobby

// Create from list
UNWIND ['Alice', 'Bob', 'Charlie'] AS name
CREATE (p:Person {name: name})

// Nested unwind
UNWIND [[1, 2], [3, 4]] AS inner
UNWIND inner AS num
```

```
RETURN num

// Combine with MATCH
MATCH (p:Person)
UNWIND p.skills AS skill
RETURN p.name, skill
```

### 15.3.14. ORDER BY

The `ORDER BY` clause sorts the results.

**Syntax:**

```
ORDER BY expression [ASC|DESC] [, expression [ASC|DESC] ...]
```

**Examples:**

```
// Ascending order (default)
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p.name
ORDER BY p.name

// Descending order
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p.name, p.age
ORDER BY p.age DESC

// Multiple sort keys
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p.name, p.age, p.city
ORDER BY p.city ASC, p.age DESC, p.name ASC
```

Strings are sorted by Unicode code point, the same order an index keeps them in (and the order Neo4j uses). The same order applies to string comparisons (`<`, `>`, ...) and to `min()`/`max()` *(since v26.10.1)*.

### 15.3.15. SKIP and LIMIT

`SKIP` skips a number of results, and `LIMIT` restricts the maximum number of results returned. Used together for pagination.

**Syntax:**

```
SKIP number
```

```
LIMIT number
```

**Examples:**

```
// Limit results
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p.name
LIMIT 10

// Skip results
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p.name
ORDER BY p.name
SKIP 20

// Pagination (page 3, 10 items per page)
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p.name
ORDER BY p.name
SKIP 20
LIMIT 10
```

**LIMIT after a write:** a `LIMIT` that follows a write clause (`CREATE`, `MERGE`, `SET`, `REMOVE`, `DELETE`, `FOREACH`, a write procedure or a subquery that writes) never cuts the write short. The write runs for every matched row first and only then does `LIMIT` trim the rows returned, as in Neo4j. `MATCH (n:Person) SET n.seen = true RETURN n LIMIT 10` therefore updates every `Person` and returns 10 of them. On a large input this means the first row comes back only after all the writes are done.

**Keyset pagination with an index:** when the `ORDER BY` sorts by the indexed property the `MATCH` reads its range from, and the query has a `LIMIT`, the rows are read directly from the index in the requested order: no sort is needed and the scan stops as soon as the page is full, however many nodes match the range. This makes keyset (cursor) pagination fast on large types *(since v26.10.1)*:

```
// Next page: pass the last id of the previous page as $cursor
MATCH (p:Person) WHERE p.id > $cursor
RETURN p.id, p.name ORDER BY p.id LIMIT 10

// Previous page: the index is read backwards
MATCH (p:Person) WHERE p.id < $cursor
RETURN p.id, p.name ORDER BY p.id DESC LIMIT 10

// First page, with no WHERE: nodes without an id still come last
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p.id, p.name ORDER BY p.id LIMIT 10
```

It applies when the query only matches and returns (no `WITH`, `UNWIND`, aggregation or write clause in between), and also works with `SKIP`, `DISTINCT` and relationship expansions from the ordered node.

`EXPLAIN` and `PROFILE` show `[index order]` on the `NodeIndexRangeScan` when it is used.

### 15.3.16. EXPLAIN

The `EXPLAIN` clause shows the query execution plan without actually executing the query. This is useful for understanding how the query optimizer processes your query and for performance tuning.

**Syntax:**

```
EXPLAIN query
```

**Examples:**

```
// Show execution plan for a simple query
EXPLAIN MATCH (p:Person) RETURN p

// Show plan for a relationship traversal
EXPLAIN MATCH (a:Person)-[:KNOWS]->(b:Person) WHERE a.name = 'Alice' RETURN b

// Show plan for a query with aggregation
EXPLAIN MATCH (p:Person) RETURN p.city, count(p)
```

**Output:**

The EXPLAIN output includes:

- Whether the cost-based optimizer is being used
- Physical operators in the execution plan (for optimized queries)
- Estimated costs and row counts
- Index usage information
- An `EAGER (read/write barrier)` step where the query reads its match into memory before writing - see Reads and Writes in the Same Query

```
OpenCypher Native Execution Plan
================================

Using Cost-Based Query Optimizer

Physical Plan:
NodeIndexSeek (Person.name = 'Alice')
   ├──── Estimated Cost: 10.00
   └──── Estimated Rows: 1
```

```
Total Estimated Cost: 10.00
Total Estimated Rows: 1
```

For queries that don't use the optimizer, EXPLAIN shows:

```
OpenCypher Native Execution Plan
================================

Using Traditional Execution (Non-Optimized)

Reason: Query pattern not yet supported by optimizer
Execution will use step-by-step interpretation
```

---

### 15.3.17. PROFILE

The `PROFILE` clause executes the query and returns performance metrics along with the actual results. Unlike `EXPLAIN` which only shows the plan, `PROFILE` runs the query and provides real execution statistics.

**Syntax:**

```
PROFILE query
```

**Examples:**

```
// Profile a simple query
PROFILE MATCH (p:Person) RETURN p.name

// Profile a relationship traversal
PROFILE MATCH (a:Person)-[:KNOWS]->(b:Person) WHERE a.name = 'Alice' RETURN b.name

// Profile a query with aggregation
PROFILE MATCH (p:Person) RETURN p.city, count(p) AS count
```

**Output:**

The PROFILE output includes:

- Execution time in milliseconds
- Number of rows returned
- Query execution plan details (when using optimizer)

```
OpenCypher Query Profile
========================
```

```
Execution Time: 15 ms
Rows Returned: 42

Physical Plan:
NodeTypeScan (Person)
   └──── Estimated Rows: 50

Actual Results Follow...
```

The profile information is returned as the first row in the result set, followed by the actual query results.

### 15.3.18. UNION and UNION ALL

The `UNION` clause combines the results of two or more queries into a single result set. `UNION` removes duplicate rows, while `UNION ALL` keeps all rows including duplicates.

**Syntax:**

```
query1
UNION [ALL]
query2
[UNION [ALL]
query3 ...]
```

All queries in a UNION must return the same column names.

**Examples:**

```
// UNION - removes duplicate results
MATCH (p:Person) RETURN p.name AS name
UNION
MATCH (c:Company) RETURN c.name AS name

// UNION ALL - keeps all results including duplicates
MATCH (p:Person) RETURN p.name AS name
UNION ALL
MATCH (c:Company) RETURN c.name AS name

// Multiple UNIONNs
MATCH (p:Person) RETURN p.name AS name
UNION
MATCH (c:Company) RETURN c.name AS name
UNION
MATCH (l:Location) RETURN l.name AS name
```

```
// UNION with WHERE clauses
MATCH (p:Person) WHERE p.age > 30 RETURN p.name AS name, 'person' AS type
UNION ALL
MATCH (c:Company) WHERE c.employees > 100 RETURN c.name AS name, 'company' AS type
```

**Behavior:**

- `UNION` removes duplicate rows from the combined result (like `SELECT DISTINCT` in SQL)
- `UNION ALL` preserves all rows, including duplicates (more efficient when duplicates are acceptable)
- Results are returned in the order they are produced by each query

---

### 15.3.19. CALL

The `CALL` clause invokes procedures and functions. This includes built-in database procedures as well as custom functions defined via SQL's `DEFINE FUNCTION`.

**Syntax:**

```
[OPTIONAL] CALL procedureName([arguments])
[YIELD field [AS alias] [, field [AS alias] ...]]
[WHERE condition]
```

**Built-in Procedures:**

| Procedure | Description |
|---|---|
| `db.labels()` | Returns all vertex type names (labels) |
| `db.relationshipTypes()` | Returns all edge type names |
| `db.propertyKeys()` | Returns all property keys defined in the schema |
| `db.schema()` | Returns schema visualization data |
| `db.schema.visualization()` | Returns schema visualization data (alias) |

These procedures only return the types the current user is allowed to read, like `SELECT FROM schema:types` in SQL. *(Since v26.10.1)*

**Examples:**

```
// List all vertex types (labels)
CALL db.labels()

// List all relationship types
CALL db.relationshipTypes()
```

```
// List all property keys
CALL db.propertyKeys()

// Get schema information
CALL db.schema()
```

**Vector Search Procedures:**

ArcadeDB provides built-in procedures for performing approximate nearest neighbor (ANN) vector search using HNSW indexes. These are accessible from Cypher via `CALL` and use the same high-performance index as SQL's `vector.neighbors()`.

| Procedure | Description |
|---|---|
| `db.index.vector.queryNodes(indexSpec, k, vector)` | Neo4j-compatible vector search. Returns `node` (the document) and `score` (in [0, 1], higher is better, as in Neo4j: `(1 + cosine) / 2` for COSINE and DOT_PRODUCT, `1 / (1 + d^2)` for EUCLIDEAN) |
| `vector.neighbors(indexSpec, vector, k)` | ArcadeDB-native vector search. Returns document properties and `distance` (lower is better) |

The `indexSpec` parameter uses ArcadeDB's `'Type[property]'` format (e.g., `'Document[embedding]'`).

**Examples:**

```
// Neo4j-compatible syntax — returns node and score (similarity)
CALL db.index.vector.queryNodes('Document[embedding]', 10, $queryVector)
YIELD node, score
RETURN node.title AS title, score
ORDER BY score DESC

// ArcadeDB-native syntax — returns properties and distance
CALL vector.neighbors('Document[embedding]', $queryVector, 10)
YIELD name, distance
RETURN name, distance
ORDER BY distance

// With parameters for k and vector
CALL db.index.vector.queryNodes('Document[embedding]', $k, $vec)
YIELD node, score
RETURN node.title AS title, score

// Search specific child type in an inheritance hierarchy
CALL db.index.vector.queryNodes('EMBEDDING_IMAGE[vector]', 5, $vec)
YIELD node, score
RETURN node.name, score
```

These procedures use the HNSW vector index for fast approximate search (O(log n)). Do **not** use `vector.cosinesimilarity()` inside a `MATCH` loop — that performs a brute-force O(n) scan over all documents. Always use `CALL` with a vector index for production workloads.

**Full-Text Search Procedures:**

ArcadeDB provides built-in procedures for searching a `FULL_TEXT` index (BM25-ranked) directly from Cypher, so text search and graph pattern matching can be combined in one statement. These are Neo4j-compatible equivalents of SQL's `SEARCH_INDEX()`; see the "Full-Text Index" how-to guide for how to create and configure one.

| Procedure | Description |
|---|---|
| `db.index.fulltext.queryNodes(indexName, query [, options])` | Searches a full-text index on a vertex type. Returns `node` and `score` (BM25 relevance, higher is better) |
| `db.index.fulltext.queryRelationships(indexName, query [, options])` | Searches a full-text index on an edge type. Returns `relationship` and `score` |

The `indexName` parameter uses ArcadeDB's `'Type[property]'` format (e.g., `'Article[content]'`), and `query` accepts Lucene query syntax.

Rows come back ordered by descending score, with ties broken by record id. The optional `options` map *(since v26.10.1)* pages over that order with two keys, both non-negative integers: `skip` (rows to drop from the top, default `0`) and `limit` (rows to return, default unlimited). Neo4j also accepts an `analyzer` key; ArcadeDB refuses it by name, because the analyzer is fixed by the index metadata when the index is created and cannot be overridden per query. Any other key is refused too.

**Examples:**

```
// Search and rank by relevance
CALL db.index.fulltext.queryNodes('Article[content]', 'java AND database')
YIELD node, score
RETURN node.title AS title, score
ORDER BY score DESC

// Second page of ten results
CALL db.index.fulltext.queryNodes('Article[content]', 'java AND database', {skip: 10,
limit: 10})
YIELD node, score
RETURN node.title AS title, score

// Search relationships and continue graph pattern matching
CALL db.index.fulltext.queryRelationships('Cites[note]', 'java')
YIELD relationship, score
MATCH (a:Article)-[c:Cites]->(b:Article) WHERE c = relationship
RETURN a.title AS from, b.title AS to, score
ORDER BY score DESC
```

A `MATCH` may follow `CALL … YIELD` directly, as above: the rows the procedure yields feed straight into the pattern, and an intervening `WITH` is not required.

**Calling User Functions:**

User functions defined via SQL's `DEFINE FUNCTION` statement can be called using the `CALL` clause with their namespace. Functions can be defined in SQL, JavaScript, OpenCypher, or Java and are callable from any query language.

```
// Define user functions in different languages
DEFINE FUNCTION math.add "SELECT :a + :b AS result" PARAMETERS [a,b] LANGUAGE sql
DEFINE FUNCTION js.multiply "return x * y" PARAMETERS [x,y] LANGUAGE js
DEFINE FUNCTION cypher.double "RETURN $n * 2" PARAMETERS [n] LANGUAGE opencypher
```

```
// Call user functions from Cypher using CALL clause
CALL math.add(3, 5)
// Returns: {value: 8}

CALL js.multiply(4, 2)
// Returns: {value: 8}

CALL cypher.double(5)
// Returns: {value: 10}

// Or call directly in expressions
RETURN math.add(3, 5) AS sum,
       js.multiply(4, 2) AS product,
       cypher.double(5) AS doubled
// Returns: {sum: 8, product: 8, doubled: 10}
```

See User Functions for complete documentation on defining and using functions.

**Using YIELD:**

The `YIELD` clause filters and renames the columns returned by a procedure:

```
// Get only the label column
CALL db.labels() YIELD label

// Rename the output column
CALL db.labels() YIELD label AS vertexType

// Filter results with WHERE
CALL db.labels() YIELD label
WHERE label STARTS WITH 'P'
RETURN label

// Yield all columns
```

```
CALL db.propertyKeys() YIELD *
```

When calling a custom `DEFINE FUNCTION` (SQL, JavaScript, OpenCypher, or Java), the result is wrapped in a `value` property, regardless of the language it was defined in. Built-in procedures like `db.labels()` return results with specific property names like `label`, `relationshipType`, or `propertyKey`.

**OPTIONAL CALL:**

`OPTIONAL CALL` is to `CALL` what `OPTIONAL MATCH` is to `MATCH`: when the procedure yields no row for an incoming row - none at all, or none that passes the `YIELD ⋯ WHERE` filter - the incoming row is kept and every yielded name is bound to `null`, instead of the row being dropped.

```
// Isolated nodes are returned too, with reached = null
MATCH (s:Person)
OPTIONAL CALL algo.bfs(s) YIELD node
RETURN s.name, node.name AS reached
```

Before v26.11.1 an `OPTIONAL CALL` whose procedure ran but yielded no rows dropped the incoming row, like a plain `CALL`; only a procedure that failed produced the `null` row. Queries such as `MATCH (s) OPTIONAL CALL algo.bfs(s) YIELD node RETURN count(*)` now also count the nodes that reach nothing.

**Subqueries (CALL { ... }):**

Cypher supports subqueries using the `CALL { ⋯ }` syntax. Subqueries are enclosed in curly braces and can import variables from the outer scope using `WITH`.

```
// Basic subquery with imported variable
UNWIND [1, 2, 3] AS x
CALL {
  WITH x
  RETURN x * 10 AS y
}
RETURN x, y

// Subquery with MATCH
MATCH (n:Item)
CALL {
  WITH n
  RETURN n.value * 2 AS doubled
}
RETURN n.name, doubled

// Multiple imported variables
UNWIND [1, 2] AS a
UNWIND [10, 20] AS b
```

```
CALL {
  WITH a, b
  RETURN a + b AS sum
}
RETURN a, b, sum
```

Subqueries allow you to isolate complex query logic, perform computations on imported variables, and return results back to the outer query.

**Subqueries IN TRANSACTIONS:**

When importing large datasets (e.g., from LOAD CSV), you can use `CALL { ⋯ } IN TRANSACTIONS` to commit changes in batches rather than accumulating all changes in a single transaction. This prevents running out of memory and allows progress to be committed incrementally.

```
// Commit every 1000 rows (default batch size)
LOAD CSV WITH HEADERS FROM 'file:///data.csv' AS row
CALL {
  WITH row
  CREATE (n:Person {name: row.name, age: toInteger(row.age)})
} IN TRANSACTIONS

// Custom batch size
LOAD CSV WITH HEADERS FROM 'file:///data.csv' AS row
CALL {
  WITH row
  CREATE (n:Person {name: row.name})
} IN TRANSACTIONS OF 500 ROWS
```

`IN TRANSACTIONS` should not be used inside an already open explicit transaction. The subquery manages its own transaction boundaries.

## 15.3.20. FOREACH

The `FOREACH` clause iterates over a list and executes write operations (CREATE, SET, DELETE, MERGE) for each element. Unlike other clauses, FOREACH does not modify the result set - it passes through the input rows unchanged.

**Syntax:**

```
FOREACH (variable IN list |
  update_clause [update_clause ...]
)
```

**Examples:**

```
// Create multiple nodes from a list
FOREACH (name IN ['Alice', 'Bob', 'Charlie'] |
  CREATE (:Person {name: name})
)

// Create relationships in a loop
CREATE (root:Root {name: 'Main'})
FOREACH (i IN [1, 2, 3] |
  CREATE (root)-[:HAS_ITEM]->(:Item {id: i})
)

// Use with MATCH context
MATCH (p:Person)
FOREACH (tag IN ['developer', 'tester'] |
  CREATE (p)-[:HAS_TAG]->(:Tag {value: tag})
)

// Update properties with SET
MATCH (item:Item)
WITH collect(item) AS items
FOREACH (item IN items |
  SET item.status = 'processed', item.timestamp = timestamp()
)

// FOREACH passes through input rows
CREATE (root:Root {name: 'test'})
FOREACH (i IN [1, 2] |
  CREATE (:Child {id: i})
)
RETURN root.name AS name
// Returns: {name: 'test'}
```

**Important Notes:**

- FOREACH can only contain write operations (CREATE, SET, DELETE, MERGE)
- FOREACH does not modify the result set - it passes input rows through unchanged, and an empty list therefore leaves the query's rows exactly as they were
- Variables defined inside FOREACH are not visible outside the clause
- FOREACH is useful for batch operations and creating multiple elements from lists
- What a FOREACH body writes is subject to Reads and Writes in the Same Query like any other write

---

### 15.3.21. LOAD CSV

The `LOAD CSV` clause reads data from a CSV file (local or remote) and makes each row available as a variable for further query processing. This is the primary mechanism for bulk-importing data into

ArcadeDB from CSV files.

**Syntax:**

```
LOAD CSV FROM <url> AS <variable>
LOAD CSV WITH HEADERS FROM <url> AS <variable>
LOAD CSV WITH HEADERS FROM <url> AS <variable> FIELDTERMINATOR <delimiter>
```

- **Without `WITH HEADERS`**: Each row is bound as a list of strings. Access fields by index: `row[0]`, `row[1]`, etc.
- **With `WITH HEADERS`**: The first row is treated as column names. Each subsequent row is bound as a map. Access fields by name: `row.name`, `row['age']`, etc.
- **FIELDTERMINATOR**: Specify a custom field delimiter (default is `,`). Example: `FIELDTERMINATOR ';'` for semicolon-separated files.

**Basic Examples:**

```
// Load CSV without headers (list access)
LOAD CSV FROM 'file:///people.csv' AS row
CREATE (:Person {name: row[0], age: toInteger(row[1])})

// Load CSV with headers (map access)
LOAD CSV WITH HEADERS FROM 'file:///people.csv' AS row
CREATE (:Person {name: row.name, age: toInteger(row.age)})

// Custom field delimiter
LOAD CSV WITH HEADERS FROM 'file:///data.tsv' AS row FIELDTERMINATOR '\t'
RETURN row.name, row.value

// Load from HTTP URL
LOAD CSV WITH HEADERS FROM 'https://example.com/data.csv' AS row
CREATE (:Item {id: row.id, label: row.label})
```

**Bulk Import with CALL IN TRANSACTIONS:**

For large files, combine `LOAD CSV` with `CALL { ⋯ } IN TRANSACTIONS` to commit in batches and avoid memory issues:

```
LOAD CSV WITH HEADERS FROM 'file:///large-dataset.csv' AS row
CALL {
  WITH row
  CREATE (p:Person {name: row.name, email: row.email})
} IN TRANSACTIONS OF 1000 ROWS
```

**Compressed Files:**

LOAD CSV transparently decompresses `.gz` (gzip) and `.zip` files:

```
// Gzip compressed
LOAD CSV WITH HEADERS FROM 'file:///data.csv.gz' AS row
RETURN row.name

// ZIP compressed (reads the first entry in the archive)
LOAD CSV WITH HEADERS FROM 'file:///data.csv.zip' AS row
RETURN row.name
```

**CSV Quoting:**

Quoted fields follow RFC 4180 and also support backslash escaping:

- Fields containing the delimiter, newlines, or quotes must be enclosed in double quotes
- Embedded quotes can be escaped as `""` (RFC 4180) or `\"` (backslash escaping)
- Quoted fields can span multiple lines

**Security Configuration:**

LOAD CSV file access is controlled by two configuration settings:

| Setting | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `arcadedb.opencypher.loadCsv.allowFileUrls` | `true` | Allow access to local files via `file:///` URLs and bare file paths. Set to `false` in multi-tenant server deployments. |
| `arcadedb.opencypher.loadCsv.importDirectory` | (empty) | Root directory for file URLs. When set, file paths are resolved relative to this directory and path traversal (`../`) is blocked. Empty means no restriction. |

HTTP/HTTPS URLs are always allowed regardless of these settings.

**Example — Restrict to import directory:**

```
// In server configuration
arcadedb.opencypher.loadCsv.importDirectory=/var/arcadedb/import
```

```
// This works (resolved to /var/arcadedb/import/data.csv)
LOAD CSV FROM 'file:///data.csv' AS row RETURN row

// This is blocked (path traversal)
LOAD CSV FROM 'file:///../etc/passwd' AS row RETURN row
```

**Built-in Helper Functions:**

Two special functions are available within LOAD CSV queries:

- `file()` — Returns the URL of the currently loaded CSV file
- `linenumber()` — Returns the current line number being processed (1-based)

Both functions work anywhere in the rest of the query following `LOAD CSV`, including inside a `WHERE` predicate — not only in `RETURN`/`WITH` projections — and they remain valid even after a `WITH` that does not re-project the CSV row variable, and after a `WITH … ORDER BY`. This makes `WITH row WHERE linenumber() > 1 …`, the common idiom for skipping a header row, work as expected.

Both functions describe the CSV row currently being processed, so an aggregation ends them: after a clause such as `WITH collect(row) AS rows` or `WITH count(*) AS total`, many rows have been folded into one and there is no single line for `linenumber()` to report, so `file()` and `linenumber()` return `null` for the rest of the query — including after an `UNWIND` that expands the collected list back into rows. This matches Neo4j. If you need the file or line further downstream, capture it into a variable before the aggregation, for example `WITH row, file() AS csvFile, linenumber() AS csvLine`.

## 15.3.22. CREATE CONSTRAINT

The `CREATE CONSTRAINT` clause defines schema constraints on node or relationship properties. Constraints enforce data integrity rules such as uniqueness, mandatory (NOT NULL), and node keys.

ArcadeDB maps Cypher constraints to its native schema features:

- **IS UNIQUE** → Creates a unique LSM-Tree index on the specified properties
- **IS NOT NULL** → Sets the property as mandatory in the schema
- **IS NODE KEY** / **IS KEY** → Creates a unique index and sets the property as mandatory
- **IS TYPED** `<type>` → Declares the property's data type in the schema (see IS TYPED data types)

**Syntax:**

```
CREATE CONSTRAINT [name] [IF NOT EXISTS]
FOR (variable:Label)
REQUIRE variable.property IS UNIQUE

CREATE CONSTRAINT [name] [IF NOT EXISTS]
FOR (variable:Label)
REQUIRE variable.property IS NOT NULL

CREATE CONSTRAINT [name] [IF NOT EXISTS]
FOR (variable:Label)
REQUIRE variable.property IS NODE KEY

CREATE CONSTRAINT [name] [IF NOT EXISTS]
FOR (variable:Label)
```

```
REQUIRE variable.property IS TYPED <type>
```

**`IS**

<type>` is a synonym of `IS TYPED <type>`.

**Examples:**

```
// Unique constraint on a single property
CREATE CONSTRAINT FOR (p:Person) REQUIRE p.email IS UNIQUE

// Named constraint with IF NOT EXISTS (idempotent)
CREATE CONSTRAINT unique_person_email IF NOT EXISTS
FOR (p:Person) REQUIRE p.email IS UNIQUE

// Composite unique constraint (multiple properties)
CREATE CONSTRAINT FOR (p:Person) REQUIRE (p.firstName, p.lastName) IS UNIQUE

// NOT NULL constraint (mandatory property)
CREATE CONSTRAINT FOR (p:Person) REQUIRE p.name IS NOT NULL

// Node key constraint (unique + mandatory)
CREATE CONSTRAINT FOR (p:Person) REQUIRE p.id IS NODE KEY

// Relationship constraint
CREATE CONSTRAINT FOR ()-[r:KNOWS]-() REQUIRE r.since IS NOT NULL

// Typed constraint: declare the property's data type
CREATE CONSTRAINT FOR (m:Measure) REQUIRE m.temperature IS TYPED FLOAT32
CREATE CONSTRAINT FOR (p:Person) REQUIRE p.age IS TYPED INT16

// Typed constraint on a list: declares the property as LIST OF STRING
CREATE CONSTRAINT FOR (p:Person) REQUIRE p.tags IS :: LIST<STRING NOT NULL>
```

If the property does not already exist in the schema, ArcadeDB will automatically create it as a STRING type. For other types, define the property first using SQL (`ALTER TYPE Person CREATE PROPERTY email STRING`).

`IF NOT EXISTS` makes the operation idempotent — running it multiple times will not cause an error if the constraint already exists.

**Constraint names:**

*(Since v26.11.1)* A constraint created without a name gets a generated one, `constraint_<Label>_<property>[<property>…]<kind>`, where the kind is `unique`, `key`, `existence` (for `IS NOT NULL`) or `type` (for `IS TYPED`):

| Statement | Generated name |
| --- | --- |
| `CREATE CONSTRAINT FOR (p:Person) REQUIRE p.email IS UNIQUE` | `constraint_Person_email_unique` |
| `CREATE CONSTRAINT FOR (p:Person) REQUIRE (p.firstName, p.lastName) IS UNIQUE` | `constraint_Person_firstName_lastName_unique` |
| `CREATE CONSTRAINT FOR (p:Person) REQUIRE p.id IS NODE KEY` | `constraint_Person_id_key` |
| `CREATE CONSTRAINT FOR (p:Person) REQUIRE p.name IS NOT NULL` | `constraint_Person_name_existence` |
| `CREATE CONSTRAINT FOR (p:Person) REQUIRE p.age IS TYPED INT16` | `constraint_Person_age_type` |

The name is derived from the statement, so repeating the same unnamed statement does not create a second constraint. It is the name `SHOW CONSTRAINTS` lists and `DROP CONSTRAINT` takes.

*(Since v26.11.1)* A property carries one property type constraint at most: a second `IS TYPED` constraint that requires a different type of the same property is refused, as in Neo4j. Drop the first one before creating the other.

**When existence constraints are checked:**

A property declared mandatory with `IS NOT NULL` (or `IS NODE KEY`) is checked when the statement finishes, not at the instant the node or relationship is created. This is what makes the standard upsert work, since the `SET` supplies the property after the pattern has created the node:

```
CREATE CONSTRAINT rec_org_exists IF NOT EXISTS FOR (n:Record) REQUIRE n.orgId IS NOT NULL;

MERGE (n:Record {id: $id}) SET n.orgId = $orgId RETURN n
```

Any clause of the same statement may supply the property. A statement that ends without supplying it fails, and the incomplete record is removed.

Only `CREATE`/`MERGE` pattern writes are deferred this way. Every other constraint (`IS TYPED`, `min`, `max`, regular expressions, read-only) is still checked at the moment of the write, as are writes issued from SQL, the Java API and `CALL` procedures.

Between the pattern creating the record and the statement ending, another connection can briefly read a record that does not yet satisfy its existence constraints. If the server stops in that window, the incomplete record is left behind.

A record left behind that way is not lost track of: it is, by definition, a record that does not satisfy its own type's existence constraints, and *since v26.10.1* `CHECK DATABASE` asks exactly that question of every record it scans. The findings come back under `constraintViolatingRecords`, and `CHECK DATABASE FIX DELETE INVALID RECORDS` removes them; a record that holds data worth keeping is instead completed by a single `UPDATE` supplying every missing property. See Existence constraints.

**IS TYPED data types:**

`IS TYPED <type>` declares the property's data type in the schema. ArcadeDB maps the ISO/IEC 39075 (GQL) type names onto its native types. Numeric values are stored and reloaded at the declared width, so a value written to a property declared `IS TYPED INT16` round-trips as a 16-bit integer and continues to satisfy the `x IS TYPED INT16` value-type predicate.

| GQL / Cypher type | ArcadeDB type | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| `BOOLEAN`, `BOOL` | `BOOLEAN` | |
| `STRING`, `VARCHAR` | `STRING` | |
| `INT8`, `INTEGER8` | `BYTE` | 8-bit signed integer |
| `INT16`, `INTEGER16` | `SHORT` | 16-bit signed integer |
| `INT`, `INT32`, `INTEGER32` | `INTEGER` | 32-bit signed integer (`INT` is the alias for `INT32`) |
| `INTEGER`, `INT64`, `INTEGER64`, `SIGNED INTEGER` | `LONG` | 64-bit signed integer (`INTEGER` is the generic integer type) |
| `FLOAT32` | `FLOAT` | 32-bit IEEE 754 floating point |
| `FLOAT`, `FLOAT64` | `DOUBLE` | 64-bit IEEE 754 floating point |
| `DATE` | `DATE` | |
| `LOCAL DATETIME`, `TIMESTAMP WITHOUT TIME ZONE` | `DATETIME_NANOS` | Nanosecond precision. A property already declared `DATETIME`, `DATETIME_SECOND` or `DATETIME_MICROS` is left at its precision |
| `ZONED DATETIME`, `TIMESTAMP WITH TIME ZONE` | `ZONED_DATETIME` | Keeps the zone |
| `LOCAL TIME`, `TIME WITHOUT TIME ZONE` | `LOCAL_TIME` | |
| `ZONED TIME`, `TIME WITH TIME ZONE` | `OFFSET_TIME` | Keeps the offset |
| `DURATION` | `DURATION` | |
| `POINT` | `MAP` | The map `point()` returns |
| `LIST<T>`, `T LIST`, `ARRAY<T>`, `LIST<T NOT NULL>` | `LIST OF` the type `T` maps to | For example `LIST<INTEGER>` is `LIST OF LONG`, `LIST<FLOAT>` is `LIST OF DOUBLE`, `LIST<INT32>` is `LIST OF INTEGER`, `LIST<DATE>` is `LIST OF DATE` |
| `LIST`, `LIST<ANY>` | `LIST` | A list with no element type |
| `MAP` | `MAP` | |

The `LOCAL DATETIME`, `ZONED DATETIME`, `LOCAL TIME`, `ZONED TIME` and `DURATION` types map onto the native ArcadeDB types that hold the value without loss (see Managing Dates). A list of lists (`LIST<LIST<STRING>>`) and a union type (`STRING | INTEGER`) cannot be declared and are refused.

**A `NOT NULL` on the type itself, as in `REQUIRE n.p IS`**

STRING NOT NULL`, is refused, as in Neo4j: existence is a constraint of its own. Declare the type and add an existence constraint:

```
CREATE CONSTRAINT FOR (p:Person) REQUIRE p.name IS :: STRING
CREATE CONSTRAINT FOR (p:Person) REQUIRE p.name IS NOT NULL
```

A `NOT NULL` on the element type of a list (`LIST<STRING NOT NULL>`) is accepted.

Following Cypher 25 / GQL, `INTEGER` is the 64-bit generic integer type while `INT` is the alias for the 32-bit `INT32`. A property declared `IS TYPED INT` therefore holds 32-bit values; use `IS TYPED INTEGER` (or `INT64`) for 64-bit values.

**When upgrading to 26.11.1**: before, a property type constraint refused a list with an element type (`LIST<STRING>`), `LOCAL DATETIME` and `ZONED DATETIME` declared a `DATETIME` (millisecond precision, which truncated the sub-millisecond digits and dropped the zone), `LOCAL TIME` and `ZONED TIME` declared a `STRING`, `DURATION` declared a `LONG` (which refused every duration value) and `POINT` declared a `STRING`. A constraint created before 26.11.1 keeps the declaration it made then.

### 15.3.23. DROP CONSTRAINT

The `DROP CONSTRAINT` clause removes a previously created constraint by its name: the name given in `CREATE CONSTRAINT`, the generated name of a constraint created without one, or any name `SHOW CONSTRAINTS` lists.

**Syntax:**

```
DROP CONSTRAINT constraintName [IF EXISTS]
```

**Examples:**

```
// Drop a constraint by name
DROP CONSTRAINT constraint_Person_email_unique

// Drop the constraint that created the unique index Person[email]
DROP CONSTRAINT `Person[email]`

// Drop only if it exists (no error if missing)
DROP CONSTRAINT `Person[email]` IF EXISTS
```

The name of the unique index a `UNIQUE` or `NODE KEY` constraint created is accepted too, and drops the constraint that created it: an unnamed `NODE KEY` dropped by its index name is dropped whole, index and existence requirement. Use backtick escaping for names containing special characters like brackets.

`IF EXISTS` makes the operation safe to run even when the constraint does not exist.

**What dropping a constraint undoes:**

*(Since v26.11.1)* `DROP CONSTRAINT` undoes what the constraint created:

- A `UNIQUE` constraint drops its unique index, a `NOT NULL` constraint clears the mandatory flag it set, and a `NODE KEY` / `KEY` constraint does both.
- A property type constraint (`IS TYPED`) lifts the type restriction. If the constraint declared the property, the declaration is removed. If it replaced an earlier declaration, for example one made with SQL `CREATE PROPERTY`, that declaration is put back; when records written since cannot be read as the old type, the drop is refused and the constraint stays in place.
- While another constraint still needs the declaration, the type stays until that one is dropped too: a `NOT NULL` constraint needs a declared property to carry its mandatory flag, and a `UNIQUE` index is built over the declared type.
- A requirement the schema enforces without a Cypher constraint, which `SHOW CONSTRAINTS` lists under a generated name, is dropped the same way: `constraint_<Type>_<property>_existence` clears the property's `MANDATORY` and `NOT NULL` flags, `constraint_<Type>_<property>_type` removes the property declaration (refused while the declaration also carries an index or other attributes, such as a default or a min/max, that would go with it), and the name of a unique index drops the index.

**When upgrading to 26.11.1**: before, dropping a property type constraint left the property declared with the constraint's type, so the type restriction stayed in force after the constraint was gone.

## 15.3.24. SHOW CONSTRAINTS

`SHOW CONSTRAINTS` lists the constraints of the database with Neo4j's syntax and columns, so the tools and drivers written for Neo4j read it unchanged. *(Since v26.11.1)* It is answered by the openCypher engine, so it works the same over every protocol that runs Cypher: HTTP, Studio, Bolt and the embedded Java API.

**Syntax:**

```
SHOW [ALL] CONSTRAINTS
SHOW [NODE | RELATIONSHIP] {UNIQUE | UNIQUENESS | EXIST | EXISTENCE | KEY | PROPERTY
TYPE} CONSTRAINTS
```

The keyword before `CONSTRAINTS` restricts the list to one kind of constraint, and a preceding `NODE` or `RELATIONSHIP` to the constraints of vertex types or of edge types. The command accepts `YIELD`, `WHERE`, `ORDER BY`, `SKIP`, `LIMIT` and `RETURN` like every `SHOW` command, see Filtering the output of a SHOW command.

**Result columns:**

| Column | Description |
| --- | --- |
| `id` | A sequence number of the row |
| `name` | The constraint name, the one `DROP CONSTRAINT` takes |
| `type` | `UNIQUENESS`, `RELATIONSHIP_UNIQUENESS`, `NODE_KEY`, `RELATIONSHIP_KEY`, `NODE_PROPERTY_EXISTENCE`, `RELATIONSHIP_PROPERTY_EXISTENCE`, `NODE_PROPERTY_TYPE` or `RELATIONSHIP_PROPERTY_TYPE` |
| `entityType` | `NODE` or `RELATIONSHIP` |
| `labelsOrTypes` | The label or relationship type, as a list |
| `properties` | The constrained properties, as a list |
| `ownedIndex` | The unique index that enforces a uniqueness or key constraint, otherwise `null` |
| `propertyType` | The Cypher type a property type constraint requires, otherwise `null` |

`YIELD *` adds the columns `enforcedLabel`, `options` and `createStatement`, the `CREATE CONSTRAINT` statement that recreates the constraint.

The list shows what the schema enforces, whether it was created with Cypher, SQL or the Java API. A requirement that no Cypher constraint created is listed as follows:

- a unique index, as a uniqueness constraint named after the index;
- a property declared `MANDATORY` or `NOT NULL`, as an existence constraint named `constraint_<Type>_<property>_existence`;
- a declared property type, as a property type constraint named `constraint_<Type>_<property>_type`.

Every name the list shows can be dropped with `DROP CONSTRAINT`. The types the user is not allowed to read are left out.

**Examples:**

```
// Every constraint
SHOW CONSTRAINTS

// The uniqueness constraints of vertex types
SHOW NODE UNIQUENESS CONSTRAINTS

// The property type constraints of one label
SHOW PROPERTY TYPE CONSTRAINTS YIELD name, labelsOrTypes, properties, propertyType
WHERE 'Person' IN labelsOrTypes

// The statements that recreate them
SHOW CONSTRAINTS YIELD name, createStatement ORDER BY name
```

### 15.3.25. CREATE INDEX / DROP INDEX

`CREATE INDEX` creates a (non-unique) `LSM_TREE` index on one or more properties of a label or relationship type, with Neo4j's syntax. `RANGE` is accepted as a synonym of the plain form.

```
CREATE INDEX person_name FOR (p:Person) ON (p.name)
CREATE INDEX IF NOT EXISTS FOR (p:Person) ON (p.firstName, p.lastName)
CREATE INDEX follows_since FOR ()-[r:FOLLOWS]-() ON (r.since)

DROP INDEX person_name
DROP INDEX person_name IF EXISTS
```

*(Since v26.11.1)* The index is created under the name the statement gives it, which is the name `SHOW INDEXES` lists, `DROP INDEX` takes, and SQL sees. An index created without a name is named `<Type>[<property>,⋯]`, for example `Person[name]`: use backtick escaping to drop it, `DROP INDEX` `` `Person[name]` ``. Before 26.11.1 the name was ignored, so `DROP INDEX person_name` dropped nothing.

Index and constraint names share one namespace, as in Neo4j:

- a name already taken by an index or a constraint is refused, and with `IF NOT EXISTS` the statement does nothing;
- an index already defined on the same properties is refused under another name, and with `IF NOT EXISTS` the statement does nothing;
- `DROP INDEX` of a name no index has raises an error unless `IF EXISTS` is given;
- the index a `UNIQUE` or `NODE KEY` constraint created is dropped with `DROP CONSTRAINT`: `DROP INDEX` refuses it, since the constraint would stay listed with nothing enforcing it.

---

### 15.3.26. SHOW INDEXES

`SHOW INDEXES` lists the indexes of the database with Neo4j's syntax and columns. *(Since v26.11.1)* Like `SHOW CONSTRAINTS`, it is answered by the openCypher engine over every protocol (HTTP, Studio, Bolt, embedded).

**Syntax:**

```
SHOW [ALL | RANGE | TEXT | POINT | VECTOR | FULLTEXT | LOOKUP] INDEXES
```

The keyword after `SHOW` restricts the list to one type of index, matched against the `type` column. ArcadeDB has no `TEXT` or `LOOKUP` index, so those two list nothing. `YIELD`, `WHERE`, `ORDER BY`, `SKIP`, `LIMIT` and `RETURN` work as on every `SHOW` command.

**Result columns:**

| Column | Description |
|---|---|
| `id` | A sequence number of the row |
| `name` | The index name |
| `state` | `ONLINE`, or `POPULATING` while the index is being built |
| `populationPercent` | `100.0` when the index is online, otherwise `0.0` |
| `type` | `RANGE` (an `LSM_TREE` index), `HASH`, `FULLTEXT`, `VECTOR`, `SPARSE_VECTOR` or `POINT` (a geospatial index) |
| `entityType` | `NODE` or `RELATIONSHIP` |
| `labelsOrTypes` | The label or relationship type, as a list |
| `properties` | The indexed properties, as a list |
| `indexProvider` | The index implementation, for example `range-1.0` |
| `owningConstraint` | The name of the constraint that created the index (for a unique index created without a constraint, the index name, which is the name `SHOW CONSTRAINTS` lists it under), otherwise `null` |
| `lastRead`, `readCount` | Always `null`: ArcadeDB does not track index reads |

`YIELD *` adds the columns `trackedSince`, `options`, `failureMessage` and `createStatement`.

**Examples:**

```
// Every index
SHOW INDEXES

// The indexes no constraint owns
SHOW INDEXES YIELD name, type, labelsOrTypes, properties, owningConstraint
WHERE owningConstraint IS NULL

// Count the vector indexes
SHOW VECTOR INDEXES YIELD name RETURN count(name) AS total
```

### 15.3.27. SHOW USERS

The `SHOW USERS` command lists all users configured on the server, along with the databases each user has access to.

This command requires ArcadeDB to be running in **server mode** (it does not work in embedded mode). See Security - Users for more information about the ArcadeDB security model.

All user management commands are non-idempotent and require a POST request (command endpoint) when executed via the HTTP API.

**Syntax:**

```
SHOW USERS
```

**Result columns:**

| Column | Description |
|---|---|
| `user` | The user name |
| `databases` | The set of databases the user has access to (`*` means all databases) |

**Examples:**

```
// List all users
SHOW USERS

// Only the rows that match
SHOW USERS WHERE user = $name

// Pick the columns to return
SHOW USERS YIELD user WHERE user STARTS WITH 'app_'
```

**Filtering the output of a SHOW command:**

Every `SHOW` command accepts an optional trailing `WHERE`, or a `YIELD` that selects columns and may itself be followed by `ORDER BY`, `SKIP`, `LIMIT`, `WHERE` and `RETURN`:

```
SHOW DATABASES WHERE name = $dbName
SHOW DATABASES YIELD name, currentStatus WHERE name STARTS WITH 'prod'
SHOW DATABASES YIELD name ORDER BY name SKIP 1 LIMIT 5
SHOW INDEXES YIELD name, type RETURN count(name) AS total
```

The filter is evaluated by the Cypher engine, so operators, functions and query parameters behave exactly as they do in any other query. Checking whether a database exists is therefore a matter of asking for it by name and seeing whether a row comes back:

```
SHOW DATABASES WHERE name = $dbName
```

A trailing `;` is accepted. A `UNION` of several commands is answered branch by branch, so a trailing clause there applies only within its own branch.

## 15.3.28. SHOW CURRENT USER

The `SHOW CURRENT USER` command returns information about the currently authenticated user

executing the query.

**Syntax:**

```
SHOW CURRENT USER
```

**Result columns:**

| Column | Description |
|---|---|
| `user` | The current user name |
| `databases` | The set of databases the current user has access to |

**Examples:**

```
// Show the currently authenticated user
SHOW CURRENT USER
```

---

## 15.3.29. CREATE USER

The `CREATE USER` command creates a new user on the server with the specified password. The new user is assigned to the `admin` group on all databases (`*`) by default.

**Syntax:**

```
CREATE USER username SET PASSWORD 'password'

CREATE USER username IF NOT EXISTS SET PASSWORD 'password'
```

**Examples:**

```
// Create a new user
CREATE USER bob SET PASSWORD 'SecurePass123!'

// Create a user only if it doesn't already exist (idempotent)
CREATE USER bob IF NOT EXISTS SET PASSWORD 'SecurePass123!'
```

The password is stored hashed using PBKDF2 — it is never stored in plain text. See Security - Users for details on password storage.

`IF NOT EXISTS` makes the operation safe to run multiple times without error if the user already exists.

### 15.3.30. DROP USER

The `DROP USER` command removes a user from the server.

**Syntax:**

```
DROP USER username

DROP USER username IF EXISTS
```

**Examples:**

```
// Drop a user (error if user doesn't exist)
DROP USER bob

// Drop a user only if it exists (no error if missing)
DROP USER bob IF EXISTS
```

`IF EXISTS` makes the operation safe to run even when the user does not exist.

### 15.3.31. ALTER USER

The `ALTER USER` command changes the password of an existing user.

**Syntax:**

```
ALTER USER username SET PASSWORD 'newPassword'
```

**Examples:**

```
// Change a user's password
ALTER USER bob SET PASSWORD 'NewSecurePass456!'
```

The user must already exist. If the user does not exist, an error is returned.

### 15.3.32. SHOW TRANSACTIONS and TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS

`SHOW TRANSACTIONS` lists the statements the server is running and `TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS` stops them, with Neo4j's syntax, so the tools and scripts written for Neo4j work unchanged. Available since 26.11.1.

Both commands read the same registry as the HTTP `list queries` and `terminate query` server commands: a "transaction" here is one running statement, whatever protocol it came from (HTTP, PostgreSQL, Bolt, gRPC, MongoDB, Redis, Gremlin), and its `transactionId` is the id `list queries` shows (`q<n>-<hex>`). The same rule decides what you see: **root** sees and stops every statement, any other user only their own.

These commands require ArcadeDB to be running in **server mode**. They work over Bolt and every other protocol that runs Cypher; in embedded mode they fail with "SHOW TRANSACTIONS and TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS require a server". On an HA cluster each server answers for its own statements: the commands run on the server that receives them, a replica included, and are not forwarded to the leader.

**Syntax:**

```
SHOW TRANSACTIONS [ 'id' [, 'id' ...] | $ids ]
  [ WHERE ... | YIELD ... [ORDER BY ...] [SKIP ...] [LIMIT ...] [WHERE ...] [RETURN
...] ]
  [ TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS ... ]

TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS 'id' [, 'id' ...] | $ids
  [ WHERE ... | YIELD ... [WHERE ...] [RETURN ...] ]
```

`$ids` is a parameter holding one id or a list of ids. The `WHERE` and `YIELD` tail works as for every other `SHOW` command, see Filtering the output of a SHOW command. A `SHOW TRANSACTIONS` can be followed by a `TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS` that names the ids by a column the `SHOW` yields, which stops the statements the `SHOW` rows select (see the last example).

**Result columns of `SHOW TRANSACTIONS`:**

A bare `SHOW TRANSACTIONS` returns Neo4j's default columns:

| Column | Description |
|---|---|
| `database` | The database the statement runs on |
| `transactionId` | The statement's id, as `list queries` shows it |
| `currentQueryId` | The same id |
| `connectionId` | The client connection, when the protocol has one (a PostgreSQL backend process id, `bolt-<n>`, ...), otherwise an empty string |
| `clientAddress` | The client's address, when known, otherwise an empty string |
| `username` | The user running the statement |
| `currentQuery` | The statement text, truncated and with credentials masked as in `list queries` |
| `startTime` | When the statement started, as an ISO-8601 string |

| Column | Description |
|---|---|
| `status` | `Running`, or `Terminating` once it was asked to stop |
| `elapsedTime` | How long it has been running, as a `Duration` |

`YIELD` also reaches these columns:

| Column | Description |
|---|---|
| `protocol` | How the statement reached the server: `http`, `postgres`, `bolt`, `grpc`, `mongodb`, `redis` or `gremlin` |
| `language` | The query language of the statement |
| `metaData` | A map; its `tag` is the label the client sent with the `X-ArcadeDB-Query-Tag` HTTP header |
| `sessionId` | The HTTP transaction session the statement runs in, if any |
| `statusDetails` | Who asked the statement to stop, once it is terminating |

**Result columns of `TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS`:**

| Column | Description |
|---|---|
| `transactionId` | The id that was asked for |
| `username` | The user running the statement |
| `message` | `Transaction terminated.`, or `Transaction not found.` when no such statement is running or it is another user's |

Like Neo4j, `TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS` does not wait for the statement to stop: it asks it to stop and answers. The statement stops at its next check and its client receives the error of its protocol (for example `Neo.ClientError.Transaction.Terminated` over Bolt, SQLSTATE `57014` over PostgreSQL). Use `SHOW TRANSACTIONS`, or `terminate query` with its `wait`, to know when it is gone.

**Examples:**

```
// Every statement you may see, with Neo4j's default columns
SHOW TRANSACTIONS

// Some statements by id
SHOW TRANSACTIONS 'q118-5e1f0a9c', 'q121-5e1f0a9c'
SHOW TRANSACTIONS $ids

// The statements labelled by a benchmark run, with where they came from
SHOW TRANSACTIONS YIELD transactionId, username, protocol, language, metaData,
elapsedTime
WHERE metaData.tag = 'bench-run-42'
```

```
// Stop statements by id
TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS 'q118-5e1f0a9c', 'q121-5e1f0a9c'
TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS $ids YIELD transactionId, message

// Find and stop in one command every statement carrying a label
SHOW TRANSACTIONS YIELD transactionId AS txId, metaData WHERE metaData.tag = 'bench-
run-42'
TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS txId
YIELD transactionId, message
RETURN transactionId, message
```

### 15.3.33. Transaction Control (START TRANSACTION, COMMIT, ROLLBACK)

ISO/IEC 39075 (GQL) transaction control statements manage a transaction from within the query language, in addition to the driver/HTTP API. A transaction opened with `START TRANSACTION` stays open across subsequent commands and is finalized only by an explicit `COMMIT` or `ROLLBACK`. They mirror the SQL `BEGIN` / `COMMIT` / `ROLLBACK` statements.

**Syntax:**

```
START TRANSACTION [ISOLATION <READ_COMMITTED | REPEATABLE_READ>]
COMMIT
ROLLBACK
```

**Examples:**

```
START TRANSACTION
CREATE (p:Person {name: 'Alice'})
CREATE (p:Person {name: 'Bob'})
COMMIT

// Discard the work instead
START TRANSACTION
CREATE (p:Person {name: 'Charlie'})
ROLLBACK
```

The optional `ISOLATION` clause is an ArcadeDB extension — GQL does not define isolation levels for `START TRANSACTION`. It accepts `READ_COMMITTED` (the default) or `REPEATABLE_READ`, matching the SQL `BEGIN ISOLATION` statement.

To span multiple requests the transaction needs a stateful session. Over HTTP, pass a session id (the `arcadedb-session-id` header); over Bolt, the connection provides the session. Over stateless HTTP without a session each request runs in its own transaction.

`COMMIT` with no active transaction reports an error; `ROLLBACK` with no active transaction is a no-op. A second `START TRANSACTION` while one is already active opens a nested transaction (as with SQL `BEGIN`). The GQL access modes `READ ONLY` / `READ WRITE` are not implemented (ArcadeDB has no read-only transaction mode); `START TRANSACTION READ ONLY` reports a parse error.

### 15.3.34. Session Management (SESSION SET, SESSION RESET, SESSION CLOSE)

ISO/IEC 39075 (GQL) session management statements operate on the current server session:

- **SESSION SET** `$name = <value>` binds a named query parameter on the session. Subsequent commands in the same session see it as `$name` (a value supplied with the request wins on a name clash). The value may reference an earlier session parameter.
- **SESSION RESET** clears the session parameters.
- **SESSION CLOSE** releases the session.

**Syntax:**

```
SESSION SET $parameter = <value>
SESSION RESET
SESSION CLOSE
```

**Examples:**

```
SESSION SET $threshold = 21
MATCH (p:Person) WHERE p.age >= $threshold RETURN p.name
SESSION RESET
SESSION CLOSE
```

Session statements require a server session — over HTTP the `arcadedb-session-id` header, over Bolt the connection. In embedded mode they report an actionable error. Session parameters are resolved by the OpenCypher engine, so they apply to both the `/command` and `/query` endpoints.

`SESSION CLOSE` is transport-specific: over HTTP it also rolls back the session transaction and invalidates the session id, whereas over Bolt it clears the session parameters and leaves the connection (and its transaction) live.

Session state is node-local and is not replicated across an HA cluster. In an HA setup without session affinity, a `SESSION SET` on one node followed by a query routed to another node will not see the parameter.

# 15.4. Expressions and Functions

This section describes the expressions and functions available in ArcadeDB's OpenCypher implementation.

## 15.4.1. Literals

| Type | Syntax | Example |
|---|---|---|
| Integer | `123`, `-456` | `RETURN 42` |
| Float | `3.14`, `-2.5` | `RETURN 3.14159` |
| String | `'text'`, `"text"` | `RETURN 'Hello'` |
| Boolean | `true`, `false` | `RETURN true` |
| Null | `null` | `RETURN null` |
| List | `[1, 2, 3]` | `RETURN [1, 'a', true]` |
| Map | `{key: value}` | `RETURN {name: 'Alice', age: 30}` |

## 15.4.2. Property Access

Access properties using dot notation:

```
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p.name, p.age, p.address.city
```

A property can also be read with the subscript form `p['name']`, through `properties(p)` (`properties(p).name`, `properties(p)['name']`), and across a `LINK` property (`a.link.name`, `a.link['name']`). *(Since v26.11.1)* `a.link['name']` on a `LINK` property reads through the link like `a.link.name`; before, it returned `null`.

**Comparing a property declared in the schema:**

*(Since v26.11.1)* A value written into a declared property is converted to the declared type, and the declaration also decides how a text is read. A property declared `STRING` stores the text of what is written into it (writing `1` stores `'1'`), and a property declared with any other scalar type (`INTEGER`, `LONG`, `FLOAT`, `DOUBLE`, `DECIMAL`, `BOOLEAN`, `DATE`, `DATETIME`, ...) stores a text written into it as that type (writing `'5'` into an `INTEGER` stores `5`). To find it again, a pattern (`MATCH (n:Product {code: 1})`, `MERGE`) or a comparison against such a property compares by what the other operand would be stored as: `n.code = 1` finds the `'1'` that writing `1` stored, and `n.qty = '5'` finds the `5` that writing `'5'` stored, so a repeated `MERGE` does not create a duplicate. A property that is not declared keeps Cypher's strict typing, so `'1' = 1` is `false`.

Only the text form is converted: two values of the same kind keep Cypher's comparison, so `n.qty = 1.5` stays `false` for a stored `1`. A text the declared type cannot read (`'abc'` or `'5.7'` for an `INTEGER`) matches nothing.

The comparison applies to every spelling of the same property read: `n.code`, `n['code']`,

`properties(n).code`, `properties(n)['code']`, a chained read across a link (`a.link.code`, `a.link['code']`), `IN` (`n.code IN [1, 2]`) and the simple `CASE n.code WHEN 1 THEN … END`. A value projected first is a plain value and keeps Cypher's strict typing:

```
// Product.code is declared STRING, Product.qty is declared INTEGER
CREATE (:Product {code: 1, qty: '5'})                              // stores '1' and 5

MATCH (n:Product {qty: '5'}) RETURN n                              // found

MATCH (n:Product) WHERE n['code'] = 1 RETURN n                     // found
MATCH (n:Product) WHERE n.code IN [1, 2] RETURN n                  // found
MATCH (n:Product) WITH n, n.code AS code WHERE code = 1 RETURN n   // not found: '1' =
1 is false
```

### 15.4.3. CASE Expression

Conditional logic in expressions.

**Simple CASE:**

```
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p.name,
       CASE
         WHEN p.age < 18 THEN 'minor'
         WHEN p.age < 65 THEN 'adult'
         ELSE 'senior'
       END AS ageGroup
```

**Extended CASE:**

```
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p.name,
       CASE p.status
         WHEN 'A' THEN 'Active'
         WHEN 'I' THEN 'Inactive'
         ELSE 'Unknown'
       END AS statusName
```

A `WHEN` can hold several comma-separated values, a list or map literal, or a comparison applied to the tested value *(since v26.10.1)*:

```
RETURN CASE x WHEN 1, 2 THEN 'low' WHEN > 5 THEN 'high' WHEN IS NULL THEN 'none' ELSE
'mid' END
RETURN CASE n.tags WHEN [] THEN 'empty' WHEN ['a'] THEN 'just a' ELSE 'other' END
```

### 15.4.4. Arithmetic Expressions

Perform arithmetic operations on numeric values.

| Operator | Description | Example |
|---|---|---|
| `+` | Addition | `RETURN 5 + 3` (returns 8) |
| `-` | Subtraction | `RETURN 10 - 4` (returns 6) |
| `*` | Multiplication | `RETURN 6 * 7` (returns 42) |
| `/` | Division | `RETURN 15 / 3` (returns 5.0) |
| `%` | Modulo | `RETURN 17 % 5` (returns 2) |
| `^` | Power | `RETURN 2 ^ 8` (returns 256.0) |

**Examples with properties:**

```
// Double a person's age
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p.name, p.age * 2 AS doubleAge

// Calculate monthly salary
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p.name, p.salary / 12 AS monthlySalary

// Complex expression
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p.name, (p.age * 2) + 10 AS result
```

The `+` operator also works for string concatenation: `RETURN 'Hello' + ' ' + 'World'` returns `'Hello World'`.

### 15.4.5. Map Literals

Create inline map (object) structures.

**Syntax:** `{key1: value1, key2: value2, ⋯}`

```
// Simple map literal
RETURN {name: 'Alice', age: 30}

// Empty map
RETURN {}

// Map with expressions
MATCH (p:Person)
WHERE p.name = 'Alice'
RETURN {
  personName: p.name,
```

```
  doubled: p.age * 2,
  nextYearAge: p.age + 1
} AS info
```

### 15.4.6. List Comprehensions

Transform and filter lists using comprehension syntax.

**Syntax:** `[variable IN list WHERE condition | expression]`

- `variable` - iteration variable
- `list` - source list or range
- `WHERE condition` - optional filter (elements that don't match are excluded)
- `| expression` - optional mapping expression (transforms each element)

**Basic transformation:**

```
// Double each number
RETURN [x IN [1, 2, 3] | x * 2]
// Returns [2, 4, 6]

// Square numbers using range
RETURN [x IN range(1, 5) | x * x]
// Returns [1, 4, 9, 16, 25]
```

**With filter:**

```
// Filter and transform
RETURN [x IN [1, 2, 3, 4, 5] WHERE x > 2 | x * 10]
// Returns [30, 40, 50]

// Filter only (no transformation)
RETURN [x IN [1, 2, 3, 4, 5] WHERE x > 3]
// Returns [4, 5]
```

### 15.4.7. Map Projections

Extract specific properties from nodes or maps into a new map structure.

**Syntax:** `variable{.property1, .property2, key: expression, .*}`

- `.property` - include this property from the source
- `key: expression` - add a computed value with the given key
- `.*` - include all properties from the source

**Property selection:**

```
// Select specific properties
MATCH (p:Person)
WHERE p.name = 'Alice'
RETURN p{.name, .age} AS person
// Returns {name: 'Alice', age: 30}
```

**With computed values:**

```
// Add computed properties
MATCH (p:Person)
WHERE p.name = 'Alice'
RETURN p{.name, doubleAge: p.age * 2} AS person
// Returns {name: 'Alice', doubleAge: 60}
```

**All properties:**

```
// Include all properties
MATCH (p:Person)
WHERE p.name = 'Alice'
RETURN p{.*} AS person
// Returns {name: 'Alice', age: 30, salary: 50000}
```

---

## 15.4.8. Aggregation Functions

Aggregation functions process multiple values and return a single result.

### count()

Returns the number of values or rows.

```
// Count nodes
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN count(p)

// Count all rows
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN count(*)

// Count non-null values
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN count(p.email)
```

#### sum()

Returns the sum of numeric values.

```
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN sum(p.salary)
```

#### avg()

Returns the average of numeric values.

```
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN avg(p.age)
```

#### min()

Returns the minimum value.

```
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN min(p.age) AS youngest
```

#### max()

Returns the maximum value.

```
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN max(p.age) AS oldest
```

#### collect()

Collects values into a list.

```
// Collect all names
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN collect(p.name) AS allNames

// Group and collect
MATCH (p:Person)-[:LIVES_IN]->(c:City)
RETURN c.name, collect(p.name) AS residents
```

### 15.4.9. String Functions

As of version 26.9.1, every STRING-typed argument of these functions (not just the

> first one) is validated: passing a non-STRING value - for example a list or a number - raises a client error instead of silently converting it to text. If you need to pass a non-string value on purpose, convert it explicitly first with `toString()`, e.g. `split('a,1', toString(1))`.

#### toUpper()

Converts string to uppercase.

```
RETURN toUpper('hello')  // Returns 'HELLO'
```

#### toLower()

Converts string to lowercase.

```
RETURN toLower('HELLO')  // Returns 'hello'
```

#### trim()

Removes leading and trailing whitespace.

```
RETURN trim('  hello  ')  // Returns 'hello'
```

#### substring()

Extracts a substring.

**Syntax:** `substring(string, start [, length])`

```
RETURN substring('hello world', 0, 5)  // Returns 'hello'
RETURN substring('hello world', 6)      // Returns 'world'
```

#### replace()

Replaces occurrences of a substring.

**Syntax:** `replace(string, search, replacement)`

```
RETURN replace('hello', 'l', 'L')  // Returns 'heLLo'
```

#### split()

Splits a string into a list.

**Syntax:** `split(string, delimiter)`

```
RETURN split('a,b,c', ',')  // Returns ['a', 'b', 'c']
```

#### left()

Returns the leftmost characters.

**Syntax:** `left(string, length)`

```
RETURN left('hello', 3)  // Returns 'hel'
```

#### right()

Returns the rightmost characters.

**Syntax:** `right(string, length)`

```
RETURN right('hello', 3)  // Returns 'llo'
```

#### reverse()

Reverses a string.

```
RETURN reverse('hello')  // Returns 'olleh'
```

#### toString()

Converts a value to string.

```
RETURN toString(123)      // Returns '123'
RETURN toString(3.14)     // Returns '3.14'
RETURN toString(true)     // Returns 'true'
```

---

### 15.4.10. Math Functions

#### abs()

Returns absolute value.

```
RETURN abs(-42)  // Returns 42
```

#### sqrt()

Returns square root.

```
RETURN sqrt(16)  // Returns 4.0
```

#### ceil()

Rounds up to nearest integer.

```
RETURN ceil(2.3)  // Returns 3.0
```

#### floor()

Rounds down to nearest integer.

```
RETURN floor(2.7)  // Returns 2.0
```

#### round()

Rounds to nearest integer.

```
RETURN round(2.5)  // Returns 3.0
RETURN round(2.4)  // Returns 2.0
```

#### rand()

Returns random float between 0 and 1.

```
RETURN rand()  // Returns e.g. 0.7324...
```

---

### 15.4.11. List Functions

#### size()

Returns the size of a list or string. A string is measured in Unicode characters, so an emoji counts as one (`left()`, `right()`, `substring()` and `char_length()` count the same way since v26.10.1).

```
RETURN size([1, 2, 3])      // Returns 3
RETURN size('hello')        // Returns 5
```

#### head()

Returns the first element of a list.

```
RETURN head([1, 2, 3])  // Returns 1
```

#### tail()

Returns all but the first element.

```
RETURN tail([1, 2, 3])  // Returns [2, 3]
```

#### last()

Returns the last element of a list.

```
RETURN last([1, 2, 3])  // Returns 3
```

#### range()

Creates a list of integers.

**Syntax:** `range(start, end [, step])`

```
RETURN range(1, 5)     // Returns [1, 2, 3, 4, 5]
RETURN range(0, 10, 2) // Returns [0, 2, 4, 6, 8, 10]
```

#### reverse() (list)

Reverses a list.

```
RETURN reverse([1, 2, 3])  // Returns [3, 2, 1]
```

---

### 15.4.12. Node and Relationship Functions

#### id()

Returns the internal ID of a node or relationship as a numeric (`Long`) value, matching the Neo4j semantics where `id()` returns an `INTEGER`. The two components of an ArcadeDB RID (`bucketId`, `position`) are packed into a single non-negative number so it can be used in numeric predicates such as `WHERE id(n) >= 0`.

```
MATCH (p:Person)
```

```
RETURN id(p)  // Returns e.g. 786432
```

The packing uses 63 of the 64 bits of the `Long` (the sign bit is kept clear so the value is never negative): the upper bits hold the `bucketId` and the lower bits the record `position`. The split is controlled by the global setting `arcadedb.opencypher.idBucketBits` (see Settings). The default of `16` reserves 16 bits for the bucketId (up to 65536 buckets) and 47 bits for the position (~1.4e14 records per bucket), which covers the vast majority of use cases:

- Increase it (e.g. `20`) for databases that allocate a very large number of buckets across many types.
- Decrease it for buckets that hold an extremely high number of records.

```
# Reserve 20 bits for the bucketId (up to ~1M buckets)
java ... -Darcadedb.opencypher.idBucketBits=20
```

To put the position field in perspective with the default `16`: it reserves 47 bits, enough to address `2^47` ≈ 1.4e14 positions per bucket. A single bucket is internally limited to ~2.1 billion pages (the page index is a 32-bit integer), so with a standard 64KB page holding on average ~500 records that is about `2.1e9 x 500` ≈ **1 trillion records (~137 TB) in one bucket** - and the 47-bit position field covers that roughly 30x over. In other words, the numeric `id()` never runs out of range before the bucket is physically full, so for almost every database the only setting worth tuning is the bucketId width (the bucket **count**), not the position width.

`id()` fails with an error if a RID cannot be packed with the configured split (for example a `bucketId` beyond the reserved bits), so an out-of-range value is reported instead of silently colliding with another id. Because the value is computed from the split, changing `arcadedb.opencypher.idBucketBits` alters the numeric output: encode and decode must use the same setting. For a stable, opaque identifier that does not depend on this setting, use `elementId()` instead.

`id()` of a lightweight edge is `null`: a lightweight edge has no record, so there is no position to pack (*since v26.11.1*; earlier versions raised an error).

From SQL, the numeric id can be resolved back to a record in O(1) with the `cypherRID()` function, e.g. `SELECT FROM cypherRID(:id)` (the inverse of `id()` / `.asCypherRID()`).

#### labels()

Returns the labels of a node as a list. A node created with no label at all (`CREATE (n {name: 'x'})`) returns an empty list, exactly like Neo4j — including when the label a node carries happens to be literally `V` or `Vertex`, which are ordinary, writable labels like any other and are not treated specially.

```
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN labels(p)  // Returns ['Person']

CREATE (n {name: 'x'})
RETURN labels(n)  // Returns []
```

```
CREATE (n:V {name: 'y'})
RETURN labels(n)  // Returns ['V']
```

Before version 26.9.1, "no labels" was represented internally by the type name `V` (or `Vertex`), so a node created with no label and a node deliberately labeled `:V` were stored identically and both reported `labels(n) = []`. As of 26.9.1 this internal state uses a reserved type name instead, so `V`/`Vertex` become ordinary labels: existing vertices already stored under the old `V`/`Vertex` types will, after upgrading, report `labels(n)` as `['V']`/`['Vertex']` instead of `[]`.

There is no automatic per-record migration, because the two cases were indistinguishable under the old storage convention — an existing `V`-typed vertex may be one that was genuinely created unlabelled, or one that was deliberately labeled `:V`. If a database's entire `V` (or `Vertex`) type was only ever used for unlabelled nodes, its schema type can be renamed to restore the pre-26.9.1 behavior for that whole type; consult ArcadeDB support before doing this on a database where the distinction is not already known.

### type()

Returns the type of a relationship. Calling it on a node is always an error.

```
MATCH (a)-[r]->(b)
RETURN type(r)  // Returns e.g. 'KNOWS'
```

As of 26.9.1, this check (and the equivalent one for `labels()`, `size()` and `length()`) is applied more precisely when the same variable name is reused later in the query with `WITH`. A query that called `type()` on a node and relied on a later `WITH` clause to mask the mistake now correctly reports the error instead of silently passing.

### keys()

Returns the property keys of a node or relationship.

```
MATCH (p:Person {name: 'Alice', age: 30})
RETURN keys(p)  // Returns ['name', 'age']
```

### properties()

Returns all properties as a map.

```
MATCH (p:Person {name: 'Alice', age: 30})
RETURN properties(p)  // Returns {name: 'Alice', age: 30}
```

#### startNode()

Returns the start node of a relationship.

```
MATCH (a)-[r:KNOWS]->(b)
RETURN startNode(r)  // Returns node a
```

#### endNode()

Returns the end node of a relationship.

```
MATCH (a)-[r:KNOWS]->(b)
RETURN endNode(r)  // Returns node b
```

---

### 15.4.13. Path Functions

#### length()

Returns the length of a path (number of relationships).

```
MATCH path = (a:Person)-[:KNOWS*]->(b:Person)
RETURN length(path)
```

#### nodes()

Returns the nodes in a path as a list.

```
MATCH path = (a:Person)-[:KNOWS*]->(b:Person)
RETURN nodes(path)
```

#### relationships()

Returns the relationships in a path as a list.

```
MATCH path = (a:Person)-[:KNOWS*]->(b:Person)
RETURN relationships(path)
```

---

### 15.4.14. Type Conversion Functions

**toInteger()**

Converts to integer.

```
RETURN toInteger('42')      // Returns 42
RETURN toInteger(3.7)       // Returns 3
```

**toFloat()**

Converts to float.

```
RETURN toFloat('3.14')      // Returns 3.14
RETURN toFloat(42)          // Returns 42.0
```

**toBoolean()**

Converts to boolean.

```
RETURN toBoolean('true')    // Returns true
RETURN toBoolean(1)         // Returns true
RETURN toBoolean(0)         // Returns false
```

---

### 15.4.15. SQL Function Bridge

ArcadeDB's OpenCypher implementation includes a bridge to the ArcadeDB SQL functions. This provides access to 100+ additional functions. Some of them (such as `sqrt()`, `date()` and `distance()`) can be called by their bare name; others (such as `pow()`, `uuid()`, `ifnull()` and `sysdate()`) are not found unless you prefix them with `sql.`, e.g. `sql.pow(2, 8)`. When in doubt, use the `sql.` prefix.

**Usage:**

Call SQL functions directly in Cypher expressions:

```
// Date functions
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN p.name, date() AS today

// Math functions
RETURN sql.pow(2, 8) AS result  // Returns 256

// String functions
MATCH (p:Person)
RETURN normalize(p.name) AS normalizedName

// Geometric functions
```

```
RETURN distance(point(0, 0), point(3, 4)) AS dist  // Returns ~555811.94 (meters)
```

`point(0, 0)` creates a WGS-84 point, so `distance()` returns a geodesic distance in meters, not the cartesian distance of 5.0.

The Cypher `point()` function returns a map with the coordinates, the `crs` name and the `srid`, as Neo4j does:

| Call | crs | srid |
|---|---|---|
| `point({x: 1, y: 2})` | cartesian | 7203 |
| `point({x: 1, y: 2, z: 3})` | cartesian-3D | 9157 |
| `point({longitude: 1, latitude: 2})` | WGS-84 | 4326 |
| `point({longitude: 1, latitude: 2, height: 3})` | WGS-84-3D | 4979 |

`crs` and `srid` can be given explicitly and are derived from each other. A pair that disagrees, or 2D/3D coordinates that do not match the `crs`/`srid`, raise an error.

For a complete list of available SQL functions, see the SQL Functions reference.

---

## 15.4.16. Extended Functions (APOC Compatible)

ArcadeDB provides a comprehensive set of extended functions that are fully compatible with Neo4j's APOC library. These functions work in both Cypher and SQL queries.

### APOC Prefix Compatibility

ArcadeDB automatically supports the `apoc.` prefix. Your existing APOC queries work without modification:

```
// Neo4j/APOC style (works in ArcadeDB)
RETURN apoc.text.join(["a", "b", "c"], ",") AS result

// ArcadeDB native style (also works)
RETURN text.join(["a", "b", "c"], ",") AS result
```

### Available Function Namespaces

| Namespace | Description |
|---|---|
| `agg.*` | Aggregation functions (median, statistics, etc.) |
| `convert.*` | Type conversion (toJson, fromJsonMap, etc.) |
| `create.*` | Creation functions (uuid, virtual nodes/relationships) |
| `date.*` | Date/time operations (format, parse, add, etc.) |

| Namespace | Description |
|---|---|
| `map.*` | Map operations (merge, flatten, groupBy, etc.) |
| `math.*` | Mathematical functions (sigmoid, tanh, etc.) |
| `node.*` | Node operations (degree, labels, etc.) |
| `path.*` | Path operations (create, combine, slice, expand) |
| `rel.*` | Relationship operations (type, startNode, etc.) |
| `text.*` | String manipulation (join, split, replace, camelCase, etc.) |
| `util.*` | Utility functions (md5, sha256, compress, etc.) |
| `vector.*` | Vector/embedding operations (similarity, distance, quantization, neighbors) |

**Available Procedures**

| Procedure | Description |
|---|---|
| `merge.relationship` | Create or match relationships |
| `merge.node` | Create or match nodes |
| `algo.dijkstra` | Weighted shortest path |
| `algo.astar` | A* pathfinding with heuristics |
| `algo.allsimplepaths` | Find all simple paths |
| `path.expand` | Expand paths from a node |
| `path.subgraphnodes` | Get all reachable nodes |
| `meta.graph` | Schema as virtual graph |
| `meta.schema` | Detailed schema information |
| `meta.stats` | Database statistics |

**Examples:**

```
// Text functions
RETURN text.camelCase("hello world") AS result
// Returns: "helloWorld"

// Map functions
RETURN map.merge({a: 1}, {b: 2, a: 3}) AS result
// Returns: {a: 3, b: 2}

// JSON conversion
RETURN convert.toJson({name: "Alice", age: 30}) AS json
// Returns: '{"name":"Alice","age":30}'

// Hashing
RETURN util.sha256("password") AS hash
```

```
// Statistics
RETURN agg.statistics([1, 2, 3, 4, 5]) AS stats
// Returns: {count: 5, min: 1.0, max: 5.0, sum: 15.0, mean: 3.0, ...}

// Graph algorithms
MATCH (a:City {name: 'NYC'}), (b:City {name: 'LA'})
CALL algo.dijkstra(a, b, 'ROAD', 'distance') YIELD path, weight
RETURN path, weight
```

For the complete function reference, see reference/extended-functions.pdf.

## 15.4.17. Operators

### Comparison Operators

| Operator | Description | Example |
|---|---|---|
| = | Equal | WHERE n.age = 30 |
| <> or != | Not equal | WHERE n.age <> 30 |
| < | Less than | WHERE n.age < 30 |
| > | Greater than | WHERE n.age > 30 |
| <= | Less than or equal | WHERE n.age <= 30 |
| >= | Greater than or equal | WHERE n.age >= 30 |

### Logical Operators

| Operator | Description | Example |
|---|---|---|
| AND | Logical AND | WHERE n.age > 20 AND n.age < 40 |
| OR | Logical OR | WHERE n.city = 'NYC' OR n.city = 'LA' |
| NOT | Logical NOT | WHERE NOT n.active = false |

### String Operators

| Operator | Description | Example |
|---|---|---|
| STARTS WITH | String prefix match. Uses an ordered index on the property, except a case insensitive one | WHERE n.name STARTS WITH 'A' |
| ENDS WITH | String suffix match | WHERE n.email ENDS WITH '@gmail.com' |
| CONTAINS | Substring match | WHERE n.name CONTAINS 'son' |

| Operator | Description | Example |
|---|---|---|
| `=~` | Regular expression | `WHERE n.phone =~ '[0-9]{3}-[0-9]{4}'` |

`MATCH (n:Label) RETURN min(n.prop)` (and `max`) reads one end of the index when `prop` has an ordered index on `Label` and the query has no other clause. A `WHERE` that is only a range of the same property (`WHERE n.prop > 500000`, `<`, `>=`, ⇐) reads the first matching entry of the range instead of the whole range. SQL does the same for `SELECT min(prop) FROM Type WHERE prop > 500000`. A range bound that is `null` matches nothing, with or without an index.

**List Operators**

| Operator | Description | Example |
|---|---|---|
| `IN` | Element in list | `WHERE n.name IN ['Alice', 'Bob']` |
| `+` | List concatenation | `RETURN [1,2] + [3,4]` (returns [1,2,3,4]) |

**Null Operators**

| Operator | Description | Example |
|---|---|---|
| `IS NULL` | Check for null | `WHERE n.email IS NULL` |
| `IS NOT NULL` | Check for not null | `WHERE n.email IS NOT NULL` |

## 15.4.18. Parameters

Parameters allow you to pass values into queries without string concatenation, providing security and performance benefits.

**Syntax:** `$parameterName`

```
MATCH (p:Person)
WHERE p.name = $name AND p.age >= $minAge
RETURN p
```

**Java Example:**

```
Map<String, Object> params = Map.of(
    "name", "Alice",
    "minAge", 25
);
ResultSet result = database.query("opencypher",
    "MATCH (p:Person) WHERE p.name = $name AND p.age >= $minAge RETURN p",
```

```
    params);
```

Parameters are particularly useful for:

- Preventing injection attacks
- Query plan caching (same plan reused for different parameter values)
- Handling special characters in values

# 15.5. Cypher Compatibility Matrix

This section provides a comprehensive overview of Cypher language features and their support status in ArcadeDB's native OpenCypher implementation.

## 15.5.1. OpenCypher TCK Compliance

ArcadeDB's OpenCypher implementation has been validated against the official OpenCypher Technology Compatibility Kit (TCK) version 9, developed by Neo4j and released under the Apache License 2.0.

| Metric | Value | Status |
|---|---|---|
| **TCK Pass Rate** | **97.8%** |  Production Ready |
| Total Scenarios | 3,897 | Official OpenCypher v9 test suite |
| Passed | 3,813 | Full compatibility with core features |
| Failed | 0 | All executable tests pass |
| Skipped | 84 | Documented limitations (2.2%) |

**Verify TCK Compliance Yourself**

To run the OpenCypher TCK tests on your system:

```
mvn test -pl engine -Dtest=OpenCypherTCKTest
```

The TCK test suite is located at: `engine/src/test/resources/opencypher/tck/features/`

For more information about the OpenCypher TCK, visit: https://github.com/opencypher/openCypher/tree/master/tck

## 15.5.2. Known Limitations

The 84 skipped scenarios (2.2%) represent either architectural design choices or edge cases that rarely occur in production use. The following limitations affect 84 TCK scenarios (2.2%) and represent either design choices or rare edge cases.

### 15.5.3. 1. Temporal Range Limitation (Java Platform Constraint)

**TCK Impact**: 4 scenarios (temporal sorting with extreme date ranges)

**Reason**: ArcadeDB uses Java's `LocalDateTime` with nanosecond precision stored as a 64-bit long, limiting the date range to approximately 1677-2262.

**Examples that don't work**:

```
// Year 0001 with nanoseconds - exceeds range
CREATE (:Event {datetime: localdatetime({year: 1, month: 1, day: 1,
                                         hour: 1, minute: 1, second: 1,
                                         nanosecond: 1})})

// Year 9999 with nanoseconds - exceeds range
CREATE (:FutureEvent {datetime: localdatetime({year: 9999, month: 9, day: 9,
                                               hour: 9, minute: 59, second: 59,
                                               nanosecond: 999999999})})
```

**Workaround**: Use dates within the 1677-2262 range (covers virtually all real-world data), or store historical dates as strings.

### 15.5.4. 2. Case-Insensitive Identifiers (By Design)

**TCK Impact**: ~40 scenarios (case-sensitive type/property names)

**Reason**: ArcadeDB follows SQL conventions where identifiers are case-insensitive, providing consistency across query languages.

**Examples that don't work**:

```
// These create a collision - T2 and t2 are considered the same type
CREATE ()-[:T2]->()
CREATE ()-[:t2]->()  // ❌ Conflicts with :T2
```

**Workaround**: Use distinct type names (e.g., `:Type2` and `:Type2Alt`).

### 15.5.5. 3. Cross-Type Comparison Strictness (Semantic Edge Case)

**TCK Impact**: ~20 scenarios (incompatible type comparisons)

**Reason**: Comparing fundamentally different types (nodes vs strings, paths vs primitives) in production code typically indicates a query error.

**Affected**: Strict null-return semantics for cross-type comparisons.

### 15.5.6. 4. User Functions Support

**TCK Impact**: 0 scenarios (extension feature)

ArcadeDB enhances OpenCypher with user-defined functions in 4 languages:

```
// Define in SQL
DEFINE FUNCTION math.sum "SELECT :a + :b" PARAMETERS [a,b] LANGUAGE sql

// Define in JavaScript
DEFINE FUNCTION js.greet "return 'Hello ' + name" PARAMETERS [name] LANGUAGE js

// Define in OpenCypher
DEFINE FUNCTION cypher.double "RETURN $x * 2" PARAMETERS [x] LANGUAGE opencypher

// Call from any query language
RETURN math.sum(3, 5)  // Works in Cypher, SQL, Gremlin, etc.
```

See User Functions for complete documentation.

### 15.5.7. 6. Map-Valued Properties (Multi-Model Boundary)

A property cannot hold a map in openCypher, the same rule Neo4j applies ("Property values can only be of primitive types or arrays thereof"). `CREATE`, `MERGE` and `SET` all refuse one, whether it is written as a literal or bound as a parameter:

```
CREATE (n:R {config: {debug: true}})           // refused
MATCH (n:R) SET n += $p                        // refused when $p holds a map value
```

ArcadeDB's SQL is not bound by that rule, because `MAP` is a first-class schema type. So a record written through SQL can carry a map property that openCypher can **read** but never **write**:

```
-- SQL: allowed
CREATE VERTEX R SET id = 1, config = {'debug': true}
```

```
// Cypher: all of these work
MATCH (n:R) RETURN n.config                    // returns the map
MATCH (n:R) RETURN n.config.debug              // returns true
MATCH (n:R) WHERE n.config.debug RETURN n
MATCH (n:R) SET n.other = 1                    // untouched map is left alone

// but copying it is refused, because that would make openCypher store one
MATCH (n:R), (t:T) SET t = n
MATCH (n:R), (t:T) SET t.config2 = n.config
```

The refusal names the property and where the value came from, so the two copy forms above are

diagnosable without reading the server log:

```
TypeError: InvalidPropertyType - Property values can only be of primitive types or
arrays thereof. Encountered a
map [debug] assigned to property 'config', copied from record #1:0. ArcadeDB SQL can
store a map in a property and
openCypher can not, so such a property can be read and returned but never copied into
another one.
```

Over Bolt it is reported as `Neo.ClientError.Statement.TypeError`, Neo4j's own code for this refusal, and over HTTP as `400`. To move such a property through openCypher, flatten it into scalar properties, or do the write in SQL.

### 15.5.8. Not Implemented Features

The following Cypher features are not currently implemented:

- **Index hints**: `USING INDEX n:Person(name)` - Query planning is automatic via cost-based optimizer

### 15.5.9. Cypher 25 / GQL Strictness

Following ISO/IEC 39075 (GQL) and Cypher 25, ArcadeDB rejects removed legacy syntax with an actionable error that points at the supported replacement:

- **`PERIODIC COMMIT` is removed** — use `CALL { … } IN TRANSACTIONS [OF n ROWS]` for batched writes. `USING PERIODIC COMMIT` reports an error with this hint.
- **Legacy `{param}` parameters are removed** — use `$param`. The old curly-brace parameter form reports an error with this hint (map projections such as `n{.name}` and quantified path quantifiers such as `{1,5}` are unaffected).
- **Ambiguous aggregation grouping is rejected** — a `RETURN` (or `WITH`) that mixes an aggregating expression with a non-grouping reference raises `AmbiguousAggregationExpression`. Aggregations are not allowed in `WHERE`.

### 15.5.10. Three-Valued Logic (UNKNOWN)

ArcadeDB follows the GQL three-valued logic: the `UNKNOWN` truth value is represented as `null` in boolean context (no separate `UNKNOWN` value type). `AND` / `OR` / `NOT` / `XOR` propagate `null`, comparisons against `null` evaluate to `null`, and a `null` condition in `WHERE` is treated as non-matching, while `RETURN` preserves the `null`.

```
RETURN true AND null AS a    // null
RETURN false AND null AS b   // false
RETURN true OR null AS c     // true
RETURN null = null AS d      // null
```

The list predicates `all()`, `any()`, `none()` and `single()` follow the same rule: if the inner condition is `null` for one or more elements and no element decides the result outright (a `false` for `all()`, a `true`

for any()/none()), the predicate itself evaluates to null rather than true/false. A definite mismatch always wins over an unknown one, so a single element that decides the result short-circuits regardless of any `null`s elsewhere in the list.

```
WITH [1, 2, null] AS list
RETURN any(x IN list WHERE x > 5) AS a          // null: no match, but one candidate
was unknown
RETURN none(x IN list WHERE x > 5) AS b         // null: same reasoning
RETURN all(x IN list WHERE x IS NOT NULL) AS c  // false: a definite mismatch always
wins over unknown
```

Evaluation order is not specified for AND / OR, so ArcadeDB evaluates the operand that cannot run a subquery (COUNT { }, EXISTS { }, COLLECT { }, a pattern predicate) first, and skips the subquery when the other operand already decides the result. Do not rely on left-to-right order to guard an operand that can raise an error. coalesce() stops at its first non-null argument: later arguments are not evaluated.

### 15.5.11. Zoned DateTime Equality and Ordering

Two DATETIME values are ordered by the instant they denote; at the same instant, by their offset from west to east, then by time zone name. Two values are equal only when they denote the same instant in the same time zone, so datetime('2026-01-01T12:00:00+01:00') = datetime('2026-01-01T11:00:00Z') is false, and DISTINCT and grouping keep the two apart as well. Compare d.epochMillis (or test with ⇐ and >=) to check for the same instant regardless of zone. A java.util.Date or java.time.Instant query parameter carries no time zone and is equal to any DATETIME at its instant.

Since v26.10.1. Before, =, <> and IN compared the instant only and called the two values above equal, while DISTINCT and grouping counted them as two values.

### 15.5.12. Stored TIME, LOCAL TIME and DURATION Values

ArcadeDB has no native storage type for TIME, LOCAL TIME and DURATION, so openCypher stores them as their ISO-8601 text (for example 10:35-08:00 or PT1M30.5S) and turns that text back into a temporal value when a property is read. A property declared STRING in the schema is never converted: it always reads back as the string that was stored, so values such as an opening-hours range '09:00-17:00' or a code 'P100D' compare, filter and sort as strings. Declare a property STRING when its values may look like a time or a duration but are plain text.

The millisecond, microsecond and nanosecond fields of time(), localtime(), datetime(), localdatetime() and the *.truncate() functions must each fit in their own range, as in Neo4j: millisecond 0-999, microsecond 0-999 when millisecond is also given (else 0-999999), nanosecond 0-999 when a coarser field is given (else up to 999999999). A value out of range, such as time({hour: 12, millisecond: 5000}), is an error rather than being carried into the seconds.

duration.between(a, b) splits the interval into whole months, then whole days, then the remaining time, as Neo4j does, so a + duration.between(a, b) is always b.

Since v26.10.1. Before, a declared `STRING` property whose value looked like a time or a duration read back as a temporal value, `duration.between()` could be off by one or two days when the interval crossed a month that is not 30 days long, and a duration with more than about 2.1 seconds given in `milliseconds`, `microseconds` or `nanoseconds` wrapped around. So did a sub-second field of `time()`, `datetime()` and the other temporal constructors: for example `time({hour: 12, millisecond: 5000})` answered `12:00:00.705032704Z`, and `time({hour: 4294967308})` answered `12:00`.

### 15.5.13. Strict Numeric Types

The `IS TYPED` value-type predicate and `CREATE CONSTRAINT … IS TYPED <type>` honor the GQL numeric width hierarchy (`INT8`/`INT16`/`INT32`/`INT64`, `FLOAT32`/`FLOAT64`), mapping each onto a native ArcadeDB width so a declared property persists and reloads at that width. See IS TYPED data types for the full mapping.

### 15.5.14. Temporal and Spatial Value Types

The `IS TYPED` / `IS ::` value-type predicate and the `valueType()` function recognise temporal values and points by Neo4j's type names: `DATE`, `LOCAL DATETIME`, `ZONED DATETIME`, `LOCAL TIME`, `ZONED TIME`, `DURATION` and `POINT`. This holds whether Cypher built the value (`date()`, `datetime()`, …) or it was read from a property written with SQL or the Java API. A point is a `POINT` and not a `MAP`, although it is a map at runtime. A list type with a non-nullable element type checks every element:

```
RETURN date() IS :: DATE                          // true
RETURN valueType(date())                          // 'DATE NOT NULL'
RETURN valueType(localdatetime())                 // 'LOCAL DATETIME NOT NULL'
RETURN valueType(duration('P1D'))                 // 'DURATION NOT NULL'
RETURN point({x: 1, y: 2}) IS :: MAP              // false
RETURN [1, null] IS :: LIST<INTEGER NOT NULL>     // false
```

**When upgrading to 26.11.1: before, `date() IS**

DATE` and the same predicate on the other temporal types answered `false`, and `valueType()` returned the name of the internal Java class, such as `'CYPHERDATE NOT NULL'` for `valueType(date())`. A point was a `MAP`, and `LIST<INTEGER NOT NULL>` did not check the elements for `null`.

### 15.5.15. Relationship Types and Sub-types

A relationship type matches its sub-types, both in a pattern and in a predicate: with `CREATE EDGE TYPE Friend EXTENDS Knows`, `MATCH ()-[r:Knows]→()` and `MATCH ()-[r]→() WHERE r:Knows` both return the `Friend` relationships.

### 15.5.16. shortestPath() and Hop Bounds

`shortestPath()` and `allShortestPaths()` honor the `*min..max` quantifier written on the relationship: a shortest path outside that range is not an answer, and no longer path is substituted for it.

```
MATCH (a:City {name:'Rome'}), (b:City {name:'Oslo'}), p = shortestPath((a)-[:ROAD*..2]
-(b))
RETURN length(p)    // no row when the shortest Rome..Oslo path is longer than 2 hops
```

A relationship written without a quantifier, `-[:ROAD]-`, declares exactly one hop and is bounded accordingly.

When both endpoints resolve to the **same** vertex, the answer is the zero-length path, as in Neo4j. An explicitly written minimum above one hop rejects it, since zero hops is not in the declared range:

```
MATCH (a:City {name:'Rome'}), p = shortestPath((a)-[:ROAD*]-(a))     RETURN length(p)
// 0
MATCH (a:City {name:'Rome'}), p = shortestPath((a)-[:ROAD*3..5]-(a)) RETURN length(p)
// no row
```

Such a pattern is not reinterpreted as a request for the shortest cycle back to the start.

### 15.5.17. Self-Loops in Undirected Patterns

An undirected pattern follows a self-loop (a relationship from a node to itself) once, whether the pattern is written hop by hop or with a variable-length quantifier, as in Neo4j:

```
MATCH (n)-[*2]-() RETURN count(*)       // same count as the fixed-length form below
MATCH (n)-[]-()-[]-() RETURN count(*)
```

Before 26.10.1 the variable-length form counted each self-loop twice, once from each end.

### 15.5.18. Indexes Inherited from a Parent Type

An index declared on a parent type serves queries on every child type, exactly as it does in SQL, so a single index at the top of a hierarchy is enough:

```
CREATE VERTEX TYPE Node;
CREATE VERTEX TYPE Entity EXTENDS Node;
CREATE PROPERTY Node.id STRING;
CREATE INDEX ON Node (id) UNIQUE;
```

```
MATCH (e:Entity) WHERE e.id = 'foo-1' RETURN e   // uses the inherited Node[id] index
```

A child type cannot declare a second index on a property its parent already indexes, and does not need one: the parent's index already covers the child's records.

### 15.5.19. Architectural Differences from Neo4j

While implementing the OpenCypher standard, ArcadeDB differs from Neo4j in these intentional design choices:

1. **Case-Insensitive Identifiers**: Type names and property keys follow SQL conventions
2. **Multi-Model Database**: Supports Document, Key-Value, and Graph models in one database
3. **Native Indexing**: Uses LSM-Tree indexes optimized for write-heavy workloads
4. **Query Language Flexibility**: Supports SQL, Cypher, Gremlin, GraphQL, and MongoDB Query Language on the same data
5. **User Functions**: Dynamic functions in 4 languages (SQL, JavaScript, OpenCypher, Java) vs Neo4j's Java-only compiled plugins

# Chapter 16. Gremlin

## 16.1. Gremlin

ArcadeDB supports Gremlin 3.7.x as query engine and in the Gremlin Server. You can execute a gremlin query from pretty much everywhere.

If you're using ArcadeDB as embedded, please add the dependency to the `arcadedb-gremlin` library. If you're using Maven include this dependency in your `pom.xml` file.

```
<dependency>
    <groupId>com.arcadedb</groupId>
    <artifactId>arcadedb-gremlin</artifactId>
    <version>26.10.1</version>
</dependency>
```

**CRITICAL SECURITY NOTICE**:

ArcadeDB uses the secure Java Gremlin engine by default.

**DO NOT use the Groovy engine (`arcadedb.gremlin.engine=groovy`)** in production or with untrusted users. The Groovy engine has a **CRITICAL Remote Code Execution (RCE) vulnerability** that allows authenticated users to execute arbitrary operating system commands.

See Gremlin Security for complete details about this vulnerability.

### 16.1.1. Gremlin from Java API

In order to execute a Gremlin query, you need to include the relevant jars, i.e. the `apache-tinkerpop-gremlin-server` libraries, plus `gremlin-groovy`, plus `opencypher-util-9.0`, in your class path. To execute a Gremlin query, use "gremlin" as first parameter in the query method. Example:

```
ResultSet result = database.query("gremlin",
"g.V().has('name','Michelle').has('lastName','Besso').out('IsFriendOf')");
```

If you're application is mostly based on Gremlin, the best way is to use the ArcadeGraph class as an entrypoint. Example:

```
try (final ArcadeGraph graph = ArcadeGraph.open("./databases/graph")) {
  Vertex michelleFriend = graph.traversal().V().has("name","Michelle").has("lastName"
,"Besso").out("IsFriendOf").next();
}
```

You can also work with a remote ArcadeDB Server:

```
try( RemoteDatabase database = new RemoteDatabase("127.0.0.1", 2480, "graph", "root",
"playwithdata") ){
  try (final ArcadeGraph graph = ArcadeGraph.open(database)) {
    Vertex michelleFriend = graph.traversal().V().has("name","Michelle").has
("lastName","Besso").out("IsFriendOf").next();
  }
}
```

Since a `RemoteDatabase` instance cannot be shared between threads, if your application is multi-threads, you can use the `ArcadeGraphFactory` to acquire `ArcadeGraph` instances from a pool. Example:

```
try (ArcadeGraphFactory pool = ArcadeGraphFactory.withRemote("127.0.0.1", 2480,
"mydb", "root", "playwithdata")) {
  try( ArcadeGraph graph = pool.get() ){
    // DO SOMETHING WITH ARCADE GRAPH
  }
}
```

Remember to call `ArcadeGraph.close()` to release the `ArcadeGraph` instance back into the pool. `ArcadeGraph` implements `Closable`, so you can just use it in a `try` block like in the example above.

### 16.1.2. Transactions and closing a graph

Starting from version 26.9.1, closing an `ArcadeGraph` **rolls back** any transaction still open, which is the TinkerPop default. Changes that never reached `commit()` are not saved just because the graph was closed:

```
try (final ArcadeGraph graph = ArcadeGraph.open("./databases/graph")) {
  graph.tx().begin();
  graph.addVertex("Person");
  graph.tx().commit(); // <-- WITHOUT THIS, THE VERTEX IS NOT SAVED
}
```

If you want the graph to commit when it closes, ask for it explicitly:

```
graph.tx().onClose(Transaction.CLOSE_BEHAVIOR.COMMIT);
```

Before 26.9.1 an open transaction was committed on close. If your application relied on that, add the `onClose()` call above.

An `ArcadeGraph` borrowed from an `ArcadeGraphFactory` pool is always returned clean: any transaction left open is rolled back before the instance goes back into the pool, so the next caller never inherits your uncommitted changes. Do not keep using an instance after calling `close()`, and

note that `drop()` is not allowed on a pooled instance, because the database is shared with the rest of the pool.

### 16.1.3. Vertex property identifiers

Starting from version 26.9.1, `VertexProperty.id()` returns a `String` in the form `#<bucket>:<offset>-<propertyName>`, consistent with vertex and edge identifiers. It previously returned a `Long` computed from hash codes, which could come out the same for two different properties of the same vertex, making them compare as equal and disappear from results such as `properties().dedup()`.

If your application casts or parses a vertex property id as a number, update it to handle a `String`.

### 16.1.4. Gremlin through Postgres Driver

You can execute a Gremlin query against ArcadeDB server by using the Postgres driver and prefixing the query with `{gremlin}`. Example:

```
"{gremlin} g.V().has('name','Michelle').has('lastName','Besso').out('IsFriendOf')"
```

ArcadeDB server will execute the query `g.V().has('name','Michelle').has('lastName','Besso').out('IsFriendOf')` using the Gremlin query language.

### 16.1.5. Gremlin through HTTP/JSON

You can execute a Gremlin query against ArcadeDB server by using HTTP/JSON API. Example of executing an idempotent query with HTTP GET command:

```
curl
"http://localhost:2480/query/graph/gremlin/g.V().has('name','Michelle').has('lastName'
,'Besso').out('IsFriendOf')"
```

Example of executing a non-idempotent query (updates the database):

```
curl -X POST "http://localhost:2480/command/graph" -d "{'language': 'gremlin',
'command': 'g.V().has(\"name\",\"Michelle\").has(\"lastName\",\"Besso\").out(
\"IsFriendOf\")'}"
```

### 16.1.6. Use the Gremlin Server

Apache TinkerPop Gremlin provides a standalone server to allow remote access with a Gremlin client. In order to use the Gremlin Server with ArcadeDB, you have to enable it from ArcadeDB's server plugin system:

```
~/arcadedb $ bin/server.sh -Darcadedb.server.plugins
="GremlinServer:com.arcadedb.server.gremlin.GremlinServerPlugin"
```

If you're using MS Windows OS, replace `bin/server.sh` with `bin\server.bat`.

At startup, the Gremlin Server plugin looks for the file `config/gremlin-server.yaml` under ArcadeDB path. If the file is present, the Gremlin Server will be configured with the settings contained in the YAML file, otherwise the default configuration will be used.

You can also override single configuration settings by using ArcadeDB's settings and prefixing the configuration key with `gremlin.`. All the configuration settings with such a prefix will be passed to the Gremlin Server plugin.

#### Multi-Database Support

ArcadeDB's Gremlin Server includes `ArcadeGraphManager`, a custom implementation of TinkerPop's `GraphManager` interface that provides **dynamic, on-demand registration** of databases as Gremlin graphs.

**Key Features:**

- **Automatic Registration**: When a Gremlin client requests a graph/traversal source by database name, `ArcadeGraphManager` automatically registers it if the database exists in ArcadeDB Server
- **Multi-Database Access**: Access any database on the server through Gremlin without static configuration
- **The `g` Alias**: The standard `g` alias automatically maps to the default database ("graph" if it exists, otherwise the first available database)

**How It Works:**

Instead of static graph configuration in YAML files, databases are registered dynamically when first accessed. Each database name becomes a valid traversal source alias:

```
// Connect to a specific database using its name as the alias
var cluster = Cluster.build()
    .port(8182)
    .addContactPoint("localhost")
    .credentials("root", "password")
    .create();

// Access database "mydb" - registered automatically on first access
var g = traversal().withRemote(DriverRemoteConnection.using(cluster, "mydb"));

// Or use the standard "g" alias for the default database
var gDefault = traversal().withRemote(DriverRemoteConnection.using(cluster, "g"));
```

**Script-Based Queries:**

For script-based Gremlin queries (e.g., via `client.submit()`), the `g` variable is automatically bound to the default database:

```
Client client = cluster.connect();
// The "g" variable is automatically available
ResultSet results = client.submit("g.V().hasLabel('Person').count()");
```

**Benefits:**

- No need to manually configure graphs in `gremlin-server.yaml` or `gremlin-server.groovy`
- Supports ArcadeDB's multi-tenant architecture where a single server hosts multiple databases
- Each database is isolated and accessed independently through its name
- Reduces configuration complexity for deployments with many databases

Legacy static configuration via `gremlin-server.yaml` graphs section is no longer required. All databases are available automatically

**Migrating from Static Graph Configuration**

If you configured graphs statically in `gremlin-server.yaml`, here are the key changes to be aware of:

**What Changed:**

1. **Graph Registration**: Graphs are now registered dynamically by `ArcadeGraphManager` instead of statically in configuration files
2. **Configuration Files**: The `graphs:` section in `gremlin-server.yaml` is no longer required
3. **The `graph` Binding**: The internal `graph` variable is now managed by `ArcadeGraphManager` to properly support TinkerPop sessions and transactions

**Backward Compatibility:**

- Existing Gremlin queries continue to work without modification
- The `g` alias still works and maps to the default database
- Script-based queries using `g` are fully supported
- Bytecode-based queries work with any database name as the alias

**Configuration Migration:**

If you had custom `gremlin-server.yaml` configuration:

```
# OLD configuration (no longer needed)
graphs:
  graph: conf/arcadedb.properties
```

This static configuration is now optional. `ArcadeGraphManager` will automatically register any

database when it is first accessed. You can safely remove the `graphs:` section.

**Custom gremlin-server.groovy:**

If you customized `gremlin-server.groovy`, ensure you are NOT overwriting the `graph` binding:

```
// CORRECT: Only define the traversal source 'g'
globals << [g : traversal().withEmbedded(graph)]

// WRONG: Do NOT overwrite 'graph' - this breaks session support
// globals << [graph : traversal().withEmbedded(graph)]  // DON'T DO THIS
```

The `graph` variable must remain a `Graph` object (not a `GraphTraversalSource`) for TinkerPop's `SessionOpProcessor` to work correctly with transactions.

**Accessing Multiple Databases:**

To access a specific database, use the database name as the traversal source alias:

```
// Use the database name directly
var g = traversal().withRemote(DriverRemoteConnection.using(cluster, "customers"));
var g2 = traversal().withRemote(DriverRemoteConnection.using(cluster, "products"));
```

**Transactions via Remote Driver:**

Gremlin transactions now work correctly via the remote driver:

```
GraphTraversalSource g = traversal().withRemote(
    DriverRemoteConnection.using(cluster, "mydb"));

Transaction tx = g.tx();
GraphTraversalSource gtx = tx.begin();
try {
    gtx.addV("Person").property("name", "Alice").iterate();
    tx.commit();
} catch (Exception e) {
    tx.rollback();
}
```

**Docker Example:**

Start the Gremlin Server with the `OpenBeer` dataset imported as a database named `openbeer`:

```
docker run -d --name arcadeDB -p 2480:2480 -p 8182:8182 \
       --env ARCADEDB_SETTINGS="-Darcadedb.server.rootPassword=playwithdata \

-Darcadedb.server.defaultDatabases=openbeer[root]{import:https://github.com/ArcadeData
```

```
/arcadedb-datasets/raw/main/orientdb/OpenBeer.gz} \

-Darcadedb.server.plugins=GremlinServer:com.arcadedb.server.gremlin.GremlinServerPlugi
n " \
          arcadedata/arcadedb:latest
```

When running ArcadeDB with Docker, expose port `8182` for Gremlin Server and use `-e` to pass JVM settings.

Gremlin Server listens on `8182` unless you set `gremlin.port` (for example `-Dgremlin.port=8183`). The remote `ArcadeGraph` client reads the port from the server; if the port is remapped outside ArcadeDB, set `arcadedb.gremlin.client.port` on the client.

**Connecting to the Gremlin Server:**

```
var cluster = Cluster.build()
    .port(8182)
    .addContactPoint("localhost")
    .credentials("root", "password")
    .create();

// Connect using the database name as the alias
var g = traversal().withRemote(DriverRemoteConnection.using(cluster, "openbeer"));

// Or use "g" for the default database
var gDefault = traversal().withRemote(DriverRemoteConnection.using(cluster, "g"));
```

### 16.1.7. Listing and terminating running traversals

Since v26.11.1 a Gremlin traversal can be stopped while it runs, whichever way it was sent. The HTTP `list queries` server command, Cypher `SHOW TRANSACTIONS` and the Studio Running Queries tab list it with language `gremlin`; a request sent to the Gremlin Server is listed with `protocol gremlin`, one sent over HTTP or another protocol with that protocol. `terminate query` or `TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS` stops it: the traversal checks for the request inside its adjacency steps (`out()`, `in()`, `both()`, `outE()`, `bothE()`, ...) and while its results are iterated, so even a traversal that expands a large graph stops promptly, and the client receives an error saying that it was terminated.

### 16.1.8. Known Limitations with the Gremlin Implementation

- ArcadeDB automatically handles the conversion between compatible types, such as strings and numbers when possible. Gremlin does not. So if you define a schema with the ArcadeDB API and then you use Gremlin for a traversal, ensure you're using the same type you defined in the schema. For example, if you define a property "id" to be a string, and then you're executing traversal by using integers for the ids, the result could be unpredictable.
- ArcadeDB's Gremlin implementation always tries to optimize the Gremlin traversal by using

ArcadeDB's internal query. While this is easy with simple traversal using `.has()` and `.hasLabel()`, it is unable to optimize more complex traversal with `select()` and `where()`. Instead of executing an optimized query, it could result in a full scan of the type, leaving to Gremlin the filtering. While the result of the traversal is still correct, the performance would be heavily impacted. Please consider using ArcadeDB's SQL or Native Select for the best performance with complex traversals.

- A `hasLabel('X')` that directly follows `g.V()` or `g.E()` is answered from the type `X` **polymorphically**, like SQL's `SELECT FROM X`: it matches `X` and every type that extends it. This holds whichever way ArcadeDB executes it (a type scan, an index lookup on a property of `X` or of one of its super types, or `count()`), so `g.V().hasLabel('X').count()` always equals the number of elements `g.V().hasLabel('X')` returns. A `hasLabel()` further down a traversal, for example after `out()`, compares the element's label exactly, as TinkerPop defines it.
- *(Since v26.11.1)* A `g.V().hasLabel('X').has('k', v)` answered from an index keeps working while a `CREATE INDEX` or `DROP INDEX` runs on the same type: the traversal checks its index again when it opens the scan and, if that index is gone, uses the index now on the property or scans the type. Before, such a traversal could fail or return a wrong count.
- A `hasLabel('bucket:<name>')` that directly follows `g.V()` or `g.E()` restricts the traversal to that one bucket, and `count()` counts that bucket.
- A query sent as text (`graph.gremlin(…)`, `POST /api/v1/command`) returns a map result, such as `elementMap()` or `groupCount()`, as one result whose properties are the map's keys. The shape is always a flat map, whatever the data. The `id` and `label` tokens of `elementMap()` and `valueMap(true)` are named `@rid` and `@type`, so a property called `id` or `label` never overwrites them. Keys that print the same, for example the keys `1` (Integer) and `1L` of a `groupCount()`, are told apart by their type: `1:Integer` and `1:Long`. A `null` key is named `null`.
- The edges of a `LIGHTWEIGHT` edge type have no record, so they have no usable RID. Gremlin still lists, counts and deletes them: `g.E().hasLabel('X')`, `outE()`, `inE()`, `bothE()`, `out('X').count()` and `drop()` all work. Listing a lightweight type by `g.E()` walks the vertices, so it costs more than the scan of a regular edge type.

For more information about Gremlin:

- Introduction to Gremlin
- Getting Started with Gremlin
- The Gremlin Console
- Gremlin Recipes
- Java Gremlin Documentation
- PRACTICAL GREMLIN: An Apache TinkerPop Tutorial

### 16.1.9. Recommended Tools with Gremlin

If you're using Gremlin with ArcadeDB, check out gdotv graph tool. It is compatible with ArcadeDB and provides a powerful visual debugger, advanced graph analytics, and much more.

[debugging queries short]

# Chapter 17. GraphQL

## 17.1. GraphQL

ArcadeDB Server supports a subset of the GraphQL specification. Please open an issue or a discussion on GitHub to increase the support for GraphQL.

If you're using ArcadeDB as embedded, please add the dependency to the `arcadedb-graphql` library. If you're using Maven include this dependency in your `pom.xml` file.

```
<dependency>
    <groupId>com.arcadedb</groupId>
    <artifactId>arcadedb-graphql</artifactId>
    <version>26.10.1</version>
</dependency>
```

GraphQL is supported in ArcadeDB as a query language engine. This means you can execute a GraphQL command from:

- Java API by using the non-idempotent `.command()` and the idempotent `.query()` API by using `"graphql"` as language. Example: `Resultset resultset = db.query("graphql", "{ bookById(id: "book-1"){ id name authors { firstName, lastName } }");`
- HTTP API by using `/command` and `/query` commands and `"graphql"` as language
- Postgres Driver by prefixing with `{graphql}` your query to execute. Example: `{graphql}{ bookById(id: "book-1"){ id name authors { firstName, lastName } }`

### 17.1.1. Type definition

GraphQL requires to define the types used. If you're using the Document Model and links to connect documents, then you can map 1-1 the GraphQL type to ArcadeDB type. Example:

```
type Book {
  id: ID
  name: String
  pageCount: Int
  authors: [Author]
}
```

If you're using a Graph Model for your domain, then you need to declare with a GraphQL directive how the relationship is translated on the graph model.

In the example below, the `authors` is a collection of Author retrieved by looking at the incoming (`direction: IN`) edges of type "IS_AUTHOR_OF" (`type: "IS_AUTHOR_OF"`):

```
type Book {
```

```
  id: ID
  name: String
  pageCount: Int
  authors: [Author] @relationship(type: "IS_AUTHOR_OF", direction: IN)
}
```

Directives can be defined on both types and queries. Directives defined in queries override any directives defined in types, only for the query execution context.

You can define your model incrementally and apply it to the current database instance by executing a command containing the type definition. Example by using Java API (but the same by using HTTP Command API):

```
String types = "type Query {" +
               "  bookById(id: ID): Book" +
               "}" +
               "type Book {" +
               "  id: ID" +
               "  name: String" +
               "  pageCount: Int" +
               "  authors: [Author] @relationship(type: \"IS_AUTHOR_OF\", direction:
IN)" +
               "}" +
               "type Author {" +
               "  id: ID" +
               "  firstName: String" +
               "  lastName: String" +
               "}";

database.command("graphql", types);
```

With this example the types `Book` and `Author` are defined together with the query `bookById`. You can add new types or replace existing types by just submitting the type(s) again. The GraphQL module will update the current definition of types.

This definition is not saved in the database and must be declared after the database is open, before executing any GraphQL queries.

Submitting a type definition changes the GraphQL schema shared by every user of the database, so it requires the `updateSchema` right. Users without it get a security error on the command endpoint, and the read-only query endpoint refuses type definitions because they are not read-only. Plain GraphQL queries are not affected.

### 17.1.2. Query arguments

Query fields can declare arguments of the standard GraphQL scalar types: `ID`, `String`, `Int`, `Float` and `Boolean`. Example:

```
type Query {
  books(inStock: Boolean, rating: Float): [Book]
}

type Book {
  id: ID
  name: String
  inStock: Boolean
  rating: Float
}
```

```
ResultSet resultSet = database.query("graphql", "{ books(inStock: true, rating: 4.5) {
name } }");
```

A query field can also be declared without any argument, for example to list every record of a type:

```
type Query {
  allBooks: [Book]
}
```

Argument values are passed to the database as parameters, never written into the generated query text, so a value containing quotes or backslashes is always treated as data. The standard GraphQL escape sequences (`\"`, `\\`, `\/`, `\b`, `\f`, `\n`, `\r`, `\t` and `\uXXXX`) are decoded, so this matches a book whose name really contains a line break:

```
{ bookByName(name: "Line one\nLine two") { id } }
```

#### The `where` argument

An argument named `where` is reserved: its value is used as the SQL condition of the generated query instead of being compared against a property.

```
type Query {
  books(where: WHERE): [Book]
}
```

```
ResultSet resultSet = database.query("graphql", "{ books( where: \"name = 'Mr.
brain'\" ) { name } }");
```

The `where` value is SQL and is used exactly as written, so it must be authored in the query, never built from end-user input. For this reason it cannot be filled from a variable. If your condition has to change at runtime, use a @sql directive with a

parameter instead.

### 17.1.3. Query variables

A query can declare variables and receive their values at execution time, so the same query text can be reused with different values:

```
query($name: String) {
  bookByName(name: $name) { id name }
}
```

```
ResultSet resultSet = database.query("graphql", "query($name: String) {
bookByName(name: $name) { id name } }",
                                     "name", "Harry Potter and the Philosopher's
Stone");
```

From the HTTP API the variables are the request parameters, and from the Postgres Driver they are the query parameters.

A variable can declare a default value, used when no value is passed:

```
query($name: String = "Mr. brain") { bookByName(name: $name) { id } }
```

Variables can also be used in the arguments of a directive written in the query:

```
query($edge: String) { bookById(id: "book-1") { authors @relationship(type: $edge,
direction: IN) { lastName } } }
```

The value passed must match the type the variable is declared with, otherwise the query is rejected:

- `Int` accepts a whole number in the 32-bit range
- `Float` accepts any number, but not `NaN` or infinity
- `Boolean` accepts only a boolean, `String` only a string
- `ID` accepts a string or a whole number of any size
- any other type name (a custom scalar, an enum, a list) is passed through unchecked

A variable declared with `!` (for example `$name: String!`) must receive a value, and that value cannot be null. A variable used but never declared is an error, as is a variable used for the `where` argument.

Commas between variable declarations are not supported yet: write `query($a: String $b: Int)`, not `query($a: String, $b: Int)`.

### 17.1.4. Field aliases

A selection can rename a field with the standard GraphQL alias syntax `alias: field`. The alias becomes the key of the field in the result, while the underlying field is resolved normally.

Example:

```
{ bookById(id: "book-1")
  {
    title: name
    authors {
      first: firstName
      lastName
    }
  }
}
```

This returns `title` (instead of `name`) and `first` (instead of `firstName`) as the result keys.

The top-level query field itself can also be aliased, including when it takes arguments:

```
{ myBooks: books(inStock: true) { name } }
```

### 17.1.5. Fragments

A selection set can reuse a named fragment with the spread syntax `···Name`, or write an inline fragment with `··· on Type { }`. The fields the fragment selects are resolved as if they were written in place of the spread, at any depth, and a fragment can be declared before or after the operation that uses it:

```
fragment AuthorName on Author { firstName lastName }
fragment BookInfo on Book { name authors { ...AuthorName } }

{ bookById(id: "book-1") { id ...BookInfo } }
```

A fragment applies when its type condition names the type the selection is written against, or the database type of the record or one of its super types, so `··· on Novel { pageCount }` under a `Book` field returns `pageCount` only for the records that are novels. When the same field is selected more than once, directly or through fragments, the sub-selections are merged into one field. A fragment that is not defined, or fragments that spread each other in a cycle, are rejected before any record is read. *(Since v26.10.1)*

### 17.1.6. Supported directives

Directives can be defined on both types and queries. Directives defined in queries override any directives defined in types, only for the query execution context.

#### @relationship

Applies to: `Query Field` and `Field Definition`

Syntax: `@relationship([type: "<type-name>"] [, direction: <OUT|IN|BOTH>])`

Where:

- `type` is the edge type, optional. If not specified, then all the types are considered
- `direction` is the direction of the edge, optional. If not specified, then BOTH is used

Example:

```
friends: [Account] @relationship(type: "FRIEND", direction: BOTH)
```

Relationships can be traversed at any depth, each level being resolved against its own type. The query below walks from a book to its authors, then back to every book each author wrote:

```
{ bookById(id: "book-1")
  {
    name
    authors {
      lastName
      wrote { name }
    }
  }
}
```

#### @sql

Applies to: `Query Field` and `Field Definition`

Syntax: `@sql( statement: <sql-statement> )`

Executes a SQL query. The query can use parameters passed at invocation time.

Example of definition of a query using SQL in GraphQL:

```
bookByName(bookNameParameter: String): Book @sql(statement: "select from Book where
name = :bookNameParameter")
```

Invoke the query defined above passing the book name as parameter:

```
ResultSet resultSet = database.query("graphql", "{ bookByName(bookNameParameter:
\"Harry Potter and the Philosopher's Stone\")}"));
```

**@gremlin**

Applies to: `Query Field` and `Field Definition`

Syntax: `@gremlin( statement: <gremlin-statement> )`

Executes a Gremlin query. The query can use parameters passed at invocation time.

Example of definition of a query using Gremlin in GraphQL:

```
bookByName(bookNameParameter: String): Book @gremlin(statement: "g.V().has('name',
bookNameParameter)")
```

Invoke the query defined above passing the book name as parameter:

```
ResultSet resultSet = database.query("graphql", "{ bookByName(bookNameParameter:
\"Harry Potter and the Philosopher's Stone\")}"));
```

**@cypher**

Applies to: `Query Field` and `Field Definition`

Syntax: `@cypher( statement: <cypher-statement> )`

Executes a Cypher query. The query can use parameters passed at invocation time.

Example of definition of a query using Cypher in GraphQL:

```
bookByName(bookNameParameter: String): Book @cypher(statement: "MATCH (b:Book {name:
$bookNameParameter}) RETURN b")
```

Invoke the query defined above passing the book name as parameter:

```
ResultSet resultSet = database.query("graphql", "{ bookByName(bookNameParameter:
\"Harry Potter and the Philosopher's Stone\")}"));
```

**@rid**

Applies to: `Query Field` and `Field Definition`

Syntax: `@rid`

Mark the field as the record identity or concepts/basics.pdf.

Example:

```
{ bookById(id: "book-1")
```

```
  {
    rid @rid
    id
    name
    authors {
      firstName
      lastName
    }
  }
}
```

**@skip and @include**

Applies to: `Query Field`, fragment spread and inline fragment

Syntax: `@skip(if: <Boolean>)`, `@include(if: <Boolean>)`

The two built-in directives of the GraphQL specification. The selection they are written on is left out of the result when the `@skip` condition is `true`, or when the `@include` condition is `false`; written together, the selection is returned only when both let it through. The condition is a literal or a variable, so the same query text can toggle parts of the result at execution time:

```
fragment Details on Book { pageCount authors { lastName } }

query($brief: Boolean!, $withName: Boolean = true) {
  bookById(id: "book-1") {
    id
    name @include(if: $withName)
    ...Details @skip(if: $brief)
  }
}
```

The `if` argument is required and must be a Boolean: a missing, repeated or non-Boolean `if`, an argument other than `if`, the same directive written twice on one selection, or either directive written on a fragment definition rather than on its spread, is rejected before any record is read. When the only field of the query is left out, the result has no record. *(Since v26.10.1: before, both directives were ignored and every selection was returned.)*

# Chapter 18. MongoDB QL

## 18.1. Mongo

ArcadeDB provides support for both MongoDB Query Language and MongoDB protocol.

If you're using ArcadeDB as embedded, please add the dependency to the `arcadedb-mongodbw` library. If you're using Maven include this dependency in your `pom.xml` file.

```
<dependency>
    <groupId>com.arcadedb</groupId>
    <artifactId>arcadedb-mongodbw</artifactId>
    <version>26.10.1</version>
</dependency>
```

### 18.1.1. MongoDB Query Language

If you want to use MongoDB Query Language from Java API, you can simply keep the relevant jars in your classpath and execute a query or a command with "mongo" as language.

Example:

```
// CREATE A NEW DATABASE
Database database = new DatabaseFactory("heroes").create();

// CREATE THE DOCUMENT TYPE 'HEROES'
database.getSchema().createDocumentType("Heroes");

// CREATE A NEW DOCUMENT
database.transaction((tx) -> {
  database.newDocument("Heroes").set("name", "Jay").set("lastName", "Miner").set("id",
i).save();
});

// EXECUTE A QUERY USING MONGO AS QUERY LANGUAGE
for (ResultSet resultset = database.query("mongo", // <-- USE 'mongo' INSTEAD OF 'sql'
    "{ collection: 'Heroes', query: { $and: [ { name: { $eq: 'Jay' } }, { lastName: {
$exists: true } }, { lastName: { $eq: 'Miner' } }, { lastName: { $ne: 'Miner22' } } ],
$orderBy: { id: 1 } } }"); resultset.hasNext(); ++i) {
  Result doc = resultset.next();
  ...
}
```

For more information on the MongoDB query language see: MongoDB CRUD Operations

#### Mongo queries through Postgres Driver

You can execute a Mongo query against ArcadeDB server by using the Postgres driver and prefixing the query with `{mongo}`. Example:

```
"{mongo} { collection: 'Heroes', query: { $and: [ { name: { $eq: 'Jay' } }, {
lastName: { $exists: true } }, { lastName: { $eq: 'Miner' } } ] } }"
```

ArcadeDB server will execute the query `{ collection: 'Heroes', query: { $and: [ { name: { $eq: 'Jay' } }, { lastName: { $exists: true } }, { lastName: { $eq: 'Miner' } } ] } }` using the Mongo query language.

#### Mongo queries through HTTP/JSON

You can execute a Mongo query against ArcadeDB server by using HTTP/JSON API. Example of executing an idempotent query with HTTP GET command:

```
curl "http://localhost:2480/query/graph/mongo/{ collection: 'Heroes', query: { $and: [
{ name: { $eq: 'Jay' } }, { lastName: { $exists: true } }, { lastName: { $eq: 'Miner'
} } ]} }"
```

You can also execute the same query in HTTP POST, passing the language and query in payload:

```
curl -X POST "http://localhost:2480/query/graph" -d "{'language': 'mongo', 'command':
'{ collection: \"Heroes\", query: { $and: [ { name: { $eq: \"Jay\" } }, { lastName: {
$exists: true } }, { lastName: { $eq: \"Miner\" } } ] } }\"}"
```

### 18.1.2. MongoDB Protocol Plugin

If your application is written for MongoDB and you'd like to run it with ArcadeDB instead, you can simply replace the MongoDB server with ArcadeDB server with the MongoDB Plugin installed. This plugin supports MongoDB BSON Network protocol. In this way you can use any MongoDB driver for any supported programming language.

ArcadeDB Server supports a subset of the MongoDB protocol, like CRUD operations and queries.

To start the MongoDB plugin, enlist it in the `server.plugins` settings. To specify multiple plugins, use the comma `,` as separator.

Example to start ArcadeDB with the MongoDB Plugin:

```
~/arcadedb $ bin/server.sh -Darcadedb.server.plugins
="MongoDB:com.arcadedb.mongo.MongoDBProtocolPlugin"
```

If you're using MS Windows OS, replace `server.sh` with `server.bat`.

In case you're running ArcadeDB with Docker, use `-e` to pass settings (Port 27017 is the default MongoDB binary port):

```
docker run --rm -p 2480:2480 -p27017:27017 \
       --env ARCADEDB_SETTINGS="-Darcadedb.server.rootPassword=playwithdata \
          -Darcadedb.server.plugins=MongoDB:com.arcadedb.mongo.MongoDBProtocolPlugin "
\
          arcadedata/arcadedb:latest
```

The Server output will contain this line:

```
2018-10-09 18:47:01:692 INFO  <ArcadeDB_0> - MongoDB Protocol plugin started
[ArcadeDBServer]
```

### Supported commands

The plugin implements a subset of the MongoDB protocol, focused on CRUD operations, queries and index creation:

| Command | Driver helpers |
|---|---|
| `find`, `count`, `aggregate` | `find()`, `countDocuments()`, `aggregate()` |
| `insert` | `insertOne()`, `insertMany()` |
| `update` | `updateOne()`, `updateMany()`, `replaceOne()`, `replaceMany()` |
| `delete` | `deleteOne()`, `deleteMany()` |
| `create` | `createCollection()` |
| `createIndexes` | `createIndex()`, `createIndexes()` |

#### Updating and deleting documents

The `update` and `delete` commands accept the same filter operators as `find` (`$eq`, `$ne`, `$lt`, `$lte`, `$gt`, `$gte`, `$in`, `$nin`, `$and`, `$or`, `$not`, `$exists`, …).

```
// Delete the first matching document
db.doc.deleteOne({ test: { $eq: "abcde" } })

// Delete all matching documents
db.doc.deleteMany({ counter: { $gte: 5 } })

// Replace the whole document (replaceOne / replaceMany)
db.doc.replaceOne({ test: { $eq: "abcde" } }, { test: "vwxyz" })

// Update with operators ($set, $unset, $inc)
db.doc.updateOne({ test: "v2" }, { $set: { name: "Jay" } })
db.doc.updateMany({ counter: { $gte: 8 } }, { $inc: { counter: 100 } })
db.doc.updateOne({ test: "v1" }, { $unset: { counter: "" } })
```

```
// Upsert: insert when nothing matches
db.doc.updateOne({ test: "missing" }, { $set: { counter: 999 } }, { upsert: true })
```

Notes:

- `deleteOne()`, `updateOne()` and `replaceOne()` affect a single matching document; `deleteMany()` and `updateMany()` affect all matches.
- A replacement document (no `$`-prefixed keys) fully replaces the matched document's fields, but keeps its `_id`. The `_id` is immutable: an update or replacement that changes or removes it is refused (error 66).
- The supported update operators are `$set`, `$unset` and `$inc`. They accept dotted paths (`{ $set: { "addr.city": "Rome" } }`): the embedded document is updated and missing levels are created. Writing below a value that is not a document (for example a string) is refused.
- With `upsert: true`, when no document matches a new one is inserted, seeded from the filter's equality conditions plus the update. If the filter includes an `_id`, that `_id` is used for the new document; otherwise one is generated. Either way, the resulting `_id` is returned.

#### Null values, projections, regular expressions and duplicate keys

- `$ne`, `$nin`, `$in` (with `null`) and `$not` also match documents whose field is `null` or missing, like MongoDB. For example `{ age: { $ne: 30 } }` returns documents with no `age`.
- Filters follow MongoDB's rules for types and arrays, in `find`, `count`, `update` and `delete`. A number never equals a string or a boolean (`{ n: 5 }` does not match `"5"`), and `$gt`/`$lt` compare within one type only. A filter on an array field tests its elements: `{ tags: "a" }` matches `["a", "b"]`, `{ tags: { $ne: "a" } }` does not, and `$all`, `$elemMatch`, `$size` and `tags.0` work. `$exists` works on dotted paths (`{ "a.b": { $exists: false } }`), and collection names with dots (`fs.files`) can be read like any other.
- A filter on `_id` (equality or `$in`) uses the unique `_id` index. A filter on any other field is tested on the documents with MongoDB's own rules, and an index narrows which documents are tested only for a field that an index starts with and whose type is declared in the schema as a scalar (`STRING`, `BOOLEAN`, `BYTE`, `SHORT`, `INTEGER`, `LONG` or `DOUBLE`; for example `CREATE PROPERTY products.sku STRING` followed by `CREATE INDEX ON products (sku) UNIQUE`). Equality and `$in` use the index, and so does a range (`$gt`, `$gte`, `$lt`, `$lte`) on an integer field, when the operand is of the kind of the field (a string for a `STRING`, an integer for an `INTEGER`). Lookups, updates, deletes and bulk upserts by such a field do not read the whole collection. A field the schema does not declare is never narrowed by its index, because an array can be stored in it and an index does not see the elements of an array: filters on it, and on dotted paths, negations, regular expressions and temporal values, read every document of the collection and are slower on large ones. The declared type is relied upon: when you declare a property on a collection that already holds data, records stored before the declaration are not converted, so rewrite them if they hold an array or a value of another kind in that field.
- A top-level `$not`, `$expr` and a `$regex` directly inside `$elemMatch` are refused with an error. Regular expressions are time-bounded by `arcadedb.command.regexTimeout`, shared by all the documents one command scans: raise it if a big scan with a regular expression times out. The same bound applies to the `$match` stages of an aggregation, including `countDocuments()` with a filter, and to the

`$match` stages nested in `$facet`, `$lookup` and `$unionWith`. A non-regex `$expr` works inside an aggregation `$match`.

- Aggregating or counting a collection that does not exist returns an empty result, and the first insert creates the collection.
- `find()` honors the projection (`{ name: 1 }`, `{ _id: 0 }`, `{ age: 0 }`, dotted paths). Inclusion and exclusion cannot be mixed, except for `_id`. Projection operators (`$slice`, `$elemMatch`, `$meta`) are not supported and return an error. Documents never contain ArcadeDB's `@rid`, `@type` or `@cat`.
- Regular expressions work as literals (`/^a/i`) and with `$regex` and `$options` (`i`, `m`, `s`, `x`), also under `$not`. An invalid pattern returns an error.
- `_id` is unique: inserting an existing `_id` fails with `E11000`. In a batch, `ordered: true` (the default) stops at the first duplicate, `ordered: false` inserts the others. The first insert creates the collection and a unique index on `_id`; on a big existing collection that first insert builds the index and other writes to it wait until it is done.
- The `_id` index keys follow the `_id` type (integers, doubles, strings or ObjectIds), so range queries and sorts on numeric ids are numeric. If a collection mixes kinds of `_id`, the index uses string keys: `1` and `"1"` are then the same key, and ordering is textual.

A String `_id` that happens to look like a 24-character hex ObjectId (e.g. `"abcdef0123456789abcdef01"`) is indistinguishable from a real ObjectId once stored, so it round-trips back as an ObjectId rather than the original String. Avoid choosing String `_id` values in that specific shape if your client needs to tell them apart.

#### BSON value types

Besides strings, numbers, booleans, dates, embedded documents and arrays, the plugin stores and returns these BSON types with their type kept: binary, regular expression, timestamp, MinKey, MaxKey, JavaScript code, Decimal128 and ObjectId. A value the server cannot store is refused with an error instead of being dropped.

- Decimal128 is stored as an exact decimal. A decimal with more than 34 digits, written through SQL, is returned as a double.
- An ObjectId outside `_id` is stored as the text `$oid:<24 hex digits>` and returned as an ObjectId. Filters (`eq`, `$ne`, `$in`) also match the plain hex text stored by older versions. `_id` keeps the plain hex form.
- Binary, timestamp, regular expression, MinKey, MaxKey and JavaScript values are stored as a small document with the reserved field `$bson`. Equality and `$in` work on them, but range queries and sorting do not follow BSON order.
- Reserved names: a field called `$bson` is refused, and a text starting with `$oid:` or `$str:` is escaped on write, so it comes back unchanged.
- The Symbol type and binary subtypes other than 0 and 4 are not supported by the bundled MongoDB library.

### Authentication

The MongoDB Protocol Plugin supports authentication through the SASL `PLAIN` mechanism (RFC 4616). Credentials are validated against the ArcadeDB server users, exactly like the PostgreSQL protocol.

Because ArcadeDB stores passwords as one-way hashes, the challenge-response mechanisms `SCRAM-SHA-1` and `SCRAM-SHA-256` (the default negotiated by most MongoDB drivers and by `mongosh`) cannot be supported: they would require the clear-text password to be available on the server side. For this reason the client must explicitly request the `PLAIN` mechanism.

Example using a connection string:

```
mongosh "mongodb://root:playwithdata@localhost:27017/mydb?authMechanism=PLAIN"
```

Or, from an already opened shell:

```
db.auth({ user: "root", pwd: "playwithdata", mechanism: "PLAIN" })
```

The `user` and `pwd` are the ArcadeDB server credentials, and the authentication database is checked against the databases the user is authorized to access.

The `PLAIN` mechanism transmits the credentials in clear text. In production always use it over a TLS-encrypted connection, the same recommendation that applies to the PostgreSQL wire protocol.

### Index management

The MongoDB Protocol Plugin supports the `createIndexes` command, used by the driver helpers `createIndex()` and `createIndexes()`. Each requested index is mapped to an ArcadeDB LSM-Tree index over the same property list.

```
// Single-field index
db.doc.createIndex({ test: 1 })

// Unique index
db.doc.createIndex({ email: 1 }, { unique: true })

// Compound index
db.doc.createIndex({ lastName: 1, firstName: -1 })
```

Notes:

- If the target collection does not exist yet, it is created automatically (the response reports `createdCollectionAutomatically: true`).
- Because MongoDB collections are schemaless, properties that are not yet declared on the type

are kept free-form and the index serializes their keys as strings, preserving the stored value type.

- The sort direction (`1` ascending, `-1` descending) is accepted for compatibility but ignored: ArcadeDB LSM-Tree indexes can be scanned in both directions.
- Re-creating an existing index is a no-op, matching MongoDB semantics.
- Specialized index types (`text`, `2dsphere`, `hashed`, …) are created as standard LSM-Tree indexes on the indexed fields.

#### Listing and terminating running commands

Since v26.11.1 the commands a MongoDB client sends are listed, while they run, by the HTTP `list queries` server command and by Cypher `SHOW TRANSACTIONS`, with `protocol mongodb`, the connection's channel id as `connectionId` and the client's address. `terminate query`, `TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS` or the Studio Running Queries tab stop one: the client receives error `11601` (`Interrupted`), the code MongoDB answers for an operation that `killOp` interrupted. **root** sees and stops every command, any other user only their own.

# Chapter 19. Redis

## 19.1. Redis

ArcadeDB Server supports a subset of the Redis protocol. Please open an issue or a discussion on GitHub to support more commands.

If you're using ArcadeDB as embedded, please add the dependency to the `arcadedb-redisw` library. If you're using Maven include this dependency in your `pom.xml` file.

```
<dependency>
    <groupId>com.arcadedb</groupId>
    <artifactId>arcadedb-redisw</artifactId>
    <version>26.10.1</version>
</dependency>
```

ArcadeDB Redis plugin works in 2 ways:

- Manage **transient** (non-persistent) entries in the server. This is useful to manage user sessions and other records you don't need to store in the database.
- Manage **persistent** entries in the database. You can save and read any documents, vertices and edges from the underlying database.

### 19.1.1. Installation

To start the Redis plugin, enlist it in the `server.plugins` settings. To specify multiple plugins, use the comma `,` as separator. Example:

```
~/arcadedb $ bin/server.sh -Darcadedb.server.plugins
="Redis:com.arcadedb.redis.RedisProtocolPlugin"
```

If you're using MS Windows OS, replace `server.sh` with `server.bat`.

In case you're running ArcadeDB with Docker, open the port `6379` and use `-e` to pass settings:

```
docker run --rm -p 2480:2480 -p 6379:6379 \
        --env ARCADEDB_SETTINGS="-Darcadedb.server.rootPassword=playwithdata \
           -Darcadedb.server.plugins=Redis:com.arcadedb.redis.RedisProtocolPlugin " \
           arcadedata/arcadedb:latest
```

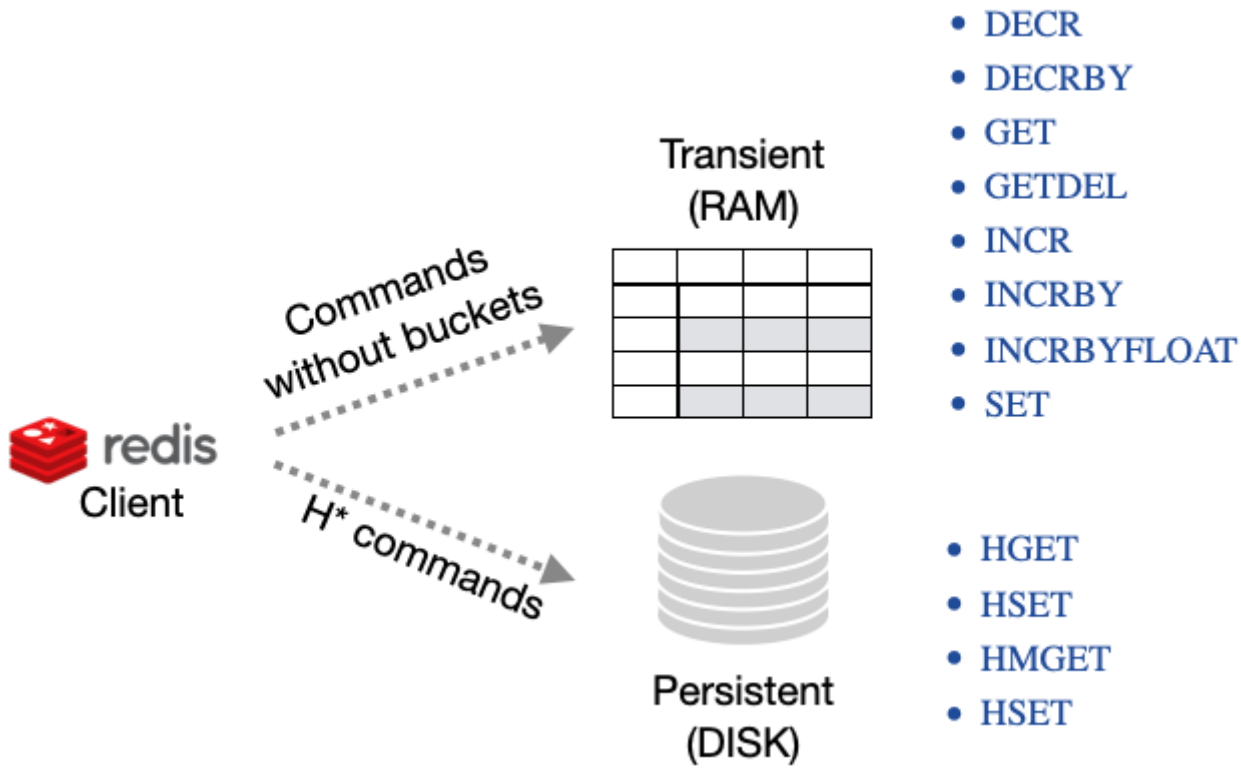
The Server output will contain this line:

```
2018-10-09 18:47:58:395 INFO  <ArcadeDB_0> - Redis Protocol plugin started
[ArcadeDBServer]
```

### 19.1.2. How it works

ArcadeDB works in 2 ways with the Redis protocol:

- **Transient commands**, key/value pairs saved will be not saved in the database. This is perfect to store transient data, like user sessions.
- **Persistent commands**, key/value pairs allows to store and retrieve ArcadeDB documents, vertices and edges




### 19.1.3. Transient (RAM Only) Commands

Below you can find the supported commands. The link takes you to the official Redis documentation. Please open an issue or a discussion on GitHub to support more commands.

The following commands do not take the bucket as a parameter because they work only in RAM on a shared (thread-safe) hashmap. This means all the stored values are reset when the server restarts.

`INCR`, `DECR`, `INCRBY` and `INCRBYFLOAT` are atomic, as they are in Redis: concurrent clients incrementing the same key all count, and no update is lost. The guarantee is **per server**, though — these values are not replicated, so in an HA cluster two clients incrementing through different nodes each update their own node's copy. The same applies to `SET` with `NX`/`XX`: it is a genuine check-and-set on one server, not a cluster-wide lock.

The commands check their argument count, over the Redis wire protocol and in the `redis` query language alike, and answer `wrong number of arguments for '<command>' command` when it is wrong, as Redis does: `INCR` and `DECR` take the key only, `INCRBY`, `DECRBY` and `INCRBYFLOAT` take the key and the amount (there is no default amount of 1), and a surplus argument is refused, never read as an amount. Amounts and stored values of `INCR`, `INCRBY`, `DECR` and `DECRBY` must be plain 64-bit integers (

`+5`, `05` and `-0` are refused with `value is not an integer or out of range`). `INCRBYFLOAT` replies and stores the result as decimal text, as Redis does (`0.1` plus `0.2` is `0.3`, an integral result is `3`, not `3.0`), so `INCR` works on an integral result. In the `redis` query language `GET` therefore returns a string for a key written by `INCRBYFLOAT`.

**Available transient commands (in alphabetic order)**:

- DECR, Decrement a value by 1
- DECRBY, Decrement a value by a specific amount (64-bit precision)
- EXISTS, Check if key exists
- GET, Return the value associated with a key
- GETDEL, Remove and return the value associated with a key
- INCR, Increment a value by 1
- INCRBY, Increment a value by a specific amount (64-bit precision)
- INCRBYFLOAT, Increment a value by a specific amount expresses as a float (64-bit precision)
- SET, Set a value associated with a key. The value is binary-safe: any bytes, valid UTF-8 or not, are returned unchanged by `GET`. Keys and the arguments of the other commands are text. `NX` (only set if the key does not exist), `XX` (only set if the key already exists) and `GET` (return the previous value instead of `OK`) are supported. `EX`/`PX`/`EXAT`/`PXAT`/`KEEPTTL` are rejected with an error rather than silently ignored, because transient keys in ArcadeDB have no expiry.

### 19.1.4. Persistent Commands

The following commands act on persistent buckets in the database. Records (documents, vertices and edges) are always in form of JSON embedded in strings. The bucket name is mapped as the database name first, then type, the index or the record's `RID` based on the use case. An index must exist on the property you used to retrieve the document, otherwise an error is returned.

For the sake of this tutorial, in a database `MyDatabase`, we're going to create the account document type totally schemaless but for some indexed properties: `id` as a unique long, `email` as a unique string and the pair `firstName` and `lastName` both strings and indexed with a composite key:

```
CREATE DOCUMENT TYPE Account;

CREATE PROPERTY Account.id LONG;
CREATE INDEX ON Account (id) UNIQUE;

CREATE PROPERTY Account.email STRING;
CREATE INDEX ON Account (email) UNIQUE;

CREATE PROPERTY Account.firstName STRING;
CREATE PROPERTY Account.lastName STRING;
CREATE INDEX ON Account (firstName,lastName) UNIQUE;
```

You can run the following Redis commands, for example, using the `redis-cli` tool;

under Debian / Ubuntu this is part of the `redis-tools` package.

Now you can create a new document with Redis protocol and the HSET Redis command:

```
HSET MyDatabase Account
"{'id':123,'email':'jay.miner@commodore.com','firstName':'Jay','lastName':'Miner'}"
```

The database and the type are two separate arguments: `HSET <database> <type> <json>`. Writing them as one argument (`HSET MyDatabase.Account <json>`) makes the plugin look for a database named `MyDatabase.Account` and fails with a "database does not exist" error.

To retrieve the document inserted above by `id` (O(logN) complexity), you can use the HGET Redis command:

```
HGET MyDatabase.Account[id] 123
"{'@rid':'#1:0','@type':'Account','id':123,'email':'jay.miner@commodore.com','firstNam
e':'Jay','lastName':'Miner'}"
```

To retrieve the same document by `email` (O(logN) complexity), you can use the HGET Redis command:

```
HGET MyDatabase.Account[email] "jay.miner@commodore.com"
"{'@rid':'#1:0','@type':'Account','id':123,'email':'jay.miner@commodore.com','firstNam
e':'Jay','lastName':'Miner'}"
```

To retrieve the same document by the pair `firstName` and `lastName` (O(logN) complexity), we are going to use the composite key we created before:

```
HGET MyDatabase.Account[firstName,lastName] "[\"Jay\",\"Miner\"]"
"{'@rid':'#1:0','@type':'Account','id':123,'email':'jay.miner@commodore.com','firstNam
e':'Jay','lastName':'Miner'}"
```

To retrieve the document inserted above by it `RID` (O(1) complexity), you can use the HGET Redis command:

```
HGET MyDatabase "#1:0"
"{'@rid':'#1:0','@type':'Account','id':123,'email':'jay.miner@commodore.com','firstNam
e':'Jay','lastName':'Miner'}"
```

You can also get multiple record in one call by using the HMGET Redis command:

```
HMGET MyDatabase "#1:0" "#1:1" "#1:2"
```

```
"{'@rid':'#1:0','@type':'Account','id':123,'email':'jay.miner@commodore.com','firstNam
e':'Jay','lastName':'Miner'}"
"{'@rid':'#1:1','@type':'Account','id':232,'email':'jay.miner@commodore.com','firstNam
e':'Jay','lastName':'Miner'}"
"{'@rid':'#1:2','@type':'Account','id':12,'email':'jay.miner@commodore.com','firstName
':'Jay','lastName':'Miner'}"
```

Or the same, but by a key:

```
HMGET MyDatabase.Account[id] 123 232 12
"{'@rid':'#1:0','@type':'Account','id':123,'email':'jay.miner@commodore.com','firstNam
e':'Jay','lastName':'Miner'}"
"{'@rid':'#1:1','@type':'Account','id':232,'email':'jay.miner@commodore.com','firstNam
e':'Jay','lastName':'Miner'}"
"{'@rid':'#1:2','@type':'Account','id':12,'email':'jay.miner@commodore.com','firstName
':'Jay','lastName':'Miner'}"
```

Or by a composite key, using the same `[…]` JSON array form `HGET` takes. A key with no record keeps its place in the reply as a null entry, so the Nth reply is always the answer to the Nth key:

```
HMGET MyDatabase.Account[firstName,lastName] "[\"Jay\",\"Miner\"]"
"[\"Nobody\",\"Here\"]"
"{'@rid':'#1:0','@type':'Account','id':123,'email':'jay.miner@commodore.com','firstNam
e':'Jay','lastName':'Miner'}"
(nil)
```

A key is matched against the index exactly as you wrote it, then converted to the indexed property's declared type. A key is therefore never guessed to be a number just because it looks like one: on a `STRING` property, `007` finds the record whose value is the three characters `007`, not the one whose value is `7`.

While the index a lookup uses is being created, rebuilt or dropped, `HGET`, `HMGET`, `HEXISTS` and `HDEL` never answer from a partial index: after a short retry they reply `-TRYAGAIN`, so a `(nil)` always means the key is not there. Retry the command once the index change is over *(since v26.11.1)*.

To delete the document inserted above by `email`, you can use the HDEL Redis command:

```
HDEL MyDatabase.Account[email] "jay.miner@commodore.com"
:1
```

The number `HDEL` replies is the number of records it removed. A key with no record is not counted, and neither is a delete the database refused because a `BeforeRecordDeleteListener` vetoed it. A multi-key `HDEL` or `HSET` is one unit of work, on the Redis protocol as in the `redis` query language: if it fails on one key, no

earlier key of the same command stays deleted or stored, and a conflict is retried. The transient form of `HSET` checks every JSON object before it stores the first *(since v26.11.1)*.

The returning JSON could have a different ordering of the properties from the one you have inserted. This is because JSON doesn't maintain the order of properties, but only of arrays (`[]`).

**Available persistent commands (in alphabetic order)**:

- HDEL, Delete one or more records by a key, a composite key or record's id. `HDEL <database> <rid> [<rid> ⋯]` deletes those records and replies with how many it deleted
- HEXISTS, Check if a key exists
- HGET, Retrieve a record by a key, a composite key or record's id
- HMGET, Retrieve multiple records by a key, a composite key or record's id
- HSET, Create and update one or more records by a key, a composite key or record's id

**Available miscellaneous commands**:

- PING, Returns its argument (for testing server readiness or latency)

#### Settings

To change the host where the Redis protocol is listening, set the setting `arcadedb.redis.host`. A name that resolves to several local addresses, such as `localhost` (`127.0.0.1` and `::1`), is bound on every one of them. By default, is `0.0.0.0` which means listen to all the configured network interfaces. To change the default port (6379) set `arcadedb.redis.port`.

#### Listing and terminating running commands

Since v26.11.1 every command a Redis client sends, except `PING` and `SELECT`, is listed while it runs by the HTTP `list queries` server command and by Cypher `SHOW TRANSACTIONS`, with `protocol redis`, the command line as its text, the connection's name as `connectionId` and the client's address. `terminate query`, `TERMINATE TRANSACTIONS` or the Studio Running Queries tab stop it, and the client receives an `ERR` error saying that it was terminated. **root** sees and stops every command, any other user only their own.

### 19.1.5. Redis via HTTP API

In addition to the native Redis wire protocol, ArcadeDB also supports Redis commands as a query language via the HTTP API. This allows you to execute Redis commands through the standard ArcadeDB HTTP `/command` endpoint by specifying `language=redis`.

This is useful when:

- You want to use Redis commands without a Redis client library
- You need to integrate Redis operations into existing HTTP-based workflows

- You want to combine Redis commands with other ArcadeDB query languages in the same application

#### Basic Usage

To execute Redis commands via HTTP, send a POST request to the `/command` endpoint with `language` set to `redis`:

```
curl -X POST "http://localhost:2480/api/v1/command/MyDatabase" \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -u root:password \
  -d '{"language": "redis", "command": "PING"}'
```

Response:

```
{"result": [{"value": "PONG"}]}
```

#### Supported Commands

All transient and persistent commands documented above are available via the HTTP API.

**Examples of transient commands:**

```
# SET a value
curl -X POST "http://localhost:2480/api/v1/command/MyDatabase" \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -u root:password \
  -d '{"language": "redis", "command": "SET mykey myvalue"}'

# GET a value
curl -X POST "http://localhost:2480/api/v1/command/MyDatabase" \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -u root:password \
  -d '{"language": "redis", "command": "GET mykey"}'

# INCREMENT a counter
curl -X POST "http://localhost:2480/api/v1/command/MyDatabase" \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -u root:password \
  -d '{"language": "redis", "command": "INCR counter"}'
```

**Examples of persistent commands:**

```
# Store a document
curl -X POST "http://localhost:2480/api/v1/command/MyDatabase" \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -u root:password \
```

```
  -d '{"language": "redis", "command": "HSET Account
{\"id\":1,\"name\":\"John\",\"age\":30}"}'

# Retrieve by index
curl -X POST "http://localhost:2480/api/v1/command/MyDatabase" \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -u root:password \
  -d '{"language": "redis", "command": "HGET Account[id] 1"}'
```

#### Batch Commands

You can execute multiple commands in a single request by separating them with newlines. Each command is executed sequentially and an array of results is returned.

```
curl -X POST "http://localhost:2480/api/v1/command/MyDatabase" \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -u root:password \
  -d '{"language": "redis", "command": "SET key1 value1\nSET key2 value2\nGET
key1\nGET key2"}'
```

Response:

```
{"result": [{"value": ["OK", "OK", "value1", "value2"]}]}
```

Comments are supported within batch commands using `#` or `//` prefixes:

```
# This is a comment
SET key1 value1
// This is also a comment
SET key2 value2
```

#### Transactions with MULTI/EXEC

Redis transactions are supported using the standard `MULTI` and `EXEC` commands. Commands between `MULTI` and `EXEC` are queued and executed atomically.

```
curl -X POST "http://localhost:2480/api/v1/command/MyDatabase" \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -u root:password \
  -d '{"language": "redis", "command": "MULTI\nSET tx1 value1\nSET tx2 value2\nINCR
counter\nEXEC"}'
```

Response (array of results from each command in the transaction):

```
{"result": [{"value": ["OK", "OK", 1]}]}
```

*(Since v26.10.1: if the transaction hit an internal conflict and had to retry automatically, the reply could contain extra or duplicated entries instead of exactly one result per queued command. `HSET` and `HDEL` could be affected the same way on their own automatic retries. This is now fixed.)*

**RAM commands inside a transaction.** The RAM commands are not stored in the database, so a transaction treats them in two different ways, depending on whether the caller acts on their reply:

- `SET` follows the transaction. While a transaction is active (a `MULTI`/`EXEC` block, the transaction the HTTP command endpoint runs every request in, or one your application opened), the new value is visible to that transaction only, is published when the transaction commits, and is discarded if it rolls back. A block that fails, for example on a duplicated key, leaves no `SET` behind.
- `INCR`, `INCRBY`, `INCRBYFLOAT`, `DECR`, `DECRBY` and `GETDEL` are applied atomically at the moment they run, as in Redis, so no two clients can ever receive the same counter value or claim the same key. When ArcadeDB retries a block automatically after a conflict, the retry reuses the value the first attempt obtained instead of applying the command a second time. If the block ultimately fails, the increment is not given back, just as a database sequence is not: the next caller gets the next value, leaving a gap. On a key the same transaction already `SET`, these commands work on the transaction's own value and follow the transaction like the `SET`.

*(Since v26.10.1. Before, an automatic retry applied these commands once per attempt, so one `EXEC` could advance a counter twice, and a `SET` in a block that failed was still applied.)*

The `DISCARD` command can be used to abort a transaction:

```
curl -X POST "http://localhost:2480/api/v1/command/MyDatabase" \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -u root:password \
  -d '{"language": "redis", "command": "MULTI\nSET discarded value\nDISCARD"}'
```

A batch can mix transaction blocks and standalone commands, and runs every line in order: a command outside a block runs on its own, the commands between `MULTI` and `EXEC` run as one atomic transaction, and the commands between `MULTI` and `DISCARD` are dropped. The reply holds one entry per command that ran, in batch order (the commands of a committed block included), so a batch with no `DISCARD` answers exactly one entry per command. A batch whose only content is a discarded block answers `"OK"`.

```
curl -X POST "http://localhost:2480/api/v1/command/MyDatabase" \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -u root:password \
  -d '{"language": "redis", "command": "SET a 1\nMULTI\nINCR a\nSET b x\nEXEC\nGET
b"}'
```

```
{"result": [{"value": ["OK", 2, "OK", "x"]}]}
```

The whole batch is checked before any command runs. `EXEC` or `DISCARD` without `MULTI`, a nested `MULTI` and a `MULTI` never closed by `EXEC` or `DISCARD` are refused with an error, and none of the batch's commands is executed.

Since v26.10.1. Before, the batch stopped at its first `EXEC` or `DISCARD` and every line after it was silently ignored, commands before `MULTI` were executed inside the transaction, and an `EXEC` without `MULTI` committed the commands before it. Batches that relied on any of these behaviors now either run their remaining lines or are refused.

#### Programmatic Access

You can also use Redis commands directly from Java code via the query engine:

```
try (ResultSet rs = database.query("redis", "PING")) {
    Result result = rs.next();
    String value = result.getProperty("value"); // Returns "PONG"
}

// SET and GET
database.command("redis", "SET mykey myvalue");
try (ResultSet rs = database.query("redis", "GET mykey")) {
    String value = rs.next().getProperty("value"); // Returns "myvalue"
}
```

# Chapter 20. Graph Algorithms

## 20.1. Graph Algorithms

ArcadeDB provides a comprehensive library of graph algorithms available as Cypher procedures and SQL functions. Cypher procedures follow the pattern:

```
CALL algo.name([arg1, arg2, ...]) YIELD field1, field2, ...
RETURN field1, field2, ...
```

SQL path functions return a list of vertex RIDs and can be used directly in `SELECT` statements.

Every `relTypes` argument (a name, a comma-separated list or a list of names; `null` or blank for all types) must name existing edge types. A name that is not an edge type of the schema, such as a typo or a weight property passed where the relationship types go, is rejected with an error instead of being answered as a graph without edges. The weighted procedures all take the relationship types before the weight property.

### 20.1.1. Algorithm Index

| Algorithm | Procedure / Function | Category | Complexity |
|---|---|---|---|
| A* | `algo.astar` | Path Finding | CPU |
| Adamic-Adar Index | `algo.adamicAdar` | Link Prediction | CPU |
| All-Pairs Shortest Paths (APSP) | `algo.apsp` | Path Finding | CPU+RAM |
| All Simple Paths | `algo.allsimplepaths` | Path Finding | CPU |
| ArticleRank | `algo.articlerank` | Centrality | CPU |
| Articulation Points | `algo.articulationPoints` | Structural Analysis | CPU |
| Assortativity | `algo.assortativity` | Network Science | CPU |
| Bellman-Ford | `algo.bellmanford` | Path Finding | CPU |
| Bellman-Ford (SQL) | `bellmanFord()` | Path Finding | CPU |
| Betweenness Centrality | `algo.betweenness` | Centrality | CPU |
| BFS (Breadth-First Search) | `algo.bfs` | Path Finding | CPU |
| Biconnected Components | `algo.biconnectedComponents` | Structural Analysis | CPU |
| Bipartite Check | `algo.bipartite` | Structural Analysis | CPU |
| Bipartite Matching | `algo.bipartiteMatching` | Structural Analysis | CPU |
| Bridges | `algo.bridges` | Structural Analysis | CPU |
| Clique Enumeration | `algo.clique` | Structural Analysis | CPU |

| Algorithm | Procedure / Function | Category | Complexity |
|---|---|---|---|
| Closeness Centrality | `algo.closeness` | Centrality | CPU |
| Common Neighbors | `algo.commonNeighbors` | Link Prediction | CPU |
| Conductance | `algo.conductance` | Community Quality | CPU |
| Cycle Detection | `algo.cycleDetection` | Structural Analysis | CPU |
| Degree Centrality | `algo.degree` | Centrality | CPU |
| Densest Subgraph | `algo.densestSubgraph` | Structural Analysis | CPU |
| DFS (Depth-First Search) | `algo.dfs` | Path Finding | CPU |
| Dijkstra | `algo.dijkstra` | Path Finding | CPU |
| Dijkstra Single-Source | `algo.dijkstra.singleSource` | Path Finding | CPU |
| Dijkstra (SQL) | `dijkstra()` | Path Finding | CPU |
| Eccentricity | `algo.eccentricity` | Centrality | CPU |
| Eigenvector Centrality | `algo.eigenvector` | Centrality | CPU |
| Graph Coloring | `algo.graphColoring` | Structural Analysis | CPU |
| Graph Summary | `algo.graphSummary` | Graph Statistics | CPU |
| Harmonic Centrality | `algo.harmonic` | Centrality | CPU |
| Hierarchical Clustering | `algo.hierarchicalClustering` | Community Detection | CPU+RAM |
| HITS (Hubs and Authorities) | `algo.hits` | Centrality | CPU |
| Influence Maximization | `algo.influenceMaximization` | Network Science | CPU |
| FastRP (Fast Random Projection) | `algo.fastrp` | Node Embedding | CPU |
| GraphSAGE | `algo.graphsage` | Node Embedding | CPU |
| HashGNN | `algo.hashgnn` | Node Embedding | CPU |
| Jaccard Similarity | `algo.jaccard` | Similarity | CPU |
| K-Core Decomposition | `algo.kcore` | Structural Analysis | CPU |
| K-Nearest Neighbours (KNN) | `algo.knn` | Similarity | CPU |
| K-Shortest Paths | `algo.kShortestPaths` | Path Finding | CPU+RAM |
| K-Truss Decomposition | `algo.kTruss` | Structural Analysis | CPU |
| Katz Centrality | `algo.katz` | Centrality | CPU |
| Label Propagation | `algo.labelpropagation` | Community Detection | CPU |
| Leiden | `algo.leiden` | Community Detection | CPU |
| Local Clustering Coefficient | `algo.localClusteringCoefficient` | Structural Analysis | CPU |
| Longest Path (DAG) | `algo.longestPath` | Path Finding | CPU |

| Algorithm | Procedure / Function | Category | Complexity |
|---|---|---|---|
| Louvain | `algo.louvain` | Community Detection | CPU |
| Max k-Cut (Approximate) | `algo.maxKCut` | Community Detection | CPU |
| Maximum Flow | `algo.maxFlow` | Network Flow | CPU+RAM |
| Minimum Spanning Arborescence | `algo.msa` | Path Finding | CPU |
| Minimum Spanning Tree (MST) | `algo.mst` | Structural Analysis | CPU |
| Modularity Score | `algo.modularityScore` | Community Quality | CPU |
| Node2Vec | `algo.node2vec` | Node Embedding | CPU |
| PageRank | `algo.pagerank` | Centrality | CPU |
| Personalized PageRank | `algo.personalizedPageRank` | Centrality | CPU |
| Preferential Attachment | `algo.preferentialAttachment` | Link Prediction | CPU |
| Random Walk | `algo.randomWalk` | Traversal / Sampling | CPU |
| Resource Allocation | `algo.resourceAllocation` | Link Prediction | CPU |
| Rich-Club Coefficient | `algo.richClub` | Network Science | CPU |
| Same Community | `algo.sameCommunity` | Link Prediction | CPU |
| Shortest Path (SQL) | `shortestPath()` | Path Finding | CPU |
| SimRank | `algo.simRank` | Similarity | CPU+RAM |
| SLPA (Speaker-Listener Label Propagation) | `algo.slpa` | Community Detection | CPU |
| Strongly Connected Components (SCC) | `algo.scc` | Community Detection | CPU |
| Steiner Tree | `algo.steinerTree` | Path Finding | CPU+RAM |
| Topological Sort | `algo.topologicalSort` | Traversal / Ordering | CPU |
| Total Neighbors | `algo.totalNeighbors` | Link Prediction | CPU |
| Triangle Count | `algo.triangleCount` | Structural Analysis | CPU |
| VoteRank | `algo.voteRank` | Centrality | CPU |
| Weakly Connected Components (WCC) | `algo.wcc` | Community Detection | CPU |

### 20.1.2. Categories

Detailed reference is split per category. Pick a category from the left navigation, or jump in:

- Path Finding — Dijkstra, A*, Bellman-Ford, BFS, DFS, K-Shortest Paths, and more
- Centrality — PageRank, Betweenness, Closeness, Eigenvector, HITS, Katz, and more

- Community Detection — Louvain, Leiden, Label Propagation, SCC, WCC, and more
- Structural Analysis — Articulation Points, Bridges, Cliques, K-Core, K-Truss, and more
- Similarity & Link Prediction — Jaccard, Adamic-Adar, SimRank, Preferential Attachment
- Network Flow — Maximum Flow
- Traversal & Sampling — Random Walk, Topological Sort
- Network Science — Assortativity, Rich-Club, Influence Maximization
- Community Quality — Conductance, Modularity Score
- Graph Statistics — Graph Summary
- Node Embedding — Node2Vec, FastRP, GraphSAGE, HashGNN
- SQL Path Functions — `dijkstra()`, `bellmanFord()`, `shortestPath()` as SQL functions
- Notes — shared parameter conventions and memory considerations

# 20.2. Path Finding

## 20.2.1. algo.dijkstra

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.dijkstra` |
| Category | Path Finding |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 4 |
| Max Args | 5 |

### Syntax

```
CALL algo.dijkstra(startNode, endNode, relTypes, weightProperty [, direction])
YIELD path, weight
```

### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `startNode` | Vertex | Yes | — | Source vertex |
| `endNode` | Vertex | Yes | — | Destination vertex |
| `relTypes` | String | Yes | — | Comma-separated relationship types; pass `''` for all types |
| `weightProperty` | String | Yes | — | Edge property name to use as weight |
| `direction` | String | No | `"BOTH"` | Traversal direction: `"IN"`, `"OUT"`, or `"BOTH"` |

#### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `path` | List<RID> | Ordered list of vertex identities on the shortest path |
| `weight` | Double | Total path weight |

#### Description

Finds the single shortest weighted path between two vertices using Dijkstra's algorithm. Internally delegates to the A* implementation with no heuristic. An edge without `weightProperty` (or whose value is not a number) weighs `1`, and an edge whose weight is negative, NaN or infinite is not walked: use algo.bellmanford for negative weights.

#### Use Cases

- Route planning in transportation networks
- Cost-optimal navigation in weighted graphs
- Network latency analysis

#### Example

```
MATCH (src:City {name:'Rome'}), (dst:City {name:'Berlin'})
CALL algo.dijkstra(src, dst, 'ROAD', 'distance', 'OUT')
YIELD path, weight
RETURN path, weight
```

#### References

- Dijkstra's algorithm – Wikipedia

See also: reference/graph-algorithms/sql-path-functions.pdf for the SQL function variant, and astar() / dijkstra() for the SQL function equivalents.

---

### 20.2.2. algo.cch.shortestPath

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.cch.shortestPath` |
| Category | Path Finding |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 4 |
| Max Args | 5 |

### Syntax

```
CALL algo.cch.shortestPath(startNode, endNode, relTypes, weightProperty [, direction])
YIELD path, weight
```

### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `startNode` | Vertex | Yes | - | Source vertex |
| `endNode` | Vertex | Yes | - | Destination vertex |
| `relTypes` | String or List | Yes | - | Relationship type(s): a name, a comma-separated list or a list; `null` for every type |
| `weightProperty` | String | Yes | - | Edge property name to use as weight |
| `direction` | String | No | `"BOTH"` | Traversal direction: `"IN"`, `"OUT"`, or `"BOTH"` |

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `path` | Map | The path: `nodes`, `relationships` (the cheapest usable edge between each pair of consecutive nodes) and `length` |
| `weight` | Double | Total path weight |

### Description

Finds the shortest weighted path between two vertices. When a Graph Analytical View keeps a Customizable Contraction Hierarchy for the same weight property and relationship types, the path is answered by the hierarchy in a time that depends on the depth of the hierarchy rather than on how far apart the two vertices are: on road-like graphs it is one to two orders of magnitude faster than Dijkstra, and the gap grows with the length of the route.

When no hierarchy can answer - none is defined, it is still being prepared after a change, the graph was found unsuitable for it, or the calling transaction holds uncommitted changes the view cannot see - the procedure answers with a bidirectional Dijkstra, on the view's columns when a view materializes the weight and on the records otherwise. The answer is always exact and always reflects the calling transaction's own changes; only the speed varies.

The weight of an edge is the numeric value of `weightProperty`; an edge without one weighs `1`, and an edge whose value is negative, NaN or infinite is not walked. Among parallel edges only the cheapest counts. Every weighted path finder (`algo.dijkstra`, `algo.astar`, `algo.dijkstra.singleSource`, `algo.kShortestPaths`, `algo.steinerTree` and the `dijkstra()`, `astar()`, `duanSSSP()` and `cchShortestPath()` SQL functions) reads the weight by this same rule, so they answer the same path.

### Use Cases

- Route planning on road, logistics and utility networks with many point-to-point queries
- Navigation where weights change often (traffic, closures) but the network itself rarely does

### Example

```
CREATE GRAPH ANALYTICAL VIEW roads EDGE TYPES (ROAD) UPDATE MODE SYNCHRONOUS CCH
(distance)
```

```
MATCH (src:City {name:'Rome'}), (dst:City {name:'Berlin'})
CALL algo.cch.shortestPath(src, dst, 'ROAD', 'distance', 'OUT')
YIELD path, weight
RETURN path, weight
```

### References

- Dibbelt, Strasser, Wagner: *Customizable Contraction Hierarchies*, ACM Journal of Experimental Algorithmics 21 (2016)

See also: cchShortestPath() for the SQL function, and how-to/data-modeling/graph-olap.pdf for defining and monitoring the hierarchy.

---

## 20.2.3. algo.astar

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.astar` |
| Category | Path Finding |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 4 |
| Max Args | 6 |

### Syntax

```
CALL algo.astar(startNode, endNode, relTypes, weightProperty [, latProperty,
lonProperty])
YIELD path, weight
```

### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `startNode` | Vertex | Yes | — | Source vertex |

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `endNode` | Vertex | Yes | — | Destination vertex |
| `relTypes` | String | Yes | — | Comma-separated relationship types; pass `''` for all types |
| `weightProperty` | String | Yes | — | Edge property name to use as weight |
| `latProperty` | String | No | — | Vertex property name for latitude (enables geographic heuristic) |
| `lonProperty` | String | No | — | Vertex property name for longitude (enables geographic heuristic) |

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `path` | List<RID> | Ordered list of vertex identities on the shortest path |
| `weight` | Double | Total path weight |

### Description

Finds the shortest weighted path using the A* algorithm. When `latProperty` and `lonProperty` are provided, a geographic (Euclidean) heuristic accelerates the search. Without the geographic properties it behaves identically to Dijkstra. Edges are followed in both directions, like `algo.dijkstra`'s default. The returned `path` includes the relationships between the vertices. An edge without `weightProperty` (or whose value is not a number) weighs `1`, and an edge whose weight is negative, NaN or infinite is not walked: use algo.bellmanford for negative weights.

### Use Cases

- Geospatial route optimization
- Game AI pathfinding with spatial heuristics
- Weighted graph shortest paths with domain-specific heuristics

### Example

```
MATCH (src:City {name:'Milan'}), (dst:City {name:'Paris'})
CALL algo.astar(src, dst, 'ROAD', 'km', 'lat', 'lon')
YIELD path, weight
RETURN path, weight
```

### References

- A* search algorithm – Wikipedia

### 20.2.4. algo.bellmanford

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.bellmanford` |
| Category | Path Finding |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 4 |
| Max Args | 4 |

#### Syntax

```
CALL algo.bellmanford(startNode, endNode, relTypes, weightProperty)
YIELD path, weight, negativeCycle
```

#### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `startNode` | Vertex | Yes | — | Source vertex |
| `endNode` | Vertex | Yes | — | Destination vertex |
| `relTypes` | String | Yes | — | Comma-separated relationship types; pass `''` for all types |
| `weightProperty` | String | Yes | — | Edge property name to use as weight (may be negative) |

#### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `path` | List<RID> | Ordered list of vertex identities on the shortest path |
| `weight` | Double | Total path weight |
| `negativeCycle` | Boolean | `true` if a negative-weight cycle is reachable from `startNode` |

#### Description

Finds the shortest weighted path between two vertices using the Bellman-Ford algorithm. Unlike Dijkstra, it correctly handles graphs with negative edge weights. It runs V−1 relaxation iterations followed by one extra iteration to detect negative-weight cycles. If a negative cycle is detected, `negativeCycle` is set to `true` and the path result is unreliable.

#### Use Cases

- Financial transaction networks with negative-cost edges

- Currency arbitrage detection (negative cycle = profit cycle)
- Graphs where edge weights can be negative

**Example**

```
MATCH (a:Account {id:1}), (b:Account {id:5})
CALL algo.bellmanford(a, b, 'TRANSFER', 'cost')
YIELD path, weight, negativeCycle
RETURN path, weight, negativeCycle
```

**References**

- Bellman-Ford algorithm – Wikipedia

See also: reference/graph-algorithms/sql-path-functions.pdf for the SQL function variant.

---

## 20.2.5. algo.allsimplepaths

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.allsimplepaths` |
| Category | Path Finding |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 4 |
| Max Args | 4 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.allsimplepaths(startNode, endNode, relTypes, maxDepth)
YIELD path
```

**Parameters**

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `startNode` | Vertex | Yes | — | Source vertex |
| `endNode` | Vertex | Yes | — | Destination vertex |
| `relTypes` | String | Yes | — | Comma-separated relationship types; pass `''` for all types |
| `maxDepth` | Integer | Yes | — | Maximum path length in hops (minimum 1) |

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| path | List<RID> | Ordered list of vertex identities for one simple path |

**Description**

Enumerates all simple (loop-free) paths between two vertices up to a maximum depth, using DFS with backtracking. Edges are traversed in both directions. Each result row contains one complete path. Use `maxDepth` to prevent combinatorial explosion in dense graphs.

**Use Cases**

- Finding all routes between two nodes in a network
- Dependency analysis between components
- Attack path enumeration in security graphs

**Example**

```
MATCH (s:Service {name:'AuthService'}), (t:Service {name:'Database'})
CALL algo.allsimplepaths(s, t, 'CALLS', 4)
YIELD path
RETURN path
```

**References**

- Path (graph theory) – Wikipedia

---

## 20.2.6. algo.kShortestPaths

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | algo.kShortestPaths |
| Category | Path Finding |
| Complexity | CPU+RAM |
| Min Args | 3 |
| Max Args | 5 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.kShortestPaths(startNode, endNode, k [, relTypes, weightProperty])
YIELD path, weight, rank
```

**Parameters**

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `startNode` | Vertex | Yes | — | Source vertex |
| `endNode` | Vertex | Yes | — | Destination vertex |
| `k` | Integer | Yes | — | Number of shortest paths to find |
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |
| `weightProperty` | String | No | uniform weight | Edge property name for weights |

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `path` | List<RID> | Ordered list of vertex identities |
| `weight` | Double | Total path weight |
| `rank` | Integer | 1-based rank (1 = shortest) |

**Description**

Finds the k shortest loopless paths between two vertices using Yen's algorithm. Internally uses Dijkstra on a V×V weight matrix, progressively building candidate paths by spur-node deviation from previous shortest paths. Memory usage scales as O(V²) for the weight matrix. An edge without `weightProperty` weighs `1`, and an edge whose weight is negative, NaN or infinite is not walked.

**Use Cases**

- Resilience planning: top-k alternative routes in case of failures
- Network redundancy analysis
- Multi-criteria path exploration

**Example**

```
MATCH (s:Router {id:'R1'}), (t:Router {id:'R10'})
CALL algo.kShortestPaths(s, t, 3, 'LINK', 'latency')
YIELD path, weight, rank
RETURN rank, path, weight ORDER BY rank ASC
```

**References**

- Yen's k shortest simple paths – Wikipedia

## 20.2.7. algo.apsp

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.apsp` |
| Category | Path Finding |
| Complexity | CPU+RAM |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 2 |

### Syntax

```
CALL algo.apsp([relTypes, weightProperty])
YIELD source, target, distance
```

### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types (pass `null` for all types when only the weight is needed) |
| `weightProperty` | String | No | uniform weight | Edge property name for weights |

Since 26.11.1 the relationship types come first, as in every other weighted `algo.*` procedure. Before that, `algo.apsp` took `(weightProperty, relTypes)`. A call still written in the old order, such as `algo.apsp('weight')`, is now rejected with "relationship type 'weight' does not exist": rewrite it as `algo.apsp(null, 'weight')`.

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `source` | RID | Source vertex identity |
| `target` | RID | Target vertex identity |
| `distance` | Double | Shortest distance between source and target |

### Description

Computes shortest distances between all reachable pairs of distinct vertices using the Floyd-Warshall algorithm. Time complexity is $O(V^3)$; memory usage is $O(V^2)$. Only reachable pairs (finite distance, source ≠ target) are returned. Suitable for small to medium graphs.

### Use Cases

- Graph diameter and radius computation
- Network reachability analysis

- Pre-computing all pairwise distances for downstream analytics

**Example**

```
CALL algo.apsp('ROAD', 'weight')
YIELD source, target, distance
RETURN source, target, distance ORDER BY distance DESC LIMIT 10
```

**References**

- Floyd-Warshall algorithm – Wikipedia

---

## 20.2.8. algo.bfs

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.bfs` |
| Category | Path Finding |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 1 |
| Max Args | 4 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.bfs(startNode [, relTypes, direction, maxDepth])
YIELD node, depth
```

**Parameters**

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `startNode` | Vertex | Yes | — | Source vertex from which the traversal starts |
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types to follow |
| `direction` | String | No | `"BOTH"` | Traversal direction: `"IN"`, `"OUT"`, or `"BOTH"` |
| `maxDepth` | Integer | No | unbounded | Maximum BFS depth (hop count) from the start node |

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | RID | Vertex identity (the start node is not included) |
| `depth` | Integer | BFS depth from the start node |

#### Description

Performs a Breadth-First Search traversal from a given start node, visiting all reachable vertices in non-decreasing distance order. Each reachable vertex (excluding the start node itself) is yielded together with its BFS depth. An optional `maxDepth` bound limits the traversal radius.

#### Use Cases

- Shortest hop-count paths from a source
- Neighbourhood exploration at a given radius
- Level-order processing of tree or DAG structures

#### Example

```
MATCH (start:Person {name:'Alice'})
CALL algo.bfs(start, 'KNOWS', 'BOTH', 3)
YIELD node, depth
RETURN node.name, depth ORDER BY depth
```

#### References

- Breadth-first search – Wikipedia

---

### 20.2.9. algo.dfs

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.dfs` |
| Category | Path Finding |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 1 |
| Max Args | 4 |

#### Syntax

```
CALL algo.dfs(startNode [, relTypes, direction, maxDepth])
YIELD node, depth
```

#### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `startNode` | Vertex | Yes | — | Source vertex from which the traversal starts |
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types to follow |
| `direction` | String | No | `"BOTH"` | Traversal direction: `"IN"`, `"OUT"`, or `"BOTH"` |
| `maxDepth` | Integer | No | unbounded | Maximum DFS depth from the start node |

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | RID | Vertex identity (the start node is not included) |
| `depth` | Integer | DFS discovery depth from the start node |

**Description**

Performs an iterative (non-recursive) Depth-First Search from a given start node using an explicit stack, avoiding Java stack-overflow on large graphs. Vertices are yielded in DFS discovery order together with their depth. An optional `maxDepth` bound limits the traversal.

**Use Cases**

- Reachability analysis
- Dependency resolution and cycle detection
- Tree/DAG structure enumeration

**Example**

```
MATCH (start:Module {name:'core'})
CALL algo.dfs(start, 'DEPENDS_ON', 'OUT')
YIELD node, depth
RETURN node.name, depth
```

**References**

- Depth-first search – Wikipedia

---

## 20.2.10. algo.dijkstra.singleSource

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.dijkstra.singleSource` |

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Category | Path Finding |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 3 |
| Max Args | 4 |

### Syntax

```
CALL algo.dijkstra.singleSource(startNode, relTypes, weightProperty [, direction])
YIELD node, cost
```

### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `startNode` | Vertex | Yes | — | Source vertex |
| `relTypes` | String | Yes | — | Comma-separated relationship types; pass `''` for all types |
| `weightProperty` | String | Yes | — | Edge property name to use as weight (must be numeric, non-negative) |
| `direction` | String | No | `"OUT"` | Traversal direction: `"IN"`, `"OUT"`, or `"BOTH"` |

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | RID | Reachable vertex identity (the start node is not included) |
| `cost` | Double | Minimum total weight from the start node to this vertex |

### Description

Computes the Single-Source Shortest Path (SSSP) from a given start node to every reachable vertex using Dijkstra's algorithm with a binary min-heap. This procedure extends `algo.dijkstra` to return results for all reachable targets at once instead of just a single source-target pair. An edge without `weightProperty` (or whose value is not a number) weighs `1`; an edge whose weight is negative, NaN or infinite is not walked.

### Use Cases

- Distance maps from a hub in transportation networks
- Risk propagation from an origin node

- Identifying the closest facility to every location in a network

**Example**

```
MATCH (hub:City {name:'London'})
CALL algo.dijkstra.singleSource(hub, 'ROAD', 'distance', 'OUT')
YIELD node, cost
RETURN node.name, cost ORDER BY cost LIMIT 10
```

**References**

- Dijkstra's algorithm – Wikipedia

See also: algo.dijkstra for the single source-target variant.

---

## 20.2.11. algo.longestPath

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.longestPath` |
| Category | Path Finding |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 2 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.longestPath([relTypes, weightProperty])
YIELD node, distance, source
```

**Parameters**

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types to follow |
| `weightProperty` | String | No | `1.0` per hop | Edge property name to use as weight |

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | RID | Vertex identity |

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `distance` | Double | Maximum distance from the furthest source reaching this vertex |
| `source` | RID | The source vertex that achieves the maximum distance |

**Description**

Finds the longest path in a Directed Acyclic Graph (DAG) using dynamic programming on topological order (Kahn's algorithm). If the graph contains a cycle the procedure detects it and returns an empty result set. When no `weightProperty` is provided, each hop has weight `1.0` (i.e., the result is the maximum hop count).

**Use Cases**

- Critical path analysis in project scheduling (CPM)
- Longest dependency chain in build systems
- Pipeline bottleneck identification

**Example**

```
CALL algo.longestPath('DEPENDS_ON')
YIELD node, distance, source
RETURN node.name AS task, distance, source.name AS criticalSource
ORDER BY distance DESC LIMIT 5
```

**References**

- Longest path problem – Wikipedia

See also: reference/graph-algorithms/structural-analysis.pdf for topological ordering.

---

## 20.2.12. algo.msa

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.msa` |
| Category | Path Finding |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 1 |
| Max Args | 3 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.msa(rootNode [, relTypes, weightProperty]) YIELD source, target, weight,
totalWeight
```

**Parameters**

| Name | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `rootNode` | Vertex | — | Root vertex for the arborescence |
| `relTypes` | String | all types | Comma-separated edge type names to traverse |
| `weightProperty` | String | `null` | Edge property for weights; `null` = all weights 1.0 |

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `source` | Vertex | Source vertex of this MSA edge |
| `target` | Vertex | Destination vertex of this MSA edge |
| `weight` | Float | Weight of this edge |
| `totalWeight` | Float | Total weight of the arborescence (same on every row) |

**Description**

Computes the Minimum Spanning Arborescence (directed MST) rooted at a specified vertex using the Chu-Liu/Edmonds algorithm. Unlike the undirected `algo.mst`, the arborescence is a **directed** spanning tree where every non-root vertex has exactly one incoming edge and all vertices are reachable from the root along directed paths.

Returns n − 1 rows (one per arborescence edge). Returns an empty result if no spanning arborescence exists (the directed graph is not strongly connected from the root).

**Use Cases**

- Optimising directed distribution networks (water, power, logistics)
- Dependency resolution with minimum total cost
- Directed network backbone extraction

**Example**

```
MATCH (r:City {name:'Rome'})
CALL algo.msa(r, 'ROAD', 'distance')
YIELD source, target, weight, totalWeight
RETURN source.name, target.name, weight ORDER BY weight
```

### References

- Edmonds' algorithm – Wikipedia
- Chu, Y. J. & Liu, T. H. (1965). On the Shortest Arborescence of a Directed Graph. *Science Sinica*.

## 20.2.13. algo.steinerTree

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.steinerTree` |
| Category | Path Finding |
| Complexity | CPU+RAM |
| Min Args | 1 |
| Max Args | 3 |

### Syntax

```
CALL algo.steinerTree(terminalNodes [, relTypes, weightProperty]) YIELD source,
target, weight, totalWeight
```

### Parameters

| Name | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `terminalNodes` | List<Vertex> | — | List of terminal (required) vertices to connect |
| `relTypes` | String | all types | Comma-separated edge type names to traverse (undirected) |
| `weightProperty` | String | `null` | Edge property for weights; `null` = all weights 1.0 |

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `source` | Vertex | Source vertex of this Steiner-tree edge |
| `target` | Vertex | Destination vertex of this Steiner-tree edge |
| `weight` | Float | Weight of this edge |
| `totalWeight` | Float | Total Steiner-tree weight (same on every row) |

### Description

Finds an approximate minimum-weight connected subgraph that spans all terminal vertices, using the Kou-Markowsky-Berman 2-approximation algorithm (approximation ratio `2(1 − 1/|T|)` where

|T| is the number of terminals):

1. Run Dijkstra from each terminal to find shortest paths to all other terminals.
2. Build a complete graph on terminals with shortest-path distances.
3. Find the MST of this terminal graph (Kruskal's).
4. Expand each MST edge back to its actual shortest path in the original graph.
5. Prune non-terminal leaves iteratively.

Edges are traversed undirected. Returns an empty result if terminals are unreachable from each other. An edge without `weightProperty` weighs `1`, an edge whose weight is negative, NaN or infinite is not walked, and among parallel edges the cheapest one is the one reported.

**Use Cases**

- Designing minimum-cost subnetworks connecting mandatory waypoints
- Content distribution network planning
- Pipeline / cable routing connecting required endpoints

**Example**

```
MATCH (a:City {name:'Rome'}), (b:City {name:'Milan'}), (c:City {name:'Naples'})
CALL algo.steinerTree([a, b, c], 'ROAD', 'distance')
YIELD source, target, weight, totalWeight
RETURN source.name, target.name, weight
```

**References**

- Steiner tree problem – Wikipedia
- Kou, L., Markowsky, G. & Berman, L. (1981). A fast algorithm for Steiner trees. *Acta Informatica*.

# 20.3. Centrality

## 20.3.1. algo.pagerank

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.pagerank` |
| Category | Centrality |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 1 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.pagerank([{dampingFactor: 0.85, maxIterations: 20, tolerance: 0.0001,
weightProperty: null, direction: 'OUT'}])
YIELD node, score
```

### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| config map | Map | No | see defaults | Configuration properties (all optional) |
| `dampingFactor` | Double | No | `0.85` | Probability of following an edge vs. teleporting |
| `maxIterations` | Integer | No | `20` | Maximum number of power-iteration steps |
| `tolerance` | Double | No | `0.0001` | Convergence threshold (max score change) |
| `weightProperty` | String | No | `null` | Edge property for weighted PageRank |
| `direction` | String | No | `OUT` | Direction rank is pushed along: `OUT`, `IN` or `BOTH` |

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | RID | Vertex identity |
| `score` | Double | PageRank score |

### Description

Computes the PageRank centrality score for every vertex using the power-iteration method. Dangling nodes (no edges in the direction rank is pushed along) contribute their rank to all nodes proportionally via the teleportation mechanism. When `weightProperty` is specified, edge weights are used as transition probabilities (normalized per node).

`direction` selects which way rank flows, and unlike most algorithms it defaults to `OUT`:

- `OUT`: rank is pushed along the stored edges, so a vertex is important when important vertices point at it. This is classic PageRank.
- `IN`: rank is pushed along the reverse of every edge, which is PageRank over the reversed graph without building a reversed copy. Use it to rank the sources rather than the sinks, for example the papers that cite the most influential work in a citation graph. Under `IN` a dangling node is one with no incoming edges.
- `BOTH`: rank is pushed both ways, treating the graph as undirected. A dangling node is one with no edges at all.

Before v26.9.1 `IN` was not honored and returned the same scores as `OUT`.

Unweighted PageRank uses a Graph Analytical View when one covers the graph. Weighted PageRank (`weightProperty` set) always runs on the slower OLTP path, even when such a view exists. `direction` works the same on both paths.

#### Use Cases

- Web page and document importance ranking
- Identifying authoritative nodes in citation networks
- Social network influence scoring

#### Example

```
CALL algo.pagerank({dampingFactor: 0.85, maxIterations: 30})
YIELD node, score
RETURN node, score ORDER BY score DESC LIMIT 10
```

#### References

- PageRank – Wikipedia

---

### 20.3.2. algo.betweenness

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.betweenness` |
| Category | Centrality |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 1 |

#### Syntax

```
CALL algo.betweenness([{normalized: true}])
YIELD node, score
```

#### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| config map | Map | No | see defaults | Configuration properties (all optional) |

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `normalized` | Boolean | No | `true` | Divide scores by `1/n-1)(n-2` to normalize to [0,1] |

#### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | RID | Vertex identity |
| `score` | Double | Betweenness centrality score |

#### Description

Measures how often a vertex lies on the shortest path between all other pairs, using the Brandes algorithm with stack-based back-propagation. Traversal follows outgoing edges only (directed). When `normalized` is `true`, scores are divided by `1/n-1)(n-2` (the directed normalization factor, matching NetworkX and Neo4j GDS).

#### Use Cases

- Identifying bridge nodes and bottlenecks in networks
- Communication hub detection in social graphs
- Critical infrastructure analysis

#### Example

```
CALL algo.betweenness({normalized: true})
YIELD node, score
RETURN node, score ORDER BY score DESC LIMIT 20
```

#### References

- Betweenness centrality – Wikipedia
- Brandes, U. (2001). A faster algorithm for betweenness centrality. *Journal of Mathematical Sociology*, 25(2), 163–177.

---

### 20.3.3. algo.closeness

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.closeness` |
| Category | Centrality |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Max Args | 3 |

### Syntax

```
CALL algo.closeness([relTypes, direction, normalized])
YIELD node, score
```

### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |
| `direction` | String | No | `"BOTH"` | Traversal direction: `"IN"`, `"OUT"`, or `"BOTH"` |
| `normalized` | Boolean | No | `true` | Use Wasserman-Faust formula for disconnected graphs |

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | RID | Vertex identity |
| `score` | Double | Closeness centrality score |

### Description

Computes closeness centrality via BFS from each vertex. For disconnected graphs, the Wasserman-Faust formula is applied: `score = (reachable / sumDist) x (reachable / (n-1))`, where `reachable` is the number of vertices reached and `sumDist` is the sum of shortest path distances to those vertices.

### Use Cases

- Identifying well-positioned nodes for information spread
- Supply chain hub identification
- Social network influence reach analysis

### Example

```
CALL algo.closeness('KNOWS', 'BOTH', true)
YIELD node, score
RETURN node, score ORDER BY score DESC LIMIT 10
```

### References

- Closeness centrality – Wikipedia
- Wasserman, S. & Faust, K. (1994). *Social Network Analysis*.

### 20.3.4. algo.degree

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.degree` |
| Category | Centrality |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 2 |

#### Syntax

```
CALL algo.degree([relTypes, direction])
YIELD node, inDegree, outDegree, degree, score
```

#### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |
| `direction` | String | No | `"BOTH"` | Traversal direction: `"IN"`, `"OUT"`, or `"BOTH"` |

#### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | RID | Vertex identity |
| `inDegree` | Long | Number of incoming edges |
| `outDegree` | Long | Number of outgoing edges |
| `degree` | Long | Total degree (in + out for BOTH, else directional) |
| `score` | Double | Normalized degree: `total / (n-1)` |

#### Description

Efficiently counts in-degree, out-degree, and total degree for every vertex using `vertex.countEdges()` to avoid materializing edge objects. The normalized score divides total degree by `(n-1)`, representing the fraction of all possible connections.

#### Use Cases

- Identifying high-degree hubs in social networks
- Popularity ranking by connection count
- Network connectivity baseline measurement

#### Example

```
CALL algo.degree('FOLLOWS', 'IN')
YIELD node, inDegree, score
RETURN node, inDegree, score ORDER BY inDegree DESC LIMIT 10
```

#### References

- Degree (graph theory) – Wikipedia

---

### 20.3.5. algo.harmonic

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.harmonic` |
| Category | Centrality |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 3 |

#### Syntax

```
CALL algo.harmonic([relTypes, direction, normalized])
YIELD node, score
```

#### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |
| `direction` | String | No | `"BOTH"` | Traversal direction: `"IN"`, `"OUT"`, or `"BOTH"` |
| `normalized` | Boolean | No | `true` | Divide raw score by `(n-1)` |

#### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | RID | Vertex identity |

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `score` | Double | Harmonic centrality score |

**Description**

Computes harmonic centrality as the sum of reciprocal shortest-path distances from a vertex to all reachable vertices: `score = Σ 1/dist(v, u)`. When `normalized` is `true`, divides by `(n-1)`. Harmonic centrality handles disconnected graphs naturally (unreachable vertices contribute 0 to the sum), unlike closeness centrality.

**Use Cases**

- Centrality measure robust to disconnected components
- Influence reach in sparse networks
- Alternative to closeness in disconnected graphs

**Example**

```
CALL algo.harmonic('KNOWS', 'BOTH', true)
YIELD node, score
RETURN node, score ORDER BY score DESC LIMIT 10
```

**References**

- Harmonic centrality – Wikipedia

## 20.3.6. algo.eigenvector

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.eigenvector` |
| Category | Centrality |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 4 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.eigenvector([relTypes, direction, maxIterations, tolerance])
YIELD node, score
```

**Parameters**

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |
| `direction` | String | No | `"BOTH"` | Traversal direction: `"IN"`, `"OUT"`, or `"BOTH"` |
| `maxIterations` | Integer | No | `20` | Maximum power-iteration steps |
| `tolerance` | Double | No | `1e-6` | Convergence threshold |

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | RID | Vertex identity |
| `score` | Double | Eigenvector centrality score in [0, 1] |

**Description**

Computes eigenvector centrality using the power iteration method. A node scores highly if it is connected to other high-scoring nodes. L∞ normalization (divide by maximum score) keeps values in [0, 1]. Convergence is checked against the maximum absolute change in scores between iterations.

**Use Cases**

- Identifying globally influential nodes
- Academic citation influence analysis
- Prestige scoring in directed networks

**Example**

```
CALL algo.eigenvector('CITES', 'IN', 50, 1e-8)
YIELD node, score
RETURN node, score ORDER BY score DESC LIMIT 10
```

**References**

- Eigenvector centrality – Wikipedia

## 20.3.7. algo.hits

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.hits` |
| Category | Centrality |

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 3 |

### Syntax

```
CALL algo.hits([relTypes, maxIterations, tolerance])
YIELD node, hubScore, authorityScore
```

### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |
| `maxIterations` | Integer | No | `20` | Maximum number of iterations |
| `tolerance` | Double | No | `1e-6` | Convergence threshold (max score change) |

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | RID | Vertex identity |
| `hubScore` | Double | Hub score (good hub points to good authorities) |
| `authorityScore` | Double | Authority score (good authority is pointed to by good hubs) |

### Description

Computes Hyperlink-Induced Topic Search (HITS) scores using alternating updates: authority scores are the sum of hub scores of incoming neighbors; hub scores are the sum of authority scores of outgoing neighbors. Both score vectors are L2-normalized after each iteration.

### Use Cases

- Web link analysis (hubs = index pages, authorities = content pages)
- Identifying experts vs. curators in knowledge networks
- Bipartite influence analysis

### Example

```
CALL algo.hits('LINKS_TO', 30, 1e-8)
YIELD node, hubScore, authorityScore
```

```
RETURN node, hubScore, authorityScore ORDER BY authorityScore DESC LIMIT 10
```

#### References

- HITS algorithm – Wikipedia
- Kleinberg, J. M. (1999). Authoritative sources in a hyperlinked environment. *Journal of the ACM*, 46(5), 604–632.

---

### 20.3.8. algo.katz

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.katz` |
| Category | Centrality |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 4 |

#### Syntax

```
CALL algo.katz([relTypes, alpha, maxIterations, tolerance])
YIELD nodeId, score
```

#### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |
| `alpha` | Double | No | `0.005` | Attenuation factor (must be less than 1/λ_max) |
| `maxIterations` | Integer | No | `100` | Maximum number of iterations |
| `tolerance` | Double | No | `1e-6` | Convergence threshold |

#### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `nodeId` | RID | Vertex identity |
| `score` | Double | Katz centrality score (normalized to [0, 1]) |

#### Description

Computes Katz centrality, which counts all paths between nodes with exponential decay by path

length. Formula: `k[i] = alpha x Σ_j(A[j][i] x k[j]) + 1`, normalized by the maximum score. Unlike eigenvector centrality, every node receives a base score (the `+1` term), making it robust for directed and sparse graphs.

**Use Cases**

- Influence ranking in directed social networks
- Ranking nodes when direct connection is sparse
- Early-stage recommendation systems

**Example**

```
CALL algo.katz('FOLLOWS', 0.01, 50, 1e-8)
YIELD nodeId, score
RETURN nodeId, score ORDER BY score DESC LIMIT 10
```

**References**

- Katz centrality – Wikipedia

---

## 20.3.9. algo.voteRank

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.voteRank` |
| Category | Centrality |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 2 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.voteRank([relTypes, topK])
YIELD nodeId, rank
```

**Parameters**

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |
| `topK` | Integer | No | all nodes | Maximum number of top spreaders to return |

#### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `nodeId` | RID | Vertex identity |
| `rank` | Integer | 1-based rank (1 = most influential spreader) |

#### Description

Identifies the most influential spreaders in a network using an iterative election process. In each round, the node with the highest accumulated votes is selected as a spreader. After selection, each of its neighbors has its voting ability reduced by `1/degree`. This suppression mechanism ensures that the selected spreaders are structurally diverse rather than clustered together.

#### Use Cases

- Viral marketing seed set selection
- Identifying structurally independent influencers
- Epidemic intervention: selecting individuals for immunization

#### Example

```
CALL algo.voteRank('KNOWS', 5)
YIELD nodeId, rank
RETURN nodeId, rank ORDER BY rank ASC
```

#### References

- Zhang, J., et al. (2016). Identifying a set of influential spreaders in complex networks. *Scientific Reports*, 6, 27823.

---

### 20.3.10. algo.eccentricity

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.eccentricity` |
| Category | Centrality |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 2 |

#### Syntax

```
CALL algo.eccentricity([relTypes, direction])
```

```
YIELD node, eccentricity, isCenter, isPeripheral
```

### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |
| `direction` | String | No | `"BOTH"` | Traversal direction: `"IN"`, `"OUT"`, or `"BOTH"` |

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | RID | Vertex identity |
| `eccentricity` | Integer | Maximum shortest-path distance to any reachable vertex |
| `isCenter` | Boolean | `true` if eccentricity equals the graph radius |
| `isPeripheral` | Boolean | `true` if eccentricity equals the graph diameter |

### Description

Computes the eccentricity of each vertex (the greatest shortest-path distance to any other reachable vertex) via BFS from each node. The graph radius is the minimum eccentricity and the graph diameter is the maximum. Center nodes have eccentricity equal to the radius; peripheral nodes have eccentricity equal to the diameter.

### Use Cases

- Graph center identification for optimal facility placement
- Network diameter and radius computation
- Peripheral node analysis for vulnerability assessment

### Example

```
CALL algo.eccentricity('ROAD', 'BOTH')
YIELD node, eccentricity, isCenter, isPeripheral
RETURN node, eccentricity, isCenter, isPeripheral ORDER BY eccentricity ASC
```

### References

- Distance (graph theory) – Wikipedia

### 20.3.11. algo.personalizedPageRank

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.personalizedPageRank` |
| Category | Centrality |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 1 |
| Max Args | 5 |

#### Syntax

```
CALL algo.personalizedPageRank(sourceNodes [, relTypes, dampingFactor, maxIterations,
tolerance])
YIELD nodeId, score
```

#### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `sourceNodes` | Vertex or List | Yes | — | The personalization origin: a vertex, a list of vertices (equal weight), or a list of `[vertex, weight]` pairs. Plain vertices and pairs can be mixed (a plain vertex weighs 1) |
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |
| `dampingFactor` | Double | No | `0.85` | Probability of following an edge |
| `maxIterations` | Integer | No | `20` | Maximum power-iteration steps |
| `tolerance` | Double | No | `1e-6` | Convergence threshold |

#### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `nodeId` | RID | Vertex identity |
| `score` | Double | Personalized PageRank score relative to the source node |

#### Description

Computes Personalized PageRank (PPR) relative to one or more source vertices. Unlike standard PageRank, the teleportation probability is concentrated at the source vertices (0 everywhere else). With a single vertex, all of it is on that vertex; with a list, it is split equally; with `[vertex, weight]` pairs, it follows the weights, which must be non-negative and are normalized to sum to 1 (only their ratios matter). A vertex listed twice counts twice. Scores represent structural proximity/importance

relative to the sources. Dangling nodes contribute their rank back to the sources, in proportion to their weights.

**Use Cases**

- Node-centric similarity and proximity ranking
- Recommendation systems ("nodes similar to X")
- Query-centric graph exploration

**Example**

```
MATCH (s:Person {name:'Alice'})
CALL algo.personalizedPageRank(s, 'KNOWS', 0.85, 20, 0.000001)
YIELD nodeId, score
RETURN nodeId, score ORDER BY score DESC LIMIT 10
```

Weighted personalization vector (Alice counts three times as much as Bob):

```
MATCH (a:Person {name:'Alice'}), (b:Person {name:'Bob'})
CALL algo.personalizedPageRank([[a, 3.0], [b, 1.0]], 'KNOWS')
YIELD nodeId, score
RETURN nodeId, score ORDER BY score DESC LIMIT 10
```

**References**

- Personalized PageRank – Wikipedia

## 20.3.12. algo.articlerank

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.articlerank` |
| Category | Centrality |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 1 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.articlerank([config]) YIELD node, score
```

**Parameters**

| Name | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `config` | Map | `{}` | Configuration map (see below) |

**Config Parameters**

| Key | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `dampingFactor` | Float | `0.85` | Damping factor (probability of following a link) |
| `maxIterations` | Integer | `20` | Maximum number of iterations |
| `tolerance` | Float | `0.0001` | Convergence threshold (sum of absolute score changes) |

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | Vertex | The vertex |
| `score` | Float | ArticleRank score for the vertex |

**Description**

ArticleRank is a variant of PageRank that dampens the contribution of low-degree nodes. While standard PageRank divides a node's rank equally among its out-degree neighbours, ArticleRank divides by `outDegree(v) + avgOutDegree`. This reduces the influence of nodes with very few connections, producing more balanced centrality scores in sparse or scale-free graphs.

Formula: `AR(u) = (1 □ d) / N + d × Σ AR(v) / (outDeg(v) + avgOutDeg)`

**Use Cases**

- Web page importance ranking where low-citation pages should have less influence
- Academic citation networks with highly skewed degree distributions
- Any domain where hub dampening is desirable

**Example**

```
CALL algo.articlerank({dampingFactor: 0.85, maxIterations: 20})
YIELD node, score
RETURN node.name AS name, score
ORDER BY score DESC LIMIT 10
```

**References**

- ArticleRank: a PageRank-based alternative to numbers of citations – WWW 2004

# 20.4. Community Detection

## 20.4.1. algo.wcc

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.wcc` |
| Category | Community Detection |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 1 |

### Syntax

```
CALL algo.wcc([relTypes])
YIELD node, componentId
```

### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | RID | Vertex identity |
| `componentId` | Integer | Sequential component identifier (0-based) |

### Description

Identifies weakly connected components using a parallel union-find, treating all edges as undirected regardless of their actual direction. Two vertices are in the same component if there exists any undirected path between them. Component IDs are remapped to sequential integers starting at 0.

### Use Cases

- Data quality: detecting isolated subgraphs
- Network partition detection
- Graph reachability analysis

### Example

```
CALL algo.wcc('CONNECTED_TO')
YIELD node, componentId
RETURN componentId, count(node) AS size ORDER BY size DESC
```

#### References

- Connected component – Wikipedia

---

### 20.4.2. algo.scc

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.scc` |
| Category | Community Detection |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 1 |

#### Syntax

```
CALL algo.scc([relTypes])
YIELD node, componentId
```

#### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |

#### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | RID | Vertex identity |
| `componentId` | Integer | Sequential component identifier (0-based) |

#### Description

Identifies strongly connected components using Kosaraju's two-pass algorithm: iterative DFS on the original graph to compute finish-time ordering, then BFS on the reversed graph in reverse finish order. A strongly connected component is a maximal set of vertices where every vertex is reachable from every other.

#### Use Cases

- Deadlock detection in dependency graphs
- Circular dependency analysis in software systems
- Identifying mutually-reachable clusters in directed networks

**Example**

```
CALL algo.scc('DEPENDS_ON')
YIELD node, componentId
RETURN componentId, collect(node) AS members ORDER BY size(members) DESC
```

**References**

- Kosaraju's algorithm – Wikipedia

---

## 20.4.3. algo.louvain

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.louvain` |
| Category | Community Detection |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 1 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.louvain([{maxIterations: 10, tolerance: 0.0001, weightProperty: null}])
YIELD node, communityId, modularity
```

**Parameters**

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| config map | Map | No | see defaults | Configuration properties (all optional) |
| `maxIterations` | Integer | No | `10` | Maximum number of phase-1 passes |
| `tolerance` | Double | No | `0.0001` | Stop when modularity gain falls below this value |
| `weightProperty` | String | No | `null` | Edge property for weighted modularity |

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | RID | Vertex identity |
| `communityId` | Integer | Sequential community identifier (0-based) |
| `modularity` | Double | Final modularity score of the partition |

**Description**

Detects communities by maximizing modularity using the Louvain method: a greedy phase where each node is moved to the neighboring community that maximally increases modularity, iterated until no improvement is found. Community IDs are remapped to sequential 0-based integers.

**Use Cases**

- Social community discovery
- Topic clustering in citation networks
- Customer segmentation in purchase graphs

**Example**

```
CALL algo.louvain({maxIterations: 15, weightProperty: 'weight'})
YIELD node, communityId, modularity
RETURN communityId, collect(node) AS members, modularity ORDER BY size(members) DESC
```

**References**

- Louvain method – Wikipedia

## 20.4.4. algo.leiden

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.leiden` |
| Category | Community Detection |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 3 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.leiden([relTypes, maxIterations, resolution])
YIELD nodeId, community
```

**Parameters**

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |
| `maxIterations` | Integer | No | `10` | Maximum number of local-move + refinement iterations |
| `resolution` | Double | No | `1.0` | Resolution parameter γ (higher = more, smaller communities) |

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `nodeId` | RID | Vertex identity |
| `community` | Integer | Sequential community identifier (0-based) |

**Description**

An improved community detection algorithm over Louvain, featuring a two-phase approach: (1) local greedy moves maximizing modularity, followed by (2) a refinement phase that checks whether nodes should be split out from their community to ensure well-connectedness. The resolution parameter γ controls granularity of the resulting communities.

**Use Cases**

- High-quality community detection with guaranteed well-connectedness
- Hierarchical community structure analysis
- Fine-grained cluster control via resolution parameter

**Example**

```
CALL algo.leiden('KNOWS', 10, 1.0)
YIELD nodeId, community
RETURN community, count(nodeId) AS size ORDER BY size DESC
```

**References**

- Traag, V. A., Waltman, L., & van Eck, N. J. (2019). From Louvain to Leiden: guaranteeing well-connected communities. *Scientific Reports*, 9, 5233.

---

## 20.4.5. algo.labelpropagation

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.labelpropagation` |
| Category | Community Detection |

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 1 |

### Syntax

```
CALL algo.labelpropagation([{maxIterations: 10, direction: 'BOTH'}])
YIELD node, communityId
```

### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| config map | Map | No | see defaults | Configuration properties (all optional) |
| `maxIterations` | Integer | No | `10` | Maximum number of propagation passes |
| `direction` | String | No | `"BOTH"` | Edge direction to follow: `"IN"`, `"OUT"`, or `"BOTH"` |
| `tieBreakProperty` | String | No | none | Vertex property used to break ties between equally frequent labels: the smallest value wins (for example the vertex id, as LDBC Graphalytics CDLP requires). Without it, ties follow the internal load order. Values must be mutually comparable, and a vertex without the property loses every tie |

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | RID | Vertex identity |
| `communityId` | Integer | Community label assigned to this vertex |

### Description

Detects communities by iteratively propagating labels. Each vertex adopts the most frequent label among its neighbors; ties are broken by choosing the smallest label. Vertex processing order is randomly shuffled each iteration. Converges quickly in practice but may produce non-deterministic results.

### Use Cases

- Fast community detection in very large graphs
- Semi-supervised classification when some labels are pre-assigned
- Near-linear time community discovery

**Example**

```
CALL algo.labelpropagation({maxIterations: 20, direction: 'OUT'})
YIELD node, communityId
RETURN communityId, count(node) AS size ORDER BY size DESC
```

**References**

- Label propagation algorithm – Wikipedia

---

## 20.4.6. algo.hierarchicalClustering

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.hierarchicalClustering` |
| Category | Community Detection |
| Complexity | CPU+RAM |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 2 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.hierarchicalClustering([relTypes, numClusters])
YIELD nodeId, cluster
```

**Parameters**

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |
| `numClusters` | Integer | No | `2` | Desired number of clusters |

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `nodeId` | RID | Vertex identity |
| `cluster` | Integer | Assigned cluster identifier |

#### Description

Performs agglomerative (bottom-up) hierarchical clustering using single-linkage: each vertex starts in its own cluster, and the two clusters with the highest Jaccard similarity between their neighbor sets are merged iteratively until the target number of clusters is reached. Uses Union-Find for efficient cluster management.

#### Use Cases

- Dendrogram-style cluster analysis
- Grouping vertices by structural neighborhood similarity
- Coarse-grained community assignment with controlled count

#### Example

```
CALL algo.hierarchicalClustering('SIMILAR_TO', 5)
YIELD nodeId, cluster
RETURN cluster, count(nodeId) AS size ORDER BY size DESC
```

#### References

- Hierarchical clustering – Wikipedia

---

### 20.4.7. algo.slpa

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.slpa` |
| Category | Community Detection |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 1 |

#### Syntax

```
CALL algo.slpa([config]) YIELD node, communities
```

#### Parameters

| Name | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `config` | Map | `{}` | Configuration map (see below) |

#### Config Parameters

| Key | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `iterations` | Integer | `20` | Number of propagation iterations (T) |
| `threshold` | Float | `0.1` | Minimum label frequency in memory to be included in output |
| `seed` | Long | `-1` | Random seed for reproducibility; `-1` uses a random seed |

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | Vertex | The vertex |
| `communities` | List<Long> | List of community IDs the vertex belongs to (overlapping) |

### Description

SLPA (Speaker-Listener Label Propagation Algorithm) detects **overlapping** communities. Each node maintains a memory of labels it has received over T iterations. In each iteration every node acts as a speaker (emitting its most frequent memory label) and a listener (recording the most common label from its neighbours). After T rounds, labels appearing with frequency ≥ threshold are retained as community assignments.

Unlike non-overlapping algorithms (Louvain, Label Propagation), SLPA allows each vertex to belong to multiple communities simultaneously, making it suitable for social networks where individuals naturally participate in multiple groups.

### Use Cases

- Overlapping community detection in social networks
- Finding cross-cutting roles in collaboration networks
- Identifying nodes that bridge multiple communities

### Example

```
CALL algo.slpa({iterations: 20, threshold: 0.1, seed: 42})
YIELD node, communities
RETURN node.name AS name, communities
ORDER BY size(communities) DESC
```

### References

- Xie, J. et al. (2013). SLPA: Uncovering Overlapping Communities in Social Networks via a Speaker-listener Interaction Dynamic Process. *ICDMW 2011*

### 20.4.8. algo.maxKCut

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.maxKCut` |
| Category | Community Detection |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 1 |
| Max Args | 2 |

#### Syntax

```
CALL algo.maxKCut(k [, config]) YIELD node, community, cutWeight
```

#### Parameters

| Name | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `k` | Integer | — | Number of partitions (≥ 2) |
| `config` | Map | `{}` | Configuration map (see below) |

#### Config Parameters

| Key | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `maxIterations` | Integer | `100` | Maximum local-search passes per restart |
| `restarts` | Integer | `3` | Number of random restarts (best result returned) |
| `weightProperty` | String | `null` | Edge property for weights; `null` = all weights 1.0 |
| `relTypes` | String | all types | Comma-separated edge type names |
| `direction` | String | `BOTH` | Edge traversal direction: `IN`, `OUT`, or `BOTH` |
| `seed` | Long | `-1` | Random seed; -1 = random |

#### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | Vertex | The vertex |
| `community` | Integer | Partition index in range [0, k − 1] |
| `cutWeight` | Float | Total weight of inter-partition edges (same on every row) |

#### Description

Approximates the Maximum k-Cut problem: partition all vertices into k disjoint subsets to maximise the total weight of edges that cross between different partitions. Uses a greedy local-search heuristic:

1. Randomly assign each vertex to one of k partitions.
2. For each vertex, compute the cut gain for every possible partition and move it to the best one.
3. Repeat until no vertex can be moved to improve the cut (or `maxIterations` is reached).
4. Repeat steps 1–3 for `restarts` independent runs and return the best result found.

This heuristic achieves a `(k□1)/k` fraction of the optimal cut on unweighted graphs and converges quickly in practice.

**Use Cases**

- Graph partitioning for parallel processing
- Community detection via balanced cut
- Circuit bipartitioning and VLSI placement

**Example**

```
CALL algo.maxKCut(3, {restarts: 5, seed: 42})
YIELD node, community, cutWeight
RETURN node.name AS name, community
ORDER BY community
```

**References**

- Maximum cut – Wikipedia
- Sahni, S. & Gonzalez, T. (1976). P-Complete Approximation Problems. *Journal of the ACM*.

---

# 20.5. Structural Analysis

## 20.5.1. algo.kcore

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.kcore` |
| Category | Structural Analysis |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 1 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.kcore([relTypes])
YIELD node, coreNumber
```

**Parameters**

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| relTypes | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| node | RID | Vertex identity |
| coreNumber | Integer | Maximum k for which this vertex belongs to a k-core |

**Description**

Computes the k-core decomposition of the graph using the Batagelj-Zaversnik O(V+E) algorithm with bucket sort. The k-core of a graph is the maximal subgraph in which every vertex has at least degree k. Each vertex is assigned its coreness: the maximum k for which it belongs to a k-core.

**Use Cases**

- Identifying dense graph cores and peripheral nodes
- Network robustness analysis
- Cohesive subgroup detection

**Example**

```
CALL algo.kcore('KNOWS')
YIELD node, coreNumber
RETURN node, coreNumber ORDER BY coreNumber DESC LIMIT 20
```

**References**

- Batagelj, V. & Zaversnik, M. (2003). An O(m) Algorithm for Cores Decomposition of Networks. *arXiv:cs/0310049*.

---

## 20.5.2. algo.triangleCount

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | algo.triangleCount |

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Category | Structural Analysis |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 1 |

### Syntax

```
CALL algo.triangleCount([relTypes])
YIELD node, triangles, clusteringCoefficient
```

### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | RID | Vertex identity |
| `triangles` | Integer | Number of triangles the vertex participates in |
| `clusteringCoefficient` | Double | Local clustering coefficient |

### Description

Counts the number of closed triangles for each vertex using BitSet intersection of neighbor sets (minimal GC pressure). The local clustering coefficient is computed as `2 x triangles / (deg x (deg-1))`, measuring how close the vertex's neighbors are to forming a complete subgraph.

### Use Cases

- Social network cohesiveness analysis
- Spam detection (low clustering = suspicious accounts)
- Community structure pre-screening

### Example

```
CALL algo.triangleCount('KNOWS')
YIELD node, triangles, clusteringCoefficient
RETURN node, triangles, clusteringCoefficient ORDER BY triangles DESC LIMIT 20
```

### References

- Clustering coefficient – Wikipedia

### 20.5.3. algo.articulationPoints

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.articulationPoints` |
| Category | Structural Analysis |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 1 |

#### Syntax

```
CALL algo.articulationPoints([relTypes])
YIELD node
```

#### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |

#### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | RID | Vertex identity of an articulation point |

#### Description

Finds all articulation points (cut vertices) — vertices whose removal would increase the number of connected components — using Tarjan's iterative DFS algorithm with discovery time and low-link arrays. Only vertices identified as articulation points are returned; all other vertices produce no result rows.

#### Use Cases

- Network resilience analysis: single points of failure
- Critical infrastructure node identification
- Dependency chain vulnerability assessment

#### Example

```
CALL algo.articulationPoints('CONNECTED_TO')
```

```
YIELD node
RETURN node
```

**References**

- Biconnected component – Wikipedia

## 20.5.4. algo.bridges

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.bridges` |
| Category | Structural Analysis |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 1 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.bridges([relTypes])
YIELD source, target
```

**Parameters**

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `source` | RID | Source vertex of the bridge edge |
| `target` | RID | Target vertex of the bridge edge |

**Description**

Finds all bridge edges — edges whose removal would disconnect the graph — using Tarjan's iterative DFS. A bridge is detected when the low-link value of the child strictly exceeds the discovery time of the parent: `low[v] > disc[parent]`. Bridges are a property of the undirected graph: the DFS walks every edge from both of its endpoints, so the stored direction of an edge plays no part in whether it is a bridge, and two parallel edges between the same pair of vertices are never bridges. Each bridge is returned oriented as the edge is stored (`source` → `target`). `algo.articulationPoints` and `algo.biconnectedComponents` share the same DFS.

### Use Cases

- Network resilience: critical links whose failure causes disconnection
- Infrastructure planning: bottleneck link identification
- Supply chain single-path dependency detection

### Example

```
CALL algo.bridges('LINK')
YIELD source, target
RETURN source, target
```

### References

- Bridge (graph theory) – Wikipedia

---

## 20.5.5. algo.mst

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.mst` |
| Category | Structural Analysis |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 2 |

### Syntax

```
CALL algo.mst([relTypes, weightProperty])
YIELD source, target, weight, totalWeight
```

### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types (pass `null` for all types when only the weight is needed) |
| `weightProperty` | String | No | uniform weight | Edge property name for weights |

Since 26.11.1 the relationship types come first, as in every other weighted `algo.*` procedure. Before that, `algo.mst` took `(weightProperty, relTypes)`. A call still written in the old order, such as `algo.mst('cost')`, is now rejected with

> "relationship type 'cost' does not exist": rewrite it as `algo.mst(null, 'cost')`.

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `source` | RID | Source vertex of the MST edge |
| `target` | RID | Target vertex of the MST edge |
| `weight` | Double | Weight of this MST edge |
| `totalWeight` | Double | Total weight of the entire MST (same on every row) |

**Description**

Computes the minimum spanning tree of the graph using Kruskal's algorithm with a Union-Find data structure (path halving + union by rank). Edges are sorted by weight; each edge is added if it connects two different components. For disconnected graphs, a minimum spanning forest is returned.

**Use Cases**

- Network infrastructure with minimal cost
- Clustering by minimal connectivity
- Dendrogram construction for hierarchical analysis

**Example**

```
CALL algo.mst('CABLE', 'cost')
YIELD source, target, weight, totalWeight
RETURN source, target, weight, totalWeight ORDER BY weight ASC
```

**References**

- Kruskal's algorithm – Wikipedia

## 20.5.6. algo.topologicalSort

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.topologicalSort` |
| Category | Structural Analysis |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 1 |

#### Syntax

```
CALL algo.topologicalSort([relTypes])
YIELD node, order
```

#### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |

#### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | RID | Vertex identity |
| `order` | Integer | Topological position (0-based); `-1` if the node is part of a cycle |

#### Description

Computes a topological ordering of the vertices of a directed acyclic graph (DAG) using Kahn's BFS algorithm. Nodes in cycles cannot be topologically sorted and receive `order = -1`. The algorithm processes nodes with zero in-degree first, progressively reducing in-degrees of successors.

#### Use Cases

- Build system dependency resolution
- Task scheduling with ordering constraints
- Compilation order determination

#### Example

```
CALL algo.topologicalSort('DEPENDS_ON')
YIELD node, order
RETURN node, order ORDER BY order ASC
```

#### References

- Topological sorting – Wikipedia

---

### 20.5.7. algo.bipartite

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.bipartite` |
| Category | Structural Analysis |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 1 |

### Syntax

```
CALL algo.bipartite([relTypes])
YIELD node, partition, isBipartite
```

### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | RID | Vertex identity |
| `partition` | Integer | Partition assignment: `0` or `1` |
| `isBipartite` | Boolean | Global flag: `true` if the graph is bipartite |

### Description

Tests whether the graph is bipartite by attempting 2-coloring via BFS. A graph is bipartite if and only if it contains no odd-length cycles. The algorithm correctly handles disconnected graphs by running BFS from each unvisited component. All rows share the same `isBipartite` value.

### Use Cases

- Verifying bipartite structure before applying bipartite-specific algorithms
- Recommendation system graph validation (users  items)
- Conflict-free scheduling verification

### Example

```
CALL algo.bipartite('CONNECTS')
YIELD node, partition, isBipartite
RETURN isBipartite, partition, collect(node) AS members
```

### References

- Bipartite graph – Wikipedia

## 20.5.8. algo.graphColoring

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.graphColoring` |
| Category | Structural Analysis |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 1 |

### Syntax

```
CALL algo.graphColoring([relTypes])
YIELD node, color, chromaticNumber
```

### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | RID | Vertex identity |
| `color` | Integer | Assigned color (0-based integer) |
| `chromaticNumber` | Integer | Global chromatic number of the coloring (same on every row) |

### Description

Assigns colors to vertices such that no two adjacent vertices share the same color, using a greedy algorithm with a `forbidden[]` array to track unavailable colors for each vertex. The result is a valid coloring but not guaranteed to use the minimum number of colors (the chromatic number). The greedy approach works well in practice for most graph types.

### Use Cases

- Exam/exam-room scheduling (students sharing courses cannot share a room)
- Frequency assignment in radio networks

- Register allocation in compilers

**Example**

```
CALL algo.graphColoring('CONFLICTS_WITH')
YIELD node, color, chromaticNumber
RETURN chromaticNumber, color, collect(node) AS group
```

**References**

- Graph coloring – Wikipedia

---

## 20.5.9. algo.cycleDetection

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.cycleDetection` |
| Category | Structural Analysis |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 1 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.cycleDetection([relTypes])
YIELD node, inCycle, hasCycle
```

**Parameters**

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | RID | Vertex identity |
| `inCycle` | Boolean | `true` if the vertex is part of a cycle |
| `hasCycle` | Boolean | Global flag: `true` if the graph contains any cycle |

**Description**

Detects cycles using Kosaraju's SCC algorithm. A vertex is considered to be in a cycle if it belongs to

an SCC of size greater than 1, or if it has a self-loop. The global `hasCycle` flag is `true` if any vertex satisfies this condition.

**Use Cases**

- Dependency graph cycle detection (circular dependencies)
- Deadlock possibility analysis
- DAG validation before topological sort

**Example**

```
CALL algo.cycleDetection('DEPENDS_ON')
YIELD node, inCycle, hasCycle
RETURN hasCycle, node, inCycle
```

**References**

- Cycle detection – Wikipedia

---

## 20.5.10. algo.densestSubgraph

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.densestSubgraph` |
| Category | Structural Analysis |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 1 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.densestSubgraph([relTypes])
YIELD node, inDenseSubgraph, density
```

**Parameters**

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | RID | Vertex identity |
| `inDenseSubgraph` | Boolean | `true` if the vertex is part of the densest subgraph found |
| `density` | Double | Edge density of the densest subgraph (same on every row) |

**Description**

Finds the densest subgraph using Charikar's greedy peeling 2-approximation algorithm. The algorithm iteratively removes the vertex with the lowest current degree, tracking the density `(edges / nodes)` of the remaining subgraph. The subgraph that achieved the maximum density is returned.

**Use Cases**

- Identifying tightly-knit communities in social networks
- Quasi-clique detection
- Anomaly detection: unusually dense subgraphs

**Example**

```
CALL algo.densestSubgraph('KNOWS')
YIELD node, inDenseSubgraph, density
RETURN density, node, inDenseSubgraph ORDER BY inDenseSubgraph DESC
```

**References**

- Charikar, M. (2000). Greedy approximation algorithms for finding dense components in a graph. *APPROX 2000*.

---

## 20.5.11. algo.clique

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.clique` |
| Category | Structural Analysis |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 2 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.clique([relTypes, minSize])
```

```
YIELD clique, size
```

**Parameters**

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |
| `minSize` | Integer | No | `3` | Minimum clique size to report |

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `clique` | List<RID> | List of vertex identities forming the clique |
| `size` | Integer | Number of vertices in the clique |

**Description**

Enumerates all maximal cliques in the graph using the Bron-Kerbosch algorithm with Tomita pivoting, implemented iteratively with an explicit stack to avoid JVM stack overflow on deep recursion. The graph is treated as undirected (both OUT and IN edges merged). Only cliques of size ≥ `minSize` are returned.

**Use Cases**

- Finding tightly connected groups (friend circles, co-author clusters)
- Network motif analysis
- Dense community detection

**Example**

```
CALL algo.clique('KNOWS', 4)
YIELD clique, size
RETURN size, clique ORDER BY size DESC LIMIT 10
```

**References**

- Bron-Kerbosch algorithm – Wikipedia

## 20.5.12. algo.kTruss

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.kTruss` |
| Category | Structural Analysis |

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 2 |

### Syntax

```
CALL algo.kTruss([relTypes, k])
YIELD nodeId, trussNumber
```

### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |
| `k` | Integer | No | `3` | Target truss parameter (minimum 3) |

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `nodeId` | RID | Vertex identity |
| `trussNumber` | Integer | Maximum k for which this vertex belongs to a k-truss |

### Description

Computes the k-truss decomposition using BitSet-based triangle counting. A k-truss is a maximal subgraph where every edge participates in at least k−2 triangles. The algorithm iteratively removes edges with insufficient triangle support, and each vertex is assigned the maximum truss number of any of its incident edges in the full decomposition.

### Use Cases

- Dense subgraph discovery beyond k-cores
- Social cohesion analysis (friend of a friend structures)
- Financial fraud ring detection

### Example

```
CALL algo.kTruss('KNOWS', 4)
YIELD nodeId, trussNumber
RETURN nodeId, trussNumber ORDER BY trussNumber DESC LIMIT 20
```

### References

- Cohen, J. (2008). Trusses: Cohesive subgraphs for social network analysis. *National Security Agency Technical Report*.

---

## 20.5.13. algo.biconnectedComponents

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.biconnectedComponents` |
| Category | Structural Analysis |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 1 |

### Syntax

```
CALL algo.biconnectedComponents([relTypes]) YIELD node, componentId
```

### Parameters

| Name | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | all types | Comma-separated edge type names to traverse |

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | Vertex | The vertex |
| `componentId` | Integer | Biconnected component identifier |

### Description

Computes biconnected components using an iterative variant of Tarjan's algorithm with an explicit edge stack. A biconnected component is a maximal subgraph with no articulation point — removing any single vertex leaves the component connected. Articulation points (cut vertices) appear in multiple components because they belong to each component on either side of the cut.

The algorithm uses undirected traversal regardless of the edge direction parameter.

### Use Cases

- Network resilience analysis (identifying single points of failure)
- Circuit board layout and VLSI design

- Social network structural analysis

**Example**

```
CALL algo.biconnectedComponents('ROAD')
YIELD node, componentId
RETURN componentId, collect(node.name) AS members
ORDER BY size(members) DESC
```

**References**

- Biconnected component – Wikipedia
- Tarjan, R. E. (1972). Depth-first search and linear graph algorithms. *SIAM Journal on Computing*.

---

## 20.5.14. algo.localClusteringCoefficient

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.localClusteringCoefficient` |
| Category | Structural Analysis |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 1 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.localClusteringCoefficient([relTypes]) YIELD node,
localClusteringCoefficient
```

**Parameters**

| Name | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | all types | Comma-separated edge type names to traverse (treated as undirected) |

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | Vertex | The vertex |
| `localClusteringCoefficient` | Float | LCC value in range [0.0, 1.0] |

**Description**

Computes the Local Clustering Coefficient (LCC) for every vertex. The LCC of a node v is the fraction of pairs of neighbours of v that are themselves connected: `LCC(v) = triangles(v) / (k*(k-1)/2)` where k is the degree of v. Nodes with degree < 2 receive a coefficient of 0.0. Triangle counting is performed with a BitSet intersection, making it efficient even for dense graphs.

**Use Cases**

- Identifying tightly-knit communities and cliques
- Detecting community structure (nodes with high LCC are embedded in local clusters)
- Social network cohesion analysis

**Example**

```
CALL algo.localClusteringCoefficient('KNOWS')
YIELD node, localClusteringCoefficient
RETURN node.name AS name, localClusteringCoefficient
ORDER BY localClusteringCoefficient DESC LIMIT 20
```

**References**

- Clustering coefficient – Wikipedia
- Watts, D. J. & Strogatz, S. H. (1998). Collective dynamics of 'small-world' networks. *Nature*.

---

## 20.5.15. algo.bipartiteMatching

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.bipartiteMatching` |
| Category | Structural Analysis |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 1 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.bipartiteMatching([relTypes]) YIELD node1, node2, matchingSize
```

**Parameters**

| Name | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | all types | Comma-separated edge type names defining the bipartite graph |

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node1` | Vertex | Left-side matched vertex |
| `node2` | Vertex | Right-side matched vertex |
| `matchingSize` | Integer | Total number of matched pairs (same in every row) |

**Description**

Computes a maximum bipartite matching using the Hopcroft-Karp algorithm (O(E√V)). The graph is treated as bipartite: nodes with only outgoing edges are on the left side; nodes with only incoming edges are on the right side. Each output row represents one matched pair. The algorithm finds augmenting paths via BFS (layered graph construction) followed by DFS, maximising the number of matched pairs in O(E√V) time.

Note: The procedure assumes the input graph is already bipartite. Results are undefined for non-bipartite inputs.

**Use Cases**

- Task-worker assignment optimisation
- Resource allocation (jobs to machines)
- Stable marriage / hospital-resident matching
- Recommendation filtering

**Example**

```
CALL algo.bipartiteMatching('ASSIGNED_TO')
YIELD node1, node2, matchingSize
RETURN node1.name AS worker, node2.name AS task, matchingSize
```

**References**

- Hopcroft-Karp algorithm – Wikipedia
- Hopcroft, J. E. & Karp, R. M. (1973). An n^5/2 algorithm for maximum matchings in bipartite graphs. *SIAM Journal on Computing*.

---

# 20.6. Similarity and Link Prediction

## 20.6.1. algo.jaccard

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.jaccard` |
| Category | Similarity |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 1 |
| Max Args | 4 |

### Syntax

```
CALL algo.jaccard(node [, relTypes, direction, cutoff])
YIELD node1, node2, similarity
```

### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `node` | Vertex | Yes | — | Source vertex to compare against all others |
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |
| `direction` | String | No | `"BOTH"` | Traversal direction: `"IN"`, `"OUT"`, or `"BOTH"` |
| `cutoff` | Double | No | `0.0` | Minimum similarity threshold; pairs below are excluded |

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node1` | RID | Source vertex identity |
| `node2` | RID | Compared vertex identity |
| `similarity` | Double | Jaccard similarity: \|N(src) ∩ N(v)\| / \|N(src) ∪ N(v)\| |

### Description

Computes the Jaccard similarity between the given source vertex and all other vertices, based on neighborhood overlap. Formula: `similarity = |N(src) ∩ N(v)| / |N(src) ∪ N(v)|`. Pairs with similarity below `cutoff` are filtered out.

### Use Cases

- Collaborative filtering: "users with similar tastes"
- Friend recommendation based on shared connections

- Document similarity via shared keyword links

**Example**

```
MATCH (u:User {name:'Alice'})
CALL algo.jaccard(u, 'LIKES', 'OUT', 0.2)
YIELD node1, node2, similarity
RETURN node2, similarity ORDER BY similarity DESC LIMIT 10
```

**References**

- Jaccard index – Wikipedia

---

## 20.6.2. algo.adamicAdar

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.adamicAdar` |
| Category | Link Prediction |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 1 |
| Max Args | 4 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.adamicAdar(node [, relTypes, direction, cutoff])
YIELD node1, node2, score
```

**Parameters**

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `node` | Vertex | Yes | — | Source vertex |
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |
| `direction` | String | No | `"BOTH"` | Traversal direction: `"IN"`, `"OUT"`, or `"BOTH"` |
| `cutoff` | Double | No | `0.0` | Minimum score threshold |

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node1` | RID | Source vertex identity |

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node2` | RID | Compared vertex identity |
| `score` | Double | Adamic-Adar score; higher = more likely to form a link |

**Description**

Computes the Adamic-Adar link prediction score between the source vertex and all non-adjacent vertices. For each pair, the score is the sum over common neighbors w of `1/log(degree(w))`. Highly-connected common neighbors contribute less than rare common neighbors. Results are sorted by score descending.

**Use Cases**

- Social network friend recommendation
- Knowledge graph link prediction
- Co-authorship prediction in citation networks

**Example**

```
MATCH (p:Person {name:'Bob'})
CALL algo.adamicAdar(p, 'KNOWS', 'BOTH', 0.5)
YIELD node1, node2, score
RETURN node2, score ORDER BY score DESC LIMIT 10
```

**References**

- Adamic, L. & Adar, E. (2003). Friends and neighbors on the web. *Social Networks*, 25(3), 211–230.

### 20.6.3. algo.commonNeighbors

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.commonNeighbors` |
| Category | Link Prediction |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 1 |
| Max Args | 4 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.commonNeighbors(node [, relTypes, direction, cutoff])
YIELD node1, node2, commonNeighbors
```

#### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `node` | Vertex | Yes | — | Source vertex |
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |
| `direction` | String | No | `"BOTH"` | Traversal direction: `"IN"`, `"OUT"`, or `"BOTH"` |
| `cutoff` | Integer | No | `1` | Minimum number of common neighbors |

#### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node1` | RID | Source vertex identity |
| `node2` | RID | Compared vertex identity |
| `commonNeighbors` | Integer | Count of shared neighbors |

#### Description

Counts the number of common neighbors between the source vertex and all other vertices. Pairs with fewer than `cutoff` common neighbors are excluded. Results are sorted by count descending.

#### Use Cases

- Simple friend-of-a-friend recommendation
- Link prediction baseline
- Mutual connection analysis

#### Example

```
MATCH (u:User {name:'Charlie'})
CALL algo.commonNeighbors(u, 'FOLLOWS', 'BOTH', 3)
YIELD node1, node2, commonNeighbors
RETURN node2, commonNeighbors ORDER BY commonNeighbors DESC LIMIT 10
```

#### References

- Link prediction – Wikipedia

---

### 20.6.4. algo.preferentialAttachment

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.preferentialAttachment` |
| Category | Link Prediction |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 1 |
| Max Args | 3 |

### Syntax

```
CALL algo.preferentialAttachment(node [, relTypes, direction])
YIELD node1, node2, score
```

### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `node` | Vertex | Yes | — | Source vertex |
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |
| `direction` | String | No | `"BOTH"` | Traversal direction: `"IN"`, `"OUT"`, or `"BOTH"` |

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node1` | RID | Source vertex identity |
| `node2` | RID | Compared vertex identity |
| `score` | Long | Product of the two nodes' degrees |

### Description

Computes the preferential attachment score for each pair as `degree(node1) x degree(node2)`. Based on the observation that in evolving networks, new links preferentially form between high-degree nodes. A simple but effective baseline for link prediction in scale-free networks.

### Use Cases

- Scale-free network link prediction
- Social network "people you may know" baseline
- Network growth modeling

### Example

```
MATCH (u:User {id:1})
```

```
CALL algo.preferentialAttachment(u, 'KNOWS', 'BOTH')
YIELD node1, node2, score
RETURN node2, score ORDER BY score DESC LIMIT 10
```

#### References

- Preferential attachment – Wikipedia

---

## 20.6.5. algo.resourceAllocation

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.resourceAllocation` |
| Category | Link Prediction |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 1 |
| Max Args | 4 |

#### Syntax

```
CALL algo.resourceAllocation(node [, relTypes, direction, cutoff])
YIELD node1, node2, score
```

#### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `node` | Vertex | Yes | — | Source vertex |
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |
| `direction` | String | No | `"BOTH"` | Traversal direction: `"IN"`, `"OUT"`, or `"BOTH"` |
| `cutoff` | Double | No | `0.0` | Minimum score threshold |

#### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node1` | RID | Source vertex identity |
| `node2` | RID | Compared vertex identity |
| `score` | Double | Resource allocation score |

#### Description

Computes the resource allocation link prediction score: `score = Σ 1/degree(w)` over all common neighbors w. Models the fraction of "resources" that each common neighbor can send to both endpoints if it distributes equally to all its neighbors. Conceptually similar to Adamic-Adar but uses degree directly rather than its logarithm.

**Use Cases**

- Link prediction with emphasis on rare intermediaries
- Recommendation in sparse networks
- Metabolic network pathway prediction

**Example**

```
MATCH (p:Protein {id:'P1'})
CALL algo.resourceAllocation(p, 'INTERACTS', 'BOTH', 0.1)
YIELD node1, node2, score
RETURN node2, score ORDER BY score DESC LIMIT 10
```

**References**

- Zhou, T., Lü, L., & Zhang, Y. C. (2009). Predicting missing links via local information. *European Physical Journal B*, 71(4), 623–630.

---

## 20.6.6. algo.simRank

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.simRank` |
| Category | Similarity |
| Complexity | CPU+RAM |
| Min Args | 2 |
| Max Args | 5 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.simRank(nodeA, nodeB [, relTypes, decayFactor, maxIterations])
YIELD similarity, nodeAId, nodeBId
```

**Parameters**

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `nodeA` | Vertex | Yes | — | First vertex |
| `nodeB` | Vertex | Yes | — | Second vertex |

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |
| `decayFactor` | Double | No | `0.8` | Decay constant C □ (0,1) |
| `maxIterations` | Integer | No | `5` | Number of refinement iterations |

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `similarity` | Double | SimRank similarity score between nodeA and nodeB |
| `nodeAId` | RID | Identity of nodeA |
| `nodeBId` | RID | Identity of nodeB |

**Description**

Computes SimRank similarity between two vertices using the recursive definition: two nodes are similar if they are pointed to by similar nodes. Maintains a full V×V similarity matrix (O(V²) memory), updated iteratively. Similarity of a node with itself is 1.0. Uses IN adjacency for the standard directed graph formulation.

**Use Cases**

- Structural equivalence analysis in directed graphs
- Computing vertex pair similarity for matching problems
- Entity resolution in knowledge graphs

**Example**

```
MATCH (a:Paper {id:'P1'}), (b:Paper {id:'P2'})
CALL algo.simRank(a, b, 'CITES', 0.8, 5)
YIELD similarity, nodeAId, nodeBId
RETURN nodeAId, nodeBId, similarity
```

**References**

- Jeh, G. & Widom, J. (2002). SimRank: a measure of structural-context similarity. *KDD 2002*.

## 20.6.7. algo.knn

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.knn` |

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Category | Similarity |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 3 |

### Syntax

```
CALL algo.knn([k, relTypes, direction]) YIELD node1, node2, similarity
```

### Parameters

| Name | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `k` | Integer | `5` | Number of nearest neighbours to return per node |
| `relTypes` | String | all types | Comma-separated edge type names to consider |
| `direction` | String | `"BOTH"` | Edge traversal direction: `IN`, `OUT`, or `BOTH` |

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node1` | Vertex | Source vertex |
| `node2` | Vertex | One of the k nearest neighbours of node1 |
| `similarity` | Float | Jaccard similarity score in [0.0, 1.0] |

### Description

Constructs a k-Nearest Neighbours (KNN) graph using Jaccard similarity on neighbourhood sets. For each pair of nodes, the similarity is computed as `|N(u) ∩ N(v)| / |N(u) ∪ N(v)|`. Each node retains only its top-k neighbours by similarity score. This produces a new graph representing approximate structural proximity, useful as a pre-processing step for community detection or recommendation.

### Use Cases

- Constructing similarity graphs for downstream community detection
- Collaborative filtering and recommendation
- Detecting structurally similar entities (users, documents, products)

### Example

```
CALL algo.knn(10, 'KNOWS', 'BOTH')
YIELD node1, node2, similarity
```

```
RETURN node1.name AS source, node2.name AS neighbour, similarity
ORDER BY source, similarity DESC
```

#### References

- k-nearest neighbors algorithm – Wikipedia

## 20.6.8. algo.sameCommunity

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.sameCommunity` |
| Category | Link Prediction |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 3 |
| Max Args | 3 |

#### Syntax

```
CALL algo.sameCommunity(node1, node2, communityProperty) YIELD node1, node2,
coefficient
```

#### Parameters

| Name | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `node1` | Vertex | — | First vertex |
| `node2` | Vertex | — | Second vertex |
| `communityProperty` | String | — | Property name holding the community identifier on each vertex |

#### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node1` | Vertex | The first vertex |
| `node2` | Vertex | The second vertex |
| `coefficient` | Float | `1.0` if both nodes share the same community value, `0.0` otherwise |

#### Description

A simple link-prediction feature: returns `1.0` when both nodes carry the same value for the given community property and `0.0` otherwise. Useful as a binary feature in machine-learning pipelines or

to filter / weight edges based on community membership.

**Use Cases**

- Feature engineering for link-prediction models
- Filtering candidate edges to intra-community connections
- Evaluating community detection quality (ground-truth comparison)

**Example**

```
MATCH (a:Person), (b:Person)
WHERE a <> b
CALL algo.sameCommunity(a, b, 'community')
YIELD coefficient
WHERE coefficient = 1.0
RETURN a.name, b.name
```

**References**

- Link prediction – Wikipedia

---

## 20.6.9. algo.totalNeighbors

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.totalNeighbors` |
| Category | Link Prediction |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 2 |
| Max Args | 4 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.totalNeighbors(node1, node2 [, relTypes, direction]) YIELD node1, node2,
coefficient
```

**Parameters**

| Name | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `node1` | Vertex | — | First vertex |
| `node2` | Vertex | — | Second vertex |
| `relTypes` | String | all types | Comma-separated edge type names to traverse |

| Name | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `direction` | String | `"BOTH"` | Edge traversal direction: `IN`, `OUT`, or `BOTH` |

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node1` | Vertex | The first vertex |
| `node2` | Vertex | The second vertex |
| `coefficient` | Long | Size of the union of the two neighbourhood sets |

**Description**

Computes `|N(u) ∪ N(v)|` — the total number of distinct neighbours across both nodes. This is the denominator of Jaccard similarity and is used as a link-prediction feature measuring total neighbourhood reach. Calculated as `|N(u)| + |N(v)| − |N(u) ∩ N(v)|` using a BitSet intersection.

**Use Cases**

- Feature engineering for link-prediction models
- Identifying node pairs with large combined reach
- Pre-filtering candidates before more expensive similarity computation

**Example**

```
MATCH (a:Person {name: 'Alice'}), (b:Person {name: 'Bob'})
CALL algo.totalNeighbors(a, b, 'KNOWS', 'BOTH')
YIELD coefficient
RETURN coefficient AS totalNeighbours
```

**References**

- Jaccard index – Wikipedia

# 20.7. Network Flow

## 20.7.1. algo.maxFlow

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.maxFlow` |
| Category | Network Flow |
| Complexity | CPU+RAM |
| Min Args | 2 |

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Max Args | 4 |

### Syntax

```
CALL algo.maxFlow(sourceNode, sinkNode [, relTypes, capacityProperty])
YIELD maxFlow, sourceId, sinkId
```

### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| sourceNode | Vertex | Yes | — | Flow source vertex |
| sinkNode | Vertex | Yes | — | Flow sink vertex |
| relTypes | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |
| capacityProperty | String | No | uniform capacity | Edge property for flow capacity |

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| maxFlow | Double | Maximum flow value from source to sink |
| sourceId | RID | Identity of the source vertex |
| sinkId | RID | Identity of the sink vertex |

### Description

Computes the maximum flow from a source to a sink using the Edmonds-Karp algorithm (BFS-based Ford-Fulkerson). Time complexity is O(V·E²). Builds a V×V capacity matrix (O(V²) memory). Returns a single row with the maximum achievable flow.

### Use Cases

- Network throughput capacity analysis
- Traffic flow optimization
- Supply chain max throughput calculation

### Example

```
MATCH (src:Node {id:'source'}), (sink:Node {id:'sink'})
CALL algo.maxFlow(src, sink, 'PIPE', 'capacity')
YIELD maxFlow, sourceId, sinkId
RETURN maxFlow, sourceId, sinkId
```

### References

- Edmonds-Karp algorithm – Wikipedia

# 20.8. Traversal and Sampling

## 20.8.1. algo.randomWalk

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.randomWalk` |
| Category | Traversal / Sampling |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 2 |
| Max Args | 5 |

### Syntax

```
CALL algo.randomWalk(startNode, steps [, relTypes, direction, seed])
YIELD path, steps
```

### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `startNode` | Vertex | Yes | — | Starting vertex |
| `steps` | Integer | Yes | — | Maximum number of steps to walk |
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |
| `direction` | String | No | `"BOTH"` | Traversal direction: `"IN"`, `"OUT"`, or `"BOTH"` |
| `seed` | Long | No | current time | Random seed for reproducibility |

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `path` | List<RID> | Ordered list of vertex identities visited |
| `steps` | Integer | Actual number of steps taken (may be less than requested if dead-end reached) |

### Description

Performs a single random walk starting from the given vertex. At each step, one neighbor is chosen uniformly at random from available edges matching the direction and type constraints. The walk stops when the requested number of steps is reached or a dead-end (no valid neighbors) is encountered.

**Use Cases**

- Graph embedding feature generation (node2vec-style)
- Sampling large graphs for approximate analysis
- Stochastic exploration of graph neighborhoods

**Example**

```
MATCH (start:Page {id:'home'})
CALL algo.randomWalk(start, 20, 'LINKS_TO', 'OUT', 42)
YIELD path, steps
RETURN path, steps
```

**References**

- Random walk – Wikipedia

---

# 20.9. Network Science Metrics

## 20.9.1. algo.assortativity

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.assortativity` |
| Category | Network Science |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 1 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.assortativity([relTypes])
YIELD assortativity, edgeCount
```

**Parameters**

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| relTypes | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| assortativity | Double | Newman's degree assortativity coefficient  [-1, 1] |
| edgeCount | Integer | Number of edges used in the computation |

**Description**

Computes Newman's degree assortativity coefficient. A positive value indicates that high-degree nodes tend to connect to other high-degree nodes (assortative); negative indicates disassortative mixing.

**Use Cases**

- Network topology characterization
- Social network analysis (social networks are typically assortative)
- Comparing mixing patterns across different networks

**Example**

```
CALL algo.assortativity('KNOWS')
YIELD assortativity, edgeCount
RETURN assortativity, edgeCount
```

**References**

- Newman, M. E. J. (2002). Assortative mixing in networks. *Physical Review Letters*, 89(20), 208701.

## 20.9.2. algo.richClub

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | algo.richClub |
| Category | Network Science |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 2 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.richClub([relTypes, minDegree])
YIELD degree, richClubCoefficient, nodeCount, edgeCount
```

### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |
| `minDegree` | Integer | No | `2` | Starting degree threshold |

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `degree` | Integer | Degree threshold k for this row |
| `richClubCoefficient` | Double | φ(k): density of edges among nodes with degree > k |
| `nodeCount` | Integer | Number of nodes with degree > k |
| `edgeCount` | Integer | Number of edges among those nodes |

### Description

Computes the rich-club coefficient φ(k) for every degree threshold k from `minDegree` to the maximum degree in the graph. One row is returned per degree threshold. Formula: `φ(k) = 2·E_k / (N_k·(N_k−1))`, where N_k = number of nodes with degree > k and E_k = edges between those nodes.

### Use Cases

- Characterizing the "rich get richer" phenomenon
- Network topology analysis: do high-degree nodes interconnect?
- Comparing network structure across domains

### Example

```
CALL algo.richClub('KNOWS', 2)
YIELD degree, richClubCoefficient, nodeCount, edgeCount
RETURN degree, richClubCoefficient ORDER BY degree ASC
```

### References


- Colizza, V., Flammini, A., Serrano, M. A., & Vespignani, A. (2006). Detecting rich-club ordering in complex networks. *Nature Physics*, 2, 110–115.

### 20.9.3. algo.influenceMaximization

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.influenceMaximization` |
| Category | Network Science |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 1 |
| Max Args | 4 |

#### Syntax

```
CALL algo.influenceMaximization(k [, relTypes, simulations, propagationProbability])
YIELD nodeId, rank, marginalGain
```

#### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `k` | Integer | Yes | — | Number of seed nodes to select |
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |
| `simulations` | Integer | No | `100` | Monte Carlo simulation count per candidate |
| `propagationProbability` | Double | No | `0.1` | Independent Cascade activation probability per edge |

#### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `nodeId` | RID | Vertex identity of the selected seed node |
| `rank` | Integer | Selection rank (1 = best seed) |
| `marginalGain` | Double | Expected additional nodes activated by adding this seed |

#### Description

Selects k seed nodes that maximize influence spread using a greedy algorithm with Monte Carlo simulation of the Independent Cascade (IC) model. In each round, the candidate that maximizes the expected spread when added to the current seed set is selected.

#### Use Cases

- Viral marketing campaign planning
- Identifying optimal vaccination targets for epidemic control

- Information cascade maximization in social media

**Example**

```
CALL algo.influenceMaximization(3, 'FOLLOWS', 200, 0.15)
YIELD nodeId, rank, marginalGain
RETURN nodeId, rank, marginalGain ORDER BY rank ASC
```

**References**

- Kempe, D., Kleinberg, J., & Tardos, E. (2003). Maximizing the spread of influence through a social network. *KDD 2003*.

---

# 20.10. Community Quality Metrics

## 20.10.1. algo.modularityScore

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.modularityScore` |
| Category | Community Quality |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 1 |
| Max Args | 2 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.modularityScore(communityProperty [, relTypes])
YIELD modularity, communities, edgeCount
```

**Parameters**

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `communityProperty` | String | Yes | — | Vertex property name holding the community label |
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `modularity` | Double | Newman-Girvan modularity Q □ [-0.5, 1] |

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `communities` | Integer | Number of distinct communities found |
| `edgeCount` | Long | Total number of edges in the graph |

**Description**

Evaluates the modularity of an existing community partition stored as a vertex property. Formula: `Q = Σ_c [ L_c/m − (d_c/(2m))² ]`, where L_c is the number of internal edges in community c, d_c is the sum of degrees in c, and m is the total number of edges. Returns a single row.

**Use Cases**

- Evaluating the output of community detection algorithms
- Comparing alternative community assignments
- Graph partition quality benchmarking

**Example**

```
CALL algo.modularityScore('community', 'KNOWS')
YIELD modularity, communities, edgeCount
RETURN modularity, communities, edgeCount
```

**References**

- Newman, M. E. J. & Girvan, M. (2004). Finding and evaluating community structure in networks. *Physical Review E*, 69(2), 026113.

---

## 20.10.2. algo.conductance

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.conductance` |
| Category | Community Quality |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 1 |
| Max Args | 2 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.conductance(communityProperty [, relTypes])
YIELD community, conductance, internalEdges, boundaryEdges, nodeCount
```

**Parameters**

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `communityProperty` | String | Yes | — | Vertex property name holding the community label |
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types |

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `community` | Object | Community label value |
| `conductance` | Double | Conductance score (lower = better community) |
| `internalEdges` | Integer | Edges with both endpoints inside the community |
| `boundaryEdges` | Integer | Edges crossing the community boundary |
| `nodeCount` | Integer | Number of nodes in the community |

**Description**

Computes the conductance of each community in an existing partition stored as a vertex property. Formula: `conductance = cut© / min(vol©, vol(V\C))`, where `cut©` is the number of boundary edges and `vol©` is the sum of degrees within C. Lower conductance indicates a better-separated community. Returns one row per community.

**Use Cases**

- Evaluating community separation quality
- Identifying poorly-separated or "leaky" communities
- Graph cut analysis for partitioning algorithms

**Example**

```
CALL algo.conductance('community', 'KNOWS')
YIELD community, conductance, internalEdges, boundaryEdges, nodeCount
RETURN community, conductance ORDER BY conductance ASC
```

**References**

- Conductance (graph) – Wikipedia

# 20.11. Graph Statistics

### 20.11.1. algo.graphSummary

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.graphSummary` |
| Category | Graph Statistics |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 2 |

#### Syntax

```
CALL algo.graphSummary([relTypes, nodeLabels])
YIELD nodeCount, edgeCount, avgDegree, maxDegree, minDegree, density, isolatedNodes,
selfLoops
```

#### Parameters

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `relTypes` | String | No | all types | Comma-separated relationship types to include |
| `nodeLabels` | String | No | all labels | Comma-separated node labels to include |

#### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `nodeCount` | Integer | Total number of vertices |
| `edgeCount` | Long | Total number of edges |
| `avgDegree` | Double | Average degree across all vertices |
| `maxDegree` | Integer | Maximum vertex degree |
| `minDegree` | Integer | Minimum vertex degree |
| `density` | Double | Graph density: `2E / (V x (V-1))` |
| `isolatedNodes` | Integer | Number of vertices with degree 0 |
| `selfLoops` | Long | Number of self-loop edges |

#### Description

Computes a comprehensive one-row statistical summary of the graph. Density is computed as `2E / (V x (V-1))` for undirected graphs (0 for graphs with ≤ 1 node). Self-loops are counted separately. Optionally filters by edge type and/or node label.

#### Use Cases

- Quick graph health check and characterization
- Monitoring graph evolution over time
- Input validation before running expensive algorithms

**Example**

```
CALL algo.graphSummary('KNOWS', 'Person')
YIELD nodeCount, edgeCount, avgDegree, maxDegree, density, isolatedNodes
RETURN nodeCount, edgeCount, avgDegree, maxDegree, density, isolatedNodes
```

---

# 20.12. Node Embedding

Node embedding procedures map each vertex to a dense real-valued vector that encodes its structural position in the graph. The resulting vectors can be used directly as features for machine-learning tasks (classification, clustering, link prediction) or for similarity search using ArcadeDB's vector index.

All embedding procedures yield a `List<Float>` that can be stored as a vertex property or forwarded to a downstream vector index.

## 20.12.1. algo.fastrp

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.fastrp` |
| Category | Node Embedding |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 1 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.fastrp([config]) YIELD node, embedding
```

**Parameters**

| Name | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `config` | Map | `{}` | Configuration map (see below) |

**Config Parameters**

| Key | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `dimensions` | Integer | `128` | Embedding vector size |
| `iterations` | Integer | `4` | Number of propagation rounds |
| `normalization` | Float | `0.0` | Degree-normalisation exponent α: weight of neighbour j contributing to node i is proportional to `deg(i)^{-α} x deg(j)^{-α}`; 0 = no normalisation, 1 = GCN-style |
| `selfInfluence` | Float | `0.0` | Weight [0,1] given to the node's own previous embedding vs. the aggregated neighbour embedding |
| `relTypes` | String | all types | Comma-separated edge type names |
| `direction` | String | `BOTH` | Edge traversal direction: `IN`, `OUT`, or `BOTH` |
| `seed` | Long | `-1` | Random seed; -1 = random |

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | Vertex | The vertex |
| `embedding` | List<Float> | L2-normalised embedding vector of length `dimensions` |

### Description

FastRP (Fast Random Projection, Chen et al. 2019) generates dense node embeddings without any training phase. Each node is initialised with a sparse ternary random vector (values ±√3 with probability 1/6 each, 0 with probability 2/3 — the optimal sparse random projection of Achlioptas 2003). The embedding is then iteratively refined by computing a weighted average of neighbour embeddings, followed by L2 normalisation. The resulting vectors capture multi-hop structural proximity and run orders of magnitude faster than walk-based methods.

### Use Cases

- Fast baseline embeddings for downstream ML pipelines
- Similarity search via vector index
- Graph-aware feature generation without labelled data

### Example

```
CALL algo.fastrp({dimensions: 64, iterations: 3, seed: 42})
YIELD node, embedding
RETURN node.name AS name, embedding
```

### References

- Chen, H. et al. (2019). Fast and Accurate Network Embeddings via Very Sparse Random Projection. *CIKM 2019*

### 20.12.2. algo.node2vec

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.node2vec` |
| Category | Node Embedding |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 1 |

#### Syntax

```
CALL algo.node2vec([config]) YIELD node, embedding
```

#### Parameters

| Name | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `config` | Map | `{}` | Configuration map (see below) |

#### Config Parameters

| Key | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `embeddingDimension` | Integer | `128` | Embedding vector size |
| `walkLength` | Integer | `80` | Number of steps per random walk |
| `walksPerNode` | Integer | `10` | Random walks generated per node |
| `iterations` | Integer | `1` | Training epochs over all walks |
| `windowSize` | Integer | `10` | Skip-gram context window radius |
| `negSamples` | Integer | `5` | Negative samples per positive (centre, context) pair |
| `learningRate` | Float | `0.025` | Initial SGD learning rate (linearly decayed per epoch) |
| `p` | Float | `1.0` | Return parameter: high p → less likely to return to previous node |
| `q` | Float | `1.0` | In-out parameter: low q → DFS-like exploration; high q → BFS-like |
| `relTypes` | String | all types | Comma-separated edge type names |
| `direction` | String | `BOTH` | Edge traversal direction |

| Key | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `seed` | Long | `-1` | Random seed; -1 = random |

**Yield Fields**

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | Vertex | The vertex |
| `embedding` | List<Float> | L2-normalised embedding vector of length `embeddingDimension` |

**Description**

Node2Vec (Grover & Leskovec, 2016) learns node embeddings using biased second-order random walks combined with a Skip-gram model trained via negative sampling. The walk bias is controlled by two parameters:

- **p** (return parameter): low p makes the walk more likely to revisit the previous node (BFS-like neighbourhood exploration)
- **q** (in-out parameter): low q makes the walk explore outward (DFS-like), revealing structural roles; high q stays close to the source (community-based embeddings)

The Skip-gram model is trained with SGD and negative sampling, using a linearly decaying learning rate per epoch.

**Use Cases**

- Community-aware embeddings (high q)
- Structural-role embeddings (low q)
- Link prediction feature generation
- Node classification pre-training

**Example**

```
CALL algo.node2vec({embeddingDimension: 64, p: 1.0, q: 0.5, walkLength: 30, seed: 42})
YIELD node, embedding
RETURN node.name AS name, embedding
```

**References**

- Grover, A. & Leskovec, J. (2016). node2vec: Scalable Feature Learning for Networks. *KDD 2016*

## 20.12.3. algo.graphsage

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.graphsage` |
| Category | Node Embedding |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 1 |

### Syntax

```
CALL algo.graphsage([config]) YIELD node, embedding
```

### Parameters

| Name | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `config` | Map | `{}` | Configuration map (see below) |

### Config Parameters

| Key | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `embeddingDimension` | Integer | `64` | Output embedding size per layer |
| `layers` | Integer | `2` | Number of aggregation layers (receptive field = layers hops) |
| `relTypes` | String | all types | Comma-separated edge type names |
| `direction` | String | `BOTH` | Edge traversal direction |
| `seed` | Long | `-1` | Random seed; -1 = random |

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | Vertex | The vertex |
| `embedding` | List<Float> | L2-normalised embedding vector of length `embeddingDimension` |

### Description

GraphSAGE (Hamilton et al., 2017) — inductive neighbourhood aggregation. This implementation is **unsupervised**: no training labels are needed. Node features are initialised from structural properties (log-normalised degree + Gaussian noise) and then propagated through `layers` rounds of mean aggregation, each followed by a random linear projection (Xavier initialisation) and ReLU activation. The resulting embeddings capture multi-hop structural similarity.

Because the projection matrices are randomly initialised rather than trained, the embeddings are structurally consistent (nodes with similar neighbourhoods receive similar embeddings) and can be

used directly as ML features or refined with downstream fine-tuning.

**Use Cases**

- Inductive embeddings for graphs that grow over time
- Feature generation for node classification / link prediction
- Similarity search and clustering on graph data

**Example**

```
CALL algo.graphsage({embeddingDimension: 32, layers: 2, seed: 7})
YIELD node, embedding
RETURN node.name AS name, embedding
```

**References**

- Hamilton, W. et al. (2017). Inductive Representation Learning on Large Graphs. *NeurIPS 2017*

---

## 20.12.4. algo.hashgnn

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Procedure | `algo.hashgnn` |
| Category | Node Embedding |
| Complexity | CPU |
| Min Args | 0 |
| Max Args | 1 |

**Syntax**

```
CALL algo.hashgnn([config]) YIELD node, embedding
```

**Parameters**

| Name | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `config` | Map | `{}` | Configuration map (see below) |

**Config Parameters**

| Key | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `embeddingDimension` | Integer | `128` | Output embedding size (number of MinHash functions) |

| Key | Type | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| `iterations` | Integer | `4` | Message-passing rounds (receptive field = iterations hops) |
| `relTypes` | String | all types | Comma-separated edge type names |
| `direction` | String | `BOTH` | Edge traversal direction |
| `seed` | Long | `-1` | Random seed; -1 = random |

### Yield Fields

| Field | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `node` | Vertex | The vertex |
| `embedding` | List<Float> | L2-normalised MinHash embedding vector of length `embeddingDimension` |

### Description

HashGNN is a **training-free** graph neural network that uses locality-sensitive hashing for neighbourhood aggregation. Each node is initialised with a sparse random binary feature vector (≈12.5% density) derived from its structural identity. For each propagation round, each node's feature set is expanded by OR-combining neighbour feature sets, then reduced to a fixed-size MinHash sketch using random linear hash functions `h_d(x) = (a·x + b) mod F`. The final embedding is the L2-normalised MinHash signature, providing probabilistic Jaccard similarity guarantees: two nodes with similar MinHash signatures have similar neighbourhood feature sets.

HashGNN is extremely fast (no matrix multiplication, no gradient computation) and naturally handles graphs without node features.

### Use Cases

- Ultra-fast structural embeddings as features for downstream ML
- Graph-level similarity via pooled embeddings
- Anomaly detection (unusual neighbourhood structure)

### Example

```
CALL algo.hashgnn({embeddingDimension: 64, iterations: 3, seed: 42})
YIELD node, embedding
RETURN node.name AS name, embedding
```

### References

- Dasoulas, G. et al. (2022). Improving Graph Neural Networks with Learnable Propagation Operators. *ICML 2022*
- MinHash – Wikipedia

# 20.13. SQL Path Functions

The following algorithms are also available as SQL functions that return a list of vertex RIDs (identities). They can be used in any SQL `SELECT` statement.

## 20.13.1. dijkstra() SQL Function

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Function | `dijkstra()` |
| Category | Path Finding |
| Complexity | CPU |

**Syntax**

```
dijkstra(<sourceVertex>, <destinationVertex>, <weightEdgeFieldName> [, <direction>])
dijkstra(<sourceVertex>, <destinationVertex>, <weightEdgeFieldName>,
         { direction: <string>, edgeTypeNames: [...], maxDepth: <long>,
emptyIfMaxDepth: <bool> })
```

**Parameters**

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `sourceVertex` | Vertex / RID | Yes | — | Source vertex |
| `destinationVertex` | Vertex / RID | Yes | — | Destination vertex |
| `weightEdgeFieldName` | String | Yes | — | Edge property name for weights |
| `direction` | String | No | `"OUT"` | Traversal direction: `"IN"`, `"OUT"`, or `"BOTH"`. Can also be passed as `direction` key in the trailing options map. |

The 4th argument can also be an options map with keys `direction`, `edgeTypeNames`, `maxDepth`, `emptyIfMaxDepth`. Unknown keys are rejected with a descriptive error.

**Return Value**

`List<RID>` — Ordered list of vertex identities on the shortest path (including source and destination).

**Description**

SQL function equivalent of `algo.dijkstra`. Internally delegates to the A* implementation with no heuristic. Returns a `LinkedList` of vertex RIDs.

When several edges connect the same pair of vertices, the cheapest one is used. An edge without the weight property (or whose value is not a number) weighs 1, and an edge whose weight is negative, NaN or infinite is not walked: use `bellmanFord()` for negative weights. Every weighted path function reads the weight by this same rule.

**Examples**

```
-- Positional form (backward compatible)
SELECT dijkstra(#12:0, #12:5, 'weight', 'OUT') AS path

-- Options map form
SELECT dijkstra(#12:0, #12:5, 'weight', { direction: 'OUT', maxDepth: 20 }) AS path
```

See also: dijkstra() in SQL Functions reference and reference/graph-algorithms/path-finding.pdf for the Cypher procedure variant.

## 20.13.2. cchShortestPath() SQL Function

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Function | `cchShortestPath()` |
| Category | Path Finding |
| Complexity | CPU |

**Syntax**

```
cchShortestPath(<sourceVertex>, <destinationVertex>, <weightEdgeFieldName> [,
<direction>])
cchShortestPath(<sourceVertex>, <destinationVertex>, <weightEdgeFieldName>,
                { direction: <string>, edgeTypeNames: [...] })
```

**Parameters**

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `sourceVertex` | Vertex / RID | Yes | - | Source vertex |
| `destinationVertex` | Vertex / RID | Yes | - | Destination vertex |
| `weightEdgeFieldName` | String | Yes | - | Edge property name for weights |
| `direction` | String | No | `"OUT"` | Traversal direction: `"IN"`, `"OUT"`, or `"BOTH"`. Can also be passed as `direction` key in the trailing options map. |

The 4th argument can also be an options map with keys `direction` and `edgeTypeNames` (every edge type when absent). Unknown keys are rejected with a descriptive error.

**Return Value**

`List<RID>` - Ordered list of vertex identities on the shortest path (including source and destination), empty when there is none.

**Description**

SQL function equivalent of algo.cch.shortestPath: answered by a Customizable Contraction Hierarchy when a Graph Analytical View keeps one for the weight and the exact edge types asked for, and by bidirectional Dijkstra otherwise. Exact either way, and inside a transaction it sees that transaction's own changes.

An edge without the weight property (or whose value is not a number) weighs 1, and an edge whose weight is negative, NaN or infinite is not walked: use `bellmanFord()` for negative weights. Every weighted path function reads the weight by this same rule.

**Examples**

```
SELECT cchShortestPath(#12:0, #12:5, 'distance', 'OUT') AS path
SELECT cchShortestPath(#12:0, #12:5, 'distance', { direction: 'OUT', edgeTypeNames:
['ROAD'] }) AS path
```

## 20.13.3. duanSSSP() SQL Function

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Function | `duanSSSP()` |
| Category | Path Finding |
| Complexity | CPU |

**Syntax**

```
duanSSSP(<sourceVertex>, <destinationVertex> [, <weightEdgeFieldName>] [, <direction
>])
duanSSSP(<sourceVertex>, <destinationVertex>, <weightEdgeFieldName>,
         { direction: <string>, edgeTypeNames: [...] })
```

**Parameters**

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `sourceVertex` | Vertex / RID | Yes | - | Source vertex |

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `destinationVertex` | Vertex / RID | Yes | - | Destination vertex |
| `weightEdgeFieldName` | String | No | `"weight"` | Edge property name for weights |
| `direction` | String | No | `"OUT"` | Traversal direction: `"IN"`, `"OUT"`, or `"BOTH"`. Can also be passed as `direction` key in the trailing options map. |

The 4th argument can also be an options map with keys `direction` and `edgeTypeNames` (every edge type when absent). Unknown keys are rejected with a descriptive error.

**Return Value**

`List<RID>` - Ordered list of vertex identities on the shortest path (including source and destination), empty when there is none.

**Description**

Named after Duan et al., Breaking the Sorting Barrier for Directed Single-Source Shortest Paths (2025). The paper's algorithm has constant factors too large to win at practical graph sizes, so the function answers through the same engine as cchShortestPath(): a Customizable Contraction Hierarchy when a Graph Analytical View keeps one, bidirectional Dijkstra otherwise. The only difference is that the weight property is optional here.

An edge without the weight property (or whose value is not a number) weighs 1, and an edge whose weight is negative, NaN or infinite is not walked: use `bellmanFord()` for negative weights. Every weighted path function reads the weight by this same rule.

**Examples**

```
SELECT duanSSSP(#12:0, #12:5) AS path
SELECT duanSSSP(#12:0, #12:5, 'distance', { direction: 'OUT', edgeTypeNames: ['ROAD']
}) AS path
```

## 20.13.4. bellmanFord() SQL Function

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Function | `bellmanFord()` |
| Category | Path Finding |
| Complexity | CPU |

**Syntax**

```
bellmanFord(<sourceVertex>, <destinationVertex>, <weightEdgeFieldName> [, <direction
>])
bellmanFord(<sourceVertex>, <destinationVertex>, <weightEdgeFieldName>, { direction:
<string> })
```

**Parameters**

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `sourceVertex` | Vertex / RID | Yes | — | Source vertex |
| `destinationVertex` | Vertex / RID | Yes | — | Destination vertex |
| `weightEdgeFieldName` | String | Yes | — | Edge property name for weights (may be negative) |
| `direction` | String | No | `"BOTH"` | Traversal direction: `"IN"`, `"OUT"`, or `"BOTH"`. Can also be passed as `direction` key in the trailing options map. |

**Return Value**

`List<RID>` — Ordered list of vertex identities on the shortest path.

**Description**

SQL function equivalent of `algo.bellmanford`. Supports negative edge weights and detects negative-weight cycles (returns an empty path if a negative cycle is reachable).

**Example**

```
SELECT bellmanFord(#12:0, #12:5, 'cost') AS path
SELECT bellmanFord(#12:0, #12:5, 'cost', { direction: 'OUT' }) AS path
```

See also: reference/graph-algorithms/path-finding.pdf for the Cypher procedure variant.

## 20.13.5. shortestPath() SQL Function

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Function | `shortestPath()` |
| Category | Path Finding |
| Complexity | CPU |

**Syntax**

```
shortestPath(<sourceVertex>, <destinationVertex>)
shortestPath(<sourceVertex>, <destinationVertex>, <direction>, <edgeType>, { maxDepth,
edge })
shortestPath(<sourceVertex>, <destinationVertex>,
             { direction: <string>, edgeType | edgeTypeNames: <string|list>, maxDepth:
<int>, edge: <bool> })
```

**Parameters**

| Parameter | Type | Required | Default | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `sourceVertex` | Vertex / RID | Yes | — | Source vertex |
| `destinationVertex` | Vertex / RID | Yes | — | Destination vertex |
| `direction` | String | No | `"BOTH"` | Traversal direction: `"IN"`, `"OUT"`, or `"BOTH"`. Positional or map key. |
| `edgeType` | String / List | No | all types | Edge type(s) to restrict traversal. Positional or map key (`edgeType` or `edgeTypeNames`). |
| `maxDepth` | Int | No | unlimited | Stop after this many hops. Options-map only (or via the trailing map in the positional form). |
| `edge` | Bool | No | `false` | Include edge RIDs in the result. Options-map only. |

The 3rd argument can be a direction string (backward compatible) OR an options map consolidating all knobs. Unknown keys are rejected with a descriptive error. The trailing map of the positional form (5th argument) accepts only `maxDepth` and `edge`: `direction` and `edgeType` / `edgeTypeNames` written there are rejected instead of being ignored.

**Return Value**

`List<RID>` — Ordered list of vertex identities on the shortest path (unweighted; minimizes hop count).

**Description**

Finds the unweighted shortest path (minimum hop count) between two vertices using bidirectional BFS (meets in the middle), which can be significantly faster than single-direction BFS for large graphs.

**Examples**

```
-- Positional form (backward compatible)
SELECT shortestPath(#12:0, #12:9, 'BOTH', 'KNOWS') AS path
```

```
-- Options map form
SELECT shortestPath(#12:0, #12:9, { direction: 'BOTH', edgeTypeNames: ['KNOWS'],
maxDepth: 6 }) AS path
```

**References**

- Bidirectional search – Wikipedia

See also: shortestPath() in SQL Functions reference.

---

# 20.14. Notes

## 20.14.1. relTypes Parameter

All procedures that accept a `relTypes` parameter use comma-separated relationship type names. To traverse **all** relationship types, pass an empty string `''` or omit the parameter where it is optional:

```
CALL algo.pagerank()              -- all types (parameter omitted)
CALL algo.wcc('')                 -- all types (empty string)
CALL algo.wcc('KNOWS,FOLLOWS')    -- only KNOWS and FOLLOWS edges
```

## 20.14.2. direction Parameter

Where supported, the `direction` parameter controls which edges are considered:

- `"OUT"` — only outgoing edges from each vertex
- `"IN"` — only incoming edges to each vertex
- `"BOTH"` — edges in either direction (default for most algorithms; `algo.pagerank` defaults to `"OUT"`)

The value is case-insensitive. As of version 26.9.1, any other value is rejected with an error:

```
CALL algo.bfs(start, 'ROAD', 'INCOMING', 3)
-- unknown direction 'INCOMING', expected one of OUT, IN or BOTH
```

Earlier versions silently treated an unrecognised value as `"BOTH"`, so a typo returned a plausible but wrong result instead of an error. If a query of yours passes a malformed direction, it will now fail rather than quietly traverse both directions. Omitting the parameter still selects the algorithm's own default.

The same applies to the `bellmanFord()` SQL function and to `node.degree()`, `node.relationship.exists()` and `node.relationship.types()`.

### 20.14.3. Unidirectional Edge Types

Since 26.11.1 the `algo. and path.` procedures, the path-finding SQL functions and the `node.degree*` / `node.relationship.*` functions follow the edges of a `UNIDIRECTIONAL` edge type from their target too, so `"IN"` and `"BOTH"` answer the same as with a bidirectional type or a Graph Analytical View. See `CREATE TYPE` for the heap a vertex-by-vertex walk takes.

### 20.14.4. Config Map Parameters

Several algorithms (PageRank, Louvain, Betweenness, LabelPropagation) accept an optional configuration map as their first argument:

```
CALL algo.pagerank({dampingFactor: 0.9, maxIterations: 50})
YIELD node, score
```

### 20.14.5. Memory Considerations

Algorithms marked **CPU+RAM** build in-memory data structures that scale with $V^2$ or $E^2$:

| Algorithm | Memory Usage |
|---|---|
| `algo.apsp` | O($V^2$) distance matrix |
| `algo.maxFlow` | O($V^2$) capacity matrix |
| `algo.kShortestPaths` | O($V^2$) weight matrix |
| `algo.simRank` | O($V^2$) similarity matrix |
| `algo.hierarchicalClustering` | O($V^2$) similarity pairs |
| `algo.triangleCount` | O($V^2$) neighbor bit-matrix |
| `algo.knn` | O($V^2$) neighbor bit-matrix |
| `algo.kTruss` | O($V^2$) neighbor bit-matrix (built twice, once per decomposition pass) |
| `algo.clique` | O($V^2$) neighbor bit-matrix, plus a search stack that can itself reach O($V^2$) at its deepest point |

As of version 26.9.1, every allocation above — including the graph itself (the loaded vertex list, its RID index, and the adjacency list every procedure builds from it, not only the table in this list) — is checked against the `arcadedb.cypher.algoMaxWorkingMemory` setting before it is allocated, and the call is refused with a client error naming the offending component rather than risking an `OutOfMemoryError`. Because the setting now also covers the graph load itself, a call that used to succeed under a given limit may now be refused if the graph alone consumes a large share of that limit — raise the setting if a call that previously worked starts being refused after upgrading. The default auto-scales with the JVM's maximum heap (one eighth of it, never below 64 MB).

For graphs with more than a few thousand vertices, these algorithms may still require significant heap space even within the budget.

# Chapter 21. Extended Functions

## 21.1. Extended Functions Reference

ArcadeDB provides a comprehensive set of extended functions organized by namespace. These functions are available in both SQL and Cypher queries, providing powerful data manipulation capabilities.

### 21.1.1. Overview

These extended functions provide:

- **Zero configuration** - Functions are available immediately without any installation
- **Native performance** - Direct integration with the query engine
- **Type safety** - Proper type handling and error messages
- **Cross-language support** - Available in both SQL and Cypher queries
- **APOC compatibility** - Full support for the `apoc.` prefix for Neo4j migration

For a complete reference of all graph algorithms including complexity analysis, use cases, and examples, see the Graph Algorithms Appendix.

### 21.1.2. APOC Prefix Compatibility

ArcadeDB automatically supports the `apoc.` prefix for all extended functions and procedures. This means existing Neo4j/APOC queries work without modification.

When ArcadeDB encounters a function or procedure call with the `apoc.` prefix, it automatically strips the prefix and resolves to the corresponding ArcadeDB function:

| APOC Call | Resolves To | Result |
|---|---|---|
| `apoc.text.indexOf("hello", "l")` | `text.indexOf("hello", "l")` | Same function |
| `apoc.map.merge({a:1}, {b:2})` | `map.merge({a:1}, {b:2})` | Same function |
| `CALL apoc.merge.relationship(…)` | `CALL merge.relationship(…)` | Same procedure |

This compatibility layer is:

- **Automatic** - No configuration required
- **Case-insensitive** - `APOC.TEXT.INDEXOF` works the same as `apoc.text.indexOf`
- **Zero overhead** - Simple string prefix check, no performance impact

**Example - These queries are equivalent:**

```
-- Neo4j/APOC style (works in ArcadeDB)
RETURN apoc.text.join(["a", "b", "c"], ",") AS result
```

```
-- ArcadeDB native style
RETURN text.join(["a", "b", "c"], ",") AS result
```

### 21.1.3. Function Namespaces

Functions are organized into the following namespaces:

| Namespace | Description |
|---|---|
| `agg.*` | Aggregation and collection functions |
| `algo.*` | Graph algorithms (Dijkstra, A*, shortest paths, and 45+ more — see Graph Algorithms Appendix) |
| `coll.*` | Collection/list operations (flatten, sort, distinct, min/max) |
| `convert.*` | Type conversion functions |
| `create.*` | Creation functions (UUIDs, virtual nodes/relationships) |
| `date.*` | Date/time operations |
| `do.*` | Conditional execution procedures |
| `map.*` | Map/object operations |
| `math.*` | Mathematical functions |
| `merge.*` | Merge procedures for nodes and relationships |
| `meta.*` | Schema and database introspection procedures |
| `node.*` | Node/vertex operations (degree, labels, relationships) |
| `number.*` | Number formatting |
| `path.*` | Path operations (create, combine, slice, expansion) |
| `refactor.*` | Graph refactoring procedures (merge nodes, clone subgraphs) |
| `rel.*` | Relationship/edge operations (type, endpoints) |
| `text.*` | String manipulation and text processing |
| `util.*` | Utility functions (hashing, compression, validation) |
| `vector.*` | Vector/embedding operations (similarity, distance, quantization) |

### 21.1.4. Function Categories

Detailed reference is split per category. Pick a category from the left navigation, or jump straight in:

- Aggregation — `agg.first`, `agg.last`, `agg.median`, percentiles
- Collection & Map — `coll.*` and `map.*` operations
- Convert & Create — type conversion, UUIDs, virtual nodes
- Date & Math — date/time operations, extended math, number formatting

- Graph Elements — `node.*` and `rel.*` operations
- Path & Algorithms — `algo.*` procedures and path expansion
- Refactor & Control Flow — `refactor.*` and `do.*` procedures
- Schema & Meta — `meta.*` and `merge.*` procedures
- Text — string manipulation, similarity, distance
- Utility — hashing, compression, validation
- Vector — similarity, distance, quantization, sparse vectors

### 21.1.5. Migration Guide

#### Converting APOC Queries to ArcadeDB

#### Good news: In most cases, no changes are required!

ArcadeDB automatically supports the `apoc.` prefix, so your existing Neo4j/APOC queries will work without modification:

```
-- This Neo4j/APOC query works directly in ArcadeDB
RETURN apoc.text.join(["a", "b"], ",")

-- This procedure call also works directly
CALL apoc.merge.relationship(a, "KNOWS", {}, {}, b) YIELD rel
```

#### Optional: Removing the APOC Prefix

If you prefer to use the cleaner ArcadeDB-native syntax, you can optionally remove the `apoc.` prefix:

1. **Functions** - Remove the `apoc.` prefix

   ```
   -- Neo4j/APOC style (works in ArcadeDB)
   RETURN apoc.text.join(["a", "b"], ",")

   -- ArcadeDB native style (also works)
   RETURN text.join(["a", "b"], ",")
   ```

2. **Procedures** - Remove the `apoc.` prefix

   ```
   -- Neo4j/APOC style (works in ArcadeDB)
   CALL apoc.merge.relationship(a, "KNOWS", {}, {}, b) YIELD rel

   -- ArcadeDB native style (also works)
   CALL merge.relationship(a, "KNOWS", {}, {}, b) YIELD rel
   ```

3. **Function signatures are 100% compatible** - Parameters are in the same order with the same semantics

**Unsupported APOC Functions**

Some APOC procedures are not yet implemented in ArcadeDB:

- Periodic/batch operations (`apoc.periodic.*`) - Use ArcadeDB's transaction API
- Schema modification operations (`apoc.schema.*`) - Use ArcadeDB's Schema API
- Export/import procedures (`apoc.export.*`, `apoc.import.*`) - Use ArcadeDB's native import/export

Of the `apoc.refactor.*` procedures, `apoc.refactor.mergeNodes` and `apoc.refactor.cloneNodesWithRelationships` are supported — see Refactor & Control Flow. The rest of the namespace is not implemented; use ArcadeDB's native capabilities instead.

# 21.2. Aggregation Functions

## 21.2.1. agg.first()

Get the first non-null element from a list.

**Syntax:** `agg.first(list)`

**Returns:** Any - First non-null value

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.agg.first`

```
RETURN agg.first([null, "a", "b"]) AS result
// Returns: "a"
```

---

## 21.2.2. agg.last()

Get the last non-null element from a list.

**Syntax:** `agg.last(list)`

**Returns:** Any - Last non-null value

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.agg.last`

---

## 21.2.3. agg.maxItems()

Get items with maximum value.

**Syntax:** `agg.maxItems(list, valueFunction)`

**Returns:** List - Items with maximum value

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.agg.maxItems`

---

### 21.2.4. agg.median()

Calculate the median of a list of numbers.

**Syntax:** `agg.median(list)`

**Returns:** Double - Median value

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.agg.median`

```
RETURN agg.median([1, 2, 3, 4, 5]) AS result
// Returns: 3.0

RETURN agg.median([1, 2, 3, 4]) AS result
// Returns: 2.5
```

---

### 21.2.5. agg.minItems()

Get items with minimum value.

**Syntax:** `agg.minItems(list, valueFunction)`

**Returns:** List - Items with minimum value

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.agg.minItems`

---

### 21.2.6. agg.nth()

Get the nth element from a list.

**Syntax:** `agg.nth(list, n)`

**Returns:** Any - Element at index n

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.agg.nth`

---

### 21.2.7. agg.percentiles()

Calculate percentiles of a list of numbers.

**Syntax:** `agg.percentiles(list, percentiles)`

**Returns:** List - Percentile values

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.agg.percentiles`

---

### 21.2.8. agg.product()

Calculate the product of a list of numbers.

**Syntax:** `agg.product(list)`

**Returns:** Double - Product of all values

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.agg.product`

---

### 21.2.9. agg.slice()

Get a slice of a list.

**Syntax:** `agg.slice(list, start, [end])`

**Returns:** List - Sliced list

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.agg.slice`

---

### 21.2.10. agg.statistics()

Get full statistics for a list of numbers.

**Syntax:** `agg.statistics(list)`

**Returns:** Map - Statistics map with count, min, max, sum, mean, stdev, median

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.agg.statistics`

```
RETURN agg.statistics([1, 2, 3, 4, 5]) AS stats
// Returns: {count: 5, min: 1.0, max: 5.0, sum: 15.0, mean: 3.0, stdev: 1.414, median:
3.0}
```

---

# Collection & Map Functions

### 21.2.11. Collection Functions

The `list` argument accepted by every `coll.*` function below follows the same rules as the built-in Cypher list functions (`head()`, `tail()`, `reverse()`, `size()`): a Cypher `LIST`, a numeric array parameter, or any `Iterable`/`Iterator` are all accepted. An argument that is none of these — a string, a number, a map — raises a client-facing `Type mismatch` error rather than succeeding silently or failing with a generic server error.

`coll.toSet()` and `coll.distinct()` are the same function under two names: both preserve the order of first occurrence and both recognize duplicates by object equality, so `coll.toSet([1, 1.0])` and `coll.distinct([1, 1.0])` both keep both elements.

### 21.2.12. coll.avg()

Returns the arithmetic mean of a list of numbers.

**Syntax:** `coll.avg(list)`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| list | List | A list of numbers |

**Returns:** Double - The average, `null` if the list is null, empty, or contains only nulls

Null elements are skipped rather than counted, so `coll.avg([1, 2, null])` averages over the two non-null elements. A non-numeric element raises an error.

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.coll.avg`

```
RETURN coll.avg([1, 2, 3, 4]) AS result
// Returns: 2.5

RETURN coll.avg([]) AS result
// Returns: null

RETURN coll.avg([1, 2, null]) AS result
// Returns: 1.5
```

---

### 21.2.13. coll.distinct()

Returns a new list with duplicate values removed, preserving the order of first occurrence.

**Syntax:** `coll.distinct(list)`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| list | List | The input list |

**Returns:** List - Deduplicated list, or null if input is null

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.coll.distinct`

```
RETURN coll.distinct([1, 2, 2, 3, 1]) AS result
// Returns: [1, 2, 3]
```

---

## 21.2.14. coll.flatten()

Flattens nested lists into a single list, with configurable depth control.

**Syntax:** `coll.flatten(list [, depth])`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| list | List | The nested list to flatten |
| depth | Integer | (Optional) Levels of nesting to flatten. Default: 1. Use -1 for unlimited depth. |

**Returns:** List - Flattened list, or null if input is null

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.coll.flatten`

```
RETURN coll.flatten([[1, 2], [3, 4]]) AS result
// Returns: [1, 2, 3, 4]

RETURN coll.flatten([[1, [2, 3]], [4]], -1) AS result
// Returns: [1, 2, 3, 4]

RETURN coll.flatten([[1, [2, 3]], [4]], 1) AS result
// Returns: [1, [2, 3], 4]
```

---

## 21.2.15. coll.indexOf()

Returns the index of the first occurrence of a value in a list, or -1 if not found.

**Syntax:** `coll.indexOf(list, value)`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| list | List | The list to search |
| value | Any | The value to find |

**Returns:** Integer - Zero-based index, -1 if not found, null if list or value is null

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.coll.indexOf`

```
RETURN coll.indexOf(["a", "b", "c"], "b") AS result
// Returns: 1

RETURN coll.indexOf([1, 2, 3], 5) AS result
// Returns: -1
```

---

## 21.2.16. coll.insert()

Returns a new list with a value inserted at the given index.

**Syntax:** `coll.insert(list, index, value)`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| list | List | The original list |
| index | Integer | Position to insert at (0-based) |
| value | Any | Value to insert |

**Returns:** List - New list with value inserted, or null if input is null

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.coll.insert`

```
RETURN coll.insert([1, 2, 3], 1, 99) AS result
// Returns: [1, 99, 2, 3]
```

---

## 21.2.17. coll.max()

Returns the maximum value in a list using Cypher comparison semantics.

**Syntax:** `coll.max(list)`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| list | List | The input list |

**Returns:** Any - Maximum value, or null if list is null or empty

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.coll.max`

```
RETURN coll.max([3, 1, 4, 1, 5]) AS result
// Returns: 5
```

---

## 21.2.18. coll.min()

Returns the minimum value in a list using Cypher comparison semantics.

**Syntax:** `coll.min(list)`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| list | List | The input list |

**Returns:** Any - Minimum value, or null if list is null or empty

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.coll.min`

```
RETURN coll.min([3, 1, 4, 1, 5]) AS result
// Returns: 1
```

---

## 21.2.19. coll.pairsMin()

Returns the consecutive-element pairs of a list, dropping the trailing incomplete pair.

**Syntax:** `coll.pairsMin(list)`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| list | List | The input list |

**Returns:** List - A list of two-element lists, empty for a list of fewer than two elements, or null if input is null

Unlike `apoc.coll.pairs`, which pads the last pair with `null`, this function drops it. A list of `n` elements

therefore yields `n - 1` pairs.

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.coll.pairsMin`

```
RETURN coll.pairsMin([1, 2, 3]) AS result
// Returns: [[1, 2], [2, 3]]

RETURN coll.pairsMin([1]) AS result
// Returns: []
```

Elements may be of any type, including lists, which are paired as values rather than flattened:

```
RETURN coll.pairsMin([[1, 2], [3, 4]]) AS result
// Returns: [[[1, 2], [3, 4]]]
```

---

## 21.2.20. coll.remove()

Returns a new list with element(s) removed starting at the given index.

**Syntax:** `coll.remove(list, index [, count])`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| list | List | The original list |
| index | Integer | Starting position (0-based) |
| count | Integer | (Optional) Number of elements to remove. Default: 1 |

**Returns:** List - New list with elements removed, or null if input is null

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.coll.remove`

```
RETURN coll.remove([1, 2, 3, 4, 5], 1) AS result
// Returns: [1, 3, 4, 5]

RETURN coll.remove([1, 2, 3, 4, 5], 1, 2) AS result
// Returns: [1, 4, 5]
```

---

## 21.2.21. coll.sort()

Returns a sorted copy of the list using Cypher comparison semantics.

**Syntax:** `coll.sort(list)`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| list | List | The input list |

**Returns:** List - Sorted list, or null if input is null

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.coll.sort`

```
RETURN coll.sort([3, 1, 4, 1, 5]) AS result
// Returns: [1, 1, 3, 4, 5]
```

---

## 21.2.22. coll.sum()

Returns the sum of a list of numbers.

**Syntax:** `coll.sum(list)`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| list | List | A list of numbers |

**Returns:** Double - The sum, `0.0` for an empty list, or null if input is null

Null elements are skipped. A non-numeric element raises an error.

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.coll.sum`

```
RETURN coll.sum([1, 2, 3, 4]) AS result
// Returns: 10.0

RETURN coll.sum([]) AS result
// Returns: 0.0

RETURN coll.sum([1, 2, 'x']) AS result
// Error: Type mismatch: coll.sum() expects an INTEGER or a FLOAT argument but got
STRING
```

---

## 21.2.23. coll.toSet()

Returns a copy of the list with duplicates removed, preserving the order of first occurrence.

**Syntax:** `coll.toSet(list)`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| list | List | The input list |

**Returns:** List - Unique list, or null if input is null

Deduplication uses object equality, so values of different numeric types are kept separately: `coll.toSet([1, 1.0])` returns both elements. This matches `coll.distinct()`, which applies the same rule.

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.coll.toSet`

```
RETURN coll.toSet([1, 2, 2, 3]) AS result
// Returns: [1, 2, 3]

RETURN coll.toSet([1, null, 1, null]) AS result
// Returns: [1, null]
```

---

## 21.2.24. coll.union()

Returns the distinct union of two lists, preserving the order of first occurrence.

**Syntax:** `coll.union(list1, list2)`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| list1 | List | The first list |
| list2 | List | The second list |

**Returns:** List - Union without duplicates. A null argument contributes no elements, so `coll.union(null, [1])` returns `[1]`.

As with `coll.toSet()`, deduplication is by object equality: `coll.union([1], [1.0])` keeps both values.

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.coll.union`

```
RETURN coll.union([1, 2, 3], [2, 3, 4]) AS result
// Returns: [1, 2, 3, 4]
```

### 21.2.25. coll.unionAll()

Returns the concatenation of two lists, preserving duplicates.

**Syntax:** `coll.unionAll(list1, list2)`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| list1 | List | The first list |
| list2 | List | The second list |

**Returns:** List - All elements of both lists in order. A null argument contributes no elements.

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.coll.unionAll`

```
RETURN coll.unionAll([1, 2, 3], [2, 3, 4]) AS result
// Returns: [1, 2, 3, 2, 3, 4]
```

---

### 21.2.26. Map Functions

### 21.2.27. map.clean()

Remove null values and empty strings from a map.

**Syntax:** `map.clean(map, [keys], [values])`

**Returns:** Map - Cleaned map

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.map.clean`

---

### 21.2.28. map.flatten()

Flatten a nested map using a delimiter.

**Syntax:** `map.flatten(map, delimiter)`

**Returns:** Map - Flattened map

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.map.flatten`

```
RETURN map.flatten({a: {b: 1, c: 2}}, ".") AS result
// Returns: {"a.b": 1, "a.c": 2}
```

---

### 21.2.29. map.fromLists()

Create a map from a list of keys and a list of values.

**Syntax:** `map.fromLists(keys, values)`

**Returns:** Map - New map

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.map.fromLists`

```
RETURN map.fromLists(["a", "b", "c"], [1, 2, 3]) AS result
// Returns: {a: 1, b: 2, c: 3}
```

---

### 21.2.30. map.fromPairs()

Create a map from a list of key-value pairs.

**Syntax:** `map.fromPairs(pairs)`

**Returns:** Map - New map

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.map.fromPairs`

---

### 21.2.31. map.groupBy()

Group a list of maps by a key.

**Syntax:** `map.groupBy(list, key)`

**Returns:** Map - Map of groups

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.map.groupBy`

```
RETURN map.groupBy([{type: "A", val: 1}, {type: "B", val: 2}, {type: "A", val: 3}],
"type") AS result
// Returns: {A: [{type: "A", val: 1}, {type: "A", val: 3}], B: [{type: "B", val: 2}]}
```

---

### 21.2.32. map.merge()

Merge two maps, with the second map's values overriding the first.

**Syntax:** `map.merge(map1, map2)`

**Returns:** Map - Merged map

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.map.merge`

```
RETURN map.merge({a: 1, b: 2}, {b: 3, c: 4}) AS result
// Returns: {a: 1, b: 3, c: 4}
```

---

### 21.2.33. map.mergeList()

Merge a list of maps.

**Syntax:** `map.mergeList(listOfMaps)`

**Returns:** Map - Merged map

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.map.mergeList`

---

### 21.2.34. map.removeKey()

Remove a key from a map.

**Syntax:** `map.removeKey(map, key)`

**Returns:** Map - Map with key removed

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.map.removeKey`

---

### 21.2.35. map.removeKeys()

Remove multiple keys from a map.

**Syntax:** `map.removeKeys(map, keys)`

**Returns:** Map - Map with keys removed

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.map.removeKeys`

---

### 21.2.36. map.setKey()

Add or update a key in a map.

**Syntax:** `map.setKey(map, key, value)`

**Returns:** Map - Map with key added/updated

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.map.setKey`

```
RETURN map.setKey({a: 1}, "b", 2) AS result
// Returns: {a: 1, b: 2}
```

### 21.2.37. map.sortedProperties()

Get map entries sorted by key.

**Syntax:** `map.sortedProperties(map)`

**Returns:** List - Sorted list of [key, value] pairs

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.map.sortedProperties`

### 21.2.38. map.submap()

Extract a subset of keys from a map.

**Syntax:** `map.submap(map, keys, [defaults])`

**Returns:** Map - Submap with specified keys

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.map.submap`

### 21.2.39. map.unflatten()

Unflatten a map with delimited keys into a nested map.

**Syntax:** `map.unflatten(map, delimiter)`

**Returns:** Map - Nested map

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.map.unflatten`

### 21.2.40. map.values()

Get all values from a map.

**Syntax:** `map.values(map, [keys])`

**Returns:** List - List of values

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.map.values`

# Convert & Create Functions

## 21.2.41. Convert Functions

## 21.2.42. convert.fromJsonList()

Parse a JSON string to a list.

**Syntax:** `convert.fromJsonList(json)`

**Returns:** List - Parsed list

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.convert.fromJsonList`

---

## 21.2.43. convert.fromJsonMap()

Parse a JSON string to a map.

**Syntax:** `convert.fromJsonMap(json)`

**Returns:** Map - Parsed map

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.convert.fromJsonMap`

```
RETURN convert.fromJsonMap('{"name":"John","age":30}') AS result
// Returns: {name: "John", age: 30}
```

---

## 21.2.44. convert.toBoolean()

Convert a value to boolean.

**Syntax:** `convert.toBoolean(value)`

**Returns:** Boolean - Converted value

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.convert.toBoolean`

```
RETURN convert.toBoolean("true") AS result
// Returns: true

RETURN convert.toBoolean(1) AS result
// Returns: true

RETURN convert.toBoolean(0) AS result
// Returns: false
```

### 21.2.45. convert.toFloat()

Convert a value to float.

**Syntax:** `convert.toFloat(value)`

**Returns:** Float - Converted value

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.convert.toFloat`

### 21.2.46. convert.toInteger()

Convert a value to integer.

**Syntax:** `convert.toInteger(value)`

**Returns:** Integer - Converted value

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.convert.toInteger`

### 21.2.47. convert.toJson()

Convert a value to JSON string.

**Syntax:** `convert.toJson(value)`

**Returns:** String - JSON representation

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.convert.toJson`

```
RETURN convert.toJson({name: "John", age: 30}) AS result
// Returns: '{"name":"John","age":30}'

RETURN convert.toJson([1, 2, 3]) AS result
// Returns: '[1,2,3]'
```

### 21.2.48. convert.toList()

Convert a value to a list.

**Syntax:** `convert.toList(value)`

**Returns:** List - Converted list

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.convert.toList`

---

### 21.2.49. convert.toMap()

Convert a value to a map.

**Syntax:** `convert.toMap(value)`

**Returns:** Map - Converted map

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.convert.toMap`

---

### 21.2.50. convert.toSet()

Convert a value to a set (unique values).

**Syntax:** `convert.toSet(value)`

**Returns:** List - Set of unique values

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.convert.toSet`

---

### 21.2.51. convert.toString()

Convert a value to a string. This is the namespaced entry point for the built-in `toString()` function and has identical semantics.

**Syntax:** `convert.toString(value)`

**Returns:** String - String representation, or null if the value is null

Strings, numbers, booleans and temporal values convert directly. Lists, maps, nodes, relationships and paths are rejected with a `TypeError: InvalidArgumentValue` error rather than being stringified.

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.convert.toString`

```
RETURN convert.toString(42) AS result
// Returns: "42"

RETURN convert.toString([1, 2]) AS result
// Error: TypeError: InvalidArgumentValue - toString() cannot convert ArrayList
```

---

### 21.2.52. Create Functions

### 21.2.53. create.uuid()

Generate a UUID.

**Syntax:** `create.uuid()`

**Returns:** String - UUID string

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.create.uuid`

---

### 21.2.54. create.uuidBase64()

Generate a UUID in Base64 format.

**Syntax:** `create.uuidBase64()`

**Returns:** String - Base64-encoded UUID

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.create.uuidBase64`

---

### 21.2.55. create.vNode()

Create a virtual node (not persisted).

**Syntax:** `create.vNode(labels, properties)`

**Returns:** Node - Virtual node

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.create.vNode`

---

### 21.2.56. create.vRelationship()

Create a virtual relationship (not persisted).

**Syntax:** `create.vRelationship(startNode, type, properties, endNode)`

**Returns:** Relationship - Virtual relationship

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.create.vRelationship`

---

## 21.3. Date & Math Functions

### 21.3.1. Date Functions (Extended)

### 21.3.2. date.add()

Add time to a timestamp.

**Syntax:** `date.add(timestamp, value, unit)`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| timestamp | Long | The timestamp (in milliseconds) |
| value | Long | Amount to add (can be negative) |
| unit | String | Unit of the value (ms, s, m, h, d) |

**Returns:** Long - New timestamp

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.date.add`

```
RETURN date.add(date.currentTimestamp(), 1, "d") AS tomorrow
// Returns: timestamp for tomorrow

RETURN date.add(date.currentTimestamp(), -1, "h") AS oneHourAgo
// Returns: timestamp for 1 hour ago
```

---

### 21.3.3. date.convert()

Convert a timestamp between units.

**Syntax:** `date.convert(timestamp, fromUnit, toUnit)`

**Returns:** Long - Converted timestamp

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.date.convert`

---

### 21.3.4. date.currentTimestamp()

Get the current timestamp in milliseconds.

**Syntax:** `date.currentTimestamp()`

**Returns:** Long - Current timestamp in milliseconds since epoch

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.date.currentTimestamp`

```
RETURN date.currentTimestamp() AS now
```

```
// Returns: 1705314600000 (example)
```

### 21.3.5. date.field()

Extract a specific field from a timestamp.

**Syntax:** `date.field(timestamp, field)`

**Returns:** Long - Field value

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.date.field`

### 21.3.6. date.fields()

Extract all fields from a timestamp as a map.

**Syntax:** `date.fields(timestamp)`

**Returns:** Map - Map of date fields

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.date.fields`

### 21.3.7. date.format()

Format a timestamp to a date string.

**Syntax:** `date.format(timestamp, unit, format)`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| timestamp | Long | The timestamp value |
| unit | String | Unit of the timestamp (ms, s, m, h, d) |
| format | String | Date format pattern (Java SimpleDateFormat) |

**Returns:** String - Formatted date string

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.date.format`

```
RETURN date.format(1705314600000, "ms", "yyyy-MM-dd HH:mm:ss") AS result
// Returns: "2024-01-15 10:30:00"
```

### 21.3.8. date.fromISO8601()

Parse an ISO 8601 string to timestamp.

**Syntax:** `date.fromISO8601(dateString)`

**Returns:** Long - Timestamp in milliseconds

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.date.fromISO8601`

```
RETURN date.fromISO8601("2024-01-15T10:30:00Z") AS result
// Returns: 1705314600000
```

---

### 21.3.9. date.parse()

Parse a date string to timestamp.

**Syntax:** `date.parse(dateString, format)`

**Returns:** Long - Timestamp in milliseconds

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.date.parse`

---

### 21.3.10. date.systemTimezone()

Get the system's default timezone.

**Syntax:** `date.systemTimezone()`

**Returns:** String - Timezone ID (e.g., "America/New_York")

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.date.systemTimezone`

---

### 21.3.11. date.toISO8601()

Convert a timestamp to ISO 8601 format.

**Syntax:** `date.toISO8601(timestamp)`

**Returns:** String - ISO 8601 formatted string

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.date.toISO8601`

```
RETURN date.toISO8601(1705314600000) AS result
```

```
// Returns: "2024-01-15T10:30:00Z"
```

### 21.3.12. Math Functions (Extended)

### 21.3.13. math.cosh()

Calculate the hyperbolic cosine.

**Syntax:** `math.cosh(x)`

**Returns:** Double - Hyperbolic cosine value

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.math.cosh`

### 21.3.14. math.maxDouble()

Get the maximum double value.

**Syntax:** `math.maxDouble()`

**Returns:** Double - Maximum double value

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.math.maxDouble`

### 21.3.15. math.maxLong()

Get the maximum long value.

**Syntax:** `math.maxLong()`

**Returns:** Long - Maximum long value (9223372036854775807)

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.math.maxLong`

### 21.3.16. math.minLong()

Get the minimum long value.

**Syntax:** `math.minLong()`

**Returns:** Long - Minimum long value

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.math.minLong`

### 21.3.17. math.round()

Round a number to the nearest integer, or to a given number of decimal places using a chosen rounding mode. This is the namespaced entry point for the built-in `round()` function and has identical semantics.

**Syntax:** `math.round(value [, precision [, mode]])`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| value | Number | The number to round |
| precision | Integer | (Optional) Number of decimal places to keep |
| mode | String | (Optional) Rounding mode: `UP`, `DOWN`, `CEILING`, `FLOOR`, `HALF_UP`, `HALF_DOWN` or `HALF_EVEN`. Default: `HALF_UP` |

**Returns:** Double - The rounded value, or null if any argument is null

An unknown rounding mode raises an error rather than falling back to the default. `NaN` and infinity are returned unchanged.

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.math.round`

```
RETURN math.round(2.5) AS result
// Returns: 3.0

RETURN math.round(3.456, 1) AS result
// Returns: 3.5

RETURN math.round(3.456, 2, 'FLOOR') AS result
// Returns: 3.45
```

---

### 21.3.18. math.sigmoid()

Calculate the sigmoid function.

**Syntax:** `math.sigmoid(x)`

**Returns:** Double - Sigmoid value (0-1)

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.math.sigmoid`

```
RETURN math.sigmoid(0) AS result
// Returns: 0.5
```

```
RETURN math.sigmoid(10) AS result
// Returns: ~0.9999
```

---

### 21.3.19. math.sigmoidPrime()

Calculate the derivative of the sigmoid function.

**Syntax:** `math.sigmoidPrime(x)`

**Returns:** Double - Sigmoid derivative

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.math.sigmoidPrime`

---

### 21.3.20. math.sinh()

Calculate the hyperbolic sine.

**Syntax:** `math.sinh(x)`

**Returns:** Double - Hyperbolic sine value

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.math.sinh`

---

### 21.3.21. math.tanh()

Calculate the hyperbolic tangent.

**Syntax:** `math.tanh(x)`

**Returns:** Double - Hyperbolic tangent value

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.math.tanh`

---

### 21.3.22. Number Functions

### 21.3.23. number.format()

Format a number as a string using a `DecimalFormat` pattern.

**Syntax:** `number.format(number [, pattern])`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| number | Number | The number to format |
| pattern | String | (Optional) A `DecimalFormat` pattern. Default: `,0.` |

**Returns:** String - The formatted number, or null if the number or an explicitly passed pattern is null

Formatting always uses the root locale, so the grouping and decimal separators do not depend on the server's locale.

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.number.format`

```
RETURN number.format(1234567.891) AS result
// Returns: "1,234,567.891"

RETURN number.format(1000000, '#,###') AS result
// Returns: "1,000,000"

RETURN number.format(0.4567, '#.##%') AS result
// Returns: "45.67%"
```

# Graph Element Functions

## 21.3.24. Node Functions

## 21.3.25. node.degree()

Get the total degree (in + out) of a node.

**Syntax:** `node.degree(node, [relType])`

**Returns:** Long - Total degree

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.node.degree`

## 21.3.26. node.degree.in()

Get the incoming degree of a node.

**Syntax:** `node.degree.in(node, [relType])`

**Returns:** Long - Incoming degree

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.node.degree.in`

### 21.3.27. node.degree.out()

Get the outgoing degree of a node.

**Syntax:** `node.degree.out(node, [relType])`

**Returns:** Long - Outgoing degree

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.node.degree.out`

---

### 21.3.28. node.id()

Get the internal ID of a node.

**Syntax:** `node.id(node)`

**Returns:** String - Node ID (RID)

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.node.id`

---

### 21.3.29. node.labels()

Get all labels of a node.

**Syntax:** `node.labels(node)`

**Returns:** List - List of labels

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.node.labels`

---

### 21.3.30. node.relationship.exists()

Check if a relationship exists from a node.

**Syntax:** `node.relationship.exists(node, [relType], [direction])`

**Returns:** Boolean - true if relationship exists

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.node.relationship.exists`

---

### 21.3.31. node.relationship.types()

Get all relationship types connected to a node.

**Syntax:** `node.relationship.types(node, [direction])`

**Returns:** List - List of relationship types

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.node.relationship.types`

---

## 21.3.32. Relationship Functions

## 21.3.33. rel.endNode()

Get the end node of a relationship.

**Syntax:** `rel.endNode(relationship)`

**Returns:** Node - End node

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.rel.endNode`

---

## 21.3.34. rel.id()

Get the internal ID of a relationship.

**Syntax:** `rel.id(relationship)`

**Returns:** String - Relationship ID (RID)

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.rel.id`

---

## 21.3.35. rel.startNode()

Get the start node of a relationship.

**Syntax:** `rel.startNode(relationship)`

**Returns:** Node - Start node

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.rel.startNode`

---

## 21.3.36. rel.type()

Get the type of a relationship.

**Syntax:** `rel.type(relationship)`

**Returns:** String - Relationship type

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.rel.type`

# Path & Algorithm Procedures

## 21.3.37. Algorithm Procedures

## 21.3.38. algo.allsimplepaths()

Find all simple paths (without repeated nodes) between two nodes.

**Syntax:** `CALL algo.allsimplepaths(startNode, endNode, relTypes, maxDepth) YIELD path`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| startNode | Node | Starting node |
| endNode | Node | Target node |
| relTypes | String/List | Relationship type(s) to traverse |
| maxDepth | Integer | Maximum path length |

**Returns:** `path` - Each simple path found

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.algo.allSimplePaths`

```
MATCH (a:Person {name: 'Alice'}), (b:Person {name: 'Bob'})
CALL algo.allsimplepaths(a, b, 'KNOWS', 5) YIELD path
RETURN path
```

See reference/graph-algorithms/path-finding.pdf in the Graph Algorithms appendix for full parameter reference and examples.

## 21.3.39. algo.astar()

Find the shortest path using A* algorithm with optional geographic heuristics.

**Syntax:** `CALL algo.astar(startNode, endNode, relType, weightProperty, [latProperty], [lonProperty]) YIELD path, weight`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| startNode | Node | Starting node |
| endNode | Node | Target node |

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| relType | String | Relationship type to traverse |
| weightProperty | String | Edge property to use as weight |
| latProperty | String | Optional - Node property for latitude (for geographic heuristic) |
| lonProperty | String | Optional - Node property for longitude (for geographic heuristic) |

**Returns:**

- `path` - The shortest path
- `weight` - Total path weight

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.algo.aStar`

```
MATCH (a:City {name: 'Seattle'}), (b:City {name: 'Miami'})
CALL algo.astar(a, b, 'FLIGHT', 'distance', 'lat', 'lon') YIELD path, weight
RETURN path, weight
```

See reference/graph-algorithms/path-finding.pdf in the Graph Algorithms appendix for full parameter reference and examples.

---

## 21.3.40. algo.dijkstra()

Find the shortest weighted path between two nodes using Dijkstra's algorithm.

**Syntax:** `CALL algo.dijkstra(startNode, endNode, relType, weightProperty, [direction]) YIELD path, weight`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| startNode | Node | Starting node |
| endNode | Node | Target node |
| relType | String | Relationship type to traverse |
| weightProperty | String | Edge property to use as weight |
| direction | String | Optional - Traversal direction ("OUT", "IN", "BOTH", default: "BOTH") |

**Returns:**

- `path` - The shortest path
- `weight` - Total path weight

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.algo.dijkstra`

```
MATCH (a:City {name: 'New York'}), (b:City {name: 'Los Angeles'})
CALL algo.dijkstra(a, b, 'ROAD', 'distance') YIELD path, weight
RETURN path, weight
```

See reference/graph-algorithms/path-finding.pdf in the Graph Algorithms appendix for full parameter reference and examples.

---

### 21.3.41. Path Functions (Extended)

### 21.3.42. path.combine()

Combine two paths.

**Syntax:** `path.combine(path1, path2)`

**Returns:** Path - Combined path

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.path.combine`

---

### 21.3.43. path.create()

Create a path from a list of nodes and relationships.

**Syntax:** `path.create(node, [rel, node, ⋯])`

**Returns:** Path - Created path

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.path.create`

---

### 21.3.44. path.elements()

Get all elements (nodes and relationships) of a path.

**Syntax:** `path.elements(path)`

**Returns:** List - List of nodes and relationships

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.path.elements`

---

### 21.3.45. path.slice()

Get a slice of a path.

**Syntax:** `path.slice(path, start, [end])`

**Returns:** Path - Sliced path

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.path.slice`

---

### 21.3.46. Path Expansion Procedures

### 21.3.47. path.expand()

Expand paths from a starting node following relationship types and node labels.

**Syntax:** `CALL path.expand(startNode, relTypes, labelFilter, minDepth, maxDepth) YIELD path`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| startNode | Node | Starting node |
| relTypes | String | Relationship types (pipe-separated, e.g., "KNOWS\|WORKS_WITH") |
| labelFilter | String | Node labels to include (pipe-separated) |
| minDepth | Integer | Minimum path length (non-negative) |
| maxDepth | Integer | Maximum path length |

**Returns:** `path` - Each expanded path

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.path.expand`

```
MATCH (a:Person {name: 'Alice'})
CALL path.expand(a, 'KNOWS|WORKS_WITH', 'Person', 1, 3) YIELD path
RETURN path
```

---

### 21.3.48. path.expandconfig()

Expand paths using a configuration map for more control.

**Syntax:** `CALL path.expandconfig(startNode, config) YIELD path`

**Configuration options:**

| Option | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| relationshipFilter | String/List | Relationship types |
| labelFilter | String/List | Node labels |
| minLevel | Integer | Minimum depth (default: 0) |
| maxLevel | Integer | Maximum depth (default: unlimited) |
| bfs | Boolean | Use BFS (true) or DFS (false) (default: true) |
| limit | Integer | Maximum number of paths to return |

**Returns:** `path` - Each expanded path

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.path.expandConfig`

```
MATCH (a:Person {name: 'Alice'})
CALL path.expandconfig(a, {
  relationshipFilter: 'KNOWS|WORKS_WITH',
  labelFilter: 'Person',
  minLevel: 1,
  maxLevel: 3,
  bfs: true,
  limit: 100
}) YIELD path
RETURN path
```

### 21.3.49. path.spanningtree()

Get a spanning tree from the start node to all reachable nodes.

**Syntax:** `CALL path.spanningtree(startNode [, config]) YIELD path`

**Returns:** `path` - Each path in the spanning tree

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.path.spanningTree`

```
MATCH (root:Category {name: 'Root'})
CALL path.spanningtree(root, {relationshipFilter: 'HAS_CHILD', maxLevel: 5}) YIELD
path
RETURN path
```

### 21.3.50. path.subgraphall()

Get all nodes and relationships reachable from a starting node.

**Syntax:** `CALL path.subgraphall(startNode [, config]) YIELD nodes, relationships`

**Returns:**

- `nodes` - List of all reachable nodes
- `relationships` - List of all traversed relationships

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.path.subgraphAll`

```
MATCH (a:Person {name: 'Alice'})
CALL path.subgraphall(a, {relationshipFilter: 'KNOWS', maxLevel: 2}) YIELD nodes,
relationships
RETURN size(nodes) AS nodeCount, size(relationships) AS relCount
```

Yield only what you need. `YIELD nodes` on its own does not read a single edge record, while `YIELD nodes, relationships` has to load one per relationship in the component. On a large component that is the difference between a walk whose cost follows the number of nodes and one that follows the number of relationships.

`nodes` and `relationships` are returned in breadth-first order from the starting node. Before 26.10.1 the order was unspecified and effectively arbitrary.

`relationships` only ever includes edges whose two endpoints are both in `nodes`, matching `apoc.path.subgraphAll`. Before 26.10.1, a `labelFilter` that excluded a neighbour could still leave the edge reaching it in `relationships`, even though that neighbour was missing from `nodes`.

---

## 21.3.51. path.subgraphnodes()

Get all nodes reachable from a starting node within configured constraints.

**Syntax:** `CALL path.subgraphnodes(startNode [, config]) YIELD node`

**Returns:** `node` - Each reachable node

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.path.subgraphNodes`

```
MATCH (a:Person {name: 'Alice'})
CALL path.subgraphnodes(a, {relationshipFilter: 'KNOWS', maxLevel: 3}) YIELD node
RETURN node.name
```

Nodes are returned in breadth-first order from the starting node. Before 26.10.1 the order was unspecified.

---

# Refactor & Control Flow Procedures

These are procedures, not functions: they are invoked with `CALL … YIELD …` and they write to the database. All three are available under their bare name and under the `apoc.` prefix.

## 21.3.52. Control Flow Procedures

## 21.3.53. do.when()

Run one of two Cypher sub-queries depending on a condition, and yield each row the sub-query produces.

**Syntax:** `CALL do.when(condition, ifQuery, elseQuery, params) YIELD value`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| condition | Boolean | Selects the branch to run. Must be a boolean; a string, number or list is rejected rather than coerced. |
| ifQuery | String | Cypher run when the condition is true |
| elseQuery | String | Cypher run when the condition is false. Pass `null` or an empty string for "no else branch", in which case the call yields no rows. |
| params | Map | Named parameters bound into the sub-query. Pass `{}` or `null` for none. |

All four arguments are required.

**Returns:** `value` - One row per row the sub-query produces, each holding that row as a map

The sub-query is routed to a read or a write execution automatically, so both `MATCH … RETURN` and `CREATE`/`SET`/`DELETE` branches work without the caller having to say which. `ifQuery` is type-checked on every call, including calls where the condition is false and the branch never runs.

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.do.when`

```
CALL do.when(
  size($names) > 0,
  'RETURN $names[0] AS first',
  'RETURN null AS first',
  {names: $names}
) YIELD value
RETURN value.first AS first
```

A write branch:

```
MATCH (p:Person {name: 'Alice'})
CALL do.when(
  p.score > 100,
  'MATCH (n:Person) WHERE elementId(n) = $id SET n.tier = "gold" RETURN n.tier AS
tier',
  null,
  {id: elementId(p)}
) YIELD value
RETURN value.tier AS tier
```

`ifQuery` and `elseQuery` run with the caller's privileges, exactly as any other command string the engine executes. Never build either argument by concatenating untrusted input — pass values through `params` instead.

### 21.3.54. Refactor Procedures

### 21.3.55. refactor.cloneNodesWithRelationships()

Clone each given node together with every relationship touching it, leaving the originals untouched.

**Syntax:** `CALL refactor.cloneNodesWithRelationships(nodes, config = {}) YIELD input, output, error`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| nodes | List | The nodes to clone. A node listed twice is cloned once. |
| config | Map | Configuration. Optional; omitting it, or passing `{}` or `null`, all fall back to the defaults. |

**Configuration keys:**

| Key | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| skipProperties | List | Property names to leave off the clones |

**Returns:** One row per input node:

- `input` - The original node
- `output` - The clone, or null if cloning it failed
- `error` - The failure message, or null on success

Each clone is a new vertex of the same type carrying the same properties. A relationship whose other endpoint is also being cloned reconnects the two clones; a relationship to a node outside the

list reconnects the clone to that same original node. This includes the incoming relationships of a `UNIDIRECTIONAL` edge type, which the node itself does not store *(since v26.11.1)*.

Cloning is best-effort per item: a node that fails to clone gets its own row with `output` null and a message in `error`, and an edge that fails to clone is skipped. This covers failures raised at `save()` time: a `UNIQUE` index violation is checked at commit, so it still fails the whole transaction.

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.refactor.cloneNodesWithRelationships`

```
MATCH (a:Person {name: 'Alice'}), (b:Person {name: 'Bob'})
CALL refactor.cloneNodesWithRelationships([a, b], {}) YIELD input, output, error
RETURN input, output, error

// Excluding properties from the clones:
MATCH (p:Person)
WITH collect(p) AS people
CALL refactor.cloneNodesWithRelationships(people, {skipProperties: ['ssn', 'email']})
YIELD output
RETURN count(output) AS cloned
```

## 21.3.56. refactor.mergeNodes()

Merge a list of nodes into the first one, rewiring their relationships and deleting the absorbed nodes.

**Syntax:** `CALL refactor.mergeNodes(nodes, config = {}) YIELD node`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| nodes | List | The nodes to merge. The first is the survivor; the rest are absorbed. A node listed twice counts once, and at least two distinct nodes are required. |
| config | Map | Configuration. Optional; omitting it, or passing `{}` or `null`, all fall back to the defaults (the `overwrite` properties policy). |

**Configuration keys:**

| Key | Type | Description |
| --- | --- | --- |
| properties | String | How to resolve a property present on both the survivor and an absorbed node: `overwrite` (the absorbed value wins; the default), `discard` (the survivor keeps its value) or `combine` (the distinct values across the merged nodes are kept, in first-seen order, as a list - or as that single value itself when every merged node agrees on it, rather than a list of duplicates). Any other value raises an error. |

**Returns:** `node` - The surviving node

A property present only on an absorbed node is always copied onto the survivor, whichever policy is in effect. Every incoming and outgoing relationship of an absorbed node is rewired onto the survivor; a relationship that connected two nodes both being merged becomes a self-relationship on the survivor. This includes the incoming relationships of a `UNIDIRECTIONAL` edge type, which the absorbed node itself does not store; before v26.11.1 they were deleted with it.

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.refactor.mergeNodes`

```
MATCH (a:Person {name: 'Alice'}), (b:Person {name: 'Alice'})
WHERE elementId(a) <> elementId(b)
CALL refactor.mergeNodes([a, b], {properties: 'combine'}) YIELD node
RETURN node

// Keeping the survivor's own values on conflict:
MATCH (a:Person {name: 'Alice'}), (b:Person {name: 'Alice'})
WHERE elementId(a) <> elementId(b)
CALL refactor.mergeNodes([a, b], {properties: 'discard'}) YIELD node
RETURN node

// Omitting config falls back to the default 'overwrite' policy:
MATCH (a:Person {name: 'Alice'}), (b:Person {name: 'Alice'})
WHERE elementId(a) <> elementId(b)
CALL refactor.mergeNodes([a, b]) YIELD node
RETURN node
```

# 21.4. Schema & Meta Procedures

## 21.4.1. Meta/Schema Procedures

## 21.4.2. meta.graph()

Get a virtual graph representing the database schema structure.

**Syntax:** `CALL meta.graph() YIELD nodes, relationships`

**Returns:**

- `nodes` - Virtual nodes representing vertex types with their counts and properties
- `relationships` - Virtual relationships representing edge types with their counts

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.meta.graph`

```
CALL meta.graph() YIELD nodes, relationships
RETURN nodes, relationships
```

---

### 21.4.3. meta.nodetypeproperties()

Get property information for each node type.

**Syntax:** `CALL meta.nodetypeproperties() YIELD nodeType, propertyName, propertyTypes, mandatory`

**Returns:**

- `nodeType` - Name of the vertex type
- `propertyName` - Name of the property
- `propertyTypes` - List of property types
- `mandatory` - Whether the property is required

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.meta.nodeTypeProperties`

```
CALL meta.nodetypeproperties() YIELD nodeType, propertyName, propertyTypes
RETURN nodeType, propertyName, propertyTypes
```

---

### 21.4.4. meta.reltypeproperties()

Get property information for each relationship type.

**Syntax:** `CALL meta.reltypeproperties() YIELD relType, propertyName, propertyTypes, mandatory`

**Returns:**

- `relType` - Name of the edge type
- `propertyName` - Name of the property
- `propertyTypes` - List of property types
- `mandatory` - Whether the property is required

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.meta.relTypeProperties`

```
CALL meta.reltypeproperties() YIELD relType, propertyName, propertyTypes
RETURN relType, propertyName, propertyTypes
```

---

### 21.4.5. meta.schema()

Get detailed schema information including all types and properties.

**Syntax:** `CALL meta.schema() YIELD value`

**Returns:** `value` - Map containing:

- `nodeLabels` - List of vertex types with their properties
- `relationshipTypes` - List of edge types with their properties

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.meta.schema`

```
CALL meta.schema() YIELD value
RETURN value.nodeLabels AS nodeTypes
```

---

### 21.4.6. meta.stats()

Get database statistics including counts of nodes and relationships.

**Syntax:** `CALL meta.stats() YIELD value`

**Returns:** `value` - Map containing:

- `labelCount` - Number of node labels
- `relTypeCount` - Number of relationship types
- `nodeCount` - Total number of nodes
- `relCount` - Total number of relationships
- `labels` - Map of label to count
- `relTypes` - Map of relationship type to count

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.meta.stats`

```
CALL meta.stats() YIELD value
RETURN value.nodeCount AS nodes, value.relCount AS relationships
```

---

### 21.4.7. Merge Procedures

### 21.4.8. merge.node()

Create or match a node by labels and properties.

**Syntax:** `CALL merge.node(labels, matchProps, createProps, onMatchProps) YIELD node`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| labels | List of String | Labels for the node |
| matchProps | Map | Properties to match on |
| createProps | Map | Properties to set when the node is newly created (optional) |
| onMatchProps | Map | Properties to set when the node already exists (optional) |

**Returns:** `node` - The merged node

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.merge.node`

```
CALL merge.node(["Person"], {email: "alice@example.com"}, {name: "Alice", created:
date.currentTimestamp()}) YIELD node
RETURN node

// with onMatchProps: bump a visit counter only when the node already existed
CALL merge.node(["Person"], {email: "alice@example.com"}, {name: "Alice"}, {lastSeen:
date.currentTimestamp()}) YIELD node
RETURN node
```

---

### 21.4.9. merge.relationship()

Create or match a relationship between two nodes.

**Syntax:** `CALL merge.relationship(startNode, relType, matchProps, createProps, endNode [, onMatchProps]) YIELD rel`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| startNode | Node | Starting node |
| relType | String | Relationship type name |
| matchProps | Map | Properties to match on |

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| createProps | Map | Properties to set on create |
| endNode | Node | Ending node |
| onMatchProps | Map | Optional. Properties to set when the relationship already exists. Default `{}` *(since v26.10.1)* |

**Returns:** `rel` - The merged relationship

`createProps` is applied only when the relationship is created, and `onMatchProps` only when an existing one is matched. Leaving `onMatchProps` out, or passing `{}`, leaves a matched relationship untouched, which is what the five-argument form has always done. A `LIGHTWEIGHT` edge type has no record to hold properties, so a non-empty `onMatchProps` on one is refused.

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.merge.relationship`

```
MATCH (a:Person {name: "Alice"}), (b:Person {name: "Bob"})
CALL merge.relationship(a, "KNOWS", {}, {since: 2024}, b) YIELD rel
RETURN rel

// Set a property on create, update another one when the relationship is already
there:
MATCH (a:Person {name: "Alice"}), (b:Person {name: "Bob"})
CALL merge.relationship(a, "KNOWS", {}, {since: 2024}, b, {confirmed: true}) YIELD rel
RETURN rel

// With batch processing:
UNWIND $batch AS row
MATCH (a), (b) WHERE elementId(a) = row.source AND elementId(b) = row.target
CALL merge.relationship(a, row.relType, {}, row.props, b) YIELD rel
RETURN count(rel)
```

# Text Functions

## 21.4.10. text.byteCount()

Get the byte count of a string.

**Syntax:** `text.byteCount(string)`

**Returns:** Long - Number of bytes

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.byteCount`

### 21.4.11. text.camelCase()

Convert a string to camelCase.

**Syntax:** `text.camelCase(string)`

**Returns:** String - camelCase string

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.camelCase`

```
RETURN text.camelCase("hello world") AS result
// Returns: "helloWorld"

RETURN text.camelCase("hello_world") AS result
// Returns: "helloWorld"
```

---

### 21.4.12. text.capitalize()

Capitalize the first letter of a string.

**Syntax:** `text.capitalize(string)`

**Returns:** String - Capitalized string

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.capitalize`

```
RETURN text.capitalize("hello") AS result
// Returns: "Hello"
```

---

### 21.4.13. text.capitalizeAll()

Capitalize the first letter of each word.

**Syntax:** `text.capitalizeAll(string)`

**Returns:** String - String with all words capitalized

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.capitalizeAll`

```
RETURN text.capitalizeAll("hello world") AS result
// Returns: "Hello World"
```

---

### 21.4.14. text.charAt()

Get the character at a specific index.

**Syntax:** `text.charAt(string, index)`

**Returns:** String - Character at index

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.charAt`

---

### 21.4.15. text.code()

Get the Unicode code point of a character.

**Syntax:** `text.code(character)`

**Returns:** Long - Unicode code point

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.code`

---

### 21.4.16. text.decapitalize()

Decapitalize the first letter of a string.

**Syntax:** `text.decapitalize(string)`

**Returns:** String - Decapitalized string

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.decapitalize`

---

### 21.4.17. text.decapitalizeAll()

Decapitalize the first letter of each word.

**Syntax:** `text.decapitalizeAll(string)`

**Returns:** String - String with all words decapitalized

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.decapitalizeAll`

---

### 21.4.18. text.format()

Format a string using printf-style formatting. Number formatting (`%f`, `%e`, `%d`, etc.) is always locale-independent (e.g. `.` as decimal separator), regardless of the server's configured locale.

**Syntax:** `text.format(format, args…)`

**Returns:** String - Formatted string

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.format`

---

### 21.4.19. text.hammingDistance()

Calculate the Hamming distance between two strings of equal length. Returns the number of positions at which the corresponding characters differ.

**Syntax:** `text.hammingDistance(string1, string2)`

**Returns:** Long - Number of positions with different characters

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.hammingDistance`

```
SELECT text.hammingDistance('karolin', 'kathrin') AS distance
-- Returns: 3

SELECT text.hammingDistance(name, 'John') AS dist FROM Person
```

```
RETURN text.hammingDistance("karolin", "kathrin") AS distance
// Returns: 3
```

---

### 21.4.20. text.hexValue()

Convert a number to its hexadecimal representation.

**Syntax:** `text.hexValue(number)`

**Returns:** String - Hexadecimal string

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.hexValue`

---

### 21.4.21. text.indexOf()

Find the position of a substring within a string.

**Syntax:** `text.indexOf(string, substring, [start])`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| string | String | The string to search in |
| substring | String | The substring to find |
| start | Integer | Optional - Starting position (default: 0) |

**Returns:** Long - Position of substring, or -1 if not found

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.indexOf`

```
RETURN text.indexOf("hello world", "world") AS pos
// Returns: 6

RETURN text.indexOf("hello hello", "hello", 1) AS pos
// Returns: 6
```

---

## 21.4.22. text.jaroWinklerDistance()

Calculate the Jaro-Winkler similarity between two strings. Returns a value between 0.0 (completely different) and 1.0 (identical). This metric is especially effective for detecting typos and misspellings because it gives extra weight to matching prefixes.

**Syntax:** `text.jaroWinklerDistance(string1, string2)`

**Returns:** Double - Similarity score (0.0 to 1.0)

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.jaroWinklerDistance`

```
-- Find similar names using fuzzy matching
SELECT name, text.jaroWinklerDistance(name, 'John') AS score
  FROM Person
  WHERE text.jaroWinklerDistance(name, 'John') > 0.85
  ORDER BY score DESC

-- Compare two literal strings
SELECT text.jaroWinklerDistance('hello', 'helo') AS score
-- Returns: ~0.953
```

```
RETURN text.jaroWinklerDistance("hello", "helo") AS score
// Returns: ~0.953

MATCH (p:Person)
WHERE text.jaroWinklerDistance(p.name, "John") > 0.85
RETURN p.name, text.jaroWinklerDistance(p.name, "John") AS score
ORDER BY score DESC
```

### 21.4.23. text.join()

Join a list of strings with a delimiter.

**Syntax:** `text.join(list, delimiter)`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| list | List | List of strings to join |
| delimiter | String | String to insert between elements |

**Returns:** String - Joined string

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.join`

```
RETURN text.join(["a", "b", "c"], ",") AS result
// Returns: "a,b,c"
```

### 21.4.24. text.levenshteinDistance()

Calculate the Levenshtein (edit) distance between two strings. Returns the minimum number of single-character edits (insertions, deletions, or substitutions) required to change one string into the other.

**Syntax:** `text.levenshteinDistance(string1, string2)`

**Returns:** Long - Number of edits required

Each argument is limited to 10,000 characters. A longer string is rejected with `String length exceeds maximum allowed`, because the computation cost grows with the two lengths multiplied together.

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.levenshteinDistance`

```
SELECT text.levenshteinDistance('kitten', 'sitting') AS distance
-- Returns: 3

SELECT name, text.levenshteinDistance(name, 'John') AS edits
  FROM Person
  WHERE text.levenshteinDistance(name, 'John') <= 2
```

```
RETURN text.levenshteinDistance("kitten", "sitting") AS distance
```

```
// Returns: 3
```

### 21.4.25. text.levenshteinSimilarity()

Calculate the normalized Levenshtein similarity (0-1) between two strings. This is computed as `1.0 - (editDistance / maxLength)`, providing a score where 1.0 means identical strings.

**Syntax:** `text.levenshteinSimilarity(string1, string2)`

**Returns:** Double - Similarity score (0.0 to 1.0)

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.levenshteinSimilarity`

```
SELECT text.levenshteinSimilarity('hello', 'hallo') AS similarity
-- Returns: 0.8
```

```
RETURN text.levenshteinSimilarity("hello", "hallo") AS similarity
// Returns: 0.8
```

### 21.4.26. text.lpad()

Left-pad a string to a specified length.

**Syntax:** `text.lpad(string, length, padChar)`

**Returns:** String - Padded string

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.lpad`

```
RETURN text.lpad("42", 5, "0") AS result
// Returns: "00042"
```

### 21.4.27. text.random()

Generate a random string.

**Syntax:** `text.random(length, [chars])`

**Returns:** String - Random string

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.random`

### 21.4.28. text.regexReplace()

Replace all matches of a regular expression.

**Syntax:** `text.regexReplace(string, regex, replacement)`

**Returns:** String - String with replacements made

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.regexReplace`

```
RETURN text.regexReplace("hello123world", "[0-9]+", "-") AS result
// Returns: "hello-world"
```

---

### 21.4.29. text.replace()

Replace all occurrences of a substring.

**Syntax:** `text.replace(string, search, replacement)`

**Returns:** String - String with replacements made

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.replace`

```
RETURN text.replace("hello world", "world", "universe") AS result
// Returns: "hello universe"
```

---

### 21.4.30. text.rpad()

Right-pad a string to a specified length.

**Syntax:** `text.rpad(string, length, padChar)`

**Returns:** String - Padded string

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.rpad`

```
RETURN text.rpad("42", 5, "0") AS result
// Returns: "42000"
```

---

### 21.4.31. text.slug()

Create a URL-friendly slug from a string.

**Syntax:** `text.slug(string, [delimiter])`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| string | String | The string to convert |
| delimiter | String | Optional - Character to use as word separator (default: "-") |

**Returns:** String - URL-friendly slug

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.slug`

```
RETURN text.slug("Hello World!") AS result
// Returns: "hello-world"

RETURN text.slug("Hello World!", "_") AS result
// Returns: "hello_world"
```

---

### 21.4.32. text.snakeCase()

Convert a string to snake_case.

**Syntax:** `text.snakeCase(string)`

**Returns:** String - snake_case string

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.snakeCase`

```
RETURN text.snakeCase("helloWorld") AS result
// Returns: "hello_world"
```

---

### 21.4.33. text.sorensenDiceSimilarity()

Calculate the Sorensen-Dice similarity coefficient between two strings based on bigram (character pair) overlap. Returns a value between 0.0 (no common bigrams) and 1.0 (identical). Useful for comparing short strings and detecting near-duplicates.

**Syntax:** `text.sorensenDiceSimilarity(string1, string2)`

**Returns:** Double - Similarity score (0.0 to 1.0)

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.sorensenDiceSimilarity`

```
SELECT text.sorensenDiceSimilarity('night', 'nacht') AS score
```

```
RETURN text.sorensenDiceSimilarity("night", "nacht") AS score
```

---

### 21.4.34. text.split()

Split a string by a delimiter.

**Syntax:** `text.split(string, delimiter)`

**Returns:** List - List of substrings

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.split`

```
RETURN text.split("a,b,c", ",") AS parts
// Returns: ["a", "b", "c"]
```

---

### 21.4.35. text.upperCamelCase()

Convert a string to UpperCamelCase (PascalCase).

**Syntax:** `text.upperCamelCase(string)`

**Returns:** String - UpperCamelCase string

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.text.upperCamelCase`

```
RETURN text.upperCamelCase("hello world") AS result
// Returns: "HelloWorld"
```

---

## 21.5. Utility Functions

### 21.5.1. util.compress()

Compress data using gzip or deflate.

**Syntax:** `util.compress(data, [algorithm])`

**Parameters:**

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| data | String | String data to compress |
| algorithm | String | Optional - "gzip" (default) or "deflate" |

**Returns:** String - Base64-encoded compressed data

The input is limited to 10MB. A larger value is rejected with `Input size exceeds maximum allowed`, so that a single query cannot exhaust server memory.

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.util.compress`

---

### 21.5.2. util.decompress()

Decompress base64-encoded compressed data.

**Syntax:** `util.decompress(data, [algorithm])`

**Returns:** String - Decompressed string

The decompressed result is limited to 100MB. Anything larger is rejected with `Decompressed output size exceeds maximum allowed`, which protects the server against a "zip bomb": a small payload that expands to an enormous one.

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.util.decompress`

```
WITH util.compress("Hello World!") AS compressed
RETURN util.decompress(compressed) AS original
// Returns: "Hello World!"
```

---

### 21.5.3. util.md5()

Compute MD5 hash of a value.

**Syntax:** `util.md5(value)`

**Returns:** String - MD5 hash (32 hex characters)

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.util.md5`

```
RETURN util.md5("hello") AS hash
// Returns: "5d41402abc4b2a76b9719d911017c592"
```

### 21.5.4. util.sha1()

Compute SHA-1 hash of a value.

**Syntax:** `util.sha1(value)`

**Returns:** String - SHA-1 hash (40 hex characters)

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.util.sha1`

---

### 21.5.5. util.sha256()

Compute SHA-256 hash of a value.

**Syntax:** `util.sha256(value)`

**Returns:** String - SHA-256 hash (64 hex characters)

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.util.sha256`

```
RETURN util.sha256("hello") AS hash
// Returns: "2cf24dba5fb0a30e26e83b2ac5b9e29e1b161e5c1fa7425e73043362938b9824"
```

---

### 21.5.6. util.sha512()

Compute SHA-512 hash of a value.

**Syntax:** `util.sha512(value)`

**Returns:** String - SHA-512 hash (128 hex characters)

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.util.sha512`

---

### 21.5.7. util.sleep()

Pause execution for a specified time.

**Syntax:** `util.sleep(milliseconds)`

**Returns:** Boolean - true after sleep

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.util.sleep`

---

### 21.5.8. util.validate()

Validate a condition and throw an error if false.

**Syntax:** `util.validate(predicate, message)`

**Returns:** Boolean - true if validation passes

**APOC Compatible:** `apoc.util.validate`

```
RETURN util.validate(1 > 0, "Value must be positive") AS valid
// Returns: true

RETURN util.validate(false, "This will throw!") AS valid
// Throws: IllegalArgumentException with message "This will throw!"
```

## 21.6. Vector Functions

Vector functions provide comprehensive operations for vector embeddings, similarity search, and machine learning workflows. These functions are available in both SQL and Cypher queries.

Every vector function has two equivalent names: the namespaced `vector.<name>()` form (e.g. `vector.dimension()`) and a camelCase alias kept for backward compatibility (e.g. `vectorDimension()`). They resolve to the same function and are case-insensitive.

**Prefer the namespaced `vector.<name>()` form** in new queries and examples: it groups the suite consistently with the other extended namespaces (`geo.`, `math.`, …) and reads more clearly. The namespaced form can be called directly, without back-ticks (e.g. `SELECT vector.cosineSimilarity(a, b)`). All examples in this section use it.

### 21.6.1. Aggregation Functions

There are two distinct categories of "statistics" functions, which is easy to confuse:

- **Row aggregates that return a vector** - `vector.sum()`, `vector.avg()`, `vector.min()`, `vector.max()` fold a column of vectors **element-wise across rows**. For example `vector.avg(embedding)` returns the **centroid** (the element-wise arithmetic mean) of all the embeddings in the result set.
- **Per-vector element statistics that return a scalar** - `vector.variance()` and `vector.stddev()` operate on a **single** vector and return the variance / standard deviation of **that vector's elements**. They are intentionally **not** row aggregates (unlike the scalar SQL `variance()`/`stddev()`).

#### vector.sum()

Aggregate function: element-wise sum of vectors.

**Syntax:** `vector.sum(<field>)`

**Returns:** Vector - Sum of all vectors

```
SELECT vector.sum(embedding) FROM documents
```

---

#### vector.avg()

Aggregate function: element-wise average of vectors.

**Syntax:** `vector.avg(<field>)`

**Returns:** Vector - Average vector

```
SELECT vector.avg(embedding) FROM documents
```

---

#### vector.min()

Aggregate function: element-wise minimum of vectors.

**Syntax:** `vector.min(<field>)`

**Returns:** Vector - Minimum vector

```
SELECT vector.min(embedding) FROM documents
```

---

#### vector.max()

Aggregate function: element-wise maximum of vectors.

**Syntax:** `vector.max(<field>)`

**Returns:** Vector - Maximum vector

```
SELECT vector.max(embedding) FROM documents
```

---

### 21.6.2. Basic Operations

#### vector.dimension()

Returns the dimension of a vector (length of the underlying array).

**Syntax:** `vector.dimension(<vector>)`

**Returns:** Integer - Vector dimension. A `NULL` argument returns `0` (consistent with `.size()`/`.length()`).

```
SELECT vector.dimension([1.0, 2.0, 3.0])
-- Returns: 3

SELECT vector.dimension(null)
-- Returns: 0
```

```
RETURN vector.dimension([1.0, 2.0, 3.0]) AS dim
```

---

#### vector.add()

Returns element-wise sum of two vectors, or adds a scalar to every element (broadcasting). The scalar may be either argument since addition is commutative.

**Syntax:** `vector.add(<vector1>, <vector2> | <scalar>)`

**Returns:** Vector - Sum vector

```
SELECT vector.add([1.0, 2.0, 3.0], [2.0, 3.0, 4.0])
-- Returns: [3.0, 5.0, 7.0]

SELECT vector.add([1.0, 2.0, 3.0], 4.0)
-- Returns: [5.0, 6.0, 7.0]  (scalar broadcasting)
```

---

#### vector.subtract()

Returns element-wise difference of two vectors, or subtracts with a scalar (broadcasting). Order is preserved: `vector - scalar` subtracts the scalar from each element, while `scalar - vector` subtracts each element from the scalar.

**Syntax:** `vector.subtract(<vector1> | <scalar>, <vector2> | <scalar>)`

**Returns:** Vector - Difference vector

```
SELECT vector.subtract([3.0, 5.0, 7.0], [1.0, 2.0, 3.0])
```

```
-- Returns: [2.0, 3.0, 4.0]

SELECT vector.subtract([1.0, 2.0, 3.0], 1.0)
-- Returns: [0.0, 1.0, 2.0]  (vector - scalar)

SELECT vector.subtract(10.0, [1.0, 2.0, 3.0])
-- Returns: [9.0, 8.0, 7.0]  (scalar - vector)
```

---

#### vector.scale()

Scales vector element-wise by a scalar value.

**Syntax:** `vector.scale(<vector>, <scalar>)`

**Returns:** Vector - Scaled vector

```
SELECT vector.scale([1.0, 2.0, 3.0], 2.0)
-- Returns: [2.0, 4.0, 6.0]
```

---

#### vector.clip()

Clips (clamps) vector elements to a specified range [min, max]. Also available as `vector.clamp()` / `vectorClamp()`.

**Syntax:** `vector.clip(<vector>, <min>, <max>)`

**Returns:** Vector - Clipped vector

```
SELECT vector.clip([1.0, 5.0, 10.0], 2.0, 8.0)
-- Returns: [2.0, 5.0, 8.0]

SELECT vector.clamp([1.0, 5.0, 10.0], 2.0, 8.0)
-- Returns: [2.0, 5.0, 8.0]  (clamp is an alias of clip)
```

---

### 21.6.3. Nearest Neighbor Search

#### vector.neighbors()

Returns k nearest neighbors from a vector index.

**Syntax:**

```
vector.neighbors(<index-spec>, <query-vector>, <k>)
```

```
vector.neighbors(<index-spec>, <query-vector>, <k>, <efSearch>)
vector.neighbors(<index-spec>, <query-vector>, <k>, { <option>: <value>, ... })
```

**Parameters:**

- `index-spec` - Index specification as `'TypeName[propertyName]'`
- `query-vector` - Query vector or key to look up
- `k` - Number of neighbors to return
- `efSearch` - (optional, positional) Search beam width. Controls the trade-off between recall and speed. Higher values improve recall but increase latency. When omitted, the index uses adaptive efSearch.

**Options map** (optional, alternative to the positional `efSearch` argument):

| Key | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `efSearch` | Integer | Same semantics as the positional form. |
| `filter` | List of RIDs or RID strings | Restricts the search to the provided set of records. Useful to combine a vector search with a logical filter: first select the candidate RIDs, then pass them as `filter`. An empty list (or a subquery that returns no rows) matches nothing, so the function returns no results. Omit the option, or pass `null`, to search without a restriction. Unknown keys are rejected. |
| `groupBy` | String | Diversifies the answer by a property: `k` becomes the number of distinct values of that property to return rather than the number of rows, and at most `groupSize` rows are returned per value. Supports nested paths (`meta.source`). Records whose property is missing share the single `null` group. |
| `groupSize` | Integer | Rows to return per group when `groupBy` is set. Defaults to `1`, so the answer is the `k` nearest records with `k` distinct values. Must be `>= 1`; ignored when `groupBy` is absent. |
| `maxDistance` | Number | Drops neighbors further than this distance, turning the query into a radius search bounded by `k`. The result may legitimately hold fewer than `k` rows. Defaults to no bound. |

**Returns:** List - Nearest neighbors with distances

```
-- Default (adaptive efSearch)
SELECT vector.neighbors('Document[embedding]', [0.1, 0.2, 0.3], 5)

-- Explicit efSearch for higher recall (positional form, backward compatible)
SELECT vector.neighbors('Document[embedding]', [0.1, 0.2, 0.3], 5, 500)

-- Options map form (named, extensible)
```

```
SELECT vector.neighbors('Document[embedding]', [0.1, 0.2, 0.3], 5, { efSearch: 500 })

-- Combine a vector search with a logical filter on the same type
SELECT vector.neighbors(
         'Document[embedding]',
         [0.1, 0.2, 0.3],
         10,
         { filter: (SELECT @rid FROM Document WHERE tenantId = 'acme' AND category =
'finance') }
       )

-- Using a parameter binding for the RID list
SELECT vector.neighbors('Document[embedding]', :queryVector, 10, { efSearch: 300,
filter: :allowedRids })

-- One result per source document: 10 distinct sources, nearest chunk of each
SELECT vector.neighbors('Chunk[embedding]', :queryVector, 10, { groupBy: 'sourceFile'
})

-- 5 distinct sources, up to 3 chunks each, none further away than 0.35
SELECT vector.neighbors(
         'Chunk[embedding]',
         :queryVector,
         5,
         { groupBy: 'sourceFile', groupSize: 3, maxDistance: 0.35 }
       )
```

`groupBy` changes how rows are capped and nothing else about what the index can see: a grouped query is answered from the same corpus as the ungrouped one, including vectors written since the graph was last rebuilt.

A grouped query can return fewer than `k` groups, and two index statistics tell you which of the two reasons applies:

- `groupedSearchesShortOfLimit` - the search ran out of candidate budget before reaching the `k`-th nearest group, which happens when the nearest groups are very dense. Raising `efSearch` is what helps here.
- `groupedSearchesGroupsUnavailable` - there were no more groups to find. Usually this simply means the data holds fewer distinct values of the `groupBy` property than you asked for: a query with `k` of 10 over a corpus with 3 source files can only ever return 3 groups. That is expected and needs no action - raising `efSearch` cannot create a group that does not exist, and only makes the query slower. Look into it only if you expected more groups than you got, which can indicate a damaged index graph that `REBUILD INDEX` repairs.

The options map rejects unknown keys with a descriptive error to catch typos, for example passing `{ efsearch: 500 }` (lowercase) will fail. Keys are case sensitive.

**Cypher Usage:**

The recommended way to use vector search from Cypher is via `CALL`, which uses the HNSW index for fast approximate nearest neighbor search:

```
// ArcadeDB-native syntax
CALL vector.neighbors('Document[embedding]', $queryVector, 10)
YIELD name, distance
RETURN name, distance
ORDER BY distance

// Neo4j-compatible syntax (returns node + score)
CALL db.index.vector.queryNodes('Document[embedding]', 10, $queryVector)
YIELD node, score
RETURN node.title AS title, score
ORDER BY score DESC
```

`db.index.vector.queryNodes()` returns `score` in [0, 1] (1.0 = identical, as Neo4j reports it), while `vector.neighbors()` returns `distance` (0.0 = identical). For COSINE the relationship is `score = 1 - distance / 2`; for DOT_PRODUCT `score = -distance`; for EUCLIDEAN `score = 1 / (1 + distance)`.

**Type-Specific Search with Inheritance:**

When a vector index exists on a parent type, you can search specific child types:

```
-- Search only in EMBEDDING_IMAGE records
SELECT vector.neighbors('EMBEDDING_IMAGE[vector]', $queryVector, 10)

-- Search across all types (parent + children)
SELECT vector.neighbors('EMBEDDING[vector]', $queryVector, 10)
```

---

## 21.6.4. Normalization and Norms

**vector.normalize()**

Normalizes vector to unit length (L2 norm = 1.0).

**Syntax:** `vector.normalize(<vector>)`

**Returns:** Vector - Normalized vector

```
SELECT vector.normalize([3.0, 4.0])
-- Returns: [0.6, 0.8]
```

---

#### vector.isnormalized()

Checks if vector is normalized (L2 norm ≈ 1.0). The optional `tolerance` defaults to `0.001`, which is an appropriate loose bound for ArcadeDB's `float` vectors (`sqrt(float eps) ≈ 3.45e-4`); pass a smaller value to tighten the check.

**Syntax:** `vector.isnormalized(<vector>, [tolerance])`

**Returns:** Boolean - true if normalized

```
SELECT vector.isnormalized([0.6, 0.8])
-- Returns: true
```

---

#### vector.magnitude()

Computes L2 norm (Euclidean length) of vector. Also available as `vector.l2Norm()` / `vectorL2Norm()`, symmetric with `vector.l1Norm()` and `vector.lInfNorm()`.

**Syntax:** `vector.magnitude(<vector>)`

**Returns:** Double - L2 norm

```
SELECT vector.magnitude([3.0, 4.0])
-- Returns: 5.0

SELECT vector.l2Norm([3.0, 4.0])
-- Returns: 5.0  (l2Norm is an alias of magnitude)
```

---

#### vector.l1norm()

Computes L1 norm (Manhattan norm) of vector.

**Syntax:** `vector.l1norm(<vector>)`

**Returns:** Double - L1 norm

```
SELECT vector.l1norm([1.0, 2.0, 3.0])
-- Returns: 6.0
```

---

#### vector.linfnorm()

Computes L∞ norm (maximum absolute value) of vector.

**Syntax:** `vector.linfnorm(<vector>)`

**Returns:** Double - L∞ norm

```
SELECT vector.linfnorm([1.0, -5.0, 3.0])
-- Returns: 5.0
```

---

## 21.6.5. Quantization

#### vector.quantizeint8()

Quantizes vector to 8-bit integers using min-max scaling.

**Syntax:** `vector.quantizeint8(<vector>)`

**Returns:** ByteArray - Quantized vector

```
SELECT vector.quantizeint8([0.1, 0.5, 0.9])
```

---

#### vector.dequantizeint8()

Dequantizes 8-bit integers back to float vector (approximate recovery). Pass the result of `vector.quantizeint8()` directly (the `min`/`max` are read from it), or supply the bytes with explicit `min`/`max`.

**Syntax:** `vector.dequantizeint8(<result>)` or `vector.dequantizeint8(<quantized>, <min>, <max>)`

**Returns:** Vector - Dequantized vector

```
SELECT vector.dequantizeint8(vector.quantizeint8([1.0, 2.0, 3.0]))
-- Returns: ~[1.0, 2.0, 3.0]
```

---

#### vector.quantizebinary()

Quantizes vector to binary (1 bit per dimension) using median threshold. The median is used (rather than a fixed value like 0) so the bits split ~50/50, which maximizes the information retained per bit for arbitrarily-centered embeddings.

**Syntax:** `vector.quantizebinary(<vector>)`

**Returns:** ByteArray - Binary quantized vector

```
SELECT vector.quantizebinary([0.1, 0.5, 0.9])
```

---

#### vector.dequantizebinary()

Reconstructs an approximate float vector from a binary-quantized result. Binary quantization keeps only one bit per dimension (the sign relative to the median), so this is lossy: each bit maps to `highValue` (default `1.0`) when set or `lowValue` (default `-1.0`) when clear. Accepts the result of `vector.quantizebinary()` directly.

**Syntax:** `vector.dequantizebinary(<quantized> [, <lowValue>, <highValue>])`

**Returns:** Vector - Reconstructed (sign) vector

```
SELECT vector.dequantizebinary(vector.quantizebinary([0.1, 0.5, 0.9]))
-- Returns: [-1.0, 1.0, 1.0]
```

---

### 21.6.6. Scoring and Fusion

#### vector.hybridscore()

Computes weighted average of two scores.

**Syntax:** `vector.hybridscore(<score1>, <score2>, <alpha>)`

**Returns:** Double - Weighted average

```
SELECT vector.hybridscore(0.8, 0.6, 0.7)
-- Returns: 0.7 * 0.8 + 0.3 * 0.6 = 0.74
```

---

#### vector.multiscore()

Combines multiple scores using a fusion method.

**Syntax:** `vector.multiscore(<scores>, <method>, [weights])`

**Methods:**

- `'MAX'` - Maximum score (ColBERT style)
- `'AVG'` - Arithmetic average
- `'MIN'` - Minimum score
- `'WEIGHTED'` - Weighted average (requires weights)

**Returns:** Double - Combined score

```
SELECT vector.multiscore([0.9, 0.7, 0.8], 'MAX')
-- Returns: 0.9
```

---

#### vector.rrfscore()

Computes Reciprocal Rank Fusion (RRF) for combining multiple rankings.

**Syntax:** `vector.rrfscore(<rank1>, <rank2>, ⋯, [{ k: <long> }])` or `vector.rrfscore([<ranks>], [{ k: <long> }])`

Ranks may be passed as variadic arguments or grouped in a single array/list (consistent with `vector.multiscore`). Every positional numeric argument is treated as a rank. The center constant `k` (default 60) is set only via the trailing options map `{ k: <long> }` - a bare trailing number is always a rank, never `k`.

**Parameters:**

- `k` - Center rank constant (default: 60), via `{ k: <long> }`

**Returns:** Double - RRF score

```
SELECT vector.rrfscore(1, 2, 4)
-- Returns: 1/61 + 1/62 + 1/64

SELECT vector.rrfscore([1, 2, 4], { k: 100 })
-- Returns: 1/101 + 1/102 + 1/104
```

---

#### vector.normalizescores()

Normalizes scores to [0, 1] range using min-max normalization.

**Syntax:** `vector.normalizescores(<scores>)`

**Returns:** Vector - Normalized scores

```
SELECT vector.normalizescores([1.0, 2.0, 3.0])
-- Returns: [0.0, 0.5, 1.0]
```

---

#### vector.scoretransform()

Transforms scores using various functions.

**Syntax:** `vector.scoretransform(<score>, <method>)`

**Methods:**

- `'LINEAR'` - No transformation
- `'SIGMOID'` - Logistic function, maps to (0, 1)
- `'TANH'` - Hyperbolic tangent, maps to (-1, 1)
- `'LOG'` / `'LN'` - Natural logarithm (requires a positive score); `LN` is the clearer synonym
- `'EXP'` - Exponential function

**Returns:** Double - Transformed score

```
SELECT vector.scoretransform(0.5, 'SIGMOID')

SELECT vector.scoretransform(0.5, 'TANH')
-- Returns: 0.4621172

SELECT vector.scoretransform(2.5, 'LN')
-- Returns: 0.9162907  (same as 'LOG')
```

---

## 21.6.7. Similarity and Distance

### vector.dotproduct()

Computes dot product (inner product) between two vectors.

**Syntax:** `vector.dotproduct(<vector1>, <vector2>)`

**Returns:** Double - Dot product

```
SELECT vector.dotproduct([1.0, 2.0, 3.0], [4.0, 5.0, 6.0])
-- Returns: 32.0
```

---

### vector.cosinesimilarity()

Computes cosine similarity between two vectors. Returns value between -1 and 1.

**Syntax:** `vector.cosinesimilarity(<vector1>, <vector2>)`

**Returns:** Double - Cosine similarity (-1 to 1)

```
SELECT vector.cosinesimilarity([1.0, 0.0], [1.0, 0.0])
-- Returns: 1.0 (identical direction)
```

```
SELECT vector.cosinesimilarity([1.0, 0.0], [0.0, 1.0])
-- Returns: 0.0 (orthogonal)
```

---

#### vector.l2distance()

Computes L2 distance (Euclidean distance) between two vectors.

**Syntax:** `vector.l2distance(<vector1>, <vector2>)`

**Returns:** Double - Euclidean distance

```
SELECT vector.l2distance([0.0, 0.0], [3.0, 4.0])
-- Returns: 5.0
```

---

#### vector.approxdistance()

Computes approximate distance between quantized vectors without full dequantization. When you pass the result objects of `vector.quantizeint8()`/`vector.quantizebinary()`, the mode is inferred and the third argument can be omitted; the explicit mode is still required for raw byte arrays.

**Syntax:** `vector.approxdistance(<quantized1>, <quantized2> [, <mode>])`

**Modes:**

- `'INT8'` - Faster than floats; preserves the top-k ordering of the true distances (the approximate scalar distances rank in the same order, even though their absolute values differ). Accepts a `vector.quantizeint8()` result or a raw int8 byte array.
- `'BINARY'` - Very fast Hamming distance, 8x fewer operations. Requires the `vector.quantizebinary()` result object (raw packed bits are not enough - the Hamming normalization needs the original length).

**Returns:** Double - Approximate distance

```
-- mode inferred from the quantization result objects
SELECT vector.approxdistance(
  vector.quantizeint8([1.0, 2.0, 3.0]),
  vector.quantizeint8([1.0, 3.0, 3.0])
)
```

---

### 21.6.8. Sparse Vectors

#### vector.densetosparse()

Converts dense vector to sparse representation.

**Syntax:** `vector.densetosparse(<vector>, [threshold])`

**Parameters:**

- `threshold` - Values below this are considered zero (default: 0.0)

**Returns:** SparseVector - Sparse representation

```
SELECT vector.densetosparse([0.5, 0.0, 0.1], 0.2)
-- Only keeps elements >= 0.2
```

---

#### vector.sparsetodense()

Converts sparse vector back to dense representation.

**Syntax:** `vector.sparsetodense(<sparsevector>)`

**Returns:** Vector - Dense vector

```
SELECT vector.sparsetodense(vector.sparsecreate([0, 2], [0.5, 0.3]))
```

---

#### vector.sparsecreate()

Creates sparse vector from indices and values.

**Syntax:** `vector.sparsecreate(<indices>, <values>, [dimension])`

**Returns:** SparseVector - Sparse vector

```
SELECT vector.sparsecreate([0, 2, 5], [0.5, 0.3, 0.8], 7)
```

---

#### vector.sparsedot()

Computes dot product between two sparse vectors.

**Syntax:** `vector.sparsedot(<sparse1>, <sparse2>)`

**Returns:** Double - Dot product

---

```
SELECT vector.sparsedot(
  vector.densetosparse([1.0, 2.0, 3.0]),
  vector.densetosparse([1.0, 1.0, 1.0])
)
```

---

#### vector.sparsity()

Returns a sparsity measure of a vector. The threshold is optional and defaults to `sqrt(eps)` for float (~3.45e-4). An optional third argument selects the measure.

**Syntax:** `vector.sparsity(<vector> [, <threshold> [, <mode>]])`

**Modes:**

- `'FRACTION'` (default) - fraction of elements with `|x| < threshold`, in [0, 1]
- `'L0'` - the L0 pseudonorm: count of "significant" elements with `|x| >= threshold` (integer)
- `'GMEAN'` - geometric mean of the absolute values, `exp(mean(ln|x|))`; returns 0 if any element is 0

**Returns:** Double (FRACTION, GMEAN) or Integer (L0)

```
SELECT vector.sparsity([0.01, 0.1, 0.05, 0.02], 0.06)
-- Returns: 0.75 (3 of 4 elements are below 0.06)

SELECT vector.sparsity([0.0, 1.0, 2.0, 3.0])
-- Returns: 0.25 (uses the default threshold; one near-zero element)

SELECT vector.sparsity([0.0, 1.0, 2.0, 3.0], 0.5, 'L0')
-- Returns: 3 (three significant elements)

SELECT vector.sparsity([1.0, 2.0, 4.0], 0.0, 'GMEAN')
-- Returns: 2.0 (geometric mean)
```

---

### 21.6.9. Statistics

#### vector.variance()

Computes variance of vector elements.

**Syntax:** `vector.variance(<vector>)`

**Returns:** Double - Variance

```
SELECT vector.variance([1.0, 2.0, 3.0])
```

#### vector.stddev()

Computes standard deviation of vector elements.

**Syntax:** `vector.stddev(<vector>)`

**Returns:** Double - Standard deviation

```
SELECT vector.stddev([1.0, 2.0, 3.0])
```

#### vector.hasnan()

Checks if vector contains NaN values. A `NULL` element (e.g. produced by an invalid math op such as `sqrt(-1.0)` that the engine coerces to `NULL` inside a collection) is treated as NaN.

**Syntax:** `vector.hasnan(<vector>)`

**Returns:** Boolean - true if contains NaN

```
SELECT vector.hasnan([1.0, 2.0, 3.0])
-- Returns: false

SELECT vector.hasnan([1.0, sqrt(-1.0), 3.0])
-- Returns: true (the NULL element counts as NaN)
```

#### vector.hasinf()

Checks if vector contains infinity values. A `NULL` element is treated as NaN, which is not infinite, so it does not trigger a true result.

**Syntax:** `vector.hasinf(<vector>)`

**Returns:** Boolean - true if contains infinity

```
SELECT vector.hasinf([1.0, 10e400, 2.0])
-- Returns: true
```

#### vector.hasnull()

Checks if a vector contains any `NULL` element. Unlike `vector.hasnan()`, this distinguishes a genuine `NULL` (a missing element) from a NaN float value. Primitive `float[]`/`double[]`/`int[]`/`long[]` inputs can

never hold a `NULL` and therefore always return `false`.

**Syntax:** `vector.hasnull(<vector>)`

**Returns:** Boolean - true if contains a NULL element

```
SELECT vector.hasnull([1.0, 2.0, 3.0])
-- Returns: false

SELECT vector.hasnull([1.0, sqrt(-1.0), 3.0])
-- Returns: true
```

---

## 21.6.10. Utility Functions

### vector.tostring()

Converts vector to string representation. Equivalent to the `asString()` method on a vector value (e.g. `embedding.asString('PYTHON')`); both share the same formatter.

**Syntax:** `vector.tostring(<vector>, [format])`

**Formats:**

- `'COMPACT'` - Single line `[1.0, 2.0, 3.0]` (default)
- `'PRETTY'` - Multi-line with formatting
- `'PYTHON'` - Python list format
- `'MATLAB'` - space-separated row vector `[1.0 2.0 3.0]`
- `'MATLAB_COLUMN'` - semicolon-separated column vector `[1.0; 2.0; 3.0]`
- `'JULIA'` - Julia vector literal `[1.0, 2.0, 3.0]`
- `'NUMPY'` - bare comma-separated `1.0, 2.0, 3.0` (no brackets), for `numpy.fromstring(…, sep=",")`

**Returns:** String - Formatted vector

```
SELECT vector.tostring([0.5, 0.25, 0.75], 'PYTHON')

SELECT vector.tostring([0.5, 0.25, 0.75], 'NUMPY')
-- Returns: 0.5, 0.25, 0.75
```

---